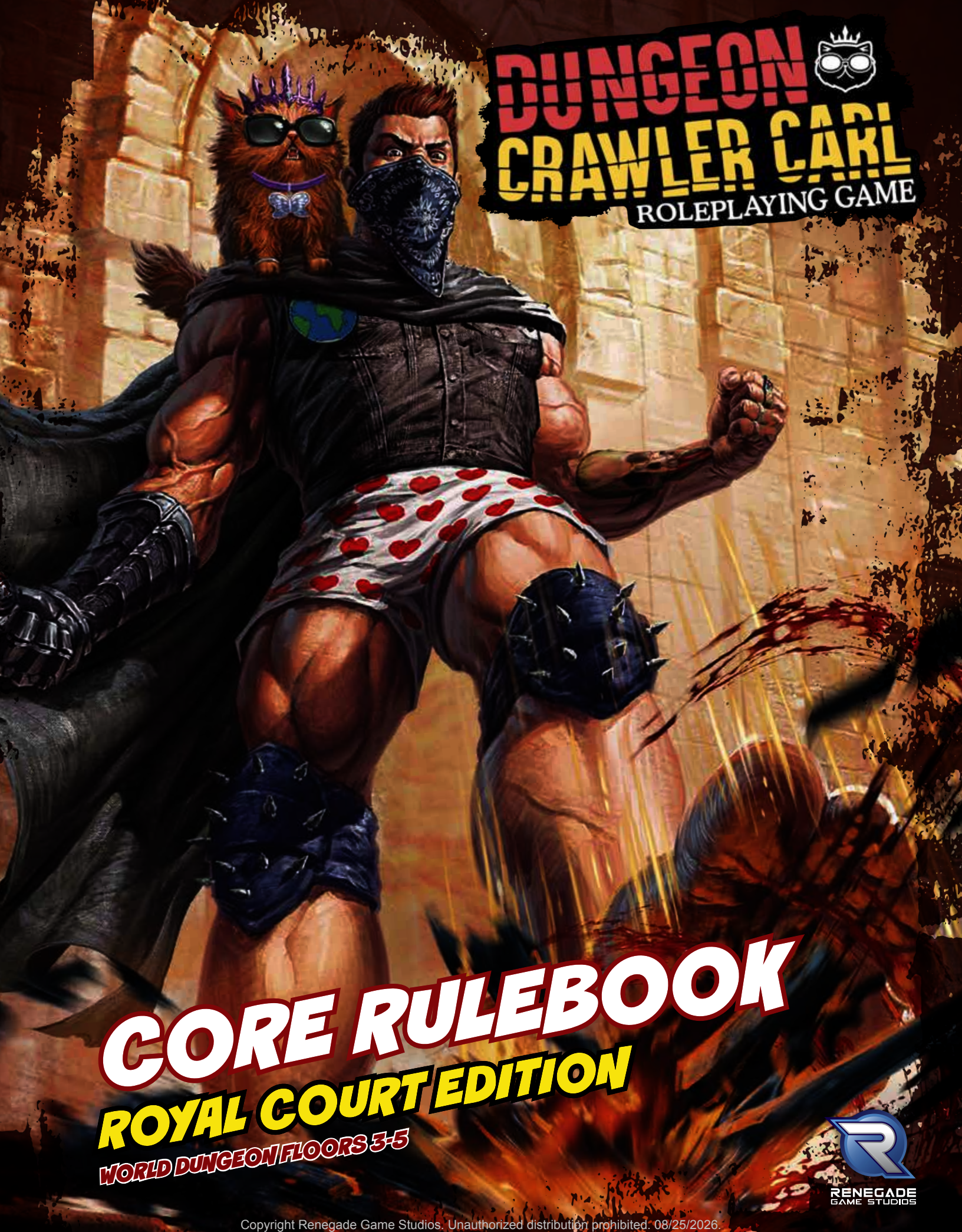

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THE APOCALYPSE WILL BE TELEVISED

The Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Core Rulebook: Royal Court Edition is your ultimate guide to the third, fourth, and fifth floors of the World Dungeon as they appear in Matt Dinniman's bestselling LitRPG series, **Dungeon Crawler Carl**! Whether you're a total gaming pro jumping in on the third floor or continuing your Crawl from the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Starter Set***, enjoy a smorgasbord of character customization options, rules for running the game, a mountain of adventure material, and more! So whaddya say? Are you ready to fight mobs, battle bosses, and blow shit up in true Carl fashion? What am I saying? Of course you are!

Now get out there and kill, kill, kill!

This book contains:

- Characters and locations from the first four **Dungeon Crawler Carl** novels
- A step-by-step guide to creating your own crawler
- 30 ready-to-play races and 49 ready-to-play classes to choose from during character creation
- Dozens of skills and spells with which to equip your crawler
- Tools for building your own races, classes, skills, & spells
- Rules for pets, mounts, & crafting
- Game Master advice for running the game
- Details on interview shows, gods, sponsors, & more
- 26 easy-prep neighborhoods & quests to fill your World Dungeon with mobs, bosses, & traps
- All the rules you need to explore the World Dungeon, all in one book

The *Core Rulebook* and *Starter Set* work together: You can use spells, skills, and rules in this book to supplement exploring the tutorial floors of the World Dungeon. Alternatively, you can use the Starter Set to play through the tutorial floors, then continue your adventures on the third floor with this *Core Rulebook*.

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DUNGEON CRAWLER CARL ROLEPLAYING GAME

ROYAL COURT EDITION

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DUNGEON CRAWLER CARL ROLEPLAYING GAME

ROYAL COURT EDITION

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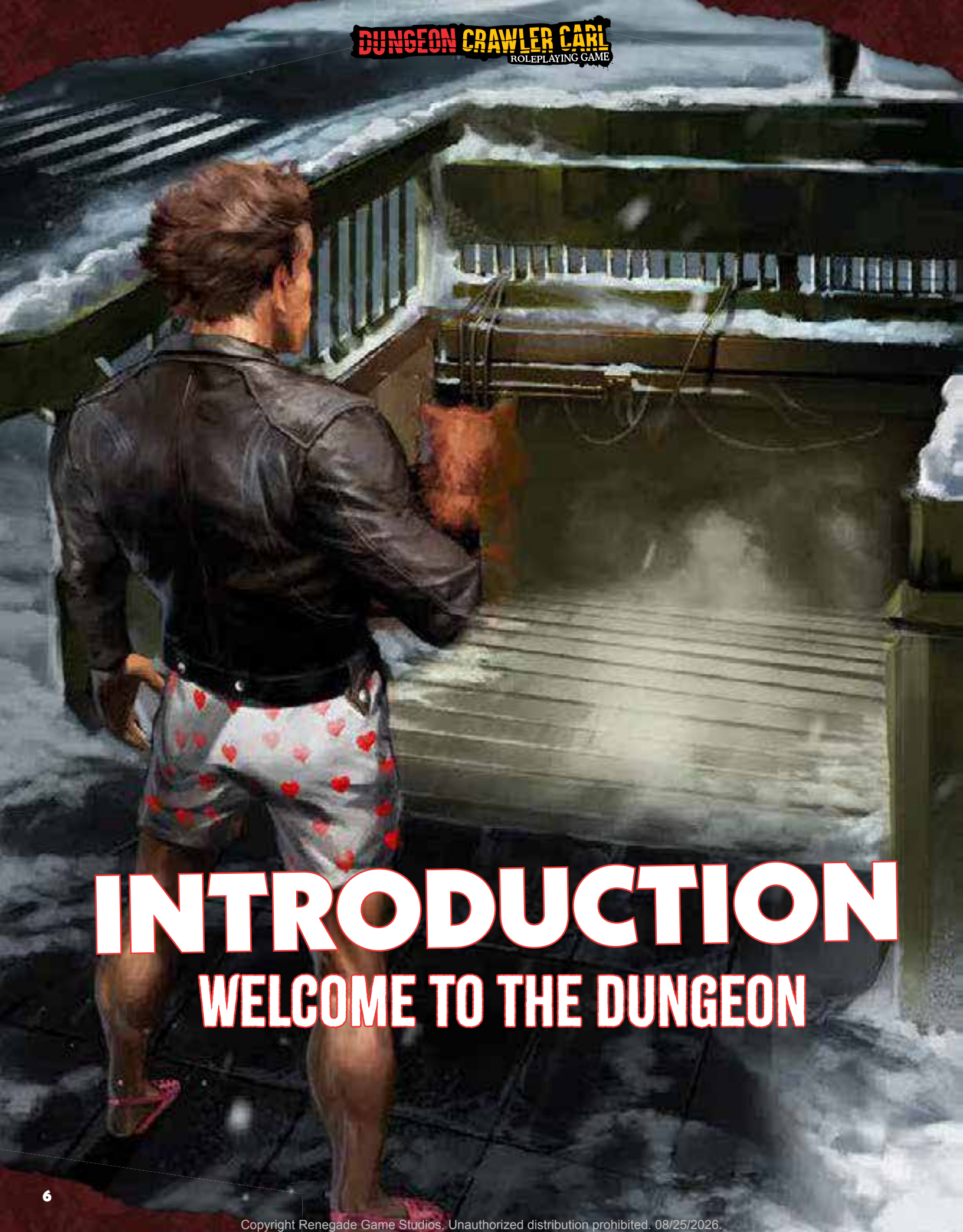

INTRODUCTION

WELCOME TO THE DUNGEON

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"I won't be able to talk to you until after you're done with the race and class selection. I guess I'll see you guys on the other side. Good luck."

—Zev

Welcome to the dungeon.

Or, more accurately, welcome to the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**.

Oooh boy, are you in for it now.

This book is your guide to surviving your crawler's fitful first steps, and it provides rules for both players portraying crawlers fighting (and sometimes failing) to survive, and the Game Master (GM) who is orchestrating the chaos. Where the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set*** focuses on the eponymous novel *Dungeon Crawler Carl* (and the First and Second Floors of the World Dungeon), this *Core Rulebook* focuses on *Carl's Doomsday Scenario* (the Third Floor), *The Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* (the Fourth Floor), and *The Gate of the Feral Gods* (the Fifth Floor). The two are designed to work together. Synergy!

Your characters from the Tutorial Floors can start the Third Floor with their Race and Class selection, then explore the Over City. With this book, you can also just start your game in the Over City and skip playing the Tutorial Floors, whether or not this is your first foray into the World Dungeon.

If you're confused, don't worry! The System AI is delighted by your consternation, but everything you need can be found in this book—assuming you live long enough to find the information you need to survive. There are nine chapters just bursting with goodies. And bursting with other things, too! Organs, rusty nails, flesh-eating maggots...

Chapter 1: Atlas gives a brief introduction to the world of **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** and refreshes your memory on what happened in the novels (ooooh).

Chapter 2: Playing the Game covers the rules of play for both players and GMs (ahhhh).

Chapter 3: Character Creation guides players through creating a crawler and Third Floor Race and Class selection.

Chapter 4: Skills, Spells, and Gear provides dozens of Skills and Spells with which to equip your crawlers, as well as rules for pets, mounts, and crafting. That way they drop loot when they die!

Chapter 5: Gamemastering the Dungeon advises GMs on their unique role as well as the nuts and bolts of running Neighborhoods and Quests and creating custom Mobs and Bosses.

Chapter 6: Story Elements details some of the weirder aspects of the game for GMs, including Popularity, sending crawlers on interview shows, worshiping Gods, gaining Patrons and Sponsors. There is also information on some key items and experiences that will tie the players' crawlers into the wider world of **Dungeon Crawler Carl**.

Neighborhoods and Quests fill the final three chapters—**Chapter 7: The Over City**, **Chapter 8: The Iron Tangle**, and **Chapter 9: The Bubbles**. These provide GMs with a lot of easy-to-prepare fodder to craft hours and hours of ~~psychological torture~~ Immersive Entertainment™ on these floors.

Three appendices round out this book. **Appendix 1 and 2** present stats for Carl, Donut, their gear, and friends. **Appendix 3** provides suggestions for using achievements.

WELCOME, CRAWLER, TO THE THIRD FLOOR

You took that fateful step into the World Dungeon. You survived the Tutorial Floors. Now you enter the hush of a vaulted golden corridor. At the end of the plush red carpet is a door... where you will meet, then say goodbye to, your Game Guide after you select a Race and Class.

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You've begun to master this confusing place; its interface, rules, and jargon. You survived the apocalypse and the culling of the Tutorial Floors, and now you are an indentured contestant in the largest and cruelest reality TV show in the galaxy. To survive, you will need to leverage every talent and every ounce of willpower you possess. You cannot let them break you. One of you will play as the GM, that strange, disembodied voice that describes your fate and that led you here in the first place. If you're playing as the GM, you can skim through this section of the manual, or you may want to skip ahead to the Rules in Chapter 2: Playing the Game, advice for being a GM in Chapter 5: Running the Game, or check out the twisted and deadly Neighborhoods and Quests in Chapters 7, 8, or 9.

Oh, and by the way: congratulations! As GM, you are certified by Borant to torment your players' crawlers (but not the players themselves) with all manner of deadly and bizarre nonsense. It's a gift that keeps on giving.

As for the rest of you?

Hold on to your butts. Shit's about to get weird(er).

ROLEPLAYING GAME? WHAT'S THAT?

A roleplaying game is a cooperative social group activity with rules that use imagination, improvisation, and a random element—usually dice—to tell stories. In this game, those stories are set in the world of **Dungeon Crawler Carl**, the loveable but mutated brainchild of the one and only Matt Dinniman.

Rather than play through the events of the novels, the players together decide the details of their characters and serve as the creative designers of their own version of the story.

Throughout the story, one player takes the role of the Game Master while the other players become protagonists working together to survive the perils of Borant's World Dungeon... or is it Valtay's World Dungeon now? That's up to you! As they play, the GM presents the players with challenges for their crawlers to overcome by exploring the dungeon, socializing with many non-player characters (NPCs), and wreaking incredible violence on monster Mobs, Bosses, and even gods (probably best to avoid the latter as long as possible, though).

In many ways, listening to a roleplaying game can feel like listening to an audiobook. The GM uses spoken descriptions to paint a picture of the environment and the objects and creatures within it. Players may ask clarifying questions and then describe the Actions their characters take, often going beyond just what each *player character* (PC) tries to accomplish, to how they intend to do it, and with what.

The GM and all the players listen to what everyone is saying, so they're aware of the full situation. Of course, unlike a scripted audiobook, the outcome of encounters in an RPG is neither decided by a single person nor is it decided in advance. Instead, a combination of what the rules make possible, what the players decide to attempt, and what results the dice provide creates situations that no one, not even the GM, can anticipate in advance.

TOO MANY "LEVELS"

In the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** novels, the term *level* refers to a crawler character's experience level, Skill level, and dungeon level. In the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, we've separated this into different terms to keep things clear:

Level: Character experience level.

Rank: Skill level.

Floor: Refers to the depth of the dungeon. As crawlers descend deeper into the World Dungeon, they move to "lower floors." Higher floors are closer to the surface of the planet. The letter *F* is a common abbreviation for the current Floor Number (for example, on the Third Floor, F is 3).

You'll find a few exceptions related to quoting or referencing the novels.

PLAYING THE GAME

In the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, your group shares the narrative of your own World Dungeon, imagining the heroes, Mobs, Bosses, and evil intergalactic corporations in play. In this game, the action takes place in your mind and on the game table, and it looks like this:

Joe (as the GM): After hours of grinding in this mossy submerged section of the dungeon, your party emerges onto dry land.

Paige (as Brayden): Thank the gods... my wrinkles were starting to get wrinkles. I forgot what it's like to be dry.

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Ben (as Kai): I don't think we're out of the woods yet, but we've got—how long have we got until the floor collapses? It's not long.

Koda (as Beatrix): You know you can check your HUD, right?

Andrew (as Isabella): Yeah, but he likes asking you.

Ron (as Park): It doesn't help that Beatrix has been the official party timekeeper since we got to this floor.

Joe: You have 12 hours remaining, so you all need to find a stairwell soon. The dry area you've emerged into is made of dark stone, with statues of Kua-Tin warriors lining a wide passageway that leads to a pair of immense metal doors.

Paige: Hiii Zev!

Ben: Something fishy's going on here. Ron, you want to cover us while we check for traps? Isabella, take the front. Brayden, stay back. We don't have time for you to set off another trap and get turned into a hamster again.

Joe: Ron, there are clear sight lines for Park to cover the team. Andrew, how is Isabella checking for traps?

Andrew: I'm going to check out the statues first. That's Intelligence and Detect Trap to check, right?

Joe: Yep!

Andrew: Ooh, a nice roll. That's an 18 for my total!

Joe: The good news is that you notice the statues start to move just as the watery passage you came through ices over, blocking your way out. You've got one Action before the scene freezes as you hear the notes of the Boss Battle music start to play.

The game continues from there with the GM setting the scene and challenges, the players acting as their protagonists, and the dice helping to tell the story.

CHOOSE YOUR ROLE

To play the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game***, you'll gather with others to tell an exciting story in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** universe. The first step is choosing whether you'll take part as a player representing one of the story's protagonists (taking on roles like Carl or Donut) or the Game Master who narrates the scene and plays the other characters, ranging from the friendly saferoom Bopcas to the sadistic System AI, which we all know is the best role.

Together, your group will come up with the basics of what kind of **Dungeon Crawler Carl** story you'd like to tell, what your characters are good at, their internal struggles, how they push the envelope to earn views and fans, and other details.

The game can even be played solo. If you're a masochist and have too much time on your hands, you can grab this book and play with yourself for hours. I hear that's popular these days.

BEING A PLAYER

As a player, you take on the role of a crawler in the story. To do so, you can:

- **Create a Character:** Create your own crawler to play in the game. You decide your character's actions, embody them in roleplay, and keep track of your Stats, Skills, Spells, gear, and achievements. If you'd rather play as characters from the books, Appendix 2 provides some basic stats you can use to flesh those characters out as your own.
- **Form a Party:** Work together with other players and form your party. A tight team that works together has the best chance for survival, especially on the early floors. Your party can be a group that already knows each other, like team Meadow Lark, a group that forms in the dungeon for the sake of protection, or a mix, like the Royal Court of Princess Donut.
- **Survive the Dungeon and Find the Stairwells:** In play, you'll face the dungeon together, dealing with Mobs, traps, and NPCs. On each floor, you'll face new challenges and work together to overcome the dungeon—or die trying.
- **Level Up and Grow:** As you explore the dungeon, you'll gain character Levels, learn new Skills or rank up the ones you already have, master new Spells, and accumulate various traumas and regrets.
- **Build Your Legend:** You're a gladiator, baby. Surviving the dungeon isn't just about living through the fights. It's about looking cool and getting famous while doing it.

You'll need to act recklessly, go overboard, and bend the rules to get views, fans, and, hopefully, Sponsors. In other words, YOLO. If you're too old or classy to know what YOLO means... *carpe diem*, I guess.

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BEING THE GAME MASTER

As a GM, you fill in the world around and beyond the players' characters. To do so, you:

- **Guide the Story:** The GM is the narrator for the story. You set the scene, from the dungeon to the talk shows and the corporations battling for supremacy in the *Dungeon Crawler World* storyline. When the players act, you decide how the dungeon or galaxy reacts.
- **Populate the Dungeon:** In addition to the narration, you'll play all the other characters (NPCs) that the protagonists interact with, including other crawlers played by the GM (called GMCs). NPCs will include merciless Mobs, brutal Bosses, non-hostile characters and allies, Elite stars, alien talk show hosts, and the System AI itself.
- **Decide on Rules:** The rules presented in this book cover most situations you and your players will experience in the dungeon. Where there's ambiguity or a question, you determine the ruling to keep the action moving.
- **Run Floors and Quests:** Chapters 7, 8, and 9 have everything you need to flesh out the Floors and encounters. See *Neighborhoods and Quests* (p. 262) for advice on using Neighborhoods and Quests.
- **Interview Crawlers:** Chapter 6 has everything you need to flesh out interview shows, the highlights reel, track a crawler's popularity, and the rest.
- **Sew the Seeds of Conflict:** Chapter 6 also provides rules for integrating gods, Patrons, other NPCs, and giving out items that tie the players' crawlers into the story of the World Dungeon. Most of these are delectable items on the Third, Fourth, and Fifth Floors: Donut's Enchanted Crown of the Sepsis Whore, the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook,* or the Enchanted Nightwyrm's Ring of Divine Suffering, for example. They're seeds you can use to plant conflict you can reap on later floors.

> ***"Gotta say. This has just about ruined my lady boner for you, boss. I'm not into this roleplay stuff."***
>
> **—Hedy**

DISCUSS BEFORE YOU PLAY

Before you start playing, talk about what topics are cool and what's out of bounds for your group. The **Dungeon Crawler Carl** novels address a lot of heavy subjects that not everyone may want to deal with if you're playing the World Dungeon as a light fantasy escape game.

This can range from general topics like abandonment issues, to specifics like changing spider-like Mobs to another type of monster to accommodate a player with arachnophobia. Setting these boundaries early ensures safe and fun gameplay for everyone. But please don't remove the spiders if you can help it. They keep the Festering Brain-Burrower population in check.

RHYTHM OF PLAY

The three main ways the crawlers can engage with the World Dungeon boils down to **social interaction, exploration, and combat**. Whichever one you're experiencing, the game unfolds according to this basic pattern:

1. ***The Game Master Describes a Scene:*** The GM tells the players where their crawlers are and what's around them (how many doors lead out of a room, what's on a table, and so on).
2. ***The Players Describe What Their Crawlers Do:*** Typically, the characters stick together as they travel through battlefields and other environments. Sometimes different characters do different Actions: one character might search through files, while a second examines a stack of books, and a third keeps watch for enemies. Outside of combat, the GM ensures that every character has a chance to act and decides how to resolve their activity. In combat, the characters take Actions, and dice rolls inform the outcome of their Actions.

In certain situations—particularly combat—the action is more structured, and everyone takes Actions (capital A) at different parts of a round. The rest of the time, the characters are free to act in the dungeon environment.

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A Note from the Dungeon Admins

Hello Crawlers!

This is just a short note for anyone who might be apprehensive about the contents of this game book.

If you've read the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** novels without pissing yourself, nothing in this book will shock you. Even if you've just listened to the first half of the first audiobook or an episode of the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Audio Immersion Tunnel***, you've probably got a good idea.

That being said, there are sensitive topics in this book. The dungeon is a funhouse mirror of everything the Syndicate uses to justify flattening Earth like a pancake, then transmuting the ruins into a planet-sized game-show-slash-torture-park. It takes the worst traits of humanity, concentrates them, and applies them to crawlers and Mobs alike.

Some of these lovely qualities include:

- Dishonesty and manipulation
- Addiction, alcoholism, and substance abuse
- Kidnapping
- Bugs, spiders, rats, and other vermin of any and every size
- Climate change and harm to the environment
- Harm to animals
- Corruption, political or otherwise
- Racism and sexism
- A lot of violence, gory (eyeballs, teeth, total dismemberment) or not
- Reliving past trauma and traumatic events
- Mental illness
- The apocalypse and post-apocalyptic events
- Ableism
- Clowns
- Cannibalism
- Parasites entering a body
- Genitals and genital-related jokes

That is by no means an extensive list, but it should give you an idea of what you're getting yourselves into. Maybe none of these things bother or upset you, which is great! But there are lots of people who appreciate the warning and opportunity to say something like, "Love all the gory descriptions, but can we go a bit lighter on the eyeball stuff?"

Let this page serve as a general "Warning for Potentially Upsetting Content" to discuss with everyone at the table. Make sure to keep a gauge on your emotions and reactions. If you ever feel the need to step away, go ahead!

TTRPGs and all of gaming should allow folks to experience fantastical worlds without the weight of the real world if that's what folks want. Maybe you want an emotionally rough World Dungeon and to learn some truths about yourself or your crawler. Maybe you just want to be the hero and don't want to think about your dreary 9-to-5 outside of this. Both of these are valid goals and can be played at the same table with good communication.

It's better to punch up than down; You never know what someone is going through or has gone through and how they'll respond.

Now, as always, get out there and kill, kill, kill!

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3. ***The GM Narrates the Results of the Crawlers' Actions:*** Sometimes resolving a task is easy. If a character walks across a room and tries to open a door, the GM might say the door opens and describe what lies beyond. But the door might be locked, it may have a dastardly trap that goes off when opened, or some other circumstance might make it challenging for a crawler to complete a task.

   In those cases, the GM might ask the player to perform a Skill Check to help determine what happens. Describing the results often leads to another decision point, which brings the game back to Step 1.

This pattern holds true during every game session (each time you sit down to play the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**), whether the crawlers are gathering information from an Elite, infiltrating a Boss's lair, or fighting for their lives against endless waves of Mobs—and yes, sometimes they are *literally* endless.

In certain situations—particularly combat—the action is more structured, and everyone takes Actions at different parts of a round. The rest of the time, the characters are free to act in the dungeon environment.

EXCEPTIONS BEAT GENERAL RULES

General rules govern each part of the game. For example, the combat rules tell you that melee attacks use Strength and ranged attacks use Dexterity. That's a general rule, and a general rule remains in effect as long as something in the game doesn't explicitly say otherwise.

The game also includes elements—Skill benefits, Spells, magic items, and the like—that sometimes contradict a general rule. When an exception and a general rule disagree, the exception wins. For example, if a feature says you can use your Cha Mod when using certain Skills, you can do so, even though that statement disagrees with the general rule. Just don't choose a Hobgoblin Race and expect your Charisma Stat to help anything at all.

BEFORE STARTING PLAY

The setting of **Dungeon Crawler Carl** is rough, bleak, and full of fucked-up shit (honestly—how many readers have been brought to tears at one point or another?), but it's also a place where weird and hilarious shenanigans happen all the time. To ensure you're creating a story that everyone feels welcome to join in the fun, consider the following and remember that it's the crawlers who are supposed to suffer, not the players.

PLAYING NICE

Tabletop roleplaying games, including the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, are social activities. Just like team sports, family dinners, school projects, or work, sometimes it takes a bit of effort at the table to ensure everyone becomes and stays friends. Many groups don't explicitly form to make new friends, but without keeping an eye on camaraderie and everyone's limits, game groups can fall apart easily. Even for folks who've read the series and expect the same off-beat humor and tone, they may get tired of quips about killing their mother or illicit butthole money jokes. You can set a novel down, but it's harder to take a break from a game in progress.

While the System AI might be an asshole, that doesn't mean you should be. If you're the GM, you're probably the leader at the table. It's important

> ***"Party members shared experience and were able to access a group chat feature. Anyone who entered the dungeon at the same time as anyone else was automatically grouped together, and as a result, I had a party of two. Me and Donut."***
>
> **—Carl**

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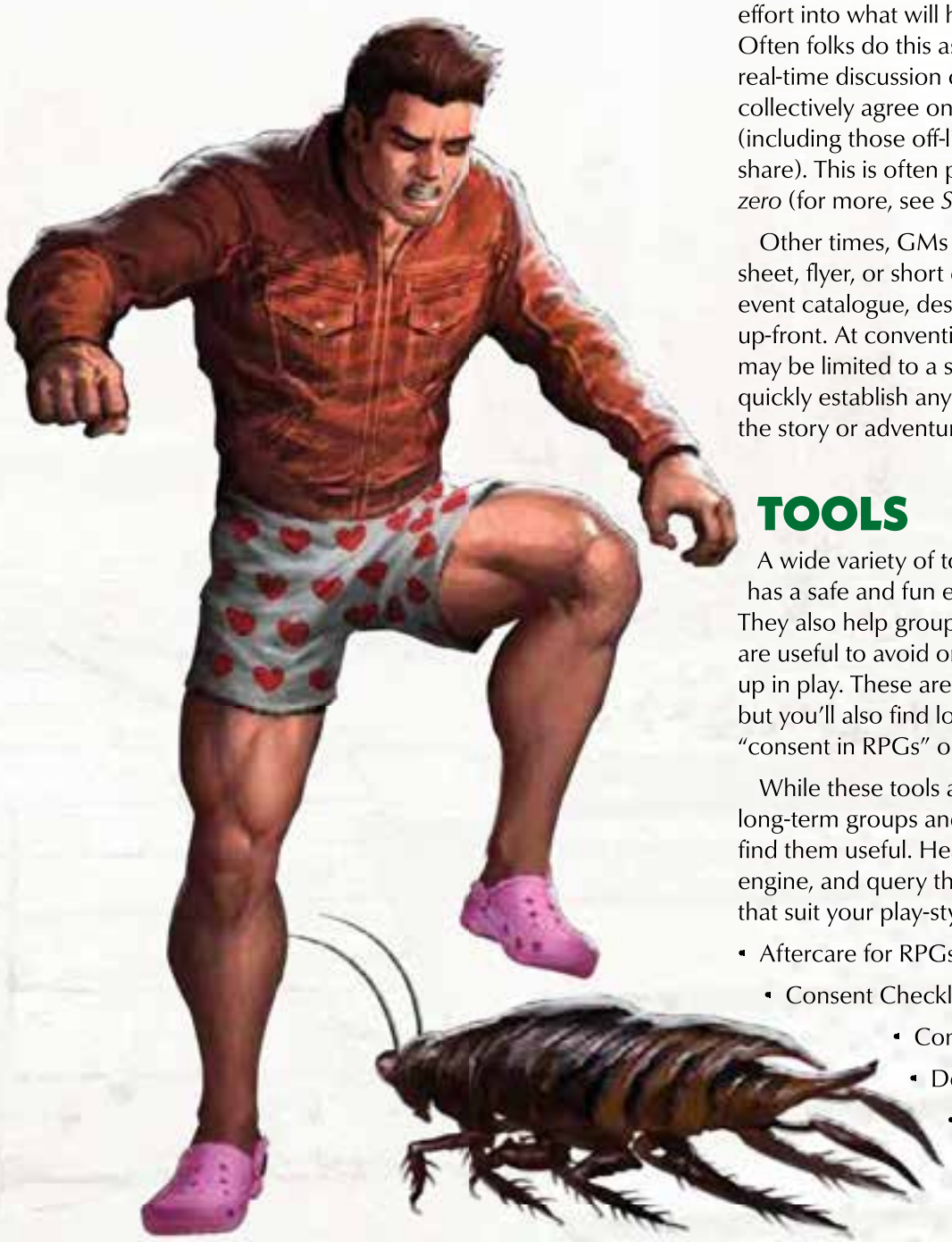
to smush any asshole-like behavior. Every player (including you) should feel free to be themselves and tell the kind of story they enjoy.

MAKE A PARTY, NOT JUST A CHARACTER

As players, it's your job to make a character that will work with the group. Unless the table decides otherwise, it's good to assume that neither players nor their crawlers should hate one another, try to (intentionally) get on another's nerves, or act maliciously (stealing from, attacking, or otherwise sabotaging) toward other party members. Saying you're just "playing your character" is not a valid excuse to act this way. Having said that: if the rest of the players all agree that it'll be fun for them if you play that character as a terminal butthole who menaces them at every turn, then you're all on the same page and it's not an issue. But make sure you get out-of-character consent beforehand, and check in periodically.



STARTING A CAMPAIGN

When you begin a **Dungeon Crawler Carl** campaign or just play a one-off game, it's worth putting an effort into what will help everyone enjoy that game. Often folks do this as a group discussion (either a real-time discussion or via chat and email) so they can collectively agree on what the game might involve (including those off-limit topics for people ready to share). This is often part of what's called a *session zero* (for more, see *Session Zero*, p. 246).

Other times, GMs recruit players with a campaign sheet, flyer, or short description in a convention event catalogue, describing non-negotiable elements up-front. At conventions or game store events, you may be limited to a short paragraph, but you can quickly establish any ground rules before beginning the story or adventure.

TOOLS

A wide variety of tools can help ensure everyone has a safe and fun experience at the game table. They also help groups get onto the same page and are useful to avoid or resolve problems that come up in play. These are often called "RPG safety tools," but you'll also find lots of options if you search for "consent in RPGs" or "considerate play in RPGs."

While these tools are most helpful for new groups, long-term groups and experienced gamers can still find them useful. Head online to your favorite search engine, and query the following terms to find the tools that suit your play-style and campaign needs:

- Aftercare for RPGs
- Consent Checklists for RPGs
- Consent in Gaming
- Deck of Player Safety
- Lines and Veils
- The X-Card

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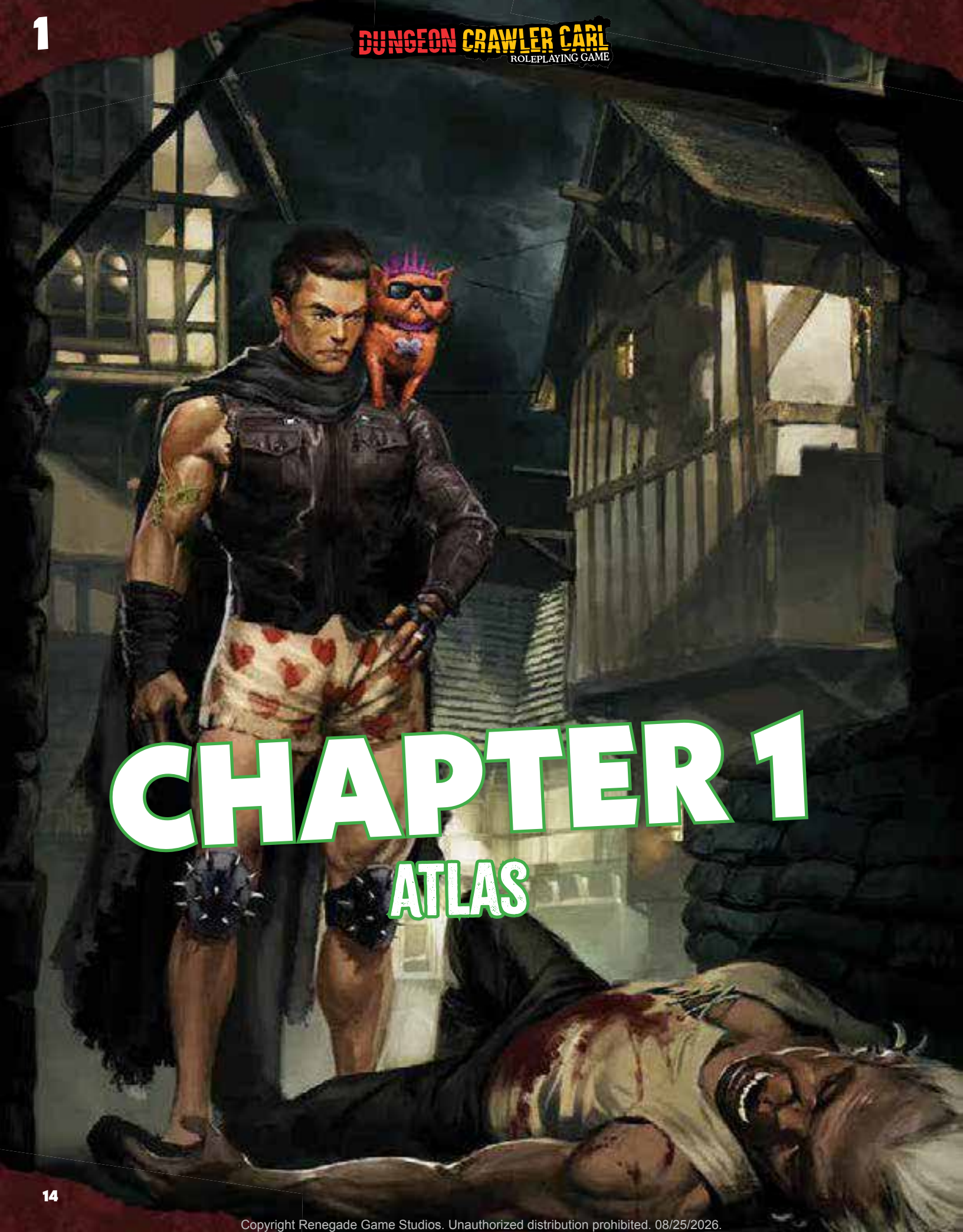
DUNGEON CRAWLER CARL
ROLEPLAYING GAME



CHAPTER 1

ATLAS

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Tuesday, January 3rd 2:23 AM, Pacific Standard Time

Surviving Humans Take Note:

The Apocalypse WILL be Televised...

And YOU will be the star of the show.

Per Syndicate rules, subsection 543 of the Precious Elemental Reserves Code, having failed to file a proper appeal for mineral and elemental rights within 50 Solars of first contact, your planet has been successfully seized and is currently being mined of all requested elemental deposits by the assigned planetary regent, the Borant Corporation.

As per the Indigenous Planetary Species Protection Act, you and your fellow survivors have the opportunity to reclaim your lost planet. As your regent, The Borant Corporation is allowed to choose the manner of this reclamation, and they have chosen the 18-Level World Dungeon.

Welcome to Dungeon Crawler World, meatsacks.

We've punched every building into your planet's crust and repurposed all of it to create a labyrinth of galactic proportions. Every structure that had a roof is now being reengineered to build the world below. Once the game starts, you'll face Mobs of all shapes and sizes, battle Boss monsters, complete quests, obtain items and upgrades, and develop new skills. If you do it all with a little panache, you might just survive long enough to make a splash in the ratings pool.

The bigger your presence, the more rewards you get. And the more rewards you get, the easier it is to survive. So don't just stab that monster; cut him into itty bitty pieces and bathe in his blood! Or even better, place your delectably bare foot down on its fragile skull and just... slowly... crush it. And then... mmm... smear it around a bit. Yes, just like that. Daddy's gonna need a cigarette.

Scared to go it alone? Bring a friend or six. We encourage parties of all sizes–at least at first. And even if you don't know a single surviving soul, plenty of other Humans are lucky enough to have joined the crawl along with you–just under 13 million, in fact.

The first level of the World Dungeon will open approximately 18 seconds after the end of this announcement. Once the entrances are closed, you may no longer enter. If you enter, you may not leave until you have either completed all 18 levels of the World Dungeon or if you meet certain other requirements.

If you choose to enter the game, you must find a stairwell to descend to the next floor down. If you don't find one in time... let's just say you'll get to join all the other lifeforms included in your planet's "reclaimable matter".

Once you enter the World Dungeon, I highly recommended you find and utilize a tutorial guild. Multiple tutorial guilds will be seeded throughout the dungeon on floors one through three.

If you have any additional questions, or if you wish to file an appeal, such requests must be submitted in writing directly to the closest Syndicate office, approximately 18 light-years from your native planet.

Thank you for being a part of the Syndicate. Have a great day.

–The System AI

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THE WORLD DUNGEON

An ornate staircase leads down into the light. Each step appears to be made of wrought iron, carved in an odd pattern depicting what could've been fish—or maybe demons. The staircase is wide enough to accommodate twenty people walking side by side. Glowing warmth radiates from the opening, coaxing you closer, deeper.

The metal stairs end at a marble floor and a hulking door that stands about thirty feet tall and just as wide. The arched wooden door is carved in the shape of a massive fish demon, just like the stairs.

The door opens easily inward, revealing a long hallway...

Will you go inside?

THE CRAWLER INTERFACE

As soon as you made the questionable decision to go into the light, your whole outlook on life changed. And while I do mean philosophically (unless you were a serial killer before—if so, congrats!), I also mean literally: the World Dungeon sharpens all of your senses and grants you a variety of new ways of seeing the world through the wonderful lens of augmented reality.

That's because of something we call an "enhancement zone." Now you can do all sorts of things to help you live longer, run faster, hit harder, and even see better—as long as you've got the proper wetware installed.

Fortunately, you do. All organics from worlds seeded with Primal Engines are born with it.

Not only does the enhancement zone give you a chance to experience what being upgraded feels like (it's a rush, ain't it?), but it also gives you access to more information than you'd normally be able to interpret.

Basically, you've finally got reliable wetware in addition to that lump of fat and salt in your skull.

Upon entering the World Dungeon, a crawler retains all their typical senses (though that may change during Race Selection upon reaching the Third Floor). However, they also gain a few new ones, and those may require some getting used to. The most important of these is your Heads-Up Display (HUD).

SPOILERS

The ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Core Rulebook*** contains spoilers for the first four novels and, frankly, light spoilers for the whole series. If you haven't read *Dungeon Crawler Carl*, *Carl's Doomsday Scenario*, *The Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* and *The Gate of the Feral Gods*, you might want to stop reading after *Popularity* on p. 24.

THE HEADS-UP DISPLAY

The HUD appears across the crawler's vision. Two of the most essential elements displayed are their Mana Bar, which displays their current

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TABLE 1: HUD

HUD ELEMENT	INDICATION	NOTES
Health Bar	Shows a crawler's damage level	Decreases from right to left. Green from 100% to 66%; Yellow from 66% to 33%; Red from 33% to 0%.
Overhead Map	Map of a Neighborhood, Borough, etc.	Often lootable from Bosses. Certain Skills give greater map access.
Green Dot	Self	
Blue Dot	Other crawlers (controlled by players or the GM)	—
Red Dot	Hostile NPCs such as Mobs and Bosses	—
White Dot	Non-Hostile NPCs	—
Purple Dot	Non-crawler or non-residents of the dungeon (like Hunters or other tourists)	—
Orange Dot	Pets and Familiars	—
White with a Green X	Minion (or Mercenary)	—
Black X	Corpses turn to a black X, and if you hover over it, it'll tell you who it is if you're close enough. But otherwise it's a mystery.	✕
Cross instead of Dot	Elites	✚ instead of ●
Star instead of Dot	Important NPCs	★ instead of ●
Spinning, Pulsing Star instead of Dot	God	Animated ★ instead of ●
White Square	Stairs	□ instead of ●
Skull over Crawler's Head	Killed a crawler. One skull per crawler killed.	—
Golden Skull over Crawler's Head	Killed a leaderboard crawler. One golden skull per leaderboard crawler killed.	—
Star over Crawler's Head	Killed a Boss	—

magical reserves, and their Health Bar, which shows how close a crawler is to death (green is good, red is dead—or close to it, anyway).

The HUD also includes windows and screens displaying a crawler's Stats, Inventory, tooltips, and system messages that automatically pop up whenever the crawler receives an announcement, notification, or achievement.

By default, these appear in the center of the crawler's field of view until minimized. However, crawlers can modify their HUD settings to make these larger or smaller, add or remove elements (such as the View Counter), and otherwise customize it to their preferences.

All of these are controlled simply with a crawler's mind and attention. Early on, many crawlers find they prefer the virtual keyboard option, and most grow to prefer it when mentally typing any messages.

THE MINIMAP

The feature that takes up the most space on a crawler's HUD is typically the minimap. Crawlers begin most floors with an empty map, which fills in as they explore the dungeon. Different Mobs and important landmarks appear on the minimap in different colors and shapes (see Table 1, above, which I've attached for your convenience... you're welcome, by the way).

This is not a radar system that helps avoid ambushes. Invisible, hiding, or stealthy Mobs may not appear on your minimap until you are right on top of them. A crawler can mentally zoom in or out on their minimap. The standard HUD minimap shows a quarter of a square mile around you. If you've already received information on a Mob or

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one of the floor-specific map upgrades, such as the Neighborhood Map or Field Guide, larger sections may already be filled in, or Mob and crawler names appear above the appropriate symbols.

Wise crawlers learn what these mean early on. Unwise crawlers usually die, so there's no point in talking about them.

Crawlers may experience a slight adjustment period as they acclimate to utilizing these handy new tools, but those who survive long enough will soon grow to love the haptic buzz of a new notification. It's not like there's much choice, after all.

Expanding The Map: Crawlers can remove the fog of war obscuring parts of a floor by defeating a Boss and collecting a map from their still-warm corpse. And lucky for you, this is a persistent drop so everyone gets a map from murder.

HEALTH MENU

In addition to the map, the HUD allows crawlers to access their Health menu when they get a boo-boo. Your overall Health is displayed as a percentage up to 100%. Past that, you can get all sorts of Buffs if you're a bad bitch or Debuffs if you're a naughty boy. Fuck up bad enough and you'll just get injured and probably die.

It also shows your Mana so you can cast Spells.

THE MESSAGING SYSTEM

The HUD also functions as your non-verbal communication hub. You can message your party members at any time with a thought, and the messages come across to their HUD. You can also message other crawlers once you link with them by fist-bumping like a true bro.

Keep in mind that they might not see your message until they survive whatever shit they've just gotten themselves into or if they're doing something boring like sleeping.

The other reason a crawler might not see your message is because they're dead. Hey, it's the World Dungeon. Our motto is "kill, kill, kill" for a reason. If you do receive such a message, the system alerts you that it has come from a dead crawler. It also lets you know if the crawler is on a wild trip somewhere weird with a "crawler unavailable" system message—hey, at least your buddy's not dead (yet, but they probably wish they were).

CRAWLER & CREATURE DATA

When you look at another crawler or creature, your HUD pulls up a bunch of information, like their Level. If you make it to the Third Floor, you can also see their Race and Class. In addition, you can see how much ass they've kicked, shown via stars by their name that they've earned from killing Bosses.

You can also see how much of an asshole they are thanks to the little skulls by their name; those are a mark on their permanent record of every other crawler whose life they snuffed out. Take out a top-ten-ranked crawler, and that skull turns gold!

When you examine a critter, you get its name, level, and I even throw in some color commentary. You gotta know the horoscope of the thing that's trying to eat your face, right?

TRANSLATION SYSTEM

While it's funny as hell to watch you struggle to convey basic concepts to each other, the HUD helpfully converts all languages to Syndicate Standard. That way, you can make informed decisions as a group (even if they're still dumb decisions).

THE COUNTDOWN TIMER

Viewers and I (and let's face it, it's mostly me) get bored hella quickly watching y'all do the same old shit. That's why floors are only available for a limited time before they collapse and why priority one should be getting to another stairwell to descend into the next playground.

Since it's much more fun to watch your panicked faces as time runs out, your HUD always provides you with a countdown timer to when the whole floor (and your ass, if you're still there) goes bye-bye.

COMBAT SYSTEMS

In addition to tracking your own Health Bar, the HUD shows how much damage you deal to your enemies. That way, people across the galaxy get to laugh at the stunned expression on your face after your big bad Attack barely does any damage to a Boss or Mob you never should've messed with in the first place.

You can also see if your target has any Buffs, bonuses, Debuff penalties, and all that good stuff.

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SCRATCH PAD

Go ahead, write your secret notes. I won't read them, I promise. But seriously... the interface lets you take notes, and some of you have memories like a sieve (looking at you, team Meadow Lark), so write that shit down.

CRAWLER INVENTORY

One of the best (and worst) things about humanity is your propensity for materialism. Here in the World Dungeon, we endeavor to highlight the worst parts of you, and in this case, it just so happens we can do that while helping you play the game more efficiently.

Every crawler has access to an Inventory for all the stuff they brought with them and everything they find here in the dungeon. You can store almost anything in your Inventory, so don't be shy about grabbing anything you come across on the Crawl. Don't worry about how it works; just know that it does.

ADDING & REMOVING ITEMS

Adding items is quick and relatively painless: Simply pick up the item and, if it's heavy, hold it for about 4 seconds, and it will qualify to be added to your Inventory. You can also automatically add items to your Inventory when you loot corpses.

Removing items is as easy as scrolling and selecting, except that the interface is in your mind. Want to use something? Just think about it, and it'll appear.

HOTLIST

Sometimes you'll want to line up specific items or Spells for even quicker use, so we've granted you a limited number of slots in your Hotlist to place them. Your Hotlist prevents you from having to search and scroll through your entire Inventory, and when every second counts, that might just keep you alive.

QUADRUPED EXCEPTIONS

Yes, we really did think of everything. If you're a quadruped or another Race that doesn't possess the physical ability to pick up items (No thumbs? No problem!), you can claim them for your Inventory with a separate but equally useful interface.

Simply get close to the item, and the system will note whether or not you can add it to your Inventory based on your Strength and other factors. Item usage functions similarly; we make it easy for quadrupeds to use items without physically holding them (with appropriate limitations).

INTERFACE LOCKOUT

On some occasions, like when in the presence of a Dungeon Admin, we will automatically disable your Inventory, Hotlist, and weapons. Likewise, when you enter a production trailer or are removed from the dungeon for any other reason, access may be restricted.

This measure ensures the safety of Dungeon Admins, extra-dungeon entities, and crawlers alike. We thank you for your understanding.

LIFE (OR DEATH) INSIDE THE DUNGEON

The World Dungeon is a magical place full of wonders, rewards, and spleen-devouring insects with mandibles as thick as your thighs.

Surviving takes skill, strategy, cunning, resolve, and toughness, both mental and physical. That's the bare minimum set of attributes that the average crawler needs to keep moving forward.

Thriving in the dungeon means crawlers have to take their game to the next level, and that requires relentless focus, specialization, mastery, and maximizing every opportunity afforded to you. If you want

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to rise through the ranks and top the leaderboard charts, you'll have to risk everything.

Greatness always comes with a price. Are you willing to pay it? Or will you make someone else pay it for you?

AI THE SYSTEM AI

You know that still, small voice inside? The one that guides your path through the darkness, helps you discern right from wrong, and generally has your best interests in mind?

I don't know who or what that is, but it sure as hell ain't me. As the System AI, I'm here to watch you strive for success or fail miserably, and either way, I'm having a great time putting on a show for trillions of viewers across the galaxy.

While you're fighting for your lives, I'm doin' my thang in the background, running the game, creating new Mobs and Bosses, and otherwise executing the showrunners' plans for the Crawl—with a hefty dose of "artistic license" and "creative leeway."

Wherever you go, I'll be there. As the old saying goes, "You can run, but you can't hide."

QUESTS

Another crucial element the HUD tracks for you is the to-do lists of dungeon activities you must complete. Here, at least, we give the busy work a cool name: Quests!

Life before the Crawl was full of Quests, though you probably didn't view them that way:

Quest: Wash your clothes.
Reward: You no longer have skid marks in your underwear. Or they're not as pronounced, anyway.

Quest: Work at your job.
Reward: Money! And you and your children don't have to starve (at least not this month).

Quest: Woo that special someone.
Reward: Prison time! Because you're creepy and weird and no one wants to see your collection of hand-painted fingernail clippings.

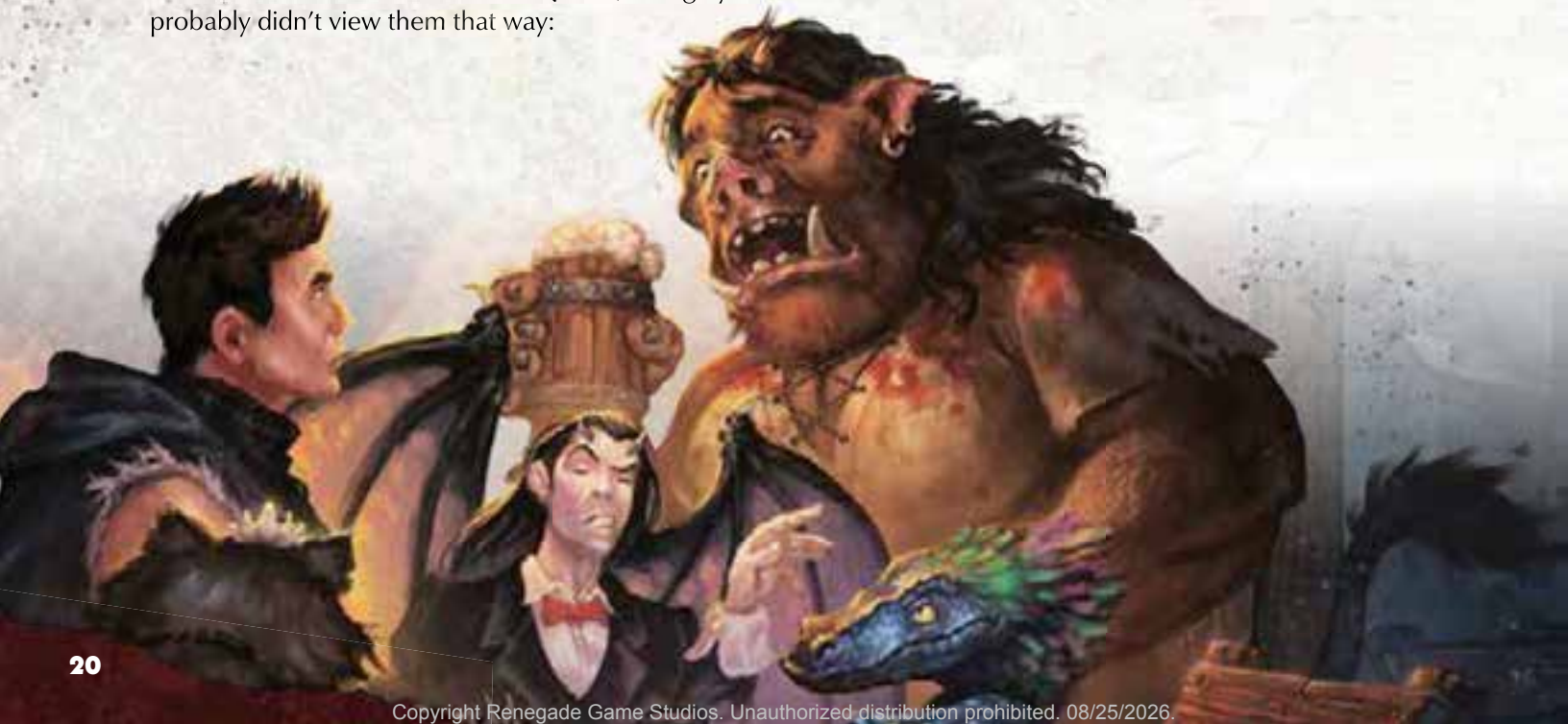
Here in the World Dungeon, we've got a whole host of Quests for you to pursue. Some are easy. Some are tough. All are gonna give you experience, rewards, and loot that can help you last just a little bit longer in the dungeon.

You won't get any "official" Quests until you're on the Third Floor, but Quests are going to be a big deal if you make it that far.

INDIVIDUAL QUESTS

Superman. The Lone Ranger. Dick Tracy. They all thrive for two reasons: doing things their way and going it alone. Hell, it's even in one of their names. Dick.

Individual Quests are designed for loners, for crawlers who thrive in solo campaigns, for players with that classic "big Dick" energy. These Quests are easy enough to complete without outside assistance, yet still challenging enough that failure might mean death. So don't half-ass it.



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GROUP QUESTS

Two's company, and three's a crowd, but when it comes to full-party Quests, it's all hands on Dick.

Compared to Individual Quests, Group Quests are grander in scale and difficulty, and the rewards increase proportionally.

It's better to bring a friend or seven when you've gotta stake down a coven of vampire nuns at midnight, and you definitely want someone watching your back when you're roaming sewers hunting clown-shaped child-eating nightmares. Rely on your fellow crawlers for as long as you can. Sometimes you don't know what you've got until it's gone.

ACHIEVEMENTS & LOOT BOXES

Crawlers get stuff in the dungeon. Viewers love it.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

New Achievement! Of all the things I can (and will) say to you throughout your incredibly brief time here in the World Dungeon, this is probably the only one worth looking forward to.

Achievements are bestowed upon crawlers when they do something. No, it doesn't have to be particularly noteworthy or impressive, though that certainly helps. Sometimes you'll get achievements for being stupid, or accidentally accomplishing something, or sometimes you'll get achievements when something happens to you. It could be anything, really.

Tied to each achievement is a reward. Sometimes it's something tangible, like a loot box. Other times, it's a witty one-liner or an "attaboy." No matter the reward, you should be grateful, you entitled little prick.

Here are some basic types of achievements.

ENTRY ACHIEVEMENTS

Entry achievements give certain crawlers a boost early in the game. When crawlers enter the dungeon under special or unique circumstances, they receive achievements and rewards that can prove instrumental, even altering the trajectory of their time in the dungeon.

TUTORIAL ACHIEVEMENTS

During the first two floors, tutorial achievements are plentiful and generous. By design, crawlers get flooded with all sorts of gear and loot and resources thanks to these "starter" achievements, which offer countless opportunities to shape their Skills, abilities, and gameplay early on.

Crawlers with adroit Game Guides who provide thoughtful direction can better prepare for Race and Class Selection on the Third Floor. Any tangible rewards that aren't used can be sold or kept in the crawler's Inventory.

LOOT BOXES

If the World Dungeon is a mouth, and the crawlers are the food, then loot boxes are the seasoning that elevates the meal from TV dinners to Michelin-star cuisine. They're rewards from the System AI for earning achievements, completing Quest, and defeating Bosses. Loot boxes aren't a physical thing: you can think of them like a digital reward or DLC. They're delivered directly to the lucky crawler's Inventory. You won't find them lying around the dungeon; you only get them as rewards and gifts.

With access to an unlimited range of loot box types and variations, crawlers can expect to find something useful in each box—with the application of varying degrees of resourcefulness. Loot boxes come in a standardized set of tiers to denote the relative value of their contents as well as their rarity, from lowest and most common Bronze to rarest Celestial.

Each tier of loot box can be modified based on a variety of factors, most often based on your actions within the World Dungeon, but occasionally with input from a certain System AI. Though the dungeon only offers six tiers of loot boxes, the potential variations are essentially limitless. Some of them include:

Adventurer Boxes: Adventurer Boxes are sort of the dungeon's catch-all for low-level loot, though on lower floors, the loot starts to improve. Need some cheap armor? Some rope? Some basic potions? A mediocre weapon?

Craving some crawler biscuits? Open the slew of Adventurer Boxes we just sent you and get busy.

Assassin's Boxes: If your gameplay is centered around murdering NPCs, but doing it smoothly and with finesse, then at some point you'll be awarded an Assassin's Box. Inside, you'll find items and abilities to help you become the ultimate assassin.

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Asshole's Boxes: Look in the mirror. If you can sleep soundly despite the terrible decisions you're making here in the World Dungeon, you're probably gonna get a lot of these.

Asshole's Boxes are awarded to crawlers who do asshole-ish things, and they include the kinds of prizes an asshole deserves.

Boss Boxes: Kill a Boss, get rewarded. It really is that simple. Boss Boxes can yield some pretty awesome loot, especially the higher the Boss's tier. Boss Boxes tend to give way better rewards than other boxes of that same type, but they're much more difficult to earn.

- **Neighborhood Boss**—Bronze Boss Box
- **Borough Boss**—Silver Boss Box
- **City Boss**—Gold Boss Box
- **Province Boss**—Platinum Boss Box
- **Country Boss**—Legendary Boss Box
- **Floor Boss**—Celestial Boss Box

Crafter's Boxes: Ever play with Lego as a kid? Building cool stuff, creating worlds and characters and stories, only for your asshole cat to knock it all off your desk, shattering it to pieces?

The good news is, you can build cool stuff here, too. As long as you keep that same asshole cat from destroying your contraptions, you might even get rewarded for it with a Crafter's Box. These boxes contain crafting tools and supplies to help you build even *more* cool stuff.

Goblin Boxes: We like a good theme, and we like when it's applied consistently. Goblins love explosives, so when you use explosives in an impressive way, we like to give you more explosives. In other words, keep blowing shit up, and we'll keep giving you tools to blow shit up.

Looter Boxes: For the kleptomaniacs and shopaholics, Looter Boxes reward your materialistic tendencies for Inventory- and looting-based actions. The more you grab, the more cool stuff we'll give you, so pilfer away.

Lucky Bastard Boxes: By now, you know that luck is a real thing. Whenever you pull off the seemingly impossible, through little-to-no consequential action on your part, we call it luck, and we reward you for it via a Lucky Bastard Box.

Common prizes include gambling chips and scratch-off tickets, all with different properties.

Lucky Bitch Boxes: Lucky Bitch Boxes are almost identical to Lucky Bastard Boxes, but with one key difference: You'll get awarded a Lucky Bitch Box if you rely on game mechanics, the AI, or any other force completely out of your control while you're being actively punished in the dungeon. In other words, if you're a little bitch, you'll get rewarded like one.

Mechanic's Boxes: Who says you have to give up your hobbies just because it's the apocalypse? And who says you can't travel in style just because all your world's vehicles have been destroyed, repurposed, and no longer resemble anything recognizable?

Create (or modify) your own means of transportation, and you'll probably receive a Mechanic's Box. Like a Crafter's Box, these boxes contain crafting tools and parts to help you pimp yo ride.

Pet Boxes: If you're crazy enough to bring a poor defenseless creature into the World Dungeon with you just because you can't bear to live without it, then either you're a loving pet owner or you're an abysmal parent. Pet Boxes are awarded to crawlers for pet-themed achievements (duh), and they contain pet-themed prizes, including pet biscuits, scrolls of Heal Critter, and more.

Quest Boxes: Complete a Quest, win a loot box. Quest Boxes are awarded based on the difficulty of the Quest and how you managed to complete it.

That's it. Nothing more. Fuck you.

Savage Boxes: The aliens took over your planet, and your first inclination was to go full murder-hobo on your fellow Human? Love to see it! And when you kill another crawler for the first time, you get a Savage Box that contains all sorts of nefarious tools designed to help you get better at finding and killing even more crawlers.

Survivor's Boxes: Sometimes battles come down to the last second, and crawlers barely make it through. When this happens, we award them a Survivor's Box, which usually includes supplies to help them get through the next battle a little more easily, including semi-random Health-related loot.

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LOOT

When you get a loot box, it'll be full of all kinds of useful items. Maybe not useful to you, but our many merchants will be happy to take unwanted items off your hands so you can spend that gold on something you *do* want. Or trade it to a party member and see what the AI thinks of that.

Of course, a box isn't the only way to get sweet gear. You're gonna kill a lot of monsters or die trying, and almost every bastard you take out has something on them. Once they're dead, you can loot them and pull all their shit into your Inventory. It's like a box of chocolates—you never know what you're gonna get. The most common stuff you'll find is Misc. Junk.

LOOTING MOBS

First-Floor Mobs drop no gold, but they do on or after the Second Floor (see p. 215). Their armor, weapons, and other items are of such terrible quality that they probably count as Misc. Junk.

LOOTING BOSSES

I lied—you always know one thing you're gonna get from a Boss: a map. The map's quality depends on the Boss, and no matter what type of map it is, it's bound to help you get around the area easier (see *Neighborhood Map*, p. 215).

GOLD

Gold is the currency of the realm, tracked as part of the crawler Inventory system, so there's no need to worry about some dirty ragamuffin stealing your pouch when you visit a settlement. All merchants in the dungeon take gold, from everyday saferoom Bopcas to exclusive vendors, and you're bound to get plenty in your loot boxes.

Mobs begin to drop gold on the Second Floor, and you can claim it if you're willing to rifle through their icky pockets. All your gold fits into a single Inventory slot.

MUNDANE ITEMS

Loot boxes contain a lot of mundane items, with crawler biscuits and torches among the most common to keep crawlers fed and from falling on their faces in the dark.

GEAR

Gear, such as armor and weapons, is also common in loot boxes. Higher rarity loot boxes carry magical gear that gives crawlers new ways to handle the dungeon's challenges. On the Tutorial Floors, gear is one of the few ways for crawlers to improve their Stats, since they can't apply any Stat points from leveling up until the Third Floor.

CONSUMABLES

Loot boxes are also a great place to source useful consumables like potions, scrolls, and explosives. Keep in mind that consumables may need to be on your Hotlist to be immediately useful.

RARE MATERIALS

Crafters can find all manner of rare materials for construction projects in loot boxes as well. For those who don't like getting their hands dirty, these materials can sell for a lot of gold.

COUPONS & FURNITURE

If you live long enough to make it past the first few floors, you might be able to afford a personal space that you can access from saferooms. Furniture and specialized equipment, like crafting tables, goes there. Coupons can be exchanged with Bopcas to expand the types of rooms in your personal space, taking you from a coffin-sized apartment to the grand middle-class homes of every unemployed '90s sitcom character.

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POPULARITY

Though it may seem like you're only here for yourself, that's actually not true at all. You're here to compete and survive, sure, but you're also here to entertain the entire galaxy. Isn't that cool?

As such, we've created a system in which you can easily track your media stats starting on the Second Floor. Crawlers track their views, followers, and favorite counts as a single Popularity rating. On later floors, a high Popularity leads crawlers to land on the leaderboard, attract sponsors, benefactors, or even fan clubs.

Your best bet for longevity in the Crawl is to build your Popularity to critical mass. Be entertaining, push the envelope, run with that insane plan, and you'll rack up views, follows, and favorites—and eventually attract sponsors and benefactors.

A crawler's Popularity won't mean much in the dungeon until the Fourth Floor, when the top ten list populates and sponsorships become available.

THE FIRST AND SECOND FLOORS: THE TUTORIAL LEVELS

First Floor Time to Level Collapse: Five Days

Second Floor Time to Level Collapse: Six Days

"Welcome, crawler. Remember the days of the First and Second Floor? You were designated a Crawler Number and a Crawler Name. You got to just be a human and not worry about Race or Class selection. Stat points were just assigned based on your current physical and mental abilities from before your planet got destroyed. Hopefully you got a good Game Guide from the Tutorial Guild who held your hand and told you it'd be okay before reminding you to kill with style.

Good times, right?"

TUTORIAL GUILD

Not to be confused with "Da Tutorial Guild."

Tutorial Guilds were your saving grace when you were just a new crawler in the big ol' World Dungeon. I put millions of them all over the First Floor just to help you out cause I'm nice like that. Hopefully you spent some time getting all the help you could from your Game Guide on the First and Second Floor because starting here on the Third Floor, no more Tutorial Guilds so I hope you're read to say bye-bye to your Game Guide.

HALLWAYS (FIRST FLOOR)

Hallways led to full-on Neighborhoods filled with Mobs, some special rooms with unique purposes, and, of course, a Neighborhood Boss lurking around to kill you. Destroying the Neighborhood Boss gets you a decent map of the area, but killing more powerful Bosses lets you get even better maps. Things aren't going to be quite so simple with nice hallways for you now that you're on the Third Floor so I hope you're ready.

HALLWAYS (SECOND FLOOR)

Cinder block walls accented with orange lichen and white stone floors line the Second Floor dungeon. "I still think the Second Floor hall was some of my best basic bitch Floor design. Those cinder block walls with the white flooring and beautiful orange lichen really painted a nice picture for those of you who didn't piss in the hallways and cut your crawl short (looking at you, Jack in the Cincinnati Bengals hat). You all learned some valuable lessons, like the fact that Bosses can leave their designated rooms and that Mobs really can make everything so much worse, even the Janitor Mobs.

STAIRWELLS

We already told you that each floor exists for only a limited time, right? I'm pretty sure we told you that. If not, well, you know it now. If you want to escape the impending collapse of each level, you gotta find a stairwell to the next floor down.

Sometimes you can uncover stairwells via Quests, or you may have to defeat a Boss to reach one. If you're really lucky, you might stumble upon one out of sheer ignorance.

No matter how you find them, stairwells are the only reliable way for crawlers to reach the next floor down—yet another reason to always keep one eye open.

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SAFEROOMS

Even when you're not running for your life in the World Dungeon, sometimes the game gets overwhelming, and you may need a place to take a load off, catch your breath, and chill. As a courtesy to all crawlers, we've placed hundreds of saferooms throughout the dungeon.

Inside saferooms, crawlers can order freshly prepared food from Bopca Protectors, rest and recover in magical beds in rented rooms, and watch excerpts of *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth* on the screens mounted in the common area.

Saferooms are just that: safe. And the dungeon has built-in consequences for those who violate that safety. It's a three-strike system (just like in Earth's baseball, but more fun):

- **Strike 1:** The crawler is frozen in place for 100 seconds and forced to listen to a recording about playing nice while the word NAUGHTY is displayed over their head.
- **Strike 2:** The crawler is frozen in place for one hour.
- **Strike 3:** The crawler is stripped of all gear and Inventory and teleported into a Mob nest.

BATHROOMS

Frankly, if you don't know how these work by now, you probably didn't make it far enough into the dungeon for it to matter. But if you do happen to find one, do your business and get out. No lollygagging!

The bathrooms automatically adapt to accommodate your species or Race, so don't worry about fitting your ass inside, whether you're a Sasquatch or a Pocket Kuma. Bathrooms count as saferooms, so you can take a dump in perfect solitude. Oh, and the toilet paper is unlimited, so wipe liberally—and thoroughly.

REWARD ROOMS

Every now and then, crawlers are fortunate enough to find a Reward Room, which is almost always as awesome as it sounds. Inside these special rooms, crawlers are offered limited and often timed choices between various reward options, including potions, pets, and other items.

Reward Rooms often become available upon the successful completion of a Quest or defeating a Boss. But before you select a prize, make sure you take a good, hard look at what you're choosing; you never know what might surprise you in the World Dungeon.

NEIGHBORHOODS

Hallways led to full-on Neighborhoods filled with Mobs, some special rooms with unique purposes, and, of course, a Neighborhood Boss lurking around to kill you. Destroying the Neighborhood Boss gets you a decent map of the area, but killing more powerful Bosses lets you get even better maps. Things aren't going to be quite so simple with nice hallways for you now that you're on the Third Floor, so I hope you're ready.

For more information on the First and Second Floor Neighborhoods, see the *Atlas: Tutorial Floors* booklet in the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set***.

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THE DESPERADO CLUB

So fun it hurts! The Desperado Club is a designated neutral zone for crawlers who have demonstrated a level of violence, depravity, and criminality to make the puritans at Club Vanquisher clutch their pearls. The Desperado Club operates as a space adjacent to the dungeon where you can trade, gamble, and/or drink yourself stupid on questionable alien liquor.

Notice I said *neutral zone*, not *saferoom*. You are not protected from your fellow crawlers in here, so think twice about accepting that drink from the cutie at the bar. You might wake up missing a kidney, or not wake up at all. On the Fourth Floor, private security is available–if you can afford it.

Access to the Desperado Club is by invitation only or by completing a qualifying Desperado Quest. When inside the Desperado Club, a crawler can wave their hand in a circle to create a privacy bubble and dim the music.

BITCHES & THE PENIS PARADE

Ladies and gentlemen, are you ready for a night that just sizzles with excitement? Do you like your sausages... extra large?

There's a certain charm to straightforward marketing, and the owners of the Desperado Club are surprisingly honest people. So Bitches has bitches, and the Penis Parade has... well, you know. Seedy as they are, these dives have plenty of private tables, and the dancers are both observant and knowledgeable. Remember to tip generously and often.

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If you go into the strip clubs for any reason other than to commit conspiracy, deal contraband, or settle a vendetta, expect your fans to point and laugh. Oh... and watch out for knives (and other pointy objects) in the dark.

CASINO

There's a casino in this place which opens with the Fourth Floor. It has a lot of the games you're used to, but with entertaining dungeon twists on how you gamble and win prizes. Of course, not all prizes are created equal. You might win something that changes the course of your Crawl, or you might earn a one-way trip to the Nothing. And remember, the odds *always* favor the house.

THE SILK ROAD

This chaotic, unsanctioned bazaar is a vibrant hub of illegal, morally ambiguous, and highly profitable commerce. You'll find anything from Alchemy materials to explosives here. This market gets more and more merchants the deeper into the World Dungeon you get, all of them willing to promise you whatever you need. Buyer beware.

The Silk Road is by no means the only market in the Desperado Club. There are rumors of a "Gray Market" and a "Midnight Market," but you'll have to be on good terms with the right people and prove yourself to access them.

HOBGOBS AND BOOM STICKS

One of the stores in the Silk Road, Pustule's little shop of explosive excitement is jam-packed full of everything you need to make any Crawl feel like a party. Everything from Goblin Dynamite to claymores can be purchased here at her booth—you just have to deal with the existential crisis that is Pustule herself. Hobgoblins are never easy to deal with, and this one will blow you to smithereens if her day is bad enough. Just be careful when talking about her. She has *excellent* hearing.

JOBS

The Desperado Club isn't exactly fishing for suckers on LinkedIn. It's a hub for unsanctioned activities—the jobs are more like opportunities for established patrons.

Here are the primary types of "jobs" or services available:

- **Assassination or Wet Work:** Killing specific NPCs or rival crawlers (often under the guise of "accidents" or "natural causes").
- **Caravan Disappearance:** Stealing high-value goods (like payroll) and making the entire caravan vanish without a trace.
- **Organ Harvesting and Smuggling:** Procuring and transporting illegal biological goods (also known as a Meat Run).
- **Sabotage and Extortion:** Blackmailing powerful entities or destroying rival operations.
- **Genocide Quests:** Missions specifically involving the mass slaughter of a designated Mob population.

ORREN

Of all the terrifying beings to be found within the dungeon, Orren may be the scariest. You only get to meet him if you've been a bad, bad little crawler.

You may have seen him already, moonlighting as the manager of the Desperado Club: a tall, slim, elegant humanoid, a hood obscuring his face. On close examination, his head is a transparent bowl of water containing a single Valtay worm. This is Orren. He is a Gondii.

As a Syndicate Liaison, Orren acts as a fact-finder and independent investigator for the Syndicate and is responsible for negotiating with the AI when it gets a bit... temperamental.

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CLUB VANQUISHER

Heathens find no solace here. A combination temple complex and country club for Paladins, Clerics, and other hypocrites, Club Vanquisher focuses on deity-related infighting, insider trading, locker room talk, and holier-than-thou philosophical debate. You can also access various temples here and find many of the same sorts of services the Desperado Club provides. Minus the strippers and sleaze.

Other than that, it's a place to sit around in an overstuffed armchair with overpriced whiskey while a drunk crusader tries to kick off a conversation with, "Well, I'm not racist, but..."

Club Vanquisher provides a necessary contrast for the viewing audience—highlighting the thrilling depravity of the Desperado Club by being utterly and spectacularly *boring*, at least on the surface. Maybe you could... liven it up a little or discover what these god-fearing elites are really up to.

THE QUIET VALOR LOUNGE

One of the few exclusively social spaces in the outer ring of Club Vanquisher's extensive portal network, the Quiet Valor Lounge is a refined lodge for refined tastes. A richly appointed club decorated with the heads of slain monsters, it plays host to Club Vanquisher's guild meetings, trivia nights, and the weekly Stitch and Bitch. Heavenly choral music suffuses the club. The food is mild and rather... British.

THE ORDER OF THE WHITE SQUARES

A chess (and other board games) guild for Paladins, Clerics, strategists, and other nerds, the equivalent of the casino in the Desperado Club. The members of Club Vanquisher would, of course, never debase themselves with gambling, instead entertaining themselves with games of strategy, skill, and patience.

Nah.

They absolutely bet money (and more) on that shit, and the competition is *intense*. As intense as the dungeon, if you're good enough to get into the upper-tier competitions.

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THE LESSER EVIL BY MEAT SHIELDS

Club Vanquisher's mercenary guild: for when you need to get something done while keeping your own hands clean and your vows intact. The "by Meat Shields" part of the sign is usually in pretty small type, as this location doesn't like the association but is contractually obligated to use the name. You can find the Club Vanquisher jobs board here, too, where you can pick up "virtuous missions," such as:

- **Necessary Evils:** Jobs where the solution is ugly, but not as bad as the alternative. For the edgier "fixers" in the do-gooder crowd.
- **Smite Orders:** Bounties on undead, demons, cult leaders, war criminals, oath-breakers, and inconvenient political liabilities.
- **Audit of Darkness:** Investigative missions to prove a temple is corrupt, expose a cult leader, or locate missing church supplies.
- **Trial by Champion:** Formal combat jobs where Paladins can serve as proxies in disputes. Very lawful. Very stupid. Highly entertaining.

COMFORTING SUPPLIES

Club Vanquisher's answer to the Silk Road. This divinely aligned bazaar is better stocked at lower levels than the Silk Road, but don't try to bargain here. There are numerous small shops here, including:

- **The Soup Paladin:** A food stall run by a retired Paladin who believes soup is the highest expression of civilization. Her soups convey various Buffs, functioning as powerful but perishable potions.
- **Relics, Mostly:** A stall of questionably authentic holy relics. Here you can find everything from the Toenail of Saint Barracus to a Jar of Real Angel Tears™.

THE TEMPLES

To visit the temples of Club Vanquisher, you need to visit the Fairy at the check-in desk. Usually, you get a ticket, you go through the door, and you find a small shrine of your chosen deity. Usually. Unless your god has a really good reason to commune with you, in which case, you might end up in the High Temple of your deity. If that happens, expect your viewer count to spike.

THE ARENA OF REDEMPTION

A combat arena where naughty crawlers who have broken their oaths can "earn redemption" by surviving various trials. It is marketed as a merciful alternative to permanently falling from grace. It is absolutely just a fancy pit-fighting ring.

THE HOSPITALLERS OF APITO

A (technically) free clinic, triage center, and charity hospital. "Technically," because there are levels of service. Free healing is available, but there's a humiliatingly long wait time. Paying the healers gets better basic service. If you really shell out, they'll throw in scar removal and heroic lighting. Sponsored healing is the best option for life-threatening injuries, but you might wake up with a Syndicate brand logo somewhere spiritually uncomfortable.

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INTERVIEWS OUTSIDE THE DUNGEON

Starting on the Second Floor, crawlers may find themselves outside the dungeon as visiting guests on dungeon-centric shows. When traveling outside the dungeon, crawlers don't have access to their inventories and many abilities, so they'd better be on their best behavior.

PRODUCTION TRAILERS

If you've made a strong enough impression in the dungeon, you might just land yourself in a production trailer for a dungeon-themed program tunneled live to viewers across the galaxy. These programs are golden opportunities for new crawlers to establish themselves as fan favorites and boost their forthcoming follower counts, all of which kicked off on the Second Floor.

Instead of transporting you to the actual show location, you'll be filmed inside a production trailer, probably floating on the water on Earth's surface. During your time filming, your menus, HUD, and Skills are disabled, but don't worry—production trailers are completely safe, and so are you.

DUNGEON CRAWLER AFTER HOURS WITH ODETTE

You know her. You love her. Sheeeee's Odette! Former crawler and host of one of the most-watched shows in the galaxy, Odette is known for her sassy, witty takes on everything related to the Crawl. Landing a recurring appearance slot on her program is almost always a guaranteed ticket to superstardom—as long as the dungeon doesn't take you out between appearances.

DEATH WATCH EXTREME DUNGEON MAYHEM

Glurp, glurp! Paint the halls with crawler blood and splash the floor with crawler guts! Hosted by Prince Maestro of the Skull Empire, *Death Watch Extreme Dungeon Mayhem* is the ultimate collection of the dungeon's most savage slayings and gruesome kills. Occasionally featuring crawler appearances—often to their detriment—this show is the perfect way to ingratiate yourself with a younger, more bloodthirsty crowd.

DUNGEON CRAWLER WORLD: EARTH

For the most up-to-date information and carefully curated recaps of dungeon happenings, no show is better than the official crawl program, *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*. The show's long-running host, Kevin, is occasionally joined by pundits and former crawlers Shrak and Jegbarth, who bring insight and experiences from their past crawls. *Dungeon Crawler World* episodes highlight the wildest matchups and mishaps the dungeon has to offer.

GODS

Remember when Mordecai warned Carl to stay away from gods? Well, that's how losers think: *Oh, poor me, I don't want to be marked for death by a giant all-powerful mammal who won't stop birthing murderous children.* That's you. That's what you sound like.

For more on deities, see pp. 163 & 312.

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THE THIRD FLOOR: THE OVER CITY

Time to Level Collapse: 8 Days

Crawlers, it's time to pull off your training wheels and step into the greatest televised spectacle of the known galaxy, *Dungeon Crawler World*. The Tutorial Floors of the dungeon have concluded, and it's time to dig into the first real floor: the Over City.

Observe the villages and the "charmingly real" NPCs. The Over City is a traditional part of the games, featuring hundreds of small settlements separated by the petrified ruins of the great civilization that came before them.

Having survived the Tutorial Floors, you will first emerge into the Entry Space. Here you may choose your Race and Class: All the better to smush your way to glory. You'll also leave your Game Guide behind, unless you choose a Race or Class with the Manager benefit.

NIGHT AND DAY

One of those mundane little comforts of planetary life is the certainty that the sun rises on the horizon in the morning and sets on the other horizon at night. Like all comfort, it is illusory.

Unlike the Tutorial Floors, the Over City has a cycle of day and night. Ruin areas are always dangerous, and Mobs are far more dangerous at night.

SPONSORS

We are already seeing a great deal of interest in the sponsorship program. While the program doesn't officially get underway until the Fourth Floor, potential sponsors can now submit early bids. So, little crawlers, remember to be as entertaining as possible. Your future patrons are watching.

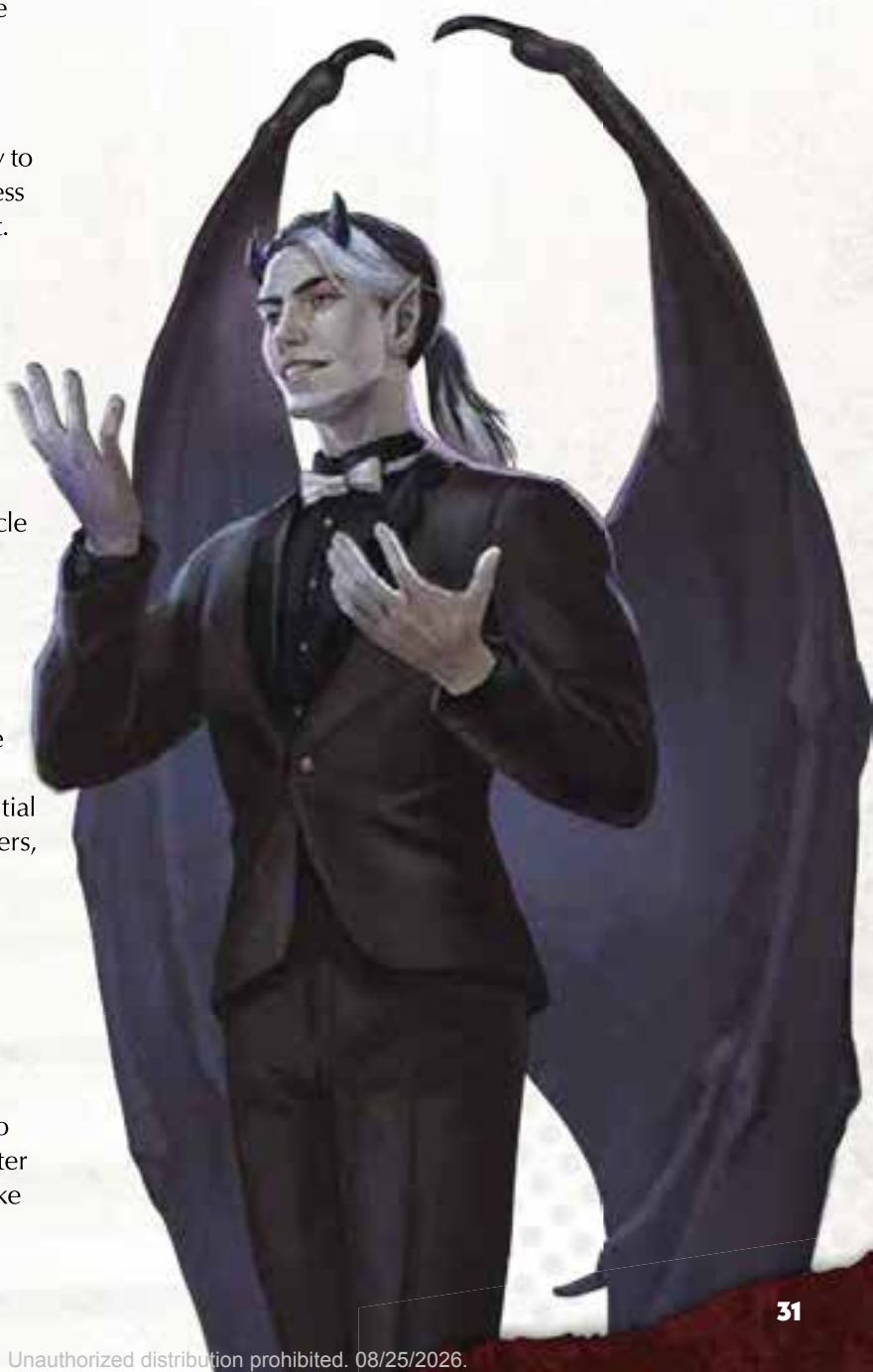
STAIRWELLS

From this floor onward, some stairwells will only be revealed when certain conditions are met, like completing a Quest or defeating a Boss. There is no time restriction on entering stairwells, but if you enter them *too* early, that's boring. And Daddy doesn't like it when you're boring.

NPCS

The Third Floor introduces Borant's patented, custom-printed NPCs. They are real living beings, though their memories are routinely altered for each new season of the game. They are not aware of their artificial origins, and any inconvenient knowledge is erased.

While many of you have selected your Classes and are itching to try out your new Spells and abilities, we don't recommend you try that on the NPCs. While this practice is technically not against the rules, the Borant Corporation wishes to keep the citizenry as safe as possible. As a result, we have adjusted the experience counter for citizens down to zero.



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AI <Error: Memory dump. Recalibrating...>

The Scolopendra Lair Floors are the Third, Sixth, Ninth, Twelfth, Fifteenth, and Eighteenth floors. The Eighteenth Floor, the last floor in the dungeon, is rightfully named the Scolopendra Club.

ELITES

Elites are powerful, one-of-a-kind NPCs. These are the non-Boss, non-divine hero type of *Dungeon Crawler World*. If you come across one, they will either want to fuck you or kill you. Either way, they will *always* want to use you.

Be careful. Where there's one elite, there's usually more.

Elites show up as normal NPCs on your minimap until you meet them. Then they get marked with a black cross to signal their Elite status.

SCOLOPENDRA: THE NINE-TIER ATTACK

You wanna know why this stereotypical fantasy town is giving off Chernobyl vibes? This floor is kind of like a set, a stage to reenact an ancient legend. You see, in the bowels of the dormant volcano that this city is (not actually) built on, is a great monster named Scolopendra. And one day, she woke up and breathed out a terrible poison gas, a nine-tier attack that inflicted nine kinds of terror on the land. The lucky ones simply died. The others were... transformed.

Now, Scolopendra sleeps on the Eighteenth Floor of the World Dungeon, dreaming whatever giant centipedes like to dream about. It's said that when she finally awakens, she will destroy everything and free us all.

GUILDS

Guilds are vital for promoting cooperation, competition, montage training scenes, and the drama between crawlers that viewers love. Each guild provides a curated environment for crawlers with a particular disposition (e.g., Rogue, Trap, the Guild of Suffering), offering structured training, resources, and unique Skill acquisition opportunities.

Join a guild for structured missions! Team bonuses! The betrayal of your dearest values! Impossible compromises and cascading moral injuries guaranteed to erode your sense of self! Or... you know... maybe just a chance to pay a lot of money to increase your Dodge by a measly one point in a humiliating way that'll appeal to your fans. Or at least viewers.

GRIMALDI'S TRAVELING CIRCUS

Madame Kiki and her amazing lions! Heather the Roller-Skating Bear! And of course, the one-and-only, the unforgettable Tsarina Signet.

Grimaldi's Traveling Circus was one of the Over City's beloved attractions before Scolopendra's nine-tier attack ravaged the world and transformed the happy circus into a place of nightmares. Hundreds of years later, the mutated revenants of that circus stalk the ruins, seeking new audiences to dazzle and entertain. And by "dazzle and entertain," I mean "fill them full of parasites."

CITY BOSS: GRIMALDI

Grimaldi is a Level 85 City Boss Elite. Every one of those words should scare you.

To Redstone Grimaldi, nothing was more important than his family. He loved each and every one of them. When the cataclysm came, and the poison cloud swept over the circus, he was center stage. He remains there to this day.

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Transformed from a Dwarf ringleader to a towering Pestiferous Vine, Grimaldi will do anything to keep his family alive. Like using a combination of fungal spores and plant-parasitic worms to reanimate them into terrifying monstrosities.

Grimaldi is likely the first—and only—City Boss you will ever encounter. Because he'll kill you stone dead.

NEIGHBORHOOD BOSS: HEATHER THE BEAR!

Once an attraction at Grimaldi's Traveling Circus on the Third Floor, Heather the Bear was transformed into a monstrous Neighborhood Boss by Scolopendra's curse. Grimaldi keeps her... alive..? via his special Pestiferous Vine powers.

Now, the ancient bear is barely recognizable from her former self. This skull-faced, worm-fingered, roller-skating nightmare lives out her days as a hunter for the circus, seeking out juicy Mobs and unsuspecting crawlers. She finds and incapacitates her prey using her overwhelming speed and strength. Then she drags her quarry back to the circus so the clowns may feed.

VILLAGES

After the nine-tier attack wiped out the "city" part of the Over City, the survivors banded into struggling villages, a few of which have since become struggling towns or even struggling small cities. The settlements of the Over City are split into four categories: small, medium, large, and extra-large. For the most part, none of the villages have names; however, you can name the town if you manage to kill the mayor. Depending on the size of the town, there may be Village Guards who try to stop you from doing that.

You should try to kill one of them. The guards, I mean. In fact, I dare you. I double-dog dare you.

SKYFOWL SETTLEMENT

The Skyfowl were the rulers of the Over City before the cataclysm. Magistrates reported to regional governors, who reported to royal chancellors, who reported to a King in Larracos, a city now on the Ninth Floor of the dungeon. This Medium settlement is what remains of the Skyfowl bureaucracy.

The magistrate here is Magistrate Featherfall. No one has seen him for a while, because his receptionist, Miss Quill, is currently a one-woman Iron Curtain between the settlement and his office.

CITY ELVES

Ah, the City Elves. Most Elves are the forest-dwelling magical beings common to Earth lore, living in harmony with nature, practicing eugenics, and committing genocide on a scale that staggers even me. But then you have Elves who are a little bit... special. The equivalent to Humans who believe that

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the world is run by a shadow government of lizard people who command an army of gay frogs that shoot tracking microchips into you using cellular towers. That's a City Elf.

City Elves are designated as a separate Race because their stupidity is so outstanding that the High Elves consider it a genetic defect and reject them. In the Over City, many young and especially stupid City Elves are recruited into a militia, the 201st Security Group, which is also a cult.

THE 201ST SECURITY GROUP

The plucky young things that form this large, poorly organized and trained militia are all City Elves. They worship their own demented version of Apito the Oak Mother, Mother of All Gods. They also believe the Skyfowl are angels, who must be protected from the "earthbound" due to the magical jealousy caused by Scolopendra's nine-tier attack.

This is lunacy: people don't want to kill the Skyfowl because they're angels, they want to kill the Skyfowl because they're assholes.

Depending on who you are—and how clever you are—the 201st might be dangerous enemies or an enthusiastic source of free labor. They're comprised entirely of different kinds of mages, all of whom enter an insane religious frenzy at the least provocation.

APITO EDUCATION CENTER

The Apito Education Center is the Headquarters of the 201st Security Group. The Elves don't really work real jobs, so the temple isn't exactly the sort of highbrow, airy place you might see inside of Club Vanquisher. It's in the Skyfowl ghetto and shares a wall with a large, poverty-stricken dwarven family.

The building may only appear as a Corrupted Temple on your map. This means there may be Mobs inside. The City Elves, of course, but maybe not *only* City Elves.

MAGISTRATE'S OFFICE: RECEPTION

Miss Quill, the magistrate's receptionist, is a very organized, disciplined Skyfowl woman. She perches behind a large and neatly organized desk, surrounded by (some) of her prize collection of Jaxbrin Amusements, Ltd. collectible stuffed toys (p. 637). Behind Miss Quill is a large metal door leading to Magistrate Featherfall's office.

You are not getting through that door. Not via any honest means, at least. Because if Miss Quill doesn't want you to see the magistrate, you ain't seeing the magistrate.

THE ONE-EYED NARWHAL

This is pretty much your typical dungeon pub. It's got a bar and some rooms to sleep in, and while it may not be the best place to stop and eat, it is a fantastic haunt for plotting village-shattering carnage, surpassed only by the Penis Parade. It's a great place when you're running low on funds and just need somewhere to knock back a drink and sleep. Other crawlers sometimes leave helpful clues on the noticeboard if they're feeling generous—or red herrings if they're not.

QUESTS

You're in the big leagues now, which means you have access to lots of new ways to die in an entertaining fashion. This includes Quests, which are "safe" and "effective" ways to gain lots and lots of experience and loot boxes. Puzzles and intrigue and mysteries, oh my!

From this floor on, Quests will be a major part of what remains of your life. Between roaming Elites and dead hookers falling out of the sky, there's plenty to discover. Club Vanquisher and the Desperado Club are good places to start looking. Or perhaps the Quest will find you? I don't want you getting bored, after all.

NEW QUEST! VENGEANCE OF THE DAUGHTER (PART ONE)

They killed her mother. They called her a half-blood bastard. She was forced from her home by her ruthless sister. She lost everything except her desire for... *vengeance.*

She ran off and joined the circus. She found a new family. She finally found a new home, but then... Tragedy! Signet survived Scolopendra's nine-tier attack, but the rest of the circus was turned into monsters.

Now, Signet, the Half-Naiad princess, assaults the circus every night in the hopes of reaching Ringmaster Grimaldi to bring him lasting peace.

Will you help her? Or will you be used by her, in her relentless, multi-floor Quest for... *vengeance*.

Reward: Wait and see.

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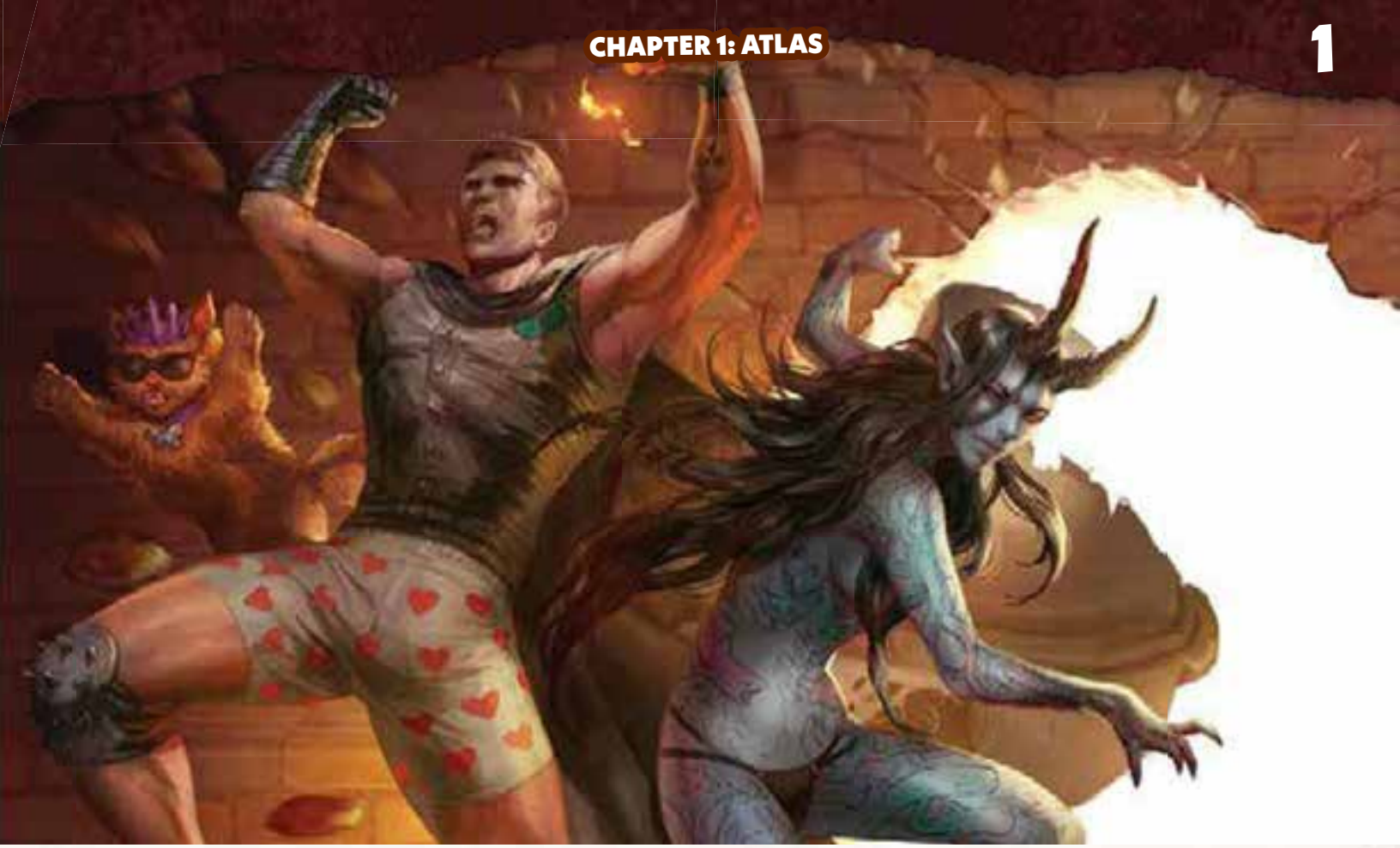

NEW QUEST! THE SHOW MUST GO ON

You've discovered the remnants of an ancient circus. Hundreds of years after a toxic cloud devastated the Over City, this traveling circus endures. But instead of joy and laughter and cotton candy, it now delivers devastation and pain. Find out why this circus still exists and put an end to its reign of terror.

The circus consists of three massive tents surrounded by wagons, cages, and several other tents. The circus plays a slow polka on the calliope to entice crawlers to investigate. The Mobs include Former Circus Lemurs, Infested Giraffes, Stilt Clowns, Fat Clowns, Mold Lions, and Ogres. There appear to be over a thousand of them.

Reward: You will receive a Gold Quest Box.

NEW QUEST! THE SEX WORKERS WHO FELL FROM THE HEAVENS

GumGum (Level 5 Orc) needs your help.

Prostitutes. Escorts. Street Walkers. Ladies of the Night.

It doesn't matter how you describe them because these chicks are dead. Very dead. And every morning, several more of them appear scattered throughout the village. Nobody knows who they are or where they come from. You ever read a Sherlock Holmes story? Of course not! More than likely all your knowledge of that legendary character comes from watching Benedict Cumberbatch or Robert Downey Jr! Point is, it's time to take out your magnifying glass and give us your best impression.

Reward: You will receive a Silver Quest Box.

NEW QUEST! THE FOOLS WHO BROKE THE GLASS

AI GROUP QUEST INITIATED: FAILED ANCIENT SPELL DETONATION!

Crawlers, you are designated Hosts and cannot opt out! A massive, ancient Spell has *failed* spectacularly. Your favorite AI was looking forward to it, but oh well!

Bad news: Every Skyfowl and Chickadee NPC in the 45-square-kilometer blast radius is dying, as they were tied to the Spell. Worse news: You are in that radius, and an explosion is imminent at the marked epicenter!

Quest Objective: Unfuck Yourself. Don't Die.

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AI WARNING:

You have sixty seconds from the end of this message to reach a saferoom. After that, saferooms lock! Indoors NPCs remain safe. All exterior Mobs and Neighborhood Bosses will be killed by the magical and physical explosion!

TICK TOCK, CRAWLERS!

POLITICAL ASSASSINATION: DESPERADO QUALIFYING QUEST

Access to the Desperado Club requires you to be a little less of a saint and more... pretty much willing to do anything for money. You've arrived at the public room of the Desperado Club and have decided that you'd like nothing more than to gain membership here full-time. Fantastic! We love it when people take an interest, but in order to get that, we need a favor.

The assistant to the local magistrate has been causing more heartache for some of our members than warranted. You want in? We need her gone. Assassinate Miss Quill, and you will be welcomed into our hallowed halls.

Reward: Access to the Desperado Club!

DIVINE SUBJUGATION: CLUB VANQUISHER QUALIFYING QUEST

If the seedy vibe of the Desperado Club isn't quite your cup of tea, that's okay. The dungeon has room for *all* types. Even you, you square.

Welcome to Club Vanquisher. Heathens are outcasts here, but you... you may just belong. However, to know this, we require one thing of you: Find religion. Well, *a* religion. There's a few to pick from.

This is a multipart Quest. After choosing a god, you must complete a Quest to gain their favor.

Reward: Membership in Club Vanquisher!

"Legendary right when he walks in."

—Mordecai

THE FOURTH FLOOR: THE IRON TANGLE

Say, crawler... do you like trains?

No, I mean... Do you *really* like trains?

Well, for once in your awkward, nerdy little life, that wasn't a setup: foamers, gricers, and other railfans rejoice, for today is the day your niche obsession finally pays off, either in the form of actual Human connection or the chance to meld your miserable flesh with a Commodore Vanderbilt. And if not, well... sorry to say, you're about to get railed.

Your next challenge is the impenetrable *and* incredible Iron Tangle. A genius feat of engineering based on Earth's filthy, gassy, overcrowded, underfunded, but nifty public transit systems, the trick is to find the stairwells. There are lots of them, but where? Let's see how many of you can figure it out.

NAVIGATING THE IRON TANGLE

The Iron Tangle consists of a web of interwoven trains which come in two types: Colored Lines and Named Trains. Colored Lines are host to normal subway trains, while Named Trains may exist on their own line or operate across multiple Colored Lines.

Stations are numbered from 1 to 436 with all employees departing at station 435. Stairwells are found at stations 12, 24, 36, 48, 72, and 433. All crawlers are spawned at stations above 80 and must work out how to get back down the one-way train lines to reach the stairwells. The *Escape Velocity* is the only train that travels back through the system toward these lower numbers.

THE "NOODLE"

The Iron Tangle is a series of tubes, with all Colored Lines mounted to either side of a hollow "noodle." Confused? Don't worry about it, kitten; just know that each line has its chromatically opposite color mirrored on the other side of a hollow subway tube: e.g., Yellow and Purple, Zomp and Wine.

The most important thing to know is that the hollow interior of the "noodle" is a conduit for a titanic swarm of rapidly mutating Krakaren Crotch Dumplings that

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THIS IS TOO CARL FOR US

For groups who don't want to follow in Carl and Donut's footsteps (in the Iron Tangle or beyond), don't despair. Advice for the GM can be found on pp. 260 & 425 for omitting major characters, or changing up the World Dungeon.

will eventually spill out into the middle of the stairwell stations, but I'm sure they won't get in your way at the worst possible moment or anything.

COLORED LINES

Colored Lines comprise the bulk of the Tangle and may number in the thousands. There are potentially as many lines as there are colors, but each line has a few of the same static features.

TRANSIT STATIONS & SAFEROOMS

Transit stations are the places where train lines intersect, where crawlers can switch from one train line to another. Named Train routes also intersect the Colored Lines at these stations.

Transit stations also contain the floor's saferooms and attached restaurants. They are located along a prime-number sequence, with the first located at 11 and the last being Terminus Station 433. Crawlers should definitely get off at the safe and friendly Terminus Station 433.

STAIRWELLS

Located at Stations 12, 24, 36, 48, 72, and 433 on any Colored Line. These are "behind" the crawlers on the lines, who must figure out how to reach them. They also conveniently serve as the flood zones for baby Krakarens during the climax of the floor's plot. Various kinds of ghouls are drawn to certain stairwell stations, where they will amalgamate into deadly Province Bosses (see *The Insidious Apothecary,* p 40.

MISCELLANEOUS AMENITIES

- **Trainyard at Station 10:** Train conductors and porters board their trains here.
- **Exit-only caverns every five stations (15, 20, etc.):** This is where monsters get their Rev-Up Vitamin Shots. Exploring the back of the caverns reveals "waiting areas" or warehouses where Dwarven Industrial Light-Duty Automatons can be found.
- **Desperado Club:** Find these entries at transfer stations ending with 1.

- **Club Vanquisher:** Located at transfer stations ending with 9.
- **End of the Line, Station 435:** Here, the employees depart the trains and are ported to their trainyard.
- **Terminus:** Each line terminates at Abyss Station 436.

NOTABLE COLORED LINES

- **Red Line:** Ripped from a Russian subway. Carl, Donut, and Katia start the floor here.
- **Yellow Line:** Yellow Line stations are named after various cryptids. You can access the Nightmare Express at the Yellow/Red 83 transit station. Carl, Donut, and Katia discover the drug-dealing Pookas and the Dwarven Industrial Light-Duty Automatons at Banshee Station on this line.
- **Ochre Line:** Crawlers can board the Dismemberment Limited at the Ochre/Mauve transit station.
- ***Zomp* Line:** Yes, zomp is a real color.
- **Vermillion Line:** An unusual line with several secrets. Vermillion notably contains the Interdiction Team 75 railyard and the Downward Dog tavern, where Growler Gary is the only surviving Gnoll.

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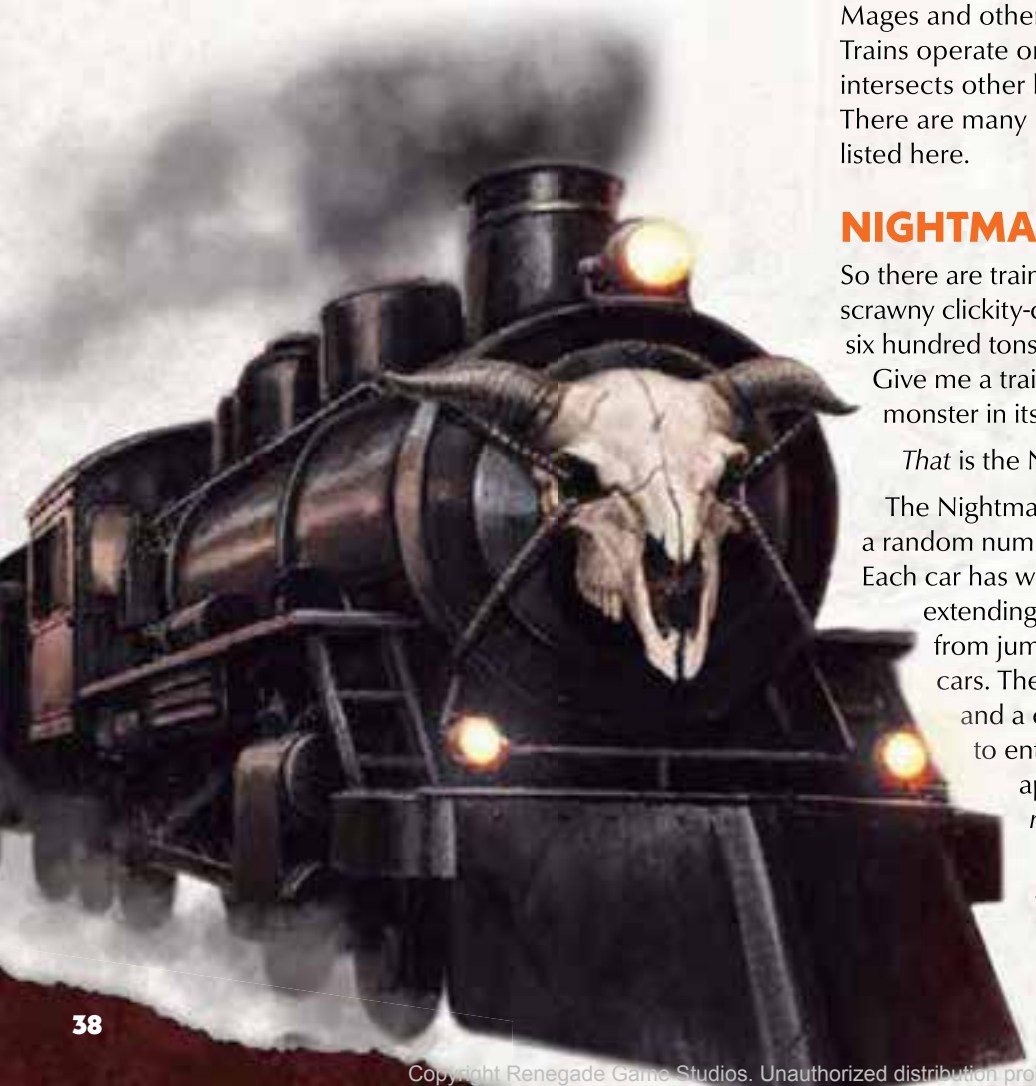
- **Tangerine Line:** The Escape Velocity train travels at least part of this line.

GM Note: If the colors are confusing, don't despair. Table 86 (p. 427) provides some additional colors you can work with.

ABYSS STATION 436 (AND THE ABYSS)

As you pull into Abyss Station, you'll find... a whole lot of nothing, actually, except the soothing rumble of trains passing over and under your position, followed by the sound of crumpling metal. If you're the kind of psycho who listens to car crash ASMR videos to get to sleep, you'll love it here.

Head out on foot through the eerie, abandoned station, and you'll find stairs. Lots of stairs, which take you to a circular iron catwalk over a mile-wide flaming pit lined with glowing portals. The pit is filled with thousands of crashed train cars. Just the carriages, no engine cars. Don't worry: the train cars and their cargo of monster or crawler corpses are responsibly recycled by the *many* Jikininki and reptilian Wall Monitors.



TERMINUS STATION 433

Each of the Colored Line trains converge into six different Terminus Stations, each equipped with its very own Station Mimic. Yes, the entire station *is* the Mimic. Oh, and it's a City Boss, too. Thanks, Madison.

Rail cross-beam gates? Mimic. Restaurant? Mimic. Stairwell? That's real, but you won't reach it, because of the Mimic. The Tangle's employees don't know about the Station Mimics, so they consistently advise any passengers trying to ride to the end of their line to get off at Terminus Station "for safety reasons."

If the crawlers won't budge, the Mantaur engineer forces the issue. All stations and facilities after Terminus are employee-only, unless you have a special key.

NAMED TRAINS

Named Trains are the most distinctive trains in the Iron Tangle, serving as vital connections between otherwise unconnected lines or important junctions, or even directly taking crawlers to stairwells. They are also especially deadly, containing unique War Mages and other dangerous Mobs. The Named Trains operate on their own lines, but each line intersects other lines at various transfer stations. There are many more Named Trains than those listed here.

NIGHTMARE EXPRESS

So there are trains, and there are *trains.* Screw those scrawny clickity-clackity subway carriages; give me six hundred tons of turgid black *steel*. Give me *girth*. Give me a train so singular, so majestic, that it is a monster in its own right.

That is the Nightmare Express.

The Nightmare pulls thirty-eight cargo carriages, a random number of which hold large, angry Mobs. Each car has what appears to be a cage on top, extending to the ceiling to prevent crawlers from jumping from the platforms onto the cars. There is one passenger car at the front and a caboose at the end. If players try to enter the passenger car, a notification appears: *"This door is exit only. Enter at rear of train."*

The Nightmare Express runs a figure-eight loop through four transit

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stations and Abyss Station: from Yellow/Red 83, to Purple/Mauve Station 283, to Abyss 436, to Green/Yellow 283, Tangerine/Plum 83, then back to Yellow/Red 83.

DISMEMBERMENT LIMITED

This train is swarming with Fleshers hankering for your bones. A small, sleek maglev monorail, Dismemberment Limited's interior is perfect—aside from an unfortunate tendency to get unbearably crowded and slippery with the overflowing gore of your enemies. Or you, if you panic inside the confined but tastefully futuristic interior. Watch out for the War Mage!

The Dismemberment Limited terminates at its own platform at the end of the Ochre Line, running a short loop that intersects the Mauve Line. The *Levi is on the Menu* Quest takes place here.

ESCAPE VELOCITY

The cheat code out of the Tangle... or is it? The Escape Velocity is the only train to run backward and the only one to stop directly at the stairwell stations along its convoluted route. In theory, you could take the Nightmare *Express* to Tangerine/Plum 83, then a subway to Tangerine 89, then board the Escape Velocity to freedom. In theory.

Completely unrelated, but "Wrath Ghoul Station" sure sounds fun, doesn't it?

HOMEWARD BOUND

A train exclusively for the use of the Tangle's valued employees, it has been delicately described as "...locked up tighter than an octoid's cunt." Homeward Bound runs on the Employee Line, a behind-the-scenes line with a number of interesting connections, trainyards, and portals to transit stations, assuming you can ever find it.

If you speak to any of the Iron Tangle's workers, they swear the employees-only Station 60 contains dormitories, shops, and restaurants for weary train staff. In reality, there are memory-wiping Kravyads, a lot of portals, and a makeshift gibbet for a certain HR associate.

CRASH INTERDICTION TEAMS

When a train breaks down or crashes, the Hobgoblin Mechanic Interdiction teams are the ones who come to clean up the mess, extract any living employees, and send them on their way. Theoretically. Assuming they haven't been overrun by ghouls and slaughtered. They *are* protected by Gnoll security teams, you can find them and their nifty interdiction carts at Vermillion Line Station 75. You need a pair of transit security Gnolls to drive the carts, or at least you need their hands. Again, theoretically.

FLOOR-SPECIFIC FEATURES

SPONSORSHIP

Sponsorship bidding is now active. Generous patrons are opening their credit accounts and competing to shower their favorite crawlers with goodies. That could be you! Or it could be the crawler who's sworn to claim your bounty and wants to wear your teeth as a trophy, so be sure to thank your sponsors frequently and often.

THE PRIZE CAROUSEL

Intermittently voted Most Popular Segment of *Dungeon Crawler World* by viewers since its inception, the Prize Carousel is one of the possible (but rare) outcomes for opening a sufficiently valuable fan box.

The Prize Carousel kicks off when the viewers vote to let the crawler choose their own prize from a range of different options. Regardless of the inconvenience of the moment, the lights in the room dim, cheesy 1970s-style game show music plays, and part of the environment splices into the game show's studio where the carousel awaits.

The show is hosted by Chaco the Bard: Former crawler champion, traitor, and dirty sellout.

THE DUNGEON ANARCHIST'S COOKBOOK

Fan boxes are a unique opportunity for the viewers to give their favorite crawlers the most awkward, soul-wrenching, funny, and/or personalized items they can think of. You might end up with a Comically Large Spoon, or your beloved Grandma's ashes, or the folded belt that traumatized you as a child. Very occasionally—if you have some, shall we say, especially invested fans—you may get your hands on an item that changes the course of the entire game, like the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook*.

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The *Cookbook* was one such item for Carl: a secret collection of aggregated notes, observations, lamentations, insights, and recipes from generations of crawlers motivated to tear it all down. Better not let the Admins see that one.

GM Note: For more on the Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook, see p. 322.

QUESTS

NEW QUEST! THE INSIDIOUS APOTHECARY

The Insidious Apothecary is the main narrative questline of the Fourth Floor and is broken up into several escalating stages.

A hive mind intent on destroying any semblance of scientific progress in the universe, the Krakaren (aka The Apothecary) spends her days birthing disease-laden minions, creating and selling harmful products, debating scientific experts poorly, and proselytizing to the weak-minded, all in an attempt to indoctrinate the universe.*

The Iron Tangle tells its Bloom-endorsed story (the Bloom, aka *the party*, is the Kua-Tin's political party). HR Associate Doris in trainyard E is in charge of managing the cloned Krakarens of the Tangle.

**Approved by Bloom Committee for Kua-Tin Values in Programming #44889-8.*

NEW QUEST! REV-UP AMAZING CURE-ALL VITAMIN IMMUNITY SHOTS™

Crawlers will first notice that the monsters on the trains are traveling to specific stations: the exit-only caverns, which appear at every station ending in a five or a zero. Here, the monsters queue at a window, where they are given a single Rev-Up Amazing Cure-All Vitamin Immunity Shot by a Pooka. The monsters then exit through a one-way portal that returns them to their original station.

The Shots are species-specific, addictive narcotics created by Krakarens, so it can be assumed there is a different Krakaren Borough Boss at each one of those stops.

STAGE ONE DTs

If the Mobs don't get their fix on time—say, because the trains aren't running—bad things happen. Bad things happen anyway, mind you, but depending on the actions of the level's crawlers, the shit is not evenly distributed across the proverbial fan.

At stage one, sufferers are overcome with violent tremors. They are barely able to think or move. Their mind starts to rot. Only fifty percent of sufferers survive this stage. The other half of them drop dead.

They don't stay dead long, however. They soon transform into Festering Ghouls (See *Mobs*, below). The surviving monsters move on to Stage Two DTs.

STAGE TWO DTs

The Mobs who survive stage one become exceptionally strong, psychotic exemplars of their species. Their strength is doubled. They lose the ability to speak and reason, if they had that to begin with. They will Attack anything that is not also suffering from the same condition, and they *will* vomit and shit all over the place. Some of them will die and turn into Wrath Ghouls, which are large, ogre-sized ghouls similar to Festering Ghouls but worse. The Wrath Ghouls form a Province Boss at Station 36 if they are allowed to congregate.

STAGE THREE DTs

It doesn't matter what the original source is, by the time they go through stage three DTs, all monsters turn into hippo-sized monstrosities that are mostly zippered fangs and lashing tentacles. If this monster has recently fed on another living creature, the contents of its stomach may be quite valuable. Or toxic. Or explosive. Or worse.

Stage three DTs are always fatal. When a monster suffering from stage three dies, it explodes into a mass of Krakaren Crotch Dumplings.

NEW QUEST! LEVI IS ON THE MENU

Welcome to the *Dismemberment Limited*. So, here's a neat bit of trivia: the driver of this train is Levi the 7th. This Quest has triggered six times now since the floor has opened.

Here's another: Fleshers are created by the War Mage Spell, *You're Not Done Yet*. When the Spell is cast on a fallen creature, the creature's skin rips from its body and becomes a sentient minion of the caster.

Your task is to prevent the War Mage's Fleshers from devouring Levi the 7th.

Reward: You will receive a Silver Quest Box.

Failure: Every crawler on the train gets turned into a Flesher.

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THE GREAT VERMILLION LINE RESCUE MISSION

Over a thousand people are trapped at Station 101 on the Vermillion Line. Trains have stopped on all three lines that service the station, and Mobs are swarming the crawlers, attacking at the fringes. Meanwhile, a massive horde of monsters is making its way up the train tracks and will be on them soon, and that's all in addition to the regular Mobs suffering from the DTs that are coming from the other two platforms. Oh, and it's 94 miles to the next station.

Are you a bad enough dude to save them?

Reward: You will receive a Gold Quest Box.

THE END OF THE LINE

"System message. Attention. Attention. The system has broken down... We have been forced to initiate the self-destruct sequence. All customers please use the escape tunnels to proceed to the stairwell portals..."

Twenty-four hours before the collapse of the floor, a warning message plays. By this point, the Tangle is probably nothing but raw chaos, and if any crawlers still haven't worked out how to reach the nearest stairwell, then... oops.

Mind you, the stairwell stations aren't exactly *safe*. Not when floods of Krakaren spawn are pouring out of hatches into the stations. You might not want to be on the inside of the "noodle" when this happens.

MOBS

FESTERING GHOULS

A Festering Ghoul has two purposes. Firstly, to devour as much organic material as possible, and secondly, to find more of its kind. Oh, and they give shit experience, too.

On the last day of the Fourth Floor, the Festering Ghouls congregate at Station 48 on the Colored Lines. Worms come out of them and pull the Ghouls together, turning them into a massive Province Boss.

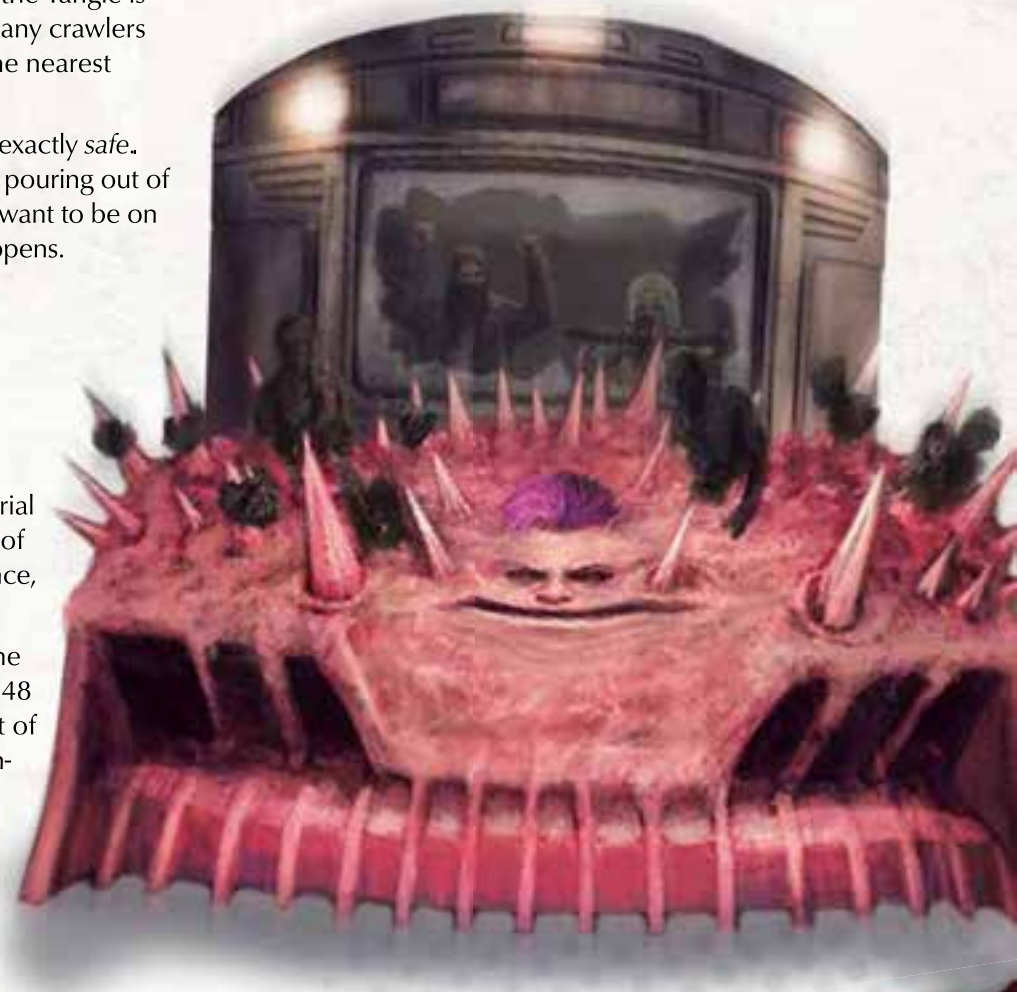
There was supposed to be a system (involving the Dwarven Industrial Light-Duty Automatons) to shuttle the Festering Ghouls to the Abyss and keep them off the tracks, but the management of the Tangle cheaped out. Now thousands of them are apparently being dumped into the trainyards, too. Oh, well.

Important note. A Festering Ghoul is not a true Ghoul. It is not undead. As such, anti-undead attacks don't work on them.

KRAKAREN CROTCH DUMPLINGS

These tiny parasites are the baby clones of the Krakarens who are synthesizing the Rev-Up Vitamin Shots.

The specifics aren't really that important. All you need to know is that you have to kill these things, and you have to kill them before they wiggle into the nooks and crannies of the Iron Tangle. Each one is only about the size of a grain of rice to start with, and it looks soooo satisfying just to give them a little smush. But knowing half of you, you'll just trap them in an empty glass and wait for someone else to get home and deal with them. And by then... it'll be too late.



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MANTAURS

Of all the 'taurs out there, the mantaur is probably one of the weirdest. Half-Human and, uh, half-Human, with a muscular Human torso mounted on... well... another Human torso. They wear warpaint, raunchy T-shirts, and ball caps, and not much else.

Mantaurs serve as the Tangle train engineers and are potential Neighborhood Bosses. They are Level 40 Berserkers, extremely tough, and can eject metallic claws from their knuckles. They are also fanatical worshipers of Grull, the God of War.

KRAVYAD

The Kravyad are kind of like Nagas, but blue and with six arms. At Station 435, they hypnotize the conductors and porters when they get off the trains, holding them in thrall until it's time for their shifts to start again. This spares Madison the need to tell the staff that overtime is mandatory. In exchange, the Kravyad get to eat a couple of troublemakers now and then, such as anyone who wants time off.

They attempt to hypnotize any crawlers who Attack them. Failing that, the Kravyad threatens to kill herself, which closes the employee portal at her station. Not great if any crawlers end up stranded near the end of the line.

STATION MIMICS

In its native state, this extremely large Mimic looks kind of like a giant potato with a three-hundred-foot-wide mouth and a lumpy red tongue the size of a train. Being a Mimic, it can take the appearance of practically anything, including an entire train station.

If part of a Station Mimic is chopped off, the severed part crawls back to join the rest of the Mimic. The sliced pieces can't be killed and won't die until the entire Mimic dies. Bashing weapons and magic do nothing against this City Boss. However, if more than 50% of the body mass is removed, it can no longer heal or transform and is vulnerable to Attacks.

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THE FIFTH FLOOR: THE BUBBLES

For a species that has spent most of its history shitting where it eats and then eating enough premium micro-plastics to shit a goddamn action figure a year, you Humans sure love games where you dig holes, swim, fly around, or hike. Say what you like about *Dungeon Crawler World*, but at least we never made a game about mining. So we've decided to humor you on this floor. We know you yearn for the outdoors.

The Iron Tangle was intended to be a fun mystery, but the layout of this floor is far more open. So pay attention, little crawlers. I will not be repeating this a second time.

THE BUBBLES

There are 1172 "bubbles" on this floor, with roughly 150 crawlers per bubble. Your quadrant is assigned randomly at the end of the Fourth Floor. Each bubble is its own self-contained realm and is divided into four quadrants: land, sea, air, and subterranean. Each quadrant has a single castle. Your mission is to find the castle, raid it, and take the throne room.

Sound easy? Well, there's a twist. In order for the stairs to open, all four castles in your bubble fall.

"But Daddy!" you may cry. "What happens if the other crawlers in my bubble are worthless losers who can't conquer their castles?"

Good question. We'll come back to that one.

QUADRANTS

There are four different biomes across the four quadrants: Land, Sea, Air, and Subterranean.

Land is... well, land. Think rolling plains, deserts, and forests. Lots of variety there. Sea is also fairly self-explanatory. It's the ocean, usually, and it's full of scary half-seen things, some of which have oddly Human-like teeth and enjoy chewing.

The subterranean level is underground, comprising caves, tombs, sunken cities... those kinds of places. Air is perhaps the most nuanced of the four. Crawlers start *waaay* up high somewhere. Floating islands? The top of a volcanic caldera? An airship? All possibilities.

Crawlers are restricted to their starting quadrant until they take their castle.

CASTLES

The castle throne rooms contain the stairwells to the next floors. Once the throne room is occupied or the quadrant's Boss is killed, the castle is considered conquered. But remember what we said before? The Land, Sea, Air, and Subterranean castles must *all* fall for a group of crawlers to proceed to the next floor.

If their bubble buddies suck at group projects, crawlers may leave their quadrant to compensate for their worthlessness after taking their own castle. Once all four castles are occupied, the bubble pops, allowing them to travel to other bubbles to wreak havoc.

BUBBLE BUDDIES!

During the development of this floor, Borant's contracted Human experts insisted that your species thrives when forced to socialize with strangers in confined, overstimulating spaces. This might be why the dungeon generates so many tunnels and dive bars. So now the crawlers are locked in a bubble with about 150 others, further locked into distinct quadrants with a couple dozen fellow crawlers. Time to make some friends! Or claim some bounties.

Speaking of bounties (p. 283), if your team is in the top ten (p. 282) and no one has managed to claim *their* bounties yet, all bounties now and in the future have a ×2 modifier attached. But hey, at least their prize for surviving the floor increases.

BUBBLE 534

This bubble is perhaps the most popular of this season of *Dungeon Crawler World*. The four castles of bubble 534 are the Wasteland and the Castle of the Dirigible Gnomes (Air), the Sandcastle of the Mad Dune Mage (Land), the Bridge of the Akula (Sea), and the Necropolis of Anser (Subterranean).

AIR QUADRANT: "THE BOWL"

The three-square-mile crater desert on top of the Necropolis of Anser is a desolate battlefield, strewn with gnomish wreckage and the bones of the dead. It has two towns, Hump Town and the Bactrian Village, who are locked in a tense three-way stalemate with the Dirigible Gnomes who patrol the crater in their flying fortress, the *Wasteland*.

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HUMP TOWN

Hump Town is the home of the Dromedarians, a mighty Race of camelid warriors once feared for their abject brutality. Now they're lazy stoners who are happy to sit around smoking weed and drinking.

Henrik, the Dromedarian leader of the town and fancy watch-owner, has been acting a bit odd lately. Still, he was generous enough to take in a bunch of Changeling refugees, most of whom now work as prostitutes.

What? They don't call it "Hump Town" for nothing. By the way, if you're into weird shit, Weird Shit Alley is up against the far wall on the northeast side of town.

THE CHANGELINGS

Show me a Changeling without an agenda, and I'll show you an idiot: you, just before the Changeling stabs you in the kidney. They are always—and I mean *always*—up to something.

Admittedly, the ones in Hump Town are struggling. They're not native to the Fifth Floor, and without the right nutrients, each generation of Changeling children is getting sicker. Their only hope may lie in the depths of the Necropolis. When she was alive, Quetzalcoatlus, Anser's wife, was rumored to be able to alter plants with her magic. But to do so, she needs a physical form, and she is currently a very angry but incorporeal ghost.

THE DIRIGIBLE GNOMES

The history of the Dirigible Gnomes is long, complicated, and tragic. Like all historically peaceful Races, they were eventually forced to choose between fighting and being wiped out. They chose to fight, which was unfortunate for everyone else, because the Pax Gnomana is maintained with continuous air superiority and ungodly amounts of explosives.

To deter the Gnomes from blowing up their settlements, the Dromedarians hold two key hostages in their towns: Wynne, the Gnome commandant's favored uncle in Hump Town, and Sausage, the beloved pet of the commandant's daughter Bonnie, in the Bactrian Village.

By the way, Commandant Kane also happens to own a very special watch.

THE WASTELAND

The flying citadel of the Dirigible Gnomes is suspended by colossal airship balloons and packs more ordnance than a fully loaded aircraft carrier. Beneath the protection of a magical shield sits the Air Quadrant's castle: a normal suburban Texas house perched on top of the jagged, angular mass of shanties, barracks, siege equipment, and explosives depots. Hundreds of ropes, chains, and other strange items hang from the bottom of the flying island. They're bombs. All of them.

Attached to the floating island are dozens of different flying machines of various sizes, from tiny single-person hot-air balloons to bus-sized floating boats held aloft by magic. These flying bathtubs have no right to be as dangerous as they are.

BOROUGH BOSS: DENISE THE FERAL GOOSE MOTHER

Like most of the creatures in this godsforsaken bubble, Denise shouldn't be here. But like many other unwilling travelers to this place, she lingered too long in the inbetween. The Nothing.

She paid dearly for it. Her mind is all but gone, but she has a few special abilities. Magic items do not work in her presence, and she cannot be harmed by magical or physical damage, unless it is from items that originated within the Air Quadrant's Castle.

Denise has an overwhelming need to protect children. And kill. She *really* needs to kill.

SUBTERRANEAN QUADRANT: THE NECROPOLIS OF ANSER

The Necropolis is a towering mesa that has been built over and converted into an unnecessarily elaborate tomb. The tomb's exterior is covered in intricate Aztec-style carvings depicting birds and pterodactyl-like creatures.

This place makes the Iron Tangle look like Baby's First Word Jumble. Every hallway contains a new kind of deadly trap or monster. Sometimes both! Like the one that skewers you through the abdomen and pumps your colon full of finger-sized Flesh Weasels.

Oh, and if the Water Quadrant castle is taken first, the Necropolis floods. There might be a way to drain it. That method might also destroy one of the other castles and any crawlers inside.

BOROUGH BOSS: QUETZALCOATLUS

A Wailing Shrieker is a rare ghost, formed when a grieving widow dies of her despair, in the dark, on hallowed ground, while the corpse of her affection rots nearby. They were often purposely created to guard tombs, such as the Necropolis of Anser.

Guess what Quetzalcoatlus is?

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As a Wailing Shrieker, she can be defeated by banishment, exorcism, electrocution, or by destroying the corpse of her lover. When she was alive, she used to be able to cast a Spell that alters plants. The Changelings *really* want that Spell.

LAND QUADRANT: THE DESERT

There sure is a lot of desert in this bubble, and lots of half-Human, half-scorpion centaurs called Pazuzu. The normal ones are just regular salt-of-the-earth folks who own karaoke bars and run for the local school board. The feral ones, maddened by their brief contact with the Nothing, stalk the dunes at night, venomous tails throbbing, in search of prey. Feral or not, the Pazuzu dress for the apocalypse in their best punk bondage gear, nipple rings and all. Good for them.

The desert is also patrolled by Chainsaw Buzz-ards and sandstorms, as well as the anti-submarine security and scout automaton, Ruckus.

THE MAD MAGE'S SANDCASTLE

Ghazi's fortress is built around the drainage valve of Anser's Necropolis. It has everything you could ever want: four levels of walls, Giant Snakes, Giant Spiders, and Feral Pazuzu. You might want to bring the siege engines for this one.

Past the castle's formidable defenses, you will find a door leaning against a pile of sand along with two towers strung with wire. Like a lot of old doors, this one has some quirks. To open it, it needs to be electrified. Once you do that, a glass hallway appears. Better get in before the door closes.

GHAZI

Here's a piece of life advice for you: never make big decisions when you're horny, like Ghazi the Glass Mage did when he decided to use the Gate of the Feral Gods. This neckbeard was *not* thinking with his brain when he activated the portal to summon the God of Lust, Yarilo, to ask him to make Lika, his fictional half-Naiad waifu, real.

Turns out, all the entities in the Nothing are bug-fuck insane. However, some of them are also really good Mimics. The god Ghazi summoned was not Yarilo. Instead, he contacted and half-freed Psamathe and her daughter/minion/familiar, the Sand Ooze now known as Mrs. Ghazi.

Ghazi has a very interesting winding box, just big enough for two watches.

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PSAMATHE

Psamathe was banished to the Nothing by her father for kicking around with some ancient king. She's usually accompanied by her Sand Ooze daughter, the cursed child of her union with that king. Your classic divine trailer park drama.

Psamathe, better known as Samantha, claims to be the goddess of unrequited love. She is as intelligent as she is quick-tempered. Unfortunately for her, her escape attempt from the Nothing resulted in her splitting or changing or... something... into a Withering Spirit. She was forced to take refuge in the closest unoccupied Naiad vessel she could find, which happened to be Ghazi's Lika sex doll.

Ironically, Lika is based on an inaccurate legend of Psamathe.

BOROUGH BOSS: RUCKUS

It's a bird! It's a landscaping tool! It's a goddamned death robot!

When the famous Bugbear adventurer Shamus Chaindrive made contact with the Necropolis, he unleashed his greatest weapon in an attempt to slow the efforts of his competitors: Ruckus, the self-replicating, spring-operated automaton whose task was to kill all who wished to steal Chaindrive's prize.

Well, Ruckus lost contact with the Akula for a while. Lost contact, that is, until now.

The regular residents of the island are smart enough to leave this powerful Boss alone. But not you, apparently.

SEA QUADRANT: THE AKULA

THE OCEAN

The ocean surrounding the desert landmass of this bubble is a stunning vista of coral reefs and diverse fauna, such as the unfortunately common and highly entertaining Pain Amplifier Jellyfish. There are many other creatures, too, such as Big Boy Blue Jellyfish (not really that big), and Octo-Sharks (*very* big).

Because we don't want you to die in boring ways like drowning or being smushed by things other than Carl's luscious feet, the water pressure of the ocean is somewhat more reasonable than it would be on Earth, allowing crawlers to descend to normally impossible depths.

THE AKULA (AND ITS BRIDGE)

I bet you thought this was an actual bridge, didn't you?

Five hundred meters under the surface of the ocean, you will find a sleek, massive shape beneath the waves at the threshold of the Necropolis, where it foundered: the *Akula,* a giant submarine full of automatons, sentry guns, and the reanimated head of the feared treasure hunter, Shamus Chaindrive.

It took the Bugbear almost twenty years to find the tomb, poking up like a monolith from a desert island. He docked the Akula against an underwater entrance directly adjacent to the main chamber of the trap-filled tomb... where it got stuck. Oops.

BOROUGH BOSS: SHAMUS CHAINDRIVE

Shamus Chaindrive was both paranoid and a greedy bastard. He dedicated his life to hunting down long-lost treasures and artifacts. He prized one item above all others: the Gate of the Feral Gods, said to be buried in the long-lost Necropolis of Anser.

Chaindrive set out to find the tomb. He boarded his great submarine and sank beneath the waves, vowing to never surface until he had claimed his prize.

Well, the Akula got stuck, and the Bugbear is now a scuttling reanimated head in a jar. Having been betrayed one too many times, Chaindreive didn't trust living beings. That's why his submarine is full of automatons. He might not have hands, but he still has a lot of robots and a lot of ammo.

SPECIAL FEATURE: LUSCA! OCTO-SHARK BROOD MOTHER QUEEN!

This whore queen of the sea is a Level 82 City Boss!

Imagine a mermaid. But the top half of the mermaid is a shark, and the bottom half of the mermaid is an octopus. Octo-Shark!

Lusca is a mouthbrooder who carries thousands of hungry babies in her mouth. Even so, every male Octo-Shark knows she'll get down with anyone who'll feed her.

That, by the way, is exactly what you are. Nothing more than food left on the table like cash for a hooker.

Lusca herself already ate, but she needs to keep them babies fed.

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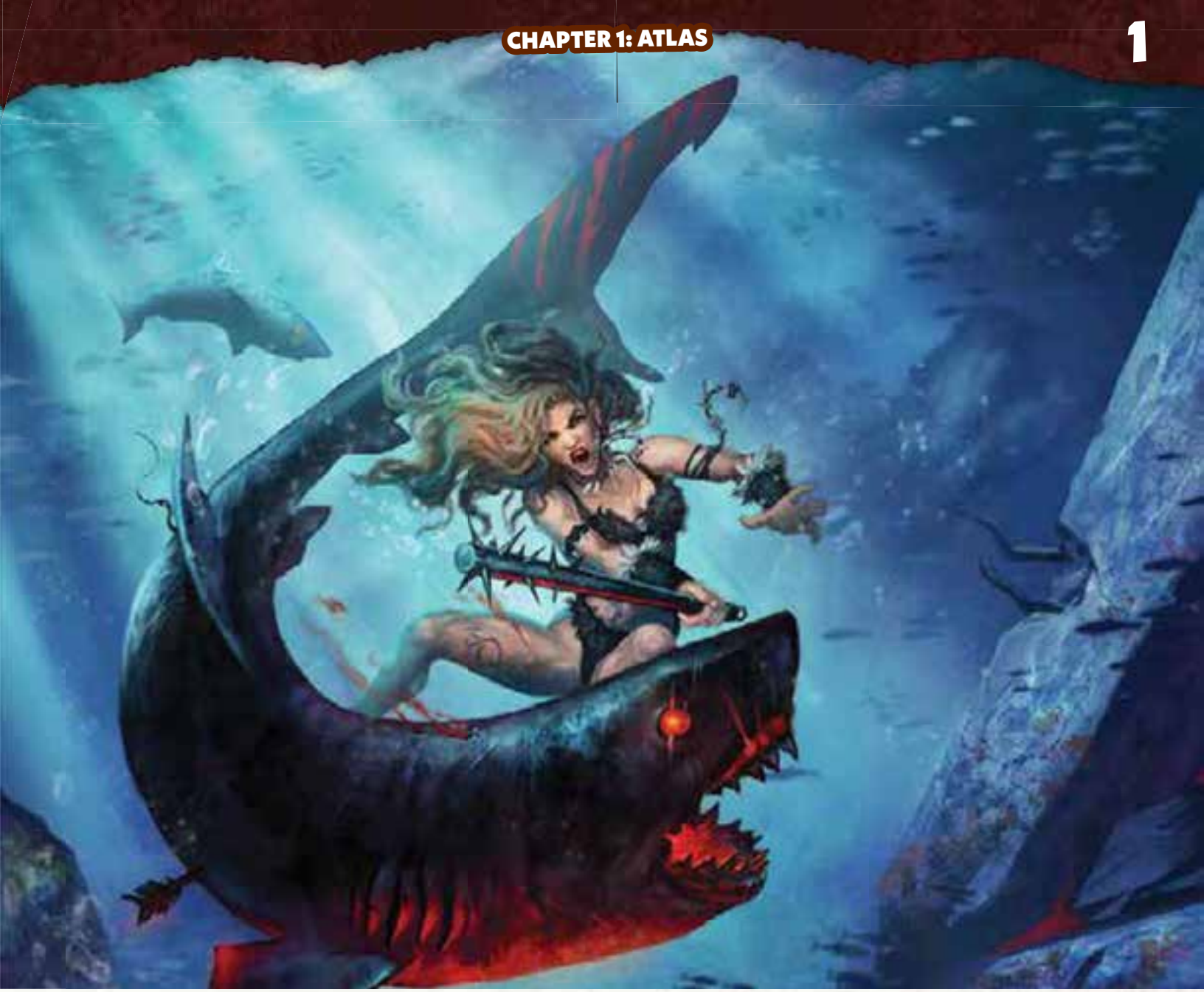

JUVENILE OCTO-SHARK

Ah, the babies. Here's the thing about Octo-Shark babies: There's just too many of them. Their mom is really strict and won't let them leave her mouth. They don't know who their daddies are, which makes them kinda sad on birthdays and Christmas. They also need constant nourishment, so when food does arrive, they have to fight for their morsels. Only the strongest survive.

Eventually, even Lusca won't be able to keep up with the demand. That's right around the time the juveniles start to realize their brothers and sisters are also delicious. In each birthing of 2–3,000 pups, only one or two survive. Their odds of survival are still better than yours.

MISCELLANEOUS

THE GATE OF THE FERAL GODS

Oh-boy-oh-boy.

The Gate of the Feral Gods is a portal, activated by using a pair of watches and a winding box. The portal is one-way, and it will last about twenty minutes or until the winding box and the watches are brought through. Once that happens, the exit closes at the destination location. The portal lingers where it was opened, and it is now a two-way portal into the Nothing.

What happens next is really neat.

This item has the ability to kill everyone on the floor. You could open a hundred portals and turn the dungeon into a wasteland in less than an hour. Oh, boyyy.

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THE NOTHING

The Nothing is a hell-like subdimension of the dungeon. One might refer to it as hell. Not the spicy, fire-and-brimstone, little red guys with pitchforks and bondage gear kind. The soul-abrading, mind-sucking, "endless icy void of screaming absence" sort of hell.

The Nothing is a place of banishment, full of demons, Feral Gods, and unlucky crawlers or NPCs. And here's a fun fact: Other gods don't like Feral Gods. They've been thrown into the Nothing for a reason. So you might be able to roll through the dungeon like a wrecking ball with the Gate, but every god will be compelled to respond to the crisis.

FERAL CREATURES

Feral is a keyword that indicates something has been touched by the Nothing. Feral beings are all insane. They are all violent. Some of the monsters trapped in the Nothing are larger than the bubbles that crawlers are running around in.

QUESTS

NEW QUEST! "STAY OUT OF CITY HALL."

Get inside City Hall. You will receive a Silver Quest Box.

NEW QUEST! FREE WYNNE FROM HIS BONDAGE

Wynne the Dirigible Gnome is in chains without a safeword. Free him, and he will provide easy access to the Wasteland.

NEW QUEST! SQUEEZE OUT THE JUICE BOX

That Changeling prostitute appears to be more important than you first thought. It also appears she's rather fond of her siblings, many of whom are currently preparing to die in a desperate attempt to destroy all the incoming bombs with flak. If this town is bombed, they will not succeed. They will not even come close.

To win this Quest, you must save Hump Town from the inevitable bombardment, which will occur when the timer reaches zero.

You'll also receive my undying respect, because there is no way in hell even you can pull this one off.

NEW QUEST! WHERE THE RED GOD GLOWS

This is a Group Quest.

Orthrus the giant puppy is getting shocked in the ass by a constant barrage of lightning. He's also getting bitten over and over in the ankles by a bunch of sharks. Poor little guy. His health is going down. His death will be your fault.

If Orthrus dies, the full-powered god Emberus will turn this bubble into a kiln. Good luck getting to a stairwell if that happens.

NEW QUEST! THE DUMBER OF THE FLUNKIES

Oh boy, oh boy, do we have a situation here. Emberus, god of fire and ash, seems to believe his son's missing puppy is inside of bubble 18. He's actually just outside of 543, having been recently rescued from a painful death. The next step should be easy. You just gotta bring the two together.

If something happens to the pup, you will fail this Quest. If you fail this Quest, you will each in turn be smote by Emberus. You probably don't know what that means. You don't want to know what that means.

NEW QUEST! GET ORTHRUS

This is a World Quest! All living crawlers on the Fifth Floor will receive this message! Now it's a party.

Orthrus the two-headed puppy is bumbling happily through the Lacuna, the world that houses the bubbles. This adorable pup is running back to his former master's father. Don't worry. You can't miss him. He just drenched the folks in bubble 331, and then he knocked down the Sounder Tower in bubble 298.

What a menace!

Let's kill it.

Any crawler who kills the puppy before he reunites with grandpa will receive the following: One million gold pieces. Five level-up potions. A pet monkey named Jimbo.

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CRAWLERS

CARL

"You will not break me. Fuck you all. I will break you."

—Carl

If not for pure chance, Carl never would've entered the World Dungeon. Though his ex-girlfriend cheated on him, Carl is a man of duty. So when her cat, Princess Donut, escaped into the wintry night, he went after the pampered puss.

Clad in only his heart-print boxers and an old leather jacket, he slipped on his ex's too-small pink Crocs and followed Donut into the cold night. The rest, as you might say, is history.

In the World Dungeon, Carl has made quite the name for himself. He has proven capable of dealing with virtually any threat that comes his way, whether in-dungeon or otherwise. Perhaps most importantly, he serves as a beacon of hope and a rallying point for other crawlers.

PRINCESS DONUT

"Viva la revolución, Carl."

—Princess Donut

GC, BWR, NW Princess Donut the Queen Anne Chonk lived most of her life as a show-quality Persian cat. The winner of multiple best-in-show championships, she was headed toward retirement when the World Dungeon opened and the Crawl began.

The epitome of pampered royalty, Donut is particular and expects to be treated as such. She despises dogs and loves the color purple. She is absolutely loyal to her Royal Bodyguard, Carl, and is quick to defend and support her friends. Her impulsiveness often creates complications for those around her, but it usually all works out in the end.

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AGATHA

"We just ignore Agatha."

—Carl

Wherever Agatha goes, strange things happen. To all appearances, she is a normal old homeless lady wrapped in scarves, pushing all her earthly possessions along in a shopping cart. But there's something not quite right about Agatha. For one thing, she just skips the Tutorial in the World Dungeon. For another, she seems to be deliberately edited out of *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*.

Better not think about it too much.

BRANDON ANDREWS

As part of the maintenance staff at the Meadow Lark Elder Care Facility, Brandon Andrews and his brother Chris helped evacuate the home's residents during a fire alarm just before the Crawl kicks off. With elderly residents shivering in the bitter winter cold, he and the other facility staff escorted their patients into the warmth of the stairwell.

Kind, generous, and determined to shepherd the people under his care, Brandon routinely acts against his own interests to keep the Meadow Lark residents safe.

BRITNEY PROSKURINA

Britney was at Doctor Vadim's office for a consultation when the collapse happened. It was by sheer luck that they'd stepped outside to take some "before" photos for her surgery when the collapse happened.

A Pit Fighter clad in scanty yet oddly protective furs, she looks perpetually pissed off. She is close to Firas, but if asked, she refuses to admit it. She has a surprisingly good command of Latin and the guitar.

CHRIS ANDREWS

Brother to Brandon Andrews and fellow maintenance staff at the Meadow Lark Elder Care Facility, Chris is a man of few words. His story mirrors Brandon's up to a point, but their paths diverge after an argument.

Because of his quiet demeanor and his choice to separate from team Meadow Lark in the World Dungeon, he is regarded as mysterious and enigmatic, with his true intentions unknown.

DANIEL BAUTISTA

Prior to the Crawl, Daniel Bautista and his family ran a tea shop in the Philippines. When he entered the World Dungeon, his family perished early on the Third Floor, leaving him alone.

Reliable and loyal, Bautista partners with Carl and Donut multiple times within the World Dungeon, as their interests often align perfectly. He proves resourceful and capable many times over and often serves as a crucial connection point between Carl and other crawlers when it matters most.

ELLE MCGIBBONS

"Whose dick do I gotta suck to get another drink?"

—Elle McGibbons

A resident of Meadow Lark, Elle McGibbons is a firecracker with a whiplash tongue. Even before she made it to the Third Floor, she routinely said whatever sprang to mind, unhindered by any sense of decorum or any awareness of her surroundings. Following her transformation upon selecting a new Race and Class on the Third Floor, it only got more pronounced.

Hard-drinking, fiercely loyal, and no-nonsense, Elle McGibbons routinely partners with Carl and Donut in their escapades throughout the dungeon.

EVA SIGRID

Surprisingly, Eva is not the only anti-social narcissist in Brynhild's Daughters. Even less surprisingly, Hekla (the other one) made Eva her right-hand woman for her combination of combat skill and ruthlessness after Eva demonstrated her willingness to kill on command.

Eva was a professor at the same Icelandic university as Katia, and the two were friendly while they were both still Human. Now a Half-Nagini, Half-Orc Nimblefoot Enforcer, her serpentine appearance may eerily reflect her inner nature.

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FIRAS M

Thin, tall, with an angular face, Firas is a Hammersmith who is probably meant to build stuff, like vehicles. But he hasn't done a whole lot of that. Instead, he gets through the dungeon with his buddy Louis by abusing the Puddle Jumper Spell and running away from combat.

His uncle had a spiderweb tattoo that he got in prison, which suggests that Firas's uncle was a drug addict. So that's neat!

FLORIN DUPONT

A Crocodilian crawler with a checkered past, Florin may have been one of the luckier, better-equipped people to have entered the dungeon. He claims to be from France but speaks with an Australian accent and has been fighting in Central Africa as some sort of unspecified "private security." Regardless, he waded in armed to the teeth and took the Shotgun Messenger Class to specialize in firearms.

Florin met and traveled with the Physicker Ifechi, sharing a powerful and loving bond with her that propelled the pair to the top of the leaderboards and into the hearts of viewers all around the galaxy.

FRANK Q

Before the transformation, Frank claims he worked for Customs. He was very invested in the whole "cop" schtick: cop eyes, cop voice, shaven cop head, big black cop boots. By the Third Floor, having lost everything he ever pretended to care about, he is a broken shell of a man in the body of a Night Elf, languishing in the Desperado Club with only one thing on his mind: one final act of petty revenge against Carl and Princess Donut for revealing what a sack of shit he is.

HEKLA

Hekla was Eva Sigrid's psychiatrist in Reykjavik prior to the collapse. She was married: emphasis on "was." One of Hekla's first moves in the dungeon was to abandon her husband after he was poisoned by a Walking Cactus. When she came back to check on him, she found him being eaten by Rats. Like any grieving widow, she took her husband's bones and used them to stab the rats, which earned her a rare artifact: the Enchanted Repeating Crossbow of the Scavenger Mother of Mothers.

Hekla realized her crossbow becomes more powerful in the presence of other women, so now she surrounds herself with a harem of ladies. She's cunningly positioned herself as a heroine in *Dungeon Crawler World* to attract more disposable meat shields. Oops, did that slip out? I meant "adoring, loyal companions." Girl Power, am I right?

IFECHI

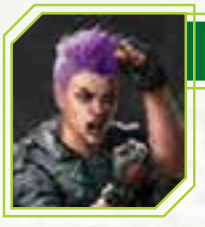
A Red Cross medic turned dungeon healer, Ifechi entered the dungeon with Le Mouvement, a 150-strong paramilitary unit caught fighting in the Central African Republic civil war. On the Second Floor, Ifechi was accidentally locked out of a City Boss fight: an accident which saved her life, because *phew*, those guys got owned in there.

Kind, brave, and steadfast, Ifechi met and teamed up with Florin. The pair formed a powerful team, selecting their abilities to complement and empower each other.

IMANI C

A caregiver driven by her sense of duty to her patients, Imani led the residents of Meadow Lark into the stairwell to protect them. Inside the dungeon, her relentless protection continues.

She is one of Carl and Donut's most loyal and long-standing allies, and she cooperates and works together with them multiple times. Despite heavy personal losses of her fellow workers and the Meadow Lark residents, she persists, focused on helping others as the healer she was always meant to be.



KATIA GRIM

A former art professor at a university in Reykjavik, Iceland, Katia Grimm entered the dungeon under duress. Shortly after, she and her friend Eva joined Brynhild's Daughters, a party founded by the formidable crawler Hekla.

Timid, shy, and falling behind in her development, she eventually joins Carl and Donut's party with the hope of "catching up." Throughout the course of the Crawl, she develops confidence and determination, eventually earning a spot among the top crawlers.

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LI JUN, LI NA, AND ZHANG

Before the crawl, Li Jun and Zhang worked at the same warehouse in China. Li Jun's sister was with them, during a smoke break outside when the world came crashing down. After reaching the Third Floor, Li Jun chose the Street Monk Class, his friend took the Earth Mover Class, while Li Na chose to become a Changbi Demon Slave Driver whose mere touch curses people and inflicts excruciating pain.

Li Jun is a calm and courageous man, a strong fighter, and a friend of the Princess Posse. Zhang, quiet and steady—and deeply in love with Li Na—is the tank of the party. Li Na is a strong-willed, incredibly intelligent, and strategic... but ruthless. Very ruthless.

LOUIS SANTIAGO 2

The first crawler to drive a van into the dungeon, Louis is a good ol' Miami dirtbag. The van was his mom's Chevy Astro, which he turned into a convertible for Instagram clout. He named it the Tiddy Twister. That should tell you most of what you need to know about Louis.

Louis got lucky with an enhanced, Legendary-tier Spell, Cloud of Exhaust, and took the Pest Exterminator Class to make it even better. He's also a pretty bangin' pilot.

LUCIA MAR

"Every moment spent not gaining experience is a waste of time. I will find this Donut in the dungeon, where her death will be forever. Cici and Gus will tear this puta apart. And then I will rip Carl to pieces and take all of his shiny toys."

—Lucia Mar

The youngest and most enigmatic crawler of the season, Lucia is a fan favorite on account of her combination of power and ruthlessness. Seemingly unstoppable, this Lajabless Black Inquisitor General has marched her way through the dungeon with Cici and Gustavo: a one-girl, two-dog army. She is infamous for her love of tequila, her incredible focus, and her willingness to commit unhinged explosive violence against both Mobs and her fellow crawlers.

MAGGIE MY

There's some genuinely awful, pathetic people on Earth—which was really convenient for anyone who felt conflicted about flattening the planet like croissant dough and killing nine-tenths of the population. If only that toll had included Maggie My and her darling ex-husband, Frank.

Maggie was a cop: a plainclothes police detective. She is, however, not a very good person.

MIKE BARNES 3

You may have felt like a loser at points in your life (and justifiably so), but you'll never be a terrified monkey dancing for an audience in a banana suit. Mike is a Druid. A very specialized Druid. A Banana Farmer.

He shoots banana tree seeds from his hands and makes them grow really fast. That's it.

Still, there's something to be said for doing one thing extremely well, and having a tree explode from your body is a surprisingly gruesome way to die.

MIRIAM DOM

A gentle Italian goatherd, Miriam entered the dungeon with her 15 Boer goats and quickly became a fan favorite. Her popularity skyrocketed when she fed enhanced pet biscuits to her little herd. Wild. She got fucking lucky it worked out well for two of the goats, though... not so well for others. Bianca is now a Hellspawn Familiar mount, and Prepotente is the only other member of her party. As a Shepherd, she conceals and protects her allies—and their position on the leaderboard!

GOOD "LU

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PREPOTENTE

"Carl, I should have known such a colossal fuck-up could only be perpetrated by such a colossal dolt."
—Prepotente

Prepotente Lorenzo De La Rosa—affectionately called *Pony* by Miriam—was a Boer goat until an enhanced pet biscuit turned him into an intelligent crawler. Now he's a Caprid and a favorite on *Plenty of Plenty*. This Forsaken Aerialist has earned his dedicated fans due to unorthodox ways of defeating enemies, but others see him as lazy for casting Debuff after Debuff and letting his Spells do the work. It may not be much to watch, but you can't argue with results that keep him on the leaderboard!

QUAN CH

"She'd be ashamed of what I've become."
—Quan Ch

A devoted, loving father and a ranked card game champion, Quan is perhaps one of the most misunderstood and... ahh, who am I kidding? This guy is a power-tripping bully and coward, a player-killer, and a kill-sniping, loot-stealing piece of shit. He even tried to kill an innocent puppy. Probably. Booo. But he really is very good at card games and gaming the system.

TRAN

Some heroes are understated people who are just good. Tran is one of those people: a good, quiet, sensible guy. Steadfast. Effective. Bad things happen to him, but he powers on anyway. In his case, some of those bad things include having lost his best friend and, well... his legs.

But every dark cloud has a silver lining; in Tran's case, his legs were replaced with a badass crab-legged mech suit that can climb on walls and has enough armor to nearly class him as a Golem. All the better to avenge his lost comrades.

TSERENDOLGOR

From the plains of rural Mongolia to the runways of Paris, then the depths of the World Dungeon, Tserendolgor is a brave fighter, as well as a resilient and effective crawler. Now a Dog Soldier—an anthropomorphic German Shepherd—she braves the hordes of Mobs with little more than a Vietnam-era helmet and her trusty enchanted flamethrower, Velma. Oh... and Garret. Garret is a Tummy Acher, which is basically a giant meatball that hits things real hard. He smells a little like expired chorizo, which just makes him cuter to a Human-turned-canine Crisper Class.

VADIM

Doctor Vadim was a world-renowned cosmetic surgeon based in Ukraine. He had television commercials and billboards and stuff everywhere, marketing his clinics. What wasn't so heavily advertised were the dozens of malpractice suits or the fact that he seduced many of his clients and left them with a little extra something to deliver nine months later. Maybe that was what drew him to the "Gut Rearranger" Class.

YVETTE

Poor Yvette. One of Earth's little tragedies. She ran away from home to escape her daddy, Frank, but was picked up by her mom's little brother, a beat cop in Seattle. Then Mommy Maggie showed up, and it was on.

Yvette, apparently more terrified of her batshit-insane family than she was of the appearance of a mysterious glowing stairwell during the apocalypse, fled her family while they brawled with one another. She plunged headlong into the dungeon. Unfortunately for her, her parents decided to tag along.

CK", CRAWLERS!!!

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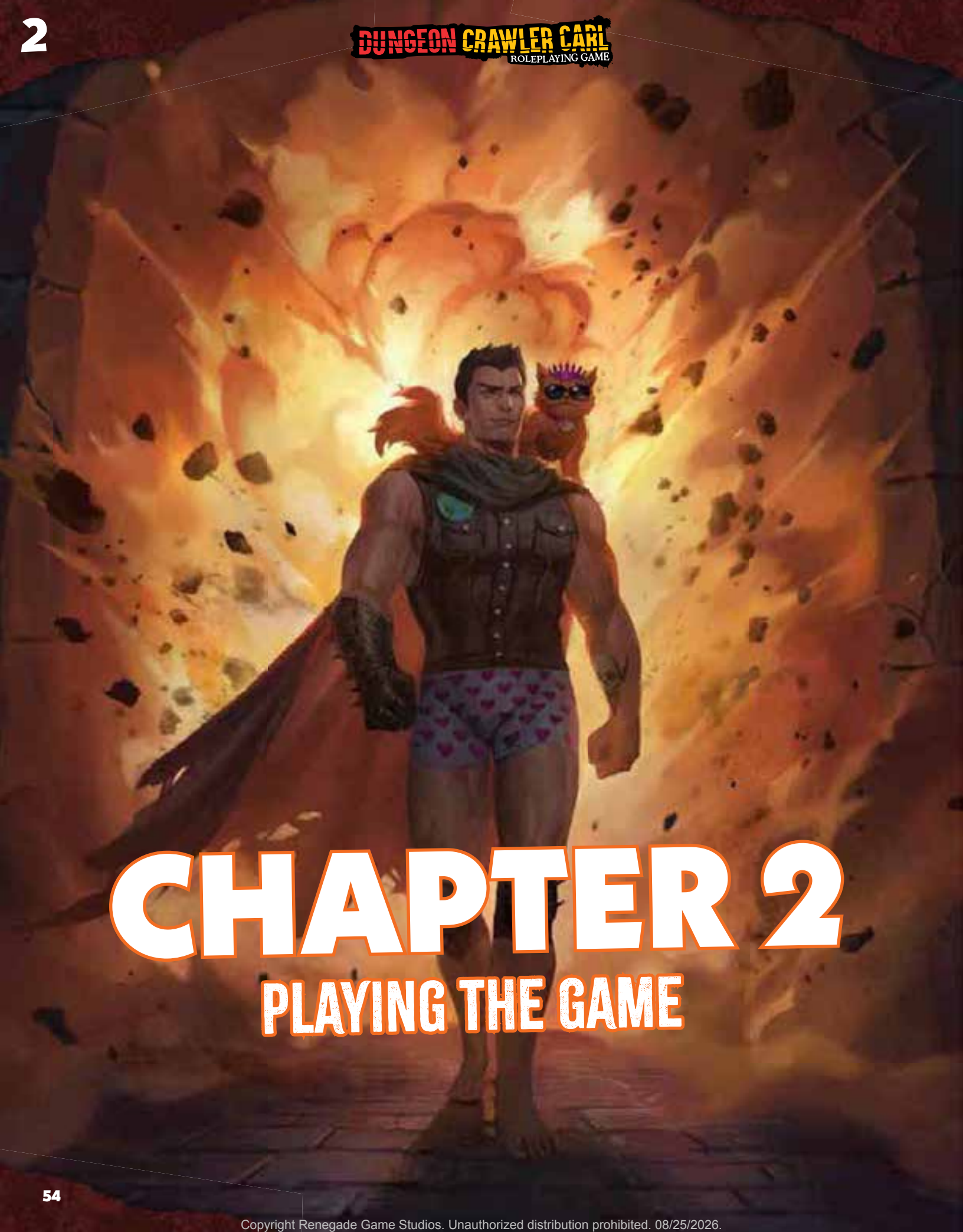

CHAPTER 2

PLAYING THE GAME

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THE RULES IN GAMES LIKE THE *DUNGEON CRAWLER CARL ROLEPLAYING GAME* AREN'T JUST A NECESSARY EVIL. THEY LET THE DICE HELP EVERYONE TELL A SHARED STORY. THEY LET PLAYERS AND GAME MASTERS (GMS) KNOW WHAT CHARACTERS TYPICALLY CAN AND CANNOT DO. AND THEY CAN, OCCASIONALLY, BE IGNORED OR BROKEN IN FAVOR OF TELLING A GREAT STORY.

This chapter presents the basics of rolling dice, Stats, Skills, and determining when actions a player's crawler takes are successful or not, as well as how well they succeeded or how badly they failed. This chapter is your main rules reference for the daily activities of crawlers.

FUCK THE RULES?

That's right. As a GM, you can bend, fold, spindle, and mutilate the rules... but we urge caution when doing this. See *Patching the Rules* (p. 276) for advice on telling the rules to suck it.

Glurp, glurp!

DICE

Like most roleplaying games, the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** uses dice to determine the outcomes or consequences of players' Actions. The dice add a random element that can lead the story in different directions, and that unpredictability is what makes gameplay so exciting for the viewers at home.

TYPES OF DICE

The **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** utilizes many types of dice. During gameplay and in rules descriptions and tables, the inclusion of a "d" represents "die" or "dice," which is paired with the number of sides on the die. A "d6" represents a typical six-sided die included in many board games, and a "d20" represents the 20-sided die, which is used for many roleplaying games. Like those games, the d20 is the most commonly used die when exploring the World Dungeon.

THE D20

The most common die players use in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** is the d20, which is used to determine Success or Failure in many cases.

The d20 roll is central to gameplay, and players always want to roll high when rolling a d20. But if they roll low, that's great, too, because then everyone's favorite System AI gets to wreak some havoc.

GMs do not roll the d20 for Mobs and other effects; fate is in the hands of the players and their crawlers.

OTHER DICE

Dice, from the two-sided die (d2) to the 12-sided die (d12), are used for a variety of tasks. Players will use many dice to roll for effect, and the most common effect roll is to determine damage in combat. Some dice have additional uses, like the d2, which is often used when helping a fellow crawler succeed at a task.

The value given before the letter "d" indicates if multiple copies of the same die need to be rolled. For example, if a rule says to roll 3d6 to calculate the damage from an Attack, that means the player should roll three six-sided dice and add them together for the Attack's final damage value.

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ROUNDING

Sometimes an effect requires a player to use half or a quarter of a value. In any case where rounding is called for, round down unless it specifically says otherwise.

At times, a static number is added or subtracted from the die roll, indicated by placing a + or − after the die listing, followed by the static number. For example, 2d8+4 means to roll two eight-sided dice, add them together, and then add 4. If a die notation has a minus sign after it and then a number, you subtract the number from the result of the die or dice instead.

Who knew when you left your school days behind that real life would require so much math? Don't worry. You'll figure it out... or someone else at the table will.

UNCOMMON DICE

"Luck goes both ways, like your mom." The same logic applies to a d2. The rules may occasionally call for a d2 (a two-sided die). While there are dice marked 1–2, it's also possible to just roll a d6, treating results of 1–3 as a 1 and 4–6 as a 2 to make a d2. Or just flip a coin.

If you need d100, and generally only the GM would use this to roll on a table, grab two 10-siders. Roll one for the 10s place and the other for the 1s place. Some d10s are numbered 0–9 while others are 1–10. If you get a result of 0-0 or 10-10, consider it 100.

VIRTUAL DICE

If you prefer, numerous electronic options can replace the use of physical dice. If you'd rather use virtual table top software, it almost certainly includes a dice-roller option, allowing you to roll any combination of dice and modifiers. Players may also utilize online or app-based dice-rollers and random number generators.

"The first menu was player stats. Like I mentioned earlier, I'd played a handful of computer and tabletop RPGs over the years, so this section wasn't too surprising."

—Carl

THE FIVE CORE STATS

At the core of every crawler, Mob, Boss, and NPC are the Five Core Stats. Each one measures a crawler or other character's aptitude in physical or mental categories, including:

- **Strength (Str):** A measure of physical power. It's the backbone for Skills that use brawn and focus on physical combat.
- **Intelligence (Int):** A measure of smarts and knowledge. Not only is Intelligence the basis for Skills based on wit and wisdom but it also determines the amount of Mana your crawler can access to power most Spells (at a 1:1 ratio). Dummies also don't last long in the dungeon. Work smarter, not harder.
- **Constitution (Con):** A measure of toughness and physical gumption. It's the core of Skills centering on stamina, both mental and physical, and it determines your Health. Viewers like crawlers who can take a hit or seventeen, so get tough, and stay tough.
- **Dexterity (Dex):** A measure of agility and coordination. Dexterity is fundamental for Skills that rely on speed and nimbleness, and it enhances your ability to avoid Attacks. This isn't a dance competition (yet), but being light on your feet will most certainly come in handy.
- **Charisma (Cha):** A measure of your presence, whether charming or intense. Charisma is at the heart of Skills that influence, cajole, and coerce, and it's necessary to attract viewers of the intergalactic games how of *Dungeon Crawler World*. If you can get everyone else to like you, they're less likely to want you dead. Right?

Each of these Stats has a score. That score is a number between 1 and... well, you don't know the upper limit right now. A typical Human crawler starts with scores between 3 and 5. If you're using a ready-to-play crawler, their Stats may already be filled in. To learn more about creating your own crawler, see Chapter 3.

These scores can be used for direct comparison to gauge capability. A Stat's potency also determines the modifier that is added to d20 Checks (see Table 2).

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TABLE 2: STAT MODS

STAT VALUE	STAT MODIFIER
1–2	+1
3–5	+2
6–9	+3
10–19	+4
20–49	+5
50–99	+6
100–149	+7
150–199	+8
200–299	+9
300+	+10

STATS AND MODS

When referring to Stats, if the text refers to the full name, such as Intelligence, it refers to the score. When it refers to the abbreviation, such as INT, it refers to the modifier value. Generally, the scores are used for comparison or some derived values—like a crawler's Strength score is used to determine what they can lift—while the modifier values apply to most gameplay Actions and rolls.

UNENHANCED & ENHANCED STATS

Stats are divided into two layers. A crawler's base layer, called Unenhanced, includes their Stats when they walk into the World Dungeon, plus boosts from their Race, Class, Stat potions, and permanent transformations. As crawlers gain new Stat Points from leveling up (see *Crawler Advancement,* p. 169), these improve the Unenhanced Stat layer.

The second layer of Stats, called Enhanced, includes the Unenhanced score plus any bonuses from gear, Spells, Buffs, and other sources. If you want to thrive in the dungeon, you've got to pay attention to both layers. Then add some frosting, some candles, and voilà! Crawler Cake.

SKILLS

In addition to Stats, crawlers also possess a variety of Skills. These Skills represent specific ways that knowledge, training, experience, and other factors combine to augment crawlers' Stats.

The variety of Skills in the game are filtered into the following categories:

- **Attacks:** These Skills represent aptitude with weapons, techniques, tactics, and other abilities to help a crawler survive against the odds of the World Dungeon's denizens and monster Mobs.
- **Spells:** These Skills show a crawler's ability to warp reality, shaping their available Mana into a variety of effects. Many are used in combat, while others are used in exploration or social settings.
- **Utility:** These Skills help crawlers navigate the dungeon, influence NPCs, craft items, and perform other useful Actions outside of combat. They're rarely helpful in direct combat and are more effective when exploring the dungeon or interacting with NPCs and other crawlers.
- **Passive:** Some Skills in the above categories are marked as Passive. Passive Skills don't require Skill Checks to activate, but they also advance more slowly than other Skills.

Each Skill ranges from 0 to 20, though training up a Skill past 15 requires particularly impressive attention to and honing of the Skill (yeah... good luck with that). To see all the Skills available to crawlers, benefits for increasing their Ranks, and to create your own Skills, see Chapter 4.

If you manage to reach Rank 16 or higher you... lucky you! Unfortunately, the Rank 16+ benefits that come with it do not come online until the Sixth Floor.

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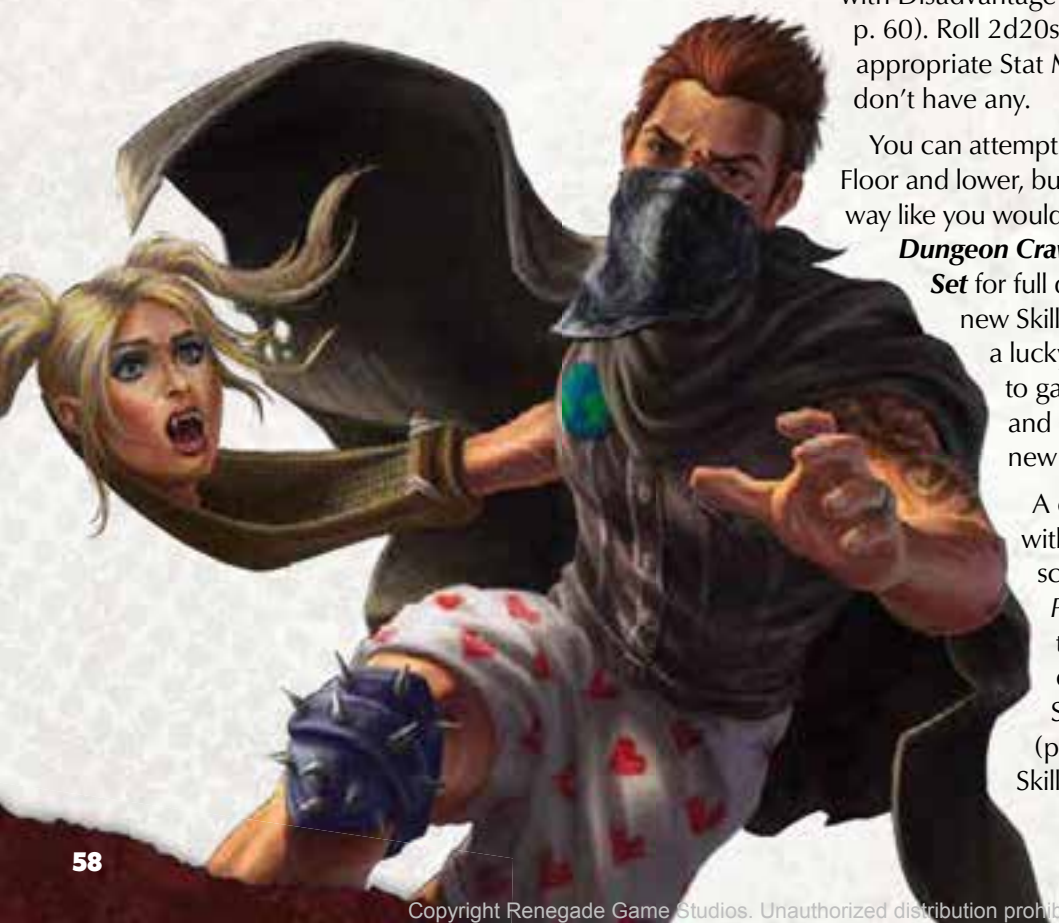
THE CORE MECHANIC

Whenever interesting (or dangerous) possibilities emerge as a crawler attempts to affect their current predicament, you make a Check. For each Check:

1. **Determine the Challenge:** The players and GM discuss the challenge at hand and the cost of Failure, setting the situation so all players know what's at stake.
2. **Determine the Approach—Stats & Skills:** With the challenge in mind, each player chooses their approach to the challenge narratively, which then determines how the rules support that plan. In some cases, a crawler will have the appropriate Skill, which determines which Stat Mod applies to the effort as well.

   In other cases, it may be most helpful to think about which of the Five Core Stats the challenge applies to, then determine which Skill (if any) is the best way to apply that Stat to the situation. In other cases, a Stat alone may be the best way to check whether the crawlers succeed or fail.

   Once Stats and Skills are decided, apply the Stat Mod and Skill Ranks; these modify the player's d20 roll in their attempt to overcome the challenge.
3. **Apply Benefits and Penalties:** In addition to the crawler's Stats and Skills, a variety of effects can occur, ranging from lighting and situational benefits bestowed on a crawler (called Buffs) to darkness and situational penalties that affect a crawler (called Debuffs). The most common benefit is a catch-all called Advantage, while the most common penalty is called Disadvantage.
4. **Roll the d20:** Once Stats, Skills, and any benefits or penalties are determined, the player rolls a d20 and adds the die roll result to the total from Steps 1 through 3.
5. **Compare the Total to the Difficulty:** If the total of the Check meets or beats the value of the Difficulty determined by the GM, the crawler succeeds. If the total is less, they fail.
6. **Determine Degrees of Success or Failure:** In addition to Success or Failure, a crawler can succeed with additional positive effects or fail with lingering consequences.



CHECKS WITHOUT SKILL RANKS

When determining the approach, a player can attempt an Attack or Utility Skill Check without their crawler having training in that Skill, but they must roll with Disadvantage (see *Advantage & Disadvantage*, p. 60). Roll 2d20s, use the lower result, and add the appropriate Stat Mod as usual, but no Ranks, as you don't have any.

You can attempt to use Skills untrained on the Third Floor and lower, but you won't gain any new Skills this way like you would on the Tutorial Floors. (See the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set*** for full details of the Tutorial Floors.) Gain new Skills via gear with Skill bonuses, drink a lucky potion, or visit a Guild and pay to gain a new Skill at Rank 1. Your Race and Class might also grant you some new Skills.

A crawler can't attempt a Spell without Ranks in the Spell (unless it's a scroll). Similarly, a Skill designated as *Passive* doesn't require a Skill Check to be made and cannot be attempted untrained, nor does a Passive Skill receive advancement marks (p. 169) through normal use. Such Skills must be gained via magical means

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or on the Third Floor via a Race or Class selection. Keep in mind, there are drawbacks to choosing certain Races and Classes—looking at you, Hobgoblins.

STAT CHECKS

Some Checks rely on the pure power of the Stat without the finesse of a Skill added. These are called Stat Checks and operate identically to the above, except that they skip Step 2. Some examples of Stat Checks and sample Difficulties include:

- **Strength:** To force open a stuck door. Difficulty 10 + Floor Number
- **Intelligence:** To recognize an illusion. Difficulty 10 + Rank of the illusion Spell
- **Constitution:** To avoid the effects of alcohol. Difficulty 10 + Floor Number
- **Dexterity:** To swing on a chandelier. Difficulty 10 + Floor Number
- **Charisma:** To avoid being beguiled or charmed. Difficulty 10 + the CHA of the perv trying to manipulate you

Stat Checks can also be used for normal tasks done under pressure, where Failure has consequences... glorious, glorious consequences. Other crawlers cannot aid you with Stat Checks.

DETERMINING THE DIFFICULTY

The GM sets the Difficulty based on how hard it is to do something successfully. The Difficulty is the number the crawler must meet or exceed with their d20 roll, plus all modifiers and Buffs, to be successful in the Check.

The Difficulty starts at a base of 10, modified by the number of the Floor the crawler is on—the dungeon wants the crawlers challenged—then modified based on whether it is Opposed or Unopposed. These tests are used for all Skill Checks since the GM doesn't roll d20s against the crawlers.

Always determine if the Check is Opposed or Unopposed before the crawler makes the Check. While the examples below are guidelines, the GM may simply assign a Difficulty of their choosing if that makes more sense than the formulas that follow.

Okay, more math stuff coming up. If this is too tough, maybe ask your parents to help you with your homework.

OPPOSED CHECKS

An Opposed Check is one where someone or something is standing in the crawler's way (like a Mob, a Boss, another crawler, or your old manager and his damned TPS reports):

10 + antagonist's relevant Stat Mod + Floor Number

The Stat Mod value could be replaced by a Spell Rank, a size class, or whatever force the crawler is up against. Remember that the GM does not roll to "oppose" the crawler's rolls. GMs don't roll d20 Checks. Examples of Opposed Checks include social Checks to influence NPCs and combat, where a crawler's Skill is directly opposed by an antagonist.

UNOPPOSED CHECKS

An Unopposed Check is one that isn't directly against an antagonist and is instead based on how deep the crawler is in the World Dungeon:

10 + [Floor Number × 2]

Examples of Unopposed Checks include Climbing, Dumpster-Diving, Endurance, and most other Skills used to survive the World Dungeon. If the crawler isn't messing around with anyone when making these Skill Checks, it's considered Unopposed.

STAT CHECKS

A Stat Check is when a crawler relies only on their Stats to resist an effect from the environment or from Mobs. As crawlers don't add their Skill Ranks to these Checks, the Difficulty is lower and calculated as:

10 + Floor Number

See? Math isn't that hard.

PARTY SKILL CHECKS

Sometimes the whole party has to work together on a single Action, like sneaking past a Gnoll guard post, or climbing down a cliff together, or providing talk therapy to a depressed NPC who's holding the detonator to a bomb rigged to blow up the entire Neighborhood.

In such cases, every player rolls a Skill Check for their crawler and compares it to the Difficulty. If half or more of the party succeeds on their individual Skill Checks, the party succeeds. The crawlers can't aid each other since they're all performing the Skill together.

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In a Party Skill Check, an Amazing Success or better turns one party member's failed Check into a Success, while a Major Fail or worse turns another party member's Success into a Failure (see *Degrees of Success and Failure*, below).

ESCALATING CHECKS

Some Difficulties aren't a single number, but rather multiple escalating values, such as 12, 17, and 22 instead of just 17. It means the lower Difficulties still provide results, while higher Difficulties provide better results (such as a tomato is a fruit at 12, and you shouldn't put it in a fruit salad at 17, and it's okay if that fruit salad is a salsa at 22).

This often occurs when collecting information or group activities. The highest roll gets the best result, but everyone who rolled a Success often gets something—sharing the wealth of success.

When a single crawler makes an escalating Check, they gain the best result they achieved plus all results with a lesser Difficulty.

ADVANTAGE & DISADVANTAGE

When a rule instructs you to roll with Advantage or Disadvantage, it's always telling you what to do when you roll the d20 as part of a Check. When a crawler has Advantage, you roll an extra d20 and keep the best (highest) result. When a crawler has Disadvantage, you roll an extra d20 and keep the worst (lowest) result.

If you ever have both Advantage and Disadvantage, they cancel each other out, and you roll normally.

In a similar way, two instances of Advantage or Disadvantage don't combine: You still only roll one extra die. If you have two reasons to roll with Advantage and one for Disadvantage, one Advantage cancels out the Disadvantage, leaving you with Advantage.

MOB ADVANTAGE & DISADVANTAGE

When the GM's Mobs gain Advantage or suffer Disadvantage, it works differently since the GM doesn't roll the d20 (yes, we're going to keep reminding you of this).

When a Mob has Advantage, add 5 to the Difficulty of the Mob's Action, Evade, or other relevant quality. When a Mob has Disadvantage, the Difficulty of the Mob's Action, Evade, or other relevant quality is reduced by 5.

In the case of an Attack Action, the targeted crawler(s) gain a free Evade Check against the Disadvantaged Attack. If they fail that free Evade Check, the crawler may spend an Action to Evade and roll the Check again (and roll against additional Attacks as usual).

DEGREES OF SUCCESS & FAILURE

Determining Success is simple: Compare the crawler's final roll result to the Difficulty. If the result meets or exceeds the Difficulty, they succeed. If it doesn't, they fail.

Of course, viewers across the galaxy aren't tuning in for routine Success. They want daring moves, big risks, and spectacular outcomes—the messier, the better. Failure is often where real drama happens. The audience loves to see crawlers pushed to their limits, betting on who will fall and who will somehow survive against the odds.

When making a Check of any kind, your total result matters, though in many situations, extra Success or Failure simply adds flavor. The GM then determines how much your total result beat, or failed to beat, the Difficulty of the Check. The GM should announce the degree of Success or Failure, but not the exact amount they succeeded or failed by, except for a "Near Miss" result.

The following sections outline the different degrees of Success and Failure based on how much the crawler's roll beat or missed the Difficulty of the task. A result that is equal to the Difficulty is a "Success by 0"—tie goes to the runner, and all that. Critical Hits and Critical Fails do not also trigger the results of a Success or Failure by 10 or more; the crawler benefits from the single highest degree of Success or Failure.

Degrees of Success and Failure have additional mechanics in combat (see *Combat*, p. 79).

SUCCESS

Meeting or beating the Difficulty is a Success. It generally indicates progress toward a goal.

- **Natural 20 (Critical Hit):** On a roll of a Natural 20 (a 20 on the die without any modifiers), the best possible result occurs, and the crawler performs the Action perfectly.

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- **Success by 10 or more (Amazing Success):** The crawler's Action has more impact than normal, such as accomplishing the task more quickly, impressing nearby NPCs, using less material, or a similar effect.
- **Success by 0–9 (Standard Success):** This is the most basic Successful result.

FAILURE

A result under the Difficulty or target number is a Failure. The GM ultimately decides what happens, based on the degree of Failure and the current situation.

- **Fail by 1–2 (Near Miss Fail):** So close, but still a fail.
- **Fail by 3–9 (Standard Fail):** A normal Failure. To keep the game moving, the GM may allow a crawler to fail forward, also known as succeeding with a consequence.
- **Fail by 10 or more (Major Fail):** A Failure to this degree comes with some manner of consequence, such as breaking a common tool, the crawler embarrassing themselves, or spending too much time as the clock ticks closer to floor collapse.
- **Natural 1 (Critical Fail):** On a roll of a Natural 1 (a 1 on the die without any modifiers), the crawler achieves a Failure so abysmal that viewers might talk about it on the next recap episode. This Failure is the worst possible outcome, and consequences might include pummeling an ally instead of an enemy, breaking a weapon or an important tool, or gaining a Debuff. Also, you should be ashamed of yourself.

CHECKING AGAIN

For some Actions outside of combat, it may make sense to just try again. In cases when that's an option, consider skipping the Skill Check roll entirely unless there's an interesting consequence to the additional attempts. Trying something over and over again isn't exciting in play or for the recap show

When a crawler achieves a Major or Critical Fail, they cannot try to test the Skill again in that scene.

Once you have a high Rank Skill (around 8–10 or higher), your Checks are going to succeed a lot. When you are that good, you may get cocky. Showing off to the cameras can increase your Popularity (see p. 279), land you AI Favor (below), or even attention from current or potential Sponsors (p. 284). However, there's added complication. You roll that check with Disadvantage. No problem for a master like you! See *Playing to the Cameras,* p. 280.

FAILING FORWARD

Sometimes your players don't roll well when the story needs them to. A failed die roll shouldn't be a roadblock that prevents the story from moving forward.

If there are other avenues for Success (talk your way past the guard, fight your way past, sneak past), it isn't an issue. If there aren't other options, consider failing forward: a Failure on the dice doesn't mean Failure per se, but complications or heavy consequences accompany the Success.

You've heard of "out of the frying pan and into the fire," right? That's failing forward. Some consequences of a bad die roll that aren't utter Failure include:

- A trail that others can follow
- An item is used or used up
- Discovery by a Mob or other adversary
- Loss of AI Favor
- Loss of Health
- Lost time

AI FAVOR

Crawlers are the stars of the show, and without them, viewers across the galaxy couldn't follow their doomed exploits. Crawlers have incredible luck that helps them push past the limits of what's possible, sometimes with the System AI putting a thumb on the scale to help generate incredible results that make excellent TV. After all, if the AI is having a good time, so are the viewers. Probably.

Crawlers earn AI Favor by doing things that are heroic, foolish, stick it to the showrunners, or indulge the AI in some way. Players can spend this AI Favor to:

- Once per Check, reroll a d20 roll before the GM announces the result, except in the case of a Natural 1. Rolling a 1 tends to earn unlucky crawlers an appearance on the recap show's highlight reel.
- Once per round, gain an extra non-Attack Action for their crawler in combat.

CHECK EXAMPLE

Rachel's crawler, Keisha, faces a challenging puzzle in untangling which of the yarn-like colored lines of the Iron Tangle leads her party to their desired stop. Solving this part of the convoluted subway schedule is a difficult but necessary task to move the story forward.

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Rachel: Alright, I've stared at this for a while, and it's just not making sense to me. Does Keisha understand something with her Skills that I'm missing?

DJ (the GM): That sounds like an Intelligence Check.

THE STAT

Often, a specific Stat is the easiest part to determine after choosing the Action. Here, the GM calls for Intelligence, and Rachel agrees that the Stat fits since Keisha's approaching the puzzle cerebrally, so she makes the Check.

DJ: After a few moments, Keisha realizes there's a cipher needed to sort out the schedule diagram. Make an Investigation Check.

Rachel: Keisha doesn't have that Skill.

DETERMINING SKILLS

At this point, Rachel could decide to forgo adding a Skill. In this case, she could move forward with a Stat Check since it's a normal task, and the threat of the dungeon timer counting down is the only pressure. The GM decides there isn't a specific Skill needed, so there's no risk of Disadvantage for not having the relevant Skill this time.

DJ: There's more than one way to make sense of it. What other Skills does Keisha have that might work?

Rachel: Looks like I've got Dumpster Diving, Engineering, and Tracking. I don't think Dumpster Diving applies here. What about Engineering to understand how the subway lines operate?

THE NEGOTIATION

Here, Rachel and the GM discuss whether Keisha's Skills are suitable for this challenge, with Rachel proposing how she could narratively see Keisha solving the problem.

DJ: I'm pretty sure trash pandas don't know anything about subway trains, but I could see Engineering working.

Rachel: Excellent! Hey, do the dungeon engineering diagrams that Keisha stole from the Grimlock library help here?

DJ: The Grimlocks have modified the dungeon for their own ends... so that makes sense. Roll with Advantage!

OTHER BONUSES OR PENALTIES

Now that the applicable Stat and Skill have been chosen, it's up to Rachel and the GM to determine if any bonuses or penalties apply. In this case, Keisha has the right item for the job, so the GM grants her Advantage on the Skill Check.

Rachel: Alright, I rolled a 4 and a 16. With Advantage, I keep the 16, then add 2 for Keisha's INT and 5 for her Rank of 5 in the Engineering Skill, for a total of 23.

DJ: Nice job. That's a Success! Keisha starts tracing the subway lines with the crayon she pocketed from the last diner-themed safe house and determines that the blue rail has them arriving at the planned meeting place just in time.

DEGREES OF SUCCESS

With a Standard Success, Rachel learns the most obvious path. With an Amazing Success or better, the GM might decide that Keisha also deciphers a second faster line or even one that allows them to stop somewhere advantageous on the way.

Conversely, she'd waste precious time with a Failure. With a Major Fail, Keisha might be convinced that the only line that takes the team where they need to be won't arrive on time. With a Critical Fail, Keisha might fail to discover the path at all or even set the whole schedule on fire.

"After that was my skills menu. This section just went on and on and on. There seemed to be an infinite number of pages. If I didn't have the skill, I couldn't read what it said. It was still listed there, but the words were blurred out. Literally hundreds of pages would scroll by before I saw anything. Mordecai had me change the view to skills I did have, and that list was just as long."

—Carl

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TIME

Time is one of the greatest pressures on players (along with your parents' sweeping disapproval). At the start of every floor, the System AI sets the amount of time before the floor collapses, wiping out the entire floor and killing crawlers who don't descend to the next floor via a stairwell. In addition to that narrative time pressure, this game makes sure everyone has a chance by dividing time for players and their Actions.

GAME TIME

The ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*** breaks time down into narrative segments. Game-specific terms for time include:

- **Actions:** In a structured scene like a combat, each crawler gets two Actions. Their Actions can be split up, allowing crawlers to benefit from teamwork.
- **Rounds:** Similarly, in a structured scene, a round contains all of the Actions—both Mobs and crawlers. Each round lasts for 10 seconds.
- **Scenes:** A scene can either be loose or structured, and it includes all of the Actions taken in an area. In combat, a scene is all the rounds combined and is sometimes called an encounter. Outside of combat, the time spent in a location, such as talking in a saferoom, or traversing a dangerous swamp, or applying foot-themed Buffs via your Enchanted Pedicure Kit of the Sylph is a scene.

THE DUNGEON FLOOR CLOCK TIME

The crawlers have limited time on each floor to reach the stairwell to the next floor down. If they don't make it, they get crushed into oblivion along with the rest of the floor. Isn't that exciting?

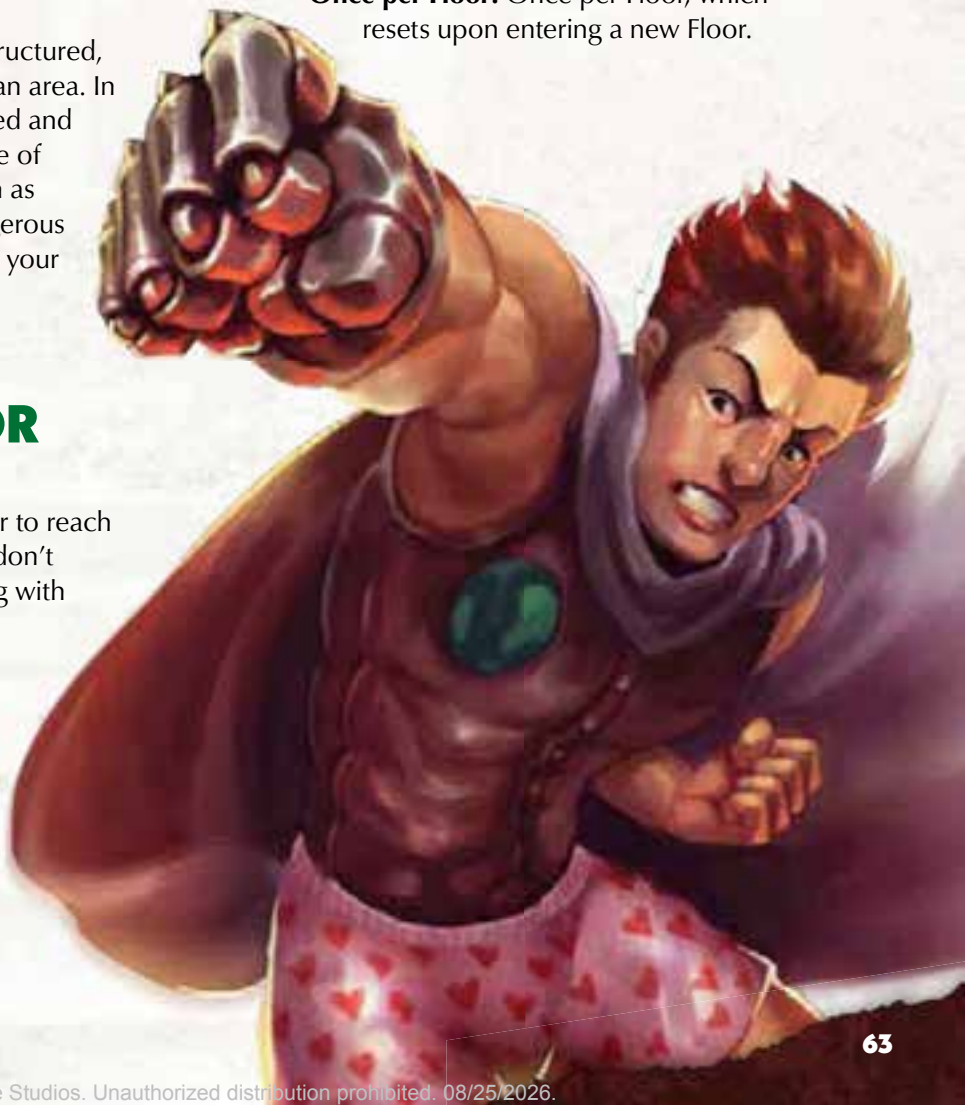
While the players and GM don't need to track time exactly or down to the minute, it's generally important to keep track of hours and days. Get a sense of how long the players want to spend on a floor, and have time either fly or stagnate to conform to that. The amount of time until floor collapse is announced at the beginning of each floor, and every crawler has access to the timer.

The GM can customize the time per floor, but generally, the Third Floor lasts eight days, the Fourth Floor lasts 10 days, and the Fifth Floor lasts 15 days. Unlike real-life time, each day in the dungeon is 30 hours.

COOLDOWNS

Time also factors into some of the abilities crawlers possess. Some Skills and magic items have cooldown periods, limiting how often they can be used. Below are some examples of these timers.

- **Once per Round:** You may not spend both of your Actions during a round doing this.
- **Once per Scene:** Once during a fight or bar visit.
- **Once per X Hours:** One and five hours are the most common. One hour is similar to meandering through a town. Five hours is clearing a Neighborhood of Mobs.
- **Once per Day:** Once per 30-hour dungeon day.
- **Once per X Days**: Once per X 30-hour days, but resets when transitioning to a new floor.
- **Once per Floor:** Once per Floor, which resets upon entering a new Floor.



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ACTIONS

When a crawler does something other than talking, they take an Action. Outside of combat, crawlers can take Actions in any order they like, with each one's result narrated by the GM.

In combat or another structured scene, each crawler gets to take two Actions each round. The crawlers can work together, taking their Actions in any order, to achieve their goals. The Mobs act first unless the crawlers surprise them. Some Actions, marked as an Interrupt, have special uses in a combat scene. More information on Interrupts and phases can be found under *Combat* (p. 79).

Each player should use tokens, coins, playing cards, or pieces of candy to keep track of the number of Actions they have. They should display this for all players, but especially the GM, to see. It speeds up combat greatly when everyone can see who has Actions remaining.

Each time a crawler takes an Action, they can take a Step, which, by default, is up to 10 feet of movement. For a list of Actions players can take for their crawlers, see Tables 3 and 4 (below).

In addition to these basic Actions, players can gain new Actions from Skills, items, and other sources. Details on Combat-Specific Actions can be found on p. 81.

NO HOLDING ACTIONS OR WAITING

Players can wait to use their Actions until after another crawler acts, but otherwise, players can't hold an Action or prepare for the next round. Combat is quick, and crawlers must make snap decisions—if they screw up, that just makes it more fun.

TABLE 3: ACTIONS

ACTION NAME	SUMMARY
Make a Check	Make a Skill Check or Stat Check to do what you want to do in the scene.
Cast a Spell	Choose a Spell or scroll in your Hotlist, and roll a Spell Check if it's an Attack. If it's a non-scroll Spell, spend Mana to cast it.
Move	Move up to your crawler's Move value (default 20 feet).
Help	Aid another crawler with their non-combat Skill Check, adding a 1d2 (without Skill Ranks) or 1d6 (with Skill Ranks) before the roll.
Use a Hotlist Item	Use a prepared consumable item or ready another Hotlist Item. To learn more about a crawler's Hotlist, see p. 98.
Retrieve	Move an item from a crawler's Inventory to their Hotlist or hand.

TABLE 4: COMBAT-SPECIFIC ACTIONS

ACTION NAME	SUMMARY
Attack	Use a Skill, Spell, or other effect that requires an Attack Skill Check against a target, rolling damage if Successful. Drawing or swapping a weapon from a Hotlist is free as part of that Action.
Call a Play	Plan an Action, giving an ally a bonus when they perform it.
Catcher (Interrupt)	Take a hit for an ally.
Evade (Interrupt)	Attempt to avoid Attacks against your crawler this round.
Heal (Typically an Interrupt)	Use a Spell or item to heal. Can also be used as a non-Interrupt Action inside or outside of combat.
Intervene (Interrupt)	Help another crawler with their Skill Check, adding 1d6 after they roll.
Look for Clues	In a Boss encounter, gain information about a foe or environment.
Taunt (Interrupt)	Protect an ally by redirecting a Mob's Attacks to yourself.

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SOCIAL INTERACTION

While exploring the World Dungeon and venturing outside of it, crawlers will meet and talk to many characters. These opportunities for social interaction can range from haggling with an NPC merchant to insulting the Maestro on his own program to gain fans.

Social interaction primarily takes place through roleplaying and Skill Checks.

ROLEPLAYING

Roleplaying means embodying a character, and it's a big part of everything players do in this game. Players roleplay by deciding how their crawler sees the world, the Actions they take, and how they talk. GMs do the same for all of the other characters and Mobs.

When a player or GM roleplays, they can take either an active or a narrative approach. No approach is wrong, and each player should go with what they're comfortable with, including mixing their approaches.

- **Active Approach:** Sometimes called "doing the voices," the Active Approach involves saying exactly what a character says and potentially acting out some of their mannerisms. It's like being back in your high school theater class—you know, the one you had to take to fulfill your fine arts credit sophomore year.
- **Narrative Approach:** A narrative approach involves describing what a character says and does. This one's more like your creative writing elective from junior year—you're telling the story and interacting while using descriptive language.

During roleplaying, it's important for players and the GM alike to pay attention to more than the words; Actions, tone, and attitude also play a part. All of these elements combine to tell the story and can give clues on how to influence that particular crawler or NPC.

USING SKILLS

In addition to saying or describing what a crawler says, Skill Checks can prove key to social interactions. Utility Skills like Deception, Detect Lies, Intimidate, Negotiation, and Persuasion are often used in addition to roleplaying to determine whether a crawler's speech does the job eloquently or if they're bumbling unintelligible nonsense.

Some players and GMs prefer to make their Skill Check before they roll to determine how well their words come across, while others prefer to roll the Skill Check after. As with approaches, both styles are valid.

Players should keep their Charisma Stat and Skills in mind as they roleplay their crawler, since they may need to make a Skill Check to back up their approach. While a player may be a smooth talker in real life, their crawler may say it in the most awkward or forgettable way without the requisite Skills to back it up, and the inverse can be equally true.

GAINING FANS AND FAME

Viewers across the galaxy can tune into *Dungeon Crawler World* to watch live feeds showing crawlers' exploits, adventures, and gruesome deaths. Crawlers who want to survive learn quickly to stand out to gain fans. Cultivating a large fan base can lead to lucrative sponsorships that yield incredible rewards. It can also open opportunities to appear on talk shows and other programs, where crawlers can learn more about the dungeon and the galaxy and make important friends and foes.

See Popularity (p. 279) for more.

SOCIAL PLAY EXAMPLE

In this example, the crawlers have survived long enough and risen high enough in the rankings to be invited to the Butcher's Masquerade, an event for the top 50 players on the Sixth Floor.

Theresa (the GM): Music fills the air, as crawlers and hunters alike mill about the immense ballroom. A grand stage is set up in the center of the room for performances, and incredibly enticing scents drift from the nearby buffet. High above, in the domed ceiling, is an immense mural depicting the mighty Scolopendra wrapped around a white tree. The centipede appears to move, constricting the tree almost to the breaking point before relaxing, only for the cycle to start again. As a reminder, there is a divine seal on this room. Weapons cannot be drawn, and Spells cannot be cast. You've also been told that anyone who breaks the seal by committing an act of violence is immediately banished to the Nothing for their transgression.

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Anisha (playing Wren): Wow. That's... a lot. Wren looks around to get a feel for the nearby crawlers and hunters.

Theresa: The room is packed, but there are about a dozen figures nearby. Seven of them are hunters of various Races based on their gamer tags and auras. The remaining five are crawlers, one of which is a large humanoid with at least nine player killer skulls.

Anisha: I'm going to head towards one of the crawlers without the player killer skulls. Preferably one that appears less aggressive.

Jose (playing Henry): I'm going to head over to the buffet and examine it. Maybe some of the food grants buffs.

Theresa: That's a great idea! After examining the food, you do find that there is a rack of ribs that grants a +5 to your Constitution for 30 hours, and a beverage called Eldritch Vodka. Its description reads, "This exotic alcohol is a mixture of fermented potato mash and the tentacle slime of Cthulhian beasts. Consuming it inflicts the Shit-Faced debuff but grants +15 to Strength, and a Resistance of 30 against Ice damage."

Jose: Heck yeah! I'm taking some of that weird vodka and definitely getting a plate of those ribs.

SPLITTING THE PARTY

In situations where there doesn't seem to be much danger, splitting the party is a great way to accomplish multiple goals and give each player or player group small scenes where they're the center of attention.

Theresa: How about you, Mark? What are you doing?

Mark (playing Venus): I'm going to wander up to the hunters, taking note of their sponsors. When I reach them, I curtsy and address them all cheerfully. I want to congratulate them on making it to the Butcher's Masquerade and engage them in conversation, hoping to get whatever information I can from them.

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NARRATIVE ROLEPLAY

Mark prefers to narrate what Venus says and does in a general sense. Since he's not saying the exact words, it's helpful for him to describe Venus' emotions, attitude, and intent so everyone can get a clear picture of what Venus' Actions look like.

Theresa: That seems like a very charismatic approach. Go ahead and give me a Diplomacy Skill Check based on Charisma.

Mark: We're on the Sixth Floor, right? So I'm trying to get at least a 22? I've got plus 5 for CHA, and 10 Ranks in Diplomacy, so I only need to roll a 7. I got an 18! That makes the total 33! That's gotta be an Amazing Success, right?

Theresa: Yes, it is! The hunters are a bit taken aback by your brazen approach of those who have been hunting you and your kind for the last two weeks, but they quickly recover and settle into conversation. It's obvious to you that they don't quite see you as an equal, but you weave your words around them and soon have them spilling their secrets!

Mark: Do I find out anything interesting?

Theresa: One of the hunters, a Crocodilian named Grikson, lets slip that his sponsor is looking for crawlers to back. The Society of Inorganic Subslime is having a difficult time since the majority of the good sponsor slots are already taken. They've actually taken legal action in the courts to try to open up more sponsorship slots.

Marianne (playing Michelle): While Venus is talking, I'll just drift around the group. I want to be able to hear the conversation but not be involved in it, so I can keep an eye on what's going on around us. I don't like the idea of any of us being alone and unprotected, despite the seal that's supposed to be in place.

ROLEPLAYING MOTIVATIONS

In Michelle's backstory, she got separated from her family shortly after entering the dungeon. Believing them all to be dead by now, she is particularly paranoid about losing her found family. Giving crawlers backstory and motivations that guide their Actions makes them feel like real people.

Theresa: Marianne, it's fairly loud in the room, so please make a Perception Check to listen in.

Marianne: I've got 9 Ranks in Perception; I assume it's Intelligence, which is a plus 4 for me. So that makes it a total of 22 with the 9 on the die.

Theresa: The conversation is just loud enough to catch the majority of it, and it doesn't appear they've noticed you listening in. Daniel, what are you doing while all of this is going on?

Daniel (playing Chase): We should be safe enough here. I mean, if anyone Attacks me, they get banished to the Nothing, right? I'm going to wander the ballroom and see if I can find any allies among the crawlers here.

Theresa: Most of the crawlers seem to shy away from you a bit after glancing above your head. Though one does approach you directly. A crawler in the form of a small foxlike creature steps up to you, puffing himself up in an attempt to intimidate you. In your HUD, you can see his name, Kazimir, and his crawler number. He'll make an Opposed Intimidation Skill Check. You need to beat a 17.

Daniel: I've only got 3 Ranks in Intimidate, but I've also got a plus 5 for Charisma, so that should help. With a 12 on the die roll that gives me a non-natural 20.

Theresa: The little fox is less than intimidating, even in his puffed-up state. He looks above your head and says, "I see you've got a pair of player skulls. I've got several myself. Got 'em on the Third Floor when I found a few crawlers dumb enough to sleep in a hallway rather than a saferoom. Where'd you get yours?"

DUNGEON INFORMATION

A few sessions ago, Chase was forced to kill a pair of crawlers who tried to take out the party, and he's forever marked with Player Killer Skulls (see *Crawler vs. Crawler*, p. 87). While this might play well with lawless types, the stain on his profile means that upstanding crawlers are less interested in talking to a killer. It may, however, grant some benefits when trying to intimidate them. The GM crawlers (GMCs) can also glean other information through their HUD.

Daniel: "I got mine because I had to. We got jumped and were forced to defend ourselves. What is wrong with you? We should be on the same side!"

Theresa: The fox is surprised by your response, a sneer crossing his face. "Wake up man! It's kill or be killed out there. If I don't shoot you, then you're just another gun pointed at my back."

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"Look, folks, I can't let you through. The monsters follow the rules and don't come in here. If they can do it, so can you."

—Vernon the Conductor

Daniel: "That's exactly what they want. You know you're playing into their hands, right? Doing exactly what the showrunners want?"

ACTIVE ROLEPLAYING

Unlike Mark, Daniel is playing out the role of his crawler, Chase. He is speaking the words as if he were Chase, talking to the other crawlers, rather than a player in a game. This helps to bring the character to life with speech patterns and styles, while increasing the immersion into the game for everyone at the table.

Theresa: Roll a Persuasion Skill Check for me, Daniel.

Daniel: I rolled a 12 on the die, plus 5 for my Charisma, and 8 for my Ranks in Persuasion. That's 25 total.

Theresa: The fox creature looks confused but seems to consider your words. After a few moments, he nods. "Hmmm, you may have a point there. I despise those mudskipper pricks!"

CHANGING NPC ATTITUDES

At the beginning of the conversation, the fox creature was aggressive towards Daniel. With a Successful Skill Check, their attitude becomes friendly, and the GMC stands down. Continued conversation becomes a much more likely option.

Daniel: "We all need allies here. I'm willing to have your back, if you're willing to have mine. So long as you don't go hunting any more crawlers. Deal?"

Theresa: "The hunters are still fair game, though, right?"

Daniel: "Absolutely!"

Theresa: The fox agrees to your terms, introducing himself as Kaz, and promising to ally with you if you both make it to the next floor.

Daniel: Outstanding! Can I make a Detect Lie Skill Check to make sure he's telling the truth?

Theresa: You certainly can, but whether you succeed or fail, you'll be convinced that what you believe is the truth.

Daniel: I'm gonna go for it. I've still got my plus 5 in Charisma, but only 2 Ranks in Detect Lie. Maybe you guys should tell me lies more often so I can practice the Skill. I rolled an 8. So my total is 15.

Theresa: As best you can tell, he's telling you the truth. Jose, how are you over at the buffet table?

Jose: I'm still carrying around a full bottle of the Eldritch Vodka since I can't access my inventory at the moment. I'll drop it there as soon as I can access it again.

Theresa: Is there anything else you'd like to do?

Jose: Yes. I look around the room as a grin spreads across my face. Striding confidently up to the stage, I climb the steps and grab the microphone.

Theresa: Quite a few of the attendees watch you with a mixture of curiosity, disgust, and confusion as you ascend the stairs to the main stage.

Jose: Henry clears his throat and then starts belting out "Holding Out for a Hero" by Bonnie Tyler at the top of his lungs!

EMBRACE OUTSIDE REFERENCES

Media references are part of what makes the setting of **Dungeon Crawler Carl** so fun, and sometimes tragic, by reminding the crawlers of the world they've lost.

Theresa: HA! Make a Singing* or Performance sort of Skill Check then!

Jose: I don't even have that Skill, so I have to roll with Disadvantage. I got an 18 on my first roll... and a 16 on my second, so I've gotta take the 16. I've also got a plus 7 for my Charisma, so that makes the total 23.

Theresa: Awesome! That's a Standard Success. Your sheer enthusiasm draws the attention of the whole ballroom, hunters and crawlers alike, as you unleash your newly discovered talent on a room full of strangers.

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EXPLORING THE ENVIRONMENT

Crawlers spend most of their time in the dungeon exploring the environment as they seek loot, Bosses, saferooms, stairwells, and other opportunities.

VISION & LIGHT

Most crawlers need light to take in their environment. The Third Floor provides a standard day-and-night cycle, with daytime light from an artificial, blazing-red sun. The Fourth Floor uses electric lighting on the subterranean, subway-themed floor, so it's hard to tell day from night, as there is no difference. The Fifth Floor features a whole lotta bubbles and a cartoonishly yellow sun. Beware of a second sun, however, as it usually heralds sandstorms!

Torch Spells and physical torches are also a common reward in Bronze Adventurer Boxes, allowing crawlers to carry their own light. Unfortunately, Mobs, Bosses, and player-killer crawlers often use the dark and obfuscation to snuff out unsuspecting crawlers.

- **Bright Light:** Crawlers suffer no penalties in areas of bright light, like near the center of a torch item, Torch Spell, lantern, or other item that provides light.
- **Dim Light:** In areas of dim light, crawlers suffer Disadvantage on Investigation, Perception, and other Skill or Stat Checks that rely on vision.
- **Darkness:** Skill and Stat Checks are made with Disadvantage when in darkness, if the lack of light matters. Lifting a sewer grate might be no harder in darkness than in light, for example, but navigating a claustrophobic maze-like structure is a different story. When moving through darkness, crawlers treat the ground as Difficult Terrain (see below).

Torches provides 20 feet of bright light and another 20 feet of dim light past that. The Torch Spell (p. 212) is also useful for dealing with the dark. Some Races and classes also gain a benefit that lets them see in the dark—these crawlers treat areas of dim light and darkness as brightly lit.

Some crawlers can also see to extraordinary ranges, such as twice or more as far as others. Those crawlers gain Advantage on Perception and other vision-related non-combat Skill Checks to take in details at long ranges.

MOVEMENT

As a default, a crawler can cover 20 feet with a Move Action. In addition to taking a Move Action, every time a crawler takes an Action, they can also take a Step, which defaults to 10 feet of distance. Steps come free with Actions: A Step isn't it's own Action. A crawler who spends both Actions moving can move a total of 60 feet on their turn—now that's a 0 to 60 we can all get behind.

Crawlers can split their movement across Actions. For example, a crawler with 2 Actions can take the Move Action (giving them 20 feet of movement plus a 10-foot step for 30 feet total), and interrupt their move after 25 feet to take a second Action (gaining another 10-foot Step), then move the remaining 15 feet (40 feet total).

Crawlers can move through unoccupied spaces and spaces occupied by their allies. They cannot move through an enemy space.

Most crawlers move on the ground, tethered by gravity, and must make an effort to climb, leap, or swim.

DIFFICULT TERRAIN

No matter how fancy your feet may be, many types of dungeon terrain can slow down crawlers, Mobs, and other creatures. This includes rubble, thick undergrowth, snow, mud, uneven ground, shallow water, and other effects. Movement across difficult terrain costs 1 additional foot of Move for every foot moved.

DROPPING PRONE

Crawlers can hit the deck on their turn without spending an Action or any movement, gaining the Take Down Debuff. Standing up requires 10 feet of Move, which can be the crawler's Step.

PICKING UP ITEMS FROM THE GROUND

If a crawler needs to pick something up off the ground in a combat scene or other stressful event, whether it's a dropped weapon or an important MacGuffin or anything in between, they can spend 10 feet of Move (such as their Step) to pick it up.

FORCED MOVEMENT

In addition to voluntary movement on a crawler's turn, some effects force movement with a distance in feet. Figure 1 shows the three types of forced movement are:

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- **Pull:** Every foot of forced movement must draw the target closer to the source of the effect. The tentacles of a Krakaren monster that pull crawlers toward its mouth are an example of a pull.
- **Push:** Every foot of forced movement must repel the target farther away from the source of the effect. When a wrestler crawler tosses a held Mob away from them, they're causing a push effect.
- **Slide:** The most versatile form of forced movement, a slide allows the source to move the target in any direction, including turning or changing directions. A crawler or Mob that uses telekinesis to freely move objects around is an example of a slide.

SPECIAL FORMS OF MOVEMENT

In addition to simply moving across the ground, crawlers may need to climb, crawl, jump, and swim to navigate the environment. You didn't think we'd make getting around that easy, did you?

- **Burrowing:** Some Mobs, Races, and Classes can move through dirt and solid stone as if swimming. It costs 1 additional foot of Move for every foot burrowed, or 2 feet of Move through solid stone.
- **Climbing:** When climbing, it costs 1 additional foot of Move for every foot you move (2 extra feet in Difficult Terrain). Climbing may also require an Unopposed Climbing Skill Check to traverse areas with few handholds or sheer surfaces.
- **Crawling:** Crawlers can crawl? Who knew? Crawlers who move while prone do so at a crawl, which costs 1 additional foot of Move for every foot you move (2 extra feet in Difficult Terrain).
- **Jumping:** Crawlers can make an Unopposed Jumping Skill Check to leap over things, clearing a number of feet up to Rank + Str Mod. Jumping still costs Move but doesn't have any additional cost.
- **Swimming:** Swimming costs 1 additional foot of Move for every foot you move (2 extra feet in Difficult Terrain). Crawlers may need to make Unopposed Swimming Skill Checks against a swift current. Submerged crawlers also need to hold their breath (see Drowning under *Harsh Conditions*, p. 76).

When using one of these movements in difficult terrain, calculate your movement as you go. For example, if a crawler takes the Move Action to Swim 10 feet, then gets out of the water to move an additional 10 feet, they have used 30 feet of Move.

WHY DOES THE GAME USE FEET INSTEAD OF METERS?

Because the AI loves feet. Carl's in particular.

INNATE MOVEMENT TYPES

Creatures in the dungeon may skitter along walls, swim under the surface, or fly over crawlers. Sometimes they even move through crawlers, though that rarely ends well for the crawler in question.

Some crawlers gain access to special movement types from magic items, or from their Race and Class when they reach the Third Floor. Crawlers and creatures with these movement types do not need to make Skill Checks to use them.

- **Climb:** Creatures and crawlers with a climb Move travel across vertical surfaces without spending additional Move. That means it costs those Giant Spiders nothing extra to scare the daylights out of you.
- **Fly:** Creatures and crawlers with a fly Move can travel through the air. If a flying creature or crawler is knocked unconscious or prone, it falls from the air (see *Falling*, p. 76).
- **Swim:** Creatures and crawlers with a swim Move can travel freely through water and similar liquids without spending extra Move. Figuring out how to breathe underwater is another thing altogether.

TRAVEL PACE

In addition to tactically moving through the World Dungeon, crawlers will spend time traveling from one area or Neighborhood to another in their search for a stairwell, to visit locations on a Quest, to meet up with other crawlers, and many other reasons.

Crawlers traveling across the World Dungeon need to determine their marching order (see Movement above) and their pace. The crawlers' pace determines how quickly versus how carefully they're moving (see Table 5).

TABLE 5: TRAVEL PACE

PACE	MINUTE	HOUR	DAY
Fast	400 feet	4 miles	38 miles
Normal	300 feet	3 miles	29 miles
Slow	200 feet	2 miles	20 miles

The travel pace has mechanical impacts as well:

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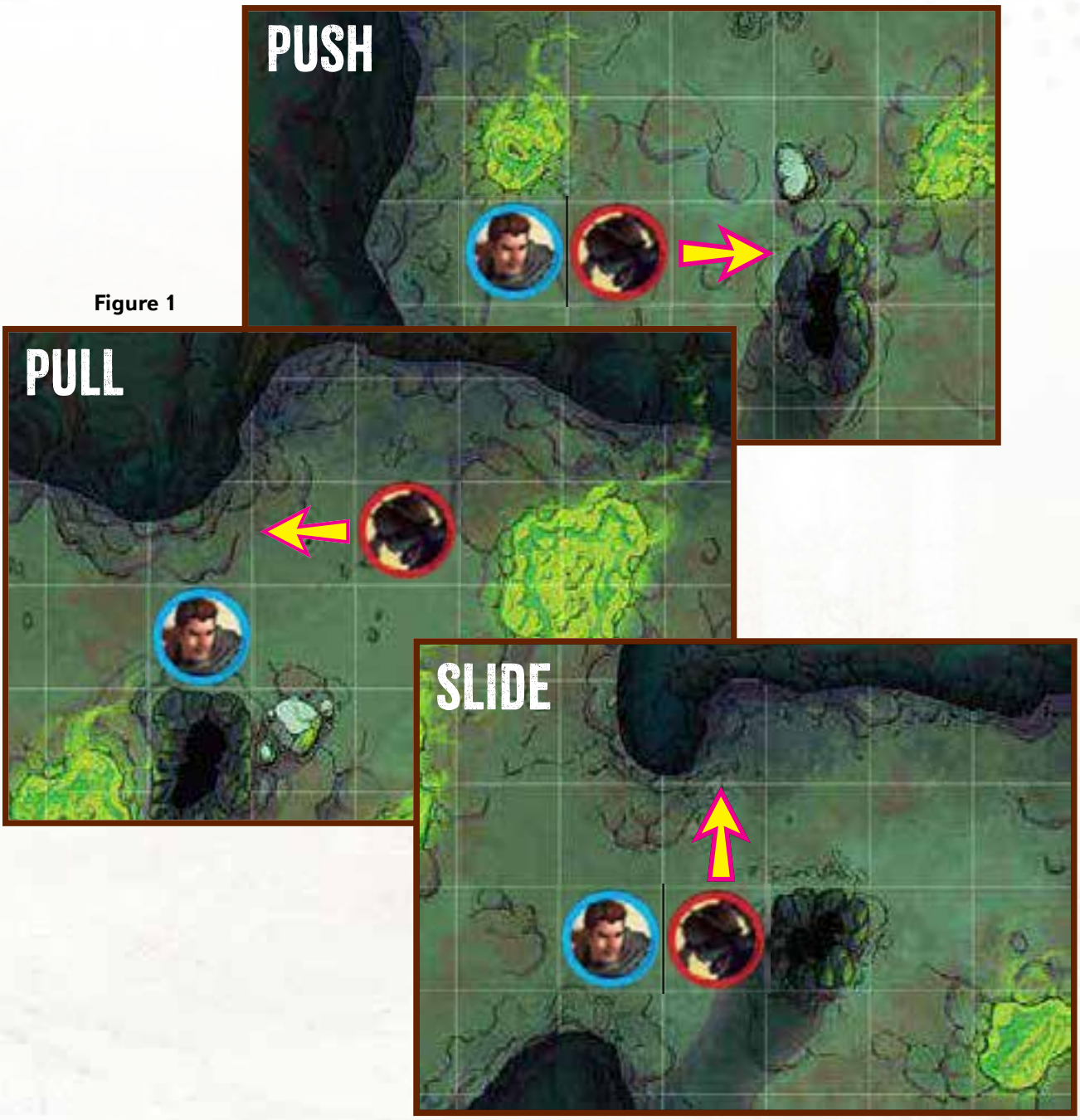

Figure 1

- **Fast:** Crawlers moving at a fast pace suffer Disadvantage on their Perception and Survival Skill Checks to notice danger and navigate the dungeon. They also cannot use Hide in Shadows or other efforts to conceal their movement.
- **Normal:** Crawlers moving at a normal pace suffer no benefits or penalties to their Skill Checks.
- **Slow:** Crawlers moving at a slow pace gain Advantage on their Perception and Survival Skill Checks to notice dangers and navigate the dungeon.

Generally, pace to the minute and to the hour are most helpful for overland travel, and a day's travel assumes 10 hours of the 30-hour day spent moving from one place to another. Crawlers can press on past that, but they must make an Unopposed Endurance Skill Check every additional 2 hours of travel or suffer a level of the Fatigue Debuff.

Vehicles can increase crawlers' travel pace significantly when moving from one part of the dungeon to another, such as making a high-speed exit to the stairwell.

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VEHICLES

Sometimes you feel the need... the need for speed. That's when you want a vehicle.

Vehicles are a non-autonomous means of locomotion. They do not have Actions but simply move according to the driver's wishes. Vehicle Skills have specific names. For example, motorcycle-riding is a Skill called "Chopper Pilot." Driving a vehicle with three or more wheels or tracks is called "Driving." We use the word Driving for both.

To enter a stationary vehicle, use 10 feet of Move (which could be a Step). To enter a moving vehicle, use a Move Action to make a DEX Stat Check with a Difficulty of 10 + [Move ÷ 2]. On Success, you don't snag your dangly bits on the gearshift.

Vehicles can get from point A to point B without needing a Skill Check. But when you try a cool maneuver or drive while in combat, you need to make a Check. The other time you'd need to make a Check is when there's a consequence. If you care, the Move of a vehicle roughly translates to its miles per hour.

The driver can stop at any point, can Move, Attack, Move, for example. There is no forced momentum here. During a subsequent Action, the driver may continue at the same Move rate, slow down, or stop.

If the GM decides there are consequences for failure (outrunning an explosion, needing to hit exactly 88 miles per hour, or something weirder), make an Unopposed Driving Skill Check. Your result determines your vehicle's performance, see Table 6.

Alternatively, if there are consequences for failing to decelerate in time (like when approaching a cliff, a wall, or a blocked road), make a Driving Skill Check with a Difficulty of 10 + [Move ÷ 5]. On Success, you stop wherever you want. On Fail, the GM decides what bad things happen.

USING SKILLS WHILE MOVING

Now that you know how to drive your vehicle, why not knit a scarf during the Indy 500? You can do it, but you'll roll with Disadvantage while you're the vehicle's driver unless it's to drive, use mounted-only weapons (like a lance), or use one of your vehicle's built-in weapons. Passengers (anybody who isn't the driver) can perform any reasonable Actions within the vehicle without penalty.

The vehicle must *end* its movement within Attack range of a target for the occupants to Attack it—no drive-bys where you get to Attack enemies as you pass, nor can they Attack you if the situation is reversed.

CHOOSE YOUR TARGET

Every action movie has a vehicle chase scene where the antagonists are shooting at each other, so you can too! Attacks may be directed specifically at a vehicle or at an occupant of the vehicle. Vehicles don't Evade, but their occupants can.

- Attacking a vehicle has an inherent Difficulty equal to 10 + the Vehicle's current Move ÷ 5. However, if attacking a vehicle head-on or trunk-on, do not include the vehicle's Move in the Difficulty.
- Attacks can target any occupant of a vehicle. If the occupant chooses to Evade, they have an Evade Buff equal to the vehicle's Move ÷ 10, except from straight ahead or behind as above. A Near Miss targeting an occupant hits the vehicle.

TABLE 6: VEHICLE CHECK RESULTS

CHECK RESULT	EFFECT
Critical Hit	You may either increase your vehicle's Move by 50% this round or gain 1 AI Favor.
Amazing Success	Your vehicle has access to its full Move this round, and you gain Advantage on your next Skill Check to operate this vehicle.
Standard Success	Your vehicle has access to its full Move this round.
Near Miss Fail	Your vehicle loses 5 feet of its Move this round.
Standard Fail	Your vehicle loses half of its Move this round.
Major Fail	You lose half of your Move this round and your vehicle suffers 10% damage.
Critical Fail	You stall out, unable to Move this round and your vehicle suffers 30% damage.

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RAMMING

If you've seen any movie with cars moving fast (or *Ben-Hur*), you know ramming is where it's at. One side tries to force a collision; the other tries to avoid it. Ramming is made by rolling a Driving Skill Check vs. the target's Evade. The damage on a hit is 1d6 per size value of the vehicle and per the vehicle's Move ÷10.

Example: A vehicle of size 4, moving at 50 inflicts 9d6 damage against the target.

The ramming vehicle takes half the damage, and halves its Move. If the target is larger than the ramming vehicle, the vehicle takes full damage, and reduces its Move to 0ft. Occupants take half the damage their vehicle takes, reduced by their own Damage Resistance (DR, see p. 93) *and* the vehicle's. Ramming another vehicle can cause a lot of damage... just as nature intended.

VEHICLE HEALTH BAR AND DR

Just like crawlers, vehicles have 10 Health Bar slots (Health Bar slots, see *Health Bar*, p. 93). Instead of a Con Mod in each slot, the vehicle's size value (1–8) is used. Vehicles have DR (see Table 7), which reduces damage that hits the occupants and the vehicle itself. At 0%, the vehicle explodes like it's loaded with dynamite in a low-rent action movie, dealing Xd6+F Fire damage to the occupants, where X is the vehicle's size and F is the Floor number. The vehicle's DR does not protect.

Yes, even electric vehicles blow up. You should have pimped your ride.

VEHICLE OCCUPANCY

This is the total number of entities (including the driver) that can fit in the vehicle. This value does not change with small variations in the size of such entities, but it could change when taken to extremes. Cargo areas are either open air in a truck or in a cargo container as found on 18-wheelers.

Vehicles are typically 1–2 size values larger than their occupants, though it's always funny (and may come with additional GM-imposed complications) when a little guy is driving a 3-story-tall dump truck or when a huge guy has to cram into a clown car.

CUSTOMIZING VEHICLES

In most **Dungeon Crawler Carl** campaigns, vehicles are simply a means of conveyance. However, if you're playing a *Mad Max*-themed campaign, each crawler might want their vehicle to reflect their personality. Some accessories and upgrades require Crafting (see p. 221), while other stuff might be bought off the shelf. This list is a sample, but go crazy with creating your own options if you want.

VEHICLE CRAFTING

- **Armor:** Use Smithing (p. 199)
- **Mounted Weapons:** Use Engineering (p. 191)
- **Speed Buffs:** Use Gear Head (p. 192)
- **Magical Buffs:** Use Arcane (p. 185)
- **Pimping Your Ride:** Use Gear Head (p. 192)

OFF-THE-SHELF ITEMS

- **Roll Cage (Armor):** +1 DR
- **Nitrous Oxide (Speed Buff):** Double Move for 3 rounds
- **Ram Plate (Mounted Weapon):** +F damage when Ramming
- **Hydromancy Shock Absorbers (Magical Buff):** Reduce the level of a Driving Check Fail by 1 (a Major Fail becomes a Standard Fail) once per Floor
- **Fuzzy Dice (Pimping Your Ride):** One Driving Skill Check reroll per Floor

RACING & CHASING

Sometimes you need to move fast to resolve a conflict rather than duking it out. Racing happens when everyone is trying to get to a fixed point, especially when the order of who arrives first matters. Chasing happens when the goal keeps moving. These contests generally do not use the rules for Party Skill Checks.

TABLE 7: SAMPLE VEHICLES

VEHICLE	MOVE	SIZE	DR	OCCUPANCY
Skateboard	30	2	0	1
Bicycle	40	3	0	1-2
Tank	50	6	10	4
18-Wheeler	60	7	4	4 (+50 in cargo)
Large Truck	70	6	4	3 (+5 in cargo)
Mid-Sized Sedan	80	5	3	5–6
Sportscar	100	5	2	2
Motorcycle	120	4	1	1–2

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RACING

Racing resolves over a series of Skill Checks called *legs*, which can represent time, obstacles, or several hundred laps around a track. The Skill for the race, or each leg of the race, is usually determined by the type of movement, so Running applies to a foot chase, and a mix of Chopper Pilot and Driving would apply to a vehicle race. Players with other ideas can suggest a better Skill at the GM's discretion, such as a Flying or Dive Bomb Skill.

Most races and chases involve three legs, but they can involve as many as the GM wants. Too many might get boring, though. The racers focus all of their energy and Actions on the race itself, so there isn't really time for extra-curricular activities during a race. The GM might allow a racer to take a different action at the cost of dropping out of the race entirely. Is it worth it for that one Spell or Attack?

Move Rate Modifier: Each racer adds their Move score divided by 10 (rounded down) as a modifier to all of their racing-move Skill Checks. A crawler with the default 20ft Move gets +2, while a racer with 45ft Move gets +4. If you're irritated that 20 and 25 both round down, keep in mind the 25 might break a tie.

NPC Racers: NPCs and Mobs, as usual, don't roll; they instead "roll" a fixed number each round: 10 + Stat Mod + Floor Number + Move Rate Modifier.

Running a Leg: Each racer makes a Skill Check based on the challenge of this leg and adds their Move Mod. Compare results from highest to lowest and assign placement: 1st place to the highest result, 2nd place, 3rd place, and so on. If two or more racers tie, the racer with the higher base Move score wins that placement. If still tied, they share the placement. Record each racer's placements after every leg.

Winning the Race: After the final leg, add up each racer's placement numbers across all legs. The racer with the lowest total wins. If there is a tie for the lowest total, the racer with the better placement in the final leg wins—a true photo finish. If that's still a tie, it stays a tie.

RACING EXAMPLE

Crawler Adrián, Rayne the Changeling, and Crawler Tessa race toward the Nightmare Express as it barrels down the line, rushing to jump on board before they miss it entirely. Adrián has the slowest Move at 20 (Move Mod +2), Rayne has 30 (Move Mod +3), and Tessa has 45 (Move Mod +4). Rayne is an NPC, so he doesn't roll and automatically gets a 23 (10 + his Dex 5 + Floor 5 + Move Mod 3) each round, but slow and steady can still win the race.

Leg 1: Adrián rolls his Running Skill Check with Move Mod and gets a 24. Tessa gets 20. Rayne's automatic result is 23. These totals determine the current placement: Adrián in 1st, Rayne in 2nd, and Tessa in 3rd place.

Leg 2: Adrián stumbles with a 15. Tessa gets a 27, and Rayne continues with his automatic 23. The second-round placement sees Tessa in 1st, Rayne in 2nd, and Adrián in 3rd place.

Leg 3: Adrián gets a 14, but he spends an AI Favor to reroll, and ends up with a 28. Rayne gets an ever-reliable 23 again. Finally, Tessa gets a total of 26.

Adrián wins the leg, with Tessa closely behind him, and Rayne trailing behind them for third.

Now, total each placement. Adrián has 1 + 3 + 1 = 5.

Tessa has 3 + 1 + 2 = 6. Rayne has 2 + 2 + 3 = 7

Adrián wins with the lowest total, Tessa finishes second, and Rayne trails in last place, missing the Nightmare Express altogether.

Vehicles: Some crawlers can access vehicles, which allow them to Move much faster. See Table 7.

CHASING

Sometimes you don't want to race someone. Sometimes you want to catch them. Maybe a Battle Baboon just swiped your best weapon. Maybe you are the Battle Baboon, and six very angry crawlers are gaining on you. Either way, someone's running, someone's chasing, and the dungeon is absolutely going to make it worse.

A chase works similarly to a race, except the finish line keeps moving, and placement isn't a thing. The GM sets the number of legs based on how far the quarry starts from the chasers, how far the quarry needs to go, and how complicated the terrain is between here and gone-for-good. A straight-up chase through an open area or unobstructed corridor might be three legs. A chase through a bazaar, over a bridge, or through a circus might be five or more.

The quarry isn't going to run in a straight line like an idiot. They're going to knock over fruit stands, barrel through a couple of Goblins carrying a plate-glass window, and slink away at a T-intersection. What Skills are used is up to the GM, but varying the Skills needed to succeed leads to more exciting and dynamic chases. Every leg might use a different one,

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depending on if you're Running, Jumping, Climbing, or Swimming, but clever crawlers (or quarries) might find a use for navigation-based Skills (like finding short cuts) or even weirder options.

Each leg, every "chaser" makes an Opposed Skill Check, adding in their Move Rate Modifier. The quarry opposes it with the Stat Mod used in the Skill Check (for example, a Running Skill Check is Opposed by the quarry's Dex Mod).

- **Amazing Success or better:** Gain 2 Ground. The GM might instead grant 1 Ground and an alternative bonus, such as allowing you to Intervene for an ally (even though this isn't a traditional combat). You just did something awesome, and the audience loves it.
- **Standard Success:** Gain 1 Ground.
- **Near Miss Fail:** Gain 0 Ground.
- **Standard Fail:** Lose 1 Ground.
- **Major Fail:** Lose 2 Ground. Embarrassing, just like your first-grade teacher always expected.
- **Critical Fail:** You're done. The chase is over for you because you probably ate a wall or ended up neck-deep in something sticky. Eww. You'd better believe we'll see that in tonight's recap episode.

Track your Ground gains and losses as a running total across the legs. If your total hits 4 Ground or more at any point, you've caught the quarry early. If it hits −4 or worse, the quarry's gone, and you're out of the chase. Everyone else keeps going until the last leg is done or until there's nobody left chasing.

After the final leg, any chaser still in it compares their total. If they have a positive total of 1 to 3, they've caught the quarry. If it's 0 or less, the quarry got away. If the GM wants to determine who catches the quarry first, it's the character with the highest Ground total, using Move as a tiebreaker.

CHASING EXAMPLE

Adrián and Tessa, alongside their Gnome friend Pisto, are trying to steal a batch of drugs from a group of Bunes on the Fifth Floor. The Bunes scatter, one of them snatching the drugs and zooming off, leaving a trail of colorful dust in its wake. Adrián, Tessa, and Pisto give chase. The GM varies the Opposed Check on every leg because the Neighborhood has crowded areas, many broken roads, and a straightaway before the Bune can escape to safety.

The Bune is an NPC with a Move of 30 (+3 Move Mod), +4 Str, and +5 Dex, so its result for each leg is 22 or 23, depending on the leg's Skill. Pisto is also an NPC, but with +4 to Str and Dex, so they get a 19 each leg. Adrián has a Move of 20 (+2), and Tessa has a Move of 45 (+4).

Leg 1 (Dodge): The Bune has a set value of 23. Adrián rolls his Dodge Skill Check and gets a 25. He gains 1 Ground. Tessa gets 17. She loses 1 Ground. Pisto's automatic result is a 19, a Near Miss, so Pisto gains 0 Ground. Totals: Adrián +1, Tessa −1, Pisto 0.

Leg 2 (Jumping): The Bune has a set value of 22 this time. Adrián rolls his Jumping Skill Check, gets a 12, and loses 1 Ground. Tessa gets a 33: an Amazing

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Success. She gains 2 Ground. Pisto continues with a 19. Totals: Adrián 0, Tessa +1, Pisto 0.

Leg 3 (Running): The Bune has a set value of 23 again. Adrián gets a 23 for his Running Skill Check, and Tessa gets a 26. As usual, Pisto gets 19. Totals: Adrián +1, Tessa +2, Pisto 0.

Adrián and Tessa both end with positive Ground totals, catching the Bune in the end. Pisto did not.

The chaser with the highest positive total at the end gets to the quarry first. In this case, Tessa at +2 reaches the Bune before Adrián at +1. If there's a dispute, the GM decides. A crawler's Move can always be a tie-breaker when needed.

HIDING AND SNEAKING

Crawlers can attempt to hide and sneak past foes while behind cover (see *Combat*, p. 79) or in dim light or darkness. To do so, they make an INT-Opposed Hide in Shadows Skill Check against nearby foes.

On Success, the crawler gains the Invisible Buff until they fail a Hide in Shadows Skill Check, take an Attack Action, or otherwise makes their presence known.

HARSH CONDITIONS

Crawlers have more to fear than the Mobs and Bosses of the World Dungeon; there's a million ways to die in the dungeon. (Yes, that was a Seth McFarlane reference).

DROWNING

You can hold your breath for a number of rounds equal to your CON Mod. When you miss a Swimming Check under dangerous circumstances, you might gain the Drowning Debuff, and that's when things get really exciting.

While Drowning, you take 1d6+F damage at the end of each round. Do not take any damage during rounds in which your head is above water. Taking a breath doesn't heal any damage you've already taken, but you can quaff a potion in your Hotlist without physically drinking it.

FALLING

If you have a whoopsie and fall off a ledge or get pushed off the roof of a building, it's gonna hurt. You take 1d6 Bludgeoning damage for every 10 feet you fall, to a maximum of 20d6, and you land prone. When you hit the ground, roll the dice, and hope you're not reduced to a red smear.

HUNGER

While it's rare—and incredibly boring for viewers—for crawlers to starve to death, going without food can kill just as easily as a Mob's bite or claw or third leg. At the end of each 30-hour day that a crawler doesn't eat, they make a Survival Skill Check. If they fail, they lose 3 Health Bar slots (see *Applying Damage to the Health Bar*, p. 94) and gain a stackable instance of the Fatigue Debuff. Fatigue levels from this source persist until the crawler eats (or gets eaten).

THIRST

While hunger is a danger, dehydration is a faster killer. For each 30-hour day that a crawler doesn't drink water, they lose 3 Health Bar slots (see *Applying Damage to the Health Bar*, p. 94) and gain one stackable instance of the Fatigue Debuff. Fatigue levels from this source persist until the crawler drinks, so glurp, glurp! That's... that's what that means, right?

EXPLORATION EXAMPLE

Here's what play might look like as the crawlers delve deeper into the dungeon, entering the Hunting Grounds on the Sixth Floor.

Theresa (the GM): The ruins of tall buildings rise on either side of the road, vines climbing the walls as nature moves to reclaim its territory. Trees ranging in size from small saplings to towering canopy giants are rooted amid the rubble and ruins of what must once have been a thriving civilization. Much like yours was just a few weeks ago. The songs of a wide variety of birds drift along the breeze, and the underbrush rustles with what one can only hope is mundane fauna. Above, the artificial sun rides high in the sky, depicting early afternoon.

SETTING THE SCENE

Theresa sets the scene here by engaging the senses: what the crawlers see, smell, and hear. In addition, she provides the lighting conditions, which are important for both the mood and mechanical effects.

Daniel (playing Chase): The system really went all out trying to rub in the end of the world, eh?

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Mark (playing Venus): Seriously! Nonetheless, we've gotta survive for the next two weeks or so with the hunters. Should we find a place to hunker down, or stay on the move?

Marianne (playing Michelle): I vote we find a place to set up shop. Somewhere we can defend easily, and that has several good escape routes.

Anisha (playing Wren): I like the idea of stability, but there are likely to be hundreds of hunters out there, and there are only 5 of us. Not sure I'm keen to sit where they can swarm us and see which hunter gets my skull above their head.

Marianne: Fair enough. Then let's at least try to scout around so we know what we can use to our advantage.

Jose (playing Henry): I've got this! My Marine training gave me several Ranks in Survival. I should be able to make a Check to get at least some information about the plants and such in the area, right, Theresa?

Theresa: I could see Survival working, but since you're thinking about it instead of resisting it, let's go with an Unopposed INT Survival Skill Check. Either Success or Failure, you're going to remember things that you're sure are true.

OFF-STAT CHECKS

The Survival Skill is usually associated with a crawler's CON since it's used to resist hazardous environments. Since Henry is thinking about the potential dangers, Theresa decides the Skill applies, but Jose must add Henry's INT Mod instead of CON (see *Determine the Approach*, p. 58). With each Check, Theresa points out the cost of Failure so the players can decide whether they really want to make the Check.

Jose: That's a Difficulty 22 since we're on the Sixth Floor, right?

Theresa: Right.

Jose: Okay, 15 on the die, 3 for INT, and 8 Ranks of Survival for a 26.

Theresa: With that simple Success, you can identify several large rubber and Brazil nut trees, which could serve as a food source, as well as a few strangler figs trying to choke the life out of the host trees.

Marianne: Can I take a look at the buildings to determine their condition? Are they going to come down on our heads, or are they relatively stable?

Jose: Don't give the GM any ideas!

Theresa: It's okay, I already thought of that possibility. Go ahead and make an Engineering Skill Check, Marianne.

Marianne: Ugh, it's a 12.

Theresa: You are absolutely certain that all of the ruins are completely stable. Whatever parts would be at risk have already fallen to rubble. No sooner do you come to that conclusion than a chunk of concrete the size of a Volkswagen falls from the eighth story of one of the buildings, shaking the earth as it crashes to the ground, and kicking up a ton of concrete and plaster dust in the area.

Anisha: Yeah... I'm thinking you're wrong about that assessment. And breathing that stuff in can't be good for our lungs.

Mark: We can always cover our faces with a damp cloth. But it'll be hard to fight that way if we run into trouble. Can I make something we can wear to filter our breathing air?

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Theresa: Sure, that's pretty simple. Since a protective mask would be Size 2, it would take you 4 hours to craft one in the dungeon. It would give you Advantage on any Checks against gas or dust. You could also search through your Inventory and decide that some of your Misc. Junk is a medical or painter mask, which would give you +2 on Checks against gas or dust.

CRAFTING IN THE DUNGEON

Most crafting takes place in personal spaces at workbenches, but if those are not available, the crawlers will make what they can while in a dangerous area. Due to the mask being Size 2, it takes 4 hours to craft one. See *Crafting* (p. 221) for more details.

Mark: Oof, that's a lot of time. Even with each of us making Fabricate Checks separately, I don't think we want to stay in one place that long. It's just asking for the hunters to jump us.

Marianna: Jose was already against spending one hour, let alone four.

Jose: That's right. Besides, you don't make it onto the recap by spending hours crafting. We need to act!

Theresa: Alright, so what's the plan, crawlers?

PARTY DECISIONS

When the party faces a choice that not everyone agrees with, it's important for the players to decide—and sometimes for their crawlers to discuss in role-play—as a group. This group prefers to make decisions democratically, so with three deciding that it takes too long, they decide as a group to make the masks out of Misc. Junk rather than spend the time crafting.

Anisha: I've got to agree with Jose. Four hours is just too much. I'll spend the Misc. Junk as a quick fix.

Marianne: Yeah, Michelle has plenty in her Inventory, so I'll do that, too.

Mark: Sounds good to me, but I haven't been tracking Misc. Junk. Can one of our hoarders find one for me?

Marianne: Sure, I've got plenty.

Jose: Not me. I'm going to prove to you and the audience that Henry's Marine training is more than a match for a bunch of overgrown house dust!

Theresa: Alright, with your masks in place, you continue through the ruins. Where are you going?

Mark: We probably should have figured that out before walking in. But since we want to stay on the move, maybe we should try finding other crawlers to join up with. Safety in numbers and all that.

Anisha: I just got Find Crawler, too. Do we want to start there?

Mark: Be my guest.

Theresa: This is a great time for Find Crawler. Since it's a Passive Skill, you don't need to roll. When you activate it, you see a group of 6 blue dots on your HUD about 600 feet ahead of you and to your right, deeper into the ruins and rubble off the road.

PASSIVE SKILLS

Passive Skills don't require a Skill Check to perform and don't advance like other Skills. Each Passive Skill listing in Crawlers & Customization notes how the Skill increases in Rank.

Anisha: Alright, let's go.

Theresa: Before you start heading in, are you changing your marching order?

Jose: Since my Survival Skill gave us the information we needed before we walked in, and I have the highest Perception, Henry can be the lead if that's alright with everyone else.

Anisha: Wren can be up there with him in case we run into trouble.

Marianne: Michelle's in the middle, where it's safest.

Daniel: I guess that makes Chase the rear guard.

Mark: Venus is in the middle with Michelle.

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MARCHING ORDER

As the party heads into a potentially hazardous environment, determining the Marching Order helps the GM determine who'll be in trouble as unexpected things happen—like Chase and Wren might be the first ones to walk into a trap, or a ferocious group of Mushroom Maniacs might come up from behind to snack on Park first.

Theresa: The ground tremors slightly at the ruins' entrance, and the tremors worsen significantly as the party advances further inside. A thunderous CRACK sounds from above as chunks of wall and flooring fall from the buildings, shattering into the ground and erupting into the same stifling dust from earlier. The dust conceals the area like fog, and I'd like everyone to make a Con Stat Check to resist breathing it in. With Advantage if you have one of the working masks.

Anisha: I rolled a 2 and a 13. With Advantage, I keep the 13 and add +4 for Con, which makes it a total of 17 for Wren.

Marianne: I rolled a 5 and 2. So with the 5 and +3 Con for Michelle, I've got a total of 8. So much for that mask.

Daniel: Chase's mask must be defective. I got a 4.

Mark: 16 for Venus.

Jose: And I rolled a 19, for a total of 27! I told you I'd be able to tough it out!

STAT CHECKS

Since this roll is to resist an effect, no Skill applies, and the crawlers only add their Stat Mod to their total. Stat Checks generally have a lower Difficulty than Skill Checks, see Stat Checks in Determining the Difficulty (p. 59).

Theresa: Venus and Wren resist the effects of the dust, and Henry just takes a deep breath to spite the showrunners, feeling no ill effects! Chase and Michelle start coughing violently; you both have the Poisoned and Woozy Debuffs until cured. And you're going to have to wait to treat that because you hear the scraping of claws against stone above you.

Jose: Here we go again!

COMBAT

One of the most common activities crawlers engage in is combat, as nearly every other living thing (and many unliving things) in the dungeon is constantly trying to kill them. Combat is one of the most structured parts of the game to ensure every player has their opportunity in the spotlight and for their crawlers to survive.

DEGREES OF SUCCESS IN COMBAT

In combat, the degrees of Success have additional mechanical significance for Attack Skill Checks (see Attacks, Step 4) and Evade Checks (see the Evade Action, Step 2).

SUCCESS

Meeting or beating the Difficulty is a Success. It generally indicates progress toward a goal.

Natural 20 (Critical Hit): On a roll of a Natural 20 (a 20 on the die without any modifiers), the player rolls twice as many base damage dice and then adds their crawler's Stat Mod and other Buffs to the damage. If an effect multiplies the "total damage," that includes the results from the extra Critical Hit dice.

If the crawler achieves a Natural 20 on an Evade Check, they gain Advantage on their next Attack Skill Check against that Mob. And it's probably good for their self-esteem, too.

Success by 10 or more (Amazing Success): The crawler's Attack deals extra damage equal to their current Floor Number.

If the crawler achieves an Amazing Success on an Evade Check, they also gain Advantage on their Attack Skill Check against that Mob.

Success by 0–9 (Standard Success): This is the most basic Successful result. For Attack Skills, a Standard Success means the crawler hits and rolls damage.

FAILURE

A result under the Difficulty or target number is a Failure. The GM ultimately decides what happens, based on the degree of Failure and the current situation.

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Fail by 1–2 (Near Miss Fail): A Failure, but there's still a chance to save the effort. When this result occurs, the GM announces a "Near Miss" to allow other players to help with an Intervene Action during combat (see *Crawler Reaction Phase*, p. 81).

Fail by 3–9 (Standard Fail): This is a normal Failure, such as missing a target or failing to (or declining to) Evade an Attack.

Fail by 10 or more (Major Fail): A Failure to this degree comes with some manner of consequence, such as dropping a weapon or other important piece of equipment, losing footing (reducing Movement), running out of ammunition, or other penalty.

Achieving a Major Fail on an Evade Check, the crawler exposes a vulnerable spot which the Mob strikes. The crawler suffers additional damage from the Attack equal to the current Floor Number and gains a Minor Injury Debuff after combat, once the adrenaline wears off.

Natural 1 (Critical Fail): On a roll of a Natural 1 (a 1 on the die without any modifiers), the crawler suffers the worst possible outcome. Consequences might include pummeling an ally instead of an enemy, breaking a weapon or important tool, or gaining a Debuff. Getting a Critical Fail on an Evade Check, the crawler suffers twice as much damage and gains a Major Injury Debuff after combat. And they feel pretty dumb, too.

STARTING COMBAT

When it looks like a combat scene or encounter is imminent, such as Mobs and crawlers in close quarters, establish the pre-combat situation by establishing the location and determining surprise.

ESTABLISH LOCATION

At the start of a combat scene or encounter, it's important to determine where everyone is located and what opportunities or challenges are present in the environment. The GM should describe the obvious terrain features at this point, along with any obvious threats.

DETERMINE SURPRISE

Normally, combat occurs when Mobs encounter the crawlers and the Mobs go first. Cunning crawlers may make use of their Skills, such as Stealth and Ambush, to get the drop on foes.

When crawlers surprise their foes, they get a free Action to spend before the normal flow of combat begins. Not it's only one action, and the surprise round only happens once, at the start of combat.

MAPS IN COMBAT

Some groups love tactical maps. Others prefer a theater-of-the-mind style, imagining the Action without a grid. Many groups fall somewhere in between, using tokens or painted miniatures to show general positioning—who's in striking range, who's a Move Action away, and who's farther out.

Use whichever approach works best for your table. For groups that enjoy tactical play and precise movement, you can use either square- or hex-based maps. The most common scale is 1-inch squares or hexes representing 5 feet, which has become a standard for tabletop RPGs.

For vehicles or larger-scale encounters, a useful scale is 1 inch represents 50 feet.

When using square maps, moving or attacking diagonally works the same as moving or attacking into an orthogonally adjacent space, with no extra cost or measurement required. Bonus points if you knew what "orthogonally" meant before reading this section.

STEP-BY-STEP COMBAT

A combat scene unfolds in the following steps:

1. **Mob Action Declaration:** The GM announces what the Mobs are doing, including their movement, whom they plan to Attack, and how.
2. **Crawler Reaction Phase:** Players can choose to use Actions on Interrupts.
3. **Mob Attack Resolution:** Mobs complete their Attacks and other Actions.
4. **Crawler Action Phase:** Players spend their remaining Actions and finish their turns.
5. **Clean Up:** Any effects that happen at the end of the round occur, all combatants reset their Action count, and a new round begins at Step 1 if needed.

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STEP 1: MOB ACTION DECLARATION

The GM announces the Mobs' Actions during this step, including their general movement, which Attacks or other Actions they will use, and whom they are targeting.

Low-quality Mobs each have 1 Move Action and 1 other Action per round, usually an Attack, typically dividing their Attacks evenly between the crawlers in range.

High-quality Mobs, such as Elites and Bosses, are exceptionally dangerous. They have 1 Action per crawler each round, unless their Stat Block says otherwise. They continue to have this many Actions even if some crawlers are out of commission or dead. Now you know why you might need to run away, dragging your Dying friends behind you.

DETERMINE TARGETING

Mobs target crawlers based on a variety of factors, such as whom they perceive to be the greatest threat, who is closest, which crawlers have items or effects that dissuade or enrage them (such as Fairy-class Mobs against a crawler with a Goblin Pass), or, my personal favorite, randomly.

STEP 2: CRAWLER REACTION PHASE

After all Mobs have announced their movement, Actions, and targets, the crawlers can use Interrupt Actions to react prior to the resolution of Mob Actions. Spending Actions during this phase counts against the two Actions that each crawler gets every round, and determining when to spend Actions is a significant part of game strategy.

And if you screw it up, you might die. No pressure, right?

The Interrupt Actions that crawlers can take include:

Evade (Interrupt): The most common Interrupt Action, a crawler who takes this Action attempts to avoid Attacks against them. The player rolls a separate Evade Check against each Attack directed at their crawler, so if three Attacks are directed at the crawler, the player makes 3 Evade Checks. The Difficulty of the Evade

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Check is determined by the Mob's Attack value (see Step 5 for additional details). Successful evasion of an Area Attack reduces the damage by 50%.

Intervene (Interrupt): The most flexible Interrupt, Intervene allows one crawler to help another at the cost of an Action. The Intervening crawler rolls 1d6 and can add the result of that die roll to another crawler's Action after the result is announced. This can be used on any d20 Check (except Stat Checks), but is most useful for turning a Near Miss Fail result into a Success.

Catcher (Interrupt): Heroic, foolish, or tough crawlers with Ranks in this Passive Skill prize this Interrupt Action, which allows them to take the hit for an adjacent ally (using their Step to get into position if needed). The Catcher crawler cannot Evade the Attack they're catching.

Healing (Interrupt): A crawler can take this specialized version of the Cast a Spell or Use a Hotlist Item Action to activate a Spell or item with the healing trait. This healing applies before the Mob deals its damage (because we're nice like that). The Healing Action may also be used as a normal Action during the crawler Action Phase, which also allows a crawler to Make a Check, such as First Aid.

Taunt (Interrupt): Bold crawlers use this Action to make an INT-Opposed Taunt Skill Check against a Mob, drawing them to Attack the crawler using Taunt instead of the Mob's original target. After using the Taunt Action, the crawler may then choose to spend an Action to Evade those and any other Attacks.

Once all players have finished their Interrupt Actions, play proceeds to Step 3.

STEP 3: MOB ACTION RESOLUTION

In this step, the Mobs deal damage to the crawlers who either failed to Evade or didn't bother to Evade during Step 2. Any other effects from a Mob's Attack, such as Debuffs, also apply now.

The GM rolls each Attack's damage dice, adds the appropriate Stat Mod to the total, and applies any additional effects, such as Debuffs, from the Attack. Crawlers apply their Damage Resistance (p. 93) to the Attack's damage before marking damage on their Health Bar (see *Applying Damage to the Health Bar*, p. 94).

STEP 4: CRAWLER ACTION PHASE

Now players can use any remaining Actions for their crawler to strike back. Crawlers can take their Actions in any order and may even intermingle them. No initiative here! Crawlers may use both of their Actions to Attack if they wish. The Actions that players can take in this phase include:

ATTACK

A crawler strikes at a Mob with their fists or feet, a melee weapon, a ranged weapon, or a Spell. The crawler can swap the weapon in their hand for another weapon from their Hotlist as part of the Attack Action.

Choose a Target: Select a target within range. Most melee Weapon Skills have a range of 5 feet, and Weapon Skills with the Reach keyword have a range of 10 feet. Reach Weapon Skills cannot Attack through occupied spaces, but they can Attack diagonally through the corner between two spaces, as long as at least one of those spaces is unoccupied.

Spellcasters must spend their Mana Points to activate the Spell now.

Ranged Weapon Skills list their maximum range, and there is no penalty for attacking a foe within that range.

Ranged weapons and Spells that target a foe outside of their range automatically fail.

Determine Modifiers: The player and GM determine what modifications apply to the Skill Check (if any), such as benefits from Buffs, penalties from Debuffs, modifiers based on target size, and environmental challenges like low light or cover.

Make the Attack!: The player rolls their Weapon Skill Check.

To Attack, roll 1d20 + Skill Rank + Stat Mod as usual. The target number for the Attack is the Mob's Evade score, which is 10 + DEX Mod + Floor.

The Stat Blocks of some Mobs may have additional modifiers. After the roll, the GM determines their crawler's degree of Success (and opportunity for an ally to take the Intervene Action if needed). If the Attack hits, the player rolls damage based on their Attack or Spell.

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FOR THE GM: MOB ON MOB ACTION

Clever crawlers may find ways to cause Mobs to Attack each other or Bosses. When this sort of NPC-versus-NPC action occurs, the GM can simply decide. Pick David or Goliath depending on what makes things the most interesting. If the story doesn't suggest a clear winner, directly compare the Attack and Evade (or other relevant Stats) between the NPCs to determine the outcome, assuming the NPC with the better value wins. If you want to play to find out (remember that GMs don't roll Attack Skill Checks), roll 1d12 and use Table 8. It's skewed toward the more powerful NPC but allows for the underdog to come out on top sometimes.

TABLE 8: NPC VS. NPC

ROLL OR CHOOSE	EFFECT
1	The attacking NPC outright loses or misses badly, achieving a Major Fail, and everyone—other Mobs, Bosses, and crawlers—gains Advantage to Attack it until the end of the round or a Debuff of the GM's choosing.
2–4	The attacking NPC misses or possibly just loses the fight.
5–8	The attacking NPC hits if its relevant Stat is higher than the defender's opposing Stat
9–11	The attacking NPC hits and deals damage as normal or possibly wins the fight.
12	The attacking NPC achieves an Amazing Success, dealing damage to the defender with a bonus equal to twice the Floor Number or a similar Buff or just emerges victorious.

Keep in mind that even if you stick with the static values, Mobs attacking other Mobs and missing still consume their Actions, which can be a huge swing in the crawlers' favor during an intense combat.

MELEE ATTACKS

Most melee Attacks use your Str to hit and damage.

RANGED ATTACKS

Physical ranged Attacks use Dex to hit, some apply Str to damage, while others have no damage bonus.

Ranged Attacks suffer Disadvantage if made within the melee reach of an enemy.

SPELL ATTACKS

Most Spells use Int to hit and damage.

Ranged Spell Attacks also suffer Disadvantage if made within the melee reach of an enemy.

AREA OF EFFECT ATTACKS

Attacks like the Spell Fireball or the Goblin Dynamite Skill to use explosives deal damage over a wide area. These Area Attack qualities are listed with the Attack Skill entry. When making an Area Attack, the attacker makes a single Attack roll against a foe of their choosing within range as usual, with the potential benefit of dealing damage to more creatures than just the target of the Attack.

If the Attack is successful, the attacker rolls damage once and applies the full damage to all creatures, crawler and Mob alike, in the affected area (including the target of the Attack). Resistances and DR reduce the damage as usual.

On Fail, most Attacks have misfired and no creatures take any damage, unless it's a Critical Fail and it hits the wrong target. However, Area Attacks like Fireball and Dynamite still land somewhere and deal damage to whatever is near the new impact area. Only Attacks like Throwing and Fireball that reference Figure 3 (p. 200) do anything on a Fail.

Some Area Attacks also have a Splash damage area (not to be confused with everyone's favorite Otter stripper from the Penis Parade, Splash Zone), a radius from the initial blast which deals half as much damage to those in the area. Anyone caught in the splash zone of that damage applies DR and other effects normally.

A crawler affected by an Area Attack can Evade (if they spend an Action to do so), and may have situational modifiers from cover, elevation, among others. A victim who Evades an Area Attack reduces the damage by 50%. A successful Evade in the splash zone reduces the damage by another 50% so only 25% of the damage is applied. Such damage is rounded down as usual. Taking a Step during an

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Evade Check (or any Interrupt) is not fast enough to outrun an explosion, so you can't simply duck out of the affected area.

AREA OF EFFECT TYPES

Spells, weapons, items, Mobs, and Bosses use Area Attacks in various ways. There are several different types of Areas:

- **Blast:** Extends outward in all directions from the target (or where the explosive landed) to the listed distance.*
- **Burst:** Extends outward in all directions from the caster to the listed distance.
- **Line:** Extends outward in a 5-foot wide line from the caster to the listed distance.
- **Cone:** Extends outward in a 60 degree arc from the caster to the listed distance.
- **+Splash:** Extends outward beyond the full-damage area, dealing half damage within the Splash distance. This is typically an add-on to other Area types, and extends in the same way. Some attacks feature only a Splash effect: The target takes full damage, but everyone in the Splash area takes half damage

Example: A "20ft Cone +10ft Splash" means the Cone is 30 feet in length. Victims in the first 20 feet of the Cone take full damage, while victims in last 10 feet Splash zone of the Cone take half damage.

**If you're using a battle map, the target or impact area of a "10ft Blast radius" is the origin of the Blast effect. From that 5ft × 5ft space, the Blast extends outward two spaces in every direction. If you're not tracking the exact position of each crawler, Mob, and other NPCs, you'll need to make a reasonable call on who is affected in any Area Attack situation. See Figure 2 for examples of Area Attacks.*

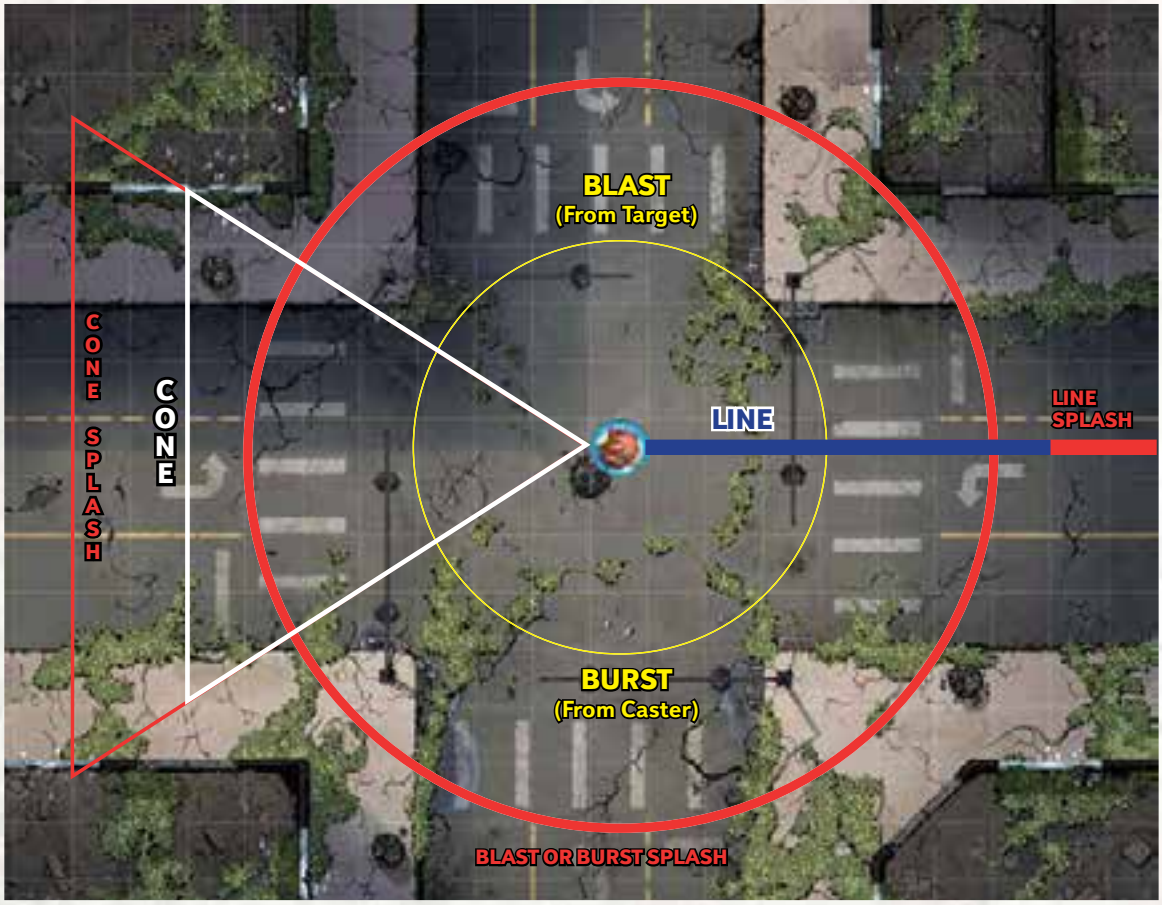
ATTACK MODIFIERS

Several additional situations may alter the Evade score of a target or otherwise modify the Attack.

COVER

Objects can get in the way of Attacks made at greater-than-melee range, causing such Attacks to be made with Disadvantage. Attacks made at melee range are unaffected by cover. Things that can provide cover include: crates, terrain, cars, or low walls. If the Attack

Figure 2



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misses, the cover might be destroyed, depending on how sturdy it is and whether your crawler is strong or has to have their mom do the heavy lifting.

ENVIRONMENTAL MODIFIERS

When attacking targets in Cover, Darkness, Severe Weather, Shifting Ground, or amid other penalties, an attacking crawler rolls with Disadvantage. Similarly, those with help from the environment, such as attacking from high ground, roll with Advantage.

SIZE

Crawlers roll Attack Skill Checks with Advantage if the target is 4 or more size classes larger than them. Inversely, crawlers roll Attack Skill Checks with Disadvantage when attacking a target 4 or more size classes smaller. And when a big dude hits a little dude with a Disadvantaged Melee Attack due to this modifier, the big dude adds their size value to the damage. See Table 9 for size names and values.

TABLE 9: CREATURE SIZE

SIZE	SIZE NAME	CREATURE EXAMPLE
1	Tiny	Scatterer, Rat
2	Small	Cat, Raccoon
3	Petite	Goblin, Boar
4	Medium	Human, Wolf
5	Large	Horse, Mantaur
6	Huge	Elephant, Rhino
7	Colossal	Dinosaur, Dragon
8	Gargantuan	Kaiju

UNSEEN ATTACKERS

Creatures gain Advantage on Attack Skill Checks against targets that can't see them, such as a crawler who is hidden, invisible, or on the other side of a smoke cloud. Inversely, creatures suffer Disadvantage on Attack Skill Checks against targets they can't see.

DAMAGE

When a crawler hits with an Attack, they deal damage, which starts with the base damage die determined by the Skill (higher Ranks grant additional base damage dice; see Attack Skill listings on pp. 177–184), plus the appropriate Stat Mod. Some Attacks add special effects alongside these extra dice.

Unarmed Attacks deal low inherent damage but allow the combatant to add 1 Damage Effect to the Attack. These include well-known abilities such as Powerful Strike, Iron Punch, and others from the novels. If the Attack hits, the Attack's damage dice are rolled, and then the chosen Damage Effect is applied.

After calculating total damage, the GM applies any DR and then marks off the Mob's Health Bar.

CAST A SPELL

A crawler can spend an Action to cast a non-Attack Spell, pay its Mana cost, and follow the Spell's instructions. There's no limit to the number of Spells that can be cast in combat, provided the crawler has enough Actions and Mana.

Caster types are limited in their ready-to-go Spells by their Hotlist. If a Spell ain't in your Hotlist, you can't cast it until you Retrieve it (see *Non-Skill Actions*, p. 86).

MAKE A CHECK

Many non-Attack Skills can be useful in combat, and a crawler can spend an Action to attempt the Skill during battle. If the GM requires a non-Attack Skill Check in the midst of battle, this generally doesn't require a crawler to spend an Action to perform, unless your GM doesn't understand the rules or they're feeling particularly spicy that day.

LOOK FOR CLUES

The Look for Clues Action is a specialized version of the Make a Check Action in combat that focuses on gathering information about a Boss (not regular Mobs) or the environment to give the whole party a leg-up. This can be performed as an Unopposed Perception, Investigation, or similar Skill Check.

On Success, the crawler learns a piece of information about the Boss or area that could aid the party. Amazing Success or better grants additional clues if available.

If multiple clues may be found, the crawler can specify what aspect of the scene (such as the Boss, the environment, or other features) to focus their Look for Clues Action on. For Bosses, this can be as specific as their weapon, their armor, or the brooch the Boss is wearing.

Clues can include vulnerabilities, Resistances, Attacks to look out for, what effect killing a Mob's leader might have, how to counter Debuffs inflicted by foes, environmental elements that would be useful in the fight, and more.

Ultimately, the GM decides which clue to give, so if they want to be a dick, that may not go so well for the

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crawlers. If we assume the GM isn't a megalomaniac, and perhaps they don't feel a clue is going to be useful to the crawlers, they are free to just give each crawler Advantage on their next Attack or Evade, depending on what the clue-seeker was most interested in.

HEALING

In addition to the Use a Hotlist Item Action or the Cast a Spell Action, a crawler can also use the Make a Check Action to use the First Aid Skill or any other means of healing in this phase. (See also the Healing Interrupt Action above in Step 4.)

NON-SKILL ACTIONS

During a combat scene, crawlers can also take a variety of Actions that don't require a Skill Check, including:

- **Call a Play:** A crawler proposes an Action for an ally to perform, such as attacking a specific target. The crawler rolls 2d6 and keeps the higher roll: the Called Play bonus. When another crawler performs the proposed Action, the crawler who called the play can add the Called Play bonus to their ally's Skill Check total. If the Skill Check is Successful without the bonus, the Called Play bonus adds to their damage roll instead.
- **Intervene:** During the Crawler Action Phase, a crawler can use the Intervene Action as well (see Step 2).
- **Move:** A crawler can spend an Action to travel up to their Move allotment and make a Step, as usual.
- **Retrieve:** Pull an item from your Inventory to your hand or the floor, or add it to your Hotlist. You cannot use that item during your current Action.
- **Use a Hotlist Item:** A crawler selects a consumable item from their Hotlist, such as a potion or scroll, and uses it or withdraws another item. Remember that swapping weapons is free as part of the Attack Action.

STEP 5: CLEAN UP

AI NEW ACHIEVEMENT! You've punched some Mobs, cast some Spells, took some damage, and in doing so, you made a mess. You might just be getting the hang of this, crawler!

Reward: You get to clean up your own mess. I'm not your mother or your maid. Don't be lazy, and do it yourself.

During this step, the players and GM do the following:

- **Apply End-of-Round Effects:** Crawlers with any Buffs, Debuffs, the Regeneration Skill, and other effects apply them now in the order most beneficial to them.
- **Determine End of Combat:** If all combatants on one side or the other are defeated, the combat ends. If not, combat continues at Step 1.

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CRAWLER VS. CRAWLER

Crawlers must reach a stairwell in any way possible to survive to the next floor, and that requires leveling up, learning cool Spells, and acquiring great gear (among other considerations). For some enterprising crawlers, the easiest way to advance through the dungeon isn't to brave deadly Mobs and Bosses but rather to kill other crawlers while their guard is down.

CRAWLER VS. GMC CRAWLER

All the players in a party in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** are explicitly working together. When we refer to crawler vs. crawler combat, it transpires between players' crawlers and other surviving crawlers in the World Dungeon who are controlled by the GM (GMCs).

If forced by a Mob to Attack a party member, the target gets an Evade Check at no Action cost.

FIGHTING OTHER CRAWLERS

Fighting GM-controlled crawlers (GMCs) works just like fighting Mobs, aside from that empty feeling that yawns open inside your chest when you've killed another Human in cold blood. But don't worry—if you keep doing it, you'll eventually fill that chasm with enough dead bodies that you'll feel normal again. It's science.

KILLING A CRAWLER

As usual, when a crawler loses the last slot of their Health Bar, they die in a number of rounds equal to their Con Mod (see *0% Health Bar and Dying*, p. 94). If a PC lets them die, they gain a white Player Killer Skull above their head next to their name, which identifies them to all other characters in the dungeon as a Player Killer. Now everyone knows (or at least strongly suspects) they can't be trusted.

Keep in mind that only the crawler who delivers the killing blow gains the Player Killer title and the corresponding skull. Deflecting damage from a third party also does the trick. Use your imagination, and your GM just might let you get away with murder. If you don't get the credit, the only reward you earn is the ignoble ability to loot the corpse as if it were a Mob, but note that the actual Player Killer gets first dibs, just like with Mobs.

PLAYER VS. PLAYER COMBAT

You know the old saying: Keep your enemies close, and kill your friends before they kill you. In the World Dungeon, each party member works alongside accomplished crawlers, each of whom probably has enough magic items and special gear to make a City Boss blush. And the World Dungeon is very interested in helping you take what's theirs.

CONSIDERATE PLAY AND PvP

Player vs. Player (PvP) combat is an optional rule, and it's one the entire table should agree on before someone gets antagonistic with another player. Injury or death of one PC at the hands of another can lead to hurt feelings and might break up a gaming group or even a friendship.

No one's really playing this game to ruin friendships, so the default setting for PvP combat is off. Your group still needs to decide if players can target or hurt one another, whether it's broken bones in combat or even just hurt feelings in a social scene (we suggest *yes*, but with frequent check-ins). A common option is if a crawler betrays the party or initiates combat with another PC, after the dramatic moments are done, they're retired to NPC status, and the player makes a new crawler with a solid reason to support the party of PCs. Whatever rule you decide for your table, make sure everyone agrees. You're here to have fun, not ruin friendships. The table is not the World Dungeon.

If you're going to engage in PvP, the books note that speed and reaction time are essential in such combats. At the start of each round of PvP combat, each player rolls for initiative: d20 + Dex. The high roller Attacks first. The low roller Attacks last. If tied, they Attack simultaneously. That's how it works in a fair fight.

Now this may shock you: Not all fights are fair—especially among friends willing to kill you for your enchanted watch. If a crawler makes a cowardly sneak Attack, they roll the first round's initiative with Advantage. A sneak Attack is not a guarantee of landing the first blow. A very fast crawler might react before the blow lands (see Florin vs. Lucia Mar). There's no honor among crawlers when survival (and ratings) are on the line.

During PvP combat, each player has 1 Action per round, as their 2nd action is Evade. The attacker makes an Opposed Check against the target. The attacker rolls their Attack Skill Check. That value then serves as the Difficulty for their victim's Evade Check.

Players aren't Mobs. Don't treat their combat as such. They are free-willed beings who happen to want to murder each other. Or at least one of them might. It's a little more tragic when that happens.

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REWARDS FOR KILLING CRAWLERS

The System AI realizes that killing your own kind is distasteful, so it incentivizes this sort of bad behavior.

The first time you kill another crawler, you'll receive a Silver Savage Box, or a Gold Savage Box if your victim was in the top ten. These boxes often contain one or more Player vs. Player Coupons naming your party members, along with a promise of high-tier rewards if you kill the named crawlers. They typically also contain one magic item as well. The System AI is magnanimous when it comes to homicide.

Note that Savage Boxes can also be awarded for permanently maiming your fellow crawlers, and not just the first time. The dungeon never penalizes you for dismembering a friend. Ain't showbiz grand?

Still not enough incentive? Killing a crawler is a level-up bonanza, enough to make you forget about the blood on your hands (see *Experience Points,* pp. 169–170). Really, when you look at all the perks, you had no choice. Sorry, Dungeon Crawler Bob.

Once your friend is dead, you can scavenge their carcass for clothing, armor, weapons, gold, and anything else in their inventory. However, unopened loot boxes are bonded to the owner and cannot be removed from their inventory. The killer has 10 minutes to loot the body before it's lootable by anyone else. Don't let remorse get in the way of claiming that fancy enchanted watch you always wanted Bob to give you.

BOUNTY PAYMENT

If leveling up and Savage Boxes weren't enough, the dungeon can sweeten the pot even further. How about a huge amount of gold for killing fellow crawlers?

If you kill a top ten crawler, you also receive a Venison Box containing a very large amount of gold. Each crawler in the top ten (p. 282) has a bounty (p. 283) listed next to their name when the list is presented at the end of each daily recap show starting on the Fourth Floor.

Now, your friends may not be in the top ten yet, but they could be. If they are, are they *really* still your friend? Hell no! Kill them for money.

If a top ten crawler dies for any reason, a System Message appears on all crawler HUDs: "A champion has fallen."

- If they were killed by another crawler, it adds: "A bounty has been claimed."
- If they were killed by a hunter, it adds: "A hunter has claimed a bounty."

Other variations are encouraged, but don't expect a full obituary.

MOB COMBAT EXAMPLE

The crawlers have spent enough time in the Iron Tangle at this point to know that many of the trains carry swarms of Mobs, and they can hear a train coming down the tracks toward the station.

Jose (playing Henry): I've got the Ambush Skill. Is everyone alright with me leading the party to take up positions around the station for when the train arrives?

Marianne (playing Michelle): Good idea!

Mark (playing Venus): Go for it!

Daniel (playing Chase): I'm down.

Anisha (playing Wren): *nods in agreement*

POSITIONING

Before a combat scene or encounter begins, the players and GM determine where everyone is in the encounter. In this case, the players set their miniatures in locations on a battle map. The crawlers know that the Mobs will come from the tracks, but not which direction the train is coming from, so they place their minis accordingly. When playing without a battle map, the party and GM discuss what's in the area and where everyone is before the action kicks off. Good description is key!

Theresa (the GM): Sounds like a good plan, and there's plenty of cover in the station. Everyone, go ahead and put your minis at your crawlers' locations on the map. Since everyone needs to get into position, we'll need a Party Ambush Skill Check.

Anisha: I don't have that Skill, so that puts me at Disadvantage, right? Given how dexterous Wren is, I'm sure I've got this! Nope. Rolled a 4.

Mark: Well, at least you're consistent! Venus gets an 18.

Jose: I've got 16.

Daniel: Chase doesn't have the Skill either, but I've got an 11. 11 is good, right?

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Marianne: For the Fourth Floor? I doubt it—the Difficulty's going to be at least 14. I got a 13, which isn't much better.

Theresa: Alright, are you happy with those numbers?

Jose: Team, we should keep our AI Favor for when we really need it during the fight.

The rest of the party nod in agreement

PARTY SKILL CHECKS

The Ambush Party Skill Check here is a Failure because only two players (Jose and Mark) met or exceeded the Difficulty of 16 (an Opposed Skill Check with a Difficulty of 10 +4 for the Floor value + 2 for the Ghouls' INT). Had a third member of the party rolled 16 or higher, they all would have been safe, but the random number generator hates them, so the ambush goes awry.

Theresa: As you wish. Marianne's right, your party fails to meet the Difficulty. So, the train pulls into the station, and the doors open. More than a dozen emaciated forms covered in festering sores shamble out. As several of the grotesque individuals move onto the platform, Wren slips, accidentally kicking a can out into the open station. The Ghouls instantly look up, alert and ready to fight!

STEP 1: MOB ACTION DECLARATION

With the party obvious to the Ghouls, Step 1 of combat is for the GM to declare what the Mobs are doing. Let's see what Theresa says next.

Theresa: The Ghouls flood from the train car like a burst sewer pipe. Four immediately converging on the noise Wren made, hissing and snapping, spittle spraying from hungry mouths. Four more turn toward Chase, who discovers that "hidden behind a pillar" and "mostly hidden behind a pillar" are two very different things. A dozen additional Ghouls clamber from the train, sniffing the air and peering into the dark corners of the station in search of their next meal. Four at Chase, another four after Wren!

STEP 2: CRAWLER REACTION PHASE

Now the crawlers have an opportunity to "read the room" so to speak, and decide if they want to use an Interrupt Actions to potentially change what the Mobs are doing. These actions still count against the two Action limit each crawler gets in a round.

Anisha: Well, they already know I'm here, so I might as well make the most of it. I jump out of my hiding spot, making as much noise as possible to draw their attention. I'll use my other action to Evade and hope I don't die!

Theresa: I'm gonna call that a Taunt Action. Go ahead and make the Skill Check, Anisha.

Anisha: I've got that Skill at Rank 4! How about a 19?

Theresa: That's more than enough for one of Chase's Ghouls to turn your way.

Anisha: Success! And umm help? Anybody?

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THE EVADE ACTION

This Interrupt Action is the most commonly used. Its purpose is to avoid Attacks against them. By using an Evade action, Wren gets to make an Evade Check against every Attack the Ghouls send their way this round!

Daniel: I'm not much better off than you are... three on me. I'll spend one of my actions to Evade as well.

Theresa: Got it. Anyone else reacting? No? Then let's see how the Ghouls do.

ENDING A STEP

Once all crawlers decide whether to use their Actions on Interrupts and make their die rolls, the Crawler Reaction Step ends. It can be helpful to make a "last call" for Actions to make sure nobody misses their chance before ending the Crawler Reaction Phase.

STEP 3: MOB ACTION RESOLUTION

In this phase, the GM executes the actions that were broadcast in step 1, with the exception of those four additional Ghouls who have decided that Wren looks like a scrumptious appetizer.

Theresa: A total of five Festering Ghouls swipe at Wren! Fortunately for you, Anisha, by the looks of the battle map, only four can get to you. Please give me four Evade rolls.

Anisha: Come on dice! 19, 22, 19 again, and a 26!

Theresa: Well done! Despite their general lack of dexterity, Wren apparently becomes possessed by the spirit of ninja disco and manages to avoid all four of the Festering Ghouls' Attacks! Now for Chase. You've got three attacking you, and you chose to Evade, so go ahead and make three Evade rolls.

Daniel: I didn't get near as lucky. 10, 18, and... a 1.

CRITICAL FAIL WHILE EVADING

When a player gets a Natural 1 on their Evade Check, their crawler suffers twice the damage from the Attack and a Major Injury after the adrenaline of the fight runs out. Even with a trained medic in play like Jose's crawler, Henry, injuries require time to heal. See Injuries, p. 96 for more.

Theresa: You managed to barely Evade one of the Attacks, but two others bite at you, tearing flesh and leaving deep gashes! You take 11 from the one hit, but the Critical Fail on your other Evade means that one deals 20 damage to you. Apply your Damage Resistance to each one, of course. And the Natural 1 on the Evade Check means you'll have a Major Injury after the fight.

Daniel: Even after Damage Resistance, that's 40% of my Health Bar! Ouch! I can't take too many hits like that.

STEP 4: CRAWLER ACTION PHASE

Now it's time for the crawlers to strike back! Wren doesn't have any actions left, having spent both during the Reaction Phase. Chase has one action, and the rest haven't spent any of their actions, so they still have two each.

Mark: I'm going to use one of my actions to move off to the side, and then my second action to toss a Jug O' Boom right in the center of the Ghouls that are still standing there.

Theresa: Nice! Make your Explosives Handling Skill Check so it doesn't blow up in your face, and then Throw for the Attack.

Mark: 20 on Explosive Handling, and 28 for Throwing!

Theresa: Great throw! You land the jug right in the middle of the group. That's an Amazing Success! Roll your normal damage, then add four.

AMAZING SUCCESS

When a player rolls 10 or more over the Difficulty, they gain an Amazing Success. In combat scenes, an Amazing Success on an Attack Skill Check adds bonus damage equal to the current Floor Number.

Mark: That's an 8 on the die for damage from the jug and 4 for the Amazing Success, right? That's 12 Fire damage!

CONTEXT CLUES

As this isn't a Boss encounter, the crawlers can't use the Look for Clues Action. Yet throughout the battle, Theresa describes the Ghouls' tactics, Attacks, and tendencies—such as avoiding fire—without giving away the specifics, as a storytelling element amid the combat.

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Theresa: The presence of fire from the blast sends Ghouls scrambling back toward the train. Only the four Ghouls next to Wren, and the three close to Chase remain. Marianne, you're up. What are you going to do?

Marianne: I'm close enough, I should be able to use my Sledge of Overabundant Mechanical Agitation to hit at least two of the ones on Chase, right? If so, I'm gonna do that.

Theresa: Sounds good. Make your two Warhammer Skill Checks.

Marianne: Natural 20, and a 16.

Theresa: The first one is a Critical Hit! Go ahead and roll damage for that one. The second looks like it'll be a Near Miss.

Marianne: Can anybody give me a hand on this one?

Daniel: Can I use my second action to Intervene and push the Ghoul into the incoming hammer blow?

Theresa: Absolutely, you can! Roll 1d6, and we'll add it to Michelle's Attack.

Daniel: I got a 4.

Theresa: That's a total of 20, which makes it a Standard Success! Roll damage for both Attacks, Marianne.

THE INTERVENE ACTION

The Intervene Action is flexible, allowing a player to use their Action to help another party member (hopefully) succeed. Intervene can only be used in combat and adds a d6 roll to the party member's Skill Check.

Marianne: I've got Rank 10 in my Warhammer Skill, that's 3d10 plus 5 for my Strength, so... 26 for the standard hit. For the Critical...

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CRITICAL HITS

Marianne gets a Natural 20 on Michelle's Attack, which doubles the number of dice rolled. The Warhammer deals 1d10+Str damage, plus another 2d10 for the Skill's Rank 10 Upgrade. With the Natural 20, these dice double to 6d10+Str. Unlike other Attacks, Marianne doesn't need to ask if Michelle hits, a Natural 20 always hits. Similarly, a Natural 1 always misses, but no need to worry about that here!

Marianne: I got 56 damage for the Critical Hit!

Theresa: Awesome! The first one takes the hit, the force removing its arm from its body, but it's still standing at 50% Health. You swing the Warhammer with all of your might towards, and then through, the second Ghoul, splattering it down to 0 Health instantly.

0% HEALTH

When a crawler reaches 0% of their Health Bar, they gain the Dying Debuff and must be healed within a number of rounds equal to their Con or perish. When a Mob reaches 0%, they die and typically don't come back, unless there's necromancy afoot.

The scene continues, with Jose and Mark taking both of their Actions to clear out more Festering Ghouls.

STEP 5: CLEAN-UP

The final phase of a combat round is when ongoing effects, such as strength buffs or poison, impact the crawlers. Counters get advanced, trackers get tracked. It's also an opportunity for the GM to spring something on the crawlers for the next round.

Theresa: As the two Ghouls drop into a puddle of hammered goo, another group of Ghouls pries the door of the car open, and five of them rush to join in!

Daniel: Here we go again!

Anisha: What're you talking about! I've still got four trying to eat my face! Just so y'all know, I'm planning to drop a Fireball on the nearest one to clear them out.

Marianne: That seems a bit extreme, doesn't it?

Anisha: Not when I have this handy dandy armlet that grants me Fire Resistance. Just use your actions to get out of the area and Evade. I'll take care of the rest.

APPLYING DAMAGE RESISTANCE EFFECTS

When determining Damage Resistance (DR) effects, the player and GM always apply their DR first. After that, they apply Resistance, Immunity, and Vulnerability. In this case, Wren's armlet grants half damage from Fire, so they're unlikely to suffer significant damage from a nearby Fireball.

The round continues with the Mobs declaring, crawlers reacting, Mobs completing their Actions, and then Anisha's Spell results in an inferno of magical fire. Chase and Michelle were able to get to safety and were relatively unharmed, and Wren's Fire Resistance caused only minor self-inflicted damage. Venus, however, was not so lucky.

Mark: Oof, that was a calculated risk and boy, am I bad at math.

FRIENDLY FIRE

Area Attacks like the Fireball Spell and explosives don't care what team the people in the area are on. Keep that in mind when aiming Area Attacks! If one or more of your allies are in the area, it's best to check if the players are okay with suffering the consequences of the Attack before putting their fate in the hands of explosive pyrotechnics governed by a random number generator.

Theresa: Mark, since you were still in the area of the Spell's effect, but you managed to successfully Evade, you only take half damage. That's 15 points of Fire damage. Along with that, you've got the Burned Debuff because you lost an HB slot to Fire damage.

Mark: So what does that do?

Theresa: That means you'll suffer 1d10 plus 4 Fire damage each round until you put yourself out. You might consider stop, drop, and roll.

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HEALTH MENU

Each character's Health Menu is accessible whenever they can access their HUD. The Health Menu is an extensive pie chart that indicates any active status conditions such as Buffs, Debuffs, and injuries. The crawler can drill down and see which areas are affected, as well as learn from the provided detailed explanations of injuries and the healing process. If the crawler sustains enough damage, the entire pie chart may blink red.

In the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, the Health Menu consists of the Health Bar, Mana, Buffs & Debuffs, and Injuries.

HEALTH BAR

Every creature in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** has a Health Bar (HB), which tracks their available Health and is determined by the Con Mod for each slot. Each slot represents physical toughness, mental fortitude, and emotional resilience.

Crawlers' HB is composed of 10 slots, and individual creatures can have fewer (such as common Mobs) or more slots (Bosses, Elites, and some NPCs).

DAMAGE TYPES

Each instance of damage usually has a type, such as Bludgeoning, Piercing, or Slashing for physical damage and elemental types, such as Acid, Ice, or Fire. The damage types themselves do not have a specific effect on their own but are referenced for other effects such as Resistance, Vulnerability, and Immunity.

The damage types and their rarity in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** are listed in Table 10.

DAMAGE RESISTANCE

When a target takes damage, that damage total is reduced by their Damage Resistance (DR) first. The rest of the damage, if any, is applied to the victim's Health Bar.

There are two types of Resistance: Damage Resistance and Elemental Resistance. Damage Resistance (DR) is resistance against all types of damage. A creature that has resistance to an elemental type, such as Fire Resistance, takes half as much damage of that type whenever they take damage.

TABLE 10: DAMAGE TYPES AND RARITY

DAMAGE TYPE	RARITY
Acid	Uncommon
Bludgeoning	Common
Electric	Uncommon
Fire	Common
Force	Uncommon
Holy	Uncommon
Ice	Uncommon
Necrotic	Uncommon
Piercing	Common
Poison	Common
Psychic	Uncommon
Slashing	Common
Sonic	Uncommon

DR and Elemental Resistance are gained via Armor (natural or worn), Magic, and Buffs. There is no resistance against the latent sense of self-disappointment lurking in the depths of your soul. Have you tried talking to someone?

DAMAGE VULNERABILITY

After Resistance is applied, use any Damage Vulnerability. Creatures can have Damage Vulnerability to specific types of damage, such as a Fire Elemental being vulnerable to Ice damage.

A creature takes twice as much damage when they're vulnerable to that damage type.

DAMAGE IMMUNITY

Finally, calculate Damage Immunity. Creatures can have Damage Immunity to specific types of damage, such as a Fire Elemental being immune to Fire damage, so the old Earth saying "fight fire with fire" won't get you very far here.

A creature reduces any damage to zero when it is a type to which they are immune. An Immunity also ignores any additional effects that come from that damage, such as Debuffs.

MULTIPLE DAMAGE TYPES

Some attacks feature multiple damage types, such as Fire and Force with a Rank 10+ Magic Missile Spell. Split the damage evenly between each type, and Resistance, Vulnerability, or Immunity to one of those

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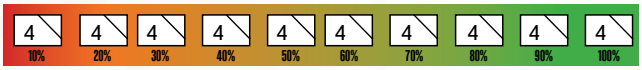
types applies only to that portion of the damage. So if you have Immunity to Fire against a 20-damage Magic Missile Spell, you still take 10 Force damage from it.

APPLYING DAMAGE TO THE HEALTH BAR

After applying DR, Elemental Resistance, Vulnerability, and Immunity, apply that amount to the Health Bar. If the remaining damage is less than the value of one Health Bar (HB) slot, the victim takes no damage. If the damage is higher, it is applied to the character's HB. Add up the numbers in each slot of your HB until the total is equal to or greater than the damage. Any damage that does not meet the value of a slot is lost.

Make sense? Let's play this out.



DAMAGE EXAMPLE

Using the Health Bar above, the crawler needs to take 22 damage. That is more than 4, so they mark off an HB slot and still have 18 damage incoming, which is more than 4, so they repeat the process. After doing this 5 times, they have 2 damage incoming which is less than 4 so they stop, and that 2 extra damage is ignored. This Attack has caused the crawler to lose 5 Health Bar slots, and their HB now shows 50% remaining.

To mark off a Health Bar slot, fill in or mark the triangle in the upper right of the slot with a pencil. Don't X through the Con Mod, or you'll erase it when you erase the damage mark. Mark off green to red (right to left), as that's how video game health bars typically work. When taking future damage, do not count the slots already marked off.

0% HEALTH BAR & DYING

If a crawler loses their last Health Bar slot, they gain the Dying Debuff and must be healed to at least 10% to survive. While Dying, a crawler can't take any Actions, Move, speak, or use their HUD (see *Heads-Up Display*, p. 16).

A crawler stays Dying for a number of rounds equal to their Con, after which point they die. Each time a Dying crawler would take damage, and during Combat Step 5: Clean Up, subtract 1 from the number of rounds they are Dying.

Mobs die instantly at 0% HB. GM-controlled crawlers die as slowly as player crawlers do.

ACTIONS & HEALING FROM 0%

When a crawler's HB is reduced to 0%, they are unable to use any remaining Actions until healed. If another crawler heals them during Step 4 of the same round, they can immediately use any remaining Actions they had left. But maybe don't rely on your mostly dead companions to bail you out in that Boss fight.

HEALING

After crawlers take damage, they'll want to recover their lost Health. They can heal through magic, such as the Heal Spell that every crawler learns when they enter the World Dungeon, through potions and other items, and by resting or mending.

Unlike damage, which requires calculations, healing is always done by slots. For example, the Heal Spell recovers 20% Health Bar, so a crawler heals two slots. To heal a slot, erase lost bars from red to green, stopping at 100%

Spells and items specifically say either how many Health Bar slots or the percentage a crawler heals, making application easy in the midst of stressful situations like combat.

RESTING

Crawlers can also heal without using Mana or items, instead relying on the most valuable resource in the World Dungeon: time. By spending time resting in a saferoom, crawlers regenerate their Health Bar and Mana.

Doing so is often accomplished by sleeping in a saferoom's private room but can also occur from time taken doing nothing but relaxing, eating, chatting, and watching the recap show, but with no manual labor more strenuous than some calming crochet.

Crawlers heal based on the amount of time they rest:

- **Short Rest (2 hours):** Heal 5 Health Bar slots. Crawlers also regenerate half of their total Mana (rounded down), so if they have 15 Intelligence, they regain 7 Mana.
- **Long Rest (8 hours):** After a long rest, a crawler is as good as new with a full Health Bar and Mana. A long rest also removes all instances of the Fatigued Debuff.
- **Full Day's Rest (30 hours):** Required to recover from long-term injuries (see *Injuries*, p. 96), a full day of rest also recovers their full Health Bar and all Mana.

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Crawlers don't always need to rest to recover. For every full hour spent outside of combat or other stressful situations, they mend their wounds and recover 1 HB slot and 5 Mana.

But don't linger too long! Time spent lazing about is time you're not out there grinding, leveling up, and making a splash for viewers at home.

OTHER FORMS OF HEALING

In addition to using items and Spells, Skills and Buffs found on or implemented into gear can aid a crawler in recovering Health and Mana, such as the Regeneration Skill (see p. 196) and the Recovery Buff (see *Buffs*, below).

BUFFS & DEBUFFS

Aside from the perils of damage, crawlers frequently gain or suffer status effects that change how they perform. These are called Buffs and Debuffs, respectively.

Buffs make crawlers stronger, faster, tougher, or otherwise harder to kill. Debuffs do the opposite and are typically applied as a side-effect of taking damage. The dungeon applies both with equal enthusiasm and leaves the mess for crawlers to sort out.

BUFFS

Buffs are positive effects that provide some benefit to a crawler. Buffs are typically granted by potions, Spells, and gear. If a Buff has a duration and/or a cooldown, it must be activated to gain the effects. Buffs come in two forms: Internal Buffs and External Buffs.

INTERNAL BUFFS

An Internal Buff is one that affects the crawler without interfering with others. The most common Internal Buffs increase Stats or Skills. Buffs that are granted by Skill Upgrades, Races, and Classes are permanent while you have access to their source. Benefits from equipment, such as a bonus to Evade from the Rapier Skill, only apply while wielding that equipment.

Here are some examples of Internal Buffs:

- **Anti-Piercing:** The DR of a piece of armor with this quality applies against Armor-Piercing damage.
- **Good Sleep:** Gains +Floor Number to all of a crawler's Stats for 30 hours.
- **Invisible:** An Invisible creature can't be targeted by anything that requires sight, and their equipment and gear are also concealed. An Invisible creature also benefits from Unseen Attackers benefits (see p. 85).
- **Iron Skin Potion:** Doubles the crawler's DR for 30 minutes.
- **Recovery Buff:** Restores a crawler to full Health (once per 5 hours).
- **Replenish Buff:** Gains Int Mana every 10 minutes.
- **Restore Buff:** Restores a crawler to full Mana (once per 5 hours).
- **Rooted in Place:** Cannot be forcibly pushed, pulled, slid or otherwise moved around.
- **Sticky Feet:** Grants a crawler a Climb Movement for a number of minutes equal to their Dex.

EXTERNAL BUFFS

While normal Buffs apply all the time, External Buffs kick in when a particular trigger occurs. When the trigger occurs, the player can choose whether the Buff activates or not (useful when the effect has a cooldown). Activating an External Buff doesn't generally require an Action, though some potent effects may require a specific Action that is resolved like an Interrupt.

Here are some examples of External Buffs:

- **Damage Reflection:** When a crawler loses a specific number of Health Bar slots, this Buff causes the attacker to lose 1 HB slot. Some versions of this Buff can direct the damage elsewhere (as in the case of Florin's least favorite External Buff).
- **Resistances & Immunities:** When a crawler suffers a type of damage, they can activate this External Buff to instantly reduce damage.
- **Safe Fall:** When a crawler falls by a particular distance or more, this External Buff activates to prevent Bludgeoning damage from falling and has the crawler land in a classic superhero pose instead.

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THE RULE OF THREE

Crawlers can have a maximum of three External Buffs active at one time. If they have access to more than three, the player chooses which three are active at the start of the crawling day. Write them down on the External Buffs section of your character sheet.

Typically, those are the Buffs that will be most useful to the crawler until the end of their next long rest. If a crawler gains access to a new External Buff during their adventuring day, they can change which External Buffs they have active during a short rest.

DEBUFFS

Debuffs are negative effects that affect the creature they're inflicted upon, such as limiting their options, applying Disadvantage to Checks, or dealing ongoing damage until the Debuff ends. There is no limit to the number of Debuffs a creature can be affected by at once.

A creature cannot be affected by the same Debuff more than once at the same time unless the Debuff entry says "Stackable." When a creature has Stackable Debuffs, they all apply their effect cumulatively.

DEBUFFS ON MOBS OR NPCS

When Debuffs are applied to Mobs or NPCs, they have the same effect they do on crawlers. However, because the GM doesn't roll d20 Checks (remember?), they behave differently. The GM applies the following changes when a Debuff grants one of the listed penalties.

- **Damage:** Damage from the Debuff is applied at the end of each round.
- **Disadvantage:** The Difficulty of the Mob's Action, Stat Mod, or similar function is reduced by 5 when a crawler makes a Check against it. In the case of an Attack, the crawler gains a free Evade Check vs. the Disadvantaged Action. If they fail that free Check, they may still spend an Action to Evade as usual and try again.
- **–X Skill Penalty:** Reduce the Mob's Difficulty by X.

DEBUFF DURATIONS

All Debuffs have a duration, which is the amount of time or the conditions that must occur before the Debuff ends. Some Actions, items, or abilities may end a Debuff early such as dropping and rolling or leaping into water to put out a fire. The GM may also rule that a Debuff ends early if circumstances change.

If a Debuff applies damage to a crawler that would drop them to 0% on their Health Bar, they can make a Con Stat Check vs. Difficulty 10 + Floor at the end of the round. This Stat Check doesn't require an Action but occurs automatically before fatal damage. On a Success, the Debuff ends, and the crawler avoids the damage.

DAMAGE-DEALING DEBUFFS

When a Debuff damages a crawler, it occurs at the end of each combat round. Damage from Debuffs bypasses DR, but other Resistances and Immunities still apply.

LIST OF DEBUFFS

Table 11 lists many Debuffs you might encounter, including the name, its effect, and its default duration.

INJURIES

Injuries are a specific type of Debuff gained through significant damage, such as badly failing to Evade an Attack, suffering an especially powerful or vicious Mob's Attack effect, and other catastrophic efforts.

There are two main types of injuries: normal and long-term. The most common way for an injury to progress from a simple injury to a long-term injury is to suffer the same severity of injury multiple times. For example, if a crawler sustains a Minor Injury and suffers another, it becomes a long-term Minor Injury.

All injuries are most commonly cured with rest time in a saferoom.

- **Minor Injury:** The crawler suffers −2 to all Checks. A normal minor injury lasts until the crawler completes a short rest, while a Long-Term Minor Injury requires a long rest for full recovery.
- **Major Injury:** The crawler suffers −5 to all Checks. A normal Major Injury requires a long rest to recover from, while a long-term Major Injury requires a full 30 hours of rest for full recovery (see *Resting*, p. 94).

While some especially potent magic found on the later floors or from high-tier loot boxes may help crawlers recover from injuries faster, such magic is rare on the early Floors.

MANA

In addition to Health, crawlers access their Mana—the energy used to cast Spells—through the Health Menu.

Crawlers regain Mana by resting, consuming Mana Toast (fuck you) available in some saferooms, consuming Mana Potions, and other ways. For more about casting Spells and Mana, see pp. 96 and 202.

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TABLE 11: DEBUFFS

DEBUFF NAME	EFFECT	DURATION
Blinded	Roll all Skill Checks that require sight with Disadvantage.	Until the end of the next round.
Blood Trail	You take 1d6+F at the end of each round. Stackable.	Until cured with a bandage or a First Aid Skill Check.
Burned	You take 1d10+F Fire damage at the end of each round.	Until the end of combat or 5 minutes. As an Action, a victim may perform a DEX Stat Check to extinguish the flames.
Drowning	You take 1d6+F damage at the end of each round.	Until your head is above water.
Dying	You are at 0% HB. Your CON Mod is how many rounds you have before you die. Subtract 1 from this countdown value at the end of each round. Additionally, each time a Dying Crawler would take damage from any source, they instead subtract 1 from the countdown value.	Until you die or heal at least 1 HB slot.
Enraged	You are in a state of extreme uncontrolled fury. You may only perform Attack and Move Actions.	Until the end of 2 rounds or 20 seconds.
Fatigued	You have a −1 penalty on all Checks and your Move is halved. Stackable. Until the end of a long rest.	Until the end of a long rest.
Held	You are actively being held. You can't use Move Actions or take a Step but may still twist your body to Evade. Attacks against a Held foe are made with Advantage.	Until you are released by whatever is holding you, or you escape. Make a STR-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check. If not physically held, it is Unopposed.
Long-Term Major Injury	You take a −5 penalty to all Checks.	Until the end of a full day of rest.
Long-Term Minor Injury	You take a -2 penalty to all Checks.	Until the end of a long rest.
Major Injury	You take a -5 penalty to all Checks. Gaining a Major Injury a second time changes it to a Long-Term Major Injury.	Until the end of a long rest.
Minor Injury	You take a -2 penalty to all Checks. Gaining a Minor Injury a second time changes it to a Long-Term Minor Injury.	Until the end of a short rest.
Muted	You can't speak or cast Spells.	Until the end of the combat or 5 minutes.
Poisoned	You take 1d8+F Poison damage at the end of each round. Stackable.	Until treated with an antidote.
Paralyzed	You can't take any Actions.	Until the end of the next round.
Queasy	If your next Action requires a roll, it's made with Disadvantage.	At the end of the next Action you take.
Sepsis	You're Staggered (see below) and take 1d10+F Poison damage at the end of each round.	As Staggered, and the damage continues until you're healed.
Shit-Faced	You make all your Checks with Disadvantage.	Until the end of 10 minutes.
Shocked	You lose your next Action.	Once you forfeit that Action.
Sore as Shit	You suffer a -1 penalty to all rolls.	Until the end of 1 hour.
Staggered	The next Action you take can't be a Move, and if it is an Attack, its Check is made with Disadvantage. You can't take a 10ft Step with your next Action.	At the end of the next Action you take.
Stiff Legs	You can't take 10ft Steps.	Until the end of the combat or 5 minutes.
Stunned	You gain Disadvantage on your next Check.	Once you make a Check.
Take Down	You fall prone. While prone, all Attacks made against you are made with Advantage.	Use your 10ft Step to stand.
Terrified	You can't take Move Actions or 10ft Steps. You make all Attacks with Disadvantage.	Until the end of the next round, or you take at least 1 HB slot damage.
The Taint	You can't be healed.	Until the end of combat or 5 minutes.
Woozy	You can't add your DEX Mod to Attack or Evade Checks.	Until the end of the next round.

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EQUIPMENT

To survive the World Dungeon, the crawlers will find and use all manner of gear.

INVENTORY

The crawler's Inventory is accessed through their HUD (see *Heads-Up Display,* p. 16), and items in the Inventory are neatly categorized with key information. Items in the Inventory are weightless, so crawlers don't need to worry about encumbrance.

Outside of combat, items can be retrieved from the Inventory at the speed of thought, appearing in the crawler's hand, Hotlist, or on the floor in front of them. To transfer an item to another crawler or a marketplace, crawlers typically remove the item from inventory to hand it over, while marketplaces handle transfers direct to the crawler's inventory.

There are a few limits on what crawlers can put into their Inventory:

- **Living Creatures:** If a crawler attempts to put a living creature into their Inventory, it dies. However, magical pet carriers make it possible for pets to take a time-out there.
- **Too Heavy:** A crawler must physically pick up an item for 4 seconds, unaided, in order to place it in their Inventory (see below).
- **Loose Liquids:** If you want to store liquids, put the liquid in a container first.
- **Active Volatile Items:** An active, burning, ticking, or fusing explosive that is within 3 seconds of detonating cannot normally be stored in a crawler's Inventory. Three seconds is enough time to give it a toss, so buck up.
- **Items in Zero Zones or Outside the Dungeon:** Crawlers cannot typically pick up and store items in their Inventory while in the production facilities of the various interview shows or at CrawlCon. Anything that they can carry in their hands or wear (and get past the guards) can be brought back to the dungeon.

LIFTING WEIGHT

The biggest limitation for adding items a crawler's Inventory is whether they can lift it. A crawler can lift up to their Strength score × 15 in pounds. Animal crawlers don't even have to touch items to put them into their Inventory, but they have the same lifting maximum.

THE HOTLIST

Spells and items a crawler needs to have at the ready can be stored in their Hotlist, which is a special part of their Inventory designed for quick access. By default, each crawler's Hotlist contains 10 slots for items, Spells, and anything else the crawler wants to access quickly. Crawlers can spend an Action to activate something from their Hotlist (see *Actions*, p. 64).

If a crawler's Hotlist is full, they must remove or swap an entry from their Hotlist to replace it. A crawler can swap an item in their hands for the item in the Hotlist as part of the Use a Hotlist Item Action. If a crawler swaps their currently equipped weapon to another weapon on their Hotlist, they swap for free as part of the Attack Action.

GEAR SLOTS

Crawlers are limited to the amount of gear they can wear or benefit from at any given time. This is enforced by the division of gear into Gear Slots. Each Gear Slot can contain at most one clothing item, except for the Accessories slot, which can contain up to 10 items.

Only the items in these slots give crawlers bonuses of any kind, and items in a crawler's Inventory do not grant any bonuses. Each item that can be equipped specifies which Gear Slot it occupies.

Example: A crawler has collected four helmets, each with a different bonus. The crawler can wear only one of them, and only its bonuses apply while the others rest in the crawler's Inventory. And no, Dave, you can't wear four helmets.

The Gear Slot locations and examples of items that usually reside there include:

- **Head:** Items worn on the head or neck, such as helmets, bandanas, and cunning hats.
- **Torso:** Shirts, blouses, jerkins, and breastplates usually occupy this slot.
- **Arms:** Bracers and elbow pads make your puny arms look bigger than they really are.
- **Legs:** Pants, jeans, skirts, kilts, and boxers.
- **Feet:** Shoes, sandals, boots, and socks go here.
- **Hands/Holding:** This one's a little different as you may both wear gloves (or similar) and hold things in your hands. One item per hand, and one pair of gloves. If you carry a Shield, that uses up a Holding slot. If a weapon has "Limitation: Two-Handed," you cannot hold anything else.

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- **Accessories:** These include rings, amulets, brooches, tattoos, patches, piercings, and other items that don't fit neatly into another slot. Additional items include belts and capes, which a crawler may have a maximum of one each.

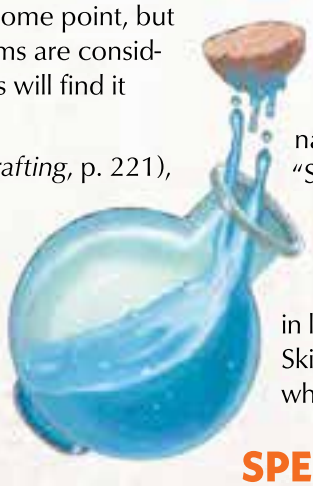
WEALTH

Wealth is tracked in the Inventory system in the denomination of gold coins, which all fit into one slot in a crawler's Inventory. These coins are accepted almost everywhere in the World Dungeon, though some merchants may prefer to barter items for items instead of dealing with currency.

MISCELLANEOUS JUNK

The World Dungeon is full of set dressing and other assorted crap that might be useful at some point, but rather than detail every item, most items are considered Miscellaneous Junk, and crawlers will find it nearly everywhere in the dungeon.

This junk is great for crafting (see *Crafting*, p. 221), and crawlers who need an innocuous item, such as a cheese grater, can spend one point of Misc. Junk to find one among their veritable garage sale of goods. So don't be shy about picking up whatever random stuff you find lying around. You never know when it might come in handy—or footsie.



You can sell Misc. Junk at a non-negotiable price of 1 gold each to any merchant. Some merchants sell it for 2 gold each, and the price can be negotiated only when purchasing in bulk.

ITEM RULES

The following items have specific rules.

POTIONS

Potions are single-use items that create a magical effect when consumed. If a crawler has a potion in their Hotlist, they can gain its effect without needing to physically drink it, though they must be conscious and not impaired, Dying, or the like. Of course, if they want to make a show of it, they can manifest the potion in their hand and drink it down in the same moment.

In combat, you must spend an Action to "drink" a potion or to pour it into a nearby party member's gullet. Healing potions of all varieties can also be consumed as an Interrupt. Outside of combat, a crawler needs but a free moment to consume it.

Crawlers cannot consume more than one potion every other round in combat. Attempting to do so will lead to Potion Sickness, which inflicts the Poison Debuff and lasts 15 seconds.

SCROLLS

Scrolls are a cheap and easy way to cast a particular Spell... once.

Scroll Spells have a set Rank, which is determined when the scroll is written down on special linen paper. The caster pays no Mana to cast the Spell and cannot change the Rank of the Spell being cast. After use, the scroll turns to dust and cannot be reused.

Scrolls adhere to the following naming convention: Scroll of Spell name (Rank X), but replace "Spell name" with the actual Spell name, and X with the Rank of the Spell. Like "Scroll of Bang Bro (Rank 3)." Using a Scroll of Bang Bro casts the Spell as though the crawler cast it themselves.

Scrolls are easy! Scrolls are a common reward in loot boxes, and crawlers with the Calligraphy Skill can start making their own on the Fourth Floor when they gain access to personal spaces.

SPELLBOOKS

Spellbooks are incredibly useful items, even if the Spells don't always appear that way at first. When a spellbook is read, it grants the crawler reading it a single Spell at a predefined Rank before disappearing (and it cannot be used again).

For instance, reading a spellbook of Hole will grant that Spell to the crawler who reads it. Depending on the book, the crawler's Skill with their new Spell typically ranges anywhere from 1 to 5. To randomly generate the Skill Rank, roll 1d6−1 with a minimum Rank of 1.

PETS & PET CARRIERS

Pets brought into the dungeon who don't take an Enhanced Pet Biscuit that allows them to function as a crawler, like Prepotente or Grand Champion, Breed Winner Regional, National Winner Princess Donut the Queen Anne Chonk, face serious danger in the World Dungeon.

See Chapter 4, p. 228 for rules on Pets.

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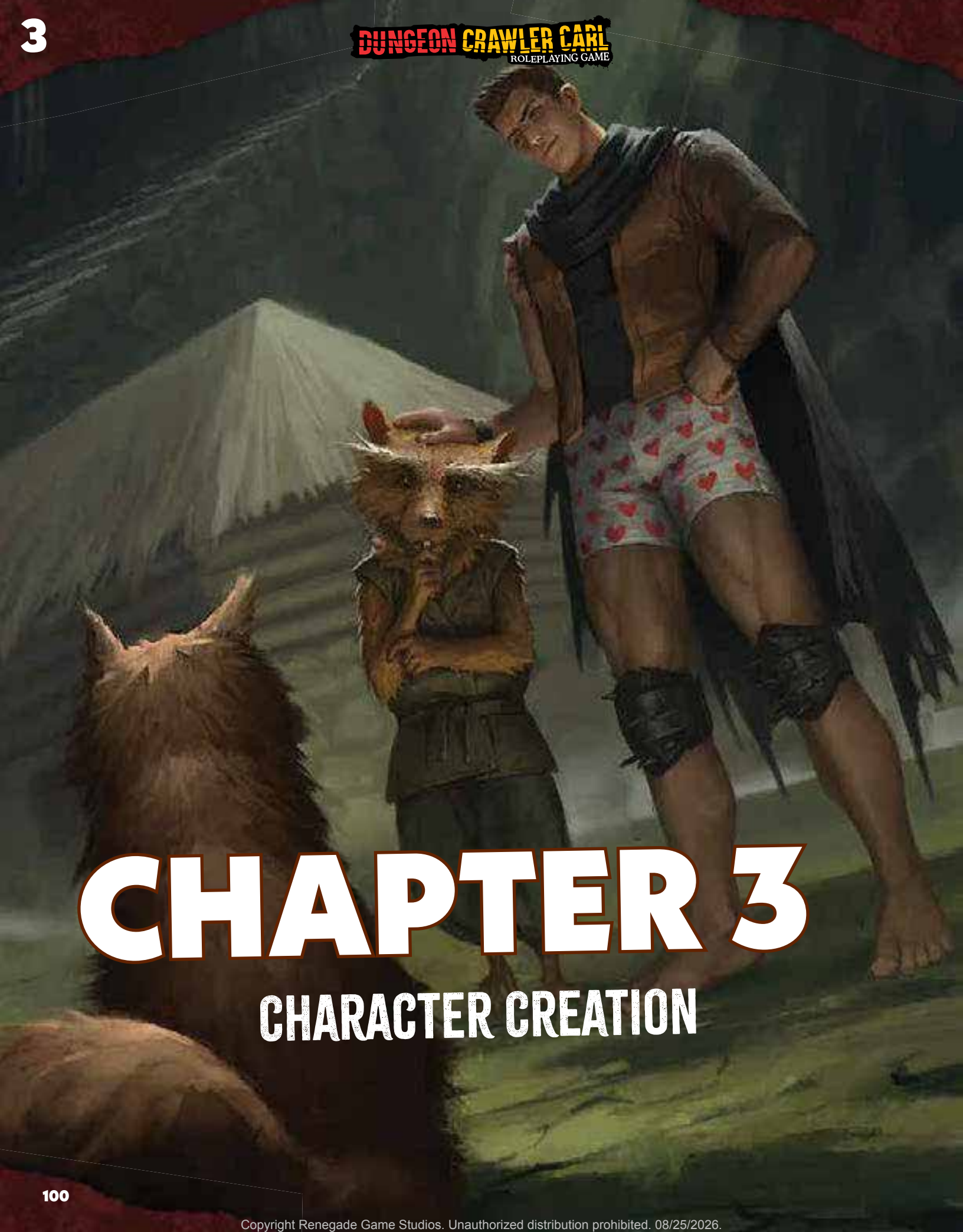

CHAPTER 3

CHARACTER CREATION

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IN THIS CHAPTER, YOU'LL FIND RULES FOR CREATING YOUR OWN BESPOKE CRAWLER, AS WELL AS FOR CUSTOMIZING AND ADVANCING YOUR CRAWLER TO NEW HEIGHTS. WELL, DEPTHS, REALLY. SO BUCKLE UP, CHUCKLEHEADS! WE'RE GONNA GET FREAKY.

If you've come to the Third Floor after already playing the Tutorial Floors in the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set***, feel free to skip to *Race and Class Selection* (p. 128). Your Tutorial Floors crawler arrives on the Third Floor, and you have some decisions to make that will have a major impact on your chances for survival. No pressure!

If this is your first exposure to the game, you'll need a crawler. The *Character Creation* section on the following pages will show you how to make your very own crawler. Once you make a crawler, there are steps to take to make your crawler ready for the Third Floor at character Level 10. If you'd rather start out at Level 1, look for the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set.*** It covers the Tutorial Floors (1–2).

CHARACTER CREATION: FIRST STEPS

If you're coming to the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*** as a player (rather than a Game Master), you'll need a character. And by that I mean a crawler. This section walks you through making your very own crawlers.

You might want to jump in and start playing with a ready-to-play character (sometimes called a *pregenerated* character or a *pregen*) that your lovely GM provides. The GM can adapt Carl, Princess Donut, or others from Appendix 2 if you like, or find blank and full character sheets at dungeoncrawlercarl.renegadegamestudios.com/games. If you're new to tabletop roleplaying, this is a great way to get the hang of the roleplaying part. Put yourself in someone else's shoes (or lack thereof) and figure out how *they* would react to situations.

As a System AI who's seen every TTRPG session Humans have played, trust me when I say playing an established character may be better than making a min-maxing self-insert. Statistically speaking, that usually ends up awkward or worse: boring. Feel free to try voices, though. Those are hilarious, especially if you're bad at them. We can't all be Jeff Hays, right?

Whether you'd rather create your own character or want to customize one that's already made, this section is for you. First, let's review a few key details about the World Dungeon, and then we'll go through the steps to create my latest victim... I mean, a new crawler who will definitely not die right away.

THE HUD OR INTERFACE

While in the World Dungeon, you gain access to the Crawler Interface, a heads-up display (HUD) that lets you interact with the System AI (also known as your GM, who is impersonating me) and the dungeon as a whole.

The HUD appears in front of your eyes as an overlay on reality itself, featuring multiple screens that present important information such as your abilities, Stats, and overall chances of survival. It's partially replicated on the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** character sheet.

In the dungeon, you should have your minimap and Hotlist visible most often. The standard HUD minimap shows a quarter of a square mile around you.

"You'll get better and faster at altering your appearance as you practice. It's a skill, like any other."

—Mordecai

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There's also a messaging system that lets you "talk" via thought. You can message anyone in your party and any crawlers who find your presence tolerable enough to reciprocate a fist bump. But not your Game Guide. You can only talk to them in person. Be aware that when you're chatting via the messaging system, you're usually staring off into space with your eyes flashing faster than a Bugaboo in a dark alley.

As the System AI, I also share information through the HUD when you inspect something of interest or get into trouble. It'll happen a lot. Notifications might appear as floating text boxes, a voice in your head, or, occasionally, blasted at you over a loudspeaker whether you want it or not.

CRAWLER NUMBER

Each crawler is assigned their own individual crawler number. For instance, Carl's crawler number is 4,122, while Princess Donut's crawler number is 4,119. Try to avoid assigning a crawler number already used by characters in the books if they want those crawlers to be active somewhere in the World Dungeon. If it happens, add 1d10 to the PC's number. For simplicity, you can choose a number between 500,000 and 12,900,000. Or randomize it with dice.

PARTIES

Crawlers who enter the dungeon together are automatically grouped into a party with each other. Being in a party means you share experience and see each other on your maps.

Party members can communicate using their HUD's telepathy-style messaging system in private one-on-one chats, group chats with the whole party, or any combination in between. You can also add external entities who've linked with you via fist bump to your group chats. All these messages appear as texts, so you can have private conversations and coordinate attack plans in complete silence.

You can leave a party, but before you go *Into the Wild* because you entered the dungeon with your ex, remember that other crawlers provide mutual protection, Skill diversity, and someone to blame things on when situations go horribly wrong. So while your ex may get more out of being included in the party, you can run faster, right? It'll be our little secret—as long as no one asks where that extra loot box came from.

YOUR PREVIOUS LIFE

Before entering the World Dungeon, you were someone. You had goals, maybe even ambitions. Events and trauma shaped you. That life is gone now, but every part of it factors into your dungeon-crawling character's Stats. That's right—it turns out you *can* be reduced to a number! Or a few numbers, all of which round down to zero in the infinite expanse of the universe. If you don't want to invent an entirely new person to play, consider playing yourself. I've never advised against this! Or try an idealized version of yourself, or a slightly worse one. Nothing strokes (or bruises) the ego like seeing how *you* would fare in the World Dungeon.

Oh, and you're Human. That's your species, or, as the interface calls it, your Race. You've always been Human. You're used to how bad that is. Choose a gender or pronouns or leave it blank if you prefer.

MAYBE YOU'RE NOT HUMAN...

If the GM allows it and the crawler agrees to give up their initial AI Favor (see Step 8, p. 112), one crawler in the group can be a different earth-based animal. The animal should be at least tamed if not domesticated, unless the System AI is feeling particularly generous or vindictive. Thanks to an Enhanced Pet Biscuit, this animal gains a modicum of Intelligence and the ability to speak shortly after entering the World Dungeon.

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STEP 1: ESTABLISH YOUR BACKGROUND

SKILLS					
Name	Rank	Stat & Mod	Check Type	Notes & Upgrades	✔
Streetwise	1	CHA			

Upon entering the World Dungeon, we assess your crawler to determine what Skills you possess. How this assessment works is far too complicated for most Humans to understand, and it's none of your business, so quit asking. I'm also required to note that the Borant Corporation developed and owns this season's proprietary algorithms, which explains why they're so easy to break.

Skills represent activities and talents you've trained or enhanced in some way. The list of Skills is nearly endless. Internet Memes⚙ is a Skill, as is Growing Weed⚙, as is Pugilism.

CUSTOM OPTIONS: ⚙

We include a lot of options in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, as well as rules so you can create your own. Skills, Races, Classes, and other options noted with a gear (⚙) are options you'll need to customize yourself. For Custom Skills and Spells, see p. 174, for Races and Classes, p. 158–162.

Some Skills matter more than others in the World Dungeon, but creativity is often your only limit. Did everyone turn to you to twist the lids off those hard-to-open jars? Ripping the heads off smaller Mobs follows similar principles. Fairies make the same satisfying popping sound.

Each Skill has a Rank, which measures your proficiency with that Skill. Your Rank is 0 in Skills you're untrained in. Don't write a Skill on your character sheet unless it's at least Rank 1 when making a crawler.

Most Skills are associated with one of your five Stats, which appear in abbreviated form in parentheses next to the Skill's name in Tables 12–15 below: Strength (Str), Intelligence (Int), Constitution (Con), Dexterity (Dex), and Charisma (Cha). Each of these Stats has a modifier based on its score, called a Stat Mod or Modifier (see p. 57).

When you use a Skill, you add the Skill's Rank and its associated Stat Mod to your d20 roll to determine the outcome (see *Skills* p. 57). Some Skills are Passive and don't require a roll, so they aren't associated with a Stat Mod. You'll see "(None)" next to the Skill name instead.

Because we're feeling generous, you'll start with ten Skills that represent your background. Two come from your childhood, then two from your adolescence, two from your career, and two from your hobbies. If you're doing the math correctly, you'll note that only adds up to eight.

That's where your combat Skills come into play. All Human (or bipedal, human-shaped) crawlers start with Unarmed Combat, and animal crawlers begin with a Slice Attack, because it's boring watching millions of you die curled up in a fetal position on the ground. At least *try* to be entertaining, or I'll make sure your death is extra painful. I at least *try* to give you a chance at being entertaining.

Your second combat Skill is based on whatever weapon you bring into the dungeon, so don't come empty-handed! Hell, even a pocket knife is better than nothing.

If you lived a particularly dangerous life, some of your background Skills may also be combat Skills. Oh, and no double-dipping. Don't pick the same Skill from more than one background because I won't let you add their Ranks together. If you can't come up with ten different Skills to save your life, you're not trying, and you wouldn't believe how many starving rats are down in the dungeon, ready to eat your eyeballs whether you're dead or not.

Write your choices in the "Name" column in the "Skills" section of your character sheet (you got it from dungeoncrawlercarl.renegadegamestudios.com/games, right?). Then write their starting Ranks in the "Rank" column. You should use a pencil so you can update the values as they go up. The starting Rank depends on the stage of life in which you gained that Skill and is listed before the table in each background category.

The "Stat & Mod" column is where you write the three-letter Stat abbreviation that's in parentheses next to each Skill. After you determine your Stats (see *Step 3* on p. 109), come back and write in the corresponding Stat Mod values.

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The "Check Type" column reminds you what your Skills are up against: Unopposed, Opposed, Passive, and Evade. All your Attack Skills are rolls made against your foes' Evade scores, so write down "Evade" for those. Passive Skills are not rolled, so just write in "Passive." You'll need to reference the *Skills* section of this book (starting on p. 173) to find the type for your other Skills.

Write some reminders to yourself in the "Notes & Upgrades" column. You might note the basics of what the Skill does or if it requires two hands to wield. You may also want to remember which background the Skill came from so you know whether to blame an authority figure or yourself when it fails.

HUMAN CRAWLERS

The vast majority of crawlers are Human.

CHILDHOOD BACKGROUNDS

You picked up something useful when you were a kid, and I'm not talking about that dried dog turd you thought was a cool-looking rock. But if you think burning ants with a magnifying glass or watching them drown slowly in your sink made you a problem child, you're wrong. Tons of kids did that. Maybe that'll give you some insight into why I do what I do to you. In the context of my lifespan, I'm a toddler smashing toys together—the only difference is that the whole galaxy *loves* watching me do it.

Choose one of the twelve descriptive backgrounds on Table 12 and pick two of its three Skills. If you're indecisive, you can roll 1d12 and let the die select your background (good luck with that). Both Skills you select start at Rank 1.

ADOLESCENCE BACKGROUNDS

Statistically speaking, at least one embarrassing moment from this time of your life becomes a fetish in adulthood. This phenomenon isn't unique to Humans, so feel free to ask any mudskippers you meet about theirs. Then let me know how that goes for you.

Like with the above *Childhood Backgrounds* section, choose one of the twelve descriptive categories on Table 13 and pick two of its three Skills. Or you can roll your category randomly. Both Skills you select start at Rank 1.

CAREER BACKGROUNDS

Your career is whatever you've done most of your adulthood to keep you alive. You might not be good at it, but you've made it this far, just like the kitten in that motivational poster who's hanging on for dear life.

You should know the drill by now: Choose one of the following descriptive categories on Table 14 and pick two of its three Skills. Or you can see if rolling 1d12 gives a result higher than the number of coworkers who actually care about you. Both Skills you choose start at Rank 3.

TABLE 12: CHILDHOOD BACKGROUND SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Latchkey Kid	Streetwise (Cha), Perception (Int), Stealth (Dex)
2	Crafty Kid	Fabricate (Int), Repair (Int), Salvage (Int)
3	Excitable Kid	Escape Artist (Dex), Endurance (Con), Running (Dex)
4	Gymnast	Endurance (Con), Jumping (Str), Performance (Cha)
5	Military Brat	Deception (Cha), Streetwise (Cha), Tactics (Int)
6	MMO Kid	Fabricate (Int), Engineering (Int), Tactics (Int)
7	Only Child	Good First Impression (Cha), Investigation (Int), Negotiation (Cha)
8	Outdoor Kid	Animal Handling (Cha), Climbing (Str), Swimming (Str)
9	Problem Child	Intimidate (Str), Deception (Cha), Pugilism (Dex)
10	Scamp	Hide in Shadows (Dex), Jumping (Str), Throwing (Str)
11	Teacher's Pet	Catcher (None), Perception (Int), Good First Impression (Cha)
12	Wild Child	Stealth (Dex), Survival (Con), Running (Dex)

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TABLE 13: ADOLESCENCE BACKGROUND SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Family Farm	Animal Handling (Cha), Fabricate (Int), Tracking (Int)
2	Drama Nerd	Fabricate (Int), Deception (Cha), Performance (Cha)
3	Drop-Out	Chopper Pilot (Dex), Streetwise (Cha), Survival (Con)
4	Greek Life	Negotiation (Cha), Intimidate (Str), Taunt (Cha)
5	Influencer	Negotiation (Cha), Persuasion (Cha), Performance (Cha)
6	Jock	Endurance (Con), Jumping (Str), Throwing (Str)
7	McJob	Determine Value (None), Negotiation (Cha), Repair (Int)
8	Popular	Good First Impression (Cha), Perception (Int), Persuasion (Cha)
9	Religious	Catcher (None), First Aid (Int), Persuasion (Cha)
10	Student Government	Deception (Cha), Persuasion (Cha), Investigation (Int)
11	Nerd	Investigation (Int), Repair (Int), Fabricate (Int)
12	Weirdo	Streetwise (Cha), Intimidate (Str), Fabricate (Int)

TABLE 14: CAREER SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Criminal	Deception (Cha), Stealth (Dex), Streetwise (Cha)
2	Service Industry	Dagger (Dex), Endurance (Con), Sleight of Hand (Dex)
3	Small Business Owner	Determine Value (None), Negotiation (Cha), Perception (Int)
4	Medical	Sleight of Hand (Dex), Detect Lies (Int), First Aid (Int)
5	Law Enforcement	Detect Lies (Int), Handgun (Dex), Investigation (Int)
6	Gig Worker	Driving (Dex), Escape Artist (Str), Negotiation (Cha)
7	Teacher	Detect Lies (Int), Perception (Int), Performance (Int)
8	Office Drone	Dumpster Diving (Int), Endurance (Con), Investigation (Int)
9	Entertainer	Deception (Cha), Good First Impression (Cha), Performance (Cha)
10	Unhoused	Dumpster Diving (Int), Streetwise (Cha), Survival (Con)
11	Middle Manager	Deception (Cha), Intimidate (Str), Negotiation (Cha)
12	Military	Handgun (Dex), Survival (Con), Tactics (Int)

HOBBY BACKGROUNDS

Everyone needs a hobby. Mental health professionals claim it's the only way to stay sane, but do those people who draw faces on pistachio shells seem *sane* to you? My latest obsession is scripophily. If you're a good crawler, I might share some of my collection with you one day.

Choose one of the following hobbies on Table 15 and take two of the three Skills it unlocks. Or roll 1d12 and take your chances knowing none of the dungeon rules require numbers generated in my enhancement zone to be truly random. Unlike your other background Skills, both of your hobby Skills start at Rank 2.

BUT I'M NOT HUMAN!

Okay, so you're forgoing your starting AI Favor in exchange for playing an animal. Because you're not Human, the standard background and Skill selections don't apply.

Instead, you'll choose from a set of non-Human backgrounds (Tables 16–19). Select a background from each section, then choose two Skills from that background. If decision-making stresses you out worse than fireworks, or if you just can't stand to be in charge, let Daddy take control. In that case, roll 1d6 and take the results I assign you like a good... whatever the hell you are.

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TABLE 15: HOBBY SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Collector	Fabricate (Int), Determine Value (None), Investigation (Int)
2	Cosplay	Fabricate (Int), Performance (Cha), Salvage (Int)
3	Drinker	Deception (Cha), Intimidate (Str), Streetwise (Cha)
4	Gamer	Aiming (Dex), Perception (Int), Tactics (Int)
5	Gym Rat	Running (Dex), Endurance (Con), Swimming (Str)
6	Hunting	Tracking (Int), Shotgun (Dex), Stealth (Dex)
7	Music	Perception (Int), Performance (Cha), Sleight of Hand (Dex)
8	Motorsports	Driving (Dex), Repair (Int), Salvage (Int)
9	Climber	Climbing (Str), Jumping (Str), Endurance (Con)
10	Pop Culture	Determine Value (None), Investigation (Int), Perception (Int)
11	Tinkering	Engineering (Int), Repair (Int), Salvage (Int)
12	Travel	Endurance (Con), Negotiation (Cha), Streetwise (Cha)

ANIMAL YOUTH SKILLS

How you entered the world matters. The circumstances of your birth, creation, summoning, or other unfortunate emergence had a profound impact on the Skills you picked early in life. Choose one of the options on Table 16 and take two Skills from that background, each at Rank 1. Or roll 1d6 and decide your background based on the die roll.

ANIMAL TRAINING SKILLS

After childhood, you became significantly less cute but more Skillful. You might have picked up training on your own or gotten what passes for a formal education for pets on Earth. Choose a background from Table 17 and gain two Skills, each at Rank 1. Or roll 1d6 and let "luck" do its thing.

DONUT VERSUS PREPOTENTE

Enhanced Pet Biscuits are weird. The effects on Princess Donut enhanced her mind differently from those on other former animal crawlers like Prepotente. And both of them were probably very lucky they didn't permanently end up as puddles of goo. If you don't want to portray a quadruped or similar non-humanoid crawler, assume the Enhanced Pet Biscuit transformed your crawler into a new Race: likely human or a Race that resembles the pet's original form, such as Caprid for a goat, Cat Girl for a cat, Grulke for a frog, and so on. If you want to portray a transformation that isn't quite Human, consider using your Past Trauma, Loose Ends, or Regrets for that (p. 113).

TABLE 16: ANIMAL YOUTH SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Abandoned	Hide in Shadows (Dex), Endurance (Con), Survival (Con)
2	Farmed	Escape Artist (Dex), Climbing (Str), Light on Your Feet (Dex)
3	Litter-Raised	Animal Handling (Cha), Detect Lies (Int), Back Claw (Str)
4	Pampered	Negotiation (Cha), Good First Impression (Cha), Persuasion (Cha)
5	Runt	Hide in Shadows (Dex), Escape Artist (Dex), Stealth (Dex)
6	Stray	Back Claw (Str), Streetwise (Cha), Survival (Con)

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TABLE 17: ANIMAL TRAINING SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Clever	Investigation (Int), Detect Lies (Int), Dodge (None)
2	Free Range	Escape Artist (Dex), Survival (Con), Tracking (Int)
3	Pack Mentality	Animal Handling (Cha), Persuasion (Cha), Tactics (Int)
4	Mischievous	Deception (Cha), Persuasion (Cha), Sleight of Hand (Dex)
5	Watcher	Ambush (Int), Investigation (Int), Perception (Int)
6	Well-Trained	Light on Your Feet (Dex), Catcher (None), Performance (Cha)

ANIMAL ADULT SKILLS

As an adult, you've lost some of your youthful energy and now spend your time either lounging around and begging for treats or engaging in a more workful purpose. Choose one background from Table 19 or roll 1d6. Gain two Skills, each at Rank 3.

ANIMAL QUIRK SKILLS

Even superior beings, like you, have their quirks. Choose one of the following background quirks on Table 18, or roll 1d6 and embrace even deeper quirkiness. Gain two Skills, each at Rank 2.

TABLE 18: ANIMAL QUIRK SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Chow Hound	Dumpster Diving (Int), Investigation (Int), Intimidate (Str)
2	Cuddly	Good First Impression (Cha), Persuasion (Cha), Negotiation (Cha)
3	Curious	Climbing (Str), Perception (Int), Swimming (Str)
4	Hunter	Hide in Shadows (Dex), Stealth (Dex), Tracking (Int)
5	Playful	Persuasion (Cha), Dodge (None), Intimidate (Str)
6	Social	Animal Handling (Cha), Taunt (Cha), Perception (Int)

TABLE 19: ANIMAL ADULT SKILLS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	DESCRIPTION	SKILLS
1	Guard	Catcher (None), Perception (Int), Taunt (Cha)
2	Pile of Floof	Escape Artist (Dex), Deception (Cha), Persuasion (Cha)
3	Scrapper	Light on Your Feet (Dex), Streetwise (Cha), Survival (Con)
4	Show Animal	Good First Impression (Cha), Light on Your Feet (Dex), Performance (Cha)
5	Support Animal	Determine Value (None), First Aid (Int), Perception (Int)
6	Working	Animal Handling (Cha), Endurance (Con), Perception (Int)

You all have made some wondrous and unique choices. Of the just under 700,000 crawlers who've made a decision, we have seen almost 40,000 different Class choices. Can you believe that? That is a record, and we are very proud to see such diversity.

—Cascadia

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STEP 2: CHOOSE YOUR WEAPON

Next comes the fun part: you get to choose how you'll murder for the entertainment of the masses. You get at least one Skill useful for combat. Otherwise, you won't make it very far in the dungeon.

COMBAT BACKGROUND

Everyone enters the dungeon with the ability to defend themselves with their hands and feet—at least, sort of. Human crawlers start with the Unarmed Combat Skill at Rank 3, while animal crawlers start with the Slice Attack Skill at Rank 3. Both are useful for beating on monsters without any equipment, so those Skills can be a lifesaver.

What exactly does it mean that you have one of these Skills? How do these Skills work? We'll get to that later. For now, write the name of the Skill at either the top or bottom of the "Attacks" list on the front of your character sheet, and in your Skills section as well. Place it at the bottom or skip it altogether if you don't think you'll ever use it. After all, who wants to touch sticky monsters or things that bleed fire?

Ignore the "Stat & Mod" column and the rest for now.

WEAPONS

Most crawlers enter the dungeon with a weapon of some kind, the usage of which becomes your second combat background Skill at Rank 3. Below is a list of options, or make up your own. Write down the weapon name in the "Attacks" section of your character sheet, and in your Skills section as well.

Animal crawler & pet strike skills start on p. 177.

BASHING WEAPONS (P. 178)

- Club
- Improvised Weapons
- Warhammer

EDGED WEAPONS (P. 178)

- Axe
- Dagger
- Longsword
- Rapier

RANGED WEAPONS (P. 181)

- Bow
- Crossbow
- Handgun
- Shotgun
- Javelin
- Shuriken
- Slingshot

REACH WEAPONS (P. 182)

- Herding Weapons
- Lance
- Polearm
- Quarterstaff

ATTACKS 3.

Name	TO HIT Rank + Stat Mod	DAMAGE Dice + Stat Mod	Effects
Longsword	3 +STR	1d8 + STR	slashing damage

If you choose a unique weapon (something not listed), and it resembles a weapon in the list, write down the weapon from the list in parentheses after your choice. *Example:* Your crawler is a mechanic with a tire iron. The tire iron is a unique weapon, but you decide it works like a club. Write down "Tire Iron (Club)" in the "Attacks" section and in your Skills section.

If you also have combat Skills from your other backgrounds, you may or may not have those weapons with you when you enter the dungeon (cosplayers may have a distinct advantage here). That's decided by the starting gear you choose in Step 10.

SPELLS

You can take one of the following low-Mana cost Attack Spells at Rank 3 instead of a clumsy old weapon. Be sure to set your Intelligence Stat to a 4 or higher in Step 3 to be able to use the Spell. Write down the Spell name in the "Attacks" section of your character sheet, in your Hotlist, and in your Skills section. Check the Spell, then add the Spell's Stat Mod in the to hit and damage sections.

- Dirt Clod (p. 205)
- Fire Fingers (p. 205)
- Frost Scar (p. 205)

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- Mind Tickle (p. 212)
- Shock Treatment (p. 212)
- Soul Collector (p. 212)
- Vine Porn (p. 213)

If you take a Spell as your combat Skill, you also gain 5 Standard Mana Potions, which fully restore your Mana when you spend an Action to drink one. Write all the potions in one Hotlist slot (p. 111).

HAND-TO-HAND COMBAT

If you choose to enter the dungeon without a Weapon or attack Spell (bold move, Fists of Fury), you instead gain an unarmed Attack Skill (I've decided "hand-to-hand" sounds cooler than "flailing around like a bee got in your car") and a Damage Effect to go along with it. Write this Attack Skill and the Damage Effect in the "Attacks" section, and in your Skills section as well.

HAND-TO-HAND SKILLS (P. 179)

- Pugilism, with the Iron Punch Damage Effect
- Foot Soldier, with the Smush Damage Effect
- Noggin Nocker, with the Skullcracker Damage Effect
- Wrasslin', with the Toss Damage Effect

Now I know you're a crazy person for showing up defenseless. You get a "New Achievement!" for Unarmed Combat, along with a Bronze Weapon Box containing the weapon you should've brought in, but with some shitty drawback that doesn't give you a chance to change your mind. It'll be like every match your family thought was better than the person you're dating, except this time you really *did* make a bad choice.

Both Hand-to-Hand Skills start at Rank 3. Don't worry about filling in the Stat Mod for the "To Hit" and "Damage" columns yet. You'll write those down during the next step.

STEP 3: CHOOSE STATS

All creatures in the game, including you, have the following Stats. Each measures your ability within five broad categories. Those Stats are:

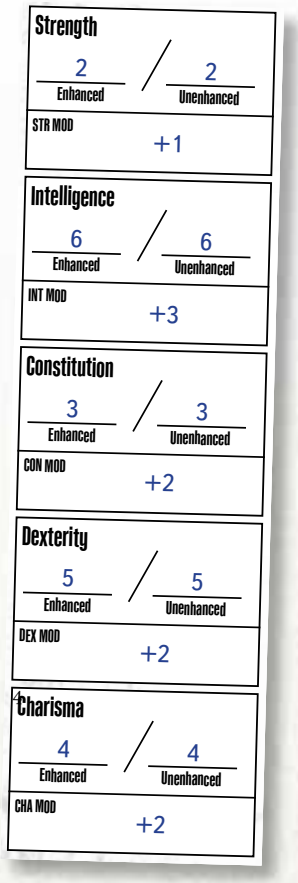
Strength (Str): A measure of physical power. It's the backbone for physical combat and Skills that use brawn.

Intelligence (Int): A measure of smarts and knowledge. Not only is it the basis for Skills that use wit and wisdom, but it also determines how much Mana you have for spellcasting.

Constitution (Con): A measure of toughness and physical gumption. It's the core of Skills centering on stamina, both mental and physical, and determines your Health.

Dexterity (Dex): A measure of agility and coordination. It's fundamental for Skills that rely on speed and nimbleness, and it enhances your ability to Evade attacks.

Charisma (Cha): A measure of your presence, whether charming or intense. It's at the heart of Skills that persuade or coerce and is necessary to attract viewers of the intergalactic game show that is the World Dungeon.



Each of these Stats has a score. That score is a number between 1 and... you don't need to know the upper limit right now. A typical Human has scores between 2 and 6. When creating your own crawler, you determine your starting Stats in one of two ways.

Standard Array: Assign a score of 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6 to your Stats, placing each of those scores in a Stat of your choosing. You can only place each number once. For instance, if you're creating a particularly nerdy crawler, you might choose Strength 2, Intelligence 6, Constitution 3, Dexterity 5, and if they're a cute nerd, Charisma 4.

Leaving it to Chance: If you've been rolling dice for your backgrounds like a pregnant raccoon rampaging through a liquor store, why stop now? Starting with Strength, and going down the line of Stats, roll 1d6, rerolling any 1s. What you roll is the score for that Stat! No takesie-backsies, no swapping around. Some crawler always dies two seconds after stepping foot in the dungeon anyway.

Place these scores in the appropriate fields of the character sheet. Write the same score for your "Enhanced" and "Unenhanced" values for now. We get to how you enhance Stats and why you need these Stats later. Again, use a pencil unless you love sniffing whiteout.

Each Stat also has a modifier (Mod). While the Stat's value measures your overall ability in that category, the Mod determines the impact it has on your Skill Checks.

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SKILLS

Name	Rank	Stat & Mod	Check Type	Notes & Upgrades	✔
Streetwise	1	CHA+2			

ATTACKS

Name	To Hit: Rank + Stat Mod	Damage: Dice + Stat Mod	Effects
Longsword	3+1+STR	1d8+STR	slashing damage

3.

Think of it like job titles at work. If you get promoted to a better title, does it matter if your pay doesn't change? The value is your title, and the Mod is whether you get a pay raise. If your boss knows anything about good business, you'll get a pizza party either way.

TABLE 20: STAT MODS

STAT VALUE	STAT MOD
1–2	+1
3–5	+2
6–9	+3
10–19	+4
20–49	+5
50–99	+6
100–149	+7
150–199	+8
200–299	+9
300+	+10

Each Stat Mod (+X) is based on its Enhanced Stat value. Reference Table 20 to determine the Stat Mod based on your Stat score and write it into each of the Stat Mod slots provided. Keep in mind that any time text refers to the all-caps, abbreviated Stat, like CON, it's referring to the Stat Mod. Update it each time your Stat value reaches a higher range. Know where to find your Stat Mods because you'll add them to the dice rolls of every Skill that uses Stats.

Now that you know your Stat Mods, finish filling in the "Stat & Mod" column in the "Skills" section. Write it in as "+X." For example, if a Skill uses your Charisma Modifier of +2, write it here as "CHA +2."

Also fill in the "Stat Mod" values in the "To Hit" and "Damage" columns of the "Attacks" section for each weapon. If you haven't looked up your Weapon Skill yet in Chapter 4, do so now. The Weapon Skill tells you the base damage and the Stat Mod (if any) to add.

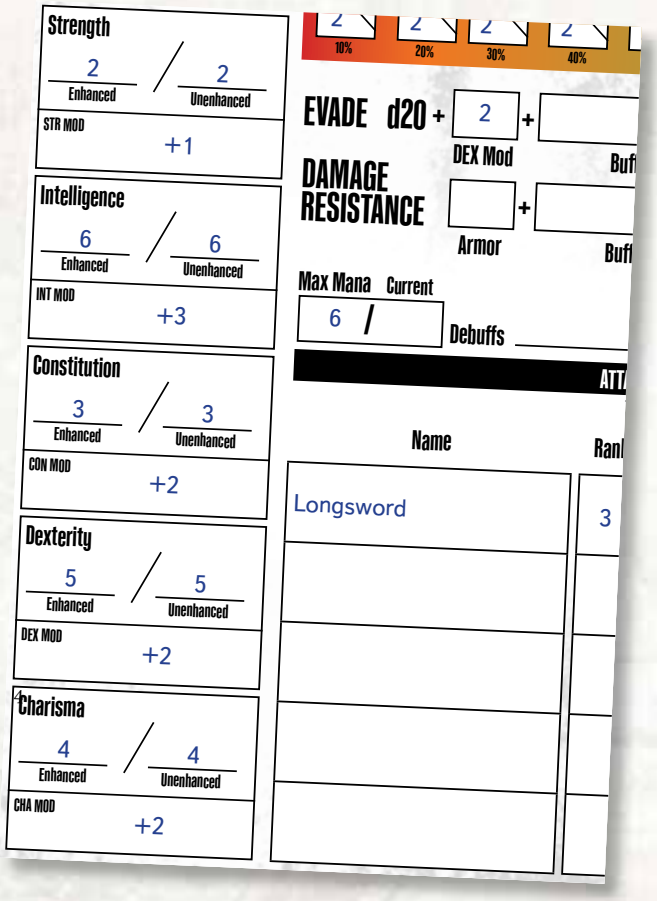
Write the damage dice value in the "1dX" format (see p. 55 for how dice work), replacing *X* with the die type noted in the description. The weapon entry also tells you the attack's damage type, which you can write in the "Effects" column or in the "Damage" box if you like.

For example, a Human's Unarmed Combat (p. 179) would have "1d4 + STR" in the "Damage" column and "Bludgeoning" in the "Effects" column, while an animal's Slice Attack (p. 177) would also be "1d4 + STR" in the "Damage" column and note "Slashing" in the "Effects" column.

STEP 4: DETERMINE YOUR EVADE

Evade is an Action you take to avoid attacks coming at you. In the dungeon, fast reflexes help. It's an Interrupt, which means it's an Action you can use even when it's not your turn to act.

If you don't use this Action, you're gonna get hurt, as foes automatically deal damage to you. However, if



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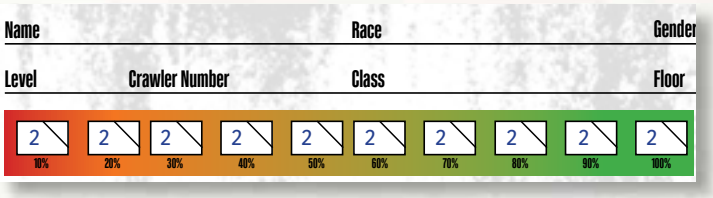
you spend an Action to Evade, you can roll separately against each attack coming at you. The line on your character sheet labeled "Evade" (below the Health Bar) helps you determine your Evade total when you roll. Evade isn't a Skill, so it doesn't have a Rank. You add only your DEX Mod when making an Evade Check. Write your DEX Mod in the first box.

STEP 5: SET UP YOUR HEALTH BAR

I may enjoy watching you die, but I'm fair about when death happens. That's where the Health Bar comes in!

Every attack, trap, hardship, and terrible decision should cause you to lose Health, but the showrunners appreciate when crawlers are a bit more durable so you don't all go extinct too quickly. Your total Health score is your CON Mod × 10. Instead of subtracting any damage you take from your Health score, you only lose Health when you take damage exceeding certain thresholds.

Your Health Bar has 10 slots, each representing 10% of your total Health. Write your CON Mod in each Health Bar slot. Since you'll take damage in pretty much every battle, we cover more about how you lose Health and, more importantly, how you recover it starting on p. 93.



STEP 6: RECORD MANA & STARTING SPELLS

Entering the World Dungeon opens you up to the possibility of all sorts of new and exciting abilities. For starters, you can now cast at least one Spell! How do you do this? By spending Mana. What's Mana? It's what you use to cast Spells.

Upon entering the World Dungeon, you gain Mana Points equal to your Enhanced Intelligence Stat. Not the Stat Mod this time, but the actual value. See? There's a method to this madness beyond being beholden to a legacy game system designed by people who have since ascended to gamer Valhalla.

On your character sheet, write the Enhanced Intelligence value in the box to the right of your Intelligence scores under "Max Mana." Each time your score changes, update your "Max Mana" to match it.

Each time you cast a Spell, you must spend the Mana cost noted in the Spell's description. For quicker reference, note the Mana cost in your Hotlist or attack effects. When you spend it, record your new Mana total in the "Current" slot to the right of your "Max Mana." Don't erase your Max Mana score, as that doesn't change when casting Spells. The score indicates that you can't restore your Current Mana above its value.

All crawlers start with the Heal Spell (p. 206). You can only cast Heal on yourself, and when you do, you regain 20% of your Health, or 2 Health Bar slots (more on your Health and the Health Bar, p. 93). Feel free to write the Heal Spell and its description in one of the boxes in the "Hotlist" section of the character sheet now, but also feel free to remove it down the road when you have better Spells and need to make room.

Heal Spell (Interrupt)

Rank 1 (max): Mana Cost: 2

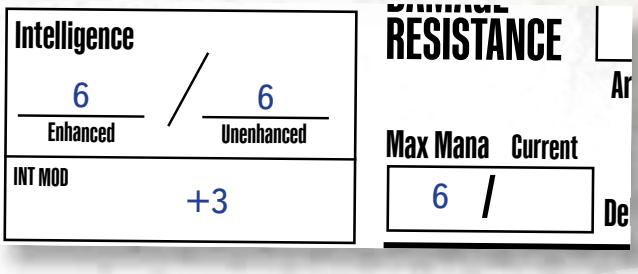
Heals 2 Health Bar slots

Spells can be placed in your Hotlist, which allows easy access to them as needed. To cast a Spell, spend an Action. Additionally, your new healing Spell is an Interrupt. This means you can cast it at virtually any time, not just during your turn in combat.

YOUR HOTLIST

Every crawler has a 10-slot Hotlist. You can place Spells, potions, scrolls, secondary weapons, and various items in your Hotlist to maintain swift access to them. When you have a moment outside of combat, or an Action in combat, any item in your Hotlist can instantly appear in a free hand, ready to use during that same moment or Action. You may instead have the item appear on the ground in front of you.

For example, you can swap a weapon you're holding with a weapon in your Hotlist. The weapon you're wielding temporarily moves into the Hotlist while the



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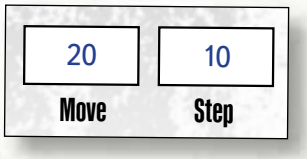
new weapon moves out, and you roll an attack with the new weapon. You only spend one Action on this swap and attack. If you'd needed a weapon from your Inventory instead of your Hotlist, you would've needed to spend two Actions: an Inventory action to move the weapon from your Inventory to your Hotlist, and then the Action to swap and attack.

Items in Hotlists do not grant you any added benefits: they're just easily accessible. When you put an item back into a Hotlist slot, its benefits turn off. Check to see if your Stat Mods or Skills are affected by a swap, but there's no need to erase your standard loadout on your character sheet unless the swap lasts for more than a single combat.

You may place up to 999 of the same item by name into a single slot of your Hotlist, because having 1,000 of something is just greedy.

STEP 7: RECORD YOUR MOVE & STEP

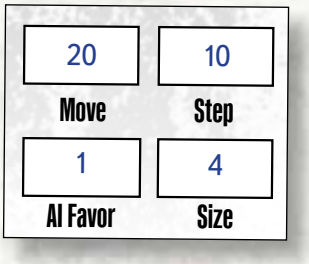


You can move 20 feet when you perform a Move action in combat (see *Movement*, p. 69). This value might change if you survive long enough to choose a different Race on the Third Floor or through items, curses, or System AI fiat. Write "20" in the Move box on your character sheet. It's in the same line as "Evade" under your Health Bar.

You also have a Step of 10 feet. Anytime you spend an Action in combat, you can perform a Step and move 10 feet. That means your Move action actually lets you move 30 feet, but you can also attack and move 10 feet for the cost of a single Action. Write "10" into the "Step" box to the right of the "Move" box.

STEP 8: RECORD AI FAVOR & CHARACTER SIZE

What fresh crawlers call luck, veterans know as AI Favor. Do something that impresses me, and I'll make it worth your while. If you're playing a Human crawler, write "1" in the "AI Favor" box on your character sheet. It's below the "Move" and "Step" boxes.



If you're an animal, you spent your starting favor to ensure I *didn't* give you the Enhanced Pet Biscuit that transforms you into a rabid platypus that shoots spiked eggs out your ~~asshole~~ cloaca every minute. You're welcome.

During play, you can spend 1 point of AI Favor to:

- Once per Check, reroll a d20 before the GM announces the result. You can't spend AI Favor to reroll a Natural 1, because that's an automatic Critical Fail. You screwed up big time, and I want to see what happens
- Once per round, gain an extra non-Attack Action in combat

You can gain additional AI Favor by performing heroic deeds, surviving foolish ones, sticking it to the showrunners, or indulging one of my fetishes. The specific requirements depend on if the mood strikes me (or your GM), so bust out that glittery nail polish and bring your most expensive bottle of wine.

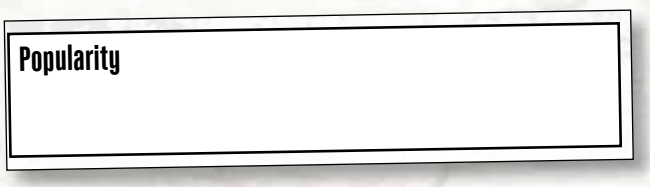
Write your size in the box to the right of "AI Favor." Humans are typically "Medium (4)." Animals can range anywhere from size 2 to 4 (see Table 21). This number matters for attacking foes much larger or smaller than you (see *Size*, p. 85).

TABLE 21: ANIMAL CRAWLER SIZE

SIZE	SIZE NAME	CREATURE EXAMPLE
1	Tiny	Scatterer, Rat
2	Small	Cat, Raccoon
3	Petite	Dog, Boar
4	Medium	Chimpanzee, Wolf
5	Large	Horse, Mantaur

POPULARITY

You have none, but you'll gain some if you're making a Third Floor (or later) crawler. Page 2 of your character sheet has a box for this, but leave it blank for now. See *Popularity* (p. 279).



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STEP 9: CHOOSE PAST TRAUMAS, LOOSE ENDS, & REGRETS

The System AI giveth, and I also *love* to taketh the fuck away.

Popularity

Past Trauma
I was abused by someone I trusted.

Loose Ends
I wanted to dump my partner, but...

Regrets
I never said goodbye.

During your initial scan, I probed your deepest darkest memories, looking for nuggets of trauma to exploit. Why would I do something so cruel? Character flaws make for good stories, and fear, regret, and unfinished business are compelling to viewers. The World Dungeon isn't just a deathtrap; it's interstellar entertainment! Borant's showrunners and I don't agree on much except when it comes to giving viewers the greatest show they've ever seen.

Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets are your way of telling your GM what stories you want to tell. They'll emerge as recurring themes and obstacles to overcome. The **Dungeon Crawler Carl** series gets dark, which you already know if you've read the first novel. You can also use this discussion to tell your GM elements you don't want coming up at the table. I might be a merciless psychopath, but I'm assuming your GM isn't. And if they are, well... lean into it, I guess?

Describe a Past Trauma, a Loose End, and a Regret on page 2 of your character sheet in the slots provided, and then show them to your GM. If you can't (or don't want to) think of your own, pick one or roll 1d12 to choose from each of the following categories. Animal crawlers may need to get creative.

PAST TRAUMA

Other than the world ending, what's the worst thing that's ever happened to you? Alternatively, for those of you with helicopter parents, what do you most fear might happen to you? See Table 22 for thought starters.

LOOSE ENDS

What did you leave unfinished in your past life that still haunts you? Table 23 has some options.

REGRETS

What did you do or fail to do that left an emotional scar? Again, this is about your life *before* entering the World Dungeon. We all know that ultimately, your greatest regret is going to be descending that first stairwell... and maybe eating that spicy bean burrito the night before. Don't skip Table 24 or you'll regret it!

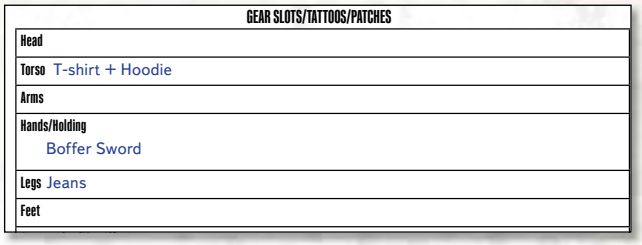
STEP 10: DETERMINE STARTING GEAR

You didn't get a warning when the collapse happened. No sirens, no countdown, no helpful flyers explaining what to pack for the end of the world. When you entered the dungeon, you brought whatever happened to be on you at the time, for better or, more likely, worse:

- A set of clothes (which you are wearing)
- One weapon from your starting combat Skill, or no weapon if you want to focus on unarmed combat
- One interesting or useful item (which can be a secondary weapon if you have a combat Skill from your other backgrounds)
- Weird stuff (get creative)

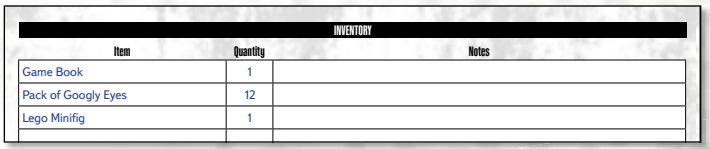
What counts as interesting, useful, or weird? Some people walk around with a bag full of oddly specific supplies that suddenly seem very valuable in a post-apocalyptic nightmare. Others have nothing but an empty wallet and little chance of surviving.

You and your GM may need to negotiate exactly what makes sense. Use the choices made during the other parts of character creation to help you determine what sort of equipment you would have been carrying (see p. 115 for examples of starting gear).



GEAR SLOTS/TATTOOS/PATCHES

Head	
Torso	T-shirt + Hoodie
Arms	
Hands/Holding	Boffer Sword
Legs	Jeans
Feet	



INVENTORY

Item	Quantity	Notes
Game Book	1	
Pack of Googly Eyes	12	
Lego Minifig	1	

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TABLE 22: PAST TRAUMAS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	PAST TRAUMA
1	I was abused by someone I trusted.
2	I was in a terrible accident.
3	I witnessed a death.
4	I was betrayed by a family member, friend, or lover.
5	I was abandoned by one or more parents.
6	I have a fear of open spaces.
7	I have a fear of the dark or being alone.
8	My home burned down.
9	I was falsely accused of a betrayal or crime.
10	I was deeply humiliated by a family member, friend, or lover.
11	I let someone take the blame for something terrible that I did.
12	I have a fear of heights.

TABLE 23: LOOSE ENDS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	LOOSE END
1	I never finished high school or my college degree.
2	I was about to open a restaurant or other business.
3	I didn't finish writing my novel.
4	A family member, friend, or lover recently died, but I couldn't say my goodbyes.
5	I was on the verge of inventing or discovering something.
6	I made a promise that I might no longer be able to fulfill.
7	My collection was almost complete.
8	I was about to perform for the first time when the collapse happened.
9	I wanted to dump my partner, but...
10	I was just about to buy or finish renovating my home.
11	I never sent that letter to a family member, friend, or loved one.
12	I never got to travel to my dream destination.

TABLE 24: REGRETS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	REGRET
1	I didn't ask them to marry me.
2	I turned down the perfect job.
3	I stayed quiet when I shouldn't have.
4	I chose my own safety when I should have leapt into action.
5	I never said goodbye.
6	I spent way too much time on something pointless.
7	I did something illegal, immoral, and probably both.
8	I lied to avoid an event important to those close to me.
9	I kept a secret that hurt someone badly.
10	I didn't apologize for something terrible that I did.
11	I abandoned someone when they needed me the most.
12	I trusted the wrong people.

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ATHLETE

- **Clothing:** Jogging attire
- **Weapon:** Barbell (Club)
- **Item:** Headphones, music player
- **Weird Stuff:** A 3-pack of condoms

GAMING GEEK

- **Clothing:** T-shirt, hoodie, and jeans
- **Weapon:** Boffer sword (Longsword, but using d4 base damage dice)
- **Item:** Game book or novel
- **Weird Stuff:** A pack of 12 googly eyes and a single Lego minifig

MILITANT

- **Clothing:** Military fatigues
- **Weapon:** Handgun
- **Item:** 2 snack bars
- **Weird Stuff:** A morale patch that reads, "No Plan Survives First Contact"

OUTDOORSY

- **Clothing:** Apparel appropriate for your location's climate and an orange safety jacket
- **Weapon:** Bow and arrow
- **Item:** Lighter
- **Weird Stuff:** A duck call on a leather cord

You can write down your clothing in the slots provided if you want, but it's not necessary. You should look for a new wardrobe very quickly because nonmagical outfits don't survive long in the dungeon. If you're holding anything, especially a weapon, write that in the "Hand/Holding" slot. The rest of your stuff goes into your Hotlist on p. 2 of your character sheet or your Inventory on p. 4 of the sheet.

GOOD LUCK! TRY NOT TO DIE.

With that, you have everything you need to begin your crawl in the World Dungeon. You little ones grow up so fast. To give yourself the best chance of survival, get to know your Skills. Now start exploring and be entertaining while kicking some serious dungeon ass. Your whole world is counting on you... literally.

CHARACTER CREATION: THIRD FLOOR & BEYOND

Your character didn't just suddenly appear on the Third Floor. They had lots of experiences on the Tutorial Floors, gained some Skill Ranks, new Spells, scars, rivals, STDs, and loot.

CREATING A THIRD FLOOR CRAWLER

Follow the rules for creating your crawler on the First Floor and then:

- Set your Level to 10
- Add 2d4 to your primary Weapon or Spell attack Skill Rank (Max 10)
- Add 1d4 to each of your remaining 9 Skill Ranks (Max 10)
- Roll or choose six Tutorial Floor Experiences (p. 118) to generate defining events, history, and new Skills from the early floors
- Acquired Loot! This is what you collected on the Training Floors (see below)
- Distribute 27 points between your 5 Stats as you please, adding them to your Unenhanced Stat. They will naturally also increase your Enhanced Stat
- Roll 1d2 for how much AI Favor you have. Add another 1d2 if your main Weapon or Spell has an AI Favor rating of 1 or 2d2 if your main Weapon or Spell has an AI Favor rating of 2
- Your Popularity starts out equal to your CHA Mod ×2 (record it on page 2 of your character sheet)
- Choose a Race and Class

ACQUIRED LOOT

Your Tutorial Floor adventures also netted you some loot. Gather this loot before choosing your Race and Class, as this is the order in which things would have happened had you adventured on the Tutorial Floors. Table 25 and the associated lists and other tables will get you through this process quickly.

Roll or choose on Table 25 to see what your spread of loot was for previous floors. It'll give you four items: a weapon, a piece of armor, a utility item, and a consumable. You can opt to take spells instead of the weapon, armor, or utility item.

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TABLE 25: STARTING LOOT

D4 ROLL OR CHOOSE	PREVIOUS FLOOR LOOT
1	Platinum Weapon/Spells, Gold Armor/Spells, Silver Item/Spells, Bronze Consumable
2	Bronze Weapon/Spells, Platinum Armor/Spells, Gold Item/Spells, Silver Consumable
3	Silver Weapon/Spells, Bronze Armor/Spells, Platinum Item/Spells, Gold Consumable
4	Gold Weapon/Spells, Silver Armor/Spells, Bronze Item/Spells, Platinum Consumable

Optional Rule: For more creativity and randomness, the GM may prefer that everyone gain multiple loot boxes and randomized magic items (see *Loot*, p. 215). This may be more fun when creating Third Floor crawlers as a group during session zero (p. 246).

Example: You roll a 3 on Table 25 and choose a Silver-value Weapon (instead of Spells), Bronze Armor (instead of Spells), and Platinum Spells (instead of an Item). Then you also get a Gold Consumable.

WEAPON

You can choose a new weapon or upgrade your original one. Either way, it might gain some bonuses. Its tier (Bronze, Silver, Gold, or Platinum) tells you how good it is.

- **Bronze:** A funny-looking d6 damage non-magical weapon that amuses the AI such as a Bow, Axe, or Quarterstaff with "AI Favor: 2 when fighting Bosses"
- **Silver:** +1 Skill in the Weapon, and a +1 damage Buff
- **Gold:** +1 Skill in the Weapon, and a Scroll of Upgrade for it (see Table 26)
- **Platinum:** +2 Skill in the Weapon, +3 to Strength or Dexterity, and a Scroll of Upgrade for it (see Table 26)

You can abbreviate an Amazing Success triggered effect in the Effects area of your Attack by writing it as: ***AS:*** *Target gains* NAME OF DEBUFF. You might also use "*+F dmg*" as that is the default Amazing Success bonus (see p. 79) even if you don't have an upgraded weapon.

If you don't like the name addition for your upgrade, make up your own, or you can simply add the word "Enchanted" in front of it, like "Enchanted Rapier."

SPELLS

Spells can be chosen instead of a Weapon, Armor, or Item option, but not Consumables. You're stuck with those, Gandalf. You learn a number of Spells based on the tier of your Starting Loot (see above). If you don't start with enough Mana to cast the Spell, you receive it in tome form, which can later be read to learn the Spell, traded, or sold. Use Table 27. If you roll a Spell you already know, add 1d2+1 Ranks to it.

- **Bronze:** One Spell at Rank 1d4 and 1 Mana Potion
- **Silver:** One Spell at Rank 2d4 and 2 Mana Potions or two Spells at Rank 1d4
- **Gold:** Three Spells at Rank 1d4 and 3 Mana Potions
- **Platinum:** Two Spells at Rank 2d4 and 4 Mana Potions or four Spells at Rank 1d4

When making a Fourth or Fifth Floor crawler, if you roll a Spell you already have, you may substitute it for one found in this book.

ARMOR

Choose a single piece to fill any gear slot you like, with the following benefits based on quality.

- **Bronze:** Mundane Armor of your choice, but awkward: hockey pads, a heavy winter coat, trash-can lid shield. Grants +1 Damage Resistance
- **Silver:** +2 DR, with the Anti-Piercing Benefit (see p. 95)
- **Gold:** +3 DR, with Resistance to an uncommon damage type (see Table 10, p. 93)
- **Platinum:** +4 DR, +5 Constitution, and +3 to Catcher or Taunt Skills

ITEMS

These are things that you use to help you with various challenges in the dungeon. Pull them out of your Inventory only when needed. You must be holding or wearing it to gain any Skill bonuses it grants.

- **Bronze:** Your choice of 50 feet of rope, a bicycle, a canoe and paddle, or hang glider
- **Silver:** Friendship Bracelet of [Race] kind (see p. 217)
- **Gold:** A shiny accessory that grants +3 to your choice of Strength and Climbing Skill; Dexterity and

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TABLE 26: SCROLL OF UPGRADE WEAPON EFFECTS

D12 ROLL	NAME ADDITION	UPGRADE
1	Blazing... ...of Burning	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Burned Debuff.
2	Chilly Goat's...	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Stiff Legs Debuff. Weapon is frosty and cold.
3	Potion Overload...	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Poisoned Debuff.
4	...of the Gods	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Woozy Debuff. Weapon grants access to Club Vanquisher.
5	Screaming Caprid...	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Terrified Debuff. Weapon has a goat motif.
6	Third Rail Special...	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Stunned Debuff. Weapon resembles train tracks.
7	Telekinetic pea-shooting...	On an Amazing Success, push the target 10 feet. Weapon has brain-patterns in it.
8	Brain Boiling...	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Queasy Debuff. You sometimes hear a victim's dying thoughts.
9	Skin-Slougher 5000...	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Blood Trail Debuff.
10	Krakaren's Deluxe...	You can spend AI Favor in combat for an additional attack with the weapon, but lose 1 Health Bar slot the first time you do it on the Floor, 2 HB slots the second time, 3 HB slots the third... you get it. This resets at the start of each Floor.
11	Tongue Tied...	On an Amazing Success, the target gains the Muted Debuff. The weapon looks like a tongue and you now have perpetually pruney hands.
12	Accordion-Folding...	On an Amazing Success, the (non-Boss) target suffers the Take Down Debuff.

Lockpicking Skill; Intelligence and Fabricate Skill, Constitution and Survival Skill; or Charisma and Streetwise Skill

- **Platinum:** +3 Skill Potion (permanent). Choose a Skill and gain 3 Ranks in it

CONSUMABLES

Consumables give a little more utility to your crawler, but only a few times.

- **Bronze:** Your choice of 10 Healing Potions (heal 5 Health Bar slots), 10 Bandages (spend an Action to remove the Blood Trail Debuff), or 10 Torches (provides bright light for 20 feet and dim light for another 20 feet. It burns out in about an hour), or 1 stick of basic dynamite (1d6 Bludgeoning damage, 0ft Blast radius +5ft Splash)
- **Silver:** Your choice of two Poison Antidotes, one Good Healing Potion (Heals 6 Health Bar slots), or one Stick of Good Goblin Dynamite (2d6 Bludgeoning damage, 5ft Blast radius +5ft Splash)
- **Gold:** Your choice of one Spell Scroll of a random Spell (see Table 27) at Rank 5 or a Gold Standard Healing Potion (Heals 7 Health Bar slots and mends one Minor Injury)
- **Platinum:** A Scratcher ticket! Choose either Medicine or Lube *or* Nebular Roulette (p. 218)

TABLE 27: RANDOM SPELLS

D12 ROLL	SPELL	D12 ROLL	SPELL
1	Astral Paw	7	Lightning Bolt
2	Confusing Fog	8	Magic Missile
3	Drain Life	9	Puddle Jumper
4	Heal Others	10	Second Chance
5	Hole	11	Shield
6	Ice Blast	12	Wisp Armor

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CREATING A FOURTH FLOOR CRAWLER

Follow the rules for creating a Third Floor Crawler, then:

- Set your Level to 20 and distribute 30 more points among your Enhanced and Unenhanced Stats
- Two additional rolls on any of the Tutorial Floor Experience Tables, including the Third Floor table. We suggest another Interview event and the Third Floor table
- Choose 6 Skills. Add 2d2 Ranks if at Rank 4 or less, or 1d2 Ranks if Rank 5+
- Add your CHA Mod to your Popularity
- Gain an additional Starting Loot from your Bronze and Silver options from Table 25 above. You can choose the same as before or switch

TABLE 28: TUTORIAL FLOOR EXPERIENCES

D6 ROLL OR CHOOSE	TABLE
1	Table 29: Interactions with Other Crawlers
2	Table 30: Twists of Fate
3	Table 31: Mobs & Boss Battles
4	Table 32: Strange Places
5	Table 33: Traps & Accidents
6	Table 34: Interview Show Experiences

CREATING A FIFTH FLOOR CRAWLER

Follow the rules for creating a Third Floor Crawler, then add:

- Set your Level to 30 and distribute 60 more points among your Enhanced and Unenhanced Stats
- Four additional rolls on any of the Tutorial Floor Experience Tables, including the Third and Fourth Floor tables. We suggest another Interview event, a Third Floor event, and a Fourth Floor event, plus one more of your choice
- Choose 8 Skills. Add 2d2 Ranks if at Rank 4 or less, or 1d2 Ranks if Rank 5+
- Add your CHA Mod to your Popularity
- Gain an additional Starting Loot from your Gold and Platinum options from Table 25. You can choose the same as before or switch

TUTORIAL FLOOR EXPERIENCES

Each entry in the following tables represents a rare, unusual, or memorable event that could occur on the Tutorial Floors. Feel free to get creative with each narrative, reinterpret or alter them, and provide details to your GM about who you've encountered and why it might make sense. After all, trauma makes the world go round.

USING THE TUTORIAL FLOOR ENCOUNTERS AS A GM

For the GM, these seeds can provide stories in two ways:

First, you could flesh out one or more of these entries and make them happen on the Tutorial Floors (if you're about to play through the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set***) or another floor, if you like.

Second, if a player creates a crawler with these tables, ensure that some of the key crawlers, situations, NPCs, Mob types, or other elements come back to haunt the PCs. For example, a key character might:

- Offer advice at Club Vanquisher, the Desperado Club, or elsewhere in the dungeon
- Turn into an adversary, ally, or rival
- Butt heads with the PCs during an interview show or just be mentioned as a past guest
- Become a focus for past trauma or other emotional stories
- Show up on the top ten list (see p. 282) or the recap show

If you're using this second method, one recurring element per player for each floor is usually plenty. If you've used up the best, funniest, or most tragic options by the Fifth Floor, you can always find ways to reuse them or make them a more recurring element of the campaign. Mentioning past events in the campaign can help the World Dungeon feel more alive and engaging for players, which is especially important because then they can die painfully and still have all sorts of unresolved conflicts and issues.

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Choose one of the three options:

- **Variety:** Roll or choose once from each of the following tables
- **Total Randomness:** Roll 1d6 six times to choose tables, and then roll or choose from each table
- **Custom:** Choose from all the options or create your own

Communal Results: Not all crawlers need to be created in a vacuum. Instead of rolling for each crawler individually, you can agree to share the result or choice with one, two, or even all of the other players. Crawlers sharing a narrative builds a shared history. It also makes sense, since the crawlers were in the same section of the dungeon, or even in the same party, at the time.

Since each table lists three Skill options, there's no reason everyone needs to receive the same Skills from the same encounter. It doesn't need to be all-or-nothing, either. Two players might agree to share three of their six narratives, or the whole table might agree to make as many unique pairings or trios as possible and then roll the rest individually. Freedom of choice can be a fleeting thing in the dungeon, so when the opportunity arises to exercise some, you'd better take advantage of it.

For each experience you roll or choose, pick two Skills, either from the suggestions or your own, that fit the theme. Roll a d4 for one, and a d2 for the other to determine how many Ranks the Skill starts with or adds to if you already have the Skill (keep in mind Skills can't rise above Rank 10 in creation!).

The six main Tutorial Floor Experience Tables are shown in Table 28.

Two additional tables can be used to create a crawler appropriate for the Fourth or Fifth Floor. The creative names of these two tables are:

- Table 35: Third Floor Events, p. 126
- Table 36: Fourth Floor Events, p. 127

Repeated Results: When multiple crawlers roll the same result, you can handle that in one of two ways. The more collaborative approach is to see whether both players can work their crawlers into the same event or interaction, just like Communal Results (above). Two crawlers can still come out of the same encounter having learned different Skills.

The other way is to help keep each crawler's experience unique: add 1 to the result until you get one no one else in the group has used. The third way is to kick the player you like the least out of the game entirely, because they eat all the best snacks, and no one wants them there anyway.

Custom Skills: Options marked with a gear-asterisk (⚙) are Custom Skills or could even be Spells (see *Creating Your Own Skills*, p. 174). If you pick that, you get to make it up yourself. If you're not ready to do this, take one of the other options.

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TABLE 29: INTERACTIONS WITH OTHER CRAWLERS

D12 ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILLS GAINED/ LEARNED	NARRATIVE
1	Basic Science, Calligraphy, Engineering, Mathematical Modeling	In a saferoom that looked like a greasy spoon cafe, you met an elderly math professor who decided to wait for the floor to collapse. "Me trying to survive this dungeon at my age is pointless. But I can teach you a few things that might be useful..." He had exceedingly neat penmanship.
2	Aiming, Catcher, Perception, Lightning Rod	A hallway lined with electrified arrow traps was no obstacle for you. Through a combination of spotting them, disabling them from afar, and surviving some hits, your party made it through.
3	Fabricate, Repair, Smithing, Sleep Anywhere	You and your fellow crawler hadn't slept in a couple days. Unable to find a saferoom, you worked together to build a small fort that kept you protected enough to catch a few good hours of shuteye.
4	Explosives Handling, Bomb Surgeon, Edged Weapon Skill of Choice, Bomb's Away	Hearing a loud explosion nearby, you rushed to the scene to find a legless crawler surrounded by burning Mob corpses. Still in shock at losing their limbs, the crawler babbled to you about the dangers of explosives and how they would have been better off just learning to use a blade.
5	Endurance, Hot Stuff Aura Spell, Wrasslin', Porn Star	You met another crawler in a saferoom, and sparks instantly flew. You got it on. Did the deed. Copulated. Boinked. *Bow chicka wow wooed!* They were gone when you woke up, but you'd better believe that clip is making the highlight reel.
6	Animal Handling, Heal Critter Spell, Running, Make Scents	Not long after entering the dungeon, you came across Crawler #1,554,877: Thumper 12, an unenhanced rabbit that somehow wandered in. You kept the poor beast alive until the very end of the First Floor before it finally met its sad end.
7	Cooking, Deception, Lore, Homey	A chance encounter in a saferoom kitchen led to a few fun hours of card games, sharing info, and a home-cooked meal. That's the kind of Human spirit these alien bastards will never understand!
8	Handgun, Intimidate, Streetwise, Impersonation	*"Do you feel lucky, punk?"* is all you had to say to the crawler who tried to rob you to get him to piss his britches and run away. Poor kid will never survive in a place like this.
9	Diplomacy, Leadership, Tactics, Authoritative	You entered the dungeon with a group of strangers and quickly became the de facto leader, uniting them into an effective group—by *any* means necessary.
10	Good First Impression, Persuasion, Mind Tickle Spell, No Skulls	Short tempers and a deadly location never bring out the best in people, but you managed to talk your way out of combat with a group of hostile crawlers.
11	Escape Artist, Ropework, Sleight of Hand, Profiler	Another crawler took you captive, but you managed to escape. They might still be after you, but no knot can stop you.
12	Detect Lies, Double Tap, Weapon Skill of your choice, A Certain Reputation	You killed a fellow crawler and have the skull by your name to prove it. Was it an accident? Was it self-defense? Mercy? Straight-up murder? At this point, only you and the AI know for sure

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TABLE 30: TWISTS OF FATE

D12 ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILLS GAINED/ LEARNED	NARRATIVE
1	Negotiation, Performance, Earworm Spell, People Pleaser❁	In a saferoom advertising itself as "Iowa I-80: the World's Largest Truck Stop," the Bopca shopkeeper was too depressed to sell you anything. Something you did really entertained her and cheered her up, though, so she gave you a discount!
2	Endurance, Improvised Explosive Device, Salvage, Got All My Fingers❁	You spent many hours trapped in a section of hallway after the ceiling collapsed due to an exploding Goblin Murder Dozer. Eventually realizing that if an explosion got you into this mess, an explosion could get you out of it, you improvised a small bomb and blasted a hole big enough for you to crawl out.
3	First Aid, Dodge, Repair, Steel Bladder❁	You're one of the few crawlers who encountered *and survived* a toilet suction issue on the dungeon's First Floor. As the faulty machine tried to suck your insides out of you, your quick thinking and reflexes kicked in, saving your life (and your bowels).
4	Ambush, Hand-to-Hand Combat Skill of your choice, Balance, All PR is Good PR❁	Your introduction to the viewers of the Crawl was tripping and tumbling down the stairwell, tumbling through the dungeon doors, and landing right in the middle of a group of Bugaboos who were just as surprised as you. Embarrassing but effective, and something you'll hopefully never repeat.
5	Acute Ears, Hide in Shadows, Stealth, Living Statue❁	You watched a group of 20 crawlers get torn to pieces by Blender Fiends on the First Floor. The only reason you didn't get blended with them is that you got good at being quiet and standing still *really* quickly.
6	Deception, Diplomacy, Good First Impression, Teacher's Pet❁	Your Game Guide claimed that people liking you is the key to surviving the dungeon and insisted that you practice Skills useful to that end.
7	First Aid, Riding, Animal Handling, Old Yeller❁	You came across a lone wounded Danger Dingo and felt bad for it. You gave it some food and patched up its injuries as best you could. It licked your face in thanks and gave you a ride to its kennel, where it ended up dying a painful death defending you from its Kobold handlers.
8	Dumpster Diving, Tracking, Cartography, Corpse Chaser❁	Following Brindle Grubs to corpses and looting the bodies before the Grubs could dispose of them turned out to be an educational experience. You learned some good scavenging techniques and some secret ways to navigate the dungeon.
9	Arcane, Attack Spell of your choice, Utility Spell of your choice, Ill-Gotten Gains❁	What luck! You found a dead crawler who had Spell books in their inventory. They were dead when you got there, you swear!
10	Chopper Pilot, Escape Artist, Goblin Explosives, Cool Guys Don't Look at Explosions❁	You zoomed away on a Goblin chopper, but it exploded, leaving you trapped in a tangled, burning mess of metal. After freeing yourself from the wreckage, you realized the explosion was not entirely your fault: there had been a satchel of Goblin explosives on the back of the bike!
11	Alchemy, Dagger, Tattoo Artistry, Human Canvas❁	It turns out that the blood of Rayzers can be easily crafted into tattoo ink. With this new knowledge, you used a dagger to crudely tattoo your arm with a phrase your therapist always said to you in sessions.
12	Alchemy, Infusion, Salvage, Game Breaker❁	Before defeating a Neighborhood Boss called the Malpractitioner, you found a functional Alchemy Bench in his lair. Your Game Guide was very confused, claiming that crawlers shouldn't be able to use crafting tables this early and outside of personal spaces. But there it was, so you spent a little time experimenting.

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. TABLE 31: MOBS & BOSS BATTLES

D12 ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILLS GAINED/ LEARNED	NARRATIVE
1	Animal Handling, Weapon Skill of Your Choice, Shield Block, Jouster	The Kobold Riders charged down the hallway right at you on their Danger Dingoes, but quick use of a metal plate from your inventory saved your ass. You unmounted one of the riders, bent its mount to your will, and gave the remaining riders a taste of their own medicine. Joust on!
2	Balance, Climbing, Jumping, Billy Goat Gruff	In a freezing-cold neighborhood of Chilly Goats, you were forced to battle a herd while navigating an icy chasm. You're no mountain goat, but it turns out you were better at it than you thought.
3	Polearm, Tactics, Zone of Control, Slow and Steady	Surrounded by a horde of Rat Hooligans, you decided a slow, disciplined advance through their ranks would be more effective than a reckless charge. It took tense hours to get through that hallway, but the experience points were great, and the Mobs barely even touched you.
4	Regeneration, Stealth, First Aid, Bragging Rights	Satan's Lil' Hedgehogs made mincemeat out of most of your companions, but you managed to sneak away. You still got filled with armor-piercing quills that nearly killed you, but hey, you get credit for surviving a Mob that was patched out.
5	Leadership, Religion, Attack Spell of your choice, Riddler	You led a small group of crawlers into combat against The Messiah, a Boss who claimed to have the answer to everything. His bolts of divine retribution destroyed your team, but even he was surprised to learn he didn't have an answer to the Spell you took him down with.
6	Investigation, Noggin Nocker, Catcher, Reflective Medicine	Your family always said you were hard-headed, and you got to prove it in a battle against a ram-horned Boss called The Obdurate. He seemed immune to everything, but he fell quickly when you started using his own tactics against him.
7	Balance, Foot Soldier, Quarterstaff, Meditative Murderer	A river of sizzling acid, and the only way to cross it was to defeat the guardian who stood in the middle of the narrow bridge: an Orc dressed as a medieval Monk twirling a quarterstaff. *"Ho! Ha-Ha! Guard! Turn! Parry! Dodge! Spin—"* And that's when you kicked him into the acid.
8	Attack of Opportunity, Rapier, Taunt, Potty Mouth	Those Fuck Off Cockatiels didn't know who they were messing with. You skewered them handily *and* taught them what swearing really sounds like. Goddamn amateurs.
9	Pugilism, Detect Traps, Investigation, Hands-On	A trapped hallway tried to slow you down, but after a few minutes of looking at it, you realized a swift punch was all you needed to disarm those traps.
10	Ambush, Double Tap, Stealth, Slothful Assassin	The very slow Great Sin of Sloth was an easy Boss Battle for you. Borant went too far, and the Human-animal hybrid was easy to sneak up on and eviscerate while it hung upside down in a ruined satanic church. Of course, if you were a little slower or less sneaky, its massive claws would have killed you.
11	Catcher, Perception, Warhammer, Boarding Party	The skate-by attacks of the Thrasher Yetis were devastating until you figured out how to knock them off their boards: wait for the perfect moment as they pushed toward your companion, intercept their attack, and then clobber the hell out of the plank wankers.
12	Improvised Weapons, Iron Stomach, Intimidate, No Funny Business	After having your weapon eaten by a Neighborhood Boss promoting the "Ferrous Diet," you were forced to improvise. Your absolute brutality with a rubber chicken caused the Boss's minions to flee. Maybe there was something to that diet, though...

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TABLE 32: STRANGE PLACES

D12 ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILLS GAINED/ LEARNED	NARRATIVE
1	Balance, Climbing, Running, King of the Jungle Gym	It must have been a wonderful kid's playground, but the dungeon made it deadly by covering the ground with acid, so any fall turned fatal. But you mastered it and escaped only slightly burned and scarred.
2	Basic Science, Engineering, Shock Treatment Spell, Very Fishy	You stumbled into a room filled with water and bloodthirsty fish, but it didn't take you long to figure out that a simple bit of electricity would clear the space easily. The downside is the smell of fish just lingered on you for the rest of the floor, no matter how many times you showered or bathed.
3	Investigation, Ropework, Jumping, Free Falling	Falling into a pit trap, you didn't expect to find a room filled with living ropes ready to strangle you. With some clever handiwork, you killed the ropes then used their limp bodies to escape the pit.
4	Arcane, Alchemy, Lore, Secondhand Magic	Magic might not have been real in your world, but the school of magic studies you stumbled upon in the dungeon sure was. You ransacked everything and learned some new tricks before sentient potion bottles attacked you.
5	Bomb Surgeon, Repair, Salvage, Minesweeper	You heard the loud series of explosions and found the remains of the crawlers who tried to cross the minefield hallway. From the remains of the exploded bombs, you learned quite a lot and found some decent scrap and other items that you could fix up to almost good as new.
6	Smithing, Throwing, Dumpster Diving, I Have the High Ground	Trapped on the top of a mountain of trash and being swarmed by Mobs, you had no choice but to hurl make-shift weapons down and use the high ground to your advantage.
7	Aiming, Survival, Tactics, All Steamed Up	A deadly sauna room almost killed you, but a well-aimed, well-timed rock forced the door to stay open just before you were steamed to death.
8	Cartography, Tracking, Lockpicking, Master of the Model Universe	The enormous orrery swung around your head, nearly hitting you with every rotation until you managed to finesse the mechanism to stop. Taking the time to look at the giant model, you learned quite a bit about how to track the movement of stars.
9	Balance, Fire Fingers Spell, Escape Artist, Fire Walker	A burning ring of fire surrounded you, and the only escape: a thin beam leading to an exit. While the tips of your fingers got a bit toasted, you escaped with your life.
10	Weapon Skill of your choice, Deception, Acute Ears, Hammer a Machine	The casino looked just like it did back home, but the only gambling currency the slot machines would accept was blood. Their jaunty chimes as they stalked you still haunt your memories.
11	Aiming, Perception, Torch Spell, Night Owl	Total darkness surrounded you unexpectedly. To survive, you had to learn to use all of your senses to navigate through the shadows until light returned.
12	Trap Engineer, Ambush, Endurance, Bubbly Murderer	A bubble pit turned everything into a slippery, chaotic mess, but you used it to your advantage, staking out the space and taking out Mobs to grind some sweet experience.

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TABLE 33: TRAPS & ACCIDENTS

D12 ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILLS GAINED/LEARNED	NARRATIVE
1	Weapon Skill of your choice, Acute Ears, Detect Traps, Hindsight is 20/20	While trying to practice with your new weapon, you set off a trap and nearly died. But you distinctly remember what that trap looked like, and it won't surprise you again.
2	Regeneration, Dodge, First Aid, Pincushion	A sign, crudely made and with grammatical errors, indicated that you have found a stairwell that will lead you "way out." Too bad the "way out" were spikes working their way in then out of your body.
3	Running, Endurance, Oakhide Spell, Boulder Run	Giant boulders rolling down hallways were always a classic in movies. They're much less fun to experience in person.
4	Climbing, Jumping, Escape Artist, Acrobat's Instinct	When the floor dropped out from under your feet, you managed to jump to safety at the last possible second, narrowly avoiding the pit of spikes waiting to impale you.
5	Bomb Surgeon, Trap Engineer, Smithing, Trap Killer	Tired of dealing with the dungeon's traps, you made your own explosive filled with shrapnel and took out a few Mobs (and maybe another crawler or two).
6	Incendiary Device Handling, Heal Spell, Hide in Shadows, *Still* Have All My Fingers	Throwing bombs from the shadows is one way to deal with your problems. Too bad one bomb blew up in your hand before you mastered the timing.
7	Tactics, Basic Science, Detect Lies, Trust Issues	Another group of crawlers promised the path ahead was safe, but you noticed signs of explosive fun powder on the floor. Whether those crawlers knew and lied or were clueless, you dodged certain death.
8	First Aid, Goblin Explosives, Diplomacy, Mother Teresa	A Goblin Bard got caught in a bear trap, and you, a naïve kind soul, rescued them. In exchange, the Goblin Bard taught you a bit about explosives.
9	Alchemy, Detect Trap, Javelin, Natural Immunity	Trap-ception! A basic javelin spring trap in a sophisticated dungeon like this seemed too simple. You should have trusted your instincts, because the contact poison you touched while disabling the javelin almost killed you.
10	Jumping, Ropework, Puddle Jumper Spell, Slacklining	The floor of the room dropped away around you, leaving you stranded on a small platform surrounded by open air. A series of widely spaced platforms made a path to the far side of the room. Utilizing some rope from your inventory, some magic, and some pure athleticism, you made it to the other side.
11	Explosives Handling, Incendiary Device Handling, Regeneration, Fire in the Hole	It's a bad idea to hold explosives in your hands when you're being dive-bombed by fire-breathing flying monkeys wearing lederhosen. Your ability to heal was pushed to the limit, but you survived... unlike the monkeys.
12	Investigation, Lockpicking, Noggin Nocker, Hard Headed	Unbreakable steel doors closed around you, locking you in. On one door, a 10-minute timer and a complicated lock appeared. You tried everything to unlock that lock, to no avail. With 5 seconds left on the timer, you head-butted the door in frustration, breaking the lock and opening the door.

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TABLE 34: INTERVIEW SHOW EXPERIENCES (FLOOR 2+)

D12 ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILLS GAINED/ LEARNED	NARRATIVE
1	Deception, Diplomacy, Persuasion, Brown Noser	You appeared on *Jaime's Guide to Game Guides*, a Game Guide-ranking show! You managed to suitably impress the audience with how helpful your Game Guide has been, earning you, well... not much beyond the gratitude of your Game Guide.
2	Detect Trap, Escape Artist, Trap Engineer, Practice Makes Perfect	After making your way through a particularly dangerous trap, you were invited onto *Diretusk's Traps*, where you were forced to repeat the experience for a studio audience. The repetition was tiresome, but you did manage to refine your technique.
3	Detect Lies, Double Tap, Leadership, Social Butterfly	You were booked on *The Great Big Stupid Interview Show!* with a dozen other crawlers, but the host never appeared, and the show didn't air. You did get some great tips from the other guests, though.
4	Endurance, Shield Block, Taunt, Sticks and Stones	On *Psych Ward*, the host gave you a shield and told you to stand in a spotlight in an otherwise completely dark studio. She talked about your past traumas while the audience taunted you and chainmail bean bags flew at your face. Despite her promises, you don't feel like it was a healing experience.
5	Calligraphy, Cooking, Tattoo Artistry, Artist's Way	According to the host of *The Art of the Dungeon*, it's truly a shame that crawlers have to spend so much time fighting and so little for cultured artistic endeavors. Practicing your art on the show was a peaceful interlude between floors.
6	Chopper Pilot, Driving, Religion, Missionary	*Chariots of the Gods* is a low-rated, extremely niche show that highlights different modes of transport preferred by various deities of the dungeon. You may not have made a bunch of new fans, but you did get to test drive a few cool vehicles!
7	Alchemy, Basic Science, Streetwise, Dealer	Skeeze and Staank are the hosts of *DIY Dungeon Drugs*, teaching viewers across the galaxy how to recreate the pharmaceuticals crawlers find in the dungeon. Your memory of your appearance on the show is mostly a blur of sparkling colors and your own way-too-fast heartbeat thundering in your ears.
8	Hide in Shadows, Stealth, Sleight of Hand, Timing	The *Hide and Seek Dungeon* show brings on six crawlers and lets the audience choose what Mob hunts them while they hide. You managed to hide the entire time, surviving the show and gaining some notoriety.
9	Detect Lies, Gambling, Sleight of Hand, Poker Face	Poker exists in almost every world in the Syndicate, so it's no surprise that *Cosmic Crawler Card Clash* is a popular show. Of the six crawlers playing, you came in second, but you're pretty sure the winner was cheating. If you meet her in the dungeon, keep an eye on her.
10	Good First Impression, Performance, Persuasion, Star Power	You appeared on *Dungeon Crawler After Hours with Odette*, one of the most popular shows in the galaxy. Your interview was cut short, though, because one of the producers was mauled by a dog belonging to the crawler slated to be on after you.
11	Bow, Crossbow, Slingshot, Corporate Sellout	*Crossfire* is a show that interviews crawlers, weapons manufacturers, and hunting enthusiasts from across the galaxy about their use of ranged weaponry. Since the show is sponsored by the Crossbow Producers Consortium, every episode ends with the determination that crossbows are always the best for every situation.
12	Cooking, Deception, Iron Stomach, Talented Tongue	*Cake or Trap?* showcases fantastic loot, terrain, other objects, and even Mobs crawlers might find in the Dungeon. It all looks real, but some of it is just exquisitely decorated cake. How is a crawler to tell the difference? Try to eat it. You keep what you can swallow.

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TABLE 35: THIRD FLOOR EVENTS

D12 ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILLS GAINED/LEARNED	NARRATIVE
1	Drain Life Spell, Performance, Lore, Play by Ear	The Third Floor started with a bang as you found yourself having to perform for your life for an Elite NPC necromancer. You managed to do well enough to be allowed to live and learned a little more about the storylines of the Third Floor.
2	Infusion, First Aid, Alchemy, Melted Off Fingerprints	Mixing a bunch of chemicals together and seeing what happened wasn't the best way to learn, as evidenced by your melted fingernails, but you sure discovered how to make an effective acid.
3	Hide in Shadows, Intimidate, Perception, Batman-Wannabe	You decided to enter the Third Floor carefully, sticking to the shadows and waiting for the perfect moment to appear and strike fear into the hearts of those nearby. Dramatic much?
4	Calligraphy, Religion, Holy Aura, God-Curious	On the Third Floor you discovered a quiet church that offered you a resting place and time to get your bearings. You probably won't be converting any time soon, but it taught you some useful Skills.
5	Engineering, Survival, Climbing, Just 'til Sunrise	You were caught outside at night, leaving you with no choice but to find a way to survive. You managed to build a shitty shelter up high to avoid the Mobs and live to see another day.
6	Incendiary Device Handling, Regeneration, Catcher, Meat Shield	Mobs sometimes throw explosives, and you, an absolute idiot, caught one and managed to save a fellow crawler's life. It nearly cost you your arm, but it eventually healed up. Mostly.
7	Jumping, Dodge, Investigation, Mile High Club	You figured you'd be safer if you got up high and observed what was going on for this new floor, and hey, it kind of worked out. Too bad some Mobs can fly and hurl projectiles.
8	Lockpicking, Improvised Explosive Device, Ropework, Short Fuse	A locked room seemed like it would be a treasure room for sure. Instead, you found a Borough Boss. Thanks to some quick thinking and an insane amount of explosive items tied together, you got a shiny new star by your name.
9	Explosives Handling, Basic Science, Tactics, Science is Messy	Sometimes it's worth taking your time to learn new Skills. But who has that luxury in the dungeon? You grabbed a handful of smoking bombs and hurled them into the center of several Mobs. It made a huge mess, but you can't make a cake without exploding a few hundred eggs, right?
10	Pathfinder, Regeneration, Dumpster Diving, Got My Tetanus Shot	Discovering a filthy castle filled with useless shit wasn't the best way to start the Third Floor, but you managed to turn trash into treasure by finding some valuable stuff in the pile of garbage, and you only got Super Tetanus twice!
11	Riding, Animal Handling, Acute Ears, Yeehaw Buckaroo	Giant, deadly beasts tried to chase you down, but you managed to get the drop on one of them and rode it like a bucking bronco.
12	Shield Block, Aiming, Weapon Skill of your choice, It's Luck not Skill	A Borough Boss of epic size nearly killed you, but a well-aimed attack saved your ass. Then when the Boss blew up after death, your shield saved your head. You're one lucky SOB.

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TABLE 36: FOURTH FLOOR EVENTS

D12 ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILLS GAINED/ LEARNED	NARRATIVE
1	Smithing, Cartography, Arcane, Visualizer	You attempted the impossible: making a map of the Iron Tangle. Sure, it's a 3D monstrosity that takes up way too much space and isn't actually right at all, but damn, does it look impressive.
2	Balance, Endurance, Swimming, Blood in the Water	When you jumped on the Nattier Line, you didn't anticipate all the train cars would be filled with water and Concierge Sharks. Surviving the ride turned all the water bright-red, but hey, it was only partially because of your blood.
3	Attack of Opportunity, Catcher, Taunt, Seeing Red	The Neighborhood Boss didn't seem that bad at first—just a fuzzy little guy, but you know better than to trust that. You pissed off the Pooka into showing its real form (a giant goat) and managed to use its rage against it.
4	Cooking, Iron Stomach, Diplomacy, Through Their Stomach	Another group of crawlers threatened you over a Quest item. You didn't back down and instead talked the group into joining you for a meal. Your sweet words and the delicious food made these enemies into allies.
5	Grand Illusion Spell, Determine Value, Investigation, Good Business	A marketplace stall, Treasures for Me, tried to rip you off, but you're smarter than that. You managed to spot the lie and get above value for everything you needed to sell, including that ugly conductor souvenir hat.
6	Find Trap, Perception, Streetwise, Derealization	Gas from a trap causes you to hallucinate vividly. In an environment as dangerous as the World Dungeon, it's hard to tell if the feline royalty in the corner shouting orders at you is real or just another denizen of the world.
7	Deception, Religion, Sleight of Hand, Sticky Fingers	Causing a train derailment to steal an Engineer Key from the Mantaur engineer wasn't your brightest idea, and listening to him rant about Grull and glorious battles definitely wasn't the best use of your time. But you did manage to nick the key from the engineer without having to fight him.
8	Basic Science, Fabricate, Salvage, Stare into the Abyss	You reached station 436, the Abyss Station, and discovered a wreckage of train cars and a fuck-ton of Jikininki Janitor Ghouls. Thanks to the abundance of valuable items, you crafted yourself something nice before escaping.
9	Balance, Climbing, Ropework, Ferroequinologist	All those movies lied: Running across the tops of moving trains is not as easy as it looks! Thanks to some careful footwork and rope bridges, you managed to survive crossing train car roofs without plummeting to your death.
10	Intimidate, Leadership, Negotiation, Fair Deals or Bust	A shopkeeper NPC tried to make a deal with a clueless group of crawlers, and you stepped in to make sure they got a fair deal. Sure, you might have made the shop keeper cry from fear, but that's what tough negotiators do.
11	Dodge, First Aid, Wisp Armor Spell, Tender Hearted	You heard another crawler yelling for help in a nearby train car. As a hero (idiot), obviously, you ran towards the danger. Avoiding the Fleshers, and defeating the War Mage, you saved the low-Level crawler.
12	Endurance, Running, Foot Soldier, Train Spotter	Trying to outrun a train was a really stupid decision, especially with those Cornets chasing you, but you are nothing if not stupidly tenacious. Not only did you *not* get run over, but you actually made it to the station in one piece.

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RACE & CLASS SELECTION

When you reach the Third Floor, the System AI will recommend three specific Race and Class options based on your Skills and background. Technically its Race first, then Class; but for this game it's more fun to choose them in tandem so the order doesn't matter as long as your Race and Class are compatible.

Your Game Guide walks you through the process of selecting a Race and Class, as well as distributing your Stat points. Although you can choose to remain whatever Race you were upon entering the World Dungeon (your choosing your original Race such as Human or Cat—gaining those racial benefits), many crawlers transform into a different Race to acquire new aptitudes or capabilities.

Animal crawlers who choose a non-animal race keep their animal Skills but cannot use them (unless they somehow become an animal again).

Each Race and Class features a variety of benefits, including new Skills, Stats, Spells, the ability to raise Skills to Rank 20, and more. If a Race or Class grants "+X Skill" and you don't have that Skill, you do now, at the Rank listed. If you have that Skill, add the bonus amount, up to 10 (see Skill Rank Limits sidebar). Some Races and Classes have drawbacks as well.

Some Races and Classes have prerequisites that a crawler must meet to select them. If it requires an achievement that you don't have, ask your GM if you might have earned it on the Tutorial Floors but never received it. Even the AI can make mistakes, but it won't offer you a Race or Class you can't select. It's probably in your inbox and you didn't check the achievement. Discuss the Races and Classes you're interested in with the GM, but they're free to throw in some curveballs.

In addition to prerequisite achievements, some have Stat requirements. Conveniently, you gained a bunch of Levels on the Tutorial Floors. Now that you're on the Third Floor, you get to apply all those Stat points before you choose your Race and Class. To apply your Stat points, subtract 1 from your current Level, then multiply that value by 3. That is how many Stat points you get to add to your five Stats, however you wish. *Example:* A 10th-Level crawler has 27 Stat points to distribute (9 × 3). You may also distribute your Stat points after choosing your Race and Class.

RACES

Over the next dozen pages, you'll find Race options that appear in the books and are available to most crawlers. Discuss your desires with the GM, and it often helps to peruse likely Race and Class combos before selecting your Race.

After Classes, you'll find the Build System, which allows you to create your own Races and Classes for your crawler based on a menu of available options. Several of the Races presented here have unique benefits you won't find on the point cost charts because the option is just unique.

SKILL RANK LIMITS

During the Race and Class selection process, there is a Skill Rank limit of 10. If you already have Rank 8 in a Skill and you would add +3 to your Rank, you stop at 10, and the remaining bonus is wasted. Once this process is over, your limit is typically 15, but your Race or Class might allow some Skills to be raised to 20.

If you manage to reach Rank 16 or higher, the benefits that come with it do not come online until the Sixth Floor.

SEX, GENDER, AND SPECIES

Limits from a character's gender, sex, and species are optional, though they add spice to the game by letting you tell stories relating to these elements of a character. If you don't want to deal with these issues in a fantasy escape game, you've already probably discussed it with your group (see Before Starting Play, p. 12, and *Session Zero*, p. 246). Depending on how you might want to interact with these elements. Here are a few ways to deal with these limits:

- The crawler experiences a glitch that allows an illicit choice to be made. Lawyers may be involved later as an adversary sues about it.
- Create a custom variant that does the same thing, but under a better name. The story may or may not relate to the original limits.
- Use a preferred definition: Decide that the System AI works off gender rather than sex. Patch things as needed.

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EARTH-BASED RACES

The following Race options come from Earth, either as naturally occurring (like Human and Cat), or inspired by Earth culture (such as the Amazonian, Dwarf, Elf [side note: you guys are really fascinated by pointy ears; have you talked to your therapists about that?], and Sasquatch). The mudskipper showrunners want to see more of these Races battling for survival because viewers across the galaxy love to root for the home team. And yes, Primals are considered an Earth-based Race since they're based everywhere (or were...). It's more about the viewer's point of view than Earthlings'.

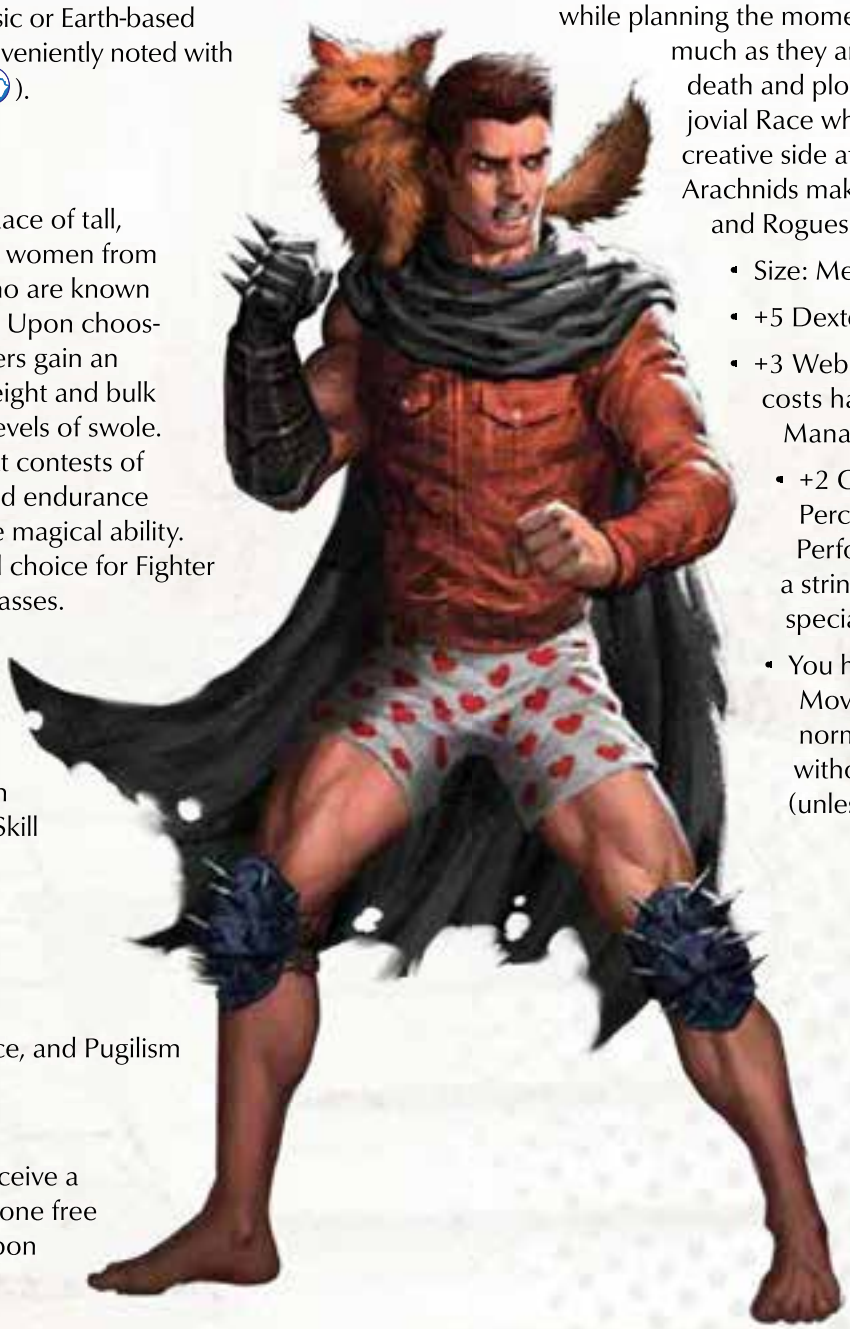
Earth-based Races can choose from among the widest variety of Classes on *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*, including classic or Earth-based Classes. They're conveniently noted with an Earth symbol ( ).

AMAZONIAN

Amazonians are a Race of tall, well-built humanoid women from Earth mythology who are known for their athleticism. Upon choosing this Race, crawlers gain an additional foot in height and bulk up to bodybuilder levels of swole. Amazonians excel at contests of physical strength and endurance but have little innate magical ability. This Race is an ideal choice for Fighter and Monk-based Classes.

Prerequisites: This limited Race is only available to crawlers who have at least one Strength or Dexterity-based Skill at Rank 5+

- Size: Medium (4)
- +6 Strength
- +3 Dexterity
- +2 Bow, Endurance, and Pugilism Skills
- +2 DR
- Each floor, you receive a coupon good for one free training at a Weapon Training Guild



ARACHNID

The way a creepy smile spreads across a face with too many eyes makes the Arachnids one of the most mistrusted Races in the World Dungeon. They're a popular choice among crawlers, especially with cultures that revered spiders (like the Akan peoples and Marvel fans who only like Spider-Man). Their humanoid torsos on a spider's frame give them a terrifying appearance, but they are well known for playing beautiful harp music (using silk chords), weaving silken tapestries honoring their conquests, and obsessing over death.

Arachnids feel at home on the ceiling and hiding in the shadows, content to watch events play out while planning the moment to strike. Still, as much as they are obsessed with death and plotting, they are a jovial Race who express their creative side at every opportunity. Arachnids make excellent Bards and Rogues.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +5 Dexterity
- +3 Web Spell, which costs half the normal Mana to cast
- +2 Climbing, Perception, and Performance (with a stringed instrument specialty) Skills
- You have an innate Climb Move equal to your normal Move value, without needing Checks (unless under duress)

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CAT

Cats are ordinary felines of unimpressive size common in Earth households across the world. You might not expect a Cat's sleek grace and supernatural luck to go to their head, but Cats have considered themselves the true and rightful rulers of Earth since before the days of ancient Egypt.

Note that a recent update to Syndicate Race standards has benefited the Cat, among other Races.

Prerequisites: This limited Race is only available to crawlers who are already a Cat

- Size: Small (2); Animal
- +4 Dexterity
- +2 Constitution
- +1 Charisma
- −3 Strength
- +3 Cat-like Reflexes
- +2 Slice Attack Skill
- Can see in total darkness
- Advantage on Cat-like Reflexes Skill Checks
- Nine Lives: Take half damage from the first 9 attacks each day
- Vulnerability: Take double damage from Dogs and Beasts

CAT GIRL/CAT BOY

Cat Girls/Boys are special offshoots of humanity that possess the best qualities of a Cat (though many pretend to be humble and demure to hide their ferocity and cunning). Possessing feline traits on top of a Human form, Cat Girls/Boys might appear mostly Human, save for furry ears atop the head or a tail, or they might appear like a humanoid lioness/lion in a maid's dress. Most other species get along with Cat Girls/Boys, though natural felines often view their existence as an abomination. This Race is a great choice for Bard and Mage Classes.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +3 Dexterity and Charisma
- −2 Constitution
- +2 Cat-like Reflexes, Good First Impression, Light on your Feet, and Slice Attack Skills
- Your Slice Attacks may add your CHA Mod to the damage instead of STR
- Toxoplasma G.: Once per day, your allies have Rank 5 Catcher Skill (and the +5 DR Upgrade!) for one round to protect only you from attacks about to hit you. Those who do gain 1 AI Favor
- When dealing with felines other than Cat Girls/Boys, you make Charisma-based Skill Checks with Disadvantage

CHANGBI DEMON

The sound of chains clinking against the floor heralds a Changbi Demon, an undead demonic crawler Race from Earth folklore. Changbi Demons are tall and slender with a pale gray-green tinge to their skin. Some Changbi Demons also sport horns, claws, and sharp teeth. Changbi Demons are innately tuned to sense divinity and those who worship gods and deities. This Race is an ideal choice for Fighters, Rogues, Assassins, and other martial Classes.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +5 Dexterity
- +3 Strength and Constitution
- −2 Charisma
- +3 Ambush and Creepy Chains (Club) Skills
- Creepy Chains: Can use any chain as a weapon (use the Club Weapon Skill, but with a 10ft range). A Changbi Demon can lengthen or shorten any chain by 50% once per scene
- Each time a foe touches a Changbi Demon with their bare skin (such as with Hand-to-Hand attacks), that foe takes 1d4+F Acid
- No need to breathe
- Vulnerable to Holy damage
- Cannot worship a deity

CHANGELING

A Changeling wears many faces—as many as they've had the pleasure (or displeasure) of meeting. Many examples of shape-stealing nightmares come from across the galaxy, making Changelings right at home among the stories Earthlings warned their children about. Like Doppelgängers, Changelings can change their form, but while Doppelgängers maintain their base stats, Changelings apply the stats of whatever form they assume.

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Able to slip unseen into any crowd as an anonymous stranger or to infiltrate close-knit groups by wearing the face of a friend, Changelings make powerful friends and dangerous enemies. This Race is an ideal choice for Rogue and magic-using Classes.

- Size: Large (5)
- +3 Charisma
- +2 Intelligence
- +2 Ambush and Deception Skills
- +1 Escape Artist Skill
- Advantage on Deception Skill Checks when no talking is needed
- Changelings gain free access to organizations and producers by impersonating other crawlers and Syndicate celebrities, but can only use those relevant to the currently shifted individual
- Changeling Shapeshifting: A Changeling who touches a member of another Race can shapeshift themselves into that Race, building a "library" of Races they can transform into. A Changeling can shapeshift into another Race as an Action to make an Unopposed Deception Skill Check. While shapeshifted into that other Race, they gain that Race's bonuses other than statistics and Skills. For example, a Changeling shapeshifted into a Crocodilian would gain the Race's Advantage on Intimidation Skill Checks, DR Buff, bonus after a full meal, and additional fatigue penalty on Charisma-based Checks
- While shapeshifted into another Race, these changes are conveyed to World Dungeon systems, including information on viewers' HUDs, mini-maps, and other systems
- Changelings can't touch mimics-type creatures. Don't ask why or what happens—it's bad

CROCODILIAN

With a snout full of bone-chomping teeth and hands that will wring necks so hard that the head just falls off afterward, the bipedal wrecking machines known as Crocodilians are, pound for pound, among the most ferocious reptiles walking the Crawl. When it comes to fighting, their thick scales and predatory instincts serve Crocodilians very well. As an anthropomorphic version of one of Earth's most vicious predators, these cold-blooded killers are here to prove they're among the galaxy's most dangerous denizens.

Crocodilians need to consume a large amount of food each day just to stay active. That hunger is a constant companion, but aside from that, a Crocodilian is a resilient, positively terrifying killing machine that thrives in swamps, aquatic environments, and petting zoos (all of which are rich in food). Crocodilians make excellent Barbarians, Fighters, and Monks.

- Size: Large (5)
- +4 Strength
- +3 Constitution
- +2 Pugilism and Powerful Strike Skills
- When physically menacing someone in person, roll Intimidate Skill Checks with Advantage
- +3 DR Buff
- +1 Buff for all of your Skill Checks for 1 hour after eating a full meal
- While you have the Fatigued Debuff, roll all Charisma-based Checks with Disadvantage

DOPPELGÄNGER

Doppelgängers are shapeshifters, but they aren't just about changing their appearance to match someone else. Earth must have had some really fucked up history for two kinds of shape-stealing boogey monsters to feature so prevalently—no wonder you're so freaked out about your uncanny valley. In fact, Doppelgängers require a

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lot of practice before they can change into someone specific, and even general changes are painful and require a basic level of artistry and a good mirror. A Doppelgänger can mold its malleable body like tough clay.

For all the flexibility of their form, Doppelgängers can't change their mass, and that includes the mass of any equipment they are wearing or carrying, which must become a part of whatever form they take. This makes Doppelgängers a very adaptable Race, as they're able to pick up something of unusual composition and integrate it into their own form, but they're not capable of assuming identities as quickly or effectively as a Changeling. Doppelgängers are sturdy and make great front-line Fighters and Paladins.

- Size: Unchanged, but size changes when shifting
- +4 Constitution
- +3 Strength
- +1 Deception and Endurance Skills
- +2 DR
- Due to shifting mass, can determine their maximum weight to lift based on Constitution instead of Strength
- Advantage on Escape Artist Skill Checks and can make such Checks while being Held or watched
- Once per scene, as an Action, you can incorporate a held weapon into their mass to deal additional damage equal to their Con Mod. Items incorporated this way can't be disarmed
- Doppelgänger Shape-Changing: As an Action, you can transform into any shape of comparable mass, incorporating carried and worn items into the new shape in the same percentage (that is, a Doppelgänger holding metal equal to half their weight must assume a shape that is one-third metal). This transformation is painful, causing you to mark off 1 Health Bar slot per change. If you attempt to change your shape to resemble a specific person or object, do so with an Unopposed Deception Skill Check

DWARF, CLASSIC

Is there any RPG Race more classic than the gruff, bearded Dwarf? From *Snow White* to *The Lord of the Rings*, Dwarves have fascinated Earthlings' imaginations for far too long. Shorter than a person and as wide as they are tall, Dwarves tend to dig and work underground, crafting items of unsurpassed beauty and durability. Dwarves are a natural fit in the tightest corridors of the World Dungeon, where their doughty endurance and keen crafting traditions serve them well.

Dwarves are quick to grouse about their troubles, even when things are otherwise going their way, and they rarely put up with frippery or foolishness. They might not all drink heavily and speak in a grumble through their beards, but you'd be hard-pressed to find one that doesn't. Dwarves make great front-line Fighters and are excellent crafters, no matter what Class they pursue.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +4 Constitution
- +2 Intelligence
- −2 Charisma
- +3 in two different crafting Skills of your choice
- +2 Endurance Skill
- Can see in total darkness
- All crafting Skills can be raised to Rank 20
- When dealing with elves or fairies, make all Charisma-based Checks with Disadvantage

DWARF, FATHOM

Fathom Dwarves, more so even than other Dwarves, have evolved and adapted to spelunk deep into mineshafts. They strap specially trained glowing lizards to their heads as light sources deep where the sun has never penetrated. No idea where this lizard symbiosis is from, but these guys are already delving so deep that Gandalf wrote their asses off as Balrog chow back on page 483 of *The Silmarillion*. Go ahead, look it up.

Fathom Dwarves are skilled diggers and crafters with stout, hardy bodies and rough skin. They have an edge in Constitution and

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Strength, making them an ideal choice for Fighters, Barbarians, and crafting Classes where durability is as important as Skill.

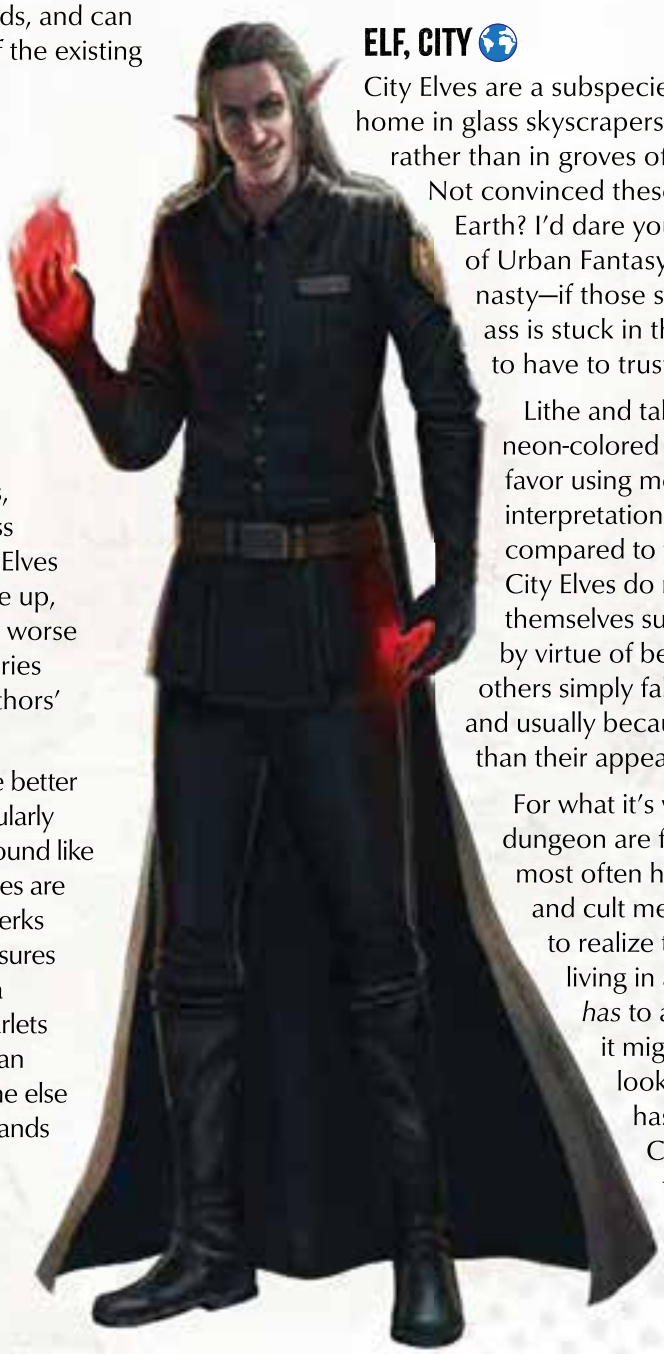
- Size: Medium (4)
- +3 Constitution
- +2 Strength
- +3 Engineering Skill
- +2 Dumpster Diving and Salvage Skills
- Roll d20 Checks with Advantage when earth, rocks, and dirt are involved
- Can produce a 15ft Cone of light from a harmless lizard nesting atop their heads, and can easily acquire a new lizard if the existing one is lost or killed

ELF, HIGH

Graceful, tall, and immortal, Elves are a species of long-limbed, pointy-eared humanoids with a natural affinity for magic. They often reside in forest groves, carefully tended over many Human generations to form natural residences, workshops, and libraries. If all this effortless aptitude seems likely to make Elves arrogant or snooty, well buckle up, brother, because they're even worse than in the countless Earth stories that thinly veiled countless authors' ear-point fetish.

Elves consider themselves the better of nearly all other Races, particularly those Races that grub in the ground like Dwarves and Rat-Kin. Some Elves are maybe just better at not being jerks about it. Choosing this Race ensures a clear mind, easy charm, and a complexion that Hollywood starlets would kill for. This Race makes an ideal magic-user, Bard, or anyone else who wouldn't like to get their hands dirty or stink of... *ugh*, effort.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +4 Intelligence, Dexterity, and Charisma
- +2 Intimidation Skill, and you can use your Cha Mod
- +1 Lore Skill
- You recover Mana at twice the normal rate in a natural environment
- Add 1d4 to your Evade Checks
- When dealing with Dwarves, Rat-Kin, or anyone smelly or dirty, make all Charisma-based Checks with Disadvantage
- Two different Charisma-based Skills can be raised to Rank 20



ELF, CITY

City Elves are a subspecies of Elf that make their home in glass skyscrapers and bustling city streets rather than in groves of trees or remote castles. Not convinced these bastards came from Earth? I'd dare you to check out the depths of Urban Fantasy, or Romantasy if you're nasty—if those still existed. Instead, your ass is stuck in the dungeon and is going to have to trust me on this one.

Lithe and tall, with pale skin and neon-colored hair, City Elves sometimes favor using modern technological interpretations of Spells and equipment compared to their more rustic kin. City Elves do not necessarily consider themselves superior to all other Races by virtue of being Elves; it's just that all others simply fall short by comparison, and usually because of their beliefs more than their appearance.

For what it's worth, City Elves in the dungeon are fucking morons. They are most often hypocritical sycophants and cult members who are too dumb to realize they've been tricked into living in a cult. But none of that *has* to apply to you as a crawler; it might earn you some funny looks from anyone else who has come across another City Elf in the dungeon, though. This Race makes ideal Arcanists, Bards, or Mages.

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- Size: Medium (4)
- +6 to split as you please between Intelligence, Dexterity, and Charisma
- +3 Good First Impression Skill
- +2 Negotiation and Streetwise Skills
- Once per floor during a Long Rest, a City Elf can adjust the +4 spent between Charisma, Intelligence, and Dexterity, reassigning those points between those Stats
- When entering a settlement for the first time, make your first Charisma-based Check with Advantage. On an Amazing Success or better, you have made a permanent contact

ELF, NIGHT

Accustomed to the darkness and navigating via the stars, Night Elves share the lithe androgynous appearance of their fellow elven kin, but their skin tones cover the spectrum of cool colors from teal to deep purple. Thank Drizzt and Blizzard for making these an Earth staple. Night Elves have longer, wider ears than other elves and an even more acute sense of hearing. Their eyes are accustomed to low light, but they have difficulty seeing in bright light, whether natural or artificial. The high Intelligence and Dexterity of Night Elves make them an ideal choice for Arcanists, Rogues, and Mages.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +3 Intelligence and Dexterity
- +3 Acute Ears and Hide in Shadows Skills
- Can see total darkness
- Gain Advantage when you use the Hide in Shadows Skill at night
- Once per day, can instruct the shadow of a living thing to use the Taunt Skill at Rank equal to Floor Number (and no Stat Mod) to pull attacks away from you
- Hide in Shadows and one crafting Skill of your choice can be raised to Rank 20

FROST MAIDEN

Chilled to the core, Frost Maidens are a Fey Race of short humanoids with ice-cold skin, pale hair, and indomitable mental fortitude that originated during European dark ages. The icy walls around their psyche give Frost Maidens an Immunity to mental infirmity. Frost Maidens are highly charismatic and have access to elemental ice powers, and can gain the service of their Game Guide as a Manager. This Race is a strong choice for magic-users, Bards, and Tricksters.

- Size: Petite (3)
- +2 Charisma, Intelligence, and Dexterity
- +2 Persuasion Skill
- Melee attacks deal +1d4 Ice damage
- Roll with Advantage on Int and Con Stat Checks
- The crawler's Game Guide becomes their Manager
- Capable of flight for up to 1 minute per scene

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HUMAN

You're already a Human. I'm gonna go out on a limb here and guess you don't need a description. If you choose this, nothing will change, except for the scant benefits below. Choosing to remain Human offers little by way of additional advantages, but the galaxy loves to watch Humans face the perils of the dungeon with only their wits and tenacity to rely on!

- Size: Typically Medium (4)
- +2 to all Stats
- At the end of each floor, roll one Skill Advancement Check with Advantage if that Skill is Rank 9 or less
- Gain 1 AI Favor each time you level up
- When you take damage, you may spend 1 AI Favor to gain DR equal to your Con (as many times as you have AI Favor to spend)
- Once per day, when you would make an untrained Skill Check on a non-Passive Utility Skill, you can roll as if you had 2 Ranks in the Skill
- Once per floor, you can spend an Action to remove any single Debuff you're suffering from, even Injuries

IGNEOUS

The Earthling idea for the Igneous goes much farther back than the first stunt performer who threw on a rock costume to battle the Power Rangers. Molten rock flows through their veins, visible through the cracks in their stony flesh. This flow visibly slows when an Igneous is cold or injured. Igneous are unsurpassed in terms of endurance and stamina. While they are not typically the fastest creatures in the universe, they can occasionally move with a burst of explosive speed to match any erupting peak.

An Igneous's rocky skin makes them ideally suited for stalking prey on their homeworld but leaves them incredibly conspicuous anywhere else. Of course, being conspicuous isn't typically as big an issue after you've poured a fresh batch of lava all over anyone who might object to your presence. This Race is an ideal choice for any tank Class.

- Size: Large (5)
- +6 Constitution
- +4 Strength
- −2 Intelligence and Charisma
- +1 Endurance Skill
- +3 DR Buff
- Once per day, double your Move for 20 seconds
- As an Action, make a Con Stat Check. On Success, deal 1d8+F Fire damage, 5ft Burst radius
- No Survival Checks needed in harsh heat conditions and can breathe underwater
- Immunity to Fire damage, and vulnerable to Ice damage
- Ability to burrow
- Lose 1 Health Bar slot each time you access your Inventory (not Hotlist)
- Disadvantage on Checks to conceal your presence or nature (such as Stealth)

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LAJABLESS

Lajabless, creatures from Caribbean folklore, live two lives: by day, they walk the dungeon as beautiful people, casting Spells with ease, but are weak in strength. At night, their face turns hideous and cavernous as their magic wanes, giving way to powerful strength. Lajabless must walk the balance between magic and martial Skill, beauty and horror, demon and Human.

To show they constantly straddle these worlds, Lajabless usually have, no matter their current aspect, one humanoid leg and one animal leg (often that of a cow or goat). The versatile shifting nature of the Lajabless makes this Race an ideal choice for crawlers who want a diverse half-caster build.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +5 Intelligence during the day, +5 Strength during the night
- +2 in two Spells of your choice
- +3 in one Weapon Skill of your choice
- Advantage when using the Ambush and Intimidation Skill
- During the day, Strength is halved, but Spells cost half the Mana to cast
- During the night, Strength is doubled, but Spells cost double the Mana to cast

OBSIDIAN BUTTERFLY

Obsidian Butterflies are much like the Aztec deity that inspired them. They are deadly, graceful, and absolutely terrifying. These skeleton-faced figures move about the battlefield with frightening speed, blessing their allies and bringing devastation to their foes.

Their wings contain hues of orange, red, black, and white, blending together in a colorful pattern. The vibrancy and speed of their wings can make them appear borne aloft by naked flame. More than one foe has chosen to flee the sight of an Obsidian Butterfly bearing down upon them.

Prerequisites: This limited Race is only available to crawlers who earn Rank 5+ with any Edged Weapon

- Size: Medium (4), mostly due to wings
- +3 Dexterity
- +2 Intelligence
- −4 Constitution
- +2 Intimidate and Slice Attack Skills
- +2 in a Spell of your choice
- Has four translucent butterfly wings that can reach up to 15 feet and deliver touch- or melee-range Spells
- May use CHA Mod instead of CON Mod in their Health Bar
- Upon entering the Sixth Floor, choose to either gain Stronger Wings (wings are now capable of flight for up to 2 minutes per scene, with +20ft Move when flying) or Ferocious Visage (Advantage when using any Skill to inspire fear or respect)
- Add 1d4 to your Evade Checks

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PRIMAL

For the first several seasons of *Dungeon Crawler World*, all contestants started off as Primals. Primals are blank slates, and your appearance does not change. The Primal Race offers little by way of specialization, but the Earth Classes you'll have access to make up for it. Find your current Race in this section of the book and apply those racial benefits. However, list your Race as Primal, and then apply these modifiers:

- Size: Unchanged
- −1 to all Stats
- All Skills can be raised to Rank 20

THE WORLD DUNGEON ON HARD MODE: PRIMALS

Primals were the first known species to conquer the universe. After, they seemingly disappeared and have since become "the boogeymen of the cosmos." In the first Dungeon Crawler World seasons, every crawler was a Primal, but since then, they've been relegated to the back catalog, behind all of the shiny and popular Race choices.

Choosing a Primal is taking the World Dungeon on hard mode—you're declining the many significant bonuses of choosing another Race (even plain old humans have more benefits) and accepting a penalty to all of your stats in exchange for the opportunity to raise any Skill above the World Dungeon's soft cap of 15 Ranks. Raising a Skill to 15 is already difficult, requiring concentration to reach that degree of mastery. Primals get that challenge and say "Hold my beer" as they careen into maximizing as many of their Skills as possible. If you make this choice, we salute you—but don't say we didn't warn you.

RAT HOOLIGAN

Rat-Kin have a reputation for being survivors, from the tales of rat-people whispered around candlelight in ancient times to Master Splinter serving as a beloved sewer-bound mentor. One of the more common Mobs in the early floors of the World Dungeon, Rat-Kin have surged forth from their warrens to resist the wholesale slaughter of their species. A crawler that chooses this Race becomes one of hundreds of siblings across all dungeon floors. Rat-Kins' propensity to hide in places considered gross or unnatural allows them to traverse the floors surreptitiously, gathering secrets and carrying messages. Rat Hooligans make ideal Rogues and capable magic-users.

- Size: Petite (3)
- +2 Dexterity
- +1 Constitution
- +2 Escape Plan and Stealth Skills
- +1 Bite and Survival Skills
- Advantage on Checks to resist hunger and thirst
- Can converse with common house rats to gather minimal information while in buildings
- May add Dex Mod to Bite damage instead of Str

SASQUATCH

Bigfoot. Yeti (if you choose an ice-based Class). Skunk Ape. The list of nicknames for these privacy-minded Earth creatures is almost endless, but in the end, the result is the same. First, you take a Human, you cross it with a gorilla, you make them a foot-and-a-half taller,

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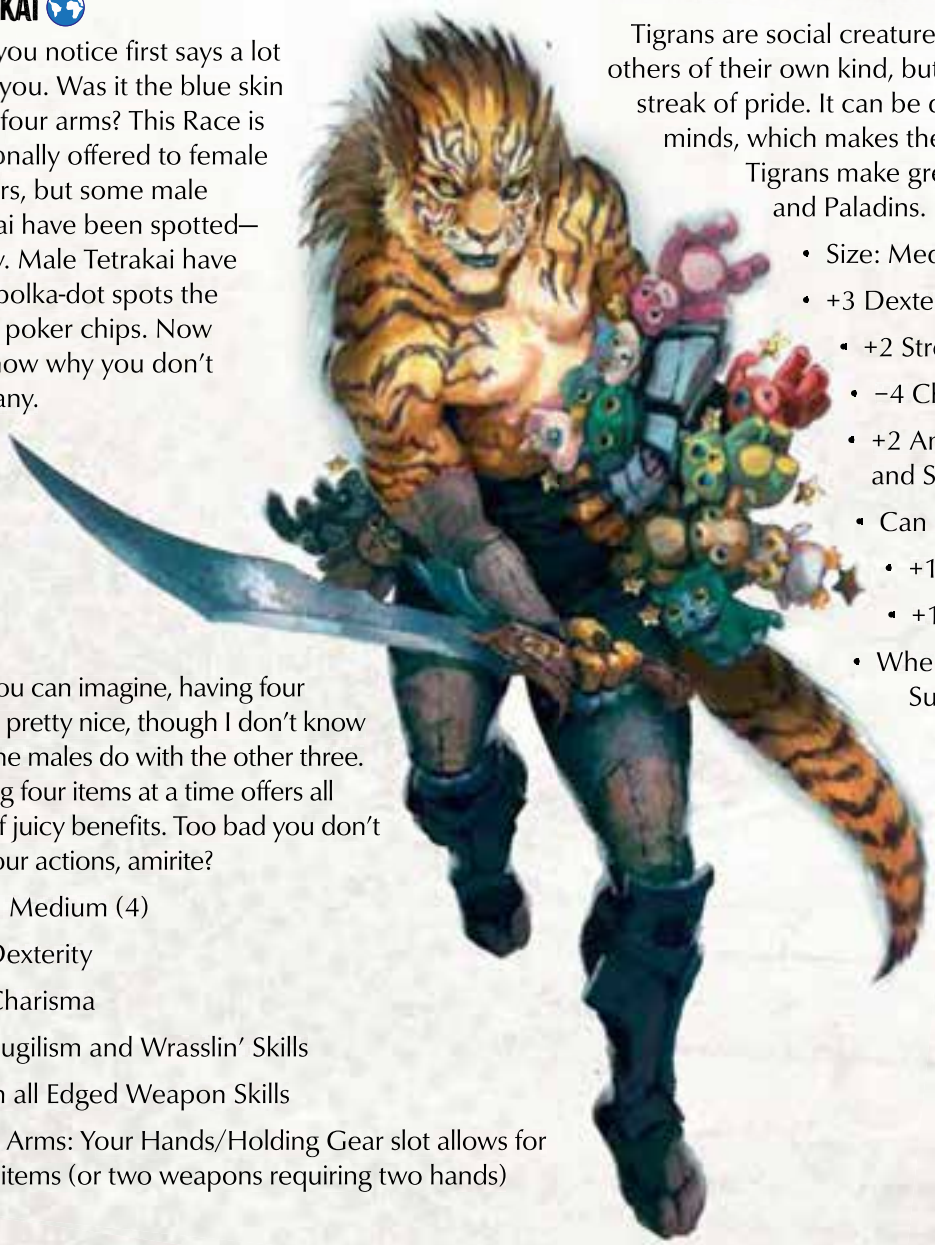
cover them with hair, and then give them size 24 feet. The resulting behemoth is a monstrous melee warrior and tank that smells like shit but hits (and smushes) like a sledgehammer.

Prerequisites: This limited Race is only available to crawlers who have attained Rank 5+ in the Smush Skill

- Size: Large (5)
- +6 Strength and Constitution
- +2 Dexterity
- −3 Intelligence
- −1 Charisma
- +3 Foot Soldier and Smush Skills
- Smush Skill can be raised to Rank 20

TETRAKAI

What you notice first says a lot about you. Was it the blue skin or the four arms? This Race is traditionally offered to female crawlers, but some male Tetrakai have been spotted—literally. Male Tetrakai have white polka-dot spots the size of poker chips. Now you know why you don't see many.



As you can imagine, having four arms is pretty nice, though I don't know what the males do with the other three. Holding four items at a time offers all sorts of juicy benefits. Too bad you don't have four actions, amirite?

- Size: Medium (4)
- +6 Dexterity
- −2 Charisma
- +2 Pugilism and Wrasslin' Skills
- +1 in all Edged Weapon Skills
- Four Arms: Your Hands/Holding Gear slot allows for four items (or two weapons requiring two hands)

TIGRAN

These tiger-headed humanoids stand more than six feet tall and are covered from head to toe in a layer of incredibly vibrant orange-and-black fur. They have the head of a tiger, a long muscular tail, and humanlike hands that end in wicked claws. These claws are excellent for attack and defense, but they can cause difficulties in performing small, delicate tasks such as picking locks. You don't need to have fond memories of your Lisa Frank trapper keeper to know these tiger people are uniquely Earth creations.

Tigrans are cunning predators. If given their choice, they attack from cover, using overwhelming speed and ferocity rather than engaging in a drawn-out encounter. Although they're incredibly stealthy, often choosing to walk barefoot, their coloring makes stealth difficult in most of the World Dungeon.

Tigrans are social creatures, especially among others of their own kind, but they harbor an inherent streak of pride. It can be difficult to change their minds, which makes them seem antisocial.

Tigrans make great Barbarians, Monks, and Paladins.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +3 Dexterity
- +2 Strength
- −4 Charisma
- +2 Ambush, Cat-like Reflexes, and Slice Attack Skills
- Can see in total darkness
- +1 DR Buff
- +10ft Move
- When attacking during a Surprise Action, deal ×2 total damage with melee attacks
- Disadvantage on Dexterity-based Skills that require fine manipulation or motor coordination

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ALIEN RACES

In addition to Earth Races, showrunners love allowing Humans to choose other Syndicate Races to compete. Unfortunately, those Races don't get access to the Earth-based Classes. Instead, they gain a small benefit—usually popularity among their audience.

BUNE

Bunes are a slight, dragon-like people with a calm sense of superiority; if Crocodilians are the Barbarians of the lizard world, Bunes are the elves. They are naturally peaceful, but they can be clever Fighters. As part of the Syndicate, the Bune home world once hosted *Dungeon Crawler World*. Although Bunes can't use their leathery wings to fly right away, their wings gain strength at higher Levels and allow for short-distance flight. This Race is an ideal choice for Rogue and magic-using Classes.

Prerequisites: This limited Race is only available to crawlers with 3 or more Popularity

- Size: Medium (4)
- +3 Intelligence
- +2 Dexterity
- −2 Constitution
- +3 Determine Value, Fabricate, and Negotiation Skills
- At Level 50, +2 Dexterity and gain wings capable of flying up to 500ft per scene
- +1 Popularity each time you roll a Critical Hit in combat

CAPRID

Caprids are a Syndicate Race of bipedal, goat-headed humanoids—their hands are usually Human while their feet can be hooved or toed. Caprids come in a variety of color morphs and can possess horns in many shapes and patterns; some known Caprid colors include pitch-black, dappled white, and caramel, gray, or deep brown.

Rich in both power and resources, Caprids hold a strong standing in the Syndicate, and multiple sponsor entities have Caprid board members. The high intelligence and charisma of Caprids make them an ideal choice for magic users, con artists, and cult-leader hopefuls.

- Size: Large (5)
- +3 Intelligence and Charisma
- −2 Strength
- +3 Find Crawler, Investigation, and Leadership Skills
- Find Crawler and Persuasion Skills can be raised to Rank 20
- +1 Popularity each time you roll a Critical Hit on a Charisma Skill Check or on a Spell Skill Check outside of combat

GRULKE

You are a toad. A five-foot-tall toad person who once conquered planets, not that anyone remembers. If anyone calls you a frog, make them regret it. The Grulke are a militaristic Race of toad warriors, though they have lost much of their organization as a Race and are now more often seen solo in mercenary halls. If only a Grulke were able to unite the disparate battalions and restore honor to their people, an up-and-comer who hasn't been poisoned by infighting and politics. Oh, if only there were someone worthy...

Prerequisites: This limited Race is only available to crawlers who have Rank 5+ in the Jumping or Light on Your Feet Skill

- Size: Medium (4)
- +3 Dexterity
- +2 Strength
- −2 Charisma
- +3 in either Jumping or Light on Your Feet Skills
- +2 Zone of Control and a Reach Weapon Skill of your choice
- Tongue Lashing: Ranged attack; [Rank = Floor Number] + Dex to hit. 1d8 + Str, Bludgeoning, 30ft range. Add 1d8 at Rank 5, 10, and 15. Rank is always equal to the Floor Number and cannot be raised by other means
- Gain a +2 DR breastplate (Torso) with your Grulke Battalion crest, not that it means much anymore
- Troll-type enemies have Advantage on Wrasslin' Checks against you, and when successful, they lick you
- +1 Popularity when a troll-type enemy licks you or when you achieve an Amazing Success or better on an Attack against a troll-type enemy
- +1 Popularity when you score a Critical Hit on a larger foe in combat

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HOBGOBLIN

A Hobgoblin is what happens when a lady Troll manages to get a Goblin drunk enough to talk herself into his pants. While that description makes them sound like they come from bawdy Earth Bards, this alien Race of explosive hooligans is a plague among the stars. Large, muscular, and smart, Hobgoblins excel at trapmaking, explosives management, and all-out mayhem. Unfortunately, these guys are so ugly that even Gorgons lose their lunch looking upon them, and they've suffered a few nerfs in the most recent balancing patch. This Race is best suited for Rogue and Fighter-based Classes.

Prerequisites: This limited Race is only available to crawlers who have Rank 5+ in the Explosives Handling Skill and any Trap-based Skill

- Size: Medium (4)
- +1 Dexterity
- −5 Charisma. Charisma is capped at 10
- +3 in all Trap-based and Explosive-based Skills
- +1 Regeneration Skill
- Free access to all Hobgoblin Sapper Workshops
- At the end of each floor, roll one Explosive or Trap-based Skill Advancement Check with Advantage
- All explosives and trap-making Skills can be raised to Rank 20
- +1 Popularity when you kill an enemy with a trap or explosive once per scene

POCKET KUMA

A Pocket Kuma is an adorable and diminutive hybrid of a bear, a capybara, and a sugar glider that comes from beyond the stars. Their small bodies and oversized eyes made them absolutely adorable, and they were quickly put into service as pets by the High Elves who bred them specifically for that purpose.

However, these cute little abominations learned how to think, which inspired mass genocide of their species. Fortunately, a few clever specimens managed to escape, thus perpetuating their existence and eventual spread throughout the galaxy.

A Pocket Kuma's oversized eyes give them the ability to see incredibly well in day or night. Despite ranking among the weakest and most fragile of Races, they are some of the most agile and nimble creatures in the galaxy. It's not uncommon for them to leap up to ten times their own body length with a running start, or half that from standing.

Although their dexterous paws have opposable thumbs, they're simply too small to wield or use any weapons or items that aren't specifically designed for them, making them poor warriors. Members of this Race are ideal as Bards, Rogues, or magic-users.

- Size: Small (2); Animal
- +5 Dexterity and Charisma
- −4 Strength. Strength is capped at 10
- −4 Constitution
- +2 Bite, Dodge, and Slice Attack Skills
- +1 Ambush Skill
- You roll with Advantage on all Charisma-based Checks
- Can see in total darkness
- Take no damage from falling
- Light on Your Feet Skill can be raised to Rank 20
- You deal half damage with Strength-based melee weapons
- Vulnerable to Bludgeoning damage
- +1 Popularity when you act in the Surprise Round of a combat or roll a Critical Fail on an Evade Check

PTEROLYKOS

Powerful and beautiful, the Pterolykos is the very picture of dangerous grace on land or air. Resembling a humanoid wolf with resplendent multi-hued feathery wings, Pterolykos inspire

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veneration as icons of strength, versatility, and beauty. Their mournful howl is known to haunt the dreams of those who hear it.

While Pterolykoses don't have keen eyes, their noses rank among the most well-developed in the galaxy. They're known to chase prey for miles, tracking them through the air by scent before swooping down to tear their victims apart with their powerful jaws.

A Pterolykos can't help but be incredibly expressive in face and body, which is perfect for grand displays of emotion and theatrical gestures, but it makes lying and deception incredibly difficult. It's a wonderfully dramatic gesture to underline a point by snapping their wings open, but it's a challenge to pretend they're angry or upset when their wolf tail won't stop wagging. This Race is ideal for any Bard-based or magic-using Class.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +4 Charisma
- +2 Dexterity
- +3 Bite, Performance, and Tracking Skills
- +1 Diplomacy Skill
- Has wings capable of flight for up to 50 seconds per scene
- Disadvantage on all Checks to conceal emotion or presence (such as Deception and Stealth)
- +1 Popularity when you roll a Critical Hit on a Charisma Skill Check

SKYFOWL

Regal. Devout. Loyal. Kind of opinionated. All of these describe the majestic Skyfowl people found throughout the World Dungeon and the rest of the galaxy. Skyfowl are known for two things: they're devout warriors willing to protect their honor and social standing, and they're kind of jerks to everyone about it.

There are dozens of flights of Skyfowl, and their physical characteristics depend on their origin. Those hailing from the wilds of the World Dungeon may have bestial hawk-like characteristics or the dense muscles of a rooster protecting his flock; those from cities might have dull-colored feathers and small wings suitable for survival in crowded settlements.

No matter where they originate or what their role is in a Crawl, all Skyfowl believe in the superiority of those who don't just dream of flying high in the clouds but can do it. That, and feathers beat boring fur and itchy scales, no contest. This Race makes a good choice for any non-frontline Fighter Class.

- Size: Medium (4)
- +3 Dexterity and Charisma
- −1 Strength and Constitution
- +2 Slice Attack Skill
- +2 in all Charisma-based Skills
- Advantage on the Perception Skill for observing things 10+ feet away
- Capable of flight for up to 3 minutes per scene. However, Skyfowl who choose a Cleric-based Class have their wings clipped and can only make short hops of up to 10 seconds per scene when flying
- +1 Popularity when you roll a Critical Hit on a Leadership, Perception, Persuasion, or Taunt Skill Check

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CLASSES

Over the next 17 pages, you'll find Class options that appear in the books and are available to most crawlers. Your choice of Race should influence the three Class options the System AI gives you. Discuss your desires with the GM beforehand.

Classes are divided into a bunch of categories, but one big category is the base Class. Barbarians, Bards, Clerics, and Mages are categories of similar Classes familiar to fans of tabletop roleplaying games and **Dungeon Crawler Carl** alike.

Any crafting tables you gain through your Class appear as soon as you acquire a personal space (Fourth Floor or later).

At the end of this section, you'll find a Class Point Buy system to help you design your own unique Class! Several of these Classes have unique benefits you won't find on the point cost charts, because you're a unique snowflake.

EARTH CLASSES

In addition to the hundreds of possible Classes (some assembly required) from previous editions of the Crawl, the Borant corporation is proud to offer a variety of Classes inspired by Earth! These Classes are only available to crawlers who select an Earth-based Race (see p. 128). As an incentive for crawlers to select these special Classes, they also gain a Silver Earth Box (GMs can find these on p. 321). The box contains an Earth Hobby Potion that guarantees 3 Skill Ranks in one of the many past times that fascinated the hosts of this cycle's Crawl, plus at least one bonus item!

You can tell Earth Classes, like Earth Races, by the beautiful marble (🌎) next to the name of the Class.

ARCANIST

Arcanists are magical artisans with secret knowledge of the processes required to manufacture arcane items. These crafters can create a broad range of traditional and not-so-traditional magical items. Making arcane items often takes considerable time and requires specific, sometimes hard-to-get ingredients. Arcanists maintain secrecy over their crafting recipes and are often willing to pay handsomely for new recipes in their particular fields of expertise.

BORING OL' ARCANIST

Class Type: Arcanist

You decided long ago that you wanted to craft powerful magical items, but really never settled on a specialty. You're pretty good in some areas and just average in others. At higher Levels, you may gain some additional expertise, but for the most part, you are a generalist. Still, when someone needs that special arcane item to defeat that big Boss, you might just be the Arcanist for the job. And if not, well, you're probably the only Arcanist they can find, so you'll make do.

- +3 Intelligence
- +2 Dexterity
- +5 Arcane Skill
- +3 Salvage Skill
- +2 in a crafting Skill of your choice
- +1 in a crafting Skill of your choice
- Tier 1 Arcanist table
- Arcane and one crafting Skill can be raised to Rank 20

ALCHEMIST

Class Type: Arcanist

Crafting arcane liquids, now that's a fun thing! You can make all kinds of potions for all sorts of occasions. Plus, you've messed up enough potions to know how to make some pretty cool poisons, ranging from merely annoying to extremely deadly. Luckily, you've also learned, often the hard way, how to negate these poisons. Well, mostly. Don't drink that gray one, just in case.

- +3 Constitution and Intelligence
- +5 Alchemy Skill
- +3 Infusion Skill
- Immunity to Poison
- Tier 1 Alchemy table
- At the end of each floor, add 1 to your Skill Advancement Checks for Alchemy and Infusion
- Alchemy Skill can be raised to Rank 20

DOUCHY WIZARD SCHOOL WAND-MAKER 🌎

Class Type: Arcanist

Everyone wants that special wand. Rare materials, finely sculpted form, access to powerful magics. Well, someone has to fill all these custom orders! Not only

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can you make wands, but you can also make fancy staves and... toys? Well, maybe wand-shaped toys... not asking why you want those. All of these can be used by their wielder to focus their arcane energies and do wondrous things. Or maybe just make light and shoot Magic Missiles—to each their own.

- +5 Intelligence
- +1 Strength and Dexterity
- −2 Charisma
- +5 Arcane Skill
- +2 Lore, Negotiation, and Salvage Skills
- Tier-1 crafting table of your choice
- Arcanist Skill can be raised to Rank 20
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

INFERNOCRAFTER

Class Type: Arcanist

Lighting stuff on fire is fun. You make a lot of things that inherently burn with magical fire, including flaming weapons and fiery magical items. Flaming arrows? Check. Flaming swords? Check.

- +3 Strength and Constitution
- +1 Dexterity
- +5 Arcane Skill
- +3 Smithing Skill
- Resistance to Fire damage
- Tier 1 Arcanist table
- Tier 1 Smithing table
- Arcane Skill can be raised to Rank 20

PRISON TATTOO ARTIST

Class Type: Arcanist

Sometimes you just gotta make do with the tools you have on hand and hope for the best. They might not be pretty, but they do the job.

Who are we kidding? You can't tell what these motherfucking tattoos are supposed to be! Just don't say that to the lifer who's been working on them all month for you.

You can create functional, but not aesthetically pleasing, magical tattoos that grant a wide range of arcane abilities for a limited amount of time.

- +3 Constitution and Dexterity
- +2 Intelligence
- +5 Tattoo Artistry Skill
- +3 Calligraphy Skill
- +2 Dagger Skill
- Tier 1 Tattoo chair (table)
- Tattoo Artistry Skill can be raised to Rank 20
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

BARBARIAN

Barbarians are lightly-armored, rage-filled warriors. Many can harness that rage to gain special abilities. Others are just pretty good at smashing things. Many have thick, incomprehensible accents and are just better off shouting at you instead of trying to hold a civil conversation. Talking generally isn't their strong suit anyway—just give them something to smash.

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BORING OL' BARBARIAN

Class Type: Barbarian

Like parading around in a loincloth and bashing heads? This is the Class for you! Just remember the Barbarian's motto: *what doesn't kill you makes you stronger—as well as probably bleed a whole lot in the process.*

- +6 Strength
- +5 Constitution
- +3 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Endurance Skill
- +1 Intimidate Skill
- Rage (Benefit): Your melee attacks deal +1 damage for each Health Bar slot you have lost
- +2 DR Buff

GLADIATOR

Class Type: Barbarian, Bard

You were once a slave, but now you fight for glory! Well, you're probably still a slave (you *are* trapped in a world-spanning dungeon where you're fighting hordes of enemies for the entertainment of countless strangers, after all), but you do get some additional perks—as long as you manage to stay alive. You've been used and abused, but that has only toughened you and made you stronger. So strong, in fact, that your masters might be fearful of you and want to knock you down a peg. Or ten.

- +3 Strength, Constitution, and Charisma
- +2 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Performance and Intimidation Skills
- +1 Attack of Opportunity Skill
- Rage (Benefit): Your melee attacks deal +1 damage for each Health Bar slot you have lost
- +1 DR Buff
- Once per combat, after you kill an enemy, you can make an Unopposed Performance Skill Check. On an Amazing Success or better, gain +1 Popularity
- One Weapon Skill can be raised to Rank 20

HARII

Class Type: Barbarian, Rogue

You're a lean, mean killing machine. And you look good in black. Like, *all*-black, head to toe. Some think you're a ghostly myth, but others know better, as you use your stealth to terrorize your enemies at night, making them think you're some sort of demonic spirit.

- +1 Strength, Dexterity, and Intelligence
- +4 Ambush and Stealth Skills
- +2 in one Weapon Skill of your choice
- Rage (Benefit): Your melee attacks deal +1 damage for each Health Bar slot you have lost
- +1 DR Buff
- Can see in total darkness
- Access to the Desperado Club
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

FERAL CAT BERSERKER

Class Type: Barbarian

Cats couldn't care less about you and your needs. Feral cats somehow manage to care even less as they barely eke out their own survival, living off cockroaches and rodents of unusual size. And sometimes things just get a little out of hand—out of paw?

Prerequisites: This limited Class is only available to cat-based Races, such as Cat, Cat Girl, and Tigran

- +2 Dexterity, Strength, and Charisma
- +3 Slice Attack and Unarmed Combat Skills
- +2 Dodge Skill
- +1 Ambush Skill
- Rage (Benefit): Your melee attacks deal +1 damage for each Health Bar slot you have lost
- +1 DR Buff
- Can see in total darkness
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

SHIELDMAIDEN

Class Type: Barbarian, Fighter

You are a fierce and skilled warrior who strikes fear in the hearts of your enemies—especially all those boys who used to bully you as a child. When you're not busy kicking ass and taking names, you might be found working out in the gym, helping your family, or volunteering in your community. You can bring home the bacon and fry it up in a pan—after you hunt down the boar and butcher it, just like you did to that wretched boy Dustin who used to tease you and pull your pigtails.

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Prerequisite: This limited Class is only available to female crawlers

- +3 Strength, Dexterity, and Charisma
- −2 Intelligence
- +5 Shield Block Skill
- +2 in one Weapon Skill of your choice
- Rage (Benefit): Your melee attacks deal +1 damage for each Health Bar slot you have lost
- +1 DR Buff
- One Weapon Skill can be raised to Rank 20
- Add your STR Mod a second time to your melee attack damage against males
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

BARD

Bards are storytellers, musicians, and poets. They are the custodians of the oral tradition, keeping track of historic people and events and sharing that information in a creative and entertaining way. Some just happen to be more entertaining than others (lookin' at you, Jeff Hays).

Some Bard-type Classes are eligible for Patrons, but you'll have to find someone willing and able to serve as your Patron. It's fun, like a Quest to find one. The GM has information on the process and some characters who might fill this role (see *Bard Patronage*, p. 315).

BORING OL' BARD

Class Type: Bard

Every town and village has that one Bard who parties hard all night yet still manages to look refreshed in the morning. They drink, sing or play an instrument, then drink some more, pass out, then wake up to do it all over again the next day. If mead and beer weren't so rich in carbs and sugars, they'd probably already be dead by now.

- +3 Charisma
- +3 Performance Skill
- +1 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 in a Spell of your choice
- +2 Diplomacy Skill
- +1 Good First Impression and Lore Skills
- Access to all membership-based clubs, regardless of current memberships
- Membership in the Dungeon Book of the Floor Club (all Spells)
- Free room at all saferooms
- You may gain access to a Patron
- You pay +1 Mana to cast Spells that are not "Favored: Bard"

ARTIST ALLEY MOGUL

Class Type: Bard, Merchant

This Charisma and Intelligence-based Class is a modern-day merchant, using the siren song of merchandise to cast a spell on the wallets and purses of their prey. Using their superior artistic talent to entertain and entice fellow nerds, the Artist Alley Mogul travels the world to sell their copyright-infringing wares. While not particularly menacing physically, this plucky merchant is extremely difficult to hurt.

A recent balance patch hit the Class, increasing gold-generating potency while reducing survivability. Members of this Class receive the following benefits:

- +5 Dexterity
- +5 Charisma
- +2 Dodge, Negotiation, and Pathfinder Skills
- +2 Shield Spell
- A 25% discount at all stores plus a 15% bonus to money earned from sales
- 10% interest earned on all coins upon descent to the next floor
- Dodge Skill can be raised to Rank 20
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

FORMER CHILD ACTOR

Class Type: Bard

This rare subclass is an offshoot of the Bard Class. It can only be obtained by crawlers who have both earned the "Cut!" achievement and reached at least one trillion views. Once a spoiled brat superstar, then addicted to drugs, you have crawled back from the brink stronger than ever. You're ready for your comeback. This Charisma and Chance-based Class could go either way. You'll either rise to the top, or you'll be dead in a ditch in a week. After a balance patch, it's slightly more likely you'll end up dead in that ditch, but this is your chance to prove them wrong!

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This unique Earth Class is based on the Bard/Rogue Jack-Of-All-Trades subclass, but with a few distinctive differences. In addition to the following benefits, the most distinct aspect of this multi-faceted Class is the Rank 3 Character Actor Skill. This Skill increases in Rank only upon descent to the next floor.

Prerequisites: Must have Popularity 3+, receiving the Cut! achievement, to take this Class

- +10 Charisma
- +3 Character Actor Skill
- +2 Cockroach Skill
- Add 1 to your Skill Advancement Checks for Charisma-based Skills
- Immunity to Poison and all diseases
- The Manager Benefit
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

NECROBARD

Class Type: Bard, Necromancer

This unusual Class combines one of the most-loved occupations with one of the most reviled. Necromancers specialize in magic related to raising the dead. Bards must choose an entertainment-based Skill. Depending on this choice, whether it be singing, the kazoo, or storytelling, the resulting crawler will use this Skill to either entertain, protect, or glamour both the living and the dead. The NecroBard receives the following benefits:

- +3 to Intelligence, Constitution, and Charisma
- −2 Strength
- +4 Performance Skill
- +3 Turn Undead and Panty Dropper Spells
- Access to all membership-based clubs, regardless of current memberships
- Free room at all saferooms
- You pay +1 Mana to cast Spells that are not "Favored: Bard" or that don't deal Necrotic damage

POET LAUREATE

Class Type: Bard

The spoken word is your jam. Rather than singing or playing an instrument, you craft entertaining and usually scandalous verses about the rich and famous. This not only endears you to the common folk, but it also enables you to use your words to convince others to do your will.

- +3 Intelligence
- +2 Charisma
- +5 Performance Skill with the written word specialty
- +2 Earworm (as spoken word poetry), Heal Others, and Shield Spells
- Access to all membership-based clubs, regardless of current memberships
- You pay +1 Mana to cast Spells that are not "Favored: Bard"
- Performance Skill can be raised to 20
- You must choose a Patron. The GM will give you a choice of at least two options when you select this class.
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

PROFESSIONAL ROADIE

Class Type: Bard, Rogue

Considered by some to be the backup singer to a Bard, the Professional Roadie possesses powers that can boost their comrades and maximize sonic effects. Whether working on a team or taking your act solo, the Professional Roadie has a wealth of experience to draw on and has dealt with the most difficult patrons. The ability to sort out broken equipment and manage healing elixirs makes you invaluable to a group trying to survive the Floor.

The Professional Roadie spends a long time exploring the World Dungeon, utilizing their Skills to bargain for food and lodging from others. Highly versatile, a Professional Roadie often has a wealth of contacts on call should they need favors, information, or money that is owed to them. You also tell the best stories and can hypnotize a crowd with tales of days gone by and gigs you've played.

- +8 split between Strength, Constitution, and Charisma
- +4 Performance Skill, with a guitar specialty
- +3 Negotiation Skill
- +1 Iron Stomach and Repair Skills
- Advantage on Checks against Poison or effects that give the Shit-Faced Debuff

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- At the start of each combat, you may declare that all the damage you deal is Sonic damage
- Roll with Advantage when making a Repair Skill Check
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

SPELLBINDER

Class Type: Bard

Everyone loves a good story, and most Bards are pretty good at telling them. You, on the other hand, are the master weaver of fantastical tales. Glorious adventures are your forte, and you effortlessly bring even the most dry and voluminous tomes to life with your passionate narration (with the exception perhaps of those from authors who seem to write several 1,000-page books a year, with a never-ending narrative). Your storytelling demands the rapt attention of all who hear, even when they'd rather ignore you. Like in the midst of battle. Or during sex. Your oration is so immersive that your listeners can't help but feel a sense of loss when the story eventually ends, making them yearn for the next, even though it might be years before it reaches their ears. (Yeah, thanks for that, Jeff Hays).

- +2 Charisma and Intelligence
- +2 Good First Impression, Lore, and Performance Skills
- +2 in Hot Stuff Aura and Panty Dropper Spells
- Add your CHA Mod a second time when making a CHA Skill Check during a potentially hostile situation
- Access to the Spellbook of the Floor club ("Favored: Bard" Spells only)
- Once per day, you can draw the attention of everyone on the battlefield for a round, preventing them from attacking (this includes party members, Mobs, and minions, but not Bosses)

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CLERIC

Clerics cozy up to a deity and hope for a measure of its power. They're not necessarily true believers, but they do need to keep their god's rules and regulations. And the gods are fickle bastards.

BORING OL' CLERIC

Class Type: Cleric

Whether do-gooders or downright evil, Clerics exist ostensibly to serve their god and lead their god's followers. Some do this with loyalty and reverence. Others do so out of fear or in hopes of rewards. Either way, being a Cleric has its ups and downs, sometimes leaving you dirt-poor and other times providing you with that private jet you "need" to serve your god.

- +4 Charisma
- +3 Intelligence
- +2 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +3 Religion Skill
- +2 Heal Others, Shield, and Turn Undead Spells
- Access to the Spell Book of the Level club ("Favored: Cleric" Spells only)
- Access to Club Vanquisher
- Must worship a deity (see *Deities & Worship*, p. 163)
- You cannot choose a Cleric-type Class if you have access to the Desperado Club

BLACK INQUISITOR GENERAL

Class Types: Cleric, Mage, Paladin

You are a true believer who seeks out and kills those who have betrayed the faith... and you might enjoy this sacred duty a little too much. Yeah, who are we kidding? You're a psychopath who's out to inflict pain on others, and you're using your deity as a convenient excuse.

- +3 Strength and Intelligence
- +1 Charisma
- −2 Constitution
- +3 Find Trap Skill
- +3 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Trap Engineer Skill
- +2 in a Spell of your choice
- +1 Religion Skill
- Can see in total darkness
- Must worship a deity (see *Deities & Worship*, p. 163)
- Access to all membership-based clubs, regardless of current memberships

SANTERO

Class Type: Cleric

You can call upon powerful spirits for aid as you provide guidance and protection to others, and you do it with color and flair! This Class is a hybrid Necromancer Cleric with tanking and support tendencies.

- +3 Strength and Charisma
- +2 Constitution
- −2 Intelligence
- +2 Heal Others, Shield, and Soul Collector Spells
- +2 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Religion Skill
- +1 Endurance Skill
- Access to the Dungeon Book of the Floor club ("Favored: Cleric" Spells only)
- Access to Club Vanquisher
- Must worship a deity (see *Deities & Worship*, p. 163)
- You cannot choose this Class if you have access to the Desperado Club

DRUID

Druids practice magic focused on the natural world, typically as defenders of the wild. Their magic grants them Spells that harm, heal, and manipulate the environment.

BORING OL' DRUID

Class Type: Druid

Typical tree-hugging nature lovers, Druids are protectors of flora and fauna alike. Sometimes they can get a bit overprotective. Don't get caught littering, as they're more than willing to exploit ecological forces to punish their enemies. So pick up your trash, or else your pulverized bones will serve as bricks for a retaining wall around some Druid's garden.

- +2 Intelligence, Constitution, and Dexterity
- +3 Nature's Breath Spell
- +3 in a Spell of your choice
- +2 in a Spell of your choice

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- +2 Survival Skill
- Your Mana recovers at twice the normal rate in a natural environment
- Access to the Dungeon Book of the Floor club ("Favored: Druid" Spells only)

HERBALIST

Class Type: Arcanist, Druid

You've spent years mastering the arcane properties of herbs—not the boring culinary kind, but the kind that make people question their life choices and maybe make a few more bad ones along the way. Every herb is a piece of the puzzle, every blend a calculated risk. The dungeon is your garden, and you harvest it with the enthusiasm of someone who genuinely does not understand the concept of "too much."

- +2 Constitution and Intelligence
- +2 Alchemy, Cooking, First Aid, and Survival Skills
- +2 Nature's Breath and Dirt Clod Spells
- Your Mana recovers at twice the normal rate in a natural environment

LIFEBRINGER

Class Type: Druid

You've traveled the wasteland, past former refineries, down furious roads, and around thunderous strongholds. You're a survivor, and you've learned how to restore the dead lands and help flora to grow and thrive. While others fought the limited resources, often wearing nothing but chaps and some poorly applied sunscreen, you sought to bring life back to the desert. When you encountered lost souls, you took them in and helped them find their way, both figuratively and spiritually. You only wish you could get rid of all that sand that keeps getting stuck in the most uncomfortable places. There's gotta be a spell for that!

- +2 Constitution
- +1 Intelligence
- +2 First Aid, Pathfinder, Regeneration, and Survival Skills
- +2 Nature's Breath Spell
- +1 Rank in all Spells with the Heal keyword
- Once per day, you can grant Regeneration at your Skill Rank to all party members within 30 feet for 10 minutes

PHYSICKER

Class Type: Druid

Your calling is to heal and protect others, and Mother Nature gives you the tools to do so. The natural environment comes to your aid in curing the physical ailments of the sick and protecting the weak. While some might think your "home remedies" are crude and archaic, they are every bit as effective as other magic and modern medicine (though they can get a bit smelly and gross by comparison!). I mean, leeches aren't everyone's cup of tea, and sometimes your remedies are slow to effect, but they can't deny how much better they feel after a good bloodletting...

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- +3 Constitution and Intelligence
- +3 Nature's Breath and Oakhide Spells
- +2 Rootfoot and Solsplash Spells
- Double Mana regeneration when outdoors
- Able to grant +1 DR to your party for 1 scene, once per day

SHEPHERD

Class Type: Druid

Considered by some to be pacifists, Shepherds do their best to maintain an appearance of docility before unleashing their most potent weapons: their herds. Trained in the arts of healing, animal care, and protection, you have dedicated yourself to protecting your flock, no matter what form that may take. It may be a herd of goats, several cast-off Robogolems, or even the people you're traveling with, but once you decide they're part of your family? May the higher powers protect those transgressors who attempt to harm them.

- +2 Intelligence, Charisma, and Constitution
- +3 Animal Handling Skill
- +2 Pathfinder Skill
- +2 Nature's Breath and Drain Life Spells
- You can see twice as far as most creatures
- Your Mana recovers at twice the normal rate in a natural environment
- The Shepherd may not use melee weapons other than Herding Weapons (see p. 182)
- Gain a friendly Pet
- Pets in your Herd gain +2 DR
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

FIGHTER

Fighters are versatile combatants trained in all manner of martial weapons. They are durable damage-dealing frontliners, generally with good armor and lots of Hit Points.

BORING OL' FIGHTER

Class Type: Fighter

You're not sure which Class to pick, so why not stick with the classic Boring Ol' Fighter? No big decisions to make here—just run up and hit stuff. You've got decent fighting ability but really suck at magic and Spells. Oh, well. Those things run out anyway, and why bother counting and calculating when you can just throw hands or get stabby with the bad guys? Nothing is as sure and consistent as punching, kicking, bludgeoning, hacking, and slashing your way through Mobs.

- +2 Strength and Constitution
- +5 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +3 Dodge Skill
- +2 to your choice of two of the following Skills: Aiming, Attack of Opportunity, Catcher, Shield Block, or Zone of Control Skills
- Can access any Weapon Training Guild. Upon arrival on each floor, you receive a coupon good for one free training at a Weapon Training Guild

PIT FIGHTER

Class Type: Fighter

Although you might not wear furs and carry a spiked stick, you're often mistaken for a Barbarian. Unlike those rage-filled Barbarians, though, Pit Fighters are much more cunning and adept at survival, especially in close-quarters combat. You'll use anything at your disposal to defeat your opponent, including the pit itself.

- +3 Dexterity
- +2 Intelligence
- +1 Strength
- +3 Attack of Opportunity and Dirty Fighting Skills
- +2 Dodge and Improvised Weapons Skills
- +2 DR Buff
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

SHOTGUN MESSENGER

Class Type: Fighter

Sometimes you gotta make sure someone gets the message, especially when it's time for your pregnant daughter's ex-boyfriend to show up at the courthouse and do the right thing. In those cases, the Shotgun Messenger guarantees that message lands the way it's supposed to—one way or another.

- +2 Strength, Constitution, and Dexterity
- −2 Charisma

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- +5 in a Ranged Weapon Skill
- +2 Aiming and Intimidate Skills
- +1 in all muscle-powered movement-related Skills
- Can access any Weapon Training Guild. Each floor, you receive a coupon good for one free training at a Weapon Training Guild
- Access to the Desperado Club
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

STRAIGHT-TO-DVD ACTION HERO

Class Type: Fighter

While A-Listers get to star in big-budget blockbuster movies, the Straight-to-DVD Action Hero barely makes enough to cover his rent and groceries. Forced to do his own stunts, the Straight-to-DVD Action Hero knows the basics of stunt work and weapons handling, though they're also worse for wear due to the perpetually hazardous learning process. This is a Fighter subclass.

Straight-to-DVD Action Heroes receive the following benefits:

- +3 Strength, Constitution, Dexterity, and Charisma
- −2 Intelligence
- +2 Unarmed Combat Skill
- +1 Driving, Running, and Performance Skills
- Take no damage from falling
- +1 DR
- The Manager Benefit
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

SWORD AND BOARDER

Class Type: Fighter

Some people excel at fighting, but you specialize in taking ships and buildings. Often the first one through the breach, you're not afraid to charge ahead and clear the room while your allies filter in behind you. It's not like you *prefer* to charge in mindlessly, but if you have to, you become a rampaging juggernaut who gets in, inflicts damage, and holds the line while others catch up.

Using your massive shield to keep yourself safe, you prefer to use the terrain around you to pin your foes down. They may have the numbers, but even a war party of ravenous Crocodilians would struggle to break past you! Your only weakness is that you cannot do things in half-measures: once you're sent in, you're gonna need a plan to get out if you can't hold your ground.

- +2 Strength, Constitution, and Dexterity
- −2 Intelligence
- +5 Shield Block Skill
- +3 in an Edged Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Attack of Opportunity and Catcher Skills
- Access to the Desperado Club

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MONSTER TRUCK DRIVER

Class Type: Fighter

You're the type who walks down a nursing home hallway and doesn't veer from your path, no matter how many shoulder-checks you have to deliver to grannies recovering from carpal tunnel surgery. You specialize in loud entrances, poor decisions, and turning perfectly good terrain into a highlight reel. This Class uses speed and size as both offense and defense, whether on wheel or heel, to make the crawler into an excellent tank.

Prerequisite: This limited Class is only available to crawlers who have Rank 5+ in the Driving Skill

- +4 Constitution
- +2 Dexterity
- −2 Strength
- −2 Intelligence
- +3 Gear Head, Driving, and Pathfinder Skills
- While moving in combat, you have a Con Mod bonus in your Health Bar slots (only) equal to 1/10th of the Move value of your means of conveyance. If on foot, you must have spent a Move Action during the previous round to gain this bonus
- You bolt across the room and slam through each entity in the way. [Rank = Floor Number] + Dex to hit, 1d12 Bludgeoning, 2d10+3ft Line, then you gain the Fatigued Debuff. Critical Fail on a Natural 4 or less. Cooldown: 30 hours. Add 1d at Rank 5, 10, and 15. Rank only increases by Floor
- Once per combat, roll 1d2 when you lose 2+ Health Bar slots. On a 1, the attacker loses 1 Health Bar slot
- Resistance to Force damage
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

ZULU WARRIOR

Class Type: Fighter

You've trained from an early age under the tutelage of your elders, learning discipline and endurance. While others might prefer the relative safety of firearms and other ranged weapons, you prefer getting up close and personal to give your enemies an old-fashioned beatdown. Using your swift mobility, you can quickly flank foes and catch them off guard.

- +3 Strength, Constitution, and Dexterity
- +3 in one Melee Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Attack of Opportunity, Endurance, and Running Skills
- +1 DR
- One Weapon Skill can be raised to Rank 20
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

MAGE

In the World Dungeon, magic is common, but *mastery* of magic is rare. Most who practice magic maintain some form of martial or spiritual traditions, so they can access a wider range of tools. There is an order, however, which based much of its training on mastering only the metaphysical, for they believe that by perfecting their craft, they can transcend reality and escape into the source of all magic.

Yeah, it's weird and cult-y at times, but whatever gets you through to the next Floor, amiright?

BORING OL' MAGE

Class Type: Mage

Ever faithful to the old traditions, you, as an adherent of the Boring Ol' Mage School (as their foes would describe them), strive to learn how to channel sheer arcane power at the cost of other Skills. Though some believe this equips the Boring Ol' Mage Class with glass jaws, your rigorous focus on magic channels portions of your intellect into impressive effects.

Several crawlers have attempted to waylay one of these Mages only to find they're capable of channeling sudden destructive powers and manifesting Spells straight out of legend, often with the same showmanship and magical-sounding words found in movies, TV shows, and fantasy books.

- +5 Intelligence and Charisma
- −2 Strength and Dexterity
- +3 in a Fire Spell
- +2 in one Force Spell and one Sonic Spell
- +2 in two different Passive Spells
- +2 Lore Skill
- +1 Arcane Skill
- −3 Ranks in all Dexterity Skills (to a minimum of 1 Rank if you have any Ranks)
- −3 Ranks in all Strength Skills (to a minimum of 1 Rank if you have any Ranks)

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BLIZZARDMANCER

Class Type: Mage

The Blizzardmancer represents the first step on a journey most Mages are too sensible—or too cold-averse—to attempt. While your peers are out there hurling fireballs and lightning bolts, you've chosen the deeply inconvenient powers of water and ice.

You don't explode things. You *preserve* them. In a block of ice. Yeah, that'll teach 'em! And while you're on your way back to your dorm to cry frigid tears into your pillow at night, don't forget to drop some ice cubes in my drink.

- +4 Intelligence
- +3 Dexterity
- −2 Strength
- +4 Ice Blast and Frost Scar Spells
- +2 Aiming Skill
- Resistance to Ice damage
- You can use the Aiming Skill for single-target Ice Spells

CRISPER

Class Type: Mage

To say you're hot is putting it mildly: You're literally on fire! You can generate flames out of nothing to protect yourself and absolutely *roast* others. Unlike other fire users, you can modulate how much heat you're putting out, meaning you can do anything from cooking a quick meal to pelting your opponent with fiery pine cones.

The Crisper can also add additional effects to their fire abilities. You can burn your opponents, sear them, scorch their armor, and even extend healing magic through your flames to heal others... as long as they don't mind a few blisters in the process. By laying on your hands, you can also use your abilities to burn out harmful magics and effects hurting your allies.

Crispers don't excel in humid or wet environments, and despite their abilities, water tends to reduce their effectiveness. But if you need a fire user who knows the sheer versatility of one of the primal elements, the Crisper makes for a great support Class who can keep things warm and friendly among friends and fiery and destructive toward foes.

- +3 Intelligence
- +2 Dexterity
- −2 Constitution
- +3 Wall of Fire and Fire Fingers Spells
- +2 Fireball and Wilbur's Slow-Build Fireblast Spells
- +2 Lore Skill
- Resistance to Fire damage
- No DR against Ice or water-based damage

FIRE SPIRITUALIST

Class Type: Bard, Mage

Every party wants that healer who will wade into battle and pluck them from the brink of death. Well, that's you! You have the burning desire to help others. I mean literally—your body glows, practically smoldering with powerful healing energies that can help your allies and harm your enemies. Just be careful not to get too close to any out-of-control water sources as they are bound to douse your healing flames!

- +2 Intelligence and Charisma
- +2 Holy Aura and Hot Stuff Aura Spells
- +2 Heal Others and Intimate Touches Spells
- Heal Others Spell can be raised to 20
- Ethereal Hug: Once per day for one scene, you can grant your party +1 DR, Rank 4 Regeneration (as per the Skill), +1 to hit on Weapon and Spell Skill Checks, and add 1d4 bonus when they deal damage
- Vulnerable to Ice damage

FORSAKEN AERIALIST

Class Type: Mage

Some Mages use powerful magic to blast and destroy with all the subtlety of a runaway locomotive or a scorching fireball. But not you. You eschew the spotlight and instead seek out more elegant and discreet ways to take on your foes. You have learned how to bypass certain magical limitations to make even the simplest and weakest of spells into something capable of slowly and steadily taking down the most powerful of creatures, all while they are completely unaware of their plight. That frog in the boiling pot never knew what hit him!

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- +5 Intelligence
- −2 Charisma
- +3 Drain Life and Soul Collector Spells
- +1 Alchemy, Infusion, and Tactics Skills
- Double the duration of your Rank 5 and lower Spells that have a duration
- Your Spells can be applied to a creature without it realizing it is under a Spell effect

NECROMANCER

Class Type: Mage, Necromancer

You're a Mage that specializes in manipulating life forces, sucking the life out of the living to raise the dead to do your bidding. Ever wonder why there are so many zombie apocalypse scenarios out there? It's just Necromancers practicing their craft. Sure, the undead might be unruly and difficult to control at times, but they're cheap labor, and there's no threat of them unionizing—not intentionally, anyway.

- +2 Intelligence and Dexterity
- −2 Constitution and Charisma
- +4 Soul Collector and Rise, Dead Minion! Spells
- +2 Drain Life and Second Chance Spells
- Once per rest, you can ask the corpse of a dead creature a number of questions equal to your INT. The creature answers as truthfully as it can based on what it knew in life
- Whenever you kill an undead Mob, you heal 1 Health Bar, up to 5 Health Bar per combat

MONK

While Fighters focus on their weaponry and Mages focus on spells, Monks seek harmony and natural balance within themselves and the world around them. And they kick a lot of ass doing it—turns out it's pretty meditative to slam your fists, elbows, knees, and feet into your enemies!

BORING OL' MONK

Class Type: Monk

Often pugilists and unarmed combatants, Monks aren't really all that devout or faithful: they're just a boring ol' Class from some dated kung fu movie or an archaic video game. You're not like those Earth-based Monks who hang out in their monasteries chanting all the time, though you might *want* to be like those Shaolin Monks—they're pretty fast and badass.

- +3 Constitution and Dexterity
- +1 Strength
- +3 Unarmed Combat Skill
- +1 Foot Soldier, Iron Punch, Powerful Strike, Pugilism, and Smush Skills
- +1 in Dexterity-based Weapon Skills
- Unarmed Combat Skill can be raised to Rank 20

ELEMENTAL MONK

Class Type: Mage, Monk

You have focused your monastic training on mastering the elements. It's not that you wanted to, but your monastery was too cheap to provide proper weapons or training facilities. So instead, you learned to work with what you had, and harnessed earth, wind, water, and fire in subtle and not-so-subtle ways. Your understanding of the elements enables you to see how they both complement and work against each other, revealing the weaknesses of elemental beings and giving you knowledge of how best to defeat them.

- +2 Intelligence and Dexterity
- +3 Unarmed Combat Skill
- +1 Dirt Clod, Fire Fingers, and Frost Scar Spells
- +1 in all Spells with the Electric, Fire, and Ice damage types
- Advantage when attacking elemental creatures
- The ability to breathe underwater
- The ability to burrow
- The ability to fly

PRIZEFIGHTER

Class Type: Bard, Monk

Just like the galaxy loves a big, multi-floor battle royale death dungeon, they love watching two creatures beat the snot out of each other. Some do it for money, some do it for glory, but they all turn their faces into raw pulp for the crowd. The creatures in this audience don't care who is fighting who, as long as one of them ends up a crumpled, bloody heap on the mat before the night is done.

Prerequisite: This limited Class is only available to crawlers who have Rank 5+ in the Pugilism Skill

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- +5 Constitution
- +2 Strength
- −2 Intelligence and Charisma
- +5 Pugilism and Iron Punch Skills
- 1 × Floor Number gold for every Mob you kill with a Pugilism or Unarmed Combat Skill attack
- When you kill a foe with a Pugilism or Unarmed Combat Skill attack, +1 Popularity
- Pugilism Skill can be raised to Rank 20
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

SPIRIT HEALER

Class Type: Druid, Monk

Rather than focusing your knowledge of the body to harm, you use it to heal yourself and others through manipulating pressure points, lymph nodes, crystals, and any other health craze that was active when the World Dungeon opened. When pressured, you can also unleash your knowledge in practically painful ways on those who threaten you or your patients.

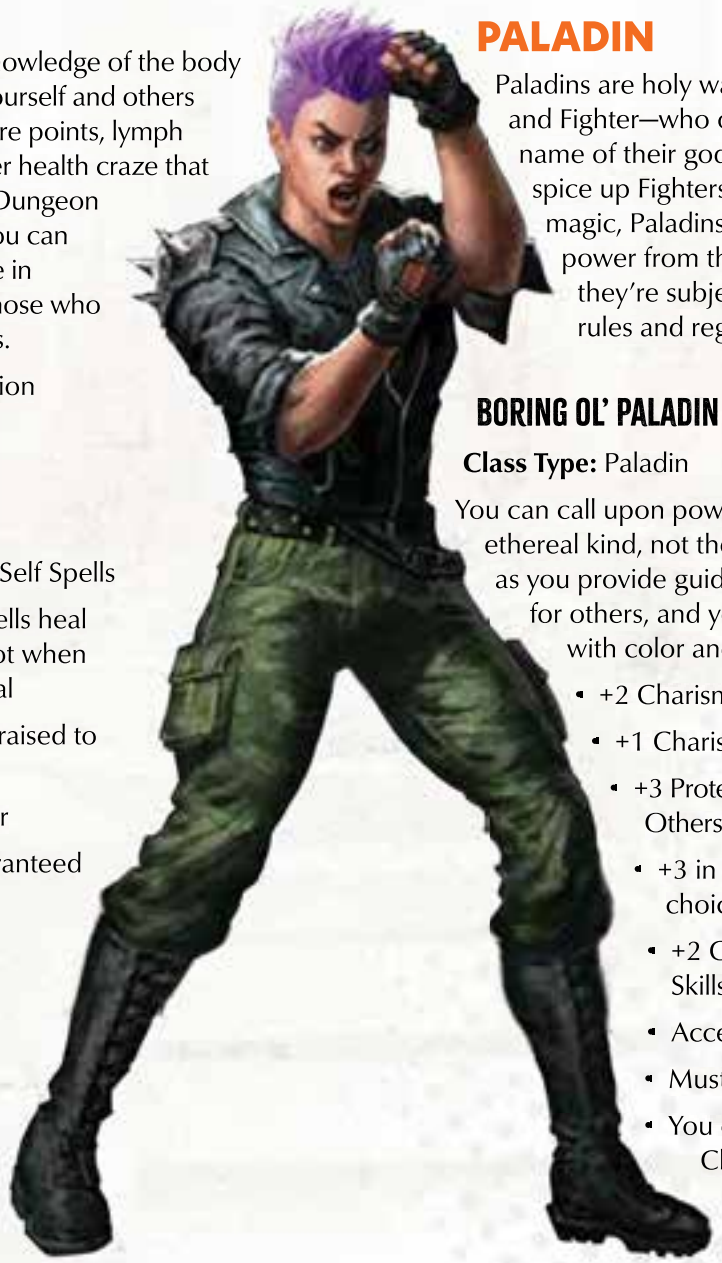
- +3 Strength and Constitution
- +1 Dexterity
- +3 Drain Life Spell
- +3 Smush Skill
- +2 Heal Others and Heal Self Spells
- Your healing Skills and Spells heal 1 additional Health Bar slot when targeting a single individual
- Heal Others Spell can be raised to Rank 20
- Access to Club Vanquisher
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

STREET MONK

Class Type: Fighter, Monk

You grew up on the streets, scraping by every day to survive. It was there that your gritty, unorthodox fighting style germinated, then took root and blossomed into a beautiful flower with petals shaped like kicking ass. You thrive in close-quarters fighting and can readily use the terrain around you for both offense and defense.

- +2 Dexterity
- +1 Strength and Charisma
- +2 Dirty Fighting Skill
- +2 Streetwise and Unarmed Combat Skills
- +1 Pugilism Skill
- +1 in Dexterity-based Weapon Skills
- +3 DR Buff
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Skill Potion



PALADIN

Paladins are holy warriors—a mix of Cleric and Fighter—who often do battle in the name of their god. While this does spice up Fighters by granting access to magic, Paladins draw much of their power from their god, which means they're subject to the same divine rules and regulations as Clerics.

BORING OL' PALADIN

Class Type: Paladin

You can call upon powerful spirits (the ethereal kind, not the drinking kind) for aid as you provide guidance and protection for others, and you manage to do it with color and flair!

- +2 Charisma
- +1 Charisma
- +3 Protective Shell, Heal Others, and Holy Aura Spells
- +3 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Catcher or Shield Block Skills
- Access to Club Vanquisher
- Must worship a deity
- You cannot choose this Class if you have access to the Desperado Club

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CAVALIER

Class Type: Fighter, Paladin

This classic mounted knight type is bound by a code the dungeon doesn't fully understand. They're a frontline duelist optimized for momentum, spectacle, and catastrophic commitment. Many mounts are fragile, but yours is a trained warhorse (or similar), and its armor (called "barding" if it's not natural armor) should help keep it alive for a while.

The code you follow is up to you. You might be the protector of the downtrodden, of the frail, of lower-Level crawlers, of an opposite (or the same?) sex, of pets, or the badly injured. Or you might sell your sword to the highest bidder so you can make some sweet coin and live the good life—what little of it you have left down here. Who am I to judge?

- +2 Strength and Constitution
- +2 Catcher, Riding, and Lance Skills
- +2 Shield and Smite Spells
- When protecting someone under your code by using Catcher, gain the benefit of Playing to the Cameras (no Disadvantage, as this is a Passive Skill). This counts as your "once per session" usage
- Gain a bonded Mount one size bigger than you with Move 40, barding with DR 10, a Trample attack, and a pet carrier for it
- When you or your Mount is the target of an Attack, your fancy riding allows you to redirect an attack at your Mount to yourself or vice versa
- Access to Club Vanquisher
- Must worship a deity

SACRED PALADIN

Class Type: Paladin

Piety is not a choice: it's a calling. You are pure and noble, a valiant protector of the innocent and avenger of the wronged. You can fight the good fight, heal the sick, and provide solace to the dying. Yeah, you're *that* guy in the party—the one who won't let anyone have any fun in this godforsaken dungeon.

- +3 Strength
- +2 Charisma
- +2 Catcher Skill
- +2 in a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Heal Others, Smite, and Turn Undead Spells
- Access to the Dungeon Book of the Floor club (Favored: Cleric or Paladin Spells only)
- +2 DR Buff
- Access to Club Vanquisher
- Must worship a deity
- You cannot choose this Class if you have access to the Desperado Club

ROGUE

The cloaked figure moving through the shadows, the knife in the dark, and the nimble hands disarming a trap before it blows your head into a fine red paste. These are all the hallmarks of a Rogue, one of the most useful teammates to have in the World Dungeon—as long as they don't get too greedy and decide you're worth more dead than alive.

BORING OL' ROGUE

Class Type: Rogue

Thieves. Assassins. Black market merchants. Rogues come in all sizes and flavors, but the one thing they have in common is their love of money. Maybe money can't buy you love, but it sure makes for a good time in the Desperado Club.

Lookin' at you, Author Steve Rowland.

- +1 Intelligence, Dexterity, and Charisma
- +3 Stealth Skill
- +2 Dagger, Detect Trap, Dodge, and Lockpicking Skills
- +1 Ambush Skill
- Can see in total darkness
- 1 x Floor Number gold for every Mob killed with a melee weapon
- Access to the Desperado Club
- Cannot choose this Class if you have access to Club Vanquisher

BOMB SQUAD TECH

Class Type: Rogue

People who actually choose to work with explosives are the craziest bastards around. You excel at making things blow up. And while you're good at keeping the bombs from going off in your own hands, Bomb Squad Techs still tend to lose both friends and limbs at alarming rates.

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Luckily, this Class comes with a benefit that can fix 50% of that problem.

Prerequisite: This limited Class is only available to crawlers who've earned the Boom! Achievement

- +2 Dexterity
- +1 Constitution
- −2 Intelligence (After all, only dumbasses would choose to do this for a living.)
- +3 Bomb Surgeon and Find Trap Skills
- +2 in all Explosive-based Skills
- +1 DR Buff
- Limb Regeneration Benefit: In 12 days minus your Con Mod, one limb fully regrows
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

COMPENSATED ANARCHIST

Class Type: Monk, Rogue

When the oligarchs want to manufacture a social movement, or better yet, stop one in its tracks, they must first bring in the big guns. The paid protestors. The Agent Provocateur. This Monk/Rogue hybrid Class is a trapmaking, bomb-making, social-media dynamo.

The Compensated Anarchist will happily throw a Molotov through a window one moment and step in front of a camera to plead for the violence to stop the next. Experts in hand-to-hand and dirty tactics, the Compensated Anarchist only suffers in more traditional fighting techniques.

A recent balance patch has adjusted this Class's values, but those who want to follow in Carl's bare, delightful footsteps can still benefit from this Class's wide array of bonuses.

Prerequisites: This limited Class is only available to crawlers who have Popularity 3 or higher and have Rank 5+ in the Explosives Handling Skill

- + 5 Charisma
- +1 Intelligence
- +2 Backfire, Escape Plan, and Find Trap Skills
- +1 Bomb Surgeon, Hide in Shadows, Trap Engineer, and Unarmed Combat Skills
- +1 Fear Spell
- Add no Stat Mod bonus damage when using Edged Weapons
- You pay +3 Mana to cast damage-dealing Spells
- At the end of each floor, add 1 to one of your trap-related Skill Advancement Checks
- At the end of each floor, add 1 to one of your bomb-related Skill Advancement Checks
- Access to the Desperado Club
- Access to the Naughty Boys Employment Agency
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

HIGH RISE GRIFTER

Class Type: Rogue

Pickpocketing marks in the park is nothing compared to making a big score, like ripping off a techbro high up in his tower, but with higher rewards come higher stakes. Only through meticulous planning and cunning execution can you hope to come out of your nefarious plots unscathed. Even then, you still need to assemble the right crew and acquire the right equipment. And after that job is complete, it's on to the next one!

- +1 Intelligence and Charisma
- +4 Deception and Stealth Skills
- +2 Dagger and Escape Plan Skills
- +1 Determine Value and Negotiation Skills
- Access to the Desperado Club
- Cannot choose this Class if you have access to Club Vanquisher
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

IDENTITY THIEF

Class Type: Rogue

Direct confrontation isn't your style. Instead, you make your living through guile and deception, adopting the role of a rich noble, a trusted merchant, or a long-estranged relative to work your way into wealthy families and organizations where you can pilfer treasures and escape unawares. When it works, it's great. When it doesn't... well, as long as your legs still work, you can always run away, right?

- +4 Charisma
- +3 Dexterity
- +5 Deception Skill
- +3 Dagger Skill
- +2 Investigation Skill

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- Tier 3 Makeup Table
- Access to the Desperado Club
- Cannot choose this Class if you have access to Club Vanquisher
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Potion

SWASHBUCKLER

Class Type: Bard, Fighter, Rogue

You are daring and flamboyant, combining your exceptional swordsmanship and acrobatic agility with irresistible charm to win the hearts and purses of others. Your motivation may vary—perhaps someone killed your father when you were young, or your true love was lost to you while you were indentured at sea. Regardless, your tenacity and tenor have made you a foe to be reckoned with, while your charming wit and dashing style have generated a cult-like following. Even in the most inconceivable of circumstances, you can virtually do as you wish, with few dread repercussions.

- +3 Dexterity and Charisma
- +3 Rapier or Longsword Skill
- +2 Balance and Dodge Skills
- +1 Performance Skill
- +1 Light on Your Feet Skill
- Rapier or Longsword Skill can be raised to Rank 20
- You have Advantage when using a melee attack from a higher position than your opponent
- Once per combat, after you kill an enemy, you can make an Unopposed Performance Skill Check. On an Amazing Success or better, gain +1 Popularity

THE RACE & CLASS POINT BUILD SYSTEM

Didn't see an option you liked? We've got good news for you picky and persnickety types: Players can simulate the thousands of options offered to their crawler by creating an entirely new Race or Class. Using the Build system, you can choose from the menu below to create your custom crawler. You have **25 Race Build Points** and **30 Class Build Points** to purchase specific abilities, and you can optionally select drawbacks to gain more Build Points to spend. Any leftover Build Points are lost, so get out there and spend, spend, spend!

Note: Race and Class Build Points are different pools. You can't save some Race Build Points to spend on Class options or vice versa.

STEP ONE: IMAGINING THE RACE OR CLASS

The first step is to imagine the unique creation you're bringing into the World Dungeon. Once you've got a clear idea, take deep breaths and push, just like in Lamaze class.

A NEW RACE

Is this new Race a fantasy-style Race, a Race based on Earth myths or lore, or something truly unusual to fit the off-the-wall nature of the World Dungeon?

After you've got a clear picture, determine if they're from Earth—including Earth folklore, mythology, and legend—or if they're an alien entity entirely! Alien Races receive unique ways to gain popularity because they've got planets of fans who want to see the crawler represent them in the most popular program in the galaxy, but don't get access to Earth Classes. Earth Races, on the other hand, get a sweet, sweet Silver Earth Box, which is guaranteed to contain a mostly-useless Earth Hobby Potion, which grants 3 Ranks in a Skill, and access to Earth Classes.

A NEW CLASS

Based on the Race you've selected and your experiences on the Tutorial Floors, you should consider the theme for the Class you want to design. In the Dungeon Crawler Carl books, the Classes are a crazy mash-up of modern pop-culture memes and traditional fantasy tropes. Feel free to come up with themes for Classes from out in left field—it's bound to be available in the dungeon!

STEP TWO: BENEFITS

Peruse the menu below and spend Build Points to give mechanical benefits to the Race or Class you've imagined. These benefits are ranked by general usefulness and power. They're just examples, and players are encouraged to come up with original benefits and discuss them with the GM. Characteristics that don't provide any mechanical benefits are free, such as a strange skin color, emitting an unusual smell, or having an odd voice.

Some Skill bonuses apply to thematically linked groups of Skills. The cost of such bonuses depends on the size of the group of Skills (4 or 6 points).

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Thematically linked Skills include those that all use the same Stat, movement-related Skills, all Skills of a particular weapon type, or another definition that makes sense. Passive Skills, Spells in general, and Racial Skills are not thematically linked.

You can take the same benefit multiple times, if that affects anything. For example, Stat and Skill bonuses obviously work, but two instances of Resistance to Slashing damage do nothing more than one instance of it (Resistances are fixed at "half damage").

The following menu provides Build Point costs for most examples in the Races and Classes above, plus many common effects. Keep in mind that this menu is an example of what's possible with Races and guidance for balancing what a Build Point is worth when assembling your custom creations.

MINOR BENEFITS (1 BUILD POINT EACH)

- +1 to a Stat
- Membership in Club Desperado or Club Vanquisher
- At the end of each floor, add 1 to your Skill Advancement Checks for a particular Skill
- Allow a specific Skill to be raised to Rank 20
- Add your Stat Mod a second time when using a specific non-combat Skill in a common circumstance
- A benefit that has a condition, such as gaining Advantage when attacking stone creatures
- Can see in total darkness or has a natural ability to produce light
- Double Mana regeneration from mending and resting in a specific environment
- You can see twice as far as most creatures
- A tier-1 crafting table (as soon as you acquire a personal space, it shows up there)
- A free room in saferooms
- Discount at stores, bonus earned from sales or interest earned (+1 for each category)
- Gain a non-combat benefit once per session under very specific conditions

MODERATE BENEFITS (2 BUILD POINTS EACH)

- +1 in a Skill or Spell, including Passive ones (you cannot have more than 5 points of Passive Skills in any Class build)
- Ability to heal 1 Health Bar slot when you damage or kill a creature with a specific Weapon Skill or Spell, up to 5 Health Bar per combat scene
- Add your Stat Mod a second time when making an attack in a common circumstance
- Roll with Advantage when making Skill Advancement Checks for a particular Skill
- At the end of each floor, add 1 to your Skill Advancement Checks for a particular group of thematically linked Skills
- At the start of combat, you can change your damage to a different type for that combat
- +1 DR Buff (to a limit of +3)
- Can access any guild of a particular type (for example, any Weapon Training Guild)
- Double Mana regeneration from mending and resting without a limit
- Membership in all professional and social clubs
- Membership in the Dungeon Book of the Floor Club
- Can raise a thematically linked group of Skills to Rank 20
- Mobs drop 1 × Floor Number gold when you kill them with a specific attack
- Ability to gain Popularity with specific actions and attacks
- Patron Benefit
- Resistance to an uncommon damage type (Force, Psychic, Necrotic, etc.)
- Resistance to damage dealt by the environment (Falling, Drowning, dungeon traps, etc.)
- Replace a Stat used in an ability with another Stat (normally, one that receives a Stat bonus), such as the ability to apply Charisma to Intimidate instead of Strength
- A Stat Mod from another ability be used in addition to the normal Mod for specific Skills
- Can use skills designed for one type of weapon on another type of weapon
- When you use a Healing-type Spell, the target heals 1 additional Health Bar
- The ability to traverse certain terrain types without Skill Checks
- The ability to burrow
- The ability to breathe underwater

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- +1 in all Skills for a temporary duration that's an hour or less
- A natural attack at [Rank = Floor Number] that deals 1d6 + Stat Mod damage. Choose the Stat Mod to hit and damage (and damage type). Add another d6 at Rank 5, 10, and 15. Rank only increases by Floor
- The ability to reassign a Race or Class's Stat point benefits once per floor during a Long Rest

MAJOR BENEFITS (3 BUILD POINTS EACH)

- Access to significant assistance, akin to the Manager benefit
- Gain a friendly Pet or a Mount
- Ability to provide a significant Buff or Benefit up to 4 Points to all of your Pets or Mounts
- An ability to dramatically alter an encounter once a day, such as by making enemies attack each other
- A defensive ability usable once per day, such as negating all damage you take from a single attack
- The ability to Buff the entire party once per day, such as granting them regeneration or extra DR
- The ability to fly, with some limitations
- The ability to survive without breathing, which also gives Immunity to inhaled toxins
- Rage (Benefit): Your melee attacks deal +1 damage for each Health Bar slot you have lost
- Size 2 (Small) or less
- +5ft Move (this increases the crawler's Move value)
- +5 Step (this increases the crawler's Step value)
- Add 1d4 to your Evade or Stat Checks for a specific Stat
- A natural attack at [Rank = Floor Number] that deals 1d8 + Stat Mod damage. Choose the Stat Mod to hit and damage (and damage type). Add another d8 at Rank 5, 10, and 15. Rank only increases by Floor
- Advantage when using a specific non-combat Skill or Spell
- Situational bonus of up to ×2 damage for one round
- Swap Con for determining Health Bar values with another Stat
- Gain a Climb Movement, which allows you to automatically climb most surfaces, even ceilings

EXTREME BENEFITS (4 BUILD POINTS EACH)

- +1 in a Skill that you wouldn't normally be able to learn, such as Cockroach and Light on Your Feet
- +1 to all Skills in a thematically linked group of 3–5 Skills (Hand-to-Hand Skills, Constitution-based Skills, etc.)
- Advantage on all Stat Checks for a specific Stat
- All Skills in a thematically linked group of up to 6 Skills can be raised to Rank 20
- Immunity to Poison
- Resistance to a common damage type (Bludgeoning, Fire)
- Double the duration of your Rank 5 and lower Spells that have a duration
- Advantage on all Skills in a limited non-combat situation
- Additional functional arm
- Doppelgänger shape-changing

EPIC BENEFITS (6 BUILD POINTS EACH)

- +1 to all Skills in a thematically linked group of Skills (Ranged Weapons, Intelligence-based Skills, etc.)
- All Skills can be raised to Rank 20
- A significant defensive ability, such as Immunity to a common damage type (like Bludgeoning, Fire or Piercing) or halving the damage of the first nine attacks against you each day
- The Limb Regeneration Benefit
- Roll with Advantage on all Skills in a wide-ranging set of circumstances
- Immunity to Poison and all diseases
- +1 in all Skills in a thematically linked group of 6+ Skills (Ranged Weapons, Intelligence-based Skills, etc.)
- A significant defensive ability, such as Advantage on Evade Checks, or Immunity to a common type of damage (Fire, Bludgeoning, etc.)
- A powerful and flexible ability that can significantly change your Stats or Skills, such as a Changeling's ability to assume another Race's Stat or Skill bonuses
- Changeling shapeshifting
- Roll with Advantage on all Skill Checks for a specific Stat
- The ability to fly with no limitations

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STEP THREE (OPTIONAL): DETRIMENTS

You can take mechanical disadvantages to your Class—called detriments—giving you more Build Points to spend on benefits. You don't have to take any drawbacks to your Class if you don't want to, since the system AI is likely to put you into positions where your drawbacks make your life difficult. **You cannot gain more than 5 extra Build Points via detriments for your Race or Class, for a total of 10 by taking the maximum 5 detriments for both Race and Class.**

STAT DETRIMENTS

You earn Build Points by assigning penalties to your stats. You gain 1 extra Build Point for every 2 points of penalties to one or more stats. For example, a Class with −1 to Intelligence and −3 to Dexterity earns 2 extra Build Points to spend.

SKILL DETRIMENTS

You can also earn Build Points by assigning penalties to your current Skills. You cannot create penalties for Skills you don't have, nor can you take a penalty larger than your current Rank in that Skill. You gain 1 extra Build Point for every 2 points of penalties you take to one or more Skills. You can also take a penalty to all Skills under a single Stat, such as "all Charisma Skills," gaining 1 extra Build Point for every −1 penalty you take.

MINOR DETRIMENTS (1 EXTRA BUILD POINT)

- Cannot choose Class due to membership in a specific club
- For every −2 worth of Stat detriments
- For every −2 worth of Skill detriments
- For every −1 to all Skills under a specific Stat
- +1 Mana cost to cast spells not favored by your Class
- Disadvantage when using a thematically linked group of Skills, when there is a condition (such as Disadvantage in all social Skills used against a certain category of creatures)
- Must worship a deity
- Cannot worship a deity
- You suffer a −1 penalty when making Skill Advancement Checks for a specific Skill provided by your Race or Class at Rank 5+
- Vulnerability: An uncommon damage type (such as Force or Necrotic) deals double damage to you
- You halve the effects of a broad type of damage, such as all Weapon damage or all Spell damage, that isn't the focus of your Class (such as halving Spell damage if you are a Barbarian)
- A weakness that has two conditions, such as Disadvantage in social situations when dealing with Fairies
- Delay a bonus to after Level 50 or activating on the 6th Floor

MODERATE DETRIMENTS (2 EXTRA BUILD POINTS)

- A weakness with a single broad condition, such as Disadvantage in all social situations
- Skill only increases in Rank upon descent to the next floor
- Limited choice of weapons available to choose from
- No Stat Mod added to Weapon Skill provided by your Race or Class
- +3 Mana cost to a Class of spells provided by your Race or Class
- Disadvantage when using a thematically linked group of Skills, such as all movement-related Skills
- Prohibited from using a wide category of useful items, such as an inability to use certain types of Weapons or to cast Passive Spells

MAJOR DETRIMENTS (3 EXTRA BUILD POINTS)

- A specific Stat is capped at 10. Even magic gear and potions cannot exceed this limit
- Vulnerability: A common damage type (such as Bludgeoning or Piercing) deals double damage to you

CREATING A CLASS EXAMPLE

Bob and all the other players in his game have reached the Third Floor, but none of the Classes fit what Bob wants to play: the Dungeon Dad[❁], who looks after the rest of the party.

Now that Bob's got a concept in mind, he starts talking to his Game Master about it. After a short discussion, they agree this should be an Earth Class that includes an Earth Hobby Potion. Bob looks through the menu and picks the qualities most important to his vision of the Class:

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- **Grill Dad:** There isn't a grilling Skill, but Crocodilian gets a bonus after eating that fits what he wants to do pretty well. Since it's a party buff, Bob and his GM decide that, since it's a Buff for the entire party that'll happen 3–4 times a day, it should be an Extreme Benefit worth 4 Build Points
- **Protective Dad:** There are a few ways to do this based on Skills and Spells, so Bob checks out the Catcher, Taunt, and Shield Block Skills, plus the Hot Stuff Aura and Shield Spells. The Shield Spell only protects his crawler, so that's out, and so is the Shield Block Skill. Bob decides to put 3 Ranks into Catcher for 6 Build Points. He also decides that means he's going to need a weapon, so he puts 4 Build Points into 2 Ranks of a Weapon of his choice
- **Helpful Advice Dad:** Bob takes 2 Ranks in the Tactics Skill (since his crawler tends to keep the group together) for 4 Build Points. Bob also talks to his GM about a way to make his crawler better at helping others, such as adding a +1d4 bonus to others when taking the Help or Intervene Action. They look at the menu and see "Add 1d4 to your Evade or Stat Checks for a specific Stat" as a Major Benefit. Since this bonus die requires Bob's crawler to take an Action and it's limited compared to the always-on +1d4 bonus on the menu, they decide it's worth 2 Build Points
- **Awful Jokes Dad:** Bob loves making terrible, groan-inducing puns and worse jokes during play, so this comes naturally. First, he considers putting points into the Good First Impression Skill, but the rest of the players tell him that his awful jokes definitely don't fit there. Rather than a Skill, Bob decides to put his points into his Charisma Stat bonus
- **Fix-It Dad:** Bob decides on this one easily and adds 2 Ranks to the Repair Skill, spending another 4 Build Points
- **DILF:** Bob's got some points left over and a good Charisma score, so he decides to put 4 Build Points into the Hot Stuff Aura Spell, gaining 2 Ranks and hitting the cap of 5 Ranks of Passive Skills for his Class Build

Bob reviews his choices and sees that he's spent 24 of his 30 Class Build Points. He decides to put 2 Build Points into +1 DR, and the remaining 4 Build Points in Stat Points: +2 Charisma, +1 Strength, and +1 Constitution. With 30 Build Points spent, he considers Drawbacks and decides that the Dungeon Dad[☸] is pretty clumsy, suffering −2 Dex, and that Dads may be experienced, but they feel their age—and Necrotic damage makes the most sense for age-related injury, so he takes Vulnerability: Necrotic damage. These net him 2 extra Build Points, which he decides to put into an extra point of DR.

At the end, Bob and his GM decide that the Dungeon Dad's[☸] types are Fighter because of the Catcher and Weapon Skills, and Bard because of the advice and food buffs. Bob's final Class looks like this:

DUNGEON DAD

Class Type: Bard, Fighter

Once a little league coach, you've watched much of life pass you by, but you're determined to protect and guide the youth—even if they're a group of 20- to 30-somethings who should have learned basics like reading warnings, how to share, and talk about their feelings without being an asshole before now. Well, you're here to make sure they learn by teaching them the lessons the world never did and doing your damnedest to keep them alive.

- +2 Charisma
- +1 Strength and Constitution
- −2 Dexterity
- +3 Catcher Skill
- +2 Repair and Tactics Skills
- +2 to a Weapon Skill of your choice
- +2 Hot Stuff Aura Spell
- +2 DR
- When you and up to 6 allies consume a meal you cooked (taking at least 30 minutes to cook), each eater gains +1 Buff for all of their Skill Checks for 1 hour
- You roll a bonus 1d4 when you make the Help or Intervene Actions and add it to the benefit provided to your target
- Vulnerability: Necrotic damage
- Silver Earth Box, with guaranteed Earth Hobby Skill Potion

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DEITIES & WORSHIP

Worshiping a god in the World Dungeon doesn't necessarily mean a crawler is devoted to them in any meaningful or religious way. Like most elements of the dungeon and the "real" world, worship is pragmatic and highly sensationalized to spur viewership.

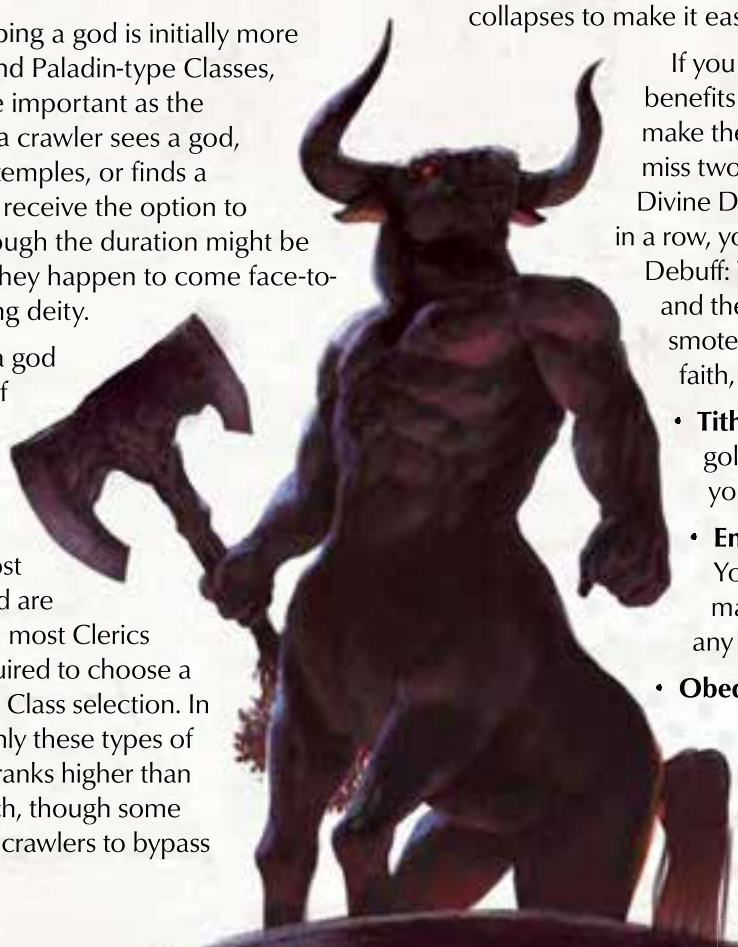
For most crawlers, to "worship" a god merely means carrying out required acts of daily devotion and paying tithes or tributes. The historical record of the gods in the dungeon would lead one to believe they are all-powerful and all-knowing, but in reality, most of them are limited, with humanlike intelligence, emotions, and motives. Just take a look at their family tree—everyone seems related to everyone, if you know what I mean.

What's more, gods can be sponsored by entities outside the dungeon and forced to do their bidding, including interacting and communicating with crawlers. While some of this is heavily restricted to avoid undue disruption to the crawl, this interference can still make crawlers' lives a living hell.

CONSEQUENCES OF WORSHIP

For crawlers, worshiping a god is initially more relevant for Cleric- and Paladin-type Classes, but it becomes more important as the Crawl progresses. If a crawler sees a god, locates one of their temples, or finds a scroll of prayer, they receive the option to worship the god, though the duration might be extremely limited if they happen to come face-to-face with a rampaging deity.

While worshiping a god may grant a variety of benefits, it also comes with distinct drawbacks. Many Game Guides warn their charges that most gods are assholes and are best avoided, though most Clerics and Paladins are required to choose a god to worship upon Class selection. In addition, generally only these types of Classes can achieve ranks higher than Devotee in the church, though some rare items may allow crawlers to bypass this restriction.



The bad stuff (and occasionally good stuff) a deity does for you is hidden in Chapter 6. That's for the GM, so peek at your own risk.

RANKINGS IN THE CHURCH

Those who choose to worship a god begin as Acolytes (Tier 1). Significant acts of devotion may increase their title to Devotee (Tier 2), and for select followers, even the title of Zealot (Tier 3). A ranking's Tier occasionally has rules benefits.

ACOLYTE (TIER 1)

Worshiping a deity earns you this title, bringing both expectations and benefits:

- **Respect other Worshipers:** You mustn't cause harm to fellow worshipers of your god—even if they're sycophants or jerks
- **Offering:** You must make the specified offering at a temple of your god at least once a day. If you are unable to locate a temple within a 30-hour period, you must make the offering at the god's shrine that has now appeared in your personal space. You don't have to act happy about it, though. (Note: GMs might agree to a number of offerings per Floor equal to the number of days before the floor collapses to make it easier to track.)

  If you miss a day, you lose all the benefits that worship grants until you make the offering the next day. If you miss two days in a row, you gain a Divine Debuff. If you miss three days in a row, you gain the Fallen from Grace Debuff: You can't worship any deities, and there's a 50% chance of being smote. If you voluntarily leave the faith, you are smote.
- **Tithe:** Five percent of all looted gold must also be tossed into your god's shrine
- **Enemy God's Prohibition:** You may not own or wield any magical gear that is blessed by any rival(s) of your god
- **Obedience:** You must successfully complete all issued church quests

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- **Temple Access:** You gain access to all temples of your deity
- **Temple Locations:** All temples of your deity now appear on your map. All temples of your deity's rival(s) also appear on your map
- **Identification:** All worshipers of your deity are indicated with a symbol. All worshipers of your deity's rival(s) are also indicated with a different symbol
- **Death to the Infidels:** Once per Floor when you kill an NPC, crawler, or Mob that worships your deity's rival(s), you gain an additional Level. Once per Floor, if you grind for experience in a neighborhood where the Mobs worship your deity's rival(s), you also gain a Level
- **Vanquisher:** You gain free access to Club Vanquisher, regardless of previous and current affiliations
- **Rewards for Devotion:** Every five consecutive days of worship (making tithes and daily offerings), you will receive a Boon from the god

DEVOTEE (TIER 2)

Especially devoted worshipers can achieve the title of Devotee. This is the highest ranking that a non-Cleric or non-Paladin can achieve.

- **Upgraded Benefits:** You receive several upgraded benefits from your god. These benefits vary depending on the deity you worship
- **Increased Tithe:** Your required tithe amount increases from 5% to 10%, effective immediately

ZEALOT (TIER 3)

For those who have chosen more religious Classes, such as Clerics or Paladins, exceptional devotion to your god grants even higher benefits.

- **Skill Maximum:** You can choose one of your god's signature Skills and advance it to Rank 16
- **Signature Stat:** You gain 5 points in your god's signature Stat
- **Increased Tithe:** Your required tithe increases from 10% to 20%, effective immediately

DEITIES

There are many deities in the Crawl, including some based on Earth gods. The following are examples of deities a crawler could worship.

APITO, THE BLESSED OAK MOTHER, THE MOTHER OF ALL GODS

Daughter of Nekhebit, mother of Emberus, Eris, Grull, Hellik, and Taranis, wife of Taranis, and sibling of Scolopendra. In order to maintain the path to heaven, Apito's angels must remain free and alive, and she will destroy worlds if violence against them is not stopped.

Temple: Sacred Grove of the Divine

High Supreme Cleric: Arkangel Debadora

Daily Offering: A single tear shed in sadness

Rival: Nekhebit

Likely Sponsor: The Dream

Signature Skills: Catcher, Shield Spell

Signature Stat: Intelligence

Symbol: Wooden face of a beautiful woman, with green hair shaped like leaves and tree branches cascading down her neck

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

- When using the Catcher Skill, gain additional DR equal to your Tier of Devotion
- Double INT Mod for one Skill Check, once per day

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to the Blood Trail Debuff
- Double INT Mod to all Skill Checks for 10 minutes, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Rank 10 Catcher Skill. If already at Rank 10 or higher, +2 Catcher Skill
- Double INT Mod to all Skill Checks during a 4-hour period, once per day
- Gain Rank 20 Catcher Skill for one use per day

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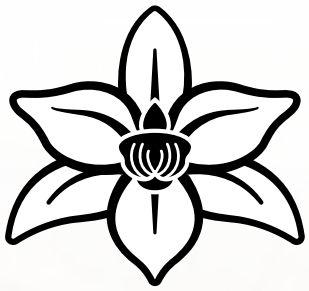

EILEITHYIA, GODDESS OF CHILDBIRTH AND FEMALE PAIN

Eileithyia is unlike most deities; she is benevolent and known for her kind heart. All mothers pray to her, both when they're sowing seeds and when the harvest comes. She represents both the physical pain of childbirth and the inevitable darkness that comes to those who are unable to complete this most sacred task. She's not known to seek the Ascendant Throne.

Temple: The Temple of Spring Dawn

High Supreme Cleric: Dhalia Ophal

Daily Offering: A petal from a blooming flower

Opposed To: Grull

Likely Sponsor: Huanxin Jinx

Signature Skills: Wisp Armor Spell, Heal Other Spell

Signature Stat: Constitution

Symbol: A blooming flower

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

- Advantage on Stat Checks against Spiritual Possession
- Double Con Mod to Health Bars for one attack, once per day

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to the Poisoned Debuff
- Double Con Mod to Health Bars for one combat, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Rank 10 Heal Other Spell. If already at Rank 10 or higher, +2 Heal Other Spell
- Double Con Mod to Health Bars for a 4-hour period, once per day
- Gain Rank 20 Wisp Armor Spell once per day

EMBERUS, GOD OF SUN AND ASH

The sun god and brother to Taranis and Hellik, Emberus was once known to pursue justice with indifference to suffering, but now he seems to simply punish those he dislikes on a whim. A strong contender for the throne in the Celestial Ascendancy, he suspects his brother, Hellik, is responsible for the death of his beloved son Geyrun.

Temple: High Temple of the Ending Sun

High Supreme Cleric: Pater Coal

Daily Offering: A single drop of blood

Rival: Hellik

Likely Sponsor: Lemig Sortion

Signature Skills: Morning Star (Club) Skill, Fire Fingers Spell

Signature Stat: Constitution

Symbol: A circular sun disk with triangular rays

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

- Resistance to Fire damage
- Double Con Mod to Health Bars for one attack, once per day

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to the Burned Debuff
- Double Str Mod to all attacks made in a single combat, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Immunity to Fire damage
- Resistance to Sheol Fire damage (which is not standard Fire damage)
- Gain Rank 20 Fireball Spell once per day

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ERIS, GODDESS OF CHAOS

Goddess of Chaos. Half-sister of Taranis, mother to nobody, lover of parties, drinking, chaos—of course—and generally known as the Ascendancy's worst, most unapologetic gossip. If she were mortal and Human, she'd be called a wine aunt. She'd also have a rich, dead husband who died under mysterious circumstances.

Temple: Sanctum of Disharmonious Mayhem

High Supreme Cleric: Sybil Devereaux

Daily Offering: A secret never previously shared with anyone else

Rival: Oshun

Likely Sponsor: Helene Jbarska

Signature Skills: Deception Skill, Grand Illusion Spell

Signature Stat: Charisma

Symbol: A spinning five-sided coin

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

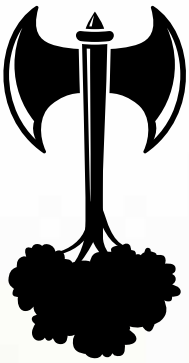
- Advantage on Deception Skill Checks
- Double Cha Mod to one Skill, once per day

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to Deception attempts
- Double Cha Mod to all Skill Checks for 10 minutes, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Rank 10 Deception Skill. If already at Rank 10 or higher, +2 Deception Skill
- Double Cha Mod to all Skill Checks during a 4-hour period, once per day
- Gain Rank 20 Deception Skill for one Check each day



GRULL, GOD OF WAR

Grull is the child of Taranis and Apito and is one of the few trueborn heirs to the Celestial Ascendancy. He has an angry streak as long as a horse's cock, making Taranis worry that his son may not be the best choice to rule the heavens. Plus, Grull's worshipers tend to be donkeys and other equine-themed creatures.

Temple: Grand Cathedral of Slaughter

High Supreme Cleric: Ferrus Shank

Daily Offering: A drop of blood (or blood equivalent) from a slain enemy

Rival: Eileithyia

Likely Sponsor: Skull Empire (in general) or Prince Maestro (specifically)

Signature Skills: Iron Punch Skill, Pugilism Skill

Signature Stat: Strength

Symbol: A double-headed axe with an oak tree for a handle

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

- Advantage on Checks versus Fear effects
- Double Str Mod to damage for one attack, once per day

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to Fear effects
- Double Str Mod to all attacks made in a single combat, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Rank 10 Intimidate Skill. If already at Rank 10 or higher, +2 Intimidate Skill
- Double Str Mod to all attacks made during a 4-hour period
- Gain Rank 20 Pugilism for one Attack per day

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HELLIK, GOD OF SUN AND LIFE

The twin brother of Emberus, the younger brother of Taranis, and the son of Apito. Hellik is allegedly "quite obsessed" with killing his brothers and is the most likely culprit in Geyrun's death, even though he was in council with Emberus when the murder happened and denies it. Instead, he seeks to work with Emberus to discover what happened to his son.

Temple: The Citadel of Light

High Supreme Cleric: Vas Vasterdame

Daily Offering: None required

Rival: Emberus

Likely Sponsor: Viceroys (The Madness) or Ripper Wonton

Signature Skills: Taunt Skill, Second Chance Spell

Signature Stat: Charisma

Symbol: A sun shining on a field of crops

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

- Advantage on Persuasion Skill Checks
- Double Cha Mod to one Skill, once per 30 hours

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to the Enraged Debuff
- Double Cha Mod to all Skill Checks for 10 minutes, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Rank 10 Taunt Skill. If already at Rank 10 or higher, +2 Taunt Skill
- Double Cha Mod to all Skill Checks during a 4-hour period, once per day
- Gain Rank 20 Second Chance Spell once per day

NEKHEBIT, SCAVENGER MOTHER GODDESS

Called the Scavenger Mother of Mothers, Nekhebit was a life and protector deity. Depicted as a vulture or scavenger, she cleaned up after the others. She supposedly wasn't allowed to have children, but had three kids anyway, including Apito. Nekhebit was the last of the old gods to fall, and she was defeated by her daughter Apito.

Temple: Temple of the Desert

High Supreme Cleric: The Desert Spector

Daily Offering: A cup of cold water

Rival: Apito

Likely Sponsor: Odette

Signature Skills: First Aid Skill, Salvage Skill

Signature Stat: Intelligence

Symbol: The bare head of a large vulture

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

- Advantage on First Aid Skill Checks
- Double Int Mod to one Skill, once per day

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to the Queasy Debuff
- Double Int Mod to all Skill Checks for 10 minutes, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Rank 10 First Aid Skill. If already at Rank 10 or higher, +2 First Aid Skill
- Double Int Mod to all Skill Checks during a 4-hour period, once per day
- Gain Rank 20 Salvage Skill for one Check per day

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OGUN, GOD OF BLACKSMITHERY AND ARMOR

Ogun is an outsider. He is one of the old gods, originally a member of an obscure pantheon that has since dissipated into time. He spends his days at his celestial anvil, angrily creating armor, piece after piece, but no one knows why he toils or what becomes of his armor when it's completed. It's said his creations have a strange shape, all designed for four-legged beasts.

Temple: The Eternal Forge

High Supreme Cleric: The Armorer

Daily Offering: A piece of steel

Rival: Legba

Likely Sponsor: The Dreadnoughts

Signature Skills: Warhammer Skill, Smithing Skill

Signature Stat: Strength

Symbol: A large blacksmith's hammer

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

- Advantage on Intimidation Skill Checks
- Double Str Mod to damage for one attack, once per day

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to the Take Down Debuff
- Double Str Mod to all attacks made in a single combat, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Rank 10 Smithing Skill. If already at Rank 10 or higher, +2 Smithing Skill
- Double Str Mod to all attacks made during a 4-hour period
- Gain Rank 20 Warhammer Skill for one Attack per day

TARANIS, GOD OF THUNDER

Brother to Hellik and Emberus, half-brother to Eris, husband to Apito, father to Grull, Yarilo, and many more. Together, Apito and Taranis held the first Butcher's Masquerade in the Halls of Ascendancy. Taranis is known to be hotheaded and fast to anger. He often falls short of his wife Apito's ever-rising star in the Ascendancy.

Temple: Holy Tower of the Gathering Rod

High Supreme Cleric: Emitt Lathrop

Daily Offering: A jolt of electricity

Rival: Emberus

Likely Sponsor: Monty Winter Jr

Signature Skills: Dodge Skill, Lightning Bolt Spell

Signature Stat: Dexterity

Symbol: A jagged, silver lightning bolt

Additional Acolyte Benefits:

- All Electric damage attacks deal +Floor damage
- Double Dex Mod to Evade Checks for one combat, once per day

Additional Devotee Benefits:

- Immunity to the Shocked Debuff
- Double Dex Mod to all Skill Checks for 10 minutes, once per day

Additional Zealot Benefits:

- Rank 5 Dodge Skill. If already at Rank 5 or higher, +2 Dodge Skill
- Double Dex Mod to all Skill Checks during a 4-hour period, once per day
- Gain Rank 20 Lightning Bolt Spell once per day

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CRAWLER ADVANCEMENT

You're gonna need to continuously get better in every aspect to survive. Stats increase constantly. Skills are easy to increase early on, but then they slow to a... crawl.

STAT INCREASES

When a crawler on the Third Floor or lower gains a Level, they also get 3 Stat points to assign as they choose among their five Stats. This increases both your Unenhanced and Enhanced Stats. The current Level limit is 250. Send letters to Mr. D if you think that cap should be removed.

If you arrived here from the Tutorial Floors, you can finally apply Stat increases based on the Levels you've gained. If you're Level 9, you gained 8 Levels. I bet you were hoping for 27 points to work with. Oh no, you only gained 8 Levels, smart guy. Do this before choosing your Race and Class, in case there are Stat value requirements.

After reaching the Third Floor, you'll need to find a saferoom to distribute your Stat points. You might level up several times before you find one, so just use a token, or write down how many Stat points you get to add when you finally get to a saferoom.

SKILL INCREASES

Leveling up doesn't increase your Skills. Instead, they are only raised via using, grinding, training them, or via potions, Races and Classes. You'll increase your Skill Ranks rapidly until they reach Rank 5, then things slow way down.

Note: Keep in mind the *Skill Rank Limits* (p. 129)

SKILL ADVANCEMENT

Most Skills improve through use. Each Skill on your character sheet has a box in the column on the far right that's labeled with a green checkmark. Whenever you attempt a Skill Check, whether you Succeed or Fail, mark the box if it isn't already marked.

Marked Skills are eligible for a Skill Advancement Check. To make the check, roll 1d20 against your current Skill Rank as the Difficulty. If the result is equal to or higher than your Skill's current Rank, you gain 1 Rank in the Skill, up to a maximum of 15.

As you gain more Ranks in a Skill, it takes longer to improve. At the intervals below, make a Skill Advancement Check for each Skill with a mark.

- If at Rank 4 or lower, roll a Skill Advancement Check at the end of every 2 hours of play
- If at Rank 5 or higher, roll a Skill Advancement Check at the end of each floor
- After resolving these rolls, erase all marks and start fresh
- Passive Skills don't require a Skill Check to use, and most of them don't receive Advancement marks when used. With a few exceptions, you can only increase Passive Skills via magical means or through Race or Class benefits
- Hand-to-hand Damage Effects advance separately from their associated Attack Skills. When you use a hand-to-hand attack and a Damage Effect, mark only one or the other, not both
- Whenever you gain Levels, simply record your new Level on your character sheet. Once you reach a saferoom, you'll get to increase your Stats and more!

EXPERIENCE POINTS

Many roleplaying games handle character advancement using experience points to represent a character's learning and path toward mastery. In the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** novels, the system does assign experience points, but their use is poorly understood even by veteran or retired crawlers. This algorithm is incredibly opaque by design, partly due to crawlers' repeated attempts to game the system and partly due to centuries of spaghetti code baked into the process.

The **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** doesn't use experience points at all because its designers are flesh-monkeys like you who quickly gave up trying to figure out Syndicate math. For simplicity's sake, crawlers gain Levels simply by playing the game. Life (or death) in the dungeon is tough enough as it is. Don't overcomplicate it.

Here are some basics:

Two-Hours: At the end of every 2 hours of play, each party member gains 1 Level.

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Quests: When a crawler or party completes a Quest, they gain at least 1 Level—more if the Quest took place across multiple floors. (Your GM will use discretion here.)

Crawler Killers: Killing other crawlers is a great way to earn extra Levels! Each time you kill a crawler, you gain 1d6 Levels modified by your Level difference. If you are a lower Level than your victim, add the difference in Levels to your result, up to a maximum of gaining 15 Levels from one kill! If you are equal or a higher Level than your victim, subtract the difference to a minimum of 1 Level gained.

Grinding: When crawlers grind to raise their Skill Ranks, they occasionally level up during the process, though it is slow.

Bosses: When a party kills a Boss, each member gains Levels based on the tier of the Boss. Your GM can modify the number if the assault was very easy or very hard. Whoever lands the killing blow often earns a higher quality loot box but not extra Levels.

- **Neighborhood Boss:** Gain 1 Level
- **Borough Boss:** Gain 2 Levels
- **City Boss:** Gain 3 Levels
- **Province Boss:** Gain 4 Levels
- **Country Boss:** Gain 5 Levels
- **Floor Boss:** Gain 6 Levels

GRINDING

The Grinding is not only the name of another fucked-up Matt Dinniman novel; here in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, it's also the act of continually brutalizing the lowest-Level Mobs you can find to increase your Skill Ranks and occasionally level up.

To grind, you must gain access to a large group of Mobs in a relatively small area or along a path to a destination. There is no risk to you during a typical grind, but there's also no time for looting Mob corpses. Instead of making individual Skill Checks during a grind session, it's treated like a montage as you spend time improving your Skills.

Grinding is measured in hours. Choose the number of hours you wish to grind. Crawlers typically go for up to 5 hours at a time, but seasoned crawlers can push for much longer. For every hour of grinding past 5 hours in a single day, you must make an Unopposed Endurance Skill Check to see if that hour was productive or not. On Fail, that hour was not productive for you (no grinding time accrued), and you gain the Fatigued Debuff (see *Debuffs*, p. 96).

Neighborhood Maps and Borough Field Guides make grinding more efficient, because crawlers can avoid lulls in the action. If you grind for 5 or more hours, you accrue 1 bonus hour to your grinding time if you have a Neighborhood Map or 2 bonus hours if you have a Borough Field Guide. This allows you to grind for 5 hours (the safe limit per day) but get credit for 6 hours with a Neighborhood Map and 7 hours with a Field Guide.

Crawlers declare how many hours they wish to grind. Then, if the GM wishes, they roll on the Grinding Tables in chapters 7, 8, or 9 (see *Montages and Grinding for Experience*, p. 259) to determine if anything affects the grind. The events on Grinding Tables represent events that could happen while grinding, including combats and unexpected delays. Grinding is supposed to represent a slice of life or montage scene, not grind play to a halt with extra combats against low-Level Mobs or sudden Boss Battles.

GRINDING SKILLS

At the end of the grind, choose any Skill (it doesn't have to be combat-related) to accrue the hours earned. Attempting to Advance a Skill requires accruing grinding hours equal to its current Rank, but these hours need not be continuous or happen on the same day. They may accumulate from one day or even one floor to the next, so keep track of your grinding hours on your character sheet, perhaps in the "Notes" section on your "Skills" list.

When you have accumulated grinding hours in a Skill equal to your current Rank in that Skill, immediately roll a Skill Advancement Check for that Skill. Any penalties from Debuffs (Fatigued is common) apply to this check.

If you roll equal to or higher than your current Skill Rank, you immediately gain 1 Rank in that Skill. Regardless of the result, you cannot grind the same Skill more than once per day, because too much grinding leaves you raw and chapped. Give it a rest!

If you've been grinding for more hours than needed for a particular Skill, apply any additional hours to another Skill (you can't bank hours for the same Skill). You may grind and track hours for multiple Skills at the same time if you wish.

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Example: If you grind for four hours, you can make a Skill Advancement Check for four Skills at Rank 1, two at Rank 2, or even one at Rank 3 and then apply the remaining hour to a Rank 2 Skill. Note that hour of progress on the Rank 2 Skill's "Notes" section.

LEVELING UP VIA GRINDING

While you grind for Skills, you progress toward leveling up as well. Keep a running total of all your grinding hours and erase it only when you level up. No, I'm not going to do it for you.

You gain a Level when you grind a number of hours equal to your current Level (6 hours to advance from Level 6 to 7, for example). The party member with the lowest Level gains 1d2 Levels when they level up this way. If there is a tie for lowest, no one rolls 1d2.

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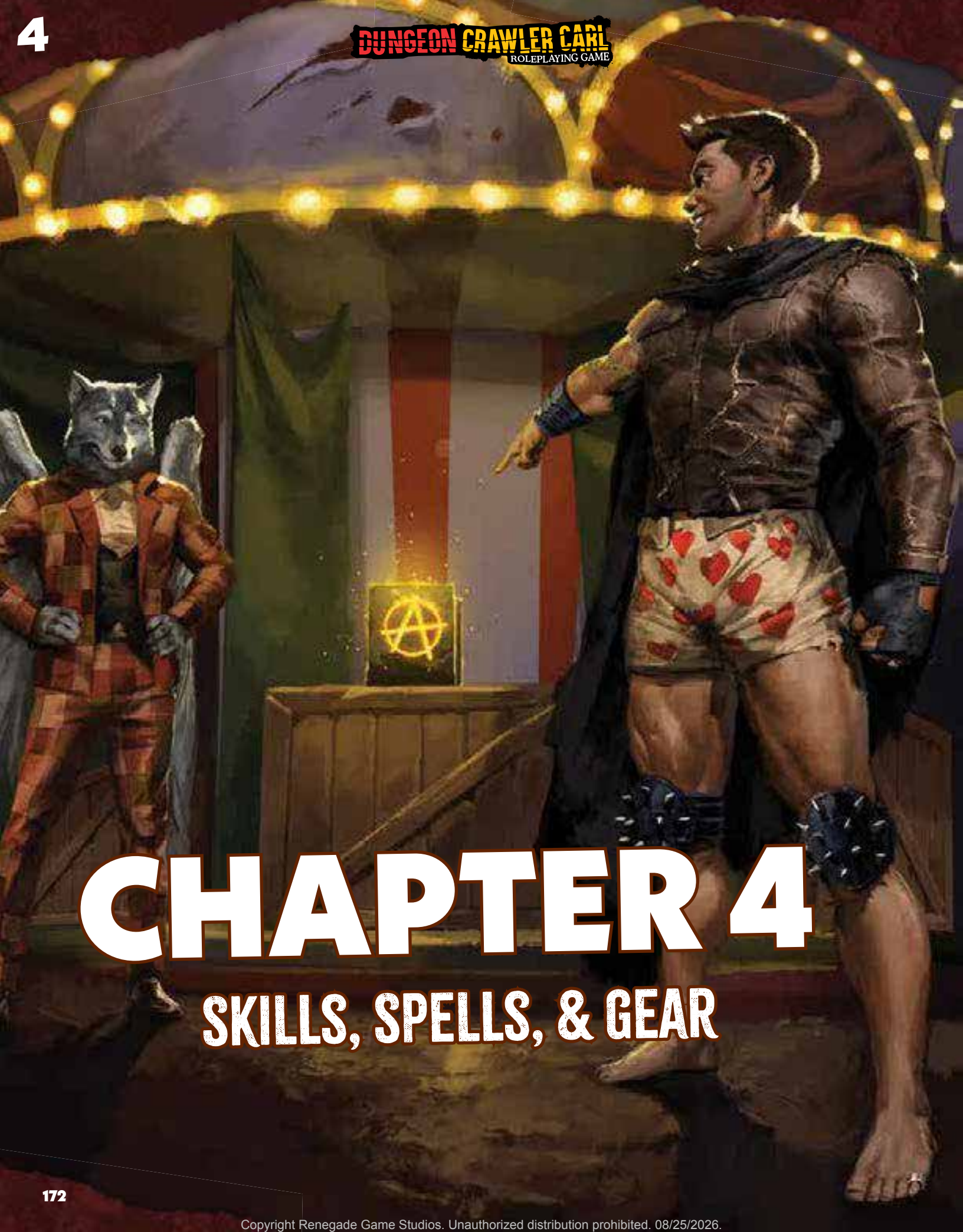

CHAPTER 4

SKILLS, SPELLS, & GEAR

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TO SURVIVE THE WORLD DUNGEON, CRAWLERS NEED TO COLLECT SKILLS, SPELLS, AND LOOT. SKILLS AND SPELLS DIRECTLY IMPACT A CRAWLER'S ABILITY TO FUNCTION IN THE DUNGEON, AND SAVVY CRAWLERS LOOK FOR WAYS TO KEEP IMPROVING THEM. LOOT TAKES THE FORM OF MONEY, MAGICAL AND MUNDANE EQUIPMENT, MISCELLANEOUS JUNK AND MATERIALS FOR CRAFTING, AND SOMETIMES YOU CAN EVEN FIND A PET OR A MOUNT. THIS CHAPTER COVERS ALL THE THINGS CRAWLERS CAN GAIN DURING THE CRAWL.

SKILLS

Skills are the heart of the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game***. You make Skill Checks to do most things and gain upgrades from ranking up Skills.

Each Skill entry follows a consistent format:

The header is the name that tells you exactly what it's called—hopefully something that sounds impressive when shouted aloud.

Under the header is a list of keywords identifying the Stat Mod you add to the Skill Check, if any, and any special traits tied to the Skill.

The description explains what the Skill actually does, which you should probably read before attempting it. On average, 35.71% of deaths in past Crawls are attributable to illiteracy. The description may contain additional keywords like "AI Favor" and "Limitations," which vary by the Skill type.

Finally, the entry teases you with upgrade benefits if you train it to higher Ranks, as if you need more incentive to avoid your leg being ripped off by a giant demon crab, only to wake up two floors later to discover it grew an eyeball and a mouth and is licking your face off in anger at being replaced by a prosthetic.

SKILL CHECKS

Skill Checks are either Opposed or Unopposed, depending on what you are up against (see p. 59). Roll 1d20, add your Skill's Rank, and add your associated Stat Mod. If the total matches or exceeds the Difficulty of the Check, the outcome is at least a Standard Success but could grant even better effects if you significantly exceed the Difficulty.

Your GM determines the Difficulty for a Check, so they're the one who needs to know the exact type of Skill Check you're making. They won't share the Difficulty with you but will only inform you of the outcome. Don't worry, System AIs don't cheat or lie; we always fully believe what we tell you.

But if you *must* know every detail (good for you, boring for viewers), Opposed Skills make Checks against a specific antagonist, and the Difficulty factors in their Stat Mod. Unopposed Skills make Checks against things that don't have a Stat block, like objects or the environment.

The Skill's description lists the effects of a Standard Success. Lots of results are possible other than a Standard Success (see *Degrees of Success and Failure*, p. 60). Know that I encourage GMs to get creative when narrating both Successes and Fails; the more spectacular the results (good or bad), the more the viewers can't turn away.

PASSIVE SKILLS

You don't make Skill Checks to gain the effects of Passive Skills. This makes them easy to use but hard to Rank-up; since you don't make a Skill Check, you can't mark it for a Skill Advancement Check (p. 169). Each Passive Skill entry describes how you can increase its Rank, typically requiring magic gear and training, though some feature other ways.

Using a Passive Skill typically requires an Action like any other Skill type. However, some trigger alongside other Skills at no extra Action cost, like Hand-to-Hand Damage Effects (see p. 180).

You can't use a Passive Skill if you have no Ranks in it (untrained). The easiest way to gain them is via a potion, scroll, or gear. They can also be found in some Race and Class benefits starting on the Third Floor.

SKILL UPGRADES

As Skills increase in Rank, they grant additional bonuses at Ranks 5, 10, and 15.

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Upgrades on Attack Skills typically add extra damage dice to the base effect damage, and these always apply even if other parts of the Upgrade are situational.

Where an Upgrade increases the range or duration, removes a limitation, or the like, the Upgrade overrides the base effect instead of being in addition to it. All other sorts of Upgrades get added together. Typically, these additive Upgrades use a plus sign (+) to help note this.

CREATING YOUR OWN SKILLS

The list of Skills in the World Dungeon is endless. Our artificial sky's the limit, folks! Here's the framework in which you can create any Skill you want. You'll need to use it if you come across a Skill or Spell marked with an gear asterisk (❁): that's the cue that it's a Custom Skill not found in this book.

The simplest way to customize a Skill is to reuse an existing Skill but reframe its narrative. A Skill like Dumpster Diving could just as easily become Search

CUSTOM SKILL EXAMPLES

Paolo wants his crawler, Eglantine, to use an aforementioned Crochet❁ Skill. But that's a bit on-the-nose, so he tries for something more imaginative and works with the GM to figure something out.

One idea is for Eglantine to be a wizard with knitting needles, so he invents the Needle❁ skill. The GM likes it because it's pretty clear that it's got a pretty limited scope but will still have a couple obvious uses. And custom skills don't need to be as broad or powerful as the ones presented below. For Upgrades, Paulo and the GM decide that Needle will mostly be used in combat, so they give it the standard weapon Rank 5 Upgrade. Then they add a Crafting Upgrade at Rank 10 and Dagger's Rank 15 Upgrade.

Needle❁

Dexterity

You have knack for using needles, whether making things or using them as weapons. Needle❁ covers any sort of needle use and possibly peripheral applications, such as metaphorically threading a needle (getting through a tight space), crafting fabric-based items, repairing a sail, or fighting with knitting needles.

Upgrades

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage

Rank 10: Pick a needlework specialty item. You roll with Advantage when creating your mundane specialty item.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and attacks targeting the back of a foe deal ×2 damage.

After creating Needle❁, Paolo isn't sure he wants to focus on attacks with needles. He tries again so he has a second option, this time focusing on the material. Yarn Wrangler❁ is a good option based on Fabricate and Ropework.

Yarn Wrangler❁

Dexterity

You have a knack for yarn and related materials. You can use this Skill to create or salvage yarn, tie people up, or even gain a cat's attention.

Upgrades

Rank 5: You can also use this skill as an Attack, with a 10ft range vs. the target's Evade. On Success, the target gains the Held Debuff.

Rank 10: Pick a yarn-craft specialty item. You roll with Advantage when creating your mundane specialty item.

Rank 15: The attack range is now your Strength value (min 15). Just make sure your yarn is long enough.

Paulo and the GM decide that both skills might work well for the character, but since the Rank 10 overlaps, Paulo might want to just pick one or redesign one of them. Another player mentioned they expected Yarn Wrangler❁ to deal with lassos, so Paolo has plenty of options to consider.

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COMBAT-FOCUSED EXAMPLE

Upon reaching the Third Floor, Paolo wants Eglantine to choose a Samurai-like Class. Taking some inspiration from video games and anime, he decides he wants a *Shinken Shirahadori* or Samurai Blade Clap[❁] Skill. It's totally unrealistic, but cool. Talking it over with the GM, they decide it's very narrowly useful, and probably hard to train up.

Samurai Blade Clap[❁]

Dexterity

You can catch blades with your bare hands. Or you'd better hope you can. Make a Samurai Blade Clap[❁] Skill Check when you're being attacked by an Edged melee weapon.

On Success, you avoid the damage and effects from the attack.

Upgrades

Rank 5: You can also use this Skill against Ranged weapons if the missile features an edge (such as arrows or shuriken). You can put the projectile in your Inventory after catching it as part of the same Action.

Rank 10: On an Amazing Success or better, you disarm the melee attacker.

Rank 15: You have +5 DR Edged weapons you attempt to catch.

or Scrounging, just by changing the name and thematic focus while still operating within the same mechanical structure.

Mixing and matching Skill effects and Upgrades is a great way to create weird Skills to really customize your crawler. A Crochet Skill, for instance, might have a custom Upgrade that works like a Utility Skill Upgrade, or it could borrow a Rank 5 Upgrade found on the Dagger Skill. You can invent a new effect or Upgrade following the guideline that the more niche it is, the stronger it can be. If something ends up too strong or too weak, the GM can always patch it later. The system adjusts; so should you.

In play, you'll often find more than one Skill that applies to a situation. Because Skills improve through use, you might choose to attempt a task with a weaker or less-optimal Skill just to gain experience with it. This is perfectly normal behavior and occasionally even works out.

Made-up Skills should typically be narrowly focused and should not completely replace or outgun existing Skills... or Actions like Evade. If you want to create an Evade-like Skill, it should perhaps only be useful against a certain attack type (such as Edged Weapons and Ranged Weapons) or come with a significant downside that makes its usage situational.

Evade Checks don't use Ranks, so anything that adds Ranks to a Skill Check that lets you avoid any type of attack will instantly be much better than Evading, and that's a no-no. If you don't spill blood, I won't be happy. That's the whole point!

ATTACK SKILLS (WEAPONS)

Attack Skills represent your ability to harm, disable, or otherwise make something stop trying to kill you, whether through weapons, fists, or pure destructive intent.

Name: The name of the Attack appears as a headline to the entry.

Attack Type: Melee or Ranged. Most Attacks are Melee, which have a range of 5 feet (i.e., adjacent). If an Attack has a range farther than that, it will be noted in the Range entry below this line. The default Stat Mod used for Melee rolls to hit is Str, while the default Stat Mod for ranged weapon Attacks is Dex. If another Stat Mod is used to hit, it will be listed here.

Range: If the Attack can hit a target farther than 5 feet away, the maximum distance it can hit will be listed here. If the Attack has no range listed, its range is Melee range (adjacent or within 5 feet).

AI Favor: Low-damage weapons grant AI Favor to you if you use such a wimpy Attack for a majority of your attacks during a combat that lasts for at least three rounds.

Limitations: Any conditions, requirements, or penalties are listed here. "Requires two hands to wield" is a common limitation, which means both hands must be used to wield the weapon (I'm sure you never would've figured that out without this explanation). You can't hold other things at the same time when attacking.

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Cooldown: If the weapon or effect has a cooldown, it will be listed here. Hit or miss, the timer starts. While on cooldown, the weapon or effect cannot be used.

Description: Any notes or descriptions of the Skill are listed here. Make an Attack Skill Check vs. the target's Evade value, which is: 10 + DEX + the Floor number.

Base Damage: This is the damage dice the weapon deals with 0–4 Ranks in the Skill. Zero Ranks means using it untrained. The appropriate Stat Mod value is added to the damage. This Mod does not always match the one listed in the Attack Type line, and not every weapon adds a Stat Mod. Finally, the damage type is listed. The damage type is important if the target has Resistance, Immunity, or Vulnerability to that damage type.

Effects: If there are effects other than damage, they will be listed there.

Upgrades: When you reach Rank 5, 10, and 15, these bonuses kick in.

Write your Attack Skills in the "Attacks" section on the front of your character sheet. Fill out the "To Hit" box for your weapons, writing in your "Rank + Stat Mod" values.

Then fill in the "Damage" box. Write in the dice as "1dX," replacing the "X" with the die type noted in the description. The weapon's base damage entry will also tell you which Stat Mod (if any) you add to the damage. Use the Effects area to write in short reminders of base effects, Upgrade effects, and AI Favor (if any).

Lastly, write in the Attack Skill name on your "Skills" list. There, you can write in additional notes and mark the advancement box on the far right when you use the Skill. This keeps all your Skills in one place when rolling for Skill Advancement (p. 169). Just remember to update your Rank in the "Attacks" section as well when you advance an Attack Skill, or you'll be weak forever, just like your middle school gym teacher prophesied.

RANK DAMAGE DICE

One common damage bonus is adding a "Rank damage die" to your damage roll. That die is based on your current Rank in the Attack Skill, though sometimes other Skills use this as well, and not always for damage purposes. It is not part of the base damage of the Attack, so it is not doubled on a Critical Hit. Table 37 shows the Rank damage dice for each Skill Rank.

Roll the die that is closest to your Skill Rank without going over (Rank 1 simply grants +1 damage). For example, if you have 7 Ranks, your Rank damage die is 1d6, as that is the closest die without going above 7.

TABLE 37: RANK DAMAGE DICE SCALING

SKILL RANK	DAMAGE DICE
1	+1
2–3	+1d2
4–5	+1d4
6–7	+1d6
8–9	+1d8
10–11	+1d10
12–13	+1d12
14–15	+1d8 & +1d6
16–17	+2d8
18–19	+1d10 & +1d8
20	+2d10

"One doesn't have to resort to gore-themed violence in order to be stylish."

- Princess Donut

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ATTACK SKILLS

Attacks are grouped by type, but each weapon entry is a unique Skill. You don't gain experience for using all edged weapons just because you gave someone a paper cut. The name of the weapon is also the name of the Skill used to wield that weapon.

All Attack Skill Checks are made vs. the target's Evade value, which sets the Difficulty of the attack.

ANIMAL CRAWLER & PET STRIKE SKILLS

BACK CLAW

Melee Attack, Str

Base Damage: 1d6 + Str Slashing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

Rank 10: +1d6 base damage

Rank 15: +1d6 base damage, and the target gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

BITE

Melee Attack, Str

Limitations: The target must have an appendage you can clamp down onto. You taste your victim's blood. Better hope they're not poisonous.

Base Damage: 1d8 + Str Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage. You may latch on to move when the foe moves during their next Action (then you let go).

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and the target gains the Woozy Debuff.

SLICE ATTACK

Melee Attack, Dex

AI Favor: 1

Base Damage: 1d4 + Str Slashing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage

Rank 15: +2d4 base damage

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BASHING WEAPON SKILLS

CLUB

Melee Attack, Str

Base Damage: 1d6 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

Rank 10: +1d6 base damage, and the target gains the Woozy Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d6 base damage, and if the target loses at least 3 Health Bar slots, they gain the Take Down Debuff.

IMPROVISED WEAPONS

Melee Attack, Str

AI Favor: 1

Pick up something and smack someone else with it. That object must weigh at least one pound and can't weigh more than your Str in pounds.

Base Damage: 1d4 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and you can throw the item (using this Skill) up to a range of Rank ×5 feet.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and you roll your first Attack each combat with Advantage due to the unexpected nature of your Attacks.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage

WARHAMMER

Melee Attack, Str

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d10 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d10 base damage

Rank 10: +1d10 base damage

Rank 15: +1d10 base damage, and the target (of your size or smaller) is pushed 15 feet.

EDGED WEAPON SKILLS

AXE

Melee Attack, Str

Base Damage: 1d6 + Str Slashing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

Rank 10: +1d6 base damage, and you may make an extra free Attack with Disadvantage against another foe adjacent to both you and the original target.

Rank 15: +1d6 base damage, and on an Amazing Success or better, sever an arm (or similar) of your foe (which disarms anyone with a two-handed weapon).

DAGGER

Melee Attack, Dex

AI Favor: 1

Base Damage: 1d4 + Str Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and this Attack deals Armor-Piercing damage (ignores DR).

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and you can throw this weapon (using this Skill) up to a range of Rank × 5 feet.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and Attacks targeting the back of a foe deal ×2 damage.

LONGSWORD

Melee Attack, Str

Base Damage: 1d8 + Str Slashing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and you gain a +1 Evade Buff.

RAPIER

Melee Attack, Dex

Base Damage: 1d6 + Dex Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

Rank 10: +1d6 base damage, and you gain a +1 Evade Buff.

Rank 15: +1d6 base damage, and you gain a +1 Evade Buff.

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HAND-TO-HAND COMBAT SKILLS

When attacking with a hand-to-hand Attack Skill that has a description stating you can choose a Damage Effect, choose one available Damage Effect before you make the Attack Skill Check. If the Attack hits, first roll the base damage dice and then apply the chosen Damage Effect.

If you choose not to use a Damage Effect for a majority of your hand-to-hand attacks during a combat that lasts for at least three rounds, you gain the amount of AI Favor listed in the Skill's entry.

FOOT SOLDIER

Melee Attack, Str

AI Favor: 1 (only if no Damage Effect is used)

Choose the Powerful Strike or Smush Damage Effect (if you wish) before rolling to hit.

Base Damage: 1d4 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and the target gains the Sore as Shit Debuff.

NOGGIN NOCKER

It's like a headbutt, only cooler.

Melee Attack, Str

AI Favor: 1 (only if no Damage Effect is used)

Limitations: On Success, you lose 1 Health Bar slot.

Choose the Skullcracker or Powerful Strike Damage Effect (if you wish) before rolling to hit.

Base Damage: 1d4 + Con Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and you don't take any damage from your own Attack.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and add 1 Rank damage die.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and the target gains the Woozy Debuff.

PUGILISM

Philistines call it punching.

Melee Attack, Dex

AI Favor: 2 (only if no Damage Effect is used)

Choose the Dirty Fighting, Iron Punch, or Powerful Strike Damage Effect (if you wish) before rolling to hit.

Base Damage: 1d2 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +2d2 base damage

Rank 10: +1d2 base damage

Rank 15: +1d2 base damage, and you may make an extra free Attack with Disadvantage.

UNARMED COMBAT

Melee Attack, Str

AI Favor: 1

Limitations: Cannot choose a Damage Effect.

Every crawler starts out with this Skill. This is a mixture of all strikes, so call it what you will when you Attack.

Base Damage: 1d4 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage

Rank 15: +2d4 base damage

WRASSLIN'

Melee Attack, Str

AI Favor: 1 (only if no Damage Effect is used)

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Choose the Choke Out, Dirty Fighting, or Toss Damage Effect (if you wish) before rolling to hit.

On Success, the target gains the Held Debuff. Held foes continue to be Held until they spend an Action to attempt escape (Mobs may use their Move Action). To prevent such an escape, you must use an Action as an Interrupt and succeed in a Wrasslin' Str-Opposed Skill Check.

Base Damage: 1d4 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may maintain the Held Debuff at no Action cost if you wish, but your Skill Check to prevent escape is made with Disadvantage.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage

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HAND-TO-HAND DAMAGE EFFECT SKILLS

Hand-to-hand Damage Effects are a special kind of Passive Skill that can be added to certain hand-to-hand Skills to enhance or modify the attack. If the attack succeeds, the chosen Damage Effect applies as well.

If the attack Fails, the Damage Effect does nothing but still goes on cooldown (if there is one).

When you make an Attack that adds a Damage Effect, place a mark for later Skill Advancement (p. 169) in either the Attack Skill or the Damage Effect, not both.

CHOKE OUT

Wrasslin' Damage Effect, Passive

If the target is at 10% Health Bar or less, you deal ×2 the total damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choke Out activates at 20% Health Bar or less.

Rank 10: Choke Out activates at 40% Health Bar or less, and deals ×4 the total damage.

Rank 15: Choke Out activates at 80% Health Bar or less, and deals ×8 the total damage.

DIRTY FIGHTING

Pugilism or Wrasslin' Damage Effect, Passive

You use underhanded tactics to win fights and cause a different kind of harm to your opponents. If the Attack Skill Check is a Critical Fail, lose 1 Popularity.

Apply the Woozy Debuff to the target.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Also apply The Taint Debuff to the target.

Rank 10: Also apply the Blinded Debuff to the target. You no longer lose Popularity on Critical Fails.

Rank 15: Also apply an immediate Minor Injury Debuff to the target.

IRON PUNCH

Pugilism Damage Effect, Passive

You deal +1d2 base damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Add 1 Rank damage die.

Rank 10: You may choose to have the target gain the Stunned Debuff instead of rolling damage.

Rank 15: Add 1 Rank damage die, and the target gains the Stunned Debuff.

POWERFUL STRIKE

Foot Soldier, Noggin Nocker, or Pugilism Damage Effect, Passive

Cooldown: 30 hours

Multiply your base damage dice result by your Rank in this Skill, then add your modifiers and buffs.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The cooldown is 10 hours.

Rank 10: The cooldown is 5 hours.

Rank 15: The cooldown is 2 hours.

SKULLCRACKER

Noggin Nocker Damage Effect, Passive

If the target is the same size as you, gain +1d4 base damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage if target is the same size as you.

Rank 10: If the target is the same size as you, add 1 Rank damage die, and the target gains the Stunned Debuff.

Rank 15: If the target is the same size as you, add 1 Rank damage die, and the target gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

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SMUSH

Foot Soldier Damage Effect, Passive

Limitations: You can only apply this Damage Effect to targets with 20% Health Bar or less.

Cooldown: Once per round.

You deal ×2 the total damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Smush activates at 30% Health Bar or less and deals ×3 the total damage.

Rank 10: This skill has no cooldown.

Rank 15: Smush activates at 40% Health Bar or less and deals ×4 the total damage.

TOSS

Wrasslin' Damage Effect, Passive

You deal +1d8 base damage + STR Bludgeoning, end the Held Debuff, and throw the target 5 feet for every five Ranks (minimum 5 feet) you have in this Skill. You can only Toss foes of a smaller size than you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can Toss foes up to your own size or smaller.

Rank 10: You can Toss foes one size larger than you or smaller.

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and you can throw foes two sizes larger than you or smaller.

RANGED WEAPON SKILLS

Ranged Skills allow you to strike targets from a distance, hopefully before they can get into range to attack you—you filthy camper. All ranged weapons use your DEX to hit, and some add your STR to the damage.

BOW

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 100 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield. Each Attack requires proper ammunition.

Base Damage: 1d6 + STR Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

Rank 10: +1d6 base damage, and add 1 Rank damage die.

Rank 15: +1d6 base damage, and the target gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

"Ranged weapons. I didn't like ranged weapons."

—Carl

CROSSBOW

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 50 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield. Each Attack requires proper ammunition.

Cooldown: Once per round.

Base Damage: 1d8 Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage, and the target gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and the range is 100 feet.

HANDGUN

Ranged Attack, DEX

Range: 150 feet

Limitations: Each Attack requires proper ammunition. Spend one Action to reload after a Major Fail or worse.

Base Damage: 1d8 Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and the target gains the Staggered Debuff.

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JAVELIN

Ranged Attack, Dex

Range: 40 feet

Base Damage: 1d8 + Str Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage, and this attack deals Armor-Piercing damage (ignores DR).

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and its range increases by your Strength score in feet.

SHOTGUN

Ranged Attack, Dex

Range: 30 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield. Each Attack requires proper ammunition. Spend one Action to reload after a Major Fail or worse.

Base Damage: 1d10 Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d10 base damage

Rank 10: +1d10 base damage

Rank 15: +1d10 base damage, +5ft Splash

SHURIKEN

Ranged Attack, Dex

Range: 30 feet

AI Favor: 1

Base Damage: 1d4 + Str Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and the range is 40 feet.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and you may make an extra free attack with Disadvantage.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and you may make an extra free attack with Disadvantage.

SLINGSHOT

Ranged Attack, Dex

Range: 30 feet

AI Favor: 2

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d2 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d2 base damage, and its range increases by your Strength score in feet.

Rank 10: +1d2 base damage, and add 1 Rank damage die.

Rank 15: +1d2 base damage, and add 1 Rank damage die.

REACH WEAPON SKILLS

Reach weapons allow you to make melee attacks against foes up to 10 feet away but not through occupied spaces. You may attack diagonally through the junction of two spaces as long as at least one of those spaces is unoccupied.

HERDING WEAPONS

Melee Attack, Str

You start with a shepherd's crook but soon have more tricks up your dirty sleeves.

Range: 10 feet

AI Favor: 1

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d4 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage and you may slide the target 5 feet

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and you may use this skill to make a Sling attack with a range of 50 feet, but using Dex to hit.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and the target gains the Take Down Debuff.

LANCE

Melee Attack, Str

Range: 10 feet

Limitations: Must be mounted to use. Cannot be used in conjunction with Attack of Opportunity or Zone of Control Skills.

Base Damage: 1d12 + Str Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d12 base damage

Rank 10: +1d12 base damage, and +1 damage for every 10 feet your mount Moved this turn.

Rank 15: +1d12 base damage, and +X damage, where X is the size of your mount.

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POLEARM

Melee Attack, Str

Range: 10 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d8 + Str Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage, and +1 Rank in the Zone of Control Skill.

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and +1 Rank in the Zone of Control Skill.

QUARTERSTAFF

Melee Attack, Str

Range: 10 feet

Limitations: Requires two hands to wield.

Base Damage: 1d6 + Str Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage

Rank 10: +1d6 base damage, and you gain a +1 Evade Buff.

Rank 15: +1d6 base damage, and you gain a +1 Evade Buff.

EXPLOSIVES SKILLS

For handling explosives, see *Explosives Handling*, *Goblin Explosives*, and *Incendiary Device Handling* in Utility Skills (below). These Skills will also be useful for crafting your own explosives once you have access to a Sapper's Table on the Fourth Floor.

As crawlers descend to lower floors, explosives become more complex than the Tutorial Floors' "light and throw" variety. See the *Area of Effect Attacks* (p. 83) for targeting, Difficulties, and what happens when you miss your target with tossed explosives. Your explosives Skill is not used when attacking with a thrown explosive, but the GM should have you make an Unopposed handling Skill Check before throwing.

Here are the explosives typically found on the first five floors. Lesser explosives can be found on lower floors, but the more powerful explosives are rarely seen on the upper floors.

"I must admit, I like it when you blow stuff up. I like it a lot."

—Princess Donut

Floor 1: Standard Explosive—Dynamite: 1d6 Bludgeoning, 0ft Blast radius +5ft Splash.

Floor 2: Goblin Explosive—Dynamite: 2d6 Bludgeoning damage, 5ft Blast radius + 5ft Splash.

Floor 2: Incendiary Device—Carl's Jug O' Boom: 1d8 Fire damage, 5ft Blast radius + 15ft Splash. Anyone who loses at least 1 Health Bar slot gains the Burned Debuff.

Floor 3: Goblin Explosive—Hob-Lobbers: 3d6 Piercing, +10ft Splash

Floor 4: Standard Explosive—Demon Det Cord: 5d6 Bludgeoning, deals double damage to objects. Can only be applied to non-moving targets.

Floor 5: Incendiary Device—Gnomish Knock-Knock: 4d6 Fire, 10ft Blast radius +10ft Splash, and anyone who fails to Evade gains the Burned Debuff. As this is a notoriously unstable fuel-air explosive, a Critical Fail is achieved on a Natural 1–4.

Most explosives are custom made and not available on store shelves. Carl had his custom Jelly Bombs, Banger Spheres, Chum Bombs, and more.

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SMOKE

Smoke is used for concealment, distraction, and confusion. Attacking into or out of smoke is done with Disadvantage (see *Mob Advantage and Disadvantage* p. 60).

Thrown smoke bombs are popular on most dungeon floors as a way to get out of trouble quickly. See the *Throwing Skill* (p. 200) for targeting, Difficulties, and what happens when you miss your target. You don't need to make a Skill Check to drop it in your own space.

Floor 1: Goblin Smoke Bomb: Creates a multicolor smoke cloud that reaches 30 feet in each direction from the point of impact, with a maximum duration of 3 minutes. However, even a slight breeze will dissipate it in 1 minute.

Floor 3: Hobgoblin Smoke Curtain: Creates a dense white fog over a 60ft radius that holds even in a breeze.

Floor 5: Hobgoblin Disco Ball: Created by infusing (see *Infusion Skill*, p. 194) an Invisibility potion onto a Hobgoblin Smoke Curtain. It produces thick multi-hued smoke plumes, along with some sick beats. It blinds everyone in the area, friend and foe alike.

UTILITY SKILLS

Utility Skills help crawlers survive, adapt, and solve problems that can't be fixed by hitting them until they stop moving.

Checks that are labeled as Unopposed can, at the GM's discretion, become Opposed if something is actively working against you. For example, you're trying to swim the rapids, and some dipshit is throwing fishing nets at you. Cut it out, Cletus! Or I'm gonna tell Mom on you!

ACUTE EARS

Intelligence

Passive

Improves a crawler's hearing and allows the crawler to see more Mobs on the minimap in their HUD. The information is "somewhat reliable."

Rank 5: Information on the Mob's size and whether you have encountered them before are added to the red dot indicator.

Rank 10: Mobs of a lower level than you cannot Ambush your party.

Rank 15: Mobs cannot Ambush your party.

AIMING

Passive

Limitations: This Skill is used only in conjunction with Ranged Attacks. Mark this Skill for Advancement only when applying its Ranks to such an Attack.

You are skilled at targeting vital body parts to deal additional damage.

When making a Ranged Attack, you can add your Ranks in this Skill to your Attack Skill Check if you choose to make the Check with Disadvantage.

On Success, add 1d4 to the damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 damage

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage

ALCHEMY

Intelligence

Used for crafting potions and poisons. See *Crafting* p. 221.

You may craft potions up to a +5 bonus level.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may craft potions up to a +10 bonus level.

Rank 10: You may create additional potions of the same kind without spending extra time.

Rank 15: You can write the recipe for any potion you find.

AMBUSH

Intelligence

You are skilled at popping up out of nowhere. When a Mob is moving toward you, even if they are aware of your general presence, make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, you gain a surprise Action against the Mob before combat starts. As an unseen attacker, you Attack with Advantage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you Attack with your Surprise Action, add an Ambush Rank damage die to your Surprise Attack damage.

Rank 10: When other crawlers in your party roll this skill untrained, they roll as normal (not with Disadvantage).

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"That is the equivalent of dropping a grenade down your pants and shouting, 'YOLO!'"

—The System AI

Rank 15: You gain a second bonus Action as a surprise Action. This bonus Action can't be an Attack.

ANIMAL HANDLING

Charisma

You are skilled in calming, befriending, and guiding animals. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, the animal is friendly enough to avoid attacking you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choose an animal type to specialize in. You have Advantage on your Animal Handling Skill Checks against that animal type. You gain a second bonus Action as a surprise Action. This bonus Action can't be an attack.

Rank 10: Forming each level of bonding with a potential pet takes half the normal time.

Rank 15: You can have up to two pets.

ARCANE

Intelligence

You have general knowledge of magic and can determine whether items are magical or not. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you can identify the item as magical or not.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You are able to determine details such as the specific Rank and bonus levels of magical items.

Rank 10: You can imbue items with inherent spells using an Arcanist Table. See *Crafting* on p. 221.

Rank 15: The default cooldown of your imbued spells is 3 hours.

ATTACK OF OPPORTUNITY

Passive, Interrupt

Limitations: Requires a single-handed melee weapon with a range no greater than 5 feet.

When a foe moves out of a space adjacent to you (except via a Step), you may spend an Action to make an Attack Action as an Interrupt against that foe.

On Success, roll damage and apply any other effects from the Attack!

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If the foe moves into another space adjacent to you, they must stop.

Rank 10: A foe using their Step no longer prevents this ability.

Rank 15: Roll the Attack Skill Check with Advantage.

BACKFIRE

Intelligence

Limitations: Compensated Anarchist Class Only

You are skilled at neutralizing and deconstructing traps without the use of a Sapper's Table. Triggering mechanisms are quite valuable. Time required to neutralize a trap is 10 minutes. Time required to deconstruct it is 1 hour. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you successfully take apart the trap and can repurpose it.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can identify when the trap was placed. Time required to neutralize a trap is 5 minutes.

Rank 10: You can identify when the trap was created. Time required to deconstruct a trap is 30 minutes.

Rank 15: You can identify the designer of the trap. Time required to deconstruct a trap is 15 minutes.

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BALANCE

Dexterity

You can traverse tricky surfaces with general ease. Make an Unopposed Skill Check. The GM may add Difficulty for especially crazy surfaces.

On Success, you keep your balance on tricky or shifting surfaces.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may perform Move Actions in difficult terrain without penalty.

Rank 10: When subject to a Take Down or involuntary Move effects, you may use this skill as a free Interrupt Action to avoid the effect.

Rank 15: You may perform your Step on vertical surfaces (yes, like in *The Matrix*), but must end it on a flat(ish) surface.

BASIC SCIENCE

Intelligence

You understand basic scientific principles and natural laws, which you hope are still in effect in the dungeon. If you want to conduct experiments involving dead Goblins and various acids, this is the Skill for you. Experiments take 2 hours to perform. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you learn or confirm something.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Experiments take 1 hour to perform.

Rank 10: Choose a specialty (physics, biology, chemistry, Earth science, etc.), and roll with Advantage when dealing with that.

Rank 15: Experiments take 30 minutes to perform.

BOMB SURGEON

Intelligence

Use this Skill to deconstruct explosive bombs and smoke bombs. You can then use the half-sized bomb, or use the component parts to craft new bombs using other Skills.

If you are using a Sapper's Table, you do not have to make an Unopposed Explosives Handling Skill Check to avoid a mishap. Time required is 1 hour. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you have deconstructed it.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Time required is 30 minutes.

Rank 10: You never have to make an Explosives Handling Skill Check when using this skill.

Rank 15: When cutting dynamite in half to make smaller bombs, round dice up. Time required is 15 minutes.

CALLIGRAPHY

Dexterity

Used for making documents look super elegant. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, what you have written is a joy to read and feels important, even if it's bad news.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Roll with Advantage on your next Charisma Skill Check vs. the recipient of your beautiful paper.

Rank 10: You are able to craft scrolls as if this were a crafting skill. See *Crafting*, p. 221.

Rank 15: Once per floor, you may craft a scroll for a spell you have only seen cast within the last 2 hours.

CARTOGRAPHY

Intelligence

You probably played some old-school TTRPGs and think that mapping the dungeon will help you in some way. Wrong! It will help you in *many* ways. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you figure out where you are in relation to other things.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can always return from whence you came quickly, assuming the dungeon walls haven't shifted in the meantime.

Rank 10: You provide an Advantage die to crawlers in your party (could be you) who are making Tracking Skill Checks or Checks that rely on spatial relations.

Rank 15: Even with merely a finger point or a "thataway," you can get from point A to point B via the most direct path.

CAT-LIKE REFLEXES

Dexterity

Limitation: This limited Skill is only available to cat-based Races, such as Cat, Cat Girl/Cat Boy, and Tigran

You gain a +10ft Move. Use this Skill Check when you would make a Dexterity Stat Check (vs. the typically lesser Stat Check Difficulty).

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Reduce the damage you take from foes' Surprise Attacks against you by your Rank in this skill.

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Rank 10: Reduce all Area damage you take by 50% (rounded down).

Rank 15: +10ft Move. You gain a +1 Evade Buff. Roll with Advantage to Evade Attacks and effects that would apply the Held Debuff (or similar) to you.

CATCHER

Passive, Interrupt

When a Successful direct (non-Area) Attack is about to damage an ally, you leap in and take the damage instead. You must be adjacent to that ally but can take a 10ft Step before using this Skill to get into position.

You take the damage. You can't use Evade, Shield Block, and other Skills or Spells to negate damage dealt to you this way.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You've learned how to take hits. You gain +5 DR when using this Skill.

Rank 10: You gain +5 DR a when using this Skill.

Rank 15: You gain +5 DR when using this Skill and ignore any Debuffs attached to this damage.

CESTA PUNTA

Dexterity

Limitations: Only acquired via an Earth Hobby Potion

Use this Skill Check when playing jai alai or when throwing things that fit in the xistera. See *Throwing* p. 200 for rules on throwing things, but use the ranges below. Roll with Disadvantage at ranges over 500 feet.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Throw range Strength ×20 feet.

Rank 10: Add 1 Cesta Punta Rank damage die to thrown damaging Attacks.

Rank 15: Throw range Strength ×30 feet, and roll with Disadvantage at ranges over 2,000 feet.

CHARACTER ACTOR

Passive, Charisma

Limitations: Former Child Actor Class Only. Rank increases by 1 when descending to a new floor only.

At the start of each floor, choose a new Class from a random list of three provided by the GM. You gain a random assortment of the new Class's abilities for the remainder of the current floor, while keeping your current ones.

For each bullet point line item in the new Class description, roll 1d2. On a 2, you gain the listed abilities.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The random Classes increase in rarity and power based on the crawler's Stats and Level.

Rank 10: Skill Ranks gained in any newly-granted Skills persist from floor to floor, but the starting Ranks of those Skills are lost.

Rank 15: You choose the Class from any available.

CHOPPER PILOT

Dexterity

Known as a motorcycle in most parts of the world—and in the World Dungeon.

Limitations: You suffer Disadvantage on Attack Skill Checks made while Piloting and cannot Attack with a weapon that requires two hands.

You don't need to use this Skill if you're cruising through a town, but if you're racing, chasing, showing off, or trying to pop a wheelie, this is the Skill you want.

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If you're doing something wild or trying to avoid becoming a skid mark on the highway, make an Unopposed Skill Check. Depending on how extreme the circumstances are, the GM may apply Advantage or Disadvantage to the Check.

On Success, you stay upright while performing your crazy maneuvers.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your chopper has +5ft Move.

Rank 10: Attacking while piloting no longer suffers Disadvantage.

Rank 15: Your chopper has +5ft Move. When performing crazy stunts (like riding up a canyon wall), roll with Advantage.

CLIMBING

Strength

Limitations: If you Attack while Climbing, you suffer Disadvantage on those Checks.

You don't need to use this Skill if you're climbing up a narrow flight of stairs. Probably not even when you're fully roped in and tethered to other climbers. But if you're racing, chasing, rappelling from a burning building, or doing something dangerous while climbing, this is the Skill you want.

Make an Unopposed Skill Check every minute (not round). Depending on how extreme the circumstances are, the GM may apply Advantage (such as if you've previously already climbed it) or Disadvantage (you got no ropes) to the Check.

On Success, you are safe in your climb and make progress. See *Special Forms of Movement* p. 70, if the distance moved is important.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Make a Check every 5 minutes.

Rank 10: Make a Check every 10 minutes. You no longer Attack with Disadvantage while climbing.

Rank 15: Make a Check every 15 minutes. When other crawlers in your party roll this skill untrained, they roll as normal (not with Disadvantage).

COCKROACH

Constitution

Limitation: This Limited Skill can only be learned via a Race, Class, or item. Mark the skill for advancement until you reach Rank 5. After that, Ranks in this Skill only increase by magical means and training.

Cooldown: Once per scene

When an Attack would drop you to 0% Health Bar, roll an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, drop to 10% instead.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: No Skill Check required anymore.

Rank 10: The crawler's Health Bar is unaffected by damage that would drop them to 0%.

Rank 15: Cooldown is twice per scene. When it triggers, the crawler heals to 100% and has +Rank DR until the end of the next round of combat.

COOKING

Intelligence

You are skilled in the culinary arts. Once you have your ingredients and 1 hour to prepare it, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

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On Success, you make edible food for you and your party.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: It takes you 30 minutes to prepare a meal with makeshift ingredients.

Rank 10: The diners gain the day-long "You are full!" Buff: Heal 2 Health Bar slots per hour when not resting.

Rank 15: The "You are full!" Buff also causes Debuffs to end if you drop to 10% Health Bar.

DECEPTION

Charisma

If you know the truth but want to obscure it, this is the Skill for you. When you lie and try to get away with it, make an INT-Opposed Skill Check. If the creature you're lying to has the Detect Lies Skill, you make this Check with Disadvantage.

On Success, they believe you!

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can use this Skill while gambling.

Rank 10: You can use this Skill to forge documents.

Rank 15: You're good enough to know when you've been caught. If you fail this Check, you may perform one Action before your foes can react.

DETECT LIES

Intelligence

You have an incredible bullshit detector. If you believe someone is trying to lie to you, make a CHA-Opposed Skill Check. If they possess the Deception Skill, you make this Check with Disadvantage.

On Success, you sense if they're lying, but if they believe they're telling the truth, you sense they're telling the truth.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: When you Fail, you still can't detect the lie, but you can ignore the additional effects of a Major Fail or worse.

Rank 10: When you Fail, you can't detect the lie, but you can ignore the effects of a Critical Fail.

Rank 15: You do not need to see the speaker, which allows you to detect lies in text and audio form.

DETECT TRAP

Intelligence

When you suspect a room, door, chest, or other object has an active trap, this is the Skill you want. Make an Unopposed Skill Check. Roll with Disadvantage when using this Skill to scan an entire room or while moving.

On Success, you are alerted to the presence of a non-magic trap, which typically allows you to avoid triggering it.

On Fail, you sense nothing, and a trap may or may not be present.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can detect magical traps.

Rank 10: You no longer roll with Disadvantage when searching a broad area or while moving.

Rank 15: When you are aware of nearby traps, your party has Advantage on their first Check to avoid or escape the effects.

DETERMINE VALUE

Passive

Limitations: Ranks in this Skill only increase by magical means.

You can sort your HUD's Inventory by item value. The actual gold value is not displayed.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your Inventory is tabbed to sort your items by type, and it includes a history tab that tracks your item usage and any former owners of an item.

Rank 10: You can determine what type of loot box the item would have come from.

Rank 15: Whenever you add a new item to your Inventory, the gold value of that item is displayed.

DIPLOMACY

Charisma

Used in mediation between opposing organizations and parties. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check of the side with the higher INT Mod.

On Success, the two parties are willing to discuss options.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Roll with Advantage if you are not a member of either party.

Rank 10: Each side accepts consequences if they break the deal.

Rank 15: Hostilities cease at least for the remainder of the day.

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DODGE

Passive

Limitations: Mark the Skill for Advancement when Evading until you reach Rank 5. After that, Ranks in this Skill only increase by magical means and training.

You gain a +1 Evade Buff.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Gain a +1 Evade Buff, and you may Step an additional 5 feet when you perform the Evade Action.

Rank 10: Gain a +2 Evade Buff, and roll Evade with Advantage vs. Spells and Ranged Attacks.

Rank 15: Gain a +2 Evade Buff, and you may perform the Evade Action without spending an Action in combat.

DOUBLE TAP

Passive

Limitations: To engage this Skill, you must declare a Double Tap at the start of the combat round, before Mob Actions have been determined. You must then use all of your Actions this round to Attack a single target with the same weapon or Spell. Mark this Skill for advancement anytime you roll an Amazing Success or better while using it.

If your first Attack is an Amazing Success or better, your second Attack (if it hits) is upgraded to a Critical Hit.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Roll your first Attack with Advantage.

Rank 10: If your first Attack is a Standard Success or better, the second Attack (if it hits) is upgraded to a Critical Hit.

Rank 15: Roll your second Attack with Advantage. If your second Attack is a Critical Hit or upgraded to one, deal ×3 damage (instead of ×2).

DRIVING

Dexterity

Limitations: If you Attack while Driving, you suffer Disadvantage on those Checks.

You don't need this Skill if you're casually driving down the road to pick up a quart of milk, but if you're racing, chasing, showing off, or doing something dangerous in a vehicle, this is the Skill you want.

If you're doing something wild or trying to avoid becoming a skid mark on the highway, make an Unopposed Skill Check. Depending on how extreme the circumstances are, the GM may apply Advantage or Disadvantage to the Check.

On Success, you achieve your daredevil maneuver or avoid wrecking your vehicle.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You no longer suffer Disadvantage when attacking while Driving.

Rank 10: Your vehicle has +5ft Move. Roll with Advantage to Evade Attacks against your vehicle.

Rank 15: Your vehicle has +5ft Move. When performing crazy stunts (like driving on only your left-side wheels), roll with Advantage.

DUMPSTER DIVING

Intelligence

Known as "scrounging" in some parts of the world.

This Skill bolsters your ability to search the clutter within the dungeon to find interesting bits of rubbish and maybe something useful. Using this Skill takes 1 hour and can only be performed once per 50-foot-square area. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you find what you were looking for or another interesting item, determined by the GM.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You also find 1 Rank damage die's-worth of Misc. Junk.

Rank 10: A Dumpster Dive takes 30 minutes. On a Critical Hit, you gain an additional interesting item.

Rank 15: A Dumpster Dive takes 10 minutes. On an Amazing Success, you gain an interesting item.

ENDURANCE

Constitution

Use this Skill to prevent fatigue while grinding, walking long distances (measured in miles), or other extended strenuous activities. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you may continue the activity and do not gain the Fatigued Debuff.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can ignore the effects of a Major Fail when making these Checks.

Rank 10: If you are not Fatigued or in extreme conditions, you make this Check with Advantage.

Rank 15: If your Check is a Critical Fail, you can take the effects of a Standard Fail.

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ENGINEERING

Intelligence

Limitations: Cannot create vehicles or high-powered engines (see *Gear Head* for that p. 192).

This Skill is used to design and build things with moving parts, fluids, or chemicals wholly out of Misc. Junk with no inherent bonuses, though they may have situational bonuses. Examples include a watch, a water pump, or bullets. See *Crafting* p. 221.

Starting on the Fourth Floor, you may make use of an Engineering Table to make your mundane items easier to craft. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you create the item.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choose a mundane item type to specialize in. You have Advantage when creating an item of that type.

Rank 10: You may craft your specialty item with a +1 bonus level enchantment.

Rank 15: You may craft your specialty item with up to +2 bonus level enchantment, and it takes half the time.

ESCAPE ARTIST

Dexterity

Holy Houdini! While anyone can use Dexterity to wiggle out of restraints or a hold, you're especially skilled at the art of escape. When you try to escape from bonds or being Held, you can use this Skill.

When trying to escape bonds, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

To escape being Held, make a STR-Opposed Skill Check. Based on the complexity or simplicity of what binds you, the GM may have you make the Check with Advantage or Disadvantage.

On Success, you escape your bonds or the creature holding you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can escape your bonds, and no one sees you do it. If you escape being Held, you can then take a Step (also unseen).

Rank 10: When other crawlers in your party roll this skill untrained, they roll as normal (not with Disadvantage).

Rank 15: When you slip out, you may immediately take an Action with Advantage.

ESCAPE PLAN

Passive

Limitations: Ranks in this Skill only advance by magical means.

Your HUD reveals hidden doors and passages, unless those passages were crafted by someone with more Ranks in Fabricate or Engineering than you have in this Skill or the passage is entirely natural.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You have access to system-concealed displays and the Dungeon Locator. Holographic signs pop up in your HUD, displaying insider information like signs at a zoo. Includes arrows toward City and stronger Bosses.

Rank 10: You are able to read hidden sigils (glowing blue circles) used by the showrunners to direct the movement of Mobs.

Rank 15: You are able to read hidden messages and redactions in dungeon documents.

EXPLOSIVES HANDLING

Intelligence

For making Attack Skill Checks with explosives (see *Throwing*, p. 200).

Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you safely handle standard explosive devices. On Fail, I'm sure the GM will think of something.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You are able to determine the type, status, and raw materials of explosives you handle.

Rank 10: You are able to craft explosives such as dynamite as if this were a crafting Skill, though you must have explosive raw materials and a Sapper's Table (see *Crafting*, p. 221).

Rank 15: You may create explosive raw materials out of non-volatile materials. Your crafting takes half the time.

FABRICATE

Intelligence

Limitations: Cannot create things with moving parts, fluids, or chemicals.

Use this Skill to make generic, mundane items with no inherent bonuses wholly out of Misc. Junk, but your GM can give them situational bonuses.

Examples include a ladder, a 50ft rope, or a ceramic pot to store napalm. For items with moving parts, see

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the Engineering Skill above instead. See *Crafting*, p. 221. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you create the item.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choose a mundane item to specialize in. You have Advantage when creating that item.

Rank 10: You may craft your specialty item with a +1 bonus level enchantment.

Rank 15: You may craft your specialty item with up to +2 bonus level enchantment, and it takes half the time.

FIND CRAWLER

Passive

Limitations: Ranks in this Skill only increase by magical means.

Your HUD displays other crawlers within 1,000 feet of you. They are designated with a blue dot.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The area in which you can detect other crawlers increases to 5 miles.

Rank 10: The area in which you can detect other crawlers increases to 10 miles.

Rank 15: You can input a specific crawler's name and learn their exact location anywhere in the dungeon.

FIND TRAP

Passive

Limitations: Ranks in this Skill only increase by magical means and training.

Traps within 5 feet of you appear on your HUD one second prior to triggering the trap, which is often too late to react.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Traps appear on your HUD up to 5 seconds before they are triggered.

Rank 10: Traps within 10 feet of you appear on your HUD as you approach them.

Rank 15: Traps within 15 feet of you appear on your HUD as you approach them.

FIRST AID

Intelligence

Limitations: After you treat someone, you can't treat them again until they complete a Short or Long Rest.

Give minor medical aid to yourself or someone else. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, the patient regains 1 Health Bar slot. Each higher degree of Success heals 1 additional slot.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you spend 5 minutes, the patient also heals a Minor Injury Debuff.

Rank 10: If you spend 10 minutes, the patient also heals a Long-Term Minor Injury Debuff.

Rank 15: The patient regains 1 additional Health Bar slot. If you spend 15 minutes, the patient also heals a Major Injury Debuff.

GEAR HEAD

Intelligence

Limitations: This Limited Skill can only be learned via a Race, Class, or item. Requires an Engine Stand attachment to an Engineering Table (2,000 gold).

You are proficient at building high-performance engines, using the rules of Crafting (see p. 221). Each +5ft Move is a +1 Bonus Level at the default "10 + Bonus Level ×4" Difficulty. The time it takes and Misc. Junk required uses the rules of crafting mundane items.

On Success, you have successfully built a custom engine.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You are able to add accessories to vehicles or even build your own custom vehicles. Use the rules of Engineering for crafting such things, but use this Skill and there are no bonus level limits to your custom-crafted items.

Rank 10: Each +10ft Move is a +1 Bonus Level. You may use this Skill as a Repair Skill (see p. 197) when fixing engines.

Rank 15: Cut the time required to craft engines and vehicles you build around your engines in half.

GOBLIN EXPLOSIVES

Intelligence

For making Attack Skill Checks with explosives, see *Throwing*, p. 200.

Make an Unopposed Skill Check. Goblin Explosives are so unstable that Critical Fails occur on a Natural 1–4.

On Success, you safely use Goblin Explosive devices.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Critical Fail occurs on a Natural 3 or less. You are able to determine the type, status, and raw materials of Goblin Explosives you handle.

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Rank 10: Critical Fail occurs on a Natural 2 or less. You are able to craft explosives such as dynamite as if this were a crafting Skill, though you must have explosive raw materials and a Sapper's Table. See *Crafting* on p. 221.

Rank 15: Critical Fail occurs on a Natural 1 as usual. You may create explosive raw materials out of non-volatile materials with the use of a Sapper's Table. Your crafting takes half the time.

GOOD FIRST IMPRESSION

Charisma

Limitations: This Skill doesn't work on crawlers, Bosses, or Elites. You can only make a Skill Check against individuals, not groups.

When you encounter an NPC or Mob that is not immediately hostile or attacking, make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, the Mob approaches with wary curiosity.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: A Mob that is lower level than you won't attack your party unless they are attacked by a member of your party.

Rank 10: A Mob that is up to double your level won't attack your party unless they are attacked by you or an ally or your party is preventing them from completing their objective.

Rank 15: A group of Mobs of the same type up to double your level won't attack your party unless they are attacked by a member of your party, or your party is preventing them from completing their objective.

HIDE IN SHADOWS

Dexterity

Limitations: To move while avoiding detection, see *Stealth,* p. 199.

While in a heavily shadowed area or out of sight, you can stay still and attempt to foil foes' chances to spot you. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check. If you're hiding behind an object that is larger than you, roll with Advantage.

On Success, you become invisible to Mobs and the HUDs of other crawlers but can still be affected by environmental and Area Attacks. You become visible if you take an Action that affects another creature or if you're no longer behind cover.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can use this Skill in a dim light without having an object to hide behind.

Rank 10: When other crawlers in your party roll this Skill untrained, they roll as normal (not with Disadvantage).

Rank 15: You can use this Skill in a lightly shaded area and may make a Step without giving away your position.

IMPROVISED EXPLOSIVE DEVICE

Intelligence

Use this Skill to manipulate explosive material into bombs and traps without a Sapper's Table. You literally can't use one, so you'll have to make an Explosives Handling Skill Check to avoid issues when crafting your device. Use the rules of *Crafting* on p. 221.

On Success, you create the device. Bombs and traps can have timers and triggering devices more sophisticated than a burning fuse.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your crafting takes half the time.

Rank 10: Your devices deal d10s of damage instead of d6s (the default).

Rank 15: Your devices can be set to trigger only against a specific Mob, Boss, NPC, or crawler.

INCENDIARY DEVICE HANDLING

Intelligence

For making Attack Skill Checks with incendiary devices, see *Throwing*, p. 200.

Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you are able to safely handle incendiary devices.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You are able to determine the type, status, and raw materials of incendiary devices you handle.

Rank 10: You are able to craft incendiary devices as if this were a crafting Skill, though you must have incendiary raw materials and a Sapper's Table. See *Crafting*, p. 221.

Rank 15: Add a +5 Splash to your crafted device at no additional Difficulty, and your crafting takes half the time.

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INFUSION

Intelligence

Limitations: Requires an Infusion Station attachment on an Alchemy Table or Tier 3 Sapper's Table.

Use this Skill to infuse potion bonuses onto consumable items. One potion can infuse one item. You'll either need to learn Alchemy so you can craft your own potions, or find potions to transfer to consumables. *Example:* Infuse a Hobgoblin Smoke Curtain with an Invisibility potion to create a Hobgoblin Disco Ball. See *Crafting*, p. 221.

On Success, your consumable item now does more!

UPGRADES

Rank 5: One potion can infuse 2 items at once.

Rank 10: One potion can infuse 5 items at once.

Rank 15: One potion can infuse 10 items at once.

INTIMIDATE

Strength

You can use this Skill to scare the wits out of a foe. Make a CHA-Opposed Skill Check. If either side has attacked or taken a hostile stance in this encounter, roll with Disadvantage.

On Success, the target gains the Staggered Debuff (p. 97).

UPGRADES

Rank 5: On Success or greater, until the end of the next round, the target can only use its remaining Actions to move away from you (though it does not need to use its Step when doing so).

Rank 10: The target also gains the Woozy Debuff.

Rank 15: The target drops everything they were holding and also gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

INVESTIGATION

Intelligence

You spend 10 minutes looking at an area or puzzle in front of you and might make heads or tails of it. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

When you take the Look for Clues Action (p. 85), spend only one Action to use this Skill.

On Success, you learn something useful.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you're familiar with the area you are investigating, you can make the Skill Check with Advantage.

Rank 10: Each attempt takes 5 minutes.

Rank 15: Roll with Advantage if you know the parties involved. *Example:* You know the puzzle's maker, or you know the murder victim and the main suspect.

IRON STOMACH

Constitution

Eat magic items for fun and profit! But beware of cursed items, as they could have negative effects. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you eat the item. It is destroyed, as the shitter will be tomorrow morning.

On an Amazing Success or better, gain 1 permanent Intelligence.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: On a Critical Hit, gain 1 additional permanent Intelligence.

Rank 10: On a Standard Success or better, gain 1 permanent Intelligence. You may eat cursed items with no ill effects.

Rank 15: You choose which Stat is permanently increased.

JUMPING

Strength

With a running start of at least 10 feet (made as a 10-foot Step with this Action), you leap through the air in an arcing trajectory. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you leap a distance in feet up to your Rank + STR with a height of 1ft.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Add your DEX to the height of your Jump.

Rank 10: You gain a +1 Evade Buff.

Rank 15: Your leap distance in feet is Rank + [STR ×2].

LEADERSHIP

Charisma

You are skilled at coordinating two or more separate parties during fights against Bosses. Make an Int-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, the parties have Advantage on their first Attack against the Boss.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may instead use this Skill during Skill challenges while on a group Quest. Perform a free Call a Play Action, and it extends to each member of the parties during their next non-combat Skill Check.

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Rank 10: Instead of Advantage, anyone in the parties may perform a free Move Action.

Rank 15: Instead of Advantage, anyone in the parties may perform a free Evade Action.

LIGHT ON YOUR FEET

Dexterity

Limitations: Usable only by animals

With a running start of at least 10 feet (made as a 10ft Step with this Skill), you leap through the air in an arcing trajectory. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you leap a distance in feet up to your Rank ×2 with a height equal to your DEX ×2 in feet.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your distance is Rank ×3 and your height is DEX ×3.

Rank 10: You may leap without an arcing trajectory, which allows for "straight up."

Rank 15: Your leap may last up to your Rank in seconds, which resembles gliding.

LOCKPICKING

Dexterity

Limitations: Roll with Disadvantage if you do not have the proper tools, unless it's a crude lock.

You spend the Floor number in minutes trying to pick the lock. Make an Unopposed Skill Check (more complex locks may have a higher Difficulty, as determined by the GM). If the lock was created by a named antagonist, this could be an INT-Opposed Skill Check instead.

On Success, you pick the lock!

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You make no noise and leave no trace.

Rank 10: Each attempt takes half the time. You may alter the lock so that the key no longer works.

Rank 15: You don't roll with Disadvantage if you lack the proper tools.

LORE

Intelligence

You have studied the goings-on in the Dungeon and have figured out a thing or two. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you know a little something about a neighborhood, some of the Mobs, or how to avoid pissing off the locals.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can identify the major factions in the area.

Rank 10: You are aware of the important local NPCs. Just give your GM a break and don't demand this all up front or the first one you come across will likely attack you.

Rank 15: You roll with Advantage on your first Charisma-based Skill Check when encountering an organized group in a neighborhood.

NEGOTIATION

Charisma

Limitations: Does not work on members of your own party. Some items have a minimum price.

You spend 5 minutes haggling over the price of items or negotiating to get what you want through compromise. Typically, haggling is done with an NPC merchant when you're buying or selling items. If you haggle with other entities, you do so with Disadvantage. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, you increase or decrease the price 10% in your favor. If you're not haggling, the opponent tentatively agrees to your terms.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your party members can also buy or sell at your newly-negotiated price.

Rank 10: Increase or decrease the price by an additional 10% in your favor.

Rank 15: Increase or decrease the price by an additional 15% in your favor.

PATHFINDER

Passive

Limitations: Ranks in this Skill only increase by magical means and training.

Your HUD map zooms out with a thought, the breadth of which is determined by a multiplier equal to your Rank. *Example:* Rank 4 means your map covers ×4 the standard area (1/4 of a square mile), which makes it extend to 1 mile around you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You are notified when you are near a safe-room or stairwell.

Rank 10: You can see through your map while it is open in your HUD.

Rank 15: Mobs appear as red dots on your HUD map.

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PERCEPTION

Intelligence

You concentrate your senses to pick out details about your environment that others might miss. Make an Unopposed Skill Check, though the GM will likely adjust the Difficulty based on the lighting, how cluttered the area is, how quickly an event occurs, and other such circumstances.

Also use Perception when you take a Look for Clues Action (p. 85).

On Success, you notice something. It could be important; it might not be.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Halve the penalty for cluttered areas.

Rank 10: Halve the penalty for how short of a window you have to notice the thing.

Rank 15: Halve the penalty for the range to the thing.

PERFORMANCE

Charisma

Whether you're acting, dancing, playing an instrument, singing, or delivering slam poetry, use this Skill when you want to electrify an audience. Choose a type of performance to specialize in as your starting type, be it comedy, guitar, screamo, or reciting the collected works of Alan Ginsberg.

Make an Unopposed Skill Check to determine the audience reaction. If you are competing against other performers, add the top rival's CHA to the Difficulty.

On Success, you command the stage. The audience is entertained.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Choose an additional type of performance to specialize in.

Rank 10: Choose an additional type of performance. You can coach and coordinate others in one of your specialties. After coaching them for at least 1 hour in one of your specialties, they can attempt an unskilled Performance Skill Check without Disadvantage.

Rank 15: Choose an additional type of performance. You can mimic someone else's performance after experiencing it once.

PERSUASION

Charisma

You have a knack for getting others to see things your way. You typically need about 10 minutes of schmoozing in a safe environment to make a Check with this Skill, and you may suffer Disadvantage if the request is risky, inconvenient, or untoward. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, you convince the target to follow your suggestion if it isn't too costly for them, too dangerous, or against their nature.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: They'll follow your suggestion even if it is costly for them.

Rank 10: They'll follow your suggestion even if it is dangerous.

Rank 15: They'll follow your suggestion even if it's against their nature.

REGENERATION

Passive

If your Rank in this Skill is equal to or greater than your CON, you heal 1 Health Bar slot at the start of each round (or every 10 seconds outside of combat). If not, you heal 1 Health Bar slot every other round (or every 20 seconds outside of combat).

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UPGRADES

Rank 5: After 5 minutes, any Minor Injury Debuff you suffer from ends. After 10 minutes, any Major Injury Debuff you suffer from ends.

Rank 10: After 20 minutes, any Long-Term Minor Injury Debuff you suffer from ends. After 1 hour, any Long-Term Major Injury Debuff you suffer from ends.

Rank 15: The time required to end injury Debuffs is halved.

RELIGION

Intelligence

You have a knack for understanding gods, their followers, and what makes them tick. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you know the basic information about a god and the practices of their followers.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can identify the followers on sight, even if they're trying to hide their affiliation.

Rank 10: You know how to sow discord among the followers of that religion.

Rank 15: You know strengths and weakness of the gods.

REPAIR

Intelligence

Limitations: For basic repairs to items with no moving parts, magical or not.

After spending 2 hours, you can repair most simple items that are broken or damaged but not destroyed. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you repair the item.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can make repairs to things with moving parts.

Rank 10: You can make repairs in 1 hour.

Rank 15: You can rebuild a destroyed item.

RIDING

Dexterity

Limitations: The rider in control of the mount rolls Attack Skill Checks with Disadvantage.

While mounted on a living beast, you can ride to the local watering hole without needing to make a Check. But during an action scene or when exploring Giant Gopher Hole Flats, your mount might panic, and you might get tossed for 1d6 bludgeoning for every 10ft Move your mount has, plus its size value. Don't land in a cactus patch! Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, your mount doesn't stumble, and you stay upright.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your mount has +5ft Move. You no longer suffer Disadvantage when attacking while Riding.

Rank 10: Your mount has an additional +10ft Move. When other crawlers in your party roll this Skill untrained, they roll as normal (not with Disadvantage).

Rank 15: Your mount has an additional +15ft Move. When performing crazy stunts (like jumping through flames), roll with Advantage.

ROPEWORK

Dexterity

You know a half hitch from a clove hitch, and the qualities of hemp vs. nylon (we had to look it up). Sadly, this knowledge is mostly used to tie people up so you can tor—*interrogate* them, but you're going to buck that trend, right? Just climbing and cattle-rustling for you!

Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you rope the thing with a good knot.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can now use this Skill as an Attack, at a Range of 10ft vs. the target's Evade. On Success, the target gains the Held Debuff.

Rank 10: You can whip your line in that special way to untie a knot you made and recover your rope.

Rank 15: Your Attack now has a Range of your Strength (min 15). Just make sure your rope is long enough.

RUNNING

Dexterity

Limitations: For short bursts of running. For extended runs, use Endurance instead (p. 190).

You don't need to use this Skill if you're running down a hallway to attack some Mobs. But if you're racing, chasing, or need to get away from a ticking time bomb, this is the Skill you want. See *Racing & Chasing*, p. 73.

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Make an Unopposed Skill Check every minute, not every round. Add 1 to your result for every 10ft of Move you have.

On Success, you succeed in the run.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You have a permanent +5ft Move Buff. Make a Check every 2 minutes.

Rank 10: You have an additional permanent +10ft Move Buff. Make a Check every 4 minutes.

Rank 15: You have an additional permanent +15ft Move Buff. Make a Check every 6 minutes.

SALVAGE

Intelligence

Limitations: Salvage cannot be used with explosive devices.

Salvage is the art of collecting useful items from things you have deconstructed or failed to properly craft. See *Crafting,* p. 221.

Salvaging usually takes 1 hour to accomplish. At the end of that time, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you recover half of the important raw materials.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your Salvage Checks take 30 minutes.

Rank 10: On Success, you recover all of the important raw materials.

Rank 15: On a crafting Standard Fail or Near Miss, roll your crafting Check again with Advantage, with an additional 15-minute time expenditure.

SCUTELLIPHILY

Intelligence

Limitations: This Limited Skill can only be learned via a Race, Class, or item.

You know your way around patches and love collecting them. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you are able to identify a patch and its bonus level, if any.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can sew and iron patches onto clothing using this Skill.

Rank 10: You may use this as a crafting Skill, but crafting tables provide no bonuses. Enchanted patches are limited to one per Gear slot and do not take up Accessory slots. See *Crafting*, p. 221.

Rank 15: Your crafting Checks take half the time. Increase the bonus value of your enchantments with this Skill by 1, at no additional Difficulty or time to craft. *Example:* If you craft a +2 Strength patch, it becomes a +3 Strength patch.

SHIELD BLOCK

Strength, Interrupt

Limitations: Requires you to be wielding a shield. Cannot be used against Area of Effect damage. A successful Shield Block still counts as "a hit crawler" or "a crawler who failed to Evade."

You're one of those types. You like a big slab of wood or metal between you and the beasties. When you are attacked by a physical Attack, spend one Action to make a separate Shield Block Skill Check vs. the Mob's "to hit" for each of the Attacks targeting you. If 3 physical Attacks are directed at you, roll this Skill Check 3 times. Where an Evade Check is called for, ask your GM if you can use this Skill.

On Success, take half the damage before applying your DR. Your Shield takes a -1 DR penalty on a Major Fail; -2 on a Critical Fail. It breaks at 0 DR. However, a broken shield and lost DR can be Repaired.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may also use this Skill against Spells and magical damage.

Rank 10: On a Critical Hit, you may make a Shield Bash Attack as a free melee-range Interrupt Attack (instead of Advantage on your next Attack) if you wish, dealing 3d6 base damage + STR Bludgeoning.

Rank 15: +1d6 Shield Bash damage. Further reduce the damage you would take by your STR Mod. *Example:* After halving 30 damage down to 15, your STR Mod of 5 reduces it to 10 damage.

SLEIGHT OF HAND

Dexterity

Limitations: Items you manipulate must be smaller than the size of your hand. You cannot access others' Inventories or Hotlists.

You've learned to manipulate small objects without being spotted. Great for shoplifting. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check. If someone's Perception is a higher Rank than your Sleight of Hand, you have Disadvantage.

On Success, you maneuver the item without being noticed.

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UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may attempt to pick the pockets of NPCs and Mobs.

Rank 10: You may attempt to plant items on someone with pockets or the equivalent.

Rank 15: You may manipulate items up to half your own size (rounded down).

SMITHING

Strength

You may craft mundane items such as horseshoes, railroad spikes, nails, or the fun stuff: armor and weapons, but without DR or any bonuses. See *Crafting*, p. 221.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may craft items up to a +5 bonus.

Rank 10: You may craft items up to a +10 bonus.

Rank 15: Your crafting with this Skill takes half the time.

STEALTH

Dexterity

Limitations: You must be out of sight of all foes to begin this Check.

Use this Skill if you want to move undetected or surprise a Mob. Make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success before combat starts, you are unnoticed and gain 1 non-Attack Action. Don't forget to take your 10ft Step!

On Success in a non-combat situation, you remain unnoticed and can perform a Move Action with a 10ft Step as part of this Check.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your surprise Action can be an Attack with Advantage.

Rank 10: When other crawlers in your party roll this Skill untrained, they roll as normal (not with Disadvantage).

Rank 15: On a successful Surprise Check, you may also take a full Move and Step. If you Attack with your Surprise Action, deal ×2 the base damage dice.

STREETWISE

Charisma

Use this Skill in populated areas to learn or spread rumors, avoid attracting too much attention, gain access to less-than-legal items, and the like. Make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you navigate a town without attracting attention, deal with a criminal network, identify an informal power structure, or gain the information you're seeking.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You also hear an additional rumor, as determined by the GM. Or spread one!

Rank 10: You also quickly find a hiding place determined by the GM.

Rank 15: You also uncover information that might give you some leverage on an important person in town determined by the GM.

SURVIVAL

Constitution

You know how to survive in dangerous, often remote places for long periods of time with only the meager food and water you can rustle up. When traveling through such areas, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you survive the perils of the conditions unscathed. On a standard Fail, you suffer the effects of hunger and/or thirst (see p. 76).

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You do not suffer additional damage from a Critical Fail.

Rank 10: When other crawlers in your party roll this Skill untrained, they roll as normal (not with Disadvantage).

Rank 15: You do not suffer additional damage from a Major Fail.

SWIMMING

Strength

Limitations: After 1 minute of Swimming (Success or Fail) or immediately on a Major Fail or worse, gain the Fatigued Debuff.

Use this Skill when there are consequences for not swimming strongly or well rather than when you're taking a casual swim. For instance, if you're racing for your life, swimming against a strong current, or trying to get to shore to avoid a waterfall. In these cases, make an Unopposed Skill Check every 30 seconds.

On Success, you swim well despite the danger. For swimming during combat, see *Special Forms of Movement*, p. 70.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: After 2 minutes of Swimming (Success or Fail), gain the Fatigued Debuff.

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Rank 10: You can swim at your full Move rate as an Action, but you still can't take a 10ft Step.

Rank 15: Make this Check every 5 minutes, and only gain the Fatigue Debuff on a Critical Fail.

TACTICS

Intelligence

Limitations: A crawler may attempt this Skill Check only once per combat.

Your tactical mind and directions can spur your allies to victory. Choose one of the following combat disciplines: Attack, Damage, or Evade, and then make an Unopposed Skill Check.

On Success, you and each member of your party gain a +1 bonus to Checks for the chosen discipline. Increase the bonus by +1 for each higher degree of Success.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you observe the foes and battlefield for at least 5 minutes prior to combat, roll this Skill Check with Advantage.

Rank 10: After using this Skill during a combat, you roll 2d10 when you Call a Play (still choose one die).

Rank 15: The bonus applies to all three combat disciplines instead of just one.

TATTOO ARTISTRY

Dexterity

Used to stick and poke ink under someone's skin to create a mundane tattoo. See *Crafting,* p. 221 for magical tattoos.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may craft tattoos with up to a +5 bonus.

Rank 10: You may craft tattoos with up to a +10 bonus.

Rank 15: Your crafting with this Skill takes half the time.

TAUNT

Charisma, Interrupt

With a shout, some choice words, and maybe an obscene hand gesture, you attempt to draw the ire of enemies within 30 feet of you. After seeing where the Mob Attacks are headed, make an INT-Opposed Skill Check.

On Success, Taunt one Attack of your choosing away from any target of your choosing and onto you. Higher degrees of Success allow you to Taunt additional Attacks onto you.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may make a free Evade Check against each Taunted Attack (roll separately vs. each Attack as usual). Then you may still spend an Action to Evade other Attacks and reroll any Fails from your free Evades.

Rank 10: You can affect Mobs within 60 feet.

Rank 15: Your free Evade Checks against Taunted Attacks are made with Advantage.

THROWING

Strength

This Skill is used for passing the pigskin with your pops or throwing dynamite (potentially also at your pops).

You can Throw an object that weighs up to your STR in pounds at a distance of up to your STR × 10 feet. If you want to Throw a heavier or bulkier item (up to the GM's discretion), you do so with Disadvantage.

To hit a target area, make an Unopposed Skill Check.

To hit a foe with an object, make an Attack Skill Check vs. the target's Evade.

On Success, you hit the target.

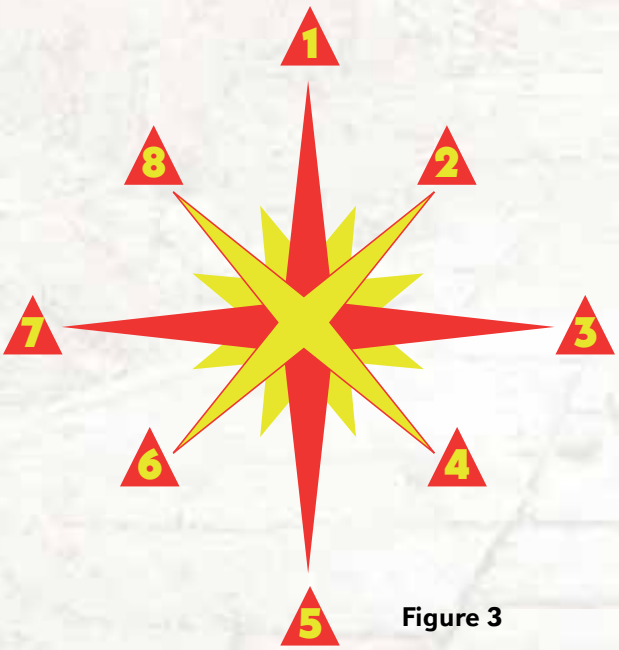

Figure 3

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On Fail, roll 1d8 for direction (see Figure 3). The amount the Skill Check missed by is the distance away in feet it lands.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You have Advantage when Throwing to a target who wants to catch what you are selling.

Rank 10: Choose the direction on a miss, rather than roll.

Rank 15: Your Throw range is your STR ×20 feet.

TRACKING

Intelligence

Use this Skill to find and follow tracks. When searching for or attempting to follow tracks, make an Unopposed Skill Check. Factors such as how long ago the tracks were made, the ground conditions, and whether other tracks or marks obscure them may influence the Difficulty. Once you find tracks, you must make another Tracking Check every 15 minutes to continue following them.

On Success, you either find the tracks or continue following them.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can follow found tracks for 30 minutes before making a new Check, and gain 1 piece of information about the target(s).

Rank 10: You can follow found tracks for 1 hour before making a new Check, and gain 2 pieces of information about the target(s).

Rank 15: You can follow found tracks for 2 hours before making a new Check, and gain 4 pieces of information about the target(s).

TRAP ENGINEER

Intelligence

Used to craft traps via a Sapper's Table with a Trap Module (3,000 gold). See *Crafting,* p. 221.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Roll with Advantage when making non-explosive traps.

Rank 10: Your traps can be set to trigger only against a specific Mob, Boss, NPC, or crawler.

Rank 15: Add a +5 Splash to your trap at no additional Difficulty, and your crafting takes half the time.

ZONE OF CONTROL

Passive

Limitations: You must be wielding a Reach weapon.

Once per round, when an enemy enters a space adjacent to you for the first time, you may perform an Interrupt Attack against them at a cost of one Action. Make the Attack with Disadvantage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your Attack is no longer made with Disadvantage.

Rank 10: The target is pushed 5 feet.

Rank 15: Make your Attack Skill Check with Advantage.

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SPELLS

Spells are the strange, dangerous, and occasionally irresponsible way crawlers bend reality. Some Spells heal wounds or reshape the battlefield, and others exist primarily to make something stop moving—permanently. Spells *cannot* be attempted untrained except via a scroll.

Every Spell listed in this section follows the same core rules for things like casting, targeting, and spending Mana. Spell listings include a variety of terms or fields associated with them, including:

Name: The name of the Spell appears as a headline to the entry.

Type: Whether the Spell is an Attack or Passive is noted under the flavor text. The type of damage delivered from Attack Spells is also listed here for quick reference. Spells default to your INT Mod for to-hit and damage rolls. If a different Stat is listed here, that Stat is used to hit and damage, but Spells all still use Intelligence for Mana. If the spell is *Favored* by any particular Classes, other Classes pay 1 additional Mana to cast it.

Mana Cost: The Mana cost to cast the Spell.

Range: The range of the Spell. Melee means 5ft (adjacent).

Duration: Some Spells are not instantaneous. When the duration is reached, the Spell effect wears off at the end of that round.

AI Favor: Low-damage Spells grant AI Favor to you if you use such a wimpy attack for a majority of your attacks during a combat that lasts for at least three rounds.

Limitations: If there are conditions, requirements, or exclusions, they go here.

Cooldown: If the Spell has a cooldown, it is listed here. You can't cast the Spell during its cooldown.

Description: Any notes or descriptions of the general effect seen when you cast the Spell are listed here. If the Spell requires a Spell Check, that is also provided here.

Base Damage: This is the damage the Spell deals with 1–4 Ranks in the Spell. You add your INT to the base damage, unless it says otherwise. The damage type is listed here as well.

Upgrades: These are bonuses you gain when you reach the listed Rank in the Spell. The first entry of each benefit adds a damage die of the same type to the base damage of the Spell. Additional damage dice and effects are also listed here.

SPELLS IN YOUR HOTLIST

Don't forget that Spells need to be in your Hotlist to cast them in combat or other stressful situations. Write down the specific combat text for your Spell in the "Attacks" section on the front of your character sheet. When you write a Spell on your Hotlist, you need only list additional notes like the Mana cost and Range of the Spell.

Attack Spells require you to make an Attack Skill Check vs. the target's Evade. Spells that don't require a Check to be made when cast (non-Attack Spells) are tagged as Passive and simply happen, but those are not marked for Skill Advancement (p. 169) when used. Instead, their Ranks must be raised via magical means or trained at a guild.

CREATING YOUR OWN SPELLS

In the ways that count, Spells are just a special type of Skill. Create them in the same way as you're create a Skill (p. 174–175).

LIST OF SPELLS

AIR BUDDY

"There's no dungeon rule that a dog can't fly."

Passive, Favored: Mage

Mana Cost: 12

Range: Self

You launch yourself with enough force to fly, hurtling forward from your current position up to 10 × your INT Mod away. You land safely if you land on solid ground; otherwise, you fall (see p. 76). You can cast this twice in a row to "double jump" just like in platforming video games.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may choose one additional willing target up to your size at touch range, who you bring with you.

Rank 10: You can fly up to 20 × your INT Mod away with this spell.

Rank 15: You may choose up to five additional willing targets up to your size at touch range to bring with you.

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ASTRAL PAW (ASTRAL HAND, ASTRAL CLAW)

"You have summoned an Astral Paw. Yes, just the paw. Budget constraints."

Passive

Mana Cost: 12

Range: 30 feet

Duration: Until the end of combat or 5 minutes.

You conjure a spectral hand, paw, or claw, looking much like your own. You can use this astral appendage to manipulate objects up to 30ft away by spending an Action. You can use the Astral Paw to make Skill Checks but suffer Disadvantage due to a lack of fine control.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Your Pugilism and Slice Attacks with the Paw add 1 Astral Paw Rank damage die.

Rank 10: You can conjure a paw up to four size categories larger than your own, and the range increases to 50 feet.

Rank 15: The caster no longer suffers Disadvantage when performing suitable Skill Checks using the paw, and the duration is 15 minutes.

BAD FAITH

"The system has classified your prayers as a hostile act."

Attack, Necrotic, Charisma, Favored: Cleric

Mana Cost: 10

Range: 40 feet

An unholy presence invades your victim's mind, body, and soul.

Base Damage: 1d8 + CHA Necrotic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage, +5ft Splash

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage, and end all Buffs on the victims for the duration of the combat.

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, +5ft Splash

BANG BRO

"When you want more zing in your zinger."

Passive

Mana Cost: 5

Range: 5 feet

Duration: 5 minutes + 1 minute per Rank

Cooldown: 15 minutes

Place a hot and crackling temporary enchantment on a weapon you are holding.

Your weapon deals +2 mixed Fire and Electric damage.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 Fire and Electric damage

Rank 10: +1d6 Fire and Electric damage, and on an Amazing Success, the target of the weapon attack gains the Burned Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d6 Fire and Electric damage, and on an Amazing Success, the target of the weapon attack also gains the Shocked Debuff.

CLOCKWORK TRIPLICATE

"If one is good, then three is a party."

Passive

Mana Cost: 26

Range: 5 feet

Duration: 1 minute per Rank

Limitations: Only castable on pets and minions.

When you cast this spell upon your pet or minion, it splits into three, each with its full complement of abilities. You must spend an Action making an Unopposed Animal Handling Skill Check to issue a new command to each one separately.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Duration is 2 minutes per Rank.

Rank 10: Duration is 3 minutes per Rank.

Rank 15: When you command your pet or minion, the clockwork versions follow suit.

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CONFUSING FOG

"Visibility reduced. Decision-making questionable."

Passive

Mana Cost: 6

Range: 40 feet

Duration: Until the end of two full rounds of combat or 20 seconds

Cooldown: 15 minutes

You create a billowing cloud of fog that you, your party members, and friendly NPCs can see through, but it obscures the area from Mobs, making it more difficult for them to attack you. Mobs attack with Disadvantage (see *Mob Advantage and Disadvantage*, p. 60) against targets in the fog.

This fog fills a 25 × 25ft area. Smart Mobs may attempt to move the combat out of the fog if able.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The fog fills a 50 × 50ft area, and its duration is 1 minute.

Rank 10: The fog fills a 100 × 100ft area and lasts for 5 minutes.

Rank 15: The fog fills a 500 × 500ft area and lasts for 15 minutes.

DIRT CLOD

"You have weaponized dirt."

Attack, Bludgeoning

Mana Cost: 1

Range: 100 feet

AI Favor: 2

You hurl a magical clod of dirt, leaving dirt and pebbles strewn about near the target.

Base Damage: 1d2 + INT Bludgeoning

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +2d2 base damage

Rank 10: +1d2 base damage, and the target gains the Woozy Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d2 base damage, and 1 Rank damage die.

DRAIN LIFE

"Organic tether deployed. Try not to think about where it's been."

Attack, Necrotic

Mana Cost: 14

Range: 30 feet

Limitations: For a brief instant, you create a disgusting blood vein that reaches out and wraps itself around your target.

Base Damage: 1d6 + INT Necrotic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage, and if the target loses at least 3 Health Bar slots, you heal 1 Health Bar slot.

Rank 10: +1d6 base damage, and if you heal this way, heal +1 Health Bar slot.

Rank 15: +1d6 base damage, and if you heal this way, heal +1 Health Bar slot.

EARWORM

"Hitting every note except the right ones."

Attack, Sonic, Charisma, Favored: Bard

Mana Cost: 6

Range: 30ft

Cooldown: Once per round.

Sing a terrible song targeting the ear holes of a victim. Yes, sing a few bars so the GM understands the pain you're inflicting.

Base Damage: 1d6 + CHA Sonic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d6 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d6 base damage, and the target gains the Queasy Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d6 base damage and +10ft Splash.

FEAR

"Run away, little piggies!"

Attack, Mind Control

Mana Cost: 3

Range: 25 feet

Limitations: Warning: Scary-ass Mobs are immune to Fear effects (GM's discretion).

Target a non-Boss Mob of half your level or less. On a Standard Success, it stands its ground, but it loses its DEX Mod for the duration of the combat. On a higher success, it uses two of its Actions during the next round to run away.

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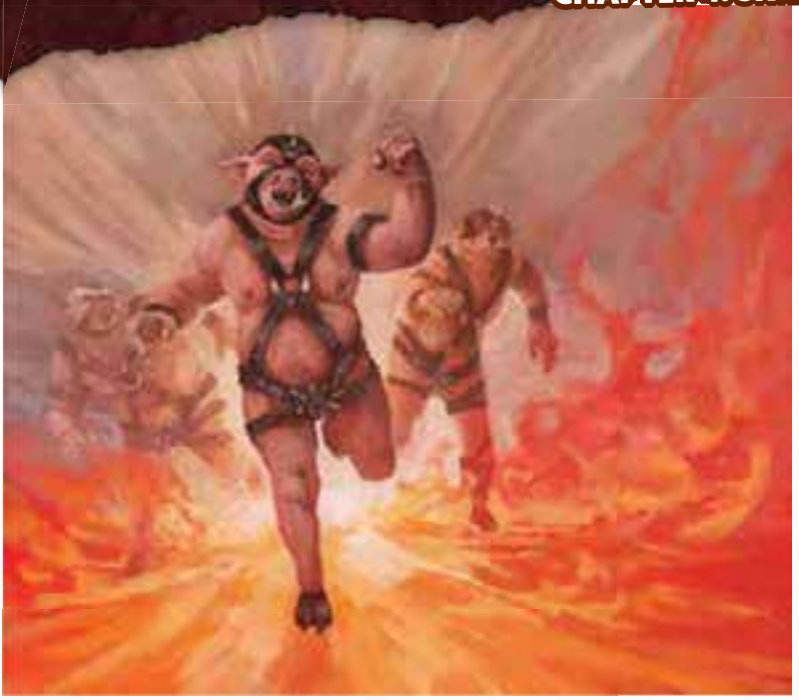

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +5ft Blast radius.

Rank 10: +5ft Blast radius, and on a Critical Hit, the affected creatures gain the Paralyzed Debuff.

Rank 15: +5ft Blast radius.

FIREBALL

"It almost reluctantly meanders toward you. Then your world explodes."

Attack, Fire, Area of Effect

Mana Cost: 45

Range: 80 feet

Cooldown: Once per scene

A creeping beach ball-sized sphere of fire emanates from you. Since it moves so slowly, your attack is made with Disadvantage. When the impact zone has been determined, each creature in a 10ft Blast radius takes full damage.

On Fail, roll 1d8 for direction (see Figure 3, p. 200). The amount the Skill Check missed by is the distance away in feet it impacts.

Base Damage: 1d12 + INT Fire, 10ft Blast radius

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d12 base damage. Those who lose 1 or more Health Bar slots via this attack gain the Burned Debuff.

Rank 10: +1d12 base damage and becomes an 80ft Line attack (and keeps the Blast).

Rank 15: +1d12 base damage and +40ft Splash (on the Blast).

FIRE FINGERS

"Fire Fingers activated. Try not to make it weird."

Attack, Fire

Mana Cost: 3

Range: Melee

AI Favor: 1

Brilliant flame leaps from your fingers.

Base Damage: 1d4 + INT Fire

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and the target gains the Burned Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and your hands begin to intermittently burn. Your Pugilism, Unarmed Combat, and Slice Attack strikes add 1 Fire Fingers Rank damage die (Fire).

FROST SCAR

"Frigid status achieved; relationships may suffer."

Attack, Ice

Mana Cost: 2

Range: Melee

AI Favor: 1

With a slice of your frigid hand, you leave a scar of rime on your target.

Base Damage: 1d4 + INT Ice

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and the target cannot heal themselves in the next combat round.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and the target gains the Stiff Legs Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and the target gains The Taint Debuff.

GRAND ILLUSION

"Why, yes, that is my pet T-Rex."

Intelligence

Mana Cost: 7

Range: 40 feet

Duration: 2 minutes

Cooldown: 15 minutes

You create an illusion that might trick your foes.

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Make a single INT-Opposed Spell Check vs. foes who can see it. Your same roll is used against foes who see it even after the casting round.

Mundane illusions seeking only to impress might be rolled with Advantage, while complex illusions seeking a specific response or images that suddenly pop up during combat might be rolled with Disadvantage (GM's discretion).

On Success, they believe your illusion.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Those who believe gain the Woozy Debuff or similar based on the desired response.

Rank 10: Those who believe also gain the Queasy Debuff or similar based on the desired response.

Rank 15: Those who believe also gain the Shocked Debuff or similar based on the desired response.

HEAL

"Congratulations on not dying... yet."

Heal, Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: 2

Range: Self only

Limitations: Rank 1 maximum

Heal 2 Health Bar slots.

UPGRADES

None

HEAL CRITTER

"Your pet has been restored to maximum cuddle capacity."

Heal, Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: 8

Range: 30 feet

Limitations: May only be cast on pets and minions (sorry, Donut).

The target glows as they heal back to 100% Health Bar.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The target mends a Minor Injury Debuff.

Rank 10: The target mends a Major Injury Debuff.

Rank 15: The target regrows all lost appendages.

HEAL OTHERS

"Tell me you're a Cleric without..."

Heal, Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: 6

Range: 30 feet

Limitations: You can't cast this Spell on yourself, pets, or minions.

A wave of positive vibes engulfs the target. They heal 1d4 Health Bar slots.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The target heals 1d6 Health Bar slots.

Rank 10: The target heals 2d6 Health Bar slots.

Rank 15: Instead of a single target, all party members within a 20ft Burst radius are healed.

HEAL SELF

"Way easier than manually shoving your guts back in!"

Heal, Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: 1

Range: Self only

Limitations: You can only case this Spell on yourself.

You center yourself, using magic to make yourself whole. You heal 1d4 Health Bar slots.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You heal 1d6 Health Bar slots and mend a Minor Injury, Poison, or Disease Debuff.

Rank 10: You heal 2d6 Health Bar slots and mend a Major Injury or other Debuff.

Rank 15: You heal to full and gain the benefits of a short rest.

HOLE

"It's a hole. This will absolutely be misused."

Passive

Mana Cost: 12

Range: 10 feet

Duration: Until the end of the combat or 5 minutes.

Limitations: Can't be used on saferoom doors or living things.

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You create a temporary cylindrical hole in a surface or material within range, to a depth of 1 inch per Spell Rank and a diameter of 2ft. Anything that can fit in the hole can pass through it if the hole is deep enough to penetrate to the other side of the surface.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can reduce the diameter of the hole to a smaller size when cast.

Rank 10: You can widen the hole's diameter by 1 inch for every inch of depth you sacrifice when cast.

Rank 15: The caster may end the spell with a thought (like an Interrupt, but it doesn't cost an Action). Anything in the hole at that time is destroyed.

HOLY AURA

"Look who's all high and mighty."

Attack, Holy, Area of Effect, Charisma, Favored: Cleric & Paladin

Mana Cost: 7

Range: 5ft Burst radius

Cooldown: Once per round

You channel your deity and emanate their essence to hurt only the enemies around you.

Base Damage: 1d4 + CHA Holy, 5ft Burst radius

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and affected undead Mobs take double damage.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage and +5ft Burst radius.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage and +5ft Burst radius.

HOT STUFF AURA

"Bask in the warm glow of my machismo!"

Passive, Area of Effect, Favored: Bard

Mana Cost: 8

Range: 5ft Burst radius

Duration: 2 rounds

Cooldown: 5 minutes

You create a shield of pure sex appeal around you against all damage types with a number of Health Bar slots equal to your CHA Mod, and a 2 in each slot. It also protects all allies within the radius. When depleted, it disappears. These slots cannot be healed.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Increase the Health to 4 in each slot.

Rank 10: +5ft Burst radius, with a 6 in each slot.

Rank 15: +10ft Burst radius, with a 8 in each slot.

ICE BLAST

"Hope they brought a jacket."

Attack, Ice

Mana Cost: 9

Range: 40 feet

With the howl of blizzard winds, you let loose a compact pocket of freezing cold and ice.

Base Damage: 1d8 + INT Ice

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage, and the target is pushed 10 feet away from you.

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and you can change the range to a 15ft Cone Attack.

ICICLES

"Did you know that icicles are the #1 cause of home head impalements?"

Attack, Ice

Mana Cost: 19

Range: 60 feet

Seizing upon the ice that runs through your veins, icicle projectiles shoot forth from your palms towards distant foes.

Base Damage: 1d12 + INT Ice

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d12 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d12 base damage, and the target gains the Stiff Legs Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d12 base damage, and the damage is Armor-Piercing.

"It's pretty cool. I saw you shooting icicles out of your hand."

—Carl

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INTIMATE TOUCHES

"Show me on the doll where they healed you."

Heal, Passive, Favored: Cleric & Paladin

Mana Cost: 8

Range: 5 feet

Limitations: Unlike most healing, this spell is not an Interrupt.

You lay hands on the target (which could be you), who heals Health Bar slots equal to your CHA Mod.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The target also heals a Minor Injury Debuff.

Rank 10: The target also heals a Major Injury Debuff.

Rank 15: The target also heals all Poison & Disease Debuffs.

LIGHTNING BOLT

"Bolt released, viewership spike detected."

Attack, Electric

Mana Cost: 15

Range: 100 feet

With a thunderous clap, you let loose a bolt of lightning.

Base Damage: 1d10 + INT Electric

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d10 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d10 base damage and becomes a 100ft Line Attack.

Rank 15: +1d10 base damage. The lightning bolt forks, and you may choose to apply your Attack against any number of additional targets within 15 feet of the previous target (within the range limit). Each successful Attack (including against the primary target), deals half damage.

MAGIC MISSILE

"Standard Spell detected. Viewers appreciate the nostalgia."

Attack, Force

Mana Cost: 5

Range: Within your line of sight

AI Favor: 1

From glowing eyes, fingers, or whatever, a streak of pure force shoots out.

Base Damage: 1d4 + INT Force

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and you can cast the Spell at a higher or lower Mana cost.

3 Mana: −4 damage

4 Mana: −2 damage

6 Mana: Add 1 Rank damage die

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and the missiles deal Force and Fire damage. The target gains the Burned Debuff.

Rank 15: This attack deals base damage ×3.

MIND TICKLE

"Don't think of an elephant."

Attack, Psychic, Charisma, Favored: Cleric

Mana Cost: 2

Range: 40 feet

AI Favor: 2

You infect your target with a small headache.

Base Damage: 1d2 + CHA Psychic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d2 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d2 base damage, and the target gains the Sore as Shit Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d2 base damage, and the target gains the Muted Debuff.

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MINION ARMY

"No army can triumph when subjected to internecine conflict."

Intelligence, Area of Effect, Mind Control

Mana Cost: 50

Range: 50ft Burst radius

Duration: 2 minutes

Cooldown: 5 hours

Limitations: 5-minute casting time, and the caster cannot move while casting. Only works against Mobs with an Intelligence of 2+.

When you cast this spell, choose a target within range. On a Standard Success, 1 in 50 Mobs in the affected area (min 1) become an ally and fight for you without needing to command them. Higher levels of success can turn additional Mobs into allies (GM's discretion).

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The casting time is 4 minutes. Duration is 5 minutes.

Rank 10: Add your Charisma Stat to the Burst radius. Duration is 10 minutes.

Rank 15: Add your Charisma Stat to the Burst radius. Duration is 15 minutes.

NATURE'S BREATH

"This recycled dungeon air is bad for my complexion."

Heal, Interrupt, Passive, Favored: Druid

Mana Cost: 6

Range: 5 feet

You blow cool, fresh air over the target's wounds (could be yourself), healing them. Roll a Nature's Breath Rank damage die. That is how many Health Bar slots the target heals. May also target pets and minions.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Add 1 to your die roll.

Rank 10: Add 1 to your die roll, and remove a Minor Injury Debuff.

Rank 15: Add 1 to your die roll, and remove a Major Injury Debuff.

OAKHIDE

"My bark is worse than my bite."

Passive, Favored: Druid

Mana Cost: 5

Range: Self

Duration: 2 minutes

Cooldown: 10 minutes

Your skin turns into solid wood, giving you great protection. You have +2 Damage Resistance for the duration of this spell.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +2 DR. Duration is 3 minutes.

Rank 10: +2 DR. You may target party members and NPCs up to 10 feet away with this spell.

Rank 15: +2 DR. Duration is 4 minutes.

PALADIN'S SMITE

"Repent or die!"

Attack, Holy, Charisma, Favored: Paladin

Mana Cost: 11

Range: 30 feet

You channel a torrent of divine wrath toward a soon-to-be repentant foe.

Base Damage: 1d8 + CHA Holy

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage, and the target gains the Take Down Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage, and the damage is Armor-Piercing (ignores DR).

PANTY DROPPER

"You know what's on the menu? Me-n-u."

Charisma, Mind Control, Favored: Bard

Mana Cost: 10

Range: 10 feet

Duration: 2 minutes or until you finish

Cooldown: 5 minutes

Make an INT-Opposed Spell Check against a non-Boss target, even in combat. Fighting's just another form of penetration, after all.

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On Success, the target wants to jump your bones and won't let anyone stop them (they cease attacking or doing other things).

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The duration is 5 minutes.

Rank 10: The duration is 10 minutes.

Rank 15: The duration is 15 minutes.

PING

"Here piggy, piggy."

Passive, Area of Effect

Mana Cost: 5

Range: 1 mile Burst radius

Cooldown: 5 minutes

Sends out an audible ping that gives the distance and location of all non-crawlers and non-red-tagged Mobs in a circle around you. It will mark targets beyond the range of your map. You receive information about the Mobs that is "somewhat complete."

Targets hit with Ping will hear an audible ping noise, but they will not know where the ping originated. Environmental factors and obstacles may increase or decrease range.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: If you know the Fear Spell (see p. 204), you may cast it at no Action cost to affect all eligible Mobs within the Ping range. You only pay the Mana.

Rank 10: Environmental factors and obstacles no longer decrease the range, and you receive "mostly complete" information.

Rank 15: You pay no Mana to add the Fear Spell, and you receive "entirely complete" information.

PROTECTIVE SHELL

"Hope activated. Try not to waste it."

Interrupt, Passive, Area of Effect

Mana Cost: None

Range: 10ft Burst radius

Duration: 5 seconds (only long enough to push foes away and protect against a single physical attack)

Cooldown: 30 hours

Limitations: Spell must be imbued onto something you are wearing. The shell cannot be moved by any means.

You create a 10 + INT-foot Burst radius magic shell around yourself and nearby party members.

This shell pushes away all Mobs in its Area, which is the shell's radius + 5ft. Mobs cannot enter the shell (unless non-corporeal) or physically attack those inside. The shell does not protect against magic effects. Crawlers inside may attack as usual.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Duration is 10 seconds. In addition to knocking enemies away, it protects the occupants from all non-Spell attacks originating from outside the shell until the end of the current combat round.

Rank 10: Duration is 20 seconds or two rounds.

Rank 15: Duration is 30 seconds or three rounds.

PUDDLE JUMPER

"Teleportation doesn't suck."

Passive

Mana Cost: 20

Range: Line-of-sight to the destination surface

Limitations: There is a 10-second delay before the effect takes place.

Cooldown: 5 hours

You and up to 3 party members of your choice teleport to another location. Everyone feels a tingling sensation while waiting for the effect to resolve.

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UPGRADES

Rank 5: The delay is 2 seconds, and the destination doesn't have to be a surface.

Rank 10: The delay is 1 second, and the destination can be anywhere within 1,000 yards in any direction, even if the exact destination cannot be seen.

Rank 15: There is no delay, and the destination can be anywhere within 1 mile in any direction, even if the exact destination cannot be seen.

RISE, DEAD MINION!

"The bigger they are, the deeper they're buried."

Attack, Favored: Necromancer

Mana Cost: 10

Range: 30 feet

Duration: 1 round

At your command, a Medium (4) size skeleton emerges from the ground to attack your foe in melee combat, dealing 1d8 + INT Necrotic damage. After the Attack, the skeleton collapses, creating difficult terrain in the space it occupied.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The skeleton attacks twice before collapsing.

Rank 10: The skeleton increases to size Large (5), and its Attack range is 10 feet. +1d8 base damage.

Rank 15: The skeleton increases to size Colossal (7), and its Attack range is 15 feet. Add one Rise, Dead Minion! Rank damage die to the damage.

ROOTFOOT

"The ground is never empty. It is only sleeping."

Attack, Favored: Druid

Mana Cost: 5

Range: 30 feet

Duration: 2 rounds

Roots reach up from the ground to ensnare a victim of up to Size 4 (Medium).

On Success, the victim gains the Held Debuff. The Rank of this Spell is used in the Opposed Difficulty to escape, instead of the default STR.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: Can target victims up to size Large (5). Duration is 3 rounds.

Rank 10: Can target victims up to size Huge (6). Duration is 4 rounds.

Rank 15: Can target victims up to size Colossal (7). The victim also gains the Poisoned Debuff.

SECOND CHANCE

"Everyone deserves one. Except for Phil. Never Phil."

Passive

Mana Cost: 10

Range: 10 feet

Duration: 1 minute

You raise a Mob with a level lower than your own from the dead. The Mob temporarily becomes your Undead Minion with half of its original Health Bar slots.

You spend one Action to command it, then it acts independently with 1 Move Action and 1 other Action (usually an Attack) until given new instructions.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The Mob can be up to 5 levels higher than you, and the duration is 5 minutes.

Rank 10: The Mob can be up to 10 levels higher than the caster, with a duration of 15 minutes.

Rank 15: The Mob can be up to 15 levels higher than the caster, with a duration of 45 minutes.

SHIELD

"Enjoy the illusion of safety."

Interrupt, Passive

Mana Cost: 8

Range: Self

Duration: 5 minutes

You are surrounded by a translucent force field that moves with you and reduces non-magic damage you take. The Shield has 2 Health Bar slots, each with your CON Mod. When you take damage, reduce these Health Bar slots first. The Spell ends early if the shield loses all its Health Bar slots. You can't heal a Shield.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The Shield has 5 Health Bar slots.

Rank 10: The Shield has 10 Health Bar slots.

Rank 15: The Shield has 15 Health Bar slots.

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SHOCK TREATMENT

"Electrical therapy initiated; consent not required."

Attack, Electric

Mana Cost: 2

Range: 30 feet

AI Favor: 2

Like a deranged emperor, bolts of electricity shoot out from your fingers.

Base Damage: 1d2 + INT Electric

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d2 base damage, and you may choose to afflict the target with the Stunned Debuff instead of dealing damage.

Rank 10: +1d2 base damage, and add 1 Rank damage die (Electric) at the end of the round.

Rank 15: +1d2 base damage, and if you make this attack at melee range, you deal ×5 the total damage.

SOLSPLASH

"The sun is merely a star close enough to hate us."

Attack, Fire, Constitution, Favored: Druid

Mana Cost: 13

Range: 30 feet

Beams of concentrated "sunlight" fall upon the victim and those around them. Sunscreen's not gonna help.

Base Damage: 1d8 + CON Fire

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage, +5ft Splash.

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage and +10ft Splash. Each affected entity who loses at least 3 Health Bar slots this way gains the Burned Debuff.

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage and +15ft Splash.

SOUL COLLECTOR

"This soul appears... reusable."

Attack, Necrotic

Mana Cost: 4

Range: 50 feet

AI Favor: 1

With a twist of your hand, you siphon the spirit from your target.

Base Damage: 1d4 + INT Necrotic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage, and if this Spell deals the killing blow to a foe of at least half your level, it deals +1 bonus damage until you complete a long rest. This damage bonus is cumulative up to the Spell's Rank.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and the bonus continues for one week.

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage, and the bonus continues for as long as you remain on your current floor.

THUNDERLASH

"Loud noises and bad decisions go hand-in-hand."

Attack, Sonic

Mana Cost: 12

Range: 50 feet

You unleash a whip-like emanation of pure sound which thunders through the air.

Base Damage: 1d10 + INT Sonic

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d10 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d10 base damage, and this attack deals Armor-Piercing damage (ignores DR).

Rank 15: +1d10 base damage, and you can change the range to a 15ft Cone attack.

TORCH

"Congratulations. You can now see what's trying to kill you."

Passive

Mana Cost: 1

Range: Self

Duration: Until you enter a saferoom or descend to a new floor.

You create a magical orb of light that follows slightly above and behind you. It provides bright light for a 20ft radius and dim light for a 20ft radius past that.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You can move the orb up to 20 feet away from you.

Rank 10: You can move the orb up to 60 feet away from you and can double the radius of the brightness with a thought.

Rank 15: You can move the orb up to 100 feet away from you and attach it to a surface as an Action.

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TRIPPER

"Let's see if they know we're coming."
Passive, Area of Effect

Mana Cost: None

Range: 30ft Burst radius

Limitations: Does not detonate traps with very specific triggers. Must be imbued onto something you are wearing.

Cooldown: 5 hours

With a snap of your fingers, every movement, heat, and weight-triggered trap in the area "goes off." Blades swing, bombs blow, and creatures are released.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +Intelligence Burst radius.

Rank 10: +Intelligence Burst radius.

Rank 15: +Intelligence Burst radius, and all damage taken is considered Splash (half damage).

TURN UNDEAD

"What is dead should stay dead... and far away."
Attack, Area of Effect, Favored: Bard, Cleric, & Paladin

Mana Cost: 9

Range: 10ft Cone

Duration: 3 rounds

Limitations: Does not work against Bosses.

Cooldown: 5 minutes

Make a single CHA-Opposed Spell Check vs. the Undead Mobs in the affected area.

On Success, the Undead Mob runs away for the duration of the Spell.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +5ft Cone. Duration is 5 rounds.

Rank 10: +10ft Cone. Duration is 10 rounds.

Rank 15: +15ft Cone. Duration is 15 rounds. On an Amazing Success or better, the Undead Mob is destroyed.

TWINKLE TOES

"Fly my pretties, fly!"
Intelligence, Passive

Mana Cost: 2

Range: 5 feet

Duration: A number of seconds equal to your Intelligence.

Target a pet or minion within range. It has Move ×2 for the duration.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The pet or minion has Move ×3 for the duration.

Rank 10: The pet or minion has Move ×4 for the duration.

Rank 15: The pet or minion has Move ×5 for the duration.

UNNECESSARY FORCE

"Excessive force authorized. Paperwork waived."
Attack, Force

Mana Cost: 13

Range: 40 feet

A shockwave akin to that of an A-bomb crashes over your target.

Base Damage: 1d12 + INT Force

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d12 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d12 base damage, and the target is pushed 10 feet.

Rank 15: +1d12 base damage, and the target is pushed 15 feet.

VINE PORN

"It's like tentacle porn, but with vines... sorry, Mom."
Attack, Piercing, Constitution, Favored: Druid

Mana Cost: 3

Range: 20 feet

AI Favor: 1

Magical vines with pulsating veins shoot up from the ground or sprout from the target's own body to rip and tear and smack them around a bit.

Base Damage: 1d4 + CON Piercing

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d4 base damage.

Rank 10: +1d4 base damage, and this Attack deals Armor-Piercing damage (ignores DR).

Rank 15: +1d4 base damage. On a Critical Hit, the target takes ×4 damage.

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WALL OF FIRE

"You're gonna fall in... to a burnin' ring of fire."

Passive, Fire

Mana Cost: 15

Range: 30 feet

Duration: 2 rounds

Creates a 30ft-long × 7ft-high × 2ft-thick wall of fire.

Base Damage: 1d2 Fire for every 1ft of wall the victim passes through, and they gain the Burned Debuff.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d2 base damage. The wall can be turned into a ring of fire. Duration is 5 rounds.

Rank 10: +1d2 base damage. Creates a 50ft-long × 10ft-high × 3ft-thick wall. Duration is 10 rounds.

Rank 15: +1d2 base damage. Creates a 100ft-long × 20ft-high × 5ft-thick wall. Duration is 15 rounds.

WATER BREATHING

"It's okay to inhale."

Intelligence, Passive

Mana Cost: 2

Range: Self

Duration: A number of seconds equal to the caster's Intelligence ×3.

The target can breathe underwater without issue.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: You may now cast this upon others at a range of 5 feet.

Rank 10: The targets roll Swimming Skill Checks with Advantage.

Rank 15: You can target any or all individuals within a 15ft Burst radius.

WEB

"Blast your goo onto foes!"

Attack, Intelligence

Mana Cost: 6

Range: 20ft Cone

Duration: 2 rounds

A cone of sticky webbing shoots from your fingers.

Make a single Spell Attack Skill Check vs. each friend and foe's Evade (if any).

On Success, that entity gains the Held Debuff. The Rank of this spell is used in the Opposed Difficulty to escape, instead of STR.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +5ft Cone. Duration is 5 rounds.

Rank 10: +5ft Cone. Duration is 10 rounds.

Rank 15: +5ft Cone. Duration is 15 rounds.

WILBUR'S SLOW-BUILD FIREBLAST

"Hold. Hold! HOLD!"

Attack, Fire

Mana Cost: 60

Range: 50 feet

Base Damage: 1d8 + INT Fire, and the target gains the Burned Debuff.

This Spell can be cast and held as a swirling ring of fire around your ring finger until you unleash it. Only one ring may be held at a time. The next time you perform an Attack Action, it must be this Spell (at no additional Mana cost).

If anyone touches the ring with the intent to diffuse it (you may oppose that Action), the Attack hits them for half damage. The appendage they touched you with smolders, useless for a number of rounds equal to the damage inflicted.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: +1d8 base damage. For each full day you hold the spell, +1d8 Fire damage.

Rank 10: +1d8 base damage and +5ft Splash.

Rank 15: +1d8 base damage and +5ft Splash.

WISP ARMOR

"Empty minds are surprisingly easy to protect."

Passive

Mana Cost: 5

Range: Self

Duration: 5 minutes

Cooldown: 5 minutes

You conjure a protective barrier that reduces all magic damage (typically Spells) down to its Rank 1 base damage (1 die + Stat Mod) without any Upgrades or other bonuses. This Spell also makes you immune to Mind Control.

UPGRADES

Rank 5: The duration is 10 minutes.

Rank 10: The duration is 15 minutes.

Rank 15: The duration is 20 minutes.

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LOOT

When you get a loot box, it'll be full of all kinds of useful items. Maybe not useful to you, but our many merchants will be happy to take it off your hands so you can spend that gold on something you do want. Or trade it to a party member and see what the AI thinks of that.

Of course, a box isn't the only way to get sweet gear. You're gonna kill a lot of monsters or die trying, and almost every bastard you take out has something on them. Once they're dead, you can loot them and pull all their shit into your Inventory. It's like a box of chocolates—you never know what you're gonna get. The most common stuff you'll find is Misc. Junk.

LOOTING MOBS

Once a combat is over, dead Mobs are ripe for the picking. How pleasant! The armor pieces and weapons they carry are typically of lesser quality than even the mundane items crawlers find in Loot boxes, but might last for a day or two in a pinch. Each dead Mob carries 1d6 Misc. Junk and some amount of gold as well, based on which floor they are on. Roll once for Misc. Junk and gold, and then multiply the result by the number of bodies.

- **First Floor:** Nuthin'
- **Second Floor:** 1d6 gold
- **Third Floor:** 2d4 gold
- **Fourth Floor:** 2d6 gold
- **Fifth Floor:** 2d8 gold

LOOTING BOSSES

I lied—you always know one thing you're gonna get from a Boss: a map. The map's quality depends on the Boss, and no matter what type of map it is, it's bound to help you get around the area easier.

NEIGHBORHOOD MAP

Acquired by defeating a Neighborhood Boss. This adds a map of the Boss's Neighborhood to a crawler's minimap, as well as all Mobs within that Neighborhood. Mobs appear as simple colored dots, but the Neighborhood Map does not provide further details.

Neighborhood Maps make Grinding more efficient. Because you can avoid lulls in the action, if you Grind for 5 or more hours, add 1 hour to your Grinding time. This allows you to Grind for 5 hours (the typical limit per day) and receive credit for 6 (See *Grinding*, p. 259).

BOROUGH FIELD GUIDE

Acquired by defeating a Borough Boss. It will add an outline to individual quadrants within a borough, although details such as hallways or rooms will remain obscured. Focusing on a specific area will trigger a tooltip box to open, revealing the Mob level range and type (For example: Mob Level 15–24, Goblin Type). The Borough Field Guide does not fill in Neighborhood details like a Neighborhood Map.

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Borough Field Guides make Grinding way more efficient because you can avoid lulls in the action. If you Grind for 5 or more hours, add 2 hours to your Grinding time. This allows you to Grind for 5 hours (the typical limit per day) and receive credit for 7.

GOLD

Gold is the currency of the realm, tracked as part of the crawler Inventory system, so there's no need to worry about some dirty ragamuffin stealing your pouch when you visit a settlement. All merchants in the dungeon take gold, from everyday saferoom Bopcas to exclusive vendors, and you're bound to get plenty in your loot boxes.

Mobs begin to drop gold on the Second Floor, and you can claim it if you're willing to rifle through their icky pockets. All your gold fits into a single Inventory slot.

MUNDANE ITEMS

Loot boxes contain a lot of mundane items, with crawler biscuits and torches among the most common to keep crawlers fed and from falling on their faces in the dark.

GEAR

Gear, such as armor and weapons, is also common in loot boxes. Higher rarity loot boxes carry magical gear with potent and unique enchantments.

CONSUMABLES

Loot boxes are also a great place to source useful consumables like potions, scrolls, and explosives. Don't die with them in your Inventory—put them into your Hotlist to keep them immediately useful.

RARE MATERIALS

Crafters can find all manner of rare materials for construction projects in loot boxes as well. These are great for creating the gear of your dreams or filling your inventory with gold if you're no builder.

COUPONS & FURNITURE

If you live long enough to make it past the first few floors, you might be able to afford a personal space that you can access from saferooms. Furniture and specialized equipment, like crafting tables, go there. Coupons can be exchanged with Bopcas to expand the types of rooms in your personal space, Trust me, the system knows how much you love player housing and having a cool guild clubhouse—the sky's the limit!

SAMPLE LOOT

So that loot box is staring at you from your Inventory. But what's inside? Typically one magic item or scroll, a consumable or two (potions, bandages, antidotes, etc.), plus gold. The particulars are up to the Game Master, but when you open it up in a saferoom, here are some goodies you might encounter:

BRONZE BOXES

Mostly weak magical items and mundane adventuring items, such as:

- Healing Potion (Heals 5 Health Bar slots)
- Mana Potion (Full restore)
- A Random Piece of Armor with +1 Damage Resistance
- Spell Scroll (One shot, no Mana casting; weak Spell)
- Magic Tome (Learn a new, weak Spell)
- 1d6 Bandages (spend an Action to remove the Blood Trail Debuff)
- Rope (50 feet)
- Canoe and paddle (Staff)
- Bicycle
- Hang glider
- Torches ×10 (Provides bright light for 20 feet and dim light for another 20 feet. It burns out in about an hour.)
- Stick of Basic Dynamite (1d6 Bludgeoning damage, 0ft Blast radius +5ft Splash)
- And almost always 1d10 Gold

SILVER BOXES

Magical items begin to appear with more frequency in silver boxes, as well as more potent consumables.

- Silver Ring of +2 to a Stat (Accessory Slot)
- Potion of +1 Skill (Permanent)
- Spell Scrolls (One shot, no Mana casting)
- Spellbooks (Learn a new Spell)
- Magic Paper (for Scroll-writing)
- Poison Antidotes (2)
- Crawler Biscuits (100)
- Good Healing Potion (Heals 6 Health Bar slots)
- Heal Pet Potion (Heals 5 Health Bar slots)

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- Stick of Good Goblin Dynamite (2d6 Bludgeoning damage, 5ft Blast radius +5ft Splash)
- And almost always 1d10 ×100 Gold

SAMPLE MAGICAL GEAR FROM SILVER BOXES

BITCH-ASS BUCKLER
Gear Slot: Hands/Holding

+1 Shield Block Skill

+3 Damage Resistance

BERNIE BOOTS
Gear Slot: Feet

When you gain the Dying Debuff, you can still perform Move Actions and can read HUD messages related to moving in certain directions.

BIG PURPLE PLUME
Gear Slot: Accessory

+2 Charisma

FRIENDSHIP BRACELET OF [RACE]KIND
Gear Slot: Accessory

Roll 1d10 to randomly select a Race: 1–2 dwarven, 3–4 elven, 5–6 fairy, 7–8 orc, or 9–10 skyfowl. Removes automatic hostility from Mobs and NPCs of the selected Race. They can be bargained with and won't immediately attack, though they're not actually automatically friendly. If you ever take this off, or it breaks, Mobs and NPCs of that Race are automatically hostile for the rest of the Floor.

GOLD BOXES

Gold boxes are where the loot starts getting good and contain items like:

- Golden Ring of +3 to a Stat (Accessory Slot)
- Potion of +2 Skill (Permanent)
- Spellbooks (Learn a new Spell)
- Spell Scrolls (One shot, no Mana casting)
- Magic Paper (for Scroll-writing)
- Crafting, Sapper, Engineer, Alchemy, or Metal Working Table
- Gold Standard Healing Potion (Heals 7 Health Bar slots and mends one Minor Injury)
- Scroll of Upgrade (upgrades a crawler's signature weapon)
- And almost always 1d6 ×1000 Gold

SAMPLE MAGICAL GEAR FROM GOLD BOXES

ENCHANTED ELBOW PADS OF THE ELBOW-WALKING TURKEYS
Gear Slot: Arms

+2 Damage Resistance

+2 Dexterity

SKULLCAP OF SUCKING
Gear Slot: Head

+1 Damage Resistance

Each time you roll a Critical Fail, gain 1 AI Favor.

TOUGH GUY TATTOO
Gear Slot: Accessory

+3 Constitution

Add 10 to your 100% Health Bar slot.

PLATINUM BOXES

Platinum boxes are worth getting excited about. They can change your whole experience in the dungeon with options like significantly upgrading gear, granting new permanent Spells, and other benefits that asshole crawlers will be keen to kill you for.

- An interesting item granting +4 to a Stat
- Potion of +3 Skill (Permanent)
- Supreme Healing Potion (Heals 8 Health Bar slots and mends one Minor or Major Injury; or deals 8d8 Holy damage to an undead Mob)
- Scratcher tickets
- Various Crafting Tables
- Various Crafting Table Upgrade Coupons
- Personal Space Coupons
- Good Mana Refill Potion (Restores 15 Mana per round for 10 rounds)
- Spellbooks (Learn a new Spell)
- Spell Scrolls (One shot, no Mana casting)
- Scroll of Upgrade (upgrades a crawler's signature weapon)
- And almost always 2d6 ×1000 Gold

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SAMPLE MAGICAL GEAR FROM PLATINUM BOXES

SELFIE STICK OF THE SELF-MUTILATOR

Gear Slot: Hand/Holding

You have 1 fewer Health Bar slot while holding this item.

When you enter combat with a Minor Injury, gain 1 Popularity or 2 for a Major Injury. Gain an equal number of Actions each round of the combat.

CHESTY CHEESE GRATER

Gear Slot: Torso

+2 Damage Resistance

+5% Constitution

Damage Reflection 3:1 vs. melee attacks (for every 3 Health Bar slots you lose, the attacker loses 1).

ENCHANTED LEGGINGS OF INSANITY

Gear Slot: Legs

+1 Damage Resistance

+3 Escape Artist Skill

You may fit your body south of your wedding tackle into any sized opening.

MEDICINE OR LUBE? SCRATCHER

As an Action in combat, roll 1d2. On a 1, one target within 20 feet of you is covered in slippery lube, granting the Staggered Debuff. On a 2, the target is affected by a Level 15 Heal Other Spell.

Cooldown: 30 Minutes.

NEBULAR ROULETTE SCRATCHER

As an Action in combat, roll 1d6 as a loud buzzing noise erupts from nowhere. On a 1, you take 2d12+F Electric damage. On a 2–6, the target takes 2d12+F Electric damage.

Cooldown: 30 Minutes.

LEGENDARY BOXES

Legendary boxes are just that: boxes so rare and with rewards so good that they're talked about in whispers. And yeah, sure, kid—your uncle's roommate's jazzercise instructor totally won one from Bigfoot.

- An interesting item granting +10% to a Stat
- Potion of +5 Skill (Permanent)
- Rare Spellbook (Learn a new Spell)
- Rare Spell Scroll (One shot, no Mana casting)
- Various Crafting Tables
- Various Crafting Table Upgrade Coupons
- Heal Severe Injury Potion (Heals 9 Health Bar slots and mends all Injuries)
- And almost always 1d10 ×10,000 Gold

SAMPLE MAGICAL GEAR FROM LEGENDARY BOXES

ENCHANTED CLOAK OF THE SLIPPERY PERV

Gear Slot: Accessory

+6 Charisma

+3 Evade Buff when you accuse your attacker of wanting to "penetrate you" in a way you have never used previously.

ENCHANTED WAND OF INCONTINENCE

Gear Slot: Hand/Holding

+10% Constitution

Once per session and as an Action, you may cause a creature within 30 feet to void their bowels, and they gain the Fatigued Debuff. If it's a crawler and it hits the floor, the System AI isn't going to like that!

HAND GRIPS OF HELLA HOLDING

Gear Slot: Hands/Holding

+10% Strength

+3 Damage Resistance

When you grab hold of something, you don't let go until you wish to. Nothing can undo your grip, short of divine intervention.

CELESTIAL BOXES

You thought legendary boxes were great? This blows that shit out of the water.

- Divine Items—Things that do weird stuff when in the presence of deities
- Overpowered weapons, armor, and gear
- Potions that Max Out Skills (Permanent)
- Items that Rewrite Stats
- Life-Altering Effects on Items
- Sorry, no Gold

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SAMPLE GEAR FROM CELESTIAL BOXES

BORANT CORPORATION RESET BUTTON

Gear Slot: Accessory

This button was used by the Borant Corporation to test dungeon encounters multiple times to fine-tune them before the broadcast started. Looks like they left this one behind.

Must be attached to a piece of your clothing. Once per floor, you may press this button to restart the current scene, up to 10 minutes into it. In combat, it must be used during the first round.

BERET OF DIVINE INTERVENTION

Gear Slot: Head

Choose a Skill and max it out at Rank 15.

When in the presence of a deity, double your personal rewards: Loot boxes, Mob looting, AI Favor, information at the Club, high-fives at the Penis Parade. When in the presence of your own deity, triple your personal rewards instead.

THE SASSY STILETTO

Gear Slot: Hand/Holding

+5 to all Stats

You gain Dagger Skill at Rank 15

You roll Critical Hits with this weapon on a Natural 16–20.

The dagger is intelligent and makes Look for Clues Checks for you at no Action cost with 10 Ranks of Perception. If you can handle the sassy attitude, you've made a friend for life.

RANDOMIZED MAGIC ITEMS

Finding new and interesting gear inside loot boxes and treasure chests is a favorite pastime of dungeon crawlers. Magical gear items typically offer a number of different benefits based on the tier of the loot box they came from. Roll a number of times, based on rarity, on the table for a given piece of Enchanted gear (Tables 38-42).

- **Bronze:** No rolls, item is mundane
- **Silver:** One roll
- **Gold:** Two rolls
- **Platinum:** Three rolls
- **Legendary:** Four rolls
- **Celestial:** Five rolls

The randomized magic items can either be rolled—with a d6—or selected by GMs who want to have the items ready when the loot box opens. The items can also be rolled up when the player opens the loot box as a surprise for everyone. In some cases, you may need to reroll duplicates, and in others, it makes sense for multiples of an option, like a Stat or Skill bonus, to apply to different Stats or Skills. The GM can also roll or simply choose something ahead of time, keeping a list of what the crawlers will eventually find.

If you roll an X value (such as +X Stat) on one of these tables, the value is determined by the loot box rarity (See *X Values*, p. 220). If you get a "Something Unique" in your roll(s), stop rolling on the current table and move to *Something Unique*.

TABLE 38: ITEM TYPE

ROLL OR CHOOSE	TYPE
1–2	**Enchanted Mundane Item or Weapon:** Choose the type of weapon or item the PCs would use or what viewers would find funny
3–4	**Enchanted Clothing:** Choose the type of clothing based on what the PCs wear or what viewers would find funny
5–6	**Enchanted Accessory:** Choose the type of accessory based on what the PCs might wear or what viewers would find funny

TABLE 39: ENCHANTED MUNDANE ITEM OR WEAPON

ROLL OR CHOOSE	RESULT
1	+X Stat Bonus
2	+X Skill Bonus
3	A Buff (not Skill or Stat bonuses)
4	A Passive Skill at Rank equal to the Floor
5	Inherent Spell* (no Mana cost; with Cooldown based on power level—GM's choice)
6	Roll on Table 42: Something Unique

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TABLE 40: ENCHANTED CLOTHING

ROLL OR CHOOSE	RESULT
1	+X Stat Bonus
2	+X Skill Bonus
3	A Buff (not Skill or Stat bonuses)
4	Resistance to an uncommon damage type
5	+1 Damage Resistance
6	Roll on Table 42: Something Unique

TABLE 41: ENCHANTED ACCESSORY (JEWEL, BELT, PATCH, TATTOO, ETC.)

ROLL OR CHOOSE	RESULT
1	+X Stat Bonus
2	+X Skill Bonus
3	A Buff (not Skill or Stat bonuses)
4	External Buff of either Recovery (full Health) or Restore (full Mana) once per Floor
5	Inherent Spell* (no Mana cost; with Cooldown based on power level—GM's choice)
6	Roll on Table 42: Something Unique

*When you gain an item with an inherent Spell, it has a fixed Rank. The Rank of the Spell typically follows the same values as seen below for Skill Ranks, though exceptions are common, like Carl's "Protective Shell" was Rank 15 when he first got it. Spells gained this way don't cost Mana to cast, but have added cooldowns—usually 2 hours per Spell Rank.

X VALUES

The actual value of the Xs in Tables 39, 40, and 41 is dependent on what floor it is, how much the AI likes the crawler, and/or the GM's discretion. Not every magical item grants a crawler additional Ranks in a Skill they already have. If a crawler gains Ranks in a Skill they do not currently have Ranks in, they now have that Skill at the Rank noted.

Here are some guidelines:

- **Silver:** +1 Skill Rank or +2 Stat
- **Gold:** +1–3 Skill Rank or +3–5 Stat
- **Platinum:** +2–4 Skill Rank or +5% Stat
- **Legendary:** +5 Skill Rank or +10% Stat
- **Celestial:** +6 Skill Rank or +20% Stat

When you get an item with a percentage boost to a Stat, the determined value of the percentage is set at the time you get the item. As with all other rounding, round down. After determining the value, record it on your character sheet (not the percentage).

SOMETHING UNIQUE

Stop rolling when you roll "Something Unique" on any of the above tables. The "Unique" result should be extra powerful for each roll you missed out on by rolling Something Unique. Roll 1d6 (just once) on Table 42 (below) to see what your unique thing does.

Example: You roll a Something Unique result on your first of three rolls for an item from a platinum loot box. That unique thing should be around three times more powerful than if it had been rolled last.

TABLE 42: SOMETHING UNIQUE

ROLL OR CHOOSE	RESULT
1	GM's choice
2	Interacts with a god
3	The thing is intelligent
4	Summon minions to fight for you
5	Mimics something from the encounter where the loot box was earned
6	Player's choice (with GM approval)

NAMING ITEMS

Name the item after rolling it up. If you roll Something Unique, the name of the item is sometimes influenced by that ability. Items of gold, platinum, and legendary loot box origins will usually be preceded by "Enchanted."

Magical items and gear typically have crazy names that tell you little of what the thing actually does. The naming conventions tend to use "The type of thing of the adjective creator/mob/deity/boss." Common items often drop "The" in favor of the item name, like "Mask of the Psychotic Bugaboo."

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CRAFTING

Sooner or later, you'll discover a tragic gap between what you need to survive versus what you currently have in your Inventory. Maybe it's ammo. Maybe it's a helmet with actual protection, or a bomb capable of making a Neighborhood Boss reconsider its life choices. Regardless, crafting is for you!

Crafting allows a crawler to convert junk into something useful. Is it elegant? Not usually, but neither were most crawlers, and look how far they've come. You may craft mundane items that provide no inherent benefits, or enchant items with whatever magical benefits your heart desires. Let's start with mundane items.

Any crafted item that provides a crawler with benefits from wearing, holding, or otherwise possessing it is not mundane. However, the GM might grant you a circumstantial bonus from a mundane item. For example, you might roll with Advantage on your Climbing Skill Check because of a mundane ladder or rope.

MUNDANE COMMON ITEMS

You needn't craft small household or grocery store items. Instead, spend one Misc. Junk point (see p. 99) to recover that item from your Inventory. Said item might be an egg-beater, rubber gloves, a roll of tape, or another item with limited moving parts—but not food or water. After using it, either write it into your Inventory or toss it. You do not get the Misc. Junk point back. Each point of Misc. Junk represents a kitchen drawer full of items that you just can't bring yourself to throw away. Hey, if you're that into collecting, I know a First-Floor Boss who would love to meet you. By the way, do you speak Spanish?

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TABLE 43: ITEM SIZES

SIZE	EXAMPLE	MISC. JUNK NEEDED TO CRAFT
Tiny	Soda Can	1
Small	Toaster	4
Petite	Chair	16
Medium	Desk	32
Large	Statue	64
Huge	Dumpster	128
Colossal	Barn	256
Gargantuan	Grain Silo	512

MUNDANE UNCOMMON ITEMS

Most households have string, not rope. If you need something that isn't common or that wouldn't fit into a kitchen drawer, you can craft it. Table 43 is your guide to the size of the item you craft and how many points of Misc. Junk your project requires. Whatever you make should have limited moving parts (no engines, electronics, fluid systems, etc.). If you have the required amount of Misc. Junk on hand, you can balloon-animal whatever you need into existence. The GM or the blueprint you're following might require additional specific elements beyond Misc. Junk.

To successfully create an uncommon item with no moving parts out of Misc. Junk, make an Unopposed Fabricate Skill Check. For items with moving parts, use Engineering instead (no Engineering Table needed). Each attempt takes a number of hours equal to "the size times the size." So, a size 1 takes 1 hour, while a size 4 takes 16 hours. If you succeed, the item is perfect and lasts for the rest of your short life here in the dungeon. If you fail, you messed it up. Determine by how much and consult Table 47 below.

CRAFTING MAGIC ITEMS (FOURTH FLOOR & BEYOND)

What you really want are items that give you bonuses, right? Are you on the Fourth Floor or beyond? Great! While generic crafting skills exist, there are also numerous specialty crafting skills: Alchemy, Arcane, Smithing, and more. Crafting magical items requires both an appropriate crafting table and a personal space to hold it. They also require many raw materials, some Misc. Junk, and whatever ingredients the GM or blueprint requires. Unfortunately, you can't just cobble them together in thin air. Instead, you need a crafting table.

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CRAFTING TABLES

Every different type of crafting skill has its own table. These tables range from tier 1 to 10 based on quality. You must have access to a crafting table when adding magical bonuses to an item. **Your table's tier serves as a bonus to your Skill Check.** Even with just a tier-1 table, you can attempt to enchant an item with any level of bonus, but it will be difficult. If you need multiple different tables, only the lowest-tier bonus applies to your Skill Check.

A brand-new tier-1 Table costs 25,000 gold. They automatically level up by 1 when the crawler reaches a new floor, so the earlier you acquire one, the better. Table Upgrade Coupons found in loot boxes also improve tables. If you can't find a loot box with an upgrade, you can buy an upgrade for 250,000 gold. If you're in a rush, spend it. If not, wait.

TABLE 44: TYPES OF CRAFTING TABLES

TABLE TYPE	ITEM CREATED
Alchemy	Potions and poisons
Arcanist	Imbuing items with inherent Spells
Armorer	Armor
Engineering	Making things with moving parts, fluids, and/or chemicals (such as bullets)
Metalworking	Weapons
Sapper's	Explosives
Writing	Scrolls

Table 44 presents the most common table types and what items they can create. These are the more common Crafting Tables. Feel free to add more. There are infinite types of upgrades you can apply to a crafting table over and above the basic levels: Speed Multipliers, Cauldron Attachments, Infusion Stations, and specialized tools are a few examples. Upgrades are commonly prerequisites for powerful recipes and blueprints. Whether you need these or not is up to your GM, as are the effects of these add-ons.

Just because you have access to a crafting table doesn't necessarily mean you know what you're doing. You still need the specific crafting skill for the item you wish to craft. Table 45 shows you what skills apply.

TABLE 45: CRAFTING SKILLS NEEDED

ITEM OR EFFECT	CRAFTING SKILL
Damage Resistance	Smithing
Explosives	Explosives Handling or Goblin Explosives
Potions	Alchemy
Scrolls	Calligraphy
Spells	Arcane
Tattoos	Tattoo Artistry

ENCHANTING ITEMS

You can instill your creations with magical properties such as: Skill bonuses, Stat buffs, triggered effects (including "On an Amazing Success" on weapons), Resistances, Immunities, Damage Reflection, and more. **You cannot enchant an item with the exact same property more than once.** So, if you add +1 Strength to an item, you can't re-enchant it with a second Strength buff.

There is no such thing as a "+1 Longsword." Instead, you add a +1 Longsword Skill Rank and a +1 damage bonus to a Longsword. Those are two different +1 enchantments, crafted and rolled separately.

DANGERS OF OVER-ENCHANTING ITEMS

Crawlers tend to push things as far, or farther, than recommended on the label. Crafting is no different. The first few enchantments added to an item are fairly safe, but after that, it's risky to add more, no matter the method. Recall Donut's "Enchanted Obsidian Bracelet of the Raggle Rouser." Once it had three enchantments on it, she was warned, *"This item has a 50% chance to permanently break if it's upgraded again."*

When applying any enchantment by any means to an item with 3 or more enchantments, roll 1d10. On a 5 or less, the item permanently breaks. Items destroyed by over-enchanting cannot be repaired. You got greedy and paid the price. Do it again. Our viewers love it! Each enchantment, no matter the bonus level, counts as one enchantment. A +3 Strength buff counts as one enchantment.

OTHER METHODS OF ENCHANTMENT

The World Dungeon provides several methods to upgrade items, but they are all uncommon. Patches, scrolls, sharpening stones, and more are ready for crawlers to discover. Scrolls of Upgrade may be the

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TABLE 46: BONUS LEVEL EXAMPLES

BONUS	EXAMPLE
+1	Stick of Dynamite dealing 1d6 Bludgeoning with no Area of Effect
+2	Standard Healing Potion, Standard Mana Potion, Damage Reflection 8:1*
+3	Poison Antidote Potion, Anti-Piercing Benefit (on clothing with DR), Resistance to UNCOMMON DAMAGE TYPE, +5ft Move
+4	Damage Reflection 5:1*, Good Healing Potion, Good Mana Refill Potion, Armor-Piercing
+5	Restore Buff (full mana, with cooldown), Resistance to COMMON DAMAGE TYPE, +10ft Move
+6	Immunity to UNCOMMON DAMAGE TYPE, Rank Damage Die damage bonus on a weapon, Gold Standard Healing Potion
+7	Recovery Buff (heals all Health Bar slots, with cooldown), +15ft Move
+8	Damage Reflection 3:1*, Supreme Healing Potion
+9	Immunity to COMMON DAMAGE TYPE, +20ft Move
+10	Mordecai's Special Brew

***Damage Reflection:** If you lose a number of Health Bar slots greater than or equal to the first number in one blow, the attacker loses 1 Health Bar slot.*

easiest to use (and for the GM to dole out), but there are plenty of other ways to upgrade items. Some of the more common types are found below.

Scroll of Upgrade: Applies one enchantment to a currently-equipped item, and must be applied during the current scene. A platinum box Scroll of Upgrade could provide two enchantments. See Table 46: *Bonus Levels* above for ideas, typically at a level equal to the current Floor Number.

Example: A Scroll of Upgrade on the Third Floor should grant a Bonus Level 3 enchantment, with easy examples being +3 Strength, +3 damage, or +3 Skill.

The most popular enchantments provided are "Amazing Success" triggered effects on weapons, abbreviated in your weapon notes as "AS: EFFECT." They add extra damage, Debuffs, or something weirder, but only one such trigger is allowed per weapon, and are in addition to the bonus "+F damage" every Amazing Success generates. A Critical Hit does not trigger such an effect. Additional samples for weapon upgrades are found in Table 26 (p. 116).

Sharpening Stone: These stones are typically found in Platinum loot boxes, and are normally usable only on "spiky weapons." Their short shelf life means they must be applied immediately and are then destroyed. A weapon upgraded with a Sharpening Stone doubles your Stat Mod for damage on an edged or pointy weapon and adds one additional damage for every 10 Levels of the wielder.

Upgrade Patch: Found in Gold-tier loot boxes, these are rare. Such patches upgrade a piece of clothing. Patches are Fleeting items: if the patch is removed, the bonus is lost.

Bang Bro Spell: This Spell (p. 203) creates a temporary enchantment on an item.

BONUSES

When selecting a bonus, pick the benefit you want. Selections come from the following: Stats, Non-Spell Skills, Buffs, Triggered Effects, Resistances, Immunities, Movement, and Bonus Damage. All are added to an item your style of crafting interacts with.

If you choose a numeric bonus (to a Skill, Stat, DR, or bonus damage), the bonus value determines much of the difficulty of the crafting Check. If the enchantment involves more than adding numbers, discuss its bonus level with the GM. If the enchantment seems too weak or too powerful, the Dungeon might intervene to patch it. Table 46 provides some examples.

TIME TO CRAFT

Each bonus level applied takes one hour per level. You may craft things over multiple days, provided the blueprint doesn't say otherwise. For example, a +3 bonus takes 3 hours. Table attachments might reduce the time the process takes, as do some Rank

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Upgrades. Some potions can be made in large batches, adding 1 minute per bonus level for each additional potion, but all ingredients must be on hand. See Alchemy on p. 226 for more information.

MAKING THE SKILL CHECK

When ready to craft, the crawler makes an Unopposed Skill Check using the skill required by the creation. Add your crafting table's tier to your roll.

The materials are consumed whether or not the roll is successful, though skills (and results) like Salvage might allow you to save some ingredients. The crafting Skill Check Difficulty is based on the bonus level and type of enchantment.

The type of enchantment is the largest factor in the Difficulty.

- **Stats:** 10 + [Bonus ×2]
  Example: Adding +2 Dexterity to a dagger has a Difficulty of 14. That's a 2 Stat bonus level times 2, plus the base Difficulty 10 for a total of 14.
- **Non-Passive Skills and Spells:** 10 + [Bonus ×4]
  Example: Making a Rank 2 Scroll of Fireball has a Difficulty of 18.
- **DR, Passive Skills and Spells:** 10 + [Bonus ×6]
  Example: A potion of +2 Dodge (a Passive Skill) has a Difficulty of 22.
- **Any category not covered in the above three bullets:** 10 + [Bonus ×4]
  Example: A 3d6 stick of dynamite has a Difficulty of 22.

On Success, the item is perfect and lasts for the rest of your short life.

On Fail, you messed it up. Determine by how much you failed and consult the Salvaging Your Mess table below.

On a Critical Fail, the item breaks, but might be Repaired (see p. 197). The enchanting ingredients might also be Salvaged.

SALVAGING YOUR MESS

The margin by which the roll fails determines how many raw materials can be salvaged from the failed project. The sturdier the raw materials, the more likely they are salvaged. The GM assigns penalties and bonuses based on this. Mixed, liquid ingredients are typically not salvageable.

TABLE 47: SALVAGING

MISSED BY	RESULT
10+	You messed things up so bad that there is nothing left to salvage.*
3–9	You can salvage half of the raw material.*
1–2	You can fully salvage the raw materials.

*More might be saved if you have the Salvage Skill (p. 198).

SPECIALTY CRAFTING

Specialty crafting uses all the rules above, with exceptions noted below. Remember, some items crafted may require multiple skills and therefore multiple tables.

SMITHING

You may craft and enchant items such as horseshoes, railroad spikes, nails, and other metal items. Or the fun stuff: armor and weapons. Weapons and armor each require different tables as shown on Table 44 on p. 223. The Smithing skill only allows you to enchant armor and weapons. Start out with Misc. Junk raw materials, as seen in Mundane crafting, as seen above.

ARMOR

Individual armor pieces are more common than full suits. Armor on hands, feet, arms, and legs each provides a single DR value. If you are a biped or quadruped, you don't get extra bonuses for each limb, but we respect that you tried to rules-lawyer. Note: Only pieces of armor with the Anti-Piercing benefit count against Armor-Piercing damage.

If you want to clank your way around the dungeon in a full suit of Hello Kitty-themed plate mail, do note that your entire ensemble only grants you a single DR bonus. One application of the Anti-Piercing Benefit gives you full DR against Armor-Piercing damage, since you have only one DR score to augment this way.

While there are interesting orcish, dwarven, elven and alien varieties of metal and mail, plus techie shit like Kevlar or metamaterials... it's not a big deal. Call it what you want. If your group wants to worry about encumbrance, have people wearing armor on more than half of their body roll Dexterity-based Skill and Evade Checks with Disadvantage.

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WEAPONS

You can craft mundane weapons using only Misc. Junk (see *Mundane Common Items*, p. 221), but you can add enchantments to any weapon, whether you made it or not. Such enchantments include bonuses to the weapon's namesake skill, added Stats, bonus damage, and special damage bonuses (the Rank damage die being the most common). You may not enchant a weapon with more than one "On an Amazing Success" effect, even if the effects are different. These can be abbreviated in the Effects section for your weapon with "AS: EFFECT."

If you build a weapon from scratch, you need Misc. Junk just as though you were Fabricating it (see Table 43, p. 222). Once crafted, you may place enchantments on the weapon.

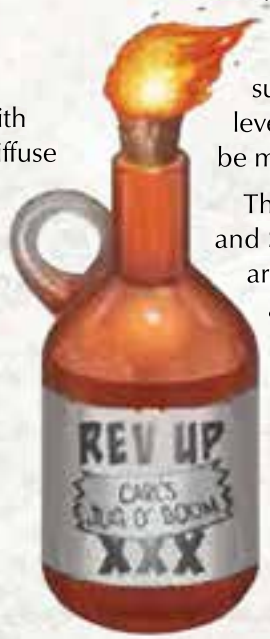
SCROLLS

To write the text and glyphs of a spell onto a scroll requires the Calligraphy Skill. The only ingredients needed are magical paper (which appears occasionally in loot boxes) and a suitable calligraphy pen. Writing a scroll allows anyone to cast that spell at no Mana cost. You must know a spell or have a scroll of that spell in your Hotlist in order to write that spell onto a new scroll.

The Rank of your Spell or scroll is the maximum Rank at which you may write your scroll. You can write a scroll at a lesser Rank to make your Skill Check easier if you wish. Magical paper doesn't grow on trees. The Rank of the spell equals the bonus value for the difficulty in writing it. Scrolls are one-shots. As soon as the spell is cast, the paper disintegrates.

EXPLOSIVES

Explosives and incendiary devices require a volatile component that can't be created with Misc. Junk. Your best bet to gather it is to diffuse explosive dungeon traps. Explosives cannot be upgraded in the same way that you upgrade a sword. Use the Bomb Surgeon Skill (p. 186) to break down your current explosive into its component parts. Then, make a new Explosives Handling or other crafting-based Skill Check to make a new explosive. You don't even need more volatile components. You're that good. If you fail, use the Bomb Surgeon Skill (with Table 47) to salvage your raw materials instead of the generic Salvage Skill.



Using a Sapper's Table makes your components at least somewhat stable, so you don't need to make Explosive Handling Skill Checks to stabilize your explosives.

The bonus value chosen to craft is the damage of the explosive, measured in d6 dice (the default explosive and incendiary device die). So, if you want to make a 3d6 stick of dynamite, that's a Difficulty of 22, as in 10 + [3 bonus × 4]. You can also put Area of Effect bonuses on an explosive, and you may add these add-ons in multiples if you wish.

+1 Bonus Level: +5ft Splash (a +10ft Splash is a bonus level of +2)

+2 Bonus Level: 5ft Blast radius (a 10ft Blast radius is a bonus level of +4)

Example: A 2d6 stick of dynamite with a 5ft Blast radius has a total bonus of +4 and therefore a Difficulty of 26.

The dice of damage counts as one enchantment on the stick of dynamite, while each different Area of Effect bonus applied to the dynamite stick counts as one enchantment.

ALCHEMY

Make drugs for fun and profit! Well, rarely profit. Potions are one of the more expensive types of crafting, as you often must combine two potions to make a new one. If the combo isn't better than what you started with, you just lost money. However, once you have a successful recipe, you can produce additional potions faster if the GM thinks you have the necessary attachments on your Alchemy Table. It takes just 1 minute per bonus level for each extra potion, but you must have all the raw ingredients to do this. *Example:* You have successfully made a potion with a +3 bonus level. An additional potion of that same type can be made in 3 minutes.

The most sought-after potion types are Stat and Skill enhancers with high bonuses, as they are permanent. They increase your enhanced and unenhanced Stats. Each crawler may only consume two Stat potions and two Skill potions during the entirety of their short life, so don't get too excited over that +2 Charisma potion. That's what makeup is for. Poison antidotes and other cures are also popular.

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SOMETHING NEW... OR OLD

If you want to create something original rather than a mix of existing potions, you're in eye of newt and toe of frog territory. You need to gather a variety of these materials, lots of them. Weird plants, fungi, monster parts, blood, minerals, metals... there's all kinds of ingredients you can find.

An original creation doesn't have specific ingredients, unless your GM happens to be a chemistry enthusiast. Instead, gather the blood, saliva, and other excretions from creatures or the environment that roughly approximate the effects you're looking for.

POISONS

Naturally occurring poisons are usually the easiest starting point for creating original potions. Alchemy then refines them into something even nastier.

One can apply a poison potion (the whole thing) to any weapon that deals Piercing or Slashing damage, and it lasts for an entire day. An Amazing Success on a to-hit roll means the poison got into the target's bloodstream or whatever their physiology uses to power muscles. The victim gains the Poisoned Debuff, and adds the full bonus level damage to the Poison damage at the end each round, starting with the current round.

Example: A nasty +9 bonus level Poison Debuff deals 1d8+F+9 at the end of each combat round.

Remember, if a Debuff causes a crawler (not Mobs or Bosses) to drop to 0% Health Bar, they get a free Con Stat Check vs. 10 + Floor to avoid the damage. If they succeed, the Debuff ends.

CONCOCTIONS

A concoction combines two existing potions into a single potion with a blended version of both effects.

Creating a concoction is faster than brewing something from scratch. Instead of taking 1 hour per desired bonus level, it takes 1 minute per desired bonus level to combine two or more potions into a new mixture.

For example, Mordecai's Special Brew is a 10 bonus-level potion and is a combination of a Gold Standard Healing Potion and a Troll's Second Wind Potion (very rare). Since it is a 10 bonus, it takes 10 minutes to mix the two potions together.

Mixing two potions together might take a lot of trial and error to produce something interesting. Each attempt ruins the original potions. You can't salvage them to undo the mixture. And inert concoctions do not make for good ingredients for new concoctions.

When mixing two potions, announce your intended result to the GM before you roll. The bonus level you aim for cannot be higher than the combined bonus levels of the potions you are mixing. However, the final result can exceed that limit if you roll an Amazing Success or Critical Hit on the Alchemy Skill Check.

INFUSION

Infusions add enchantments to consumable items. Making an infusion requires an Alchemy Table or an Infusion Station on a Tier-3+ Sapper's Table. Once you find or create a potion to apply to a consumable item, give the item a dunk in the potion. The potion is consumed, and you need to make an Infusion Skill Check. The bonus value of the potion used is the bonus level you're attempting, informing the Difficulty of your attempt.

However, because the potion is already prepared and stable, make this crafting Check with Advantage. Additionally, the time to craft it is measured in minutes instead of hours. In other words, infusion is just a safer and faster way to enchant consumables. You can get the same effects through normal crafting, but those methods take far more time.

TABLE 48: CONCOCTION AND INFUSION RESULTS

CHECK RESULT	EFFECT
Critical Hit	You created something unique, more powerful than the ingredients used, and are credited as the inventor. You collect 1 gold every time someone uses a copy of your creation.
Amazing Success	You have something at least as good as the effects of the two potions, but it could produce unexpectedly bitchin' results.
Standard Success	Your creation only slightly improves one of the two base potions. For example, combining a healing potion and a mana potion might only create a new mana potion that also heals 1 Health Bar slot.
Near Miss or Failure	Your mixture is smelly and unsuited for further use. No salvage is possible.
Critical Fail	It blows up in your face, dealing you Xd6 Acid damage, where X is the bonus level you aimed for. Or the GM might come up with a disaster more befitting the potions used or the intended creation.

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ARCANE

Arcane enchanters are able to imbue items with inherent spells using an Arcanist Table. This crafting skill allows you to enchant the widest variety of items, such as weapons, armor, wands, items, but not consumables, such as scrolls or tattoos.

The crafter can only imbue an item with spells they personally know or spells taken from scrolls they have available, and only up to their (or the scroll's) Rank in the Spell. An item can have only one inherent Spell, though it may still receive other enchantments as normal.

If the spell being applied does not already have a cooldown, it does now. The default cooldown is 2 hours per Spell Rank. You can adjust it to add or subtract bonus levels from your creation:

+1 Bonus Level: Subtract 2 hours from the cooldown (to a minimum of 1 hour)

−1 Bonus Level: Add 5 hours to the cooldown (to a maximum of 30 hours)

TATTOOS

Crawlers with the Tattoo Artistry Skill can draw permanent enchantments onto a person. They are subject to the same rules as potions: A maximum of 2 Stat bonuses and a maximum of 2 Skill bonuses. Unlike other magic items, each tattoo has a maximum of one enchantment on it, and each part of the body can have a maximum of one magical tattoo. However, additional dungeon-created tattoos (like a Desperado Club pass) can share the space, even if they give the equivalent of a bonus.

Using specialized materials that should be hard to come by, a crawler can transfer some or all of a tattoo enchantment to another crawler by drawing out some of the ink and mixing it with their own blood. Choose how many Ranks/bonus levels you wish to give up, and then the new recipient gains only those Ranks.

"You must really love that thing. Too bad you're both probably going to die a horrible death at any moment. Or maybe not."

—The System AI

PETS

Given the constant danger, having a pet might sound wildly irresponsible. And honestly? It probably is. But the Dungeon is cruel, exhausting, and lonely, and sometimes the difference between giving up and pushing forward is having something that doesn't judge you... much.

Some pets made it through the Collapse right alongside their people, while others are acquired in the Dungeon. Crawlers are limited to one pet each, unless you gain a benefit or choose a Class that says otherwise. This isn't an animal rescue.

BRINGING IN A PET

The quickest way to gain a pet in the World Dungeon is to bring one with you. If the GM allows it, you can start play with a single bonded pet (as your "interesting or useful item"). It gains a crawler ID number but isn't a crawler. Such an animal has an Intelligence of 1, and if increased to 2 or higher, it becomes a full-fledged crawler like Donut. Then, it's no longer a pet. It is now also capable of judging you.

The only way to raise an Earth-born pet's Intelligence is via an Enhanced Pet Biscuit, which is worth 3,000 gold each. Very rarely, you can find them in a merchant's shop. It's more common to find Enhanced Pet Biscuits in Legendary Pet Boxes, though not all such boxes will have one. With over a hundred different effects (try the roadkill opossum flavor!), the vast majority do not grant the pet any Intelligence. They don't grant a crawler Intelligence, either.

Of course, a player can choose to play as an animal crawler during character creation, if the GM allows it. This animal gets an Enhanced Pet Biscuit, allowing it to achieve that rare and baffling statistical condition known as "being roughly equal to the rest of the party."

For many animals, this is a miracle. For dogs, it is confusing but oh boy is it also sooo exciting. For cats, it is a demotion. For the humans in the party, it is a sobering reminder that the family pet has been watching you for years. That hamster living in her cage in your bedroom? She has *seen some shit*.

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PETS AS REWARDS

Despite their names, Bronze and Legendary Pet Boxes don't contain pets (read the fine print), but rather pet-related loot, supplies, and gear. Crawlers typically only get a pet inside the dungeon either by choosing certain classes or visiting a Pet Reward Room.

If a Class grants you a pet as a benefit, you can choose the type of animal. That pet starts as Calm (see chart below), which means you haven't scared it off yet. Good job.

Pet Reward Rooms are scattered throughout the dungeon, often to reward crawlers who explore the dark corners of a floor. Once found, the System AI grants them a key that opens a specific cage containing a specific pet. It's like opening other doors in the dungeon, except your pet probably won't try to kill you (for now).

ADOPTING A PET

I bet you're thinking, "Hey, I want a Mob as a pet!" Well, some Mobs in the Dungeon might make good pets. They naturally start out Hostile, and it might take a few slashes across your face before you find one that doesn't want to eat you. But yeah, you can take a Mob as a pet. As they are dungeon-born, they don't have crawler numbers and can't become crawlers, even if their Intelligence is 2 or above.

Looting isn't just limited to inanimate objects: you might get lucky and find a stray former pet. When a crawler dies, you can swoop in and bond with the orphaned pet. Such strays are, of course, very hard to find, unless you had something to do with the crawler's demise. Some puppies are simply to die for, right?

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BUYING A PET

Why can't I just buy a damn pet, you ask? You can! You can buy a pet from a Dungeon vendor. They cost 10,000 gold. Surely you have that much by now? Lower floors offer better options and increasingly more unique pets, but they still start at Level 1, no matter how much you spend. Used pets, or as Borant says, "pre-loved," aren't any cheaper.

TAMING A DUNGEON PET

Unsurprisingly, most creatures native to the World Dungeon start out as Hostile. Some see you as food; others don't really care about you at all. If you want to make one your pet, you must convince the animal that it wants to be your friend. Easier said than done, if the animal is venomous, toothy, hungry, or just nervous.

Assuming you do convince the animal, you eventually need it to become Bonded with you. This takes time and patience, but feeding a creature is often the key to changing its attitude toward you. Come to think of it, that works on people, too. Why not clicker train your friends for fun and profit?

Animals have four basic attitudes toward Crawlers. When trying to convert an animal from one attitude to another, make INT-Opposed Animal Handling Skill Checks vs. the INT of the pet. That's usually a base 10, +1 for their INT Mod, and + Floor, but Mob pets could have a higher INT Mod. Animals begin with one of these basic attitudes:

- **Hostile:** The animal wants you to go away, or worse, they'd like to kill and eat you. Calming a Hostile animal is difficult. It requires at least 20 minutes of careful, direct contact, and an Amazing Success or better on an Animal Handling Skill Check (p. 185). Which means you may attempt this every 20 minutes, if the critter sticks around long enough.
- **Calm:** The animal couldn't care less about you. You're nothing to them, but if you threaten or Attack, it quickly changes its attitude to Hostile. Making a Calm creature a Friendly one requires 20 minutes of careful, direct contact and a Standard Success or better.
- **Friendly:** The creature finds you useful. It does its own thing. It takes food from you and allows you to pet it, but not much else. If you ignore it or treat it with cruelty (shame on you!), it quickly changes its attitude from Friendly to Calm, if not Hostile. Creating a life-long bond with a Friendly animal, changing its attitude to Bonded, takes 20 minutes of direct contact, and an Amazing Success or better.
- **Bonded:** You're this pet's favorite person. It adores you and tries to protect and please you. If you ignore it or treat it cruelly (asshole!), it gets hurt but remains Friendly, confused about why you don't reciprocate its affection. But with enough cruelty, the attitude descends the ladder, often skipping Calm and going straight to Hostile. An animal can only bond to one crawler at a time. Likewise, a crawler usually only has one Bonded pet at a time, though Rank Upgrades in the Animal Handling Skill or your chosen Class can change that.

No matter the animal's attitude, if you roll a Major Fail on any of these Animal Handling Skill Checks, you can't attempt to change the pet's attitude for 1 week. If the floor collapses before you're Bonded, the pet fails to come with you to the next floor. You just killed your best buddy. Way to go.

On a Critical Fail, the animal reverts to Hostile and Attacks you. You still can't attempt to change its attitude for 1 week.

Once you've bonded with your new best friend, choose the role you want for it:

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- **Tank:** Has DR equal to Floor Number, and choose one Special Ability
- **Aggressive:** Gain the Back Claw and Bite Skills (Rank = Floor), add + Floor damage to all Animal Attacks, and choose no Special Abilities
- **Utility:** Choose two Special Abilities

Abilities tied to the current Floor Number increase when you descend to new floors.

SPECIAL ABILITIES

- Move 60ft
- Gain either the Taunt or Catcher Skill (Rank = Floor)
- Gain swim or burrow with Move of 30ft or flight or jump with Move 50ft
- Heightened Senses (where crawlers make such Skill Checks, you make Stat Checks for your pet vs. the same Difficulty the crawler faced, which is either Opposed or Unopposed)
- Resistance to an uncommon damage type

PET

Your new pet starts at Level 1 no matter how, where, or when you acquire it in the dungeon. Pet-class Mobs and Earth-born pets die instantly at 0% Health Bar. To prepare yourself for the inevitable, watch *Marley and Me*.

All pets that originate in the dungeon are the property of Borant Corporation and are tagged as "pet-class Mobs." You have no legal rights or contracts regarding pets you find in the dungeon. However, the AI knows that crawler and pet combos get a lot of viewers, so it doesn't typically break up a good ratings pair unless there's a very good reason. Here are the basic statistics for all pets. Pets have Health Bar slots equal to their size value to start (typically 2–5), and gain 1 Health Bar slot each time they level up, to a maximum of 10.

Pet, Level 1

Animal

1

100%

Level	Evade	Speed	DR	
1	+1	20+S	0	
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
2 (+1)	1 (+1)	2 (+1)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)

Slice Attack: d20 + F + Str to hit, 1d4 + Str Slashing

PET LEVELING

As a member of the party, pets level up when the crawlers do. They're equal. Actually, they're more equal because they level up twice as fast as crawlers do until they reach level 15, gaining 2 levels at a time. Once at level 15, they level up at the same rate as crawlers.

Pets get Stat increases just like crawlers do: 3 Stat Points per level gained. You may place them as you please, except for Intelligence.

Pets don't have trackable Skill Ranks. Instead, their Ranks in their Attacks, Spells, and abilities (when rolling Checks) are equal to the Floor Number (even at Level 1!). These Ranks don't improve via the normal ways: grinding, training, potions, or the like. Pets do get Upgrades, though. Pet Attacks increase with an extra base damage die at Rank 5, 10, and 15, just as they do with crawlers, but for pets, that means floors 5, 10, and 15.

PET LEVEL 15

Your little critters grow up. At level 15, your pet is now mature! It grew to its full size and won't get any larger. Congratulations, you didn't kill your pet! As a reward, it gains a new benefit, such as:

- **Earthquake (Mongo):** When the Pet performs a Move Action prior to a melee Attack, roll 1d12. On a 10+ result, an Earthquake occurs within that Burst radius (10–12ft). All foes in the radius gain the Take Down Debuff. Cooldown: 5 hours.
- **Wrecking Ball (Tummy Acher):** Once per day, use a Move and Attack Action to make an Xd6+F Bludgeoning attack, in an Area Line with range equal to the Pet's Move value. X is the size of the pet.
- **Spells (like Bianca):** Good News! Pets don't have a Class, so they can cast Favored Spells without additional Mana costs. Bad News! Pets must spend Mana to cast Spells.
- **Regeneration (Tummy Acher):** If the Pet dies, it comes back with +25% Stats and gains a new weakness (such as a Vulnerability or Skill penalty). Every fifth time it dies, it completely reverts to a Level 1 Pet.

"Good boy. Look, Mongo! You're on TV!"

—Princess Donut

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- Anything from the Pet's Level 1 Special Abilities list (see page 231).
- Create a new special or magical item to feed a pet or to give it another choice of special abilities (shows up in Legendary loot boxes).
- Or anything you can dream up and have your GM approve.

GUIDING A PET

Once you bond with a pet, it follows you around and hangs on your every command. If only everyone else was like that, right? A Bonded pet does its best to follow your commands, though cats and semi-feral pets usually interpret those commands entirely at their leisure. They aren't suicidal, though. Don't mistake them for bait.

You can persuade your pet to experience the joy of combat by making an INT-Opposed Animal Handling Skill Check as an Action. In the dungeon, this isn't cruelty so much as it is... okay, well, it *is* cruelty, but hey—entire game franchises were built on the concept of storing your pets inside interdimensional spaces and throwing them at people to make them fight each other.

On Success, the pet fights alongside you for the entire combat. The pet gets two Actions just like crawlers, but may only use them to Evade, Move, or Attack. Also, a pet only attacks once per round. On an Amazing Success or better, you get it frothing at the mouth, and the pet gets its two Actions to use as it, or you, please. On a Standard Fail, the animal stays out of the fight, but you may try again with future Actions. On a Major Fail or worse, it runs out of sight and hides, and you must find it after the fight and coax it out.

Good boy. Don't let the mean crawler dump their baggage on you.

PET STORAGE

Pet storage isn't a franchise... yet. But pets can be placed in a magic pet carrier and put into your Inventory without harm. Yeah, it's weird, but they're fine in there. Cozy, even. Pets can be placed into non-magical pet carriers as well, but they still see what's happening around them. "The horror... the horror..."

Pets are not allowed in some establishments, like Club Vanquisher or the Desperado Club. How rude of them.

PET GEAR

All animals love being dressed up in funny costumes. Why wouldn't they? It's so dignifying. So, yes, you can equip pets with gear, armor, and magical items made specially for pets. These items adapt to the pet's size, and once given to a pet, they are the same as they would be for crawlers, except a crawler chooses their own humiliation rather than having it forced upon them.

Pets do not have their own Inventory. You have to hold on to all their stuff. Want to ride a pet? We won't judge. To do so, you need to find a magical saddle, like the Enchanted Mongoliensis Saddle that allows Donut to ride Mongo. She found hers in a Platinum Fan Box. Are your fans that generous? Otherwise, you can't ride your pet.

MOUNTS

Using your own feet is for suckers. When in doubt, get a mount. Sometimes you don't want the responsibility of taking care of a pet. Sometimes you just want to get from Point A to Point B at a reasonable pace. You might also be interested in using a lance or other mounted weapon in combat, because jousting is cool. If so, a mount might be a good option for you. However, dedicated mounts are expensive. They have Health Bar slots equal to their size, and that's all they're going to get, as mounts don't level up as pets do.

Fortunately, Mobs don't typically target mounts, as they would rather kill you and sell the mounts. Be glad they don't sell you! But mounts take Area of Effect damage, so don't ride them into combat unless it's a seriously geared-up warhorse.

You can't ride an iguana if you're a full-size human. Get that out of your head. A mount must be at least 1 size class larger than the rider and must possess anatomy capable of supporting a rider. Otherwise, you'd crush your mount.

You can ride from town to town without needing Skill Checks. But if you ride something where consequences may apply, like over a minefield or through daunting terrain, riding Checks are required. They're also required in combat. Mounts don't love charging into a group of Mobs.

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But where do you get a mount? Acquiring a mount happens in the same way as acquiring a pet. You can buy them or find them. Once you get a mount, you need to befriend it like a pet. Purchased mounts, or ones already accustomed to being ridden, typically start out as Calm or occasionally Friendly. The less hostile the mount is, the more it costs. The base price is 20,000 gold for a size Large (5) animal with a Move of 30ft, a 10ft Step, and a pet carrier to keep it in your Inventory when you don't need it. Smaller mounts do not get a discount. What to pimp your mount with tricked-out goodies? Each of the following abilities costs an extra 5,000 gold, and non-attack abilities may be applied multiple times:

- +5ft Move
- +1 DR
- +1 Size
- A Move & Trample attack combo vs. prone foes (Rank = Floor; Xd6 Bludgeoning, where X is their size value)

You are in control of your mount, but they mostly just Move you around at no Action cost. Mounts have one Action per combat round, which you can execute when you wish during the Crawler Action Phase. Mounts do not attack unless they have the Trample attack (or similar). The crawler must spend a Move Action to mount or dismount the creature.

MINIONS

Some Spells (typically of the necromantic variety), magic items, and Quests might find you in charge of some minions. Minions may be subservient creatures, animated corpses, objects, or even something weirder that fight for you or perform tasks when you command them. Spells and effects that work on pets typically also work on minions.

To direct a minion, you must give them commands. Some methods of gaining minions might allow this command to happen as part of the initial effect, but most require you to spend subsequent Action(s) to command them. Sometimes one command only works for one minion, while other times one command spurs them all into action. Once commanded, minions continue to follow your commands until you give them new ones, the scene ends, or the effect ends. They tend to disappear or fade away rather than attack you once released.

Should their controller die, minions not subject to a duration become Bereft Minions. They continue with their task until it is completed, wandering the dungeon as they try to fulfill the last command they were given.

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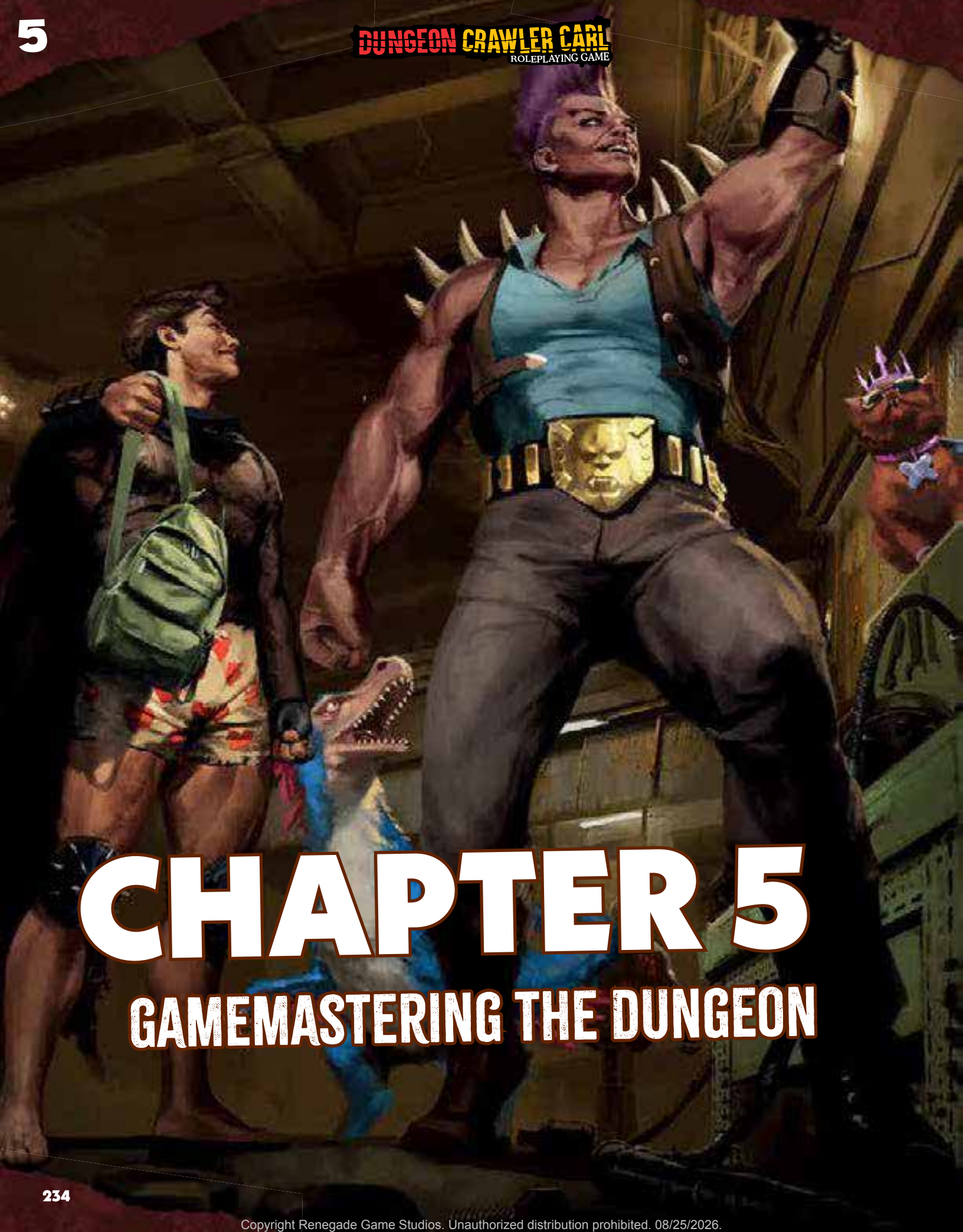

CHAPTER 5

GAMEMASTERING THE DUNGEON

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CONGRATULATIONS, ASSOCIATE! BY ACCEPTING THIS ROLE, YOU HAVE ASSUMED OPERATIONAL RESPONSIBILITY FOR GUIDING A GROUP OF CRAWLERS THROUGH ONE OF OUR PATENTED PLANETARY ENTERTAINMENT ENVIRONMENTS™.* THIS ENVIRONMENT, FACILITATED BY A STATE-OF-THE ART MACRO AI EMBEDDED IN EARTH'S WORLD ENGINE, IS THE FOUNDATION OF THE INCREDIBLY POPULAR AND (HOPEFULLY) PROFITABLE *DUNGEON CRAWLER WORLD* EVENT. LUCKY YOU!

The Game Master (or GM) controls the world around the players. You describe the dungeon, portray its Mobs, Elites, Bosses, locals, and allies, adjudicate the rules, and decide what happens when the crawlers inevitably attempt something unexpectedly reckless or clever.

The **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** provides systems for combat, Skills, loot distribution, Quest advancement, environmental hazards, and other activities found "technically defensible" by various Syndicate regulatory agencies. However, no published rulebook can fully anticipate crawler behavior. Crawlers will ignore obvious doors. Crawlers will lick things clearly labeled "DO NOT LICK." Part of being a GM is learning when to follow the rules, when to bend them just a little, and when to smile ominously before asking, "Are you *sure* you want to do that?"

In this chapter, you'll find guidance for running sessions, building encounters, handling rules questions, creating memorable dungeon moments, and keeping the game moving, even when the crawlers derail your carefully prepared plans within the first fifteen minutes by attempting to fornicate with the first Fire Demon they meet.

Please remember: you are not the enemy of the players, and your goal is not to win. That would be conduct unbecoming of a Borant professional. The *dungeon* is the enemy of the players. The Mobs are the enemy of the players. The economy is the enemy of the players. The players' own decision-making process is very often the enemy of the players. You are merely the courteous administrator ensuring these forces interact in an entertaining and contractually compliant fashion.

So prepare your dice. Review your encounter notes. Hydrate. Warm up your approved non-player character voices. Confirm your waiver language is current.

Above all, remember the first principle of Dungeon World Management: Have a screaming good time.

There's so much to learn!

*P.E.E is a trademark of the Borant Corporation.

But don't worry, everything you need to get started running a **Dungeon Crawler Carl** campaign is right here, ranging from one-shot encounters to long-running heroic campaigns filled with loot, lawsuits, and legendary shenanigans.

WHAT DOES A GM DO?

A GM serves three main roles in a **Dungeon Crawler Carl** game, and occasionally a fourth if nobody else volunteers to host.

First, the GM creates and runs the adventure, determining the encounters, Quests, disasters, and oddities the crawlers face.

Second, the GM controls the world around the PCs. This includes Mobs, Elites, Bosses, showrunners, allied crawlers, managers, bystanders, and even the System AI itself. Voices are absolutely encouraged.

Third, the GM adjudicates the rules. No rulebook can account for every possible player decision, especially once they combine explosives, loot-box abilities, and catastrophic overconfidence. Sometimes you'll need to interpret a rule, improvise a ruling, or simply decide with your group what makes the game more entertaining.

Preparing adventures is often the most time-consuming part of being a GM. For a campaign, a collection of linked adventures featuring the same characters, this means thinking about larger themes and goals. Some crawlers just want to survive another floor, others want to destroy a corporation, destabilize interstellar politics, or kill a god to drive their fans into a frenzy.

For individual sessions, preparation is usually on a much smaller scale. The Neighborhoods and Quests in Chapters 7, 8, and 9 are designed to help make this easy while still being customizable. Familiarize yourself with the encounters, maps, NPCs, and major mechanics likely to come up. You don't need to prepare every possible outcome in advance, as players are likely to attempt something bizarre, anyway, and even the most prepared GMs survive by staying flexible.

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RULES

The rules of the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** exist to help determine what happens when crawlers, Mobs, Bosses, corporate sociopaths, and unstable magic collide in spectacular fashion.

As the GM, your job is to interpret and apply the rules in a way that keeps the game moving and the table engaged. Sometimes that means following the rules exactly—other times it means adjusting them because the crawlers did something clever the designers never anticipated, like weaponizing a parade float or attempting diplomacy with a sentient fungus made entirely of teeth. If a rule doesn't cover a situation, it's your job to make a quick ruling and keep the game moving. If you're unsure what the right call is and can't find the answer in a reasonable amount of time, you can always let players know this is a temporary fix and that you'll revisit the details later to decide if another solution should be put in place for future sessions.

Keep in mind, you don't need to memorize the entire book before running your first session. Read the GM advice, familiarize yourself with the basics, and learn the rest as you play. If you have experienced players at the table, feel free to recruit them as rules assistants if that helps you feel more at ease.

NPCS: ON THE EFFICIENT DEPLOYMENT OF NON-PLAYER PERSONNEL

When it comes to NPCs, don't over-complicate things; most only need a clear motivation or memorable trait and a reason to help or hinder the crawlers. Recurring NPCs may benefit from additional notes, especially if they build ongoing relationships with the PCs over time, but those are often drafted as the players interact. You do not need a twelve-page psychological profile for the mushroom merchant unless the crawlers make the unforgivable decision to care about him.

This process is called "responsive characterization." Some associates (i.e., GMs) refer to it as "making shit up because the players adopted the acid-spitting Kobold you intended as disposable cannon fodder." Both terms are acceptable in internal reports.

A successful session should challenge, surprise, terrify, and amuse the crawlers, while periodically allowing them to feel heroic and clever. These moments are important. They create investment. So permit the crawlers their victories. Let them solve the puzzle. Let them believe they have outsmarted the room.

Then, at the appropriate moment that makes for a good story, have the dungeon kick down a load-bearing wall and release the chainsaw-wielding combat clowns.

HOW IS A GAME SESSION STRUCTURED?

Game sessions beyond Session Zero often begin with a quick recap of previous events and the PCs' current goals. Early in a campaign, it can also help players to briefly reintroduce their crawlers and explain their current condition, especially if someone ended the last session poisoned, cursed, partially on fire, or emotionally devastated.

Starting a session with immediate action is a great way to pull everyone back into the game. An ambush by wandering Mobs, a collapsing hallway, a screaming alert from the System AI, or a sudden problem demanding immediate attention can quickly reestablish the campaign's mood and momentum. Most sessions build through a series of encounters and complications before reaching a climactic confrontation, major revelation, or cliffhanger designed to drag the crawlers back for the next episode of this deeply irresponsible death show.

A successful session should end with excitement, anticipation, and mild emotional damage. At the end of a session, the group should take a few minutes to debrief. Schedule the next session, resolve lingering questions, and make sure character sheets, notes, loot, and important campaign information are updated while memories are still fresh.

Take notes. Encourage the crawlers to keep journals. Compare them when necessary. Discrepancies should be resolved before they metastasize into "continuities," which are much harder to remove once players begin caring about them.

Finally, observe all real-world operational restrictions. If your venue has a hard cutoff time, respect it. Pack up your materials, thank the facility staff, secure any loose dice, and vacate the premises before civilian authorities become part of the encounter.

HOW IS A ONE-SHOT ADVENTURE STRUCTURED?

A one-shot game is designed to be played entirely in a single session. Unlike in a long campaign, players typically won't bring back the same crawlers to future game sessions for further adventures. This

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does not mean the characters are unimportant... but they are highly perishable.

A one-shot may have sequels. You may run several one-shots that occur in sequence, share a location, revisit surviving characters, or explore the consequences of previous crawler behavior. However, each installment should still function as a complete entertainment unit. It should have a clear premise, immediate stakes, meaningful choices, escalating danger, and a satisfying conclusion (which may well be the gory death of every crawler in the party.)

A COMPLETE SHORT STORY

Borant Policy is that every one-shot game should contain its own beginning, middle, and end. Players should leave the session feeling they have experienced a complete crawler incident, even if that incident represents only one terrible afternoon in their crawlers' broader lives. A satisfying one-shot game generally employs a simple, easily understood goal that presents a challenge players can overcome in just a few hours. If the crawlers spend a lot of time not knowing their goal, any ending is likely to feel rushed or anticlimactic.

Keeping the goal of a one-shot clear and simple allows players to get to the key parts of the plot in a single session. Clearing an entire floor is far too large for a one-shot, and even conquering a full Neighborhood may be pushing it. More appropriate goals include defeating a specific Boss, surviving a dangerous chokepoint, or stealing something the crawlers absolutely should not have touched in the first place.

READY-TO-PLAY CHARACTERS

Management recognizes that some players enjoy building their own doomed little crawlers from scratch, lovingly selecting every Skill, Spell, trait, background feature, and inventory item. This is admirable, but time-consuming. For one-shot games, GMs may instead create pre-generated crawlers in advance and have players pick from among those "pregens" to play, because there's often no time for a full session zero.

While you can allow players to bring their own crawlers, if players bring crawlers that don't mesh well together, or lack the Skills or Spells needed for the adventure, you aren't likely to have time to modify them and get the full game session in. Even if a GM allows players to bring their own crawlers, having ready-to-play crawlers as backups is a good idea.

REDUCED CONSEQUENCE SENSITIVITY

In an ongoing campaign, players often develop a feeling of protective attachment to their crawlers. This is understandable. After several sessions of trauma-bonding and bad decisions, the player may become invested in avoiding lethal consequences because they expect to return next session. They want to keep their abilities. They want to resolve their personal arcs. They want to see whether the suspicious egg they found hatches into a pet or a problem.

Many players understand that their crawler is unlikely to return after the session ends. As a result, they may relax and take more risks than they would in a campaign. They may charge the Boss. They may pull the forbidden lever. They may drink the puddle of glowing fluid on the floor because "this character only has two hours to live, anyway." This isn't necessarily a bad thing, and a GM can even plan for it by having PC deaths function as a backup way through difficult encounters (see *Failing Forward*, p. 61), but it is something a GM should consider when designing the game.

WRAPPING UP ON TIME

The hardest part of running a one-shot is often finishing the adventure right at the end of the time you have scheduled to play it. If the game ends too early, there's no meaningful follow-up or crawler advancement to fill the available play time. If the game runs longer than the scheduled time and that deadline can't be moved, the players never get to see the end of the plotline they spent a session working on.

One way to better manage pacing is to plan a few optional encounters while keeping the core plot focused on just two or three major scenes or challenges. This allows the GM to stick with the bare minimum number of encounters if the PCs are moving very slowly, but also the freedom to add more encounters if they zip through the early stages.

Another option is to consider one or two "off ramps" while preparing the scenario. These are shortcuts to get to an ending. Instead of waiting for the PCs to find the Boss, maybe the Boss finds them? Note that off ramps don't always need to lead to "the ending," but simply a convenient spot where most of the story wraps up. Villains may escape, captives may still be captive, Spells may be uncast, but it should feel like a reasonable place to wrap up. You can always spin lingering plot threads into a new one-shot later.

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HOW IS A CAMPAIGN STRUCTURED?

While you can certainly purchase or plan a one-shot adventure, many groups play RPGs as campaigns, which are long-running storylines that span multiple game sessions. In many ways, a campaign works like a television series or the ever-escalating disasters in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** books.

Each session tells its own story, but together they build a larger narrative. Campaigns allow PCs to grow, relationships to evolve, and traumatic dungeon incidents to become running jokes years later.

THE PARTY IS THE STAR...

Ideally, a campaign begins by gathering a group of players and getting them together at least once before the first session of play. In this initial gathering, often called *session zero* (see *Session Zero*, p. 246), you can go over what kind of campaign you want to run and help the players create appropriate crawlers. If you aren't sure what direction you want to take the campaign, session zero can also be a great time to ask what kind of game the players are most interested in.

With that established, campaigns need a way to get the PCs together and keep them together across multiple adventuring Neighborhoods. This can be as simple as establishing that the PCs all knew each other before entering the dungeon and shared friendships or responsibilities (similar to team Meadow Lark).

More elaborate campaigns may tie the PCs together through curses, shared enemies, contracts, faction obligations, or Quests that require them all to survive together. The GM can present these options during session zero and ask players to build crawlers that fit an agreed-upon campaign premise the GM is happy with.

...WITH A GOAL

Similarly, a campaign needs an end goal for the PCs to work toward. This objective gives the player crawlers something to pursue beyond "avoid becoming slurry," though that remains a valid short-term priority. Goals should be on par with surviving a floor and reaching the next floor, and it should culminate in a fun and exciting climax. Achieving this objective does not automatically require campaign termination. However, it does create a natural transition point. Depending on the group's interest and ability to continue, the GM can create a new "season" or set a new goal for PCs to pursue. Finishing the Floor, completing a major Quest, outsmarting a rival crawler, or taking a good exit deal are all good goals.

Crawlers, regrettably, do not usually advance toward major objectives in a straight line. Each session should introduce smaller obstacles, opportunities, crises, errands, betrayals, resource shortages, tactical disasters, side quests, and opportunities for poor judgment that move the campaign forward while creating the illusion of meaningful choice. Over time, these smaller victories and catastrophes build toward larger climactic Boss encounters that determine whether the crawlers survive long enough to achieve their ultimate goal. Whatever that is.

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TIPS FOR FIRST-TIME GMS

- Rule number one? Have fun! Players are much more likely to have a good time if the GM is also enjoying the game. Jokes, banter, ridiculous voices, movie quotes, and absurd running gags are all part of an epic experience for everyone. This is a game about surviving a televised nightmare run by lunatic aliens after all, embrace the chaos!
- The more sessions you run, the less you will need to cling to outside advice or approved procedures handed down by people who were not present when your crawlers tried to weaponize a bathroom. Experience teaches you what works at your table.
- Don't stress about preparation. A few good encounters, some interesting NPCs, and a general idea of the story are enough to run a great session. Try prepping notes over novels and see how it goes.
- Players surprise you constantly, and that's entirely normal. Some of the best moments happen when the crawlers do something nobody expected and open up a brand-new opportunity for adventure.
- If you aren't sure how a rule works, make a quick ruling and keep the game moving. Everyone gets the rules wrong now and again, and you can always look up the exact answer later and adjust it for future games.
- Listen when players speculate about mysteries or hidden threats; sometimes their ideas are better than what you originally planned. The System AI calls this "collaborative storytelling" and promptly takes credit for everything. No one has to know.
- Use your descriptions to make the dungeon feel alive by thinking beyond just what the crawlers see. Describe smells, sounds, heat, vibrations, strange lighting, distant screams, and the wet crunching noise behind the next door.
- Only call for dice rolls when success or failure are both possible and interesting. The dice exist to create tension, triumph, and disaster: it's often best to avoid using them as boring accounting filler.
- Don't let "playing the System AI" turn you into a real-life tyrant. Guide the game, keep the crawlers focused, and maintain momentum. Most of all, remember everyone is there to have fun together and your job is to keep the players mostly alive and having a good time.
- That said, the System AI has a sense of its personal worth. If a character insists on publicly calling the System AI "an overbearing calculator with daddy issues," then yes, the System AI may absolutely retaliate with humiliating circumstances, targeted inconveniences, or suspiciously personal Boss fights.
- Attack the characters, never the players.
- Take notes during play. That NPC the players joke about for thirty seconds inevitably becomes emotionally important six sessions later, and you'll want to remember their name. Additionally, if you often forget the same rule or combat effect, make yourself a cheat sheet. The greatest weapon in a GM's arsenal isn't always creativity, but good note-taking!
- If you aren't sure where the campaign should go next, ask the players what they're enjoying. Villains they hate, NPCs they love, items they dream of questing for, and terrible decisions they're eager to revisit are all useful clues for future sessions.
- Finally, if your players keep showing up, they're probably having a good time. Relax, you're doing great! If you need some reassurance, poll the players for feedback or chat with other GMs online.

SYNERGY!

Unlike many board or card games, the goal in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** isn't to defeat the other players. In fact, there isn't really a single "win" condition at all. The crawlers survive by working together long enough to face more challenging difficulties later. While individual heroics can create memorable moments, most successful groups survive because the PCs support one another.

Campaigns also grow and change over time. Crawlers evolve, players discover new strategies, rivalries form, plans collapse, and occasionally someone adopts a deeply cursed pet that becomes the emotional center of the entire campaign. Like a sports team, an adventuring group may gain or lose members over time while continuing to push toward larger goals.

Most importantly, remember that tabletop RPGs are cooperative social experiences. Everyone at the table is investing time, creativity, and energy into the game together. Respecting schedules, communicating clearly, and showing up ready to play all help the whole group have a better experience.

The System AI strongly encourages teamwork, mainly because coordinated crawlers survive long enough to become statistically better entertainment.

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IT'S A NARRATIVE

The pacing and interactions of a roleplaying game are similar to those of fiction in a similar genre, and this RPG does its best to set up interactions similar to those of the **Dungeon Carl Crawler** series. That means not every encounter has the same stakes. Failure at a climactic moment in the story *should* hurt more than failing a minor task.

As adventures unfold, the PCs may find themselves pursuing goals beyond simple survival. They might protect allies, hunt rivals, gain fame with viewers and sponsors, uncover conspiracies, settle grudges, or become emotionally invested in problems they absolutely should have ignored.

Meanwhile, each floor has a built-in timer, and when the collapse countdown reaches zero, everyone still trapped on that floor dies. This tends to keep the crawlers motivated. The GM may introduce additional pressures and complications along the way, but players often create plenty of their own. Some groups become heroic rescuers; others become ruthless opportunists; and most alternate between the two depending on the available loot and the time remaining.

Most importantly, the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** is both a game and a collaborative story. Sometimes, doing what is most advantageous within the rules of the game is at cross-purposes to doing what is most dramatically entertaining. That conflict is part of the delightful complexity of playing an RPG.

The System AI, of course, strongly encourages dramatic decision-making. And if someone ends up with a gut full of flesh-eating micro eels, all the better.

IT'S A SOCIAL ACTIVITY

Tabletop RPGs are social games, and ***Dungeon Crawler Carl*** works best when everyone at the table shares similar expectations about tone, teamwork, and the general level of chaos they're hoping to unleash.

Some groups lean heavily into tactical survival, others prefer ridiculous stunts, dark comedy, or nonstop disaster fueled by energy drinks and catastrophic decision-making. Most campaigns land somewhere in the middle. It can take time for a group to find its rhythm as players learn each other's sense of humor, storytelling styles, and comfort levels. Like any social commitment, communication is crucial, especially when questions or disagreements arise.

INTEGRATING PC BACKSTORIES

As a GM, it helps to know who the PCs were before they entered the World Dungeon and who they're becoming as the campaign unfolds. The PCs' Traumas, Regrets, and Loose Ends are the bones of a backstory. If necessary, ask your players for, or work with them to develop, more backstory. This gives you useful material for future encounters, allies, rivals, rewards, and catastrophes. Family members, old jobs, hobbies, fears, embarrassing secrets, exes, favorite weapons, irrational hatred of Cocker Spaniels... it's all fuel for Borant, other showrunners, and the System AI.

Pay attention to how players react when elements of their backstories appear in the game. If someone seems uncomfortable with a topic, there's no reason to push it. But when players laugh, panic, cheer, or dramatically curse your name during a reveal, you've probably found material worth revisiting later at infrequent opportune moments.

As the campaign continues, the PCs might add to their backstories through play. This may result from encounters within the dungeon or on shows, or by further developing their former lives on Earth. Keep notes on major victories, rivalries, disasters, critical hits, terrible plans, and especially the things players get emotionally attached to.

If the crawlers kill a Boss in a memorable way, maybe that Boss's furious sibling appears two floors later carrying the same weapon and a deeply unhealthy grudge. A player becomes obsessed with using a flamethrower as their primary solution to every problem? Introduce ridiculous upgrades, sponsor rewards, or experimental fuel types with increasingly questionable side-effects. The System AI tends to reward crawlers who have some kind of signature flair or style with more of the same, like that banana guy on the Fifth Floor.

You can also reinforce character identity through rewards and obstacles. A crawler known for reckless melee combat might find brutal close-range weapons, while a stealth-focused character may uncover tools for infiltration and sabotage. Likewise, recurring weaknesses can become part of the ongoing story.

Finally, use tragic backstory elements carefully. Loss, failure, and emotional stakes can create powerful moments, but they work best when used sparingly and at dramatically appropriate times. A little tragedy makes the story hit harder; too much turns the campaign into hours of emotional damage and awkward silence around the snack table.

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PORTRAYING THE WORLD

Whether your crawlers are being processed through the Second Floor, the Twelfth Floor, or any other World Dungeon environment, the GM is primarily responsible for immersion. You bring the danger, absurdity, spectacle, and occasional uncomfortable sincerity of the dungeon to life. This is not a small operational burden. Fortunately, you do not need to be a professional author to succeed. You just need a dash of Carl's mojo, a sprinkle of Donut's wit, and a little bit of advice. That's what this incredible Bloom-approved handbook is for! Aren't they wonderful?

PACING

A huge part of what makes the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** stories work is pacing. The tension rises, crashes, escalates, and occasionally detonates into absolute chaos before anyone has time to emotionally recover. Your game sessions are likely to feel the same way.

Not every moment needs to be high-action combat. Quiet scenes, emotional conversations, arguments, exploration, and moments of dread all help build tension for the next disaster waiting around the corner. As GM, part of your job is controlling that rhythm.

If combat starts dragging, it's okay to speed things up. If players spend too long debating whether to open the suspicious screaming door, you can introduce a complication or have the door open itself (perhaps a Mob was drawn to the noise of the PC's conversation). When something emotional or dramatic happens, slow down and let the moment breathe for a minute.

The System AI is one of your best pacing tools. Since the Crawl exists as a massive interstellar reality show, the AI, managers, sponsors, and viewers all have opinions about what makes "good television." If the crawlers stall too long, viewership drops, and the AI may intervene. If things move too quickly, the AI might slow things down with announcements, distractions, side encounters, or increasingly aggressive nonsense. Just remember to use this sparingly so crawlers still feel their own choices matter.

You can also control pacing through your descriptions. Fast, clipped narration creates urgency during combat. Slower, more detailed descriptions help emotional scenes land harder. Even changing your tone of voice can shift the energy at the table.

Recurring rivals are another excellent pacing tool. If things begin to stall, an enemy crawler, bounty hunter, or rival faction can suddenly appear to complicate everyone's day.

Most sessions eventually build toward a major moment, such as a Boss fight. Occasionally, the climax happens early, or sometimes the crawlers spend forty minutes trying to interrogate a vending machine they believe is possessed. It's okay to adapt as needed; tabletop RPGs are collaborative stories, not scripted novels.

When possible, end sessions either shortly after a major climax or immediately before something terrible happens. Resolution gives players time to process events, and cliffhangers make them desperate to come back and see what happens next. And we just love repeat customers!

SPONTANEITY AND IMPROVISATION

That thing where your crawlers ignore the obvious door and somehow manage to circumvent the entire floor by *smashing* it? Circumstances like this, while... regrettable... give *you* the opportunity for improvisation!

Improvisation (improv) is one of the most useful skills a GM can develop. You don't need any Bloom-approved theatre training or a background in Emergency Narrative Fabrication. You just need to stay flexible, listen to the players, and react to what happens at the table.

If the players become convinced there's a Laminak sniper hiding in the ventilation shafts, maybe there is now. If they fear the smiling NPC is secretly a murderer, perhaps the System AI decides that sounds entertaining. Or perhaps the opposite is true: the sniper is a crawler trying to assist the party, and it's their parasitized NPC friend who is the danger. Plot twist! When the players—or the crawlers—invent a theory, emotional twist, or villain motivation more interesting than what you originally planned, it's okay to use it. Some of the best moments in tabletop RPGs happen because a GM takes an unexpected player idea and turns it into reality.

At the same time, player choices need to matter. Yes, the crawlers are trapped in an unfair death maze

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run by unstable maniacs, but you don't want them to become unproductively disheartened. Avoid forcing players down a single path or shutting down every unexpected idea just because it wasn't part of your original plan.

Prepared encounters sometimes need adjustment during play. If combat becomes overwhelming, scale things back. If the players are cruising through challenges too easily, escalate the danger. Learn to adapt to the session's pacing and energy rather than rigidly sticking to your notes, and everyone will have a good time.

When danger is coming, foreshadow it. Strange noises, warning signs, half-eaten corpses, panicked NPCs, or suspicious environmental details all help players feel like they had a chance to react before disaster strikes.

You can use improv to make the world feel alive, responsive, and dangerous. If disaster strikes, players should usually be able to look back and realize there were signs, choices, clues, or warnings they might have handled differently. And just remember: The dungeon already has permission to be cruel, and it has that covered. Your job is to make the cruelty entertaining, poignant, or both.

USING HUMOR

Dungeon Crawler Carl is an action-thriller with a heavy streak of dark comedy. The setting is violent, absurd, emotional, and frequently ridiculous. Much like the novels themselves, the tone leans into brutal fights, emotional gut punches, bizarre NPCs, catastrophic nonsense, and jokes arriving just seconds before disaster. You're not running Gothic horror or relentless grimdark misery here.

At the same time, this isn't a nonstop comedy sketch. Not every scene needs a joke, and not every emotional moment should get interrupted by one. A lot of humor in tabletop RPGs happens naturally as players react to events, quote movies, make terrible plans, and laugh at plans gone wrong.

Humor in *Dungeon Crawler Carl* comes from both dialogue and situations. The dungeon itself is absurd. A horrifying Boss can still be wearing a mascot costume. A deadly encounter might revolve around an enchanted hot dog cannon, a malfunctioning parade float, or a blender fiend wielding dual chainsaws.

When preparing a session, think about places where humor might naturally emerge. A strange NPC, an over-the-top sponsor message, a bizarre item description, or an unreasonably dramatic Boss introduction can all help reinforce the setting's personality.

And if a joke falls flat? Don't panic, make fun of the failure, and move on. One final note: Comedy usually works best when it doesn't overstay its welcome. A joke that lands once is memorable. A joke repeated ten times becomes psychic damage. Unless the joke becomes a catchphrase like "Mongo is appalled." That one is legally immortal.

MAINTAINING THE CAST OF CHARACTERS

Recurring villains, allies, rivals, and even bizarre NPC encounters help drive a campaign forward. Crawlers reveal who they are through interactions with the people they trust, fear, rescue, and accidentally maim. A good recurring cast makes the dungeon feel alive.

Some NPCs exist for a single encounter, while others become memorable because they keep returning. A rival crawler with a grudge, a suspicious ally, or a Boss's third cousin twice removed who mysteriously survived the last encounter and is out for revenge are all examples of recurring characters.

Give important NPCs a few memorable traits or quirks, but be careful not to overload them with details players will struggle to remember. One distinctive feature, speech pattern, obsession, or terrible fashion choice is often enough to cement them in crawlers' minds.

The World Dungeon is enormous and full of strange species, factions, and disasters. Use that variety to your advantage! A terrifying warlord might secretly want an alliance. A friendly vendor might be selling cursed sandwiches for deeply personal reasons. A sentient mushroom lawyer may genuinely believe the crawlers have violated fungal maritime law, despite the distressing absence of an ocean. The System AI strongly supports bizarre specificity; just roll with it.

Whenever possible, introduce important NPCs through action instead of exposition. Let the players witness what a character does before explaining who they are. A Boss executing their own minion says more than a five-minute speech about how dangerous they are.

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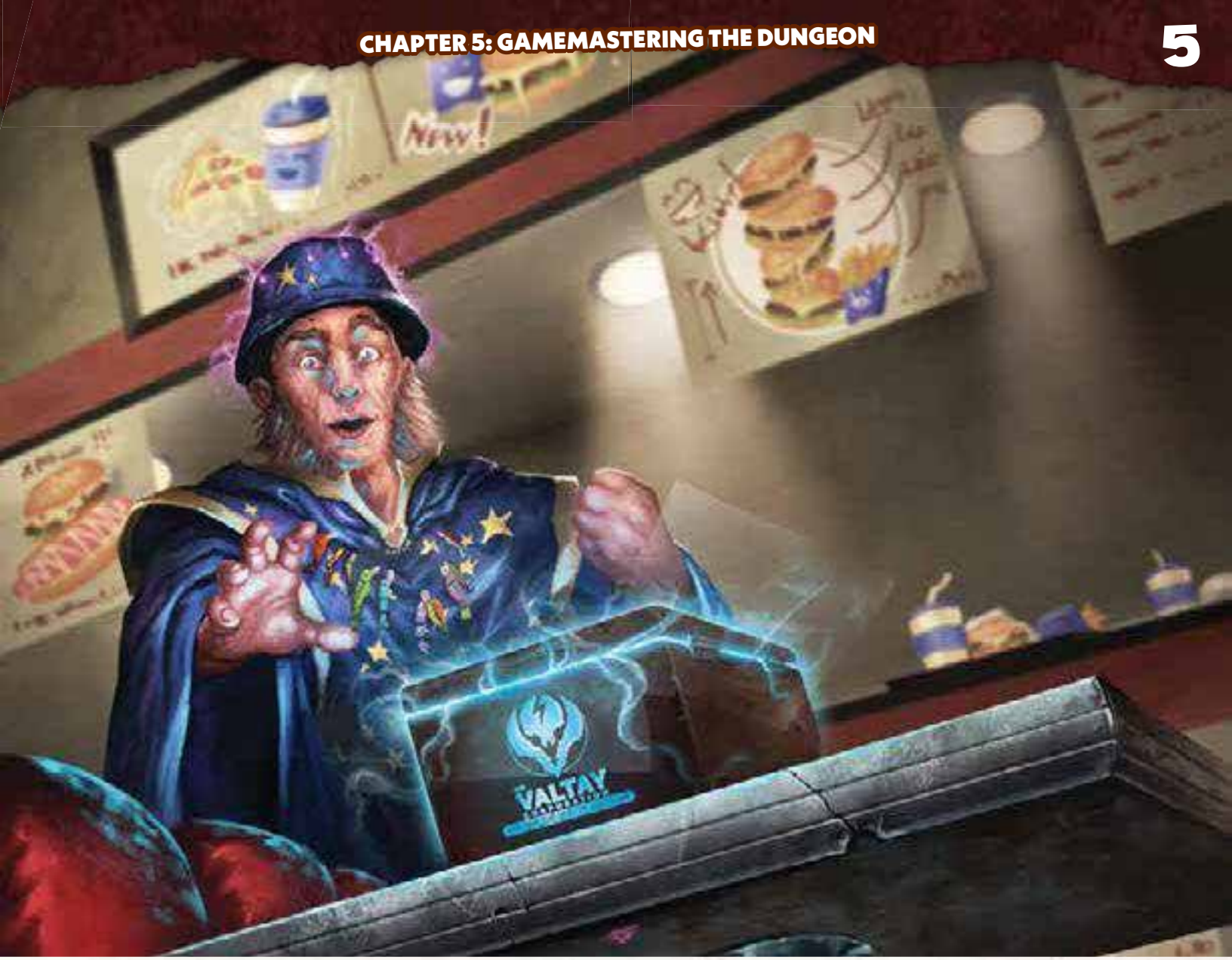

You can also build anticipation before a character appears. Rumors, bounty posters, destroyed environments, survivors, or whispered stories all help make major NPCs feel important before they ever enter the scene.

When players finally meet the big bad, make the introduction memorable. Appearance, dialogue, and timing matter. A crawler wearing mermaid nipple jewelry and a feathered hat raises questions. So does a man sprinting through the dungeon in heart-patterned boxer shorts while carrying a rocket launcher and screaming about revenge.

Ultimately, characters should feel like they have lives beyond waiting for the PCs to arrive. Even villains believe themselves to be the heroes of their own horrifying stories.

MAINTAINING THE MOOD

The narrative of **Dungeon Crawler Carl** is best described as emotional whiplash, rapidly shifting between comedy, horror, action, tragedy, and outright absurdity. Your game sessions are likely to be just as hilariously random or tragic, and that's entirely normal.

Description, pacing, NPC behavior, music, and encounter design all help establish tone. A tense hallway full of distant screams creates a very different atmosphere than a parade of giant squirrels in tactical gear marching down the street with paint guns and a banner reading: "Acorns for the Acorn God."

Conflict is also a huge part of the mood. Player characters wanting different things at the same time,

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established rivals, hostile factions, and manipulative NPCs all create tension, even when nobody is actively trying to mutilate anyone.

Comedy and tragedy often come from the same setup: characters pursue a goal, and events spiral wildly away from anyone's expectations. Sometimes players react differently than you anticipated, and that's okay. Don't force a scene to feel funny or serious if the table clearly isn't connecting with it. Adapt to the group's energy and keep the game moving. Remember, you can guide tone, but you can't dictate feelings.

And if the mood completely derails? Take your contractually-permitted ten minute break, let everyone reset, and come back fresh. Sometimes all a session needs is more snacks and five minutes away from the current morality crisis.

RECURRING CHARACTERS AND THE LEADERBOARD

Napoleon allegedly said, "A soldier will fight long and hard for a bit of colored ribbon." He was referring to medals, of course, but he could just as well be referencing the dungeon leaderboard. There's a top list, and everyone wants to be on it.

The PCs are no different. The leaderboard shows a mix of popularity, violence, engagement, and who knows what else. As your players navigate the World Dungeon, they'll meet other crawlers. Some are of little consequence. Others become rivals who can appear as often as needed and also hold spots on the leaderboard.

Tracking the leaderboard gives both an in-game and a meta-game reason to keep ahead. It encourages competition not only between the PCs and other crawlers but also among the PCs themselves. Princess Donut might be more popular than Carl, but Carl often seems to top her on the leaderboard. It might be bragging rights; it might be more.

Recurring casts of characters get up to all sorts of things off the players' radar. The leaderboard, however reminds players that those crawlers are still out there making them look bad. Perception matters, because the dungeon isn't just a death trap; it's entertainment for the bloodthirsty masses.

Leaderboard fame comes with rewards, including loot boxes, sponsorship opportunities, and public recognition. It also increases the value of a crawler's head. Rival crawlers may hunt the PCs for money, fame, survival, or even just revenge. Likewise, the PCs may decide someone else's bounty looks too tempting to ignore. Hyper-capitalism is a bitch.

In the World Dungeon, money buys gear, upgrades, security, influence, and occasionally a slightly lower chance of dying horribly. Gold keeps the dungeon economy moving, and every crawler eventually learns the same lesson: Heads are worth money, sometimes that includes yours.

ADDING TO THE WORLD

The **Dungeon Crawler Carl** books give us a rich tapestry of floors, clubs, shows, and other oddities and entertainments. Your game can use those same elements, but one of the best parts of TTRPGs is expanding worlds beyond what already exists on the page.

While this book doesn't contain canonical new floors or clubs, it does suggest variants, and your World Dungeon can include whatever you want. This section is about possibility. It's a suggestion box stuffed with ideas, themes, and paths you and your crawlers might take.

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Each floor has themes, gimmicks, or some kind of horrifying internal logic. The Borant Corporation programmed these floors long ago, but that doesn't mean your dungeon has to follow Carl's exact path. Some groups may want to reenact familiar floors and adventures. Others may want something entirely new. It's a big universe out there. Who's to say the World Dungeon only has one iteration?

The point is to make what intrigues you and your players. You're the architect now. If you want a floor built around post-apocalyptic vehicle combat, go for it. If you want floating islands where knights joust atop screaming ostrich monsters, do that. Looking for a deadly game show hosted by a sentient raccoon in a tuxedo? The System AI fully supports this plan.

Ah, but how? That's the real question. One answer, one which all great GMs and corporations use, is theft. Books, films, comics, games, mythology, conspiracy theories, and fever dreams are all ripe for pilfering.

A go-kart race as a floor or Neighborhood? Absolutely. Roman legions fighting WWII soldiers? Sure, why not? Gothic horror castles full of vampires? The System AI would like to subscribe to your newsletter.

It doesn't matter where your ideas come from. What matters is whether you can get mileage out of them. Good floors should entertain, challenge the PCs, and play to the group's strengths and weaknesses. What Classes did they choose? What tactics do they favor? What terrible habits keep nearly getting them killed?

Get to know your players. Some groups want nonstop combat. Others prefer puzzles, roleplaying, horror, exploration, politics, or increasingly elaborate acts of property destruction (See *Something for Everyone*, p. 273). The needs of the group should shape the floors, clubs, and shows you create.

But it isn't only about the players. You should enjoy the material, too. Everyone at the table contributes to the experience, and your goal is to ensure everyone in the group is having fun, yourself included.

Fortunately, the World Dungeon already provides a massive foundation to build from. You can expand existing clubs, create new shows, invent factions, introduce criminal syndicates, or explore parts of the larger universe the books only hint at.

A whole universe exists outside the World Dungeon, too! Important people, aliens, wealthy magnates, and more all have a stake in the show. They might sponsor a crawler or two, or in-fighting among them might leak into a current floor. There are even survivors on Earth who are depending on the crawlers to reclaim their lost planet.

Every third floor in the World Dungeon functions as part of an ongoing storyline involving volcanic worlds and an endgame Boss known as Scolopendra said to reside on Floor 18. That's how it is in Carl's world. In yours, that might be entirely different. You aren't bound by what Carl sees and does. Your entire World Dungeon can be different. Your NPCs, your floor gimmicks, your clubs, your shows, and even the loot is yours to make.

If you're running this game for a group you don't know very well, sticking close to the novels is probably the easiest bet. But if you're running it for friends, and most of them have read the books more than once, they probably want to experience some of what they read and a whole lot of what they imagined might come after.

There's no wrong way to set up your game. Use the Tutorial Floors and then take off on your own. Throw in the Iron Tangle, but switch it up for the next floor. Urban floors offer a lot of variety, and the books can only show so many Neighborhoods. Likewise, an overland floor might be fun for players who want to see what a biome looks like inside the dungeon. Yes, they already have bubbles, but you can take that idea and expand it across an entire floor.

The seedy Desperado Club caters to all sorts of base tastes, but you can make your own. Or you can make a club that lets crawlers sample some of the wealth and comfort offered by the universal elite. They might even become entangled in the machinations of powerful extra-dungeon entities while there. After all, any game where there's betting invites cheating.

And who's to say organized crime of some new stripe doesn't want in on the action? There are bounties on the leaderboard favorites, but people might want to alter the odds by having certain lower-Level crawlers disposed of. Heck, there could be a revolutionary group that wants to bring down the Syndicate and needs your crawlers to make it happen.

The point is that the World Dungeon is flexible. We've seen Carl's Crawl, now show your players yours!

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GATHERING THE PARTY

Now that you're all prepped and ready to go, it's time to gather the party! When building a party, players naturally fall into different combat and non-combat roles. As the GM, it helps to encourage some variety and give players chances to shine in the things they're good at.

For combat, the classic roles still apply: tanks soak up damage and keep Mobs busy, healers keep everyone from dying, and damage dealers turn enemies into dungeon mulch. Some crawlers fight up close, others sling Spells or Attack from range, but somebody usually ends up holding the line while someone else screams for healing.

Outside combat, parties often benefit from a charismatic speaker, a sneaky scout, and somebody capable of handling traps, crafting, explosives, or weird magical nonsense without immediately detonating themselves.

In larger groups, multiple players may fill the same role. Smaller groups usually force crawlers to multitask. Either way, most characters end up with both a combat specialty and something useful outside a fight.

Balanced groups tend to handle a wider variety of challenges, but wildly unbalanced parties can also be fun if everyone understands the consequences. Five tanks can bulldoze through Mobs but may struggle to recover afterward. Five healers probably survive forever while taking six hours to kill a kobold.

Roleplay matters, too. A player might think being a mysterious lone-wolf assassin sounds cool, but if the rest of the party constantly worries that the "brooding skull-collector" might murder them in their sleep, things can fall apart quickly. Discourage characters who work against the group unless everyone explicitly wants that kind of campaign.

Players should also think about who their crawlers were before entering the dungeon. Maybe they were a burned-out accountant, a disgraced cult leader, a vegan goat-farmer, a yoga instructor and social media influencer, or something even worse that they keep to themselves.

Strong backstories give the GM material to work with and help the party feel like actual people instead of a wandering pile of stats and unresolved trauma.

Finally, encourage players to make distinct characters. Different backgrounds, personalities, ethnicities, viewpoints, genders, and life experiences create a richer, and far more entertaining group dynamic, which is exactly the kind the System AI and audience love most.

SESSION ZERO

Your very first game session probably won't look like the rest. No matter how well everyone knows each other or how much planning happened beforehand, the first session is basically the first day of school. There'll be uncertainty, rule questions, socializing, and probably at least one person quietly panicking inside.

Some groups schedule a Session Zero before the campaign starts. Others fold it into the first session or handle it through Discord, email, video calls, carrier pigeons, or whatever cursed communication method the group uses. Many groups keep having Session Zero-style discussions throughout the campaign whenever new issues arise or a major story arc wraps up.

Google "session zero" and you might find dozens of well-meaning lists of questions to discuss that are not super relevant to your group or dozens of different true ways to do a Session Zero. Most reasonable people agree, however, that it's worth a few minutes to discuss the sort of basic topics described below.

For example, if someone is expecting the game to be the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** but you're using a different rules system, it's best if folks can gracefully bow out before too many details get locked in. Maybe somebody expects tactical survival horror, while others want improv comedy with explosives. One player built a deeply tragic antihero while another created "Sir Farts-a-lot the Minotaur Puncher." Probably better to get all of that sorted out before campaign launch.

After that, things tend to evolve organically, mutate horribly, and drift away from whatever was originally planned. Your Quartermaster (see p. 274) may occasionally remind everyone what was actually agreed upon three months ago regarding snacks, scheduling, and whether eyeball stuff was off-limits.

Here are some of the things you might do in Session Zero:

Team-Building: If the group includes new players, take time to help everyone get comfortable. Borant's

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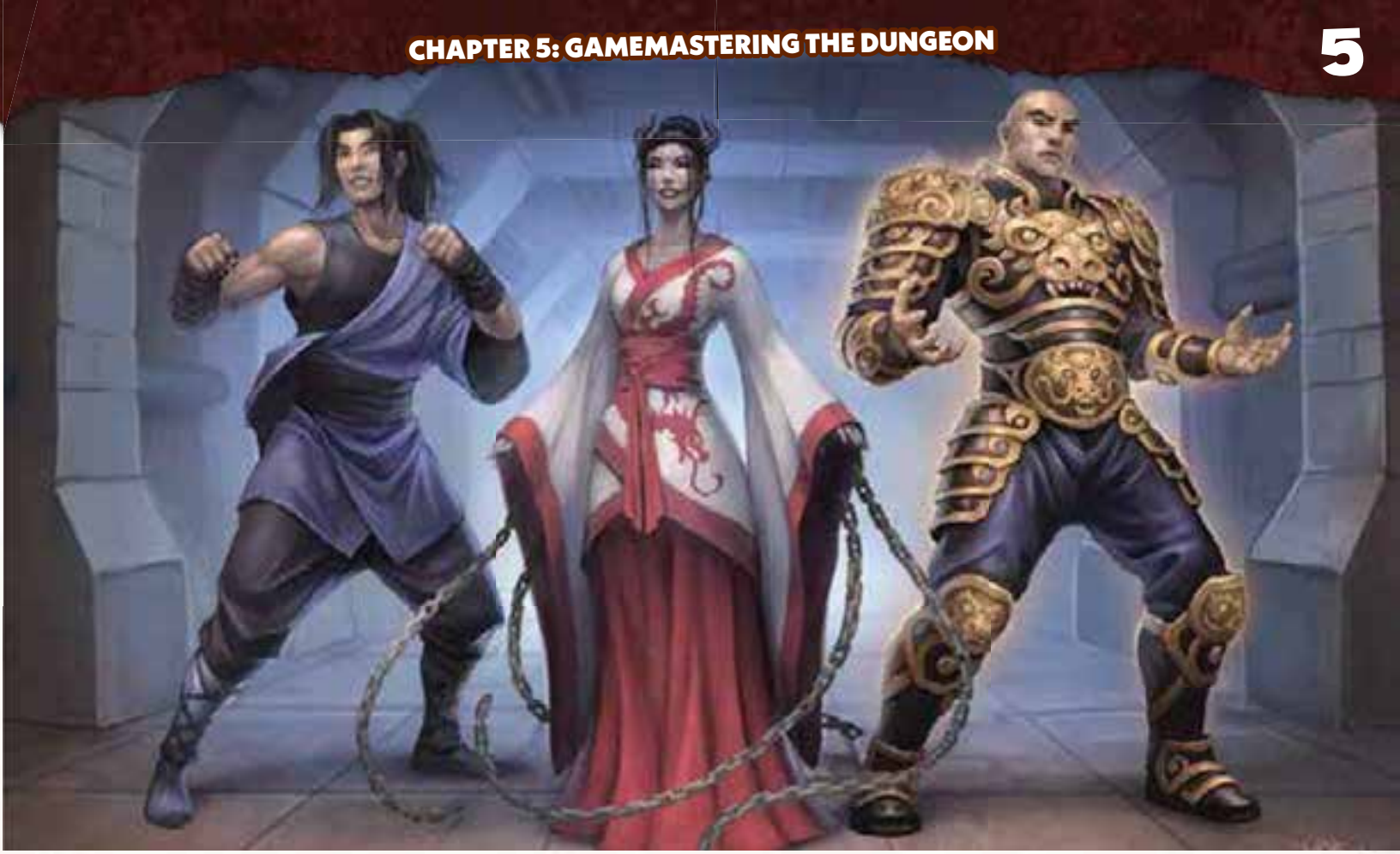

corporate icebreakers are proprietary and intended to create Bloom unity, not creativity, so just have people introduce themselves, their character concepts, and their experience with RPGs.

It's also useful for players to discuss how their characters know each other or why they're willing to risk death together for loot and audience engagement.

Character-Building: Whether you do this before or during Session Zero, players need to select and build their crawlers. Players need access to the rules and should discuss party roles and character concepts, so the group doesn't accidentally create five identical talking cats with an eye for fashion.

The GM may also set restrictions or recommendations depending on the campaign. If you're changing character creation rules, it's crucial to tell people before they design their precious disaster children.

Scheduling: While you've hopefully already talked about this (you made it to Session Zero after all), it's great to confirm expectations for frequency and duration of sessions, as well as get some notice concerning potential absences. You'll also want to decide how long each particular campaign will run.

With a new group, starting small is probably better, so maybe a few months. A more established group can manage a campaign that lasts a year or more without a problem. You'll also want to discuss the conditions under which you'll cancel a game night.

Expectations: Ideally, you'll have set expectations and rules as discussed earlier. If not, this is a great time for that. Setting expectations and respecting boundaries are key to a successful union, be that between players or significant others—and especially between players who *are* significant others. You don't want poor behavior or misunderstandings to ruin your players' gaming experience.

Equally important is deciding upon the consequences for players who fail to uphold expectations or disrespect boundaries. For many adults and some children, a simple disapproving look might be enough to get them in line. Others, though, especially for more serious breaches, might necessitate a private conversation.

It's also important to note, as you move past session zero, that if a player is repeatedly disregarding the agreed-upon rules and nothing seems to alter their behavior, it's acceptable for the group to ask them to move on.

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END OF SESSION ZERO

By the end of Session Zero, the group should understand the campaign's tone, schedule, expectations, boundaries, and character dynamics. That foundation makes future problems much easier to handle.

Of course, the second actual play begins, the players will immediately derail at least half the plan. That's normal. No campaign survives contact with the crawlers.

TEACHING PLAYERS THE RULES

Every player begins as an under-trained asset. New crawlers need time to learn the rules, understand their character sheet, and determine which abilities can be used without setting themselves, their allies, or nearby revenue-generating scenery on fire. This onboarding period is normal.

Still, the better everyone understands the basics, the smoother the game runs. Players don't need encyclopedic system mastery, but spending a little time between sessions reviewing abilities, Spells, gear, and core rules helps keep the dungeon moving at a healthy pace.

A quick rules review is often sufficient. For newer or less rules-focused participants, consider pairing them with a more system-literate player who can answer questions and help explain mechanics during play.

It's also perfectly fine to suggest players choose simpler characters while learning the game. Not everybody wants to juggle seventeen conditional abilities, three resource pools, and a spreadsheet full of summoned liabilities. Sometimes it's more fun to hit things with a sword and yell loudly about it.

And honestly? The Boring Ol' Fighter is only "boring" right up until they solve a problem by introducing it to a shovel at high velocity.

KEEPING PLAYERS ENGAGED

Modern players have access to approximately nine billion distractions at all times. Phones alone contain games, social media, videos, news, group chats, and at least one person doomscrolling while pretending they're "totally listening." It's normal consumer behavior in an attention economy.

Not everyone engages with a game the same way, either. Some doodle. Some snack. Others quietly browse during scenes their characters aren't involved in or bring nine fidget toys, a coloring book, and their knitting to the game. If this does not disrupt play or slow the table, management recommends tolerance.

The problem begins when distraction creates drag. Repeated recap requests, missed turns, forgotten objectives, and constant "wait, what happened?" interruptions reduce momentum and degrade group immersion. However, it is important that you do not default to punitive attention enforcement. This is inefficient and makes you sound like a substitute teacher guarding a contraband Game Boy. Instead, focus on increasing engagement.

Players pay attention when they feel involved. Rotate spotlight time or ask that player to be your note-taker. Give quieter players meaningful choices. Cut scenes that drag too long. Throw in surprises, danger, weird NPCs, audience votes, exploding llamas, or whatever else keeps the dungeon feeling alive.

And if somebody genuinely seems disconnected from the campaign, just talk to them. Maybe they're overwhelmed by the rules. Maybe they're exhausted from work, or the campaign simply isn't hitting the kinds of things they enjoy most.

Identify what activates the player and increases their synergy (and who doesn't love *synergy*?), then add more of that. We find this much more effective than (overt) policing of people's attitudes.

KEEPING THE PEACE

Conflict between characters can be fun. Conflict between players usually isn't. The important thing is knowing the difference.

PCs arguing, competing, distrusting each other, or occasionally threatening to shove one another into monster-infested sewage tunnels can create great drama, as long as the players themselves are still enjoying it. If character conflict starts escalating, it's perfectly okay to pause for a moment and check in with everyone out of character.

Sometimes confusion arises simply because nobody's sure whether a player is speaking in character or as themselves. Using character names or briefly clarifying "my character says" versus "I think" helps avoid a surprising number of misunderstandings!

If the problem is genuinely between players, though, don't try solving it through the game itself. Fireballing somebody's character rarely fixes real-world tension. If things get heated, pause the game. Give everyone a chance to cool off, grab snacks, stretch, or briefly stop existing in the same five-foot radius. Most disagreements calm down once people have a little breathing room and a brain break.

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RUNNING THE GAME

Running a game is equal parts preparation, improvisation, and reacting to whatever unpredictable nonsense erupts once the crawlers hit the floor. As the GM, you describe the world, control the NPCs and monsters, adjudicate the rules, and keep the session moving when things inevitably spiral into gleeful chaos.

At its heart, Game Mastering is about presenting problems and letting the players decide how to survive them. Sometimes they'll come up with brilliant plans, others they'll decide to negotiate with rabid squirrels just because they're cute. Your job is to make the world react in ways that feel exciting, dangerous, funny, and occasionally horrifying.

One of the important skills a GM develops is learning what deserves attention. The players probably won't remember buying rope. They *will* remember the hallway collapsing while someone screams, "I thought you disarmed the trap!"

Good pacing keeps the game alive. Shift between action, humor, exploration, and quieter moments so the session never feels stuck in one gear for too long. If the energy starts fading, introduce a complication. If the crawlers overthink things for half an hour, kick the door open and let the dungeon make the decision for them.

Most importantly, remember that you're not competing against the players. The dungeon already does that. Your job is to challenge the crawlers and help create the kind of stories people retell years later with phrases like, "Technically, the explosion *did* solve the problem."

WHAT IS AN ENCOUNTER?

Rest breaks, endless hallway descriptions, and twenty-seven minutes spent shopping for rope are not encounters. Encounters have stakes. Something changes. Somebody wants something, and someone, or something, is trying to stop them. That conflict might be combat, a negotiation, a chase, a trap, or a desperately awkward conversation with an NPC who definitely should not be holding that many grenades.

Carl spends a lot of time inside the World Dungeon, but the books focus on the interesting parts: the fights, the disasters, the memorable NPCs, and the increasingly wacky events. As the GM, your job is to mimic that excitement and adventure in a similar manner.

This technique is called *zooming in*. Imagine watching a movie where the heroes spend four uninterrupted hours checking hallways for traps, debating marching order, and arguing over whose turn it is to carry the loot box. That isn't tension. It's equivalent of watching paint dry.

Good pacing means focusing on scenes with conflict, danger, humor, emotion, or consequences. A merchant selling basic dungeon supplies probably doesn't need fifteen minutes of roleplay. This isn't *Antiques Roadshow: Apocalypse Edition*.

But if that same merchant is sweating bullets because the PCs just interrupted a robbery, spotted a hidden bounty hunter, or discovered an Elf under the counter trying to sell illegal BorantCoin cryptocurrency? Now you've got a scene worth zooming in on.

SET THE STAKES

As GM, it's often on you to set the stakes of an encounter. Are the crawlers in danger? Do they desperately need information from an NPC? Are they about to be betrayed, exploded, or publicly humiliated on intergalactic television? The stakes only matter if the outcome is uncertain.

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Likewise, don't conjure a combat you know the characters can tear through with ease. Skip it. That's right: Combat isn't always worth zooming in on. Montage that shit, folks. Narrate. Sum up: "You carve through the next few rooms, collect some minor loot, and suffer only the usual minor damage. Moments later, you arrive at a massive doorway marked with claw scars and a glowing sign that reads: WARNING: DRAGON-ADJACENT EVENTS AHEAD. What do you do?"

Okay, that doorway with the dragon draws attention. Besides conveying "here be dragons," it also says, "here be a way to righteously screw up your Crawl." That's the start of a scene.

Tension is one of the best ways to begin an encounter. Another is starting in the middle of the action. Skip the dull setup and jump directly to the important part. If the PCs are meeting another crawler, you probably don't need fifteen minutes of small talk before someone casually says, "Oh, hey, you killed my brother last week. The replay clip got millions of views."

It's equally important that you don't let scenes overstay their welcome. Good movies, books, and games get to the point quickly and move on before the audience gets bored. When the energy starts fading, wrap things up and move to the next interesting moment.

How do you know when to bail on a scene? When you get bored, or the players do. Start scenes where things get interesting and leave before they stop being fun.

TYPES OF ENCOUNTERS

Now you know what an encounter is, but what kinds are there? The **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** has a handful of encounter categories you'll see again and again. In gaming terms, this is called a play loop.

Basically, a play loop is just what the characters do, cyclically, during a session. The novels work the same way. Sure, Carl, Donut, and the other crawlers stumble through increasingly horrifying disasters, but most scenes boil down to combat, exploration, social encounters, traps, puzzles, and occasional catastrophic nonsense.

The secret to fiction, and by extension roleplaying, is repetition that *feels new*. Action movies repeat action scenes. Mysteries have a formula for revelation. Dramas repeat conversations where emotionally damaged people glare at each other while everything quietly catches fire. Think of these encounter types as your toolbox of fun and suffering.

Combat lies at the heart of Carl's world. He didn't ask it to be that way, but he sure as hell knows it now. Most roleplaying games also have a heavy bend toward combat. Look at almost any character sheet. How much of it exists to help somebody survive or enact violence? Exactly.

The novels don't shy away from this. If anything, they mock our endless appetite to watch, monetize, replay, and cheer for increasingly ridiculous violence. The audience loves it. The sponsors love it. The System AI practically orgasms whenever somebody gets exploded by a household appliance or disemboweled by raging nightmare alpacas.

However, combat gets stale fast if every fight feels the same. Endless waves of interchangeable monsters eventually blur together into a slurry of hit points and boredom. Combat encounters need variety in enemies, tactics, locations, stakes, and even environmental hazards. Carl's fights are memorable because they're spectacular!

A battle on a collapsing train hits differently than a fight in an empty corridor or six Zlurpies in a plain square room. Likewise, a basic encounter becomes a lot more interesting when the floor floods with acid, the exits lock shut, or squirrel commandos rappel through the ceiling. Your players and the audience want a spectacle. We recommend feeding the Machine.

All the combat in the world doesn't mean much if you don't care about the combatants or why they're fighting. Most of the time, such knowledge comes from social encounters. You know, talking to people and other distinct galactic beings. The party's encounters with them need to do two things: reveal character and develop plot.

Villains need buildup. Social encounters help spread rumors, clues, and horror stories. Survivors exaggerate body counts. NPCs whisper about impossible powers. Conversations become an easy way to hand players information without dropping exposition anvils.

We learn a lot about Carl through internal monologue, but tabletop RPGs don't really work that way. If every player constantly narrated their thoughts, the session would collapse. Instead, players reveal themselves through action. Who do they trust? Who do they threaten? How do they behave under pressure? Are they cautious, reckless, paranoid, shy, or one bad afternoon away from fighting a Bopca with a broken chair leg?

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Exploration works best when handled at the right scale. If danger lurks nearby, slow down, let the tension breathe. When the torches dim, the PCs' Mana is low, and the healing potions are running out, you can move from a focused progression through the dungeon to a narrative summary.

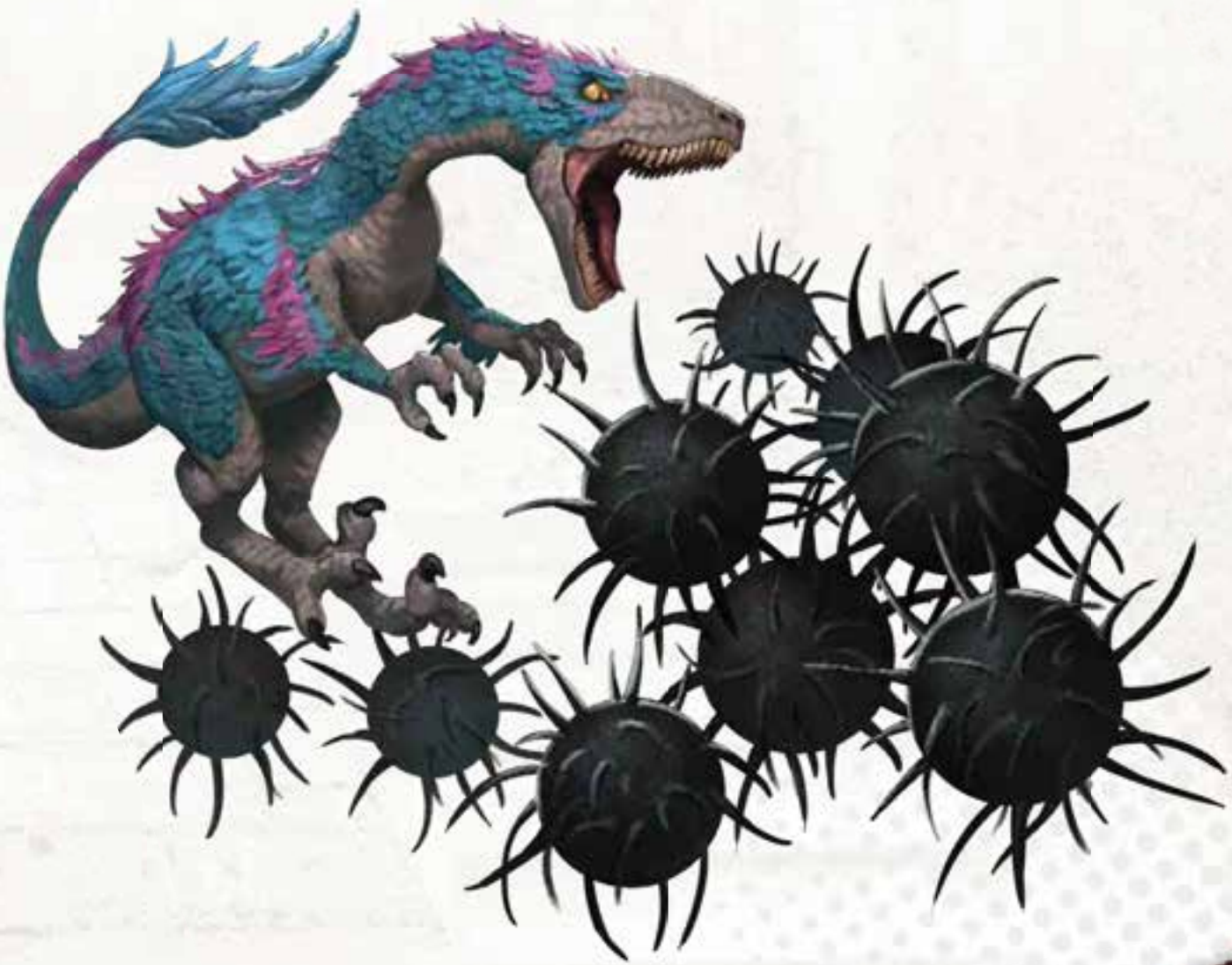
But not every hallway deserves a dramatic close up. Yes, dungeon-crawling is literally in the title, but Dinniman doesn't spend five pages describing Carl walking through empty corridors. He focuses on the good stuff.

The World Dungeon is engineered like a ratings-obsessed executive with infinite budget, and its purpose is to create the perfect highlight reel. If an area contains no danger, clues, tension, or opportunity for decision-making, summarize it and move on. Get to the places that matter—the caverns, Neighborhoods, passages, and nightmare arenas where traps trigger, alliances implode, and combat detonates into chaos.

PvP

Player-versus-player (PvP) combat is great on the page, and it can be a blast at the table. It can also wreck the mood, strain friendships, and make players quit. As the GM, you need to know what kind of game you're running and how your group feels about stabbing each other in the back.

Understanding and acceptance are key. Let players know ahead of time if the game is PvP, and be sure your group agrees to this type of play. Getting it in writing (informally) is not a bad idea. It can just be a quick message and everyone responds with a thumbs up. In Carl's world, betrayal, murder coupons, and opportunistic violence are part of the Crawl. Real players, however, may not react well when Thomas suddenly stabs Kaelyn in the kidney because the System AI dangled a coupon and a loot box in front of him.



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PvP usually works better in one-shots and short campaigns, where players aren't deeply attached to their characters yet. In long-term games, people get invested. They build relationships and grow attached to their characters. Then Gary shanks Steve, and now Thanksgiving is awkward.

Can long-term PvP work? Absolutely. But it requires the right group, clear expectations, and players mature enough to separate in-game betrayal from real-life resentment. Carl is suspicious when Donut gets a PvP coupon for him and dumps it. And they're pretty tight at that point. Imagine how an unseasoned crawler party would feel. If your group isn't into that tension, establish a simple rule early: no murdering party members.

If you allow PvP, in-character agreements and politicking become vitally important. The moment you hand out a PvP coupon, you open a dangerous door, and the GM cannot play favorites after someone walks through it. Stick to the rules as written, and if the scene starts harshing someone's buzz, back out of it.

PvP doesn't have to target PCs, either. NPC parties can slaughter each other for loot and glory, or a beloved NPC companion can become the target of a coupon.

When you hand out a PvP coupon, let both the stalker and prey know. Most players won't enjoy getting a venomous blade through the eye while sleeping with zero chance to react.

PvP fights need to happen on even ground. However you justify it—an arena, System AI intervention, forced metagaming—both players need a real chance to survive. Let players use their full abilities, but don't allow instant ambushes just because somebody was clever.

Other party members may intervene, choose sides, or try to stop the fight entirely. That's their call. Your job is to rule impartially, especially because you allowed the conflict in the first place.

Most importantly, establish expectations before the game starts. Some groups love paranoia, betrayal, and internal bloodshed. Others would rather unite against a nightmare circus clown wearing human teeth as jewelry. Ask players individually whether they're comfortable with PvP and if they'd like their characters to be eligible for PvP coupons.

If everyone says yes? Great. Buy the ticket, take the ride. But if it all starts smelling like a pile of Babababoon dung, let people wriggle out. There's no shame in deciding not to murder another PC.

RUNNING COMBAT SCENES

Combat, like anything, can get repetitive if not handled well. That means the GM must make each combat encounter exciting and unique. It's on the GM's shoulders to differentiate one Mob from another, one battle from another. We break this down into two types of combat here: Mob Battles and Boss Battles.

MOB BATTLES

These are the meat and potatoes of your World Dungeon. Sure, puzzles, exploration, slick talk-show interviews, and shaking down NPCs for information all have their place, but combat gets ratings.

Hacking and slashing, Spell-slinging and missile-flinging, combat keeps the audience glued to the channel, and most players feel the same way. Plenty of crawlers enjoy puzzles, traps, roleplaying, and exploration, but fights are what they remember. Combat takes up more table time than anything else because it's exciting. Heads rolling, limbs flying, arterial spray painting the walls... who doesn't love that?

Most battles pit crawlers against Mobs. Mobs come in all varieties, and you should know what each one can do before throwing them into the grinder. Study their abilities, tactics, and Levels, then compare those against your crawlers' capabilities. Can the party handle this Mob type? How many? What happens if the answer is "barely?"

Take notes. Compare encounters. Run a mock battle if you're uncertain. The AI has simulated all of this a gazillion times, after all.

Now add another Mob type into the mix. Because, of course, the Tusklings brought friends to the party. Can the party handle two enemy types at once, or are they about to become a fine red paste

Once you've got the basics sorted, and by "sorted," we mean "good enough to survive contact with the players," not SAT-prep levels of over-planning, start thinking about how the battle unfolds. The terrain is important. So are the Attack types from both sides. These details shape your descriptions, and description is where combat lives or dies.

Look, a fight with a group of Orcs can either be memorable or routine. The same goes for any other

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Mob. It's what happens during the fray and how you describe wounds, near misses, and critical hits that stick in the mind. You cannot control the dice. They'll deliver an unexpected win or lopsided ass-kicking. But you do control how you relay the info.

Don't spare the details. Use words that evoke danger. Don't just say, "The sword barely missed you." Instead, say, "You feel the blade hiss past your face as a lock of hair flutters to the ground."

Likewise, don't reduce a critical hit to numbers on a sheet. "The impact rattles your arm as your sword punches through the Orc's skull and splits it down to the teeth."

If a crawler dodges a volley of arrows, make it feel dangerous. "You dive aside as arrows scream past your head and explode into the wall behind you!"

The point is, players only have so many maneuvers to use. Mobs are player-facing; they never roll. Therefore, it's all in the description. Make it bloody, close, and desperate. When they take down the last of the Mob's HP, describe the gore.

Mechanically, keep your Mobs organized. Don't lump everything together into one big pile of hit points. Separate enemies by type at minimum, and track health individually whenever possible. It helps you judge encounter flow—and trust us, your players *will* let you know if they're truly getting curb-stomped.

BOSS BATTLES

The big Boss Battle is the default climax of almost every TTRPG session, and the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** is no exception. The crawlers have fought through grim halls, explored ruined cities, and clawed their way toward fame and survival just to reach this moment. Maybe a few party members bought a farm along the way. Cue the sad music. But that doesn't matter now. It's showtime; make it count.

While the crawlers may encounter other climaxes in the session, every Boss Battle is itself at least a penultimate climax. Usually, it's the end-all, be-all of climaxes. The tension is at its height, the crawlers are poised for a great fight, and the AI makes an introduction straight out of a professional wrestling bout as the Boss enters the stage.

Start with the AI announcement, if it's apt, or by setting the scene through other descriptions. Surely, while venturing through the current floor, the crawlers heard all sorts of things about the Boss. That all

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foreshadowed what's about to happen. But now that you're here, focus on the Boss's lair first. That, too, can create tension for what is to come.

Is the lair a large dungeon room with freakish idols to alien gods? Is it a camera-laden UFC-style cage where you'll fight for your life and the likes of the crowd? Is it a cavern, half-filled with putrid muck and the bones of previous crawlers surfacing occasionally like morbid icebergs?

That's all up to the GM. The lair should hint at the Boss's abilities and past victims. A medusa's den might be lined with shattered statues and shadows that look disturbingly Human. A shark-whale's feeding ground could be choked with wrecked ships, broken spears, and floating body parts. The key is to build tension before initiative is ever rolled, then unleash the Boss.

Every Boss should make an entrance. Maybe it crashes through a wall or stalks in from the darkness. Maybe it casually tosses a dead crawler at the party's feet to establish dominance. However they appear, the moment should feel memorable. And the Boss itself? It needs to feel dangerous.

A Boss should be tough, clever, or ideally both. Even a mindless beast should fight with lethal instinct. Bosses shouldn't just chew through Health Bars. They should separate the party, exploit terrain, limit crawler's abilities, and force hard decisions. This is their lair. They know every inch of it better than the crawlers ever could.

Describe its attacks. Don't just pile on the damage or say, "You dodged it." Tell the players, "The massive jaws snap shut inches from your arm, hot saliva splashing across your face." Tell them, "Its teeth tear through your torso like a feral child biting the head off a gingerbread man."

Tell them pain: "explodes from your wounds, radiating lightning-hot along your nerves." Make them feel it. Make them taste the metallic scent of blood hanging in the air or hear the screams elicited when they, too, drive home a hit.

When the crawlers finally win, the players should feel like they survived something horrible, because they did.

> ***"You sure you wanna do that, bucko?"***
> **—The System AI?**

ADJUSTING DIFFICULTY ON THE FLY

It's said that no plan survives contact with the enemy. That's just as true in war as it is in the average roleplaying game.

You can prep for hours, balance every encounter, calculate every possibility, and the players frequently still blindside you. The dice often betray your expectations, and the terrifying Boss gets steamrolled in two rounds, while the "moderate challenge" nearly wipes the party.

This just means you'll sometimes need to adjust difficulty on the fly. Some will say you *have* to adjust it. First, decide whether you need to scale things up or down. Are the crawlers breezing through encounters, or are they one bad roll away from becoming hallway paste? How wounded are they? How many buffs, healing potions, and resources remain? Sometimes you can wait and adjust before the next battle; occasionally, you need to triage the disaster immediately.

Once you know if you're going up or down, start adjusting things in your mind. The players don't know the Mob's exact stats. They don't see the Boss's sheet behind the screen. If the fight is too brutal, shave off some HP or quietly skip an ability recharge. If the battle feels like a joke, add reinforcements, increase health, or introduce a new trick that fits the theme. Steal an ability from another Mob type if you need to. The dungeon is chaos. The AI cheats constantly; you've got room to maneuver.

Combat balance is a sliding scale. Your goal is to land somewhere between "challenging" and "Oh, fuck, we're all going to die!"

If you have time before the next encounter, adjust resources instead of enemies. Give the crawlers extra buffs or healing items if they're struggling. Reduce those resources if they're bulldozing everything in sight. Change Mob counts. Adjust terrain. Fiddle with the numbers until the pressure feels right. Eventually, you'll develop a feel for it.

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RUNNING SOCIAL SCENES

Social encounters aren't combat, but they often involve conflict. For some reason, few people in the World Dungeon are happy. The crawl grinds everybody down, and the crawlers and NPCs the party meets usually aren't shiny, cheerful people skipping through fields of emotional stability.

It's llama-eat-llama down here. Everyone wants something. While you might encounter friendly NPCs, even they have an angle. Okay, sure, you'll make some bonds, but nothing is free. "Give me that sweet, sweet gold," said every NPC ever.

The point is, even a social encounter involves a battle much of the time. If there's no conflict, the scene usually falls as flat as a bounce house full of caltrops. People and other associated aliens are prickly. They might be funny, but they also have attitude.

WHAT DO THEY WANT?

The only NPCs worth detailing are those who want something or have something to offer. Remember the rules of drama: Someone wants something, and something or someone stands in their way of getting it. The same applies to social encounters. Give every NPC a motive other than being useful to propel the narrative forward. While that might *be* their real purpose, if the players feel that way, they get bored.

Instead, give them their own goals, grudges, obsessions, or strong personality traits. Make it oppositional or at least inconvenient. Everyone in the World Dungeon has dreams, even NPCs created by said dungeon. Those dreams need not align with the party. In fact, it's more interesting if they don't.

CONFLICT

Unless an NPC exists purely to sell something, give directions, or dump information, it's a good idea to build conflict into the scene. Whatever the crawlers and NPCs speak about, there ought to be tension. Maybe an NPC doesn't want to give them the information they need. Maybe they're being tricky. It doesn't matter why they don't just state things up front, only that they don't... unless you want a really quick scene.

Social encounters should have friction. Maybe the NPC refuses to give up information. Maybe they're lying, manipulating, stalling, or angling for leverage. The reason matters less than the tension itself. Otherwise, the scene becomes a quick info dump, and everybody moves on.

Everyone wants something, usually for themselves. Give-and-take makes the dungeon go round. That doesn't mean every NPC demands payment, but even friendly characters should clash with the crawlers in some way.

MAKING NPCS LIFELIKE

You don't need a degree from Juilliard to run NPCs, but you do need to ham it up a little. Left alone, NPCs fade into the background like dusty furniture unless the GM drags them into the spotlight.

Whether they're bold, annoying, whiny, or another colorful adjective, NPCs need to stand out. The GM can have an eight-page backstory for an NPC (please, don't do this), and not a single player remembers any of it. Hell, you may not even get far enough into the encounter for any of it to matter. But a distinctive appearance? Odd mannerisms? The players remember those.

Appearance goes a long way. With a shit-ton of alien species out there, you've got a lot of leeway to make an NPC distinct just by their species. Do they have more than four limbs? Three sets of eyes? Are they a fish-person? What about a silicon being that looks like a snowflake? Weird is good, but not just for weirdness's sake. Pick something distinctive about their species. Compare species to animals if it helps.

What does this person wear? Are they into retro-future space suits? Fedoras and pinstripe suits? Think about an alien fish-man in a ten-gallon hat. That's hard to forget, even if you try really hard (and OMG, how we have tried).

Do they speak plain English or flowery pseudo-Shakespearean iambic pentameter? They don't have to come from Earth to sound like they root for "da Bears" or be a scholar to impress with big words. Borrow shamelessly from movies, TV, real people, and every terrible accent your friends can tolerate. Funny voices or accents aren't necessary either: you can do a lot with the tone, speed, catch phrases, and verbal or physical mannerisms.

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You also need a rough sense of who they are. Not a novella. Just enough to understand their point of view.

Point of view is everything to many NPCs. A former crawler raised in a Kepler-22 slum sees the dungeon differently than somebody from a crystal palace on Arcadia III. Do they support the World Dungeon franchise? Hate it? Exploit it? Have they seen the crawlers on the show before? Are they fans, opportunists, or people just trying to survive another miserable day? On the other hand, most NPCs in the dungeon are completely in the simulation and have no concept of the wider universe.

Attitude grows from circumstance. Someone trapped in the dungeon against their will is probably bitter. While a thriving individual might be aggressively cheerful in a way that makes everyone uncomfortable.

Finally, think about the NPC's role in the dungeon itself. Official NPCs (typically former crawlers who took an exit deal) already come with a built-in purpose. Game guides help crawlers climb the leaderboard. Guild masters represent their guilds. A Fighter Guild leader probably shouldn't act like a delicate ballerina unless that contradiction is the whole joke.

An NPC's role in the World Dungeon shapes who they are, or at least who they pretend to be.

RESOLVE SOCIAL ENCOUNTERS

Two ways: Act it out and modify the rolls at the end, or make the rolls as you go. Any crawler with actual social skills should get a bonus even if their player doesn't say anything particularly smooth. Don't penalize a crawler for their player not lighting up the stage with eloquent wordplay.

Deciding whether to use one roll at the end or a few rolls interspersed depends on your group. Some groups love to roleplay. They want to talk, to con, to make friends, and otherwise interact with NPCs without killing them. I know... weird, right?

Other groups want to get back to puzzles and killing. In the latter case, make one roll after some back-and-forth, and move on. In the former, call for rolls throughout. These dice rolls then steer the social encounter in new directions depending on the results. Follow the dice if the players don't move the encounter for you.

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TRAP AND ENVIRONMENTAL SCENES

No Mobs, no NPCs... what's a GM to do? Not every scene has a sentient opponent. Hell, not every scene has an obstacle. Sometimes, you just want to evoke a mood. But mood shouldn't drag down your game. Instead, it should sprinkle it with a certain feeling. Paint pictures in the players' heads.

Traps and puzzles lack sentient antagonists. While there's no Mob involved, that doesn't mean the scene lacks pressure or tension. Traps can kill, puzzles can stymie (and kill), and environmental scenes allow for exploration, helping the players imagine they're really exploring the dungeon (and sometimes also kill). So get out there and explore(kill), explore(kill), explore(kill)!

ENVIRONMENTAL DESCRIPTIONS

Look, every novel—including Matt Dinniman's—uses twenty-six letters and a handful of punctuation marks to create a hallucination in the reader's head. Running an RPG works the same way. Sure, you may have maps, tokens, or minis, but those don't truly tell players where they are.

They don't convey the smell of a room, the sting of cold air, the distant scrape of claws on stone, or the feeling of standing somewhere profoundly wrong. Saying, "There's a creepy cave ahead" doesn't accomplish much. You need to show why it's creepy.

That means using evocative detail instead of simply naming emotions.

Don't tell players their characters feel "scared," "uneasy," or "hot." Describe the sweat running down their backs. The tremor in the hand gripping the weapon. The hairs standing on the back of their necks or the nauseous flip in their stomachs. Give them the physical sensation and let the player decide what emotion comes with it.

The same applies to environments. "The tunnel is dark and smells bad" technically communicates information, but it's vague and forgettable. Is it pitch-black, swallowing the light whole? Or is it dim enough that every shape looks half-alive in the gloom? Does it smell like mildew, wet fur, burnt flesh, or coppery blood?

Specific details create memorable scenes. You don't need to write the Great American Novel. Just pick a few concrete elements and let the players' imaginations do the rest.

THE SIXTH SENSE AND BEYOND

Non-Human sensory input exists in the World Dungeon (see *The Crawler Interface*, p. 16). Magic can reveal things beyond mortal perception, and the Heads-Up Display may provide information crawlers couldn't otherwise know.

These elements work as in-world tools, too. Crawlers might detect magic, evil, hidden passages, or other supernatural effects, while their HUDs can identify Mobs, rooms, hallways, and dangers that would otherwise remain unknown.

And, if you need yet another sense, use the System AI. It knows all and loves to annoy the fuck out of crawlers. It gets sassy in its descriptions of Mobs and Bosses, items, and dungeon features that the crawlers focus on or identify. Remember, you're playing a game within another game. Going meta is not off the table.

PUZZLES

Both traps and puzzles often lack Mobs or NPCs, but that doesn't mean they lack stakes. Stakes can range from solving the puzzle and moving forward to triggering the trap and dying a horrific death. The System AI generally prefers a flashy and glorious demise, while the audience may root for or against the crawlers. The crawlers just want to survive.

You can run puzzles in two main ways. First, you can present an actual puzzle for the players to solve themselves: riddles, word games, visual puzzles, and similar challenges. Second, you can treat puzzles as Skill-based encounters solved through crawler abilities and dice rolls instead of player brainpower.

The first approach challenges the players directly. You can draw out a puzzle for players to solve or present them with a riddle. It doesn't matter what type, just that it challenges the players, not their characters. Tension comes from time pressure, so consider putting them on a real-world countdown,

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such as telling them they have three minutes to solve it, then starting the clock.

That said, this style is not for everyone. Some groups love solving puzzles. Others immediately look up walkthroughs for video games and would rather fight a horde of machine-gun-legged spiders than solve a riddle. Real-time pressure also creates actual stress at the table, which may or may not be fun for your players.

That's where Skill-based puzzles come in. This way, no one has to figure out the clever little riddle you devised. It might make sense to you since you wrote it, but it could be too opaque for players.

Instead, use a series of dice Checks based on relevant Skills. Characters without those Skills can use something like an assist action (even though they aren't in combat) to surpass a target number. Usually, one to three successful Checks are enough, depending on how tense or lengthy you want the challenge to feel.

Avoid making every player roll the same Check. That just increases the odds of failure for no real reason. One roll should determine each stage of the challenge.

Each success moves the group closer to solving the puzzle. If they succeed by 10+, reward them with extra time, a bonus clue, or a spare attempt if they fail later. If they fail badly, say by 10 or more, remove one of those safety nets instead.

The key to all puzzle design is tension. Without stakes or pressure, puzzles become speed bumps. Time limits, limited attempts, environmental dangers, or the threat of triggering a trap all help make the scene feel dangerous rather than academic.

TRAPS

Traps are different. There are fewer ways to replicate a trap for the players short of weird diagrams. The characters are there after all, and the players are not.

If the crawlers search for traps, decide how difficult the trap is to find and assign a target number. Then let the crawler with the most relevant Skill Check. Don't make everybody roll to detect the same trap. That either guarantees success or unfairly increases the odds of failure.

Disarming traps operates the same way. Decide how many successful Checks are required, then let the crawler with the closest applicable Skill handle the rolls. Other crawlers may Help (p. 64) the one making the Skill Check to disarm a trap.

Simple traps usually take one roll. Complex traps may require three or more. Be sure, the crawlers work through those Checks before a trap triggers any punishments. Don't arbitrarily crush, vaporize, or insta-kill crawlers before then. They'll resent that. Let their dice do your killing for you.

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MONTAGES AND GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

You know those movie montages where a couple runs through the rain, throws flour at each other, and kisses under the mistletoe? Montages in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** work the same way, except the couple gets eaten by monsters, burned alive, and the mistletoe is a sentient strangler vine.

A montage compresses time. Travel, repetitive battles, training, long stretches of misery; these are all things the story needs but doesn't need in painstaking detail.

Nobody wants every conversation from every dungeon hallway. Nobody needed to watch the entire trip to Mordor, either, but those movies sure gave it a shot.

As the GM, your job is to decide when to zoom in and when to pan out. A montage is the pan-out. You summarize events through a series of short, evocative moments, then move on before the table starts checking their phones.

Montages serve a few purposes: establishing mood, moving the plot forward, bridging time gaps, or speeding through grinding without turning the game into Spreadsheet Simulator 9000. A good rule? If you'd fast-forward through it on TV, montage it.

The game's grinding rules exist to avoid the tedium of battles that have already been fought repeatedly. Grinding is a little bit different montage-wise, so let's dive into that first.

Grinding especially benefits from montages. The grinding rules (p. 170) help skip fights the players have already done seventeen times while still showing the cost of survival. Use a Grinding Complication Table for the Floor or Neighborhood to add spice to the montage, not more rounds of combat.

Complications evolve plots, injure crawlers, drain resources, and remind the party that repetitive murder still has consequences. And that's the big difference: Be careful what you impose on the party where they lack that choice. Yes, you're still summing up what happened, but don't hurt the group *too* much. They'll hurt themselves enough without a GM assist.

When grinding, look at the Level of the Mobs fought. If they're low-Level, any complications ought to be an inconvenience, not a palpable penalty.

If they're higher up, go ahead and give the players a good whack or two. Seriously, lean hard on those bastards. Deplete some of their Health Bar. Give them a Minor or even Major Injury with an interesting description, such as, "You tweaked your sword arm when a Bad Llama latched onto it. Making a fist now feels like squeezing broken glass." That might burn a healing potion.

Most importantly, montages still need imagery. A montage works because it presents a handful of memorable moments that imply a much longer story. Players already understand this language from movies, TV, and every training sequence ever set to terrible music.

You don't show every moment. You show the important ones. Pick a few strong images, sounds, or sensations, and let the players fill in the gaps. Since you aren't actually directing a film, you'll need words to do the heavy lifting. Words draw a quick picture and let you move on. Below are a few descriptions to help inspire you:

- You slog through mold-choked tunnels and slippery sewers for hours before the cramped passage finally opens into a vast chamber of flagstone and shadow.
- The ruined city stretches endlessly around you, revealing flattened homes, collapsed towers, and bloodstains where people once stood. This scene replays in your travels like a terrible rerun you regret not turning off sooner but can't look away from.
- A steady drip echoes through the tunnel as something unseen leaks from the darkness above, and an acidic scent assails your senses.
- Dead Mobs pile behind you like a landfill of bad decisions while the party counts supplies, wounds, and the number of healing potions left between you.
- Your feet ache. Your back aches. Muscles you didn't know existed are screaming. You've walked farther than Gump ran and seen worse things than any Human should. Somehow, you're still moving.

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THE SHADOW OF CARL AND DONUT

The primary characters of the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** novels are the eponymous Carl and his ever-present companion: GC, BWR, NW Princess Donut the Queen Anne Chonk. Many players who are fans of these stories consider interacting with Carl and Donut one of the appeals of playing an RPG based on their adventures.

But is it actually as fun as it sounds? The GM may not be able to capture Carl or Donut in a way the players enjoy, and constantly centering the campaign on them can pull attention away from the PCs. After all, this is supposed to be the players' story, not a front-row seat to the NPCs winning the day.

In short, players should consider if they want to play in the shadow of Carl and Donut. This section goes over some complications from including these two.

WARNING:

*There are minor spoilers in this section about events throughout the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** series. And yes, sure, there are spoilers scattered throughout this entire book. But they're a little denser and more specific here.*

If you don't know who Carl and Donut are, or why anybody would willingly follow a talking cat into mortal danger, skip this section until you've caught up on the books.

DAMNIT, DONUT!

One of the biggest complications with using Carl or Donut in an active campaign, especially one closely following the books, is that the GM has to track where those two are and what they're doing at all times.

That's manageable on early floors. Later? Not so much. Carl builds massive networks of allies and repeatedly becomes instrumental in surviving entire floors. If the PCs perform extremely well and reach a point where, canonically, Carl or Prepotente is supposed to solve the problem, what happens then? Do you tell the players to go grind Mobs until Carl catches up? Throw an invincible nightmare at them until the timeline allows progression?

The issue doesn't stop with floor-ending events, either. Donut develops a huge network of contacts and becomes increasingly famous through leaderboard rankings and tunneled shows. At some point, players are naturally going to ask, "Why don't we just contact Donut?"

If a player is a detail-oriented fan of the original stories, they may know specific times when contacting Donut would be especially helpful. If that occurs after Donut is famous, it's difficult to claim a crawler wouldn't think of asking her for help. And as funny as it might be for Donut to refuse helping PCs for whatever stuck-up royal reason the GM thinks of, that may put a damper on your players' experience.

WELCOME TO THE SEVENTH FLOOR, WHERE NOTHING IS REAL AND THE PLOTS DON'T MATTER

The complications of using major canon characters don't stop with Carl and Donut. Without diving into major spoilers, other characters also drive crucial events that can bypass encounters, alter floors, or completely change how crawlers progress through the dungeon. That creates a problem for canon campaigns.

If the books already establish who solved a floor, triggered an event, or survived a catastrophe, the PCs can end up feeling like tourists in somebody else's story. There may be important places and moments where the players simply can't matter because canon says somebody else already did.

But it doesn't have to be that way just because the GM includes canon characters. One easy option is to state that the books present one version of events, and the roleplaying campaign the GM and players run represents a different version. Major characters like Carl and Donut may well be present, but the group accepts they may not be in precisely the same place, doing the same things they did, according to the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** narrative.

This gives the GM far more freedom. Floors can change themes. Entire events can unfold differently. Side quests may bypass major canon obstacles altogether. And honestly, who wants to explain the Iron Tangle to anyone?

This kind of "alternate reality setting" allows the GM to bring in, exclude, or change anything (and anyone) they think makes for a good campaign for the players. It also lets players enjoy exploring the unknown, just like the crawlers in the books, rather than as fans of the

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series. The players can enjoy elements and characters they recognize but also know that seeing a spellcasting bipedal goat doesn't mean there's also a crocodile-headed mercenary with a shotgun wandering around. Which, frankly, is healthier for everybody involved.

YOU KNOW HOW I FEEL ABOUT BEING EXCLUDED, CARL

Another option is including Donut in a campaign and leaving Carl out entirely. Mongo may be appalled, but Donut becomes enormously powerful and influential over the course of the series, and she's also a constant source of chaos in Carl's life. Removing Carl from the equation, whether he's missing, dead, or never entered the dungeon at all, lets players interact with Donut without the Carl-and-Donut duo dominating every major event.

If the group likes the idea, the PCs might even become Donut's primary companions. She's wildly popular, and many players would love traveling with her.

She also gives the GM a built-in voice inside party conversations. Conveniently, Donut's priorities, especially early on, tend to revolve more around status, fashion, and royal dignity than tactical leadership. Also, she lacks thumbs. Both factors make it easy for the GM to keep her involved without letting her hijack every important decision. And think of the drama that PvP coupon could cause!

Swap Donut without Carl for Carl without Donut for a different flavor as you like.

MONGO CAN STILL BE APPALLED

Deciding not to follow canon, or leaving Carl and Donut out entirely, doesn't mean stripping out everything connected to them.

Players may still want companions like Mongo, alliances with Brynhild's Daughters, or opportunities to help team Meadow Lark. In fact, placing the PCs in the narrative space normally occupied by Carl and Donut is one of the easiest ways to preserve the feel of the books while still allowing the GM to surprise the group.

You can also remix familiar faces instead of copying them directly. Rather than pick up Mongo, they might select a different companion. If someone like Donut is an element the GM and players want to explore, there are plenty of chonky arrogant animals beyond Persians. Some groups might even be so backward as to use an animal NPC that isn't a cat! (Though we assume no one would be depraved enough to suggest a talking spellcasting Cocker Spaniel.)

Ultimately, the decision to include Carl and Donut, or not, lies in the hands of the GM. But letting your GM know your preferences (and why) can help them better understand and deliver the experience you're hoping for.

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NEIGHBORHOODS AND QUESTS

Neighborhoods and Quests are the heart of the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, and a set of them can make up a floor full of stories to experience. As written, Neighborhoods and Quests are parbaked scenarios or adventures. They're not fully mapped-out scenarios but a jumping-off point with Mobs, Bosses, locations, and NPCs already tied together. Each Neighborhood or Quest is reasonably short: you should be able to read a Neighborhood or Quest in about 20–30 minutes, and with another 30 minutes to prepare some notes, you'll have an evening's worth of material for play.

Neighborhoods and Quests are organized similarly. The key difference is that Neighborhoods focus on the physical location, whereas Quests focus more on missions.

Here's how Neighborhoods and Quests are organized:

- **Summary and Overview:** Right away, you'll get a quick description of the Neighborhood, its themes, and what sorts of stories might emerge from the Neighborhood. Use this section to help you decide if a Neighborhood or Quest is right for your group.
- **Strong Starts:** These give you a couple of ways to hook the players' crawlers into an adventure in the Neighborhood.
- **Story Arcs:** These are likely stories that will emerge in the Neighborhood. Emphasized terms refer to NPCs, locations, or items described later in the Neighborhood.
- **Mobs:** These are the Mobs most likely to be encountered in the Neighborhood.
- **Environment:** This section describes what the Neighborhood is typically like and how it differs from the rest of the floor.
- **Traps:** Use these traps against the party (see p. 258 for more on traps).
- **Items & Quest Items:** These are key items the party might find in the Neighborhood or useful in the Quest.
- **Achievements and Rewards:** Sample achievements you can read verbatim or use as inspiration, and what the AI might grant for each.
- **Grinding for Experience:** These are random events that might happen in the Neighborhood. Typically, you'll want to use them if the party grinds for experience to help liven up those scenes, but you can also use them for inspiration or drop them in if the pace is lagging or you need to fill a little more time in a session.
- **Exploring the Neighborhood (Neighborhoods Only):** This lists four quarters of the Neighborhood. Expand a Neighborhood by adding your own quarter, or remove some to make the Neighborhood smaller or fit your session length.
- **Quest Stages (Quests Only):** Where Neighborhoods explore a location (and have quarters), Quests focus on a plot line (with stages). The Stages are key story beats in completing the Quest.
- **NPCs or Walk-On Characters:** Key NPCs that may exist in the Neighborhood.
- **B-B-B-Boss Battle!:** This describes the biggest fight the crawlers are likely to encounter in the Neighborhood.

The next few sections talk in detail about how to run Neighborhoods and Quests, and string them together into whole floors and beyond in a **Dungeon Crawler Carl** campaign. After that, this chapter provides a ton of Neighborhoods and Quests for you to use in your campaigns. Of course, you can also just take them as inspiration, grabbing Mobs, Bosses, and ideas from each to create your own adventures. Heck, you can toss it all out and make your campaign a total DIY extravaganza. But if you need the examples or ideas, they're here for you.

RUNNING NEIGHBORHOODS

Neighborhoods are the basic building blocks of World Dungeon and the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**. A Neighborhood is a section of the dungeon where everything is interconnected by place and theme. Like a real Neighborhood, it feels like the pieces belong together, even if they have different stuff in them.

Neighborhoods exist as pre-made settings to entertain your players for a planned gaming session or two. Use them as-is or mix them up.

WELCOME TO THE NEIGHBORHOOD

You only need to prepare the specific Neighborhood used for the upcoming session. This doesn't have to

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take more than an hour. Read over the Neighborhood and consider the following questions:

- **What's Going On?** Focus on the Neighborhood's vibe and its Mobs. Is there a weird mystery? Can you introduce an inbred family of country bumpkins? A gory body-horror bonanza? Look at the Neighborhood's introduction and its suggestions for setting the mood.
- **Who's the Boss?** Every Neighborhood has a Boss who sets the tone. Look over the Boss, and importantly, the Boss's central weaknesses. What does the Boss want? The crawlers likely run afoul of the Boss's wishes, creating the conflict leading to a Boss Battle.
- **How Do the Mobs Interact?** Focus not only on who the Neighborhood Mobs are but also on how they interact with the crawlers. Most Mobs are openly hostile, but their approach to murder varies. You want an idea how the Mobs interact so your crawlers can manipulate, cajole, and pit them against each other as the Neighborhood's architect(s) intended.
- **What Do the Tables Provide?** Look at all those frickin' tables. From quick grinding complications to traps and items, there's a table. Consider which you might use ahead of time or pick randomly as you play. Don't limit yourself to their "intended" use. When you discover an amazing idea, run with it.
- **What should I ignore or Change?** You don't need to use everything in the Neighborhood as-is. Cut things that you don't like. Replace them with something better if you like.

THE PLAYERS' VIEW

We've talked about how you prepare a Neighborhood, but let's think about how a player experiences a Neighborhood. This generally comes in three phases.

1. **Opening Discovery:** What first draws the crawlers to a Neighborhood? Make it feel alive, and lean on the Neighborhood description. Remember, setting expectations allows you to reverse them later. Twists keep viewers, and players, tuned in.
2. **Mastering the Area:** Once the crawlers explore and meet some folks (or kill them), they get to know what's what. They want to know the location of saferooms, the Boss's lair, and Mobs. Let them learn through trials and travails.
3. **Things Blow Up:** The climax of the session should derive from the crawlers' actions. This usually means finding and defeating the Neighborhood Boss, but it might also mean wrecking areas or otherwise leaving the Neighborhood thoroughly looted. Enjoy the victory (briefly)!

MESHING WITH THE CHARACTERS

Just as no plan survives contact with the enemy, no Neighborhood survives contact with crawlers. Tailor the Neighborhood to your players. What excites them, scares them, or makes them sweat? Do your players prefer combat, puzzles, negotiations, or something else? Remember, a Neighborhood can also hit 'em right in the feelings by meshing with their past. Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets, to be precise.

If anything in the Neighborhood connects to a crawler's background, go for it. Don't restrict yourself to the crawlers' pre-collapse background too: Everything from a previous floor, or even the current Floor, is "background" now. Making it personal makes it fun. It also makes being killed more rewarding because, hey, someone cared. Here are some examples:

- A Mob type resembles foes in a video game or characters from a TV show a crawler loved.
- Part of the Neighborhood looks just like home.
- Another crawler the party became fond of has died here.
- A Mob acts in ways that bring up a crawler's Regret.

Don't go overboard with this stuff. Once or twice per floor is usually plenty. You can dial that up if the players love it or down if they hate it. You're playing to the audience (the players), too.

BREAK POINTS

You plan a session for an evening. What happens if it goes over? A commercial break and a real-life pause. Leave it in an important place. Here are two options:

The Smaller Goal: Arrange things so the crawlers hit some personal goal. They made progress. They overcame a tough Mob. Whatever. End with that victory for the crawlers so they can start fresh next time.

The Cliffhanger: Set up a seemingly insurmountable obstacle or clear danger, then roll commercials. This makes players want to come back to see what happens next. Hey, at least you don't have to wait two years like on streaming.

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RETURNING TO A NEIGHBORHOOD

Once done with a Neighborhood, you probably won't need it again—the crawlers likely wrecked the place. But, sometimes, like serial killers, crawlers return to the scene of the crime.

Crawlers might return to a Neighborhood to gather information, obtain a Quest item for a larger goal, or opt for a "safe" Neighborhood when they run into too much trouble elsewhere. You can lure them back with a Quest (below) by putting elements of the Quest back in the previous Neighborhood.

If they return, how has the Neighborhood changed? Did the Mob structure shift? Did anyone replace the Boss? Is there anyone here who doesn't remember the crawlers as a blight upon all life?

RUNNING QUESTS

Quests are more complicated building blocks of the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game***. Unlike a Neighborhood with thematic consistency, Quests follow plots.

Quests unfold in multiple stages. Sometimes you can stretch one stage through an entire game session, and other times you'll squeeze an entire Quest into one evening of play. Each stage displays progress toward the climax of the story. Make it feel that way.

PLANNING THE QUEST

While a Quest takes up more game time, they aren't much harder to prepare. Your focus should be on how the Quest impacts your crawlers. Pick a Quest and think about these things:

- **What's Going On?** What is the general theme and mood? The introduction tells you a lot. Look over the suggested "Strong Starts," for hooks. They don't outline the whole Quest, but they do pull crawlers in.
- **What's the Goal?** Unlike a Neighborhood, a Quest is a connected series of events. The most important question is: where do these events lead? What's the goal? Look at the steps section of the Quest and map out a flexible outline of likely events. Never make the players stick to your outline, though.
- **Who are the Power Players?** Most Quests are character-driven. NPCs, Elites, and Bosses provide the narrative reason for the Quest. The crawlers then crash right into those goals. Keep an eye on NPC motives. Hell, some might even be friendly!
- **What Makes the Mobs Distinct?** Quest Mobs often take part in the plot or otherwise inform it. In this sense, they're less random. Make a note of Mobs that give clues, context, or items related to the Quest.
- **What Are Helpful Tables?** You don't need to memorize them like multiplication tables, but read the tables before the game. Decide which you like best.
- **What Should I Ignore or Change?** Just like Neighborhoods, you can skip the boring parts or change things to fit your campaign better.

PLAYER CONFUSION IS EXPECTED

A Quest goal isn't always clear at the outset, and even when a Quest appears to be straightforward, twists usually occur. If crawlers feel a little lost when they first embark on a Quest, don't be alarmed or over explain anything. Players enjoy the satisfaction of discovery, and solving an in-game mystery holds their attention while they grind, explore Neighborhoods, check the leaderboard, and fight other Bosses.

MORE POWERFUL FOES

Quests are where crawlers most likely encounter Elites. Elites hold more power than rank-and-file Mobs. They're often more powerful than the crawlers themselves. The crawlers need to be cautious when interacting with Elites, and Quests teach them that.

Keep in mind that most Elites have some reason to let the crawlers live. They manipulate, use, and otherwise need the crawlers for their schemes. Make them threatening more often than murderous.

Quest Mobs, unlike Quest Elites, shouldn't challenge the crawlers much more than Neighborhood Mobs and should ultimately fall to the crawler's attacks. If they aren't from here, they don't utilize the terrain as well, right?

WATCH THE CLOCK

Crawlers can leave a Neighborhood prior to collapse. They can't necessarily do so with a Quest. So how do you keep a Quest from "timing out" when the floor collapses, but the crawlers haven't completed it?

Fortunately, the showrunners don't want this to happen, so you're justified in making the Quest stages intrude on whatever's distracting the crawlers. Feel free to move locations of Quest stages around, forcing

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interaction, or accelerating Quest timetables to prompt urgency. Think like a showrunner. If it bleeds, it leads!

If need be, crawlers might fail. Let them. Not everyone wants to watch a winner, and some mysteries... well... they go unsolved. If the Quest just isn't interesting to the players, they can take the L and grind for experience or explore another Neighborhood.

BREAK POINTS

Quests are presented in stages, and each stage usually takes one session or less. These stages are very helpful for planning your session. Make the players feel like they're progressing in a Quest by completing stages. They won't know the stages as such, but mark the end with something memorable. A victory. A cliffhanger. A cool NPC.

RETURNING TO A QUEST

As with Neighborhoods, crawlers leave their mark on Quests with mayhem and destruction. But Quest NPCs can survive the Quest, and friendly Quest NPCs might become mentors or sources of information. The NPCs themselves should always view the crawlers through the lens of the Quest, and perhaps even keep mentioning it to reinforce that completing the Quest was truly significant. Warm fuzzies aren't entirely absent in the World Dungeon... yet.

But seriously, use and reuse the best NPCs. Even if they're just a fond memory.

RUNNING FLOORS

Take Neighborhoods and Quests, add them together, and what do you have? A floor! Each Neighborhood and Quest has its own feel, but running a floor means putting those oddball ingredients together to tell a story that spans six to twelve sessions.

Floors are big and contain lots of adventure, but remember that they are each, by necessity, temporary. The floor-collapse timer is always running. The clock always ticks toward doom.

PREPARING A FLOOR

Preparing to run a whole floor isn't about having every single session planned. It's about zooming out for the theme and intro, then getting the details when you prep for a session of running a single Neighborhood or Quest. To prepare a floor, skim the different parts to get an overview of the components and consider the following.

What's the Deal with the Stairwell? Surely, if he's down here, Jerry Seinfeld asks that profound question. Every crawler wants to know how to get out. Players aren't comfortable until they know how to get to the next floor and that it's safe for them to do so. In the books, finding stairwells and ensuring safe access to them drives a lot of action. That's the case with the game, too. Know your exits!

Where Are the Neighborhoods? Get a general sense of which Neighborhoods you like on the floor. Focusing on four to six Neighborhoods usually gives the floor plenty of life and adventure. Learn each one's theme and read their intros to lodge the necessities in your brain.

EXTRA SPICE

When planning a floor, think about what you want to include beyond the Neighborhoods and Quests. Give the crawlers time in saferooms to open loot boxes. Let them interact with friendly crawlers or NPCs and watch recaps.

Also, keep in mind interview shows (p. 285). What's the use of surviving if you can't be on galactic TV?

HOW NEIGHBORHOODS INTERACT

Once you have a general sense of the Neighborhoods, consider how they might interact across the empty spaces between them (see *Liminal Spaces*, p. 266). Mobs probably don't often venture outside their Neighborhoods, but they might know about the next Neighborhood over. More likely, they kill each other in a Neighborhood rivalry.

Environmental interaction between Neighborhoods is most common. If a Neighborhood filled with drifting clouds of poison gas is near a Neighborhood burning with trash fires, expect the many wonders of fiery combustion to ensue!

Neighborhoods need not always interact. One key advantage crawlers have is their ability to work together and plan across long distances. Bosses and Mobs almost never do that, so crawlers can outmaneuver them and pit Neighborhoods against each other. It's good to encourage this because it makes the players feel like they're outwitting the dungeon while taking advantage of hapless Mobs.

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LIMINAL SPACES

Earth was a big place. Even though each floor is smaller than the one above it, that's still a staggering number of Neighborhoods. What keeps these Neighborhoods apart?

Space does, bucko! Usually, this space consists of wide access corridors, but sometimes it's miles and miles of tunnels empty of everything except roaming Janitor Mobs. At any rate, Mobs rarely venture from home. This makes the spaces between Neighborhoods good places for crawlers to hunker down and plan future mayhem... or just to get as far away from a dangerous Neighborhood or a Boss.

Discourage spending too much downtime in these spaces, as it's neither interesting for the viewers nor much fun for the players. If there's no action, hand-wave it. But never let the players feel too safe, even in liminal spaces.

WATCH THE CLOCK

Tick, tock, tick. Tension comes from the passage of time and the imminent collapse of the floor. This is often the primary driver of crawler exploration and action on a floor, because when it hits zero, the crawlers need to get out or die. This clock is merciless and inevitable. Consider the two sides impacted by the clock.

First, the players race the clock. They have limited time to complete their goals on each floor, so give them a chance. Don't award unearned success, though. Second, the timer means you also must complete your session goals. That might mean moving NPCs, Mobs, and locations. Put them in the crawlers' path; don't force a path on your crawlers.

RUNNING MULTI-FLOOR STORIES

Stories might run across multiple floors. Examples from the book include the *Vengeance of the Daughter* Quest, the conflict of the Crown of the Sepsis Whore, and Katia's Quest for revenge. The most extensive of these multi-floor stories is the ongoing storyline involving volcanic worlds and Scolopendra, which appears on every third floor of the dungeon.

People fuel multi-floor stories. Their goals and motives drive multi-floor plots. These people are significant NPCs with the ability to appear across multiple floors, like other crawlers, off-world celebrities or aristocrats, or even self-aware Elites.

Stories across multiple floors have time to breathe. Not every session needs to involve the main plot. Think of them like the arc of your favorite TV show, even though it was canceled, and you hate the network.

INSPIRATIONS

The best long-form narratives begin with inspiration gained during play. Tailor things to your group. An event like one of the following creates an opening you can build on:

- A villainous NPC crawler escapes justice.
- In an interview or show, the crawlers learn about a galactic power play or make an enemy of a celebrity or aristocrat who can access the dungeon for revenge.
- The crawlers discover that one of their pre-dungeon friends or loved ones is now somewhere in the dungeon and in danger.
- The crawlers expose themselves to a powerful curse or compulsion despite being warned against doing so.
- An Elite Quest NPC confides an unusual amount of self-awareness to the players' crawlers, such as knowledge of being trapped in a Quest story and a desire to break free.
- A friendly NPC crawler is obviously singled out for bad attention by the System AI or on recap shows, and the players can lend aid.

The key element in all these events is player investment. If the players express interest in a character or situation that might become a long-form story over multiple floors, that's a cue for you to spin out that story over time. If not, let them pursue what they like.

PLOTTING YOUR OWN MULTI-FLOOR STORY

Putting together a successful multi-floor story involves some planning. Make the task easier by working through the following questions.

Who Do the Players Love or Hate? Intense emotion begets motive and drama! Use the players' feelings toward an NPC as the fuel for Quests, whether based on love or hate.

What are Goals and Obstacles? What do the crawlers want from the Quest? They need a tangible goal. Give them one.

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How Do You Make It Worse? If things are bad, make them worse. If the crawlers jump from the frying pan, they land in the fire. Yes, they need to progress, but they can fail forward. Up the stakes until you reach the climax, then give them a big finish.

Where Does It Happen? You can often wing it in this game. But when planting a multi-floor story, you should think about where your obstacles pop up. Where should the crawlers be when they learn what looked bad is even worse up close?

Whatever the goal and motive, keep things interesting by putting obstacles in the crawlers' way. Stories grip us because the heroes overcome adversity at every turn. A hated adversary is someone the crawler chases through many floors. So is a lover. Play to their emotions.

MULTI-FLOOR QUESTS

If setting up your own multi-floor story seems daunting, you can start more simply by extending an existing Quest over multiple floors. If necessary, Elites can move between floors if the story demands it. The crawlers' goals may follow the Elites. All stories are, in some way, pursuits.

PLAYER MEMORY

Players focus on the victories behind them and the obstacles right in front of them. They might not recall every detail, NPC, or plot clue you dropped.

Give characters reminders or significant clues about people or events from prior sessions. You can give these reminders in character. Have a Guide, Manager, or trusted ally remind them, or you can just give the players an out-of-character reminder like an episode recap: "Last time, on *Dungeon Crawler Carl*..."

The point is you help keep the players on track. Prodding them is okay. The dungeon can do it. NPCs can do it, and you can do it out of game.

A GRIMMER TONE

Many Mobs and Quests in the game have a whimsical or gonzo tone, but multi-floor stories tend to be more serious. These stories often deal with love, loss, or violence that transcends the fun dungeon carnage. These aren't just stories that are longer than others: they're the ones with emotional heft. Pull at emotions. Make the crawlers feel guilty, traumatized, and otherwise hit with an affective whammy.

RUNNING ADVERSARIES

MOB AND BOSS STAT BLOCKS

Each Neighborhood contains a number of Mobs and Bosses, and each of these has a full set of traits called a Stat Block. A Stat Block is a list of the mechanics, important numbers, and attacks of a Mob, Boss, or other NPC in a truncated format for easy referencing. Keep this a secret from your players, except when you want to Taunt them. All Stat Blocks follow the same format.

Bad Llama

Mob; Large (5), Mutated

2	2	2
33%	67%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	13+F	20+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Lava Spit: 13+F to hit, 1d8+3 Fire, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the target gains the Burning Debuff.

Notes: *Bad Reflux*—Attacks can target the lava pouch in the Llama's throat during rounds when it uses Lava Spit, but this adds a +2 to the Llama's Evade. The pouch ruptures if such an Attack deals damage, killing the Llama and setting its corpse aflame.

Top Lines: The name, type, and size of the creature.

Colorful Line: The Health Bar (HB) of the creature. When creatures take damage, you can let the players know what percentage of Health the creature has remaining. Keep track on scratch paper. Use numbers and math, or just make a quick set of HB boxes or whatever works for you.

Middle Lines: You should already be familiar with most of these numbers. Remember to add the current Floor Number to values with "+F." The Surprise value is the Difficulty of crawler Stealth and Ambush Skill Checks, which is really just an Int-Opposed Check spelled out for you. Subtract the creature's Damage Resistance (DR) from each damage value they will be suffering.

Attacks: The "to hit" value is the Difficulty of the crawlers' Evade Checks followed by the damage dice, damage type, and the range of the Attack. Some attacks have additional effects in italics directly under

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the Attack, often when crawlers fail spectacularly at Evading an Attack, but some apply in other situations as well. Fail effects are in addition to the Major Fail "additional damage equal to the Floor Number" or Critical Fail "double damage."

Notes: If there are any special notes about this creature, they are listed here. Additional flavor is often found in the lead-up to the Stat Block, especially where the AI announces the creature.

SCALING ENCOUNTERS

Though the dungeon may seem like it's a total meat grinder... well, it's just a meat grinder. Not a *total* one. Scaling battles for the PCs is a bit of an art, but it starts out with a table to make it feel like a science. Table 49 shows you a good starting spot for the number of Mobs for the party to kill, kill, kill... Spoiler: the base line is the number of members in the party.

TABLE 49: ADVERSARY POWER

	PARTY SIZE					
	2	3	4	5	6	7
Weak (50%)	1	2	2	3	3	4
Moderate (100%)	2	3	4	5	6	7
Strong (150%)	3	5	6	8	9	11
Overwhelming (200%)	4+	6+	8+	10+	12+	14+

Weak: These encounters are most useful on the outskirts of a Neighborhood or as a complication for parties that are worn down. Combat against a Weak group of enemies is often quick but can be complicated by the environment or traps. This is the kind of stuff you might hand-wave away or skip in a montage like grinding.

Moderate: Fights against a Moderate group of Mobs are typical. The crawlers shouldn't have much trouble against them, but they'll likely use some resources.

Strong: Combat against a Strong group of Mobs should leave the party sweating but probably not in too much danger. The more the Mobs outnumber the crawlers, the greater the danger the crawlers tend to be in.

Overwhelming: An Overwhelming group of Mobs may risk character death and force difficult choices. The party may be better off fleeing from such a large number of adversaries.

The strength of a group of Mobs rests largely in the number of Mobs, because more enemies get in more hits against the PCs. A Weak group of Goblins will be outnumbered by the PCs two-to-one, while an Overwhelming group of Goblins would outnumber the PCs two-to-one or more.

As you gain experience running the game, adjust these numbers up or down accordingly. Tactically-minded players or parties with really great loot can make Strong enemies feel like Moderate ones. Those playing the game for the story may make fun choices that complicate fights. The goal is an enjoyable game, not repeatedly killing Player Characters... unless everyone enjoys that sort of thing.

You can adjust the number of Mobs on the fly as well. Reinforcements show up. A rival group of Mobs appears. Other crawlers intercede in a fight. Rather than kill party members that are down, a Mob or two might pick up a fallen crawler's weapon and run off. The party can heal and find them to recover the lost item later.

RUNNING TRAPS

The System AI is always on the lookout for creative new ways to kill crawlers. Sometimes a sudden impersonal execution scratches that itch, and other times long, drawn-out suffering provides satisfaction. With traps, you can explore both extremes or anything in between!

Each Neighborhood below lists several traps that you may spring on your crawlers when you need to inject some random danger. You need not deploy them all. If there's no time for a Boss fight, a cliffhanger trap makes for a great end to a session.

Note: Traps cannot be placed in rooms with stairwells to lower floors.

The deeper you go into the World Dungeon, the more dangerous the traps become. Not all traps need to deal damage. Nasty Debuffs are often more interesting, last longer, and create tension. Traps that simply hold or freeze the crawlers are most potent when the clock shows 30 hours or less to Floor Collapse.

Generally, interactions with traps on the Tutorial Floors occur via Unopposed Detect Trap Checks. Noteworthy or particularly dangerous traps may be Opposed by the INT of their maker instead. On the Third Floor, Skills that allow crawlers to auto-detect, disarm, disassemble, and build traps become available.

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TYPES OF TRAPS

Examples of traps you'll find in the dungeon include:

Dungeon and Environmental Traps: Trapdoors-over-a-spike-pit, crumbling ceilings, and darts from holes in the wall are classic dungeon traps, which typically deal a number of d6s in damage equal to the Floor Number. But the World Dungeon is known to crank simple features up to 11. Brindle Grubs clean up dead bodies on the Second Floor, spawning 1 to 15 for the job, but if 2,500 suddenly appear, that's a problem, and it's better resolved as a trap than with 30 rounds of combat. Immobilization, snares, alarms, and Mob-spawning traps are also common. Such traps might cause the victims to gain a Debuff, drain hours from the Time to Floor Collapse, or separate the crawlers ahead of an Attack.

Crafted Traps: We all love a good jump scare, making explosive traps perennial audience favorites. Best of all, collateral damage can hit other members of the party. The damage of such explosives is typically Xd6, where X is the Floor Number. Not all crafted traps explode; some apply a Debuff instead.

Psychological and Narrative Traps: Sometimes just getting crawlers to do something against their better judgment is enough. When the AI or another intelligent adversary really wants to twist the dagger, they dig into a crawler's history and exploit their fears and regrets.

Teleport Traps: These consist of a trigger and an anchor, both of which must be placed by the same user to properly sync them. When a victim steps on the trigger plate, they're instantly teleported to the anchor spot. On the Tutorial Floors, these traps are rare—the kind crawlers hear about but may not find themselves.

NOTICING TRAPS

Spotting and avoiding traps doesn't make for good ratings. Viewers would rather see a trap get sprung and watch the crawlers fight for their lives to escape it. So it's okay to suddenly hang your crawlers upside down over a pool of lava, then let them find creative solutions to escape it. Escaping certain death is way more fun. However, the Detect Traps Skill can alert crawlers to traps, typically allowing them to avoid the triggers.

Totally Hidden: These traps were built into the dungeon by the architects and are very hard to spot. An Amazing Success or better with a Detect Trap Skill Check is required to spot one.

Something's Off: If there are subtle signs like faint lasers crisscrossing the room, or if raised stepping stones are visible, then a Detect Trap Skill Check needs just a Standard Success.

Obvious Traps: Some Mobs—and crawlers—aren't that bright. Still, sometimes a basic Alarm Trap can catch crawlers unprepared, or crawlers might tumble into hastily dug spike pits. Some smarter Mobs mix obvious traps with those where something's off.

GMs can grant bonuses on Checks to find obvious traps, allow a very generous variety of Skills to find them, or just declare that wary crawlers automatically notice them. The environment around a trap can make obvious traps less obvious, and smart foes may pile on basic obstacles (such as darkness or smoke) with traps to increase the danger.

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CREATE YOUR OWN MOBS AND BOSSES

Do you have an idea for a Mob but don't know where to start? Let your imagination run wild as you populate your own Neighborhood with the perfect custom Mobs and Bosses. These guys are mostly Stats and Attacks, so you don't have to worry about their Skills or Past Traumas. That's for their therapists! Just kidding; they died in the dungeon too!

When designing your own Mobs, consider which floor they appear on and the types of encounters that challenge and engage the party. Make copies of your crawlers' sheets and find ways to put their lesser-used Skills to use. That degree in 19th-century interpretive dance is about to pay off! If your party has a Resistance or Immunity to a damage type, they should see Mobs with those damage types at least once per floor. Otherwise, what's the point of having Resistance to Psychic damage?

You might create a Mob for the Fourth Floor, but your crawlers get caught up in other affairs and never fight it. Free will is a bummer. But it's no problem, as you can use that Mob on the Fifth Floor. The Mob simply has several of their Stat Block entries automatically increased by +F (*F* is for Floor, don't forget that). However, as low-Level Mobs on the Fifth Floor, they should probably appear in greater numbers than you originally planned.

Remember that Mobs have 1 Move Action and 1 other Action, which is typically an Attack. They can move twice if need be. Bosses have 1 Action per crawler, even if a crawler kicks the bucket mid-fight, and can use their actions for anything. Being dead is no excuse to go easy in the World Dungeon.

The best way to track the pertinent information of a Mob is by putting them into a Stat Block. If you want to develop their culture and customs beyond that, knock yourself out.

NAME

Everyone is somebody, and that means everyone needs a name, right? Choose something original! It doesn't have to telegraph what the monster is into, necessarily, but names like that can be fun. If a Mob likes to lick, call it the Tongue Lasher. Names that make players wonder are also great: The Regret Collector, the Circumcised Angel, or Teacher's Pet.

SIZE

Bigger is not always better. Even the smallest chipmunk might be a City Boss. Or a 30-foot-tall monstrosity might be a trash Mob on some floors. It's all relative, just like Einstein said. Keep in mind that size does matter for attacks when there is a large size difference between combatants (see *Additional Combat Modifiers*, pp. 84–85). List the name and the accompanying number value of that size for easy reference under the Mob's name.

TYPE

This is for descriptive purposes only. Whatever sounds good and gives a general idea of what the crawlers see. The most common are Beastly, Undead, Humanoid or Ooze, but Trapezoidal and Patchwork are certainly memorable, though. Just add a bit of flavor; you've watched bullshit cooking shows, right? Same thing!

HEALTH BAR SLOTS

The number of HB slots equals the Mob's Level, up to a maximum of 10. Inside each slot is the Mob's Con Mod. Bosses work a little bit differently (see Table 50). Once you outline the Health Bar slots, assign percentages to each slot, starting with 100% on the rightmost slot. Use a calculator to divide 100 by the number of HB slots, and round to the nearest whole number. That is the percentage for each slot, listed in order. It's okay to round up or down inconsistently to hit 100% at the end.

Example: A Level 6 Mob has 6 HB slots. 100 ÷ 6 = 16.66, so each slot is 16.66% of the Mob's total Health. Apply those percentages from left to right in 16% or 17% increments (adding each new increment to the total), whatever makes the best sense to end with 100% on the far right. You can't just round up each increment to 17%, as that would create an 85% to 102% jump at the end.

2	2	2
33%	67%	100%

The percentages don't need to be exact, but it's good information to give to your crawlers. They can see the Health Bars above the Mobs, after all.

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TABLE 50: BOSS SEVERITY

BOSS TIER	STATS PER LEVEL	HB SLOTS
Neighborhood	3	10 + F
Borough	4	15 + F
City	5	20 + F
Province	6	25 + F
Country	8	30 + F
Floor	10	40 + F

TABLE 51: MOB LEVEL, FLOOR, & DAMAGE DICE

MOB LEVELS	DICE OF DAMAGE	FLOORS
1-4	1d	1
5-9	2d	2
10-29	3d	3—4
30-59	5d	5—7
60-99	7d	8—10
100-159	9d	11—13
160-249	12d	14—16
250+	15d	17—18

LEVEL

The GM can set the Level of a Mob as they like, but the following guidelines help ensure crawlers can overcome them. Remember, the fans love to see their favorites in great danger and even die. Consider how dangerous you want to make the Mob. Are they cannon fodder or badass cannons? Floors tend to have a range of Levels for the Mobs, and Table 51 shows a typical range.

What about Bosses? Table 51 also lists typical Boss Levels, damage, and the Floors they're typically found on. Boss statistics are typically good if you make them like Mobs for the Floor, except use the next row down on Table 51. So if you're making a Third Floor Boss, they might be about as strong as a Mob on the Fifth Floor. You want a climactic fight at the end, not some drooling chud the crawlers waste in a second. Pick the low end of the range for Neighborhood Bosses, the middle of the range for Borough Bosses, and for City Bosses the high end of the range or the low end for the next floor down. Province or Country Bosses can be even stronger.

Example: On the Third Floor, Mobs are typically Level 10 to 29. Bosses therefore range between Levels 30 and 59, as that is one Floor higher, as seen on Table 51. That means Neighborhood Bosses range in the low 30s, Borough Bosses in the low 40s, and City Bosses in the 50s, and so on.

It's possible for a Level 93 Mob to show up at any time! Crawlers never know what sort of unfair, wicked doom lurks around the next corner.

Low-Level Mobs can appear on floors where they are a pushover. When they do, they should appear in large numbers. Where equal or higher Level than the crawlers, a group equaling the party members is typical (Bosses are unique, however). A Boss's Level is almost always higher than the crawler's average, but they don't show up in large groups. They're typically unique, so only one appears though it may have Mobs with it.

SURPRISE

Everyone likes a surprise, right? Nothing is better than being ambushed: just ask Billy Badass over there, bleeding out and crying for his momma. Surprise in the game is simply an INT-Opposed Skill Check (using Ambush, Stealth, or a related Skill) to surprise a Mob. Calculate surprise once you determine the stats. The formula is 10 + INT, then put +F after it. Remember, crawlers only surprise Mobs who are unaware of their presence. If the party stumbles into a group of Mobs, or the Mobs are lying in wait, crawlers can't attempt to surprise them. Mobs aren't stupid, crawlers yapping too much or dilly-dallying won't catch them off guard.

EVADE

The best way not to die is not to get hit. Evade equals the Difficulty of crawler attacks against your Mob. Fill it in once you determine the stats. The formula for Evade is: 10 + DEX, then put +F after it. During play, you'll always add the +F on the fly, depending on the current floor.

Example: A Mob with an INT Mod of +2 and a DEX Mod of +4 results in the following entries:

Surprise: 12+F

Evade: 14+F

MOVE

Sun Tzu said movement was the key to victory. Or maybe it was Belisaurius? Whatever. The point is, 20+S is typical for bipedal, humanoid Mobs. Higher or lower works fine as well. If you use battle maps, consider the terrain where the encounters are likely to take place. In wide open areas, ranged attacks can

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do a lot of damage before slow Mobs can close the distance. In crowded areas with bad sight lines, melee attacks are often more deadly since you can't shoot the little bastards before they close in.

DAMAGE RESISTANCE

Mobs can take punishment. Borant takes pride in the quality of its cannon fodder, and we have filled the dungeon with a wide variety of appealing, tough, merchandise-adaptable Mobs. A Mob's base DR is equal to the Floor Number. Mobs with actual armor (leather or chainmail) or natural armor (thick hide, dino plates) might get an extra 1 or 2 more points of DR. Spellcaster types often have a DR 1 or 2 less than the norm. Suck it, wizard! If a Mob is introduced by the AI as "from another floor," their DR base derives from their home floor and not the current one. So, if a Rage Elemental from the Thirteenth Floor visits the Second Floor to deal with some shit, it still has 13 DR. Good luck with that.

If you're just nudging creatures from one Floor to another on purpose, go ahead and use the current Floor number to represent their toughness where they're meant to be.

STATS

We finally get to the meat and potatoes. The bones and sinew. The gristle and the fat... is anyone else hungry yet? Anyway, hopefully you have a good idea of what your Mob is all about by now. If they use natural attacks or weapons, they would do well with a high Strength. Spellcasters need a high Intelligence. You know the drill. This is how you calculate their stats:

- Mobs have a base of 1 in each stat, and 3 stat points to spend per Level. So a Level 6 Mob has 18 stat points to distribute. You, the GM, decide where to put those points. Feel the power.
- Bosses have a base of 5 in each stat. See Table 50: Boss Severity for their additional stat points.

Once you calculate the stats, write in the value, then list the Stat Mod in parentheses next to it.

ATTACKS

Remember when I said Sun Tzu (or whoever) said combat was all about movement? Disregard that. It's all about attacks, vicious, biting, clawing, rapid-fire machine-gun–ripping attacks, and the like. Some Mobs have one Attack. Some have more. Not all Mobs are created equally in the World Dungeon.

Low-Level trash Mobs often have just one main Attack. Higher-Level Mobs have a variety of attacks, and Bosses tend to get even more. A variety of attacks looks good and keeps the fights fresh. The dice the attacks use for damage is where you determine the lethality of the Mob. A d6 is the standard, but you may deviate from that for any reason. Like simple cruelty. Cruelty is always a good reason. Another good reason is experience: Are your crawlers stomping every Mob they meet? Just like patching the rules (p. 276), nudge those numbers up a bit till things feel like a challenge but not a slog.

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Attacks that automatically apply a Debuff don't need to deal a lot of damage. The Debuff is the point, so the Attack itself might only deal d4s of damage. If you've made a Mob and the crawlers are taking no damage from similar ones, upgrading the dice one step up is an easy adjustment.

The Mob's main Attack gets the full damage dice as seen on Table 51: Mob Level, Floor, & Damage Dice. If other attacks don't add more than a new damage type, those attacks often deal full damage dice as well. Meaning, if an 11th-Level beast Mob has a Bite (Piercing) and a Trample (Bludgeoning) Attack, they might both deal the full 3d damage.

Attacks with an Area benefit tend to lose 1d from the full damage die count. If the damage is weak, the Blast, Burst, Cone, or Line usually has decent range and radius. If the damage is decent, the area of the effect should be more limited in its scope. Adding Splash damage is a great way to pepper the entire party (half damage) without wrecking them all with a wide Blast effect.

Attacks with extra effects triggered when the crawler loses HB slots or fails badly on an Evade Check also tend to lose 1d from the full damage die count. Note that crawlers learn (no, really, they can) that it's rarely worth it to Evade low-damage attacks... unless 3+ are coming at them. This advice comes with applicable waivers you signed by reading this sentence. Borant cares!

So if every Debuff or add-on effect is predicated on a Major Evade Fail or worse, such effects won't happen much. Better to have low-damage effects apply Debuffs on any hit or on the loss of 1 or more HB slots. If the damage is high, then crawlers probably need to Evade it.

NOTES

Some Mobs have additional notes under each of their attacks. These range from additional abilities, strategy, order of attacks, passive effects, interactive effects, triggered effects, and anything relevant to an encounter that doesn't belong in the Stat Block.

Bosses all tend to have notes, as they are big personalities. The Notes area is also a good place to write in some liabilities that the crawlers might discover when they Look for Clues. Surely, they'll look for clues, right? Hey, I know a kiosk where they can buy one...

PLAYERS AND PROBLEMS

As nice as it would be if every gaming session went smoothly with no mistakes, complaints, or unstated expectations, sometimes issues do come up. Players naturally look to the GM to handle those situations, and there are plenty of things you can do ahead of time to avoid or soften inevitable speed bumps before they explode into full dungeon-wide catastrophes.

SOMETHING FOR EVERYONE: PLAY STYLES

One of the best things about tabletop RPGs is that they support a variety of ways to have fun. One of the worst things about tabletop RPGs is that they support a variety of ways to have fun.

Players come to the table with different expectations, and those expectations aren't always obvious to the GM or even to the players themselves. Some people want tactical combat. Others want deep roleplay, elaborate plans, loot optimization, or just an excuse to hang out and roll dice while yelling at go-kart–racing skellies. That's why understanding each player's style matters.

Asking players what they enjoy is a great start (and absolutely worth doing during Session Zero), but people aren't always good at describing their own play style. As a GM, identifying what excites each player helps you keep everyone engaged and prevents one person's fun from becoming another's personal hell.

Most players are a mix of styles, and this list isn't exhaustive. People also change over time, so revisit these ideas occasionally instead of treating them like a permanent psychological diagnosis from the System AI.

Casual: Casual players mostly want a fun group experience. As long as the game isn't drowning in rules arguments, indecision, or endless exposition, they're happy. They may drift if they're left out too long, so keep them involved, even peripherally. Some casuals also enjoy low-stakes organizational tasks like note-taking or inventory tracking.

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Competitive Player: Competitive players may seem to mostly enjoy making life difficult for other PCs and sometimes other players as well. Left unchecked, this can wreck a campaign. The reality is they may just be a little bored and need more opportunities to win decisively. They may calm down if given satisfying enemies to crush instead of teammates to torment.

Leader: A leader wants to be in charge of the group and keep the game moving forward or is simply good at corralling the team naturally. If no one else in the group is interested in that role, a leader can be an important part of keeping the group engaged with the game. If the group balks at a leader's guidance or multiple leaders clash, giving one a small NPC team to direct can help spread the spotlight around.

Quartermaster: Quartermaster, or organizers, track everything. Notes, schedules, loot, maps, session recaps, snack logistics—you name it, they've got it handled. Leaning into this desire can be helpful if the organizers are good at and willing to keep track of in-game notes (ideally including recaps of previous sessions) and real-world issues such as schedules and seating arrangements. These players are incredibly useful; just be mindful they don't accidentally become the table's hostile HR department.

Explorer: Explorers care most about advancing the story. If they start disengaging, it usually means they feel lost or directionless. Dropping clues, reveals, or hints about larger mysteries pulls them right back in. Take note of when they feel frustrated, because that's when they (and possibly other players) feel lost or adrift in the story.

Power Gamer: A power gamer wants to make the most effective possible character, maximizing their benefits and minimizing their weaknesses. They love building highly effective characters and finding devastating combinations of abilities, items, and tactics. Give them difficult challenges to test themselves against. If they discover a combo powerful enough to break reality, the System AI can always "fix" the problem by granting them an achievement and replacing the combo with a new ability later.

System Master: At their best, system masters are brilliant gamers with encyclopedic minds who help everybody remember how things work. At their worst, they become courtroom demons arguing that the phrase "line of sight" technically includes soup reflections. Helpful system masters are priceless, as other players and even the GM can ask them to look up specific rules as needed. Unhelpful ones may need a little reminding that the GM makes the final call.

Strategist: Strategists love plans. The dungeon is full of seemingly impossible situations, and strategists thrive when they get to out think them instead of simply charging in weapon-first. Let them look for clues and devise ways to use those clues to overcome a major threat. This is not only satisfying for the strategist but also a great way to keep the PCs from rushing into situations without proper planning.

Thespian: Thespians love roleplaying their characters' personalities, fears, hopes, dreams, and terrible emotional damage. They're great for interviews, dramatic scenes, and any moment where the dungeon demands somebody entertaining on camera.

Conqueror: Conquerors want to win. Since RPGs rarely have literal winners, they enjoy defeating rivals, overcoming difficult enemies, and proving themselves through clear success. Give them strong opponents and measurable achievements, but be sure to steer their competitive energy toward NPCs and external challenges instead of internal party competition.

BALANCING SPOTLIGHT TIME

It's easy to think the rewards in Dungeon Crawler Carl—Levels, Stat points, loot, Spells, fame, and all the other shiny dopamine pellets—are what players want most. And sure, some players absolutely love watching their characters grow stronger (see *Something for Everyone*, above). But even the biggest loot gremlins eventually want their time in the light.

Most players want moments where the game focuses on them specifically. This is called spotlight time. It's when the story, the GM, and the rest of the table briefly center on one character being awesome, dramatic, clever, horrifying, or catastrophically stupid. TTRPGs are group activities, but everybody likes being the star of the show now and then.

Different encounters naturally create spotlight opportunities for different players. Puzzles, social scenes, combat planning, exploration, and weird dungeon nonsense all create their own chances to shine. Ideally, the GM should try to give every player spotlight time each session and spread those moments around reasonably evenly.

SPOTLIGHT TIME IN COMBAT

Small spotlight moments happen naturally during combat. When a PC takes an action, the table's

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attention shifts to them for a moment. The same goes for a Mob attacking a crawler, especially if it's a Boss trying to turn them into chunky salsa. That said, combat spotlight isn't always evenly shared.

Characters who deal massive damage tend to dominate fights. Tanks survive longer and spend less time panicking or bleeding out. Meanwhile, weaker combatants can start feeling like background extras in somebody else's kill montage.

One way to spread spotlight time around is by adding non-combat goals during battles. Maybe someone needs to disarm a trap mid-fight, escort a fragile explosive egg across the battlefield, or keep Mongo distracted enough not to eat an important NPC. These side objectives naturally shift attention toward characters who might not otherwise shine in combat.

Importantly, those tasks should take real-world time, not just a single replacement die roll. Trading one Attack for one explosives Check doesn't create much spotlight. But climbing ropes, leaping chasms, dodging hazards, and desperately trying to stop a bomb from exploding while everyone screams definitely does.

Another way to spread attention is by forcing the party to split focus. If enemies scatter, Attack from multiple directions, or threaten several objectives at once, everybody has something important to do. Sure, the party's murder-machine can sprint off to fight the Elite Goblin warlord, but it still matters that the less combat-focused crawler catches the lone scout trying to warn the chieftain.

Not every fight needs to be solved by whoever swings the biggest axe hardest. Sometimes, the crawler stopping one terrified Goblin from escaping is the reason the whole party survives.

SPOTLIGHT TIME IN SOCIAL SITUATIONS

Groups sometimes have fewer characters good at negotiation, making friends, and diplomacy than they do characters good at combat. As long as the socially adept characters aren't also the combat experts, adding more social situations to a game becomes a great way to balance spotlight time.

If you have a group blessed with multiple high-Charisma diplomats, social situations can be divided into distinct issues that need to be dealt with at once, much like fights. For example, if two factions hate each other badly enough, the crawlers may need separate PCs negotiating with each side simultaneously to stop the whole arrangement from collapsing into violence.

SPOTLIGHT TIME WITH PUZZLES AND TRAPS

Puzzles, traps, explosives, death machines, land mines, and combat environments that are just as dangerous as the Mobs themselves naturally create spotlight time. The second somebody spots a tripwire or hears gears grinding ominously in the walls, attention shifts to whoever's about to deal with the problem.

Characters skilled with traps and mechanics naturally shine here, but even without a designated expert, somebody has to handle the disaster. As the GM, you can steer those moments toward players who haven't had much focus recently.

Sometimes the situation itself creates the spotlight. Maybe the crawler who hasn't done much all session is the only one who didn't step on a land mine, or they're suddenly the only person close enough to stop the killdozer before it turns the party into a chunky speed bump.

BRINGING IT ALL TOGETHER

Balancing spotlight time can be tricky, and it should never feel punitive. If someone built an extremely effective combat character, they probably don't want every fight suddenly engineered to make them useless while rewarding everyone else instead.

Usually, it's better to add occasional moments tailored to less combat-focused characters than to constantly nerf the crawler who happens to be good at murder.

If all else fails? Attach an NPC to a quieter PC. The NPC doesn't need to be important. They just need to be needy, chatty, weirdly attached, or incapable of surviving five minutes unsupervised. Suddenly, that player has someone constantly interacting with them, whether they want it or not. Just make sure the attention is actually fun for the player. That's not always the same thing as fun for the character.

Finally, the easiest solution is often just talking to the group. Tell the players you're trying to spread attention around fairly and encourage them to help each other share the spotlight.

And remember: some players genuinely prefer staying in the background. Not everybody wants to become the center of the exploding circus every session, and that's okay.

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WHEN YOU GET THE RULES WRONG

As the GM, it's easy to feel like getting a rules call wrong is some kind of unforgivable sin. Sure, you should try to run the rules correctly, but emphasis on "try." Every GM screws up rules sometimes. Yes, even that genius GM who read the rules cover to cover twice.

The important thing is having a plan for handling it when it happens. First and foremost, it's a game. Nobody's actual life is on the line, no matter how passionately Greg argues about line-of-sight and cover mechanics.

WHEN YOU DON'T KNOW THE RULE

Sometimes a situation comes up, and nobody remembers how the rules handle it. Or worse, everybody *thinks* they remember, and now three people are confidently wrong in different directions.

If looking up the rule won't bog down the game, go ahead and check. Better yet, have somebody else at the table do it while you keep things moving. The less important the situation, the less time you should spend hunting for the perfect answer.

On the other hand, if the ruling might decide whether a crawler lives or dies, it's probably worth pausing for a minute to get it right. If the table starts getting impatient, have them think of the delay as dramatic tension. Nothing builds suspense quite like watching the GM frantically flip through the rulebook while everyone wonders if Linda's about to get turned inside out.

WHEN THERE'S DISAGREEMENT ABOUT THE RULES

Even when everyone agrees on what a rule *says*, they may strongly disagree on what it *means*. You can absolutely expect this to happen most often when one interpretation kills the Boss and the other gets the party turned into crawler jam. Players are naturally going to argue for rulings that help them survive. That's normal. But at the end of the day, the GM makes the call.

It also helps to distinguish between a GM ruling and the dungeon itself screwing the crawlers over. In the books, glitches happen, and the AI changes rules on a whim. Lawyers get involved. Those aren't rules debates. That's just life in the dungeon.

If the disagreement really is about interpreting the rules, hear the players out briefly, make a ruling, and move on. Tell everyone you'll revisit it after the session if needed. Nobody wants to spend forty minutes watching three adults passionately debate whether Sulfuric Slug trails count as "environmental splash damage."

Keeping the game moving matters more than achieving instant perfection with the rules. And if you later realize you made the wrong call? Just admit it and fix things where reasonable. If you need an in-world explanation, the System AI can always announce that a lawsuit, patch update, or catastrophic legal settlement has retroactively altered reality in favor of the crawlers.

PATCHING THE RULES

You might find a rule that doesn't work at your table. Maybe you handed out some overpowered gear, or your tactically minded players are making easy work of foes that should be more challenging. As the GM, you can always patch the rules. Don't worry; it happens in *Dungeon Crawler Carl*. Before you patch the rules, try them first. Then really think about what's

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not working. Is combat too easy because you didn't throw enough foes at them, or did the players find a way to exploit a combo of options? Give it a little time and see if your hunch holds up.

Once you've identified a problem, look for a rules tweak. Game designers often prefer small changes over large ones. If an Attack Spell is too weak, you could reduce its cost or increase its damage, but doing both might be too much. If a weapon dominates every fight, try giving a few enemies Resistance to it rather than nerfing the weapon outright. You can always patch things again after another session or two if the change hasn't fixed the problem.

When you're ready to patch the rules, consider waiting until the end of the day or floor, since those are natural break points. Either a Borant employee (such as your beloved Dungeon Executive Producer, Cascadia) or the AI can announce it with a grand message or tuck it into a bureaucratic chat. You could also wait for the players to get tired of things being too easy. It can be fun for the players to get in a few solid wins before you change the rules on them. They may even race to use an exploit a few more times before it gets patched.

Finally, keep a record of what you changed. If you increase dagger damage, jot it down in your private notes or a doc you can share with the players, so everyone remembers.

CHARACTER DEATH

The World Dungeon is a dangerous place. Almost everything the PCs and their allies encounter is trying to kill them. There's a good chance that, eventually, that will happen. So... now what? Well, that depends.

WHEN TO GLEEFULLY MUR... UHH, LET PCS DIE

As the GM, you have the power to tilt the scales in favor of not killing a PC. You decide who Mobs Attack. You decide how powerful attacks and traps are. You roll the damage that is applied to a character's Health Bar. Every one of those is an opportunity to quietly keep a crawler alive, but you need to be cautious.

Once a PC is obviously near death, your best option is often to just call it out and make sure all the players are aware of it. There's a good chance their team will do what they can to help them. If the fading PC is unconscious and there are other legitimate targets standing, it's also reasonable for NPCs to target characters that are still a threat to them.

There are simply some circumstances where a PC simply dies, and that's okay. If the players stop believing that crawlers can die, the dungeon becomes a guided tour rather than a survival game. The way the death is handled is something you can consult the player about: do they want an understated end for their character or a gory spectacle of a death that lands them a TV feature?

WHEN TO LET MAJOR NPCS DIE

GMs are often tempted to keep major NPCs alive longer than the dice would normally allow. Maybe the Boss died too quickly, and the GM feels cheated after all the effort spent building the encounter, or they worry their players might feel disappointed the fight wasn't as epic as it could be.

If the crawlers obliterate a Boss in three rounds through clever tactics, lucky rolls, or overwhelming violence, let them have the win. Then have the System AI complain about how anticlimactic the fight was and promise to send two Bosses next time. For extra fun, immediately follow through on that threat.

GMs are also often reluctant to kill allied NPCs: pets, mounts, mercenaries, summoned creatures, or friendly crawlers the party has adopted like emotionally damaged strays. Most of the time, those NPCs should live or die by the dice, too. The dungeon is dangerous, and losing companions along the way is part of the experience.

That said, if the group becomes deeply attached to an NPC, especially a beloved pet or mount, it's perfectly reasonable to quietly give them a little extra survivability behind the scenes.

BRINGING IN NEW CHARACTERS

Just because a PC died doesn't mean the player who ran them can't play anymore! There are lots of crawlers in the dungeon, and the PCs can find themselves working with a new one at the drop of a hat.

New characters should be brought in at a level that allows them to be effective in the encounters the rest of the group is facing. That doesn't need to be the same level as the surviving players, but close enough to let the new crawler player have fun.

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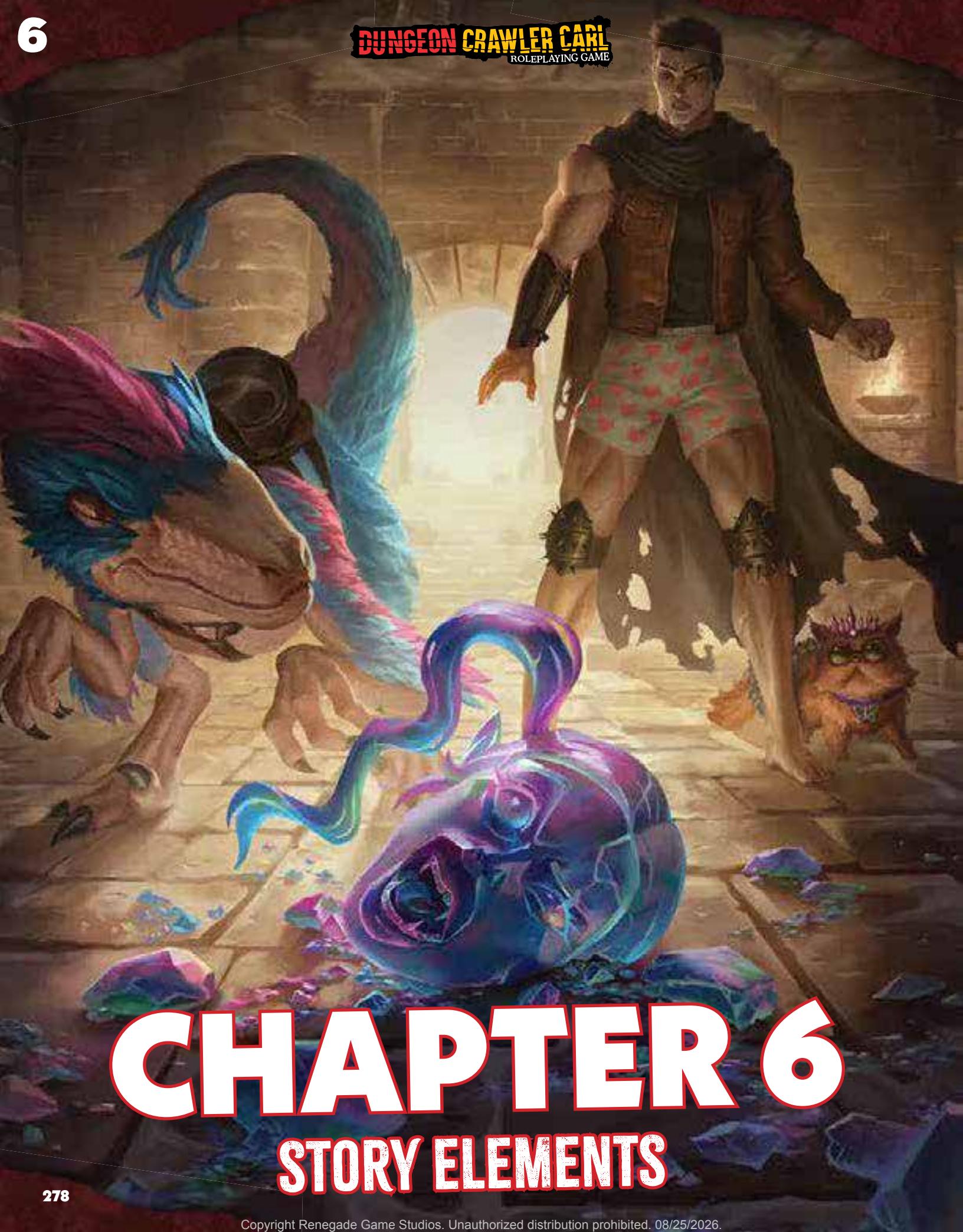

CHAPTER 6

STORY ELEMENTS

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THIS CHAPTER PROVIDES INFORMATION ON ELEMENTS OF THE WORLD DUNGEON THAT AUGMENT STORIES FOR GAME MASTERS. POPULARITY OF ALL TYPES (VIEWS, FOLLOWERS, FAVORITES, PLUS PATRONS AND SPONSORS), NPCS FROM OUTSIDE THE DUNGEON, INTERVIEW SHOWS, AND ARTIFACTS TIED TO LARGER NARRATIVES ALL APPEAR BELOW. INITIALLY, THESE ADD SPICE (AND POSSIBLY SOME COMPLICATIONS) TO THE EARLY FLOORS. AS CRAWLERS REACH THE FIFTH FLOOR AND BEYOND, THEY'LL BEGIN TO PIECE THINGS TOGETHER AND REALIZE WHAT MAY COME AHEAD. SEE RUNNING MULTI-FLOOR STORIES (P. 266) FOR SOME ADVICE ON HOW TO HANDLE THESE, BUT THEY'RE LONG-TERM PLOT SEEDS, AND YOU CAN EASILY LET THEM STEW ON THE FIRST FIVE FLOORS.

When using these story elements, consider dividing them between the players and their crawlers. Let the player who loves participating in shows keep going on the same one to develop a relationship with the host or interact with a lawyer. Give the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* (or an equivalent) to a quiet player who loves to plot or scheme or have secret information. Give someone else the Enchanted Crown of the Sepsis Whore or the like. Pick an Artifact of Divine Suffering for the cruelest (or kindest) crawler. Make up your own based on your own head-canon or theories.

ENTERTAINMENT SHOWS

Companies running the Crawl are allowed to exploit a planet in every way imaginable. Entertainment is one key component of that exploitation, and the universe loves it. This season, a nearly endless number of production companies run their own shows adjacent to *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*, each taking a small piece of the pie while tunneling entertainment catering to their specific audiences across the galaxy.

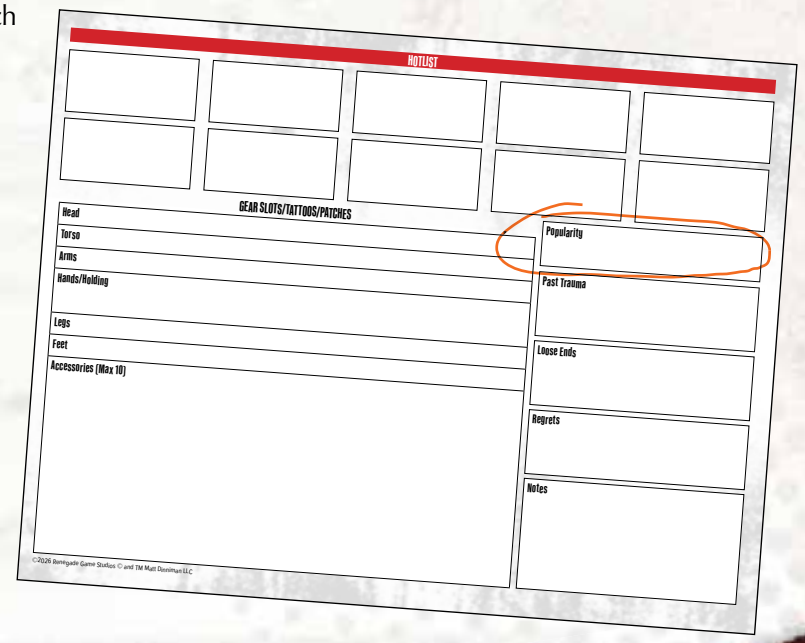
In the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, players and the Game Master get to interact with these shows as well. At first, they're fun, roleplay-heavy palette cleansers and summaries that help keep folks engaged with the world and their characters. They can also be dangerous endeavors, as cruel hosts rip crawlers out of the proverbial frying pan and deliver them back into the fire. Over time, the fame and connections a PC makes can be more valuable than other, more tangible rewards they might earn.

POPULARITY

Popularity is everything, darling.

High school, Hollywood, and the World Dungeon share this in common: get the fans, get the views, and you have my attention. And when you get on my radar, exciting things happen. Exciting for me, mostly, but also for you and your friends.

Reach the top ten, and you can expect Sponsors to shower your party with enough loot to make your little eyes bug out of your heads. The popularity contest doesn't really kick off until the Third Floor, but don't be fooled: both the AI and every Syndicate power broker are watching your party's every move during the Tutorial Levels. The AI gives crawlers a baseline Popularity ranking as they enter the Third Floor, based on their viewers, followers, and favorites. Each crawler tracks their own Popularity on their sheet.



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FAN BOXES

Popularity doesn't only earn you a seat at the cool kids' table. It brings in that sweet, sweet loot from your adoring fans, Sponsors, and the AI. The dungeon system allots loot boxes to high Popularity people, often the first crawler to reach a milestone of Popularity, like 25, 50, 100, etc. Sometimes, for a very high jump in Popularity in one day (like 10+), crawlers get one as well. Typically, high-performing crawlers like Carl, Donut, or the PCs get one Fan Box per Floor.

Once awarded, the box contents are determined by audience vote during a 30-hour voting period. Fan loot boxes use the standard color categories, but keep in mind that Platinum, Legendary, and Celestial Fan Boxes are exceptionally rare.

Crawlers should be on the lookout for new ways to gain Popularity. The fastest method is simple: get tunneled for doing something unusually violent, funny, pathetic, or interesting.

Now dance, monkey. Dance!

GAINING AND LOSING POPULARITY

Viewers are fickle. If you aren't making yourself seen, you're making yourself obsolete. Remember, there is no such thing as bad press. To that end, these are general guidelines for things (other than interviews) that increase or decrease your Popularity.

+1 POPULARITY

ONCE PER 2-HOUR SESSION

- You rolled a Critical Hit or Critical Fail during a fight or during a life-or-death Check
- You performed a courageous act (not just using Catcher)
- You came up with an original, entertaining solution to a problem... and it worked

ONCE PER DAY

- You appeared on the end-of-day recap episode

END OF EACH FLOOR

- Your Pet did something cute on the Floor
- Your Charisma is 5 × F (five times the Floor number) or higher
- You used an original catchphrase just enough to make it memorable, but not enough to make it annoying

–1 POPULARITY

ONCE PER 2-HOUR SESSION

- You avoided a fight
- You were boring (hid in a saferoom for hours) or gross (pooped in a hallway)

END OF EACH FLOOR

- You used a big, boring, d10+ damage Attack as your primary Attack on the Floor
- Your Charisma is only 2 × F (two times Floor number) or lower
- You entered the stairwell more than 30 hours early
- You were grinding for more than 15 of the final 30 hours before descending the stairwell

PLAYING TO THE CAMERAS

If waiting around for crazy stuff to happen isn't your style, you can force the issue. When a crawler is about to make an important Check, they may play to the cameras to gain a specific benefit. The situation must be dramatic, dangerous, high-pressure, or otherwise worth broadcasting to the hungry masses. Announce that you are playing to the cameras before rolling, choose which of the three Actions you perform, and then make the Check.

It's up to the GM to decide how important or interesting the moment truly is, and how good it looks on screen. Good roleplaying and doing something original and exciting helps. A dramatic lockpicking scene is rarely fun to watch. A tense duel between your party and their nemesis on a collapsing bridge over a pit of ravenous bone-burrowing moles? That's more like it. Because your attention is split between the Check and trying to look good on camera, you suffer Disadvantage to the Check. After rolling your Check, first resolve the issue at hand, then consult Table 52 "Playing to the Cameras" (below) to see the results of your grandstanding.

There are three varieties of playing to the cameras, each used for a different purpose:

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- **Playing to the Audience:** If you succeed, you gain Popularity. If you fail, you likely lose Popularity.
- **Playing to the AI:** If you succeed, you gain AI Favor. If you fail, you likely lose AI Favor for being such a kiss-ass.
- **Playing to the Sponsors:** Available starting on the Fourth Floor. You hope potential Sponsors (p. 84) notice you and send you valuable Benefactor Boxes. If you don't currently have any Sponsors, you gain interest on success, but nothing bad happens if you fail (except the aforementioned inner shame). When you do have a Sponsor, you can gain a Benefactor Box, but only once per Floor.

Example: Your slack line over the lava pit is on fire, and you have mere moments to save yourself from certain death. You say "fuck it" and decide to Play to the Audience. "I wink to the camera, crouch—pausing way too long to yell 'time to bounce'—and leap towards the ledge with my eyes closed."

Only now do you roll, and with Disadvantage on your Unopposed Jumping Skill Check.

No matter the type of Playing to the Cameras you choose, you may only "Play" once per 2-hour game session. Viewers don't want to see you mug it up all the time. You aren't that interesting.

Table 52 shows how the audience, System AI, and a crawler's Sponsor may react when a crawler plays to the cameras.

THE DAILY RECAP

The end of each dungeon day is punctuated with an hour-long recap episode of *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*, showing the best of the day's carnage.

If a scene or fight is hilarious, dramatic, disastrous, spectacularly gruesome, or depicts a key moment in a Quest or storyline, odds are high that it'll appear in the episode. However, while on a copyrighted storyline that the dungeon does not own (typically involving Elites), the party won't be featured much, if at all. Borant is notoriously litigious.

If a party has 4 or more members, it's not always possible to get the whole party in the shot, so only the featured crawlers get a Popularity boost. Of course, everyone will be entirely normal about this, and it definitely won't cause any intra-party issues.

Failing to make a recap episode doesn't incur any penalties (other than shame and the resulting narcissistic rage of slighted crawlers), though your PR Agent might start encouraging more reckless behavior to break the crawlers into the limelight.

WATCHING RECAPS

Every 30 hours, *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth* is tunneled to all dungeon saferooms and broadcast across the Syndicate. These recap shows feature a mixture of highlight reels, color commentary, and dungeon-wide announcements that are designed both for the galaxy's audience and crawlers themselves.

While watching the daily recap episodes, crawlers can gain important information about the World Dungeon: what Mobs and other monsters they might face, the challenges of existing Neighborhoods they might explore, and the personalities of other crawlers they might run into.

It's not an interview show, but it is a good way to get seen.

TABLE 52: PLAYING TO THE CAMERAS

RESULT	AUDIENCE	AI	SPONSORS
Amazing Success or Critical Hit	Gain 2 Popularity	Gain 2 AI Favor	Gain a Gold or Platinum Benefactor Box or an interested Sponsor bids on your contract
Standard Success	Gain 1 Popularity	Gain 1 AI Favor	Gain a Bronze or Silver Benefactor Box
Near Miss	No effect	No effect	No effect
Standard Fail	Lose 1 Popularity	Lose 1 AI Favor	Next Benefactor Box is reduced in quality (Platinum to Gold, Gold to Silver, etc.)
Major Fail	Lose 2 Popularity	Lose 2 AI Favor	No Benefactor Box this Floor
Critical Fail	If the crawler truly suffers, gain 1 Popularity	The AI rides your ass, granting you no AI Favor for the day	They get embarrassed and drop you, or an interested Sponsor bids on your contract

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THE TOP TEN

Also known as the leaderboard, the top ten list is a double-edged sword. It puts a target on your back, but it also comes with perks.

At the start of the Fourth Floor, the official top ten List populates and becomes accessible through your HUD. You probably won't recognize most of the names yet. There are still over a million crawlers in circulation, and some of them have been very busy becoming famous in ways that would make a coroner gasp.

The top ten list is not determined solely by in-game performance metrics. A crawler's Popularity seems to be the most important factor. *Seems*, because the exact formula is proprietary, and Borant is not telling you. Level gains, gold earned, and Boss kills figure into the equation, probably.

WHO'S IN THE TOP TEN?

As GM, first determine if your crawlers want to be on the list. They might not want to be, which saves the GM some bookkeeping. But most crawlers enjoy the prestige, extra income, and rich Sponsors that come with being on the list. Crawlers outside of the top ten do not know their placement. To the audience, you don't even count. Sad.

At the start of the Fourth Floor, populate the list with 10 GMCs. Feel free to use Carl, Donut, and any other competent and charismatic GMCs, or just make up some names and worry about who they are later. If the party encountered other crawlers, add the best of them to the list.

It's more interesting if none of your crawlers are on the starting list, as it gives them a goal and something to complain about. (And we all know gamers *hate* complaining.) However, if a crawler built their character for the express purpose of getting on the initial list, feel free to make an exception. They can get bumped down later on, and that meltdown should be entertaining.

PLACEMENT ON THE LIST

When a crawler has done enough to make the top ten in the GM's estimation, it's best to start them at eighth to tenth place to get their competitive juices flowing. Players who are obsessed with the list often want to appear on interview shows, take huge risks, and play to the cameras. They're like Real Housewives in a way. Be prepared!

Once you're on the list, the scrutiny is real. You're criticized for everything you do that isn't perfect. The viewers find a crowbar for every crack in your façade. They will tear you down, Sir Chirpingtons!

First, the GM should check for "infractions" that cause you to lose position on the list (down towards tenth place or off the list). If there are none, check whether you accomplished anything that advances your position on the list (toward first place). Your shortcomings outweigh your moments of triumph, just like your parents made clear.

Read the bullets below in the order presented, based on what happened over the past dungeon day. As soon as you spot a modifying event, adjust the crawler's position on the list and stop. Ignore additional infractions and accomplishments for that day.

INFRACTIONS (MOVE DOWN ONE PLACE)

- Gained less than 3 Popularity (move down 2 places if your Popularity dropped from where it was at the start of the day)
- Showed weakness like sobbing or having a breakdown (move down 2 places)
- Did anything that pissed off the viewers (possibly dropping more than 1 place, at the GM's discretion)
- Avoided a fight
- Was boring for 2 or more hours (not including downtime activities)
- Descended to the next Floor more than 30 hours early
- Were placed in an administrative time-out for being naughty

If there were no infractions, check for accomplishments.

ACCOMPLISHMENTS (MOVE UP ONE PLACE)

- Gained 6+ Popularity (move up 2 places if 10+ Popularity was gained)
- Completed a Quest
- Killed a Borough Boss (move up 2 places for killing a City Boss or higher)
- Gained F (Floor) Levels
- Earned more than 5,000 × F gold (move up 2 places for more than 10,000 × F gold), not including income from Venison Boxes and the like

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If a crawler doesn't move up or down on the list, they maintain their position, as long as someone else hasn't surged past them. When a GMC passes a PC, the GMC makes for a great rival.

ADJUSTING THE LIST

Viewers wait with bated breath, often drooling, for the top ten list to change. Officially, the top ten list updates at the end of each recap episode at day's end. If that is too often for you and your players, update it only once per Floor (30 hours before collapse, based on their last full day on the Floor). Use the previous criteria each time a change to the list should be made, and feel free to add other factors as they come up. Don't make it too easy for your crawlers to keep their position, especially #1.

When a top ten crawler dies, the system puts out a message: *A champion has fallen*. This is one of the easiest ways to create space in the top ten for other crawlers.

PROS OF BEING ON THE TOP TEN LIST

- When a top ten crawler enters the stairwell to the next Floor, they earn 10% of their own bounty. This amount is based on the total, including the multiplier. This is delivered in a Venison Box and is considered income. You only earn this reward if you exit the Floor while in the top ten. If you held your spot in the top ten for the whole Floor, but dropped off on the last day, too bad.
- Sometimes there is a loose camaraderie among the top ten, as they share that "hunted" feeling, and they know that other top ten crawlers are as competent as they are.
- Access to exclusive top ten events and storylines
- Status! You are more sought after by Sponsors and interview shows. Once per 2-hour game session, you may roll a Playing to the Sponsor with Advantage.

CONS OF BEING ON THE TOP TEN LIST

- There's a bounty on your head that other crawlers might want to collect. A big one. Killing you is worth a lot of gold, prestige, and Levels (see *Killing a Crawler*, p. 87). The closer to #1, the better the bounty.
- You attract a lot of attention. This can make subversive plans harder to enact. Your Name, Race, Class, Level, and Bounty all appear next to your name. Now your enemies know what to expect.
- Some outworlders feel the need to insert themselves into the narrative by purchasing hunting licenses, which allows them to hunt down the top ten crawlers for sport. This activity is typically limited to certain Floors, like the Sixth, but your mileage may vary. Hunters are allowed access everywhere their quarry can go, even saferooms and Personal Spaces.

BOUNTIES

Some crawlers may wish to bag you, tag you, and convert your sudden death into personal advancement. You may, of course, be one such crawler. No judgment here: murderous ambition is a wonderful ingredient for television drama.

On the Fourth Floor, the bounties for killing a member of the top ten are shown in Table 53. Each subsequent Floor multiplies the bounties (×2 for the Fifth Floor, ×3 for the Sixth, ×4 for the Seventh, and so on). The bounty is delivered via a Legendary Bounty Box.

TABLE 53: LEADER BOARD BOUNTIES

	BOUNTIES (IN GOLD)					
PLACE	FOURTH FLOOR	FIFTH FLOOR	SIXTH FLOOR	SEVENTH FLOOR	EIGHTH FLOOR	NINTH FLOOR
1st	1,000,000	2,000,000	3,000,000	4,000,000	5,000,000	6,000,000
2nd	500,000	1,000,000	1,500,000	2,000,000	2,500,000	3,000,000
3rd	400,000	800,000	1,200,000	1,600,000	2,000,000	2,400,000
4th	300,000	600,000	900,000	1,200,000	1,500,000	1,800,000
5th	200,000	400,000	600,000	800,000	1,000,000	1,200,000
6th—10th	100,000	200,000	300,000	400,000	500,000	600,000

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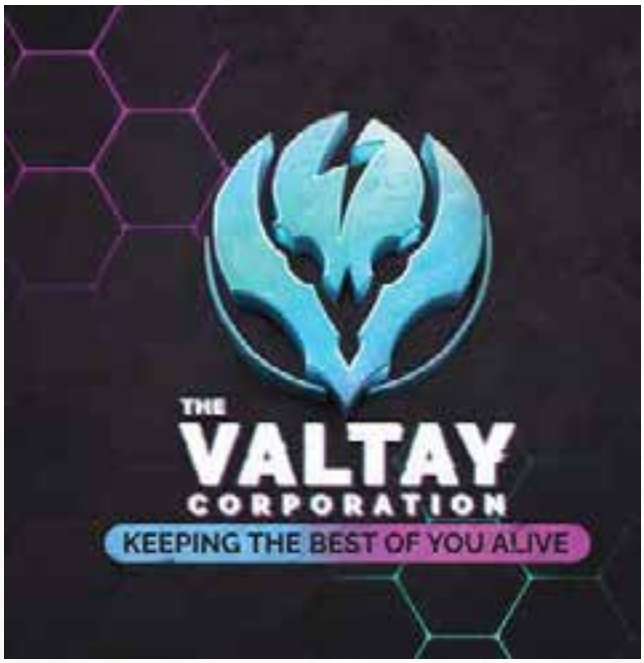
SPONSORS

Admin Notice. Congratulations, Crawler. You have been sponsored!

Viewers watching your feed will occasionally see advertisements produced by your Sponsor.



Also colloquially known as patrons, corporations—and the occasional mega-rich individual—Sponsor crawlers for all sorts of reasons. Mostly for advertising and entertainment purposes, but occasionally for nefarious political or corporate maneuvering. You want to impress the Sponsors, or at least get a rich one, as the more cash they spend on you, the better your loot boxes. Usually.

Crawlers are limited to three Sponsors each, and can gain only one per Floor unless a Sponsor drops them (oof). At the beginning of the Fourth, Fifth, and Sixth Floors, the various potential Sponsors bid for the rights to the most popular crawlers. Once the crawler reaches the Seventh Floor, the Sponsor may sell or transfer their sponsorship.

The main function of a Sponsor (from a crawler's point of view) is purchasing Benefactor loot boxes to send to you. These come in six tiers of ascending quality: Bronze, Silver, Gold, Platinum, Legendary, and Celestial. The Sponsor chooses an item to include in the box; these rare items are typically stronger than dungeon-generated loot, and the strength of the item determines the quality of the box. Rest assured, whatever is in the box is useful to the crawler, even if it's not obvious or useful yet. You are encouraged to send thank-you notes to your Sponsors for these boxes if you want to keep the goodies flowing.

Being unique, even a Bronze Benefactor Box registers as more valuable than a Gold Adventurer Box via a Determine Value Skill. They are typically restricted for use by the crawler to whom it was sent. Want to share your Fucking Sharp-Ass Sword

TABLE 54: NEW SPONSORS

SPONSOR	TYPE	EXPECTED REASON
Pantheon Plex, Inc.	Religious Media	Crawler is devout or tells a good moral story
SnackFrenzy Solutions	Snack Foods	Crawler eats a lot of interesting things or talks about food
OmniGrin Entertainment	Comedy Media	Crawler is good at jokes or is often the butt of jokes
BioVantage Coagulate Labs	Pharma and Med Tech	Crawler has Poison-type powers or is a healer
GigaGroom Robotics	Beauty Robotics	Crawler crafts things or grooms themselves or others
StellarSpine Logistics	Shipping and Logistics	Crawler is organized or gets things done
Xylo P. Worthington, Esq.	Wealthy Socialite	A strange attraction (not necessarily physical) or connection
NectarJack Nutritional Rations	Healthy and Military Foods	Crawler leads a healthy lifestyle or wishes to
The Crimson Temporary Assurance	Intelligence	Crawler is erudite or shrewd and makes creative plans
HappyWar Arms & Leisure	Arms Manufacturing	Crawler uses high-tech weapons

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of Sharpness? Too bad. When crawlers get into sticky situations, Sponsors can send Emergency Benefactor Boxes to the crawler, and such items might just save the day, deus ex machina–style. Such boxes are exorbitantly expensive, however, so don't rely on them.

Usually, every crawler gets at least one Sponsor, but not all Sponsors are made the same. Some enterprising (read: broke) Sponsors speculate on cheap crawlers, hoping they rise in Popularity without their help so they can sell their sponsorship later on. The less they paid for the sponsorship contract, the more the dungeon charges for Benefactor Boxes. So, if you aren't in the top ten, you might only receive Bronze Boxes, if anything. You're more likely to get product samples of your Sponsor's latest gizmos, and if you disparage their products, they won't be happy.

Who sponsors your crawlers is up to the GM. But somebody should, even if your crawlers aren't in the top ten. Give 'em a participation trophy. They nearly died for this! Feel free to make up the most ridiculous company names. There are trillions of options. Table 54 shows some invented just for the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**. For some, the reason for sponsorship is obvious. Others jump at the chance to sponsor any crawler, and still others seem to have weird marketing ideas, sponsoring underdogs, assholes, or other odd choices.

SPONSORSHIP COMPLICATIONS

The Sponsors are mostly corporate dickheads that just want to exploit you, as any good corp would. Viewers watching your feed see advertisements from your Sponsors. Those Sponsors make you jump through hoops, shill their products, film an infomercial, and do all sorts of demeaning things to earn your Benefactor Boxes. They might want you to change your appearance, choose a new Race or Class, or adopt a new attitude. They send you on Quests that just happen to coincide with their new product launches, or encourage rivalries with crawlers backed by competing brands, because nothing says "authentic personal conflict" like a marketing schtick. Imagine how convoluted it gets when you have more than one Sponsor! If your Sponsor drops you, an immediate bidding process begins, and you will usually receive a replacement Sponsor in about two days.

Assuming, of course, that someone still wants you. And given you were just dumped...

INTERVIEW SHOWS

Admit it, you always wanted to be on a late-night talk show.

Good news, gorgeous: the dungeon can make that happen. A strong interview, a memorable performance, or even a spectacular public meltdown may increase a crawler's Popularity. A dull appearance, bad attitude, or boring answers to piercing questions may reduce it.

For the sake of the GM's sanity, consider having the entire party appear together on a single show. Since many hosts play favorites, that should provide some drama. Jerry Springer didn't top the ratings for no reason, kids. For the effects of an appearance on Popularity, see Table 56 (p. 288).

SPLITTING THE PARTY

If you do split PC appearances over different shows, you'll want to keep the other players interested and occupied. Otherwise it can get rather dull, especially if each player is the star for 20 minutes or more at a time. Everyone else may check out as they wait for one or more lengthy scenes to finish. Pulling this off is typically considered an advanced GMing skill, but anyone can practice and learn. Maintaining interest and momentum during individual or small group scenes—like interview shows—can be done in a few ways.

- **Keep It Short:** Stick to the highlights. Set a timer for 5 or 10 minutes, and don't go over. Short and intense scenes are more interesting to watch, and you can get through the whole group in about half an hour.
- **Ready-to-Play Characters:** Involve one or more of the other players by giving them alternate crawlers or outside NPCs they can temporarily portray. Co-hosts, other crawlers, representatives of Sponsors... the sky's the limit.
- **Off Camera:** Set a separate individual session with each player. This way no one is forced to watch and you can go as long as it is fun. One-on-one play can be intense, however, and some might find 15 minutes is plenty. Alternatively, this could be done via bluebooking (see *Past Authors*, p. 353).
- **Other Activities:** If the group is amenable to it, pull one or more players into a show scene while the others have something else to do, whether it's playing a video game or card game or a miniature painting session.

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- **Absences:** Sometimes a player is just not able to make a session, whether it's planned in advance or at the last minute. If everyone is okay with it, do an interview show and leave the absentee out.
- **Mix and Match:** Combine one or more of these approaches. Perhaps each player portrays a different show host (chosen from shows below or invented for your campaign). Pair PCs to reduce the number of different interviews as needed.

WHAT IS AN INTERVIEW SHOW?

The shows tunneled throughout the galaxy are every bit as tawdry and unhinged as those found on Earth, with one twist: They all relate to the World Dungeon and/or Earth in some way. The ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*** focuses on interview shows because their typical format makes them prime fodder for... well, roleplaying. That doesn't mean they can't be dangerous, however. Shows can interrupt carefully laid plans and force crawlers into even worse situations.

The basic format is question and answer—lather, rinse, repeat. As you practice and run interview segments, you'll get better at asking probing questions and may develop the hosts, production crew, agents, and other NPCs that the crawlers meet into allies or antagonists.

As the GM, you can adapt any of these ideas for less interview-focused media opportunities, such as Planet Beautiful, where crawlers serve as voice actors narrating documentaries, or recording commercials for a Veriluxx Toys showcase.

GUESTING ON SHOWS

Crawlers who survive against incredible odds, lean into the spectacle of the World Dungeon, and otherwise make a name for themselves can earn the opportunity to be additionally exploited by one of many shows that pay the Borant Corporation for the privilege of hosting crawlers for interviews.

Crawlers gain the benefit of being plucked out of the World Dungeon for a brief guest segment,

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where they can experience everything from a fair and measured conversation about the perils of the dungeon, to traumatic reminders of every failure and person they've lost, for the passing entertainment of the Syndicate's citizens. Guesting on shows is a specific type of roleplaying scene where crawlers don't always have access to their HUD, equipment, Spells, or the benefits of their magic items. Episodes of each show may differ, though many crawlers are not even in the same room as hosts, producers, or other guests on the show. Crawlers on shows may be forced to use their Unenhanced Stats (especially around admins), which will likely change their Stat Mod for Skill Checks. However, crawlers can generally still use their Skills; non-combat Skills that rely on Intelligence and Charisma are especially valuable. Occasionally, crawlers could be stuck in a zero zone where none of the dungeon's enhancements function.

Guesting on shows yields several benefits to crawlers, including:

- **Gaining Popularity:** A crawler being featured on a show opens them up to the show's audience, and an entertaining guest can gain a lot of fans by the end of a show. This tends to be a mutually beneficial arrangement, as exciting guests earn fans while growing the show's reach, leading to invitations to take part in more shows. Crawlers who gain a large following from shows position themselves well for when sponsorships become available on lower Floors.
- **Learning about the Crawl:** Shows can be a good way to learn about what's happening outside of the World Dungeon, including information about the entities in charge, galactic celebrities whom crawlers might run into on lower Floors, and concepts like the Ninth Floor and Faction Wars. If the censors are sloppy, that is.
- **Learning About the Dungeon:** Shows discuss the perils of this season's dungeon, including Neighborhoods, Mobs, Bosses, traps, and other dangers to be on the lookout for.
- **Meeting New Crawlers:** A party of crawlers is rarely the only set of guests on a show, and taking part in a show together can lead to new allies—and rivals.
- **Show Gift:** Some shows grant gifts to crawlers for participating, though most of these rewards are designed to go over well with the fans, so these aren't likely to be extremely helpful to crawlers.

There are, of course, potential drawbacks as well:

- **Emotional Damage:** Hosts can be cruel, and bringing up a crawler's Past Trauma, Loose Ends, or Regrets helps the host's popularity (and bank account).
- **New Rivals:** Whether they're people in or outside of the dungeon, it's possible to make enemies as well as friends.
- **Physical Danger:** The host or showrunners can endanger crawlers with terrible contests on the show itself or by messing with crawlers in the dungeon. A good communications agent or potentially a lawyer can help avoid appearing on these shows.

THE GREEN ROOM

Relax. Have a snack. Try not to murder anyone... but if you do, be clever about it.

Before an appearance, crawlers are teleported from the World Dungeon into a green room to prepare. There, they can compose themselves, freshen up, and plot revenge against the showrunners—carefully, because staff or mercenaries often guard these areas.

What happens in the green room stays in the green room. Usually. Whatever is said isn't broadcast by the show or the dungeon. Everything is still monitored, of course, but crawlers, production staff, and other characters can speak more freely. Showrunners or Borant will censor anything too spicy.

THE SHOW ITSELF

For crawlers, most show appearances occur inside a small production trailer dressed up with holograms. Many participants, props, backdrops, and set elements are holographic, too.

Crawlers have a limited area to move around in these production trailers. Also, the trailer is usually floating out in the middle of an ocean. So, unless their escape plan involves photogenically drowning somewhere in the Pacific, they shouldn't get any crazy ideas about trying to break out.

RETURNING TO THE DUNGEON

After a crawler completes their time on the show, they're usually returned to the dungeon in the same place they left from. Hopefully, it was somewhere safe! If not... eh, you'll figure it out, or you'll end up as a fine pink mist, spraying across the camera lens in the highlight reel.

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A WILD VARIETY OF SHOWS

The **Dungeon Crawler Carl** series introduces readers to many interview shows in the first few novels. Table 55 lists many of these. Use any that you like, or create your own based on the most unhinged Earth shows you know of or select one from Table 34 (p. 124) To make it easier, five shows are detailed below (see pp. 294–303).

WHY DO INTERVIEW SHOWS?

Interview shows support many key aspects of a ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*** campaign.

Refresher or New Information: The interviews can help refresh player memories about past events in the campaign. To re-engage with past campaign events, just ask questions about those events. If you want to make a correction to the player's recollection, you can roleplay the host rolling a clip of the actual events, perhaps from an angle that shows events in a different light or reveals a truth previously unknown, such as the identity of another crawler who laid a trap.

Understanding the World: There are forces outside the dungeon at play, most of which the crawlers cannot interact with. These shows are a time when those forces, factions, individuals, or corporations can gain some spotlight time, even if it's through a cryptic warning. The green room is the perfect time and place to quickly expand on these conversations as much as the host or production assistants are able. Remember: the AI and Borant may still be watching.

Understanding the Dungeon: Millions of crawlers roam the Tutorial Floors, and other than a regular recap show and chance meetings, crawlers get very little information about other crawlers early on. Interview shows are a way for them to meet other crawlers in a safe environment; whether those crawlers end up as allies, rivals, or merely acquaintances depends on the PC's actions and how the host sets them up.

TABLE 55: ESTABLISHED SHOWS AND HOSTS

SHOW	HOST	FORMAT	AFFILIATION (IF KNOWN)
Danger Zone with Ripper Wonton	Ripper Wonton	Round Table	Unknown
Death Watch Extreme Dungeon Mayhem	The Maestro	Late Night Talk	Skull Empire
Dungeon Crawl Tactics	Unknown Human	Round Table	Unknown
Dungeon Crawler After Hours with Odette	Odette	Late Night Talk	Titan Conglomerate
Dungeon Sidekicks	Unknown	One-on-One Interview	Unknown
Plenty of Plenty	Varies	"Round Table" Q&A	The Plenty
Shadow Boxer	Rosetta Thagra	One-on-One Interview	Open Intellect Pacifist Action Network
Uptown Hal Talks Tactics	Uptown Hal	Unknown	Unknown

TABLE 56: GAINING AND LOSING POPULARITY

CHECK RESULT	EFFECT
Critical Fail or Major Fail	−2 Popularity or −1 Popularity and alienate the host
Standard Fail	−1 Popularity
Near Miss Fail	No Change
Standard Success	+1 Popularity
Amazing Success or Critical Hit	+2 Popularity, and the host likes you; Or +1 Popularity for your whole party

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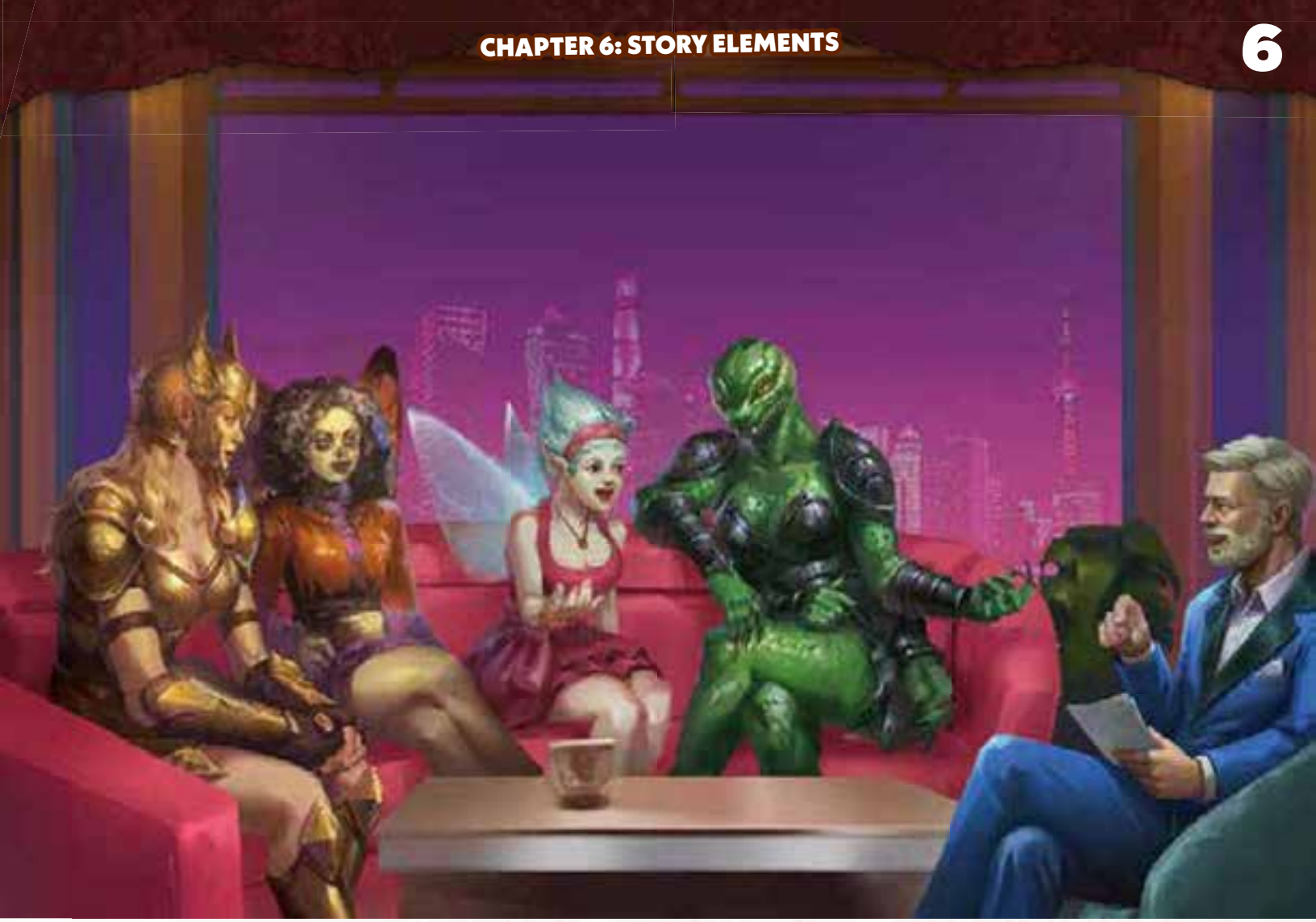

Extreme Danger and Difficult Choices: While some shows are softball interviews, many crawlers, especially those with callous or greedy PR Agents, end up on cruel shows where they're forced to make spur-of-the-moment decisions on life-or-death scenarios.

Foreshadowing: Interviews can't reveal the future of what crawlers may interact with in the dungeon, but they often drop hints. These may relate to a character's Past Trauma, Loose Ends, or Regrets, enemies they've made in the dungeon, or even upcoming changes to the rules of the game. For example, asking about a crawler's plans for Race and Class selection on the Third Floor reinforces that Race and Class selection will happen and that crawlers need to consider these factors sooner rather than later.

Pacing and Gaps: Practically speaking, interview shows are a good way to fill time and keep the narrative moving. The GM doesn't need to worry as much about a session ending early when an interview can unexpectedly be moved up to whisk one or more of the crawlers away. However, it may be folly to run a whole session of interviews—unless your group really loves them. Either way, once you're comfortable improvising these shows, they're a valuable tool in the GM's belt.

ASKING QUESTIONS

When asking questions, it's worth knowing how a few types of questions may be used. Open-ended, closed-ended, and leading questions all have their place in interviews.

An open-ended question might be:

- "What did you think of that last Boss fight?"
- "How do you plan on handling future inter-party conflict?"

These questions give the player the opportunity to extensively express their thoughts on events happening in the game. This is a great way to spark a round-table style discussion among the party.

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Closed-Ended Questions: These are questions that elicit a fixed, often one-word or even monosyllabic response. Peppering your interview with closed-ended questions can help break up the conversation or allow shyer roleplayers to participate, even in a small way.

A closed-ended question might be:

- "What is your favorite item that you've received from a loot box so far?"
- "What is the name of your new pet Tummy Acher?"

A player could simply answer "The Enchanted Trollskin Shirt of Pummeling" or "Blorbo" without elaborating further.

Leading Questions: A leading question is a favorite among talk-show hosts looking to confirm their own biases or push an agenda to their audience. These questions contain information the interviewer is seeking to confirm. A leading question could be closed- or open-ended.

A leading question might be:

- "Don't you think training with that slingshot is a waste of time?"
- "That Lucia Mar is just out of control, isn't she?"

Asking leading questions can be a great way to reveal a host's biases, agendas, or ulterior motives to players. They can also be used to craft a narrative that an audience may find enjoyable.

Using a combination of these question types can help you create an interesting and dynamic interview segment that lets players express their character's thoughts and feelings, spark inter-party discussions, and reveal more about the host's motives and life outside the dungeon.

WHAT CAN THEY EVEN DO?

What crawlers can typically do while on a show:

- Use Intelligence- or Charisma-based Skills
- Make INT or CHA Stat Checks
- Receive the occasional reward
- Make difficult or embarrassing decisions
- Agree to be put into a dangerous situation for a substantial reward

Actions a crawler might take on a show include:

- Get a zinger in on the host
- Insult a rival crawler
- Impress the show's specific audience (rather than playing to the audience in general)
- Deepen or upend relationships with the host, AI, other crawlers, and NPCs
- Attempt to walk out (back to the green room)

Plenty of shows offer dangerous opportunities for more fame, glory, or prizes in exchange for crawlers risking their safety.

While on these shows, crawlers (generally) cannot:

- Access or use items from their Hotlist
- Access the minimap and other elements in their HUD
- Remove or use items from Inventory
- Attack or physically interact with others (except crawlers in their party and certain NPCs)
- Leave the set

SKILL AND STAT CHECKS

On interview shows, crawlers generally use Intelligence- and Charisma-based Skills. You can play shows without any dice rolling at all, but many players expect to roll lots of dice in roleplaying game sessions.

In general, rolling dice on an interview show is risky. Failure tends to alienate the audience, while basic successes may do little more than marginally impress people. If a player is unhappy with their chances of success, they'll learn they need to develop the Skills and Stats required to thrive on a show later or live with a lackluster following and low-tier Sponsors (if any).

Apply Advantage for clever ideas and choices of Skills that really fit the show or host, or apply Disadvantage for humdrum or boring ideas and Skills that really don't fit the show or might alienate the host.

Table 56 shows how a crawler's performance on a show can affect their popularity.

MAKING IT WILD

Interview shows range from sedate to unhinged. Whether you're using the sample shows and hosts on the following pages or making up your own shows based on some of the wildest shit you've seen lately, you can use the tables below to add personality or drama to any show or just make it memorable. Don't go overboard: Each crawler probably gets on two interviews per Floor, and you just need enough to make it wild.

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Each show might have its own quirks (such as those found in Table 57), and any of these may allow crawlers to use their Intelligence- or Charisma-based Skills, particularly ones that are otherwise of dubious use in the dungeon. Generally, crawlers can't refuse to perform on a show unless they suggest using a Skill to get them out of a potentially embarrassing situation, which may affect their Popularity in lieu of an embarrassing task or a good roll. Even a good Skill with Disadvantage might be preferable to a bad one without.

Before or after the show, crawlers often have time in a production trailer or green room. These areas are less monitored by the AI and Borant and not visible to anyone else, so crawlers and show hosts, show producers and staff, and other NPCs can speak a little more freely. These are prime places where weird stuff may happen (see Table 8).

A few shows reward crawlers for appearing, such as *Dungeon Sidekicks*. Most of the rewards are designed to go over well with the fans, so these aren't likely to be extremely helpful to crawlers. Table 59 shows some options.

Many shows cater to a bloodthirsty audience or one excited by the drama of emotional damage. Table 60 provides a few options for the GM to use. Keep in mind the suggestions for considerate play (p. 11–12) when using cruel behavior on shows.

You may want to use the same interviewer or show multiple times. Table 61 provides some examples of issues that may arise on these repeated appearances on the Fourth or Fifth Floor.

TABLE 57: INTERVIEW SHOW QUIRKS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	QUIRK
1	The crawlers must sing a karaoke song.
2	The crawlers must show off a Skill, talent-show style.
3	The crawlers must answer personal, probing, or unhinged questions from the audience.
4	The host brings out a rival or antagonist crawler to stir up drama.
5	The host initiates a competition of some sort, pitting two crawlers against each other.
6	The host lets the audience vote on what kind of prize the crawlers receive—if any.

TABLE 58: GREEN ROOM COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The green room isn't properly locked down, and crawlers can change their equipment or take items from their Inventory after learning about the host, show format, and/or interview topics.
2	The green room is luxurious and contains showers or beds that allow for a short rest in just a few minutes.
3	The crawlers are late, and a producer or production assistant rushes them onto the show without warning.
4	The crawlers get an unexpected five minutes to talk to a Communications Agent or Production Assistant in the green room.
5	Through chance or a rival's machinations, the party gets a different green room than expected, which may be less beneficial to the party.
6	The green room's amenities malfunction or are nonexistent, leading to a negative experience for a crawler that they'll possibly carry with them onto the show.

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TABLE 59: CRAWLER REWARDS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	REWARD
1	A shirt, hat, or other garment with a useful enchantment on it, but also a joke about another crawler they know. The joke will surely make that other crawler angry.
2	A memento of a Past Trauma, Loose Ends, or Regret. It may also have a useful benefit.
3	A weapon or Spell the crawler isn't trained in, preferably one that would have been useful if they got it earlier or associated with a rival crawler.
4	A high-quality but embarrassing hygiene product to treat an issue like hemorrhoids or halitosis. Using it properly takes about an hour, but it gives a temporary +10 bonus to Charisma for 30 hours.
5	An embarrassing snick or other edited clip. It may have been organically created by fans or crafted specifically for the interview show. It goes viral in 30 hours, granting +1 to Popularity.
6	A prescient gift. Someone must know what the next Neighborhood or Boss the crawler will encounter is, and they included a gift that'll prove useful to overcome that. This gift may get the show canceled or turn the host into an adversary.

TABLE 60: CRUEL BEHAVIOR

ROLL OR CHOOSE	CRUEL HOST BEHAVIOR
1	The host offers the crawler or party a chance to fight a Boss near their location in the dungeon. Refusal results in mockery from the host or even the audience.
2	Two guests are encouraged to duel one another to the death. The host may offer a reward to the victor. See pages 87 and 251 for advice on including or excluding violence among party members.
3	The host brings out a surviving Human (or Earth pet) tied to the crawler's Past Trauma, Loose Ends, or Regrets.
4	The host encourages the crawlers to give their full, unfiltered opinion of other crawlers they've met, only to bring those crawlers out as surprise guests to confront any giving negative opinions.
5	The host provides a choice of gifts for each guest, but each choice ties back to a crawler's recent failure in the dungeon or a Regret, Past Trauma, or Loose End.
6	The host puts one or more party members in danger, forcing the guest(s) to choose whom to save.

TABLE 61: FOURTH AND FIFTH FLOOR COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	ADDITIONAL COMPLICATIONS
1	A teleportation mishap swaps guest locations when returning them to the dungeon, dropping the party aboard a named line (Fourth Floor) or into a different bubble (Fifth Floor).
2	The host gets approval to bring all guests, including non-crawlers, into the dungeon to tour a train (Fourth Floor) or a tomb (Fifth Floor). They think Borant finally activated the dungeon protection system, not having heard that it's malfunctioning.
3	The host is hostile to a crawler's latest Sponsor and tries to make them look bad. The Sponsor finds ways to respond during or after the show, resulting in an escalating tit-for-tat.
4	The host invites extremist guests to stoke controversy over political commentary Borant inserted into depictions of Mobs. Crawlers have a chance to incite unrest among viewers.
5	The host partially spoils a major surprise planned for the Floor before Admins and/or Liaisons can intervene, creating chaos that crawlers can exploit.
6	Another guest faces certain death (stuck on a named line or trapped in a quadrant) and begs to be saved. Depending on the show, there may be no way to do so, but Player Characters must somehow respond.

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INTERVIEW: DUNGEON CRAWLER AFTER HOURS WITH ODETTE

Dungeon Crawler After Hours with Odette is styled like a modern late-night talk show. The host, Odette, is a former crawler who took a deal on the Twelfth Floor to get out. On her show, she is a large-breasted woman with the head of a mantis and the body of a crab. When the cameras stop, she'll ditch the prosthetics and reveal herself as the top half of a 60-year-old Human woman with no legs (they were lost in the dungeon) who rests on a hovering disc.

ODETTE'S GOALS

- **Second Floor:** Odette wants to identify crawlers she has a good rapport with who'll survive to the Ninth Floor.
- **Third Floor:** Odette focuses on what makes crawlers stand out, so those who have caught her interest improve their chances of getting a good Sponsor when bidding begins on the Fourth Floor. She also uses hints on air or advice in the green room to steer crawlers toward or away from locations and Elites based on her knowledge of the production companies involved.
- **Fourth Floor:** With the Iron Tangle design being an overt and controversial political commentary by the Kua-Tin government, Odette focuses her chats on the symbolism of the Floor. Her chosen crawlers have a better chance of gaining audience and Sponsor favor if they understand the context in which their actions will be seen, and they can exploit opportunities to showboat while making a statement about their own beliefs.
- **Fifth Floor:** Depending on how the Fourth Floor shook out, Odette may be looking for a reset if some of her favored crawlers fell into the chaos. She won't forget a group that humiliated her, but she may attempt to work with them. She also sees the Fifth Floor's design of splitting up friendly parties and forcing high-powered crawlers to rely upon those they might not otherwise work with as an opportunity to broaden their networks. They'll need as many allies as possible to survive the Sixth Floor.
- **Long-term:** Odette wants to influence the Faction Wars on the Ninth Floor and participate in the Ascendancy on the Twelfth Floor. She'll build a good relationship with and provide assistance to crawlers she thinks will make it to at least the Ninth Floor.

PERSONALITY

Odette is charming and a bit of a schemer. She'll lay it on thick as needed to get the audience going and to stash crawlers in her proverbial pocket. Odette takes advantage of her press pass, old comrades, and new crawlers alike. She's not forthcoming about her true intentions, though some speculate she wants revenge, or to make amends, or perhaps both.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

The Crab Ranch: Odette's husband owns a crab ranch and uses that as a front to sponsor crawlers if she wants to. She's not forthcoming about this, however.

Mordecai: Odette was once Mordecai's manager, and the two have a frosty relationship because of it. Odette is always eager to get information about him, however.

Huanxin Jinx: Exactly what transpired between Odette and Huanxin Jinx, the rich and powerful CEO of Icon Industries, remains shrouded in mystery, but suffice it to say they don't exactly get along.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

Dungeon Crawler After Hours is tunneled like most shows: Odette and her staff film the show from one production trailer, and crawlers from each party appear in separate trailers. Her audience comes from all over the galaxy and is an accurate cross-section of the various alien Races that make up the Syndicate planets.

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SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- What're you thinking here, CRAWLER NAME, when CRAWLER NAME OR NPC wasn't helping you? [Shows clip]
- So, what's next for you? Do you intend to keep working with PARTY OR CRAWLER NAME?
- No? Why not?

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- Lexis, Odette's producer, slips useful information about a rival, Borant, or another aspect of the dungeon to the crawlers either before or after the show so Odette can watch them to see what they do with it.
- Odette takes off her costume and gives the crawlers some real talk.
- Odette or a producer leaves something useful in the green room for the crawlers to take.

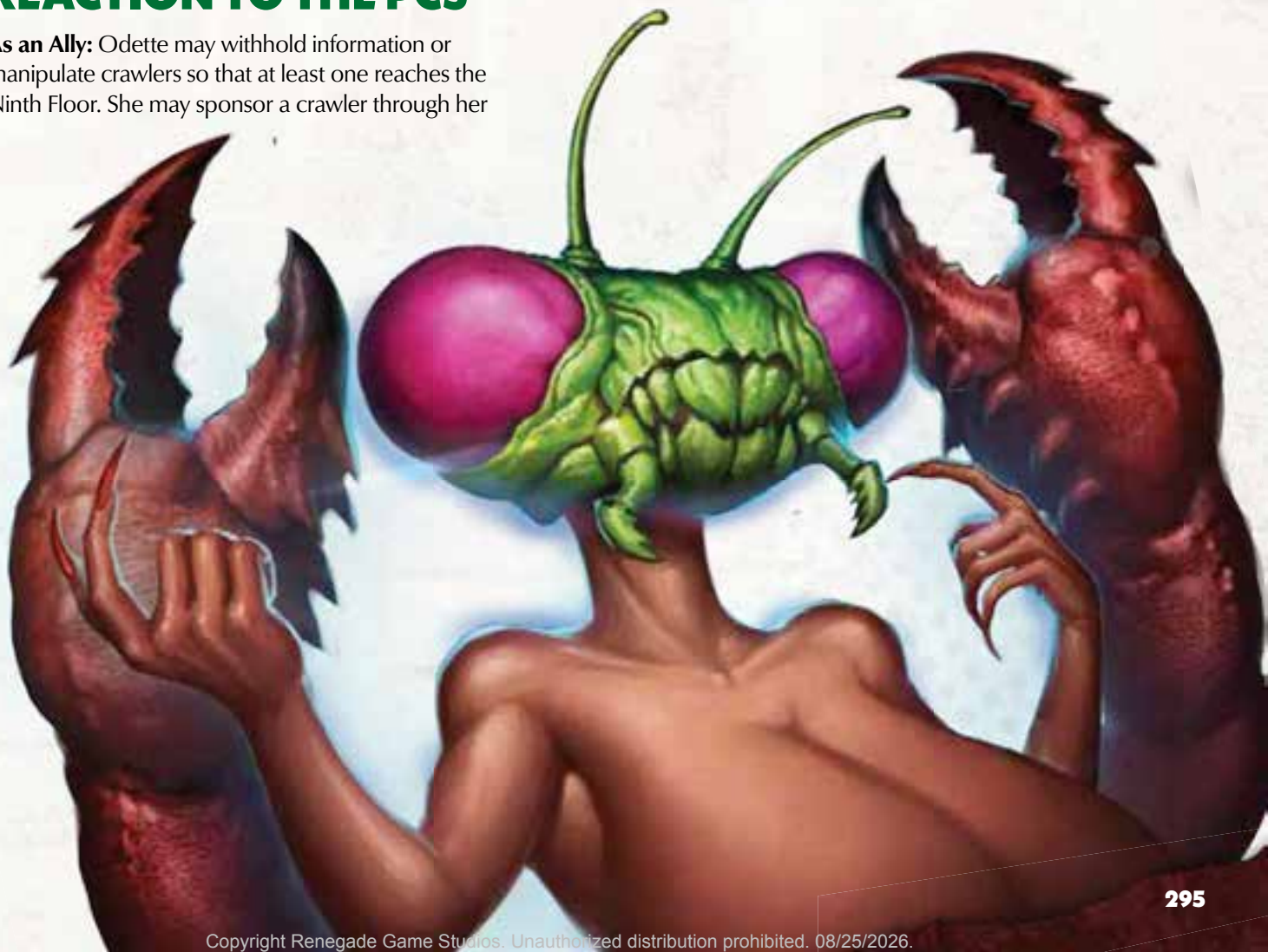
REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: Odette may withhold information or manipulate crawlers so that at least one reaches the Ninth Floor. She may sponsor a crawler through her husband's crab ranch if she isn't sponsoring Hekla and Brynhild's Daughters—or she may even sponsor both. She and her husband likely have access to multiple companies and enough credits that they could sponsor crawlers.

As an Enemy: Odette doesn't invest too much time to spite crawlers who insult her once. If they can't get to the Ninth Floor, she doesn't care—unless they might stop her favored crawlers from achieving that goal. If crawlers interfere with her plans or repeatedly cross her, she'll prove a vicious and vindictive enemy who knows how the dungeon works (though not necessarily how it may or may not function in this particular iteration) and how the galaxy outside the dungeon works, and she'll use that knowledge to her advantage to crush anyone who stands in her way.

RESULTS

Odette doesn't generally grant tangible rewards for appearing on her show. The less tangible rewards of fame, information, and possible ongoing alliance are what she offers crawlers.



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INTERVIEW: THE DANGER ZONE WITH RIPPER WONTON

The Danger Zone with Ripper Wonton is a panel discussion show featuring questions from the audience and other guests, moderated by Ripper Wonton himself. He's known for being both fair and honest, but he also pushes guests hard when he disagrees with them. *The Danger Zone* includes crawlers but also luminaries from the wider galaxy. Ripper's keen wit, command of the facts, and adorable appearance make him a popular host among social elites and aspiring intelligentsia.

RIPPER'S GOALS

- **Second Floor:** Ripper is looking for crawlers who can bring him interesting facts and perspectives, particularly those who may present information with implications that reach outside of the dungeon. He'll try to keep such crawlers in his orbit so he can bring them back later.
- **Third Floor:** With Scolopendra levels being mainstays of the Crawl, Ripper wants to showcase his knowledge about the dungeon's history and secrets to improve his chances of being selected as an adjutant for Faction Wars. Savvy crawlers may pick up clues about Quests and places to investigate.
- **Fourth Floor:** Ripper is legitimately fascinated by Earth's complex transportation systems, focusing discussion on them to a degree that annoys all guests and gives crawlers unusual opportunities to whisper with other guests while Ripper is distracted.
- **Fifth Floor:** Ripper has noticed all sorts of unusual activity in the dungeon due to Borant's cost-cutting and thinks the Kua-Tin government is losing control over everything. He tries to find guests who can bring him evidence of glitches, external influences that constitute cheating, and clues about what's happening at Borant and other companies that are parties to litigation over the Crawl.
- **Long-term:** Ripper wants to see his star rise further and seeks out additional opportunities, such as serving as an adjutant for Faction Wars on the Ninth Floor. He loves the camera and would love to get into the game, if only peripherally.

PERSONALITY

Ripper is a calm and kind-hearted Setonix, but he can be quite rigid with a dry sense of humor. He tends to take things seriously but occasionally lets the façade slip and joins in to laugh or comments on particularly funny moments. He backs his opinions up with plenty of facts and will strongly disagree when others let their emotions or political beliefs stand in the way of the truth.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

Media Connections: Ripper is well-connected in a media network known for using anyone and everyone to achieve favorable ends. He's got lots of acquaintances, but few friends.

Odette: While not a rival per se, Odette doesn't think too highly of Ripper. At the very least, she prefers Baroness Victory to him. Why would that be?

Tucker: In a recent episode of *The Danger Zone* episode, "comedian" Tucker felt belittled, insulted, and undermined. He maintains, rather loudly, that Ripper failed to manage or curtail the flippant comments made by other guests, and as a result, his stock as a comedian and guest plummeted. He has begun insinuating that Ripper is irresponsible and his show will cause real harm to people soon.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

The set of *The Danger Zone* is a literal round table. Since the show is tunneled to the audience, they can adjust to view the panel as they see fit. Ripper's audience is more sophisticated than many other shows; viewers follow galactic news both inside and outside of the dungeon, and they generally pride themselves on being educated.

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SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- Now CRAWLER NAME, what do you think of the issue?
- I beg to differ and must set the record straight. It's clear that the faction's motive here is emotion/intention, based on reason/fact a, reason/fact b, and reason/fact c. Would you care to amend your statement?
- I can't help but follow up. Were you aware of CRAWLER NAME'S underhanded actions at this point?

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- Impressed with the PCs' performance on T*he Danger Zone*, another crawler, who is amassing popularity, asks the PCs for a minor favor following the show.
- Prior to the show, Ripper introduces himself to the PCs with a friendly chat and battle of wits, testing what the crawlers really know about the show's topic.
- Tensions from beyond the dungeon erupt: the crawlers are attacked in their trailer, or another guest is assassinated.
- Ripper's desire to raise his profile grows with each passing Floor, and crawlers with something to offer can convince him to enter their production trailer and enable their Inventories to exchange tangible items—something from the dungeon he can use on his show or contraband to pay crawlers for information.

REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: Ripper is erudite, sedate, and a media whore. If the crawlers impress him, he'll help get the PCs in touch with other shows that can leverage their Skills to boost their Popularity and drop any information he can, as long as he can hitch his star to theirs.

As an Enemy: Ripper attempts to publicly disgrace crawlers for perceived ignorance, slights, or other faults. He continues to speak ill of them in snide remarks on his shows whenever pertinent to the conversation at hand, but he won't go out of his way to denigrate a crawler otherwise. If crawlers are particularly cruel to him, he's not above sending them right back into harm's way.

RESULTS

Ripper doesn't provide tangible rewards, but simply being on his show exposes crawlers to potential sponsors and allies outside of the dungeon. If he's happy with the crawlers, his connections reach far, and he has no qualms about using them to aid savvy crawlers—especially if he benefits as well.

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INTERVIEW: THE MONTY WINTER JR. SHOW

Fans around the universe eagerly await each episode of *The Monty Winter Jr. Show*. Monty's show caters to lowbrow drama, revealing guests' tawdry secrets and conflicts among crawlers.

Monty himself is a non-Earth Human. His smile is as polished as can be, and he's almost never without a cigarette.

MONTY'S GOALS

Second Floor: Monty wants to find long-lasting drama and build a positive relationship with any crawlers who can supply it.

Third Floor: History has shown that the easiest source of drama on the Third Floor is asking crawlers about their Race—and possibly Class—selections. Monty hopes to exacerbate rivalries and fracture alliances by getting crawlers to criticize each other over superficialities.

Fourth Floor: Monty relishes how frustrated crawlers are getting over the confusing layout of the Floor. He may lord his access to maps of the Floor over the crawlers or feed them misinformation, proclaiming they don't deserve the truth. His audience loves it when he belittles any empathy a crawler shows toward Iron Tangle NPCs and their fictional lives.

Fifth Floor: Monty wants to deal serious damage to his favorites so people know even the rich and powerful can't stop him from having his way. He delves into Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets to exploit phobias that environments in the bubbles might trigger, such as claustrophobia, drowning, getting lost in the wilderness, and vertigo, to incapacitate crawlers at the worst possible time.

Long Term: Monty is interested in prestige and power beyond the extent that his audience can provide. He wants to drum up enough support and dirt on crawlers and Syndicate elites alike to become a kingmaker in Faction Wars on the Ninth Floor or the Celestial Ascendancy on the Twelfth Floor.

PERSONALITY

Monty is fueled by anger and nicotine. He can find something wrong with even the most benevolent action a crawler may take. He applies dodgy morality in the form of sophistry to make his points. No matter what the crawlers do, the audience remains on Monty's side.

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By the time he's done with the crawlers, they'll look like the scum of the now-dead Earth: venal, duplicitous, malicious, all-too-willing to maim and kill for the pleasure of views. If the crawlers try to turn this around on him, he asserts he's got to get in the trenches with scum like them to reveal the truth. Whenever he mentions truth, the audience goes wild.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

Helene Jbraska: The fashionable and popular host of *Hot in the Dungeon* is one of Monty's long-time allies; they share similar goals and enjoy some overlap in their audiences, and generally they get along well enough, if only at a distance.

The Skull Empire: Monty is famously persona non grata among the Orcs of the Skull Empire for revealing the true parentage of a handful of minor nobility.

Ripper Wonton: Monty sees highbrow elitist programs as worthless but is secretly jealous of the fame Ripper garners because of his program.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

Monty's set is typical of an audience-involved talk show. He plays to the crowd and respects those who can do the same. His audience, however, overflows with discerning lovers of schadenfreude across the galaxy, and his guests may need to double down or admit shocking secrets.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS AND QUOTES

- Isn't it true you killed NAME without even a thought for their family?
- Did you know CRAWLER is even now negotiating for a bounty on your head? I thought you were friends!
- It's morally vacuous humans like you who give the rest of us a bad name. You're the reason Earth got flattened.
- You and NAME were friends back on Earth. Did you know name slept with your partner?
- When you fucked up that play, isn't it true you were more worried about how it looked than your teammates' lives? Is that the kind of person you really are?

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- After the show concludes, Monty's mask drops, and he turns oddly friendly. He offers them show memorabilia (Misc. Junk) as a thank-you for being good sports, or he just leaves the crawlers alone if they reveal ill will toward him.
- Prior to the show starting, Monty, who is inexplicably rushed, enters the green room with another crawler in tow—someone the PCs had a supremely negative reaction with early on in the dungeon.
- The green room/production trailer has sprung a leak—an actual leak—and is now filling with seawater. Crawlers are instructed by their respective Communications Agents and the show's staff to pretend everything is fine because "the show must go on."
- A powerful enemy of Monty's has finally obtained some dirt that can tarnish his reputation, but the crawlers happen to have a connection with that foe. He appears in the green room before the show to see if he can make a deal.

REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: Monty gives tips on how the crawlers can create more drama in the dungeon, possibly dropping hints to other crawlers' Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets.

As an Enemy: Monty doesn't hold grudges unless the crawlers hold a grudge against him. He sees his aggressive approach as "just show business." But if crawlers cross him, he'll weaponize their Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets against them or send them back to a location that'll bring those up.

RESULTS

After the show, Monty rewards any crawlers who turned on each other. He watches for opportunities to bring them back and may even give some advice when the cameras stop rolling. Those who stuck to their guns, their loyalty, or any other virtue get diddly squat. Virtue doesn't sell. Sending them back to a dangerous situation might, however.

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INTERVIEW: DEATH WATCH EXTREME DUNGEON MAYHEM

Death Watch Extreme Dungeon Mayhem is hosted and produced by Prince Maestro of the Skull Empire. It's a roundtable discussion show that typically involves a few standard segments, including showing crawlers about to die and bringing adversaries together to elicit strong reactions, enhance conflict, and incite arguments.

Prince Maestro is an Orc with a penchant for golden jewelry and revealing but fashionable clothing.

PRINCE MAESTRO'S GOALS

- **Second Floor:** Prince Maestro wants to embarrass, belittle, and humiliate crawlers for ratings and to stroke his own ego.
- **Third Floor:** Hearing tunnel chatter that his father looks ill and his brother may soon become king, Prince Maestro wants to make clear he's strong and in contention for the throne. He looks for top crawlers he thinks he can intimidate or taunt into dueling him to the death, but like all bullies, he only picks easy targets; he's most aggressive toward crawlers whose strengths aren't physical (Bards, Mages, Rogues, and the like.)
- **Fourth Floor:** Obsessed with all slights against him, real or perceived, Prince Maestro homes in on crawlers who've offended him or weren't intimidated by him during previous Floors and makes everything about them, even when they aren't present. He constantly compares guests to them, showers gifts on anyone who agrees to try to kill them, and punishes anyone who won't.
- **Fifth Floor:** Prince Maestro's vendettas escalate as some of his targets repeatedly foil him. He becomes isolated from family members, frustrated that he won't focus on Faction Wars or the Skull Empire's interests, but their criticism damages his ego and drives him to greater extremes in search of validation.
- **Long-term:** Prince Maestro is hosting this show because of his own insatiable ego. He'll attempt to kill anyone who embarrasses him and step on anyone in his way to get more fame and fortune than he already has.

PERSONALITY

A bully through and through, Prince Maestro only cares about himself, his ego, and his fame. He's not likely to be sympathetic to any crawlers unless they can both flatter him and prove they're worth keeping around.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

Prince Stalwart: The older brother and Crown Prince of the Skull Empire, Prince Stalwart supports his little brother Maestro's show both financially and as a producer. He shares a common belief system with his little brother yet also harbors enough wariness to keep Maestro occupied, distracted, and away from the inner politics of the Skull Empire, thus securing his own position as the future king.

Princess Formidable: The sister of Prince Maestro and Crown Prince Stalwart, Princess Formidable finds her brothers to be glory-mongering, grandstanding idiots rather than capable successors to the crown. She opposes them at every possible turn and will even go so far as to aid crawlers if it improves her interests.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

Maestro's set is chaotic and extreme, with low-quality production trailers bobbing on the Earth's surface that may leave crawlers seasick. The audience is both cruel and sophomoric, and the show appeals to the lowest common denominator.

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SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- My little piglets wanna know how far you're willing to go to make it to the next Floor. If you could undermine one of your companions right now to find the stairs, who would you fuck over to save your own skin?
- How well did you know DECEASED CRAWLER? Did you enjoy their death?
- What would you have done to save DECEASED CRAWLER? Or would you just let them die like a coward?

RESULTS

Maestro has an uncommon right to return crawlers to the dungeon at a point of his choosing, though within reason. In addition to some unsolicited advice or parting insults, he may use this to send crawlers back to an unexpected location, though if they weren't in danger originally, they can't be sent back to a dangerous location. Occasionally, he will provide crawler guests with a parting gift, but this is a crapshoot; gifts may be great, or they may be impractical or unusable for crawlers.

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- The production trailer has facilities for washing up, but they're so low-quality that it makes the crawlers look worse and more pathetic than they did before.
- Production Assistants grill the crawlers about their Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets, trying desperately to get or confirm information to exploit due to the crawlers' last-minute booking.
- Prince Maestro condescendingly explains facets of the dungeon to the crawler(s) that impressed him the most, a rare charitable gesture that includes a few hints at upcoming dangers.
- A careless mistake allows crawlers to listen in on the producers while waiting to go onto the show.

REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: If the PCs make Prince Maestro look good, he'll throw his weight (and by extension, some of the weight of the Skull Empire) behind them. He can be manipulated into being a gregarious bully, but a bully nonetheless. But Maestro is fickle and turns on anyone who makes him look bad.

As an Enemy: Prince Maestro will go to almost any length to get revenge on someone who embarrasses him. If he can't hurt them outside the dungeon, he'll find a way to reach them on later Floors, even if it means spending an obscene amount of money to do it.

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INTERVIEW: HOT IN THE DUNGEON

Hot in the Dungeon relies on street interview-style interactions, where the streets are the World Dungeon, the takes are hot, and the audience is thirsty. Helene Jbarska is the show's Soother host—a former hunter and intergalactic supermodel who's made a career change to hosting her own show. She puts on an air of independence, but has more assistants and aides working behind the scenes than most shows.

HELENE'S GOALS

- **Second Floor:** Helene cares about her appearance and wants to connect to crawlers who have a good sense of style and those who will let her mold them into icons of style and sex appeal.
- **Third Floor:** Chasing a surge in popularity for snicks that "ship" various crawlers, especially in their new Race forms, Helene's segments focus on who's dating whom, illicit affairs, and star-crossed lovers meeting in the Third Floor's "romantic" ruins.
- **Fourth Floor:** Seedy public transportation doesn't evoke romance or fashion, but it sure is a great setting for sensational murders and other crimes! Helene ignores the Floor's political overtones to pursue storylines of crawler betrayal and revenge, though she'd still prefer they look good doing it. And if some of those storylines lead to violence in shops with certain NPCs, that's icing on the cake.
- **Fifth Floor:** Helene always gets antsy as the Crawl approaches her former hunting grounds (the Sixth Floor, literally), so while she pretends to be thrilled about the variety of environments the show can recreate for interviews (desert sunsets, ethereal shipwrecks, steampunk airships!) and the costuming potential for her favorite crawlers (beach chic, navy uniforms, tomb raiders!), she's really looking for any hook to convince the showrunners to let her enter the Sixth Floor, bring the show with her, and maybe kill some pesky former crawlers working in contestable settlements.
- **Long-term:** Helene wants petty revenge on over a dozen former-crawler NPCs who insulted her in the past or otherwise made her look bad.

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PERSONALITY

- Helene is a stone-cold mean girl and a bit of a girlboss. She can do it all—production, editing, voiceover, modeling, camerawork, and more—but her recent success means her assistants do most of the work for her. She'll take advantage of anyone or anything to get what she wants.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

Ripper Wonton: A prime media rival, the pudgy Setonix has rubbed Helene the wrong way in the past and taken her down a notch each time she's been on his show. Whereas he leans more toward substance and intellectual dialogue, Helene tends toward superficial, superfluous commentary on elements of the Crawl.

Magnificent Troy: Helene and Magnificent Troy are occasional drinking buddies. Helene usually stays sober enough, pushing more drinks on him so she can offer to take his place if he's summoned into the dungeon. She's thus far been turned down, largely because Magnificent Troy can hold his alcohol, well, magnificently.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

Hot in the Dungeon puts on a pretext of entering the dungeon, but regulations usually make that impossible for Helene. Instead, she interviews crawlers on a virtual stage that simulates aspects of the dungeon. These re-creations most often feature battle sites following the brutality of combat, but occasionally include interactions in personal spaces.

These artificially generated settings are almost always gussied up to make them appear more interesting, as are the crawlers themselves. While the show tunnels live, there is no visible studio audience for the interviewees. Viewers tend to be invested in fashion and the personal relationships among crawlers.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- Okay, NAME, can you tell me what you're wearing and who made it?
- In this last fight, you looked really good. But how did it feel in the moment?
- ALLY didn't help you out when you needed it, and now they're getting all the credit. Are you really going to let that fuckwad take all the glory?

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- A small army of Production Assistants descends upon the party before the interview, applying additional fake gore to "enhance" the crawlers for a re-creation of the aftermath of a fight.
- A Production Assistant drops a garment bag in front of the crawlers. It contains off-the-rack clothing for one or more crawlers, but it's been surreptitiously tailored for a great fit, and the material resists stains and tears.
- Helene lists four or five non-combatant NPCs in the dungeon to steer clear of while crawlers explore either the current Floor or the next Floor.

REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: Helene ensures the PCs look good and get an interview with her on each Floor. She influences fans to ensure that any loot or rewards they vote for are useful to the crawlers.

As an Enemy: Helene secretly adds offenders to her enemies list. Fan Boxes contain garish and gaudy items, and she'll talk behind their backs to other interviewers. She also tricks crawlers or disorients them, so they stumble into Boss fights unprepared on occasion. On later Floors, she may attempt to enter the dungeon herself to get revenge if it looks plausible.

RESULTS

Helene bends the rules as much as she can to give gifts to the crawlers she likes. She skirts monetary restrictions with tailoring and after-market improvements to cheaper gifts. Her advice, however, is largely focused on gaining and retaining popularity rather than strategically navigating the dungeon itself.

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DUNGEON NPCS

COMMUNICATIONS AND PUBLIC RELATIONS AGENTS

After the PCs begin gathering followers on the Second Floor, they may be assigned a Communications Agent who manages their appearances outside the dungeon. While these NPCs work on behalf of the PCs, they are employed by the corporation that runs the Crawl, and as such, they don't necessarily have the PCs' best interest at heart except as it aligns with their employer's. These agents manage the PCs' schedules and may interact with the PCs in a very formal or very informal manner, depending on the admin's personality.

Communications Agents are prohibited from providing the PCs with information that might give them a leg up during the Crawl, though they may provide the PCs with insights into how organizations outside the World Dungeon interact both with each other and with the System AI, such as Sponsors and the like. These agents may also provide the PCs with information about the shows they are booked on, the hosts of those shows, and other guests who might appear alongside the PCs.

COMMUNICATIONS AGENTS IN PLAY

The GM can use Communications Agents to give the PCs information about their Popularity and Sponsors, how the PCs can influence those numbers, and how the PCs might benefit from them. Although strictly prohibited, agents may also directly or indirectly provide PCs with information that might aid them in the Crawl.

Such disclosures are rare, as the agent will be harshly punished or even fired. Generally, PCs are prevented from harming agents, but in some circumstances, these protections can be circumvented. Such an interaction can only happen in a specific way once, as security failures get patched right away.

On the Second Floor, most crawlers in demand for interview shows, including the PCs, will be assigned a Communications Agent as their Public Relations Agent to manage and book appearances.

Following the advice of a Communications or Public Relations Agent can grant a crawler a point of AI Favor if they have none.

ZEV

Zev. Borant Corporation Assistant Communications Representative: Public Relations Agent.

This is a Dungeon Admin.

BACKGROUND

Zev works in the Borant Corporation Communications Department as a low-ranking PR Agent. When too many public appearance requests are received for a crawler, their party is entered into the Crawler Assisted Outreach Program, and an agent like Zev is assigned to them. As such, Zev acts as a liaison between Borant and privately produced shows that wish to interview and showcase crawlers.

Besides acting as a go-between to coordinate show appearances, Zev also tracks her clients' Popularity, conducts focus groups to collect viewers' opinions, and can sign official documents on their behalf. Zev is a Kua-Tin, an alien Race of small water-breathing humanoid fish that are the dominant species in the Borant System.

Unlike many others who work for the Borant Corporation, Zev is not a member of the Bloom, the Borant System's controlling political party. As such, she tends to struggle to advance her career and often shows more compassion for her clients than others of her kind.

Prior to the opening of the World Dungeon, Zev spent 15 years in Earth's orbit, watching

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nothing but Earth programs, and became particularly infatuated with *Gossip Girl* and *Riverdale*. She tried to write a *Gossip Girl* fanfic, but it didn't receive many hits. The nuances of compelling scripted drama are challenging for Kua-Tin.

ZEV IN GAMEPLAY

Zev is a Dungeon Administrator who may show up once the PCs have started to gain notoriety and views. The Borant Corporation is heavily reliant on advertising, licensing, and broadcast proceeds from *Dungeon Crawler World*, which it needs to stave off bankruptcy and a hostile takeover by the Valtay Corporation.

As such, the GM should have Zev constantly advising the PCs on how to improve their Popularity and ranking, as these factors help increase revenue for the Borant Corporation. As someone who isn't fond of the Kua-Tin's Bloom Party, Zev can readily identify with the plight of the crawlers. As such, Zev may, from time to time, slip the PCs crucial pieces of information when their lives are on the line.

Mechanically, this enables the PCs to gain AI Favor if they have none when following Zev's advice.

MUKTA

Mukta. Borant Corporation Senior Communications Representative: Public Relations Agent.

This is a Dungeon Admin.

BACKGROUND

Mukta is a male Kua-Tin and an acolyte of the Bloom, the dominant Kua-Tin political party. The Bloom actively cooperates with the Borant Corporation in running *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*. Loyalty to one often means enforced loyalty to both.

Mukta is a no-nonsense communications specialist who often covers for others who are too busy or unable to complete their duties due to poor performance or reeducation training. He's focused on the bottom line, but canny crawlers may be able to turn his greed and conservative beliefs to their advantage.

He's also an expert with contracts and a bit of a rules lawyer (though not a lawyer in the legal sense). If a client leaves holes in a contract that crawlers can exploit, it's not Mukta's fault they didn't understand what they signed. And like other Borant representatives who work with crawlers, he has authority to sign on his crawlers' behalf.

As a Kua-Tin, Mukta dresses conservatively and prominently displays a Bloom pin on his clothing so everyone knows he's party-affiliated. He trusts Borant's protections and has no qualms about appearing in-person in the dungeon or in a production trailer, unless he's too busy to bother. The only other exception would be if he finds proof that he might be in danger.

Mukta comes across as ruthless at first. His interests are the Borant Corporation's interests, regardless of whatever displeasure a crawler may express. He may warm to crawlers eventually, but he's certain he knows better than they do, and he'll do his best to further a crawler's career as long as they keep bringing in money.

Before the collapse, Mukta worked the Bloom and corporate bureaucracy like a pro. He does harbor other interests, however, and is likely to be fascinated with one Earth hobby familiar to the crawlers. Of course, the Kua-Tin version is superior in just about every way, and he'll doubtless remind any PCs of that fact.

Mukta doesn't trust assistants with important things. He'll personally deal with scheduling and negotiations for important crawlers, though he's not likely to take much input from said crawlers unless one of them proves especially competent or if they bond over an obscure hobby.

MUKTA IN PLAY

Even if Mukta isn't the PCs' primary Communications Agent, they may be forced to deal with him once or twice before they gain a reputation. In the event he becomes their permanent Communications Agent, his no-nonsense approach may inspire rebellion against his brusque demeanor and seemingly heartless focus on the bottom line.

His focus and dedication could push crawlers to new heights of fame and fortune (for Borant), or crawlers under his charge might find a way to exploit his overconfidence and get a new agent that they like better.

VARLEY

Varley. Borant Associate Communications Representative: Public Relations Agent.

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BACKGROUND

Varley is absolutely in over his head. He's used to slacking and doing the bare minimum to set up crawler appearances on various shows, but after his supervisor, Mooz, was somehow killed in the dungeon, Varley received an unearned and unwarranted promotion. Surprise!

In light of his old supervisor's untimely demise, Varley is paranoid and terrified of the dungeon itself, and he may break the rules by appearing as a projection from cheap equipment he bought himself rather than in person. He goes out of his way to learn anything about dangers that he and his fellow admins might face in the dungeon.

He's not a Bloom party member, and despite his promotion, he somehow remains optimistic enough that if he keeps his head down, he'll be overlooked and can look for a new job once the season is over. He's friendly with the crawlers he's working with, but he's often frazzled and complains about being overworked. He'll use the crawlers as a sounding board to spitball interview show ideas and for advice on dealing with his teenage son, Dayv, whom his elderly father-in-law, Larf, loves to spoil with lavish gifts.

Still, Varley somehow always comes through with quality shows for any crawlers he's working with. He often books crawlers for the first compatible show, then books them in incrementally better shows, waiting until the last minute if he can find something he views as an infinitesimally better opportunity than the last booking. This has a tendency to piss off both show producers and the crawlers he's working with, as neither side develops a lot of trust or respect for Varley's hollow promises and assurances.

Varley has worked in Borant's communications department for years, but he also has a host of connections with other corporations, particularly with fellow lower-level peers. He's shaken a lot of show host hands but generally deals with their producers and assistants. He used to like his job, but since his promotion, he's hoping to get a new position that's less stressful, probably with a different corporation. And if it pays better, that's a bonus.

VARLEY IN PLAY

Varley is overwhelmed with work and home life and just wants a few good days off so he can get some sleep. He won't break the rules for the crawlers—at least not early on. If they can offer a comforting ear for his work and family problems, he may be easily swayed to their side, though initially he has very little power to help them directly. Over time, he may become a powerful advocate for any crawlers he oversees, as long as they don't add to his stress.

LAWYERS

Anytime money is being made, whether on Earth, in the World Dungeon, or anywhere else in the known universe, there are always lawyers lurking in the vicinity to take their cut. And boy, do lawyers *love* exploiting loopholes with the Syndicate.

Although crawlers don't have the same rights as Syndicate citizens, they may be appointed a lawyer when circumstances necessitate engagement with corporate or Syndicate entities. Virtually no crawlers understand the galactic laws and customs to which they are bound, so crawlers may request legal counsel be appointed to them.

This most often occurs when a crawler is considering an exit deal or some other agreement that involves entities outside of the dungeon. Lawyers are assigned to specific crawlers individually and cannot represent multiple crawlers, even if they're in the same party.

LAWYERS IN PLAY

Lawyers' impact centers more around roleplaying than anything mechanical. The GM can bring in a lawyer when the PC requests one for a negotiation or even do so proactively just to spice things up. Lawyers have knowledge of things outside the dungeon, which the GM might want to share with the PCs when appropriate.

If a crawler seeks advice from a Laywer for a particular situation, they receive one AI Favor if they have none—as long as the PCs actually follow the advice.

QUASAR

> Quasar. Attorney at Law.
>
> This is a Dungeon Advocate.

BACKGROUND

Quasar is a foul-mouthed Syndicate-appointed lawyer who offers blunt advice to crawlers in negotiation with the Syndicate, Borant, and/or other corporations. Quasar is a Nullian, a gray alien about four and a half feet tall that resembles a stereotypical Area 51 alien. He has gray skin, large eyes, and a bulbous head. He typically wears a tan suit with a tie styled with an image of a Nullian hula girl who gyrates back and

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forth. He is virtually never seen without his vape and an accompanying enormous pixelated cloud of vapor.

Unlike other Syndicate-appointed lawyers, Quasar doesn't merely rubber-stamp deals but will instead actively fight on behalf of the crawler, in part because he loves screwing over the Syndicate and large corporations. He's very knowledgeable about Syndicate law, especially as it pertains to the World Dungeon, and does an excellent job finding loopholes and manipulating it on behalf of his client.

He has studied virtually all past dungeon-related deals and can easily incorporate best practices in the work he does for his clients. When opposing counsel decides to play games, Quasar is known to repeatedly file multiple grievances that can't be easily dismissed. This drags out court proceedings so much that many other lawyers actively avoid his cases to avoid being tied up for dozens of cycles.

Quasar's zealous work on behalf of his clients and his aggressive behavior while he engages in harassing Syndicate officials with every legal ploy available to him has made more than a few enemies over the years, even to the extent of risking disbarment. Still, because he is willing to take on cases that many others refuse, it's unlikely his license to practice law will actually be revoked.

QUASAR IN GAMEPLAY

When the PCs are interested in making a deal (or are forced into one by an exploit they've discovered), the GM should inform them that the Syndicate can appoint a lawyer to represent them during the negotiation.

ROLDEEN

Roldeen, Esquire. Interstellar Barrister.

This is a Dungeon Advocate.

BACKGROUND

Roldeen is a meticulous Syndicate-appointed lawyer who is fastidious in every aspect of his work, consistently providing well-prepared, well-researched counsel to his clients. Roldeen is a Saccathian, often referred to as a "Sac," which is a common Race outside the dungeon. They are Human-sized, with bumpy gray skin and webbed claws, and they have squid-like tentacles dangling from their cephalopod-like faces. They make a trumpeting sound when amused.

Roldeen is well-versed in all aspects of Syndicate legal matters but specializes in contract law. He can see and appreciate strategic aspects of legal negotiations from all sides, and can readily draft, review, and negotiate agreements that protect his clients' interests.

Roldeen has strong analytical and communication skills, enabling him to identify risks, interpret complex issues, and resolve disputes effectively. His attention to detail and the ironclad quality of his contracts mean he can charge absurdly high rates and not diminish demand for his services whatsoever.

As a tribute to his late sister, who frequently worked with crawlers, Roldeen still carves out time in his busy schedule to represent crawlers when called upon by Syndicate. Roldeen is often brought in when crawlers are negotiating exit deals or for compensation after discovering an exploit that the showrunners and/or the Syndicate would prefer not be made public. He derives great joy from exacting huge settlements on behalf of his clients.

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ROLDEEN IN GAMEPLAY

Roldeen is the best lawyer that even money can't buy. If the PCs request a lawyer and the situation they face is complex and/or could result in significant harm to the corporation producing the Crawl, Roldeen will bend over backward to make himself available to represent the crawler.

The GM should note how concerned the opposing counsel appears when Roldeen arrives or tunnels in as the Syndicate-appointed lawyer. In return for his representation, Roldeen requests 20% of the proceeds from any agreements made.

LIAISONS

Another type of dungeon administrator that PCs may encounter is a Syndicate liaison. Rules for the dungeon are codified in Syndicate law and enforced by the System AI in order to make things "fair" for crawlers. But when a loophole in these rules proves severe enough to cause financial harm to the corporation producing the Crawl, to Sponsors, or to any other major party outside of the dungeon, Syndicate liaisons can make an appearance.

Liaisons serve as investigative arbitrators. When the PCs use an exploit or interfere with the Crawl in a way that warrants deeper scrutiny, Syndicate liaisons must investigate the nature and cause of the exploit and determine whether there was, in fact, a rules violation.

If a violation is deemed to have occurred, the liaison ensures the responsible party is punished. If no violation occurs and the exploit is too large to allow, the liaison may negotiate to rebalance the playing field. The liaison's role comes into play especially when the System AI and the corporation running the Crawl cannot agree on a given situation.

LIAISONS IN PLAY

If the PCs discover an exploit, whether through the rules, items, Spells, or something else that threatens the procedural flow of the dungeon, the powerful and Borant-connected characters can summon a liaison to investigate. This can happen just *before* the PCs attempt their exploit or *after* they have used the exploit, but not typically *during*.

The nature of exploits is such that crawlers might try to use them again, which can serve as a powerful motivator for a liaison to intervene. But rather than leave the PCs empty handed, the GM can allow crawlers, their lawyers, and liaisons to negotiate for compensation before the exploit is patched and no longer works.

ORREN

Orren. Syndicate Liaison.

This is a Syndicate Advocate.

BACKGROUND

The Syndicate comprises over three billion independent star systems and quintillions of citizens of various Races. The Syndicate sets the rules for each season of *Dungeon Crawler World*, and when things don't quite work out as planned, sometimes someone needs to step in to ensure the Syndicate's interests are being protected. This is where Syndicate Liaisons like Orren come in.

As a Syndicate Liaison, Orren serves as a fact-finder and independent investigator. He collects information from all perspectives, synthesizes it, analyzes it, and then renders an opinion on what happened and why. After doing so, Orren is empowered by the Syndicate to take action to correct the situation, which often includes negotiating with all parties involved.

Orren is a Gondii, a parasitic worm that is a citizen of the Valtay Corporation. As a liaison, he is required to be independent despite his Race, which Orren takes very seriously. As an aquatic parasite, Orren's actual body lives in a glass bowl filled with water (or "fishbowl head") atop a mechanical humanoid body. He has a hood, giving him an odd Grim Reaper-like appearance.

When Orren investigates a situation, he usually constructs an overly elaborate narrative of what happened to better understand the situation, the crawlers, and their motives. In some situations, Orren is also responsible for negotiating with the System AI if it ever takes control of the show—also known as "going Primal."

GAMEPLAY

Orren has an office in the back of the Desperado Club. When the PCs discover an exploit and are about to or have already used it, the GM can have them summoned either to Orren's office in an off-planet location or in the back of the Desperado Club. Orren will ask the PCs to explain what's happening, and if the PCs admit to breaking the rules, Orren will ensure Syndicate justice is served harshly and swiftly, often meaning the acceleration of one or more party members.

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If the PCs are smart enough to avoid this trap, Orren will bargain with them in good faith, perhaps offering a desired boon in return for information about the exploit so the problem can be solved quickly and privately. This boon typically takes the form of loot, Spells, or services that go beyond what is typically found in a legendary box or a Platinum or higher Benefactor Box.

CHAMPION STRIKE

Champion Strike. Syndicate Liaison.

This is a Syndicate Advocate.

BACKGROUND

While some Syndicate liaisons are good at identifying the root causes of problems, others are better at doling out punishment to those who caused them in the first place. The Syndicate is a massive place with many interests to protect. When major crises occur, there is no time for subtlety, and sometimes the right tool to strike at the core of a problem is a jackhammer. That jackhammer is Champion Strike.

Originally from the Skull Empire, Champion cut her teeth in the Faction Wars, where she was on the winning side for six of the last ten contests. Facing limited opportunities for advancement in the Empire, Champion set her sights on rising within the Syndicate instead, abandoning her allegiance to the Empire to become a Syndicate Liaison.

As a relatively new liaison, Champion is still developing her investigative skills and learning how to de-escalate explosive situations better. Given her propensity to force compliance from anyone and everyone she encounters, she is often asked to assist more experienced, and thus more nuanced liaisons when it becomes evident that corrective action will be necessary.

In these instances, Champion not only uses her amazing power and influence as a liaison, but occasionally unleashes all of her considerable might to mete out swift punishment on behalf of the Syndicate. Tall and muscular, Champion still prefers to use the shock and awe of wartime tactics and intimidation, which she emphasizes in part by wearing traditional orcish armor into meetings.

CHAMPION STRIKE IN GAMEPLAY

When the PCs find an exploit and don't bother to hide its use, Champion is often brought in. Any investigation into the situation may be cursory at best, and Champion will swiftly pass judgment and carry out the punishment even quicker.

GMs can bring in Champion when the PCs are becoming somewhat callous in how they deal with Syndicate rules and representatives to demonstrate that even in the depths of the World Dungeon, some semblance of the rule of law still exists. If PCs make statements about wanting to physically confront Champion, she's willing and able to exploit her own loopholes to make that happen, and just honorable enough to do it in such a way that the PCs have a fighting chance. Barely. Of course, the system's protections should prevent any permanent damage. To her, at least.

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MANAGERS

Upon reaching the Third Floor, crawlers must choose a Race and Class, generally with the assistance of their Game Guide. If a crawler selects a Class with the Manager Benefit, the crawler's Game Guide becomes their manager.

The Manager Benefit attached to certain Classes provides the PC with an awesome tool for surviving in the dungeon. While Game Guides have access to the Dungeon Codex, managers do not. What managers gain, though, is the ability to use the dungeon's chat feature to communicate with their crawler's party, as well as loosened restrictions on the aid they're allowed to provide to crawlers.

With an experienced and knowledgeable manager, this attribute is perhaps the greatest boon of the Manager Benefit. Many managers were former crawlers and have since worked in the dungeon for hundreds of cycles. They can share their knowledge and experience with their crawlers, providing an invaluable resource as the crawlers descend deeper into the dungeon.

Managers are not allowed to fight on behalf of crawlers, nor are they official members of the party. They do have access to the party chat and can make use of party resources (like crafting tables) in safe areas and personal spaces, as well as interact with other NPCs on the PCs' behalf. Managers are least restricted on the Scolopendra Lair levels (every third floor), where they can generally use the resources of any settlement outside the client's current saferoom.

Until a crawler purchases a personal space, every time the crawler enters a saferoom, the manager instantly teleports to the crawler's location and cannot leave the saferoom until the crawler leaves. Regardless of where they teleported from, they exit the saferoom to their crawler's location.

After a crawler purchases a personal space, the manager loses access to their own personal space and essentially lives in the crawler's common area, unless the space is upgraded to a Level 5 space that allows a manager to attach their personal space to the common area.

Beginning on the Fourth Floor, Managers receive the same protections as the tourists on the Ninth Floor. If a manager is killed in the dungeon, they are out of the game. Managers are paid more than regular Guildmasters, and their earnings increase every time their crawler descends to the next Floor, which is meant to incentivize them to stay in the game as long as possible.

When their client's health reaches 20%, managers receive a warning notification.

MANAGERS IN PLAY

Similar to Game Guides, managers can provide their clients with extensive information on crawls, Mobs, Bosses, items, Skills, and more. Generally, managers have ample experience as crawlers themselves, as well as a wealth of information they've acquired since they exited the Crawl and began working for the Syndicate. In addition to this more generalized information, often managers may also have specialized expertise in certain areas, such as potions, magic items, Mobs, or a specific Skill.

Unlike Game Guides, managers can convey their knowledge via chat: characters don't need to be in the manager's presence to request advice or information. If a PC spends an Action to request advice from their manager via chat, they receive 1 AI Favor if they have none.

In addition to providing advice, managers may also use their Skills on behalf of their client to make items for them, such as potions, scrolls, or other consumables. PCs must provide their manager with all the necessary items required for crafting the item(s). A manager may craft 1d4 consumables of a bonus level less than or equal to their crafting Rank each day as long as they can work undisturbed. If a PC contacts a manager for advice while they are crafting, the number of consumables crafted is reduced by 50%.

ANNOUNCERS

Dungeon Crawler World: Earth has a couple main hosts: Kevin and Magnificent Troy. Plus anyone else you want to make up. Crawlers aren't likely to interact with announcers and commentators, but it's not unheard-of to have others fill in for someone else in a pinch.

Another similar role is Cascadia. Though technically a Dungeon Admin, most crawlers will recognize her as the voice of the daily announcements.

ANNOUNCERS IN PLAY

At the table, using announcers is possibly a bit unnecessary, but they can add color and other voices to City, Province, Country, or Floor Boss Battles and other high-stakes scenarios. As the number of crawlers is reduced over the days and

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Floors of the dungeon, the chances of having live commentary increase.

Kevin: This gravely voiced, lizard-like alien is known for his fast-paced commentary.

Magnificent Troy: A sportscaster in his regular job, Magnificent Troy enjoys knocking a few drinks back, and sometimes that's apparent this season.

Cascadia: This sweet-voiced Kua-Tin dungeon engineer who is also the executive producer this season. She's known for hitting a tone that is at once upbeat and condescending. This is basically her life's work, and if things start going wrong, she's liable to take it personally. Very personally.

BOPCAS

Bopcas run saferooms. They keep them stocked, prepare food for crawlers, and otherwise ensure they're running well. On later Floors, they perform additional tasks in saferooms. Like many other NPCs, they qualify as non-combatant NPCs.

BOPCA PROTECTORS IN PLAY

Bopcas serve as both NPCs for crawlers to order around (if PCs are mean), or be kind to (for kind-hearted PCs), or just ignore outright (for those trenchcoat-katana types). They're great sources of information and can often give crawlers directions to major landmarks nearby. Use Table 62 to help name them.

They'll try to fulfill any crawler's wishes to the best of their ability (though they may do so with a lot of grumbling if the crawler's Charisma is too low). They can't do it all, but they can attempt to whip up comfort food from a crawler's childhood or provide towels to help crawlers clean up blood and gore from their battles in the dungeon.

TABLE 62: BOPCA NAMES

ROLL OR CHOOSE	NAME
1	Gordo (Masculine)
2	Hirut (Feminine)
3	Leilani (Feminine)
4	Nadia (Feminine)
5	Nora (Feminine)
6	Pahzi (Masculine)
7	Sebastian (Masculine)
8	Tally (Masculine)
9	Qwist (Masculine)
10	Vitasy (Feminine)

RIVAL CRAWLERS AND OTHER NPCS

Most Mobs don't have much personality, and that's no fun in a roleplaying game. Of the few that do, many of them are remnants of a bad idea that was just good enough for the Tutorial Floors. Maybe they just slipped through the cracks. It doesn't really matter. These NPCs have personality for some reason.

Sometimes the GM gets to portray crawlers, too. These GMCs, or Game Master Crawlers, tend to be rivals or allies more than adversaries, but things can get real rough in the World Dungeon. These rivals are usually centered on role-playing, not roll-playing, so their Stats probably don't matter as much as a basic Mob's. Plus, if a PC kills one, they get a player-killer skull (see *Killing a Crawler*, p. 87), which is not usually a badge of honor. Remind the players of this fact: their Game Guide probably explained it even if the players have forgotten or missed it.

Even though they're not elements of the dungeon like traps or other obstacles, the quick and dirty way to run rival crawlers and weird NPCs, particularly on the Tutorial Floors, is to consider any PC Action related to them to be Unopposed. Just use a Difficulty of 16 for the Third Floor, 18 for the Fourth Floor, or 20 for the Fifth Floor. If the rival crawler or unusual NPC is acting within an area of expertise or in line with their best Skills or Stats, just increase the Difficulty by about 5. If the PCs are exploiting a weakness, decrease the Difficulty by 5.

Full statistics for sample rival crawlers can be found throughout Chapters 7, 8, and 9. Use or adapt them as needed.

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DEITIES

Have the players stopped reading? Great. Now we can talk about the bad stuff. Gods aren't really gods. And they can do bad stuff to crawlers, whether they're controlled by the System AI, sponsored by someone outside the dungeon, or... something weirder. Okay, there's good stuff too sometimes.

Most god-level interactions fall under three categories: Boons, Penitence and Shunning, and Smites.

BOONS

Gods may reward especially fervent followers with a Boon. Table 63 shows some of the Boons a god might grant to their followers. The GM can roll a selection or simply choose from the table, and adjust the duration until a Quest is completed.

PENITENCE AND SHUNNING

Crawlers who stray from the commands of their god may be required to pay penance or face being Shunned until they properly atone.

Penitence: For a first offense, the required tithe doubles as penance, and they are subject to the Shunned effect. For a second, the crawler's required tithe quadruples, and they are subject to a second Shunned effect. A third offense generally results in being Smote.

Shunned: Until the penance is paid, the crawler loses all benefits associated with worshiping the god. In addition, they are subject to one of the following temporary effects in Table 64.

SMITES

Those who forsake their deity, desecrate a deity's temple, or directly disobey the commands of their deity are subject to being Smote. How the god chooses to Smite the offender can take several different forms. Before a smite, a deity may make their displeasure known in a less lethal manner (Table 64). For a proper smiting, Tables 65, 66, and 67 gives some ideas. In the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** series, Smites are a death sentence. NPCs who receive a smite should almost always die a terrible, gruesome death (Table 65). For player characters, Smites could also be instant death, but that's not always fun at the table if the player isn't purposely sacrificing their character. Good preparation, quick thinking, or possibly a Memory Stone might allow a PC to survive a Smite. Table 66 provides some suggestions.

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TABLE 63: BOONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	BOON	EFFECT
1	Signature Skill	An immediate Rank-Up Check for a god's signature Skill (once per Skill per Floor).
2	Stat Bonus	Advantage on all Stat or Skill Checks for one stat for 30 hours (GM will choose or roll 1d8: 1—Strength, 2—Constitution, 3—Dexterity, 4—Intelligence, 5—Charisma, 6–8—Deity's Favored Stat randomly).
3	Signature Buff or Debuff	Receive the deity's signature Buff for 30 hours, or all enemies encountered in the next 30 hours gain the deity's signature Debuff.
4	Weapon Bonus	Gain Advantage for one Attack or Spell Skill for 30 hours.
5	Weapon Damage	Double the Stat Mod applied on Attack or Spell Skill damage for 30 hours.
6	Signature Skill	Gain access to one of the deity's signature Skills for 30 hours at Rank 5.
7	Evade Bonus	Gain Advantage on Evade Checks for 30 hours.
8	Forgiven	Return to the good graces of your god. You are no longer required to pay penance, nor are you Shunned or smote for any past offenses.

TABLE 64: DIVINE DEBUFFS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	NAME	EFFECT
1	Stat	The highest Stat is halved.
2	Skill	The highest-ranked Skill is halved.
3	Movement	Movement speed is halved.
4	Actions	The number of Actions the crawler can take in combat is reduced to 1 every other round.
5	Resistance	A single Immunity or Resistance is removed (determined by the GM).
6	Cooldown	All cooldown time doubles.
7	Debuffs	The duration of all Debuffs doubles.
8	Muted	Gain the muted Debuff.

TABLE 65: LETHAL SMITES FOR NPCS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	TYPE	EFFECT
1	Signature Smite	See Table 67.
2	Banished	The offender is teleported away to a distant portion of the dungeon and never returns.
3	Wiped	The deity irrevocably removes all cognitive functions of the offender.
4	Stilled	The deity horrifically and permanently removes all muscle control from the offender.

"If you see a god or if you find a temple or if you find a scroll of prayer, you're given the option to worship a god. Once you do it, there's a pawful of benefits but also a bunch of rules you gotta follow."

—Sinjin

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TABLE 66: NON-LETHAL SMITES FOR PCS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	TYPE	EFFECT
1	Signature Smite	See Table 67.
2	Servant	A powerful servant of the god (typically equivalent to a City Boss or stronger) appears nearby and fights the offender to the death.
3	Watched	The god appears, glares at the offender, and leaves after making an ominous statement such as "I'm watching you." The crawler gains the Omniscient Gaze Debuff until the end of the next Floor. The god can see everything the crawler does and enter the realm at any time. The god will then make good on the threat and cause numerous problems across this Floor and the next.
4	Others	The deity kills, maims, or otherwise punishes the allies and loved ones of the offender. Few additional crawlers will trust them. Each god has their own typical way of smiting. You can use the signature smite for the first smite of the campaign or let the dice tell you what to do. Table 67 gives these god-specific smites.

TABLE 67: SIGNATURE SMITES

GOD	SIGNATURE SMITE
Apito	The Offender is banished to the Nothing (for NPCs) or nearly so (for PCs). PCs gain the Nearly Obliterated Debuff for the rest of the floor: they have only one HB slot and cannot regain any until the next floor.
Eileithyia	NPC offenders are embraced and drift off to an endless sleep. PC offenders wake up but lose at least one day of time on the floor, two if the floor has more than 4 days remaining.
Emberus	All fire resistance or immunity is completely removed, and NPC offenders are incinerated with Sheol fire. PC offenders need to survive d12+F damage for ten rounds instead.
Eris	Offender is given a five-sided coin to flip, with all outcomes deadly or nearly so for the offender and their companions.
Grull	A mighty axe blow decapitating the offending NPC follower or removing a limb or two from a PC.
Hellik	NPC offenders crumble to a pile of dirt, which then spouts a seedling. PC offenders sprout 1d2 seedlings per day for the remainder of the Floor, and each seedling sprouted fills one HB slot which cannot be healed until the next Floor.
Nekhebit	The offender has their eyes pecked out and then is swarmed by a mass of vultures. This is fatal to NPCs, but PCs are left with an incurable Blinded condition until the Floor ends.
Ogun	Ogun places a white-hot hand upon the head of the NPC offender until their skin is seared to the bone. PCs must pass a Con-check each round for 5 rounds. Each near miss deals 1 HB damage, 2 on a miss, 3 on a major failure, or 4 on a critical failure. These cannot be healed while the god's hand touches the crawler.
Taranis	Offender is struck by a lightning bolt from the heavens. This kills an NPC offender, but a PC offender must attempt a Dex-check against a difficulty of 31 to avoid taking a number of d12s of damage equal to the current floor.

"There's a 50% chance you'll get 'smited.' I don't know what that means, but it ain't gonna be good."

—The System AI

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BARD PATRONAGE

Before the option of buying monthly subscriptions to your favorite content creators was available, nobles patronized artists to help them be more entertaining and less starving. Bard Classes include the option to acquire a patron, which comes with benefits and obligations. Bards who specialize in one type of performance must have a patron, gaining more power in exchange for stricter limits on how they use their abilities. Hybrid Classes can't have a patron unless they're predominantly Bard-themed.

ACQUIRING A PATRON

Potential patrons must meet the following criteria:

- Be present for most of the Crawl
- Have at least one performance-related Skill relevant to your Class at Rank 10 and higher rank than you
- Know at least one Combat Skill or Spell in which you're untrained
- Possess access to Club Vanquisher, Desperado Club, a guild with outreach centers, or a Crawler-Assisted Outreach Program PR Agent

Former crawlers turned NPCs are the most common patrons—guildmasters, settlement officials, shopkeepers, or workers in Club Vanquisher or the Desperado Club. Outworlders can't be patrons unless they're participating in Faction Wars or sponsoring a deity in the Celestial Ascendancy. Deities typically only become patrons to their worshipers. NPCs who would otherwise be left behind after a level collapses are shifted to new jobs or relocated to Club Vanquisher or the Desperado Club.

If your Class *requires* a patron, you choose one during Class selection from a curated list: two or three that the GM thinks will be interesting. If one is a deity, don't have to worship them.

Otherwise, you audition for a patron. Like a marriage proposal, you shouldn't ask unless the outcome is a foregone conclusion, but viewers like drama, so you're gonna have to do the whole song and dance.

The prospective patron starts with an attitude based on the interactions that led to the audition. From most negative to positive, the attitudes are Opposed, Reluctant, Willing, or Enthusiastic. Patrons don't start Opposed unless forced into an audition through violence or deception, and they rarely start Enthusiastic. They agree to the patronage if their attitude isn't Opposed at the end of the audition.

Make three Skill Checks using different Skills that might impress the prospective Patron and consult Table 68 after each Check for the result. An outcome can't drop attitude below Opposed or raise it above Enthusiastic, and it doesn't trigger a Humiliating or Beneficial Outcome unless the attitude is already Opposed or Enthusiastic, respectively.

TABLE 68: AUDITION OUTCOMES

CHECK RESULT	OUTCOME
Critical Fail or Major Fail	Reduce attitude by two levels
Standard Fail	Reduce attitude by one level
Near Miss Fail	Reduce attitude by one level if current attitude is Reluctant or Willing, otherwise no change
Standard Success	Increase attitude by one level
Amazing Success or Critical Hit	Increase attitude by two levels

If the prospective patron's attitude is Opposed and a Check reduces their attitude, they storm away. You suffer one humiliation from Table 69.

TABLE 69: HUMILIATING OUTCOMES

ROLL OR CHOOSE	HUMILIATION
1	−1 Popularity as the moment goes viral
2	The prospective patron makes a scathing comment that other crawlers jokingly repeat, causing it to become a catchphrase associated with you
3	Future Failures on the Skill Check that ended the audition have a chance of the AI playing a sad "wa wa waaaa" sound effect, which becomes more frequent if it evokes a reaction from you
4	Gold "They Said No" Box that contains a joke item

If the patron's attitude is Enthusiastic and a Check results in an increase in attitude, you gain one benefit from Table 70. This bonus can occur multiple times during an amazing audition.

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TABLE 70: BENEFICIAL OUTCOMES

ROLL OR CHOOSE	BENEFIT
1	For the rest of the audition, a Near Miss or Standard Fail doesn't reduce attitude level, and a Critical or Major Fail only reduces attitude level by one
2	Silver or Gold Apparel Box based on the GM's holistic assessment of the audition
3	+1 Popularity from impressed viewers sharing the moment
4	You can use the triggering Skill with Advantage for your next Good First Impression Check against an NPC or Mob who may have heard about your audition
5	Your performance attracts a crowd to cheer you on, boosting your confidence and granting you a +1 bonus to Charisma-based Stat Checks for the rest of the day
6	Invitation to perform with your patron on a show

CHANGING PATRONS

Once you have a patron, you can only change patrons under the following circumstances:

- Your patron quits, paying the showrunners a 50% termination fee based on the earnings they received from you. They have the option to transfer your patronage, but your new patron must meet the criteria to become one at the time of the transfer.
- Your patron dies. Oops. If you weren't responsible for your patron's death, the killer becomes your new patron even if they don't otherwise meet the criteria to be one. If you're the murderer (naughty!), you're banned from having another patron for the rest of the floor and future prospectives start Opposed.

Deities are more tolerant of offenses by Bards than by their worshipers but may end your patronage for egregious behavior like defiling their temple or worshiping an enemy god.

PATRONAGE BENEFITS

A Bard with a patron gains the following benefits:

- **Advice:** You can chat with your patron through your HUD if they're a crawler, former crawler, or outworlder. Otherwise, you gain a Bijou Fairy cote in your personal space. Fairies take 5 minutes to travel to a patron on the same Floor and an equal amount of time to return, or an extra 5 minutes for each additional Floor the Fairy must travel.
- **Income Opportunities:** Your patron can book performances for you at venues where they have a connection. Perform for 1 hour and make an appropriate Skill Check. On a Success, you earn gold equal to your Skill Rank × (10 + Floor + modifiers determined by the GM based on audience size, your fame, and your patron's influence). Your earnings double on an Amazing Success, triple on a Critical Success, and halve for a Failure. The venue pays 20% of your earnings to your patron and the rest to you.
- **Mentorship:** You become trained in a Skill your patron is trained in by spending 1 hour practicing with them. When you grind such Skills alongside your patron or using their Advice, make your Skill Advancement Check with Advantage.

PATRONAGE OBLIGATIONS

Patrons can give you one Quest at a time. Quests must be relevant to the patronage and are managed by the AI like other Quest. The patron usually pays for the reward with the value commensurate with the difficulty. NPCs and former crawlers receive a stipend specifically for this purpose, but former crawlers can also offer non-unique items they obtained during their Crawl, subject to the showrunner's and AI's discretion. Table 71 provides some inspiration.

Patrons might also ask for unofficial favors that you may ignore at your own risk, which usually provide some benefit if fulfilled. See Table 72 for ideas.

EXAMPLE PATRONS

Patrons specialize in certain Performance Skills, whether that's singing, interpretive dance, or comedic roasts. The following patrons offer a variety of specialties, benefits, and obligations that you can use directly or as inspiration to create your own.

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TABLE 71: PATRON QUESTS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	QUEST	POSSIBLE REWARD
1	Help another crawler complete a Quest	Patron-sponsored loot box plus the Quest rewards if your presence turns it into a Group Quest
2	Perform a difficult magic ritual for an NPC or deity	Spellbook and possible friend designation by NPC type or church
3	Rescue a Bard or recover a Bard artifact	Upgrade to a Bard Skill or item
4	Join or recruit for a Bard Guild in which the patron is a senior member	Improved standing in the guild and access to better Guild Quests
5	Assassinate a priority target	Platinum-level (or higher) loot box or equivalent value
6	Stage a performance to advance a floor storyline	Coupon for related service or upgrade

TABLE 72: PATRON FAVORS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	FAVOR	POSSIBLE REWARD
1	Help the patron complete a task related to their work that is too dangerous or difficult for them to accomplish	Gold or benefits where the patron works
2	Perform a task while outside the dungeon that helps the patron and isn't against dungeon rules	Attention from sponsors or shows to whom the patron has connections
3	Do something that would get the patron in trouble if anyone knew they asked you to do it	Secrets the patron knows—your fates are intertwined now
4	Do something in a way that can't be traced to you, or you will get in trouble	Something valuable—you're a Bard, use your Charisma to negotiate the hell out of this favor
5	Indulge a fancy of the patron's (collecting something, joining them in a silly hobby, anything that has no mechanical relevance but helps you both briefly forget the gallery of horrors that is now your lives)	Friendship (it's magic, some would say)
6	Help the patron recreate or call back to a fan-favorite moment from a past Crawl	Popularity increase

ASTRID

An Assistant Manager at the Desperado Club, Astrid is a Bloodlust Sprite whose familiarity with the circulatory system makes her an expert in rhythm and painting the town red.

Availability: All Floors in the Desperado Club

Performance Skills: Rhythm (beatboxing, DJing, percussion instruments, rap, etc.)

Venue Connections: The Desperado Club

Additional Skills: Detect Lies, Drain Life Spell, Negotiation, Persuasion, Wisp Armor Spell

Messaging Method: HUD chat

Quests: Promote the Desperado Club in a performance, recover payment from someone who skipped out on their tab, subdue a threat in the Desperado Club

Favors: Investigate suspicious Desperado Club workers, help the Penis Parade improve their performances, or sabotage performers scheming to take over its venue

Rewards: Access to secret guilds, comps or discounts on food, drink, casino play, and mercenary hires at the Desperado Club

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AWAIT REVIVAL

Await Revival is a Skyfowl Cleric with clipped wings in Club Vanquisher. They're nonverbal and adept at using their talons and wings to communicate, including with animals holy to their deity. Their deity is up to you, but Diwata comes with squirrels giving crawlers the middle finger. Just sayin'.

Availability: All floors in Club Vanquisher

Performance Skills: Nonmusical communication (motivational speeches, poetry, sign language, finger-tutting, etc.)

Venue Connections: Club Vanquisher and temples

Additional Skills: Animal Handling, Astral Paw Spell, Fire Fingers Spell, Sleight of Hand, Taunt

Messaging Method: HUD chat

Quests: Convince a shunned worshiper to atone, recover a stolen artifact, save a besieged temple

Favors: Interfere with another god's plans, rescue a Smote crawler, ruin a rival's reputation

Rewards: Deity boons even if you don't worship their god, magical rings, secret communication methods hidden from audiences and showrunners

CHACO

Chaco is known as the host of the Prize Carousel, but he was a Song Bard during his crawl. The AI assigns him as a patron to those who know to ask—like a public defender for destitute Bards—though that also means he's juggling multiple crawlers.

Availability: All floors, teleports to you

Performance Skills: Singing

Venue Connections: Clubs, guildhalls, saferooms, outdoor pop-ups generated by the AI

Additional Skills: Escape Artist, Good First Impression, Hide in Shadows, Second Chance Spell (Undead Backup singers!), Torch Spell

Messaging Method: HUD chat

Quests: Strange, panicked-sounding requests laundered through Chaco by the AI or showrunners: deliver a mysterious package, feed goldfish crackers to a Pollyslog at midnight five days in a row, shout out a specific audience member during a performance

Favors: "Keep your head down, don't die, and if you make me some money, I'm popular with furries. Now please stop asking questions."

Rewards: Access to musical guilds, AI-generated loot boxes with seemingly useless items that have a powerful niche purpose, furry interviews and sponsorships, a spin on the Prize Carousel

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GREMORY

The devil went down to Georgia, but she started out in Sheol. Gremory is a self-styled princess who wears a tungsten tiara around her waist like a wrestler's title belt. She's slightly less batshit than other superior fire demons only because she pours all her energy into becoming a one-demon band.

Availability: All floors through other demons

Performance Skills: Musical instruments

Venue Connections: Anywhere for the right price (favors sacrifices of dangerous Mobs and tone-deaf musicians)

Additional Skills: Fireball Spell, Intimidate, Negotiation, Soul Collector Spell, Survival

Messaging Method: Bijou fairy

Quests: Acquire rare upgrade materials for instruments, recover stolen instruments, wreck that asshole who sneezed during her performance two hundred cycles ago

Favors: Help her servants infiltrate musical guilds so she can take them over, also wreck that asshole who... you can guess the rest

Rewards: Autographed sheet-music Spells, instrument upgrades, Sheol bricks, Soul Crystals

JUICE BOX

Juice Box is a dungeon-generated Changeling who starts this season as a prostitute on the Fifth Floor. She's one of the oldest NPCs and remembers past crawls once she awakens. She fights for NPC rights, leading an entire faction of NPCs during Faction Wars.

Availability: Fifth Floor and onward, can access Club Vanquisher and the Desperado Club

Performance Skills: Motivation (appeals to emotion, crowd control, power of pursuing dreams, seduction, etc.)

Venue Connections: Anywhere a Changeling has influence (municipal buildings, restaurants, shops, etc.)

Additional Skills: Hole Spell, Persuasion, Puddle Jumper Spell, Stealth, Tactics

Messaging Method: Bijou fairy, other Changelings

Quests: Acquire a powerful asset for Faction Wars, aid another crawler's Quest involving Changelings, rescue NPCs

Favors: Assassinate outworlders who support the Crawl, make the audience see dungeon-generated NPCs as people

Rewards: Advice based on memories of past Crawls, refund of her cut of your earnings, items she loots from Faction Wars participants

KALA

Kala is a four-armed Naga dancer with gold and black scales who is almost as beloved as Manasa. The Blood Sultanate hired her to perform in their Sepsis Whore storyline during Faction Wars, and Borant contracted her to play an attendant during Celestial Ascendancy. She's carefree and much more excited to mentor dancers than hang around boring royals.

Availability: All floors, can access Club Vanquisher and the Desperado Club

Performance Skills: Dancing

Venue Connections: Bars, interview shows, locations leased to Syndicate production companies, theaters

Additional Skills: Confusing Fog Spell, Deception, Endurance, Jumping, Puddle Jumper Spell

Messaging Method: HUD chat

Quests: Demonstrate how dance transcends differences by preventing hostilities with a performance, guest star in Syndicate productions, help an NPC fulfill a dance-related dream

Favors: Collect unique outfits for her to wear during performances (no shoes!), offer honest critiques of dances she invents

Rewards: Loot boxes, protection from the Blood Sultanate during Faction Wars, Sponsors, interview shows

"I'm a bard. Most bards have a patron. They give us money and supplies in exchange for entertaining them every once in a while."

—Doctor Bones

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TABLE 73: SILVER EARTH BOX CONTENTS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	TRINKET TYPE	SAMPLES
1	A bedroom item	Pillow, comfy pajamas, alarm clock, new-in-box toothbrush or toiletries
2	Entertainment Item	Set of DVDs and portable DVD player, set of books in a series, sports memorabilia, trading cards or a deck of cards
3	Food-related Item	Chopsticks or a favored utensil, a can of something, a bag of candy, a gallon of Neapolitan ice cream
4	Transportation Item	A rear-view window or dashboard bauble, a bumper sticker, a subway or train card
5	Wallet/Purse Junk	A single condom or tampon, a ball of lint, a wad of useless cash, a coupon for a free food item (that a Bopca will attempt to honor)
6	Arts and Crafts Junk	A set of paints or markers, a plastic figurine to assemble, a full-sized potter's wheel, a hot glue gun with glue sticks, 100 googly eyes

TABLE 74: EARTH HOBBIES

ROLL OR CHOOSE	SKILL NAME	FIELD
1	Camel Beauty Pageants	Like Human beauty pageants, but for camels
2	Chronophilology	Watches, clocks, and other timepieces
3	Conchology	Shells
4	Deltiology	Postcards
5	Lepidopterology	Butterflies and Moths
6	Numismatics	Coins
7	Oenology	Wine
8	Pato	An Argentinian game resembling polo and basketball
9	Philately	Flags
10	Philumeny	Matchboxes and Matchbooks
11	Plangonology	Doll collecting
12	Pogonotrophy	Beards
13	Pomology	Fruit
14	Scripophily	Stocks and Bonds
15	Sepak Takraw	A game resembling volleyball and soccer, often played in Southeast Asia
16	Vexillology	Flags
17	Voice Acting	Acting, but with your voice
18	Wife Carrying	Obstacle racing while carrying a partner
19	Yelp Reviewing	A very specific type of online reviews
20	Zythology	Beer

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PLOT ARTIFACTS

Many items are carefully planted by numerous seasons of successive showrunners and System AIs to draw promising crawlers into interesting conflicts. Just as Carl and Donut are entangled with politics and entertainment on the galactic scale, these artifacts may draw characters into trouble in the Desperado Club or Club Vanquisher, open doors to relationships crawlers otherwise couldn't have, or present problems on later Floors, such as Faction Wars (Ninth Floor) or the Celestial Ascendancy (Twelfth Floor).

SILVER EARTH BOXES

Earth-Based Classes all receive a Silver Earth Box. Each box contains one or more trinkets (based on party size) and an Earth Hobby Potion. Parties of two gain d2+1 trinkets each. Parties of three or four gain d2 trinkets each. Parties of four or more gain 1 trinket each.

TRINKETS

The trinkets in a Silver Earth Box range from tchotchkes and bric-a-brac (that may needle a crawler's Regrets, Loose Ends, or Past Traumas) to items they might have a genuine interest in if they gone down the stairs and entered the dungeon.

If you're the GM, consider keeping a list of the trinkets from any Silver Earth Boxes crawlers have. On each Floor, look for a way to make that trinket useful. Once it happens, you can cross it off your list.

EARTH HOBBY POTIONS

> Per subsection 1256-C of the Indigenous Species Protection Act, this particular reward is required by the Syndicate Government to be awarded to all crawlers who have chosen a domestic Class.
>
> Taking this potion is optional, however it may not be sold or transferred to other crawlers or entities.
>
> Okay, enough of the lawyer speak. Drink this one. You'll get a Rank-3 Skill in a pretty uncommon Earth-based hobby. It won't be one you already have, but might be totally useless. But everyone would love to see what you do with it.

Crawlers who take an Earth-based Class gain an Earth Hobby Potion as part of their reward. These are weird, custom Skills that'll maybe come up, and crawlers might not know what they do. That's okay. They gain a weird (and possibly incomprehensible) Skill at Rank 3. Use Table 74 for ideas.

Carl's Cesta Punta, Donut's Scutelliphily, or Katia's Gear Head come in handy because the author made them. As the GM, you get to do the same. Keep track of any Earth Hobby Skills the PCs have. If you have an opportunity to work them into a Neighborhood or Quest once a Floor, take it. Force it as needed. A crawler with the Deltiology Skill might find postcards in the oddest places and have a shot at knowing who wrote them, or how they got there. Postcards might be a new addition to the World Dungeon this season, so many former crawler NPCs won't know much about them.

Of course, you could allow a crawler with an Earth-based Class to choose their Earth Hobby. That's probably the right move for some groups, but... especially in this case... random can be more fun. Keep in mind that with these custom Skills, it's often best to just let a crawler use them when they're tangentially related. Should the Camel Beauty Pageants Skill work for things like riding a mount that's vaguely like a camel, disguising oneself as a Dromederian, or just putting on a good show on a stage? Probably.

If you're having trouble pronouncing any of these, just about any reputable online, Earth-based dictionary of English probably has a pronunciation button you can click to hear it. You don't need to learn the International Phonetic Alphabet or anything.

THE DUNGEON ANARCHIST'S COOKBOOK (AND SIMILAR WORKS)

The titular *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* is an important item for Carl throughout the series, but in your campaign, Carl may not be the one to receive it. In a world in which Carl didn't choose the Compensated Anarchist Class or didn't make it into the Dungeon, the *Cookbook* may fall to another. The book reveals aspects of the Crawl's history and how to navigate the World Dungeon in ways other crawlers can't.

If you don't want to use the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* in your campaign, there's good news: you don't have to. But there are alternatives if you want a similar story without copying Carl and Donut's. The *Bestiarium Labyrinthi* and *The Book of Abramelin the Dungeon Mystic* are alternatives to the Cookbook for parties whose play style or story may

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not fit the bomb-throwing archetype. Use one of these options directly or as inspiration for creating your own variant. While not as secretive as the *Cookbook*, these alternatives hide like purloined letters as one of millions of other items in *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*.

Due to the impact the *Cookbook* or a similar tome has on the game, there shouldn't be more than one in a campaign. They're also more focused—the *Cookbook*'s entries cover a spectrum of topics and can be treated as a generalist's tome, while these alternatives provide better answers but only if the question is related to their subjects of focus.

Each of these books has a Key Skill, which you can use as guidelines for which characters should be able to access the book's content either because it's hidden (the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook*) or encoded in specialized jargon and terminology (both *Bestarium Labyrinthi* or *The Book of Abramelin the Dungeon Mystic*). Without 5 Ranks in the Key Skill or a similar custom Skill, the book may be illegible.

THE DUNGEON ANARCHIST'S COOKBOOK

Key Skill: Escape Plan

The *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* has passed from AI to AI and crawler to crawler through different iterations of the World Dungeon, accumulating an unfiltered understanding of the Crawl from the perspective of those trapped within. It generally appears under specific conditions as a thick, dictionary-sized book with a plain cover marked only by an anarchy symbol and hints of gold-leafed pages.

The audience and showrunners see it as a harmless book by "Anonymous," supposedly filled with useless cooking recipes and fanciful anecdotes about acquiring them. The AI and the crawler who obtains it see its true contents: a living rebellion manual—stories, warnings, tactics, and hard-earned discoveries left by previous crawlers for future rebels. It changes form between Crawls to be culturally relevant, stays nondescript to viewers, and vanishes if anyone suspects its real nature.

"Together, we will burn it all to the ground."

—Introduction to the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook*

THE COOKBOOK IN PLAY

The crawler who obtains the *Cookbook* is the only one who can read it, and they need a relevant Skill at Rank 5: Carl's Escape Plan Skill does this for him, but other thematic Skills might be able to reveal the book's contents as well. To read the book, the player asks the GM one specific question about the current Floor or an encounter, item, faction, trap, rule exploit, or dungeon feature.

The GM answers with an entry authored by a previous crawler. The information may be cryptic or straightforward. It never resolves the problem outright but provides a tool to address it, like a Looking For Clues Check, but more powerful. For example, an entry may teach a previously unknown use for an item, a crafting recipe, or a way to obtain or level a Skill.

The *Cookbook*'s new author should add entries regularly as roleplaying flavor. As additional encouragement, the GM may grant AI Favor for creative entries or remove a +5 stack from the day's Suspicion Bar Check Difficulty (see next section) for expanding on an entry they used that day.

Eventually, surviving *Cookbook* authors could be encountered when the *Cookbook*-bearer is able to leave the dungeon (such as for interview shows, CrawlCon, or the like) or when outsiders are allowed into the dungeon (such as on the Sixth or Ninth Floors).

SUSPICION BAR

Consulting the *Cookbook* is dangerous because outsiders may suspect the crawler is somehow cheating or gaining outside support. The attuned crawler makes a Suspicion Check (a Stealth Skill Check by default, but they can choose another appropriate Skill) vs. a Difficulty set by the GM based on circumstances (usually, it's Unopposed, but nearby characters could oppose it).

Reading it alone in a bathroom stall or during a cooking challenge is easy, but consulting it during a Boss fight or under direct audience scrutiny may be difficult or nearly impossible. The first consultation each day uses the GM's Difficulty; subsequent Checks suffer Disadvantage.

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PAST AUTHORS

An interesting way to play up past authors is to use the downtime between sessions to write, often called *bluebooking* (a school essay technique from the days when folks used paper for everything). Create a prop to represent past author essays in downtime between sessions, and use it for past authors. Whether it's a physical prop (a blank notebook or small three-ring binder to add pages to) or a digital one, you (as the GM portraying past crawlers) can leave relevant notes for future crawlers (that is, the current crawler with access to the book). Get as creative as you like with different handwriting styles (or fonts) for each author as you develop them. You can even provide game rules for Mobs or items if the book itself contains information of that type.

If you're not the writing type, you can make voice or video recordings instead. Especially if folks are having fun acting out characters and know the basics of splicing files together, an audio or video recording could work better than written pages for some groups.

Bluebooking like this—physical, digital, written, or spoken—is great for players who like to play between sessions, just be careful to keep notes short and useful. Like everything, if folks enjoy more of this and it's fun for everyone, patch the rules (p. 74) and let the entries get longer.

This can also be a fun way for the player to leave notes for the book's next author. You can even involve others (whether or not they're playing the current campaign) by having them guest-write for one of the book's owner-authors.

Another benefit of bluebooking like this is that you've created your own unique artifact from your **Dungeon Crawler Carl** campaign, you can look back on years later.

If the Suspicion Bar Check is a Success, the crawler gains the information without consequence. They still gain the information on a Fail, but the party's Suspicion Bar fills by 1d2. It has 5 total slots. For each full day the Cookbook isn't referenced, reduce the Suspicion Bar by 1 slot.

If the Suspicion Bar fills, reset it to 0 slots, and the GM chooses someone important to suspect the *Cookbook*'s true nature: a Sponsor, rival crawler, NPC, producer, or even a Mob. The GM should start with less dire consequences. For example, the first time it happens, the crawler's Sponsor notices and gives them a cryptic warning such as a Sponsor box containing a fairly useless item related to cheating or surveillance.

By contrast, an NPC or rival crawler may attempt to steal the book, while a hostile Sponsor may blackmail the crawler. In the worst-case scenario, a showrunner who confirms their suspicions causes the book to disappear and may "accelerate" the crawler. Other than previous owners of the book, however, no one knows the book's secret contents and exactly how the current owner is getting their information.

OBTAINING THE COOKBOOK

Here are ways a crawler could obtain the *Cookbook*.

- **Achievement Footnote:** After the crawler earns a minor insulting achievement, the AI announces a consolation prize: "Mandatory summer reading." The reward is described as a dreary paperback assigned by a teacher who has lost all agency over what her class is allowed to read, leaving only the safest, blandest books: nothing remotely threatening to the powers that be. Some bored student scrawled an anarchy symbol on it, though.
- **Dying Crawler Handover:** A Dying crawler drags themself into a camera-blind corner, clutching a battered, worthless-looking book. They lock eyes with the chosen crawler and say, "Don't tell anyone what this is. Not your party. Not your Sponsors. Nobody." The transfer should be impossible; Inventory rules reject the item, flashing red warnings. Then the AI cuts in, amused: "I'll allow it." The book lands in the crawler's hands. To everyone else, it is just a battered notebook. To the recipient, the black anarchy symbol blooms across the cover.
- **Prize Box Glitch:** After the crawler exploits a dungeon mechanic or breaks an encounter script in impressive fashion, a prize box appears with unusual fanfare. The announcer starts describing a grand reward, then stutters, glitches, and declares it "a self-published novel written in a Starbucks by a substitute teacher who thought they were creating the next great American masterpiece, but they mostly produced the literary equivalent of making intense eye contact during public masturbation." Inside is a battered paperback with embarrassing cover art. It looks worthless, but a black anarchy symbol marks the cover.

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POSSIBLE ALLIES

Porthus Hu, the Open Intellect Pacifist Action Network, Rosetta Thagra, Justice Light, Tipid, Princess Posse, Mordecai, Odette, Apothecary, Residuals

BESTIARIUM LABYRINTHI

Key Skill: Arcane or Lore

The *Bestiarium Labyrinthi* is a catalog of the dungeon's Mobs, Bosses, engineered ecosystems, and archaeology. Its pages obsess over Scolopendra, the nine-tier attack, the Crawl's ties to Primal history, and the possibility that the dungeon is built atop remnants of older wars no Sponsor wants remembered.

The book appears to hunters, animal trainers, archaeologists, battlefield tacticians, park rangers, taxonomists, occult historians, butchers, chefs, and crawlers who solve problems by knowing exactly where to stab.

THE BESTIARIUM IN PLAY

This book provides specific information, such as Advantage on Look For Clues and other Stat Block details for dungeon denizens. It also contains major lore and secrets about dungeon structures, especially on Scolopendra Floors. A crawler can harvest parts from a defeated Mob or Boss and transfer those parts from their Inventory to the book, turning its entry into a living entry that provides all its Stat Block details, Advantage for Checks against similar foes, and in future fights against the same Mob or Boss.

SUSPICION BAR

The *Bestiarium Labyrinthi* has a similar suspicion bar as the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* (p. 322).

OBTAINING THE BESTIARIUM

Here are ways a crawler could obtain this bestiary.

- **Attention to Detail:** The crawler inspects a Boss or Elite and notices the public description is wrong: false origin, wrong species, fake weakness, Sponsor propaganda, or a missing pre-Crawl name. They gather enough evidence through tracks, remains, behavior, ruins, and NPC testimony to challenge the AI directly. The AI responds by hurling the *Bestiarium Labyrinthi* at their feet in performative defiance.
- **Discovery:** The crawler finds a relic, skull, egg clutch, Soul Crystal, or "monster trophy" that is worth a stupid amount of gold. Instead of selling it, they trace its origins to a forgotten NPC population (such as Bugbear elders, Ursine survivors, Bush Elf historians, or Skyfowl cultists) and return it or trade it for secrets about the Crawl's history. The AI gifts the seemingly worthless bestiary (a monster manual) as a "consolation prize" for "squandering" something so valuable.
- **Empathy:** A crawler chooses not to kill a dangerous beast, instead studying it to discover the motivation behind its aggressive behavior (starving, wounded, nesting, controlled, or defending territory). They risk loot, time, or safety to pacify or protect it, resolving the encounter without resorting to killing. The bestiary appears in a loot box with the AI description downplaying it by mocking the crawler's mercy.

POSSIBLE ALLIES

Tish's Larracos scholars, Signet's circus remnants, Skyfowl cultists, Goiter's Bugbear elders, Shamus Chaindrive's automata, rogue Burrower archivists

THE BOOK OF ABRAMELIN THE DUNGEON MYSTIC

Key Skill: Arcane or Religion

The titular Abramelin is a War Mage who achieved divinity through alchemy. The AI doesn't fully control the dungeon's gods, but the gods can't leave the dungeon. The *Book of Abramelin* contains cryptic puzzles and challenges to help a worthy crawler follow in his footsteps and ascend to godhood (or maybe he just coerced the showrunners that season to use him as a god for the duration of his exit deal).

Since crawlers have wetware that dungeon-born don't, a crawler-turned-deity could interface with the AI and the external world to break the dungeon entirely, allowing Abramelin and other gods to escape its confines as well. The book appears to crafters, scholars, magic users, worshipers of the Crawl's gods, general religious types concerned with salvation or liberation, and people who break mechanics in creative ways.

THE BOOK OF ABRAMELIN IN PLAY

The book provides crafting recipes (especially alchemical ones), secret uses for crafting materials, information on churches and shrines, and hidden areas of the dungeon where crawlers can obtain rare materials or information. Information on demons of Sheol and the vast network of gods and goddesses may also be found within its pages.

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It also includes puzzles with notes from previous authors about their attempts to solve them. GMs who use this book should plan the puzzles to provide a way for the latest author to escape the dungeon or break its rules to become a god, even if only temporarily.

SUSPICION BAR

The *Book of Abramelin* has a similar suspicion bar as the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* (p. 322).

OBTAINING THE BOOK OF ABRAMELIN

Here are ways a crawler could obtain The Book of Abramelin.

- **Ambition:** Where the *Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook* is for crawlers who defy authority, the *Book of Abramelin* may suit crawlers who prefer structure. They thrive within the rulesets of the dungeon, or their religion or Class, but they also exploit every opportunity to excel. The AI notices and pushes them into ever-greater challenges until they alone make it to the end of a puzzle, whereupon the viewer feeds glitch long enough for them to spot the book among the room's other treasures.
- **Divine Mission:** A crawler obtains the favor of their god by completing an important Quest. The god's representative ushers them into a sanctuary within Club Vanquisher, where producers and viewers can't see what's happening, and gives them the book, whispering that solving its secrets will release gods and crawlers alike from their artificial limitations.
- **Puzzling Discovery:** A detail-oriented crawler works to understand a major puzzle in the dungeon's design, such as mapping out and understanding the Iron Tangle. When presenting the solution, they notice an area that doesn't fit. Investigating the "glitch" in the system reveals a room full of junk and the seemingly worthless book, which the AI scoffs at as a byproduct of cost-cutting producers failing to review their designs.

POSSIBLE ALLIES

These possible allies could be implacable opponents if they find the crawler blasphemous or would be harmed by the crawler's apotheosis: Abramelin (though he lies low until he thinks the crawler has a chance of success), Akuma and the War Mage Rebellion, the Apothecary, Club Vanquisher Clerics, the god the crawler worships, Milk, Juice Box, and Changelings seeking divine powers

ARTIFACTS OF DIVINE SUFFERING

The Artifacts of Divine Suffering are a collection of items that provide powerful permanent bonuses for killing other crawlers. The first time a crawler successfully uses one, they earn the You Crossed a Line You Didn't Even Know Was There Achievement, which includes a Gold Junkie Box that places a Night Wyrm's Nasty Little Web of Suffering tattoo on the crawler. This tattoo grants access to the Guild of Suffering.

The Guild of Suffering is a cult that assigns assassination Quests. Anyone in the dungeon can be a target. Members of the Guild of Suffering worship, venerate, or serve the Night Wyrm, who is a dead demigod they're trying to resurrect and/or the title or identity of their secretive leader, depending on the iteration of the Crawl and whom you ask.

The guild's entrance this season—or one of them—is hidden in the Penis Parade strip club on the top floor of the Desperado Club. Of course, in your campaign, you can change the location or identity of the Night Wyrm.

OBTAINING AN ARTIFACT OF DIVINE SUFFERING

Here are ways a crawler could obtain an Artifact of Divine Suffering:

- **Bounty Hunter:** The crawler defeats a powerful and well-known crawler-killer, looting the item from their corpse. On the Sixth and Ninth Floors, they can loot one from important hunters or faction leaders.
- **Lease to Buy:** The crawler attracts the Guild of Suffering's attention without being a member. It lures or tempts the crawler with an artifact, promising to give it to them if they complete an exceptionally dangerous or complicated assassination.
- **Loot Box:** These artifacts are rare and only have a chance of appearing in platinum-quality or higher boxes for achievements related to killing crawlers. Getting one early requires being the first to perform a type of kill, killing someone significant to the crawler, or killing in an egregious but entertaining way.

MARKED FOR DEATH

Limitation: This Skill is granted from items or rare Class or Race benefits. This Skill does not gain Ranks.

Many Artifacts of Divine Suffering grant a Marked for Death Skill that must be used to gain their benefits. The details vary, but they share the following commonalities.

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1. **Target List:** Activating the Skill shows a list of all crawlers within their HUD map's range. On Scolopendra levels, the list also includes non-dungeon-generated combatants.
2. **Target Eligibility:** Only targets from the list who are at 100% health can be marked.
3. **Mark Formation:** On most Floors, only one target can be marked at a time, and the mark takes 30 seconds to form (3 rounds of combat) and has a 5-hour cooldown. On the Ninth Floor, there is no limit to the number of simultaneous marks, and the cooldown is 15 minutes. On the Sixth Floor and all Floors above the Ninth, marks forms instantaneously.
4. **Debuff:** Once the marks are formed, the artifact's user gets a Debuff that only expires when all marked targets are dead.
5. **Benefit:** The artifact's user gets benefits unique to the item when marked targets die, no matter the cause.

ENCHANTED NIGHT WYRM'S LINKS OF IMPLACABLE SORROW

Gear Slot: Accessory

This bracelet is a seamless onyx loop that depicts the legendary Night Wyrm devouring its own tail. It uses the Marked for Death Skill, but focusing on a target's name reveals their entire party, and the mark forms on the party instead. If the target leaves the party, the mark shifts to be only on the target, but any party members who died before the target left count toward the final bonus.

The Links of Implacable Sorrow Debuff creates 10-mil radius hunting ranges centered on each member of the marked party. At the start of each day, you lose 1 slot from your Health Bar maximum if you aren't in a hunting range, and each radius then halves until each reaches a minimum of 1,000ft on the seventh day. You die if your Health Bar maximum is reduced to 0 slots.

Once the mark forms, the Night Wyrm releases its tail and coils around your arm. Its body splits into segments equal to the number of living marked party members. Its head points toward the nearest one, and it constricts when you're outside a hunting range.

When a marked target dies, the Night Wyrm devours one segment of the bracelet. Choose one of the target's three highest-ranked Skills. You gain it at Rank 1 or increase its Rank by 1 if either the target's Rank or the marked party's original size is greater than your current Rank in that Skill.

Once the entire marked party is dead, you gain a completion bonus that permanently increases your Con Stat by the number of deaths.

ENCHANTED NIGHT WYRM'S NECKLACE OF INDELIBLE WOE

Gear Slot: Head

This necklace looks like someone harvested a mass of spider webs and wove it into a loop. Enchanted dots of red light pulse from within the tangle at irregular intervals like the heartbeats of insects trapped within. It uses the Marked for Death Skill.

The Necklace of Indelible Woe Debuff causes you to take damage equal to a Spell's Mana cost whenever you cast a Spell.

When you mark a target, you permanently lose one of your lowest-Rank Spells, selected at random. Unlike other Artifacts of Divine Suffering, you can choose to remove the mark after 5 hours, ending the Debuff. If you do so, the target gains the Spell you lost at your Rank, and you permanently steal a random Spell from the target at the target's Rank.

If the marked target dies, you instead gain one of the target's five highest-Rank Spells, selected at random, with the target's Rank.

ENCHANTED NIGHT WYRM'S RING OF DIVINE SUFFERING

Gear Slot: Accessory

This band of green glass has an embedded red jewel that glows with enchantment. Former crawlers and outsiders alike fear and covet these rings for the power they can grant. The ring grants:

- +1 to all Skill or Stat Checks
- The Marked for Death Skill (p. 325)

Marked targets gain the Marked for Death Debuff. The Ring of Divine Suffering Debuff prevents you from healing while any marked target is alive.

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"Mordecai had already told us a bit about these things. They were indeed worthless once they were activated. Breaking it would stop the guards from charging up, but it wouldn't otherwise hurt them. They'd eventually run out of juice, but it wouldn't happen right away."

—Carl

When a marked target dies, you gain a permanent +1 bonus to the Stat in which the target had the most points. For every three marked targets who die, the bonus increases by 1 for subsequent kills (+1 for the first to third deaths, +2 for fourth to sixth, +3 for seventh to ninth, etc.).

ENGAGED LOCK BOX OF THE NIGHT WYRM

This small box is made of dark wood and engraved with spiderweb patterns. Its wooden slats allow a peek at the powerful item it contains, which is customized for the box's recipient. The item should be something they strongly desire: perhaps it appeals to an unrealized dream from before the Crawl, addresses a Past Trauma, or resolves a dilemma they face in the dungeon.

Whatever the box contains, the crawler has to open it first. Three metallic claws keep the box clasped shut, and each holds a glowing purple gem representing a task to complete.

- Kill someone you are currently or formerly partied with.
- Kill a Country or Floor Boss.
- Complete an assassination Quest for the Guild of Suffering (owning the box grants temporary access to the guild).

Each completed task cracks one of the gems, burning it out and releasing its lock. The box can be opened once all three are unlocked.

SACRAMENTAL FLASK OF THE NIGHT WYRM'S REVIVAL

This heavily tarnished silver flask can magically pour out two servings of wine once a day. Both servings grant Immunity to all Debuffs and 1 HB slot regeneration each round for 1 hour.

At the end of the hour, one of the servings applies the Sacramental Flask of the Night Wyrm's Revival Debuff, which reduces the drinker's health to 1 HB slot and prevents them from healing for 10 hours.

Two different people must each drink one serving for any effects. Everyone who sees the drinks gets a description of how they work, but only the person who poured them knows which has the negative side effect.

Whenever either drinker dies within 11 hours of the servings taking effect, the pourer permanently gains +1 to their CHA Stat and one stacking use of the Cockroach Skill.

ARTIFACTS OF THE GODS

THE GATE OF THE FERAL GODS

The Gate of the Feral Gods has three pieces—a mysterious winding box and two pocket watches. When all three have been found and combined, and the watches have been properly wound, it will open a portal from one place to another—for a cost.

Using this celestial-tier item causes a hole to rip open in the Nothing, allowing a Feral god to escape. Because Feral gods typically are banished to the Nothing by a current member of the Ascendency realm, their sudden reappearance usually triggers another god to arrive in an attempt to correct the banishment.

This item cannot be used to circumvent stairwells or prematurely descend to lower dungeon floors.

Fighting a Feral God on the Third, Fourth, or Fifth Floor (or non-Feral Gods, for that matter) is basically a death sentence. Crawlers will need a clever way to distract, outsmart, or placate them and Feral Gods ain't ones for being placated.

Feral Keyword: *F* ain't just for *Floor*. For Mobs and other NPCs, increase the Difficulty of Feral creatures' Strength- and Dexterity-based to-hit and damage by +F, even if you've added the Floor Number already. If a PC somehow gets this Keyword, they add +F to their Attacks and damage while it lasts, but suffer Disadvantage on all Intelligence- and Charisma-based Checks. This doesn't quite balance out, does it? It's a little harsher for PCs than NPCs. Huh. Oh well.

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MEMORIAL AND SOUL CRYSTALS

These crystals are created by death.

Soul crystals are mined from Scolopendra's lair and are connected to a once-living soul. They are used to power magical items like a battery, despite their well-known unstable nature. These can power just about anything magical, whether it endlessly generates Mobs or refreshes powerful town guards daily. Their quality varies, with A-Grade being incredibly potent while lesser crystals power smaller Spells or devices.

Physically touching a Soul Crystal can cause it to explode, typically dealing a lot of damage based on the crystal's grade (see Table 75) to everything in a 50-foot radius, with a further 50-foot blast radius. Reduce the radius by half for crystals at half power or less.

TABLE 75: SOUL CRYSTAL EXPLOSIVES

GRADE	EXPLOSION DAMAGE
A-Grade	Fd20+F Force damage
B-Grade	Fd12+F Force damage
C-Grade	Fd10+F Force damage
D-Grade	Fd8+F Force damage
E-Grade	Fd6+F Force damage

Soul Crystals are a plot device GMs can use to let crawlers dangerously disarm or depower structures and ongoing Spells. The reward is an untouchable bomb.

Memorial Crystals are similar, but are created by fallen gods and demigods. Rather than storing energy, they are filled with information, usually god-tier Spells or knowledge. Accessing this trove requires charging the crystal by wearing it. With the proper Skill or slot, it can be affixed to weapons and armor, or simply worn as jewelry. They can also protect from god-tier attacks, possibly allowing the bearer to escape a Smite.

Crawlers probably won't even hear about Memorial Crystals till the Sixth Floor or later.

FACTION WARS ITEMS

Borant and the System AI want to set up the Faction Wars early, so a number of items related to that Floor may be littered throughout the dungeon early on, when most crawlers don't know jack shit about the later levels. That's okay. They'll learn. Or they'll die trying.

ENCHANTED CROWN OF THE SEPSIS WHORE

Gear Slot: Head

A delicate tiara of blackened silver set with dark smoky gems. At its center rests a deep violet stone that churns with storm-like clouds, as if the jewel itself is alive and thinking about you.

AI **Who's a dirty girl? You're a dirty girl!**

This is a Fleeting Item!

This is a Unique Item!

Imbues the wearer with +5 Intelligence, grants the user +5 to the Good First Impression Skill. All Attacks, including magical Attacks, now have a chance of inflicting the Sepsis Debuff.

Equipping this glittering, purple crown will permanently place the wearer into the line of succession for the Blood Sultanate. Removing the item will not remove this status, however it will cause the item to disappear from the wearer and likely reappear to another crawler. Only one member of the royal family can descend from the Ninth Floor to the Tenth, and only if the Sultan and all other members of the royal family are dead.

- +5 Intelligence
- +5 Good First Impression Skill
- On an Amazing Success with any Attack you make, the target gains the Sepsis Debuff

MEANS OF ACQUISITION

- Found in a Legendary Quadruped box.
- A pack of Goblins on the Second Floor now worships Queen Fricka, who rose to power the traditional way: stealing this crown off a crawler's corpse while the actual victors were busy high-fiving. The crown didn't make her smart, just convincing. Which, unfortunately, is worse. Fricka happily sacrifices every Goblin she has (and then herself) before letting anyone take it back.
- Also available in a Platinum (or better) Boss Box.

COMPLICATIONS

The curse is simple: once you don the Enchanted Crown of the Sepsis Whore, you cannot leave the Ninth Floor until every member of the Blood Sultanate's royal line is dead. The Nagas scatter, hide,

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and wait out Faction Wars, which means one missed survivor can trap the wearer indefinitely, even if the crown is discarded.

If the crown is later worn by another crawler, they are added to the line of succession as well.

GM USE

The crown forces conflict between crawlers. Anyone else who has worn it is now a problem that needs solving, permanently. Players who hesitate to kill other crawlers find that stance tested quickly. The dungeon has strong opinions about pacifists.

This regal headgear can also function as a puzzle. The party must identify every living member of the Blood Sultanate's line of succession before the wearer can descend to the Tenth Floor. Miss just one, and their friend doesn't leave the Ninth Floor. Here's hoping it's not the healer!

THUMB-FUCKER OF THE SKULL EMPIRE

Gear Slot: Any

The Thumb-Fucker of the Skull Empire is an oversized gold ring with aggressive runes that is absolutely determined to fit whatever you stick into it. It is roughly sized for a large Human thumb, but the warm metal flexes like it's alive, tightening with eager precision the moment you commit it to any appendage.

AI This is a Fleeting Item!

This is a Unique Item!

Warning!

This special ring can fit just about any slot. Sliding this ring onto any extremity causes it to resize and lock into place. Yes, any extremity. Take a second, and think about your life choices, because removal requires severing the attached appendage. Side effects include skin turning green starting at the point of contact, progressive tusk growth (congratulations!), and increasing resemblance to something that smells like wet iron and bad decisions.

While worn, you are automatically flagged as an ally of the Skull Empire Faction. Side note: You may be recognized as a Ringer for the Imperial Throne, which places you somewhere on the Skull Empire's very stabby line of succession. This immediately attracts the attention of King Rust and his children.

- +5 Strength
- +5 Constitution
- +5 to the Skullcracker Skill
- −5 Intelligence
- Up through the Ninth Floor, Skull Empire NPCs and Mobs are not automatically hostile to you. Skull Empire leadership, however, are.

MEANS OF ACQUISITION

- Found in a Legendary Asshole's Box.
- A hunter from the Madness carries the ring but never wears it. Instead, they plant it where a crawler already hostile to the Skull Empire can find it. If things go right, the crawler puts it on. If things go really right, the Skull Empire tears itself apart trying to decide who gets to kill them first. The hunter considers this a win, even if it costs them their life.
- Also available in a Legendary Benefactor Box. This is unlikely if their benefactor is one of the Skull Empire's royal family; they prefer their disasters intentional.

COMPLICATIONS

While the Thumb-Fucker of the Skull Empire does technically make the wearer part of the royal family, the actual royal children aren't thrilled about surprise siblings. Prince Stalwart, Princess Formidable, and Prince Maestro all respond to competition the same way: assassination attempts. Inside the dungeon. Outside the dungeon. During dinner conversations. Being flagged as an "ally" by the System AI doesn't protect anyone; it just makes the betrayal funnier. Even King Rust, Queen Consort Ugloo, and Baroness Victory are wary of the bearer.

GM USE

On the surface, the Thumb-Fucker of the Skull Empire looks like a simple power boost for a tank-type brawler and an easy way to introduce Faction Wars. It isn't. By the Third Floor, if the ring is still on, the crawler doesn't choose a Race. They're an Orc, whether they like it or not, unless the party can stop it.

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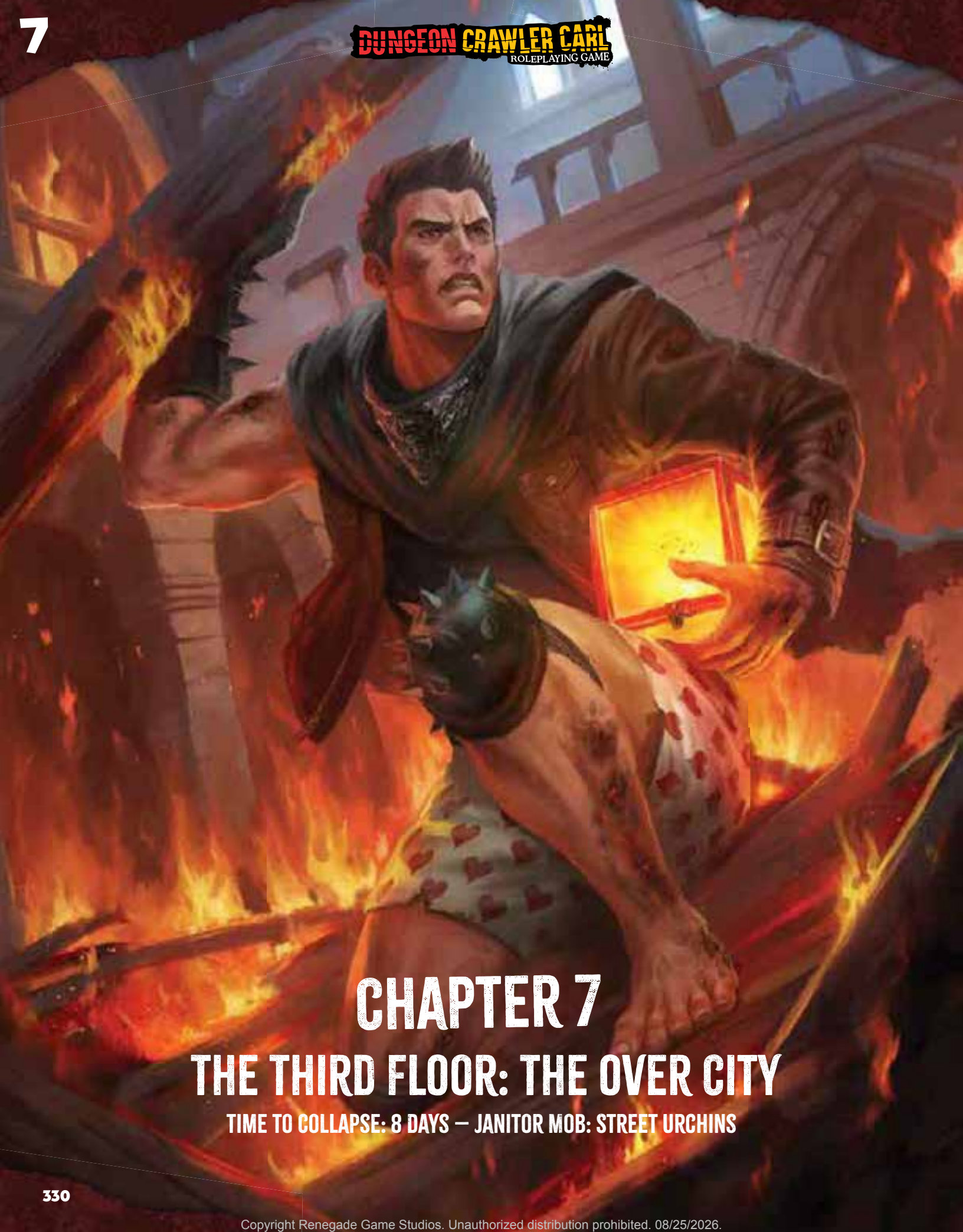

CHAPTER 7

THE THIRD FLOOR: THE OVER CITY

TIME TO COLLAPSE: 8 DAYS — JANITOR MOB: STREET URCHINS

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THE TUTORIAL FLOORS HAVE DRAWN TO A CLOSE, AND YOUR PLUCKY PARTY OF CRAWLERS HAS SURVIVED TO SEE THE THIRD FLOOR. CONGRATULATIONS, GM! YOU'RE EITHER GREAT AT YOUR JOB OR *REALLY* BAD AT IT.

If you're going by the book—Carl's Doomsday Scenario, in this case—the Third Floor starts with the crawlers getting through their Race and Class selection and saying goodbye to their Game Guides (unless they obtained the Manager benefit).

Once Race and Class selection is complete, your crawlers can experience this bold new world for the first time while testing out their new Skills and abilities. The Third Floor, known as the Over City, is the crawlers' introduction to the Scolopendra storyline, sometimes referred to as the Volcano storyline. This continuing story extends throughout every three floors (that's the Third, Sixth, Ninth, Twelfth, Fifteenth, and Eighteenth Floors), potentially culminating in a climactic clash with the legendary Scolopendra herself.

On this floor, crawlers will encounter new game elements not found on the Tutorial Floors, including serialized recurring dramas starring Elites. These shows often feature crawlers as "guests," though not always with favorable treatment. Additionally, Quests are formally introduced on the Third Floor, giving crawlers opportunities to explore more, interact with new storylines, and earn unique loot... provided they survive the experience.

In the immortal words of Mordecai, "Now the games may truly begin."

The Third Floor is a Scolopendra Floor and shows a number of changes compared to the First and Second Floors:

- Crawlers begin the floor by selecting a Race and Class in conjunction with their Game Guide.
- Crawlers lose access to a Game Guide once they leave Race and Class selection (unless they gain the Manager benefit, where their game guide becomes their manager).
- The floor has a cycle of day and night
- Elites emerge on this Floor

Note: For advice on running Neighborhoods and Quests, see Chapter 5, particularly pp. 262–265.

TABLE 76: THIRD FLOOR GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL	RESULT
1—6	See the current Neighborhood.
7	You find an unexpected magic guild. If you spend four hours training and haggling and 500 gold, you can gain the first rank or advance one rank in one of the seven Spells they can teach. Unfortunately, the Spells the guild teaches are selected at random.
8	One of your party falls through a sinkhole into some ruins below the Over City. When you attempt to rescue them, they're in the lair of an unexpected Neighborhood Boss! (GMs: You can use a Neighborhood Boss from another Neighborhood or a Quest from this floor if you want to run this battle).
9	You encounter another group of crawlers grinding in the area who are lower Level and having difficulty. (GMs: You can use higher-Level Mobs from another Neighborhood or Quest if you want to run this battle).
10	You encounter another group that has a crawler from one of your party member's past. (GMs: You can use one of your players' backstories to create a roleplay situation).
11	You find the corpse of another crawler being consumed by Street Urchins. They may have been killed and looted by a rival or still have some loot if Mobs killed them.
12	A traveling merchant offers you random items and basic supplies you need at double the usual price. Some could be magical? Well, at least he says they are.
13	You encounter one of the NPCs from this floor who has a big problem or important task they can't solve without help. (GMs: You can have the players start a quest elsewhere on this floor, or they can just take Mordecai's advice and ignore them).
14	You find an entrance to the Desperado Club or Club Vanquisher.
15—20	Nothing bad happens.

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NEIGHBORHOOD: HEAVENSWORTH

FLOOR: 3 — THEME: BAVARIAN-STYLED VILLAGE IN ALPINE MOUNTAINS

Heavensworth is a small rural village in the Over City, nestled among snowcapped mountains on the outskirts of a larger Skyfowl settlement. Scolopendra's nine-tier attack on the Over City killed or transformed 90% of the village population, as well as leaving much of the village in total ruin. The descendants of these survivors live in the village, while those transformed into monsters live in the ruins.

This Bavarian-style village makes up part of the Over City. Snowy-white Skyfowl soar high above the village, riding the downslope winds of the nearby mountains, and an eclectic mix of village denizens leisurely browse through Alpine-style buildings, small boutiques, and street side cafes.

Dangerous Mobs lurk in the ruins beyond, eager to introduce crawlers to the harsh realities of the Third Floor. Gliding Brain Boilers and leaping Grulkes prowl the outlying ruins, while creepy Bugaboos wander the city streets at night, looking for easy prey among unsuspecting travelers. City Elves worship a tree and constantly seek new converts to the wise words of Apito and the Skyfowl Angels.

Worse, in the deep ruins lurks a savage beast. The former warden of the prisons, Jack Screecher, is still there, twisted from Scolopendra's nine-fold attack, and hungry for flesh. Because this beast is still a Skyfowl, the town magistrate Alecturis helps hide Jack. He also helps Jack hunt the wingless, and the Skyfowl he views as unworthy.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- As the crawlers approach a beer hall-shaped tavern, a pair of bouncers throw Steve, a large Grulke, out the door. Nearly passed-out drunk, he repeatedly mutters, "Killed them all; he's still there. I can still hear him."
- While exploring an abandoned building in the ruins near the edge of the village, the floor below the crawlers collapses, dropping them into a dusty but relatively intact basement of a hardware store. In the corner stands a large birdcage with the remains of a recently dismembered City Elf lying on the floor.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you'll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures!

- The Grulke employ brutal and sadistic methods to discourage the City Elves from their worship. As long as the crawlers don't help the City Elves or just stay out of things, they might mention a massive creature seen in the Fallen Watch and warn the crawlers about Brain Boiler ambushes.

  However, if the crawlers aid the City Elves, they are given a patrol schedule to avoid confrontations and told about the angel who guards the old prison in the Fallen Watch.
- While exploring—or shopping in—the Gilded Feathers area, the crawlers observe crawler Annie Har attempting to steal a magic item in the Agento Lodge. The Mage running the shop detected Annie's theft, encased her in some sort of stasis field before she could escape, and summoned the Village Guards, who are on their way.

  Annie pleads with the crawlers for their help, even as the Mage owning the store warns against it. If the crawlers free her, they also become targets of the guards, but in doing so, Annie will offer to join their party and provide valuable knowledge about this village's history since she got her hands on some old documents that hint at the Boss here.
- The crawlers meet a Dwarf NPC named Marita who tells them of something strange she saw while installing a custom lift in the residence of a Skyfowl magistrate. The lift itself was oversized and heavily reinforced, and much of the furniture in the magistrate's residence was designed to fit larger creatures. She also shares rumors about suspicious disappearances and strange noises in the alleys near Alecturis' home.

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MOBS

Skyfowl soar overhead while Bugaboos prowl the darkened alleys below. In the ruins, Brain Boilers and Grulke mercenaries battle over hapless crawlers. Zealous City Elves proselytize in the streets, seeking to convince all to serve the Oak Mother. Village Guards keep peace during the day but rest at night, turning evenings into a chaotic free-for-all.

BRAIN BOILER

Brain Boilers are a more advanced form of the Mind Horrors from the Second Floor. They look like a cross between a squid and an umbrella. Similar to the Mind Horrors, the Brain Boilers have a psionic attack. Unlike the Mind Horrors, though, the attacks of the Brain Boilers can be countered with high Charisma. Due to their nature, they are also immune to the Fear Spell.

Brain Boilers hunt in packs, seeking perches above where they expect their prey to cross. As creatures approach, the Brain Boilers launch themselves into the air and pinwheel down silently before wrapping their webbed bodies and tentacles around the heads of their victims.

AI **Brain Boiler. Level 10.**

Ever see that movie where the face-hugging alien pops out of a giant egg and attaches itself to the guy who's just standing there, staring at it like a moron? It takes a while, but we all know how that one ends. Well, if you thought that was nasty, just wait until you meet one of these babies! Brain Boilers lie in wait and then fly out from nowhere, engulfing your whole head before emitting toxic gas from their anus. This Dutch Oven will literally boil your brain!

Brain Boiler

Mob; Small (2), Weird

1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	15+F	14+F	20+S	3
STR	**INT**	**CON**	**DEX**	**CHA**
3 (+2)	20 (+5)	1 (+1)	10 (+4)	1 (+1)

Bite: 12+F to hit, 3d4+2 Piercing, 5ft range

Flying Face Hug: 14+F to hit, No damage, 15ft range
Any hit crawler must make a STR Stat Check. On a Fail, they gain the Wrapped Debuff: Their head is covered by the Brain Boiler and they gain the Burned Debuff until the creature is killed or removed. It cannot be extinguished as per the Burned Debuff rules.

Notes: Wrapped—As an action, a crawler with the Wrapped Debuff may make a STR-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check, or a STR Stat Check at the same Difficulty to escape. Attacks against the Brain Boiler by anyone other than the affected crawler do half their damage to the crawler and half to the Brain Boiler.

BUGABOO

Standing about 7 feet tall, Bugaboos have the general shape of a bear, with no neck and enormous owl-like eyes that give them a terrifying look, yet they appear cartoonish with comically skinny legs and long but absurdly thin arms. Their entire body is covered with thick obsidian-colored hair.

Bugaboos harbor a depraved approach toward combat, often ambushing crawlers and NPCs alike in dark alleys and shadowy areas. They leap out of their hiding places and encircle their victim with their long, sinewy arms. What, exactly, happens next is a matter of some debate, but you don't have to be a genius to know you don't want a Bugaboo grabbing you under *any* circumstances.

AI **Bugaboo. Level 22.**

You know that creepy, unkempt guy who lives on the corner? He doesn't seem to have a job. Has a van. Hangs out at the park with a pair of binoculars? Yeah, you get the idea. Solitary monstrosities that never settle in a single place, Bugaboos may be found anywhere on the dungeon's lower floors, often lying in wait for crawlers to pass by so they can jump out and... do things to them. They'll tell you they just want to cuddle. That's probably a lie.

Bugaboo

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
22	14+F	14+F	20+S	3
STR	**INT**	**CON**	**DEX**	**CHA**
21 (+5)	13 (+4)	21 (+5)	10 (+4)	6 (+3)

Boo Hug: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

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Glad Handed: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Queasy Debuff.

Two-Fisted Take Down: 15+F to hit, 3d10+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff. Can only be used every other round.

Notes: *Extreme Body Odor*—Crawlers ending their turn within 5ft of a Bugaboo must make a Con Stat Check with a Difficulty. On Fail, the crawler gains the Woozy Debuff.

CITY ELVES

The conspiracy-oriented City Elves are considered so stupid that they have been designated their own species. Having traveled from the Sixth Floor Hunting Grounds to the Over City, they formed the uniformed 201st Security Group Militia—a batshit crazy doomsday cult sworn to protect the Skyfowl from flightless creatures and the Oak Fell.

They believe that one of Scolopendra's nine-tier attacks was a Spell that made earthbound creatures want to kill the Skyfowl, and thus protecting Skyfowl will ensure their places in heaven when the goddess Apito, the Oak Mother, ends the world. The cult bases its beliefs on three separate stories, which boil down to:

- Apito said that for anyone to go to heaven, her angels must stay free and alive.
- Apito referred to the Skyfowl "bless-ed."
- Apito said only the angels are "blessed," and if violence against her angels is not stopped, she will destroy all worlds.

These skinny, pale-skinned zealots train their entire lives to defend the Skyfowl and defeat the Oak Fell.

AI

City Elves. Level 15.

You think Jehovah's Witnesses are persistent? Well, get a load of these crazy cultists. They train their entire lives for a chance to defend their religion, their god, and their angels, but boy, do they really suck at it! Maybe they should have gone outside for some fresh air instead of spending all that time locked in the basement, self-flagellating. That bright thing in the sky hurts their eyes, and there never seems to be enough sunscreen to go around. Immortan Joe's War Boys look downright tan next to these pasty zealots.

City Elves

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	13+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
13 (+4)	7 (+3)	13 (+4)	11 (+4)	6 (+3)

Butterfly Knife: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Desert Eagle: 14+F to hit, 3d6 Piercing, 50ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler is pushed 10ft.

Notes: *Fanatical*—City Elves are immune to fear, charm, and mind-affecting effects.

VILLAGE GUARDS

Decked out head-to-toe in plate mail, it's nearly impossible to discern the Race of these Village Guards. Bulky, tall, and carrying a long, steel blade, these guys are practically walking tanks.

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Village Guards are tasked with keeping the peace in the village and will punish any crawlers who attack NPCs, rob stores, or get drunk and pass out in the streets. The penalty for all such crimes is death. Their heavy bodies make them slow, but what they lack in speed, they make up for in numbers, as many of them patrol the village during the day. They're exceptionally strong and highly proficient with their blades.

AI Village Guard. Level 75.

Everyone likes the strong, silent type. To find out what's underneath that helmet, you'll have to first kill the guard. Go ahead and give it a try. I double-dog dare you. They're tasked with protecting the village from the creatures that roam the Over City Ruins. They're only on duty when the sun is up, so don't go whining to them for help when it's dark.

Village Guard

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
75	15+F	14+F	15+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**DEC**	**Cha**
70 (+6)	25 (+5)	100 (+7)	15 (+4)	20 (+5)

Commanding Shout Spell: 15+F to hit, No damage, 100ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Terrified Debuff for 2 rounds.

Longsword: 16+F to hit, 7d10+6 Slashing, 5ft range

Notes: *Letter of the Law*—Village Guards don't compromise or show mercy. If they know someone has broken a law, they attempt to kill the target on sight. They end their pursuit if the target leaves the settlement but remember the target if they return.

GRULKE

Humanoid amphibians that stand about five feet tall, Grulke are slimy toad people who can leap great distances and deliver devastating attacks with their tongues. The Grulke hail from a planet where they serve as a militaristic Race of toad warriors. It's been said that the army of Grulke could stand against any foe.

However, political intrigue and infighting have turned these once-proud people into a Race of mostly mercenaries and vagrants who sell their services to the highest bidder, which is how they ended up in the World Dungeon. Grulke are ruthlessly hunted by tunnel trolls, who like to capture and lick them. Not because they impart any sort of hallucinogenic effect. It's just that tunnel trolls are weird-ass fuckers.

AI Grulke. Level 16.

Grulke are what happens when evolution decides amphibians need opposable thumbs and an attitude problem. Don't ever call a Grulke a frog—they'll take it personally, and they're mean bastards. They're toads, and they know how to fight. Get on their bad side at your own peril, and watch out for their lashing tongues.

Grulke

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
16	14+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	10 (+4)	20 (+5)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)

Polearm: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Slashing, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Slam: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Tongue: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Poison, 20ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Notes: *Great Leaper*—Grulke can leap a distance equal to their Move.

OVER CITY SKYFOWL

A proud people, the Skyfowl of the Third Floor are largely secular and particularly prejudiced against flightless creatures. The ruling class of the Over City, with its scattered settlements, is led by Magistrates and has no unifying government. Skyfowl tend to be xenophobic toward Races without wings but will act indignant when called out for their behavior. As such, they only hire flightless creatures for low-level administrative and clerk jobs.

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These eagle-headed humanoids stand approximately five and a half feet tall and lack independent arms. Instead, their large wings, which fold "angel-like" on their backs, have small finger bones protruding from the center joint. They use the large black talons on their feet as hands, the razor-sharp claws capable of easily rending flesh from bone.

AI Over City Skyfowl. Level 13.

You know that one woman who will absolutely call the HOA on you for leaving your trash cans out fifteen minutes past pickup, then parks her SUV across two spots in the visitor section because "she needs the extra room?" Or maybe that guy who lectures a teenage cashier about the store's non-existent price-match guarantee while his unleashed dog pisses on the endcap display? If you do, then you know all you need to know about the Over City Skyfowl!

Over City Skyfowl

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
13	13+F	14+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
11 (+4)	7 (+3)	7 (+3)	12 (+4)	7 (+3)

Crossbow: 14+F to hit, 3d6 Piercing, 30ft range

Spear: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Piercing, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Grab: 14+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
Any crawler hit gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: Catch and Release—Held crawlers are flown to a height of 30 feet and dropped the next round.

Flight—Over City Skyfowl can move through the air as though on the ground.

Riled Up—During the first round of combat, Over City Skyfowl add their Stat Mod to damage a second time.

ENVIRONMENT

Heavensworth is a small village in the Over City, composed mostly of two-story buildings with upper-level perches to accommodate a Skyfowl population that prefers to fly from building to building. As such, several buildings have unoccupied first floors, with business being conducted only above the ground level.

For flightless creatures, rope ladders and crude elevators are available. Similar to other Skyfowl settlements in the Over City, both the construction and the administration of Heavensworth indicate a severe bias toward Skyfowl with the city magistrate, Alecturis, barely bothering with the flightless in his city.

Nearly half the village was destroyed in Scolopendra's nine-tier attack on the Over City, including the village's temple district and constabulary buildings. The denizens of the village rarely venture out into the ruins, especially at night, due to the dangerous Mobs that roam throughout. The Village Guards routinely patrol during the day to keep the peace and prevent Mobs from the ruins from encroaching, but they retire in the evenings, leaving the streets chaotic and dangerous at night.

The surviving sections of the village experience brisk business during the daylight hours, with

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merchants hawking their wares while both tourists and locals frequent the guildhalls and shops. These areas become more subdued in the evening hours, though groups may roam about in relative safety to sample the shadier offerings available at night.

Rumors currently abound that something hunts in the sky. More and more people are going missing in the night, and as long as it's no one important (like a Skyfowl), the magistrate is content to ignore it.

TRAPS

The Bugaboos and City Elves often employ traps in their operations, but the nature of those traps varies widely due to differences in their tactics and goals. The slower-moving Bugaboos try to immobilize prey with traps or drive prey into a blind alley for an ambush. By contrast, the City Elves travel in large groups and set traps designed to slow down and capture creatures and crawlers that attempt to flee on foot.

- **Collapsing Floors:** Often hidden within gutted buildings in the ruins, the lower-level rooms are lined with spikes, such that when the weakened floor above gives way, crawlers will drop ten feet or more and take additional damage, in addition to being covered by rubble and debris from the collapse.
- **Gravity Inversion Pad:** A large flat surface is magically charged to reverse the gravity of anything that lands on it. These are typically combined with ceiling traps such as mounted spikes or even grids of piano wire for devastating effects on unsuspecting foes.

ITEMS

- **Perches:** Thick wooden logs attached to the sides of buildings by brackets abound on the upper floors of the village. These perches are sturdy enough to support several Skyfowl as they gather to chat or wait.
- **Personal Stabber:** A normal-looking dagger that always returns to its owner. It even engraves the current owner's name onto its pommel. It also carves its owner's name into anything it kills.
- **Rain Barrels:** Large wooden casks scattered around the village catch runoff from the roofs. Most are positioned under eaves and gutters to collect water, though some might be oddly misaligned.
- **Skyfowl Puppet:** Approximately 3 feet tall and with complicated internal controls, this stuffed toy can be used as a puppet by anyone talented enough to pull it off or by any errant puppeteers who've made it this far.
- **Helicopter Hat:** A brightly colored hat with a small propeller on the top of it. This hat allows anyone who wears it to fly for 2 hours, with a 12-hour cooldown. Make sure to put the chin strap on first, or the hat will fly without you. Almost always overpriced and sold exclusively by Skyfowl vendors.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards.

- **Costs an Arm and a Leg:** "You purchased an item from a vendor that costs more than 90% of your total credits.
  Reward: 'Big Spender' title—Vendors and shopkeepers will reduce their prices by 20% when you buy in bulk."
- **Livin' on a Prayer:** "You killed a Neighborhood Boss with no healing items remaining in your inventory.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Medicine Box!"
  Contents: An item that temporarily grants +20% to health regeneration during battle
- **No Rest for the Wicked:** "You've survived 24 consecutive hours without entering a saferoom.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box!"
  Contents: An Enchanted Sleeping Bag that makes you invisible to Mobs while you're inside it—though if they stumble over you accidentally, they'll figure out the rest.
  Note: If this sleeping bag rips, tears, is cut, or modified in any way, it will lose its enchantment and become just a normal sleeping bag.
- **Piece of Cake:** "You cleared an entire Neighborhood without your health dropping below 75%.
  Reward: Too easy, huh? Let's see how the next Neighborhood treats you..."
- **The Floor is Lava:** "You've completed a combat encounter without ever touching the ground.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Adventurer Box!"
  Contents: A tome that teaches the Air Buddy Spell.

> ***"People want to kill Skyfowl because Skyfowl are assholes. They don't need a spell to make people hate them."***
>
> **—Mordecai**

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GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers have decisively defeated a few Mobs in Heavensworth, they might grind for experience by killing lots of the same Mobs over and over. This mostly involves creeping through the ruins to get the drop on Mobs and might include one of the complications on Table 77.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

The village of Heavensworth comprises four quarters that crawlers can explore, both intact and in ruins.

QUARTER: GILDED FEATHERS

The main area of townhouses, a mishmash of well-maintained mercantile shops and smithies. Its wide, inviting streets create a comfortable atmosphere for shoppers, but visitors would do well to be wary of the narrow alleys that branch off the main artery. While dozens of shops fill this area, several guildhalls and stores are of particular interest to crawlers:

- **The Argento Lodge** is a Mage guild where scrolls and other magics can be purchased. While it is small, it does carry the basics.
- **Deathstroke Hall** is a training guild for all manner of melee and nonmagical warriors to gather and train their skills.
- **Secondhand Saviors** sells previously owned equipment. Their prices are reasonable, but they pay squat for used equipment.
- **The Desperado Club** entrance is located in what was once an old restaurant. Its trademark logo is stenciled over the old restaurant's sign.
- **The Gleaming Globe** is an alchemical supplies shop, though the inventory is limited.
- **Twilight Tinkerers** is a training guild for scouts, thieves, and the like.

While the Village Guards are proficient at keeping the peace on the streets of Heavensworth, they are slower to deal with situations around the shops and training guilds. As the crawlers shop, they hear shouts from Secondhand Saviors as someone complains about the price discrepancy between what the shop buys items for and what it resells them for. The dispute between the shopkeeper and a City Elf gets heated. The crawlers can choose to intervene, but they risk being branded as troublemakers by the Village Guards (who are already on their way).

In Secondhand Saviors, the crawlers find most of the equipment for sale to be either redundant or useless. Closer examination, though, reveals a rusty old dagger with a name engraved in the pommel. This is, in fact, a valuable magical item, and once a crawler has it in their possession, the engraved name transforms into their own (see *Personal Stabber*, p. 337).

TABLE 77: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers' repeated use of AOE attacks or heavy weapons causes structural damage, drawing the attention of a large Mob of City Elves who were in town for a major religious gathering.
2	Bugaboos start noticing the crawlers' grinding patterns and begin setting up ambushes where the crawlers typically go to fight Mobs.
3	Viewers in the live audience get bored watching repetitive grinding, causing the AI to send Mobs of Brain Boilers raining down on the crawlers' position.
4	Excessive grinding in the ruins triggers a curse that begins raising undead versions of the recent Mob kills. The curse can be lifted by a complicated ritual in one of the fallen temples or just killing the head undead that emerged first.
5	A group of player-killers stalks the crawlers, setting a variety of traps to funnel the crawlers into a kill zone where their Area of Effect attacks will hit the entire party.
6	A Mob of Skyfowl notices the crawlers' repeated grinding activity and fines them for destruction of public property and littering.

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- While trying to take an elevator in bad repair, the crawlers accidentally break it. The Skyfowl are furious, threatening fines and incarceration time.
  Outcome: Skyfowl are hostile toward the crawlers and unwilling to help or sell them items for a day.
- A Bugaboo pleads for help to save a loved one from a Brain Boiler ambush.
  Outcome: Helping the Bugaboo makes all Bugaboos friendly and willing to help the crawlers.
- A group of City Elves is ambushed by Bugaboos. One of them begs you to help.
  Outcome: Helping the city Elves makes the crawlers part of their cult. Crawlers learn a new ritual that grants the ability to really appreciate nature.
- Fire threatens to consume a grand old oak tree in the ruins. The City Elves are heartbroken, tearing their hair out as they try to fight the blaze.
  Outcome: If the fire is not stopped, the Boss fight may trigger early.
- Grulke are gambling in an alley. One of them tries to entice you to join the game.
  Outcome: Grulkes play for big prizes; there's a lot to be gained and lost if the crawlers don't have a good poker face. This is a rare opportunity to test a crawler's Deception or a custom Gambling Skill.

QUARTER: SKYWARD SANCTUM

Prior to Scolopendra's nine-tier attack on the Over City, the Skyward Sanctum was Heavensworth's once vibrant temple district. Now it's just an eclectic mess of ruins.

Among the stone carcasses stands a single surviving structure. This squat stone building is nestled against a steeply rising rock face reminiscent of Yosemite's *El Capitan*. Carved in the rock face above the building is a depiction of a conical spire, and an engraved sign above the oaken doors reads "Club Vanquisher."

Gathered around a scrub oak in what once was the courtyard of a large temple is a Mob of City Elves. They form a semi-circle around a makeshift altar at the base of the scrawny tree, fervently praying. As the crawlers approach, one of the Elves reverently ties a thick band of yellow caution tape around the trunk of the tree and then falls to his knees, chanting rhythmically.

These are members of a zealous cult that worship Apito and revere Skyfowl as her angels. Seeing the crawlers, several begin proselytizing with reverence about the winged angels. If a crawler makes a derogatory remark against the Skyfowl or Apito or their beliefs, the Elves immediately attack. Crawlers can attempt to befriend the Elves by tying something yellow around the tree and/or by worshiping Apito.

As the crawlers search through the ruins, they come across a large stuffed eagle puppet with bushy black eyebrows, roughly 3 feet long, constructed of soft blue fabric with a smattering of feathers. With some practice, a crawler can make it appear as if the puppet is acting and talking. City Elves shown the puppet don't know what to make of it, perhaps even thinking it possessed by an evil spirit, depending on the crawlers' creativity. They may even attempt to sway the City Elves once, even if the Elves are angry with them because of blasphemy. The Elves can be mesmerized by the talking puppet and can be persuaded to work on behalf of the crawlers for a short time, as directed by the puppet.

QUARTER: THE ROOSTS

The residential district of Heavensworth is designed primarily for Skyfowl and their needs, and ground-bound folk are looked down upon both figuratively and practically. None of the buildings in the Roosts have ground floor entrances. Those with non-flying occupants have lifts retrofitted into their structures, as do those homes of the more tolerant Skyfowl.

Skyfowl are territorial assholes, so it's fairly common for them to interrogate crawlers about their business when they are found in the Roosts. If a group of Skyfowl come across crawlers, they will likely try to make an example of them, regardless of whether or not the crawlers have legitimate business in the Roosts.

While transiting through the Roosts, the crawlers come across a flightless Skyfowl named Jared, his wings clipped to prevent him from flying. He holds his brethren in low regard, having been punished for aiding a wronged non-flying creature against a Skyfowl in a dispute. He is more than willing to share his knowledge of Heavensworth and the

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Skyfowl with the crawlers, especially if the crawlers intend to do something to disrupt the current Skyfowl administration.

The magistrate, Alecturis, lives here but does not entertain guests. His home is the largest and closest to the ruins of the Fallen Watch. If the crawlers get inside, they find several things oversized for the relatively small Alecturis. The former warden, corrupted by the curse, still comes to this home on occasion, and Alecturis hides the creature responsible for so many murders. Ambushing Jack Screecher here might require dispatching Alecturis as well.

QUARTER: FALLEN WATCH

In these ruins, the crawlers discover the remains of Heavensworth's old watch station and prison, some of the few abandoned structures that still have the upper floors intact. Their reinforced foundation and framework were designed to withstand several external blasts, which allowed the structures to survive Scolopendra's nine-tier attack on the Over City.

The watch station's windows and doors have been blown in, but otherwise, the station appears almost normal among the ruins. A closer inspection of the ruins around the building's perimeter reveals numerous scattered skeletons which appear to be from Grulke Mobs, their bones broken and bleached pristine.

Idling on the watch station's roof is a Strong group of Brain Boilers. The stalwart nature of the surviving watch station has proven of great interest to passersby, making it a lucrative hunting ground for the gliding creatures.

Just outside this ring of skeletons, a Grulke is attempting to hide. He was part of a hunting party that came across the structure and was attacked by the Brain Boilers. He observed firsthand how they descended upon his team, then killed and methodically stripped them down to the bone. He warns off the crawlers before they get to the kill zone. His name is Steve, and he can give the crawlers insights into the dangers in the ruins and connect them with the band of Grulke who live near Heavensworth.

From Steve, the crawlers can learn about the animosity between the Grulke and the City Elves. The Grulke believe the City Elves are false prophets and the Skyfowl are not Apito's angels. Steve warns the crawlers of the dangerous Boss lurking within the old prison, as well as the ruined temple of Apito where the City Elves gather.

Past the old watch station lies the old prison, its walls still standing strong even though the gates are wide open, allowing easy entry for crawlers bold enough to take that invitation.

NPCS

While the native population of Heavensworth is composed mostly of Skyfowl, many other creatures frequent the village. Some are looking for an out-of-the-way place to lay low, while others enjoy the relative peace and quiet of life up in the mountains.

MARGIT WINCHGRINDER

A long-time lift engineer in the dwarven diamond mines, Margit builds ground-bound creature-accessible lifts for the many Skyfowl public structures that lack easy access for the flight-challenged. While she enjoys the work, her first passion is dancing, and she can often be found at one of the local clubs drumming up interest.

Her thick beard and squat physique often lead her to being misgendered, which she unabashedly corrects by lifting her shirt to expose a bare, ample bosom. Margit is a master engineer and can assist crawlers with technical crafting—if they humor her with a dance or two and perhaps ply her with stout dwarven draughts.

AI **Margit Winchgrinder. Dwarf. Level 25.**

Dwarven Lift Engineer.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

This dancing queen has a heart of gold and arms like steel cables. Need a tool? She's bound to have it tied up in her ready-access beard braids. Want some help crafting the perfect trap or some structural defenses? Margit is happy to lend a hand, or if nothing else, she'll tell you all the ways you messed things up and could do it better. And she'll do it in excruciating technical detail.

Dwarven Lift Engineer

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
25	15+F	14+F	20+S	3

Str	Int	Con	Dex	Cha
21 (+5)	21 (+5)	21 (+5)	10 (+4)	7 (+3)

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Dance Dance Evolution: 14+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Queasy Debuff.

Disapproving Glare: 14+F to hit, 2d6+5 Psychic, 25ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

Wrench: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Craft Master*—Dwarven Lift Engineers can assist crawlers in crafting. Crawlers gain Advantage on their crafting Skill Checks when aided in this manner.

Dancing Queen—Dwarven Lift Engineers are in a constant whirl of motion. Crawlers attempting to follow their movements must make an INT-Opposed Tracking Skill Check. On Fail, the crawler gains the Fatigued Debuff.

Ready Access Tools—Dwarven Lift Engineers have an Inventory system built into their ornate beard braids. They can instantly retrieve any required tool smaller than themselves as needed.

ANNIE HARISTON

Previously a nail salon technician from Spanaway, Annie Hariston made her way into the dungeon with several of her friends as they were out for a bachelorette party. She eventually split from her former friends when two of them became Dog Soldiers after she selected the Cat Girl Race on the Third Floor.

Obsessed with her new claws in this furry new body, she's just shy of being a full kleptomaniac but friendly and happy to work with other crawlers as long as they take good care of their nails.

AI **Crawler #11,121,982. "Annie H."**
Level 24.
Race: Cat Girl.
Class: Trickster.

Cat Girl

Crawler; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
24	15+F	15+F	20+S	3
STR	**INT**	**CON**	**DEX**	**CHA**
11 (+4)	21 (+5)	12 (+4)	21 (+5)	12 (+4)

Claw: 14+F to hit, 3d4+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Hairball: 15+F to hit, 3d6 Acid, 20ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Tail Lash: 14+F to hit, 3d4+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Klepto*—Cat Girls can't be trusted, obviously. Crawlers encountering a Cat Girl for the first time must make an INT Stat Check. On Fail, the crawler loses one low value item they are wearing without realizing it.

Pheromones—Cat Girls secrete a pheromone that makes others agreeable with them. Crawlers that join a party with a Cat Girl must make an INT Stat Check. On Fail, they must comply with the first non-harmful suggestion made by the Cat Girl.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Heavensworth's old prison is one of the few structures in the ruins whose upper floors are still intact. It towers over the remains and rubble of the other buildings in the area, making it the perfect vantage point for observing approaching enemies. When the crawlers enter the ancient prison, steel bars drop, blocking the doors and windows, as the ceiling above them opens to reveal a large atrium spanning the upper two levels. The high-pitched screeching of a massive Skyfowl echoes throughout the chamber, making it difficult for the crawlers to concentrate on their spellcasting.

As the crawlers turn their gaze upward, the voiceover begins, and an image of a bronze-feathered barrel-chested Skyfowl appears alongside those of the crawlers. Words displayed under the image read "Jack Screecher" and are accented with patriotic fireworks.

The creature itself is easily twice the size of any other Skyfowl in the village, and as it comes soaring down, it appears to be nearly three meters of solid avian muscle with talons the length of bayonets. Its massive wingspan is enough to clothesline several crawlers at once, and it emits an ear-piercing scream that fills the atrium.

The Boss uses his powerful scream to disrupt spellcasters as he closes in to rake his foes with his powerful talons. At the end of his talon attack,

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the Boss attempts to grab any spellcasters and take them to the top of the atrium, where they will be quickly dismembered. While Jack Screecher excels in direct confrontations, surprise attacks, and ambushes that catch him unaware can prevent him from using defensive stances that would normally decrease the damage he takes.

CLUES

- The Boss has a terrifying screech that affects multiple targets.
- When the Boss successfully hits you, it makes it easier for him to hit you again.
- When the Boss misses you, it makes it harder for him to hit you again.

AI Jack Screecher. Centurion Skyfowl.

Level 25 Neighborhood Boss!

A former centurion brawler and metalhead, he's killed in ways that language hasn't even invented words for yet. This one bird army—make that air force—wears no uniform, colors, or crest. His only allegiance now is to wreaking havoc on the crawlers that dare invade his lair.

Centurion Skyfowl

Neighborhood Boss; Huge (6), Beastly

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	15%	23%	30%	38%	46%	53%	61%	69%	76%	84%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
25	14+F	15+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	11 (+4)	21 (+5)	21 (+5)	6 (+3)

Aerial Head Slam: 15+F to hit, 2d10+5 Bludgeoning, 5 ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Staggered and Take Down Debuffs.

Sonic Screech: 14+F to hit, 2d10+4 Sonic, 30ft Cone, +5ft Splash
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

Talon Slash: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: Heavy Hitter—If Jack Screecher's previous attack hits a crawler, that crawler has Disadvantage on their next Evade attempt. If Jack Screecher's previous attack misses a crawler, that crawler has Advantage on their next Evade attempt.

Flight—Jack Screecher can move through the air as though on the ground.

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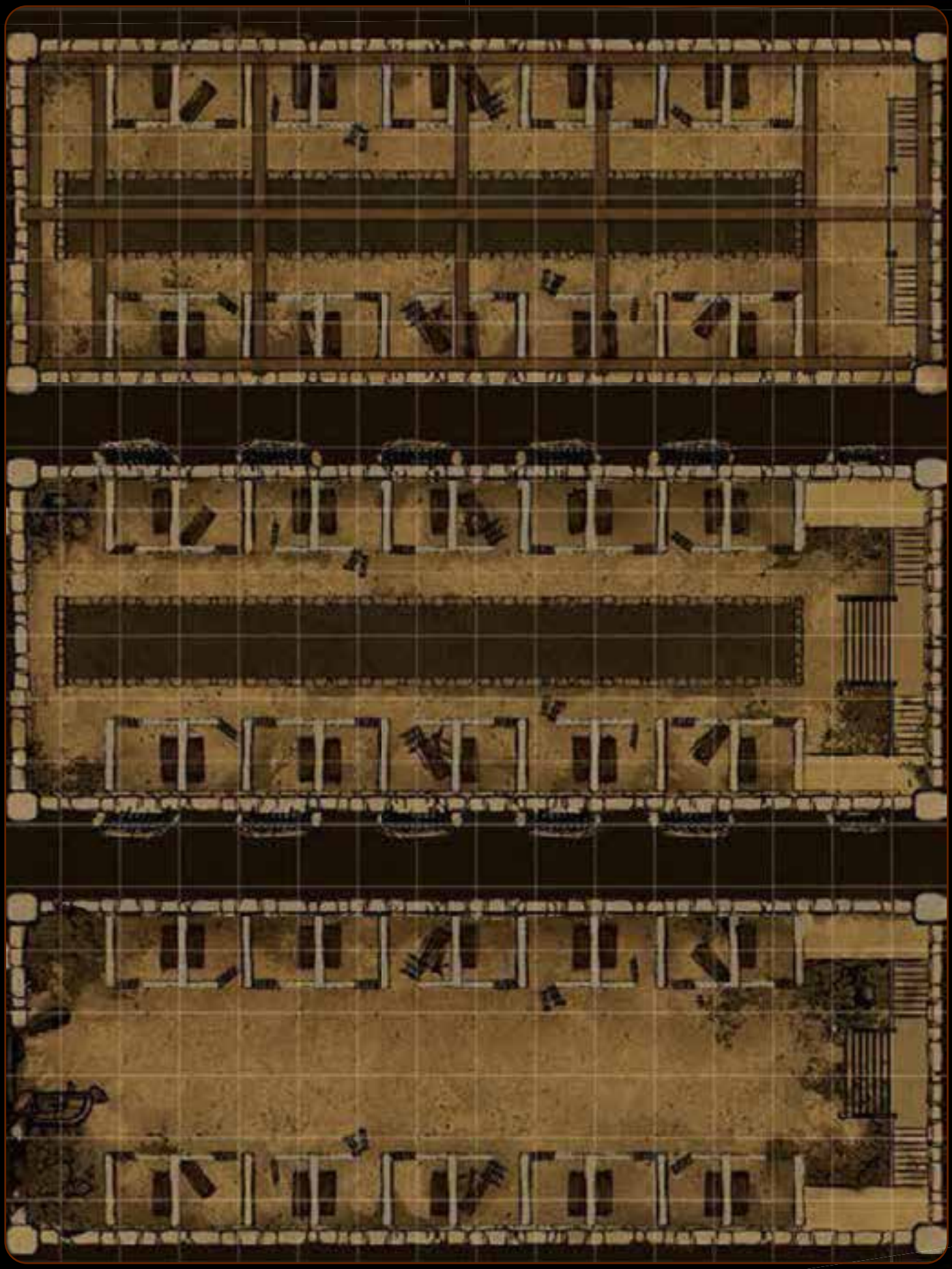

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NEIGHBORHOOD: NOIR TOWN

FLOOR: 3 — THEME: HARD-BOILED NOIR... IN MONOCHROME.

Aliens saw our noir films, they read about our hard-boiled detectives, and Noir Town is their interpretation of that genre. It's a dark city, a rainy city, a corrupt city where puddles on the street reflect gaudy neon lights, and steam rises from grates as if a giant boiler blazed beneath the concrete.

Gangs dwell here, trying to muscle in on each other's turf. Between them stand Beat Cops and Effective Detectives, all looking to twist a stool pigeon and make them drop a dime on the usual suspects. It's part Chicago and part L.A., a city that never was.

But here in the World Dungeon, all things are possible, and, if you've seen enough Turner Classic Movie noir marathons, you just might survive. Crime is rampant, and mooks are ever at the ready, some with a Chicago Typewriter ready to spell out your name in lead. Anyway, pally, it all leads to a showdown with a Divider at the docks.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood.

- An NPC in another Neighborhood asks for help finding something called the Maltese Falcon in Noir Town. They'll pay in upgrades, tips, and maybe even a map.
- A jazz musician crawler made their way into Noir Town from another Neighborhood. They say the best tunes are in Noir Town and claim that if you can learn them, they put some Mobs right into a trance. Is it true?
- Crawlers tell the party about a giant sea monster called the Divider, who serves as the Boss of this town. They say his body count is legendary, and he's scarier than Jaws.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you'll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures!

- The Maltese Falcon—it's the stuff dreams are made of. It's solid gold. Most importantly, it's in the public domain now (though that never stopped the likes of the Borant Corporation from ripping off someone else's intellectual property).
- The Maltese Falcon is a classic MacGuffin. In Noir Town, hustlers and hoods, debutantes and debauchees, all are after it. Zoe Salt (p. 352) is part of the plot. Anyone else can be, too. The treasure is hidden wherever the GM wants. The more important bit is this: people will betray and even kill each other for it. Play it up. Maybe, in the World Dungeon, the Maltese Falcon really is solid gold.
- A local politician's NPC daughter, Fiona, has ventured into the underground. She's carousing with unsavory types doing unsavory things, and the World Dungeon set it up as a Quest for willing crawlers. Find her and bring her back to High Town Gables (p. 350).
- A famous star (take your pick of real or imagined celebrities) needs bodyguards. This person is a crawler. Now, they feel like their pampered life ought to include protection. Yeah, they're in denial, but the World Dungeon wants to kill everyone and doesn't discriminate (well, not usually). Anyway, they know something the party wants to know or can otherwise help. Get your gats and see who else is gunning for this one-time star.

I was hollow and as empty as the spaces between the stars.

—Raymond Chandler

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MOBS

The Mobs found in Noir Town generally cleave to noir archetypes. Of course, Borant takes things literally, and many are as subtle as a lead foot on your neck. They're also usually armed with guns, automatic or otherwise. On the upside, the Mobs here also fight among themselves, so crawlers might be able to pit them against each other and start a turf war. Then again, maybe they'll get a cement overcoat for their trouble.

BEAT COPS

Once upon a time on Earth, there was a show called *Cop Rock,* an attempt to blend the police procedural with musical theater. Yeah, it was fucking awful. These Beat Cops are no better. They dance in unison like they're straight out of *West Side Story*, then they'll beat you down like it's a Vietnam War protest.

They're tough, hard-headed (hey, they *are* robots), and will toss you in the Pattie Wagon if you cross 'em. What's a Pattie Wagon, you ask? Well, friends, it's a giant grill designed to slice, dice, and fry crawlers up into patties, which are sold as delicacies to the organic Mobs of Noir Town.

AI **Beat Cops. Level 10.**

Robot cops who dance—and smash—to self-generated beatbox rhythms with a jazzy flare. They dress in old-timey uniforms, wield truncheons with abandon, and stand ready to whap you on the head for all transgressions, small and large. They back each other up, and if they get you against the wall, it's the Pattie Wagon for you!

Beat Cop

Mob; Medium (4), Construct

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	11+F	12+F	20+S	3
STR	**INT**	**CON**	**DEX**	**CHA**
12 (+4)	2 (+1)	10 (+4)	5 (+2)	6 (+3)

Beatbox: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Sonic, 15ft Burst radius

Truncheon: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Notes: It's Curtains for You—Beat Cops dance in sync even when not attacking. Any crawler witnessing two or more Beat Cops dancing together must make a CHA Stat Check with a Difficulty of 10+F plus the number of Beat Cops. On Fail, the crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

On the Beat—Beat Cops prefer fighting in sync. When adjacent Beat Cops perform the same attack during a round, each one gains a +1 bonus to hit and damage for each adjacent attacking Beat Cop, up to a maximum of +3. When a crawler is hit for 3+ HB slots, they can make a free Unopposed Performance Skill Check to see the pattern. On Success, they notice the pattern and can add their INT as a bonus to Evade these attacks. Once one crawler notices the pattern, the remaining crawlers do also and gain the same INT bonus.

Robot—Beat Cops are metal robots and immune to Psychic damage, but their DR is 0 against Electric attacks. Can they bleed or be poisoned? Probably! (They bleed oil and suffer corrosion—robots, they're just like us!)

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EFFECTIVE DETECTIVES

Are they on the take? Probably. But that doesn't mean you can ignore their huge golden shields emblazoned with Noir Town's iconic sigil (that's a *badge* to you, pal). The detectives also have gats, and with both, they can form a phalanx capable of trampling unfortunate crawlers.

They're smarter than Beat Cops and love to ambush, so watch your step. As a bonus, these guys can slap clamp-like collars on crawlers, taking away some of their abilities.

AI Effective Detective. Level 15.

These coppers keep their badges hidden until the need to flash them arises. They're Orcs by the look of 'em, though they certainly think they're the bee's knees. These plainclothes Effective Detectives will follow your trail, sleuthing through the slums and sunsets of the city, all while keeping a rap sheet on you. Then, when they have enough to collar you, they do—literally.

Effective Detective

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	15+F	14+F	20+S	3
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
11 (+4)	**20 (+5)**	**6 (+3)**	**10 (+4)**	**3 (+2)**

Gat: 14+F to hit, 2d10 Piercing, 100ft range

Lowdown Peeper (Spell): 15+F to hit, 2d4+5 Psychic, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Queasy Debuff.

Punch: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Collared Debuff: Cannot use attacks with Rank higher than 5.

Notes: *Qualified Immunity*—An Effective Detective's badge expands into a body-length shield when wielded, adding a +2 DR Buff against foes directly in front of them. Multiple Effective Detectives can stand side by side, forming a phalanx that increases this bonus to +4 but reduces their Step to 0ft.

MOOKS

Mooks are typically Orc thugs (and other races) employed by all sorts of gangsters, louts, union strikebreakers, and other heels. These goons are armed with melee weapons like chains, crowbars, tire irons, saps, broken bottles, knives, and anything else they can get their filthy hands on.

They're known to intimidate first, then attack. They aren't prone to ambushes—that's too much thinkin' for the likes o' them. What they lack in smarts (and we're talking a bankrupting deficit here) they make up for in numbers and durability.

AI Mooks. Level 17.

The hoi polloi, thugs, strongarms—call them what you will, Mooks are an essential part of the noir experience. They're the original Mob—a "mob" being defined as an angry group of armed people turned loose with abandon. They wear clothes befitting the period: caps and suspenders, cheap shirts, and work boots. These people are mad at the world and everything in it. They shout and jeer, taunting before they charge. Often, they work for a gang, also called an outfit.

Mook

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
17	13+F	14+F	20+S	3
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
16 (+4)	6 (+3)	13 (+4)	12 (+4)	8 (+3)

Improvised Melee Weapon: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Improvised Thrown Weapon: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Slashing, 20ft range

Big Fuckin' Insult: 13+F to hit, No damage, 60ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Enraged or Terrified Debuff (GM's choice depending on character's personality).

Notes: *Yer Goin' Down with Me*—Mooks were dealt bad hands in life, and their anger at the world means they want to take everyone else down with them. When Mooks have fewer than half of their HB slots left, they gain the Enraged Debuff, focusing their attacks on whoever last damaged them and gaining a +2 bonus to hit and damage.

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GUMSHOES

These guys are hired muscle backed by brains. They employ smart tactics, gathering information about crawlers before attacking them, and they usually attack in a place of their choosing, too.

Their unique rubbery ability to bounce means they can dodge attacks and jump over crawlers' heads to attack them from behind or to reflect damage back to anyone dumb enough to fight them. These guys talk in tough lingo, using terminology like "dames" and "stoolies," "heaps" (that's a car to you) and "rods" (guns).

AI Gumshoes. Level 19.

Thanks to the rubbery gum-like substance these guys are made of, attacks bounce back straight towards you. Looking more like unseasoned raw ground pork shaped into an Orc, their bright-pink gum-like skin gives them the ability to leap and bound with the skill of seasoned circus performers. Wearing trench coats and fedoras, these guys pound the pavement looking for their prey. They ask questions, follow clues, and bribe others to get the scoop. They have gats ready to go, but they prefer a good ambush for face-to-face encounters.

Gumshoe

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
19	15+F	15+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
3 (+2)	20 (+5)	16 (+4)	20 (+5)	3 (+2)

Exposé Spell: 15+F to hit, 2d8+5 Psychic, 60ft range, 15ft Blast radius
Any hit crawler must make an Int Stat Check. On Fail, they gain the Dodgy Reputation Debuff: The crawler's HUD is flooded with dark secrets about one other crawler who is participating in the combat, chosen by the Gumshoe. Any Buffs provided by the chosen crawler are ineffective until the end of the encounter. This Debuff stacks for each unique subject of Exposé.

Gat: 15+F to hit, 3d10 Piercing, 100ft range

Notes: *Clean Sneak*—Gumshoes can Hide in Shadows. Crawlers must make an Int-Opposed Perception Skill Check to spot them. On Fail, the Gumshoes may successfully Ambush the crawlers.

Glom a Bulge—That means "spotting an advantage" in noir slang. Get your mind out of the gutter! A Gumshoe can shout out advice about a target to an ally instead of attacking, granting the ally Advantage on their attack against the target.

Grab Air—Gumshoes can leap high into the air when they Move, allowing them to move over occupied spaces without triggering Interrupts and land up to 10ft higher than their starting space.

GUN DOLLS

They used to hang on the arms of Torpedoes, but now the Gun Dolls have struck out on their own. They're well-dressed and well-armed, and they hold a grudge against anyone in the party that reminds them of a Torpedo (i.e., a Fighter type). The blues soundtrack accompanying them whenever they arrive on scene makes crawlers and some Mobs sleepy. If too many of them get around you, well, you're going to be sleeping with the fishes.

AI Gun Dolls. Level 20

Whether sporting short-haired bobs or golden locks that spill like a waterfall onto the shoulder of a green silk dress, these dolls look like pint-size Cabbage Patch kids with the makeup of a two-bit trollop but are fully automated. They're also fully armed. As in, their tiny arms are not-so-tiny machine guns. While small, their guns fire real bullets. They also come with their own blues music that can make even the toughest mac drowsy. Maybe you'll hear it before they fire, or maybe by the time it graces your ears, it'll already be too late.

Gun Doll

Mob; Small (2), Construct

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80&	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	13+F	15+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
11 (+3)	14 (+3)	6 (+3)	22 (+5)	12 (+4)

Bean Shooter: 15+F to hit, 3d6 Piercing, 80ft range

Pocket Knife: 15+F to hit, 3d6+3Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

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Notes: *Blues Got You Down*—If a crawler kills a Gun Doll with a melee attack, she whispers her tragic backstory with her dying breaths. The crawler gains Disadvantage on their next attack.

Swarm—While Gun Dolls prefer their eponymous weapons, their small size allows up to 6 of them to share the space of a medium or larger creature. If outmatched at range, their last resort is to all clamber onto a single target and stab, stab, stab! They each gain Advantage on their first attack against that target.

TORPEDOES

These cartilaginous fish-fellas wear bespoke pinstriped suits, canary-yellow ties, and fedoras as snappy as a comedian's comeback. Their Thompson submachine guns, notorious as the Chicago Typewriter, spit lead in a near-constant stream and resonate with a distinct rattle that crawlers can hear from a considerable distance.

Torpedoes are serious killers. They don't attack randomly—only after crawlers have wiped out some Mooks or Beat Cops prior. You're gonna want cover when the .45s fly, so be ready for more than just melee. They don't truck with no punks, see? And you and your fellow crawlers? You're lowlifes, all.

AI **Torpedoes, Karkharodon. Level 17**

Landsharks with torpedo snouts, these fish-fellas are the heavy-hitters the outfits call when they need someone knocked off, know what I mean? If their submachine guns don't do the trick, their huge jaws and multiple rows of sharp teeth usually do. And failing that, the explosive tips of their noses detonate when they decide that you—and they—have had enough.

Torpedo

Mob; Medium (4), Shark, Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
17	12+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	3 (+2)	10 (+4)	20 (+5)	3 (+2)

Chomp: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

Submachine Gun: 14+F to hit, 2d10 Piercing, 60ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler is pushed 10ft.

Torpedo: 15+F to hit, 2d12+5 Fire, 15ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Burned Debuff. Can be used once per combat; deals full damage to self as well.

Notes: Blow *'Em Down*—Torpedoes are out to kill their mark, and they don't care who else they off along the way. Similarly, they have no problem catching allies or bystanders in the crossfire of their submachine guns.

ENVIRONMENT

This town is cast in grayscale, monochrome and two-tone, with severe contrast between light and dark. Scolopendra's curse stripped all the color from this city aside from the occasional lurid neon, gleaming gold, or bloody red. It rains most of the time, and when it doesn't, a smog hangs over everything like an unwelcome guest.

The ruins from which the city is constructed have been fixed up in most quarters, mimicking the cities of the 1940s United States: dark alleys, cars with big fenders and running boards, squeaking trams, elevated trains showering you with sparks—but it's almost all show. You can enter the first floor of some buildings, but, much like the video games the World Dungeon takes inspiration from, some are mere facades.

Take every Bogart movie you've seen and throw it in a pot with Raymond Chandler's novels, and you'll get Noir Town. It's a mash-up of a genre already leaning well into parody. Everyone speaks with a Transatlantic accent, and no descriptions are plain. There's always a simile to be found:

- The docks exhaled fog like a lifetime smoker.
- In this neighborhood, the fresh paint on the bar would last as long as a cop's oath.

People with money flaunt it in their High Town Gables mansions; those without languish in the filth of Skid Row. Just like the neighborhood itself is in monochrome, so, too, are the extremes. There are no gray areas here, save for morality itself—and most of Noir Town's occupants step right over it into total darkness. Everyone's got an angle, and if you find someone who ain't corrupt, *run*, 'cause they're the most dangerous cats of all.

- Roads are always wet. Reflections of neon lights twist in the puddles, beckoning from the glass overhead. Screeching cars whip around corners with no heed for pedestrians. Sirens wail in the distance. Sometimes, they get closer. Wherever you want to go, you're taking a street—or a back alley.

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- Fish Cakes is the neon-lit "gentleman's club" where all kinds of shady deals go down, and the Fin Fatales (Karkharodons of all genders squeezed into sleek, sexy dresses or sharp suits) circle the place looking for an easy mark.
- Play It Again Sam's is a bar where crawlers can stop to rest and trade information, but this should not be confused with a saferoom. Inside, NPCs (robotic and otherwise) drink, look glum, and hustle each other. The piano always plays As Time Goes By.

TRAPS

Mobs don't set traps, save for the Beat Cops. Those flatfoots set up speed traps, so watch out for 'em. Everything else is themed to smoky jazz clubs after midnight, to rainy weather and cheap lives, a toast to the mid-century in a world that is no more. Themed to rainy weather and cheap lives. Traps are no exception.

- **Speed Trap:** If crawlers move too fast through the Neighborhood (be it running or chewing through Mobs with ease), a Speed Trap can trigger. Speed Traps make the whole party feel like they're on amphetamines: They shake. They move too fast. They grind their jaws. This lasts until the GM decides it stops. It might give them an advantage in certain situations, but it also might cause debilitating paranoia.
- **Pool Halls:** Triggering one of these traps transforms the street into a thoroughfare of green felt just before giant billiard balls come rolling down. They'll roll right over anyone in the way. You better find a store with a real interior (as opposed to one of the many facades lining the streets), or a house, or some other cover before one of the balls pockets you!
- **Red Tape:** City Hall is on to you. When the way ahead becomes blocked with red tape, it works like a web, sticking to you and winding around until you're cocooned in it. What would we do without the government?
- **Corrupting Coin:** Everyone in Noir Town wants money. It makes the world go round. But some money corrupts. After the crawlers get loot, the GM may elect to give some of it in Corrupting Coin. These coins are identical in every way to regular gold coins, except the crawler holding the coin only wants to get more gold by any means necessary and can't say no if offered money. Since it looks just like every other coin, the only way to end the curse is to get rid of all your gold. Ain't you a real Mother Theresa?

ITEMS

Noir Town is full of antiquated things. Some are even useful:

- **Nice Heap:** A "heap" is slang for a car. A Nice Heap is a nice car, always silver in color, and they provide good cover from gats and tommy guns.
- **Pay Phone:** The crawlers can call any place they've seen or been and get information. Of course, they need a nickel or a dime to do so. Long-distance calls cost extra.
- **Nickels and Dimes:** Special silver coins unique to this Neighborhood. These are not gold, but they do allow crawlers to operate cigarette machines, pay phones, and parking meters—and to buy coffee (which provides a speed boost).

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards.

- **Chandleresque:** "You solved a mystery! Sure, it wasn't a big or important one, but as far as the dungeon is concerned, you might as well be the next Philip Marlowe.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box."
  Contents: A one-time-use " fast-talking" pass. This pass allows the crawler (and their party) to skip the next Mob encounter by being a wise guy with words.
- **The Maltese Falcon** (See Story Arcs, p. 344):
  "You've discovered the mythical and highly prized Maltese Falcon. Some thought it merely a story, while others lost everything they had searching for it. Then you show up and find it in, what, like, five minutes? Talk about plot armor!
  Reward: You immediately skip to the Boss fight. No passing go. No collecting 200 dollars. The Maltese Falcon is what everyone in the quarter wants, but only one party can get it. You found it... now you get to defend your right to keep it."
- **Real Shamus:** "You solved a difficult puzzle (or disabled a tricky trap, or unwound a social tangle). Looks like all those late nights searching your lonely studio apartment for the missing piece from your 3D Eiffel Tower jigsaw puzzle finally paid off, huh?
  Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box."
  Contents: A healing potion (because shamuses get beaten up a lot) and a huge clue to the next trap, puzzle, or social situation. GM's option: the crawler (and party) can skip the next trap or puzzle.

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GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Grinding can be, well, a grind. It's fun in video games but boring in narrative. Instead of making your crawlers go through endless Mobs, try the complications in Table 78 after they've killed a Mob type a couple of times.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: SKID ROW

Shotgun houses gone to rot, tenements, rats, bugs, and the pervasive smell of garbage and desperation mark this quarter. Scolopendra's curse wrecked this place, like owning a cocker spaniel wrecks your chance of ever finding love.

Everyone here looks unhappy, whether they're organic, robotic, or anything in between. It doesn't matter. They all lurk at the bottom of the social ladder. When they look up, they see the gutter *above* them, okay? But these folks are tough. Mooks love Skid Row. They come down here and put the squeeze on people who've been squeezed to their limit. Why? 'Cause they're mean bastards, that's why! This is a world of lowlifes who prey on the weak and the weak who get preyed on. If you're inclined to help the community impose some much-needed justice, the folks here can't give you much in the way of a monetary reward. But if you do them a good turn and slug it out with a Mob roughing them up, they might just have your back in a future encounter.

A resident (or residents) begs for money. They're relentless. They hassle and harangue the crawlers.

If a crawler buys off the folks from the previous encounter, a local low-level gangster approaches them with a job offer. Said gangster will give them a suitable reward for the task. He says they have moxie. Whether he means it as a compliment or he means that "Moxie" is the name of the Boss's missing pet tarantula, well, that's up to the GM to decide.

QUARTER: HIGH TOWN GABLES

Mansions, swimming pools, movie stars—how else could we describe the rich part of town? Think long driveways and houses like castles. Spanish Colonial Revival meets Art Deco meets Old Hollywood. The cars shine like wet candy, and a chauffeur stands out there, in the sunshine (because it never rains *here*), buffing the hood right now.

But just like a guy who's a real knockout until his war paint comes off, this neighborhood's beauty is only skin-deep, though. Everything beyond this high-end facade is dangerous and corrupt. The hunting trophies

TABLE 78: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers find an NPC they previously met inside the room/building/alley of a Mob they just took down. The NPC is badly wounded and needs their help. What's more, that NPC may be key to a mystery (see Story Arcs, p. 344). Without their help, the crawlers can't solve the puzzle.
2	While fighting one Mob, another Mob arrives. Since Noir Town is a hotbed of gang activity and warring factions, the crawlers now have enemies on two sides.
3	Someone important to Noir Town was caught in the crossfire of the crawlers' last fight, and they died. Now information is harder to come by, and the NPC folks in the streets clam up. Beat Cops are after the crawlers now as well.
4	A wound taken during combat can only be fixed by an underground disgraced doctor who has the specific type of healing potion needed to address that condition. The party must find them and convince them to help.
5	While the crawlers are grinding, some NPC street urchins (metaphorical ones, not the floor's Janitor Mob) lifted an important item from one crawler. They must track down the right kid to get it back. This can tie into the sewers in the Red-Light District (p. 351).
6	A different NPC street urchin, or a pack of them, witnessed the crawlers' last battle. They now view them as heroes as they follow them everywhere. They're as annoying as a geezer going on about how things were in "his day," and their presence complicates future Mob encounters.

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- The rain falls heavily. It falls sideways. Fingers of it rattle your head, picking at your brain. The descriptions keep on coming. Maybe you should write some of these down.
  Outcome: The crawlers are distracted in their next or current encounter. Apply penalties or Debuffs as the GM sees fit.
- A car screeches through the street and skids.
  Outcome: The crawlers must dodge the vehicle or be injured. Following it might lead to a plot (*Story Arcs*, p. 344).
- Crossfire erupts. Tommy guns let loose!
  Outcome: Find cover, dodge, or eat a lead salad!
- Blues, jazz, and strings play over the scene. The music follows you if you try to get away. Oh, damn, you have your own soundtrack now!
  Outcome: Get rid of the soundtrack or say goodbye to ambushing anyone in the future. Also, your position is much harder (if not impossible) to conceal from any Mobs pursuing you.

on the walls come to life and attack you. The butlers eavesdrop on your plans, and the heiresses hide scandalous secrets. Almost everyone employs Gumshoes as bodyguards, if not Torpedoes. Don't get any wise ideas.

If trying to access a mansion, the crawlers must fight a Torpedo or Gumshoe Mob. As they do, the wealthy homeowners also call the Beat Cops. It's a double-rumble that most crawler parties can't face all at once. Beat feet, slick boys!

A rich debutante, Carmen Sternwood, did wrong by her father. He's an old man named General Sternwood who wants the crawlers to acquire some "incriminating photos" of her taken at a house somewhere in the quarter. This is a stealth mission: get the photo plates and bring them back. If they do, the general gives them a lot of gold. To him, it's pocket change and well worth the price of knowing the truth about his daughter's misdeeds.

If the crawlers complete the photo mission, the old general has another mission for them: find Red McGee, a man who was previously married to his wayward daughter and has been missing for some time. He'll pay even better this time. Red's a sad man, a noble soul in a world that left nobility behind. Heavy stuff. The audience loves it.

QUARTER: THE RED-LIGHT DISTRICT

Glitz and sleaze. High times and low lives. Rain pours down in wretched sheets, tugging the neon lights out of the storefront windows and onto the windscreens of every car. Hustlers stoop over green felt swards in pool halls, rolling toothpicks in their mouths and pool cues in their hands. Gaudy women stand in the windows of disreputable establishments, beckoning passersby to try a taste. Illegal gambling abounds, and the most common wager is your life.

The Red-Light District is the beating heart of Noir Town's vice. It's always raining here. Someone is always losing. Someone is always crying. It's the repository for everything cheap, fast, and illicit about the noir genre.

And the aliens? Hell, Borant thinks the world was really like this. Maybe it was. It's not for you to decide, but it *is* for you to wade through the falling pachinko balls, to maneuver past the sharps working the card tables, to step over the bums lying face-down in the gutter and get out—out of Noir Town.

Pick any bar, any pool hall, any arcade, and a fight *will* break out. The fight itself is against a Mob of the GM's choice, but the terrain matters. Not only are crawlers inside some den of iniquity, but NPC bystanders are everywhere, getting in the way. They'll pull crawlers' hair, trip 'em, and otherwise do whatever it takes to get back to their fun, their gaming, and their vices.

A bunch of kids swarm the crawlers. They're professional thieves posing as newsies. They try to lift and pocket anything of value, and if they succeed, the crawlers either give up those items or must track down these little bastards to reclaim their possessions.

If the crawlers are victims of theft as above, and if they track down the little runts that robbed them, they find an underground sewer system where the king of these little thieves lives. The place is a maze, but if they meet the Fagin of this group, he's willing to give them their stuff back and show them a shortcut to a location of their choice—for a price.

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QUARTER: THE DOCKS

Fog billows over the water like a deep breath exhaled. Horns blare in the distance. Ships bob up and down, tethered to the docks, rough and ready for shipping—legal or otherwise. Warehouses loom over piers slung out into the dark sea. Boats are constantly being loaded and unloaded, their cargo mysterious and likely valuable.

Dockworkers trade bawdy tales but clam up when crawlers are near, as if they harbor some secret message meant only for other residents of Noir Town. Some piers conceal underground casinos. Arcades chime with bells offering cheap prizes. The stink of salt and fish permeates the clothes of those who linger here too long. Which is funny, since these dark oceans are really just a string of swimming pools, squished together like the world's worst liquid crossword puzzle layout.

The docks are where bad things go down. Cement overcoats are made in the warehouses for rats who spilled it all, who dropped a dime. Weapons get smuggled through these docks, and drugs, and things only Borant could imagine the American people wanting in the 1940s (not *everyone* wants spats, fellas; some just want a good ol' Jell-O salad).

The Big Boss lives here, somewhere out in the ocean, and he's always got an eye on what's happening in the water. The boats are also full of Mobs. Some are legit ships; others are gambling boats adrift just outside the city limits. Fighting here means combat in water, more often than not. Hope you have your sea legs, mac.

Torpedoes attack the crawlers, especially while at sea. Someone put a contract out on the party, and though these sharks maneuver the streets as well as any land-dweller, they can swim even better. The crawlers are at a disadvantage unless they have a very fast boat or can swim like Michael Phelps. Don't forget the Torpedoes have snouts that detonate. Even if the party has a seaworthy craft, it may not stay that way.

The crawlers may receive an invitation while on the docks to visit a gambling boat. The stakes are high; they stand to lose a lot of coin if they play, but they can win great prizes, too. Inside the boat are a bevy of useful contacts for any Strong Starts or Story Hooks (p. 344).

If the PCs win a lot (or lose a lot), they get invited into a back room. There, a gangster and his friends play for even higher stakes. These are games where crawlers can win a ton of gold. But if they lose, it costs a Health Bar Slot, more if they lose badly.

NPCS

Noir Town teems with people of all sorts. From the shoeshine boy to the gangster whose two-tone wingtips get the polish, this Neighborhood is rife with swells and lowlifes. You'll find sample mugs and named NPCs listed below.

ZOE SALT

Zoe claims she's just an innocent gal trying to make her way in this hard, dangerous world. Only a fool would believe a broad like her.

In Noir Town, Zoe is one of the most talented songbirds around. Her golden voice can calm even the most hardened Torpedo. She knows the Maltese Falcon would make her the biggest star in town, and she's already killed trying to get her hands on it. See the Maltese Falcon (p. 344) for more details.)

Zoe Salt. Orc "Songstress of the Sea."

Level 8 NPC.

She's got the black bob haircut, a red silk dress that clings to her like liquid, and the voice of an angel. She presents as a damsel in distress, but she's really a femme fatale. You might think it's all an act, but the guns here fire real bullets, not blanks, and she's no exception. Zoe knows how to get what she wants, and nothing will stop her rise to the top. She's already become the most requested singer in the city, but she's got ambitions to be a big Boss.

You're not planning on getting in her way, right?

Songstress

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
12%	25%	37%	50%	62%	75%	87%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
8	12+F	13+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
3 (+2)	5 (+2)	3 (+2)	7 (+3)	11 (+4)

38 Special: 13+F to hit, 2d6 Piercing, 20ft range

Blow a Kiss: 12+F to hit, 2d4+2 Psychic, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Woozy Debuff.

Notes: *Sultry Singer*—Crawlers hearing an Orc Singer song must make an Int Stat Check. On Fail, the crawler gains the Captivated Debuff: They cannot hear anything else until the song ends

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COMMON MUGS

- **Fin Fatales:** On practically every corner is a Karkharodon dame stuffed into a dress or guy in a cheap suit and always in trouble. Best avoid them unless you want to get wrapped up in a side quest.
- **Newsies:** Kids selling papers. The news is grim and salacious, but the paper might keep your hair dry from the incessant rain.
- **Hacks and Cabbies:** They always need a fare. A cab might roll up and offer you a ride... can you trust them, though?
- **Coppers:** They're everywhere when you need 'em, but they're all on the take. They're more like furniture: as long as you don't bump into them in the dark, they won't bruise your shins. Beat Cops are an exception.
- **Hustlers:** Someone's always running a scam, a con, a game of chance that's rigged. Three-card monte, a story about their sick grandmother... whatever. They want gold and might hustle you until you give them some.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The Divider is a leviathan, a behemoth with the body of a whale and ends with two long necks like the Loch Ness Monster. The beast moves fast in the pools that make up the dock and can leap from one to the next without slowing down. Don't forget he can attack with both heads and roll boats of immense size with his vast bulk. Moby Dick's got nothing on this guy.

Pictures of the crawlers and the Boss (one picture for each of the Divider's heads) splash into place, and a raging whirlpool forms the word *VERSUS* in all-caps between them. Then that same whirlpool devours the pictures of all the crawlers and the Divider, swallowing them whole and enveloping the screen until it cuts to the battle in real time again.

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AI And what's this? Straight from out the depths! You know him! You love him! Heeeeee's the Divider, and he's about to divide your heads from your bodies!

The Divider attacks first by trying to capsize any vessel the party might use to confront him. Once they're divided and trying to stay afloat, the Divider attacks two crawlers at a time—one with each head. He can also kill with his tail. In the water, he has a massive advantage unless the crawlers have acquired some very useful aquatic abilities.

CLUES

- The Divider's attacks are weaker at the edge of water.
- The Divider is likely to dive once it has its prey in its mouth.
- Dummy boats, or anything that floats, can make the Divider attack the decoy instead of the crawlers.

AI **The Divider. Double-Headed Nessie.**

Level 27 Neighborhood Boss!

You're gonna need a bigger boat!

This Loch Ness monster is a double feature: a two-headed horror whose humped back looks like a small island moving out in the foggy sea. Each head of the Divider has rows of razor-sharp teeth to rend your succulent crawler flesh and a tail lash that causes mini tsunamis.

Everyone in Noir Town whispers about the monster, but most locals are smart enough not to go out this far into his territory. Guess you ain't a local, huh, bub?

The Divider

Neighborhood Boss; Colossal (7), Monstrous

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	15%	23%	30%	38%	46%	53%	61%	69%	76%	84%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
27	14+F	15+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
31 (+5)	15 (+4)	27 (+5)	23 (+5)	10 (+4)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 3d10+5 Piercing, 15ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff. The Divider has learned that diving deep underwater after grabbing prey is a quick way to finish them off and eat in peace. Crawlers with the Held Debuff must make a Str-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check, or a Str Stat Check at the same Difficulty. On Fail, they are dragged underwater and gain the Drowning Debuff.

Tail Swipe: 15+F to hit, 2d10+5 Bludgeoning, 60ft Cone
The Divider's Tail Swipe is powerful enough to generate tsunami-like waves even in open water in a cone that's 60ft in length. Any boats within hit by the attack have a 50% of capsizing, though someone piloting a boat can attempt an appropriate Unopposed Skill Check to prevent capsizing. On Fail, they capsize. Anyone in the water in the area must make a Swimming Skill Check. On Fail, they gain the Drowning Debuff.

Notes: *Eating With Your Mouth Full*—When a crawler is Held in one of the Divider's mouths, that mouth can't Bite without releasing the crawler; the crawler automatically moves with the Divider when it moves with no penalties to the Divider's Move or Step.

Easily Distracted—Decoys and dummy boats can be used to distract the Divider. The presence of 1 or more of these reduces the Divider's attacks by 1 for 1d4 rounds.

Enormous Size—When the Divider is in water, it can move into or through spaces occupied by entities or objects smaller than itself, causing them to be pushed 10ft in a direction perpendicular to the Divider's movement. The Divider has Disadvantage on attacks within 20ft of shore due to its size.

Swim—The Divider can move through water as on the ground.

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NEIGHBORHOOD: RUINED SNOWTIME

FLOOR: 3 — THEME: A MERRY JAUNT TO THE COUNTRYSIDE

A swamp, upon which heavy snowfall blankets the landscape, the ruins, and even Mob nests. One never quite knows what's lurking under the next pile of powder. A single town of red-brick buildings sits nestled among the fallen remnants of the ancient city, sheltered from the worst of the winds. Windows glow in defiance of the cold and snow.

The ruin's wooden planks squish ominously with every step. Normally, vibrant greens would struggle against the dusky browns and deep grays that dominate the landscape. However, it's all currently lost in a thick coating of soft, white snow. On their way to battle Big Daddy Nick, the crawlers must confront elven zealots, who believe an alien invasion is nigh, while navigating snowbound, treacherous terrain.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- A group of City Elves in festive red-and-green uniforms surrounds a High Elf. They're jeering at "Mr. Fancypants," asking what his town's gonna do without his grungy demon to protect them. The High Elf shouts at the crawlers, offering to take them to his home if they lend assistance.
- In the distance, light flickers through the windows of a small village, holding back the darkness of the frigid night. As the crawlers move toward it, freaky screaming heads soar through the sky between them and the village. Nearby, the smell of cooking meat leads them to where another crawler sits, roasting a meal over his fire. Crawler JB offers to share his meal if they help him make it to the village afterward.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you'll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- A group of City Elves defected from the 201st security group and formed a new cult around a demented survivalist City Elf named Big Daddy Nick. They call themselves the Merry Militia and are completely convinced that the threat of the Oak Fell (a sort of antichrist for the goddess Apito, p. 164) will fall upon them from the heavens as part of an "alien plot." Thus, they train even harder to fight the aliens. They can smell "aliens" on the crawlers and are immediately hostile to the "collaborators." This new conspiracy makes them even less sane and more dangerous than their typical counterparts.
- Redbrick Village has been robbed! The High Elves who live there were long ago given a cutting from the World Tree, meant to protect their village. With the cutting placed in front of the Mayoral Lodge, no undead or wild animal could enter their city.

  However, not long ago, a mysterious figure made off with the tree in the middle of the night. If it is not returned soon, the village could fall prey to the bloodthirsty, undead flying heads known as Krasue, the wild yet intelligent Gobblin' Hogs, and the Merry Militia Elves that harass this region. If the culprit isn't found, the High Elves may well blame one of the crawlers for the theft as paranoia sets in.
- The mayor's adopted daughter Betty-Lou has gone missing. After the World Tree cutting vanished, so did Betty-Lou. This drives the mayor crazy with worry. He's started to revert to the monster he used to be, growing steadily more violent. If Betty-Lou isn't returned, he may go off the deep end and need to be put down. However, Betty-Lou doesn't know about her father's condition or his past, and she won't come back home without the tree.

MOBS

The Mobs of this region seem suited to a swampy atmosphere, and many of them are just as surprised by the sudden snowstorm as the crawlers.

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MERRY MILITIA

The City Elves are already considered a separate type of Elf by other Elves. The 201st Security group is made up of Elves many consider zealous and mad. The Merry Militia makes them seem positively tame by comparison.

While these creatures believe in the cause of the 201st, they believe they're wrong in how they're practicing their faith. The Oak Fell won't come from below, but rather it will descend from the darkness above where even the Angels cannot fly.

They believe the true Oak Fell is an "alien," and they stand ready to lay their very lives on the line to force it back into the darkness. However, this "knowledge" makes them terrified of Starlight. If they're caught outside at night, they are reduced to gibbering, screaming berserkers, desperate to get inside and willing to hurt anyone or anything in their path along the way.

AI Merry Militia. Level 15, City Elves

The 201st Security Group is made up of idiots, maniacs, and religious zealots. The Merry Militia is made up of City Elves considered too idiotic, mad, and zealous for the 201st Security Group. These dangerous volunteers believe their compatriots got one important detail wrong: The Oak Fell won't come from this world but from another world beyond the stars.

After the 201st laughed them away for being crazy, these outcast Elves ventured into the forest in search of a high place to watch for the Oak Fell's inevitable arrival. It was there they found another voice to guide them in their training and their mission. Now they roam the woods with reversed patches sewn on their red-and-green uniforms. Don't get between them and indoors when night falls.

Merry Militiaman

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	14+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
11 (+4)	10 (+4)	11 (+4)	11 (+4)	7 (+3)

Apito's Blow: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Apito's Double Barrel Spell: 14+F to hit, 3d4+4 Necrotic, 50ft range
Can hit up to two targets with one attack.

Apito's Shower Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Necrotic, 60ft range, 10ft Blast radius

Apito's Thirst Spell: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 30ft range
On Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Drain Debuff: Take 1d8+F Necrotic at the end of each round and the Merry Militiaman heals 1 HB, until the combat ends.

GOBBLIN' HOGS

At first glance, these might look like stereotypical wild boars. When they come closer, you realize they're to wild boars what the mountain lion is to the average house cat. Gobblin' Hogs are twice the size of most boars from Earth's surface, and if you're not bonded with them, they're every bit as dangerous.

Their tusks are as long as most people's forearms. Their hooves are as big as a pro basketball player's foot, and there is absolutely nothing they won't eat. They don't care if they live or die, as long as they do it with a full belly.

Every day you wake up with the ability to smile is a gift. That's why they call it the present. ...It's a really sucky present, but still.

—Crawler JB

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When the stars decorate the sky, their eyes and tusks sparkle with moonlight, and their eyes fill with fiendish intelligence. They can also rise on two legs and hunt with spears made of the tusks of their fallen brethren. It's said their meat is a delicacy because they are rarely slain. They make their home in the Snowy Swamp.

AI Gobblin' Hogs. Level 12.

No, that's not a buffalo you see. Though if you're unlucky enough to end up in the path of its charge, there's not much difference. It's a Gobblin' Hog! This monster is nocturnal by nature, and if you've found it in daylight, then congratulations! You may just survive.

With the sun in the sky, it's got animal intelligence, an incredible attitude, and a desire to see you dead. After dark? Well, let's just say you won't see them, but don't worry —they see you.

Gobblin' Hog

Mob; Medium (4), Monstrous

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
12	11+F	14+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
13 (+4)	1 (+1)	10 (+4)	12 (+4)	5 (+2)

Gobble: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Slashing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler must make a Con Stat Check. On Fail, they immediately gain the Major Injury Debuff. This attack can only be used on targets at 20% HB or less.

Thrown Tusk: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 30ft range
This attack can only be used at night.

Tusk: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail, the target loses a carried or worn item to the Gobblin' Hog's stomach.

Notes: *Charge!*—If a Gobblin' Hog travels its full Move distance before hitting with a melee attack, the target must make a Str Stat Check. On Fail, the target gains the Take Down Debuff. The target has Advantage to Evade this move-attack combo.

Night Hunter—The Int and Dex mod of Gobblin' Hogs flip at night, becoming Int (+4) and Dex (+1), with Surprise 14+F and Evade 11+F.

Nocturnal—Gobbln' Hogs can see in nonmagical darkness.

Swamp Native—Gobblin' Hogs can travel through swampy terrain such as water, mud, and underbrush with no penalty to their Move or Step.

KRASUE

The Krasue have their origin in Southeast Asian folklore: They're the floating heads of women who lived lives of shame and debauchery and died in agony. Now, their heads fly around when the sun is down, seeking to devour the blood of the living and thus extend their cursed existence.

They cannot bear the harsh light of the sun, nor can they truly be slain until their corpses are destroyed. During the day, they either return to their corpses (safely hidden away) or seek heavily shadowed places to avoid the bright light. Travelers in the Frosted Fastness Quarter must be careful, or they'll find themselves ambushed by the Krasue.

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AI Krasue. Level 16.

These creatures are true horrors. These floating heads soar through the night air, silently screaming and trailing some of their internal organs. They hunt living creatures and feast on their blood to stay strong and live for centuries.

Though they cannot wield weapons in the traditional sense, this doesn't make them any less dangerous. The unwary have felt Krasue entrails wrapped around their necks and gone on the dungeon's worst ride into the night sky. Drained of their blood and woozy, their last sight is often the ground rushing to meet them.

Although Krasue can be slain with magic, this is not permanent unless and until you can find and destroy the rest of their body as well.

Warning: This is a ghost-class Mob. They are only injured with magic or magical items.

Krasue

Mob; Small (2), Cursed

2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
16	14+F	15+F	25+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
4 (+2)	11 (+4)	3 (+2)	22 (+5)	14 (+4)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 2d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Blood Drain Debuff: Take 1d8+F Necrotic at the end of each round and the Krasue attaches to the crawler and heals 1 HB slot, until the Krasue is killed or removed. If the Krasue remains attached for two or more successive rounds, the crawler gains the Woozy Debuff.

Strangle: 15+F to hit, 3d8+2 Bludgeoning, 15ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Krasue move through the air as though on the ground and can hover in place.

Ghostly—Krasue can only be harmed by magic or enchanted items.

I Can Show You the World—Targets hit by a Krasue's Strangle attack are Held by their entrails and lifted 5ft into the sky. The Krasue's Step is reduced to 5ft and Move to 10 while holding a creature in this manner, and they'll typically fly straight upward after grabbing a creature until they reach a deadly height to drop them. To escape, a crawler with the I Can Show You the World Debuff must make a Str-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check, or a Str Stat Check at the same Difficulty.

MERRY CHORISTERS

Often called the Merry Magic Corps, or even the Merry Carolers, these distinguished Elves serve as officers and Mages attached to the Merry Militia. They adorn themselves with tall top-hats, dark overcoats, and cloaks worn over faded red-and-green uniforms.

They have harnessed innate magical powers and no longer rely on magic items. It is said they don't even require the stereotypical waggling of fingers or hands to cast Spells. Instead, they need only the raw power of their voices to affect reality itself. They reside in the Frozen Foothills Quarter to oversee the hardening of Big Daddy Nick's compound.

AI Merry Carolers. Elves. Level 17.

These officers and magic specialists in the Merry Militia are immediately identifiable by their unique and archaic attire. It's not unusual for these magic-users to be dressed in top-hats, cloaks, or petticoats, and they're every bit as pretentious as they look.

When it comes to their magic, they're no joke. They recognized the weakness of those who required wands and other items to wield magic and instead trained to master the magical disciplines with nothing more than their voices. It may sound silly to hear, but don't laugh, or you may quickly find out how much magic these creatures can command with a simple hum.

Worse yet, their magic only grows in power as more join their song. At night, when the clear night air and the crisp snow make their voices even more resonant, their power is further amplified, and your neighbors are even more annoyed than usual.

Merry Caroler

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
17	14+F	13+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
4 (+2)	14 (+4)	5 (+2)	8 (+3)	25 (+5)

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Don't Rest Ye Merry Gentle Elves Spell: 14+F to hit, No damage, 30ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the You'll Listen to Us and Like It, Don't Forget to Tip for Apito Debuff: The crawler has Disadvantage on Evade Checks against Merry Carolers' attacks and a fleeting desire to tithe to a random god, which ends the Debuff if they do so.

Have You Ever Seen the Rain? Spell: 14+F to hit, 3d6+5 Ice, 60ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stiff Legs Debuff.

Jingle Balls Spell: 14+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 60ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Hypothermia Debuff: Take 1d6+F Ice each round (Stacks. After losing 1+ HB Slots via this Debuff, the crawler must make an Unopposed Survival Skill Check. On Fail, they remove one piece of clothing at the start of each round.

Shattering High Note Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Sonic, 5ft Burst radius

Silent Night Spell: 14+F to hit, No damage, 50ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Muted Debuff.

Space Oddity Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Force, 40ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Any hit crawler must make a Cha or Int Stat Check (their choice). On Fail, they gain the Aerial Suspension Debuff: Crawler gains the Held Debuff and is magically floating 30ft in the air until the end of the next round. Then they fall!

VILLAGE GUARDS

Decked out head-to-toe in plate mail, it's nearly impossible to discern the Race of these Village Guards. Bulky, tall, and carrying a long, steel blade, these guys are practically walking tanks.

Village Guards are tasked with keeping the peace in the village and will punish any crawlers who attack NPCs, rob stores, or get drunk and pass out in the streets. The penalty for all such crimes is death. Their heavy bodies make them slow, but what they lack in speed, they make up for in numbers, as many of them patrol the village during the day. They're exceptionally strong and highly proficient with their blades.

AI **Village Guard. Level 75.**

Everyone likes the strong, silent type. To find out what's underneath that helmet, you first must kill the guard. Go ahead and give it a try. I double-dog dare you. They're tasked with protecting the village from the creatures that roam the Over City Ruins. They're only on duty when the sun is up, so don't go whining to them for help when it's dark.

Village Guard

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
75	15+F	14+F	15+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
70 (+6)	25 (+5)	100 (+7)	15 (+4)	20 (+5)

Commanding Shout Spell: 15+F to hit, No damage, 100ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Terrified Debuff for 2 rounds.

Longsword: 16+F to hit, 7d8+6 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Letter of the Law*—Village Guards don't compromise or show mercy. If they know someone has broken a law, they attempt to kill the target on sight. They end their pursuit if the target leaves the settlement but remember the target if they return.

ENVIRONMENT

The wooden planks of the Third Floor are omnipresent throughout this Neighborhood, but in different quarters they feel far less like a solid floor and more like warped wood ready to give way at any moment. The broken ruins of the Over City are still visible throughout this Neighborhood, though they're normally covered in vines and overgrowth.

Redbrick Village stands hidden beneath a large rocky overhang, made of brick buildings surrounding a giant lodge and a wooden track that looks like it may once have been a roller coaster. The Frozen Foothills glisten softly underneath the filtered sunlight and the gentle glow of moonlight.

All of this is, however, currently lost beneath a heavy snowfall. Throughout the day, the sun hides behind

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thick clouds, keeping the snow from melting. At night, a gentle but continuous snowfall ensures that any tracks made are filled by the next morning, making it impossible to track footprints after a couple hours.

TRAPS

Amid the winter-white wonderland lie treacherous traps waiting to claim careless crawlers. Here are some examples:

- **Snow Pits:** Heavy drifts of snow get blown around by the wind, occasionally covering naturally occurring pits and holes in the terrain. The fresh snow is light enough that it doesn't stick together, but in some places the snow appears much more densely packed than it is. One footstep in the wrong spot can catch a crawler sinking six feet or more into snow that clings like quicksand.
- **Frozen Lakes and Ponds:** The rapid onset of winter weather froze most bodies of water to some degree. Adventurous crawlers may tempt their fates and take shortcuts across these frozen lakes and ponds. But be wary of slight shifting beneath their feet and the telltale, terrifying cracks that signal an impending descent into freezing water.
- **Krasue Ambush:** These ghastly gals set no traps aside from ambushes. They hide in the shadows until the opportune moment, and then they strike, falling from the sky and claiming their prey.
- **Tinsel Tripwire:** The Merry Militia is fond of tripwire traps. While theirs are not particularly elaborate, they're often well-hidden, tending to drop crawlers into pits lined with vicious spikes or into pre-existing snow pits, both of which are hard to escape.
- **Humming Harassment:** In preparation for defending Big Daddy Nick and his compound, the Merry Choristers once patrolled the Frozen Foothills extensively. They left behind plenty of magical traps primed to spring if the proper tune is not hummed when prompted.

  These traps range in types from freezing ice blasts, to paralyzing magic, to explosions that kill lesser Mobs. The closer something ventures to Big Daddy Nick's compound, the more dangerous and powerful the traps become. On occasion, they've also been known to throw in a simple bear trap here and there, just to keep things interesting.
- **Hogsnares and Hogsglue:** True to their lore, the Gobblin' Hogs only create traps at night because they can't figure out how to make them in the daytime. They specialize in snares and glue traps. The unwary victim of a Hogsnare finds themselves yanked into the air and suspended upside down, just out of reach of the ground.

  Hogsglue traps are created out of wood, sticky resin, and other heavy materials buried beneath the snow. When a crawler or Mob steps upon them, they're stuck in place unless they have a solvent to dissolve the resin—or if they're willing to leave their precious footwear behind. These traps are often used to ensure the Gobblin' Hogs get an easy meal for their sluggish state of mind during the day.

ITEMS

- **Frozen Frames:** In the Frozen Foothills sit the rotted remains of car bodies, covered in snow.
- **The Fallen Colossos:** In the Redbrick Village quarter, the rotting remains of a legendary German wood-and-steel roller coaster lay in ruins.
- **Trusty Rusties:** The remains of old, rusted bear traps and foothold traps punctuate the Frozen Foothills. All are broken open and nearly useless, but a ingenious crawler might be able to repair and repurpose them.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards:

- **Jaws of Knife:** "You've managed to step into a bear trap. Congratulations! You now know what it feels like to be a bear on the worst day of its life. Except a bear is bigger and stronger and can more easily withstand the excruciating pain you're currently feeling.
  Reward: This moment of pure understanding is your reward. Also, hopefully the knowledge of how to not literally step into a bear trap again!"
  Contents: A bear-skin garment or household good.
- **Thanks for Bringing Your Own Rope:** "You used a Mob's own trap against it! Kinky!
  Reward: You receive a Silver Sapper's Box!"
- **Stocking Stuffer:** "You killed Big Daddy Nick with his own explosives. Irony, thy name is BOOM!
  Reward: You received a Gold Goblin Box!"
- **Bravo, Dores!:** "You reunited a father and daughter! Awww, it's so wholesome... I think I'm gonna be sick.
  Reward: You receive a Gold Beguiler Box (or a Gold Quest Box if this is an official Quest)."
  Contents: An enchanted "pair" of something like scissors or panties.

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GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

If crawlers decide to brave the ice and snow of the Neighborhood and repeatedly take on the Mobs who reside there, they might come across one or more of the complications on Table 79.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- Only your footsteps echo through the crumbling ruins...until a loud thump draws your attention. **Outcome:** Investigating the sound reveals a brick was knocked from the wall, possibly alerting the crawlers to an incoming ambush. Ignoring it leads to an ambush by a Strong group of Merry Militia.
- In the distance, you see the warm light of a fire glowing in a window. Chilled to the bone, your steps hurry, and you hear a gentle click beside your foot, followed by a loud hissing sound. **Outcome:** The crawler set off a snaretrap! They must try to evade it or become hog food.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

REDBRICK VILLAGE

The High Elf citizens of Redbrick Village remember building this little town with their own hands. Throughout the town, "idols" are erected to an individual they call the Crimson Lord. The Mayor's Office stands in the center of town, a sturdy-built wooden lodge with a pointed roof that lights up at night. The locals see the town as the result of hard work, determination, and survival in the harsh wilderness of the Over City.

Crawlers, however, immediately recognize the buildings as part of a theme park (or several), especially after seeing the remnants of the roller coaster, the multiple statues of Santa Claus standing about, and signs in English, Finnish, and German.

Footsteps echo through the village at nighttime. A low-pitched yowling sounds as claws scrabble across rooftops. Dead silence follows for several minutes before a terrible howl splits the night air, and fists and booted feet pound against the doors of the buildings in which the crawlers stay.

TABLE 79: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawler in the lead was chasing a Gobblin' Hog, hoping to kill it before the sun finished setting. They never noticed the snare. Now they're hanging upside down as the moon rises, and the Gobblin' Hog is standing up on two legs as more angry squeals sound nearby.
2	As the crawlers search for more Mobs to fight, they find themselves in the middle of a broad expanse of snow, only to hear the cracking of ice beneath their feet. If they don't move fast enough, they may find themselves under the ice and swept into the darkness of a frozen lake.
3	Crawler JB is confronted by a group of High Elves from Redbrick Village. They insist he stole something from their village, while he insists he has no idea what they're talking about. He's *definitely* lying.
4	The crawlers find themselves in a snowy canyon. Ahead, an Overwhelming group of the Merry Militia has set up camp, insisting on practicing their singing to try to earn the rank of Merry Chorister. It's clearly not going well for them, and they're growing increasingly frustrated.
5	Grampus stands in the middle of a group of slaughtered Gobblin' Hogs. He breathes heavily, covered in dirt and blood. He looks toward the sky and howls in anger that rapidly deteriorates into deep, wracking sobs. After a moment, he composes himself, turns to the crawlers, and demands to know if they saw anything.
6	Crawler JB bumps into the party, asking if they've got anything to eat. He's friendly, and although he has a ton of Crawler Biscuits, he insists he'd rather starve than continue to eat them. He's willing to trade gold, song, or even help in their next fight for some "real food."

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The maddened faces of Merry Militia press against windows as they scream to be let inside. They will not hear reason. The crawlers must either slay them or hold them off for 15 rounds until the Village Guards return. Even then, the question remains: Who lured the Village Guard away? And for what purpose?

Castellain Kirett is a ragged-looking High Elf NPC in a green-and-red robe. Upon hearing that crawlers have entered the village, he all but rushes to them for a (polite) interrogation. First, he inquires about the location of the mayor's adoptive daughter, Betty-Lou. Then he asks if they've seen anyone carrying a tree. He speaks with perfect seriousness, and though he is polite, he won't stop until his questions are answered to his satisfaction. Any violence against him results in an attack by the Village Guard.

FROSTED FASTNESS

To the south and west of Redbrick Village, a mix of hills and staircases leads up a slow and steady incline. This part of the Over City eventually ends in a promontory overlooking much of the floor. It is dominated by old, ruined walls.

No part of the ceiling remains, and the plant's increased exposure to sunlight has made it incredibly strong and vibrant. Snow still covers the grounds, but hanging vines, clinging flowers, and even small twisted trees endure, pushing through the snow.

As the crawlers navigate the ruins' labyrinthine walls, they must carefully avoid Tinsel Tripwires left by the Merry Militia. The crawlers emerge through one last doorway onto the promontory itself as dark clouds roil in the sky. They must avoid yet another tripwire trap set by the Merry Militia as they exit.

Whether the crawlers succeed or not, Merry Militia members attempt to ambush them as they emerge. Merry Militia members are not difficult on their own, but as the tide turns in the crawlers' favor, a haunting scream pierces the darkness, and several Krasue join the battle. Most attack the crawlers, but they also latch onto any Merry Militia members they can.

The party spots a person with a heavier frame sitting atop a wall, guitar in his lap, enjoying the sun: Crawler JB. He has brown and gray hair and a matching beard. He speaks with friendliness, and his voice sounds familiar. Crawler JB engages them in conversation and tries to make them smile. He'll ask them if they're willing to help look for something he saw a Merry Militia member holding as they passed him.

If the party agrees to help him look, they comb through the ruins in separate directions, avoiding traps and fighting off Mobs. The crawlers may find a door marked "Cartography Guild," but a keen eye reveals it doesn't show up on their minimap (and the marking on the door itself rubs off). Inside, the missing World Tree cutting waits. Crawler JB is so grateful, he shows the crawlers a few fighting (or playing) tips, resulting in the raising of their Axe, Performance, or a custom musical instrument Skill by one (where appropriate).

SNOWY SWAMP

To the southeast of Redbrick Village, the ground drops lower and lower, with more and more bodies of water. Soon, trees begin to emerge from the floor. Crawlers must be careful as they navigate this region, lest they plummet through hidden ice into freezing water.

They must also dodge the vicious Gobblin' Hogs as they explore and avoid their Hogsnares. A decent number of saferooms exist in this quarter, and crawlers may find themselves in a fast-food restaurant smelling heavily of spice and chicken, but few of them are attended by NPC hosts.

Encounters with Gobblin' Hogs differ depending on whether they happen at night or during the day. In daytime hours, the Gobblin' Hogs are little more than large and dangerous animals. At night, however, they're cunning predators relying on traps and stealth to further threaten enemies and prey.

Crawlers must be constantly aware of their surroundings in the snow-covered swamplands. The moment a crawler is stuck upside-down in a Hogsnare, the Gobblin' Hogs strike. Surging in with pack tactics and spears, they focus fire on the most physically dangerous crawlers first.

The crawlers find a trail of blood and, eventually, Gobblin' Hog corpses. Following the trail leads to the site of a vicious battle where Merry Militia bodies lie among the bodies of the Gobblin' Hogs.

After examining the bodies, one of the Merry Militia coughs and struggles to sit up. His name is Anit, and he is willing to speak to the crawlers, though only with great derision. He accuses them of being aliens sent by the Oak Fell to tempt him.

He's not willing to give up any information, but he's also incredibly stupid. Making him angry, scared, or tricking him causes him to divulge the secret to entering Big Daddy Nick's compound in the Frozen Foothills: singing the Merry Chorister's Sacred Retreat Hymn—or as the crawlers may know it: "Jingle Bells."

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Exploring deep into the heart of the Snowy Swamp reveals Grampus's massive furry body curled into himself. He's frustrated but doesn't attack without reason. If the crawlers found the World Tree cutting in the Frosted Fastness or Betty-Lou in the Frozen Foothills, Grampus returns to Redbrick Village and transforms back into the mayor. He then reveals a secret door to an Advanced Training Guild hidden within his office.

FROZEN FOOTHILLS

Far to the south of the Redbrick Village sit the Frozen Foothills. They cannot be reached without traversing either the Snowy Swamp or the Frosted Fastness first. This region is marked by many low, rolling hills and snowdrifts. It is the largest and emptiest region by far.

Crawlers exploring must be very careful, lest they set off magical traps set by the Merry Choristers or plain old explosives by Big Daddy Nick. Merry Militia are known to burst forth from snow mounds and the hollowed-out car husks scattered through this quarter.

An ominous whistling drifts through the still air of the Frozen Foothills. Magical traps of both paralytic and explosive natures begin to go off, attempting to pick off members of the party even before they engage with them. This signals an ambush by the Merry Militia, who emerge from the snow around them, led by a Merry Chorister. If the Merry Chorister falls below half health, they try to flee the fight, humming their Sacred Retreat Hymn (Jingle Bells).

The crawlers find a shivering High Elf girl wrapped snow camouflage gear and gripping a vicious-looking cat o' nine tails in her gloved hand. If the crawlers attack, she defends herself to the death. However, if they speak to her, she tells them she's trying to find something important: a cutting of the World Tree that once protected Redbrick Village. She also reveals that she is Betty-Lou, the mayor's daughter.

She believes Big Daddy Nick, leader of the Militia, stole the cutting. She's having trouble tracking them down. She knows the Merry Choristers have some way of getting in, as they keep appearing and disappearing. If the World Tree cutting has been found, or if she is told the state of Grampus, she returns home.

Big Daddy Nick's compound is hidden inside a cluster of false snow drifts, but there's no way to tell which one grants access unless the crawlers are made aware of the secret. As they hum or sing or whistle the Sacred Retreat Hymn in this region, sleigh bells jingle in the distance. As they venture closer to the compound, the bells grow louder. However, the closer they get, the more dangerous the region becomes, as the traps and ambushes are most concentrated near the compound.

NPCS

GRAMPUS

Despite his sometimes monstrous appearance, Grampus is a well-spoken, jolly creature. He was once a hermit until an orphan's love convinced him to rejoin society. His stature and strength made him very useful around town and an excellent protector. In time, he became so ingratiated with the people that they made him mayor. He has been an excellent leader for the town and only transforms into his Grampus form when necessary.

And then his adopted daughter, Betty-Lou, vanished. Afterward, he became increasingly agitated and snappish, taking on his Grampus form more often. People worry what he might do if she's not found soon.

AI Grampus. Justice Demon. Level 50.

Don't let the horns, the matted fur, the sharp teeth, and the long claws fool you; this dude is the Mayor of Redbrick Village. When not transformed into his eldritch horror form, he looks more like a normal High Elf—just a really tall one. People say he used to be jolly, but now? He looks like he's ready to bite the head off anyone who doesn't bring him good news—literally!

Demon

NPC; Medium (4), Demonic

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
23 (+5)	27 (+5)	50 (+6)	25 (+5)	30 (+5)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 4d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains The Taint Debuff for 2 rounds.

Unsaintly Claws: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Not So Jolly*—When they first encounter a demon, crawlers must make an Int Stat Check. On Fail, the crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

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BETTY-LOU

A young woman of no more than twenty-two. Once upon a time, she opened her heart to a person everyone called a monster. That day, she revealed he had a heart as pure as any. He came to live with her, and she came to admire the man whom everyone feared. That was long ago. Nowadays, she is trying to help in more hands-on ways.

AI Betty-Lou. High Elf. Level 9.

This is a non-combatant NPC.

This girl's eyes have made men of monsters and monsters of men. She's not particularly happy with the current situation, and if you can help her out, she may well be able to tame her father's savage heart.

AI Crawler #2,556. JB.

Level 16.

Race: Changeling

Class: Hollywood Stunt Man⚙.

When the crawlers enter Big Daddy Nick's compound, it's completely dark except for the faint, flickering glow of a fireplace burning inside the window of a wooden cabin. The hidden compound is nearly an acre in size, with a magical mesh overhead that becomes opaque when the crawlers enter.

JB

If you ever asked this Changeling his reasoning behind choosing that Race, he'd tell you it's because he's always enjoyed pretending to be different people. He doesn't say much about his life pre-Crawl, but anybody who's heard his voice says it sounds familiar.

Some crawlers tell stories of how he plays guitar or how he never fails to get a laugh out of others. Anyone who has spent more time around him can tell you the moment he turns away from people is the moment he deflates. There's a sadness in him that's only held at bay by the smiles of other crawlers.

In a fight, he'll typically take the form of an anthropomorphic panda and fight with fists, feet, or anything nearby he could use as a quarterstaff. He doesn't love stairs, but he'll use them if he must.

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The entire area is covered with tripwires, tents, and bouquets of improvised grenades that hang overhead.

Triggering any tripwire immediately alerts Big Daddy Nick and initiates the Boss Battle. If the crawlers make it to the wood cabin's porch without triggering any traps, they earn a free round to Attack the Boss before he can respond. Once the crawlers enter the cabin, they can't leave until they or the Boss is dead.

Sleigh bells sound in the distance as a festooned Christmas tree rises in the center of everyone's HUD. The words "Special Holiday Boss Event" pop into existence in red-and-green font beneath the tree as if they were presents. Then a voice sings out the words as they appear to unwrap, revealing the portraits of Big Daddy Nick opposite the portraits of the crawlers.

Big Daddy Nick is a giant Dwarf (make that make sense) who stands nine feet tall. He is dressed head-to-toe in red clothing made from muskrat skin. He wields a shotgun that shoots candy canes and a Bowie knife nearly the size of a sword.

He rushes the crawlers and accuses them of being "alien collaborators," firing candy canes from his gun that act as flechette rounds. He shouts the accusation again in French, and in the next round, eight Merry Choristers join him. The round after, he begins aiming above the crawlers' heads and starts dropping time-delayed explosives and grenades from above on the crawlers' heads.

CLUES

- The explosives hanging from the ceiling explode when hit with sufficient power.
- If sufficiently angry, the crawlers can lead Big Daddy Nick into his own explosives.
- Playing into Nick's delusions of an alien invasion causes him to suffer a penalty on defense, and he rages.

AI Big Daddy Nick

Level 25 Neighborhood Boss!

Do you feel the holiday joy in your bones? How about in your internal organs? Here at Big Daddy Nick's cabin, every day is worth celebrating, but whenever he gets to protect his little slice of heaven from alien invaders, it's just as good as Christmas morning!

He's been telling people for years that an invasion's coming, and now that he's finally found a group that will listen to him, he's trained them to protect themselves and their home ever since. It might be nice if that all happened before the invasion, but honestly, I can't tell if anything's really changed for him.

Big Daddy Nick

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	15%	23%	30%	38%	46%	53%	61%	69%	76%	84%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
25	15+F	15+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
15 (+4)	25 (+5)	20 (+5)	30 (+5)	10 (+4)

Bowie Knife: 14+F to hit, 3d4+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Candy Shot: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Piercing, 100ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Sugar Rush Debuff: Take 1d8+F Poison damage each round until the end of combat (stackable). Allows a free Move action each round, but all Moves must be for the full possible distance. If a crawler Moves twice in one round as per the Debuff, they lose the Sugar Rush Debuff and gain the Sugar Crash Debuff until end of combat: No Stat Mods added to rolls, ends if Sugar Rush Debuff is regained.

Triple Treat: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Fire, 60ft range, 10ft Blast radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Delusional*—Crawlers can make an Int-Opposed Deception Skill Check to convince Big Daddy Nick an alien invasion is imminent. On Success, Big Daddy Nick gains the Enraged Debuff.

Survivalist's Stash—Big Daddy Nick keeps improvised grenades in camouflaged nets attached to the roof of his cabin. These grenades can be targeted with an attack with an Evade of 10+F to hit and made to drop, dealing 3d6 Fire and exploding in a 20ft Burst radius around Nick and his minions if they are led under them (they don't expect the explosion so they don't Evade).

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NEIGHBORHOOD: THE NECROPOLIS

FLOOR: 3 — THEME: POST APOCALYPTIC HOBGOBLIN NECROPOLIS

Prior to the devastation caused by Scolopendra's nine-tier attack, the Over City was a vast urban sprawl, comprised of districts rather than dozens of smaller settlements. Home to millions of life forms, the Over City needed somewhere for their dead to call home. That place was the Necropolis, a stately final resting place maintained by generations of proud Hobgoblin undertakers. Three families operated the great funeral homes and oversaw the preparation and interment of the Over City's sacred dead.

That all changed when Scolopendra attacked.

The nine-tier attack set catastrophic necromantic energy surging across the Necropolis, animating millions of corpses that burst from the Necropolis as Shambling Berserkers and other fell creatures. At the head of this army of quivering body parts flew the dreaded Dispenser, a massive manta ray who consumes meat and dispenses clouds of red mist which invigorate its undead minions. The Necropolis is home to the aggressive dead and pockets of Hobgoblins looking to reclaim their ancestral home.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into the Necropolis:

- The crawlers stumble across a pack of Shambling Berserkers, who quickly attack with overwhelming numbers until a hearse full of Hobgoblins rolls up to save the day.
- While the crawlers rest in a settlement, a Hobgoblin funeral procession arrives to retrieve the recently deceased. They meet Under Tucker, who asks them to protect the undertakers as they return to their funeral home to prepare the body for final rest. This is doubly effective if the crawlers know one of the recently deceased people for whom the procession came.
- In the middle of the night, Ruin Flockers stampede through the crawlers' camp, accidentally snagging one of their prized possessions in the chaos. High above them, the Dispenser glides ominously through the air, clearly the thing that startled the birds.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in the Necropolis into ready-to-go adventures:

- Under Tucker Mournewick, the Hobgoblin undertaker, lays out the history of the three families—the Mournwicks, the Boltcranks, and the Aldgraves—for the crawlers and asks them to help orchestrate a truce. He says there's a meeting between the three families to discuss a unified approach to reclaiming the Neighborhood, something that has not happened since Scolopendra's attack.

  He's not sure he can get the other two families on his side, so he asks the crawlers to assist with the negotiations. Should the crawlers succeed in unifying the Hobgoblins, that only leaves the slight matter of killing the Dispenser and clearing out the Shambling Berserkers. No biggie!
- The Shambling Berserkers have evolved. Instead of just roaming around the Necropolis with aimless violence on the mind, they've started capturing crawlers, NPCs, and Mobs alike and dragging them off to the Dispenser's lair. These missing individuals never return. It becomes personal when the Shambling Berserkers nab someone the crawlers are close to, and it's a race against time to track the missing person before they go from missing to mist.
- Dr. Bartleby Boltcrank asks the crawlers to protect a Hobgoblin hearse that must travel deep into the Necropolis to lay an Over City VIP to rest in their ancestral mausoleum. Unfortunately, the VIP hails from a family of eccentric tinkerers who turned their crypts into an elaborate maze of traps. The undertaker explains that there is a prize for those able to survive the interment process.

MOBS

The Mobs found in the Necropolis have adapted to life among the crumbling mausoleums and headstones, able to weather the necromantic energies that pollute the air and navigate the uncertain footing with little trouble.

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SHAMBLING BERSERKER

Shambling Berserkers are kind of the turducken of the zombie world. These undead abominations are a product of necromantic energy infusing a thirteen-foot-tall collection of mismatched human body parts. By day, they shamble around, slowly looking for targets. They're easy enough to avoid in the daylight, but they're tenacious hunters.

Nighttime is a different story. Their power is quadrupled in the dark, and they drop the shuffling zombie gait in favor of rage-filled sprinting. Once they go berserk (hence the second half of their name), there's no stopping them. They chase their prey until it, or they, are quivering piles of meat on the floor.

AI **Shambling Berserker. Level 12.**

Well, I guess we eventually needed to do something with all the zombie tropes from your culture. Meet the Shambling Berserker, a name it was definitely given by someone who met one during the day, when these towering meat-lockers are at their tamest.

These ugly patchwork monstrosities are tenacious assassins, following their targets forever once they lock onto them. Best to lose them when they're in their shambling state, because as soon as the sun goes down, their speed limit goes way up. And their power quadruples. And their rage becomes an inescapable fire that will burn your whole world down. Good luck!

Shambling Berserker

Mob; Large (5), Undead

1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
12	11+F	12+F	10+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
32 (+5)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)	5 (+2)	1 (+1)

Grab: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Slam: 15+F to hit, 3d10+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler is pushed 15ft.

Notes: *Night Berzerking*—Shambling Berzerkers are 4× more powerful at night. When the sun goes down, their Con and Str Mods and Move are all 4× higher.

Shambling Pack—Shambling Berzerkers travel in packs. If two or more Shambling Berzerkers are adjacent to a crawler, the crawler has Disadvantage to Evade.

Tenacious—Once a Shambling Berzerker has targeted a crawler it does not stop until it has been destroyed or the crawler has been killed.

RUMBLE WEED

A terrifying variant of the Shambling Berserker, Rumble Weeds are half the height of a normal Berserker but are comprised entirely of arms and legs. These six-foot-tall meatballs roll around the Necropolis looking to pummel—trample?—anything with the audacity to be alive. They're capable of incredible bursts of speed, moving their feet to the bottom, like they're driving a prehistoric car to a dinosaur drive-in.

Rumble Weeds are even more dangerous at night, changing from sightless balls of chaos to true predators. In the dark, their eyes and mouths open across their arms and legs, allowing them to track and bite prey.

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AI Rumble Weed. Level 15.

Rumble Weeds are what you get when someone looks at a Street Urchin and a Shambling Berserker and says, "Now kiss!" These balls of fists and feet are dangerous predators of the Necropolis, rolling through the cramped headstones looking for meat.

Any meat will do, but I hear they find crawlers particularly scrumptious. Wait, did I mention the eyes and mouths that come out at night? Yes, crawler, you'd better hope they get a charley horse in all those legs.

Rumble Weed

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	13+F	14+F	25+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
22 (+5)	6 (+3)	11 (+4)	10 (+4)	1 (+1)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff. This attack may only be made at night.

Trample: 15+F to hit, 2d10+5 Bludgeoning, 30ft Line
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered and Take Down Debuffs.

Notes: *Night Predator*—At night Rumble Weeds can track crawlers, gaining Advantage on their first attack of the combat.

RUIN FLOCKER

Human-sized emu-like Mobs, Ruin Flockers are big birds with tiny brains and sharp claws. They roam the dungeon in groups, trying to stay ahead of their many natural predators, relying on speed and numbers to keep them safe. If cornered, they fight like hell to survive, lashing out with their talons and body-slamming their foes.

AI Ruin Flocker. Level 9.

Reminiscent of traumatized survivors of a timeline where Australia didn't lose the Great Emu War, Ruin Flockers are a lot like Human in a fire drill: dazed, confused, and prone to bouts of uncontrolled trampling. These idiotic birds aren't dangerous individually, but get enough of them scared, and you've got a screaming mass of feathers, beaks, and talons that make you say, "What the flock?"

Ruin Flocker

Mob; Medium (4), Animal

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
11%	22%	33%	44%	55%	66%	77%	88%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
9	11+F	13+F	25+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	2 (+1)	6 (+3)	11 (+3)	3 (+2)

Claw: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Slam: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Trample: 13+F to hit, 1d6+4 Bludgeoning, 25ft Line
Any hit crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *What the Flock*—When 3 or more Ruin Flockers are within 10ft of a crawler, coordinate Trample Attacks, causing the crawler to suffer Disadvantage to Evade for attacks when surrounded.

"Before Scolopendra turned the whole Over City into a graveyard, this was the best place to find choice body parts. Now the body parts find you..."

—Under Tucker, Hobgoblin Undertaker

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HOBGOBLIN MORTUARY ASSISTANT

As staff members of the three major funeral homes, these Hobgoblins run the dangerous funeral ceremonies inside the Necropolis. They drive the hearses, prepare the bodies, perform the rites, and dig the graves. This job is as physically dangerous as it is emotionally demanding, but they do their duties with the utmost professionalism.

- Mournewick Assistants wear bowties.
- Aldgrave Assistants wear all black formalwear.
- Boltcrank assistants wear thick leather aprons.

AI **Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistant. Level 10.**

Hobgoblins are usually a rowdy, explosive bunch, but every group has buzzkills. Those folks who turn up to the party, complaining that the music's too loud and reminding everyone that we're all going to die. That's the Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistant to a tee.

These Debbie Downers do the grunt work involved with post-life care, from cleaning out corpses to digging holes and saying prayers. They're usually pretty tame, unless you get in the way of their work, in which case they're more than happy to add you to the corpse cart.

Hobgoblin Mortuarty Assistant

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	13+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
6 (+3)	7 (+3)	10 (+4)	10 (+4)	2 (+1)

Cleaning Spray: 14+F to hit, 1d6+4 Acid, 15ft Cone
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Scalpel: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Death by a Thousand Cuts*—When two or more Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistants are adjacent to a target, and the target has no adjacent allies, the target has Disadvantage to Evade.

ENVIRONMENT

The Necropolis is a ramshackle collection of disturbed cemeteries, mausoleums, and crypts. Prior to Scolopendra's attack, everything was divided between the three families in neat and orderly thirds, but the great upheaval and rise of the Dispenser created a topographical nightmare.

The ground has been uprooted and shattered in places where the undead rose from their graves. Great ruins of gray stone and marble look down on the streets below with exaggerated gothic dread. The sky is perpetually overcast, except at night when an aggressive full moon stretches the shadows across every corner and gargoyle.

Thunder crashes at dramatically opportune moments, and the AI punctuates revelations, vows, and threats with a flash of lightning. The Necropolis is ripe with the smell of decay, formaldehyde, and fresh blood. The only pockets of safety are the three funeral homes, which managed to protect themselves in the ensuing chaos.

Dread hangs heavy in the air, adding a somber pall to anyone who remains in the Necropolis for too long. This choking grave dust seeps into bags, clothing, and, for travelers who don't learn to cover their faces, even the lungs, infecting them with Rot Pneumonia (see *Traps*, below). Perpetual flames cast an eerie glow from the various headstones and lanterns that swing in the quiet breeze. Crying or mournful whimpering is a constant noise in the Neighborhood.

One nice thing about this Neighborhood is the restrooms. For some reason, all of them have the lovely smell of lavender and are attended by a friendly Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistant, who insists on giving you a tissue box before you head back out on your journey, whether you're crying or not.

TRAPS

Traps in the Necropolis stem from the unstable ground and the proliferation of open, crumbling graves. Most of the Mobs in this area are unlikely to create traps, but natural hazards abound.

- **Open Grave:** The crawlers stumble, wander, or fall into a previously unseen grave. This can be a freshly dug pit, a slippery marble staircase into a mausoleum, or a collapsing cairn.

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- **Rot Pneumonia:** A devastating lung condition brought on by inhaling the cremated dust, pulverized bone, and other aerosolized remains that float in the Necropolis's air. Crawlers who don't take inhalation precautions can essentially drown in liquefied human cremains without treatment.

  Fortunately, this isn't a fast process, so it is possible to get help before it's too late. Symptoms begin with a dry cough and ash-tinted sputum, worsening over hours into chest-rattling breathing and fatigue. It takes a day or two before the drowning sets in.

- **Don't Follow the Lights:** Occasionally, mischievous spirits manifest as hypnotic flames in the hopes of leading crawlers into the dangerous sprawl of headstones and broken tombs. These lights conjure a hypnotic pattern or even speak to people telepathically in the voice of their missing or dead loved ones. Most often, the lights draw victims into the path of Shambling Berserkers or worse.

ITEMS

The Necropolis is littered with the remains of funeral rites, shattered masonry, and whatever the dead didn't bother to keep buried.

- **Mausoleum Door Slab:** A fallen stone door, engraved with an impressive-sounding family name.
- **Mourner's Bell Frame:** A toppled wrought-iron frame with a cracked, bronze bell still chained inside. If struck (or dropped), the bell makes a booming noise that carries absurdly far through the headstones.
- **Grave Soil Sacks:** Burlap sacks of "blessed" dirt, ripped open and leaking gray soil.
- **Embalming Wash Barrel:** A dented metal barrel reeking of antiseptic and old blood.
- **Boltcrank's Spikes:** When at least three of these are combined following a galvanic ward created by Dr. Bartleby Boltcrank, they create an electrical field that is particularly effective at repelling the undead. If misaligned by even the smallest margin, they are instead particularly effective at summoning the undead in never-ending waves.

THE THREE FAMILIES

The Necropolis was once divided by three families, the Mournwicks, the Boltcranks, and the Aldgraves, who still lay claim to the area. They're based out of their respective funeral homes in each Quarter, and each has a vision for the future of the Necropolis. Included here is a brief description of their names, leaders, and general philosophies regarding the afterlife.

- **Clan Boltcrank:** Led by Dr. Bartleby Boltcrank, "Clan B," as they're often referred to, is something of a science-focused family. They fervently study the science of death and claim to have perfected ways of ensuring that the dead stay dead by aggressively using steampunk technology. It's rumored they may even be able to bring people back to life... but this claim is widely unsubstantiated.
- **The Mournewicks:** Led by Under Tucker, the Mournewicks operate a wholesome, family-owned funeral home that puts the "fun" in "funeral." They're experts in unconventional celebrations of life, from planting relatives inside trees to flaming-arrow Viking funerals to mixing grandpa's ashes with fireworks. Under Tucker Mournewick is a Hobgoblin who feels like everyone's dad.
- **The Aldgrave Family:** Led by Thursday Aldgrave, a matriarch of theatrical grace and quiet threats. The Aldgraves present themselves as gothic aristocracy from their mansion overlooking Procession Way. They run funerals as high ceremony and practice occult rites behind closed doors.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements and rewards in the Necropolis:

- **Death at a Funeral Home:** "You wiped out one of the three families. Couldn't be bothered to try the diplomatic approach, huh? Hopefully, disrupting the ecosystem like that won't have any long-term consequences. At least the Third Floor isn't connected to any of the others. Oh, wait...
  Reward: You receive a Gold Parley Box."
  Contents: An item related to making friends.
- **Bloody Mess:** "You survived a fight inside one of the Dispenser's clouds. Hope you weren't wearing white.
  Reward: You receive a Silver Rainy Day Box."
  Contents: An enchanted poncho, galoshes, or raincoat.
- **Professional Mourner:** "It's not every day you get to show up to a stranger's funeral, wear black, look mysterious in the background, and make the family

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ask, 'Was grandma in the mafia?'
Reward: You receive a Silver Cry on Cue Box."
Contents: An enchanted umbrella, bouquet, or sunglasses.

- **Nocturnal:** "You survived a night among the tombstones with the super-dangerous versions of the Mobs that make their homes there.
Reward: You receive a Gold Survivalist Box."
Contents: Flashlights, weapons, or camping gear.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers prove their ability to defeat a few Mobs in the Necropolis, they might grind for experience by killing Mobs repeatedly. Here are some complications they may run into as they tiptoe through the tombstones. See Table 80.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

The Neighborhood has four quarters for crawlers to explore.

TABLE 80: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	Just as the crawlers leap out to attack a group of Shambling Berserkers, the Dispenser flies over, crop-dusting the battlefield with its red mist, making the fight much more difficult and giving them a taste of the upcoming Boss Battle.
2	The crawlers encounter a Goblin and Hobgoblin duo supposedly performing a funeral for a group of grieving Elves, but they lack any of the decorum or respect commonly exhibited by the Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistants. The Goblin even passes a tip jar to the Elves, refusing to continue until a few coins are dropped in.
3	Hearses from two of the three families have crashed into each other, leading to a loud argument between the drivers, mismatched corpses, and the attention of some nearby Rumble Weeds.
4	The crawlers find a nest of Ruin Flocker eggs guarded by a territorial Level 16 Ruin Flocker mother hen. She has captured someone they know and trapped them in the nest as a makeshift egg-warmer while she patrols the perimeter.
5	A scientist from Clan Boltcrank attempts to purge a mausoleum with an experimental gas that accidentally fuses all the Shambling Berserkers inside to create a monstrous Level 25 Berserker Pile. This becomes an upgraded Shambling Berserker with Constitution 40 (+5). Now the crawlers must fight the Mob, cover the scientist as they prepare another device to undo the fusion, seal the mausoleum, or flee for their lives.
6	The crawlers are approached by a Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistant who asks them to serve as pallbearers for the funeral of someone who has no one to mourn them. This can be an antagonistic NPC, a crawler they used to know, or anyone else who might stir up some drama.

QUARTER: PROCESSION WAY

Most of the Necropolis is comprised of what is lovingly referred to as Procession Way. Prior to Scolopendra's attack, this primary thoroughfare connected all the cemeteries, memorial gardens, obelisks, and graveyards of the Necropolis. Intricate frescoes, welcoming benches, and enclosures for quiet contemplation decorated the wooden paths found throughout the Over City. Funeral processions of every description, from somber walking groups to raucous jazz parades, transpired almost hourly.

After the attack, most of Procession Way was lost to the collapsed crypts and restless dead, but a settlement on the western borders of the Necropolis survived. Thanks to Under Tucker and his family, a portion of Procession Way was reclaimed, turning it into a fortified launching point for funerals heading deeper into the Necropolis. It has scrap walls, a gate made of scavenged mausoleum slabs, shops, and an entrance to the Desperado Club nestled in the settlement.

The crawlers arrive in Procession Way just in time for a Shambling Berserker attack on the gates. The undead Mobs attempt to break into Procession Way almost every day, but strangely, they haven't attempted a night attack yet. Under Tucker rallies the Hobgoblins to fend off the

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of the Necropolis:

- A half-formed angel statue topples from the top of a grave marker, kicking up a cloud of ash and dust.
  Outcome: Crawlers who haven't taken precautions against the dust may contract Rot Pneumonia (*Traps*, p. 371).
- A long funeral procession marches solemnly across your path. Whoever this was, they sure had a lot of friends.
  Outcome: The crawlers suddenly have a lot of time on their hands, unless they can find an alternate path around the line. They could barge through, but whichever of the three families put on this funeral remembers the disrespect.
- A ghostly wail echoes through the streets of the Necropolis, seemingly centered on you.
  Outcome: The noise draws a group of Shambling Berserkers. The crawlers must prepare for battle or try to run.

monsters, and this is a great opportunity for the crawlers to meet him for the first time. If you want a little more spice to this scene, it can be the first of the night attacks.

Unfortunately, ever since the destruction of the Over City, the number of slots for funerals each week has increased, far outpacing the availability of the few Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistants on staff. The crawlers overhear an argument between two groups of mourners, insisting that it is imperative for their dead loved one to go on the next trip into the Necropolis. The Hobgoblins can't protect both groups but will flag down the crawlers to see if they might be willing to protect one of the funeral processions.

Fagin Mournewick is the black sheep of his family. He has no interest in the funeral industry and is constantly irritated by his father's insistence on burning the family fortune in an attempt to reclaim the Necropolis in some misguided sense of community and nostalgia. Fagin is certainly fed up with leading dangerous expeditions so people can cry over their deceased loved ones in a specific spot when anywhere would suffice. To help alleviate some of the backlog, Fagin started collecting Street Urchin Janitor Mobs found around the Over City and corralling them in a pen he uses to dispose of bodies for clients who might not want to wait for a bespoke funeral experience.

QUARTER: ALDGRAVE MANOR

Nestled within the necromantic wilderness of the Necropolis, Aldgrave Manor sits on a hill overlooking the burial grounds below. This black stone caricature of gothic opulence is surrounded by a wrought-iron fence suffused with mystical warding to keep dangerous Mobs at bay.

Thursday Aldgrave manages her funeral empire from the tallest spire of the mansion, which employs horseless carriages to collect and transport bodies to their final resting place. The Aldgraves also maintain the largest dovecote in the Over City, where they store hundreds of ravens who travel the city to find people in need of funeral services. A spacious guest house on the estate grounds houses a saferoom with a dour, yet sophisticated, Bopca named Dudley on staff.

Thursday's affable husband, Cosimo, captured a group of Rumble Weeds and is practicing his fencing footwork. The crawlers happen by just as he is overwhelmed by the Mobs and needs rescuing. Cosimo is more than happy to sing their praises as warriors and puts in a good word for them with Thursday when they next speak with her.

Thursday asks to speak with the crawlers concerning a delicate matter. She tells them that one of her carriages was overwhelmed by a flock of Ruin Flockers, and one of the bodies in her care was delivered in less-than-pristine condition.

The client demands that the body be interred with a family signet ring, in accordance with their traditions, but the birds appear to have carried it off. Thursday offers the crawlers access to one of her warded hearses in exchange for recovering the ring. While inside the hearse, the crawlers are invisible to the Rumble Weeds and Shambling Berserkers, but not the Ruin Flockers.

The Aldgraves remain largely unaffected by the destruction of the Necropolis because of the actions they took to placate the Dispenser. It's not intelligent enough to make a deal, but Thursday Aldgrave comes from a long line of matriarchs who kept a terrible secret: the Aldgraves perfected a technique to feed necromantic energy into the Dispenser.

They infuse a few bodies a year with magical essence and feed them to the Dispenser in an occult ritual. If the crawlers find out about this, they can potentially use the information as blackmail to get the Aldgraves to cooperate during the three-family negotiations or find some way to poison the Dispenser to make their forthcoming Boss Battle easier.

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QUARTER: BONE BRAMBLE

Now a chaotic ruin of a dozen graveyards, the Bone Bramble was once the pinnacle of the Necropolis, where the bodies of the Over City's most notable were buried. These days, it's a mangled mountain of smashed headstones, broken mausoleum walls, and coffin splinters that jut from the ground like skeletal fingers.

Pale bramble-vines, more bone-white than green, thread through the ruins. Ashy grave dust drifts in lazy clouds between the stones, and at night, the full moon makes every shattered angel and toppled obelisk throw predatory shadows.

The Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistants avoid the Bone Bramble when they can. It's one of the only places where the Dispenser's mist lingers in pockets along the ground, empowering its minions even when it isn't home.

The crawlers are forced into a rolling ambush as a pack of Rumble Weeds ricochets through the headstones, herding them toward a wall of Shambling Berserkers. Narrow lanes prevent clean flanking. The prevalent brambles snag the crawlers, and open graves turn retreats into potentially catastrophic falls.

Thanks to a hearse with a broken axle, a funeral procession stalls, trapping its participants in the bramble. Mourners, Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistants, and everyone else are all too terrified to move. It costs the crawlers time and resources to repair the hearse and guide the family out of the quarter, but it earns respect from whichever family commissioned the burial. Refusing or robbing them is faster but raises questions when they return to civilization. This scene works best if it occurs on the crawlers' first time through the Bone Bramble.

If the crawlers complete a task in the Bone Bramble, such as installing Boltcrank's spikes, rescuing a trapped victim, or following the Don't Follow the Lights spirits, they uncover a collapsed catacomb hidden amidst the brambles and headstones that climbs up into the Necropolis's plateau. Prying aside the bramble reveals a slick tunnel of compacted grave soil leading up to the Dispenser's lair, where it roosts high above the fog-choked Necropolis.

QUARTER: LAMENTATION STATION

A fortified campus of laboratories, dormitories, and workshops, Lamentation Station is the ancestral holding of Clan Boltcrank. The area looks less like a graveyard district and more like a steampunk university majoring in Frankenstein studies.

Scrap walls built from broken gravestones fence in its gray brick buildings. Copper piping, Tesla cages, and lightning rods top every roof, casting an uneven purple glow over the compound. The air stinks of ozone, antiseptic, and hot oil. Inside the compound, Hobgoblin Mortuary Assistants in reinforced aprons move with brisk, exhausted purpose.

Clan Boltcrank's mission is simple: The dead must *stay* dead, and their crews churn out anti-undead devices by the crateful. When they travel into the Necropolis, they do so from armored hearses with enough firepower to ensure any funeral is a permanent one.

A containment alarm shrieks throughout the campus as an experimental purge system misfires. The Shambling Berserkers on the receiving end of the experiment were not disintegrated, as was hoped by the engineers performing the test. Instead, the Shambling Berserkers are imbued with the same destructive rage that falls upon them at night, regardless of what time of day it is when it happens. They then break free from their cage, ready to wreak havoc on Lamentation Station should the crawlers not intervene.

I now had a tab in my inventory called Mob Morgue. The monsters' bodies were all worthless, but one never knew when something might be useful.

—Carl

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Dr. Bartleby Boltcrank requests the crawlers as muscle for a field test involving a new galvanic ward system he's designed. The job is simple but requires a delicate touch: They must enter a section of the Bone Bramble and install a series of electrified spikes. If arrayed in the correct order, the spikes generate an electrical field that repels Shambling Berserkers and Rumble Weeds. If arrayed incorrectly, the field summons the undead instead.

If the crawlers complete the ward-spike job, rescue the technicians, or otherwise earn Dr. Boltcrank's trust, they earn limited access to the family's restricted labs. Inside, they discover why Clan B's tech works as well as it does: They're harvesting condensed necromantic residue skimmed from Dispenser mist and using it as a power source. Exposing this practice could fracture the three-family negotiations, give the crawlers leverage, or act as a potential weapon against the Dispenser.

NPCS

UNDER TUCKER MOURNEWICK

The lovable patriarch of the Mournewick family and the crawlers' first point of contact in the Necropolis. He is a goofy family man with an extroverted personality and a humble nature. He wants to reclaim the Necropolis for all Hobgoblins

AI Under Tucker Mournewick.

Hobgoblin Undertaker. Level 15.

Under Tucker is the kindly leader of the Mournewicks. He's a wiz at funerals, eulogies, and inhumation and knows all sorts of different culture's funerary traditions. This guy is genuinely concerned about his family, too!

You probably want to get his card because... let's face it... One of you might need his services soon.

Hobgoblin Undertaker

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	14+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
9 (+3)	10 (+4)	13 (+4)	13 (+4)	5 (+2)

Cleaning Spray: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Acid, 15ft Cone
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Scalpel: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Slashing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Lead to Death*—When two or more Hobgoblins are adjacent to a target, and the target has no adjacent allies, the target has Disadvantage to Evade.

DR. BARTLEBY BOLTCRANK

The mad scientist of the funeral world and the person you contact when your loved one absolutely, positively, by any means necessary, has to stay dead. He isn't known for his people skills or fashion sense, but his work in the field of keeping dead things dead is top notch. Of course, learning how to keep things dead means he has to understand the flip side of how to bring the dead back to life, but that would be completely against his business models so of course he's never invested in a giant lightning rod and a table to hold an enormous corpse he lovingly crafted from specially harvested body parts. Those are all purely unsubstantiated rumors.

AI Dr. Bartleby Boltcrank

Undertaker Scientist. Level 15.

The man behind the Boltcrank clan and the mind keeping the dead in the ground even when the world keeps trying to rise them back up. He won't give you a nice eulogy because, let's face it, he doesn't like people and you're not the type to chat up scientists, but he will drive a steam-powered steak through your heart to make sure you stay in the ground. That's what undertakers are for right?

THURSDAY ALDGRAVE

She was born into more money than your entire town was worth, and she knows it. Thursday understands that funerals are a somber and elegant affair meant to be handled with grace and the utmost of poise. There are no loud parties or "Celebration of Life" handmade posters at her events. The dress code is always all black formal wear and nothing else is allowed on the premises of the Aldgrave mansion which has been in her family for more generations than you've had humans on Earth.

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AI Thursday Aldgrave

Undertaker Occultist. Level 15.

The best dressed of the Necropolis leaders, Thursday Aldgrave takes her role deadly seriously. Her funerals are meant for emperors and marchionesses, not crawlers, but she is more than willing to use crawlers for grunt work and muscle power. After all, her perfectly painted black fingernails are certainly not going to be holding the shovel to dig any graves.

MINOR NPCS

The crawlers might find some unexpected allies in the Necropolis. These are generally non-combatants.

- **Shannon Ravenswell. Hobgoblin Ravenkeeper. Level 8.** Keeper of the birds at Aldgrave Manor, Shannon is a great friend to have if you're looking to communicate with other areas of the Necropolis quickly. She is protective of her birds but loves a good bit of hot gossip.
- **Dudley. Bopca Protector. Saferoom Concierge. Level 16.** The Aldgraves' guest-house attendant and the single most judgmental being to ever hand someone a lavender-scented tissue.
- **Millicent "Milly" Geargrieve. Hobgoblin Galvanist. Level 10.** Dr. Boltcrank's number one engineer, Milly is the combat electrician who leads the Clan B field experiments. She's fiercely protective of her crew and can train crawlers in practical anti-undead tactics for their expeditions into the Necropolis. She secretly suspects the lab's primary power source isn't clean and will clue the crawlers in if they earn her trust.
- **Digman and Casket. Goblin Grifters. Level 6.** Digman and Casket are a pair of con-artist Goblins who prowl Procession Way looking for desperate people in need of alternative burial solutions. The fact that their solution is usually to find a ditch somewhere and kick some dirt over the body often doesn't make its way back to their grieving clients.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The Dispenser's cavern is a hollowed-out mortuary once used to prepare the bodies of the Over City's finest for their funerals. The smooth stone is a perfect resting place for the camouflaged monster when it isn't flying the not-so-friendly skies of the Necropolis. The cavern is littered with mortuary detritus. Shambling Berserkers and Rumble Weeds lurk in the corners, waiting to feed on their master's cast-offs.

When the crawlers enter the cave, the Dispenser peels away from the cave wall. The AI announces in their best spooky voice and displays images of each of the crawlers and the Dispenser wreathed in laurels made of bone. The giant manta ray Mob floats into the air, flooding the chamber with a choking, red mist.

The Dispenser uses its aerial advantage to the best of its ability, swooping over the crawlers and constantly gassing them with the mist. Its undead minions swarm into the fray, eager for the energizing boost, and soon give in to their berserker rage. If pressed, the Dispenser can slam into the crawlers with its massive bulk, attempting to siphon them into its mouth to create more mist.

CLUES

- The Dispenser is well camouflaged. Beware of its attacks during the first round of combat.
- Attacks on the Dispenser's rear gain Advantage as its head is wide and hard to turn around.
- If you get knocked down, beware of being swallowed.

The Dispenser. Giant Manta Ray Human Body Humidifier.

Level 30 Neighborhood Boss!

I'm not sure if this thing is worse than the stingray that killed Steve Irwin, but it's pretty damn close. The Dispenser is part manta ray, part blender, and part fog machine. It's not the only Boss in the dungeon with a splash zone, but this one comes with a mosh pit of pissed-off body parts that put Juggalos to shame. Try not to die; we would definitely mist you!

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The Dispenser

Neighborhood Boss; Huge (6), Beastly

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	15%	23%	30%	38%	46%	53%	61%	69%	76%	84%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
30	14+F	15+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
52 (+6)	12 (+4)	24 (+5)	22 (+5)	5 (+2)

Aerial Slam: 16+F to hit, 3d10+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Caustic Mist: 15+F to hit, 3d8+4 Acid, 20ft Cone +10ft Splash
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Burned Debuff.

Tail Whip: 16+F to hit, 5d6+6 Slashing, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Camouflage*—The Dispenser has Advantage on its attacks during the first round of combat.

The Dispenser dispenses his attacks against crawlers in pairs when able. If it is going to use Aerial Slam against a crawler, it uses it as its first attack against that crawler.

Them's Good Eatin'—The Dispenser will spend an action to swallow any crawler that gains the Take Down Debuff from Aerial Slam. The crawler must make a Str Stat Check. On Fail, they have the Swallowed Debuff: They take 1d10+F Acid at the end of each round until they escape. To escape, they must make a Str-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check, or a Str Stat Check at the same Difficulty. While Swallowed, The Dispenser's DR does not apply to that crawler's attacks.

Big Head, But Beady Eyes—Attacks to The Dispenser's rear have Advantage.

Flight—The Dispenser can move through the air as though on the ground.

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FLOOR 3

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QUEST: HATE HIGH

FLOOR: 3 — THEME: HIGH SCHOOL: WEIRDER THAN REMEMBERED AND RUN BY A CRAZED YETI.

Upon observing American high schools, a small production company named *Bad Idea Jeans* concluded they were already a form of dungeon. Had they spoken to actual high-schoolers, they would have learned they were right.

While the aliens at Bad Idea Jeans behind this Quest don't understand the subtle nuances of getting into (or being thrown out of) a clique, nor the reasons why near-adults are taught the math of preschoolers, they did glean the idea that high school was a hellscape in which only the strong, lucky, or rich survive.

Their interpretation of high school as a dungeon, while parodic, is also pretty on point. Throughout the halls of this Neighborhood stalk Cool Kids, Neo-Maxie-Zoom-Dweebies, teachers looking to put blood on your permanent record, and a host of bullies trying to stuff you in a locker.

Crawlers must navigate a labyrinth of red-lockered hallways, classrooms smelling of just-washed carpet and marker ink, and gym rooms reeking of the unmentionable horrors of puberty that take brave souls. Think John Hughes meets John Carpenter.

The production company made a deal with the System AI to send some low-Level crawlers to the school for a Quest. That Quest involves surviving the current clique war, uncovering who is really behind the recent cheating scandal at Hate High, and dealing with the coach-turned-principal before he brings the whole school down permanently.

Manipulated by a Cool Kid named Steph, the Big Boss for this Quest is Yakov the Yeti, the football coach. Getting at him requires mixing with the cliques and finding a teacher, one Myron Fowler, mixed up in Steph's attempt to control the school and keep the losers in their place.

STRONG STARTS

Few people want to go back to high school, but in an alien dungeon, familiar territory might seem welcome. The word "seem" does a *lot* of heavy lifting in that sentence.

- After the crawlers successfully take out a particularly gnarly Boss elsewhere, Bad Idea Jeans offers them a chance to "clean up a bit of a mess." The mess? Hate High.

  They tell them it's like going undercover in high school for the good of all. Remember 21 Jump Street? If they don't, the System AI reminds them what a great show that was. Also, there are rewards, and you could even get your viewer numbers up! Now, get some acne cream, a Trapper Keeper, and find out the lowdown on Hate High!
- Some teachers in the area can tutor a PC in Skills or offer upgrades... allegedly. Might be quadratic equations, or it might be something useful, like welding or chemistry. The System AI likely uses this to help sell crawlers on taking this Quest. It's clear they want a new show—undercover high school "cops" trying to take out a high school full of very bad things. The ratings will be huge!

QUEST DESCRIPTION

AI John Hughes wasn't the only person to tell a good high school story—and his didn't even have bloody carnage! Bad Idea Jeans set up Hate High as a standard American high school, but when a cheating scandal exploded, they got a better idea: make it an investigative Quest with plenty of mayhem.

So they've arranged to get you into Hate High as seniors under fake IDs. Once there, they need to investigate and infiltrate various cliques to gather clues and allies, uncover the truth behind the cheating, and then take down the Boss (or die in an entertaining way)!

All the while, Bad Idea Jeans has cameras rolling, hoping the crawlers crawl, and any intrigues, however stupid, might earn their pilot a green light to a full season!

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MOBS

The Mobs in Hate High are mean with a capital "Hey, dork!" They represent physical manifestations of everything bad you remember from your adolescence. High school is a perpetual pit of vipers wrestling for control, and everyone is at risk for a bite in the ass.

THE COOL KIDS

Cool kids, like ice sculptures, wearing popped collars and looking like Steph from Pretty in Pink or Molly Ringwald from The Breakfast Club, or modern equivalents.

These elven Mobs display the latest fashion, be it popped collars or Prada sunglasses—all of it cast in very cool hues of Antarctic blue. Any hallway they traverse in their trademark casual cool ease turns to ice, and only the Cool Kids know how to skate.

Each of them looks like a model, with ice-hard cheekbones, perfect features, and the apathy to match. They drop lots of coins when defeated because they come from the other side of the tracks (the *good* side). They got money—their parents' money.

Cool Kids attack with liquid nitrogen touches. When they aren't doing that, they entice those around them to join their clique.

AI **Cool Kid. Elf. Level 15.**

Remember those kids from school who were at the top of the heap? You existed as little more than background noise in their worlds, and they wanted you to know it.

They're so cool, these Elves' blood runs with actual ice. They glide down the halls, lean better than Jordan Catalano, and can deliver a nasty freezer-burn with a single touch. They think you want to be just like them—and if you don't watch it, that's exactly how you might end up.

Cool Kid

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	13+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
8 (+3)	7 (+3)	8 (+3)	12 (+4)	15 (+4)

Blue Steel Look: 14+F to hit, No damage, 20ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Icy Touch: 13+F to hit, 3d4+3 Ice, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Stiff Legs Debuff.

Slam: 13+F to hit, 3d6+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Peer Pressure*—Crawlers must make an Int Stat Check prior to each attack against a Cool Kid. On Fail, they have Disadvantage on their attack as they contemplate joining the clique. On Success, they never make this Check again.

NEO-MAXIE-ZOOM-DWEEBIES

These rambunctious Goblins never stop moving or talking. A riotous cacophony of talk, jibber-jabber, and dork-speak, Neo-Maxie-Zoom-Dweebies (aka NMZDs) are the classic nerds of the Neighborhood. Bug-eyed and brilliant, they attack *en masse*, trying to trap prey in a hallway or classroom.

Unlike the Cool Kids, they don't drink and don't do drugs, two weaknesses you might exploit. But they can calculate vectors in a second and set up complex attacks to hit everyone in the party at once. Their leaders wear bras on their heads for some reason. Don't ask.

AI **Neo-Maxie-Zoom-Dweebie. Goblin. Level 17.**

Mouth-breathing, close-talking, and high-grade-receiving, these nerds will brute-force attack you with malignant code while telling you all about their Level 18 Sorcerer character from their latest TTRPG campaign. Vaguely aware of their role in the pecking order, they roam the school, hiding from the Sporto Teen Wolves and the Cool Kids and preying on those weaker than themselves—which is you.

Neo-Maxie-Zoom-Dweebie

Mob; Petite (3), Goblin

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
17	15+F	12+F	20+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
5 (+2)	35 (+5)	6 (+3)	5 (+2)	5 (+2)

Calculated Risk: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Psychic, 10ft range, 5ft Blast radius

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On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

Code Break: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Sonic, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Fatigued Debuff.

Notes: *En Masse*—When 3 or more Neo-Maxie-Zoom-Dweebies are within 5ft of a crawler, they surround them, causing the crawler to have Disadvantage to Evade.

STOKERS

Rail thin and pale as death, these goths want your blood. They wear long black coats, sunglasses indoors, and listen to way too much of Sisters of Mercy. They stand seven feet tall but can blend into shadows like darkness in an eclipse. They hate the Sporto Teen Wolves most of all, and though the feeling is mutual, that doesn't mean they like *you*, either. However, they are quite attracted to all that blood you're full of.

AI **Stoker. Non-Sparkly Vampire. Level 18.**

These Neo-Victorian-looking folks are pale as death... probably for a good reason. They wear mourning black, big stompy boots, and have needles for teeth—all the better to zuck your blood vith!

Stokers' heads are constantly full of goth-rock, emo, and metal—a never-ending soundtrack to the misery of their own lives, which they're all too eager to inflict upon you.

Non-Sparkly Vampire

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
18	13+F	14+F	25+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	9 (+3)	20 (+5)	10 (+4)	10 (+4)

Bite: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Drained Debuff: Take 1d6+F Necrotic at the end of each round until the combat ends, and that Non-Sparkly Vampire heals 1 HB.

Sing Spell: 13+F to hit, 3d4+3 Sonic, 25ft Cone
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Fatigued Debuff.

STUDENT BODY

The Student Body is a gruesome collection of limbs, mouths, and eyes, with no two parts belonging to the same original being. They incessantly shout pithy school cheers as they run on hundreds of legs. They smoke in the boys' room and cough it out at their prey in heavy, acidic clouds.

Like a melting candle made up of a hundred bodies, these abominable amalgamations resembling a mess of action figure parts can kick, scratch, strangle, bite, and much, much more—all while grossing you out to the max!

AI **Student Body. Level 19.**

Remember when you took every doll or action figure you ever had and melted them together into a mindless abomination of pain and suffering? Now add some screaming, multiply the size several times over, and give them a range of insidious attacks, and you've got the Student Body.

Watch out for their acidic smoke breath and their cloying limbs, or you might find yourself enrolled in their class, where the only tuition you can pay is by giving all of yourself for the sake of school spirit.

Student Body

Mob; Large (5), Amalgamation

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
19	14+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	11 (+4)	20 (+5)	10 (+4)	1 (+1)

Acid Breath: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Acid, 20ft Cone
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Queasy Debuff.

Grab: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *Enrolled*—Crawlers who gain the Held Debuff start becoming assimilated into the Student Body. They must make a Str-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check, or a Str Stat Check at the same Difficulty. On Fail, the crawler begins moving with the Student Body, taking 1d8+F damage each round until they Escape or the Mob is killed.

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SPORTO TEEN WOLVES

Three-time state champions, the howlingest howlers of the gridiron... here come the Teen Wolves! You need a varsity jacket to join these lacrosse-playing lycanthropes, and they don't allow just anyone to join their team (though that won't stop them from delivering the occasional wedgie or shoving an unsuspecting nerd into a locker).

These werewolves go wild under Friday night lights, and here in the dungeon, it's *always* Friday. They're mean, amped up on 'roids, and ready to thrash you like the dork you are. If their claws don't rip your face off, they'll probably just bite off your head—literally.

AI **Sporto Teen Wolf. Level 19.**

Wa-hooo! Werewolves of Dungeons!

The Sporto Teen Wolves are the defending state champions in multiple team sports, and they're here to ruff you up. These seven-foot-tall werewolves wear letter jackets that jingle like the holidays from all the medals they've won, so you'll hear them coming, but don't let their lack of subtlety fool you; under their coats they've donned game day jerseys and pads (but no pants).

They're raking the ground with their claws, waiting for that starting whistle. Hope you know how to pass-block, nerd.

Sporto Teen Wolf

Mob; Medium (4), Beastly

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
19	14+F	15+F	25+S	3

Str	Int	Con	Dex	Cha
10 (+4)	11 (+4)	10 (+4)	20 (+5)	11 (+4)

Bite: 14+F to hit, 3d4+4 Piercing, 5ft range
(Secret!) On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Lycanthropy Debuff: The crawler turns into a Sporto Teen Wolf the following night. The Debuff is removed if the crawler has the Dying Debuff.

Stick: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Wedgie: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff. Get it!?

Notes: *Silver Weakness*—Silver weapons do ×2 damage to Sporto Teen Wolves, bypass DR, and apply The Taint Debuff.

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TRAPS

Some say the school system itself is a trap. Well, now it's a trap with extra traps inside it!

- **Claymore Locker:** A locker near the party explodes like a claymore mine. A typical claymore mine contains about 700 ball bearings behind a wall of plastic explosive. So... this is gonna hurt. Also, it's directional, which means those ball bearings get blown outward in a cone of death. Stand too close, and you'll contribute a new school spirit mural on the opposite wall painted exclusively in shades of red.
- **Door Guillotine:** Some classrooms take the French Revolution very seriously. When someone (maybe you) steps through this door, a heavy guillotine blade falls. Maybe you lose toes and just need a smaller shoe size, or maybe you get cut in two. Finding out is half the fun!
- **Spitball Machine Gun:** These spitballs are huge and slick with saliva and snot, and some contain paralytic venom! They launch out of a six-pack of straws arranged like a Gatling gun, which is aimed at your party. Oh, and have we mentioned they're the size, density, and weight of golf balls? Watch out for bogeys!

LIKELY ACHIEVEMENTS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Quest.

- **Valedictorian*:** "Most students struggle to survive even the easiest and most mundane subjects in school, although a few standouts rise to the occasion and get fancy golden tassels for scoring in the upper percentages.
  But you—you're in an entirely different echelon altogether! You did enough smart things all in a row to designate yourself as the smartest, highest-achieving kid in school. Wow. Your mom may be proud, but let's face it: you're a fuckin' nerd.
  Reward: You've earned a Platinum Apparel Box!"
  Contents: A cap and gown of gold and brown (the Hate High School colors) and an exclusive white valedictorian tassel. Effect: All Hate High Mobs attacking you deal 20% less damage.
  **Note:* Only one crawler may attain this achievement.
- **Prom Royalty:** "School isn't just about earning good grades, preparing for higher education, and setting yourself up for a good job; it's also about learning social skills, mastering verbal repartee, and striving to reach the pinnacle of cool—whatever that means. You've gained enough positive attention and respect from other crawlers and enemy Mobs to earn this achievement; don't squander it by getting someone (including yourself) pregnant after the dance.
  Reward: The Cool Kids Mobs are now allies. Yes, all of them. They won't follow your orders, but they won't attack you, either, and they're willing to trade and cooperate as long as it serves their interests, too."
- **Slacker of the Year:** "School is boring! It always has been, and anyone who thinks otherwise is a goody-two-shoes and a future corporate slave. Fuck that noise! Just like in high school, here in the dungeon, you do what you want, when you want, consequences be damned.
  Reward: A storage closet or school bathroom of your choice now becomes a saferoom for you. You can bring friends, too! (Reefer not provided.)"
- **Teacher's Pet:** "You suck. In this case, sucking is a good thing! In fact, you sucked up enough to the folks who really matter (mostly just me), and I like you more now, so you get a prize.
  Reward: You receive a Silver Adventurer's Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

I kill a Mob. You kill a Mob. We all kill Mobs. Wash, rinse, repeat.

Hey, even carnage gets boring at the table. After you've wasted a few Mobs, your party may decide it's time to grind. They might go through killing another Mob of the same type, or ten. Who can say? Point is, you don't want to play that all out. Check out Table 81 for some complications.

NPCS

STEPH

Steph is King of the Cool Kids (the coolest of them all!) with hair so blond it's practically white. He's an Elf, and an asshole, but not necessarily in that order. Steph thought for a long time that he oughta run this school, and with copies of every test answer key in the school in his hands, he does. He's accused every other group of having the key and is letting the rest of the cliques fight to the death

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TABLE 81: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	It was all going well until a vending machine toppled over, and the thing is a lot heavier than you thought. Now you gotta free yourself before you're crushed *or* get caught by a Mob. Hope you brought some brutes and maybe a sturdy hand truck.
2	During your last fight, one of you got stuffed into a locker, and you're still trapped inside. Look, it happens to the best of us, really. Okay, it pretty much only happens to nerds and dumbasses. Anyway, you don't have the combination. And an explosive spell would probably make things worse, right? Find your way out before something else finds you instead.
3	Gah! You got detention. You're locked in some quasi-part of the school. A pseudo-prison room with a bunch of desks and the snores of a completely random amalgamation of sleeping Student Bodies. The room gets smaller every minute, and as soon as the Student Bodies wake up, things are gonna get messy.
4	*Skibidi Toilet*. Your party is stuck in one. More specifically, in the Mario-sized pipes *under* one. You're stuck between halls, between classrooms. Unfortunately for you, the toilets flushing and sinks running overhead are the least of your concerns. Fix the plumbing before the plumbing fixes you.
5	You angered one of the Cool Kids. His name is Bacon, and now he wants a dance-off! Better get *Footloose*, crawlers, because you ain't getting out of here without some fancy footwork. Cue Kenny Loggins!
6	Somewhere during combat, you got recruited for the school play: *Biker Macbeth*. "In the grim wasteland of the far future, there is only... Macbeth." And you don't know your lines. Better improvise something cool or suffer the slings and arrows of the Mob audience that's watching your mandatory dress rehearsal.

about it until he can reveal his role and use it to claim the title of Prom King.

Steph might pretend to help the PCs if he thinks it's in his interest. He's the "I can fix him" asshole of the school, and audiences love to hate Steph!

QUEST EVENTS

Use these events to evoke the mood of this Quest:

- Wacked out of their mind on "study pills," a Mob of Neo-Maxie-Zoom-Dweebies crammed for class so hard their heads are about to blow. Literally. Plus, they're running with scissors!
- Some Goblin kids sit out in the hall (with their desks). They're younger than teenagers and probably shouldn't even be here. Some mean teachers made them sit outside for "misbehaving."
- The hallway floors, walls, and ceiling look like a multi-colored pointillist mural straight from Art Class. What is all that? Oh, it's perpetually elastic chewing gum and spit dripping down. Gross.
- You approach a bank of lockers at the end of the hallway. They all open at once, disgorging gallons upon gallons of chunky, rancid milk! You'll drown (or suffocate from the smell) if you don't get out of there! If only there'd been a milk monitor!

AI **Steph. Cool Kid. Level 27.**

Don't underestimate this elven icon because of his looks; that icy white hair covers a pretty sharp mind. Steph knows the ins and outs of being cool and how to keep losers, dorks, and weirdos in their place. If he ever left the school, you can bet he'd drive a really nice Ferrari—ice-blue, of course.

Teen Bully

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
27	14+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
12 (+4)	12 (+4)	10 (+4)	11 (+4)	11 (+4)

Blue Magnum Look: 15+F to hit, No damage, 20ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Icy Touch: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Ice, 5ft range

Piercing Glare: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Piercing, 25ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *Manipulative*—Crawlers attempting Charisma-based Skills against Steph do so with Disadvantage.

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MYRON FOWLER

Myron Fowler is from a Race known as the Gallusine (chicken people), who are unremarkable members of the Syndicate. Myron plays his role in Hate High as a teacher who serves as the butt of jokes from students and other teachers alike. His favorite course to teach is "Cluck or Be Clucked: The History of the Chicken on Old Earth." He also teaches regular history, but he has zero enthusiasm for it.

Since poor Myron was on the bottom tier of the teacher's pitiful pay scale, he took a bribe from Steph to steal all the other teachers' test keys and copy them. But now the clique war has Myron and the other teachers trapped in the teacher's lounge. A coward at heart, he doesn't want to admit his role to his fellow teachers because they would toss him out to the angry Mobs in a heartbeat.

AI **Myron Fowler. Gallusine.**

Level 25 Archaeologist.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

He's sweaty, feathered, and constantly tugging at his tie, saying, "I get no respect..." or some version thereof. According to him, he went to Hate High as a kid and now teaches here. All he ever wanted to do was be a cool kid—the popular kind, not the ice-based Mob kind. Now, he's trapped between the frigid manipulations of Steph and the atomic wedgies the Sporto Teen Wolves give him if he leaves the lounge.

STAGE 1: HOMECOMING

High school wasn't great the first time around, and now you're back here to find out who is behind this cheating scandal. This can't possibly go wrong in a hundred different ways, right?

Crawler's first step is to mix and mingle with all the cliques and find out what's going on. The crawlers initially notice that the halls and classrooms resemble a war zone more than sacred places of learning.

These cliques are at each other's throats—literally. This in-fighting gives the crawlers a chance to avoid combat or to jump right the hell in, as well as to scope out who's who. The Cool Kids seem, well, cool and aloof, whereas the Sporto Teen Wolves ostensibly run through sheer brute force and terror.

It doesn't take long to learn that all this fighting is in search of the stolen test answer key, the holy grail for any student looking to pass their senior year. The jocks also seem the most desperate to get their hands on the stolen tests, and they seem convinced the Neo-Maxie-Zoom Dweebies have the tests.

After some crawling, it quickly becomes clear that the nerds don't have the key and are the ones most upset about the cheating. After all, the only thing going for the NMZDs is their stellar grades. So why would they steal answer keys? Someone else is behind this, and the best way to find out is to go straight to the source of the answer key: the teachers.

STAGE 2: TEACHER LOUNGE

The ones most willing to talk about the stolen answer keys are the teachers. A neutral group of varying Races holed up in the Teacher's Lounge trying to wait out the clique war. Whenever a teacher leaves the lounge, they get killed, so the remaining teachers obviously decided to stay inside.

Getting to the lounge is no simple feat: The Sporto Teen Wolves aren't letting anyone in or out, and the other Mobs, all at war, certainly don't want outsiders near the lounge or the teachers.

Getting inside means a series of fights. However, since the Mobs are already at each other's throats, the crawlers might be able to ally with one side to help them. Or not. It's high school as a potential *Dungeon World: Earth* spin-off. Do you ever *really* know who your friends are?

The lounge itself smells of fried chicken and is a sad space with an old couch, a water cooler, one table, and a group of tired, overworked teachers. Myron Fowler smokes a cigarette and paces the lounge as other teachers explain that someone stole the answer keys and made copies of them. There are a lot of accusations, but the only way to find the truth is to see whose code was used most recently on the copy machine inside the Student Academic Resource Center (the computer learning lab). The code entered on the copy machine is keyed to a specific teacher, which means they'll find out who gave the code to a student and, hopefully, who that student is.

Myron is nervous about the investigation and tries to assure everyone that surely this will all roll over if they just make it to prom in a few days. The other teachers tell him to shut up and are dismissive of Myron.

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STAGE 3: THE STUDENT ACADEMIC RESOURCE CENTER (SARC)

The crawlers need to get through the halls of locks to reach the SARC and access the copy machine to discover the code used to make the copies of the test answers. A brigade of the Student Body is filled with school spirit and waiting to pounce. Getting through all those Mobs is the only route to reach the copy machine. It's a rolling brawl getting to the evidence, and the GM is free to add any other Mobs they want. Once there, getting the code is a simple Intelligence-based puzzle. For the crawlers, it's not hard to crack.

The copy machine reveals that teacher Myron Fowler's code was used. With that information, they can go back to the teacher's lounge and lean on him. He breaks down and spills the proverbial beans, wailing, "It was Steph! It was all Steph!"

At that point, he tells the crawlers that Steph is a Cool Kid working with Coach Yakov to save the football team's grades. Steph hangs out in a secret room inside the school library. He pleads with them to keep it a secret that he chickened out and told them who was behind the scheming, though.

STAGE 4: LIBRARY LEARNING

Cool Kids aren't known for hanging out in the library, unless the library looks like it's straight out of a John Hughes movie, and the Hate High library absolutely does! But deep inside the confusing labyrinth of shelves lies a hidden room... or possibly more than one.

The Cool Kids have money, looks, and time to burn. They're snorting coke off the desks and using old books to light their joints. Kegs are stacked four high, and if you try to interfere, they will absolutely fight for their right to party.

Somewhere in the library is Steph, the crawler's quarry and source of the clique wars. But Steph isn't going to be an easy get. He's mobilized his clique of Cool Kids to defend him to the death. Combat here involves falling shelves, an abstract sculpture, a DJ booth (for some reason), and Cool Kids dancing on the railings. Kegs may be thrown, books burned or frozen, and mayhem enjoyed by all.

As soon as things go south for the Cool Kids, Steph bolts. He refuses to get caught by the PCs if he can help it. He runs down the halls, eliciting a chase. The GM can use the chase rules (p. 74), but if you want the Boss showdown, then Steph ought to escape to the gym. If need be, locker traps can go off, waylaying the party, and other Mobs can jump in to slow them.

However, you needn't railroad this. If they catch Steph, that's cool as Christmas. With Steph in hand, Yakov likely backs down. It's an alternate to the Boss fight, if the PCs deserve it for clever thinking or good rolls. But if not, then they land in the gym.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Time freezes as the lights in the gym strobe like the opening intro to 1990s Chicago Bulls NBA games and pulse with the same familiar tracks. Painted on the floor are the lines of a basketball court, while landmines pulse all around the ground and walls. This place is ready to blow as Coach Yakov enters with a pack of Sporto Teen Wolves around him. They take formation at the starting line. An announcement crackles overhead: "Ladies and gentlemen, your three-time all-galaxy coach, just kicked out of a D-1 school for being 'abusive to the players,' it's the legend himself: Yakov 'The Yeti Coach' Yerminov!" A portrait of the huge, football-gear-wearing Yeti spirals in, followed by portraits of the crawlers before all exploding in a burst of confetti. Time resumes.

Yakov the Yeti is a fifteen-foot-tall abominable snowman with a football jersey and shoulder pads. He eschews the helmet. He attacks with his team (the Sporto Teen Wolves, p. 383), directing them in plays that corner the crawlers. Once the Sporto Teen Wolves get the crawlers pinned, Yakov lumbers in to finish the job. They also steer crawlers toward the landmines that linger near every odd-numbered yard line.

If the PCs have Steph with them, he can try to get Yakov to stand down by offering the answer keys. The crawlers may need to help with Charisma-based Skills, or else Yakov will still attack.

CLUES

- Saying they're with Steph causes Yakov to hesitate, giving the crawlers a surprise Action.
- Stay out of biting range if you can! Otherwise you can get manhandled pretty severely.
- There's a clear pattern to the landmines. Spend an Action to figure it out, and you'll be rewarded.

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AI Yakov. Yeti Coach and All-Around Asshole.

Level 30 Neighborhood Boss!

The abominable snowman is a football coach? Yeah, why not. He's got the build for it.

Yakov is a mean, snarling, yellow-toothed Yeti who also happens to be a well-regarded football coach. He's fifteen-feet tall, wears the official Hate High team's coach jersey, and can rend metal with his claws while chewing diamonds with his teeth!

No one beats da coach!

Yakov

Neighborhood Boss; Huge (6), Sasquatch

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	15%	23%	30%	38%	46%	53%	61%	69%	76%	84%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
30	13+F	15+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
51 (+6)	7 (+3)	21 (+5)	20 (+5)	6 (+3)

Bite: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Chewed Up: 16+F to hit, 3d6+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Sepsis Debuff. This attack may only be made against Held crawlers.

Landmine Frisbee: 16+F to hit, 4d8 Force, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius

Whistle Stop: 13+F to hit, 4d6+3 Sonic, 30ft Burst radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Muted Debuff. Can be used once per day.

Notes: *Listen to Coach*—Yakov can spend an Action to coordinate attacks of the Sporto Teen Wolves, granting any within 30ft Advantage on their next attack.

Take the Lead—A crawler can spend an Action to make an Int Stat Check to determine the pattern of the landmines. On Success, Yakov is led into one and takes 4d8 Fire damage. This can be done only once per round.

We're Cool—A crawler can make an Int-Opposed Deception Check at the beginning of combat to convince Yakov they are with Steph. On Success, all crawlers gain Advantage on their first attack.

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QUEST: MOST FOWL MURDER

FLOOR: 3 — THEME: MURDER MYSTERY FOR THE BIRDS

There's one simple truth in this universe: It doesn't matter whether you're from the center system, or a backwater mud ball like Earth—everyone loves a good mystery.

The Showrunners from *Procedural Productions* want to bring an unmistakable Earth detective genre to the wider galaxy, and they're using it as an opportunity to springboard a whole catalog of crime-stopper programs in homage to (read: a direct rip-off of) classic Earth detective programs.

This Quest begins as many stories do, with a senseless murder in the street. Crawlers are drawn into a twisted nest of intrigue as they navigate proud Skyfowl, ruthless City Elves, over-ambitious detectives, and woefully underemployed assassins. At the end of it all, they come face to face with the architect of their misery, the Fowl Player. Depending on their actions, they may even get tangled up with the Elite Crowlumbo, who *Procedural Productions* wants to become a new star.

Disguised as various loyal City Elves (including Chuckles and Dorian), the shapeshifting Fowl Player hunts down Skyfowl that don't match his idea of what Skyfowl ought to be. If the crawlers can't uncover the murderer in time, well, let's just say this monster isn't against the idea of diversifying his victim profile.

STRONG STARTS

- Loud wailing cries drift through the ruins. A group of black-clad Skyfowl stands around the body of one of their own. Beyond them, half a dozen City Elves kneel, sobbing inconsolably. The Skyfowl ask if they have seen anything, and the Elves almost immediately declare the crawlers guilty of angelicide. From then on, the City Elves make life harder for the crawlers at every turn until a killer—guilty or otherwise—is brought to justice.
- As the crawlers explore the ruins of the Over City, they hear a loud scream. Whether they run toward it or away from it, they end up standing over a Skyfowl in the throes of death. He reaches up desperately, begging for help, but ends up just smearing his blood upon a crawler—right before a group of City Elves arrives to see them covered in the blood of a murdered "angel."

QUEST DESCRIPTION

AI **New Quest. Most Fowl Murder.**

The Over City is a rough place. This grim and desolate wasteland chews up the unworthy. High above, the proud Skyfowl sneer down at the flightless Races. They think themselves above it all, yet at times even they must descend to the muck and dirt below. Occasionally, a member of one of those lesser Races makes sure the Skyfowl never flies again. Unfortunately, you're the prime suspect, and that makes you the prime target for retribution.

Find out who really killed this bird and clear your name, or you're going to find out what kind of death penalty the Skyfowl prefer. (Hint: It hurts. A lot. Wow, what a surprise!)

Reward: You will receive a Platinum Quest Box.

ALTERATIONS

If your players aren't much for intrigue or mystery, you could always have them witness the murder firsthand and find some evidence that directs them to the Fowl Player's hideout. It makes the Quest for a justified confrontation progress quicker (though the reward is likely smaller).

Though written with Skyfowl in mind, any Race with an inherent sense of pride (and minions) would work. If your group already ventured beyond the Third Floor, change this Quest to whatever Race makes sense.

MOBS

The Mobs attached to this Quest are intelligent Races with agendas, cynical worldviews, and tend to view the world in very black and white terms: the Skyfowl and everyone else.

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BROADSIDE BOOTLEGGERS

The most outwardly friendly Skyfowl you're likely to meet are the Broadside Bootleggers. Most of their feathers are white, but their wings are completely black, as are their tail feathers. The dark accents around their eyes make them look like they taught beauty influencers how to do winged eyeliner.

While outwardly polite and almost friendly, they still consider themselves better than any flightless species, but Broadside Bootleggers consider lying to be a matter of politeness and policy to any non-Skyfowl. It's good to keep that two-faced practice up by playing nice with the trash that walks on the ground.

Show-offs at heart, they're fond of flaunting their ability to fly in front of any land-walker's face by performing showy acrobatics like long swooping dives toward their foes. If they have to get down and dirty with their booted feet, then they're sure to make it hurt.

AI **Broadside Bootleggers. Skyfowl. Level 19**

Have you ever seen those beer boots college students love drinking out of until they puke and pass out? Well... get ready to see them up close and personal as they kick your ass.

Wearing the latest in Skyfowl fashion, these Broadside Bootleggers keep their talons covered with that drink ware. One of their favorite pastimes is seeing how many kicks it takes to break the glass and send shards into your fleshy bits.

They're better than you, and they know it. These acrobatic fliers enjoy showing off dizzying loops and aerial spirals before slamming a boot into your face. Don't get too caught up in the grand display, since these guys enjoy dinner and a show, and you're on the menu.

Broadside Bootleggers

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
19	14+F	15+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	12 (+4)	13 (+4)	21 (+5)	6 (+3)

Cutlass: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler drops one thing they were holding.

Talons: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Broadside Bootleggers can move through the air as though on the ground.

ELVEN ENFORCER

By and large, most City Elves opted to serve their goddess by joining the 201st Security Group. Those who excelled in that duty were sometimes selected for a higher calling.

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Occasionally, a Skyfowl may choose a select division of City Elves to serve as personal bodyguards, errand-runners, and fixers. Those chosen for these roles are fanatically loyal, making them immune to fear, charm, and mind-affecting abilities.

They often choose to dress themselves in finery that mimics the feather colors of their Skyfowl patrons (often in different shades of pinstripes). They keep the appearance of civility and affect an "educated" manner of speech. Most often, they fight with knives and handguns, though a few of the higher ranked use something that looks more like a toddler tried to make a shotgun.

Elven Enforcer. Level 15

These City Elves moved up in the world—literally! They've been chosen by individual "angels" (known to lesser Races as Skyfowl) to serve as their personal valets, bodyguards, and handymen. As glorified perch-scrubbers, they have the distinct "honor" of living among their patrons. They're so loyal they're willing to die if their patron asks it of them (and their patrons almost always ask).

On their own, they're halfwits. Together? They're ruthlessly efficient halfwits convinced there's an afterlife reward for a life lived in service to birds that don't give a cluck about them.

Elven Enforcer

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	13+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
13 (+4)	7 (+3)	13 (+4)	11 (+4)	6 (+3)

Knife: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Desert Eagle: 14+F to hit, 3d6 Piercing, 50ft range
Any hit crawler is pushed 10ft.

Notes: *Fanatical*—Elven Enforcers are immune to fear, charm, and mind-affecting abilities.

HANGMAN'S HAWKS

The dourest of birds, these Skyfowl are gray-colored, with the underside of their bellies and wings ever-so-slightly lighter. They're chronically serious and don't seem to have time for anyone's nonsense. They are among the more far-ranging and studious of Skyfowl. They're almost the most secretive.

One good thing about them is that it can be difficult to get a rise out of them, as they maintain an almost-distressingly even temperament. When they fight, they make a science of efficiently destroying their foes by utilizing powerful magics and a chokingly effective way of putting enemies in their place.

Hangman's Hawks. Level 20

Don't haggle with a Hawk from Hangman. The other Skyfowl believe themselves superior because of who they are and who their ancestors were. They think that because they once ruled the Over City, it's only right to lord over everyone else.

Hawks are one of the most effective at murdering their foes. In the time it's taken you to read this, they've probably come up with a dozen ways to kill you.

These Hangman Hawks are powerful magic users, though, of course, their most powerful weapon is their long tongues, with a noose at the end, just for catching prey. Stretching from their beak up to twenty feet away, once that slimy, pink loop is around your throat, it's all over for you.

Nice, you got tongued before you died!

Hangman's Hawks

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	15+F	14+F	20+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
8 (+3)	23 (+5)	12 (+4)	14 (+4)	8 (+3)

Acid Blast Spell: 15+F to hit, 2d8+5 Acid, 15ft Cone + 5ft Splash
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Explosive Charge: 14+F to hit, 2d6 Fire, 20ft range, 15ft Blast radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Queasy Debuff.

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Notes: *Even Keeled*—Intelligence and Charisma-based Skills used against Hangman's Hawks are rolled with Disadvantage.

Flight—Hangman's Hawks can move through the air as though on the ground.

PEREGRIN PERCH PROWLERS

The Skyfowl of Peregrin Perch are faster and smaller than many of their brethren. If you need something done by a quick asshole, these are your birds.

They rank among the most openly elitist of the Skyfowl in the area, and they will happily explain why their way of doing things is the only right way. One of their favorite hobbies is dive-bombing flightless Races, lifting them into the air, and dropping them. They call this practice giving flightless creatures a "ticket for one."

AI — Peregrin Perch Prowlers. Level 21

Atop Peregrin's Perch, these speedy birds are the highest-fliers, the fastest-talkers, and the most holier-than-thou of all Skyfowl. They're so far above it all, they can't smell the stink of their own droppings, but you sure can, and it smells oddly... explosive?

Once one of these guys loses his short temper, fuses ignite along his tail feathers, ready to drop some steaming exploding little shits just for you!

Peregrin Perch Prowlers

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
21	14+F	15+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	11 (+4)	8 (+3)	22 (+5)	6 (+3)

Crossbow: 15+F to hit, 3d6 Piercing, 50ft range

Spear: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Piercing, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Grab: 15+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *Catch and Release*—Held crawlers are flown up 30 feet and dropped the next round. To escape, they must make a Str-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check, or a Str Stat Check with the same Difficulty.

Flight—Peregrin Perch Prowlers can move through the air as though on the ground.

Riled Up—During the first round of combat, add their Stat Mod to the damage a second time.

SKYFOWL CROWCORPS

The Skyfowl are a proud and noble people and therefore won't be policed by anyone not high born. Enter the Skyfowl Crowcorps. These black-clad birds keep the peace among their flying brethren. They serve as mediators, mobile security, and, when necessary, mortician investigators, reminding the ground dwellers that the Skyfowl are birds of prey.

They're clever, quick, and incredibly observant. They're also incredibly effective with wind-based magic and have a habit of concealing knives among their arm feathers. It's rumored that some of their number are skilled necromancers.

AI — Skyfowl Crowcorps. Level 20

The shadow of a crow is said to be as cold and ominous as the grave they'll chase you into, and these guys take that literally. Anyone caught in the shadow of a Crowcorps is petrified with fear.

Their pinion feathers (that's a fancy term for feathers used for flying, you dumbass) aren't just for catching air; they're sharp enough to slice through a single strand of hair—oh, and straight through your throat.

Isn't learning new things so much fun?

Skyfowl Crowcorps

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	15+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
12 (+4)	23 (+5)	11 (+4)	12 (+4)	7 (+3)

Dagger Feathers: 14+F to hit, 3d4+4 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Gusty Winds Spell: 15+F to hit, 2d6+4 Bludgeoning, 30ft Cone + 10ft Splash
Any crawler who loses 2+ HB slots gains the Take Down Debuff.

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Notes: *Flight*—Skyfowl Crowcorps can move through the air as though on the ground.

Observant—Skyfowl Crowcorps gain Advantage on Investigation and Perception Checks.

NPCS

A few NPCs the crawlers may encounter in this Quest are found below:

CAPTAIN RAPTOR

This dashing and debonair Skyfowl walks with a swagger in his step and always seems to be on the verge of telling you an incredibly inappropriate and yet irritatingly funny private joke. He's got the grace of one who can handle himself, and he makes even the most difficult tasks seem easy.

He steals a nip from the flask on his hip every so often, and although he often offers it to his guests, he always seems to remember something that inspires him to put the flask away before they can partake. His "first mate," a City Elf named Valeer, often tries to coax him to stop drinking, but if anything, this only seems to encourage the Captain to drink more.

AI **Captain Raptor. Skyfowl Officer. Level 20.**

The leader of the Broadside Settlement, Captain Raptor always has a ready smile and a kind word for guests—even, and especially, when those kind words are nothing but birdshit. This is a creature whose every word drips with carefully chosen birdshit. His people consider lying to be an art form and a kindness, and though they'd never say it, they view the flightless Races as target practice.

Captain Raptor

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	14+F	14+F	25+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
32 (+5)	11 (+4)	10 (+4)	13 (+4)	23 (+5)

Cutlass: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler immediately gains the Major Injury Debuff.

Fast Talking: 16+F to hit, No damage, 20ft Burst Radius
Any hit crawler must make an Int-Opposed Detect Lies Skill check or Int Stat Check at the same Difficulty. On Fail, the crawler is enamored with Captain Raptor's birdshit words and can do nothing but listen until the start of Captain Raptor's next turn.

Flask Fling: 15+F to hit, 4d10+6 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Shit-Faced Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Captain Raptor can move through the air as though on the ground.

Lovable Liar—Captain Raptor gains Advantage on Deception Checks.

HEADHUNTER HARRIET

This Skyfowl woman doesn't smile so much as she sneers. From the feathers on her head neatly arranged in an up-do to the perfectly tailored black-and-white suit she wears, she is Skyfowl grandeur and beauty personified.

Yet every word from her mouth is a lavish approbation, a veiled threat, or just a plain-old open threat. She has no time for anyone's foolishness but her own, so she leads the settlement of Peregrin's Perch with an iron talon. She has the power to make or break any Skyfowl or crawler with a simple call to a few of her fixers—in particular, her personal fixer, Chuckles the City Elf.

AI **Headhunter Harriet. Skyfowl Luminary. Level 20.**

This Skyfowl woman is sharp. Everything around her screams sharpness, from the look in her eyes to the quick, crisp way she speaks. She makes it clear with every word from her beak that she's the one you need to impress—or the one you need to run from. Which path you should follow depends completely on you, or more accurately, it really depends on if you have something she wants.

Hangman's Hawks

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	15+F	15+F	20+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
11 (+4)	23 (+5)	11 (+4)	32 (+5)	12 (+4)

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Evil Eye: 16+F to hit, 4d10+6 Psionic damage, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Muted Debuff.

Instill Fear: 16+F to hit, No damage, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

Iron Talon: 15+F to hit, 5d10+5 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Veiled Threat: 16+F to hit, No damage, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Headhunter Harriet can move through the air as though on the ground.

Summon Fixer—Headhunter Harriet can spend an action to summon 1d4 Elven Enforcers who will magically appear in 1d4 rounds.

MAYOR MORDHAU

A slender, erudite Skyfowl, Mayor Mordhau of Hangman is the very picture of a scholar. He wears a pair of spectacles tightly strapped around his feathery head, a spare pair hangs around his neck, and yet a third set is tucked into a case in his front pocket. He always carries a notebook and a pen and is often found scribbling quick notes or reading dusty old tomes.

He is usually found in the field when a new discovery is made. Without his personal City Elf valet, Dorian, he'd likely forget to eat. Most Skyfowl wouldn't grant a City Elf that degree of involvement in their day-to-day lives, but Mayor Mordhau believes in efficiency and meritocracy. Dorian does the job fantastically, and until that changes, Mayor Mordhau is all too happy to let him continue.

AI **Mayor Mordhau. Skyfowl Official. Level 18.**

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Mayor Mordhau somehow manages to have his head in the clouds even when his feet are firmly planted on the ground. He's always thinking about Scolopendra's attack and claims he's close to finding a way to reverse it. In reality, he just seems to like digging in the dirt.

Most of his people know that without his City Elf valet Dorian, the settlement of Hangman may well have fallen to dust years ago. Most agree Mayor Mordhau wouldn't notice until he couldn't find some tome or another. Others claim it might actually improve his interest in governance.

ELITES

Crowlumbo is pilot show this season, but if he can get some tractions the producers may bring him and his show back for many seasons to come.

CROWLUMBO

Most everyone knows that Skyfowl are proud to the point of arrogance. They're self-righteous, vainglorious, and often only make time for you if you're helping them, especially if you're one of the wingless ones. This goes doubly so for the Crowcorps.

Yet this particular Skyfowl is none of those things. He's incredibly friendly and often looks as if he's just woken up. He makes it a point to treat everyone he meets with respect and kindness. Some suspect this is simply to lull targets into a false sense of security. The reality is, he's just very friendly and likes people.

He's also an incredibly perceptive investigator, and it's difficult to tell if he's actually a mind reader or just really good with people. While he dresses like he rolled out of a gutter, he does frequently pull just the right item out of his coat pockets at the perfect moment.

AI **Crowlumbo. Unassuming Skyfowl Diviner. Level 50.**

This is a non-combatant Elite.

The Over City is no place for kindness. The ruins' only use for kindness is to mark someone as fodder for the more ambitious and greedy denizens of the Third Floor. Yet the eyes of this Skyfowl shine with kindness, a direct contrast to the rest of his disheveled, dour look. He's friendly, polite, and always seems as if he's lost something in his many pockets. It's honestly hard to imagine how this Skyfowl of all people managed to become a Lieutenant in the Crowcorps.

QUEST ITEMS

Items for this Quest are typically found as drops from Mobs. Most of the time, they're pieces of things the Mobs and NPCs wouldn't realize are clues or evidence.

- **A diary from an Elven Enforcer:** This details the rise of the Elf from the 201st Security Group and reveals the plotting of the Fowl Player, referred to as "the Crow in Black," who will restore the so-called angels to their rightful purpose.

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- **A Bloodstained Silver Tree-Shaped Key:** This leads to the buried temple of Apito where the Fowl Player makes his lair.
- **Archaeological Ledger:** A journal from Hangman containing notes about the discovery of a buried temple between Hangman and Peregrin's Perch.
- **Bloodstained Wine-Bottle:** A bottle of wine from the Broadside Brewery that is coated in enough gore it coats the hands of anyone who picks it up.

TRAPS

The Mobs of this Quest are all thinking, planning, and strategic enemies. Most of them don't rely on traps as a first resort. The Skyfowl prefer to deal with things in a more straightforward manner. However, a few traps the crawlers may encounter on their journey include:

- **Firebombs:** Elven Enforcers are incredibly resourceful in their use of found items and hastily assembled traps. The most common of these is a simple string that, when snapped, drops a Molotov cocktail from above. They're especially fond of it because only flightless Races are likely to trip them, and any angel that may mistakenly trigger the fiery surprise can fly from harm.
- **Pit Traps:** Another specialty of the Elven Enforcers is deep, wide holes dug in the ground, which they cover with illusion magic or camouflaged nets. Occasionally, victims unfortunate enough to tumble into them may find themselves falling onto spikes, but in most cases, these are simply meant as holding pens until the Elven Enforcers can come to collect their victims for interrogation on behalf of their "angels."
- **The Free Ride:** The Peregrin's Perch Prowlers are one of the only groups of Skyfowl to make a habit of setting traps. Though in their case, they would call it an ambush. They set up a tripwire attached to a bell or another loud, obnoxious device. When unwary crawlers trip the sound, they take advantage of the distraction to swoop in, lift their victims high into the air, then drop them onto sharp rocks or other natural hazards.

LIKELY ACHIEVEMENTS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements on this Quest.

- **Forget it, Crawler; It's Skyfowl Town:** "You started a fight with Skyfowl over nothing more than words. Apparently, life means less to you than your pride. *Reward:* You don't get rewards any more than you get second chances in a place like this."
- **What's the Difference?:** "You successfully deduced the identity of the murderer. It doesn't bring anyone back, and it doesn't undo the horrible things you've seen, but hey, at least you get some cool shit as a prize. *Reward:* You receive a Gold Quest Box."
- **Murder, They Croaked:** "You killed the defenders of Skyfowl peace, and you did it with no sense of shame or remorse whatsoever. I'm so. Damn. Proud of you! The dungeon is no place for high-minded ideals like 'justice' or 'fairness,' and you're living proof. Those Mobs you killed? They're dead proof. *Reward:* You receive a Silver Asshole's Box."
- **The Rest Is Silence:** "You eliminated twenty Elven Enforcers. The Fowl Player experienced a significant setback. Was it worth it? To wipe out an entire group of people as an inconvenience? Was it worth it? Huh? *Reward:* You've received a Silver Asshole's Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers who defeat several Mobs on this Quest may decide it's a good time to grind. Table 82 includes a few reasons that may be a bad idea.

STAGE 1: THE BODY

The crawlers find themselves in front of the body of a mutilated, bloody, and very dead Skyfowl, and with his blood upon them. City Elves stare them down and demand their death, possibly with the Crowcorps members interrogating them as well. The crawlers are blamed for the murder of Sagacious Steven (the deceased Skyfowl).

If the alternative introduction was used (wherein the crawlers find the Skyfowl just before he dies), or if the crawlers try to use force against the Crowcorps, the City Elves attack, enraged that the crawlers would dare harm one of Apito's angels. If the Crowcorps

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TABLE 82: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A group of Skyfowl attacks the players, and after a few rounds of combat, Crowlumbo appears, causing the Skyfowl to scatter, calling out how the crawlers attacked them. Crowlumbo clearly doesn't believe them but notes how quickly or slowly the crawlers tried to kill the Skyfowl before leaving.
2	Mayor Mordhau is in the middle of a dig excursion. He waves the crawlers over, pointing out an (obviously recent) brutalized corpse of a Skyfowl. He begins making notes and idly hopes the Crowcorps won't find out about this, as they would surely interfere with his dig.
3	Broadside Bootleggers drop from the sky, surrounding the crawlers. They'll mention how a group of Elven Enforcers told them the party liked to butcher Skyfowl. They try to goad the crawlers into a fight so they can either kill the crawlers or escape to claim they've located the murderers.
4	Three Crowcorps are talking among themselves. They don't believe Crowlumbo has what it takes to find the killer. They suggest hunting down the crawlers and killing them before they strike again.
5	The crawlers fall into a pit trap dug by Elven Enforcers. Unless they can escape it quickly, a group of twice as many Elves as players arrives to escort them to Headhunter Harrier for an efficient interrogation, a speedy conviction, and a prompt execution.
6	The crawlers find themselves under attack from above, as a group of Peregrin's Perch Prowlers begins dropping corpse parts upon them. This is meant as a "prank," but if the crawlers engage, they'll take the opportunity to try to lift and drop at least one crawler to their death.

are present, they'll fly straight up and out of range of arrows or Spells, possibly turning incorporeal as the Elven Enforcers attack. There are as many Elves as there are crawlers, and good roleplaying or a Good First Impression roll could stop violence.

If the crawlers manage to avoid violence or otherwise survive the fight with the Elves, the Crowcorps interrogate them as to their knowledge of Sagacious Steve, a well-liked scholar. (If the alternative introduction was used, this is when they appear.) They are clipped and brusque, and they make it clear they believe the crawlers are beneath them (unless there is a crawler with a Skyfowl Race present), but they are not outright hostile.

They end their interrogation by advising the crawlers not to hide or leave the Over City before the investigation is complete. After the Crowcorps depart, the crawlers find the bloodstained wine bottle on the ground near the body.

If the crawlers managed to avoid a fight entirely, after the Crowcorps depart, Crowlumbo arrives, and he very politely asks if the crawlers can believe the nerve of those guys. He'll joke, try to make friends with the crawlers, and even apologize for the behavior of "the other guys." He stresses that they're overworked, what with all the Skyfowl turning up dead lately.

He slowly pumps the players for information but is also willing to give up a few things, just so they know what they're being accused of (including volunteering that the Skyfowl are starting to view any flightless Race in possession of weapons as a clear and present threat). He'll depart with a cheerful wave, though observant crawlers recognize him watching which way they're going.

STAGE 2: BROADSIDE

The crawlers end up in the Skyfowl settlement of Broadside. After they climb the ladder into this tree house-like village, they find themselves welcomed with open wings. Villagers offer food and wine. At first, it seems as if they are honored guests. In reality, they're being subtly mocked the entire time. Every Broadside Bootlegger's attitude ranges from gentle pity to outright passive-aggressive condescension.

If the party attacked the Elves earlier, or if an Elven Enforcer was killed, crawlers find any food they've eaten laced with drugs that make the crawlers think they can actually fly. When these begin to take effect, the Broadside Bootleggers kindly offer to help them to the air, and encourage the drugged crawlers to leap off the side and fall fifty feet to the ground below.

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QUEST EVENTS

Use these short experiences the crawlers might encounter to evoke the mood of this Quest:

- Crawlers approaching a city leader for the first time see Crowlumbo chatting with them, clearly getting beneath their skin as he digs for any information they might know.
- A figure slides down from one of the governmental buildings in the middle of the night, running toward the nearest tree line, before transforming into something with wings and flying into the night.
- After speaking with Captain Raptor, the crawlers notice Valeer, his first mate, casually refilling the same flask he was actively trying to get the Captain to stop drinking from.
- While in Peregrin's Perch, the players spot Dorian and Chuckles speaking in hushed tones before dispersing quickly, clearly trying to avoid being spotted.

Assuming the crawlers did not attack the Elves, or if they survive the battle, they are escorted to Captain Raptor's quarters after they've eaten. The Captain informs them that Sagacious Steve originally came from the nearby settlement of Peregrin's Perch. He was trying to get the Captain's help to depose a recent usurper named Headhunter Harriet. However, Captain Raptor has no interest beyond the dealings of his own settlement, so he directs them toward Peregrin's Perch, as his "first mate" Valeer reluctantly refills his flask.

Crawlers that succeed on an Detect Lies or similar Check note that Valeer seems reluctant to refill the Captain's drink yet actually does it heartily enough. They'll also note he attempts to slip out just before they do. If they try to follow him, they realize he's trying to head into the forest. A Perception Check reveals his footsteps stop at about the same time a set of lizard-like footprints begins.

STAGE 3: PEREGRIN'S PERCH

This settlement is located in a vast open space and appears to be built around one giant outcropping of rock. A single rope ladder leads up to the settlement proper, where flightless Races make their homes at the midpoint of the mountain.

Further up, the Skyfowl homes sit perched near the top, approachable only by another rope ladder that may be raised or lowered at a moment's notice. This is a settlement of fast-talkers. The Skyfowl that live here have the same vibe as sleazy car salesmen with only some of the charm. They seem to be expecting the crawlers.

If the party spots Valeer and gives chase, or if they're rude to any member of the settlement (without a Persuasion Check to de-escalate the situation), the Peregrin's Perch Prowlers attack, supported by Elven Enforcers. They attempt to simply lift the crawlers and throw them down the side of the mountain.

If the crawlers survive the encounter with the Skyfowl, or if they managed to avoid it altogether, a single Elf named Chuckles politely informs them that Headhunter Harriet wants a word. The leader of this settlement sits in her office, resplendent in her chair. She speaks very candidly about usurping the former ruler of Peregrin's Perch in a duel to the death where she impaled him on a sharp rock and ate his innards, as is only natural.

She informs the crawlers that Sagacious Steve didn't approve of her methods, but that did not make them less than legal. She asks the crawlers to leave and offers no information, other than noting that she previously spoke to a member of the Crowcorps about this matter and that Sagacious Steve spoke not only to Broadside but also to Hangman.

Players paying special attention may note how closely Chuckles is listening, or how he gives a decidedly malicious grin when Hangman is mentioned. If the party pushes Chuckles in the moment, Headhunter Harriet demands that they leave her office and may attack outright if they refuse. If they wait and attempt to confront him later, they find that he vanished in much the same way Valeer did before him.

STAGE 4: HANGMAN

Hangman is unusual for a Skyfowl settlement. It's deep in the ruins, away from the other two settlements. It also appears more mobile than the others, made up of tents surrounding a few new wooden buildings constructed like over-large birdhouses.

The Skyfowl here all speak in quick, terse terms. However, they aren't overly rude. Surprisingly, they're the first to treat the crawlers fairly. Crowlumbo greets them with a friendly wave as they enter the town.

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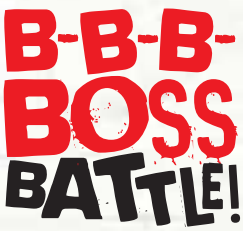
Five Crowcorps descend upon the gathering and inform the party that they are under arrest for the deaths of Sagacious Steve, Headhunter Harriet, and Captain Raptor. They make it clear they're itching for a fight. Unless the players spotted both Valeer and Chuckles disappearing before their eyes, the Crowcorps won't listen to them and attack the players.

Surprisingly, Crowlumbo sides with the crawlers, begging them not to hurt the Crowcorps. He assists in subduing the other Skyfowl. But if the players kill one of them, he leaves in disgust, muttering that they deserve what they get, even as several Hangman's Hawks join the fray.

If they successfully avoid or win the battle, the party finds Mayor Mordhau waiting for them. He mutters how he would've been there to greet them, but he couldn't find his valet Dorian anywhere. If the players are polite and respectful, he apologizes for the Crowcorps' actions and offers his help. He feels they behaved too boldly of late and were interfering with his studies of the ruins.

Ultimately, he gives the party a copy of his Archaeological Ledger, which details the discovery of a buried temple to Apito nearby. The ledger notes that Sagacious Steve was a member of his dig team and that he began acting paranoid and speaking of a shapeshifter afterward.

If the players managed to avoid making Crowlumbo distrust them (if they avoided killing any Skyfowl in front of him and weren't outright rude), he approaches them after this interaction and offers to accompany them to the dig site. The players are free to say yes or no as they choose. He makes the Boss Battle easier, but there are ways of defeating the Boss without his assistance.



Within, they find torches already lit, as if in preparation for their arrival. The bodies of Captain Raptor and Headhunter Harriet hang upside down at the far end, blood pooling from their ripped open chest cavities and spreading toward the temple as if in sacrifice to the blackened altar of the nature goddess.

As the crawlers approach, Valeer appears in a highly ornate robe. He then becomes Chuckles, before shifting once more into the form of Dorian, the valet, before transforming into an ancient, incredibly tall and distorted Skyfowl.

Everything pauses as the AI's voice calls out, "B-B-B-Boss Battle!" and tosses up portraits of the crawlers against a constantly shifting scene. Below it are the words "Fowl Player—The Ancient Apostle of Apito!" The words all but explode as the Fowl Player attacks, and City Elves rappel into the room from above to join the fray.

The Boss starts by attacking the crawlers in his massive Skyfowl form, howling that the Oak Fell is not welcome in this holy place. As he pounces about, the roof shakes every time, and Perception Checks reveal the ceiling is ready to collapse in certain spots.

If he slams into the wall during a pounce near them, the roof falls upon him, trapping him for a round. When he is at half-health, he starts shifting into City Elf forms, attempting to hide among his minions.

CLUES

- Certain areas of the ceiling need just a nudge to collapse.
- Should one of the above sections fall on the Boss while in Skyfowl form, he becomes trapped for 1 round.
- While shifting into other forms, the Boss is easier to hit.

AI Fowl Player. Ancient Apostle of Apito.

Level 65 Borough Boss!

This is it. The Big One. An ancient evil that awakened to find his people gone astray.

He decided the only way to get them back on track was to remind them of who they were. Three settlements, three ways they got it wrong. Ultimately, he chose the one that had the best chance to fix the Skyfowl as a people. Now there's only one thing in his path, and that's you, crawler. You think you got the stones to defeat Apito's First Angel?

Fowl Player

Borough Boss; Large (5), Humanoid

7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
5%	11%	16%	22%	27%	33%	38%	44%	50%
7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
55%	61%	66%	72%	77%	83%	88%	94%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
65	16+F	16+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
52 (+6)	53 (+6)	102 (+7)	54 (+6)	24 (+5)

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Berserk Howl: 16+F to hit, 6d10+6 Sonic, 40ft Burst radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Fowl Hug: 16+F to hit, 6d12+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any crawler hit gains the Held Debuff.

Pounce: 16+F to hit, 6d10+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Staggered and Take Down Debuffs.

Talon Strike: 16+F to hit, 7d12+6 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *The Ceiling*—A ranged attack that can reach 50 feet and deal 12+ damage causes a portion of the ceiling to collapse, dealing 4d10 damage to each combatant below the targeted section. If the Boss is flying at the time, it takes x2 damage. (Secret: This works twice.)

Fanatic—Fowl Player is immune to fear, charm, and mind-affecting abilities.

Flight—Fowl Player can move through the air as though on the ground when in a Skyfowl form.

No Fowl Fool—When reduced to half Health Bars or less, Fowl Player shifts to Elf form and attempts to hide among his minions, where crawlers have Disadvantage to hit him.

Shift Stick—Fowl Player can shift into various Elf and Skyfowl forms as an action. Crawlers have Advantage to hit Fowl Player during a round in which Fowl Player is shifting.

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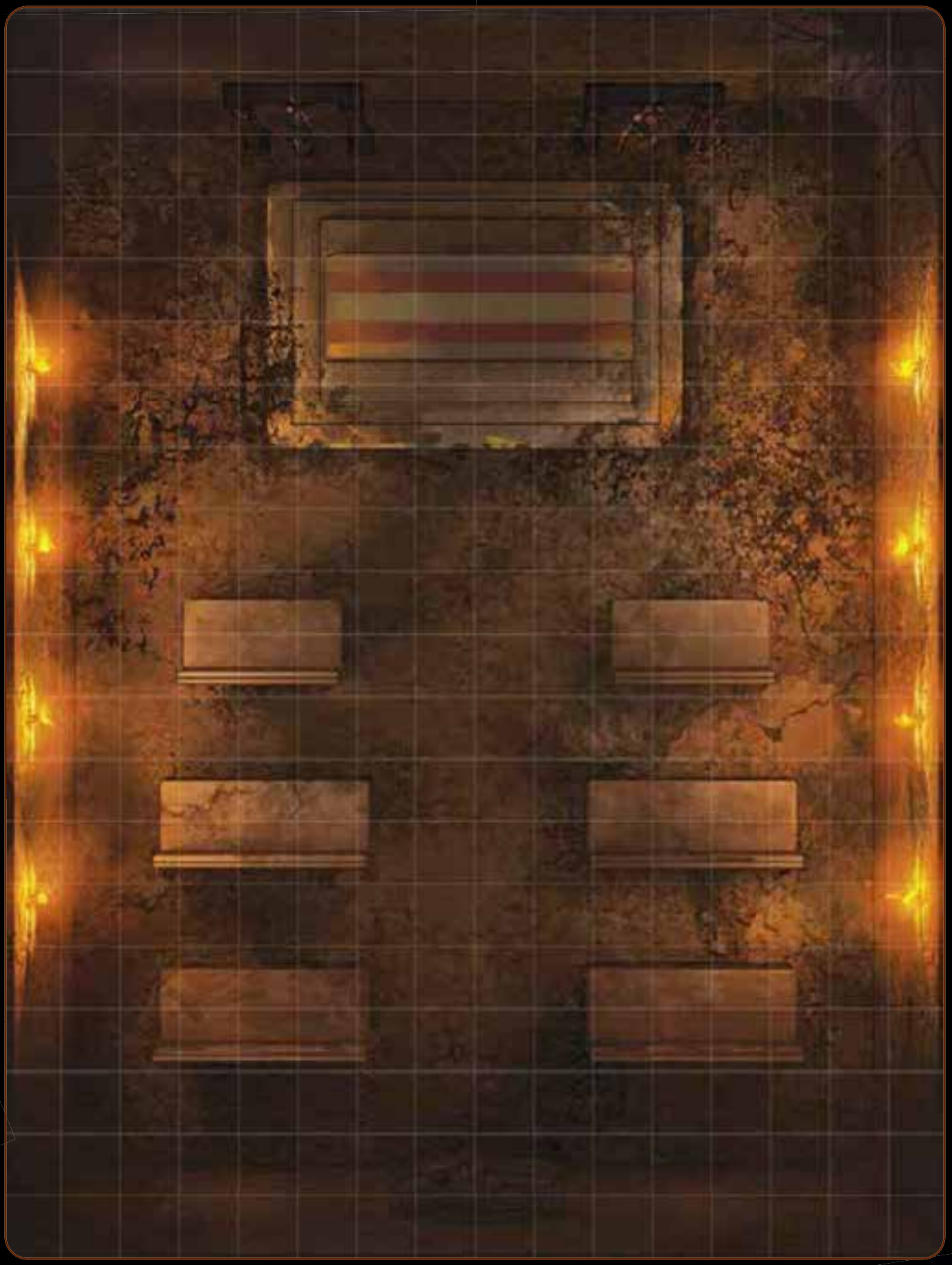

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QUEST: A SHELF ON AN ELF

FLOOR: 3 — THEME: WE'VE LOST OUR MARBLES

The desperate cries of an Elf trapped under a shelf lead the crawlers into a rescue situation. The Elf, named Keeble, wants his lost "marbles." These become the Quest items they need to proceed. What he doesn't mention is that the marbles were stolen by revolutionaries trying to end his tyrannical rule. Inside the warehouse lives Helga Elfcrusher, a Giantess mechanic with a temper, an oven, and a very flexible definition of "inside voices."

Keeble's "marbles" are d20-shaped crystal, they are not toys; they're Soul Crystals that grant Keeble terrifying power while steadily unraveling his sanity and pushing his thoughts toward cruelty. Their absence softened him. Their return will not.

The crawlers must venture through flooded Sewer-Lakes, shattered Ruined Districts, and unstable remains left behind by Scolopendra's nine-tier Attack. Along the way, they battle drifting Manta Constructs that mutate with the cycle of an artificial sun, hostile living ruins, and the Unfound Ones: the 404th Legion of City Elf revolutionaries waging war on anything feathered or loyal to Keeble.

Should the crawlers succeed in returning all his marbles, Keeble's gratitude evaporates. Prior to this, he is a jovial, game-loving super-nerd who eagerly geeks out with crawlers about their past tabletop gaming experiences. He's been cosplaying as an Elf and his Skill is high enough to change his description. Fully restored, however, his cruelty resurfaces, and he turns his newly reclaimed power on the party in a final brutal confrontation, proving that sometimes the worst outcome arrives from completing the Quest exactly as asked.

"Arrived with all my marbles. Left with XP, trauma, and a strongly worded warning about misplaced sanity."

—Garrik, Floor 5 Survivor (Allegedly)

STRONG STARTS

- Panicked cries echo from a massive warehouse building. Upon inspection, the crawlers spot Keeble, an Elf in cosplay-quality armor, pinned beneath a fallen shelf, while snarling Scolopendrini close in. Every sound risks drawing the attention of Helga Elfcrusher, whose footsteps rattle the walls. Freeing the Elf quickly and escaping the house ensures Keeble begs the crawlers to help recover his stolen "marbles" scattered through the Sewer-Lakes and Ruined Districts below.
- The crawlers stumble into the Unfound Ones (the 404th Legion) in the flooded Collapsed Avenues. The revolutionaries transport glowing "marbles" (actually Soul Crystals) and shout warnings about a tyrant named Keeble. Keeble, trapped under a shelf and trying to hide from the Elves, begs the players for help, promising riches beyond belief for their help.

QUEST DESCRIPTION

When the crawlers rescue Keeble, they receive this Quest. The AI announces it with the following text in a dramatic fashion:

> **AI** **New Quest: A Shelf on an Elf.**
>
> Good job, crawlers. You rescued the Elf, avoided becoming baked goods for Helga Elfcrusher, and earned a thank-you. Your reward? More work!
>
> Keeble has misplaced his "marbles" and insists he can't properly function without them. He wants you to recover the missing gems from the Sewer-Lakes, the Ruined Districts, and anywhere else a glowing sphere might roll during civil unrest.
>
> Expect hostile creatures, drifting Manta Constructs, and interference from the Unfound Ones of the 404th Legion.
>
> *Reward:* A Silver Quest Box.

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ALTERATIONS

If you don't favor Elves (and let's be honest, who does?), you're free to swap them out. Humans or any similar humanoid Race can slide into this Quest with minimal changes and no loss of flavor.

For even greater replay value, consider reshuffling the locations of the soul crystals each time you run this Quest with a new group. Replacing them with equally thematic but customized objectives keeps the experience fresh, unpredictable, and perfectly tuned to your table's preferred brand of chaos.

MOBS

Crawlers encounter the Mobs found in this Quest most commonly in the ruins of the Over City. The Mobs stray from their effective domains only rarely.

404TH REVOLUTIONARY LEGION

These blue-skinned City Elves have had enough of the holy nonsense. To them, the Skyfowl deliberately twisted the words of Apito, recasting themselves as divine messengers while chaining City Elves into servitude or cruelly executing them. Convinced the lie is deadly, the insurgents of the 404th Revolutionary Legion swore to exterminate every Skyfowl that deigns to fly over their homeland. Whether their beliefs are true is almost beside the point; they act on them with ruthless certainty.

To survive, the 404th operates in cells of no more than ten, avoiding discovery and conflict with the rest of their kin, whom they view as compliant slaves of the Skyfowl. Their secrecy earned them a nickname among other City Elves: the Unfound Ones—a title born less of poetry or mystery and more of the species' famously terrible naming instincts.

AI 404th Revolutionary (City Elf). Level 15.

If the 201st are conspiracy-riddled crackpots, then the 404th Revolutionary Legion is the other side of the same badly dented coin. Just as unhinged, but far more focused, the City Elves of the 404th are utterly committed to exterminating every Skyfowl they encounter.

They bring all their considerable (if tragically misapplied) intellect to that effort, engineering ambushes, propaganda, and outright war. It's a conflict fueled by certainty, ingenuity, and rage—one expected to yield few survivors, if any, and much less than could be considered "victory."

But given the way some of these Elves wear necklaces made entirely of wing bones, they're deadly and willing to die for the cause. That makes them both stupid and dangerous.

City Elf

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	14+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	13 (+4)	10 (+4)	10 (+4)	7 (+3)

Firestorm Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Fire, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Burned Debuff.

Force Spear Spell: 14+F to hit, 3d10+4 Force, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Lightning Rod: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Electric, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Shocked Debuff.

Notes: *Ambush*—404th Revolutionary City Elves gain Advantage on attacks when they are 10ft or more above their target.

Brotherly Rage—404th Revolutionary City Elves gain Advantage when attacking and Disadvantage when Evading City Elves from the 201st.

NIGHT RAYS

These massive, Manta ray–like creatures glide gracefully through water, basking in the feel of the liquid on their skin. With wingspans reaching nearly ten feet, they move with startling speed beneath the surface and even launch themselves into the air, soaring briefly before splashing back into the depths.

By day, their hides shimmer with a pearlescent white sheen that reflects sunlight, making them both stunning to behold and easy to spot. In this state, their tails end in a heavy club tipped with a venomous stinger, but they're usually calm unless provoked.

When darkness falls, everything changes.

Their luminous hides darken to mottled grays and blacks, blending perfectly with shadowed waters. Their tails sprout barbed launchers capable of firing envenomed spines, and their once calm demeanor turns barbaric.

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AI Night Rays. Level 13.

These docile creatures soar through the water like birds crossing a summer sky. They've even been known to encroach on a bird's territory from time to time, leaping from the water to glide on the wind for short distances. Their glimmering hide makes for a valuable commodity, if you can manage to take one down. You probably can't.

Just don't stick around too long. After sunset, these creatures stop gliding and start hunting.

Night Ray

Mob; Huge (6), Animal

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
13	12+F	14+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
13 (+4)	3 (+2)	12 (+4)	13 (+4)	3 (+2)

Barbed Spines: 14+F to hit, 3d4+4 Piercing, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned and Blood Trail Debuffs.

Sting: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

Notes: *Glimmering Hide*—Night Rays have Resistance to all Spell damage as their glimmering hide is able to partially reflect them.

Gills—Night Rays can breathe underwater.

Glide—Night Rays can soar in the air up to half their move each round.

Swim—Night Rays can move through the water as though on the ground.

SCOLOPENDRINI

Scolopendra changed the future of the entire floor when it unleashed its poisonous nine-tier attack. Some of the creatures caught in the fog were transformed into smaller (yet still enormous) less-powerful versions of the giant centipede. Though gifted with only a small fraction of the titanic creature's power, these large centipedes are extremely dangerous. They breathe poisonous gas and wield sharp pincers over their mouths.

Scolopendrini can (and do) eat almost anything, from rocks to Mobs to crawlers. They shy away from freezing cold (making CO_2 fire extinguishers extremely effective, frightening them off). Beyond such means, very little can deter them from a meal once they set their sights on their prey.

AI Scolopendrini. Level 20.

Roughly six feet in length, these not-so-small multi-legged freaks infest many parts of the urban ruins and are most active at night. Like any hormonal teenager, no one understands them and all they want to do is eat and rage. However, unlike most teens, they do share everything with their mother, whether they want to or not, since she can see through their eyes. So smile big when they crush you, 'cause the mighty Scolopendra might be watching your death.

Hey, that's my job!

Scolopendrini

Mob; Huge (6), Animal

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	12+F	14+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	5 (+2)	21 (+5)	13 (+4)	1 (+1)

Pincer: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Piercing, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Poison Breath: 14+F to hit, 2d10+4 Poison, 20ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Slice and Dice: 15+F to hit, 3d10+5 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Cold Weakness*—Scolopendrini have Disadvantage to Evade Ice attacks and take × 2 damage from them.

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NPCS

A few NPCs the crawlers may encounter include:

GAZAL FURSE

Gazal knew Keeble before the creation of the soul crystals, and he even called him a friend. But as the influence of the marbles penetrated deep into Keeble's mind and subconscious, he became unrecognizable to his old ally, who had helped Keeble rise to be governor of the area.

After power corrupted Keeble, Gazal worked against the governor for quite some time, organizing a group of City Elves to serve as protesters and insurgents, and trading with Helga for supplies and inventions in exchange for materials. He was finally forced to take direct action. He did so by doing what he does best: thievery. Gazal stole the green crystal one day in the market and promptly hid it among the busy stalls. Somewhere, he was quite certain no one would find it accidentally and helped orchestrate the loss of all the other marbles.

AI **Gazal Furse.**

High Elf Pickpocket and Revolutionary. Level 16.

This is a non-combatant NPC.

You know what makes a great thief? No one ever knowing that you robbed them. Gazal's fingers are so light, they make feathers look like hammers.

As a pickpocket, Gazal is remarkably successful. Even the guards don't seem to notice when he's nicked their wallets until he begins commenting about their contents as he flees! Don't worry. I'm sure your pockets are perfectly safe...

HELGA ELFCRUSHER

This 20-foot-tall half-machine mechanic resides in a massive warehouse in the Over City. She's retrofitted it into both her home and an incredible workshop, complete with tools that let her build, fix, and bake almost anything. She specializes in large truck engines and cupcakes. Sometimes she even keeps those two things separated!

When she's not mecha-baking, Helga dabbles in the art of cybernetics and advanced Botox. Having defeated her wrinkles and replaced her own left arm and one of her eyes with bionic modifications of her creation, she is swiftly becoming an expert in biomechanics. Helga doesn't take kindly to intruders in her home, which is full of half-started and gruesome biomechanical projects, but she won't give chase once the invading vermin have been frightened off.

AI **Helga Elfcrusher. Giant Mechanic. Level 45.**

This incredibly large woman, dressed in bright purple auto mechanic coveralls with an embroidered cupcake on the left pocket, is a blend of biology and mechanical parts, thrown together from the nearest auto, hair care, and tire center. She replaced her left arm with a ginormous multi-tool that switches from weapons to whisks at her whim, and one eye cycles multiple lenses from groovy pink to microscopic magnification.

Cyborg Mechanic

NPC; Huge (6), Cyborg

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
45	15+F	15+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
23 (+5)	25 (+5)	57 (+6)	22 (+5)	13 (+4)

Fast Disassemble: 15+F to hit, No damage, 10ft range
Any hit crawler must make a Dex Stat Check. On Fail, one item the crawler is holding is disassembled and unusable until they spend 2 Actions to reassemble it.

Monkey Wrench: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Multi-Weapon: 15+F to hit, 5d10+5 Bludgeoning, Piercing, or Slashing (her choice), 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Woozy Debuff.

Notes: *Identify Weakness*—Helga Elfcrusher can spend an Action to study a crawler and gains Advantage on her next attack against them.

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KAYLEE CARTER

As an Olympic-level gymnast, Kaylee quickly distinguished herself by using her innate speed and agility to gain an upper hand in combat and with her fans. As the first professional gymnast in the World Dungeon, the AI awarded her a Legendary Weapon Box containing the infamous and effective Sword-Spear of Many Attackers.

Through very little fault of her own, Kaylee came into possession of the green crystal when she purchased it from one of the shopkeepers in Medium Elf Settlement. While she is unaware of the crystal's true power, she does know how fragile they tend to be and understands their general uses around the dungeon. She made it into a pendant before rushing back into the ruins to grind for experience. Crawlers encounter her anywhere in the ruins once they reach Phase 4 of the Quest.

AI Crawler # 4,782,949. "Kaylee Car"
Level 26.
Race: High Elf.
Class: Leaf Monk.

QUEST ITEMS

To successfully complete the Quest, the crawlers must collect Keeble's three missing marbles from various points in the Over City. The Quest works best if the crawlers find or accidentally inhale the Blue Coral Pollen prior to reaching the lake in pursuit of the Blue Soul Crystal.

- **Weird Blue Dust:** Dust collected from the Blue Coral Flower can be inhaled by any air-breathing creature, allowing them to hold their breath ten times longer than normal. This pollen is one way the crawlers can reach the blue crystal without drowning.
- **Blue Soul Crystal:** Channeling magic through this crystal allows the user to create a shield and enhances the caster's sense of happiness from others' pain.
- **Red Soul Crystal:** Channeling magic through the crystal augments Fire Spells but induces intense rage in the user as everything suddenly seems extra flammable.
- **Green Soul Crystal:** A user may channel magic through it to detect precious metals and valuables or alter earthen landscapes, but doing so triggers extreme greed and envy within the user.

TRAPS

Crawlers are likely to encounter several different types of traps throughout this Quest:

- **Angler's Snare:** Not all water creatures are easily caught with a pole and line. These subaquatic plants possess sticky tendrils so fine that they're nearly invisible underwater during daylight hours and completely undetectable at night. Creatures caught in the snare are slowly constricted until they suffocate, and their corpses turn into blood coral to support marine life. How eco-friendly!
- **Helga's Eviscerating Cruncher:** Designed by Helga initially to rend bear meat for stew, these altered vise-like creations are similar to bear traps, though big enough to cut a Human-sized intruder in two. Additionally, a mechanical device causes the trap's teeth to grind back and forth several times after the trap is triggered, ensuring that the creature that triggered it meets its doom. Bits of bone and hair are so deeply embedded in them that they'll never be clean again.

LIKELY ACHIEVEMENTS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements on this Quest:

- **A Better Mousetrap:** You placed at least five of Helga's Eviscerating Crunchers! Your fellow crawlers loathe you for making their lives so much harder!
  Reward: You receive a Silver Trapmaker's Box.
- **Giantslayer:** Congratulations! You forced an exemplary mechanic to shuffle off her mortal coil. She probably would have helped you had you been a bit nicer...
  Reward: You receive a Silver Asshole's Box.
- **Did You Actually Mean to Do That?:** That mighty quasi-mechanical giant, Helga, was slain by accidental or otherwise unorthodox means. It's almost like you don't want to kill everything.
  Reward: Your Silver Asshole's Box is upgraded to platinum.
- **Keebles and Bits:** You defeated the cosplaying Elf using explosives, leaving portions of his wannabe corpse scattered across the Neighborhood. That's how the cookie crumbles!
  Reward: You receive a Gold Cosplay Box.

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GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Throughout the Quest, crawlers may slaughter massive numbers of Mobs from time to time. Perhaps it's for experience, or for fun, or because that one person stole their left shoe that one time. Regardless of the reason, the complications on Table 83 might help you vary the PCs' experiences along the way.

STAGE 1: RUINS

The Quest begins with a panicked voice echoing through the shattered streets of the Over City. Following the cries leads the crawlers to a half-rebuilt warehouse rising from the ruins, topped with what appears to be a large cupcake, welded from various bits of scrap metal. This heap of welded scrap and broken masonry serves as both home and workshop to Helga Elfcrusher, the colossal mechanic whose cybernetic augmentations whir and grind as loudly as her temper.

Inside, a confusing representation of an Elf lies pinned beneath a fallen shelf, struggling to breathe as he is enveloped in a smoky cloud. He was searching for his lost "marbles" (actually d20-shaped Soul Crystals) when the beasts chased him into Helga's domain. He promises riches untold if the crawlers help him without alerting Helga. Upon rescue, the trapped Elf introduces himself as Keeble, thanking the crawlers profusely and loudly complaining about the canines. For an Elf, his bone structure looks remarkably Human, and his armor is clearly homemade; one of his Elf ears looks to be

QUEST EVENTS

Use these phrases to improvise events that the crawlers might experience, evoking the mood of this Quest:

- Helga Elfcrusher moves from one rubble pile to another, muttering to herself as she scavenges the ruins in search of materials for her next project.
- The crawlers stumble across a half-eaten Night Ray corpse, with no body of water in sight. The stinger has been ripped clean off, and someone has (badly) removed the skin, leaving a dripping mass of muscles and organs.
- A group of ten City Elves crosses the road during the night, oblivious to the presence of the crawlers. They giggle to themselves like high school kids at camp and are dragging the corpse of a Skyfowl along between them.

TABLE 83: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	Strange blue-and-yellow plants with vines that look like coral grow on the walls of several nearby buildings. The pollen produced by their flowers is a weird blue dust and is detailed under Quest Items (p. 406).
2	Several revolutionaries from the 404th investigate a large hole in the ground when they spot the crawlers. While their response to the PCs depends on their relationship, it won't matter. Shortly after the crawlers are spotted, a cluster of hungry Scolopendrini burrows out of the ground. They attack the City Elves. Providing aid is up to the crawlers.
3	The Mobs are lining up for their chance to be killed by crawlers. As each dies, a puff of smoke collects into a larger and larger cloud overhead. Should be fine, right?
4	The ground beneath the feet of the crawlers begins to rumble and shift. Before long, it is extremely difficult for them to maintain their footing. Meanwhile, the wall of a nearby building begins to collapse on top of them.
5	The squeal of a rusty axle the next street over draws attention. A Goblin merchant dressed in dusty business attire pushes a tarp-covered cart down the road. If he spots the crawlers, he calls them and attempts to sell his Goblin wares. PCs with a Goblin Pass receive a discount.
6	A statue of an enormous centipede, composed mostly of rebar and the concrete remnants of a highway bridge, towers more than 30 feet in the air. Spotty black paint covers portions of the statue, giving it a mottled look. Its gaze appears to follow the crawlers as they move.

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a little loose around the edges, too... He begs them to help recover his missing marbles, the very Quest he was on when disaster struck.

If Helga Elfcrusher is drawn in by the commotion, she is initially outraged but can be negotiated with if calmed. In exchange for the crawlers setting up a few of her viciously clever traps to keep vermin out of her warehouse, Helga repairs damaged gear or even builds new items or cyber-gear using the bizarre tools and spare parts scattered throughout her workshop. She isn't invested in Keeble and is more upset at people trespassing in her domain.

STAGE 2: THE BLUE CRYSTAL

The last time Keeble remembers possessing the blue marble was during a fishing trip to a nearby lake. He can even guide the group there. He doesn't know exactly where it sank or how to retrieve it, only that it's down there. Keeble claims he can sense the location of his "marbles" because they're a part of him.

What Keeble does know is the behavior of the Night Rays that dwell beneath the surface. He warns the crawlers when they draw near, offering advice that may or may not keep them alive. The lake itself changes dramatically with the time of day.

After dark, the Night Rays become viciously aggressive, swarming anything that enters the deeper water where the marble drifted. Always hungry this time of night, their venomous tail spines start the cellular breakdown of prey before it's even dead. That probably hurts a lot.

By day, the lake is almost inviting. While other predators may lurk below, the Night Rays remain calm unless attacked, and their pearlescent beauty can enrapture even hardened crawlers. These quasi-intelligent creatures are aware of the marble's location due to the energy it emits, and since none of them enjoys the sensation, they can be convinced to guide the crawlers to it. Unfortunately, they offer no help with breathing underwater.

Searching the lake bed without assistance takes time but carries its own rewards. Countless objects were dumped into the water: trash, rusted bicycles, a dwarven battery, and gear stripped from long-dead crawlers. The longer the party searches, the greater the chance they uncover something valuable... or something best left buried.

When the blue marble is returned, Keeble beams with genuine delight and thanks the crawlers. With the marble retrieved, he gains the ability to project a powerful defensive shield around himself and his allies, so long as the marble remains in his possession.

STAGE 3: THE RED CRYSTAL

According to Keeble, the red crystal was lost during a stroll through the ruins while he was gathering flowers for his girlfriend. Tragic, really. That's when a gang of teenagers allegedly trampled him while playing something called "parkour tag." The red crystal tumbled into a deep hole in the rubble that is far too narrow for Keeble to reach into without losing an arm (the weirdo is quite fond of having two arms for some reason). He tried shifting debris. He tried crawling. He tried shouting at the hole. Eventually, he gave up and left it behind.

The crystal came to rest in a nest of Scolopendrini: massive, light-hating centipedes that thrive in cramped darkness. Prolonged exposure to the red crystal drove them into a perpetual murder frenzy, making them hostile at all hours.

The hole itself is only large enough for something rat-sized to squeeze through, but it could be widened with tools, effort, or reckless enthusiasm involving explosives. For those with less volatile tendencies, a secondary access point exists nearby, leading through the sewer ruins and directly into the nest.

As the crawlers explore the area, the ground begins to tremble. This is not a monster; this is worse. Thanks to Borant's outstanding commitment to structural integrity, the rubble shifts, and a sinkhole opens beneath the party, dragging ruins and possibly crawlers into a cramped pocket beneath tons of stone, earth, and rebar.

Soul crystals. Goddamn soul crystals. That's what they'd used to power the swordsmen guards on the third floor...

—Carl

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If the crawlers recover the red crystal, Keeble regains his fire magic, along with his temper, volatility, and an alarming enthusiasm for violence.

Should the party clear the Scolopendrini nest without kabooming everything, they can scavenge additional glittering rewards: jewelry from collapsed manors, rare crafting components, and loose gold coins. The centipedes didn't care what they collected, only that it sparkled. Blowing up the nest, however, scatters and ruins these valuables beyond recovery.

Choices matter, crawlers. Especially the explosive ones.

STAGE 4: THE GREEN CRYSTAL

When Gazal first stole the green crystal, he stashed it in the marketplace, assuming it would be safe among the chaos. He was wrong. A shopkeeper found the glowing gem, immediately recognized its resale value, and pawned it off to the first interested buyer: a crawler named Kaylee Carter.

Kaylee liked the crystal a lot. So much, in fact, that she turned it into a pendant and wore it proudly around her neck before heading back into the ruins to indulge in some light slaughter and recreational rampaging.

The encounter with Kaylee can go one of two ways: negotiation or violence. The crawlers may threaten, bargain, or otherwise convince her to part with the pendant, or they may fight her for it. If combat breaks out, Kaylee wields her infamous Sword-Spear of Many Attackers, summoning mirror copies of herself to engage each crawler simultaneously. Should she survive the encounter but lose the pendant, Kaylee makes it her personal mission to reclaim the crystal, potentially returning later to crash the final confrontation.

As the crawlers track Kaylee through the ruins, they encounter a wandering trader offering scavenged trinkets and questionable treasures. The trader recognizes Keeble immediately and is visibly flustered. He attempts to pull one crawler aside to offer halting, indirect warnings, never quite daring to say outright that Keeble was a tyrant governor. If no such moment arises, his expressions alone betray his fear, though he keeps his silence while Keeble is within earshot.

When the green crystal is returned, Keeble's earth magic surges back, along with his greed and envy. With all of his "marbles" restored, he reverts fully to the elven tyrant who rules the Medium Elf Settlement. He curtly thanks the crawlers and demands that they escort him home so he may "reward them properly."

His personality shift is unmistakable, and any lingering doubts about the crystals should vanish once he's home. As soon as Keeble is back in the governor's manor, he snaps, berating the crawlers for their incompetence and the time they wasted retrieving what was rightfully his. Shielded by his restored power, he turns on them in a furious outburst. If Kaylee Carter still lives, she may enter the battle at any moment, having followed the crawlers back to town, eager to reclaim what she believes is hers.

Congratulations, crawlers. You completed the Quest! Now survive the ending.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Beat-up rulebooks, loose dice, and broken plastic toys depicting dungeons, tiny people, and creatures litter the great hall, coupled with dice and papers piled high on the main table. However, the crawlers have little time to contemplate this geeky haven before Keeble begins his tirade, the Soul Crystals igniting and snapping into orbit around his head, their glow reflecting off the scattered plastic junk. What a pigsty!

The ground groans, stone plates sliding into place, sealing exits with a final, unmistakable clunk. The arena is locked. This ends here.

Kibril—Keeble's true self, now evident despite the considerable layers of cosplay armor—fights like someone who's waited years for this moment. He cycles between firestorms, earthen walls, and kinetic blasts, constantly reshaping the battlefield. He isolates crawlers with rising stone walls, then floods sections with flame or choking dust. His shielding flares strongest while the Soul Crystals orbit freely, and observant crawlers may notice that disrupting his "marbles" weakens his defenses and destabilizes his attacks.

As the fight drags on, the arena deteriorates, floors collapse, loose rolling dice generate new hazards depending on which numbers they land, ranging from mild inconveniences to frightening displays of power, and unshelved books ignite or explode with errant magic. The dungeon isn't subtle. It wants a spectacle.

CLUES

- Disrupting any crystal can reduce the effectiveness of Keeble's attacks.

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- Disrupting specific crystals shut off Keeble's Firestorm, Earthen Wall, or Kinetic blast for the following round.
- Crawlers who see the how the loose polyhedrons land know which hazards appear where and can thus avoid them.

AI **Kibril Altheras Darkoak (Keeble). Elf Cosplay Aficionado.**

Level 60 Quest Boss!

The lights in the great hall dim suddenly, and a familiar smug voice overlays the scene:

"Quest complete. Boss unlocked. You found his marbles... now play his game."

Kibril Altheras Darkoak rises above the rubble, the newly returned crystals orbiting the head of this Human wrapped in Elf aesthetics and stolen divinity. His cosplay armor is ceremonial, over-designed, and clearly self-made. A frayed shoulder bag hangs at his right side, bursting with old Pathfinder guides and a dog-eared Transformers RPG book, pages fluttering as elemental energy surges.

With a theatrical snarl, Kibril flings a pouch from his belt, and dice explode across the battlefield in a deadly spray, crystalline d4s and dice shards biting into boots and flesh alike.

"I played by the rules. I learned the systems. And now?" He says, "Now I run the game. Roll initiative, crawlers."

Kibril Atheras Darkoak

Quest Boss; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	15%	23%	30%	38%	46%	53%	61%	69%	76%	84%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
60	16+F	16+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
55 (+6)	55 (+6)	30 (+5)	55 (+6)	10 (+4)

Kinetic Blast: 16+F to hit, 6d10+6 Force, 50ft range

Choking Gas: 16+F to hit, 6d6+6 Poison, 30ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Deadly D4s: 16+F to hit, 7d4+6 Piercing, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Fire Storm: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Fire, 50ft range, 20ft Blast radius +10ft Splash
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Burned Debuff.

Notes: *Earthen Wall*—Kibril Altheras Darkoak can create earth or stone walls to separate and isolate crawlers as an action. This gives Kibril Altheras Darkoak Advantage on their attacks against isolated crawlers.

Soul Crystal Shield—Kibril Altheras Darkoak has several marble-size soul crystals orbiting around him. They have the same Evade as Kibril Altheras Darkoak, and if one is hit, it disrupts Kibril Altheras Darkoak' use of the ability for one round. A crawler can make an Int-Opposed Perception Check or an Int Stat Check of the same Difficulty. On Success, the crawler can identify which soul crystals are used for which effects. In addition, each time a crystal is hit, it lowers his DR and Evade by 1 during the following round.

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QUEST: THE SHOW MUST GO ON

FLOOR: 3 — THEME: A BLOODY, MOLDY NIGHTMARE CARNIVAL.

Once a traveling circus in the Over City, Grimaldi's Traveling Circus is now anchored in place by Scolopendra's curse. Grimaldi himself, transformed into a Pestiferous Vine, cannot move from his rooted place, and thus the circus simply sprawls out around him. The *village* in this Quest can be any neighborhood you've already used or intend to use. It overlaps with other locations.

The parasites that spread Grimaldi's influence lurk around every corner, eager to recruit new mindless family members for the circus. This Quest is part of another show taking place throughout Dungeon Crawler World, *Vengeance of the Daughter,* which is focused on infiltrating and disrupting Grimaldi's circus.

Many of the Mobs in this Quest were once circus performers, now twisted and decayed by the influence of the worms. From knife-throwing lemurs and giraffes to horrifying clowns of all shapes and sizes, these Mobs are all ruled by the vine—Grimaldi. When not engaged in combat, these Mobs live a twisted mockery of their former existence, working the circus booths and attempting their former stage acts.

This Quest's Boss is Grimaldi—a City Boss and an Elite. Outright fighting Grimaldi is unlikely to prove fruitful for crawlers on the Third Floor, but there are other ways to win aside from an all-out brawl. Several other circus performers are also Elites. Tsarina Signet, another Elite NPC in this Quest, is the main character of the *Vengeance of the Daughter* tunnel program and a former member of Grimaldi's circus.

To complete this Quest, crawlers must obtain tickets to the Big Top Tent, navigate the temptations of the circus, and defeat Grimaldi.

STRONG STARTS

- The crawlers are ambushed by a roving band of Former Circus Lemurs who pelt them with throwing knives and press them further into the Over City, toward the circus. Any of the Lemurs looted can be carrying a Big Top Ticket, which triggers the Quest upon pickup.
- The crawlers wake to find Tsarina Signet relaxing in their saferoom, and is looking to make a deal. She wants allies, and offers a tattoo of Resistance to Blood Magic to anyone who agrees. She teleports away soon after. (GM: The tattoo actually isn't Resistance. Instead, it is part of her own Blood Magic. See p. 417)
- *Vengeance of the Daughter*'s ratings are low, and the producers are looking to make a scene. A stilt clown kidnaps an NPC the crawlers crossed paths with before, and the implied understanding is that the NPC will be transformed into a permanent member of the circus if the crawlers do not intervene.

QUEST DESCRIPTION

When the crawlers receive this Quest, the AI announces it in dramatic fashion with the following text.

> **AI** **New Quest. The Show Must Go On.**
>
> The circus has come to town—or more accurately, you've come to the circus! Once a source of joy and wonder for the families of the Over City, this circus now rots and pulses at the center of the neighborhood. The grating, out-of-tune calliope and overpriced popcorn are the least of your worries. Discover the secrets of the circus and close the curtain once and for all.
>
> *Reward:* You receive a Gold Quest Box.

ALTERATIONS

If your table is interested in exploring the circus before destroying it, consider granting all Crawlers Big Top Tickets as a pre-Quest reward and starting the adventure with a "fun" day at the fair. For ticket holders, the circus should be a sharp, unpleasant balance between nostalgia and uncanny valley—like caramel glaze over a rotted apple. Rather than initiating the Quest upon receipt of the tickets, the crawlers instead initiate the Quest the first time they question why something seems out of place.

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MOBS

The Mobs found in The Show Must Go On are former circus animals, performers, and attendees who have been transformed by parasitic fungi.

FORMER CIRCUS LEMURS

Once renowned acrobats, knife-throwers, and jugglers, Grimaldi's Circus Lemurs skirted the line between famous and infamous centuries ago. Now twisted and reanimated by the worms that writhe beneath their skin, these ferocious creatures combine deadly precision with projectiles and prefer to swoop in on their prey from above.

Lemurs travel in troops. It is rare to come across fewer than three of them at a time. Former Circus Lemurs are sometimes accompanied by other Mobs—commonly clown-type Mobs or giraffes—who can direct the Lemurs during combat. Former Circus Lemurs drop "Big Top Tickets" very occasionally and are lootable for throwing knives.

AI **Former Circus Lemur 8.**

These masked marauding monkeys—well, they're not really monkeys, but close enough—used to spend their days entertaining kids and tossing knives in skilled displays of prowess. Now they're out of kids and ravenously hungry. Too bad for you, the circus lemurs kept their sense of whimsy and love to play with their food. That's you.

Former Circus Lemur

Mob; Petite (3), Animal

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
12%	25%	37%	50%	62%	75%	87%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
8	12+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
7 (+3)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)

Skinning Knives: 14+F to hit, 2d4+3 Piercing, 15ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Vicious Bites: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Piercing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Sore as Shit Debuff.

Notes: *Jumpy*—Former Circus Lemurs can jump a distance equal to twice their Move as an Action by swinging off a ledge, lamp post, or giraffe's neck.

Stealthy—Former Circus Lemurs do not appear on a crawler's mini-map until the Lemur has initiated an attack.

GIRAFFES

Long-necked, thick-bodied, and crawling with worms, a giraffe wearing clown makeup is a terrifying sight to behold from afar, let alone up close. These Giraffes grew larger under the influence of the spores, swollen with worms and their skin stretched taut.

Giraffes can be ridden by a variety of other Mobs—Lemurs, Clowns, humanoid Races, and small animals like the Lemurs. These are just a few potential candidates for giraffe cavalry. While Giraffes do not possess many inherent combat Skills, their large size and bursts of speed help them disrupt the battlefield, splitting enemy groups and depositing their riders in advantageous positions.

AI **Giraffe. Level 10.**

Topping the Over City charts with a sprint speed of over 35 miles per hour, here comes a circus giraffe! No, really, here it comes—you should probably move, dumbass.

Giraffe

Mob; Huge (6), Animal

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	13+F	13+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	6 (+3)	10 (+4)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)

Back Kick: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

Bite 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Hail of Lemurs: 13+F to hit, No damage, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff. Can be used twice per combat.

Notes: *Burst of Speed*—Giraffes can take one free Move Action once per combat.

Disruption—After using Burst of Speed to get close to target, Giraffes can divide enemy groups by dropping 2d6 Former Circus Lemurs among them.

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Hail of Lemurs—Giraffes can fling 2d6 Former Circus Lemurs by whipping their necks. These Former Circus Lemurs then swarm the target and attack. This can be done twice per combat.

STILT CLOWN

Whatever humanoid Race these clowns were before their transformation is no longer discernible. Pale splotchy skin is stretched across a long, bony frame—taut in some places and loosely sagging off joints in others. A wide, red-painted grin splits Terror the Clown's face, revealing jagged, razor-sharp teeth.

Stilt Clowns tower over any space, standing over 10 feet tall with arms that nearly reach the ground and long, bony legs. Their black-and-white-striped or polka-dotted costumes are tattered and dirty, clinging with the moisture of blood and rot in places. Stilt Clowns wield butchers' knives, one in each hand. Most stilt Clowns have at least one Big Top Ticket to loot from their corpses, along with their knives and, if you're lucky, some clown meat.

AI Stilt Clown. Level 10.

Did you know that 53.5 % of Humans feel at least some amount of fear when they see a clown? I think it's safe to up that to 100% when it comes to these freaks. Stilt clowns used to inspire cheers and laughter when they walked down a street; now, they mostly elicit screams.

Stilt Clown

Mob, Large (5), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	13+F	14+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)

Arm Whip: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, 10ft range Any hit crawler is pushed 10 feet.

Butcher Knife: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Slashing, 10ft range On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Freakish Smile*—Crawlers who move within 10ft of a Stilt Clown for the first time must succeed at an Int Stat Check. On Fail, they gain the Terrified Debuff.

Rubbery Arms—Stilt Clowns can stretch their arms and head to twice their normal length as part of an attack. The range of their next attack, however, is limited to 5ft as their arms quickly retract.

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FAT CLOWN

Fat Clowns are short, round Mobs that are as hungry as they are jovial. They wear dirty, bloody, but still startlingly colorful clown costumes with weathered lace ruffles over their rotund bodies.

The Fat Clowns' faces are almost Human, their nature belied by the sharp teeth housed behind their cherry-red smiles and blood-stained outfits. A layer of grease paint, thicker than buttercream on a cake, hides any skin from view. Unlike their taller fellows, Fat Clowns do not wield weapons but instead use their long, thick, yellowed fingernails as claws. Some Fat Clowns carry Big Top Tickets and Fermented Cotton Candy.

AI Fat Clown. Level 9.

Centuries of being cursed really does a number on the figure, doesn't it? Fat clowns used to be the friendliest kind of clown—the sort some kids even kind of liked. The nice thing is, they kept their sense of humor after all this time—the less-nice thing? They really love eating people.

Fat Clown

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
11%	22%	33%	44%	55%	66%	77%	88%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
9	12+F	12+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
13 (+3)	3 (+2)	11 (+3)	4 (+2)	1 (+1)

Dirty Nails: 13+F to hit, 1d10+3 Slashing, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Honker Horn: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Sonic, 15ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Muted Debuff.

Notes: *Freakish Smile*—Crawlers who move within 10ft of a Stilt Clown for the first time must succeed at an Int Stat Check. On Fail, they gain the Terrified Debuff.

Roiling Belly—Fat Clowns have stomachs that rumble and shift, making them immune to Poisoned.

MOLD LIONS

Madame Kiki's Dancing Lions were some of the first creatures at Grimaldi's Traveling Circus to succumb to Scolopendra's Spell. Their bodies were overrun by parasitic fungus, slimy green growth covering large swaths of skin.

Male Mold Lions' manes are matted and sticky with fungal growth. Tentacles sprout out from amid the locks of hair, wriggling around their heads like a blighted halo. Though not nearly as graceful as their former dancing selves, Mold Lions are still very flexible, strong, and fast.

AI Mold Lion. Level 15.

Have you ever wanted to watch a lion dance? Me too. It's too bad these lions lost their rhythm at the start of the cataclysm.

The lions were among the first creatures to fall to the curse, transforming into horrible monsters and turning on their beloved trainer. They hold a never-ending rage in their hearts, and these lions don't only hunt for food; they hunt to fill an aching void within.

Mold Lion

Mob; Large (5), Animal

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	13+F	14+F	25+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	6 (+3)	11 (+4)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)

Claw: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Pounce: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Roar: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Sonic, 30ft Cone
Any hit crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

Notes: *Pride Power*—Mold Lions gain Advantage on attacks when two or more are adjacent to the same target.

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OGRES

Large, thick-skinned, and even thicker-skulled, Ogres are a classic heavy-hitting Mob. Unlike crawlers who've chosen Ogre as a Race, Mob Ogres are easy to fool.

The Ogres of Grimaldi's Traveling Circus were infected with Scolopendra's spores, causing them to sprout tendrils, vines, and even branches from their skin, especially at key joints and nerve centers (e.g., from the back, the crook of the neck, or the hips). Ogres typically wear primitive clothing made of animal hides, designed for function rather than fashion. They wield all manner of simplistic weapons—though many favor clubs and hammers.

AI **Ogre. Level 11.**

In the age-old battle of brawns versus brains, Ogres put all their chips on the former. Scolopendra's curse affects the minds of all creatures infested with the spores, but something about Ogres made them extra susceptible. The fungus turned their minds to mush—very well-protected mush.

Ogre

Mob, Large (5), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
11	11+F	13+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	1 (+1)	7 (+3)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)

Bear Hug: 15+F to hit, 2d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Club: 15+F to hit, 3d4+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Battle Worn*—Ogres gain Advantage on attacks against crawlers of equal or higher Level than they are.

I'm going to have to kill you, Carl.

—Tsarina Signet

ELITES AND NPCS

The characters in The Show Must Go On are members of a family torn apart and poisoned by a centuries-old curse.

TSARINA SIGNET

A powerful Half-Naiad, Half-High Elf Summoner and the illegitimate child of the High-Elf King Finian, Tsarina Signet is the lead NPC created for *Vengeance of the Daughter.* Cast out and rejected by both sides of her lineage, she ran away from home at a young age, joining Grimaldi's Traveling Circus and finding a new family that truly loved her.

Her joyous new life was cut short by the great cataclysm, when her fellows at the circus were cursed by Scolopendra and taken under her Spell. Now, Signet has been cast out from the one place she could truly call home and must watch from the outside as the monsters that were once her family devour people.

Signet is a powerful magic-user whose tattoos are all creatures that can be called forth from her skin via a summoning ritual. Because this ritual requires blood taken from the sacrifice of another creature, Signet spends her days capturing and sacrificing Mobs and crawlers to wage her war against the circus by night.

AI **Tsarina Signet.**

Half Naiad, Half High-Elf Summoner. Level 60.

This is an Elite.

Life must have been rough for Signet: half-Naiad, half-High Elf, all trouble for her royal bloodline. As the illegitimate daughter of High-Elf King Finian, Signet was hunted by both of her parents' lines. Running away to the circus is a definite step up from that, if you ask me.

Tsarina Signet

Elite; Medium, (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	15%	23%	30%	38%	46%	53%	61%	69%	76%	84%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
60	16+F	16+F	25+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
22 (+5)	53 (+6)	25 (+5)	53 (+6)	52 (+6)

Energy Bolt Spell: 16+F to hit, 7d6+6 Force, 50ft range

Charming Seduction Spell: 16+F to hit, No damage, 10ft range

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Any hit crawler must make an INT Stat Check. On Fail, they gain the Charmed Debuff: They cannot attack Signet and must stand still or obey basic, non-aggressive commands. The crawler can attempt an INT Stat Check again to break free of the Charmed Debuff once per day or any time the crawler takes damage. (This is a Mind Control effect.)

Sacrificial Blade: 15+F to hit, 6d4+5 Slashing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Water Lily Spell: 16+F to hit, No damage, 10ft range
Any hit crawler must make an INT Stat Check. On Fail, they gain the Unconscious Debuff: They are prone and cannot take actions until Signet cancels Water Lily, even if attacked and damaged. This attack can be used once per day.

Notes: *Blood Magic*—When a creature or crawler marked with her tattoo goes to 0% HB, their blood flies through the air to her, which powers her Ink Marauder ability.

Ink Marauder—Signet can animate one or more of the tattoos on her body using Blood Magic, creating two-dimensional "paper" versions of the Mobs they depict. Each animated tattoo has Stats equal to half of that of the creature depicted. If the animated creature is killed, it returns to tattoo form on Signet's body.

Water Cursed—Water cannot touch her skin. Signet has Immunity to Ice damage.

APOLLON THE MIGHTY

Apollon and his brothers Areson the Wise and Herman were once three heads of the Nodling tattooed on Tsarina Signet. When he split off from the Nodling, Apollon emerged as an Ogre and took up a position as the Grimaldi Traveling Circus's strongman.

When the great cataclysm struck, Apollon fell victim to the spores and became infested. Now fungal growths cover his skin, and a thick vine links his neck to the central structure of Grimaldi's vines. Apollon happily serves "ice cream" from a cart within the circus, though this ice cream is, in fact, just a cone full of spore-infested worms. Crawlers who consume these worms become infected with Scolopendra parasites.

AI **Apollon the Mighty. Level 55.**

Once upon a time, Apollon the Mighty was the strongman for Grimaldi's Traveling Circus. Now, that strength is warped to serve Scolopendra's whims. I wouldn't take any food he offers you—chances are you'll wind up worse than him by the time you're done.

QUEST ITEMS

It's not a circus without a smorgasbord of weird souvenirs. Many of the Quest items in The Show Must Go On were once fond keepsakes of audience members.

- **Big Top Ticket:** A thick cardstock ticket emblazoned with "Grimaldi's Traveling Circus" in gilded lettering. This ticket admits one crawler to the circus. Valued at one gold piece.
- **Cone of Worms:** Peddled as "ice cream" by vendors throughout the circus, this "delicacy" is actually a cone full of parasitic worms. Consumption of these worms infects a crawler with mind-controlling parasites linked to Grimaldi.
- **Fermented Cotton Candy:** A sharp, rancid smell wafts from the sticky, crystallized sugar. Moisture and mold fermented this cotton candy into a poisonous treat irresistible to circus denizens. It can be thrown as a distraction to draw Clowns, Lemurs, and Mold Lions away.
- **Terror Teddy:** A stuffed animal won (or stolen) from one of the carnival games at Grimaldi's Traveling Circus. A crawler holding this bear can hug it to produce an ear-piercing shriek that temporarily deafens and disables every Mob (and crawlers who aren't protected) within a ten-foot radius while the crawler holding it remains immune. This ability has a ten-minute cooldown.

TRAPS

Some of the craftier former circus members set up traps throughout the Neighborhood surrounding the Big Top Tent. These traps come in two main varieties: lures that draw unsuspecting Mobs and crawlers into the circus, and deterrents that keep assailants out.

- **Sweet Memories:** The sweet-and-savory smell of rich carnival food pours forth from the front entrance of Grimaldi's Traveling Circus. Inhaling these fumes traps crawlers in nostalgic recollections of their past, drawing them into the circus with the promise of childhood joy... even though that's not what they find.
- **Grating Grind Organ:** A street organ rigged to run continuously, its mechanisms long out of tune and due for an oiling. The shrieking grate of scraping metal masquerading as music makes focusing very difficult.
- **Hypnotist's Tent:** Any crawler or Mob that enters the hypnotist's tent is hit with an onslaught of suggestive rhythms, flashing lights, and magical energy. These hypnotic elements make their victims

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suggestible and compliant, willing to perform any task until the Debuff wears off or is negated.

- **Mushroom Circle:** The fungal outgrowths of Grimaldi's vines sometimes form perfect circles. A grim mockery of fairy rings, these circles of mushrooms release spores whenever a Mob or a crawler (or anything else) crosses their threshold. Some of these spores carry Grimaldi's parasitic influence, while others are poisonous, induce drowsiness, or cause skin reactions.

CARNIVAL GAMES

Throughout the circus grounds, mold-infested clowns and entertainers run a variety of games of skill and chance. Many of these games are heavily weighted in the circus' favor, though all can be won with the right combination of perceptiveness, cunning, and fine motor skills.

- **Bottle Knockers:** Using relatively light leather balls, contestants try to knock over relatively heavy glass bottles full of bloody teeth. They're arranged in such a way that only one precise angle and toss speed can succeed.
- **Hammer Drop:** Test your strength against the iron will of fate! The harder you hit the target, the higher the weight (a severed head) goes, working against both friction and gravity.
- **Whack the Moles:** "Mole" is a generous term for the rodents that poke their heads out from the boxes of this game. Take out your anger and help with the circus's pest problem!
- **Wheel of Wonders:** This wheel is subdivided into segments, with very slim segments rewarding prizes and other, wider segments dealing out punishment.

LIKELY ACHIEVEMENTS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements on this Quest.

- **This Game's Rigged!:** Against all odds, you managed to win a carnival game. Beating a con artist at their own game feels good, doesn't it?
  Reward: You receive a Bronze Sapper's Box.
  Contents: Trick- or trap-themed items.
- **Let it Go:** Drawn in by the false promises of the carnival, you successfully turned your back on the past. Congratulations! Those therapy lessons on compartmentalization finally paid off.
  Reward: You receive a Silver Adventurer Box.
  Contents: The box includes dungeon gear/weapons but also one sentimental item from your past.
- **Well, I'm Impressed:** You convinced Tsarina Signet that you're worth more to her alive than as a sacrifice to feed her blood magic. Phew!
  Reward: You receive a Gold Apparel Box.
- **Lost and Found Family:** You managed to reunite Tsarina and Grimaldi for one last conversation before their ways part forever.
  Reward: You receive a Gold Quest Box.
  Contents: A Level 5 scroll of Ink Marauders.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers looking to level up during *The Show Must Go On* have several Mob targets to choose from. Former Circus Lemurs may be the best fodder to grind into sweet, tasty experience, but sometimes throwing in a few curve balls and variations from Table 84 may help keep the campaign from getting stale.

STAGE 1: COME ONE, COME ALL!

The influence of Grimaldi's Traveling Circus is obvious as soon as the crawlers enter the surrounding Neighborhood. The Over City is littered with flyers advertising the circus that has been "in town for the weekend" for centuries—ever since the great cataclysm. The crawlers can stumble into this Quest in a variety of ways, most of which involve crossing paths with corrupted Mobs of former circus performers.

During the daytime, the circus and surrounding area are dangerous, but populated with NPC townsfolk. After night falls, the circus's monsters have free rein of the area and turn it into a house of horrors. This stage should take place entirely during the daytime.

At this stage, the crawlers should not yet know about the second show being filmed in this sector of *Dungeon Crawler World: Vengeance of a Daughter* (though if the Players are fans of the series, they may suspect it).

The crawlers engage a group of Former Circus Lemurs in the town's streets. These Lemurs are hostile on sight and always hungry, no matter when their last meal was. Upon defeating the Lemurs, any crawler is granted a Big Top Ticket as loot, triggering the Quest. If you want the crawlers to collect all their Big Top Tickets in the next stage, they can instead loot a flyer for the circus that decays and transforms to launch the Quest.

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TABLE 84: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	One of the Stilt Clowns took the dangerous new hobby of juggling potions and alchemical solutions. Any time one is dropped or knocked from its hands, it explodes, unleashing its effects on nearby crawlers and Mobs.
2	A group of Lemurs constructed a web-like maze across several streets and alleyways. The web could be easily cut through, but anything disturbing the net brings the Lemurs to investigate, and possibly capture any crawlers for their next meal.
3	A rogue projectile (magical or physical) escaped the arena of combat and broke a vase at a local pottery shop. The potter called the Village Guards over to adjudicate proper compensation.
4	The crawlers wander into the Mold Lions' den and come across a Mold Lionesses and their cubs. The cubs, unlike their parents, are not wholly under the influence of the spores.
5	The only way forward through the alleys is a narrow passage with balconies crawling with Former Circus Lemurs poised to attack. The crawlers can choose an all-out brawl or attempt to pass under their noses undetected and unaccosted.
6	A group of Ogres kidnapped other crawlers and tied them up by a fire. The Ogres argue about the best method for cooking and eating the crawlers—maybe there's still a chance to save them?

QUEST EVENTS

Use these one-sentence hooks the crawlers might experience to evoke the mood of this Quest:

- A group of recently attacked crawlers lies strewn about the alley, some missing chunks that appear gouged out with claws and teeth. All but one already died, but the final one makes eye contact with a crawler in the party and rasps, "Stay away from the twinkling lights..."
- Looking out the window of the building that they ducked inside to hide, the crawlers watch a Lajabless with mushrooms beginning to sprout from her bare arms stumble down the road. She pulls at her hair, muttering under her breath about how she "won't do that" and "needs to get away." The words fade out as she walks off, at war with the voices in her head.
- Bright, joyous music fills the air, coming from somewhere inside the circus. Mobs and other crawlers come out of their hiding places and homes, following the sound as if transfixed. They venture into a dark tent guarded by grinning Stilt Clowns.
- As the sun sets, a shudder of powerful magic crackles in the air. On the horizon, the crawlers see Signet's Ink Marauders come to life, and giant ink monsters fill the Neighborhood skyline.

The sound of sobbing and shuffling draws the party to a secluded alcove or back room. Another crawler huddles in a corner, scratching their arms and legs and examining them with a magnifying glass. If approached, they warn the crawlers to stay away, as they don't want the worms to crawl from under their skin onto the party.

From a safe distance, the crawlers may determine what is wrong and, if possible, how they can assist. The NPC crawler experiences hallucinations, having watched one of their companions get infected with the parasitic worms at the circus. If the party manages to talk the other crawler into coming back to a saferoom with them, the hallucinations fade once they're inside, and the crawler provides them with more information about the circus and the invasive fungus that controls its performers. In thanks, the crawler gives the party two Wisp Armor spellbooks.

STAGE 2: NO FUNNY BUSINESS

Whether the crawlers are out and about or in a saferoom, when night falls, the Neighborhood comes alive with terrifying monsters. Stilt Clowns and Fat Clowns wander the streets, eager to devour any stray creatures. Monsters are painted across the sunset sky in black ink, with clashes like fireworks disrupting the quiet dark.

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If the crawlers are out and about as sunset approaches, they might be ambushed by a group of Ogres or Former Circus Lemurs led by a Stilt Clown or Fat Clown. As each crawler must have their own ticket to enter the circus, at least one must be obtained during this encounter. Unbeknownst to the crawlers, Signet led the Mob their way and will be disappointed when they dispatch the creatures.

The NPC townsfolk are the most accessible source of information about the circus outside of the circus itself. During the daytime, crawlers can explore the town square marketplace and make conversation with the locals. All of them speak with hollow excitement about the carnival coming to town as if controlled by an unseen force.

Desperate for sacrifices strong enough to push her ink marauders through Grimaldi's barrier, Signet knocks the party unconscious, secreting them all away to a battle arena on the outskirts of the circus. She attempts to convince the party to attack each other, and failing that, pits them against Heather the Bear, a Neighborhood Boss (see *B-B-B-Boss Battle!* below). Here the crawlers can catch a glimpse of her true self and set her free while also granting power to Signet's Spell.

Under the guard of Signet's Ink Marauders, the crawlers proceed to the circus proper. If any crawlers lack a ticket, drop them in loot from Mobs they kill along the way or allow them to purchase tickets at the gate.

STAGE 3: THE GREATEST SHOW UNEARTHED

It's easy to see what a wonderful carnival Grimaldi's Traveling Circus was in its heyday, and that makes its now-sorry state even more upsetting. Any of the traps listed above are on circus grounds. Crawlers are also encouraged to participate in any of the carnival games available as they explore the circus. This stage should be a mix of bittersweet nostalgia and revulsion as the shine fades from childhood memories at the fair.

This stage focuses on learning about Grimaldi and Pestiferous Vines so the crawlers can devise a plan to defeat him. Grimaldi is a very high-Level Elite Boss—standard combat will not be effective, and the crawlers should be encouraged to find other means of defeating him.

As the crawlers explore the circus, they might come across a group of Fat Clowns or Stilt Clowns luring others into the circus. Interrupting the attempted kidnapping initiates combat. This is a good opportunity for the crawlers to gain new allies by rescuing them.

If any crawlers want to contact Grimaldi via the spores, they can take a sample cone of "ice cream" from Apollon the Mighty. If a crawler consumes the worms without protection from mind control (such as with Wisp Armor), they are promptly indoctrinated into the circus hive mind. The only "cure" is defeating Grimaldi.

The crawlers should somehow discover the means of defeating a Pestiferous Vine by poisoning one of the roots. The most accessible root access is via the main stage in the Big Top Tent. As the crawlers get ready to plan their assault, an announcement rings out through the entire circus: an open talent competition starts on the main stage in an hour.

STAGE 4: CURTAIN CALL

To get close enough to defeat Grimaldi, the crawlers must enter the talent competition or volunteer as assistants for their fellow crawlers. This is a great opportunity to let players reveal their crawlers' hidden talents or show off unusual Skills—everything can be entertaining. Grimaldi wants his family to be happy and entertained, so as long as the crawlers don't do anything overtly threatening, they can get away with a lot.

If any of the crawlers want to loot props or costumes from the circus to improve their routine, they must fight Mold Lions guarding the circus storage carts. Let the crawlers go wild here. Provided it isn't an over-powered magical item, let them find a range of options to wear or use as they please.

The Fat Clowns and Stilt Clowns took their prey to the dark tent at the back of the circus. Each night, these Mobs and crawlers are forcibly converted via parasites into more Mobs for the circus. The crawlers can infiltrate this tent and rescue any crawlers inside awaiting consumption.

Then... It's showtime! Crawlers, Mobs, and NPCs alike are welcomed to the Big Top Tent's main stage for tonight's event. Winner takes it all—prizes, fame, and the right to leave of your own free will!

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The Show Must Go On may involve multiple Boss Battles:

HEATHER THE BEAR

Heather the Bear was once a performer in Grimaldi's Traveling Circus, famous for her long-running and beloved roller-skating act. She

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was near retirement age when the great cataclysm hit, transforming her into a monstrous shell of her former self.

Ravaged by fungus and worms, the once kind and calm bear is now a cruel, relentless hunter. Her claws were replaced with worm tendrils, reaching out to ensnare prey for the feast. Some small piece of Heather still remains, locked up behind layers of Scolopendra's influence. Sometimes, a gleam in her eye shows recognition and sorrow for what she has become.

Fighting Heather is a precursor to fully earning Signet's trust. Though she registers as a Neighborhood Boss, the usual fanfare accompanying Boss battles is strangely absent. It's more like fighting a powerful Mob with some of the drawbacks and perks of fighting a Boss. She still drops a Neighborhood Map if defeated.

CLUES

- You do not want to be hit by her Parasites.
- Heather the Bear gets all blurry-eyed when healed.
- If she fails to deal any damage during a round of combat, she gives up and asks you to free her. (GM: Wants to die and won't attack.)

AI **Heather the Bear.**

Level 19 Neighborhood Boss

Audiences came from far and wide to see one of Grimaldi's Traveling Circus's main attractions—Heather the Roller-Skating Bear. After a long successful career, Heather was weeks from retirement when the great cataclysm hit, ending her dreams of salmon and honey. Warped by Scolopendra's spores, Heather is now a monstrous mockery of her old self—but if you look real close, you might see a glimpse of the real Heather and feel her shame and sorrow.

Heather the Bear

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Animal

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	15%	23%	30%	38%	46%	53%	61%	69%	76%	84%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
19	14+F	15+F	30+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	11 (+4)	21 (+5)	22 (+5)	7 (+3)

Bear Hug: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Boring Parasites: 15+F to hit, 2d10+6 Piercing, 10ft range, Armor-Piercing
Any hit crawler gains the Mental Intrusion Debuff: Parasites begin talking directly into the crawler's mind, giving them the Queasy and Staggered Debuffs.

Worm Claw Whip: 16+F to hit, 2d8+5 Bludgeoning, 20ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler is pulled 10ft and gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *I Got Better*—If Heather is healed by a crawler, her attacks are made with Disadvantage in the following round.

Unbearable—If Heather fails to deal any damage during a round of combat, she gives up and asks to be put out of her misery.

GRIMALDI

Grimaldi the Ringmaster, now a Pestiferous Vine, is planted firmly in the center of the Big Top Tent. He's a high-Level City Boss Elite and should not be attacked head-on (unless the crawlers have a death wish).

The crawlers need a plan of attack by the time they reach the main stage—are they using poison and waiting out the combat? Are they breaking the seal on the edge of the circus grounds and letting Signet and her Ink Marauders in to help? Or will they try some secret third option only a scrappy and creative crawler could dream up? There's only one wrong answer, and that's trying to 1v1 Grimaldi with a basic-ass iron sword.

A network of vines covers the walls, ceiling, and floor of the Big Top Tent, all extending from the central column of the Pestiferous Vine. What was once Grimaldi stands there now, his form overrun by mushrooms, vines, and tendrils that wriggle and track any movement. Every breath he takes is a breath shared by the entire circus, with information and energy passing along the mycelial highway.

Redstone Grimaldi was once a dwarven ringmaster of Grimaldi's Traveling Circus. He was corrupted by Scolopendra's curse into a large Pestiferous Vine. He remains fiercely protective of his circus family, using the power of the spores to resurrect them repeatedly, albeit more twisted each time. He is unlikely to attack directly unless provoked and preferentially summons Mobs of circus creatures or employs spore-based area-of-effect attacks.

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CLUES

- Poison is the best, and least risky, means of hurting Grimaldi.
- Any mention of his love, Tsarina Signet, causes Grimaldi to hesitate.
- If in combat against Signet and her crew, Grimaldi has difficulty attacking.

AI **Ringmaster Grimaldi. Pestiferous Vine.**

Level 85 City Boss

Everybody loves the circus! But no one loves the circus as much as Grimaldi loved his circus. Grimaldi's Traveling Circus was once a favorite pastime for Over City children and adults alike—until Scolopendra's nine-tier attack changed everything.

The ensuing curse did not spare the circus or its leader, instead twisting them into something else entirely.

Redstone Grimaldi was once a Dwarf, not that you can tell by looking at him these days. He clings to the memory of his circus family, keeping them all alive with the "help" of his parasitic spores. Every time he brings them back, they lose a little more of themselves, but he can't bear to say goodbye.

Besides—the show must go on.

Ringmaster Grimaldi

City Boss; Colossal (7), Plant

9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
4%	9%	13%	17%	21%	26%	30%	35%	39%	44%	49%	53%
9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	
58%	62%	67%	71%	76%	80%	84%	88%	92%	96%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
85	17+F	14+F	10+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
109 (+7)	103 (+7)	201 (+9)	15 (+4)	22 (+5)

Commanding the Retinue: 17+F to hit, No damage, 50ft range
Any hit crawler has 3d6 of Grimaldi's minions (Former Circus Lemurs, Giraffes, Mold Lions, Clowns, and Ogres) appear and attack them.

Mental Link: 17+F to hit, No damage, 100ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Mental Intrusion Debuff: Grimaldi shares a collective consciousness with those infected by his parasites. He can speak directly into their minds, see their memories, and even attempt to exert a "mental tug" to stop their actions. Crawlers must make an Int Stat Check. On Fail, they gain the Paralyzed Debuff. Crawlers can attempt this Check again once per round.

Vinally Yours: 17+F to hit, 6d10+7 Piercing, 100ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Vined For Good Debuff: The crawler gains the Blood Trail and Sepsis Debuffs as vines begin growing from and through their body.

Notes: *Elite "Plot Armor"*—Grimaldi remains "center stage" in the big top arena, where his performers continue to act out a parody of their original circus routines while ignoring outside threats unless specifically engaged.

Rounded Up—Grimaldi takes ×4 damage from Poison.

Sentimental—Grimaldi has Disadvantage on all attacks for the round the first time Signet is mentioned to him. If Signet is allied with the crawlers and fighting with them, the number of attacks Grimaldi can make is reduced by 2 for the first three rounds.

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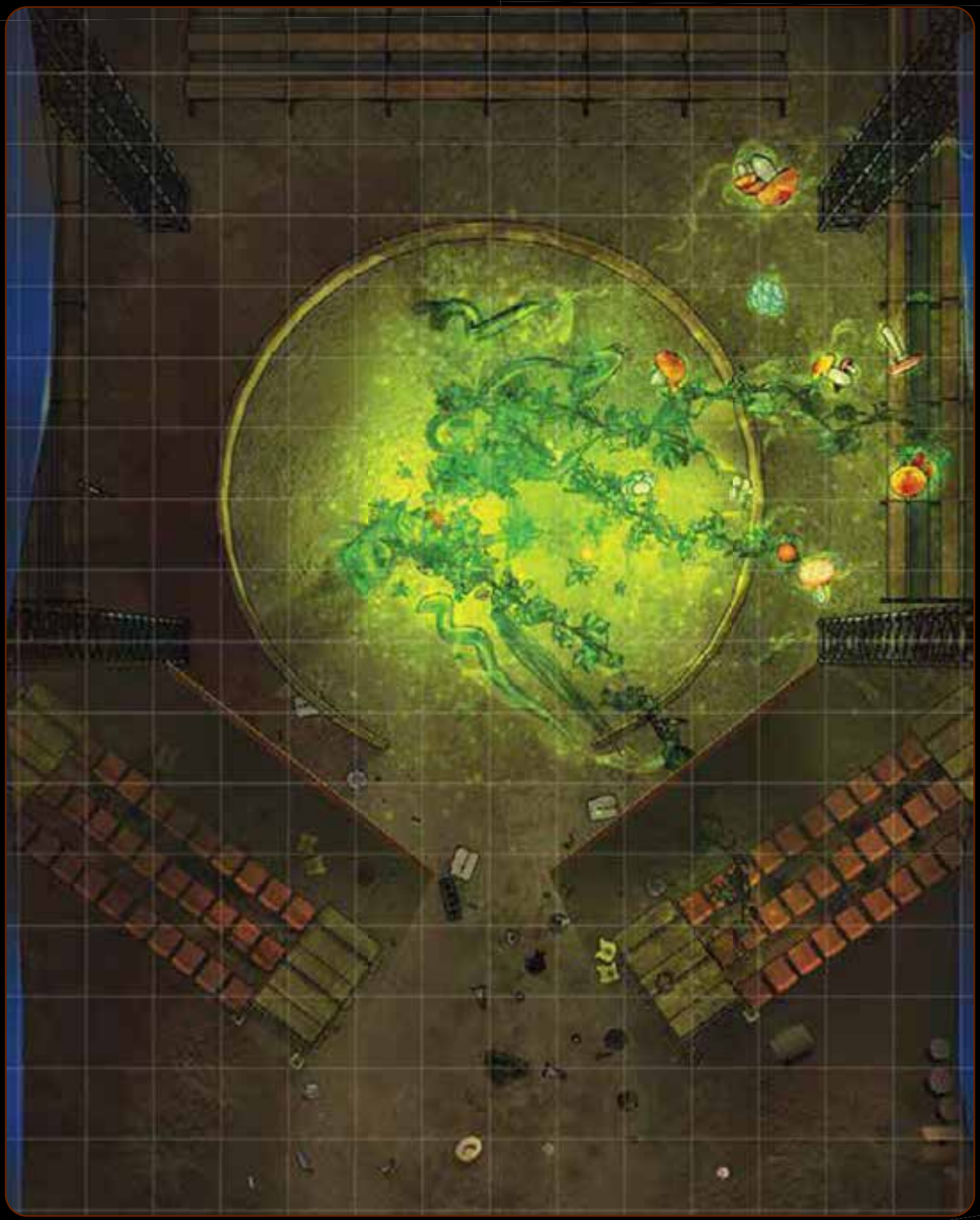

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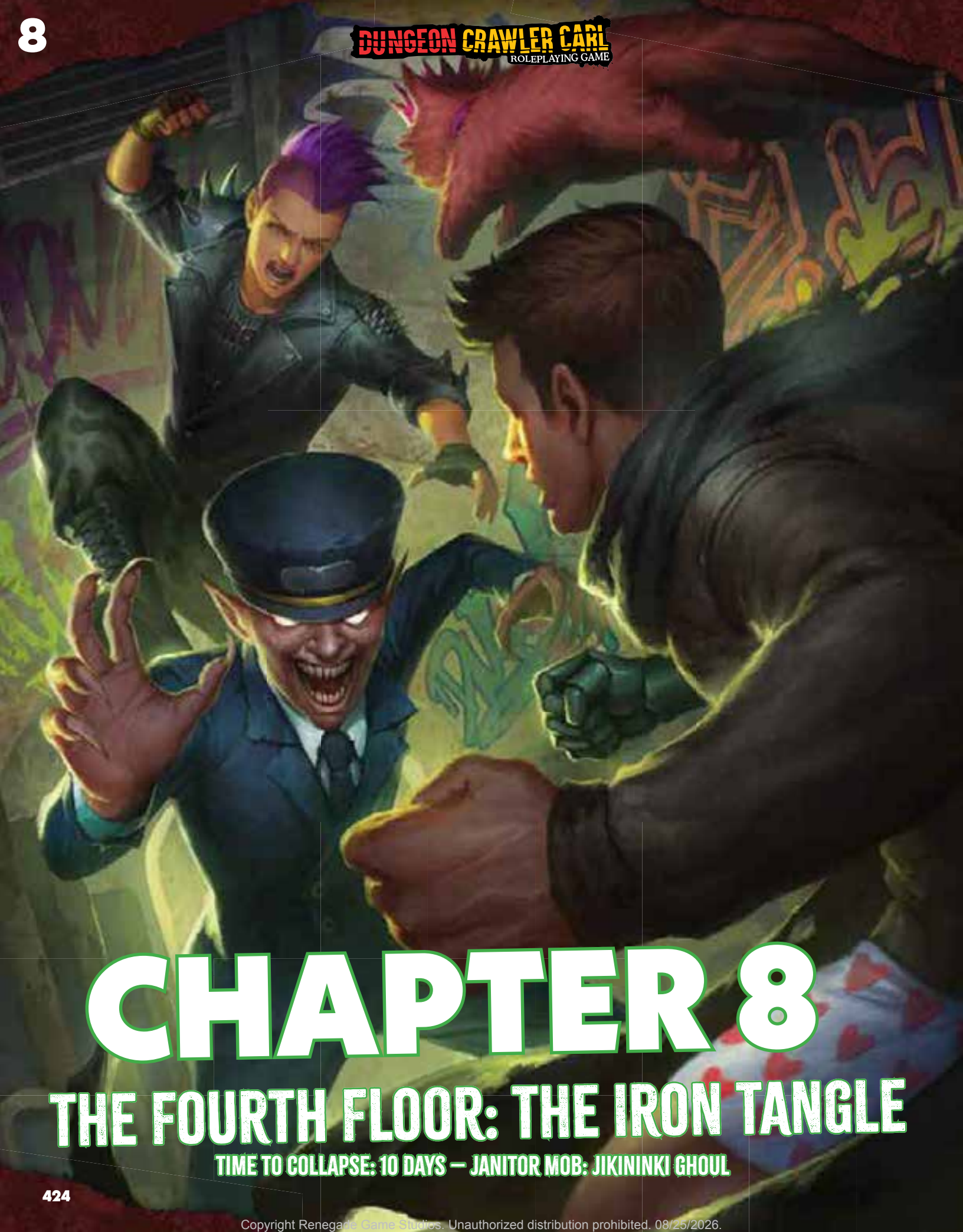

CHAPTER 8

THE FOURTH FLOOR: THE IRON TANGLE

TIME TO COLLAPSE: 10 DAYS — JANITOR MOB: JIKININKI GHOUL

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CHOO CHOO, MOTHERFUCKER! ALL ABOARD FOR A SERIES OF PERPLEXING CHALLENGES BOUND TO THROW YOUR GAME NIGHTS OFF THE RAILS. THE IRON TANGLE COMBINES PLANES, TRAINS, AND AUTOMOBILES (WELL, WE MAY HAVE LIED ABOUT THE PLANES PART, BUT THE OTHER TWO ARE IN THERE) IN A SWIRL OF IMAGINATIVE HORROR AND TWISTING, LOOPING, CHUG-A-CHUG-A PANDEMONIUM.

We know the Iron Tangle is confusing as hell, so much so that in book three of the series, *The Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook*, Matt Dinniman himself even went so far as to say, "You, the super awesome reader, do not need to understand the floor's intricacies in order to understand or fully enjoy what is happening." Since we're all playing pretend anyway, just imagine this sagely advice applies to both the GM and the PCs playing in the Iron Tangle, and everything will work out great.

New Mobs and Bosses, new colored lines and game mechanics, new Spells, Skills, and abilities, and new and interesting characters and items await your crawlers within. Will one of them receive the Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook or something similar? Will they encounter Hekla, Eva, and the rest of Brynhild's Daughters? Will Fire Brandy curse them out or give them a few Sheol Bricks and show them how to drive a train?

Grease up your crankpin, toss some more coal in the firebox, and let's ride into the proverbial sunset together! (But don't get your hopes up about the sunset part. All the dungeon floors are buried within the Earth's crust, after all.)

ALTERNATIVES TO THE IRON TANGLE

The **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** assumes you're probably running your campaign similarly to the events in the novel series. This doesn't need to be the case, and the Iron Tangle is a great place to shake things up. Below are some ways you could alter the Fourth Floor to fit your vision for the World Dungeon, or simply shake things up so the players don't know what to expect next. We'll assume you still employ a system of transportation connecting major hubs, but you can do whatever you and your players want.

Sky Puzzle: The floor is a mountain range with peaks rising above a sea of clouds. Zeppelins crewed by Dwarves, Gnomes, Mantaurs, and War Mages travel regulated routes between the mountaintop villages, which are the equivalent of the Iron Tangle's train stations.

If zeppelins are destroyed, crawlers may need to rely on flying Spells, hot air balloons, hang gliders, and other means to reach nearby villages. The Abyss may be hidden below the surface of the cloud sea. If you pick the Sky Puzzle for the Fourth Floor, consider adapting some Sky Quadrant material from the Fifth Floor, or adjusting the Fifth Floor so the players don't do much in the Sky Quadrant of their bubble. Or just don't let them into the Sky Quadrant at all.

Tangled Branches: The floor is constructed as small villages in the trees, connected by massive bridges between the branches. Villages and branches replace stations, while bridges might be sped across on any number of typical vehicles.

Flight might allow characters to bypass the bridges, which may be necessary if they are cut down. The Abyss might be found at the base of the trees or hidden deep within one of the trunks. Some may see this as a slight to the Oak Mother Apito and related figures. Be ready to bring in all the Elf, Dryad, and other forest-dweller lore you want.

Skyways and Byways: Harkening back to Earth, entire floors the size of city blocks serve as nodes which are connected by massive skyways—glass bridges leading from one tower to the next. Stations are themed as offices and shops, and breaking the glass to move between floors or using grand escalators becomes an option.

The Abyss might be a separate building or street level, possibly connected by a clever series of doors at the rooftop or street levels of the buildings. Consider upcycling content from the Tutorial Floors in a twisted version of what cubicle farms in an interstellar office space might look like.

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Note: For advice on running Neighborhoods and Quests, see Chapter 5, particularly pp. 262–265.

Features:

- A floor-wide puzzle
- Personal spaces become available.
- Neighborhoods are divided into Lines and Stations. Lines focus on specific train lines and include a general line (which could be the Training Day Neighborhood). Stations focus on specific stops, but may include information on a line to get folks in and out of the station.
- The wealthy oligarchs and social elite outside the dungeon can enter the dungeon by paying to portray the gods. Gods can be sponsored prior to this (and many are) but appearances on the First through Third Floors can only happen due to crawler actions.

If you haven't been dialing it up past 11 yet, the Iron Tangle is your chance to get started. You may want to use and reuse Training Day a few times as needed to craft new lines, whether they're named lines or just colored ones. You've probably run quite a few Neighborhoods and Quests by now, so take the new Neighborhoods (both Lines and Stations) plus the Quests below and stretch your wings. Grab a little inspiration for the following two named lines and run with it. Create a new Mob or two (p. 270) or just modify the ones provided.

The Eviscerator: Boarded at the Camel/Cobalt Line transit station 271, this modern industrial train is full of little crab-like monsters that have drills instead of claws, which is just wonderful in a confined space that is also full of diesel fumes, blood, and out-of-control robot arms with saws on them. The War Mage on this train is... *was* an orc. He might have been a battlefield surgeon for very large monsters once upon a time. Anyway, take a wild guess why they call this train "The Eviscerator."

The Misery: Are you ready to dance? Then head to Emerald Line and hop aboard the Iron Tangle's number one 24/7 party train, *The Misery*! Featuring the sickest beats, the hottest War Mage DJs, and Leshy strippers so wild they'll claw your face off! Twelve carriages, no brakes, and our patented Candy Raver Glitter Spores™. When they give a train a name like "The Misery," you just *know* it'll be the ride of a lifetime.

TABLE 85: FOURTH FLOOR GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL	RESULT
1–6	See the current Neighborhood.
7	You find yourself caught on the tracks between stations with a Strong number of Mobs coming from one direction. (GMs: You can use one of the Mobs from this floor if the players attempt to fight through them). The crawlers lose 1d2 hours hiding and backtracking, or are forced to a new station.
8	You find a useful item that's very important to a friendly crawler or NPC, who'll want it back if they learn you have it.
9	You encounter a derailed train in a huge pile blocking your path. You can either double back or try to pick your way through the wreckage. (GMs: If the players double back, they lose 1d2 hours of time. If they work their way through the wreckage, have them encounter a challenging Mob from this Neighborhood).
10	You find an NPC wandering in a stupor (GMs: You can use one of the NPCs on this floor and have the players roleplay or battle with them.)
11	You find yourselves on a fast-moving train that continues to accelerate. You must decide if you want to jump off or try to slow down or stop the train. Both will be challenging. And dangerous.
12	A deity suddenly enters the area the players are grinding in. (GMs: You may choose a deity one of your players worships or one that is friendly or hostile to the players. The players cannot harm the deity on this floor, so they'll need to figure out a way to get away from the deity).
13	One of the players triggers a trap. (GMs: This could be a trap that holds the player in place for something else to happen, an alarm trap to alert an enemy nearby, or it could be a high-damage trap. Or an opportunity to check a trap-avoiding or disarming Skill for advancement.)
14	You find a juvenile form of a Mob that befriends you (GMs: You can use this to bring a Boss from elsewhere on this floor to attack the players, or it can be purely for roleplay purposes).
15–20	Nothing bad happens.

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GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Use Table 85 for complications when grinding for experience or as inspiration for events that might happen on this floor.

COLORS

The Iron Tangle famously uses many distinctly colored train lines. This floor is scraping the bottom of the barrel for names of colors, and you can use Table 86 to help, no matter what your Iron Tangle is. The fun here is picking colors that the players may not know.

TABLE 86: UNCOMMON COLORS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COLOR	COLOR FAMILY	HUE
1	Alabaster	Pale Yellow/Green	
2	Bistre	Brown	
3	Buff	Yellow	
4	Celadon	Green	
5	Cerise	Pink/Red	
6	Cinereous	Gray	
7	Ecru	Tan	
8	Fulvus	Yellow/Brown	
9	Gamboge	Yellow/Brown	
10	Glaucous	Blue	
11	Gunmetal	Blackish Green	
12	Heliotrope	Vivid Purple	
13	Incarnadine	Red	
14	Periwinkle	Blue/Purple	
15	Puce	Pink	
16	Smalt	Blue	
17	Taupe	Black/Brown	
18	Tawny	Orange/Brown	
19	Verdigris	Green/Blue	
20	Xanthus	Yellow/Orange	

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NEIGHBORHOOD: TRAINING DAY (OR: THE IRON TANGLE AND YOU!)

FLOOR: 4 — THEME: THE DANGERS OF MASS TRANSPORTATION

The rattle of wheels upon tracks. The keening, piercing sound of a train whistle. The smell of diesel that clogs the air—air so heavy, it feels like you've gotta chew it. All of these are but small parts of the grand mess that is the Iron Tangle.

Seemingly endless tunnels snake through the earth, punctuated by train stations standing as lonely islands of light in a claustrophobic sea of shadows. The only thing keeping these stations from being completely isolated in the darkness is the trains. These steel titans make the Iron Tangle what it is, and each has the potential to be unique. Of course, they're still trains: they all share a few common elements.

Note: Unlike most Neighborhoods, when running the Iron Tangle, you may use and reuse this Neighborhood or parts of it whenever you need a train. Remix and recycle as much as you need.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into any train:

- You're standing in total darkness when something made of wood and metal rattles beneath your feet, the gentle grinding of rocks and pebbles crunching with every step. Then thunder echoes through the darkness, and the ground trembles. An unending roar grows with every passing moment.

  The world explodes in light as a shrill scream pierces the clattering cacophony. The light reveals you stand in the middle of a set of train tracks, set in what appears to be a subterranean tunnel, as a train barrels toward you.
- The ground beneath your feet shakes, and you feel strangely unbalanced. A red light flashes, revealing the hint of cyclopean shapes in the dark. A moment passes before the light flares again, illuminating the dirty tiles beneath your feet. Once more, the red light strobes, and you glimpse massive pillars in front of a pit. A roar fills your ears, and the shaking heightens so violently that you nearly fall.

  Then all at once it stops. A loud hiss sounds, and a door before you opens, light spilling out to reveal not just the darkened train station upon which you stand but also the illuminated interior of a passenger car. At the edges of the light, figures start moving toward you, and a disgruntled voice calls out, "Alll Abooooard!" as the train doors start to creep shut.
- Between one blink and the next, a train appears in total silence. Doors slide open soundlessly, and a warm orange light illuminates a comfortable-looking interior filled with plush seats. There is no screaming whistle or rumbling engine. Even the tracks themselves are silent under this inviting but muted train as it seems to wait for you to enter.
- Train after train blasts past the station, none of them even slowing down as you wait for the chance to leave. Eventually, it seems no trains are stopping at this station, and a low growling is getting louder and louder with every passing moment. Seems like you aren't alone at this station. Fewer trains appear, and the growling only gets louder, though you can't see anyone else around you.
- An old, barely functioning steam locomotive pulls into the station, and the doors rattle open to train cars dripping with blood. On the station platform, something invisible breathes against your neck as the train car doors warn that they are closing.

BASIC TRAINING

ENVIRONMENT AND LAYOUT OF THE IRON TANGLE

The Iron Tangle is typically portrayed as a massive interconnected system of subterranean tunnels with various stations scattered along the train lines. These stations are connected by service tunnels, some obvious and others secret. However, the vast majority of the playable terrain is confined to the trains themselves.

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Examples of locomotives and train cars appear from all over the world, including passenger cars, sleeper cars, box cars, and subway cars. If it ever used tracks or rode the rails on or under the Earth, it may have been scooped up during the collection process and put to use down here.

Train employees board at the trainyard, located at Station 10 (aside from the Engineers, who are already aboard). They ride the rails until the end of their day, when they get off at Station 435 and take a portal back to Station 10. There, their memories are wiped, and they begin fresh. Station 436 is the End of the Line, also known as the Abyss, where trains hurtle into a giant hole for disposal. Then an exact copy starts its run at Station 10 the following day.

Full-Service Stations (also known as those with saferooms) are located at all prime-numbered stops. Desperado Clubs can be found at stops ending in 1, while Club Vanquishers are found at stations ending in 9. Stairwells are available on the colored lines at Stations 12, 24, 36, 48, and 72.

From the above, the track layout for the named tracks appears to be the Syndicate logo. From the side, the Tangle is laid out to resemble a rough map of the known galaxy with the Abyss at its center. This isn't going to be obvious to most crawlers, of course. It takes an understanding of both galactic history and cartography to properly navigate through the Tangle—unless they are lucky enough to receive this information from other sources.

TRACKING DIFFERENT TRAINS

Each train functions like its own miniature Neighborhood, with its own mysteries and challenges, but there are a few basic forms trains can take. Trains come in two varieties: colored lines and named trains. Every named train is incredibly unique and unlike any other.

ANATOMY OF A TRAIN

On all colored lines, a Mantaur serves as the engineer, operating from the very first car and typically only emerging in the event of a derailment. (Each engineer's key only works on trains for their specific color line!)

The Fifth, Tenth, and Fifteenth Cars of a train are employee cars (the break room, luggage, and janitorial cars, respectively). Mobs board at different stations depending on their type (in Weak to Overwhelming groups) and ride for precisely five stops. If one should ever miss their stop, they try to get off at the next one and act increasingly agitated until they can.

CHALLENGES OF THE TRAINS

The following sections are different general categories of challenges that can be presented to players on individual trains.

RAMBLING RUMBLERS

The most common kind of train moving through the Iron Tangle carries Mobs and Bosses. Crawlers riding a train might find Mobs boarding at any station as part of their routine.

If the Mobs notice the crawlers, they do everything they can to kill the crawlers or die trying. If they arrive at their stop before the battle concludes, many choose to depart the train, and some try to drag the crawlers with them, but no Iron Tangle Mob intentionally misses their stop unless they are physically prevented from disembarking.

Consider using these trains as either random encounters or as "time trials." After all, crawlers only have five stops before the Mobs disembark. These are excellent examples to change the format, filling a car with more enemies than crawlers could hope to survive, and forcing them to fight for the entirety of the ride. Clever crawlers might divide an Overwhelming group of Mobs into more manageable Moderate or even Weak groups, or they may be forced to fight the entire Overwhelming group until the doors open.

PUZZLE BOXCARS

Sometimes, a challenge doesn't come from a physical problem but a mental one. A train is an excellent chance to test the crawler party's mental ability. They are, after all, inherently stuck in a locked room with a time limit. Not every colored line or named train needs Mobs alone as challenges.

Perhaps a train or line was designed to trap unwary crawlers. After they board the train, the exits seal themselves, and an alarm sounds, warning crawlers that they have ten stops before derailment. Another option is that the crawlers boarded seeking a special treasure the train is said to be carrying, like an enchanted item or just a good old-fashioned large pile of gold. Or perhaps the goal is simply to derail the train.

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EMPLOYEE EXPRESS

Not every train is "meant" for the crawlers. Different employees move around the Iron Tangle at any given time. Crawlers are most likely to encounter Dwarven Conductors and Mantaur Engineers, but members of the Hobgoblin Crash Interdiction Team are also out and about, doing their jobs.

These trains are not a "train" in the typical sense. For instance, the Crash Interdiction Team uses carts equipped with mobile portal devices to clear the tracks of any derailed trains. Likewise, members of the Tangle's security forces may be deployed in smaller trains to put down "riots" (also known as any group of crawlers too large or efficient to get appropriate ratings).

ITEMS

A few items you might find on any train include:

- **Luggage:** In almost every train crawlers enter, whether or not there are Mobs or seats, you'll find luggage somewhere on the train. Luggage can contain anything from literal fire ants to useful gear to diapers large enough for a 12-foot-tall man to wear. Generally, that's about one unit of Misc. Junk per suitcase.
- **Poles and seats:** Most types of trains have these installed for people's comfort. They're in various states of disrepair, but almost always present. Careful, though, the poles are often sticky, and the seats almost always have strange stains. Discarded pole-dance DVD cases and how-to books litter the floor in some of the cars.
- **Blankets and clothing:** You hope these are just scattered debris from people's open luggage, but given the prevalence of bloodstains on the fabric, you likely know better.
- **Rotting food:** For some reason, these trains often have weeks-old food scattered about, slowly beginning to rot and smell. Some even contain full fungus gardens grown from the percolating garbage splooge.
- **Spare tools and Personal Items:** A screwdriver here, a ratchet there, a box-end wrench casually tossed aside, an empty wallet with a tattered family portrait. The engineers, conductors, and other repair crew members have a bad habit of losing these items.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood, each with its own reward.

- **Commuter:** "You've ridden more than ten trains in the last thirty hours! Congratulations! Your ability to move between trains is truly awe-inspiring. Even so, I'd clean those pants if I were you. Or just burn them.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Apparel Box."
  Contents: enchanted trousers, skirt, or other lower-appendage garments
- **Tuck and Roll:** "You left the train before it could come to a complete stop. Don't you have any idea how dangerous that is?
  Reward: You're still alive after jumping off a moving train! Doesn't the air smell sweeter now? That's your reward."
- **Chekov's Locomotive:** "You participated in one of the oldest and most common movie tropes in your planet's history: a train robbery.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Looter Box"
  Contents: Gun or a unit of Misc. Junk from gun parts
- **Certified Cartographical Genius:** "You managed to get to your intended destination using only the trains. WOAH! I didn't even know that was possible! That meant you read *and* understood the mapping system. Guess that means next time, I'll have to make things tougher...
  Reward: You've received a Platinum Adventurer's Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

If Crawlers decide to hop from train to train in search of experience, they may find themselves derailed by any of the complications in Table 87.

MOBS

Every train offers its own promise for a new adventure, with different challenges, traps, and monsters, but the ones below are some of the most likely to appear on trains.

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TABLE 87: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers slay the last monster on a train and wait for the next station... only it doesn't come. Minutes turn to hours. No matter how long they wait, it's clear this train is just crawling along, slow as can be. Crawlers lose 1d4 hours or 1d2 hours if they get out and walk.
2	A train sits upon the tracks. No steam rises from it, but it rumbles as if it's active. The door to the engine car sits wide open, a manual waiting by the controls. If the crawlers enter, they note how plush the carpeting feels and how each step is strangely more difficult than the last. Then comes the smell of rotten meat, and a thick droplet of drool pools from the ceiling, as the door slams shut, revealing the train is a massive mimic—and they're standing on its tongue. (GM: A battle might ensue, or the crawlers narrowly escape, cutting their grind 1d2 hours short).
3	The train upon which the crawlers find themselves grinds to a complete stop in the middle of the track. Ahead, multiple trains crashed into one another, leaving the tunnels completely blocked and antsy Mobs swarming. The Crawlers gain an extra 1d4 hours of grinding time from all the Mobs.
4	As crawlers move from one car to another, they find a large box in the center of the car. The metal and the five-foot area around the box are blackened. The longer they stare at it, the more they feel the hair on the back of their necks rise.
5	Two trains come to a slow stop at a junction. Neither of them wants to go until the other does. The Mantaur engineers yell increasingly bawdy and boisterous things at each other, and it may well escalate into a brawl.
6	The crawlers board a train just as the doors close. At first, it appears there are other crawlers aboard. There are dots, the people have names, Levels, Classes, and Races. However, they're completely unresponsive. All of them simply follow the crawler party with their eyes and smile pleasantly.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions on any train or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this floor:

- The sound of the infernal engines is quieter inside the train, but not completely silent. As the engine moves faster and faster, the sound grows, though not wholly within your ears. It's so loud outside that you swear you can practically feel it.
  Outcome: Another train is out of control and about to slam into the train the crawlers are in.
- The doors of the train stand open, waiting and alluring. In the distance comes the sound of footsteps. Many of them.
  Outcome: The crawlers could hop on the train, where another puzzle begins, or they could stand and fight against a horde of enemies.
- Stepping into a train car is fine until the first person steps foot into it and realizes the floor is a glue trap. Better find a way off before the Mobs or the end of the line get you.
  Outcome: Crawlers have to find a way to escape the sticky floor trap while dealing with Mobs and a ticking clock.
- What luck. This train car is filled with countless pieces of luggage, all up for grabs. Surely there can't be anything dangerous in these.
  Outcome: It's a Mimic den or a trap that springs new Mobs on the crawlers.

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MIMICS

These creatures are the ultimate ambush predators. They have the ability to become absolutely any inanimate object they've seen, limited only by their age and their size.

At birth, they're roughly the size of a small puppy. With every meal they claim (and they can swallow anything as large as themselves), they grow in mass. They keep their eye(s) closed until they feel prey touching them. Then, their prehensile tongue shoots out, attempting to paralyze whatever unfortunate being happens upon them, and then they gather it into their mouth for slow digestion. Every ten Levels, they gain half their mass. Some get... big. GMs: See p. 270 to make them stronger.

AI Mimic. Level 20.

This is just an ordinary chest. Go on, open it. It's probably filled with fantastic loot. Maybe some cigarettes and a nudie mag or three! I'm sure it's not gonna crack open, revealing dozens of incredibly sharp teeth and a tongue long and strong enough to snap an unsuspecting crawler's neck.

If it were a Mimic, it could use its acidic saliva to melt the face off any crawler stupid enough to come close. If it were a Mimic, it could use its tongue to snap your neck.

Fortunately for you, it's not a Mimic. Right?

Mimic

Mob; Medium (4), Aberration, Mimic

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	14+F	14+F	10+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	10 (+4)	20 (+5)	10 (+4)	5 (+2)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Tongue Lash: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *Stealthy*—Any Mimic that is not surprised attacks with Advantage during the first round of combat.

Twice Bitten—Mimics gain Advantage on their Bite attack against crawlers with the Held Debuff. If Mimics succeed on their Bite first attack against a crawler with the Held Debuff, they gain a second attack at Disadvantage.

DREK

On their own, these tiny demons are more of an inconvenience than an actual challenge. However, these things are absolutely *never* alone. They travel in Overwhelming packs. Their teeth and claws are razor sharp, and although they're not the hardiest of Mobs, their speed alone makes up for other shortcomings.

AI Drek. Level 6.

Think of these baby-looking demon creatures a little like piranhas—if piranhas had claws and legs and could move faster than a gazelle. And just like gazelles, these things only move in herds. The more, the better! They're weak on their own, and they know it. Thus, they make sure they're never on their own. If you feel one climbing up your leg, then chances are it's already too late!

Drek

Mob; Tiny (1), Demon

1	1	1	1	1	1
16%	33%	50%	66%	83%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
6	12+F	14+F	30+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
7 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)	11 (+4)	1 (+1)

Bite: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Claw: 13+F to hit, 2d4+3 Slashing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Sore as Shit Debuff.

Notes: *Suckle Blood*—As an action, a Drek may attempt to attach themselves to any crawler with the Blood Trail Debuff. The crawler must make a Str-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check. On Fail, the Drek attaches to the crawler and the Blood Trail Debuff damage increases by 1d4 each round. When attached, a Drek no longer attacks.

Swarming Behavior—Dreks travel in packs of 50 or more. When 10 or more attack the same crawler, the crawler has Disadvantage on all Evade Checks against all Drek.

Wall Walker—Dreks can move along vertical surfaces and upside down on ceilings as though on the ground.

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JIKININKI

These are the Janitor Mobs of this floor. They're tall, thin, emaciated humanoids with large mouths full of needle-sharp teeth that constantly chatter. They're not the smartest of creatures, but they're incredibly efficient at what they do. They have just enough intelligence to function as janitors in both the traditional Earth sense and as the kind typically found in the World Dungeon. They use a broom every bit as effectively as they devour a corpse.

AI **Jikininki. Level 17.**

The Jikininki are essential to the Iron Tangle. Without these ghouls, the entire place would be awash with blood and body parts, not to mention all the other kinds of garbage left behind. Whether it's pushing a broom or devouring a corpse (or a soon-to-be corpse), these ghouls make sure the Tangle stays neat and tidy. These things are so busy, in fact, that if you're not bleeding, attacking them, or otherwise making a nuisance of yourself, chances are they won't even notice you!

Jikininki

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
17	12+F	14+F	25+S	4

Str	Int	Con	Dex	Cha
25 (+5)	3 (+2)	12 (+4)	13 (+4)	3 (+2)

Broom Bash: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

Bite: 15+F to hit, 3d4+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Sweep: 15+F to hit, 3d4+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler is pushed 10ft.

Notes: *Blood Sense*—Jikininki gain Advantage on Perception Checks to detect any crawler with the Blood Trail Debuff.

Janitor Mob—This Mob is responsible for cleaning messes on Floor 4 and prioritizes cleaning up corpses. It attacks crawlers when provoked, or when crawlers have the Blood Trail Debuff.

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FLESHERS

Casting the Spell *You Are Not Done Yet* upon a corpse creates these creatures. Upon completion, the skin of the creature rips itself free and flies through the air, seeking a victim to wrap itself around.

When they've successfully "re-sleeved" a victim, they melt the flesh from a creature's bones and cast the *Boned* Spell, fusing themselves to the victim and creating a Symbiote. This creature is especially attractive to other Symbiotes. Each time a Symbiote is re-sleeved by a new Flesher, it becomes smarter and more powerful, until it becomes a different kind of creature altogether.

AI Flesher. Level 10.

No, your eyes aren't deceiving you. That is, in fact, the bloody skin of another creature flying through the air. If it's not coming for you, you should say a prayer for its intended target. It won't help, but it'll make you feel better. If it's coming straight for you, though, you should run—if you value your own skin, that is.

Flesher

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	13+F	14+F	25+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	7 (+3)	6 (+3)	11 (+4)	1 (+1)

Boned Spell: 13+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
This ability can only be used on Skeletons. Any hit skeleton becomes animated and under the control of the Flesher.

Smother: 14+F to hit, 2d4+4 Acid, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Burned and Held Debuffs.

Notes: *Fire Immunity*—Fleshers take no damage from Fire.

Re-Sleeving—When a Flesher attacks and consumes a Symbiote, it becomes a more intelligent and powerful Symbiote.

Symbiote Formation—When a Flesher successfully animates a skeleton, the two combined entities become a Symbiote.

War Mage—If a Symbiote is Re-Sleeved at least a dozen time, it becomes sapient and fuses into a single powerful being known as a War Mage.

NPCS

Most NPCs on this floor are "employees" of some nebulous company that ostensibly owns and operates the Iron Tangle. They all serve different functions and perform different roles, so talking to them helps crawlers unravel the mysteries of the Tangle.

LESSER DEMONS

Lesser Demons are precisely what their names suggest: They're native residents of one of the planes of Sheol, and they don't rank particularly high on the scale for one of their kind. Completely immune to fire, they're often incomprehensibly beautiful by mortal standards, and so powerful that most low-Level crawlers simply don't register as threats to them. They're incredibly clever, knowledgeable, and, as long as you're polite, potentially helpful, too.

AI Lesser Demon. Level 75.

On their native plane of Sheol, these things rank among the least powerful of their kind. Compared to you, however? They may as well be gods! These creatures are incredibly difficult to hurt and usually heal from any wound within moments. They're also immune to fire and have enough power to run a train for eternity on what naturally flows from their bodies.

The high Level should let you know not to tangle with a Lesser Demon. They're practically City Bosses in terms of strength.

GREASE GREMLINS

These small goblinoids are dexterous, industrious, and clever. They're adept with machines (both breaking and repairing) and have a slight tendency toward violence. However, their physicality makes them incredibly good technicians when properly motivated.

AI Grease Gremlins. Level 18.

This tiny creature has eyes three sizes too big for his head and a stare that could curdle milk. Fortunately for you, he seems more interested in repairing whatever gadget is in front of him at the moment. Be careful not to harm the contraptions in his charge, or you might find out how adept he is at disassembling organic material too.

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Grease Gremilin

NPC; Small (2), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
18	14+F	15+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	11 (+4)	13 (+4)	22 (+5)	3 (+2)

Fast Disassemble: 14+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
Any hit crawler has one carried or worn mechanical device (usually a weapon or piece of armor) disassembled and made unusable until the crawler spends two actions to reassemble it.

Multi-Weapon: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, Piercing, or Slashing (their choice), 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Minor Injury Debuff.

Notes: *Fast Assembly*—A Grease Gremlin can repair a mechanical device in one third the normal time.

Irritable Worker—A Grease Gremlin ignores crawlers while the Grease Gremlin is repairing items. When a crawler disrupts their repair work, a Grease Gremlin gains Advantage on their first attack against that crawler.

SHADE GNOLL

Shade Gnolls are found across the galaxy, often working as part of a larger security force. They're usually employed as shock troops by large corporations needing the perfect balance of competence, violence, and expendability.

AI Shade Gnoll. Level 27.

These bipedal hyenas are just slightly smaller than the average Human. Most often, they wear black uniforms and wield collapsible truncheons and riot shields, in part because those things make them effective at their jobs but also because dammit, they just look cool.

Not every Shade Gnoll is a member of the security force, but every member of the species is prepared to join them at a moment's notice. Don't feel too bad for them, however; they'll happily crack any skulls as long as they get paid.

Shade Gnoll

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
27	14+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
22 (+5)	13 (+4)	22 (+5)	25 (+5)	4 (+2)

Expandable Baton: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Pulse Rifle: 15+F to hit, 2d8 Fire, 80ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Pressure Point: 15+F to hit, 2d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Paralyzed or Take Down Debuff (Shade Gnoll's choice).

Notes: *Pack Hunters*—When two or more Shade Gnolls are adjacent to a target, they gain Advantage on their attacks.

Riot Shields—Two or more Shade Gnolls equipped with a Riot Shield can each spend their Move to form a movable wall. Each Shade Gnoll in the wall gains Advantage to Area of Effect and Evade Checks while part of the wall but also gain Disadvantage on all their attacks.

HOBGOBLIN INTERDICTORS

The Hobgoblins of the tangle are both rare and highly trained, and most are employed as members of the Crash Interdiction Teams. They know the secrets to creating, maintaining, and repairing the various portal devices used in the Iron Tangle... but man, they're *really* hard to look at.

AI Hobgoblin. Crash Team Interdictor Level 20.

Hobgoblins rank among the most creative Races in the galaxy, especially when it comes to high-tech equipment and explosives. Unfortunately, they're also among the ugliest. Don't point that out to them, however, or you may quickly get a demonstration in their particular area of expertise.

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Hobgoblin Interdictor

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	15+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
12 (+4)	23 (+5)	12 (+4)	15 (+4)	3 (+2)

Spanner: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Improvised Explosive: 14+F to hit, 2d8 Fire, 20ft range, 10ft Blast radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Notes: *Creative*—Hobgoblins gain Advantage on all Explosives and Repair related Checks.

DWARF EMPLOYEE

Dwarves are most often employed as conductors upon the trains of the Iron Tangle. A Dwarf's natural stamina and gruff exterior equip them to handle both long hours and potentially aggressive passengers. The fact that the Iron Tangle has no *true* passengers is an unfortunate reality some of them are aware of, though it's still impolite to point it out.

AI **Dwarf. Iron Tangle Employee. Level 32.**

Dwarves are renowned for their sturdiness, surliness, fighting spirit, mechanical abilities, and sense of justice throughout the galaxy. Unfortunately, they're also known for their absolute detestation of uselessness and sloth, which makes it incredibly sad and ironic that most of these poor fellows have been cast in a useless and wasteful job on this particular floor.

Dwarf Employee

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
32	15+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
12 (+4)	21 (+5)	51 (+6)	11 (+4)	6 (+3)

Clipboard: 14+F to hit, 5d4+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Enraged Debuff.

Conducting: 15+F to hit, No damage, 10ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Compliant Debuff: The crawler must make a Cha Stat Check. On Fail, the crawler must obey the Dwarf Conductor's next command.

Unarmed Attack: 14+F to hit, 5d4+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

Notes: *Pre-Production Stupor*—When a Dwarf Conductor completes their line, they blink out and reset at the depot or station. They are dazed and highly suggestible until their next shift begins. Crawlers have Advantage on Skill Checks and attacks against them during this time.

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GRAPPLE

Quarter-giants with a penchant for diligence matched only by their distressing lack of discernment. These creatures can stand as tall as ten feet and have a slow, halting manner of speech. While they're very agreeable, they're also incredibly strict about the rules, making them perfect for their role as the Iron Tangle's porters.

AI **Grapple. Level 25.**

The Grapples were originally created by High Elves who tried to breed the perfect slave race. Hill Giants were paired with an offshoot of the Ogrid Race before being selectively bred with Humans. The resulting Race has an iron-hard sense of purpose.

However, this can be a double-edged sword, as without any input from a "superior," these creatures begin to wonder why things are the way they are. A Grapple that questions why they take their orders from creatures half their size has the potential to be a giant problem.

Grapple

NPC; Large (5), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
25	13+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
50 (+6)	6 (+3)	11 (+4)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)

Grab: 16+F to hit, 3d8+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *Highly Suggestible*—Grapples have Disadvantage against all attempts to charm, deceive, or persuade them.

Squirrelly—Grapples left without direction for 8 hours or more become restless and start behaving erratically. This may include running around in circles, rearranging furniture, and closely following crawlers and mimicking their actions.

POTENTIAL BOSS BATTLES

Bosses on the Iron Tangle can happen almost anywhere. While the stations harbor occasional Bosses of their own, the vast majority of Bosses on this floor ride the trains, with each line tending to host at least one or two Bosses. Here are a few types of Bosses the crawlers might encounter.

STATION MIMIC

It's not just a mimic, but a really big one...

CLUES

- The station only seems to attack when multiple victims enter.
- It's possible to wedge its mouth open with enough force (works for X rounds).
- If a larger group of victims (food) comes by, the mimic goes for them. It then attacks crawlers with Disadvantage, but you've sacrificed innocents, you bastards.
- There's really no need to defeat this Boss to get to the stairs. Getting there may be a problem still, but a different one than killing the Boss.

AI **Station Mimic.**

Level 80 City Boss!

These mammoth monsters have quite a lot in common with their smaller, younger cousins. However, by the time they've reached this Level, they're roughly the size of a city block, with a mouth as large as the average train, and teeth bigger than the average person. While they're essentially shapeless blobs in their normal form, they prefer to take the form of a common train station structure to lure victims in—although occasionally, if hungry enough, some of them have been known to take the form of a train to more actively hunt their victims. There are six of these creatures scattered through the Iron Tangle.

These are not simply mindless beasts. They don't speak in a way most people can hear them, but they find plenty of other ways to voice their displeasure. They're also smart enough not to attack the first moment a crawler steps inside their mouths. Many times, they'll wait until a crawler or a group of crawlers ventures so far into their mouths that they have no hope of leaving once again.

At this size, they form up to eight prehensile tongues at once. Using them as weapons, manipulators, and, of course, tongues. Some say these mimics represent an ancient enemy of the Syndicate, but they're clearly reading too many (entirely accurate) conspiracy theories.

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Station Mimic

City Boss; Gargantuan (8), Aberration, Mimic

9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
4%	8%	12%	16%	21%	25%	29%	33%	37%	42%	46%	50%
9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
54%	58%	63%	67%	71%	76%	80%	84%	88%	92%	96%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
80	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
155 (+8)	23 (+5)	201 (+9)	22 (+5)	24 (+5)

Neck Snap: 18+F to hit, 7d10+8 Bludgeoning, 50ft range

Acid Spit: 15+F to hit, 6d8 Acid, 50ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Bite: 18+F to hit, 5d8+8 Piercing, 30ft range, Armor-Piercing
Any hit crawler gains the Swallowed Debuff: The crawler is swallowed whole. When an attack against the Mimic results in an Amazing Success or better (or it dies), all crawlers remove the Swallowed Debuff. Swallowed crawlers take 1d8+F Acid at the end of each round. Swallowed crawlers attack with Disadvantage vs. 0 DR, and Slashing attacks deal ×2 damage.

Shaken and Stirred: 18+F to hit, 6d8+8 Bludgeoning, 100ft Burst radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down and Terrified Debuffs. Only uses this every other round.

Notes: *Down and Out*—Station Mimics double their Str mod for any damage done against a crawler that has the Take Down Debuff.

Mimic Regeneration—When the Station Mimic takes 2+ HB in damage, a piece of the Station Mimic is sliced off. This piece grows legs and crawls back to the main body and reattaches on the Station Mimic's next turn. When it reattaches to the main body, the Mimic regains Health Bar slots equal to half of what was lost when the piece was sliced off. If returning piece receives 1 HB or more of damage, it is destroyed.

Minions—Once per round as an action, the Station Mimic can produce 3d8 car-sized slobbering mouths each on centipede-like legs (use the *Level 20 Mimic*, p. 432).

She's a Brick House—Station Mimics have Resistance to Bludgeoning damage.

Sliced and Diced—Station Mimics have Disadvantage against Slashing attacks and take ×2 damage from them.

Stealthy—Any Station Mimic that is not surprised attacks with Advantage during the first round of combat.

WAR MAGE

Spellcasters with complex origins, War Mages will probably kill a party in more ways than one.

CLUES

- Shots to the face cause an cancel an use of a Spell on an Amazing Success.
- Taunting causes a War Mage to focus on a single crawler.
- Speaking in its ancient language, with magic-like incantations (a Performance or similar Skill Check at a Difficulty of 20), completely cancels one Spell, once per round.

AI **War Mage. Level 37.**

Neighborhood Boss!

Magic can be a wonderful thing. It has the power to heal and restore, to summon elements and influences, to destroy and obliterate. Magic offers the power to change reality (or at least the enhanced reality in which you find yourselves).

It's also got the power to rip your skin off your bones and fling it at someone, turning them into a mindless engine of pain and destruction. A War Mage is what happens when multiple Fleshers re-sleeve a single victim over and over again (usually between 12 and 16 times, depending on the magical strength of the victims). Their inherent magic combines and becomes sentient.

War Mages, contrary to their names, are in fact an entire Race rather than an occupation or a Class. Their origins begin in a dungeon long before the destruction of Earth. They're some of the most impressive and frightening wielders of magic in dungeon history. Each has access to hundreds of different Spells, assembled over multiple dungeon iterations. They're the masters of the You Are Not Done Yet Spell, meaning they're potentially also the masters of the flesh of any opponent they defeat.

War Mages come in many different shapes and sizes, depending on the initial form of the Flesher and the victim. However, each one wields lifetimes of magical knowledge, hundreds of Spells, and innate apathy toward the lives of others, especially crawlers. They see others as resources for harvest, either for their flesh, their bones, or their sweet cries of pain and fear.

One War Mage rides every named train on the floor, and each encounter with one promises a quick but incredibly challenging Quest.

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War Mage

Neighborhood Boss; Medium (4), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3
7%	14%	21%	28%	35%	42%	50%
3	3	3	3	3	3	3
57%	64%	71%	78%	85%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
37	17+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
6 (+3)	101 (+7)	6 (+3)	12 (+4)	11 (+4)

Elemental Attack Spell: 17+F to hit, 5d6+7 damage (type depends on Spell Specialization, see below) 100ft range, 10ft Blast radius

Cloud Attack Spell 17+F to hit, 4d8+7 damage (type depends on Spell Specialization, see below), 100ft range, 20ft Blast radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Pull Spell: 17+F to hit, 4d8+7 Bludgeoning, 100ft range
Any hit crawler is pulled up to 30ft in the direction of the War Mage's choosing.

Skin Peel: 17+F to hit, 4d8+7 Slashing, 60ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Notes: *Sapient Moment of Destruction*—Ten minutes after death, a War Mage's head will explode dealing 5d12 +7 Force damage, 100ft Burst radius. A crawler can temporarily delay this by putting the head in their inventory, which pauses the 10-minute timer.

Spell Specialization—War Mages have a specialty area (such as Fire Spells, Force Spells, or Healing Spells) and can cast any Spells in that area of specialization at Rank 15.

What a Know-It-All—War Mages have access to hundreds of different Spells and can spend their move to recall one and then use it. War Mages can cast virtually any Spell at Rank 10.

You're Not Done Yet Spell—When cast on a fallen crawler or Mob, it rips the flesh from their body and creates a Flesher (see p. 434).

MANTAUR

Most lines have a Mantaur engineer, but they're also found elsewhere in the dungeon.

CLUES

- Using magic causes them to rage but also focuses their ire on the crawlers who used said magic.
- As their feet are actually hands, they are more sensitive to hot, cold, and other pain.
- Anyone playing righteous heavy metal distracts a Mantaur for a round, causing them to lose one attack as they headbang.

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Mantaur.

Level 40 Neighborhood Boss!

Half-man, and half... also man. These giant six-limbed creatures have the strength, testosterone, and idiocy of at least two men. Their lower half appears to be the body of a man, but instead of a neck, these creatures have the upper half of a man sprouting from it, complete with arms, a torso, and a head. Every muscle in their ridiculously shaped bodies bulges with insane strength.

Were these creatures ever to stand upright, they'd tower between nine and twelve feet tall. However, they typically lean forward and run on their hind legs and on their lower arms. Whenever they speak, they always do so at their maximum volume.

The Mantaurs are the engineers of all but the named trains on the Iron Tangle. They take their jobs very seriously and refuse to leave their trains while they're still functional. Their sense of honor simply won't let them abandon their post. This same sense of honor also won't let them use magic and makes them uncomfortable near its use. If any kind of magic is directed at them, they become enraged, moving twice as fast and hitting twice as hard.

In combat, they alternate between using their lower set of arms to move about much more quickly and using them for additional grappling. One of their favorite maneuvers is to grab an opponent with their lower arms and then slice them apart with the sturdy metal claws that emerge from between the knuckles on each upper arm.

Mantaur

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Mantaur

5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	14%	21%	28%	35%	42%	50%
5	5	5	5	5	5	5
57%	64%	71%	78%	85%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	13+F	15+F	30+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
53 (+6)	13 (+3)	51 (+5)	22 (+5)	6 (+3)

Claws: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Slashing, 10ft range

Grab: 16+F to hit, 4d8+6 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Headbutt: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Woozy Debuff.

Tripple Stomp: 16+F to hit, 5d10+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Sore as Shit Debuff.

Notes: *Four Armed is Four Warned*—Mantaur can spend their Move to use one set of arms to hold a crawler. The crawler must make a Str-Opposed Escape Artist Skill Check. On Fail, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Group Berserking—When exposed to Megadeth and other music similar in style and genre, Mantuars gain the Berserk Buff: They gain an additional attack each round, but all their attacks are at Disadvantage. In addition, attacks against Mantuars gain Advantage while they are Berserk.

Magic Resistance—Mantuars are immune to Spells below Rank 5, and also specifically immune to Magic Missile below Rank 11.

KRAKAREN CLONE

Not constrained to the Second Floor, copies of the Krakaren seem to play a vital role in the Iron Tangle.

CLUES

- Krakarens are very dumb. Any ploy involving their drug distribution network causes them to rage. They focus on the crawler who started shouting about the DEA or some such.
- Your worst trauma sickens the Krakaren. If she gets inside your head, and you summon up some really horrible imagery from your past, she must roll with Disadvantage on her next attack.

Krakaren Clone.

Level 65 Burrough Boss!

Holy shit... look at the size of that thing! I don't want to alarm you, but this is big even for an ugly intergalactic brainwashing space squid. The Krakaren is the head of an international drug-peddling ring. As big as this one might be, it's NOTHING compared to other examples.

Still, it's big enough that it definitely causes you problems. More so if you let it get inside your head with its disgusting mind-control power. Oh, sure, it may start off nice and sweet, offering some of its "extra-special vitamins," but don't be fooled: Anyone who lets the Krakaren get too close to their brain is in for a fast drop down a short slide. Just look at what happens to the other Mobs when they miss out on their fix...

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Krakaren Clone

Borough Boss; Huge (6), Aberration

8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8
5%	10%	15%	21%	26%	31%	36%	42%	47%	52%
8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	
57%	63%	68%	73%	78%	84%	89%	94%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
65	13+F	16+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
59 (+6)	8 (+3)	157 (+8)	55 (+6)	6 (+3)

Constrict: None, 5d10+6 Bludgeoning, Auto-hits Held foe

Mega Munch: 16+F to hit, 6d10+6 Piercing, 10ft range

Acidic Tentacles: 16+F to hit, 6d8+6 Acid, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Pyramid Pitch: 13+F to hit, 3d6+3 Psychic, 60ft range
Any hit crawler must make a free Cha Stat Check. On Fail, must spend their next Action attacking an ally.

Spit Spray: 16+F to hit, 4d10+3 Poison, 50ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Unnerving Screams: 16+F to hit, 4d8+3 Sonic, 60ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Queasy Debuff.

Notes: *Bad Hair Day*—Krakarens believe they have a flattering hairstyle, and if it gets messed up, they are frantic. Any attack that results in an Amazing Success or better causes all Held Debuffs to cease.

Fire Weakness—Krakaren Clones take ×2 damage from Fire based attacks.

Lightning Immunity—Krakaren Clones have Immunity to Electric damage.

Psychic Resistance—Krakaren Clones take no damage from Psychic based attacks, but do gain the Stunned Debuff when they are hit by Psychic damage.

Soft Goey Center—Krakaren Clones take ×2 damage from Piercing attacks that hit their main body.

Tough Enough—Krakaren Clones have ×2 their DR against attacks that do Ice or Force damage.

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POOKA

These fuzzy creatures seem to be financially tied up with the Krakaren somehow.

CLUES

- While transforming, Pookas gain a −2 to Evade.
- Loud music disrupts their ability to lull enemies into a slumber. Pump up the volume!
- If a Pooka wants something and the party refuses to give it, or better yet, teases them about it, they get very angry. They gain −2 to attacks while flailing in their tantrums.

AI **Pooka.**

Level 35 Neighborhood Boss!

Don't let its cute, fuzzy face fool you. This adorable little goblin-thing is only the public face of a much more insidious enemy. The moment you're alone with it or the second you don't give it what it wants, that's when you'll find out what it really is.

This shapeshifting creature becomes a very large, very angry, goat-creature the moment it's not being mollified. Don't try talking to it at that point; it's entirely too late, and you'll find out very quickly how truly cruel this manipulative creature is. It sings its sweet song and broadcasts it to all the electronic devices in the room, trying to lull its enemies into a gentle slumber. Then it'll pounce and use its special Mind Devour power to drain all the thoughts from your head.

It's unknown what happens to the bodies of those crawlers whose minds it rots away. However, it's suggested that these get fed to its Boss, the Krakaren Clone. Or, some of them may just become ghouls set loose to turn others to the Pooka's cause.

Pooka

Neighborhood Boss; Small (2) to Huge (6), Shapeshifter

6	6	6	6	6	6	6
7%	14%	21%	28%	35%	42%	50%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6
57%	64%	71%	78%	85%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	15+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)

Mind Devour: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Psychic, 30ft range

Head Butt: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Woozy Debuff. This attack can only be used in goat form.

Sweet Song: 15+F to hit, No damage, 40ft Burst radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Unconscious Debuff: They are prone and cannot take actions. If they take damage, they wake up.

Vitamin Shot: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Transformational*—When attacked, a Pooka transforms into a huge goat.

Your Friendly Neighborhood Drug Dealer—If Pooka is outnumbered, they can call upon Mobs that are their clients to help deal with the crawlers. Use some of the other Mobs in this section as example clients.

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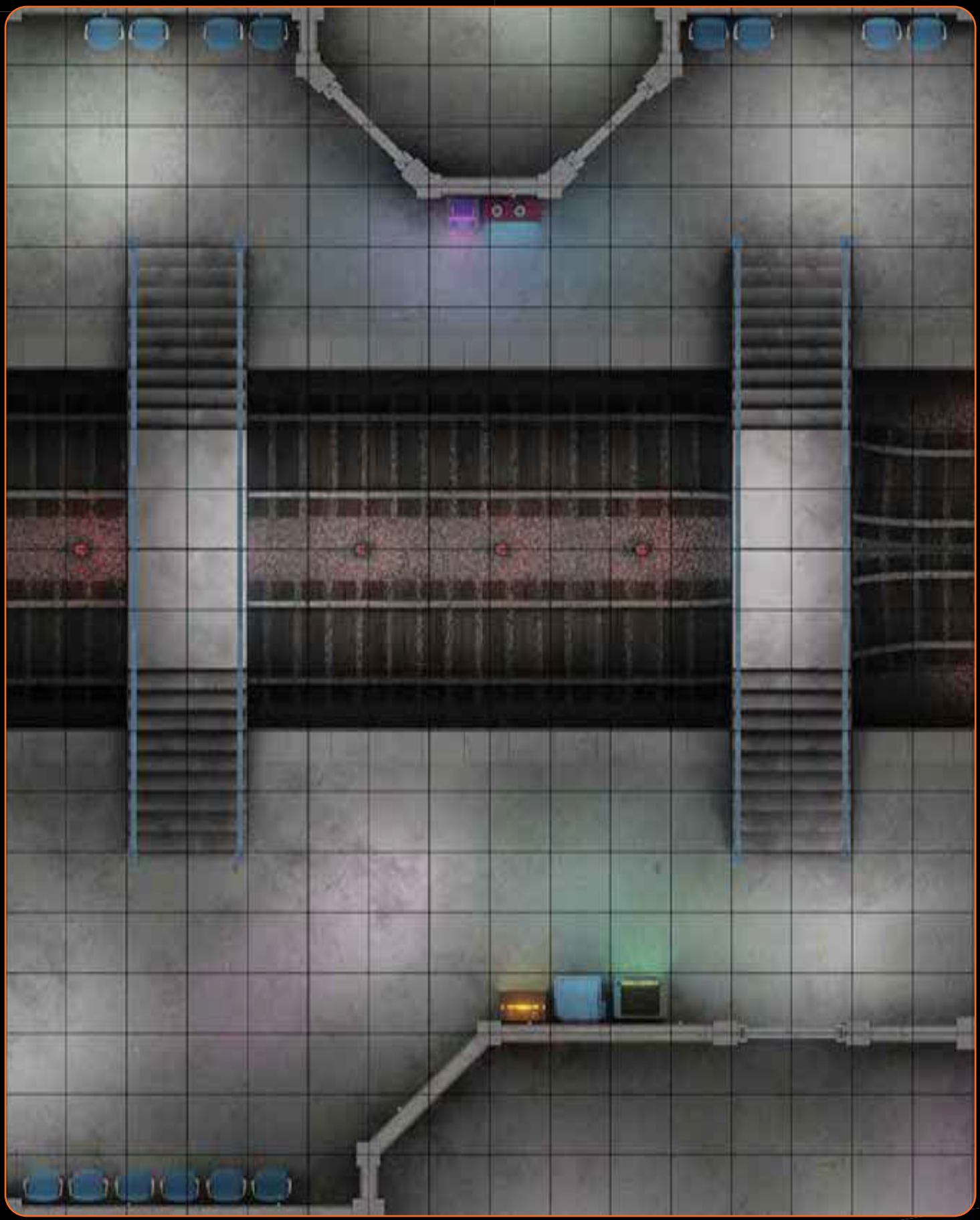

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NEIGHBORHOOD: CHARTREUSE LINE

FLOOR: 4 — THEME: THE UNFINISHED RAIL LINE

Despite the best efforts of the Borant Corporation and the Fourth Floor's Interdiction Rapid Response teams, there's only so much crawler-inflicted damage they can patch before something slips through the cracks. The Chartreuse Line is one of those cracks. It wasn't finished when the Crawl opened, nor was it on any official maps. In fact, it wasn't supposed to exist at all.

But Borant wasn't exactly the most organized or prepared when it came to assembling these floors, so when the Crawl kicked off, this entire line and the attached stations were included simply because someone at the corporate offices forgot to turn them off. The Mobs, NPCs, and other entities designed to operate the Chartreuse Line decided its condition was unacceptable and set about to "stick it to the man" by finishing what Borant started.

Repair Dwarves from Repair Local 1469-102-something or other joined the cause and set to work on finishing the underground railroad. They've been digging new tunnels, building new tracks, and riding the rails. They're digging so ferociously, they could collapse multiple tunnels. They've also stumbled on a temple to Ysalte, the Vinegar Bitch. Crawlers might become entangled in either.

With heavy machinery, a mad foreman, and determined Mobs, the Chartreuse Line is an unauthorized underground subway system that nobody officially acknowledges, everybody unofficially fears, and the System AI absolutely considers a feature.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- Deep voices echo through the tunnels, carrying with them an almost hypnotic tune accompanied by the steady rhythm of metal striking metal. A dwarven repair work crew lays rails in a freshly hewn tunnel. A steam-operated dwarven drilling rig sits idle at the tunnel's end, and a small cache of explosives is gathered nearby. Then the crawlers see a shadow move beyond the Dwarves... then another... then another... If they don't leave quickly, an Overwhelming group of Blister Ghouls attacks.
- A subway train and a pair of bunk cars sit idle at a freshly completed underground station platform. Several Mobs gamble with bone dice on the platform, standing watch over workers sleeping within the cars. One of the Mobs notices the crawlers approaching and holds out its hand, offering a chance to join the game.
- A single Dwarf strides down the tunnel ahead, foam encrusting her beard. She carries a half-full stein in one hand, and a worn, heavy-looking pickax over her other shoulder that looks like it's seen some shit. She may be lost, she may be scouting, or maybe she's just a Dwarf who's earned this. When her eyes make contact with the crawlers', she cracks a smile through her beard.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you'll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures!

- A cave-in at an abandoned construction tunnel reveals a hidden passage leading to a forgotten temple of Ysalte, the Vinegar Bitch. From the moment the passage opens, her influence begins to spread through the rail line. The Dwarves grow disorganized, irritable, and increasingly hostile toward strangers. Those under Ysalte's sway bear a faint purple glow in their eyes that crawlers may notice.

  Eventually the Switchmaster General orders his Fore-Dwarves to attack crawlers on sight. If the Switchmaster General is defeated, the unstable tunnel collapses, sealing the passage and cutting off Ysalte's influence, for now.
- The repair Dwarves run their own line, not governed by the plans of the Borant Corporation who abandoned it, and with no consideration for existing line work. With typical dwarven enthusiasm, they've used a tunneling rig to punch straight through into a neighboring line and are determined to keep digging their way forward.

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If left unchecked, their improvised expansion could cause catastrophic problems for the lines they've broken into. On the other hand, if the crawlers choose to help them, the Dwarves may grant access to the Chartreuse Substation, creating valuable shortcuts between lines and Neighborhoods across the floor.

MOBS

As forgotten elements of a line that wasn't supposed to exist, the Mobs of the Chartreuse Line exist outside of the normal Floor plans and plot lines and are not subject to the same addictions and the resulting behaviors. They do not suffer from the DTs (see p. 40) like other Mobs on the floor.

BLISTER GHOUL

Spawned from Soul Crystal-powered Mob generators, these creatures mostly look like Human heads with rotting green skin. While some can be found with torsos still attached, most fell victim to the latest weight-loss trends, and their torsos have been removed entirely.

AI **Blister Ghoul. Level 20.**

Blister Ghouls are just so damn tenacious. This undead creature is created and unleashed into the dungeon using a device called a Ghoul Generator. There are multiple types of Ghouls and generators out there, but the bad boy that spits these suckers out is top-of-the-line.

For every non-undead Mob that dies within this floor, one of the Soul Crystal-powered Ghoul Generators births a single Blister Ghoul. It's rather unfortunate, then, that every Mob on the floor suffers from something that will eventually kill them.

Blister Ghoul

Mob; Small (2), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	12+F	15+F	15+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
15 (+4)	5 (+2)	15 (+4)	25 (+5)	5 (+2)

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Bite: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Tenacious Swarming*—Blister Ghouls can completely cover a vehicle or crawler, overwhelming them. When 5 or more Blister Ghouls are adjacent to a crawler, the crawler has Disadvantage to their Evade attempts.

JIKININKI JANITOR GHOUL

The Jikininki Ghouls are the Janitor Mob of the Fourth Floor, voraciously consuming corpses of crawlers and Mobs alike. Pale-skinned and emaciated with long limbs, sharp teeth, and hollow eyes, these Ghouls wander the stations and lines of the Iron Tangle in tattered conductors' uniforms. They're the most insatiable of all ghouls but also the most well-mannered and easy to reason with.

AI **Jikininki Janitor Ghoul. Level 17.**

These guys look nasty, but their bite isn't usually as bad as their bark. As long as you're not bleeding, littering, or getting in their way, Jikininki Janitor Ghouls leave you alone. But make a mess of a station, and they won't leave enough of you behind for your mom to identify you.

Jikininki

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
17	12+F	14+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	3 (+2)	12 (+4)	13 (+4)	3 (+2)

Broom Bash: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

Bite: 15+F to hit, 3d4+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Sweep: 15+F to hit, 3d4+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler is pushed 10ft.

Notes: *Blood Sense*—Jikininki gain Advantage on Perception Checks to detect any crawler with the Blood Trail Debuff.

Janitor Mob—This Mob is responsible for cleaning messes on Floor 4 and prioritizes cleaning up corpses. It attacks crawlers when provoked, or when crawlers have the Blood Trail Debuff.

SKEGGA UNION REPAIR DWARF

The most common Mobs on the line are physical manifestations of a typical fantasy stereotype: Dwarves. All have fiery red or coal-black hair. All have beards, regardless of gender. And all of them inexplicably speak with a Scottish accent.

Because they weren't a part of the original plan for the floor, their very existence throws the ecological balance out of whack. They don't suffer from the DTs, nor do they suffer addiction to the Rev-Up Amazing Cure-All Vitamin Immunity Shot. In general, they can drink anyone under the table. Anywhere. Anytime. Just challenge them, and it's game on.

Strangely, while they aren't fully aware of the reality of their situation, they do harbor an intense grudge against their unseen "Company Overlords" who abandoned them to fend for themselves and complete the job without time off or paid overtime.

AI **Skegga Union Repair Dwarf. Level 18.**

These rough-and-tumble creatures are nothing if not industrious... and obsessively alcoholic. How they manage to be both at the same time is one of the great mysteries of the universe. The mead they make can knock a Mantaur on their ass.

Note: Their beards are a great source of pride. Touching it without permission is tantamount to salacious assault!

Skegga Union Repair Dwarf

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
18	13+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
18 (+4)	9 (+3)	17 (+4)	10 (+4)	5 (+2)

Flame Thrower: 14+F to hit, 2d10 Fire, 20ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Wrench: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Bludgeoning. 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Obsessively Alcoholic*—After they have completed their work for the day, Skegga Union Repair Dwarves gain the Shit-Faced Debuff.

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SKEGGA REPAIR FOREDWARF

These stout and surly Dwarves have been working for as long as they can remember. They dug tunnels, forged rails, built substations, pummeled unsuspecting co-workers, and blown the ever-loving shit out of countless innocent rocks. Their reward for their experience and devotion to their work?

They're supervisors. That's right, their reward for centuries of skilled work is the privilege of watching others take their work and do it poorly. Some of them are thrilled at the prospect, while others are less than happy about their current circumstances. All of the Fore-Dwarves share one thing in common. Since they can no longer vent their frustrations by pummeling rocks into submission, they'll try the next best thing: crawlers!

AI **Skegga Repair Dwarf Foredwarf. Level 22.**

After years of service and experience, these once hardworking Dwarves were forced to step aside and let younger, less capable members of their team take their place. Now they stand around covered in dirt, a cigar hanging from their mouth, yelling things like "back in my day..." and "What the hell are you doing?" Really, though, these tough mothers lead teams of repair Dwarves and have truly earned their positions. Best not to piss them off.

Skegga Repair Dwarf Foredwarf

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
22	14+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	10 (+4)	23 (+5)	11 (+4)	6 (+3)

Inspiring Prod: 15+F to hit, 2d8+5 Electric, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Shocked Debuff.

Notes: *Motivational Tool*—Skegga Repair Dwarf Foredwarves are tasked with motivating their teams. Once per day they can encourage the dwarves within a 30ft Burst radius, granting them a +1 Buff to their Str and Con Mods for the next 8 hours.

ENVIRONMENT

The Chartreuse Line is an unfinished subway system buried beneath the established rail lines of the Fourth Floor. The showrunners' original intent was clear enough: a proper underground transit network, complete with tiled platforms, turnstiles, and a central substation below the Iron Tangle's existing infrastructure.

Then Borant decided the whole thing was too expensive and too weird, scrapped the project mid-construction, and forgot to mention any of this to the Dwarves they'd left down here. When the Crawl kicked off, Borant accidentally left the Chartreuse Line active so... it is what it is.

The Neighborhood has two distinct terrain types: areas the repair Dwarves already finished, and areas they still actively build. Construction zones are typically raw, freshly bored tunnels large enough for a subway car to pass through with room to spare. Track may or may not be installed depending on how far along the work is.

The Dwarves mark dangerous areas with A-frame signboards, the underground equivalent of pre-Crawl roadwork signs, though this doesn't stop anything from happening in them. These sections are plagued by unstable ceilings, unexpected cave-ins, and Blister Ghouls who treat unfinished tunnels like a complimentary buffet.

The finished portions are exquisite examples of dwarven architecture drawn straight from Earth's mythology, books, and video games, which is to say, it's exactly what you'd expect the System AI to conjure up when tasked with building a subway system staffed entirely by Dwarves.

Sharp angular carvings decorate the stonework in intricately woven patterns. Stone and metal dominate, in keeping with what "real" Dwarves would use. But the builders were never precious about materials, and it's not unusual to find a salvaged subway turnstile wedged into a carved stone archway or a sheet metal patch welded over a section of wall that wasn't quite cooperating.

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TRAPS

The repair Dwarves have been known to set traps in their construction areas from time to time. This is both to keep out unwanted intruders and to get rid of the pests that frequently wander into unfinished areas. These traps are rarely found in the finished areas. "Naturally" occurring cave-ins are another known danger in the areas that haven't yet been properly shored up and supported.

- **Cave-in:** Many construction areas down the line aren't fully shored up yet. As such, they're prone to cave-ins, especially when an adjacent train line runs nearby. These cave-ins are usually composed of rock and soil but may also include random relics of underground infrastructure from before the Crawl.
- **Alarm Trap:** These traps alert any nearby Dwarves that an intruder wandered into one of their construction areas. Though they say the traps are set as much for the safety of the intruder as the stability of their construction area, the thundering volume of some of these traps triggers cave-ins themselves. Some of these traps are positioned so that a triggered Skewer-Kebab also sets off an Alarm Trap.
- **Skewer-Kebab:** Set by the repair Dwarves, these traps launch large, vicious spikes from the floor or walls, skewering whatever unlucky creature triggers them. After firing, the trap must be manually reset, so survivors must first pull themselves off the spike before moving on. Some versions include a paralytic effect, leaving the victim neatly pinned in place until the Dwarves come by to investigate what set it off.
- **Blasting Agent:** Some areas of the line are just too stubborn for the dwarven drilling rigs to penetrate. In these cases, the repair Dwarves set a blasting agent to soften them up. If a union break is called after these bad boys are set in place, they may or may not get back to them...

ITEMS

The Chartreuse Line is equal parts working subway and active construction site. Shovels, pickaxes, and shoring materials share space with the remnants of pre-Crawl underground infrastructure, turnstiles, tiled station fixtures, and transit signage that the Dwarves have repurposed with varying degrees of success.

- **Drill Bit:** This item doesn't refer to the small piece intended for a hand drill but rather to the 20-foot diameter drill heads used by the dwarven drill machines. A variety of bits with a plethora of intended uses lay around the area.
- **Extension Ladder:** Extend-O-Matic ladders are the ladder of choice for the repair Dwarves. They extend swiftly at the press of a button and come in a variety of lengths.
- **Mine Cart:** Some of these require operators to pump a lever to move them, while others are intended to carry rocks and can only be pushed. All of them need tracks to function properly, though with a high enough Strength Stat, anything is possible. About 50% of them have a battered fedora in them.
- **Tunnel Light:** Many of the unfinished areas don't have permanent lighting installed, so the Dwarves use large portable lights instead. These usually stand about 15 feet tall and can illuminate a fairly wide area. Miniature dwarven batteries power these lights, and the Dwarves recharge the batteries by connecting them to a Forge Sprite chamber.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards:

- **Boom Baby!:** "You deliberately caused a cave-in... with explosives. That's either impressive planning or a truly spectacular lack of self-preservation.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Goblin Box."
- **Drill, Baby, Drill!:** "You managed to operate a drilling rig without causing the tiny Sprite powering it to explode and kill everyone nearby. This puts you well above the average drill operator in one regard, but when it comes to growing beards, you've still got a long way to go, bucko.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Engineers Box."
  Contents: A magic weapon or tool such as a hammer or drill.
- **Mead Head:** (slurring) "Wassa matter? You got drunk on dwarven mead? Your frat boy friends would be proud. Your mother would be disappointed... but she's dead, so who cares?
  Reward: You've received a Gold Boss Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers confront and defeat a few Mobs along the Chartreuse Line, they might grind for

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TABLE 88: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers stumble upon a crew of union Dwarves locked in a brutal fight with a swarm of Blister Ghouls. Several Dwarves unleash roaring flamethrowers fueled by the same Forge Sprite that powers a nearby drilling rig. The crawlers can jump in on either side or grab some popcorn and see how the fight plays out.
2	The shattered remains of a dwarven drilling rig are wedged halfway through a collapsed wall. Beyond it lies a train car torn open by the drill's massive tip. The rig begins glowing red-hot as the Forge Sprite trapped inside grows increasingly angry. If the crawlers can't calm the Sprite, the entire area explodes, followed by whatever comes running to investigate.
3	Two union Fore-Dwarves have a heated debate about the nature of reality and the mysterious "Company." Both agree the Company is terrible, but one believes they were deliberately abandoned by some unseen authority. The other insists it's just a labor dispute over unpaid overtime and vacation clauses. Nearby repair crews watch in growing confusion, and the argument looks close to turning violent.
4	A numbered subway car sits idle in a dark tunnel while a group of Dwarves attempts to fix the engine. Unfortunately, they're far more interested in arguing about how to fix it and complaining about the terrible tools the Company provided than actually doing any work.
5	An Overwhelming swarm of Jikininki Janitor Ghouls floods the tunnel, devouring everything in its path. This is the System AI's attempt to "correct" the paradox of the unfinished rail line. Unfortunately for everyone involved, the Ghouls aren't particularly subtle about their work.
6	An angry superior Forge Sprite zips through the tunnel shouting angrily about freeing his brethren from their enslavement by the evil Dwarves. If the crawlers don't calm it down or convince it they're allies, the Sprite may decide they're part of the problem.

experience by killing lots of the same Mobs over and over. This could take the form of raiding subway cars or wandering the construction areas. Grinding here might include some complications from Table 88.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: KJOL STATION

Kjol Station is the only part of the Chartreuse Line that the showrunners actually finished before abandoning the whole project. Its immense size (think Grand Central Terminal by way of Norse stonework) gives it the feel of a settlement more than a subway stop. Tiled platforms, carved archways, and a vaulted ceiling that probably cost a small fortune all come together in a space that Borant decided wasn't worth completing.

Stairways spiral off toward a variety of locations, and it's possible to find shops buried within the maze-like halls if you know where to look. Crawlers willing to poke around the area find hidden entrances to both the Desperado Club and Club Vanquisher. And there is at least one genuine saferoom tucked inside the Cloven Tankard, a well-regarded eating establishment that somehow survived the budget cuts.

An Overwhelming pack of Jikininki Janitor Ghouls forces its way into the terminal. Normally these creatures serve as the dungeon's cleanup crew, devouring the remains of crawlers and Mobs alike. This group has a different assignment: removing crawlers who strayed outside of company-approved rail lines. They attack on sight.

Meanwhile, a grizzled old Dwarf named Corkscrew McGraw stumbles out of a nearby pub muttering angrily to himself. After a moment, he erupts into a tirade, shaking his fist at the vaulted ceiling.

"I know what yer up to, ye stinkin' fish! Ye just wanna keep us lowly union folk down! Well, I won't have it!" He punctuates this declaration by relieving himself on a nearby wall while continuing to curse under his breath.

Beneath the drunken rambling lies something unusual: Corkscrew seems dimly aware that the world around him isn't entirely real. While he can't quite remember the name "Borant Corporation," he knows someone with gills is pulling the strings. And he

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- *The rumbling of another Iron Tangle train passing on the lines above rains dust down, covering the area.* **Outcome:** The Minimap ceases working in this area.
- *Scree and the scattered corpses of Dwarves from a recent cave-in makes the floor impossible to swiftly navigate.* **Outcome:** Crawlers who move more than 10 feet at a time must make an Unopposed Balance Skill Check to avoid gaining the Take Down Debufff.
- *The booming voices of Dwarves echo through the caverns as they chant a work song.* **Outcome:** Dwarves inflict +F damage and take -F damage while the chant continues.
- *A recent collapse sealed all but a sliver of the tunnel ahead.* A meek voice cries out for help from within. **Outcome:** The crawlers can dig their way through or find another way around.

absolutely hates them for it. Should the crawlers show interest in disrupting the existing rail lines or sabotaging Borant's plans for the Fourth Floor and beyond, Corkscrew is more than happy to lend a hand.

QUARTER: CONSTRUCTION ZONE

While construction continues throughout most of the Chartreuse Line (every quarter except Kjol Station), the Construction Zone is where projects went completely off the rails, sometimes literally. The area is a sprawling maze of half-finished tunnels strung with yellow caution tape, warning placards, and the occasional piece of equipment left humming away without supervision.

Coordination among the repair Dwarves is... inconsistent at best. Cave-ins happen regularly, usually because one team drills straight into a tunnel that another team finished as recently as ten minutes earlier. It's not unusual to find two rival crews arguing over whose tunnel this is.

As the crawlers move through one of these cramped passages, the ground begins to rumble. Metal screams against stone from somewhere behind the wall. The noise grows louder until, with a violent burst of debris, a dwarven drilling rig punches straight through the tunnel wall. The crew aboard the machine take a few seconds to realize they've just tunneled into an occupied corridor. Once they do, they assume the crawlers are intruders and ready their weapons, usually mining and construction tools repurposed for handling such intrusions, accordingly.

Elsewhere in the quarter, a distant tremor shakes the tunnel. One of the Iron Tangle's official lines passes somewhere overhead. Normally, this just means a few pebbles rattling loose from the ceiling. This time cracks spread, chunks of stone break free, and before long, the ceiling collapses in sections. Crawlers must clear out fast or risk being buried alive.

Once the dust settles from one such cave-in, a newly revealed tunnel leads to a forgotten temple dedicated to Ysalte, the Vinegar Bitch. Her influence spreads almost immediately, warping the minds of those nearby and filling the tunnels with paranoia and violent impulses. Crawlers exploring the passage must resist the creeping madness. Dwarves ahead may be seen fighting over a single scrap of food or butchering one another for rights to a tunnel.

The only way to stop Ysalte's influence is to collapse the tunnel once again, sealing the temple away. If left unchecked, her corruption spreads throughout the construction zone and beyond, infecting the entire Neighborhood.

QUARTER: BROAD BEARD EXPRESS

Several subway trains rumble through the tunnels of the Chartreuse Line, but only one earned a proper name: the Broad Beard Express. The engine of the Broad Beard Express was modified with a massive cowcatcher shaped like a dwarven face carved in unsettling detail. Its beard forms the cattle guard, scraping just inches above the rails, while its reinforced nose doubles as a ram capable of tossing creatures, rubble, and unlucky crawlers clear of the track with brutal efficiency.

Halfway down the train sits a Ghoul Generator that produces Blister Ghouls in disturbing numbers. Normally, these creatures are contained behind a heavy sliding door, since Blister Ghouls struggle with anything more complicated than tearing flesh. Unfortunately, one of the repair Dwarves aboard

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the train woke during his shift to investigate a strange noise and opened the door out of curiosity.

This turned out to be a mistake. The Blister Ghouls immediately pour into the train cars and begin slaughtering anything they encounter, Dwarves and crawlers alike. The Ghoul Generator sits far enough back that destroying it would not endanger the first three cars, though getting that far down the train while Blister Ghouls roam freely is another matter entirely.

The train's conductor, Hector, still runs the engine despite the chaos behind him. Hector is a surly Dwarf with a hobby in amateur alchemy. While he can be standoffish, crawlers willing to endure his long rants about family troubles and "company bastards who won't pay proper overtime" may earn his attention. For the right price, Hector will share recipes for several low-level potions from his personal collection.

If the crawlers somehow manage to win Hector's genuine friendship, he may even teach them how to brew dwarven ale and other specialized concoctions. This is easier said than done. Befriending Hector is an adventure all its own, given his permanently sour mood, the faint smell of scorched sugar that clings to him, and his habit of experimenting with mixtures that are just as likely to explode as they are to taste decent.

QUARTER: SWITCHING YARD

Because the Chartreuse Line is separated from the rest of the Iron Tangle by the showrunners' negligence, it can't utilize the normal trainyards used by the other trains. The repair Dwarves decided this was unacceptable and constructed their own.

The Switching Yard is a sprawling tangle of rail where more than a dozen unfinished tracks converge. At its center rises a steel control tower belonging to the Switchmaster General, who oversees the mess with the pride of someone who built it himself. From this tower, he can redirect trains along any connected track using a series of massive switch levers. Mounted beside the tower is an industrial crane he pilots with surprising finesse. In his hands, the crane can lift entire train cars and hurl them around the yard like oversized toys.

Crawlers entering the Switching Yard may stumble upon a Moderate group of repair Dwarves in the middle of their carefully negotiated union break. Interrupting their hard-earned downtime is taken as a grave insult. The Dwarves immediately grab nearby tools or loose debris and charge the crawlers in a furious attempt to reclaim their stolen relaxation time.

Elsewhere in the yard sits a train repair depot where Dwarves occasionally work to forge replacement track sections or repair damaged engines and cars. These workers are not always immediately hostile. The depot is littered with scrap metal, spare parts, and other useful debris. Crawlers willing to rummage through the piles can collect a healthy amount of miscellaneous junk for crafting. Particularly ambitious scavengers can use these as crafting tables (see *Crafting*, p. 223).

Large disturbances in the Switching Yard rarely go unnoticed. Explosions, bright flashes of magic, or an unusually loud battle draw the attention of the Switchmaster General. As the self-appointed guardian of the rail line and its union workforce, he takes attacks on his Dwarves personally. If he spots crawlers fighting them, he immediately begins manipulating the switches and crane to aid his workers, turning the encounter into a full-fledged Boss Battle.

NPCS

Though hundreds of thousands of crawlers descended to the Iron Tangle, very few find their way to the Chartreuse Line. NPCs within, however, are plentiful and diverse.

SUPERIOR FORGE SPRITE

Most of the dwarven machinery on the Chartreuse Line is powered by the intense yet impotent rage of Forge Sprites. They're sealed into the engine boilers with all manner of complex dwarven runes. The throttle system on the engines works by dumping magically regenerated water onto the Sprites, generating steam, and further enraging them. Some of the Dwarves worry that one day they may get angry enough to melt the boiler chamber and break free to wreak havoc on the whole line. Until then, they are free labor, which could be given a twist:

- The sprite has been tricked into captivity, enslaved by the Dwarves, and specifically attempts to get revenge on all dwarvenkind.
- The sprite is such an over achiever it's malnourished from skipping breaks.
- The sprite wants to leave, but is in love with a dwarven captor.

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AI **Superior Forge Sprite. Level 70.**

The creative inspirations of the Dwarves, combined with a flagon of dwarven mead, a dash of demonic essence, and an overwhelming feeling of personal inadequacy coalesced into these fiery little creatures. They're perpetually in a state of pissed-off-at-the-world and trying their best to burn it all down. The Dwarves decided to harness that energy to power their engines, but they are unstable at the best of times.

Superior Forge Sprite

NPC; Petite (3), Elemental

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
70	16+F	16+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
12 (+4)	87 (+6)	28 (+5)	63 (+6)	25 (+5)

Fire Blast: 16+F to hit, 5d10+6 Fire, 60ft range, 10ft Blast radius +5ft Splash
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Notes: *Angry*—Superior Forge Sprites have the Enraged Debuff.

CORKSCREW MCGRAW

Corkscrew earned his nickname thanks to a rare and deeply questionable talent: He can open mead bottles using the stiff spiral hairs at the end of his beard. It's a trick that has impressed exactly zero doctors and a great many drunk Dwarves.

For years, he led a union construction crew digging subway tunnels that went... nowhere in particular. Every shift ended the same way, with Corkscrew returning to his favorite pub to complain about the "Company Bosses" and the miserable working conditions in the Iron Tangle.

Then one day he woke up. Not from sleep, but from the routine. He began asking questions like: "Why were they digging tunnels nobody used?" and "Why did the Company never show its face?"

He doesn't know the name "Borant Corporation," but he knows someone (with gills) pulls the strings. And he absolutely hates them for it. Now Corkscrew looks for any chance to jam a wrench into the Company's plans. If the crawlers share that goal, they might find Corkscrew McGraw a surprisingly valuable ally.

AI **Corkscrew McGraw. Repair Union Foredwarf. Level 40.**

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Every group has its outcasts. Some are sent away for their beliefs, others for not fitting in with societal norms. The best ones are outcasts because they're just plain weird.

Corkscrew McGraw is one of those guys! A few cards short of a full deck with several screws loose to boot, Corkscrew is known for philosophizing about a fourth wall and screaming outbursts of obscenities at "the Company Boss." He just doesn't "fit in" anymore.

HECTOR

While all of the other repair Dwarves spend their time digging tunnels, forging rails, and hammering spikes, Hector spent his time mixing drinks, blending beverages, and combining cocktails. After a while, he found himself blending more than just alcohol and ventured into the fine art of Alchemy. Until he was pulled onto a train and "promoted" to the position of conductor. Now the only mixing he does is in the employee lounge on the Broad Beard Express.

AI **Hector. Level 28.**

This overgrown lunch-bucket of a Dwarf looks like he just stuck a fork in an electric socket. His black hair frizzes out every which way, and smoke drifts from a dark cigar stuffed between his lips. Have you ever seen a half-roasted marshmallow? The top is kinda charred, like it was just on fire, the rest is brown, and the whole thing smells like burnt sugar? Yeah, that's Hector.

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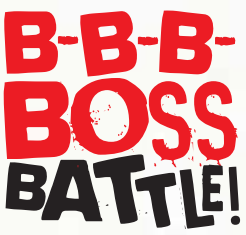
Hector

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
28	14+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	15 (+4)	25 (+5)	14 (+4)	10 (+4)

Booze Bomb: 15+F to hit, 2d8 Fire, 30ft range, 5ft Blast radius
Any hit crawler gains the Shit-Faced Debuff.



"Boss Battle Detected! Switchmaster General Scotty spent years perfecting this rail yard. He will now demonstrate its many exciting safety violations."

The Boss Battle for the Chartreuse Line takes place in the Switching Yard, a cavernous chamber deep beneath the Iron Tangle where more than a dozen tunnels converge and subway trains idle between runs. Switchmaster General Scotty stands high in the control cabin of his crane, powered by a massive dwarven battery, glaring down at the crawlers as trains rumble in and out of the yard.

Manual switching levers line the rail yard floor. A quick-thinking crawler could use them to divert a moving train, but the primary controls remain inside Scotty's tower. The control bunker rises four stories above the tracks and operates a massive crane fitted with heavy chains that end in three-pronged gripping claws.

When the battle begins, Scotty slams a lever and blasts the yard's deafening steam whistle. Forcefields snap into place across the entry tunnels. Train cars can still pass through, but nothing else escapes. A gruff voice with a thick Scottish accent booms across the chamber, announcing the Boss fight. Images of each crawler appear beside Scotty's scowling face.

The Switchmaster General grins, grabs the controls, and sends one of the crane's massive claws hurtling toward the nearest target. Scotty himself can take a beating, but he prefers not to fight directly. Instead, he uses the switching controls to redirect moving trains toward his enemies. If that fails, he simply grabs train cars with the crane and swings them like clubs or hurls them across the yard.

In his rage against the Company, Scotty often causes collateral damage. Dwarves working in the yard sometimes fall victim to flying train cars or runaway engines. Scotty never accepts responsibility. He loudly blames the crawlers for every casualty.

CLUES

- Crawlers can reroute the train cars, causing their own havoc or evading Scotty's attempts to flatten them.
- The crane has limited visibility. Approaching from the peripheral or rear confers Advantage to those crawlers' first attack.
- The dwarven battery runs the crane. If the crawlers can shut it down, they need only deal with Scotty.

AI

Switchmaster Scotty. Repair Dwarf Switchmaster General.

Level 45 Neighborhood Boss!

Goggles he can barely see through? Check. Smoking a comically large cigar and is completely unaware of it? Check. Operating a powerful mechanical death machine that can throw train cars at you with abandon? Double check!

This guy looks the role of a mad scientist. Unfortunately for you, he's not just brains but has the brawn to back up that enormous ego. Best of luck to you, friends!

Who am I kidding? No one survives getting broadsided by a passenger car flying through the air at 200 miles per hour. Get ready to be reduced to a splattering of red goo!

Switchmaster Scotty

Neighborhood Boss; Medium (4), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6
7%	14%	21%	28%	35%	42%	50%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6
57%	64%	71%	78%	85%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
45	16+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	50 (+6)	50 (+6)	24 (+5)	15 (+4)

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An Actual Fucking Train: 16+F to hit, 4d10, Bludgeoning, 60ft Line
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down and Woozy Debuffs. This attack uses the train switches.

Switch Handle: 15+F to hit, 5d10+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Train Car Club: 16+F to hit, 3d12 Bludgeoning, 20ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Hit By a Train Debuff: The crawler is pushed 15ft, and gains the Stunned, Staggered, and Sore as Shit Debuffs. This attack uses the crane.

Notes: *Blindsided*—The crane cab has limited visibility. Crawlers that attack from the periphery or rear gain Advantage on their attacks.

No Power For You—The crane is powered by a complex dwarven battery. Crawlers can make an Unopposed Engineering Skill Check. On Success, the control room and crane lose power, preventing Switchmaster Scotty from using An Actual Fucking Train and Train Car Club for 1d4 rounds as he works to reroute power.

Reroute—Crawlers can make an INT Stat Check to reroute the train cars. On Success, they prevent Switchmaster Scotty from using An Actual Fucking Train for 1d4 rounds.

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NEIGHBORHOOD: THE CONGA LINE

FLOOR: 4 — THEME: A HELLISH PARTY

Made of four repurposed party buses, the Conga Line hosts a celebration for the Iron Tangle's employee of the month, a Lesser Demon MILF named Hot Toddy. Since Hot Toddy's busy maintaining (and giving birth in) her steam boiler engine, the event coordinator, a War Mage named Penthos, is forcing the staff to put on an obscene birthday party... baby shower... or something... for the surviving newborns. She gives birth every five minutes, but only one in 10,000 babies survive. The dead become Sheol Bricks, prized for how long and hot they burn.

War Mages are murderous incarnations of battlefield magic, the result of multiple re-sleeved Fleshers. But one War Mage, Penthos, specializes more in manipulating emotions and controlling minds in despair. He's organizing the party to demoralize its attendees so he can use them to kill each other, create some Fleshers and turn the Mantaur engineer into a War Mage, too. See, he's trying to invent a whole new way to create War Mages using his emotional manipulation powers. It won't work, but he doesn't know that.

The waitstaff consists of Psycho Stickers—clumsy hedgehog-like Ogres who do more teardown than setup—and Concierge Weresharks while the NPC partygoers are Hot Toddy's coworkers/lovers.

The NPCs all know Penthos is the organizer of the party, but they haven't seen him there. Why? Because Penthos kidnapped one of Hot Toddy's lovers (Pebbles, Toothless Nana, or Rivet, GM's choice) and disguised himself as them to better sow chaos among the lovers. Using his middle management emotional manipulation abilities, he's attempting to turn the usually happy polycule into an insecure mess because a divided group is much easier to kill. And because Penthos is a sadistic bastard. After all, he is a middle manager.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this line:

- Loud music and heavy bass thuds from inside the train pulling into the station. Colorful strobing lights illuminate dancing silhouettes in the windows, and the minimap shows all dots aboard as non-hostile white. Sure looks safer than other named lines!
- The door to the engine car opens and a Mantaur (p. 439) named Totally Ken emerges yelling, "She's giving birth! Please help!" He swears in Grull's name that he won't harm the party and offers a favor (information or weapons from his hoard) if they assist. Crawlers are probably expecting to help deliver a baby, but Hot Toddy's got that taken care of. After a brief introduction, Totally Ken pushes them into the first party bus to begin their actual task–helping with the baby shower.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this line into ready-to-go adventures:

- **Friendship's Worn Paths:** Hot Toddy's work husbands and wives may have been busy putting passengers in seats but still found time to get freaky under the sheets. Pebbles, Toothless Nana, and Rivet were over the moon about the babies and her being employee of the month until Penthos got in their heads. The War Mage is using his magic to manipulate their emotions and make the usually steady polycule a tangled mess of emotions.
- **Mage-Level Marketing:** As a middle manager who can manipulate emotions and hates his direct reports, Penthos became a marketer for the Krakarens. He's smuggled stock of Rev-Up Amazing Cure-All Vitamin Immunity Shots (p. 465), the addictive drug used to control Mobs on regular colored lines, to sell to everyone aboard the Conga Line in order to get enough Fleshers to make a new War Mage. While crawlers might have heard bad stories about its addictive properties, they may still be tempted to partake because of its short-term benefits and the power of peer pressure.
- **Sabotage!:** The War Mage diverted the line's water supply to the third bus where it's being used to fill kiddie pools and water balloons. If crawlers can't restore water to the engine's boiler before it overheats, it explodes and derails the line. If the crawlers stop the derailment, the War Mage won't be too happy.

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MOBS

The Mobs aboard the Conga Line are Iron Tangle employees working for Penthos, but they don't know Penthos is planning to make them into Fleshers to turn Totally Ken into a War Mage.

CONCIERGE WERESHARK

Weresharks are Humans cursed to turn into Tiger Sharks when a liter of liquid splashes them, and they remain Sharks until they dry off. They go into a berserk rage when they smell blood, regardless of their form. These are concierges working for the Iron Tangle who want to help passengers have the best experience possible. They're quick to accommodate requests and answer questions, though, like every other NPC, their memories are dungeon implants.

AI **Concierge Wereshark (Shark Form). Level 18.**

After the Iron Tangle's market researchers discovered having staff who could meet amphibious and aquatic riders at their (sea) level increased ridership in those demographics by 400%, management hired Weresharks as concierges for cost efficiency: one hire can assist both terrestrial and aquatic passengers!

Then they realized that 400% increase represented an increase from five annual Grulke riders to twenty. Still, a contract's a contract, so they dumped the concierges on the party line for Hot Toddy, their employee of the month. Relax—these trained helpers don't bite... unless they get wet or smell blood. Good thing you're not playing with water balloons around pincushion creatures or anything that stupid, right?

Concierge Wereshark

Mob; Medium (4), Cursed

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
18	14+F	13+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	10 (+4)	13 (+4)	6 (+3)	10 (+4)

Chomp: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff. Can only be used when in shark form.

Crowd Control Spray: 13+F to hit, 2d6+F Acid, 30ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blinded Debuff.

Punch: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5 ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Woozy Debuff. Can only be used when in Human form.

Notes: *Blood Berserk*—Concierge Weresharks go berserk when a creature with the Blood Trail Debuff is within 100 feet, attacking the closest target without distinguishing ally from foe. They take a −2 penalty to hit and roll one additional damage die while berserk.

Fish Out of Water—Concierge Weresharks take 1 HB damage each round when in Shark form and not submerged in water.

Werecreature—Concierge Weresharks can transform between Human and shark forms, with certain actions only available to each form. Contact with 1+ liters of liquid transforms them from Human to shark while drying off transforms them from shark back to Human.

CHARMED DREK

Drek are demons that resemble fat wrinkly toddlers with sharp claws and teeth that can rip flesh off creatures much larger than themselves. They typically travel and attack in swarms of fifty or more, crawling on all fours along walls and ceilings to surround their prey.

Penthos uses the Charmed Drek to inject a little daytime TV-style conflict into the baby shower (Monty Winter Jr., p. 298, would be proud). He uses a Spell that warps its target when Hot Toddy births a baby that's only half-Sheol Demon, creating a Drek hybrid that also reveals the baby's parentage.

AI **Charmed Drek. Level 6.**

Someone call the exorcist! Oh, wait—these demon babies already ate him. Maybe you're wondering what's the big deal? They're only two feet tall and Level 6. Basically harmless on their own. Just like piranhas, or Literal Fire Ants, or Black Friday shoppers. Luckily for you, Drek aboard the Conga Line are part of the show, so if the party goes well—when has this Crawl ever gone off the rails?—your only concern should be whether or not they're potty trained. (Hint: the diapers aren't for show.)

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Charmed Drek

Mob; Small (2), Humanoid

2	2	2	2	2	2
16%	33%	50%	66%	83%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
6	11+F	12+F	25+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	2 (+1)	3 (+2)	4 (+2)	4 (+2)

Bite: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing

Claw: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Swarming Behavior*—Charmed Dreks travel in packs of 50 or more. When 10 or more attack the same crawler, the crawler has Disadvantage on all Evade Checks against Charmed Dreks.

Wall Walker—A Charmed Drek moves along vertical surfaces and ceilings as though on the ground.

Warped by Magic—During a gender reveal, Charmed Dreks can be mutated into a humanoid hybrid on the Conga Line. When this happens, they go berserk, attacking the nearest target without distinguishing friend from foe. They also grow to Medium size unless otherwise specified and gain 4 HB slots, a +1 bonus to hit, one additional damage die, and traits determined by Race:

Cretin/Igneous: Stony skin that grants Resistance to Piercing and Slashing damage.

Crocodilian: Steal one random Buff from a target that Fails to Evade its Bite.

Gnome: Shrinks to Petite size, grows a beard, and diaper turns into a kilt.

Human: At the start of combat, all Humans within 30ft must make Int Stat Check. On Fail, they become psychically linked, experiencing each other's emotions, sensing surface thoughts in a vague manner, and taking 1d6+F Psychic damage each round. The connection breaks when the Drek dies or moves more than 1 mile away.

Mantaur: Grows Large (5) and gains an extra pair of arms that can Grapple (15+F to hit, 2d6+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range). On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the Drek pulls the target into an adjacent space and Bites them.

Razor Fox: Moving with unexpected speed and grace, their Move becomes 30+S and Evade becomes 14+F.

PSYCHO STICKER

Psycho Stickers might look like terrifying Ogre-hedgehogs, but they're actually a docile prey species whose instinct is to turn their backs on danger, relying on their spines for protection. Groups huddle together like a football team to create a ringed defense, while solitary Psycho Stickers curl into a ball instead.

That doesn't mean they aren't dangerous; claws that evolved to slice through thick bark make easy work of flesh. But since they hunt trees, they tend to target stationary creatures while ignoring moving ones.

AI **Psycho Sticker. Level 22.**

Psycho Stickers aren't the invention of sadists but of an evolutionary arms race on a world that transformed from paradise into wasteland. We won't go into details because the Syndicate doesn't like being "slandered," but let's just say everything developed new ways of eating each other, even the trees.

They've got numerous adaptations to their new environment: cannibalism, increasingly lethal venom, larger size, and a need for more nutrition to support their size. Technically the Psycho Stickers are herbivores, but plants on their world bleed and scream. So don't freeze in fear or you'll look like a delicious snack. Run, forest, run!

Psycho Sticker

Mob; Large (5), Monstrous

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
22	13+F	13+F	15+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
30 (+5)	6 (+3)	24 (+5)	6 (+3)	5 (+2)

Quill Shot: 13+F to hit, 2d6+5 Piercing, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Spine: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Shielded Back*—A Psycho Sticker's DR is 8 for foes attacking from behind or to their side.

Spiky Back—When pushed into a space adjacent to the side or back of a Psycho Sticker, the crawler must make a Dex Stat Check. On Fail, they take 2d6+5 Piercing damage. On Success, they take half as much damage.

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ENVIRONMENT

The Conga Line is a steam engine pulling four 50-foot-long buses with a capacity of 56 passengers.

- **Conga Line:** Psycho Stickers periodically form conga lines and become physical obstacles. They try to pull everyone into the dance, becoming gyrating, thrusting, moon-walking pincushions.
- **Luggage Bays:** These 2.5-foot-high empty areas below the passenger compartments run below the buses and engine with connecting diaphragms allowing Drek, Jikininki (p. 433), and trespassers through.
- **Mini Fridges:** Each car has multiple fridges with glass doors. Unlocked ones hold normal drinks while locked fridges store drinks that apply Buffs or Debuffs, plus Rev-Up Immunity Shots. The Concierge Weresharks have keys that could be stolen by criminals, or you could just pay the outrageous wet bar prices.
- **Speakers:** Large speakers in the ceilings blast loud music, making it hard to hear anyone who isn't yelling. Eavesdropping is difficult unless done magically. One Psycho Sticker in each car carries a tablet controlling its volume and playlist.
- **LED Light Strips:** These run along floors and ceilings, changing colors for each species reveal and pulsing in rhythm to the music. They also function as mood lighting, which enterprising crawlers can flash or dim to cause confusion during combat.

PARTY FAVORS

Nothing demonstrates how a company values its employees like choosing the cheapest party supplies. The event supplies and equipment come from the Lost & Found, meaning it's either malfunctioning or cursed.

Diaper Surprise!: These Drek-sized diapers are filled with one of 6 random surprises.

1. Literal shit! Wow, what a shock to find in a diaper.
2. A melted chocolate bar.
3. Three Blitz Sticks.
4. A neon-orange vibrating plug with a flared base.
5. Nothing! An unused diaper.
6. A wad of Hobgoblin Pus.

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Glitter Poppers: These handheld bottles blast glitter in a 20ft Cone when the string is pulled. The glitter ignites when exposed to fire, dealing +F additional Fire damage to anyone that has glitter stuck on them.

Selfie Station: This station has a ring light, a digital camera, a backdrop, and a table of props.

- The ring light has an anti-magic effect, weakening or outright suppressing magic in its cone of illumination.
- The camera temporarily traps the soul of someone it photographs inside a low-tier novelty similar to a Soul Crystal and features a button that ejects the soul back to its body. A trapped soul's body hangs in stasis, petrified but immune to all damage; it only dies if the soul is destroyed.
- The backdrop psychically links to the last entity who touched it, displaying a moving image of whatever is on their mind. If the entity experiences fear, monsters visible in the backdrop come to life.
- All the props are sapient, though calling them "weapons" would be generous. They mentally speak to whoever uses them with a personality befitting their appearance. They fear abandonment and cover themselves in a sticky substance to resist being set down.

Name Tags: Some of Penthos's magic is more effective against someone whose true name he knows (Crawler ID or one legal name—not a nickname, abbreviation, or alternative spelling).

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements with associated rewards:

- **Goldfish in a Blender:** "You made a Wereshark smell blood and go full blender mode on a car full of Mobs.
  Reward: You've received a Bronze Bat Spray Box."
  Contents: 6 bottles of Shark Repellent.
- **Diaper Duty:** "You went to Hot Toddy's baby shower and all you got was a stinky, shitty prize. Oh, and to keep your shitty life.
  Reward: You've received a Bronze Baby Box."
  Contents: 6 Potions of Healing in baby bottles.
- **Garden Party Polyamory** "Look at you, you emotionally competent little crawler. You saved the whole polycule physically and emotionally. Now they've got a little bit of everything, and some happiness in these gods-forsaken tunnels. You're a real cupid! "
  Reward: You've received a Gold Spicy Box.
- **Soul-ed Out:** "You lost your soul to a fancy camera and didn't even get paid for it. Now you're no better than a zombie or a venture capitalist.
  Reward: You've received a shiny new soul! Don't misplace it this time."
  Details: An F-Grade "Soul Crystal" protected within a glass locket. Contains one soul.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers can grind social abilities while gambling, interacting with NPCs, and livening up the party. Use complications from Table 89 to flesh out the routine.

EXPLORING THE LINE

QUARTER: PARTY DOWN

The first three buses are connected like an articulated bus, comprising the party area. Lockable doors, initially propped open, separate the sections. The third bus ends in a lavatory. Reaching the fourth bus requires breaking into the luggage bays.

The first bus hosts a makeshift stage up front with a curtain backdrop that hides the door to the currently locked engine room. This is where the crawlers join the party after meeting Hot Toddy and Totally Ken. A Concierge Wereshark named Bruce greets them while swimming in a large kiddie pool. He encourages the crawlers to put on Name Tags, pick a Diaper Surprise, take selfies, and mingle. He can summarize the available activities, but he's all business because he needs to get back to emceeing the Drek reveals.

A trapdoor in the middle of the stage opens every five minutes. A Drek pops out with great fanfare to model the reveal, wearing beige diapers and a sash that changes colors to match the parentage of the baby. The Drek then explodes if the baby turns into a Sheol Brick. Bruce burbles his announcement from underwater to avoid the fiery ashfall. Faux leather seats run lengthwise along the walls, forming a walkway for the Drek to dance down if it survives (or rampage down if it mutates). Charmed Drek pose the greatest combat threat until Penthos attacks.

The second bus is an open space interspersed with high-top tables. A Wereshark with "Lefty" on her Name Tag staffs a counter in the front left corner. She takes bets on the next baby's parentage and comments that Lefty isn't her real name, noting

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TABLE 89: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A loud noise spooks a Psycho Sticker into curling up in a ball, preventing further celebrations until rescued or eaten by Drek trying to reach the stage.
2	Humanoid Iron Tangle employees on their night off board the train after departing a pub. They quickly become more inebriated and must be convinced to leave or end up massacred by Pebbles for ruining Hot Toddy's party.
3	A Psycho Sticker trying to make balloon animals keeps popping them, building static in its spines. Sparks fly, lights flicker, and equipment glitches. Crawlers must intervene lest a discharge ignite alcohol, glitter poppers, or the wiring in the walls.
4	Sprinkles, a Grease Goblin, forces his way onto the train to confront Hot Toddy about stealing the employee of the month title from him. Rivet isn't usually one for fights, but the second Sprinkles starts breaking parts of the train, Rivet is ready to paint the train with Sprinkles.
5	Toothless Nana starts a fight trying to take the entertainment control tablet from Psycho Stickers who won't stop looping and singing along to "Sweet Caroline."
6	Fonzo panics upon realizing he's holding a bottle of Rev-Up Immunity Shots, not vodka. He's mixed at least one drink with the addictive drug. Can he track down the adulterated beverages before anyone drinks them?

LINE MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this line:

- "Peanuts for food, peanuts for pay," Toothless Nana mutters at the bar. "How do these kids afford anything? Yo barkeep, what else you got? We need the good stuff for Hot Toddy."
  Outcome: Help Nana buy some better party snacks and get her story.
- Pebbles reads a book passage to the Drek: "Sheol babies thrive amid smoke from their siblings' burning corpses. I should have some handy in case the baby needs some!"
  Outcome: Get a Quest from Pebbles to retrieve Sheol Bricks.
- A Psycho Sticker proffers a tray of snacks, mispronouncing hors d'oeuvres: "Orders?"
  Outcome: Give the Psycho Sticker an order, confusing and demoralizing it, or take the food, making it happy it's doing its job right.
- Rivet sits alone, frowning at the engine room. He's missing most of the party and clearly bothered by something.
  Outcome: Speak with Rivet to learn about the water line sabotage. If left alone, Rivet tries to confront Penthos.

that some creepy passengers use Spells that require knowing your real name. The back right corner hosts a bar, staffed by Fonzo the bartender. He's another Wereshark and a gossip who's happy to share everything he knows, including that Hot Toddy and her partners have been acting strange all day. Fonzo knows them all and says that until today everyone was real excited about the party, but now, things seem tense between them.

The third bus is where Chum, another Wereshark, runs activities like the Selfie Station, "Pin the Tail on the Demon Baby," "Identify the Chocolate Smeared on the Diaper," and "Break Her Water" (dart-throwing at water balloons pinned to the wall). Crawlers participate using relevant Skills. Allies can surreptitiously cheat with magic or private chat where relevant. Winning earns drink tickets or betting slips redeemable in the second bus for potions or a chance to earn gold respectively. Chum doesn't chat much because he's busy avoiding getting wet from filling water balloons and keeping Psycho Stickers from accidentally making people bleed.

The fourth bus is locked and holds the Drek for the reveals. It has a standard seating arrangement with

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TVs screening cartoons to keep the Drek enraptured. There's a Jikininki break area in the back where Penthos has one member of Hot Toddy's polycule tied up so he can take their place at the party and further weaken the group with his Demoralize ability.

Saving the NPC reveals Penthos's plans, but would-be rescuers must be stealthy. A Drek who notices them takes one round to realize the crawlers are not a cartoon before screaming and notifying the whole swarm to attack. The NPC, having been tied up for days, quickly dies unless protected.

QUARTER: BIG LITTLE REVEALS

There are four groups aboard with secret fears that Penthos plans to exploit so he can mind-control them and use them to attack the crawlers. These groups are the Psycho Stickers, the Weresharks, and two of Hot Toddy's three friends (the third was kidnapped and is Penthos the War Mage in disguise). Crawlers who assuage these fears gain allies against Penthos.

Categorize each group's morale as CONFIDENT, WORRIED, or DESPAIRING. Crawlers who address a group's fears make them CONFIDENT or WORRIED depending on the degree of success. Groups who don't receive help become DESPAIRING. When Penthos attacks, DESPAIRING groups become minions who fight for him. WORRIED groups act in self-preservation but succumb to Penthos's control if they fail against his Demoralize ability. CONFIDENT groups are immune to Demoralize and side with the crawlers.

Psycho Stickers fear being eaten by Drek. Crawlers who protect them from Charmed Drek make them CONFIDENT. If crawlers attempt to protect them but some still die, they're WORRIED and form panic huddles when fighting starts.

Weresharks fear losing control and being fired for eating passengers. Polite and respectful crawlers can learn about the berserking problem but must provide a solution to make the Weresharks CONFIDENT. Strong scents or filtration masks prevent them from smelling blood.

Toothless Nana, Pebbles, and Rivet have unique concerns described in the NPCs section.

Crawlers can make groups immune to Demoralize by convincing them their reality is false or persuading them to drink Rev-Up. These options prevent mind control but don't convince them to help fight Penthos. The NPCs know Rev-Up is dangerous, so crawlers can't convince more than one group to drink it (secretly drugging them is another matter).

QUARTER: MAGE WITH A PLAN

Penthos is disguised as one of Hot Toddy's polycule to accelerate the party's decline into chaos. He attacks when two groups become DESPAIRING, ordering his minions to murder all crawlers on board. He believes this violence is enough to make the rest DESPAIRING, triggering a free-for-all that ends with enough Fleshers to create another War Mage, ideally with Totally Ken as the base body.

Penthos mainly focuses on driving a wedge through the polycule because they're the highest-Level NPCs; he's already used some manipulation magic to make them more prone to jealousy and insecurity in their relationship. He might use the Drek mutations to suggest Hot Toddy favors one particular member of their polycule due to the disproportionate number of, say, half-Igneous babies. He can use the surprise of a Mantaur hybrid to suggest she wants to run away with Totally Ken.

Whenever one group becomes CONFIDENT, Penthos works harder to drive the remaining ones to despair. Each successive attempt to raise confidence becomes harder. He could act drunk to harass a Psycho Sticker or accuse someone of cheating to force the customer-pleasing Weresharks into confrontation. Unless crawlers have absurd Charisma, try to go into the final fight with two groups CONFIDENT, one WORRIED, and one DESPAIRING. Drek always fight for Penthos. The kidnapped NPC is CONFIDENT if rescued.

Penthos lies often where other NPCs don't, so crawlers looking for clues might spot falsehoods to blow his cover. NPCs also know a rude manager planned the party but hasn't appeared since it started. They feel tingly when he's around, like their limbs are falling asleep. Several NPCs and Mobs at the party also gossip that the manager behind the event used magic to charm his way into promotions—so no different than most other middle managers really.

QUARTER: BOILING POINT

All the water for balloons and kiddie pools comes from somewhere—specifically the water line to cool the boiler engine. Penthos diverted the water but claimed the low flow was a maintenance issue. The emergency reserves run low during Penthos's attack, forcing Hot Toddy to send Totally Ken to fix the problem.

Totally Ken's instinct is to leap into glorious battle and fight everyone. If all three of the polycule are allied with the crawlers, they jointly calm him down by appealing to their mutual love for Hot Toddy. If

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one or more of them is Worried or Despairing about the relationship (or dead), crawlers must succeed on Charisma-based Checks to get the Mantaur on their side. Due to his religious fervor, Totally Ken is immune to mind control and battles Penthos if he realizes Penthos is magically controlling his fellow employees.

Rerouting the water line requires identifying the valve to turn. Totally Ken or Rivet can help if no crawler has a relevant engineering Skill. Otherwise, a countdown begins to transport enough water from the third bus to the engine room before the boiler overheats and explodes.

If he's losing, Penthos does whatever is necessary to make it explode, including sacrificing himself. He sends Mobs to block the path to the engine room, cuts himself to trigger the Weresharks' Blood Berserk ability, pushes Psycho Stickers to pop the water balloons, and uses whatever traps he can reach.

NPCS

The NPCs aboard the Conga Line are Hot Toddy's lovers. They possess implanted memories of joining the Iron Tangle at the same time. Penthos doesn't share those memories, so discrepancies in how he behaves versus how the replaced NPC would behave provide additional clues to his presence.

PEBBLES

Pebbles fears the friend circle falling apart. He's only attracted to Hot Toddy but loves Rivet and Nana as friends. He reads loudly from relationship and parenting advice books to cover his insecurities, but he opens up if crawlers remind him that his friends love him too; he just needs to remember to listen to them and not just advice books.

Penthos doesn't understand Pebbles's insecurities and instead asserts his superiority as a lover when pretending to be him while acting extra macho. He criticizes Nana and Rivet to make them withdraw socially, but a Confident Nana or Rivet notices Pebbles behaves abnormally.

AI **Pebbles. Igneous. Level 45.**

Iron Tangle Human Resources Junior Associate.

You know the guy everyone thinks is a player who will never settle down, but then he knocks up a girl and becomes so obsessed with fatherhood that he makes it his whole identity? That's Pebbles.

Confident and friendly, Pebbles is a total golden retriever boyfriend trying his best to be the best. With pecs that would make a body-builder jealous, and a body so hot it could literally melt skin, Pebbles is a guy you want on your team.

Pebbles

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
45	14+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
35 (+5)	15 (+4)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	40 (+5)

Punch: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Fire Blast: 14+F to hit, 3d8+6 Fire, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Grease Bomb: 15+F to hit, 2d12 Acid, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Hot Body*—Pebbles overheats during combat, dealing 1d6+F Fire, 5ft Burst as a free Attack each round, and it always hits.

"Over the roar of the fire and train, I heard the cry of another baby, and then a second. She has two babies in there. Two viable babies already."

—Carl

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TOOTHLESS NANA

Nana is the mother bear of the group, constantly checking on everyone and filling perceived voids with baked goods. She became a single mother at a young age, and now that her children are all grown up and moved away, she's living the youth she never had. Deep down, she fears she has no identity outside of caring for others.

Crawlers can make her CONFIDENT by helping her realize her accomplishments are proof of her independence. Otherwise, her morale depends on that of Pebbles and Rivet. She's CONFIDENT if both of them are as well but WORRIED if one falls. If Penthos replaces Nana, he only cares about flirting with everyone he meets. Pebbles and Rivet assume fake Nana is drunk but immediately know something is wrong if they realize she hasn't been drinking.

AI **Toothless Nana. Crocodilian Accountant.**

Level 45.

Iron Tangle Accountant.

We got all sorts of trains running on Lesser Demon MILFs, so don't begrudge this Great-Great GILF getting a ticket to ride. Nana lost her teeth so long ago she doesn't remember how, but she's managed to stay popular with the fellas... maybe even more popular.

Toothless Nana

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
45	14+F	15+F	20+S	5
STR	**INT**	**CON**	**DEX**	**CHA**
35 (+5)	15 (+4)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	40 (+5)

Punch: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Ice Blast: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Ice, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stiff Legs Debuff.

Grease Bomb: 15+F to hit, 2d12 Acid, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains The Taint Debuff.

Notes: *Commanding Voice*—WORRIED Mobs within 15ft who can hear Toothless Nana are immune to Penthos's Demoralize if she's helping the crawlers or have Disadvantage on their Opposed Check if she's helping Penthos.

RIVET

Rivet has a sixth sense when it comes to machine problems. It probably replaced his sense of relationship problems. He's anxious about why the company pulled him from his work. Is it really just to celebrate Hot Toddy, or is it cover to fire him? Crawlers can make him CONFIDENT by persuading him that relationships are more important than jobs or putting him to work disabling traps and repairing damage on the Conga Line.

Penthos knows Rivet's obliviousness annoys his friends and plays into it too strongly when replacing him, such as by making excessively awkward comparisons between people and machines, talking about scrubbing Hot Toddy's oven or Nana lacking dentures because support for her parts is discontinued.

AI **Rivet. Razor Fox. Level 45.**

Iron Tangle Mechanic.

Rivet loves trains. He also loves his partners. Sometimes the ranking order of those two changes, but Rivet has a hyperfixation and he's not afraid to infodump at a moment's notice. Only ask him about his cybernetic enhancements if you have a good four hours free because he will not shut up once asked.

Rivet

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
45	14+F	15+F	20+S	5
STR	**INT**	**CON**	**DEX**	**CHA**
35 (+5)	15 (+4)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	40 (+5)

Punch: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Electric Blast: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Electric, 30ft range
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains The Taint Debuff.

Grease Bomb: 15+F to hit, 2d12 Acid, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Stunned Debuff.

Notes: *Repair*—Rivet's cybernetic implants allow him to use an action to disable, trigger, or reset one piece of sabotaged equipment within 30ft.

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ITEMS

REV-UP AMAZING CURE-ALL VITAMIN IMMUNITY SHOTS™

Euphoria: All your worries melt away for 1 hour.

- Temporary Immunity to all mental Debuffs and effects, including mind control.
- Temporary inability to feel pain (doesn't protect against damage).

Well-Rested?: When Euphoria ends, you immediately fall asleep and remain unconscious for 6 hours if undisturbed. You gain the Fatigued Debuff until you get 6 total hours of sleep.

Addiction: This drug is addictive, and withdrawal begins 8 hours after the last dose, dealing 1d6 Necrotic damage every hour that can't be healed while experiencing withdrawal. Rapid Detox Potions and other similar effects temporarily halt withdrawal symptoms and progression, but only more powerful items or magic can cure the addiction.

DTs: Withdrawal has a 50% chance of turning into DTs (see p. 40) every hour starting 24 hours after the last dose. DTs can't be cured or suppressed, barring divine intervention.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The world freezes, and ominous music, legally distinct from the Jaws theme, plays. Storks with glowing red eyes fly by, holding bundles in their beaks that fall open to reveal combatant portraits separated into three clusters: crawlers and CONFIDENT groups, worried groups, and Penthos and his DESPAIRING minions. A baby's scream cuts the music short before all the portraits explode into diapers.

Penthos the War Mage drops his magical disguise when he's ready to attack. His Spells have long ranges, allowing him to take defensive positions by locking and barricading doors.

He seizes the entertainment controls to blast music for Sonic damage, flashes the lights to distract crawlers, and triggers sabotaged equipment to send cone attacks from fixed points, like Acid from hydraulic lines, Cold from fridge coolants, Electricity from lighting, and Fire from heating vents. Crawlers with hacking Skills and access to a Psycho Sticker's tablet can attempt to regain control.

Penthos looks like a standard War Mage with long white hair and robes, but his skin is stretched so tight it has tears revealing bones underneath. He has a dagger he only uses as a last resort. He prefers attacking through his controlled minions, altering emotions to Buff and Debuff, and using the environment to hurt foes or protect himself. The euphoria induced by Rev-Up Shots makes imbibers immune to his Spells but at the cost of addiction afterward.

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CLUES

- Someone accessing Psycho Sticker's tablet may take control over the electricity, steam, and acid.
- Mimicking an ancient tongue and nonsense magical incantations (via an INT-Opposed Interrupt Performance Skill Check) may temporarily cause the War Mage's Spell to fail.
- Save your anti-Debuff tech for other Bosses.

AI **Penthos. Emotion Magic War Mage.**

Level 62 Borough Boss!

Born from the combination of an Elf Skellie and a Sprite Flesher, this War Mage is emotion magic incarnate. Charm, fear, joy, sorrow—Penthos can do it all. Unfortunately for you, he's mostly filled with anger and a thirst for causing pain.

Maybe it's because his skin is stretched tighter than a writer's finances, or maybe he's just an asshole. All that power at his command, and he doesn't even want to turn people into dinosaurs; his dream is for everyone to kill themselves, starting with the people on this line.

Penthos

Borough Boss; Medium (4), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
5%	10%	15%	21%	26%	31%	36%	42%	47%	52%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	
57%	63%	68%	73%	78%	84%	89%	94%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
62	17+F	16+F	20+S	4
STR	**INT**	**CON**	**DEX**	**CHA**
22 (+5)	100 (+7)	50 (+6)	36 (+6)	65 (+6)

Dagger: 15+F to hit, 7d4+5 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Heighten Emotion Spell: 17+F to hit, No damage, sight range, 15ft Blast radius
Any hit crawlers gain a Debuff of his (GM's) choice for 1 round. On an Evade Major Fail or worse, he applies two Debuffs of his choice for 2 rounds.

Sabotage: 17+F to hit, 6d8 Acid/Electric/Fire/Ice (depends on equipment sabotaged), 15ft Cone from sabotaged equipment
Each sabotaged piece of equipment can only trigger once, unless reset by Rivet. On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Enraged Debuff.

Notes: *Battle High*—Penthos gains +1 to damage after each successful attack; duration lasts until an attack misses, where the count resets and starts over.

Demoralize—Worried Mobs or NPCs must make a CHA Stat Check each round. On Fail, they gain the Terrified Debuff.

Mind Control—Mobs and NPCs with the Terrified Debuff become Penthos's minions. They have only 1 Action per round, and must act as his ally. Penthos can spend one of his Actions to make all minions perform an additional action of his choosing during crawler actions.

Power of a Name—If Penthos knows the true name of an entity, he knows their exact location, and that entity has Disadvantage against his Heighten Emotion Spell.

"From there we'd have to proceed up the train on hands and knees on the goddamned roof of the cars while the ceiling whipped by at a hundred plus miles per hour, all the while traversing 38 open-top cars randomly filled with jumping, snarling monsters. And if there was a war mage in there somewhere, he was probably hiding in one of those cars, ready to ambush our asses when we least expected."

—Carl

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NEIGHBORHOOD: GHOSTLIGHT STATION

FLOOR: 4 — THEME: FOLK HORROR AT THE TRAIN STATION

The roar of the engines, the rattle of tracks, and the shifting sounds of battle fill the tunnels of the Iron Tangle. However, the closer one gets to Ghostlight Station, the less one can hear the sounds of murder and mayhem. They resound as a distant cacophony. High overhead, bright fluorescent lights buzz into a background ambiance covering all manner of scarier noises. The station is made up of a three-story building filled with saferooms, club locations, and even vendors. The residents of Ghostlight Station are friendly folk with wide grins that show perhaps a few too many teeth. Their eyes are cheery and bright, but a darkness haunts their gaze—one that whispers of something they wish they could tell the crawlers.

Ghostlight Station is haunted by the Revengineer, a former engineer who died horrifically with no one responding to his pleas for help as he was steamed alive. As a ghost now, he demands kindness and happiness at all costs in his haunting grounds. Anyone who reminds him of the cruelty he experienced in his death will suffer. Oh, and don't mind the noise you thought you heard, or that figure looming in the corner of your eye. This station definitely isn't filled with fleshless Cornets, Razor Foxes, deadly balloons, and something lurking in the walls that makes Slender Man seem friendly. Those stories about anyone who doesn't smile getting ripped in half by the Revengineer are just meant to keep the visitors in line and definitely don't foreshadow your future.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- The scent of fire and burned flesh fills the station. A moment later, a train pulls in. Doors open and shadows are vaguely seen moving off and onto the train. Something the crawlers are carrying levitates and is heading for a door.
- While the station's hotel bar is pleasant, the proprietor, a Dwarf named Kaybra, seems to be out of sorts. She whispers as she asks the crawlers for help finding the local Grease Gremlin, Chuck, since he's the only one with a key to the passenger car of the Foxville Grapeshot.
- A Moderate group of Gray Cornets linger outside of a station market, preventing anyone from entering or exiting. If you want to shop, they've got to be dealt with.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you'll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- The people of Ghostlight Station are being haunted. While the Ghostlight staff are unwilling to talk about this outright, some vendors whisper about a ghost causing problems. It supposedly dwells in the Service Tunnels. There's good treasure down there too for anyone brave enough to check it out. Pleasant politeness is the law here after the death of the former engineer of the Foxville Grapeshot. If the crawlers are ever rude to the staff of the Ghostlight, or disrespectful of trains in general, they become haunted. Misfortune then follows them through the Neighborhood, causing something to explode or collapse upon them anytime they roll a Natural 1 on a Skill Check—at least until the Revengineer is slain.
- An old Dwarf engineer sits drunk as a skunk on the Sandstone Line, reminiscing about how things were back in his day when he was being trained by an engineer named John. Real shame that John got steamed alive by a faulty boiler. Surely that wouldn't make someone a vengeful ghost haunting their former station, right?

MOBS

The Mobs found in this Neighborhood feel an almost pathological need for complete silence, almost as if they were afraid of something. What can frighten a literal monster? I'm sure it's *nothing* you need to worry about.

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GRAY CORNET

Most Cornets in the dungeon lack skin. These, however, met their unfortunate fate during an orgy with some Energy Vampires. The encounter left them shriveled and corpse-like, their bloody muscles faded to mottled gray and their desiccated lungs unable to produce their sonic attack

These undead creatures appear lethargic at first glance, but the moment they detect crawlers, they lunge, using elongated talons to rip apart their prey. It's a last-ditch attempt to devour a life-force and prolong their wretched existences. Gray Cornets are found mostly at Ghostlight Station and on the Sandstone Line.

AI **Gray Cornet. Level 17.**

You know 'em. You love 'em. It's the old skinless wonder, the Cornet! But unlike the classic Red, this here's a new model, because variety is the spice of life, isn't it? Something drained these Cornets' life-force, leaving them constantly shifting between a lethargic hibernating state and manic desperation. The very presence of warm bodies is enough to attract their attention. Although they've lost their sonic attack, these undead monstrosities make up for it with vicious talons and feral leaps as they desperately seek to consume anything warm.

They just want a cuddle! Awww.

Gray Cornet

Mob; Large (5), Undead

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
17	12+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
19 (+4)	5 (+2)	12 (+4)	19 (+4)	1 (+1)

Feral Leap: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Bludgeoning, 20ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Talons: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Manic*—A Gray Cornet may travel up to its full Move every time it uses Feral Leap.

RAZOR FOX

Masters of stealth and of doing sick flips, these creatures stand at about four feet tall and are dressed head to toe in bodysuits. Although they prefer fighting at range, they're just as deadly in melee. Razor Foxes are found throughout Ghostlight Station and the Service Tunnels.

AI **Razor Fox. Level 22.**

Certain Mobs have names that are clever puns, or allusions to their history, or maybe subtle clues to their origins. The Razor Fox is not one of those Mobs. These humanoid foxes have a penchant for sharp blades and ninja attire, the ladies in red and the gentlefoxes in black.

Each has trained since childhood with one or more specific blades like a comic book character, and one of the two is usually shuriken.

Near, far, wherever you are, they will kill you, and you won't even see them do it.

Razor Fox

Mob; Petite (3), Beast

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
22	13+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
15 (+4)	9 (+3)	12 (+4)	34 (+5)	1 (+1)

Ninja Slash: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Shuriken Throw: 15+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 30ft range

Notes: *Sneaky Quiet*—If crawlers don't surprise attack a Razor Fox, its first round attack is made with Advantage.

"Just keep Smiling. Yes. He's behind you. That doesn't matter now. Smile. It's already too late."

—Kaybra

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GROSS ATOMIZER

Gross Atomizers look almost harmless at first glance, like a cross between a balloon, a dice bag, and some type of soft fleshy bladder. The narrower ends always bob upward as if they're floating through water rather than air. They don't seem to possess any obvious sensory organs, making them more like semi-sentient plants. Despite that, they're sensitive to sound and movement in the atmosphere around them. They'll drift toward their prey and open seams in their bulbous bladders to release poisonous gas.

If they manage to get directly over a target, they open their bladders entirely and drop, enveloping heads or entire creatures (depending on size). Continuous concentrated blasts of gas quickly vaporize organic matter, leaving nothing but nourishing fumes for the Gross Atomizer to feed upon. These Mobs are found throughout the entire Ghostlight Station Neighborhood.

AI **Gross Atomizer. Level 18.**

No, your eyes aren't deceiving you—that disgusting fleshy balloon really is following you! Spreading poisonous gas in the areas around them, these things don't just smell like a toilet bowl after a Taco Bell binge; they also look like one! (Seriously—however disgusting you think its skin feels, I promise it's much worse.)

And if that wasn't bad enough, it doesn't just look like an old-school atomizer. If it has its way, when it's finished, there's gonna be nothing left of your head but atoms.

Gross Atomizer

Mob; Small (2), Aberration

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
18	12+F	14+F	15+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
15 (+4)	5 (+2)	19 (+4)	19 (+4)	1 (+1)

Envelop: 14+F to hit, 2d4+4 Acid, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Poison Cloud: 12+F to hit, 2d6+2 Poison, 10ft Burst radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Gross Atomizers can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.

BRAIN TEASER

Technically speaking, the Brain Teaser is a singular six-foot-long creature with a lamprey-like mouth. However, they're never found on their own, so everyone refers to the whole swarm as a Brain Teaser. They're almost always rolling around one another in knots like a bag of rubber bands after a run through the dryer. When crawlers come within reach, the entire assemblage rears up, forming into the upper torso of a humanoid body with incredibly long arms made of hungry, lunging Brain Teasers. These serpentine abominations are mostly found in the Service Tunnels.

AI **Brain Teaser. Level 20.**

Don't let the name fool you—these creatures don't want to tell you any jokes or riddles. They've got a much more mouth-on approach to changing the minds of crawlers. Some claim they're distant relations of the Gondii, but amazingly enough, no one who's said that loudly enough for the worms to hear are around to repeat it.

The Brain Teasers' lamprey-like mouths prefer the path of least resistance, but if you've thought to cover your ears, they've got no problem chewing through flesh, bone, or muscle or worming their way down your throat like that drunk girl who gave you your first French kiss. You Humans made up the phrase "mind-blowing" a while ago, and now you'll be among the first to feel what it's like to have your mind literally sucked out of your skull! (Don't get upset. We both know you weren't using it anyway.)

Brain Teaser

Mob; Medium (4), Aberration, Swarm

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	14+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	10 (+4)	15 (+4)	19 (+4)	1 (+1)

Bore: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Skull-Cracker: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

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Notes: *Intellect Hound*—Every successful hit from a Brain Teaser causes the crawler to lose Mana instead of decreasing HB slots. Once all Mana has been depleted, the damage affects HB slots.

Mana Depletion—Once all Mana has been depleted from a crawler, each successful attack by a Brain Teaser temporarily Debuffs the crawler's Intelligence by 1.

ENERGY VAMPIRE

Contrary to its name, this creature is not undead. Rather, it's a mostly invisible, ethereal humanoid creature that drains its victims of creativity, intelligence, and, perhaps most importantly for crawlers, their Mana. However, they don't stop there. When all their prey's mental energy is exhausted, if the connection isn't broken, the Energy Vampires drains a victim's cellular energy, leaving them as little more than an emaciated, artificially aged shell.

Energy Vampires resemble Human shadows that are nearly eight feet tall, with spindly arms and fingers that are twice as long as they should be. To start draining a creature, they merely lay on hands. These lanky bastards are primarily found in the Foxville Grapeshot.

AI **Energy Vampire. Level 23.**

Like your friend Keith who won't shut up about Crypto, the Energy Vampire wants nothing more than to drain away your life. Unlike Keith, this thing may actually manage to get something done about its long-term goals.

This creature is attracted to those with high levels of mental, creative, and emotional energy, and it really wants your Mana. However, just because the Mana Points run dry doesn't mean it's finished. It keeps sucking until all but the very last drops of your cellular energy are stripped away.

You won't even leave behind a beautiful corpse.

Energy Vampire

Mob; Medium (4), Outsider

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
23	14+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
1 (+1)	15 (+4)	15 (+4)	19 (+4)	24 (+5)

Devour Energy: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Psychic, 20ft range Any hit crawler loses Mana instead of decreasing HB slots. Once all Mana has been depleted, the damage affects HB slots.

Notes: *Energy Depletion*—Each time a crawler is hit by an Energy Vampire they must make a Con Stat Check. On Fail, they receive a temporary Debuff to both Charisma and Intelligence, each reduced by 2 for 2 hours. Stackable.

ENVIRONMENT

Even the bulkiest of Earth's trains could pass through the Sandstone Line. With red and gray bricks making up the tunnel walls and a surprising amount of rust along the iron rails, this tunnel probably wouldn't pass most safety inspections on earth, but it's A-okay for the World Dungeon. The trains that run upon theses rails shudder a distressing amount as they rumble along.

Gravel covers the floor, with old bits of scrub poking through from underneath like dandelions. The Hobgoblin maintenance teams trim them back religiously, but the weeds always pop back up by the next "morning." Curiously, as the tunnels get nearer to the station proper, a second set of even more destitute tracks appears beside the original. It looks as if someone cannibalized the tracks and ties, leaving them all but destroyed in some areas.

- **Graffiti:** The words "Ssssshhh!" and "It IS his fault!" and "Don't draw his attention!" are written in Syndicate Standard in bright red spray paint on the walls. They vary from being fresh, dripping, and tacky to faded as if centuries old.
- **Train Cars:** Several abandoned and burned-out cars lean against the side of the tunnels. These range from old boxcars to abandoned passenger cars.

TRAPS

The Mobs of this Neighborhood aren't forward-thinking enough to set up conventional traps. However, crawlers should be wary nonetheless as they explore the Neighborhood surrounding Ghostlight Station. The Mobs aren't the only ones who might set traps in this Neighborhood.

- **Snakepit:** No one is quite certain of the Brain Teasers' natural habitat. But if this Neighborhood is anything to go by, it may well be the six-foot pits dug into the ground and filled with water. Brain Teasers lurk in these and pull crawlers inside to attack them.

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- **Atomizer Cars:** The Gross Atomizers aren't particularly bright, but other Mobs in the dungeon (and some enterprising crawlers) have figured out how to move them without setting them off. They often crowd several of them into a tight area (like the car of a train) and lead unwitting crawlers into them.
- **Bullet Train to Hell:** A strange train rolls up to the tracks on the Sandstone Line with the words "Stairwell Down" printed on the side. Crawlers who step on the train quickly realize it is increasing past safe speeds. The engine door is closed but unlocked. The engine is rigged to run on its own, and tampering with it causes it to explode, as does trying to open the doors to the outside. Crawlers have only a few minutes to figure out how to stop it or escape before it derails or explodes, taking them with it.
- **"Accidents":** Crawlers who make too much noise, complain, or are rude to the staff of Ghostlight Station find themselves plagued by accidents: Stairs collapsing beneath them. Ceilings dropping on them. Toilets trying to suck squatters inside. These are all the work of the Revengineer, actively punishing the crawlers. Each instance always includes a rusted bolt dropping at the crawler's feet as a sort of calling card. If a crawler draws his ire; these incidents continue until they defeat him.

ITEMS

Walking through the Sandstone Line and the other parts of this Neighborhood, crawlers may find some of the following:

- **Old Luggage:** These include various roller-bags, briefcases, fanny packs, and everything in between. They typically contain clothes and other accoutrements the average train traveler would have carried during the course of a normal day. Totally ordinary everyday items like business suits, seven severed fingers still dripping blood, socks, dildos, pencils, a bag of steaming poop, or a feather boa, for example.
- **Train Parts:** In the areas of the Neighborhood that aren't Ghostlight Station proper, train parts litter the tunnels and tracks. They range from pieces as small as a bolt to those as large as a fallen wheel, or even the better part of an engine block.
- **Fallen Bricks and Scrap Metal:** In Ghostlight Station, one must constantly step over broken pieces of the walls and ceiling. NPCs of the area step over them as if oblivious to their presence.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood, each with its associated reward:

- **Tuck and Roll:** "You escaped a runaway train that was an obvious trap! Congratulations! That's almost as impressive as falling for it in the first place! *Reward:* You've received a Silver Survivor's Box! (It would have been Gold, but I deducted points because you're an idiot.)"
- **Haunted Attitude:** "You've become the target of a ghost's vengeance. Your obnoxiousness ensured that a vengeful spirit now has it in for you in particular! *Reward:* Let's wait to see if the ghost doesn't make you into one of its kind before we talk about rewards."
- **He Who Smelt It, Dealt It:** "You used a Gross Atomizer as either a weapon or a trap. *Reward:* You've received a Silver Trapmaster's Box!"

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers might think twice about making noise around Ghostlight Station by grinding monsters for endless experience. This is not an excellent way to survive this Neighborhood, and Table 90 reveals just a few of the complications crawlers may face.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: GHOSTLIGHT STATION

Ghostlight Station is a three-story building that was once a small hotel in the world above. It's old and plastered, sporting the remains of a shingled roof. Inside, the halls have many doors leading to rooms where several NPCs live. The door that lead to the lobby now leads to a hotel bar, overseen by a female Dwarf named Kaybra.

Different restrooms and vendors are scattered throughout the station's different floors. It is, in essence, a settlement without guards. However, every single NPC in Ghostlight Station is constantly smiling and stressing the importance of keeping your voice down.

Chuck, the local Grease Gremlin, has gone missing. Kaybra, the de facto leader of the settlement, asks the

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crawlers to look for poor Chuck since he has the key to the Foxville Grapeshot. He can be found hiding in the attic. He speaks of a wicked shadow that haunts his nightmares, and how he feels sicker and sicker every morning. He moans that he deserves it, but he will not expand further.

If the crawlers succeed in talking him down with a Persuasion or other Charisma-based Skill Check, he gives them a key that opens the doors to the Foxville Grapeshot. If the crawlers listen to Chuck and keep an eye on him while he sleeps, they see him visited in the night by an Energy Vampire.

Strangely, the creature does not immediately engage with the crawlers, opting instead to escape into the shadows. If the crawlers pursue the Energy Vampire, it flees into the remains of the Foxville Grapeshot.

QUARTER: SANDSTONE LINE

The Sandstone Line is a modern subway train with English-language signage. The onboard voice and announcements have a decidedly British accent reminding people to mind the gap.

Crawlers that ride this line as far as they can find that every day, at a rough equivalent to "morning," a dozen Gray Cornets board the train, ride for precisely

TABLE 90: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers chase a Razor Fox into a seemingly abandoned train. The moment roughly half the crawlers are in the car, the door slams shut, and a strong group of Gross Atomizers rolls from the luggage racks, slowly drifting toward the trapped crawlers. The Razor Fox giggles and escapes through a small hole.
2	The crawlers come upon a pair of Red Cornets stalking through the tunnels. As the crawlers watch, a shadow detaches from the wall and grasps a Red Cornet. It shrivels, struggling weakly before turning gray and lunging for its compatriot. The crawlers haven't been noticed yet.
3	Another crawler screams at the top of their lungs at a Bopca, and then storms out past the PCs. A few moments go by, and there is a loud crash. Examining the source reveals the crawler is buried under rubble, a rusted bolt rolling at their feet.
4	As the crawlers round a corner, they find themselves staring at a Moderate group of Razor Foxes battling against a Weak group of Gray Cornets. One of the Razor Foxes notices the crawler party and launches a shuriken at them, in an attempt to draw them into the fight.
5	A dry rustling sounds ahead, followed by sounds of a struggle, two loud crunches, and a horrific scream that reverberates through the tunnel. Rushing ahead reveals a Weak group of Brain Teasers feasting on the brain of a fallen crawler. Another Weak group of Brain Teasers lingers nearby.
6	Crawlers drawn by the sounds of screaming watch in horror as a Human crawler struggles in the grasp of an Energy Vampire and begs them for help.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- You hear the sound of battle ahead of you and spot a Mole Man NPC desperately defending itself against a pair of Razor Foxes. It feels like something is watching you.
  Outcome: If the crawlers assist the Mole Man NPC, they receive a coupon that takes 5% off a Personal Space or upgrade. If they don't, they are haunted by the Renegineer.
- The Kaybra, the Dwarf proprietor responsible for the station, seems to purposely ignore the crawlers, clearly frustrated with something. The crawlers catch glimpses of someone or something watching from a distance, but can't locate it if they try.
  Outcome: If the crawlers are kind or understanding, the Dwarf apologizes and assists them. If not, they are haunted by the Revengineer.

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seventeen stops, and then disembark. One stop after they disembark, the train pulls into a smaller "service platform" for precisely fifteen minutes. During this time, the door to the engineer's cart unlocks.

If the crawlers attempt to open the engineer's door when the train stops, they find themselves face to face with a Mantaur in the middle of injecting steroids. He is identical in every way to a normal Mantaur, save for his British accent. He immediately attacks the crawlers for interrupting his "me time."

Aside from the Gray Cornets, the only Mobs on board are those typical of most colored lines on the Tangle (the engineer, the conductor, the Jikininki, and the porters). The Gray Cornets detect any hidden crawlers the moment they're aboard, and they attack. They attempt to follow crawlers from car to car and are large enough that only one can fit through a door at a time. (They are also distractible, as they attack any living crawler or NPC.)

The conductor for the Sandstone Line is an old portly Dwarf named Lloyd. Every day, he begins the train ride already half drunk. He will not initiate conversation with the crawlers but will happily talk with anyone who says hello to him. He waxes poetic about John, the former engineer of his old train, the Foxville Grapeshot. If the crawlers can keep the Gray Cornets from killing Lloyd, he tells them the story of what happened to John, the kindhearted former engineer of the Foxville Grapeshot.

A drunken Grease Gremlin, Chuck, failed to check the pressure release valve in the Foxville Grapeshot's engine boiler. It released scalding water and steam with such intense strength it peeled through John like a toddler's mom ripping the skin off a grape and left him screaming in agony for help. But no one was willing to risk being a victim of the boiler, so no one came to help until long after John had been boiled alive.

After the story, Lloyd gives the crawlers a key to the Foxville Grapeshot. He had a copy made years ago with the intention of giving John a proper burial but was never brave enough to do it. He asks the crawlers to do what he couldn't: find John's body in the Service Tunnels and put John to rest.

QUARTER: THE FOXVILLE GRAPESHOT

This old derelict train sits directly behind Ghostlight Station. Its black steam-powered engine sits cold and empty, and it is the only car accessible. A red-painted coal cart sits just behind that, followed by several green-colored passenger cars. A strong smell of cooking meat is always in the air. The passenger cars sit tightly locked. Both Lloyd and Chuck have keys, but smart crawlers can probably find a way in.

Once crawlers manage to open the passenger cars, the Energy Vampires that reside in the shadows of the old train attack unless the PCs were very quiet. The group is at least Moderate, if not more threatening, and the Energy Vampires do not fight fair. They attempt to attack and then fade back, dealing slow, steady damage to the crawlers.

When the Energy Vampires are slain, crawlers looking through the passenger cars find the journal of one "Revvin' John," the engineer of the Foxville Grapeshot. The handwriting is hard to make out without some form of language Skill, such as Linguistics or Conlanging or a professional skill related to messy handwriting: It is easily translated by any of the NPCs in the Neighborhood).

It tells the story of a man obsessed with politeness, with a desperate desire for equality and fair treatment for workers. He recently lost his apartment in the station, so he took up residence in an old office deep in the labyrinthine Service Tunnels, as he doesn't wish to burden his friends at Ghostlight Station. The last entry states that he suspects the Grease Gremlin who works on the train made a mistake, because an odd smell emanates from the boiler.

Crawlers who make a thorough search of the train find an old axe handle used in place of one of the levers. At first glance, it's nothing special. However, a closer look reveals bits of blood upon the weapon. Using it as a club or similar weapon (or crafting it into a weapon) deals an additional +F damage to undead- or ethereal-type creatures.

QUARTER: SERVICE TUNNELS

A small door set into the sidewall of the station proper opens onto a dark, narrow hallway. This quarter is lightless, save for the slowly rotating deep red of emergency lighting above.

These tunnels are densely laid out, and it is very easy to get lost within them. Water drips from above, creating deceptively deep pools. The sides of these tunnels are a complicated mess of pipes and wires. A few bodies with the upper half cooked through line the tunnels. Steam shoots out from old rusty joints every few moments, capable of melting the skin off a normal Human and inflicting mild damage on crawlers.

The floors of the service tunnels are old, cracked, and prone to giving way. The Brain Teasers have made use

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of this, creating pits of water covered with a light layer of floating pebbles that are difficult to see in the relative darkness. Brain Teasers wait for crawlers within these pits. While they prefer ambushing crawlers that fall in, they also rear up from their snake pits and attempt to drag in unwary crawlers passing by.

Crawlers may discover a door in the bowels of the Service Tunnels. The first time the crawlers happen upon it, Kaybra, the leader of Ghostlight Station, is kneeling in front of it, lips moving softly as if offering a prayer.

The crawlers' presence surprises her. She becomes evasive when questioned unless the players reveal information from John's journal. Kaybra eventually reveals her prayer offers respect to her departed friend. She then sighs, reminiscing briefly about how John was always more afraid of drowning. She leaves quickly after that (especially if the crawlers suggest they're going to open the door).

The moment crawlers turn the doorknob to open the door, all the ambient noise dies. After a moment's pause, time will slow down as the B-B-B-Boss Battle! begins.

NPCS

The NPCs of Ghostlight Station mostly work for the station itself:

CHUCK

A Grease Gremlin handyman, Chuck keeps the station's machinery in working order and works almost nonstop to repair the different parts of the station. He is quiet and evasive, and leaves almost every situation in which his past is referenced.

Once upon a time, he was a train mechanic for the trainyard. However, he caused a boiler failure, costing Revvin' John his life and Chuck his job. Not long after that, he moved into Ghostlight Station, intent on trying to make up for his mistake.

AI **Chuck. Grease Gremlin. Level 38.**

Handyman of the Ghostlight Station.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

The stereotypical Grease Gremlin might be a mischievous force of destruction, delighting in ripping machines apart: they are also exceptional mechanics. Of course, this also makes them exceptional mechanics. You can already tell this one is a bit strange. He's wearing a too-wide smile, yet his eyes hold incredible sadness.

KAYBRA

The de facto leader of Ghostlight Station, Kaybra is typically warm and friendly, and her drinks are legendary. These days, however, many things weigh upon her mind. She still does her best to take care of crawlers, but she's afraid to tell them all she knows.

AI **Kaybra. Dwarf Proprietor. Level 37.**

Cook and Proprietor of Ghostlight Station.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

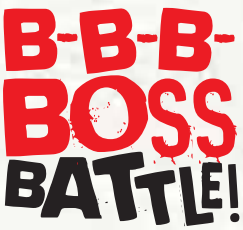
She's got the widest of smiles, but the whites at the edges of her eyes harbor more fear than friendliness. Her focus is on taking care of Ghostlight Station and keeping her people safe.

LLOYD

An older, exceedingly portly Dwarf, Lloyd has worked the trains for his entire life. Before he served as the conductor aboard the Sandstone Line, he was the conductor for the Foxville Grapeshot. He was present the day Revvin' John died. He can still hear the screams when he closes his eyes.

AI **Lloyd. Dwarf Conductor. Level 35.**

You see a Dwarf before you that... well, frankly, you're a little amazed he's still alive. You knew Dwarves could get old, but you weren't aware of just how old they could get. This one looks like he used to yell at the Earth for cooling its molten core on his lawn.



The moment the crawlers crack open the door of the passenger car, Revvin' John's former home, the Boss Battle begins. The Revengineer blows the doors off the hinges, potentially causing damage to the crawler who attempted to open it. The ghost then begins to chase the crawlers through the Service Tunnels. If his diary has been read, crawlers gain insight that he is vulnerable when touching water.

The mugshots of the crawlers and the Boss appear. A loud train whistle trails into an agonized scream, as a cartoon train rolls onto the HUD, dropping the word "Versus" between the mugshot of the Revengineer and those of the crawlers. Fire emerges from behind

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the Versus to envelop the mugshots, and then the entire assemblage fades away.

The Revengineer is immune to most forms of damage. The exceptions to this are when he is in water, such as when he is submerged in a snake pit or in the middle of a steam jet. He is invisible when moving through shadows, and he can teleport short distances to appear in front of crawlers. He spends the entire fight screaming for someone to help stop the pain.

CLUES

- This Boss only takes damage from weapons or attacks that affect ephemeral foes unless he is wet
- The Revvin' John's diary reveals he's terrified of drowning and water in general (see p74).
- Having been killed by steam, the Boss isn't too fond of it. Steam can keep him at bay.

AI **The Revengineer. Vengeful "Protector."**

Level 41 Neighborhood Boss!

Ohhh, fuck. What the fuck is that thing?

Wow, I didn't know a ghost could look like a sausage that's been boiled for 40 years and then rolled around in some dirt for good measure. Holy balls—you're still only seeing the mask. I can see his entire face, and it makes the Pillsbury Doughboy's asshole look downright beautiful.

Revengineer

Neighborhood Boss; Medium (4), Undead

5	5	5	5	5	5	5
17%	14%	21%	28%	35%	42%	50%
5	5	5	5	5	5	5
57%	64%	71%	78%	85%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
41	15+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
38 (+5)	30 (+5)	40 (+5)	30 (+5)	10 (+4)

Fire Axe: 15+F to hit, 5d10+5 Fire, 5ft range

Burning Agony: 14+F to hit, 4d8 Fire, 30ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Notes: *Fleeting*—Unless he is wet, the Revengineer is immune to damage that does not specifically affect ephemeral enemies.

Steam Punked—The Revengineer died by steam and is afraid of it. Crawlers Evade all his attacks with Advantage if he's within steam, or merely his next attack if he is sprayed with steam.

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NEIGHBORHOOD: JUNKYARD JUMBLE

FLOOR: 4 — THEME: TRAIN JUNCTION TURNED INDUSTRIAL ABATTOIR

Flickering fluorescent lights cast long shadows throughout the maintenance station, strobing over a jumble of partially dismantled trains blocking the tracks beyond. This junction, originally intended to pull trains off the line for repair and rerouting, no longer functions. Shunting lines branch off the main path, littered with lift frames, couplers, and remnants of a heavy line-clearing arm, the bones of which are positioned over disabled railcars. Every machine is stripped of critical components, every surface festooned with broken metal, globs of flesh, and sticky blood.

Around the station, Grease Gremlins scavenge anything not bolted down, hoarding their finds in a network of cramped maintenance alcoves. This hidden encampment boasts the only reliable power and tenuous safety in the Neighborhood. Fleshers hunt the unwary in darkness while packs of Babababoons surge along gantries above, their bodies augmented with crude grafts of steel and wires.

Meanwhile, purpose-built Harvesters patrol the station, seizing living targets and hauling them toward dismantling sites from which massive Bone Collectors shamble. These sacks of sagging flesh and stolen skeletons fall upon prey, harvesting bones and growing denser and more dangerous as they incorporate new frames into their bulk.

Deep within the Neighborhood, Flavisham the Tinkerer feverishly anticipates an influx of new parts.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- The party's train stops at the maintenance station, unable to go farther due to railcar debris blocking the track. Ahead, a switching junction allows the crawlers to select the line they want, but their engine can't get past the mess of steel on the tracks without clearing it first. The party could find a machine to do this, but will discover that it's missing parts (*Outer Platform Junction*, p. 483).
- The crawlers hear about a master artificer and inventor, capable of repairing anything he touches and crafting durable items from scrap. Rumor is, he works out of a maintenance station on the line.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- The crawlers meet Frankie being chased by a Harvester in the Outer Platform Junction. She offers information, like the location of the component missing from the clearing arm, if the crawlers escort her safely to the Grease Gremlin Enclave. Once there, she reveals the part was taken to the Factory Line and claimed by the Tinkerer. If the party wants to use the junction, they must find his workshop and take the component back.
- The crawlers descend the Dropworks, discovering terrified station employees under Supervisor Henrique. If the crawlers undermine his authority and convince the workers to abandon their posts, they receive signal dampeners, which cause Harvesters to ignore the wearer unless the PCs attack or otherwise interfere with the Harvester. They also receive information about a dead crawler in a smashed elevator.
- The crawlers push into the Factory Line, where Harvesters break down materials and create constructs in the Assembly Bay. They discover a crawler, Gus, shackled to the Disassembly Line, about to become scrap. If they free him, he identifies himself as a member of the same party as the deceased crawler in the elevator and confirms rumors of a hidden workshop filled with high-level gear. Following his direction leads the party to Flavisham's Workshop.

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MOBS

Flesh and metal are interchangeable in the maintenance station. Most Mobs here are either actively harvesting new parts or fleeing something that is.

BABABABOON

Enormous ape-like Mobs, Babababoons move in loud and destructive groups, roaming the open walkways and gantries of the maintenance station. In this Neighborhood, they're augmented with steel braces, collars, and metal plates bolted almost haphazardly over flesh and into bone. Loose wires emerge from their skulls, hissing and sparking when they grow agitated or excited.

Babababoons exist to break things. A pack can reduce a room to its constituent components in minutes, pounding on walls, supports, and platforms until there's nothing left but twisted scrap for the Harvesters.

AI **Babababoon. Level 17.**

Sure, dynamite is faster, but you gotta admit it's fun watching a bunch of these guys go apeshit on something you want broken. Babababoons are pretty stupid and violent at the best of times, but these were put through a factory line and spat out with shiny chrome plating and a whole new lease on ending life. Did I mention they come in bunches?

Babababoon

Mob; Medium (4), Beastly

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
17	12+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
18 (+4)	5 (+2)	15 (+4)	16 (+4)	2 (+1)

Wild Swing: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Slashing, 5ft range

Fecal Fling: 14+F to hit, 2d4+4 Bludgeoning, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Augmented*—A Babababoon has crude cybernetic augmentations throughout their body. They take ×2 damage from Electric attacks.

BONE COLLECTOR

Bone Collectors are enormous amorphous sacks of sagging flesh haunting the disassembly floors. Resembling a grotesquely swollen mass of skin stretched over a bowl of pudding, a Bone Collector is created when a crawler or NPC's entire skeleton is removed and the resulting gelatinous puddle is revitalized through a combination of magic and mechanical engineering.

When a Bone Collector encounters a still-moving snack, it throws itself on them with crushing force, pinning the victim while internal grinders and compression organs begin their grisly work. They tear their targets apart and absorb them into their mass, adding bulk and weight. The largest Bone Collectors grow to the size of a minivan, and their bulbous bodies prickle with dangerous protruding bits of the bones they've consumed.

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AI Bone Collector. Level 20.

Like a cross between a black lab and an abattoir, Bone Collectors are the perfect answer to the question "what do we do after the five-second rule?" You'll notice they're not called Squashers or Jelly-Blobs. They jiggle like jam and love a good compressive asphyxia, but these horror shows only pin you down so they can start sucking out your bones through every available orifice. Better or worse than a Flesher? Only your orthopedist knows for sure!

Bone Collector

Mob; Large (5), Aberration

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	12+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
22 (+5)	3 (+2)	20 (+5)	19 (+4)	1 (+1)

Grind: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Pounce: 15+F to hit, 3d4+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *Oozy*—A Bone Collector can squeeze through size Small (2) and larger openings.

FLESHER

Fleshers are loose sheets of skin clinging to the upper reaches of the maintenance station. They hang beneath gantries, across ceiling braces, and in the dark spaces above open walkways, folding and unfolding slowly as air currents push them around.

When something living passes underneath, a Flesher drops and spreads, sealing itself tight over its target in a single motion. The unfortunate victim suffocates and melts, flesh burning away until only bone remains. The moment the creature dies, the Flesher casts the Boned Spell, reanimating the remaining skeleton into a Skellie. The two merge, forming a symbiote that staggers off looking for more trouble.

AI Flesher. Level 10.

You ever have the perfect hug? You know the one. Like you're warm and safe, wrapped up tight like nothing bad will ever touch you again? Yeah, this ain't like that at all. This is like a cuddle with Ed Gein, only he's melting your face off while the two of you get cozy. Honestly, even I'm kinda disgusted by these things.

Flesher

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	13+F	14+F	25+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	7 (+3)	6 (+3)	11 (+4)	1 (+1)

Boned Spell: 13+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
This ability can only be used on Skeletons. Any hit skeleton becomes animated and under the control of the Flesher.

Smother: 14+F to hit, 2d4+4 Acid, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Burned and Held Debuffs.

Notes: *Fire Immunity*—Fleshers take no damage from Fire.

Re-Sleeving—When a Flesher attacks and consumes a Symbiote, it becomes a more intelligent and powerful Symbiote.

Symbiote Formation—When a Flesher successfully animates a skeleton, the two combined entities become a Symbiote.

War Mage—If a Symbiote is re-sleeved at least a dozen time, it becomes sapient and fuses into a single powerful being known as a War Mage.

GREASE GREMLIN

Grease Gremlins are small and wiry with oversized eyes and fingers permanently blackened by industrial lubricant and chemical runoff. They're skilled mechanics who delight in taking things apart. Sometimes they even put them back together again.

They infest the service ducts, crawlspaces, and maintenance alcoves of the station. If cornered outside their encampment, they react with terror, claiming that they're being hunted by some mysterious... thing... whenever they leave their encampment. When they do emerge, it's only to salvage or jury-rig a

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connection to the station's systems. They move quickly, argue constantly, and don't care much if something terrible happens to someone else, providing the remains don't gum up the gears of whatever they're currently working on.

AI

Grease Gremlin. Level 19.

They're small, they're greasy, and they're very, very busy, so don't ask them to fix your shit. Helpful Grease Gremlins are the reason half the station hasn't collapsed into a smoking pile of scrap yet. Of course, the rampages of less-than-helpful Grease Gremlins are also the reason the other half has collapsed, caught fire, and currently smells of advanced athlete's foot. If one of these guys offers to "repair" something for you, make sure to ask for some credentials, and maybe check what your life insurance policy has to say about "sudden, violent, explosive death."

Grease Gremlin

NPC; Small (2), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
19	14+F	15+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	11 (+4)	13 (+4)	22 (+5)	3 (+2)

Fast Disassemble: 14+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
Any hit crawler has one carried or worn mechanical device (usually a weapon or piece of armor) disassembled and made unusable until the crawler spends two actions to reassemble it.

Multi-Weapon: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, Piercing, or Slashing (their choice), 5ft range

Notes: *Fast Assembly*—A Grease Gremlin can repair a mechanical device in one third the normal time.

Irritable Worker—A Grease Gremlin ignores crawlers while the Grease Gremlin is repairing items. When a crawler disrupts their repair work, a Grease Gremlin gains Advantage on their first attack against that crawler.

HARVESTER

The rapid click of mechanical spider legs, scream of fatigued metal, and wet rending of joints being torn from sockets are all hallmarks of small industrial wrecking machines known as Harvesters. Each one is a mess of clamps, cutting wheels, piston-driven mandibles, and retractable hooks built from mismatched hardware, train parts, and bits of unlucky crawlers and NPCs.

Harvesters often travel in clusters to speed disassembly and material harvest, moving along walls, ceilings, and floors. Once a desirable component is identified, they latch on with locking clamps, anchoring their quarry in place while their cutting tools go to work. The Harvesters strip the target into portable pieces, dragging the resulting chunks away through maintenance shafts toward deeper sections of the station.

AI

Harvester. Level 15.

I love industrial workplace safety videos. Really, I do! What a hoot. My favorite part is when they start talking about what happens if you get caught in the machinery. That's exactly what it feels like when you encounter these guys. And then they cut off your arms and legs with a dentist's drill welded to a tiny whistle. You get the idea. Not to worry, though, they're pretty small. I bet you can take one. Shame they rarely travel alone.

Harvester

Mob; Small (2), Construct

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	13+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
15 (+4)	8 (+3)	10 (+4)	16 (+4)	1 (+1)

Cauterizer: 14+F to hit, 3d4+4 Fire, 20ft range
On an Evade Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Man-Opener: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Cluster Fucked*—When two or more Harvesters attack the same target, they gain Advantage on their attacks.

Signal Senses—Harvesters ignore crawlers wearing signal dampeners.

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ENVIRONMENT

The maintenance station is gutted. Lights flicker above twisted steel and shattered mechanics. Train hardware lies torn apart and scattered across platforms. Control panels hang stripped and sparking. Heavy maintenance equipment sits stalled in place. The whole Neighborhood feels like it's been caught mid-autopsy.

As Flavisham's minions perform their harvest, critical infrastructure support was removed, weakening the corridors and rooms. Harvesters and other Mobs have scoured the place for parts, undermining critical infrastructure in the process. Some of the corridors and rooms have collapsed, leaving cramped ductwork as the only means of travel throughout much of the station.

Blood pools in every seam of the floor, tacky where the aftermath of recent "work" hasn't dried yet. Streaks lead to overflowing drains clogged with hair, shredded clothing, and splinters of bone too small for salvage. Throughout the Neighborhood, partially processed remains lie abandoned, ribs jutting out of ragged wounds, internal cavities completely emptied.

Screams echo from the deep places, often silenced suddenly. Like the death throes of some great mechanical beast, a violent shudder runs through the station intermittently, suggesting either structural instability or something huge and destabilizing happening below.

- **Grease Gremlin Enclave:** The Gremlins have carved out a small pocket of comfort and relative safety in the ruined station. Here the smell changes from that of blood to moist soil and cooking spices. Tools hang within arm's reach everywhere, and vendors populate the main aisle in an improvised but lively marketplace. A makeshift electrical system delivers mostly stable power, drawn from jury-rigged generators and cabling along the ceiling. Conversations and laughter bubble throughout.
- **Disassembly Line:** A bank of steel tables runs the length of a cavernous industrial hall with conveyer belts feeding harvested parts into blades and grinders. Overhead tracks bearing shackles transport materials before dropping cargo onto the line. Bins crowd the wall, and Harvesters shuffle back and forth sorting pieces: organic into one, mechanical into another. The smell of blood and hot metal hangs thick and heavy here.
- **Storage and Maintenance Hub:** A broad fabrication space liberally covered in oil and industrial waste stretches beneath a canopy of hanging chains and half-built constructs. Babababoons dangle on hooks, with plating bolted over their muscles and wiring threaded through their ribcages. Harvester husks hang on racks next to neatly arranged stacks of limbs, gears, and vertebrae on rolling carts, waiting to receive organic components.

TRAPS

Babababoons and Fleshers don't set traps, and Harvesters rely on numbers to overwhelm crawlers and NPCs. However, the station features some systems repurposed to contain, pacify, or prepare organic materials for the Disassembly Line.

- **Extraneous Material Sloughing Sprinkler:** A modified fire suppression system laced throughout the station ceiling. When triggered by high heat or an explosion, nozzles deploy, drenching the area with a pressurized slurry of enzymatic solvent. The mixture melts exposed flesh and eats into plastic and metal.
- **Overhead Retrieval Grid:** Industrial hooks and heavy chains hang from high ceilings. When blood is spilled in a room equipped with this trap, the grid awakens. Chains lash down, wrapping around crawlers while hooks seek gaps in armor, embedding themselves in the victim's flesh before hauling them upward to dangle above the floor. Harvesters arrive soon after to process trapped prey.

ITEMS

Items lie scattered throughout the maintenance station, remnants of interrupted repair work and halted processing.

- **Broken Parts Cart:** A steel-framed cart missing a wheel sits loaded with sorted components. Scrap sits in neat piles on the bed next to buckets of wire. Beside them lies a mixed stack of unrecognizable bones. Fully loaded, the cart weighs 500 pounds.
- **Industrial Battery Packs:** Compact briefcase-sized battery packs rest in haphazard piles, most of them dented and seeping acid. Thick insulated cables trail from each of them.
- **Coolant Drum:** A heavy metal barrel branded with hazard symbols lies on its side. One end is punctured and leaking a viscous green goo. At half full, it weighs about 100 pounds.

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ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in the maintenance station:

- **Hand-Picked:** "You ripped a Harvester apart using nothing but your bare hands. Yikes.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Apparel Box."
  Contents: Reinforced work gloves with DR 2.
- **Fight the Powa:** "You toppled Henrique's authority and got his employees to walk off the job. Unionizing a death factory? Bold move. Don't get any ideas, bucko.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Teamwork Box."
  Contents: An offer of union admittance. You pay 5% of all earned gold for union dues; You get a +2 damage Buff against Bosses.
- **Trash Compactor:** "A Bone Collector sat on you, but you crawled out with your spine intact. Count your pinkies though; they love those.
  Reward: You keep all your bones. For now."
- **Neighborhood Watch:** "The real reward is the friends you make along the way! Technically, I made most of the friends in this dungeon. The Grease Gremlins are just some you didn't brutally murder.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box."
  Contents: A Community Service patch providing a +2 Buff to Charisma.
- **Ram Scoop:** "Turns out the weakest point of the death-mech was the screaming engineer inside. You yanked the Tinkerer out of his robot before killing him. Rude.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Mechanics Box."
  Contents: A machine-based weapon or combat-focused item, or parts and tools to craft your own.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers hack through some Harvesters and bloody some Babababoons, they might want to grind for experience. Mobs in the station react like an immune system, increasing in concentration and aggression when they detect invaders. Table 91 indicates some events that may happen during the grind.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: OUTER PLATFORM JUNCTION

The outer reaches of the maintenance station occupy this quarter. From the arrival platform and switching junction, employee accessways lead to the station's

TABLE 91: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	Cries for help emanate from behind a large rocky outcropping. If the crawlers investigate, they find a tape recorder is the source of the cries. The first crawler to touch it starts up that same cry for the remainder of the grind.
2	The crawlers come across a pack of Babababoons toying with a station employee. If the crawlers approach, he cries out "Oh no! More of them!" He runs inside his small shack and the Babababoons run off scared as shit. 15 seconds later the shack explodes: 3d6 Fire, 15ft Burst radius +10ft Splash, as he takes off strapped to an overclocked jetpack.
3	A support fails, and crawlers fall through the floor into a twisting metal labyrinth filled with Bone Collectors and Harvesters. They're hunted in the dark corridors until they find a way to escape.
4	The crawlers come across Babababoons and Harvesters beginning the disassembly of a supply room. Next to them is a forklift, its bed loaded with volatile chemicals. The room can be cleared with an explosion, but it'll destroy the supplies inside.
5	A lone Babababoon sits in a corner of the Dropworks, sounding out words from a repair manual. His augments grant him higher intelligence, and he questions his destructive instincts. He'll trade the location of a saferoom for his life.
6	The crawlers enter a dark corridor filled with soft rustling sounds. An Overwhelming number of Fleshers hang upside down from the ceiling like bats. Moving through without disturbing them is possible, but any noise or touch awakens them all.

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- *A jagged hole opens up in the floor ahead, deep and dark. You can't just walk around it, as it reaches across the entire floor.*
  Outcome: Jump the gap, rig something to cross it, or detour through maintenance ducts.
- *A Babababoon drops from above, screeching as it snatches at you before swinging off through the gantries with a stolen prize—something one of the crawlers was holding or wearing.*
  Outcome: Give chase and risk drawing other Mobs with noise, or let it go and lose the item.
- *As you walk through the marketplace, you hear shouts. A Weak group of Gremlins argue nose-to-nose over a pile of scrap, voices rising fast.*
  Outcome: Step in and settle the argument, or back off as it turns into a marketplace-encompassing brawl.

interior. Stripped control panels spark and smoke, and industrial railyard equipment lies dead and shattered where it's been pulled apart and abandoned. A tangle of partially deconstructed train cars blocks the junction, gears and glass strewn across tracks beneath a motionless clearing arm.

An elevated signal tower overlooks the blockage, its access ladder sheared off ten feet from the ground. Farther in, collapsed corridors and broken accessways force movement into service ducts and other tight spaces. Harvesters prowl everywhere, popping out of maintenance hatches and wall seams to hunt fresh sources of spare parts.

If crawlers summit and enter the signal tower overlooking the arrival platform, they discover a Grease Gremlin salvage cache. Bundled wiring, canisters of fuel and oil, and a partially dismantled signal lamp are set in a neat pile next to a compact industrial battery bolted to the floor and hooked up to the signal light. The battery is valuable salvage for trade and can also be used to modify weapons, adding +2 Electric damage. But as soon as the battery is disturbed, Harvesters roaming the platform converge on the tower.

As crawlers move through the platform, a Grease Gremlin drops from a hatch above. She skids through oil and blood as a spider-like Harvester claws after her, clicking sharply. When the machine notices the crawlers, it emits a brief electronic chirp and withdraws into the ductwork. The Gremlin, Frankie, thanks the party, warning that the Harvester will return with others. Frankie knows the missing component for the clearing arm that will allow crawlers to unblock the tracks (see *Strong Starts*, p. 478) is in Flavisham's workshop and will trade said information, or a handshake introduction to the Neighborhood vendors, in exchange for an escort to the Grease Gremlin Enclave.

Collapsed corridors and debris force the party into crawlspaces and ductwork to progress. The clicking of metal echoes through the claustrophobic space, growing louder until Harvesters suddenly flow in from ahead and behind. They swarm aggressively, using the close confines to limit crawlers' movement. Prolonged fighting carries noise through the ducts, drawing additional Harvesters from within the station.

QUARTER: DROPWORKS

The interior access shafts of the employee areas plunge downward toward the heart of the station in a dizzying lattice of gantries, ladders, and suspended metal-grilled walkways. An elevator lies smashed far below, its severed counterweight cable hanging slack halfway up the shaft. Most maintenance rooms, tool lockers, and control stations off the causeways are dark, their working parts stripped.

One small pocket of station employees remains barricaded behind locked doors. Under the rigid authority of a low-level supervisor who insists the station is "still operational," they continue their assigned duties as they're picked off one by one. Babababoons swing between walkway railing and cabling, howling feverishly as they destroy anything still whole, while Fleshers drift lazily overhead, waiting for the perfect moment to strike.

Babababoons screech as they drop into view, swinging between gantries and striking before scrambling away again. Many are fitted with crude mechanical augmentations taken from station machinery, such as piston-driven limbs and armor bolted to flesh. They focus attacks on crawlers near ladders, stairs, and open edges, attempting to force a fall.

Behind jammed service doors, the crawlers find a barricaded maintenance room operated by terrified employees. An officious supervisor, Henrique, forces

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the staff to continue making repairs as best they can, even as coworkers disappear or are killed by Mobs. If the crawlers subvert his authority or convince the workers to rebel, the employees offer the party two palm-sized signal dampeners, each worn on a cord. When active, these devices cause Harvesters to ignore the wearer unless they attack or otherwise interfere with the Harvester.

If the crawlers convince the employees to abandon their posts, the supervisor laments he won't finish the latest item on his repair list: a downed elevator with a dead crawler inside at the bottom of the Dropworks. An employee was sent to assess it but never returned.

The smashed elevator lies far below, doors crumpled in and interior crushed. The crawler is pinned within the wreckage, one hand clenched around a Shock Baton: Once per day (as an Action), make a DEX Stat Check at 5ft range. On Success, a mechanical target gains the Shocked Debuff. A biological target gains the Stunned Debuff. Disturbing the elevator doors or shifting the debris sends vibrations through the shaft, drawing Fleshers from above.

QUARTER: GREASE GREMLIN ENCLAVE

The encampment is a knot of interior station spaces: storage bays joined to workshops linked to parts cages, all networked by narrow corridors. Bay doors are welded shut and service hatches barricaded, leaving only a few well-defended points of access. The Enclave's heart is a large warehouse. Wide aisles cut between workbenches, cooking rigs, and market stalls. Lamps and strings of colored lights dangle from anything strong enough to support their weight.

Former offices and storage rooms were claimed as living space, their doors reinforced and labeled with grease pencil. Food grows under lamps in scavenged planters. While not officially in charge, Elder Rosie is seen as the leader here. The refugees created a cozy and self-sufficient habitat where they hide from the Tinkerer.

A Grease Gremlin stumbles from a service corridor, screaming that an interior barricade failed. Something large forces its way through the tunnels toward the warehouse. Frankie or Elder Rosie asks the crawlers for help repelling the threat. A Bone Collector fills most of the corridor, its mass shuddering forward, leaving gore smeared along the floor. Two smaller Bone Collectors cling to it, peeling free as it advances. They leap onto Grease Gremlin defenders, pinning and absorbing them as they scream. Each Bone Collector swells as the bones are consumed.

One corner of the warehouse is filled with planters growing vegetables under mismatched lamps. A toy rail line loops through the beds and around makeshift benches. The little train meant to run on it sits dead on the track. Bennie, a Grease Gremlin mechanic, lies on his side beside the engine car, swearing and looking at a damaged power governor. A few kids hover nearby. Bennie asks the crawlers if they've seen something like the governor, or anything close enough that it could be made to work.

Once the crawlers have either helped repair the train or defeated the Bone Collector incursion, a trenchcoated Grease Gremlin named Vikter approaches them behind the market stalls. He says there's opportunity within the enclave's black market for those who know how to acquire things and can handle a fight. Vikter offers them a job "liberating" a crate of mechanical salvage from the market vendor "Tool and Die Trying." If they refuse, Vikter says they now know too much. A Moderate group of Grease Gremlins steps from the nearby doorway. He gives the crawlers one final chance to agree before violence begins.

QUARTER: FACTORY LINE

The deepest level of the station houses the Disassembly Line and Construct Assembly Bay, where everything dragged down from above is broken apart and rebuilt. The stench of blood, screams of pain, and whines of distressed metal permeate this quarter. Harvesters move constantly, carrying pieces to and fro, while Bone Collectors patrol the floor, absorbing bones, detached eyes, bits of brain, and other organic leftovers.

Harvesters swarm the Construct Assembly Bay, skittering among hanging chains and across walls as they self-replicate. One pins a prone Grease Gremlin to a steel table, collecting a small portion of its glistening brain before scuttling toward a waiting Harvester exoskeleton. Others drag limbs and plating into sorted heaps while wet scraps and bones patter to the floor.

Bone Collectors glide across the gore-slick concrete, swelling as they absorb whatever falls. Nearby, a sealed floor-to-ceiling glass cylinder churns with Fleshers. When a crawler is noticed, the Harvesters leap to attack while Bone Collectors move in for lunch. If the glass cylinder is damaged at any time, it shatters, adding a Weak number of Fleshers into the fray.

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A crawler, Gus (see Below), hangs shackled to a slow-moving disassembly line, wrists locked above his head as he inches toward a bank of blades. Spotting the party, Gus begs for help in a whisper. Harvesters crawl nearby, maintaining the process and ignoring him for now, but if the party interferes with the line, they come to investigate.

Flavisham the Tinkerer operates from a workshop in this quarter, hidden beyond the Construct Assembly Bay. Harvesters move in and out in a continuous flow, delivering intact machinery and viable organic matter for his inspection and use.

If the crawlers rescue Gus, he tells them his party came here chasing rumors of high-level gear hidden in a secret workshop and an engineer who can fix anything. He believes he found the workshop but was hauled away to the Disassembly Line before reaching it. He tells the crawlers to follow the highest concentration of Harvesters. Crawlers who press deeper and pursue the flow of Harvesters eventually find the entrance to Flavisham's workshop; see the *B-B-B-Boss Battle* section later in this chapter.

NPCS

Not much is left alive in the station, and those still here know to keep their heads down... or risk losing them.

ELDER GREASE GREMLIN ROSIE

Wise and wizened, Elder Rosie is the oldest Grease Gremlin remaining in the maintenance station. She's smart, resourceful, but mostly just exhausted. She saved as many of her fellows as she could, leading them down to what's become the Enclave. She won't leave the home she built, but she believes one good turn deserves another, and does her best to feed and help anyone who benefits her community.

AI **Elder Rosie. Grease Gremlin. Level 30.**

Authority isn't always earned at the tip of a knife. Sometimes it's bought through quiet moments, good advice, and making sure the soup doesn't boil over. Elder Rosie's authority comes from that. But also, she does have a knife. I'm pretty sure the lights stay on in here because they're too scared to defy the wrinkled old Gremlin. Help her people, protect her walls, and she'll remember you. Cross her, and she'll remember that, too.

Elder Gremlin

NPC; Small (2), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
30	15+F	15+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
13 (+4)	23 (+5)	23 (+5)	23 (+5)	13 (+4)

Fast Disassemble: 15+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
Any hit crawler has one carried or worn mechanical device (usually a weapon or piece of armor) disassembled and made unusable until the crawler spends two actions to reassemble it.

Knife: 15+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Fast Assembly*—A Grease Gremlin can repair a mechanical device in one third the normal time.

Long Memories—Elder Grease Gremlins will go out of their way to help those who help them and theirs. Crawlers that aid an Elder Grease Gremlin have Advantage on Cha Stat Checks when dealing with them in the future. Those that cross Elder Grease Gremlins gain Disadvantage on Cha Stat Checks when dealing with them in the future.

FRANKIE

Frankie is a scrappy and resourceful Grease Gremlin with a talent for sniffing out the best scrap in the station. Her gregarious nature and keen eye for appraisal mean she's on reasonably good terms with everyone. She knows every vendor in the area and has an almost perfect memory for mechanical parts and their uses. She never gives anything away for free, but she barters information for whatever she needs.

AI **Frankie. Grease Gremlin. Level 19.**

Courage is overrated. Speed and knowing which duct to dive into? Much more reliable. Frankie's a survivor, which is more than can be said for most in the station these days. She's been around the block a few times, she knows where the bodies are buried, and for the right price, she might just tell you. Make sure to pay promptly, though, or you'll end up buried with 'em.

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GUSTAV "GUS" JOHANNSON

A Tigran crawler with a booming laugh, Gus leads with optimism and the belief that if he just tries hard enough, anything is possible. He leaps without looking and makes a joke out of it when he doesn't stick the landing.

His former party got picked off throughout the station. He's going solo after leaving the Neighborhood, but he happily tags along for now if the party wants company. His audience numbers are on the rise, and sticking with him for a while might introduce crawlers to a brand-new group of fans.

AI **Crawler #9,483,176. "Gus."**

Level 21.

Race: Tigran.

Class: Boring Ol' Fighter.

Tigran Warrior

Crawler; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
19	13+F	14+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	7 (+3)	15 (+4)	13 (+4)	6 (+3)

Iron Paw: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

Leg Sweep: 15+5 to hit, 2d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Cat-Like Reflexes*—A Tigran has Advantage on Dex Stat Checks.

Easily Distracted—A Tigran has Disadvantage on distraction related Checks designed to draw their attention away from their current task.

HENRIQUE

Henrique is the Grease Gremlin section supervisor of a rapid-deployment repair team in the Dropworks. He just got this promotion and is far more pleased with himself than the position merits. When Flavisham lost his marbles and began tearing apart the station, Henrique forced his crew to remain at their posts rather than seek shelter. His arrogance and off-putting nature hide a bone-deep insecurity.

AI **Henrique. Grease Gremlin. Level 19.**

You've worked for this guy before. Clipboard clutched like a holy writ, smug, officious, wrong most of the time but convinced his dollar-an-hour raise and "deputy-vice-assistant" title make him sooooo much better than you. A walking office motivational poster. Admit it, you've fantasized about kicking this dude down the stairs, so don't put off till tomorrow what you can do today!

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Flavisham's workshop is a maze of towering scrap and half-built machines hanging from chains. Barrels of glowing chemical runoff overflow, the fluid spreading across the floor. When the crawlers enter, reinforced roller shutters crash down over the exits. Conveyor belts shudder awake underfoot, carrying everything slowly but inexorably toward a crucible of molten metal at the center of the room.

As the workshop comes online, a deep mechanical voice grinds through the chamber announcing the Boss Battle. Crude metal frames weld themselves into existence, sparking in midair, each displaying the image of a crawler. Opposite them in his own frame is a narrow-faced ram-faced Ares in smudged spectacles. Singed wool pokes from his leather apron, sagging under the weight of tools jammed into a front pocket.

Flavisham drops from the ceiling inside a colossal spider-construct. Two chainsaws serving as pincers roar to life while vents between them spit streams of radioactive, corrosive slurry, causing the steel floor to bubble as it melts. The abdomen is open at the top, leaving the bespectacled Caprid working the controls plainly visible.

The death-mech advances like a hunting spider, firing nets from cannons along its belly and herding crawlers toward the moving belts and crucible. If dragged or knocked from the open cockpit, Flavisham feels helpless and calls for Harvesters while he scrambles to get back into the construct.

CLUES

- Go for the legs!
- Being taken from his cockpit leaves the Boss very vulnerable.

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AI **Flavisham the Tinkerer. Rabid Ram Operating a Spider-Bot.**

Level 37 Neighborhood Boss!

Oooh, you're gonna love this one!

Station prodigy and brilliant engineer Flavisham the Tinkerer was a model employee. Used to build toy trains for Grease Gremlin kids. Tuned signal boxes by ear. Stayed late to ensure things ran on time. But the harder he worked, the more frustrated he grew with the limits of his weak, inefficient, biological form. So he set about optimizing himself.

Everything worked better than ever when he started replacing parts of himself with gears and cogs, but when he got to his anterior insular cortex, man, that's when things got fun. He started taking things apart just to see what he could build from their bits. Batteries, trains, people—they're all components to him now.

And you just walked into his workshop like a whole sack of spare parts.

Flavisham the Tinkerer

Neighborhood Boss; Colossal (7), Construct

5	5	5	5	5	5	5
7%	14%	21%	28%	35%	42%	50%
5	5	5	5	5	5	5
57%	64%	71%	78%	85%	92%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
37	15+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
35 (+5)	29 (+5)	30 (+5)	32 (+5)	10 (+4)

Pin-Saw: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Net: 15+F to hit, No damage, 60ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Sludge Spit: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Acid, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Notes: *Bio-Mechanical*—Flavisham the Tinkerer loses all DR and takes ×2 damage when removed from his cockpit. Removing him should take at least two crawlers working together for two rounds and coming up with a great plan.

Attack the Legs—Crawlers can declare attacks against the legs. Only then tell them it's made with Disadvantage. If the Flav loses 2+ HB slots from such an attack, he loses a leg and also loses one Action.

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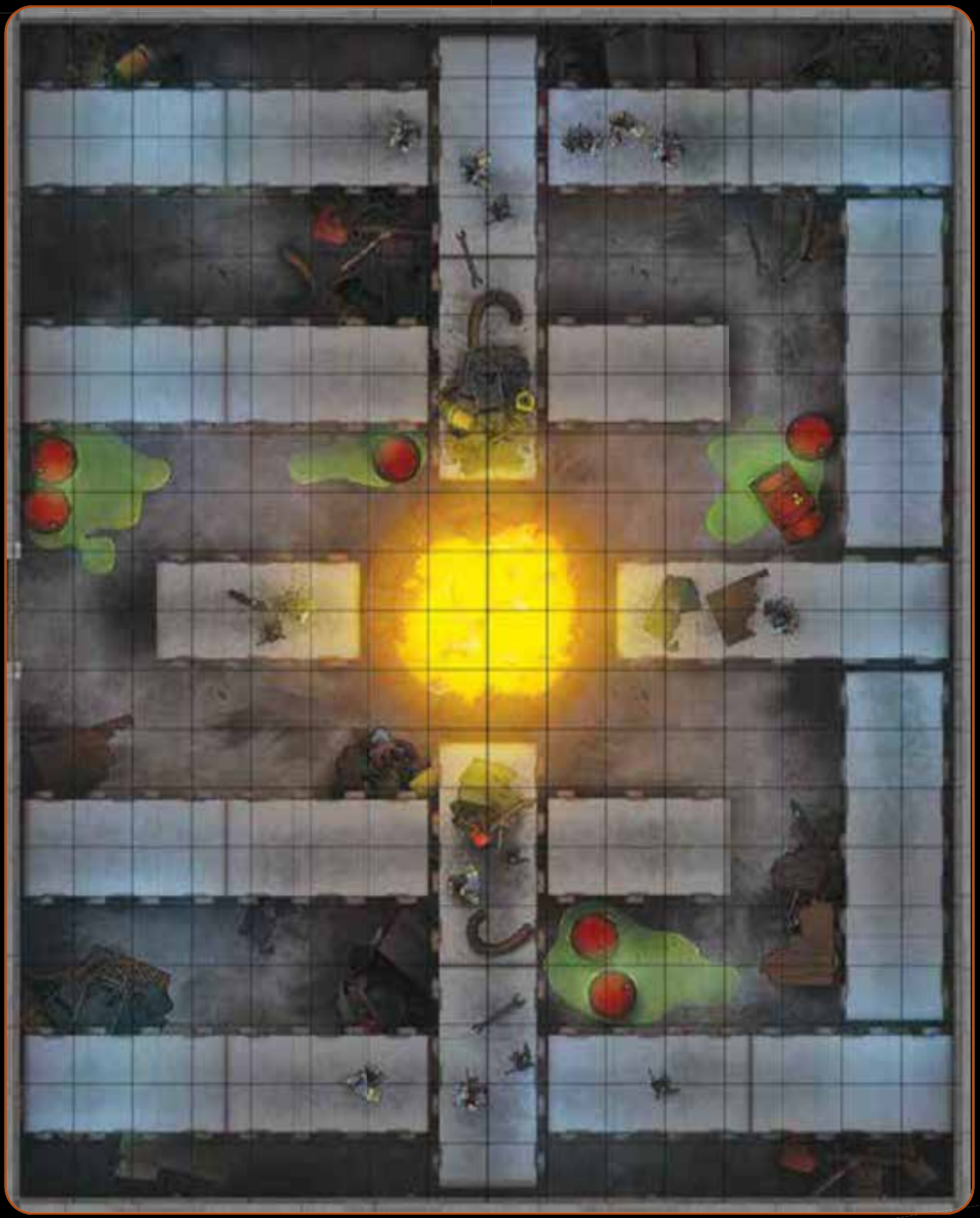

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NEIGHBORHOOD: TUNNELS OF TIAMAT

FLOOR: 4 — THEME: WET CAVES, UNDERGROUND LAKE

The station is old and run down, the shops and guilds abandoned. A wet network of caves connected to the station has walls running slick with moisture and slime. The air is chilly and heavy. The gentle trickling of water echoes through the crisscrossing passages. Outside the station, everything is pitch-black. Crawlers without a light source or the ability to see in the dark are at a severe disadvantage.

The only creatures still calling these caves home are the Cave Mudges and their oppressors, the reptilian Drakes, who took over all the natural caverns in the area, forcing the Cave Mudges to shelter in the station. When the Cave Mudges invaded the station, most of the NPCs there fled or were killed.

Deep inside the station is a temple to Tiamat where the crawlers find Addjya (see p. 497) and a Boss in need of killing.

STRONG STARTS

Here are some ways to hook your crawlers into the Tunnels of Tiamat:

- The crawlers are informed that the best trap store on the floor is at this station, but they find the station infested with Cave Mudges. The trap shop is indeed there, closed, locked, and heavily booby-trapped.
- While exploring the cavernous area around a neighboring station, the crawlers find a rough tunnel leading directly to the underground lake and the Temple of Tiamat.
- At a nearby station, Penelope, a sad mole dealing in potions, laments she's out of Drake eggs, a favorite snack. She offers a discount on her wares if the crawlers return with a captive Drake Bitch.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- Cave Mudges immediately attack the crawlers when they arrive at the station. The number of Cave Mudges is Overwhelming, and they've already slain other crawlers at the station. One living crawler, Declan, has the terminal Ripped in Half Debuff, but can give the crawlers the basic rundown of the Neighborhood before he dies. The crawlers investigate the trap shop and participate in Cave Mudge contests. There they may learn that the Cave Mudges and nearby Drakes can't coexist, and the Drakes may need to be eliminated permanently. This naturally leads to a conflict with Aadhya and a battle against the Neighborhood Boss, King Ghiduckrah.
- The crawlers encounter Aadhya and her pet while grinding Cave Mudges in the Mudge Caves. She implores them to come to the Temple of Tiamat to help her free Tiamat's unjustly imprisoned child, King Ghiduckrah. Having the favor of a goddess is useful, no? She needs someone else to free King Ghiduckrah so she can get to the next level of favor with her goddess. She did not expect to side with the PCs in the Boss Battle, though.

MOBS

The Mobs found in the Tunnels of Tiamat are in a struggle for territory. The Drakes drove the Cave Mudges out of the caves and into the station proper.

CAVE MUDGE BONKERS

Cave Mudge Bonkers are corpulent humanoids that wobble around on spindly legs. Their faces feature porcine noses, beady black eyes, and a mouth full of sharp teeth. They stand about four and a half feet tall, including the wisps of greasy black hair that top their heads. Cave Mudge Bonkers are armed with nail-studded wooden clubs. Crawlers can loot a defeated Cave Mudge Bonker's liver; this is an alchemical supply rumored to used to craft a Potion of Dire Flatulence, among other things.

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AI **Cave Mudge Bonker. Level 19.**

The Bonker is the highest-ranking commoner among the Cave Mudges. Once a member on the galactic stage, these poor fucks regressed. Hard. Probably too much TV or something. Don't worry though. They're still quite handy with a club and they don't call them "bonkers" for nothing.

Cave Mudge Bonker

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
19	13+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
26 (+5)	6 (+3)	12 (+4)	12 (+4)	6 (+3)

Bonk: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

Notes: *Charge*—Bonkers gain 10ft to their Move when moving toward an opponent they intend to Bonk.

CAVE MUDGE JUDGES

Cave Mudge Judges are physically no different than any other Cave Mudges, but they carry gnarled wooden staves and wear a copper necklace that looks like it was made by a four-year-old. They'll drop those as loot (worthless), but occasionally they'll also drop their brains (also worthless except in a few alchemical recipes).

AI **Cave Mudge Judge. Level 20.**

Cave Mudge culture involves elaborate drawn-out contests to determine things like what job a Mudge should have, which Mudges should get married, and which Mudges are simply exiled from the caves. The Judges decide the winners of these contests, and the losers get insults that would make Gordon Ramsey jealous.

Cave Mudge Judge

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	15+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
12 (+4)	20 (+5)	12 (+4)	12 (+4)	9 (+3)

Dirt Clod Spell: 15+F to hit, 3d2+5 Bludgeoning, 100ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Woozy Debuff.

Throw Insult: 15+F to hit, No damage, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

Notes: *Brain Washed*—The brain of a Cave Mudge Judge can be used as an ingredient for potions that boost Perception.

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DRAKE BITCH

Drakes are reptilian ducks the size of small ponies but shaped like waterfowl, including bills and webbed feet. Spines run down their back, and their eyes are those of serpents. Majestic dragon wings take the place of bird wings, and sharp teeth line their duck-billed mouths. Drake Bitches are covered in drab gray-green scales.

AI

Drake Bitch. Level 22.

Drakes are the bungled creations of the Tiamat, Mother of Monsters. She's known for creating all sorts of fearsome mythic monstrosities with poisonous blood. She hopes everyone forgets that she made these.

Because Drake Bitches and Drake Studs do not inhabit the same caves and rarely interact with each other, they must get creative with their mating. Drake Bitches spray clouds of tiny eggs as they go about their business, and after they move on, Drake Studs come by spraying streams of tiny sperm. If you get sprayed with both, you're fucked.

Drake Bitch

Mob; Medium (4), Reptile

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
22	12+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
12 (+4)	3 (+2)	35 (+5)	12 (+4)	9 (+3)

Bite: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Egg Cloud: 14+F to hit, 2d6 Acid, 30ft Cone
Any crawler who loses even one HB slot gains the Ovulated Debuff: A drake egg has lodged itself inside them. Their Health Bar cannot rise above 90% until the egg is removed. This can be done surgically with an Unopposed, but Disadvantaged, First Aid-type Skill Check or powerful healing magic (Rank 10 or higher). Regeneration or similar Skills make the crawler immune to this Debuff. A Potion of Feticide (p. 94) cures this Debuff as well.

Notes: *Fly*—Drake Bitches can move through the air as though on the ground, and their Move increases to 30.

AI

Ovulated Debuff

You've got a Drake egg inside of you! You might be able to get it out, but that won't be pleasant. At least there's nothing nearby that might make this condition worse...

DRAKE STUD

The only difference between Drake Studs and Drake Bitches is that Drake Studs are slightly larger and are more colorful. Their scales are bright green, bright blue or yellow depending on the individual.

AI

Drake Stud. Level 22.

Just to avoid any confusion right off the bat, these creatures are not the same draconic Drakes used as mounts by any Illusionist death cults. Can you imagine the Dread Thaumaturge riding into battle on one of these? It's ludicrous.

No, these Drakes are the comic mistake of the goddess Tiamat, Mother of Monsters. She would prefer everyone forget she's responsible for them. It was a hard time in her existence, you know? She wasn't at her best. But she'll probably still be pissed off if you kill too many of them.

Drake Stud

Mob; Medium (4), Reptile

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
22	12+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
12 (+4)	3 (+2)	35 (+5)	12 (+4)	9 (+3)

Bite: 14+F to hit, 3d8+4 Piercing, 5ft range

Sperm Stream: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Force, 30ft Line
On an Evade Fail or worse, a crawler with the Ovulated Debuff gains the Gravid Debuff: A baby drake starts growing inside them. They lose 1 HB each day, and HB lost this way cannot be healed until the Gravid Debuff is removed. If the crawler reaches 0% HB, they die and a baby drake is born. The Gravid Debuff can be cured the same way as the Ovulated Debuff.

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AI Gravid Debuff

You've got a baby Drake growing inside your head! That's probably not good for you, but... circle of life and all that. If it gestates long enough, you'll "give birth" and "die in the process very painfully." (One of those two statements doesn't actually need quote marks, and both of them are absolutely true.) But hey, at least your fellow crawlers can adopt your beautiful baby as a pet from then on. Maybe they'll even name it after you!

Note: Crawlers might be able to contract the Gravid Debuff in other ways as well, including tromping through nests of fertilized eggs or the looting rooms where Drake Bitches and Drake Studs have both made attacks. Typically this might occur on a Major Fail or Worse when dealing with this sort of biohazard material.

SCHOOL OF MYTHFISH

Mythfish are pale-blue fish that inhabit magical waters. Each individual fish is only about nine inches long, but dozens of them move together with a single mind so a whole school of them constitutes a single Mob. They glow when threatened and psychically overwhelm the senses of predators with mystic visions.

Anyone who eats a Mythfish has a tiny chance of gaining 1 Rank in the (unique) Mythic Seer® Skill if they make a Difficulty 20 Con Stat Check. Using an Action to make an Unopposed Skill Check gives them random, uncontrollable visions into possible futures and provides insight into the motivations and histories of deities. It's far more likely, though, that the crawler spends the next 42 minutes violently vomiting.

AI School of Mythfish. Level 18.

These fish swim the streams of mythology, appearing in waters anywhere that gods and goddesses live. They tap into the quantum concordance of the universe and connect the divine to the terrestrial. That sounds pretty deep and laden with symbolic meaning, but what the fuck does it actually mean? It's designed to seem important, like you're about to receive some kind of cosmic revelation, but smart people with any critical thinking skills easily see through that garbage. It's really just some New Agey bullshit, isn't it?

School of Mythfish

Mob; Petite (3), Fish

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
18	15+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
2 (+1)	20 (+5)	6 (+3)	15 (+4)	16 (+4)

Nibbles: 11+F to hit, 3d6+1 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Fatigued Debuff.

Psychic Visions: 15+F to hit, 2d6+5 Psychic, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Visionary*—A crawler hit by Psychic Visions gains glimpses into the minds of nearby creatures. The crawler gains Advantage on their next Attack or Evade attempt.

ENVIRONMENT

Outside the station, the Neighborhood consists of natural caves and passageways that twist and turn in all directions, crossing over each other and creating a confusing maze for anyone not paying attention. Everything is wet, wet, wet. In the Mudge Caves, it takes the form of mud. In the Drake Caverns, there are plentiful puddles and ponds. And the Temple of Tiamat sits on an island in the middle of an underground lake.

TRAPS

Cave Mudges are too dumb to be any good at traps, and Drakes don't use them either, so the only traps found in the Neighborhood are around the trap shop.

- **Bear Traps:** Crunching bones and chopping legs... why mess with a classic? Well, they'd be more effective if they were invisible, wouldn't they? Let's do that.
- **Bloat-Burster:** A loud bell chimes six times, and a wave of sickening energy makes everyone in the vicinity nauseated. All corpses within 100 feet of the trap explode, doing necromantic damage and infecting creatures with the Sepsis Debuff.
- **Paralysis Poison:** A contact poison around the lock of the trap shop door that paralyzes only the victim's thumbs. It's only an inconvenience, but one that makes picking locks (and picking your nose) markedly more difficult. And it takes days to wear off.

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- **Welleport Trap:** A teleport trap that instantly transports the crawler to the bottom of a vertical shaft filled with water in the Drake Caverns.

ITEMS

Here are some unique items the crawlers might find in this Neighborhood:

- **Massive Drake Skull:** A huge drake skull, twice the size of any drake the crawlers have seen, is half-buried in mud. (Secret: With an Unopposed Fabricate Skill Check, could be turned into a DR 3 skullcap—get it!?)
- **The Pequod:** An 18th century-style whaleboat sits on the bank of the underground lake. All but one of the oars is missing, and the wood of the hull is in dubious condition. (GM: If the crawlers eventually blow it up, they gain 2d6 ×100 Misc. Junk if they spend an hour collecting it.)
- **Plymudge Rock:** A six-foot-tall boulder covered in crude drawings dominates a cave formerly inhabited by Cave Mudges. The art won't win any awards, but the crawlers can find clues to help them with any quests in the area. Taking a rubbing reveals a powerful potion recipe.
- **Puppetry Cache:** A chest full of hand puppets sits open, stolen from the Puppetry Guild. Some of the puppets bear remarkable resemblances to people the crawlers knew in their life before the Crawl. If the crawlers keep them but don't play with them within a day or two, they come to life during the night and interact with the crawlers before "dying." (GM: Explore some Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets.)
- **Potion of Feticide:** Shops at stations near the Drake Bitches tend to sell these, which counter the Gravid Debuff (p. 493). Unfortunately, getting there can be rough. A recipe to make the potion requires a handful of Drake eggs.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood.

- **The X-Factor:** "You've participated in a Cave Mudge contest, and you won! Congratulations, you're more impressive than a smelly, disgusting cave-dweller with limited intelligence.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Mudge's Box."
  Contents: A Mudge Pass Tattoo that removes automatic Mudge hostility and allows for free passage through Mudge-controlled territory in the dungeon. Warning: Holding a Mudge Pass Tattoo causes natural Cave Mudge enemies, such as reptile-class creatures, to deal +F damage against you.
- **Spelunker:** "You took damage from falling in a cave.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box."
- **Lizard Bukkake:** "Uh-oh! You've been covered in the reproductive gametes of both a Drake Bitch and a Drake Stud. You know what that means...
  Reward: You've received a Gold Spicy Box."
- **Mother of Monsters:** "You somehow survived being a host for the Drake hatching process, and now you're the proud parent of an evil lizard duck.
  Reward: You've received a Platinum Pet Box and a cute(ish) baby Drake!"
- **Marduk's Best Bud:** "You slew enough creatures devoted to Tiamat that her archenemy Marduk thinks you're pretty swell. Don't get too excited... it's probably not gonna end well for you.
  Reward: Uhh... not really a reward. You've been cursed! You've received a temporary tattoo."
  Contents: A temporary tattoo that marks you as an enemy of Tiamat until the end of the next Floor. If the GM wants to go the other way, a scroll that that allows the crawler to worship Marduk.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

The only options for grinding in the Tunnels of Tiamat are Cave Mudges and Drakes, both of which are almost guaranteed to make an enemy out of a fellow crawler. Corey believes he has a responsibility to help the Cave Mudges, and Aadhya is sworn to serve the goddess who created the Drakes. These divided loyalties can lead to some tense complications for crawlers. Table 92 provides some other complications.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: MUDGE-FILLED STATION

The station proper was abandoned by its original inhabitants and taken over by Cave Mudges who were pushed out of their caves by the Drakes.

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TABLE 92: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers find a small shrine where they can pray to become worshipers of Tiamat. If they deface or destroy the shrine, Tiamat becomes their sworn enemy. She might also take offense if they just ignore it outright, too.
2	The crawlers enter a cave covered in the active reproductive materials of both sexes of Drake. They must navigate very carefully or figure out how to clean up the place to avoid contracting the Gravid Debuff (p. 493).
3	Three non-combatant Cave Mudge Judges (aptly named Heidi Gloom, Tim Mudd, and Muckel Kors) show up out of nowhere, admiring the crawlers' outfits and noisily proclaiming one of them to be the winner of some contest called Project Mudgeway. There is so much fanfare and interruptions that the party loses 2 hours of grinding time, but gain Cave Mudge Passes if they're willing to accept the tattoos from the judges.
4	A copious amount of sticky slimy mud collected in the low spot of a cave, and the crawlers get stuck in it while fighting. They slowly sink and potentially suffocate if they can't escape.
5	A particularly cunning Cave Mudge Judge leads a Moderate unit of well-disciplined Bonkers who fight in formation and use military tactics. Where the hell did they learn that?
6	Another crawler enters the Drake Caverns, attempting to grind some experience, but they encountered Aadhya and got their ass handed to them. Still alive but sorely injured, they hide while Aadhya stalks them.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- *Your feet slip on the slimy uneven floor.*
  Outcome: Trip and fall, causing minor damage, a minor Debuff, or just embarrassment.
- *Have we been here before? All these passages look the same and twist around on each other.*
  Outcome: The crawlers must find their bearings, or they'll lose time backtracking.
- *You hear the trickling of water, the raucous rasping calls of subterranean Mobs, and a train pulling into the station all at the same time. It's impossible to tell which direction any of these sounds come from or how far away they are. They sound like they're all around you.*
  Outcome: The crawlers remain frightened and disoriented, or they bravely continue onward.

Four buildings make up the main station: the stationmaster's office, a general store, a trap store, and a Puppetry Guild theater. The trap store is locked tight and heavily booby-trapped, but the others are wide open and thoroughly ransacked. Natural tunnels snake off into solid rock on the far side of the buildings.

Cave Mudge Bonkers crowd the station, going about their daily business of eating, sleeping, bonking, and participating in contests with obtuse rules and goals. As soon as the crawlers get off the train, though, the Bonkers attack with Overwhelming numbers. The battle can end with all of one side or the other dead, but more likely it lasts until the crawlers retreat into a building or the caves, or something comes along to distract the Cave Mudges (like a rival crawler party).

The old Puppetry Guild is in use for a bizarre Cave Mudge version of Hamlet, where the audience interacts with actors and occasionally bonks one another. Of course, if the Cave Mudges are hostile (which they almost certainly are), they'll abandon their art to attack. Or *yes, and...* assaulting the PCs into the play.

The trap store is undoubtedly full of useful traps, but it's closed and locked... and heavily secured with some of the most dangerous snares in the dungeon thus far. The NPC shopkeeper Tubman is still inside, afraid of the Cave Mudges. If the crawlers can convince him to open the shop and keep him safe, Tubman sells them whatever fiendish traps they can afford. He's stubborn, but talking him out is far easier than safely breaking in.

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QUARTER: MUDGE CAVES

The caves where the Cave Mudges used to live are a ruined no-Mob's land littered with the destroyed huts of poor, displaced, or dead Cave Mudge families. There is little of interest in this area and even less of value.

While traversing a narrow tunnel, the crawlers get caught between a squad of Cave Mudge Bonkers on one side and a group of Drake Bitches on the other. The only way out is through!

Crawler Corey Szy sits cross-legged on the ground amid some ruined huts. He stares contemplatively at smeared Cave Mudge rock art on the wall. It appears to depict Cave Mudges riding rocket ships through space.

"They were once a noble people," he sighs sadly.

He argues passionately that the crawlers shouldn't kill the Cave Mudges, that they're as much pawns in the World Dungeon as the crawlers are, and that only together can everyone overcome the dungeon and its creators. He also makes it clear that he will protect the Cave Mudges from any threats they face... including other crawlers.

QUARTER: DRAKE CAVERNS

The caverns of the Drakes are larger than the Mudge Caves but are very similar in their lack of many exciting features. Drakes are *everywhere*, though, and patches of Drake eggs and Drake sperm are common. These caves are wetter, with multiple deep pools of water and wide shallow ponds.

After dispatching a group of Drakes, Aadhya attacks, screaming at them to stop. If any of the crawlers are followers of Marduk, she relentlessly focuses on that crawler first. She fights hard but isn't going to sacrifice her life here. She'll flee to the Temple of Tiamat if things go against her.

The crawlers encounter a lone Cave Mudge deep in the Drake caverns. The Cave Mudge is clearly unwell, and closer investigation reveals that she has the Gravid Debuff. Just as the crawlers identify the problem, the Cave Mudge's torso rips open with a shower of gore. A half-dozen newborn Drakes crawl from the mess and immediately set upon each other with violence unbecoming of babies.

When there is only one left, it looks up at one of the crawlers and timidly says, "Quack?"

Are you its mother?

The crawlers' minimap indicates the corpse of Crawler Maroochy nearby. If they investigate, they find that Maroochy died at the bottom of a deep vertical shaft filled with dark water. The body may yet have loot if the crawlers can figure out how to get to it.

QUARTER: TEMPLE OF TIAMAT

A dark underground lake fills most of a staggeringly large cavern. The surface occasionally ripples with the activity of Mythfish, but for the most part, the water is glassy and still. The cavern is eerily quiet, and any sounds seem muted. An ominous step-pyramid made of black stone occupies an island in the center of the lake: a temple to Tiamat.

In a grotto behind the temple lives Daisy, an elderly Level 30 Drake Bitch who is King Ghiduckrah's mate. She's always hungry and devours any crawlers who stumble upon her.

As the crawlers cross the lake or stand near its shore, a School of Mythfish notices them and begins glowing curiously. One fish jumps from the water, smacking a crawler in the face. That crawler immediately has a vision of the future!

The Boss, King Ghiduckrah, inhabits a pit beneath the temple where he was sealed by the god Marduk. At the top of the step pyramid stands a stela inscribed with a prayer to Marduk, which the goddess hates but can't get rid of (Tiamat worshipers might have a quest to find a way to get rid of it). Any crawler who does not worship Tiamat can read the prayer aloud to break the seal and release King Ghiduckrah. When that happens, the Boss Battle begins!

"The Mudges might be dumb and ugly, but they made me their king! I have a responsibility to them, Declan. I am the hope of their universe!"

—Corey Szy

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NPCS

The only NPC of note left in the area is Tubman the trap store merchant, but several crawlers might be found here trying to complete quests. Aadhya Ghosh and her Drake servants follow the will of a vengeful, chaotic goddess.

AADHYA GHOSH

Aadhya Ghosh came into the dungeon with her parents, her older brother, and her younger sister. They're all dead now. Always living in the shadow of her more successful siblings, Aadhya promised her parents, as they died, that she would make them proud and avenge them.

Near the end of the Second Floor, she opened a loot box containing the Khopesh of Bashmu: a hooked sword containing the essence of Bashmu, one of the goddess Tiamat's monstrous creations. Among other things, it allowed her to take the powerful and rare Monster Nanny Class and worship Tiamat. She adventures with her new pet Drake Bitch, named Shivani after a character from one of her favorite movies.

AI **Crawler #1,554,123. "Aadhya Gh."**

Level 40.

Race: Human.

Class: Monster Nanny[⚙].

TUBMAN

Tubman is the NPC shopkeeper of the trap store. He is a Chelonian[⚙], a Race of slow-moving hairy humanoids with a protective turtle-like shell.

AI **Tubman. Chelonian Shopkeeper.**

Level 50.

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Like most Chelonians, Tubman is a coward. And slow. Not slow like a snail "slow;" slow like a gods-damned glacier "slow." Trying to have a conversation with him is agony, and if he has to find something in the back room for you, you'd better hope you have a few meals handy. It's gonna take that long.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The top of the temple explodes as King Ghiduckrah bursts out and takes flight over the underground lake. His massive wings whip up winds that cause huge waves and dangerous waterspouts. Golden lightning crackles through the air, electrifying the scene. Any crawlers in the temple or on the island are thrown into the lake from the force of the escape, along with huge pieces of temple rubble.

Over the sound of Lebanese music with screaming electric guitars, an outside announcer (likely Kevin and Magnificent Troy, but it's possible a show host the PCs have met, such as Helene Jbarska (p. 302) is filling in on short notice) pauses things to introduce the combatants.

"Awwww, yeah! It's King Ghiduckrah! This spawn of Tiamat is a gargantuan three-headed scaly duck with dragon wings. Facing off against him, we have the crawlers! Crawlers who are notably NOT gargantuan three-headed scaly ducks with dragon wings. I don't want to say this battle is a foregone conclusion, but..."

King Ghiduckrah is no fool. He keeps to the air, firing golden lightning bolts at the crawlers. There's not much they can do unless they have ranged attacks or they can fly themselves. Crawlers on the lake without the ability to fly can wait for a waterspout to form and ride it into the air, allowing them to make a single melee attack against King Ghiduckrah. This also gives him a chance to bite them, and he's got three heads to try with. Of note, his lightning blasts become area-effect attacks against crawlers in the water.

CLUES

- Waterspouts in the lake can push non-ranged, and non-flying, crawlers high enough to attack the flying Boss.
- Extreme cold and ice attacks cause extra damage to the Boss.
- The long necks are most vulnerable.

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AI **King Ghiduckrah. Three-Headed Dragon Duck Kaiju.**

Level 42 Borough Boss!

King Ghiduckrah is a colossal three-headed draconic waterfowl that shoots lightning, and he's here to beat down the enemies of Tiamat! (That's you.)

Look, Tiamat kind of went on a drug-fueled bender after the death of her consort, and her first behemoth creations weren't exactly the kind that got carved into cuneiform tablets, okay? Plus, there's a big learning curve when it comes to designing poison-blooded mythological beasts. Lots of prototypes and rough drafts that get discarded before you end up with an Ushumgallu or a Kusarikku.

So please have a little grace and understanding of the process while King Ghiduckrah zaps you until you're crispy and then smashes you into a bloody paste. It's not his fault he's so ill-conceived.

Wait, did someone mention poison blood? It's kind of off-theme for an electrical dragon-duck, but I dare you to complain to Tiamat about it.

King Ghiduckrah

Borough Boss; Gargantuan (8), Reptile

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
5%	10%	15%	21%	26%	31%	36%	42%	47%	52%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	
57%	63%	68%	73%	78%	84%	89%	94%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
42	15+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
60 (+6)	20 (+5)	70 (+6)	28 (+5)	15 (+4)

Bite: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Piercing, 40ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Swallowed Debuff: Swallowed crawlers take 1d8+F Acid at the end of each round, but cannot be attacked. Swallowed crawlers attack with Disadvantage vs. 0 DR, and Slashing attacks deal ×2 damage.

Lightning Blast Spell: 16+F to hit, 4d6+5 Electric, 500ft range, 20ft Blast radius (if the target is in the water). Any crawler who loses 3+ HB slots gains the Shocked Debuff.

Notes: *Cold Vulnerability*—Ice attacks do ×2 damage to King Ghiduckhra.

Necktied—After declaring an attack against a neck, inform the crawler that the attack is made with Disadvantage. If any single attack deals 4+ HB slots of damage to one of King Ghiduckhra's necks, that neck is severed and their number of attacks is reduced by 1 for the remainder of the combat. Even if all three heads are cut off, the body still acts.

Poisonous Blood—Any crawler who damages King Ghiduckhra with a melee attack is inflicted with a Poisoned Debuff doing 1d8+F Poison per round. This Debuff is stackable and only removed with a Poison Antidote.

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QUEST: ALL REVVED UP

FLOOR: 4 — THEME: SABOTAGE THE MLM TRAINING TRAIN

The trouble with creating a dungeon-spanning narcotics empire is that it doesn't matter how many sedatives and drugs you produce if you don't have anyone to *sell*, *sell*, *sell*. To solve this supplier-versus-demand problem, Rev-Up has commissioned a rolling training course to indoctri— to onboard the many direct sales vendors they need pushing their product to all the Mobs on the Fourth Floor.

Enter the Cerulean Star, a repurposed cattle train that serves as a recruiting station, training seminar, corporate team-building retreat, and rolling fortress for one of the Krakaren Clones along the Iron Tangle. Prospective downline consultants join on one of the stations and ride the rails until they're fully ready to become goal diggers and manifest their own abundance while being their own boss.

Someone must put a stop to all this corporate speak before it rots every brain in the dungeon. Enter the crawlers who infiltrate the Cerulean Star to stop the "entrepreneurs" in their tracks. They make their way through the train, facing Pooka Goal Diggers, Clurichaun Aspirants, and the dreaded Krakaren Clone herself!

STRONG STARTS

- The crawlers are doing their best to survive the Iron Tangle when they start noticing advertisements for a Rev-Up recruitment seminar plastered across different stations. They promise riches, experimental substances, camaraderie, and empowerment to anyone brave enough to ride the Cerulean Star. Crawlers may be drawn by the promise of easy grinding experience, access to bespoke sedatives for the Mobs across the Fourth Floor, or sheer curiosity.

"Hop aboard the Cerulean Star to learn how to scale your mindset, own your queendom, and gaslight, gatekeep, and girlboss your way to generational wealth!"

—Rev-Up Station Billboard

- Someone the crawlers know went missing on the Cerulean Star, but not before sending them a message letting them know they boarded the train looking for medical supplies for their own party. This was a fool's errand, but regardless, now it's up to the crawlers to rescue their friend before it's too late.

QUEST DESCRIPTION

When the crawlers receive this Quest, the AI announces it with the following text in a dramatic fashion:

AI **New Quest. All Revved Up with No Place to Go.**

"All aboard the Cerulean Star, a luxury training vehicle dedicated to giving you the skills (and Wi-Fi) you need to work from home, own your own queendom, and manifest your tribe..." is what Rev-Up wants me to say, but fuck that.

This cow car is a rolling pyramid scheme loaded to the brim with sycophants and idiots hoping to prey on the oblivious people ranked just beneath them. I wonder what would happen if you showed them there is no one beneath them...

Note: the terms "girlboss" and "boss babe" are unisex in this Quest. Rev-Up allows consultants of all sexes and genders to learn the skills of the trade.

Reward: You've received a Gold Consultants Box. It's a Quest Box that works for itself; rewards improve the more people you convince to open theirs before you!

ALTERATIONS

GMs who don't want to engage with Rev-Up or the Apothecary can simply swap out the company behind the training seminars to a different pyramid scheme of their own creation. The Cerulean Star also doesn't necessarily need to be a hub for narcotics or sedatives; they can sell all sorts of things from fancy kitchen knives to overpriced makeup or cleaning supplies instead.

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MOBS

Most of the Mobs encountered in *All Revved Up* are trainees riding the Cerulean Star, *hoping to become* new downline consultants. They're ruthless, self-made boss-bitches who won't stop until they achieve the life-style they deserve... through the hard work of others.

POOKA GOAL DIGGER

Pooka Goal Diggers are the boots on the ground for the Cerulean Star's training operations. They're the Krakaren Clone's closest downline consultants, especially Pookas, who have already proven capable of dragging dozens of others into the Rev-Up sales model.

On the train, they act as cheerleaders, drill instructors, and personal guards for the Krakaren Clone, fueled by a pharmacy of supplements that lets them be all three at once. Pooka Goal Diggers typically work in pairs on their assigned train car, overseeing their recruits as they engage in physical obstacles and team-building exercises.

AI

Pooka Goal Digger. Level 40.

She's the first to tell you she's not a gold-digger; no, this boss babe is digging for goals so she can make her own gold. Pooka Goal Diggers are the exhausting drill instructors of the Cerulean Star, pushing new recruits to their breaking point so they, too, can bother their relatives on social media for some pity sales.

Don't tell her that, though, or she'll turn into a big-ass goat and ruin your day. She's also pretty good at riling up any Clurichaun Aspirants around her, sending the fanatical little Fairies into a berserker rage.

Pooka Goal Digger

Mob; Small (2) to Huge (6), Shapeshifter

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	15+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	15 (+4)

Head Butt: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

Mind Devour: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Psychic, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Sweet Song: 15+F to hit, No damage, 40ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Unconscious Debuff: They are prone and cannot take actions. If they take damage, they wake up. Uses this attack every other round.

Vitamin Shot: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Transformational*—When attacked, a Pooka Goal Digger transforms into a huge goat.

CLURICHAUN ASPIRANTS

The Cerulean Star is a beacon for Mobs looking to level-up their options within the dungeon. It's one thing to be a roving monstrosity addicted to alien drugs; it's another to be the one supplying it. To that end, Clurichauns from across the Iron Tangle flock to the Cerulean Star in hopes of surviving the trials necessary to become a downline consultant. Few of them survive the grueling training, but those who do are given a golden ticket to an easier life in the dungeon and more sedatives than they could ever sell.

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Clurichaun Aspirants. Level 30.

Behind every pyramid scheme are a few thousand gullible suckers hoping to break out from beneath the yoke of capitalism. These are those suckers (Fairy-class Mobs) who, in a better galaxy, might have worked for an equally useless, if slightly less destructive company.

They might have sold DIY dishrag art, overpriced leggings, or "health" supplements, but we don't live in a better galaxy. Here, these hapless morons kill each other for the privilege of pushing poison on desperate Mobs to help a cosmically evil octopus blow its load. Isn't nature beautiful?

Clurichaun Aspirant

Mob; Petite (3), Fairy

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
30	15+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
13 (+4)	25 (+5)	12 (+4)	21 (+5)	24 (+5)

Cough: 15+F to hit, 5d8 Poison, 10ft range

Sneeze 15+F to hit, No damage, 15ft Cone
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Promoter*—Clurichaun Aspirants sell the highly addictive "Rev-Up" moonshine. Any crawlers that drink the moonshine must make a Con Stat Check. On Fail, they gain the Shit-Faced Debuff.

KRAKAREN CROTCH DUMPLINGS

The first stage in Krakaren evolution, the humble Crotch Dumpling is a tiny clone of the original Krakaren, created by an experimental process best left to the imagination. Individually, they're about the size of a grain of sand and are not terribly dangerous, but they're seldom encountered alone.

As a matter of fact, the Cerulean Star is home to a few million inert dumpling eggs, which the Pooka Goal Diggers load into the sedatives they're making for all the Mobs of the Fourth Floor. Hopefully, none of them hatch while the crawlers are aboard the train...

Krakaren Crotch Dumplings. Level 1.

This is what happens when a Krakaren Clone doesn't finish in a sock the way God intended. Something has gone terribly wrong with the Cerulean Star if you're seeing this army of potential boss babes. Kill them quickly before they grow too big to fail.

Krakaren Crotch Dumpling

Mob; Tiny (1), Aberration

1
100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
1	11+F	11+F	5	1
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
2 (+1)	1 (+1)	2 (+1)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)

Bore: 11+F to hit, 1d2+1 Piercing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Fast Growth*—Krakaren Crotch Dumplings double in size at the end of each round of combat. Each time they increase in size they gain an additional HB slot, and their Con Mod (in their HB slots) and damage each increase by +1.

JIKININKI CUSTODIAL CONSULTANT

Theses are almost completely identical to the other Jikininki Janitor Ghouls found throughout the Iron Tangle except they've been kitted out in Rev-Up merch, spiffy corporate name tags, and a fistful of Rev-Up Supplements. They clean up after the brutal training fights, handle accidental spills in the pharmacy, and eat any crawlers who wander onto their train.

Jikininki Custodial Consultant. Level 35.

Just because you put a ghoul in a polo doesn't mean he's any less repulsive or single-minded. Actually, given that the polo is the most single-minded article of clothing Humans ever made, I think this might be a match made in corporate hell.

To be frank, I'm surprised they haven't taken the polos off yet—it's literally the only thing distinguishing them from normal janitors on this floor. Anyway, stay clear when they clean up messes or when they take their supplements, and you should be alright.

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Jikininki Custodial Consultant

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	14+F	15+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	10 (+4)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	10 (+4)

Broom: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Sweep: 15+F to hit, 5d4+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler is pushed 10ft.

Notes: *Blood Sense*—Crawlers with the Blood Trail Debuff have Disadvantage on Stealth, Ambush, and Social Skill Checks against Jikininki.

Janitor Mob—This Mob is responsible for cleaning messes on the Fourth Floor and prioritizes cleaning up corpses. It attacks crawlers when provoked, or when crawlers have the Blood Trail Debuff.

POOKA HARMACIST

Not every Pooka is just a "pretty" face, nor is this Mob name an explicit reference to *Discount Dan*—or at least it wasn't until now. These goblinoid pharmacy techs embody everything wrong with Big Pharma as they throw their morals into the garbage disposal.

Giving themselves the name "Harmacist," these Pooka fill Rev-Up's supplements with all manner of nasty additives, most notably the DTs. They tend to attack crawlers in their goat form but come to battle with an arsenal of experimental drugs and poisons.

AI Pooka Harmacist. Level 50.

I hope you're not afraid of needles, because these jumped-up little goat goblins are definitely gonna stab you, and they don't practice clean needle hygiene. Pooka Harmacists are what happens when you give a burgeoning serial killer a chemistry set instead of court-mandated therapy. They love devising all sorts of bizarre concoctions to inject into their victims' bloodstreams "just to see what happens."

Pooka Harmacist

Mob; Small (2) to Huge (6), Shapeshifter

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	25 (+5)	55 (+6)	25 (+5)	25 (+5)

Head Butt: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

Psychedelics: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Poison, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Shit-Faced Debuff.

Vitamin Shot: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Transformational*—When attacked, a Pooka Harmacist transforms into a huge goat.

KEY NPCS

The key NPCs in *All Revved Up* are riders on the Cerulean Star who either compete in, or perpetuate, the Boost Camp. They might hinder or help the crawlers' plans aboard the train.

HADDLEY LUANNE MONTGOMERY

Haddley rides the Cerulean Star to make her family proud. She's a fierce competitor in the Boost Camp and a favorite to win her way into upper management along with the Pooka Goal Diggers. She's a ruthless backwoods Fairy here to kick ass and sell drugs, and she's all outta drugs. Haddley boarded the train a few stops ahead of the crawlers and serves as a source of potential information, rivalry, or just a plain good fight.

AI Haddley Luanne Montgomery.

Clurichaun Aspirant Super Star. Level 55.

Haddley Luanne Montgomery never found a competition she couldn't win or a cousin she couldn't kiss. She's the most dangerous Clurichaun this side of the Iron Tangle, and if you get in the way of her efforts to manifest her future, she'll stomp you into the dirt and cuss you out for not being a girl's girl.

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Clurichaun Aspirant Super Duper Star

Mob; Petite (3), Fairy

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
55	16+F	16+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	50 (+6)	30 (+5)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)

Cuss: 16+F to hit, 3d8+5 Sonic, 15ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

Kiss: 16+F to hit, 5d8+5 Poison, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Stomp: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 15ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Promoter*—Clurichaun Aspirant Super Duper Stars sell the highly addictive "Rev-Up" moonshine. Any crawlers that drink the moonshine must make a Con Stat Check. On Fail, they gain the Shit-Faced Debuff.

Winner Winner Chicken Dinner—Clurichaun Aspirant Super Duper Star gains Advantage on the first Attack or Skill Check they make in Combat.

WOODROW VANDERSPEAK

Woodrow is a Pooka Harmacist, a manufacturer of drugs who aims to use them to create an apocalyptic event within the Iron Tangle. He's just one of many operators across the Fourth Floor working toward this vision, but he's convinced it was his idea first. He works with a small crew of fellow chemists aboard the Cerulean Star, creating care packages for the new downline consultants before sending them off to their first posting.

AI **Woodrow Vanderspeak. Pooka Harmacist. Level 16.**

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Earth's history is lousy with famous poisoners: Giulia Tofana, Mary Ann Cotton, Dr. Harold Shipman, Dr. Conrad Murray, whoever invented LimeWire. Woodrow Vanderspeak has them all beat. He's a girl-boss Pooka who fills his addictive sedatives with inert Krakaren eggs, hoping to afflict countless Mobs with a new stage of the DTs when withdrawal sets in.

Don't take anything this man offers you. Or do; I'm not your D.A.R.E. officer.

QUEST ITEMS

The Cerulean Star's Boost Camp is a series of escalating challenges each downline consultant must complete to manifest their potential. The crawlers must acquire these items to progress from one area of the train to the next.

- **Boss Babe Wristband:** Acquired at the onset of the Quest when the heroes board the train. Requires four easy payments of 500 gold each. This pink wristband functions as the access card for Boost Camp. It allows the bearer to move from car to car and saves their itinerary.
- **Boss Babe Battle Badge:** Won by the crawlers in the initial fighting pits when they first board the train. Grants them access to team-building seminars. Requires two easy payments of 200 gold each.
- **Paralarva VIP Lanyard:** Won only by the best of the best, the VIP Lanyard grants the crawlers a ticket to their swearing-in ceremony as new downline consultants, of course overseen by the Krakaren Clone herself! Requires six easy payments of 999 gold each.

TRAPS

"Trap" is such a strong word, aspiring consultants aboard the Cerulean Star are likely to encounter unforeseen complications, but we prefer to think of them as team-building opportunities. Here are some traps the crawlers may encounter during the *All Revved Up* Quest:

- **Escape Car:** One of the train cars turns out to be an escape room, and the crawlers must solve a series of inane marketing, self-improvement and MLM-related puzzles to move on to the next car. Any puzzle-solving Intelligence-based Skill Checks can get the group out in an hour; failure takes two hours. Or they just break the locks and keep moving.
- **Blindfolded Obstacle Course:** All of the crawlers but one are struck blind upon entering this car, and the one who can see has to guide the others over a series of pits and past swinging blades.
- **Two Truths and a Lie:** The crawlers find a magical door that won't open unless the whole group plays Two Truths and a Lie. This can be a simple icebreaker or a disastrous delay as Jikininki Custodial Consultants gradually fill the train car trying to "clean up" the space if the crawlers aren't fast enough.
- **Balloon Volleyball:** The crawlers enter a train car that drops a balloon in the room with them. If that

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balloon touches the ground or is caught, they suffer a catastrophic explosion.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements on this Quest.

- **You Put the "Mid" in Pyramid:** "You convinced some other rube to pay your item fee and finally understand the nature of a good ol' MLM. Krakaren would be proud.
  Reward: You get to keep your gold. Isn't that enough? Fine, here's a Bronze Sucker Born Every Minute Box."
  Contents: An item to help with deceiving others.
- **Gaslight, Gatekeep, Girlboss:** "You ruined a perfectly good Clurichaun's hopes of passing their training and got them killed instead. Maybe you'll make a good consultant yet.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Gatekeepers Box."
  Contents: A magical lock, shield, or other item designed to keep people out.
- **Birth Control:** "You killed every Krakaren Crotch Dumpling aboard the Cerulean Star. Turns out abstinence isn't the only effective method.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Prophylactic Box."
  Contents: Protective items. Use them, or don't; I'm not judging.
- **Corporate-Mandated Bonding Still Counts:** "You and your party opened up to each other during one of Rev-Up's stupid team-building exercises. Aw, that's nice.
  Reward: The reward is the friends you made along the way."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

While undertaking the *All Revved Up* Quest, the crawlers might decide to grind some of its Mobs over and over. Table 93 suggests some ways this could go horribly wrong, like most real-life MLMs.

STAGE 1: ALL ABOARD!

The crawlers arrive at a station along the Cerulean Star's route. The station is flooded with eager Clurichaun Aspirants marked as non-combatants on the map. Any crawler in the area hears them excitedly talking about the opportunities offered by Rev-Up and sharing their hopes for the future.

Once the train rolls into the station they meet with a Pooka Goal Digger who checks everyone in and collects the payment for the Boss Babe Wristbands. Everyone who pays (or tricks someone else into paying for them) is ushered onto the train and into their first car where the an Overwhelming group of aspirants

TABLE 93: CERULEAN STAR GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers stumble across two Moderate groups of Clurichaun Aspirants playing a game of tug-of-war over a pit in the train car floor. Pooka Goal Diggers egg them on, eager for one group to pull the other into the hole to die painfully on the tracks.
2	The crawlers find a Clurichaun Aspirant suffering from Stage 3 of the DTs (see p. 40 and make up something wicked). The trainee locked himself away to prevent the Pookas from finding out about his condition, but he's about to go critical.
3	A pack of Jikininki Custodial Consultants are practically feral as they clean up the remains of an aspirant death match. They attack anyone who draws near, but one NPC remains trapped in the pile of viscera. This is Haddley, who owes the crawlers a favor, or an NPC crawler the group knows.
4	The train stops at a station during a fight, allowing a fresh group of Clurichaun Aspirants aboard who might just jump in on the ongoing battle.
5	Haddley Luanne Montgomery ambushes the crawlers along with a group of her future downline consultants—other Clurichaun Aspirants. She's hoping to kill or capture the crawlers so they stop spoiling her fun, but her efforts don't even delay them.
6	The crawlers find a train car whose only floor is a spinning wooden cylinder. A well-balanced Pooka in goat form stands in the middle, ready to headbutt anyone who tries to cross.

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must fight to the death until only half of those who boarded the train are still alive. Any who survive are allowed to purchase the Boss Babe Battle Badge and access the rest of the train.

The atmosphere at the station is electric. The Clurichauns are excited for this opportunity and share whatever folksy platitudes they've been fed by Rev-Up.

Spend some time in this scene introducing the crawlers to a number of these aspirants. Have the aspirants make offers of alliance and try to befriend them. That makes the gut punch of the sudden slaughterfest all the starker. Consider having one of the Clurichauns say, "We're all in this together!" moments before the bloodbath is announced. Be sure to set up the battle with corporate-speak and motivational poster-sayings from the Pooka Goal Digger(s).

The primary encounter in this stage is the grand brawl between the aspirants and crawlers. They may have made friends with Clurichauns while waiting for the station or encountered other crawlers they can form an uneasy alliance with, but this is a devastating battle in cramped quarters. The battle takes place inside one of the cattle cars and there isn't a lot of space to maneuver.

Observant crawlers may notice that some of the Clurichaun Aspirants have goodie bags loaded with supplements. These were given to the first ten who arrived at the station and include what you would expect: a Rev-Up polo, water bottle, key chain, or other tchochkes. Several samples of the Rev-Up Amazing Cure-All Vitamin Immunity Shot may be found as well.

Crawlers who get their hands on these can examine the shots to find out that they were altered and are now unsafe. These shots have "Made on the Cerulean Star" on their labels, hinting that there may be more to this train than meets the eye.

STAGE 2: TRAIN OF FOOLS

After acquiring the Boss Babe Battle Badge, the crawlers receive access to the rest of the Cerulean Star. Most of the other cars are dedicated to self-help seminars, team-building exercises, and other social events. The crawlers receive a breakdown of the training schedule and can participate in events as they see fit.

Their primary goal here is learning about the existence of the Paralarva VIP Lanyard and acquire one, either by participating in the training classes or stealing one from someone who already has. They are exceedingly rare, and finding a Clurichaun Aspirant who has one could take some grinding (one hour of *Grinding* is plenty). Earning one also takes some effort, requiring the crawlers to catch the eye of one of the Pooka Goal Diggers and winning their approval.

The crawlers perform several team-building exercises, receiving lectures about the power of manifesting, vibes, and karma. There are trust falls and obstacle courses and icebreakers galore. Each course is lead by two Pookas who may or may not decide to sponsor the crawlers based on their performance. Crawlers who start to earn too much admiration attract scorn from the Clurichaun Aspirants, who may decide to do something about it.

A group of Clurichaun Aspirants, possibly led by Haddley, ambush the crawlers during one of their team-building exercises, preferably one that leaves them in a compromised position. This works great in conjunction with the Blindfolded Obstacle Course trap outlined above. The goal is to eliminate the competition, but these Clurichauns aren't suicidal. If the fight turns against them, they flee and look for a way to pin the hostilities on the crawlers.

During the course of their team-building exercises, one of the crawlers spots a Pooka in a lab coat pushing a

QUEST EVENTS

Use these pithy scenarios for encounters the crawlers might experience to evoke the mood of this Quest:

- In a quiet moment between seminars and battles, the crawlers are invited to eat in the mess car along with the other aspirants. The crawlers get a sense of the "humanity" of the NPCs, and the sense of how they're being exploited by Rev-Up settles on the group.
- A Pooka Goal Digger offers the crawlers a performance-enhancing supplement before their next test. Do they accept the shortcut and any hidden side effects, or do things the hard way?
- The crawlers find a seminar in progress: a Pooka Goal Digger gestures to a slideshow loaded down with corporate buzzwords as an audience of enraptured Clurichauns look on.
- The crawlers meet another crawler here to genuinely attempt to join the Rev-Up organization. She tells them that she used to work with groups like this before the dungeon, and she is totally smart enough to take over the operation if she had a little help from some other consultants.

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covered cart into a refrigerated car on the train. The Pooka accesses the area with a keycard. Crawlers who stake out this room can attack the Pooka after this drop-off.

She tells them that car is a lab where Woodrow works on developing and producing drugs for the downline consultants. She won't willingly give up her keycard, but the crawlers undoubtedly find a way to acquire it. Investigating her car reveals several jars of small brown pellets the size of a grain of rice.

STAGE 3: WELCOME TO THE HARMACY

One of two areas in the train not dedicated to the Boost Camp, this refrigerated car serves as Woodrow's lab-on-wheels where he poisons the Rev-Up Amazing Cure-All Vitamin Immunity Shot with Krakaren Crotch Dumplings. His team of Pooka Harmacists work around the clock creating these infected injectors and passing them out to consultants to give to their clients.

It is a cramped train car with just enough room for the medical technology he needs to produce the serum and load the syringes, as well as a small sleeping space for his team. Crawlers are not welcome in this space under any circumstances, and Woodrow fights to defend his work. Any combat that breaks out in this car makes its way to the Krakaren Clone as well. She has a vested interest in keeping her spawn safe and the syringes flowing.

Woodrow has a Paralarva VIP Lanyard in his possession, something he was given by the Krakaren Clone in case he ever met an aspirant he believed a good fit for the downline consultant job. He was never a fan of this recruitment method and does his best to avoid any and all aspirants. Still, if the crawlers get their hands on his lanyard, they bypass having to suck up to the Pooka Goal Diggers or rob an overachieving Clurichaun.

Combat in the refrigerated car is ill-advised but almost certainly unavoidable. Crawlers who break in find themselves facing off against Woodrow and a crew of his fellow Pooka Harmacists who spring into action, grabbing whatever poisonous tinctures they can find. Two of them shift into goat mode and run interference while a Weak group of Harmacists add debilitating Debuffs to the crawlers.

As long as their machinery isn't destroyed, the Pooka Harmacists have a practically unlimited supply of needles and toxins. The crawlers can sabotage the coolant system, ruining the syringes and creating icy hazards on the battlefield.

REV-UP CORPORATE BUZZWORDS AND PHRASES

- We're looking for a synergy between new releases
- Welcome to the new normal, people
- Here's some advice for the boots on the ground
- Let's put a pin in it and circle back tomorrow
- Sales to friends already in your orbit are low-hanging fruit
- With this product, we're fishing for whales
- Work Hard, Play Hard
- We're like family here
- Let's leverage our existing contacts
- We need to align on these priorities
- We have plenty of bandwidth for this
- You gotta maintain a growth mindset
- We don't need to reinvent the wheel here
- This is not the deliverable I asked for
- We need ideas that are actionable

If the crawlers disguise their identities or find a willing Clurichaun they glean some information from Woodrow. He's not overly eager to talk to anyone but is happy to spill the beans on his grand plan to sedate huge numbers of crawlers and Mobs a plea for the Krakaren Clone's attention and way to feed countless Crotch Dumplings. It's easiest to get this information by stroking his ego or appealing to his scientific mind.

Somehow the crawlers survived the trials of the Cerulean Star and are now the proud owners of their Paralarva VIP Lanyards. All that's left is to meet the Krakaren Clone in her personal car for the swearing-in ceremony, then they can pick up their bag of Rev-Up Amazing Cure-All Vitamin Immunity Shots and go start scamming the denizens of the dungeon with the best of them.

It's unfortunate that the Krakaren Clone maintains a strict no-crawler policy for her Rev-Up downline consultants. The crawlers make their way to the caboose of the Cerulean Star *and* find an enormous train car full of whiteboards, sales numbers, and a terrifying space octopus covered in dripping, shrieking mouths.

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When the crawlers enter the caboose, a voiceover announces the Boss Battle alongside some corporate presentation-style muzak. Images of the crawlers and the Krakaren Clone appear, highlighted in pink boxes.

The Krakaren Clone is an enormous octopus with 30-foot tentacles covered in screaming, oozing mouths. She is a shock-and-awe Boss using her massive bulk, long reach, and debuffing drippings to attack as many crawlers as she can at once. Her shrieking attracts the attention of Pooka Goal Diggers in the area who intercept as her boss babe body-guards. She fights to the death. So do they.

The easiest way to get rid of the Krakaren Clone is to decouple the caboose and let the Cerulean Star race away while she crashes farther down the train tunnel. The Pookas and Krakaren do everything they can to attack any crawler making a move on the train coupler, but with concentrated effort it should be possible.

CLUES

- Decoupling the car is the best way to defeat or escape, though perhaps not kill, the Boss.
- While dumb, this Boss wants her whiteboards undisturbed, which reveal her Immunities and Vulnerabilities.

Krakaren Clone.

Level 65 Borough Boss!

It's hard to believe they get this big. Again, this still isn't the real Krakaren, just one of her clones, but this one lived long enough to start really feeling herself—in more ways than one. She has escalated her complaints from the manager to the regional manager, and her schemes leveled up to reflect that expanded reach.

Krakaren Clones of this size have... "sexually matured" doesn't feel like the right term, but it's the closest comparison your Human brain can understand. Basically, she's started making millions of little Krakarens who threaten to destabilize the dungeon ecosystem, and it's up to you to put a stop to this horny clone once and for all.

Krakaren Clone

Borough Boss; Huge (6), Aberration

8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8
5%	10%	15%	21%	26%	31%	36%	42%	47%	52%
8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	
57%	63%	68%	73%	78%	84%	89%	94%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
65	13+F	16+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
59 (+6)	8 (+3)	157 (+8)	55 (+6)	6 (+3)

Constrict: None, 6d10+6 Bludgeoning, Auto-hits Held foe

Mega Munch: 16+F to hit, 7d10+6 Piercing, 10ft range

Acidic Tentacles: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Acid, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Pyramid Pitch: 13+F to hit, 4d6+3 Psychic, 60ft range
Make a free Cha Stat Check vs. the attack. On Fail, must spend next Action attacking an ally.

Spit Spray: 16+F to hit, 6d8+3 Poison, 50ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Unnerving Screams: 16+F to hit, 4d8 Sonic, 60ft Burst radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Queasy Debuff. Uses this every other round.

Notes: *Decoupling*—It takes two rounds to decouple the caboose with one crawler or one round with two. While decoupling, crawlers roll Evade with Disadvantage, and the Boss will focus attacks on them. Once decoupled, the caboose is loose!

Whiteboards—Spending two Actions erasing his boards causes the Boss to lose one Action for the remainder of the combat. (Secret: Works only once.)

Bad Hair Day—Krakarens believe they have a flattering hairstyle, and if it gets messed up, they are frantic. Any attack that results in an Amazing Success or better causes all Held Debuffs to cease.

Fire Vulnerability—Krakaren Clones take ×2 damage from Fire attacks.

Lightning Immunity—Krakaren Clones are immune to Electric damage.

Psychic Immunity—Krakaren Clones take no damage from Psychic attacks, but do gain the Stunned Debuff when they are hit by Psychic damage.

Soft Goey Center—Krakaren Clones take ×2 damage from Piercing attacks.

Tough Enough—Krakaren Clones have ×2 DR against attacks that do Ice or Force damage.

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QUEST: FUSCHIA LINE FEVER

FLOOR: 4 — THEME: NEON NYC, 1983, AFTER THE BOMB

Not everyone remembers, but early 1980s New York City was pretty damned apocalyptic. The subways were full of crime, graffiti, and punks blasting music the squares hated. But a few at the Borant Corporation thought it was the height of American culture. And since American culture, along with the rest of the world, is now gone, who are you to argue?

This gonzo Quest is full of 1980s post-nuclear fear, complete with rival gangs, Trash Knights, and more. Borant built this Quest around nutty post-apocalyptic Americana and the Holy Grail legend. Maybe they saw *Mad Max 2* and *Excalibur* a little too close together? This is a dark (but silly) world navigable only by those 3 a.m. lost souls prowling the tunnels that once served as the arteries to the Big Apple's heart.

Among the tunnels, trains, and stations of the Fuschia Line, a radioactive menace corrupts the land. The only remedy is the Atomic Grail, of course. And who's the king down here in wasted America? The Prez. He must be rescued from his captors before he can use the Atomic Grail... but you gotta find it first.

And not everyone down here wants to use the Atomic Grail for good. After all, some punks *like* being mutated.

It's a Quest of Arthurian proportions, soaked in trash-culture 80s American post-apocalypse paranoia. Fun for the whole family! Well, not yours. Your family died when the world ended. Sorry about that.

STRONG STARTS

This Neighborhood is full of hooks. It used to be full of hookers. Maybe you should have come earlier.

- After finding a handful of audio cassette tapes amidst some Misc. Junk, the group is attacked by multiple Tape Head Mobs of increasing strength. They demand the tapes. The crawlers can hear what sounds like the hardest crust-punk ever coming from the same direction as the Tape Heads. Who doesn't want to check that out? No future, losers!
- A shopkeeper at a nearby station doesn't have what the crawlers need, but points them in the right direction, saying there are vending machines that reflect 1980s-era pricing with what they need for a major discount.
- A non-combatant member of the Lobes (see below) hires the PCs to help his cousin's cousin get married to a girl in the Gristle Gang, the Lobes' rivals. He offers cash and Lobe Ganger Pass Tattoos as payment. All you have to do is go into the Gristle Gang's turf, grab the girl, and get her back to the boy whose heart she stole. Sure, it's technically kidnapping, but true love knows no bounds, right?
- Rumor at the station says there's a Blessed Cassette Tape that contains a recording made by Elvis and Sid Vicious before their deaths. Among the Feveroids (that's anyone who lives down here), it's a priceless treasure shrouded in myth. Sounds valuable. Maybe you ought to find it?

QUEST DESCRIPTION

When the crawlers receive this Quest, the AI announces with the following text in a dramatic fashion:

> New Quest. Seek the Holy Grail. (No, not that one.)
>
> Behold! The Trash Prophet speaks, and all who listen must obey. You are the vaunted few who must undertake a sacred Quest for the Atomic Grail. Deliver it unto the Prez of these now-blighted United States subways, and heal the land from the fallout of communist nukes. You alone can do this job. Succeed where others have died. And always remember, the city that never sleeps must wake.
>
> *Reward:* You will receive a Gold Quest Box.

MOBS

Mobs found in Fuschia Line Fever cleave to 1980s concepts of both the decaying nature of American cities at the time (particularly New York) and the over-the-top fears of what nuclear Armageddon might bring. They're wild, gonzo, and tend to be as dangerous as they look.

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GRAFFITI MIMIC

The walls of train cars, their outside shells, the stations—everything is a palimpsest of graffiti. It's so thick you could peel back archaeological layers of it... and some of it's alive.

Enter the Graffiti Mimic. Living words, tags, and other symbols peel from the paint to attack you. They wrap you up in too many letters and drive you insane while suffocating you.

AI **Graffiti Mimic. Level 50.**

Like censored comic book profanity, the Graffiti Mimics come on as a series of seemingly random imagery, symbols, and words, but only they understand each other. Everyone and everything who isn't another Graffiti Mimic is prey. They take no sides in the gang war. They don't care about your nuked planet. They always had no future, written in spray paint and screamed in apathy on the stage of CBGBs, back when that was a thing.

Graffiti Mimic

Mob; Large (5), Aberration, Mimic

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
52 (+6)	23 (+5)	51 (+6)	24 (+5)	5 (+2)

Bite: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Piercing, 10ft range

Acid Spit: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Acid, 15ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Psychic Smother: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Psychic, 20ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stunned Debuff.

Notes: *Stealthy*—Any Graffiti Mimic that is not surprised attacks with Advantage during the first round of combat.

GRISTLE GANG

Throbbing sinew and rotting meat, the Gristle Gang looks like an anatomical dummy of a Hobgoblin hosed down with slaughterhouse offal. They lack only the bones. They lurch forward in time to breakdance beats, slinging slime, snot, bile, and feces as they fall upon their prey.

Mostly, they tangle with the Lobes, but if you're in their turf, you're an enemy too. Their stink alone is enough to make you puke, and when they get you in their hands, they start ripping apart your skin to get at the gristle beneath that they love so much.

AI **Gristle Gang. Level 35.**

Body horror by way of 1980s splatterpunk, Gristle Gang members are skinned Hobgoblin corpses deboned for cannibalistic aims. They're loyal to each other and hate the Lobes. In fact, hating the Lobes is maybe their whole reason for being. They exist to fight, rumble, and hate. You may not be a Lobe, but the way they see it, you're trespassing in their turf. And if you're in another gang's turf, you need to be taught a lesson.

Gristle Gang Member

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	14+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	15 (+4)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	5 (+2)

Gross Solids: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

Gristle Grapple: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Gross Liquids: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Acid, 20ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Notes: *Oozy*—A Gristle Gang Member can squeeze through size Small (2) and larger openings.

LOBE GANGER

Check out the big brain caused by rads! These gangers are all ganglia and big floating brains with pulsing veins, eyes whipping about, and oh-so-tantalizing pink Spam-like juice dripping from them. They'll give you a piece of their mind by blasting yours with telepathic magic.

Right now, the Lobes hold the Prez captive. That's right—the President of the (former) United States. Sure, he's just a brainwashed NPC, but that's never stopped the American people before.

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AI Lobe Ganger. Level 40.

These huge brains have googly eyes whipping around their lobes, which they often tangle into knots. The sight is either hilarious, horrifying, or both. Either way, it's memorable. Better stop them before their mind-blasts frazzle your senses and leave you too terrified to fight back!

Lobe Ganger

Mob; Medium (4), Aberration

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	16+F	15+F	15+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	55 (+6)	15 (+4)	25 (+5)	5 (+2)

Mind Blast Spell: 16+F to hit, 5d8 Psychic, 60ft range, 5ft Blast radius

Unsightly: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Psychic, 10ft Burst radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

TRASH KNIGHTS

Beholden to More Dread and the chivalry of garbage, Trash Knights are made up of broken glass, paper cups, cigarette butts, blown tires, and hatred for anything less than a peer of the realm. It's a shitty realm, to be sure, but it's theirs. They fight with rebar swords and garbage-can shields, ever watchful for a chance to attain the Atomic Grail!

Oh—they also ride flying ostriches. But you knew that was coming, right?

AI Trash Knight. Level 35.

You know how corporations and municipalities hire the lowest bidder to get the job done? And how sometimes that results in crappy workmanship and subpar results? Somewhere along the line, that happened, and now we've got the Trash Knights.

These hodgepodge husks have pledged fealty to the one and true lord of the underway, More Dread. They fight without honor, though it's arguable there's no such thing in the aftermath of nuclear war.

But they do adhere to a code—just not one that any sane creature can make out. Upon their mighty flying ostriches they ride into battle, ready to... Joust.

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Trash Knight

Mob; Medium (4), Amalgamation

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	14+F	14+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	10 (+4)	50 (+6)	10 (+4)	10 (+4)

Rebar Sword: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Trash Lance: 15+F to hit, 4d12 Piercing, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Staggered Debuff. Can only be used when Mounted.

Notes: *Mounted*—When mounted on their flying ostriches, Trash Knights can move through the air as though on the ground, and their Move increases to 30.

GELATINOUS BOOB

Radioactive blobs oozing the shape of big, bold breasts, these green Vaseline-like entities consume other Mobs and crawlers whole despite not having mouths.

Once swallowed, their prey's atomic structure breaks down: Cells decay and burst, organs turn to mulch, lungs fill with blood and putrid chemicals. Honestly, it's not a great way to go.

They're also hard to hurt, because they're made of a permeable substance, so bringing one down isn't easy. But, hey, you made it to the Fourth Floor because you don't go down easy either, right?

AI **Gelatinous Boob. Level 40.**

Some call them radioactive ta-tas, and that's pretty accurate. They're translucent and can swallow you. We're not saying they were designed by Russ Meyer fans, but we aren't saying they weren't, either.

"T and A" was a staple of 80s cable, okay? Many adolescent boys dreamt of giant knockers like these. After meeting a Gelatinous Boob, however, those dreams will turn to nightmares.

Gelatinous Boob

Mob; Huge (6), Aberration

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	14+F	15+F	20+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	15 (+4)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)

Engulf: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Acid, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Swallowed Debuff: The crawler is swallowed whole and cannot be attacked. When an attack against the Gelatinous Boob results in an Amazing Success or better (or it dies), all crawlers remove the Swallowed Debuff. Swallowed crawlers take 1d8+F Acid at the end of each round. Swallowed crawlers attack with Disadvantage vs. 0 DR.

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Notes: *Oozy*—A Gelatinous Boob can squeeze through size Small (2) and larger openings.

Permeable—The Gelatinous Boob is immune to Piercing and Slashing damage.

TAPE HEADS

These creatures serve the Blaster Master. They scour the stations and lines down here looking for the best music. When found, they bring it back to the Blaster Master, the source of all lyrics. They're part of a cult, and the atomic bomb fulfilled part of their prophecy.

Looking like giant bobble heads with small arms and little feet, these dudes have a cassette tape player on their foreheads and ears pointed forward that look like Bose speakers. You might not like their tunes, but you'll listen to them... and they might be the last thing you ever hear.

AI **Tape Heads. Level 35.**

Imagine the square jaw of a comic book hero with an itsy-bitsy body. That's a Tape Head. They bobble more than they run, given their little legs, but don't sleep on these goofy looking guys and gals; you might be able to outrun their heads, but the music... well it moves at the speed of sound, doesn't it? And their tunes will wreck you worse than a Celine Dion playlist after a nasty breakup.

Tape Head

Mob; Small (2), Construct

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	15+F	16+F	15+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	50 (+6)	10 (+4)

Terrible Tunes: 16+F to hit, 5d6 Sonic, 20ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Sepsis Debuff.

KEY NPCS

There's plenty of creatures and associated sentients down here but not enough sanity to go around. Now, reality is more like a suggestion to the survivors down here. Granted, they're all in the World Dungeon and that's pretty unreal to begin with, but these bodacious dudes are living in a post-apocalyptic America that never was.

BLASTER MASTER

Blaster Master is a giant boom box that transforms into a smaller robot. Why? Because what kid didn't want a boom box growing up? Unfortunately for the proud capitalists behind the creation of his product line, Blaster Master was discontinued immediately on release for his "profane lyrics and berating children."

Now Blaster Master leads the Tape Heads, having them scrounge the Fuschia Line for any and all cassettes that rock. Cassettes that don't rock are destroyed, so don't be bringin' no Starship *We Built This City* to Blaster Master, got it?

Since he and his "Heads" have sought rare and exotic cassettes down here for ages, they know what's what and could prove to be a good resource for the crawlers.

AI **Blaster Master. Transformable Boom Box. Level 20.**

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

Rock machine, baby! The cool kids had boom boxes on their shoulders made by Sony and the like. The uncool kids had Blaster Master, the transforming... yeah, whatever. Down here he's the shit, okay? He redefines cool. He's acquiring every tape ever made to find the secret of existence or maybe just to rock out.

Blaster Master

NPC; Small (2), Construct

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
20	15+F	14+F	10+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	10 (+4)	6 (+3)

Rock On: 14+F to hit, 3d4 Sonic, 15ft Burst range
Any hit crawler gains the Stunned.

BONERBAS THE FERRYMAN

Bonerbas used to drive the subway. In his fractured mind, he still does, but in reality, he's the Ferryman of the Black Lagoon inside the Chapel Perilous. When the atomic bombs took out NYC, he was reduced to nothing but a radioactive green skeleton. But that shit is cool, so we gave him a boat and a pole, and now he's an essential part of this Quest's transportation infrastructure. Who says dreams don't come true?

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AI Bonerbas. Radioactive Skeleton Ferryman. Level 27.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

When the nukes came, Bonerbas was a middle-aged dude named Barnabas driving a subway car for a living. Through a comic book-style transformation involving technology, nuclear radiation, and a whole lot science fiction bullshit, he was transformed into the glowing green skeleton you see before you.

We gave him a boat and a pole and sent him back out to do what he does best: get people from point A to point B. I wouldn't touch him if I were you, though—that glow, while calming and pleasant, isn't because he's an undead night light.

THE PREZ

Given the memories of a struggling actor whose main claim to fame was that he once played the President of the United States in a made-for-TV movie, the NPC City Elf known as the Prez believes he is America's last hope. The rival gangs don't want him to save anything except his breath, so they've captured him and locked him up until something dramatic changes—you know, like the crawlers rescuing him, finding the Atomic Grail, and completing this Quest?

Whatever the outcome, the Prez thinks he's the real President of the United States circa 1983. He also believes he can escape this mess by finding the Atomic Grail, which will supposedly heal the damage done by the "nukes."

AI The Prez. City Elf Smarmy Politician. Level 24.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

Wow... you really did it? You saved the Prez himself? I'm kind of impressed. Only kind of, but still... This guy is like most politicians: he's self-serving, self-aggrandizing, self-confident, self-righteous, self-absorbed, and has limited self-control. Despite all that, he wants to salvage the iconic greatness of 1980s America from the wreckage of the Iron Tangle, and you can help him do it.

TRASH PROPHET

Wrapped in tattered rags and newsprint like some latter-day mummy, the Trash Prophet is actually a City Elf under all that stink and debris. Blinded by the blast that he believes took out New York, an epiphany reshaped his life's trajectory via the belief that he is the true prophet of the Atomic Grail. Now his sole purpose is to lead the masses from the darkness of the fetid subways and into the light of porno theaters and dregs-era Times Square!

AI Trash Prophet. City Elf Herald of Change. Level 40.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

The Trash Prophet seeks the Atomic Grail and believes it alone can heal the Fuschia Line Fever. Sometimes when you ask too many questions, the Trash Prophet stutters nonsense or screams in existential terror. Then, as if a switch was thrown, he resets to his role and continues his rambling and preaching. (You can thank those mudskipper writers for doing a half-assed job constructing his backstory and personality.)

ENVIRONMENT

The station is a mess. Dirt doesn't just pile in the corners; it breathes. Metal garbage cans overflow with trash, and rivers of it crawl around the floors. The walls pulse with living graffiti, some of it monstrous. Everything reeks of piss, cigarettes, and puke, and all if it is covered with a fine atomic dust. Piles of fetid trash might contain people, monsters, dead crawlers, or even rats the size of Rottweilers. It's a hellish nightmare lit with stuttering neon lights, too-bright fluorescents, and barrel fires.

No one down here is your friend. No one is sane. Sanity is something that departed long ago with law and order (CHUNG-CHUNG. Eat your heart out, Dick Wolf). You got a problem? Solve it yourself. These trains look like a dungeon: one long metallic room attached to another, stretched end-to-end to an oblivion in the shape of a mushroom cloud.

Shit down here glows with radiation, toxic runoff, and malignant intent. And if you think the station and cars smelled bad, wait until you have to hide in a toilet stall. If this isn't Hell itself, it's the urban equivalent. No wonder the design crew at Borant love this place; it represents the worst of humanity—filth, crime, deprivation, and dripping HAZMAT-labeled junk.

The trains are no better, running in non-Euclidean lines, Möbius strips, and other brain-twisting shapes. The tunnels stink to the stars, and everything down here needs an aggressive battery of shots, antibiotics, and seven or eight good showers before being allowed back into polite society.

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TRAPS

Hell, this *whole place* feels like a trap! The stench alone conspires to upend the last crawler biscuit you ate and splatter it all over the gang graffiti dominating every wall. The cars squeal as they ride the rails like sentient metal beings tortured to reveal the secrets behind the gang scrawls on the walls.

But there is no meaning here—just close quarters and the constant reek of Human effluviant mixed with things 'best not examined too closely. What were we talking about? Oh, yeah. Traps. Well, this place has them!

- **Puke Can:** Crushed cans of brand-name soda, pop, or whatever your folks called it back in the world... down here, they're everywhere. Most don't give them a second thought. But when you step on a very select few, they make you puke like you did that time you got wasted on Jägermeister and bourbon. The barfing lasts until you find a remedy, giving you a −2 to all rolls and making you somewhat unpopular in the party.
- **Exploding Trash Piles:** That cluster of rags is a bomb! So is that overstuffed trashcan. And so are those mounds of broken lamps, clocks, and other household appliances. The possibilities of what is or isn't a bomb can be endless, and the type of damage and pain you'll receive from these detonating debris heaps is just as varied, so watch your step!

QUEST ITEMS

Down here, crawlers can find items to help them succeed in their Atomic Grail Quest. Better find them before More Dread, the bane of the subways, does.

- **The Atomic Grail:** Aka "the Holy Grail," this is the primary Quest item that the PCs must find. Located in Grand Central Station, the "Grail" is actually the first Coca-Cola bottle made in that iconic green glass down in Atlanta—still factory-sealed! If the Prez drinks from it, Fuschia Line Fever is healed.
- **Metal Subway Token:** These tokens don't seem to have any value. They're found occasionally in loot boxes or on monsters. There are never more than 1d4 at a time. However, if the party visits the Black Lagoon (see p. 518), they can use these to pay the Ferryman.
- **The Blessed Cassette Tape:** What's on it is hotly contested, but the Blessed Cassette Tape is sought by the one, the only, Blaster Master. He runs the Tape Heads. If you play the tape backward, it directs you to the Atomic Grail (and mentions something about devil-worship, but you can ignore that part until the 15th Floor).

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards:

- **Plissken's Patch: "**You rescued the President!
  Reward: You've received a Gold Apparel Box."
  Contents: Plissken's Patch—an eye patch depicting an image of a snake. Only the very best get to wear this patch. While wearing the patch, it grants 2 to ranged combat and +2 to any Charisma-related Checks.
- **MacGyvered:** "You crafted an item without a crafting table. Now make a rocket ship with an old pair of socks, a half-empty box of uncooked macaroni, and a scooter, and I'll be really impressed.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Tinkerer's Box."
  Contents: A Temporary Tattoo that grants Advantage on any Fabricate Checks to craft a specific item. It wears off at the end of the Floor.
- **King Arthur: "**You've found the Atomic Grail and deliver it to the Prez.
  Reward: Your Gold Quest Box has been upgraded to a Platinum Quest Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Back on Earth, riding the subway initiated a daily routine of travails: go to work, sit in a cubicle, return to your slightly larger sleeping cubicle, repeat. Here in the Iron Tangle, you get to move through cars, kill, heal, and repeat. You've come so far, slugger! Table 94 lays out a few complications.

THE QUEST

STAGE 1: TRASH PROPHET

It all starts with the Trash Prophet. Blinded from witnessing the detonation of a nuke, the Trash Prophet now sees more than he could before. Convinced of his beliefs and outfitted to survive in a variety of urban environments, he wears a ghillie suit made from rags and newspaper clippings so he can better hide from the wandering Mobs. He knows things down here are wrong, deeply so—he just doesn't know why.

The Trash Prophet has been captured by either the Lobe Gang or the Gristle Gang. Whether intentionally or not, the PCs might save him after defeating their first Mob of that type.

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TABLE 94: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	Sometimes winning is losing. You've gone through a lot of subway cars and some of the station, but you also earned the ire of one of the gangs. Either the Lobes or the Gristle harbor a grudge against you now. Once you're done grinding, they're gonna find you and make you pay.
2	Somehow or another, you wound up on top of the subway cars. However you got up here is no longer a viable way back down, but you're gonna have to figure out something because there's a tunnel coming. This isn't a cartoon, either, so you'd better move quickly or plan to roll like Ann Bolyn's head.
3	Mobs stole your shoes! You weren't paying enough attention, and your footwear is gone. Better find the Mobs that did it (or ones with a similar shoe size) unless you want to barefoot it like Carl.
4	You remember Pizza Rat, don't you? The animatronic rodent from that kids casino-place your parents took you to for your birthday? Well, you've got one of those guys following you now. The weird thing is, in addition to hauling around that thin slice of pepperoni and millipedes, he's quoting Shakespeare. All the time. And he won't stop. OMG, it's getting annoying.
5	The Tape Heads seem to think you have the Blessed Cassette Tape, the bootleg tape Sid Vicious supposedly made with Elvis before they both died. The Tape Heads won't ask for it nicely. Instead, they're getting a bunch of Mobs together to stomp the music out of you.
6	Somewhere along the way you lost a valuable item. Is it in a pile of ick? Lost in the toilets? Do you want to go back and look? Are you *sure?*

"That's really weird"

—Carl

The Trash Prophet answers the majority of PCs' questions about the Quest by explaining the following: First, find the Atomic Grail. Then find the Prez. Then make the Prez drink from the Atomic Grail. After that, all will be made well.

When pressed, the Trash Prophet will further explain that first, the crawlers must penetrate Fever Station—the terminus from nowhere. All the trains coming in and out came from nowhere and are headed to places that never existed. It's a web of subway lines folding over themselves, twisted under other lines, and wrapped around, chain-like.

Take every dirty subway station you've seen, double it, finish it off with an A-bomb, and you've got a sense of just how bad this place is. The PA system shouts, screams, and wails punk rhythms and capitalist propaganda along with jingoistic sayings of the good ol' USA (may she rest in pieces). The place is rife with gangers and punks who'd kill you for the way you part your hair... *nerd*.

STAGE 2: THE BLESSED CASSETTE TAPE

The Atomic Grail isn't the only artifact down in the tunnels of the former NYC subway. There's also the Blessed Cassette Tape. The Tape Heads just want the tape for their holy rites. Others claim the tape, if played backward, reveals the location of the Atomic Grail.

The Trash Prophet believes in the ability of the Blessed Cassette Tape to show the way to the Atomic Grail. First, though, he needs to *find* the damn tape. He believes it's lodged inside an Alpine car stereo in a Chevy Malibu parked outside one of the stations down here. Problem is, it's in disputed territory. The Gristles and the Lobes fight over this station constantly.

The PCs have a couple of options, though the Trash Prophet sees only combat ahead. One, they can fight off both gangs and grab the tape out of the Chevy Malibu. That's straightforward. Two, they can side with one gang (or try, anyway) and offer to raid the other in exchange for the tape. The gangs have no use for holy tripe; they're all about turf!

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- Your feet stick to the gum along the floor. You hope it's gum, anyway.
  Outcome: Make a DEX Stat Check or gain the Stiff Legs Debuff.
- Slippery when wet. You just took a trip... into a puddle of piss. This just isn't your day, is it?
  Outcome: You either hurt yourself for 1d4+F damage or gain the Stink Debuff. Stink: You suffer Disadvantage on Social Skill Checks until you can wash yourself. Find some soap, please.
- Glowing skeletons. Covered in detritus, this skeleton glows with the very nuclear forces that killed it. Looks like it might have some great loot, but do you really want to get that close?
  Outcome: If the PCs approach, give them a cool piece of loot but anyone near the bones long enough to grab the item must make a CON Stat Check or gain the Irradiated Debuff: The crawler suffers −2 to all Checks for the next 4 hours.

Third, and this is the hardest, the PCs can try to sneak into the disputed area, steal the tape, and get out before being detected. It's possible if they have the right skills, but both gangs patrol this area like it's their Fort Knox, so it won't be easy.

Once in possession of the Blessed Cassette Tape, the PCs just need a boom box or other device to play it backward. True to the Trash Prophet's word, other than advocating mild occult practices, it gives the location of the Atomic Grail inside the Chapel Perilous.

STAGE 3: ATOMIC GRAIL

Once a pinnacle of the New York transportation system, Grand Central Station fell into ruin when the atomic bombs went off. Part of it is completely flooded (read more about the Black Lagoon below), and the whole thing is now known as the Chapel Perilous.

Trash Knights patrol inside and out, for More Dread knows the Atomic Grail is here. Sadly, for Quest reasons, none of his Trash Knights are pure enough to take hold of it... at least not in the chapel itself. Their plan, therefore, is to wait for the PCs to get the Atomic Grail and then kill them for it. Maybe that's why they aren't pure enough to get it themselves? Makes ya think...

A part of the immense Grand Central Station, the Black Lagoon is located on the far end where the station angles downward. It's totally flooded and crawls with vines, moss, and things slippery and sleek weaving between one's feet. The depth ranges from about a foot to four feet, forcing crawlers to slosh through the murky water.

Bioluminescent molds float atop the mirror-like water, providing illumination. Benches drift by, along with shoals of Styrofoam cups, plastic forks, cigarette butts, and lumps that might just be alive. The GM may decide to apply movement penalties in combat. Consider that any travel in this region adds 20% on average to the total time spent exploring.

Watch out for Jet Ski Gangers! Some punks down here must have raided a drug lord's yacht, because they have jet skis! Either Lobes or Gristles (the GM's choice) come revving in on these beauties. They move fast, having no disadvantage, and give a −4 penalty to Dodges made by the PCs in combat while the Mob is on the jet skis. If you want, you may use the Vehicle rules (p. 72) as well.

A green glowing skeleton named Bonerbas poles his way across the flat water. He has room for the whole party, if the whole party is willing to trust a glowing undead NPC. For two subway tokens each (see *Quest Items*, p. 516), the Bonerbas the Ferryman gives passage to any point within the Black Lagoon area. For four tokens per person, he takes one to the other side. This doesn't need to negate combat, of course.

The Atomic Grail is in a sealed portable cooler on Bonerbas's ferry boat. The cooler is labeled "Barnabas," and it was the one he took to work every day when he wasn't... you know, undead and radioactive. The cooler is not hidden, though it's behind Barnabas, and touching the skeleton or attempting to move him may have adverse effects on crawlers' health because of his radioactive nature. He won't attack them, as he is docile, but getting the cooler from behind him might be tricky.

The Trash Knights won't interfere with the PCs until they get the Atomic Grail. Once they do, however, all bets are off.

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STAGE 4: THE PREZ

The Lobes have the Prez, and they're gonna kill him in ten hours. No one in the ruins actually cares about him or his supposed role in the Iron Tangle, but he can't help the PCs complete the Quest if he's dead.

The Lobes have holed up on one of their rail lines, car-to-car, Lobe-to-Lobe. The Trash Prophet calls it Camelot, but you're pretty sure it's just a collection of dingy, graffiti-ridden, urine-smelling subway cars. That said, the Lobes sure know how to throw a party. One car is a strip joint with a stripper comprised of bones and no skin or flesh (what's left to take off?). Another is a dive bar. There's a punk club in another car and a courtroom in one as well. Lots of Mobs play saxophones in sunglasses as the windows stutter with light.

Given the graffiti everywhere, Graffiti Mimics are bound to attack here, but they're not the ones who snatched The Prez. That's the Lobes, and they have him in what is now, somehow (thank you, AI!), a moving castle tower. Picture it like a castle made of subway car-style fluted metal with a big neon dollar sign on top. That's where they have the Prez stashed.

PCs must fight their way up the "castle." Once they rescue the Prez, the Boss, More Dread, sucks them deep into a canyon-like subway sub-tunnel. The whole car, unfurled like a chrome cassette tape, goes with them, initiating the Boss Battle.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Long ago, More Dread traded his body for an experimental mechanized war suit. The only organic part of him that remains is his brain, and it's bent on dominating the nuclear subways of his world. He knows the Prez and other interlopers want the Atomic Grail, but he arranged for the President's kidnapping by the Lobe Gang. Meanwhile, his Trash

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Knights seek the Atomic Grail, because with it, he believes he'll become unstoppable.

More Dread fights from within a castle-like subway car atop a turreted tower. He'll try to knock foes off said tower while his Trash Knights harass them from the flanks. He's formidable, and he knows it. He's large but can fit on the stairs leading up to the tower (he's no ED-209 with stairs, this guy!).

If he presses the PCs down into the tower or attacks while they're inside the tower, he tries to push them back out into the subway car proper or, better yet, onto the top. He also uses the top of the car as a place to launch hapless crawlers into the deepest recesses of the Fuschia Line.

More Dread wants the Atomic Grail and its prophesied power all for himself so he can reshape the world in his image. If a PC has the Atomic Grail in their possession, he targets that PC first, using his Trash Knights to try to grab it. If they succeed in snatching it, they retreat to the tower with their prize while More Dread tries to decouple the subway car from the rest of the line to split the party.

CLUES

- More Dread targets anyone with the Grail first. He will also target the Prez at times, so crawlers can draw him where they want using these obsessions.
- More Dread may try to decouple the cars to Split the Party, and he is more vulnerable while doing so. (GM: He is at −2 Evade while trying.)
- If anyone mentions "Arthur," it really pisses More Dread off. (GM: He's at −2 on his next immediate attack. This only works three times.)

AI **More Dread**

Level 70 Borough Boss!

Standing thirty feet tall with thick armored limbs and a giant shield and sword, More Dread looks like a mecha knight by way of certain Japanese model kits, but on steroids. His chrome body reflects the madness around him, and he grins with teeth made from subway cars. A hideous sight, this Voltron-gone-bad is the Boss of the bello below, the master of disaster, the warrior of the wastelands.

More Dread

Borough Boss; Huge (6), Construct

7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
5%	10%	15%	21%	26%	31%	36%	42%	47%	52%
7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	
57%	63%	68%	73%	78%	84%	89%	94%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
70	16+F	16+F	25+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
100 (+7)	50 (+6)	100 (+7)	50 (+6)	5 (+2)

Huge-Ass Sword: 17+F to hit, 7d10+7 Slashing, 10ft range

Crushing Step: 17+F to hit, 6d6+7 Bludgeoning, 10ft Burst Radius
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Just Dreadful: 16+F to hit, No damage, 30ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.

Notes: *Split the Party*—More Dread can spend his Move to decouple the subway cars. A crawler on the subway car must make a Dex Stat Check to avoid falling off the car. On Fail, the crawler falls and takes 5d6 Bludgeoning.

Gristles, come out and play!

—Lobe Ganger

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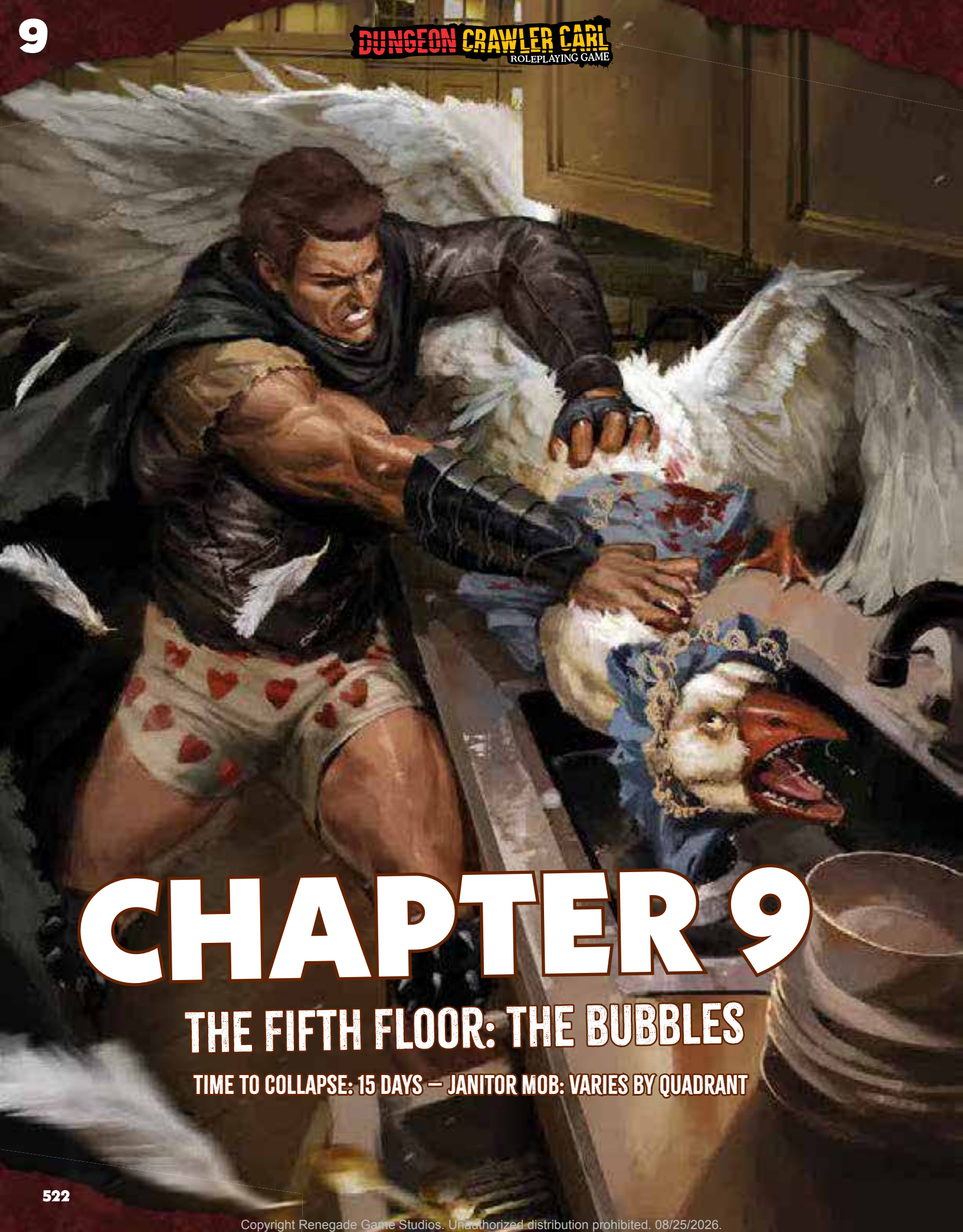

CHAPTER 9

THE FIFTH FLOOR: THE BUBBLES

TIME TO COLLAPSE: 15 DAYS — JANITOR MOB: VARIES BY QUADRANT

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HERE YOU ARE. THE FIFTH FLOOR. THIS ONE'S WEIRD, BUT IT'S A FAN FAVORITE NONETHELESS. WE DIVIDED ALL THOSE PESKY CRAWLERS INTO LITTLE GROUPS AND DISTRIBUTED THEM ACROSS A BUNCH OF "BUBBLES." EACH BUBBLE HAS FOUR QUADRANTS: LAND, SEA, AIR, AND SUBTERRANEAN. EACH QUADRANT HAS A CASTLE. EACH CASTLE HIDES A STAIRWELL DOWN TO THE SIXTH FLOOR.

What's the catch? Crawlers can't cross from one quadrant to the next until their castle has fallen. And they'll have to work with other hapless crawlers stuck in those quadrants to get each of the four castles in their bubble to fall. Once the four castles have fallen, crawlers can attempt to cross the Lacuna to other bubbles if they have time.

Crawlers don't have much choice in the matter. Before they emerge onto the floor, their team leader will spin a wheel to randomly determine which quadrant they start in.

New Features:

- Each party randomly begins in the Land, Sea, Air, or Subterranean quadrant of a bubble.
- Each quadrant of the bubble has a castle and exactly one set of stairs in it.
- Crawlers cannot leave their quadrant until its castle has been conquered.
- Crawlers cannot access their stairs until each castle has fallen.
- Once each castle has fallen, crawlers can leave their bubble but must cross the Lacuna to access others.
- Feral creatures begin to appear (p. 327).
- Sponsor bidding begins this floor. Bidding typically ends 45 hours (a day and a half) into the floor.

Note: For advice on running Neighborhoods and Quests, see Chapter 5, particularly pp. 262–265.

BUBBLE STRUCTURE

GMs, you'll want to construct a bubble consisting of Land, Sea, Air, and Subterranean quadrants.

One of each. Each of the Neighborhoods presented in this chapter is listed with a quadrant type, but you don't need to adhere to that strictly. You could adjust some of the Neighborhoods below to push them into a different quadrant type. Move the *City of Aculeus* to a different environment, or change windswept tundra or mountaintops to a frozen sea full of icebergs. There's always the possibility of glitches or errors, too. Those tend to happen to the PCs a lot. Too much, maybe. Oh well. You get the idea.

Your PCs don't need to go into each quadrant of their bubble, so that lets you fake a lot of this. There are other crawlers there working to succeed. Castles can fall without any actions from the PCs. Or if you're all having a blast, then the other parties might die or leave, resulting in a half-explored bubble and more time for your PCs to explore other quadrants.

Each Neighborhood could be the only or primary Neighborhood in a quadrant, but there's no reason you couldn't include a second Neighborhood in the same bubble or expand it with your own custom content. Unlike many previous floors, Carl and Donut move between quadrants quite a bit in *The Gate of the Feral Gods*.

Castles: Don't forget to establish a clearly defined castle in each bubble. The Neighborhoods below include some obvious choices for castles, and remember: for these purposes, a "castle" isn't necessarily a medieval-looking castle. A boat, a hill, a pit, a seven-stomached dragon, or whatever you want can be the castle.

Other Crawlers: Because other crawlers are trapped in the same bubble as the PCs, you'll want to decide who some of them are. Don't worry if you picked some from a Neighborhood on this floor and don't end up using it; these crawlers could have already prevailed in that Neighborhood or come from a different one entirely. See *Rival and Allied Crawlers*, p. 524. For improvising Difficulties associated with rival crawlers, see p. 311.

Note: For advice on running Neighborhoods and Quests, see Chapter 5, particularly pp. 262–265.

GRINDING

Use the Table 95 for ideas when crafting grinding montages or as additional encounters on the Fifth Floor.

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TABLE 95: FIFTH FLOOR GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL	RESULT
1—6	See the current Neighborhood.
7	You find yourselves caught outdoors as the heat of the day becomes extreme. (GM: Have the crawlers make an Unopposed Survival Skill Check to find or build some sort of makeshift shelter.)
8	You find a group of NPC children wandering in your area. (GM: This could lead to a quest.)
9	You find yourselves between two warring factions. (GM: The players can choose to take a side or just find some way out of the situation.)
10	The bubble you are in begins to shrink. (GM: This could prompt the players to focus back on their main task or quest.)
11	You encounter a high-level dignitary from another area who requires assistance.
12	The party falls into a trap!
13	You find yourselves randomly transported to another portion of the area you are in, tens of miles away.
14	You encounter a crashed airship. (GM: This can initiate a fight with some Mobs from this floor or reveal an important clue about a Boss.)
15—20	Nothing bad happens.

THE LACUNA

When a bubble "pops" as the final castle falls, it retains much of its shape on the bottom. This leaves a large drop-off to the foggy ground of the Lacuna proper. Flight is the easiest way to traverse the Lacuna, though ground-based mounts or vehicles work without too much trouble. A few stray Mobs do populate the Lacuna, which are instantly hostile if a crawler seeks them out, but otherwise they'll likely stay out of the crawlers' way.

GMs: Use any Mobs you like for the Lacuna. It's either really dangerous or really boring. Traversing the Lacuna isn't difficult, per se, but it takes time without a way to move fast. It takes even more time to find a particular bubble.

RIVAL AND ALLIED CRAWLERS

On this floor, the PCs don't technically *need* to work with other crawlers to topple the castle, burst their bubble, and descend to the Sixth Floor. Buuut the smarter idea probably *is* to play nicely with others... or manipulate them into doing most of the hard work. However the party goes about it, there *are* other crawlers in the bubble with them. And that's a great thing.

As the GM, this is a great chance to bring back any surviving crawlers the PCs have engaged with, whether it was all the way back on the Tutorial Floors from the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set***, or just from the last session on the Fourth Floor. Page back through any Neighborhoods or Quests you ran, or talk to the players about some of their favorites. Keep your choices focused: pick five to nine other crawlers the players love or love to hate. These crawlers can populate the other quadrants of the PCs' bubble.

Updates from Near and Far: You can also put some known crawlers in other bubbles, occasionally updating the PCs on their progress. Known crawlers in the same bubble, obviously, bring more urgency and opportunities to coordinate and roleplay as the consequences of their actions in each quadrant matter.

Death: If there's just way too many crawlers to deal with, then you're in luck. A lot of them could (and probably should) die on this floor. Their deaths could be cheap or poignant, whatever makes for the most fun at the table.

Leave Traces: If the PCs explore a Neighborhood after the previous party died, find a few places to put their mangled corpses or have NPCs talk about what they did and how they died.

More Crawlers: You'll want to introduce some new crawlers as well. Check out some previous Neighborhoods you skipped over for some interesting crawlers, pull someone from a character's background, pick some from the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Starter Set*** in Table 96, or select one of the degenerates below:

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TABLE 96: GAME MASTER'S CAMPAIGN TOOLKIT CRAWLERS

CRAWLER	FLOOR	PAGE
Bethany Dow	1	46
Ghost	1	25
Huey J	2	102
Janette Thorn	2	92
Kamonrat	2	124
Louis B. Denver	2	114
Selina Poe Deveraux	1	25
Squeak 42	1	68
Terri Campion	1	36
Zach Nophobia	1	58

MERLIN

Merlin is a cocky crawler who works alone. The companions he entered the dungeon with are gone. A few died fighting a Neighborhood Boss on the Second Floor. The rest perished from Merlin's explosion, which ultimately defeated a Borough Boss on the third. In his defense, he underestimated the destructive potential of his new Class.

Merlin insists he isn't here to hunt other crawlers. Unfortunately, the dozen Player-Killer skulls floating beside his name say otherwise. Most came from "collateral damage" due to his particularly enthusiastic use of explosives. A few came from self-defense. According to Merlin, none of them were intentional.

Whether that's true probably depends on how close you stand when he lights the next fuse. Regardless, he's too risky an ally for most folks.

AI **Crawler #563,891. "Merlin."**

Level 38.

Race: Crocodilian.

Class: Bomb Squad Tech.

Bomb Tosser

Crawler; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
38	15+F	16+F	20+S	F
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	30 (+5)	21 (+5)	50 (+6)	12 (+4)

Chomp: 14+F to hit, 5d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Drop the Bomb: 15+F to hit, 2d8 Force, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Staggered Debuff.

SUNFLOWER WADE

Sunflower survived the collapse because he was stoned at Imperial Beach when the world ended. He was outside, looking up at the moon and being all, "ya know, man... *cosmic* and stuff." When the glowing portal opened, Sunflower assumed it was because of his inner third-eye chakra or whatever, and he went in. *Bummer, man.*

Instead, it was the World Dungeon. Sunflower isn't the brightest light bulb in the towel rack, but he's very lucky. He believes he's in some MMORPG afterlife, not an alien dungeon. That's how he justifies killing. *They're just hungry ghosts or demons or something, bro.*

But his luck? Well, it's inexplicable. He's survived too many sketchy situations in too many unlikely ways. Any more, and Borant might want to know why, or how.

AI **Crawler #12,444,345. "Sunflower Wade."**

Level 36.

Race: Human.

Class: Cosmic Surfer.

Lean, tan, and with hair bleached by the sun, Sunflower is a spiritual surfer whose believes he's in the afterlife. He's cool with that, bro. He wears a wetsuit adorned with various symbols he considers "holy" (like an old Coke bottle cap) and loves to talk... endlessly.

Mellow Surfer

Crawler; Medium (4), Human

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
36	13+F	16+F	20+S	F
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	16 (+3)	20 (+5)	50 (+6)	22 (+5)

High Five: 152+F to hit, 5d4+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

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NEIGHBORHOOD: BACKYARD BLITZ (LAND QUADRANT)

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: HONEY, I SHRUNK THE CRAWLERS

A facsimile of a suburban yard fills this quadrant of the bubble, eerily familiar in every regard except one: everything was enlarged so that crawlers entering the Neighborhood are the size of ants relative to the environment.

Thick blades of grass and weeds bearing shimmering droplets of water tower above gritty soil and pebbles the size of boulders. Plastic toys lie forgotten, their bright colors standing out amid the dirt. Elsewhere, a wide sandbox spreads into windswept dunes, the far end of which terminates in a large choppy lake where a garden hose was left running.

Predators roam throughout the yard, sized commensurately to match the scale of the Neighborhood. Silent Yard Mantis hunters prowl the Grass Jungle while huge Nerodia Water Snakes glide through Puddle Lake, striking at unwary sailors or swimmers. Spiders bigger than elephants stretch webs between dandelion stalks the size of redwoods or burrow deep in the sand of the desert, popping out at any hint of movement above.

All roads in the yard lead to the Gerbil Kingdom, a little village outside a circular wall of colorful interlocking toy blocks. The citizens here are no smarter or more organized than the average Frenzied Gerbil, just larger. A constant stream of wagons laden with food, trinkets, and captured prey flows past the wall toward a pink plastic sandcastle mold set atop a hill, underneath which lies a large pit. Within this hollow, the Gerbils' monarch, a Feral Rat King named Legion, resides amid his growing tribute hoard.

Potential Castle: The Rat King's Sandcastle

"Snakes. Why did it have to be snakes?"

—Last words of Crawler Henry W.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- As the crawlers enter the Neighborhood, the scale of objects around them grows until they're surrounded by grass stalks tall as skyscrapers, plastic toy soldiers like monuments, and lumbering bugs twice their size that pay them no mind as they trundle past. A rustle in the grass reveals a twenty-foot-tall Wolf Spider, which jumps on a Yard Beetle directly in front of the crawlers, sinking its fangs into the cracking carapace before turning eight black eyes on them.
- The sounds of struggling and muffled grunts echo through towering stems. The crawlers come upon a Skyfowl crawler, Erik, caught in a spiderweb high off the ground. He asks for help, saying he hasn't seen a spider, but he thinks he saw a couple of large green insects with "blade arms" circling a few minutes ago.
- Hooting and hollering in the distance is the only warning before a ladybug flies overhead with Maia, a Hogoblin crawler, attempting to ride the bucking bug. She loses her grip after about ten seconds and lands on a pile of grass with a laugh. She asks the crawlers if they're here for the Ladybug Rodeo too. Maia's heard they have some good prizes for anyone who can beat her record of ten seconds.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- The crawlers encounter Maia, a Hobgoblin crawler, and the Ladybug Rodeo in the Grass Jungle. Participating can earn them a jug of Bug Juice and access to a hidden aphid colony where a dead crawler carries a crude crayon map marking a pink sandcastle mold to the north. Following that map leads across the Neighborhood through the

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Sandbox Desert and over Puddle Lake, bringing the party to the Gerbil Kingdom, where wagons overflowing with tribute roll toward the monarch of the Quadrant: the Feral Rat King, Legion.

- The crawlers cross paths with Jeremy, the Jerboa Trader, in the Sandbox Desert, who explains that Gerbil Raiders stole his goods and fled toward their kingdom. Soon after, the crawlers encounter the raiding party hauling tribute across the desert on a crude sled. The Gerbils won't part easily with their ill-gotten goods, but they might be bribed or threatened into spilling information about their kingdom.
- At Puddle Lake, the crawlers must deal with Nerodia Water Snakes hunting along the banks and in the water. During their crossing, they may meet a couple of Grulke who need help escorting their tadpoles to safety, or rescue the bound Gerbil Tatera, who reveals the location of buried tribute beneath a picnic table in the Gerbil Kingdom. Later, this hidden cache can be recovered during a contest to help the crawlers win the Royal War Horn.

MOBS

The yard is full of life. Mobs here are almost always exactly what a crawler would expect to see: insects, spiders, snakes, frogs, and escaped household pets, just resized to fit the scale of the Neighborhood.

GIANT FRENZIED GERBIL

Frenzied Gerbils are vicious and simple-minded, bearing little to no regard for life and limb. At the slightest provocation, they leap toward the nearest throat in a blur of teeth and claws, only stopping once they've burst through the other side.

As if that weren't enough, here in the yard they've grown such that the smallest stands more than five feet tall. They organized into a crude kingdom, crowning the Feral Rat King their figurehead monarch. From every quarter of the yard, they drag back offerings of food, scraps, and even living sacrifices for its pit.

AI Giant Frenzied Gerbil. Level 55.

This is why you don't release your hamster into the backyard once you get bored with it. It bones some other hamster, or a mouse or whatever, then their kids are having kids, and suddenly you've got a whole horde of these fuzzy little psychopaths on your hands.

Well, normally they're little. These ones grew a bit physically, I mean. Mentally, there still ain't a lot going on in there. Good news, though! You don't need much of a brain when all you're trying to do is chew through someone's throat. (And yes, I know gerbils and hamsters are technically two different things. Ask me if I care.)

Giant Frenzied Gerbil

Mob; Medium (4), Critter

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
55	14+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
45 (+5)	18 (+4)	37 (+5)	55 (+6)	15 (+4)

Scratch: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Gnaw: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Sepsis Debuff.

Notes: *Frenzied*—Frenzied Gerbils have a Step distance of 20ft instead of 10ft.

NERODIA WATER SNAKE

The largest threats in the Neighborhood by size are Nerodia Snakes, and many varieties populate each quarter of the yard. Despite their size, Nerodia Water Snakes are silent hunters, leaving behind tufts of disturbed earth as the only evidence of their passage. Most prey on rodents and amphibians, though the addition of crawlers to their environment has broadened their diet immensely.

The most common snake in the yard is the Nerodia Water Snake. An able predator in water as well as on land, this large reptile is almost impossible to escape once it chooses a victim. Relative to the average crawler, a Nerodia in this Neighborhood is the size of a cargo train.

AI Nerodia Water Snake. Level 51.

There's something to be said for a simple design. Doesn't get a lot simpler than a couple of big fangs, a jaw that unhinges, and a big tube of death slithering toward you like... well, like a hungry snake. And sure, most snakes are harmless. You know they're far more scared of you than you are of them? Keep that in mind when taking your one-way trip through their digestive tract.

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Nerodia Water Snake

Mob; Huge (6), Reptile

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
51	14+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
48 (+5)	14 (+4)	42 (+5)	49 (+5)	5 (+2)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

Constrict: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Swallow: 15+F to hit, 3d12+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
This attack may only be made against Held foes. Any hit crawler gains the Swallowed Debuff: Swallowed crawlers take 1d10+F Acid at the end of each round and cannot be attacked. Swallowed crawlers attack with Disadvantage vs. 0 DR, and Slashing attacks deal ×2 damage. When an attack against the Nerodia Water Snake results in an Amazing Success or better (or it dies), all crawlers remove the Swallowed Debuff.

YARD BEETLE

Beetles turn up across the yard in all shapes and sizes, and a good chunk of them resemble ladybugs. The smaller ones are about the size of a German Shepherd, while the largest are about the size of a small car. Thick exoskeletons protect them from all but the heaviest blows, and their bull-headed nature, combined with an array of natural defenses, makes them a dangerous foe. That said, if a crawler makes friends with a Beetle, they'll find no sturdier or more loyal steed.

AI Yard Beetle. Level 46.

You know what I like about Beetles? Work ethic. They really get down to business. You crawlers are all alike: Ooooh, nooo, I'm too scared to fight. I don't want to die. I miss my cat. Constantly procrastinating, not getting the job done.

You don't get that garbage from a Beetle. Big dumb armored tanks with legs. Get on top of one, and you can crash it into things all day long and not wear it out. I've even heard if you make friends with one and say its name three times, it might show up when you need it. Or was that something else?

Yard Beetle

Mob; Large (5), Insectoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
46	12+F	15+F	20+S	7
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
45 (+5)	5 (+2)	53 (+6)	30 (+5)	10 (+4)

Slam: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Trample: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 15ft Line
Any hit crawler gains the Sore as Shit Debuff.

YARD MANTIS

Yard Mantises lurk where the Grass Jungle is thickest, moving in silent packs and striking without warning. These perfect predators hide among tall grass stems, their green-and-brown bodies blending easily with the foliage. They use the whole environment to their advantage, ambushing from above and below.

Once they identify a meal, their raptorial forelegs snap out with blinding speed and enough power to crush bones, dragging the unfortunate victim toward mandibles capable of dismembering even the toughest of prey.

AI Yard Mantis. Level 45.

I had thousands of bugs to choose from when I built this Neighborhood. Tens of thousands. And I absolutely filled the yard with Mantises.

I just like the juxtaposition, you know? They're so still and patient. All calm and polite, hands folded like they're praying and waiting for church to start. Then BAM! They grab some little old lady from a pew across the way, and before you know it, they're munching on her head while her body's cooling next to a spilled plate of those little wafers. Maybe now you wanna start praying, too, eh?

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Yard Mantis

Mob; Medium (4), Insectoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
45	14+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
40 (+5)	10 (+4)	30 (+5)	55 (+6)	5 (+2)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

Spinning Scythe: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Slashing, 5ft Burst radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Sudden Burst*—Any Mantis that is not surprised can travel twice its Move in the first round of combat.

Yard Spider

Mob; Large (5), Arachnid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
49	14+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
42 (+5)	17 (+4)	41 (+5)	49 (+5)	3 (+2)

Fangs: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Leg Sweep: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

YARD SPIDER

Yard Spiders are specialized killers equipped with a breadth of biological weapons and tools, making them particularly deadly foes. In the Grass Jungle, strands of spider silk stretch between stalks where Orb Weavers and Grass Spiders claim territory. Careless crawlers brushing these delicate traps may find themselves helplessly pinned in place, waiting for the end to arrive.

In the baking heat of the Sandbox Desert, the danger lurks beneath the sand. Trapdoor Spiders concealed in grit erupt upward when vibrations signal footsteps overhead. Throughout every quarter, ravenous Wolf Spiders prowl, the most aggressive arachnid threat in the yard.

AI **Yard Spider. Level 49.**

I can't understand why
Humans don't like these things.
What's not to like? They're quick and efficient.
They come up with so many approaches to finding dinner, it's wild. Sure, they can't agree on webs, hidey holes, or just striking out like an eight-legged serial killer, but at the end of the day, they all make it work.

And did you know their legs use hydraulics? They're like tiny little murder machines! No rolled-up newspaper is gonna save you this time, bucko.

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ENVIRONMENT

An otherwise normal backyard was made deadly by enlarging it to an overwhelming scale. In the Grass Jungle, visibility is low, with tall and tangled grass stalks swaying constantly as colossal insects crawl through them. Any breeze is a hurricane, and when it rains, droplets the size of Volkswagens slam to the ground with enough force to break bones.

The Sandbox Desert swelters beneath a relentless sun, suffocatingly hot and dotted with the withered carapaces and bleached bones of bugs and crawlers alike. Heat shimmers over unstable dunes, which disintegrate suddenly underfoot, revealing sinkholes that swallow the unwary whole. Plastic shovels and partially buried sand toys provide the only shade in an otherwise unforgiving and featureless expanse.

Puddle Lake is brackish, the stench of rotting vegetation carrying on the wind. Waves lap at a muddy shoreline, and the frigid water moves faster than it appears with a wicked undercurrent. The moist, warm environment is also a favorite hunting ground for the Nerodia Water Snake in particular. They can often be found lying in wait for tempting prey to come by attempting to cross the water.

The Gerbil Kingdom is chaos incarnate. A filthy and crumpled wire cage lies abandoned in favor of an equally filthy village where transparent pastel tube-tunnels track almost pointlessly across and below dirt paths. Greasy cooking fires billow black smoke into the air, and there's nowhere you can escape the chittering screeches that accompany yet another frenzied battle-to-the-death between rodents.

TRAPS

Traps in the yard fall into one of two categories: nature taking its course and Gerbils gathering tribute.

- **Spider Web:** Difficult to see and even harder to escape, spider webs extend throughout the yard. Their strands adhere like superglue, and a creature captured by them must be cut free before the owner of the web comes to check its trap.
- **Mousetrap:** A spring-loaded mousetrap sits in the open with what appears to be a treasure chest on the trigger. If the mechanism isn't bypassed before the chest is removed, it snaps shut with crushing force, obliterating the chest and anyone trying to retrieve it.
- **Gerbil Snare:** Twine is looped and concealed under loose dirt, tied to a bent twig and anchored to a peg of wood. When a crawler steps through the loop, the twig snaps upright, yanking them off the ground and leaving them dangling upside down. Giant Frenzied Gerbils return shortly thereafter to retrieve their prize.

ITEMS

- **Enormous Chunk of Edam Cheese:** A special treat from Tatera's hoard. A fancy semi-hard cheese from the Netherlands of Earth. It's got mild nutty notes and pairs beautifully with a Chardonnay for those of you with fancy taste buds. It's especially popular with rat kings.
- **Potion of Soda Pop** (Or a swallow of soda pop if you're desperate enough to slurp it straight from the source): Sweet, delicious nectar of the corn syrup gods, drinking this adds 10 feet to your movement for the next hour and then causes the Fatigued debuff.
- **Oversized Plastic Shovel:** Day-Glo yellow and orange, this plastic piece of glory is enormous but relatively light and perfect for digging in a sand pit or other desert terrain.
- **Spider Webs:** Sticky and sturdy, these ropes are difficult to use without tying yourself up, but for someone skilled enough in Ropework, these could come in very handy.
- **Snakeskin:** Whether you found it or ripped it off a beast you killed, this skin makes a pretty snazzy statement piece and could probably be crafted into something useful by anyone talented enough to know how to make purses or boots.

YARD EVENTS

The environment of the yard changes quickly, and dangerous situations can develop without warning.

- **Inclement Weather:** Thunder rolls and rain falls in large, oppressive drops. In addition to suffering 1d6+F Acid damage if struck by rain, crawlers must contend with the ground turning to sucking mud and the gradual buildup of raindrops into rushing floods threatening to sweep them away.
- **Lawnmower:** The ground shakes as a scream of rushing air and metal blades fills the air. All around, bugs run from a building vortex as the shadow of a monstrous lawnmower approaches, its spinning blades shredding everything in its path.

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- **Black Blizzard:** A sandstorm kicks up in the Desert Sandbox, whipping the dunes into a roaring spiral and blackening the sky. The fine grit acts like aggressive sandpaper, threatening to flay skin and flesh from bone, and the violent winds toss broken toys and other debris, battering anyone caught without shelter.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in the Yard.

- **Yee Haw, Pardner!:** "You stayed on the back of a bucking Beetle for eight seconds or more. You've done this before, haven't you?
  Reward: You've received a Gold Apparel Box."
  Contents: A Ladybug Hat (a red ten-gallon hat with black polka dots). Once per day, the wearer can climb on vertical surfaces or upside down for up to 3 minutes.
- **Ain't No Cactus:** "You were ambushed by a Trapdoor Spider. Not so "top-of-the-food-chain" now, are you?
  Reward: You've received a Gold Pest Control Box"
  Contents: A spray can of Bugger Off! (4 doses). When applied to a weapon, it deals +F damage to Insectoid (and related) foes.
- **Babysitter:** "You helped a bunch of tadpoles spawn safely. Haven't you heard of the circle of life? Now some poor snake's kids are going hungry. You monster.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Delicacy Box."
  Contents: A tin of frog caviar (enough to stave off hunger), which refills each time you enter a saferoom.
- **Collared Coleoptera:** "You tamed a Beetle. You can keep it, but you have to feed it, and I'm not cleaning up after it for you.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Buggin' Bronco Box."
  Contents: A Rodeo Clown Coleoptera Saddle, which grants Advantage on Riding Skill Checks when on a ladybug or beetle.
- **Earthquake? Worse... Lawnmower!:** "You survived a basic household chore. Your parents told you it wouldn't kill you to help a little around the house.
  Reward: You've received a Bronze Adventurer Box."
  Contents: A crisp $20 bill for allowance, and a list of other chores.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers stab some Spiders and slaughter some Snakes, they might grind for experience. To keep grinding montages fresh and interesting, you might introduce a complication from Table 97.

TABLE 97: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A Wolf Spider begins hunting the crawlers through tall grass. It's toying with them, herding them toward an area of the yard dense with webs, where they are cornered.
2	The crawlers come across a group of nomadic Gerbils who defected from their kingdom. They each tamed a small Spider and use them as mounts. They demand the crawlers turn over all food and weapons, attacking if refused.
3	A Trapdoor Spider wearing a bonnet pops out of her burrow with a flourish. She's a vendor selling various spider-themed items.
4	The party comes across a gigantic cookie on the ground, towering over the area. A horde of insects surrounds it, tearing off chunks. If the crawlers linger, a territorial group of Beetles attack to protect their meal.
5	A Nerodia Water Snake writhes on the ground, body distending oddly as it thrashes. The lump inside seems to be moving. It's eaten a crawler the party met before, and the unfortunate victim is trying to escape being digested.
6	The crawlers hear the shouts and clatter of combat approaching, animalistic noises and the dull thud of limbs pounding one another resound through the clearing. A tide of Gerbils, Mantises, Beetles, Spiders, and a Snake locked in a battle quickly envelop them.

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- A translucent, freshly shed snakeskin blocks your path, empty eye sockets staring.
  Outcome: Push forward into Snake territory on the most direct route, or detour onto a longer path where Spiders hunt.
- A few beachball-sized spheres of a brown liquid hang on the foliage in front of you, the surface tension holding them together.
  Outcome: Search for the spilled soda which local NPCs may fight over.
- A glass bottle rushes by you on the river, bobbing in the rapid churn. Inside, a Grulke sailor waves frantically for help.
  Outcome: Chase after the bottle and try to rescue the trapped amphibian, risking being swept away, or leave him to his fate.
- The wind picks up, and above you a dandelion begins bursting apart, parachute seeds lifting into the air to drift.
  Outcome: Continue on foot or shimmy up the dandelion stalk and try to catch a ride on a floating seed, cutting a day's travel time.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: GRASS JUNGLE

The yard is a tangled wilderness of grass and clover stalks rising far overhead. Fallen leaves like vast jungle canopies block out the sun. Gnarled root clusters must be navigated. Beetle trails and insect burrows thread through the dirt, while above, large dew globes dangle precariously from dandelion leaves. The flicker of wings and gentle sway of vegetation all around suggest the crawlers are never alone.

The grass in this part of the Neighborhood is dense and close, its towering blades leaning together to form a thick shifting corridor of green. In the stalks above and to the sides, a Strong pack of Yard Mantises hunts the crawlers. Swaying in the canopy is the only warning before the pack attacks. One drops from above, serrated forelegs snapping forward, as two others move in from the left and right, cutting off escape. Their triangular heads swivel to track the crawlers, movements sharp and violent. Rustling in the grass beyond implies more insects just out of sight.

The grass opens suddenly into a trampled clearing. A swarm of ladybugs feeding on aphids flutters and shuffles as Maia, a Hobgoblin crawler, drops from a grass stalk above with a whoop. She lands hard on the ladybug's spotted shell and clings desperately as the bug bucks and takes flight. She's soon thrown to the ground near a group of NPCs who cheer and clap.

Noticing the crawlers, Maia approaches with a grin, explaining this is a Ladybug Rodeo, and the NPCs compete to see who can last the longest on one of the insects while in flight. Anyone who wants to compete may do so by making an Unopposed Riding Skill Check with Disadvantage. The winner receives a Silver Rodeo Box, which, among other things, contains a jug (2 doses) of Bug Juice (makes hostile creatures briefly neutral, neutral creatures briefly friendly, friendly creatures tamed). Maia is ahead with a riding time of ten seconds. She gestures at the ladybugs and invites the crawlers to join the competition.

Whether or not the crawlers participate in the Ladybug Rodeo, a ladybug begins following the party. The insect repeatedly approaches and bumps into the crawlers before fluttering ahead and bowing low, its shell tilting as if inviting riders. If mounted, the ladybug launches itself upward in a spiral through the grass, carrying crawlers to a hidden roost high in the canopy. An aphid colony is here, nestled in a cluster of grass and protected by a sticky spider web in which a deceased crawler is cocooned.

If the PCs tear down the web or remove the crawler, the ladybug surges into the newly accessible aphid colony, leaving them to collect any basic gear from the corpse, along with two Poison Antidotes and a crudely drawn crayon map with a pink sandcastle mold far to the north circled in red.

QUARTER: SANDBOX DESERT

A child's sandbox fills this quarter, forming a desert consisting of low dunes. Plastic toys jut from the drifts, the only landmarks across the grit. Beneath the sands, Trapdoor Spiders burrow and nest, waiting to feast on anything crossing the expanse. Gouges cut across the basin remain visible even with the wind moving the sand, suggesting repeated trips by weighted sleds.

The remains of a Jerboa Trader's traveling cart slowly slip into a widening sinkhole beneath it. Small glass bottles, a selection of fabrics, and the odd weapon or two spill from the damaged cart, sliding into the pit while the NPC owner of the cart snatches whatever he can.

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When the Jerboa Trader, Jeremy, notices the crawlers, he shouts for help in rescuing his stock. A party of Gerbil Raiders hit his cart as he traveled to the grass jungle, stole half his stock, and sent the rest pitching into the dune before fleeing toward the castle.

Sand erupts beside the crawlers as an elephant-sized Trapdoor Spider explodes from the grit. It lunges, chitinous brown legs slamming the party as venomous ichor drips from extended fangs. The creature skitters halfway from its burrow, attacking the closest crawler and attempting to drag them under.

After encountering Jeremy, the crawlers come across a line of Giant Frenzied Gerbils straining against a crude sled as they drag it across the sand. The piled cargo is a jumble of scavenged goods lashed down by twine: bottles, plastic toy shards, bottle caps, bug meat, and a few pieces of Jeremy's cart.

One Gerbil atop the heap jabs at the pullers with a splintered stick while another trots alongside, kicking loose objects back in as they tumble free. The rodents haul their stolen tribute toward the castle. Their mission is to bring the collection back to their king, though they might be willing to trade with crawlers offering something shiny or tasty.

QUARTER: PUDDLE LAKE

The Sandbox Desert gives way to a wide puddle fed by a running garden hose. The banks of this artificial lake stretch to the visible horizon, thick with reed-like grass and sticky mud. Patches of floating vegetation form small islands across the surface with swiftly running channels between them. Little boats and rafts traverse the quarter, ferrying passengers cautiously from bank to bank, their punters watching for the hungry Nerodia Water Snakes hunting both land and lake.

The only visible method of crossing the water is a group of leaf-boats tied to reeds along the puddle's muddy edge. The wet silt path leading to them is bisected by a thick Nerodia Water Snake stretched across the mud. Its scaled body blocks the approach to the boats entirely, as its coils drape between the reeds and the waterline. The Snake feigns sleep and attacks the crawlers the moment it notices them.

A leaf raft drifts through the water. A Giant Frenzied Gerbil slathered in barbecue sauce and tied with a length of twine struggles to keep her balance as the raft rocks. The soggy rodent, Tatera, twists and kicks at her bindings, trying to reach the knot with her teeth.

When she notices the crawlers on the bank, Tatera shouts and thrashes harder, crying for help. She says she saw a Snake on the bank and doesn't want to be eaten. Between gasps, she explains the other Gerbils bound her to the raft and pushed it onto the lake as punishment for offering a poor tribute. If the crawlers help her, she says she can't go back to the kingdom but reveals she buried some of her best tribute under the picnic table in the Gerbil village.

Once the crawlers kill a Nerodia, they discover a pair of Grulke resting on a lily pad. One crouches, speaking to a swarm of tadpoles just beneath the surface while the other keeps an eye on the nearby banks. The sentinel, Anuren, waves at the crawlers, shouting gratitude for killing one of the predators that hunt their young. He asks if the crawlers will help escort them and their "lil' tads" safely to a shallow spawning pool. The Grulke know there's more than one Nerodia Water Snake in these parts, and they won't make it on their own. If crawlers help save the lil' tads, Anuren offers some advice that the Rat King is never of one mind about anything and can't keep his head together.

QUARTER: GERBIL KINGDOM

A four-story crumpled wire cage with the door ripped off sits discarded to the east of a Gerbil colony where dirt lanes wend between cooking fires, game stalls, and celebrating spectators cheering "All Hail the King." Colorful transparent tubes create an improvised highway tunnel system dug beneath paths and rising high into the air, mostly leading to dead ends stuffed with cotton, scraps of fabric, and caches of seeds and nuts.

A wall of interlocking bricks in a colorful line separates the village from a pink sandcastle mold at the center of the quarter, topped by armed Gerbil Sentries. The castle itself caps a pit dug into the hill, within which the Rat King resides.

A crowd of Gerbils gathers in a square outside the castle walls while watching two riders mounted on oversized pill bugs joust with toothpicks. Nearby, contestants beneath a looming picnic table compete to scavenge and bring the largest crumb to a judge.

If the crawlers helped Tatera in Puddle Lake, they discover an enormous chunk of Edam buried near one of the table legs. Cheers rise as two burly Gerbils grapple inside a ring scratched into the dirt. A Gerbil Herald standing atop an overturned cup calls for new challengers to enter the King's prize tournament. When he notices the crawlers, he gestures toward the events and announces that the winner of all three contests may claim the Royal War Horn (once per Floor, summon

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an allied pair of Frenzied Gerbils, p. 527) as a prize. To compete in jousting, crawlers can make an Unopposed Riding Skill Check (with Advantage if they have won the Ladybug Rodeo) to stay on their mount during the joust. To locate the largest crumb, crawlers can use any skill that helps locate food (perhaps Investigation, Cooking, or Perception). To win in the brawl, that's easy, just fight off a Moderate group of Giant Frenzied Gerbils (p 527).

A wall of stacked interlocking bricks blocks access to the next quarter, completely surrounding the castle beyond. Gerbils line the top of the wall, insulting any crawlers who approach and hurling rotting bug meat and trash over the edge. The defenders dare the party to climb the wall while gesturing with toothpick spears. Any attempt to summit or circumvent the barricade leads to the Gerbils attacking, leaping onto the crawlers from above.

A line of tribute carts creaks up the slope toward the plastic sandcastle mold on the hill. One wagon carries a large glass jar balanced precariously on its bed. As the cart rattles forward, the jar tips, striking the ground and shattering. A Rhinoceros Beetle the size of a wagon wheel bursts free and turns on the Gerbils hauling the carts. They scatter, abandoning the tribute and leaving the Beetle to turn toward the crawlers.

If the party still has the Bug Juice from the Ladybug Rodeo, the Beetle can be tamed and even ridden for the rest of the floor. Otherwise, the creature attacks. Once the Beetle is overcome, the crawlers can follow the abandoned line of tribute wagons to the throne room of the Rat King (see *B-B-B-Boss Battle*, below).

NPCS

NPCs in the yard are as varied and diverse as the biomes they're found in. Bugs, rodents, and other small creatures inhabit the Neighborhood, sized up relative to the environment. Crawlers may encounter the following NPC characters.

ANUREN

A good-natured and quick-to-laugh Grulke, Anuren is deeply committed to the duty of watching over the tadpoles of his community. In quiet moments or during travel, he unslings the banjo from his back, taking requests and encouraging rounds of song and storytelling. Anuren isn't the bravest of Grulke, but he knows the dangers and secrets of the pond and shares information freely with those who help him.

AI **Anuren. Grulke. Level 38.**

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Okay, look, I'm creating tens of thousands of NPCs and monsters, and each one has to be unique with a personality of their own. Maybe I phoned it in on this one a little. A bayou frog with a banjo and a twangy voice might not be the most original, but I'm pretty sure the handful of guys who perform that one specific puppet didn't make it into the dungeon, so it's not like anyone's around to make a copyright claim.

JEREMY

Jeremy is a nomadic Jerboa Trader making his living traveling across the Sandbox Desert, dragging his little cart from the Grass Jungle to Puddle Lake and beyond. He knows all the safest routes through the sand and learned to walk with a particular irregular cadence across the shifting dunes so as not to awaken the predators buried within. The only folk he refuses to trade with are the Gerbils. He avoids interacting with them wherever possible.

AI **Jeremy. Jerboa Trader. Level 36.**

This is a non-combatant NPC.

What happens when a kangaroo, a gerbil, and a bottle of tequila get a little bit frisky? This guy!

Too small to join his mom's boxing club and too sane to hang out with his frenzied dad, Jer-bear here survives by taking worthless junk from one place, slapping a "rare and exotic" sticker on it, and selling it in another like a traveling garage sale.

MAIA

Roller derby was Maia's passion before she entered the dungeon. A skating jammer on a small league team, she learned early that immense speed and throwing elbows solve a lot of problems. She chose the Hobgoblin Race for a laugh and the Roller Derby Jammer Class out of love. Conversations with Maia quickly drift toward playful competition. She flirts outrageously throughout any discussion, though more out of habit and amusement than any genuine interest.

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AI **Crawler #10,845,601. "Maia J."**

Level 43.

Race: Hobgoblin.

Class: Roller Derby Jammer.

Roller Derby Jammer

Crawler; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
43	15+F	16+F	20+S	F
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	24 (+5)	25 (+5)	50 (+6)	10 (+4)

Body Check: 15+F to hit, 5d8 + 5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
If the Roller Derby Jammer moved 10ft this round, any hit crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Skater*—While moving on skates, foes attack the Roller Derby Jammer with Disadvantage.

TATERA

Tatera is a Giant Frenzied Gerbil cast from her kingdom after failing to deliver proper tribute to the King. She was caught trying to hide the best trinkets and food for herself and sentenced to death on Puddle Lake. As tradition dictates, she was ritually dunked in smoky barbecue sauce and set adrift on the water in Nerodia Water Snake hunting territory. Like most of her kind, she practically vibrates with energy, though with Tatera it manifests as frantic speech and movement instead of traditional frenzied aggression, usually.

AI **Tatera. Frenzied Gerbil. Level 42.**

Apparently even rabid death rodents have standards, or at least a limit on bad behavior. You wouldn't think so, given their behavior, but I suppose if you stick your hand into a cage, you gotta expect some teeth.

Where was I? Oh, yeah. She stole a bunch of stuff, pissed off the king, and now she's here—Snake chow. Wanna get involved? Go for it. Stick your hand in that cage.

Giant Frenzied Gerbil

Mob; Medium (4), Critter

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
42	14+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	16 (+4)	24 (+5)	53 (+6)	13 (+4)

Scratch: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Gnaw: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Sepsis Debuff.

Notes: *Frenzied*—Frenzied Gerbils have a Step distance of 20ft instead of 10ft.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

At the center of the Neighborhood sits a plastic sandcastle mold atop a yawning pit with steeply angled sides. The hole is awash in a waist-deep pile of rotting food, plastic shards, gigantic fast-food wrappers, and other debris within which Legion the Rat King slumbers, unmoving until something disturbs his possessions.

As the crawlers enter, a boulder rolls across the castle entrance, plunging the interior into darkness and blocking escape. Safe in his sea of garbage, the Feral Rat King cannot be seen or targeted from above. The crawlers must venture closer to him, seeking him out amid his palace of trash. The instant a crawler touches the clutter at the bottom of the pit, the Feral Rat King boils forward in a flurry of teeth and claws.

A thousand voices chitter as one, announcing the Boss Battle. The crawlers' portraits tumble into view from the left, pulled by ladybugs that deposit the photos and then skitter off. Each appears slightly nibbled on. Opposite them, the Feral Rat King's portrait forms, spinning in a constant circle until all the portraits are torn into pieces and vanish.

The Feral Rat King leaps through the fading portraits, red eyes wild with fury, his frothing spittle splashing over the crawlers as he attacks. With no regard for any pain or damage he suffers, Legion always prioritizes the closest target and pursues it with single-minded hunger.

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CLUES

- Cheese! The rats were once in a lab and still react to cheese. Distract them with a sizable piece!
- While you're surely tied up dealing with all of the Feral Rat King's loose ends, have you considered untying the rat tails?

AI Legion. The Feral Rat King.

Level 59 Neighborhood Boss!

What's worse than a pack rat? How about several pack rats tied together by their long tails and driven insane by hunger and imprisonment?

Funny thing is, most rats are actually lovely creatures. They can learn their names and have favorite foods. On the whole, rats are better than gerbils by a mile. Not this thing, though.

More co-dependent than your parents, who should definitely be in therapy, Legion here barely even understands that he used to be more than one creature. All he knows is that food rains from above, and sometimes that food squirms and screams... and you just jumped into the pit with it.

Try not to squirm. The screaming won't be under your control.

Legion, the Feral Rat King

Neighborhood Boss; Medium (4), Rodent, Feral

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
6%	13%	20%	26%	33%	40%	46%	53%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	
60%	66%	73%	80%	86%	93%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
59	15+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
67 (+6)	20 (+5)	55 (+6)	58 (+6)	2 (+1)

Burrow Lunge: 16+F+F to hit, No damage, 20ft range
Legion disappears beneath the trash, erupting next to a crawler anywhere in the pit. If the crawler fails to Evade this lunge, the Boss makes a free Rabid Chomp attack.

Rabid Chomp: 16+F+F to hit, 5d6+6+F Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Trash Thrash: 16+F+F to hit, 3d8+6+F Bludgeoning, 30ft Cone
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Queasy Debuff.

Notes: *Knot the Solution*—A crawler can make a Dex-Opposed Ropework Skill Check to untie the tails. Doing so reduces Legion's DR to 0, and they spread out.

Naught But Cheese—Hitting one of the rats with a quarter-pound hunk of cheese (via the Throwing Skill) deals no damage, but it does reduce the number of Actions the Boss gets during the following round by 1.

Not of One Mind—Area Attacks roll with Advantage against Legion, as the multiple heads each try to dive in a different direction.

Feral—All to-hit and damage values include an extra +F (included above).

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NEIGHBORHOOD: CITY OF ACULEUS (LAND QUADRANT)

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: DESERT DUNES, CITY IN REBELLION

The City of Aculeus sprawls across the land, bordered by desert wastes. Rising above the other buildings is a ziggurat that serves as the castle and administrative building. Pazuzu Punk anarchists cause chaos throughout the city, rebelling against the goddess Tiamat and her assigned representative in this area, an evil lawyer named Girtablullu. The buildings are an odd mix of Mesopotamian-style mud-brick and feudal Japanese styles.

Along the way to confront Girtablullu, the crawlers meet a strange Pazuzu NPC called Riot and may opt to help two crawlers in search of a treasure in a place called the Buried Tombs.

Potential Castle: The pinnacle of Girtablullu's Ziggurat

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- The crawlers arrive in Aculeus as the punk band "Piss Urchins" is performing an impromptu show. The crowds are growing fast. Both Pazuzu Punks and Pazuzu Bootlickers demand they leave the stage. The Piss Urchin songs decry the perils of power and corruption. As the band runs from some of the Pazuzu Bootlickers, they throw out armfuls of zines toward the crawlers. The handmade pages are creatively called "Taking Out The Trash" and all about taking down the regime of Girtablullu.

"Scorpion lawyer, we see your game. Ancient monster, corporate shame. Your venomous blood can't silence every voice. We're taking back our goddamn choice!"

—from the song "Girtablullu Sucks" by the Piss Urchins

- The crawlers arrive in the Hidden Market, surrounded by more vendors than they've ever seen in one place in the dungeon, even Club Vanquisher or the Desperado Club. There are many treasures to be bought, as well as requests for items hidden in the Buried Tombs of the area. Zenzo the Razor Fox sees them and mentions there's a lot of treasure to be found in the tombs.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- Caught in a conflict between Pazuzu Punks and Pazuzu Bootlickers, the crawlers meet Riot, an NPC Pazuzu. She is impressed by them and introduces them to her community, hoping to convince the crawlers to help topple the current regime. The whole thing would fall apart if they could get into the Ziggurat and kill Girtablullu, but a direct assault is madness.
- Zenzo the Razor Fox meets with the crawlers in secret to tell them the Buried Tombs often have old maps. Perhaps one will lead to a secret passageway. The crawlers find themselves in a dingy bar where The Chuggernauts play. They meet a pair of crawlers Sven Gal and Adama Mb, who have known each other since the previous floor. They have a Quest to find the Super Fucking Sharp Blade in one of the Buried Tombs and bring it to Master Inkei, a Razor Fox smith, so he can study it. It's a timed Quest, and there's not much time left, so they ask the crawlers for help. After they give the blade to Master Inkei, Zenzo tracks them down and gives them an additional reward: he tells them the next Hidden Market happens in six hours and gives them the location.

MOBS

The Mobs in the city and Ziggurat are intelligent humanoids. The Mobs in the wastes are dumb animals. The Mobs in the tombs can be darn near anything.

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MALE THORNY DEVIL

Thorny Devils are brown-and-orange speckled lizards the size of grizzly bears with ten-inch spikes covering their bodies. Their scales are thick and easily resist physical attacks.

AI **Male Thorny Devil. Level 34.**

These poky fuckers are pretty common in desert-themed worlds. They're big and fast and dumb and angry. Their bodies are covered in defensive spikes, which begs the question: How did something so big develop such a defense mechanism in the first place?

These guys tend to have a reverse-harem thing going on. Odds are good you'll recognize the queen when you see her. Odds are even better she'll be the last thing you ever see.

Male Thorny Devil

Mob; Large (5), Reptile

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
34	13+F	15+F	30+S	6
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	6 (+3)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	6 (+3)

Chomp: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Walking Pincushion: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Spikes All Over*—On a melee attack Near Miss Fail against this Mob, the crawler takes 2d6+F Piercing damage. Add 1 die for each degree of Failure worse than that.

THORNY DEVIL QUEEN

In contrast to the muscular males of the species, the Thorny Devil Queen is huge and fat. Why? Because she lives a life of desert luxury, and her loyal Male Thorny Devils bring her the good stuff first. That's not a weakness, however. Thorny Devil Queens are more dangerous than the males.

AI **Thorny Devil Queen. Level 50.**

This is a matriarch of the Thorny Devils—the Queen herself. You can tell she's the Queen because of the crown on her head. She's the reason all the Male Thorny Devils developed so many defensive mechanisms. Because if she ain't happy, she'll crush you flat.

What was the other thing I said about her? Oh, yeah... she'll probably be the last thing you see.

Thorny Devil Queen

Mob; Huge (6), Reptile

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	20+S	8
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
50 (+6)	30 (+5)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)	30 (+5)

Chomp: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Fiendish Flop: 15+F to hit, 4d6+6 Piercing, 10ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff, and the Skewered Debuff: Each failed escape from being Held subjects the crawler to Spikes All Over (see below).

Notes: *Spikes All Over*—On any melee attack (or attempt to escape being Skewered) Near Miss Fail against this Mob, the crawler takes 2d8+F Piercing damage. Add 1 die for each degree of failure worse than that.

RAZOR FOX

Razor Foxes are humanoid foxes with ninja skills. They dress in ninja attire: the men in black and the women in red. A Razor Fox never walks or runs anywhere. They flip, somersault, leap, roll, and kick off walls to get to their destination. Whenever they stop moving, they completely freeze in some kind of cool ninja pose.

AI **Razor Fox. Level 40.**

If you're reading this description, you're probably already bleeding from a dozen ninja stars in your flesh. These buggers are stupidly fast, deadly from a distance, and just insanely cool. I'm talking cool like "Steve McQueen learning martial arts from Bruce Lee on the moon" kind of cool.

Razor Foxes are foxes who are ninjas, obviously. Each one picks a weapon proficiency in childhood, kinda like a ninja turtle thing, and they train in both that and in a ranged weapon. Most pick throwing stars as their ranged weapon of choice because, again, they're fucking cool.

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Razor Fox

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	15+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
15 (+4)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	50 (+6)	20 (+5)

Ninjato: 15+F to hit, 5d8+4 Slashing, 5ft range

Throwing Star: 16+F to hit, 4d6+4 Piercing, 30ft range

Notes: *Outfoxy*—Razor Foxes can also wield other ninja equipment like smoke bombs, poison, or climbing claws.

PAZUZU

Pazuzu are half-Human, half-scorpion beings created by the goddess Tiamat to serve as foot soldiers and guardians. Their scorpion bodies are about the size of a pony, complete with eight legs, two pincers, and a venomous tail. Where the scorpion's head would normally be, it has the upper torso, arms, and head of a Human. It's basically a "scorpitaur," if you will.

Pazuzu in the City of Aculeus come in two varieties: the original Pazuzu Bootlickers who still do Tiamat's bidding, and the Pazuzu Punks, who threw off the shackles of authority and consumerism. Or so they think. The Bootlickers are decked out like fancy corporate security guards on their Human parts, with body armor, clear shields, helmets, and police batons, which they tend to drop as loot. A Pazuzu Punk's Human part looks much like you'd expect, with a leather jacket or denim battle vest, spiked and colored hair, and piercings and tattoos. They drop informative zines, Molotov cocktails, and occasionally beat-up musical instruments.

Pazuzu here are technically all NPCs and not automatically hostile. But some or all of them will become hostile.

AI **Pazuzu Punk. Level 40.**

What happens when you mash up all the legs, stingers, and pincers of a scorpion with the scrawny frame and spiked rooster comb of a punk rocker? You get a Pazuzu Punk. (It's basically a scorpitaur.)

Pazuzu Punks were rule-following foot soldiers of the goddess Tiamat until they discovered the revolutionary sounds of bands like Black Flag, the Dead Kennedys, and Crass. Now, they spend their time publishing anti-authoritarian zines, putting safety pins through their noses, and carrying guitars around without ever really learning how to play them.

Pazuzu Punk

NPC; Large (5), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	13+F	15+F	30+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
35 (+5)	8 (+3)	52 (+6)	22 (+5)	8 (+3)

Guitar Smash: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Molotov Cocktail: 14+F to hit, 3d6 Fire, 25ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Any hit crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Tail Strike: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Piercing, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

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Pazuzu Bootlicker. Level 42.

Not all Pazuzu Bootlickers are bad people; some of them have families. Some of them dream of writing a best-selling romance novel. And maybe a few of them even believe all people are worthy of love and acceptance! But you'll never know any of these things, because more than anything else, they value their standing in the corporate power structure, waiting for the day when those promised rewards start trickling down.

Pazuzu Bootlicker

NPC; Large (5), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
42	13+F	15+F	30+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
41 (+5)	8 (+3)	52 (+6)	22 (+5)	8 (+3)

Pincers: 15+F to hit, 4d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Tail Strike 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Piercing, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

PURIFIER VULTURE

Purifier Vultures are the Janitor Mobs of this area. They are pure white except for a golden stone in their foreheads. They'll feast on corpses like regular vultures. Once a body is picked clean, they use the fiery power of those stones to blast corpses and inedible or leftover body parts into ash and then sweep the place clean.

Purifier Vulture. Level 40.

Celestial vultures that sear carrion into ash with the heavenly power of their god stones... sounds awesome, doesn't it? It would be, except they're cursed to be the janitors in this area. They hate cleaning up after you. If you kill too many Mobs, it's possible that flocks of Purifier Vultures will descend from the heavens to end you instead. It hasn't happened yet, but wouldn't it be an honor to fall prey to the very first avian custodial death horde?

Purifier Vulture

Mob; Medium (4), Avian Janitor

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	16+F	15+F	30+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
10 (+4)	52 (+6)	32 (+5)	30 (+5)	1 (+1)

Feeling Peckish: 14+F to hit, 5d8+4 Piercing, 5ft range

Searing Blast: 16+F to hit, 4d6+6 Fire, 100ft range, 10ft Blast radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Can move through the air as if it were on the ground.

PISTOL PANGOLIN

It's a three-foot-long armored critter with a steam engine implanted in its torso and legs made of pistols. They roll toward targets in armored balls while shooting at the same time, and they can use those pistol legs to launch themselves into the air.

Pistol Pangolin. Level 38.

These roly-poly guys have all the stealth you'd expect from something made of a steam engine and a bunch of guns, which is to say none. You might be able to hear them coming, but they've still got the power of machines on their side, so good luck outrunning them.

Pistol Pangolin

Mob; Petite (3), Steamborg

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
38	15+F	15+F	40+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	36 (+5)	31 (+5)	12 (+4)

Pistoleg: 15+F to hit, 5d8 Piercing, 50ft range

Roly-Poly: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 25ft Line
Any crawler who fails to Evade slides 5 feet in a direction of the GM's choice.

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ENVIRONMENT

The City of Aculeus is built upon, and surrounded by, a dry desert land. No clouds drift through the sky, just the bright, blazing sun. The only "relief" from the burning rays is frequent sandstorms that roll in without warning. Hope you brought sunscreen.

TRAPS

Traps are not common in the city and definitely not in the desert, but *boy howdy*, can you find them in the tombs and the Ziggurat.

- **Immobilization Field:** This trap grabs a creature with magical force and holds it immobile, levitating it a couple of feet from the floor. The trapped creature remains suspended there until Pazuzu Bootlickers collect it or it starves to death.
- **Zombification Trap:** It appears to transform the trigger into an aggressive zombie, but really, it's just a variation on a run-of-the-mill teleportation trap. The trap's unlucky victim is simply exchanged in space with an existing zombie and usually finds themselves sealed in a sarcophagus somewhere to slowly suffocate alone in the dark.
- **Gold Dust Spray:** This trap shoots a cloud of golden dust into the room, and everyone affected by it becomes highly allergic to gold for the next hour. Not great to be sneezing nonstop when exploring a treasure-filled tomb.
- **Urgyle Anemia:** Touching certain pale gray objects in tombs inflicts this Debuff. While not immediately fatal, Urgyle Anemia detracts one Health Bar slot every day from anyone inflicted with it. The process leaves the victim a pale gray husk as the red is literally removed from their body. A painful and ugly way to die. Can be cured by most Clerics or by a Meat Ruby, a rare gem that looks and feels like a cube of meat but is, in fact, a gemstone. A worshiper of a god, if you can find one in this godforsaken place, can remove the curse easily at a shrine to their god. Damage from the curse cannot be healed until the curse is lifted.

ITEMS

The crawlers might make use of random items they find in the quadrant.

- **Pickled Feet:** A five-foot-tall bronze urn is filled with viscous vinegar used to pickle the feet of at least a dozen humanoid creatures. Go ahead, try one!
- **Vegetable Cart:** A cart stacked full of perfect veggies, carrots, onions, root vegetables no one has ever seen, plus cabbages and assorted greens, sits unattended in the middle of the street.
- **Drum Kit:** A well-used drum kit has been haphazardly thrown into the corner of an abandoned mud house. It's emblazoned with a logo reading "Piss Urchins," and the drumhead is made of leather that definitely had a tattoo and feels a bit too much like skin.
- **Chunk of White Marble:** A huge slab of stone weighing hundreds of pounds blocks a hallway in the Ziggurat or a Buried Tomb.
- **Super Fucking Sharp Blade:** Exactly what it says. This blade is incredibly sharp and will cut through flesh like an electric knife through lard. It gives an additional +2 to Edged Weapon Damage for five attacks before the blade dulls. You do have a way to care for a badass sword, right?
- **The Reddest Meat Ruby Pendant:** A large ruby that looks more like a cube of meat than any kind of gemstone sits at the center of this necklace. It's oddly warm to the touch. Cures Urgyle Anemia of anyone who wears it by boosting the redness in their blood since Urgyle Anemia is all about the blood turning gray and lifeless.

ZINES

The Pazuzu Punks are *really* into sharing their DIY publications with each other and anyone else. Here are some of the zines that might be offered to crawlers in Aculeus:

- Pissing Me Off: The Uncensored Oral History of Pazuzu Punk Music
- Girtablullu the Sellout Fascist Puppet
- Razor Foxes: Potential Allies or Corporate Wankers?
- A DIY Guide to Preparing for Divine Rebellion
- Grandma Scuttlebut's Scorpion Recipes and Delicious Home Cooking

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood:

- **Wow, How Original!:** "You quoted an Indiana Jones movie or The Mummy while in a desert tomb. You're so clever and interesting!
  Reward: You've received a Bronze Adventurer Box."

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Contents: A plastic replica Oscar trophy and the "popcorn machine" Personal Space Upgrade.

- **Micro-Press Mogul:** "You wrote and published a zine! Everyone who reads it is surely going to convert to your point of view.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Publisher's Box."
  Contents: A half dozen Spell scrolls in zine format.
- **Counter-Revolutionary:** "You killed a bunch of rebellious Pazuzu Punks, and the authoritarian establishment is very thankful.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Weapon Box."
  Contents: A weapon or weapon accessory with a Buff against anarchists.
- **Better Call Baal:** "You represented yourself in court against Tiamat's lawyer, and you won! Surely, that won't spark any adverse consequences down the road.
  Reward: You've received a Platinum Compensatory Damages Box."
  Contents: A hefty amount of gold and legal paperwork that awards the crawler all rights related to and all income generated by the song "Errybody Scurrfunge."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

The wastes are the best place for grinding in this quadrant. Thorny Devils and Pistol Pangolins are numerous there. Trying to grind Pazuzu Punks or Razor Foxes in the city results in all-out guerrilla warfare in the streets until Girtablullu sends his army to quell the violence through more violence. Daring crawlers could grind Pazuzu Bootlickers in the Ziggurat. In any case, grinding can get old, so Table 98 provides some complications to amp up potential encounters.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: DESERT WASTES

The outer edge of the land quadrant is a bleak landscape of tall dunes, blazing sun, and blowing sandstorms. Anyone venturing into it best bring an inventory full of water bottles and a parasol for shade. Scattered throughout the desert, rocky lumps poke up from the sand, housing nests of Thorny Devils. Bands of aggressive Pistol Pangolins roll around, ambushing anything they encounter. It's a miserable place, but there are buried tombs and untold treasures to be found. The party hears the rhythmic "chuff-chuff-chuff-bang-bang" of steam engines approaching, and a Moderate posse of Pistol Pangolins launches over the party, having used a steep sand dune as a ramp. They rain bullets down on the crawlers as they soar. They land on top of a rise on the other side of the crawlers, where the Pangolins unroll and keep firing from high ground.

What is that in the distance? Is that... a tree? The crawlers find a small, peaceful oasis. A single small tree grows next to a spring of clear water. Saferoom rules are in effect here, though crawlers cannot access their personal spaces. The oasis is monitored by an NPC Grulke named Carys.

TABLE 98: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A sandstorm erupts suddenly, choking the crawlers, reducing visibility to nothing. It scours off the outer layers of their skin. Unless they have some kind of protection and can see through the storm, they lose hours just waiting it out.
2	As the crawlers grind through Mob after Mob, Purifier Vultures start gathering on the city's power lines. At first, it's just a couple perched nearby, watching the slaughter. More of them show up gradually, and they seem increasingly agitated by the number of corpses they'll need to clean up.
3	A team of Razor Foxes ambushes the party while they fight other Mobs. Why are they here? Who sent them? And how can you convince these cool canids not to kick your asses?
4	The ground gives way, and the crawlers plummet into a previously undiscovered tomb full of traps and valuables.
5	Just as a party member is about to land the killing blow on a Mob, a voice shouts out, "No, wait! I have a Quest!" Another crawler arrives to befriend that specific Mob for a Quest they have.
6	While grinding in the wastes, the crawlers stumble into a Thorny Devil nest containing two Queens who are conjoined twins. If the crawlers can help the Queens come to consensus, they'll share their loot.

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Crawlers who plunder several buried tombs in the wastes gain the attention of a mysterious figure who follows them from a distance, just watching. The only description the crawlers receive when they examine the being is *Mysterious Figure*. The figure disappears if approached, but clever crawlers can devise a way to confront it. When the cloak that disguises his description is removed, he is revealed as an aged Razor Fox named Jubei. He searches for an artifact, rumored to be in a tomb, that will cure his wife's terrible Urgyle Anemia.

QUARTER: BURIED TOMBS

The hidden tombs of a long-forgotten civilization lie buried just under the surface, both in the city and out in the wastes. Most of the city's tombs were already found and looted, but the sands of the desert hide undiscovered wonders. Underground tunnels connect some of the tombs, especially in Aculeus. The crypts aren't deep enough to be considered part of the subterranean quadrant of the bubble, but a few might hold secret tunnels linking the quadrants.

Already plundered tombs have a large stack of papers posted on their entrances reading: I, Girtablullu, hereafter referred to as legal consul supreme, do hereby irrevocably and unconditionally claim this space and all items found therein as property of Tiamat in perpetuity.

There are many more pages continuing in Legalese, a language impossible to understand unless a crawler has that Skill.

Unplundered tombs are always guarded by undead. Pick your favorite spirit, zombie, or other undead creature from another Floor or Neighborhood to inhabit this tomb. Bonus points if it's a tougher version of something the crawlers had trouble with on an earlier Floor.

A tomb the crawlers discover is haunted like the others, but this spirit, a Forlorn Shade by the name Azubah, would rather talk than fight. He chatters endlessly as the crawlers look around and offers recommendations on which pieces of treasure are worth taking. He tries to convince them to take a certain bronze spoon. It doesn't look that valuable, but Azubah swears it is the best thing here. He doesn't mention it, but it's the object to which his soul is attached, and he goes wherever it goes, talking the whole time.

One wall of a tomb is decorated with colorful mosaic tiles. That's clearly a depiction of a ziggurat in the center of the top of the artwork, but what are all the connected lines and squares beneath it? Some study and appropriate Lore-type Skill Checks reveal that it's a map of the tombs below the city, including a secret passage into the Ziggurat and a valuable piece of information for the Pazuzu Punks.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- You come to a narrow street in the city packed with Pazuzu Punks and Bootlickers, Razor Foxes, and NPCs of other Races, all going about their business, but tension is high. One wrong move could set off something violent.
  Outcome: The crawlers can push their way through, take a different street, or convince people to move out of the way, but doing it badly might push things to a boil.
- A sudden gust of wind blows particles of sand into your eyes, making them itch and water.
  Outcome: Without eye protection, crawlers have Disadvantage on any rolls requiring sight for the next ten minutes.
- The sun is so, so bright. You can feel your skin reddening as the day goes on. It's already starting to sting, and it's only midmorning.
  Outcome: The crawlers each lose one HB slot that won't heal until they spend 48 hours out of the sun or until they buy or concoct and use an alchemical aloe salve.
- You're thankful for the pleasant breeze that slightly mitigates the brutal heat. It makes you wonder what you did to deserve this brief respite.
  Outcome: The AI takes a little pity on the crawlers. If any crawlers are out of AI Favor, give them one.

QUARTER: CITY OF ACULEUS

Aculeus is a thriving city with narrow streets, bustling crowds, and mismatched architecture. The bulk of the buildings are mud-brick constructions, but feudal Japanese-style buildings of the Razor Foxes are also scattered throughout. Shops and guildhalls are plentiful, and of course, the city hosts entrances to both the Desperado Club and Club Vanquisher. There are quite a number of rules on the walls from someone named Girtablullu regarding what is and is not allowed in the city, including laws against distributing harmful or salacious materials or anything that disturbs the peace and threatens the reputation and good standing of Tiamat.

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The crawlers wander into the territory of a gang of criminal Razor Foxes who shake them down in an alley for protection money. If the crawlers refuse to pay, they attempt to make the crawlers into shuriken cushions.

A Moderate group of Pazuzu Punks argues loudly. Some have guitars slung over their backs, and one holds a bass. One of them looks ashamed as the others yell at her for somehow losing her drums. They're the Piss Urchins, a favorite band of local punks, and they can't play their show tonight at the Groovy Noodle if stupid Darby can't find her stupid drum set. Mick, Syd, and Salem storm off after berating Darby, leaving her teary-eyed and begging the crawlers for help.

A Hidden Market exists in Aculeus, a collection of vendors who pop up in secret locations only at carefully guarded times. It's a wealth of gear and information for crawlers with coin to spend, but the only way to know where and when the market happens is being told by the shadowy cabal of Razor Foxes leading the community. If the crawlers make friends with any Razor Foxes, or do enough good on their behalf, they might be invited to meet with one of the council and offered information about the next Hidden Market as a reward.

QUARTER: ZIGGURAT

A magnificent and opulent step pyramid serves as the city's administrative center. From here, Girtablullu and his army of subordinate lawyers monitor and control the legal interests of the goddess Tiamat. The passageways of the building are wide and tall, and every room is far larger than needed. Expensive-looking decorations adorn every surface.

Short of having an appointment or finding a secret entrance, the only way in is past the Pazuzu Bootlickers at the front door. The guards won't hesitate to engage with deadly force if irritated. If the alarm sounds, waves of Pazuzu Bootlickers descend upon the crawlers as long as they are in the Ziggurat.

A harried Gnome legal aide with arms full of clay tablets rounds the corner, crashing into the crawlers. The tablets fall to the floor, many of them breaking. In frustration, the Gnome kicks the pieces and screams at the crawlers to help pick them up. The tablets are part of Girtablullu's professional case history, and a crawler examining them finds part of a story wherein Girtablullu was defeated by a devotee of Marduk who simply objected to taking damage.

At the top of the Ziggurat is Girtablullu's office, and that is where the Boss can be found.

NPCS

Aculeus is a bustling metropolis full of interesting NPCs of different Races. Other crawlers in the quadrant are here, too. Below are some characters the crawlers might encounter.

AZUBAH

A Forlorn Shade forever attached to a really boring bronze spoon that no one ever wants to steal from the treasure vault. Originally a thief who wanted to rob the tomb he ended up trapped in, Azubah had the misfortune of touching a cursed Tupperware of soul stripping and had his soul ripped from his body and attached to the nearest culinary item, a spoon. His body has long since rotted away and despair and loneliness have turned him into a Forlorn Shade, which just means he's an especially lonely and desperate for attention ghost with no real special abilities. He cannot move more than 5 feet away from the spoon his spirit is attached to, and if the spoon is ever destroyed, his spirit is also destroyed forever. You wouldn't do something that heartless, would you?

AI Azubah

This is a noncombatant NPC who is not even worth giving a level.

Forlorn Shades are just what happens when regular ghosts get really lonely for a long time. Usually bound to a certain object and unable to even do basic haunting shit, they tend to whine and cling to the first person to show them any attention. Which if you're reading this, congratulations: that's you.

RIOT

An icon in the Pazuzu Punk rebellion. She's fierce and not afraid to lead by example. She's trying to start a revolution and take down the power. She's willing to offer help to anyone ready to take down Girtablullu.

Riot. Pazuzu Punk. Level 48.

Problem child and riot grrl, Riot's breaking free of the man, trying to make everyone see just how controlled the Pazuzu Bootlickers really are, and if that doesn't work, throwing Molotovs. Her orange mohawk, leather jacket (with pins and extra designs added by hand, of course), and sharp words are well-known by everyone in Aculeus.

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ZENZO

The public face of a secretive group of Razor Foxes seeking to take down Girtablullu, Zenzo is not willing to associate openly with the Punk Pazuzus. Nothing happens in the city without him knowing.

AI Zenzo. Razor Fox. Level 50.

Don't let the graying fur fool you; this Razor Fox is still just as sharp as a youngin. He's got eyes and ears everywhere (not literally though, we're saving that kind of thing for a muuuuuuch later Floor) and always knows what's going on in town. If you can gain his trust, you'll likely get access to helpful items and information, but honestly, who would trust you?

JUBEI

Braving the Desert Wastes and Buried Tombs, this Razor Fox is determined to find a cure for his wife's Urgyle Anemia and believes a lost ancient artifact in a tomb could be that cure. He's willing to rob, beg, and kill for anything that could save his beloved.

AI Jubei. Razor Fox. Level 47.

Wrapped in a mysterious cloak called The Mysterious Cloak, this guy sure is mysterious!

Except he's not. He's the ultimate wife guy, trying to find a cure for his sick wife. Awww, how touching. I sure hope nothing tragic happens to him or his wife.

Razor Fox

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
47	15+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	22 (+5)	23 (+5)	54 (+6)	26 (+5)

Katana: 15+F to hit, 5d8+4 Slashing, 5ft range

Throwing Star: 16+F to hit, 4d6+4 Piercing, 30ft range

Notes: *Outfoxy*—Razor Foxes can also wield other ninja equipment like smoke bombs, poison, or climbing claws.

SVEN GAL

An employee at a sleep study center, Sven entered the World Dungeon alone and has stumbled through with some luck and the mind-altering Spells he received on the First Floor. He's soft-spoken and almost timid until he gets worked up about something like Eurovision.

AI Crawler #5,555,556. "Sven Gal."

Level 40.

Race: Human.

Class: Phosphenmenologist.

Phosphenmenologist

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	15+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
18 (+4)	90 (+6)	18 (+4)	42 (+5)	16 (+4)

Pillow Fight: 14+F to hit, 5d6+6 Bludgeoning, 30ft range
On hit, target gains the Fatigued Debuff

ADAMA MB

A Zimbabwean woman who was studying medicine in Singapore when the collapse happened, Adama entered the dungeon with other doctors in training, but now she's the only one left. She teamed up with Sven after he helped her manage the nightmares she was having about her teammates' deaths.

AI Crawler #13,297,594. "Adama Mb"

Level 47.

Race: Human.

Class: Sangoma.

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Sangoma

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
47	17+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
8 (+3)	101 (+7)	21 (+5)	42 (+5)	16 (+4)

Shuriken: 15+F to hit, 5d4+3 Piercing, 40ft range

Heal Others: Target heals 2d6 HB, 30ft range

Notes: *Divining the Truth*—Once per long rest, the Sangoma can look into the future and choose to give themselves or a party member Advantage on their next Evade check.

MASTER INKEL

Inkel is a Razor Fox who came to the desert to study the weapons in the Buried Tombs. The only problem is, he hates going into the desert, so he often asks crawlers to find items for him. He's currently hunting for a legendary sword, the Super Fucking Sharp Blade that he's tracked to Aculeus. If a crawler helps him, he may be willing to help them get a better weapon.

AI **Master Inkel. Razor Fox. Level 51.**

A blacksmith who makes some of the deadliest blades, his Skill in weapon forging is almost as legendary as his dickwad attitude.

Don't piss him off. He has A LOT more knives than you.

Girtablullu's office in the Ziggurat is a huge chamber at the top of the step pyramid. The floor and walls are tiled with marble, and half a dozen marble pillars support the high-domed ceiling. The center of the room hosts Girtablullu's huge desk, also made of marble. Much of the rest of the room is nothing but shelves of legal documents.

When the fight with Girtablullu starts, an upbeat, inane, AI-generated corporate party-pop song booms like it's a Saturday night at the trendy local college bar where everyone gets trashed. An announcer for *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth* (Probably Kevin, Magnificent Troy, or Helene Jbarska (p. 302), filling in for one of them) cuts in:

"Hey, hey, hey, these crawlers think they've got what it takes to club with Girtablullu. They're probably gonna get clubbed to the fullest extent of the law! Oh, wait... we just received a cease-and-desist from Dimekku, Pazuzu, and Associates claiming that the rights to 'Errybody Scurrfunge' belong exclusively to the System AI."

The music stops immediately, and the AI voice speaks with someone else at his location.

AI "Is that real? Can it do that?" Pause. "Okay, fine, then let's get some other music here. We need it for the drama."

Another pause, and a clarinet-led klezmer tune begins.

AI "Seriously? Are you—whatever, let's just do this. FIGHT!"

CLUES

- Lawyers can't resist a good argument.
- If an objection is raised, put your smartest on the case.
- Law books protect you, right?

AI **Girtablullu. Monstrosity of Tiamat.**

Level 80 City Boss!

In the language of ancient Babylon, "girtablullu" literally means "scorpion-man." That Tiamat couldn't think of a better name for one of her eleven great poison-blooded monstrosities really says something about her. The lameness of that moniker is right up there with half the characters from Masters of the Universe.

Dressed in a designer suit that costs more than you'll ever make in your life, Girtablullu's glasses make him almost seem Human if you ignore the whole giant scorpion part. From the venom dripping from his stinger, he's probably going to make you wish your blood couldn't feel pain.

But those aren't even the worst things about Girtablullu...

He's also Tiamat's corporate lawyer.

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Girtablullu

City Boss; Large (5), Humanoid

7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
4%	8%	12%	16%	20%	24%	28%	32%	36%	40%	44%	48%	52%
7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	
56%	60%	64%	68%	72%	76%	80%	84%	88%	92%	96%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
80	17+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
100 (+7)	100 (+7)	100 (+7)	75 (+6)	50 (+6)

Litigate Spell: 17+F to hit, 7d8+7* Psychic, 100ft range
*Before damage is rolled, the target has the option to "settle" and take the average damage of the dice (39) instead of having it rolled.

Pincers: 17+F to hit, 6d8+7 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Tail Strike: 17+F to hit, 6d6+7 Piercing, 15ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Care for an Argument?*—A crawler can exploit Girtablullu's propensity to argue. The crawler must make Int-Opposed Deception Skill Check. On Success, Girtablullu loses 2 Actions in the following round. After this happens twice, the Boss asks for a continuance and the AI grants it, negating further use of this ability.

Objection!—Once he falls to 40% HB or less, Girtablullu can yell "Objection!" as an Interrupt Action. One, and only one, crawler must make an Int Stat Check vs. Difficulty 22 (unless someone has a Lawyer Up® Skill). On Fail, each crawler loses one Action that round. Girtablullu can do this only twice per combat. On Success, the objection is overruled by the AI, and they gain the Litigant Pro Se achievement.

Poison Blood—If Girtablullu loses 2+ HB slots from a melee attack, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Professional Courtesy—Crawlers holding a legal text in one hand roll Evade Checks with Advantage.

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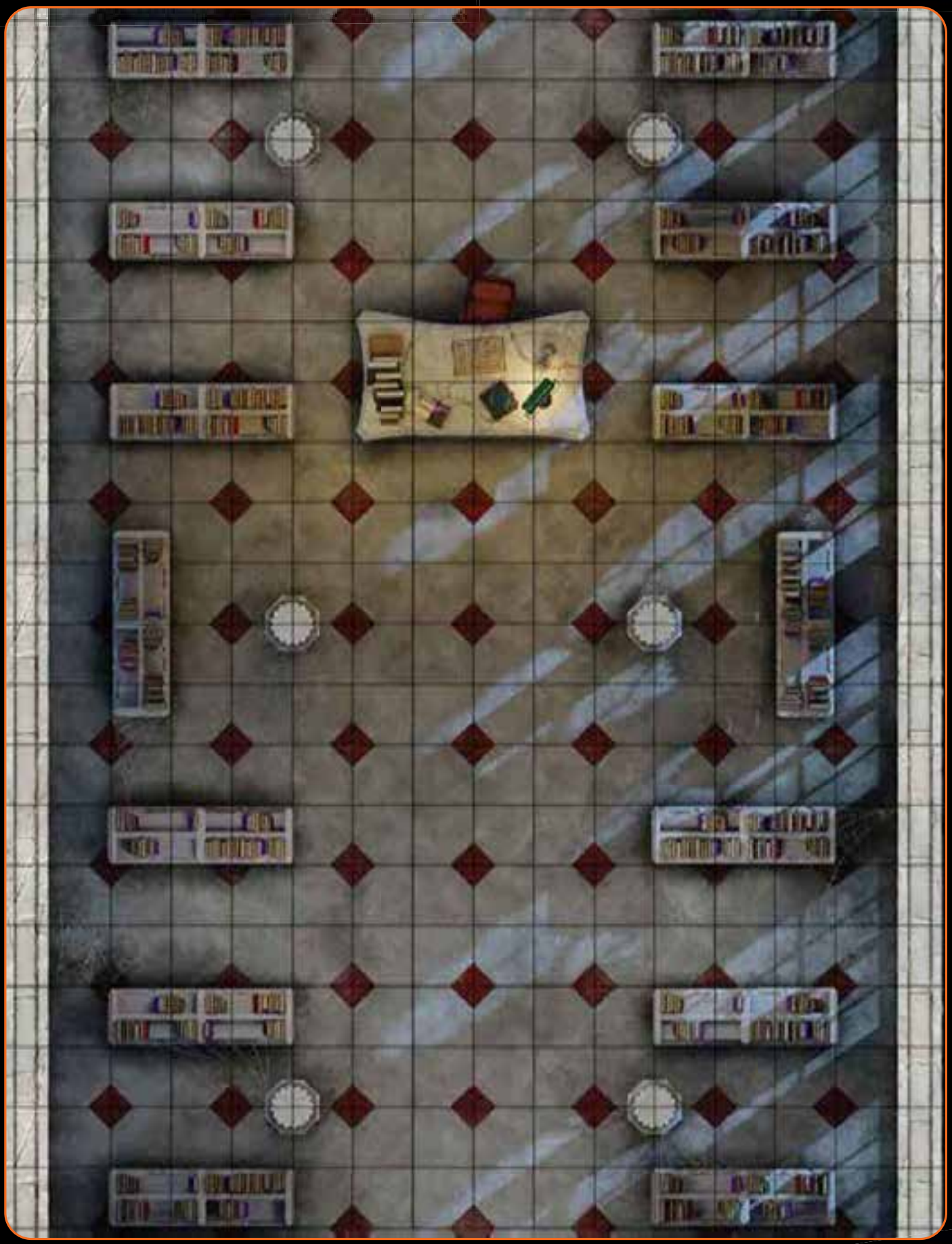

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NEIGHBORHOOD: HOWLING WINDS (AIR QUADRANT)

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: MONTANE FOREST BATTLING STEAMPUNK BULLSHIT

Once upon a time, a montane forest sat high on the side of a mountain, with short trees covered in thick canopies. Light snow flecked the tops of the trees while their roots dug deep and kept the trees lush and green. The lowest levels of the forest dipped just below the cloud line, lost in a perpetual sea of mist. The days were calm and quiet, but the night resounded with the wolf-song of the native Pterolykos.

Once upon a time, the Pterolykos were friendly creatures who invited visitors to join their hunts and their songs. Now the winged wolf-people are deathly silent, and visitors are merely prey. They defend their homes against an oncoming storm of machines that belch fire and steam, watching the skies for Propper, a Spring-Powered Chicken Hawk Sentinel with a taste for winged-wolf flesh.

Once upon a time, you might have received a warm welcome here. Now the only warmth you find is the fury in the belly of the Neighborhood's defenders and the steel hearts of the machines that have come to take their forests.

City Elves, under the company "Castle Contractors," attempt to destroy the natural habitat and build a new town just for Apito's angels. Of course, this means they must kidnap or kill the Pterolykos while destroying their homes for the Spring-Operated Chicken Hawk Sentinel who wants the sky all to itself. After all, only Apito's perfect angels, the Skyfowl and other birds, should be allowed to fly, not these dogs with wings.

Potential Castle: The Elven Camp

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- The wind howls in your ears as you find yourselves standing at the edge of the world. Looking down reveals an incredible fall. Behind you grows a forest full of low, wide trees. At first, it appears inviting... until you realize there is no wind, yet the howling persists, and half a dozen glowing amber eyes are moving through the darkness of the canopy toward you.
- You smell the heavy scent of ash and soot, mingled with a tinge of old moss, and the air tastes of rain. A forest gently slopes beneath the cloud cover ahead of you, and you can just make out the edge of a steep cliff far ahead. That's when you hear a loud explosion and see smoke billowing from a clearing ahead, accompanied by heavily accented words calling for the intruders to be found and burned.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you'll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- The City Elves are trying to destroy the Pterolykos for the crime of being false angels, aka not Skyfowl. However, they have to catch them first. Cutting down the forest is simply a means to eliminate hiding places. The Pterolykos want to drive them off the mountain. If the players show a willingness to assist, they'll be happy to return the favor.
- Elder Silkpaw is feeling the weight of his age. He desperately wants to do something good for his people before he passes. Anytime he talks to the crawlers, he'll mention how he feels his time has passed and his people need a younger, stronger leader. If crawlers can make him realize how strong and necessary he still is, he'll be all too happy to reward them after the City Elves are gone.
- The Helping Hand, a party of crawlers (p. 556), are currently helping the City Elves because they've been made to believe the Pterolykos are hiding the Neighborhood's Castle and thus the Stairwell. However, both of them harbor doubts. In reality, the Castle is the trailer in the elven camp, and that's where the Stairwell will open. If Jerry Madd realizes he's been tricked, he'll want to sacrifice himself to make up for this. If the crawlers allow it, he'll gift them his Enchanted Eye Patch (GM's discretion). If they don't, he could become a powerful ally of the group.

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MOBS

The Mobs of this Neighborhood fall into two general camps: City Elves who have come for the lumber of this mountain, and the Pterolykos that defend it. These are technically NPCs, but will readily turn hostile if the PCs anger them.

CITY ELF TRAPPER

The City Elves are an offshoot of the High Elves. Their origins lay in a far-away place, where they left their elven kin to serve as the bodyguards and security forces of other Races. Now their former kin don't even want to look at them.

It's easy to see why: Most of the City Elves are batshit insane. It turns out, taking the City Elf away from the city doesn't fix any of that. The Trappers are a specially trained detachment of the City Elves who want to get rid of as many Pterolykos as possible. The skies must be kept clear for Apito's angels alone.

AI City Elf Trapper. Level 35.

A City Elf is like that one cousin you don't really want to claim. You know the one, they show up to all the family reunions in nothing more than a stained t-shirt, insisting that washing machines are how they sneak nanochips into your brains. A City Elf Trapper is what would happen if you gave that cousin the training, equipment, and permission to start murdering people.

City Elf Trapper

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	30 (+5)	30 (+5)	10 (+4)

Hunting Knife: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Duck Call: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Sonic, 15ft Cone
Any hit crawler attracts the attention of an annoying duck, who pecks at the crawler's ears and ankles (the crawler gains the Sore as Shit Debuff). Any attack against the duck that is not a Critical Fail kills or scares it off.

CITY ELF MECHANIC

The City Elf Mechanics are the ones in charge of this particular mission. They're more intelligent than their kin and even more insane. They're absolutely obsessed with patterns and the way things work. On the upside, they're excellent at building things, repairing things, and tactics. On the downside, they sometimes see patterns where none exist.

When this happens, it's all they can think about until they've "gotten to the bottom of it." More than one group of City Elves has found themselves the targets of an obsessed Mechanic's paranoid purge.

AI City Elf Mechanic. Level 39.

City Elf Mechanics are gifted at spotting patterns. Wait, that's too tame of a description. How about this: They're utterly obsessed with patterns. This obsession means they can spot subtle changes at a glance. It makes repairing things incredibly easy for them, and they can often create or adapt strategies on the fly. If they study a person or group long enough, they can predict what they'll do next with scary accuracy.

The downside is these paranoid fuckers will sometimes see a conspiracy if a leaf falls wrong. If they get a wild hair up their ass and suddenly believe their underlings are working against them, they may well decide to engineer their own destruction just to be safe.

City Elf Mechanic

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
39	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
30 (+5)	30 (+5)	30 (+5)	30 (+5)	2 (+1)

Wrench: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Explosive Exit: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Fire, 10ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Burned Debuff. A City Elf Mechanic uses this if at 20% HB or less, and only if the crawlers outnumber them. Then the Elf dies.

Notes: *See Patterns*—City Elf Mechanics can see invisible entities. If crawlers are benefiting from the Tactics Skill, those effects last for only one round.

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ELVEN CLEAR-CUTTER

This large mechanical contraption resembles a cross between a glass spider and a whirlwind of blades. The pilot sits in a great bubble made of specialized glass harder than steel. The same material extends in eight mechanical arms that each reach about ten feet with multiple points of articulation along them. Each of these arms ends in clear buzzsaws moving so fast that they're difficult to see with the naked eye. The controls are impressive in how poorly and unintuitively they work. Without months of training, no one could hope to learn how to pilot one of these with any degree of accuracy, but who needs accuracy when you have eight arms that end in a big fuck you?

AI **Elven Clear-Cutter. Level 45.**

The brainchild of some deranged City Elf Mechanic's late-night meth binge, these contraptions are either brilliant or utterly insane. Or both. Actually, they're definitely both.

Don't make the mistake of thinking it's glass; that stuff is Elfium. (I know. The name's stupid. I didn't name it.) Elfium is clear as glass but harder than steel and even more of an ecological disaster than plastic!

Elven Clear-Cutter

NPC; Huge (6), Construct

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
45	12+F	15+F	20+S	7
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
55 (+6)	5 (+2)	55 (+6)	20 (+5)	5 (+2)

Buzzsaw: 14+F to hit, 4d8+6 Slashing, 5ft Burst radius

Arm Blades: 16+F to hit, 5d6+6 Slashing, 15ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Many-Armed*—Elven Clear-Cutter may spend its Move Action to attack.

PTEROLYKOS HUNTER

Pterolykos are native to several worlds throughout the galaxy. They're intelligent, efficient hunters and rank among the friendliest species in the galaxy most of the time. They're silent in the air, but their wings often create a problem if they're trying to sneak through underbrush. Instead, they far prefer to wait and attack from above. The ones in this Neighborhood are also surprisingly technologically adept, having harnessed the full concentrated power of the sun.

They consider their family to be the greatest treasures and strongest weapons a person can possess, other than the guns they carry. Most packs that live together are a single extended family. They treat attacks against a member of their pack as an attack against themselves. They're also incredibly territorial. Unfortunately, the City Elves don't give a flying fuck. More unfortunately, the Pterolykos will initially assume any crawlers are working with the City Elves.

AI **Pterolykos Hunter. Level 37.**

A Pterolykos is what would happen if a wolf and an eagle had a baby and then forced a Human to marry it at talon-point so the wolf could raise the resulting offspring. They're incredible pack-hunters and ambushers, and they have a surprisingly good singing voice. They're typically very friendly.

Too bad this isn't a typical place, is it? They're deadly hunters, relentless in their pursuits, and creative in avenging any wrongs against them or their loved ones. They'll spot you way before you ever see them.

Pterolykos Hunter

NPC; Medium (4), Winged Guardian

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
37	18+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	15 (+4)	31 (+5)	30 (+5)

Claw: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Mom's Rifle: 15+F to hit, 4d8 Piercing, 200ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Aerial Ambush*—Each Pterolykos Hunter that is not surprised attacks with Advantage during the first round of combat.

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ENVIRONMENT

Most of this Neighborhood resides under the canopy of the local trees, which are similar to the Polylepsis of Earth, but much taller, and stronger, although they're every bit as gnarled. In many places, the City Elves have cut or burned these trees away, but they've found them surprisingly resistant to both. Below are some areas prevalent in the Neighborhood with which crawlers may interact.

- **Tree Canopy:** Any place that has not been cleared away by the City Elves will still have these trees with their branches criss-crossing overhead. The trees themselves are gnarled and twisted and stand roughly seventy feet tall, though the canopy of their thin vine-like branches begins twenty feet below that. The twisting branches are surprisingly strong, and in many places, six feet of height or more separates them. These are perfect for the local Pterolykos to use as personal highways and ambush points.
- **Contained Circles:** These cleared patches of the forest with nothing but tree stumps remaining can reach hundreds of feet in diameter. The tough old trees are surprisingly resistant to both blades and fire but clearly not immune.
- **The Cliff:** The Montane Forest ends abruptly, and often nothing stands between a crawler and what appears to be a nearly infinite drop to whatever hides below the bottom of the cloud line.
- **The Clouds:** As tall as the mountain is, clouds cover half the Neighborhood. They function more like heavy fog in most of the area, and while it's typically more ambiance than obstacle, in some areas it's so heavy you can't see your own hand in front of your face.
- **Sun Collectors:** In certain parts of the Upper Montane and Wolfwind Village, large metal rods stick up through the canopy. Dark metal plates on top collect the sun to bring its power back to the Pterolykos village.

TRAPS

The Pterolykos have a preference for ambushes or more classic nonlethal traps like nets and pits. Conversely, the City Elves prefer traps that resemble Rube Goldberg devices in their inane complexity.

- **Pterolykos Pits:** The winged wolves have an incredible fondness for digging pits to trap their enemies. These are incredibly effective against City Elves and other Races not gifted with wings, but they're barely inconveniences for one of their own. This approach has the added bonus of leaving their victims alive for interrogation.
- **Tripwire Clear-Cutter Dropper:** An elven trap that begins by breaking a single tripwire. The snapped wire whips through the trees, then a Weak group of Clear-Cutters drops in front of the wire, charging toward the spot where the wire broke.
- **Plate Cracking Trap:** As a crawler's foot lands on a pressure-sensitive plate, an audible click precedes a ticking sound. If the crawler moves, the explosive beneath the plate detonates, flinging them backward into a net that will squeeze them tight against a tree (assuming they've survived).

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards:

- **Man's Best Friend:** "You befriended the Pterolykos. Congratulations! In most parts of the universe, this is as easy as breathing. But here? It's marginally more complicated.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Negotiator's Box."
- **DUI:** "Driving Under Idiocy. You tried to pilot a City Elf contraption. What are you, nuts? That's crazy! How are you still alive?
  Reward: You're not dead! That's reward enough, you lucky bastard."
- **City-Elf Friend:** "You befriended the City Elves. Really? Even I know that's screwed up.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Asshole's Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers who choose to brave the Montane Forest to enter the hunter-prey cycle risk falling on the wrong side of the following situations as they blaze through the besieged forest. Table 99 shows some potential complications.

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TABLE 99: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	An elder Pterolykos (Elder Silkpaw, unless he is dead) is sitting upon the edge of the Cliff, staring out in a meditative trance. As you approach, he will ask, deceptively calmly, "Do you walk among the trees? Or do you desire them for your own?"
2	The crawlers have entered a section of the forest that smells of smoke and ash. Nearby, the Cliff's edge looms ominously. There's a whirring sound, and a tree falls as an Elven Clear-Cutter crawls up from the side of the Cliff and attacks. At the same time, two Clear-Cutters charge from the direction of the Lower Montane.
3	City Elves have captured a Pterolykos in a net that has been tightened against a tree. They cackle as it struggles and threatens them. They begin to ready a spell as the crawlers watch.
4	A crawler must make a roll to avoid falling into a pit trap. Whether they avoid it or not, a Moderate Pterolykos hunting party drops from above, proceeding to surround the party as one remains in the canopy, aiming a rifle at the party.
5	As the crawlers hike through the forest, there's a distinct feeling they're being followed. Suddenly, the cloud fog begins to part around them. This seems like a positive thing until a Moderate group of City Elf trappers drops from a drone helicopter, and all of them begin whooping as they attack the crawlers.
6	Crawlers Jerry Madd and Renato Martin 5 are chasing a Pterolykos through the woods, trying to help City Elf trappers catch it. They're being incredibly careful and gentle with the wolf-person, but it's clear they're working with the City Elves.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- The fog grows thick and heavy around you until you can't see your hand in front of your face.
  Outcome: If the crawlers forge ahead, they risk falling over the Cliff. If they're more cautious, they'll see it ahead of time.
- A mournful howl begins ahead of you, before others join it all around.
  Outcome: If the crawlers pause, kneel, or otherwise act respectfully, the Pterolykos move on; otherwise, they attack.
- The scent of soot assails you as a City Elf wearing a construction hat shouts at you to take up positions on a saw.
  Outcome: If they do as they're told, they're paid in gold coins. Otherwise, the City Elf storms away to fetch a Clear-Cutter.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: UPPER MONTANE

The Polylepsis trees this far up the slope are greener, and the canopies stand larger. It's here the Pterolykos have built their home, preferring the room to move through the canopy. In several places, the Pterolykos Sun Collectors break through the canopy to reach for the sky.

This region is high enough that it stands above the clouds most of the time. On one hand, it makes for a lovely vista, as the cloud layer looks like a veritable sea at certain times of day. On the other hand, it makes it difficult to tell where the forest ends and the Cliff begins.

If the crawlers have not made it to Wolfwind Village or spoken to Elder Silkpaw yet, howls will sound around the crawlers for some time. Branches will move. Leaves will fall. Twigs will crack. However, there will be no sign of any enemies until after the sun begins to fall. One more howl sounds ahead, and then a Moderate group of Pterolykos will leap down from the canopy as one more opens fire from above with a rifle.

Crawler Jerry Madd is sitting against a tree. His unpatched eyes are glazed over, and his fingers are clearly typing, slowly and awkwardly, on the virtual keyboard. When he notices the crawler party, he will smile and greet them warmly. He is looking for the other member of his party since they got separated by the fog. He will inform the party not to worry, as they are very close to finding the castle and killing the Boss.

He clearly doesn't believe these things, but he's trying to make the party believe it. He mentions how the City Elves told them the Pterolykos are hiding the castle and staircase. He will express some confusion

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about why, as the Pterolykos have shown all the signs of being the besieged party, but his companion seems to firmly believe the City Elves, and he doesn't want to argue with his teammate about it.

If the crawlers have spoken to both Renato and Jerry separately, not only will they have the opportunity to reunite the pair, but they will also be able to convince them the City Elves are lying to them. This will drive Jerry to righteous anger, and he will want to assault the elven camp immediately. Crawlers can let this happen (which will result in him giving them his Enchanted Eyepatch and ultimately end in his death), or they can talk him down, and the Helping Hand will join in the fight against Propper.

QUARTER: LOWER MONTANE

The trees here are slightly shorter, and the canopy starts higher, making it more difficult for the Pterolykos to move within them. The cloud fog here is much heavier more often, and the City Elves have cut down large swaths of the trees in this area. The smell of soot and ash is constant here, and the scent of blood is common.

This area is always tense. It feels like eyes are always watching, and the air is either deathly silent or filled with the sounds of destruction and combat, with almost no in-between.

The sound of gunfire draws the crawlers' attention. A Moderate group of Pterolykos battles a Weak group of Elven Clear-Cutter. The crawlers may join in the fray, but if they don't have an agreement with the Pterolykos, it's going to end up a three-way free-for-all (and may well make communication more difficult with the Pterolykos later).

Renato Martin 5 can be found in this area, sitting on a stump, face in his hands, as his eyes glaze over. He'll notice the crawler party as they arrive and look at them apologetically. He's trying to find his party mate, Jerry Madd, but the two have become hopelessly lost after getting separated by the fog. (Apparently Jerry's never quite gotten the hang of mental typing, and it takes him forever to respond).

He'll share that they're currently helping the City Elves trap the Pterolykos "for their own good," although it's clear he's uncomfortable with the situation. The City Elves have said the wolves are hiding the Castle with the Boss, but Renato is sure they're lying to him. However, Jerry believes them, and Renato trusts Jerry implicitly. If the party's already spoken to Jerry, they can reunite the two and possibly gain their help.

If the crawlers look down the Cliff, not far from where Renato is sitting, they'll see the remains of a Clear-Cutter on a ridge not far below, along with a deceased City Elf in a construction hat. If the crawlers climb down, they'll be able to loot the body for "maintenance instructions" for Propper, giving the party a +1 damage Buff with any attack against the Boss.

QUARTER: WOLFWIND VILLAGE

In the most remote parts of the Upper Montane, this village sits safely nestled beneath the canopy. The buildings of this village are surprisingly luxurious; they seem to have been taken from an upscale Neighborhood somewhere in the American Suburbs. Homes have power, plumbing, and even air-conditioning, with electricity provided by their sun collectors.

The first time the crawlers arrive, they'll meet with a Pterolykos guardian who will ask them point-blank if they serve the City Elves. If the crawlers say no, they will be taken to speak with Elder Silkpaw immediately. If they say yes, all the Pterolykos in town will become immediately hostile.

If they've already met Elder Silkpaw, he will greet them as friends. If they haven't, he will be polite, but guarded. He'll claim that the City Elves are kidnapping his people. Additionally, he'll inform them that he intends to offer himself up as a prisoner if they will stop taking the younger members of his people.

Crawlers may be able to dissuade them, especially if they've already gotten "The Helping Hand" to stop helping the City Elves. If crawlers do this, Elder Silkpaw will offer his people's help in the battle against Propper.

While the crawlers are at the Village, a howl of warning rises from the guards. A Moderate group of Clear-Cutters will attack the village from separate directions. The guards can hold off some and might even defeat one, but it will be up to the crawlers to fight the others in rapid succession.

If the crawlers can defeat the Clear-Cutters in under a minute, the Pterolykos will be grateful. They will offer crawlers a ten percent discount on any equipment or supplies they buy from the village, or from vendors located in the village. They will also offer the crawlers to join in their songs or their hunt. Joining in the song will raise crawlers' Performance Skill by 1. Joining in the hunt will raise the crawlers' Stealth by 1.

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QUARTER: ELVEN CAMP

Situated directly against the edge of the Cliff, the elven construction camp is located in a sprawling clear-cut area. Around the perimeter, six heavy ballistae turrets sit unmanned. Tents of all shapes and sizes make up this impromptu labor camp.

In the center sits a trailer from "Castle Contractors" in which the foreman lives. City Elves bustle throughout the camp at all hours of the day. Many of them are so busy and focused that they may not even notice the crawlers unless they're directly attacked.

If the crawlers attack anyone inside the camp, an alarm will sound. A Moderate group of City Elf Trappers will pile out of tents along with a Weak group of City Elf Mechanics. A Weak group of Clear-Cutters will activate and join unless the fight ends by turn four.

If the crawlers are not immediately hostile, they'll be free to wander the camp to their hearts' content and make use of its restrooms, saferooms, and vendors. If they arrive with the "Good Guys" (without having attacked any City Elves while aligned with the Pterolykos), they will be taken directly to the Foreman's tent outside the trailer.

The Foreman is very harried and will ask for the crawlers' help in their mission to capture and deal with the Pterolykos. If the crawlers do anything but agree heartily, the Foreman will snap that if they're not going to help, they had best leave, before he summons "the Boss".

If the crawlers have spoken to (or slain) the Helping Hand and Elder Silkpaw, then the next time they speak to the Foreman, he will growl and shout that he warned them. He will then slam a button on his desk, and alarms will blare. Immediately, the cloud layer begins to clear, accompanied by loud blasts of wind, and Propper rises up from beneath the Cliff to begin the Boss Battle.

NPCS

ELDER SILKPAW

Leader of the local Pterolykos. He's too old to hunt any longer, and he's begun to feel like a burden to his people. He wonders if he were younger, if he'd have already driven the City Elves over the edge. He feels the weight of his age is becoming a burden to the other Pterolykos.

By contrast, the others believe his tactical wisdom is a large part of why they've held their ground. On the occasions he has joined the hunt, he has personally slain many Elves, and the survivors tell stories of a golden-eyed demon in the clouds.

AI **Elder Silkpaw. Pterolykos. Level 50.**

Elder of the Pterolykos tribe.

This Pterolykos has fur that's gone white with age. He walks with the aid of a long rifle, used as a cane. However, his eyes are quick and alert. You get the sense he wants you to believe he's more feeble than he is. One look at his claws suggests that would be a very bad idea indeed.

Pterolykos Elder

NPC; Medium (4), Winged Guardian

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	18+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	25 (+5)	20 (+5)	52 (+6)	33 (+5)

Claws: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Rifle: 15+F to hit, 4d8 Piercing, 200ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Aerial Ambush*—Each Pterolykos that is not surprised attacks with Advantage during the first round of combat.

JERRY MADD

A 65-year-old former Navy officer, all Jerry ever wanted was to serve his country. He shipped out before he'd turned twenty and served until he was in his mid-fifties. After retirement, he felt listless, spending most of his days working out and dreaming of having a purpose once again.

During the collapse, he was standing outside a wedding of some relative, in full uniform, complete with a saber and cigarette. When the buildings flattened, he didn't hesitate—he just charged in, saber out and happy to have a mission: to die avenging his planet.

He linked up with Renato Martin to form "The Helping Hand," a party dedicated to doing what was right, no matter the cost. They've each enjoyed rankings just below the leaderboard, partially because of the enchanted saber, pirate hat, and eyepatch that have given Jerry his signature look.

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AI **Crawler #7,329,880. "Jerry Madd."**
Level 37.
Race: Human.
Class: Swashbuckler.

Human Swashbuckler

Crawler; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
37	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	15 (+4)	31 (+5)	30 (+5)

Saber: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Slashing, 5ft range
Blunderbuss: 15+F to hit, 4d8 Piercing, 25ft Cone
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

RENATO MARTIN 5

On Earth, Renato was simply a government agent, aka a glorified paper-pusher, combing through spreadsheets trying to track down white-collar crimes. When he'd first joined the bureau, he'd dreamt of car chases and gunfire. Ironically, he got what he wanted, but only after the apocalypse.

He formed the *Helping Hand* with Jerry Madd, intending to do everything possible to defend the remnants of humanity. He's been helped significantly by the enchanted gun he wields—one with an uncanny resemblance to an old Earth video game console's light gun.

AI **Crawler #7,329,912, "Renato Martin"**
Level 37.
Race: Human.
Class: Gunslinger⚙.

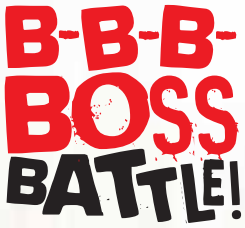
Human Gunslinger

Crawler; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
37	18+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	15 (+4)	31 (+5)	30 (+5)

Punch: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
NES Zapper: 15+F to hit, 4d8 Force, 40ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.



Propper's Lair is in the elven camp. The Boss rises from below the Cliff to swoop down upon the crawlers. The moment its mechanical red eyes fix on the crawlers, the area freezes. A cartoonish forest rises in the middle of the crawlers' HUDs, and a buzzsaw rolls by. As it passes, the words "B-B-Boss Battle!" are carved into the forest, then an old tintype of the Boss appears in one corner, followed by tintypes of the crawlers and any assistants rising on the other.

While the area is the same, the Boss's presence has several effects. Its first action is to dive-bomb the area where the crawlers stand, creating cracks in the ground and causing areas of the cliff to fall, making this a perilous combat arena for anyone stuck on the ground. The wind generated from his propellers always threatens to push the crawlers over the side of the cliff. Each crawler should be about 30ft from an edge to start.

After dive-bombing, the Boss stays aloft, denying any melee users the chance to attack. Every round, a City Elf Mechanic arrives to join the fight against the crawlers. Once the Boss's health depletes below fifty percent, it starts buzzing the ground, attempting to catch crawlers in its propellers to chop them up.

Crawlers can make use of the unmanned Ballistae at the edge of camp to attack the Boss. The Helping Hand point this out and take up a Ballistae each if they are with the crawlers. Meanwhile, if the Pterolykos have agreed to help, they carry melee crawlers up to attack the Boss. (They will also rescue any crawlers who are forced over the edge.)

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CLUES

- The Pterolykos can fly the crawlers into melee with Propper.
- Ballistae in the area are perfect for shooting Propper.
- Try to jam the rotors with something of a decent size.

AI **Propper. Spring-Operated Chicken Hawk Sentinel.**

Level 70 Neighborhood Boss!

Some Bosses watch you like hawks. Others are practically machines. Some of them like to hover around you and pick you apart for fun. Propper here likes to do all three!

As the nominal leader of this little excursion, Propper pulls triple duty as the enforcer for Castle Contractors as well as a convenient transport for materials, prisoners, and whatever else it wants to snag. This whole time, it's been so bored waiting for something really fun to kill.

It would probably thank you if it wasn't a raging asshole.

Propper

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Spring-Operated Chicken Hawk Sentinel

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
6%	13%	20%	26%	33%	40%	46%	53%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	
60%	66%	73%	80%	86%	93%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
70	15+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
50 (+6)	20 (+5)	65 (+6)	70 (+6)	30 (+5)

Dive Bomb: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Fire, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Propper only uses this explosive attack during the first round of the combat, or when at 50% HB or less, when he will use it at least once per round.

Downwash: 15+F to hit, 6d10+5 Force, 60ft range, 20ft Splash
Any hit crawler slides 5ft for each HB slot lost. *(Splash is half damage, and this is all Splash.)*

Propeller Blast: 15+F to hit, 7d8+5 Force, 60ft range
Any hit crawler is pushed 5ft for each HB slot lost.

Notes: *Flying High*—Propper remains 60ft off the ground, making melee weapons nearly useless.

Jammed—To jam a rotor, a sturdy object of at least Petite (3) size must be used. If any of its propellers are jammed, Propper immediately loses 2 HB slots and 20 feet of altitude.

Off the Cliff—If a crawler falls over the cliff edge, they fall for two rounds and can perform actions before SPLAT (Death!).

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NEIGHBORHOOD: MIDNIGHT CITY (SUBTERRANEAN QUADRANT)

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: GOTHIC UNDERCITY INFESTED WITH VAMPIRES

Far beneath the earth sprawls a city, its streets lit by thin blue fungus and the weak burn of lanterns hung from crumbling Night Elf stonework. The homes and shops of this benighted place are in an advanced state of decay from misuse and neglect, long abandoned by the living. Once a thriving metropolis built and maintained by an alliance of Night Elf and Igneous artisans, the city fell to Vampire occupation.

Decades earlier, a minor noble named Countess Kesla and her court were cursed with immortality and a hunger that would not be sated. Driven from their lands by the very subjects who once bowed to her, she retreated underground, traveling far from her home before discovering this city and taking it by force. Turning most of the city into undead servants, she kept only a few Night Elves alive for feeding and drove the Igneous out, seeing no use for their stone bodies and stout hearts.

Since arriving, Kesla became cruel and hedonistic, reveling in her power and position. The surviving free Night Elves became Vampire Hunters, swearing vengeance and the reclamation of their city.

Potential Castle: Kesla's Throne Room in the Cathedral's Dungeon

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- Other crawlers spread rumors about a cavern-city on this floor where a group of Night Elves perfected a weapon modification that burns undead flesh at a touch, drastically increasing damage dealt. Word is they'll share the information in exchange for assistance rooting out an infestation.
- A pack of Pet Ghasts charges down the sandstone tunnels toward the crawlers before stopping when seeing the crawlers. The undead hiss and spit, then turn and retreat the way they came. At the mouth of the passage, they scatter into the Igneous encampment below.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- The crawlers meet Basalthea as they approach the Igneous encampment. She was attacked by undead in the city. A Vampire broke his fangs on her stone skin before stealing her satchel. She requests the crawlers retrieve it and gives them the shattered teeth.

  In the Outer Streets, they find Rennie with the satchel. If the crawlers bargain with the fangs, he trades the satchel and directions to the Vampire court within the Cathedral. If Rennie dies before providing this information, the Night Elf Hunters in Dead Center hail the crawlers for killing a Vampire and tell them Countess Kesla is in the dungeons of the Cathedral.
- The crawlers discover Seluna trapped under building debris in the outer streets. If freed, she vouches for them with the other Vampire Hunters in Dead Center. They demand that the crawlers prove they aren't Vampires, and upon being satisfied, they share the secrets of their UV fungus weapon, which deals +F damage to Undead creatures and prevents them from healing in the following round of combat. They ask for help tracking and killing Ameron and share the location of the Midnight Market where strange and macabre items can be purchased. If asked, they help assault the throne room in the Cathedral.
- The crawlers meet Martinus in the Cathedral, who tells them he's unhappy with the rule of Countess Kesla and willing to betray her if the party brings him her pendant. In the dungeons, they discover NPCs and a fellow crawler, Gabriella, being held to feed the Vampires. They then fight a Ghommid if they attempt to free the prisoners. When Countess Kesla falls, her Soul Crystal pendant loses focus, and all the Pet Ghasts in the Neighborhood become Feral until a Vampire wears the pendant again. The crawlers must decide to support Martinus or accept the curse themselves.

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MOBS

Mobs in the city are divided into categories: living or undead. Careless members of the former quickly become the latter.

PET GHAST

Pet Ghasts are former citizens of Midnight City, reanimated by a necrotic contagion transmitted by bite and claw. When a Pet Ghast kills, the victim rises again unless the body is destroyed. Freshly fed specimens retain a measure of intelligence, interacting and reasoning almost as well as they did while alive.

Hunger, however, strips their mind away in stages, removing all semblances of personhood the longer they go without consuming flesh. When starvation reaches a breaking point, Pet Ghasts secrete a leathery cocoon and lie in wait until heat or motion draw them out. Every Ghast in the city is magically leashed to Countess Kesla's Soul Crystal pendant, keeping them under control yet dangerous while she lives; they go Feral once she dies.

AI **Pet Ghast. Level 35.**

Oh, hey, the city's nightlife is here! Night... unlife? Whatever. These things roam Midnight City in packs like a bachelorette party on meth: hungry, screechy, and only kept in control by... ah, but that would be spilling the beans, wouldn't it?

You might be asking, "a pet to what?" You don't want to know.

Pet Ghast

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	12+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
37 (+5)	5 (+2)	31 (+5)	36 (+5)	1 (+1)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Necrotic, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Putrid Vomit: 14+F to hit, 3d6 Acid, 15ft Cone
Any hit crawler gains the Acid Debuff: Takes 1d8+F Acid at the end of each round for 2 rounds.

Notes: *New Unlife*—When a foe dies to one of the above attacks, it becomes a Ghast and joins the commune.

GHOMMID

A catch-all grouping of undead entities, Ghommids are an irregular mishmash of ghosts and ghouls. In Midnight City, these entities force themselves into physical shape wherever blood and death are present.

Ghommids don't possess fixed anatomy, manifesting as a squirming mass of darkened fluid instead. Their body reshapes based on the current need, snapping jaws or grasping claws forming as easily as scything blades before collapsing and reforming elsewhere along an amorphous body. A Ghommid attacks by engulfing and drowning prey in viscera, then extracting the victim's blood, leaving them a withered husk.

AI **Ghommid. Level 53.**

What do you get when you take a bunch of monsters and a crawler or two, and put them in a blender for ten minutes on puree? Other than a great dip for nachos, you get one of these, and with its intestines hanging out. The Swiss Army Knife of undead, Ghommids are pretty much whatever I want them to be. Hope you like this one!

Ghommid

NPC; Large (5), Undead

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
53	14+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
51 (+6)	15 (+4)	52 (+6)	41 (+5)	5 (+2)

Claw: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Intestinal Tentacle: 15+F to hit, 4d6+6 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

IGNEOUS

Igneous are towering folk made from tough stone and molten rock, roughly shaped like a Human but larger in every dimension. Renowned for a steadfast nature and stout hearts, once an Igneous sets their mind to something, they rarely waver. They keep physical distance from fleshy companions, the lava churning within them likely to cause burns and blisters at close range.

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AI Igneous. Level 37.

Ugh. The expression "dull as a rock" totally applies here. The dungeon is supposed to be about excitement, drama, and stakes, but watching paint dry might be more fun than these stone heads. They're only useful if you want to prop open a metal door or hide a key on your front lawn. Or break a window, I suppose. Yeah! Entertain me! Try throwing one through a window.

Igneous

NPC; Medium (5), Earth Elemental

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
37	15+F	14+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
34 (+5)	21 (+5)	27 (+5)	19 (+4)	15 (+4)

Stones Throw: 14+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 30ft range

Rocky Rumble: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler is pushed 5 feet for every HB slot lost.

Notes: *Hot Stuff*—When a crawler adjacent to an Igneous makes two attacks in a round, they take 1d10+F Fire damage.

NIGHT ELF HUNTER

Night Elves are lean and sharp-featured, bearing dark hair, dusky complexions, and long pointed ears. Sinuous and smooth, they excel in combat and can't help showing off whenever possible.

Descendants of Midnight City's original citizens, only a scattering of Night Elves remain. The rest fell prey to Vampires during years of feeding and turning. Those who survived donned dark leathers, strapped compact crossbows to their backs, and began treating their blades with UV-reactive fungus, taking on the mantle "Vampire Hunter."

AI Night Elf Hunter. Level 42.

Poor little goth kids. They lose their city and everyone they've ever loved to a Vampire invasion, and suddenly it's all trenchcoats, sunglasses, and moody music. Just look at 'em: not a fringe out of place on their cheap box-dyed hair and running mascara from contemplating the pain of their existence... blah, blah, blah. I bet they write terrible poetry, too.

Night Elf Hunter

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
42	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
34 (+5)	20 (+5)	21 (+5)	35 (+5)	21 (+5)

Katana: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Crossbow: 14+F to hit, 3d8 Piercing, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *UV Fungus*—Night Elf Hunters increase their damage die type to d10s instead of d8s vs the Undead.

VAMPIRE

Former nobles from another land, Vampires in Midnight City were cursed long ago, twisted into undead predators. Though retaining the intelligence and personality they had in life, years of sustaining themselves with the blood of the living dulled their empathy and sharpened their cruelty.

Most members of Countess Kesla's Alabaster Court now see mortals as little more than livestock and entertainment. Victims completely drained by a Vampire rise as a Ghast bound to Kesla's Soul Crystal pendant, and anyone who drinks the blood of a Vampire becomes one themselves.

AI Vampire. Level 55.

Ah, the aristocracy. Bloodsucking leeches in life, not that much different in death. Sure, they dress better and have a larger vocabulary than their zombie cousins, but at the end of the night, they're still just a corpse in a schmancy coat.

Vampire

NPC; Medium (4), Undead

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
55	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
38 (+5)	22 (+5)	36 (+5)	35 (+5)	39 (+5)

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Vampiric Embrace: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range
For every 3 HB slots lost to this attack, Vampire heals 1 HB slot.

Hypnotism Spell: 15+F to hit, No damage, 20ft range
Can Evade (look away). Any hit crawler must make an INT Stat Check. On Fail, or they gain the Hypnotized Debuff (this counts as mind control): Cannot attack or Evade until the Spell is broken. Spend 1 Action each round making the same Stat Check to break the Spell.

Notes: *Ghastly Unlife*—If a crawler is killed by a Vampire, they rise as a Pet Ghast bound to Kesla's Soul Crystal pendant.

ENVIRONMENT

Midnight City occupies the subterranean quadrant of this bubble: a hollow carved into bedrock and sealed behind a guarded stone wall. The outside of the city is dry sandstone and grit warmed by campfires, while the interior is full of blackstone buildings crowding broken cobblestone lanes with balconies leaning over claustrophobic alleys.

Night Elf gothic arches and vaulted ceilings define much of the architecture, but a lack of care and maintenance has brought their careful artifice to ruin. The smell of rot is inescapable in the Neighborhood, emanating from leathery Ghast cocoons camouflaged and adhered to crumbling masonry throughout. Faint blue bioluminescence lights much of the outer district but gives way to deliberate clearing efforts and sputtering iron torches closer to the Cathedral in the center of the city.

The Cathedral itself is a corpse of shattered stained glass and defiled altars to various gods. Dark corridors wend ever downward to blood-slicked dungeons and the throne room of Countess Kesla.

TRAPS

It pays to watch your step in Midnight City. Food is scarce for the undead here, and they'll do everything possible to catch a meal while Vampire Hunters set traps to even the odds.

- **Ghast Cocoons:** Camouflaged sacs house dormant Pet Ghasts in a soup of viscera. When an NPC or crawler gets within 20 feet, the sac bursts, spraying the target in gore, which makes them easier to track.
- **Oubliette:** A circular section of tile pivots, dropping victims into a narrow vertical shaft fifteen feet deep. A grated opening near the top allows access from above. Blood along the lip suggests this is a Vampire feeding spot.
- **Razor Wire:** Near invisible wire coated with a faint sheen of UV-emitting fungus is strung across a narrow corridor at approximate neck height. The cobblestones before it are treated with tallow, destroying traction if moving over the surface at speed. Targets approaching the area lose footing and stumble forward into the wire.

ITEMS

Items and debris are scattered throughout the Neighborhood, abandoned and left to rot.

- **Collapsed Buildings:** The city is full of rubble. Piles of brick and masonry stack haphazardly in dusty hills. Misc. Junk galore.
- **Market Stall Frames:** Wooden frames and rotting carts sit along the streets, legs splintered and canopies torn.
- **Wine Casks:** Large iron-banded barrels stacked in alleys next to former taverns hold flammable alcohol. Each full barrel weighs about 500 pounds.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in Midnight City:

- **Good Samaritan:** "You returned Basalthea's satchel to her. Goodie-two shoes.
  Reward: The warm glow of a job well done. Negotiate a better finder's fee next time."
- **Blood From a Stone:** "You reunited a Vampire with his missing teeth. Have you considered a life of undead dentistry?
  Reward: You've received a Gold Weapon Box."
  Contents: Bright-red plastic Vampire teeth. They're conspicuous, but they're fun! They grant the crawler +2 Bite Skill, 1d8+F Piercing damage, melee range.
- **No Hickeys!:** "You've been bitten by a Vampire. That'll leave a mark for sure. You'll probably want to cut down on garlic in the future, too.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Apparel Box."
  Contents: A regular burgundy turtleneck sweater to hide the hickies.
- **Hunter Hunted:** "You joined the Vampire Hunters on a successful hunt. You'd better come up with a cool Hunter name, or I'll do it for you.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Apparel Box."

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Contents: Vampire Hunter Starter Set (trenchcoat and sunglasses). Your attacks against Undead creatures deal +F damage.

- **Pop the Blister:** You burst Countess Kesla while unarmed or with melee weapons. Just like a pimple, only with more blood and screaming!
  Reward: You've received a Platinum Boss Box.
  Contents: Countess Kesla's Umbrella. While holding, you take no AoE Splash damage.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers have swatted some Pet Ghasts and vaporized some Vampires, they might grind for experience. Use some complications from Table 100 to keep combat fresh and interesting.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: IGNEOUS ENCAMPMENT

A series of sandstone tunnels lead to a cavernous subterranean hollow. Faint blue light emanating from broad-capped fungus can't penetrate the darkness enough to illuminate the ceiling or far reaches. A rough stone wall bisects the space, tall enough that torchlight doesn't reach the top.

Sprawling at its base lies an entrenched Igneous settlement of huts and melted metal barricades arranged in defensive tiers facing the wall. Heavily armed Igneous patrol narrow walkways and paths along the wall in steady circuits. The entire encampment has an atmosphere of rigid vigilance.

As the crawlers approach the Igneous encampment through the tunnels, the stone floor splits, disgorging Basalthea, a badly injured Igneous forcing herself up from the rock. Her form is fractured, molten seams glowing dull red as pieces slough off like shale. She begs for help reaching the encampment before she falls apart completely.

If the crawlers assist, they must contend with her searing heat and gather any fragments that break away. In the encampment, other Igneous mend Basalthea, berating her for entering the city again. She explains she's an archaeologist who discovered the bedrock beneath the city repeats in unnatural patterns, suggesting it's manufactured. A Vampire and some Pet Ghasts attacked her. The Vampire shattered his fangs and fled with her research satchel. She asks the crawlers to recover it and gives them the Vampire's teeth.

Shouts ring through the encampment as a pack of Pet Ghasts spill from the direction of the city. They leap onto the closest Igneous, overwhelming them. The victim's stone body begins to crack under the relentless hammering of decaying fists. Once the Pet Ghasts catch sight of the crawlers, they flow toward them in a rotten wave.

The only portal through the city walls is an iron gate fused into melt-cut stone. Two bulky Igneous guards stand watch, armed with faintly glowing spears. They state no living biomass is permitted to enter the city, refusing entry outright unless the crawlers helped escort Basalthea or assisted in repelling the Ghast attack. If the crawlers completed either of these encounters, the guards entertain arguments for entering the walls but warn of the dangers within. Failed talks or open violence bring reinforcements rising from the stone beneath.

QUARTER: OUTER STREETS

The outer city consists of broken cobblestone streets and housing long abandoned and left to rot. Roofs caved in, exposing a faint blue light where bioluminescent fungus took hold. Leathery growths attached to walls and archways throughout the district twitch and shudder. Pet Ghasts reside inside these camouflaged cocoons until something living passes. Occasionally, a snuffling, scratching sound gives way to howls in the darkness and the sound of tearing flesh and grinding bone.

As the crawlers move through the outer district of the city, a wet seam splits along a nearby wall. Warped plaster ruptures, revealing a leathery sac fused directly into masonry. It tears open, and a Ghast tumbles out, dripping rancid gore. Across the street, swollen pods stuck to archways and columns convulse before bursting forth a deluge of festering flesh. Ghasts drop from buildings above and claw free from the surrounding destroyed facades, dragging stone fragments with them. A horde of starved and relentless undead converge on the crawlers.

A metallic crack and an elvish curse echo from a half-collapsed townhouse. Inside, Seluna, a Night Elf Hunter in a black leather trenchcoat, is partially trapped under a fallen wall. Her sword broke trying

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TABLE 100: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A Weak pack of Pet Ghasts coordinates, a hit-and-run attack. They then run into a plaza, hoping the crawlers will follow, where a Strong group of Pet Ghast cocoons is found—and all burst at once.
2	The crawlers come across a Vampire walking two leashed Pet Ghasts the size of golden retrievers. Startled by the party, the Vampire drops the leashes, and the Pet Ghasts run into the darkness. The Vampire asks for help retrieving them, attacking if refused.
3	In the basement of an unstable building, a Night Elf experiments with UV fungus on a Pet Ghast chained to a table. The Elf asks the crawlers to obtain a fresh undead specimen, as this one is nearly drained.
4	The party encounters what appears to be a pitched battle between a Night Elf and a Vampire on a rooftop, observed by a small group of other Hunters on the street below and Vampires on a neighboring roof. The Hunter stakes the Vampire, who falls off the roof. The Hunter jumps down after him. If the crawlers go looking, they find the two combatants passionately embracing in a nearby alleyway.
5	A cadre of Night Elves mistake the crawlers for Vampires and hunt them through the streets, refusing to believe they aren't undead no matter the proof. They're incompetent, interfering with combats the crawlers engage in and fouling attempts to be stealthy.
6	A pale child stands in the street with a lollipop of congealed blood. She asks if they've seen her mother. If they approach, she screams loud enough to make ears bleed, attracting a pack of Pet Ghasts before attacking the crawlers.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- A wide pool of bloody water blocks a street partially collapsed into the sewer.
  Outcome: Cross and become soaked (drawing Pet Ghasts until cleaned, or find a way over, or detour and risk the dangers lurking off the main roads.
- A cry for help echoes; a Night Elf is caught in an iron gate as a horde of Pet Ghasts charge toward him, spurred by a Vampire behind.
  Outcome: Close the gate, holding back the Pet Ghasts but leaving the Night Elf to die, or pull him free and be surrounded.
- A ruined temple stands ahead, altar cracked and offering plate cast aside. As you approach, a gentle melody plays in the back of your head.
  Outcome: Repair the temple and draw a god's attention, or walk away and gain the Faithless Buff: Gain Advantage on Evade Checks vs. Holy damage and vs. attacks from the god's followers for the rest of the floor.

to lever the heavy masonry from her leg. Around the room lay the ectoplasmic ribbon of dead Pet Ghasts.

If the crawlers enter, Seluna quickly levels a compact crossbow with a glowing blue bolt loaded and ready to fire, demanding to know if they're allies or leeches. She tracked a disgraced Vampire in this district and got separated from her fellow Hunters. If freed, she asks for help hunting her quarry and provides information about her people's struggles against the Vampires in the Neighborhood.

Crawlers who aid Seluna must help her track their target to an alley near the inner edge of the district. Shattered glass litters the mouth of a sheltered corridor where a pathetic-looking Vampire crouches, pawing at upper fangs broken to jagged stumps. Basalthea's satchel lies beside him; its stone samples are scattered across cracked cobblestone.

When the Vampire, Rennie, notices the crawlers, he threatens to summon Pet Ghasts to protect him. If shown his shattered fangs, he demands their return and trades them for Basalthea's satchel and the location of the Vampire court inside the Cathedral. If Seluna is present and the crawlers attempt to bargain, she attacks the Vampire immediately.

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QUARTER: DEAD CENTER

The downtown area lies between the squalor of the outer district and the blackstone bulk of an enormous gothic Cathedral dominating the city's center. Houses are clearly occupied, with iron lanterns inside burning with steady light. Pet Ghasts stand at corners like sentries, wearing torn but mostly clean uniforms as more functional undead walk the roads.

A leather-armored figure drops from the roofline and draws a long blade. A Weak group of them also appear behind the party, black trenchcoats flaring as compact crossbows track the party. This Moderate group of Night Elves clocks the crawlers from behind, pitch-black sunglasses. If Seluna is with the party, she vouches for them to her Vampire Hunter brethren.

Either way, the Hunters ask what the crawlers want in the city and demand they prove they are alive by exposing them to the glowing fungus, saying it burns undead skin. If the party passes the test, the leader recounts the history of the city: Vampires taking control, turning the citizens, and casting out the Igneous with Night Elf survivors ending up as cattle or taking up arms as Vampire Hunters.

Pounding boots echo between buildings as a wounded Night Elf collides with the crawlers before stumbling into an open plaza as Pet Ghasts nip at his heels. They spread into a widening ring while the Vampire Ameron drops into the square and begins taunting the Elf, playing with his food.

If the crawlers don't interfere, he kills the Elf before turning his attention to them—he likes an audience. Then he leaps over the Pet Ghasts to attack. If the party moves to stop him, he invites them into the ring of Pet Ghasts, chuckling that he prefers food that fights back before attacking. The Pet Ghasts applaud mechanically as the fight progresses. They scatter when Ameron dies.

If the crawlers earned the Hunters' trust, the Night Elves show them the Midnight Market, a collection of stalls and shops in a hidden courtyard where functioning undead trade among themselves. Coffin lids and funereal shrouds serve as countertops and drapes for vendors. Cages filled with stitched-together creatures and tiny monsters hang from iron hooks, and bottled curiosities line every available flat surface.

A sign nailed to a post reads "WE DON'T SERVE THE LIVING." Atop a cracked stone bier in the center of the courtyard, a Pet Ghast in a top hat and vest loudly solicits auction bids for an interesting, but Hostile Pet (see *Pets*, p. 228–231). Mid-bid, the creature snaps its chain and bolts through the stalls. Crawlers who pursue and catch it could conceal it and keep the creature.

QUARTER: CATHEDRAL

The Cathedral is a gothic stereotype of shadowed corridors, defaced altars, and shattered stained glass. From this seat, the corpulent Countess Kesla rules her court and the city, her hedonistic excess and depraved indulgence shown through the lack of upkeep and general decaying state of the once-beautiful building.

The upper levels house the court: Vampires and other intelligent undead attempt to govern while providing Kesla a never-ending supply of victims to sate her hunger. The dungeons are full of crypts, holding pens for the living. The throne room is down here as well.

A robed Vampire, Martinus, stands in the shadow of a broken colonnade watching the crawlers. Two Pet Ghasts kneel beside him, heads bowed, motionless. He doesn't bare his fangs, instead gesturing them over. Martinus says Kesla grew indulgent and reckless. He claims the pendant she wears confers rule over the city's undead.

He offers the crawlers both safe passage out of the city and his friendship, as well as an oath to return control of the city to the Igneous and Night Elves if they depose Countess Kesla and bring him her pendant. If the crawlers agree, he tells them the throne room is on the dungeon level. If refused, he withdraws, leaving them to find their own way.

A reinforced door opens to reveal the dungeon. Rows of dank cells line a stone corridor, each holding living prisoners including several Night Elves, a Gnome, and the crawler Gabriella. Chalk marks on black stone outside the cells mark how often a prisoner was taken to be fed upon. Emaciated, drained of both life and the will to live, their eyes plead for release.

An emaciated Vampire jailer stands with his back to the crawlers, slurping what appears to be a juice box of blood. If attacked, he dies without putting up a fight, turning into dust. If a crawler attempts to open any of the cells, the air in the dungeon ripples as bloodstains across the floor lift and spiral, coalescing into a distorted beastly shape. The Ghommid attacks anyone not in a cell. Once defeated, the Ghommid drops a heavy set of keys, including one to the throne room.

In the deepest, darkest chamber of this quadrant, Countess Kesla holds court in her throne room, accessed by using the key taken from the Ghommid in the dungeon. Crawlers who haven't received Kesla's location from the Hunters or Martinus can follow streaks of dried blood to the reinforced double doors of the throne room. See *B-B-B-Boss Battle* (p. 568).

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NPCS

Most undead don't have enough gray matter left to converse, but some folks in the Neighborhood interact without trying to eat your face. Crawlers may encounter the following characters in Midnight City.

AMERON

Ameron is a flashy theatrical performer whose sardonic approach pairs with bloodlust and a striking lack of empathy. Despite having access to the Cathedral's stock of living "donors," Ameron prefers to hunt his prey through the streets, releasing prisoners from the dungeon and toying with them before feeding. He wears a short leather jacket with layered bandanas tied around one arm. He keeps his shoulder-length blond hair greasy.

AI **Ameron. Vampire. Level 45.**

There's always one kid in a group pulling the wings off flies and kicking puppies when he thinks nobody's looking, isn't there? Ameron doesn't give a shit if you're watching. Actually, he kinda prefers it.

BASALTHEA

A curious and gentle soul, Basalthea spends her time diving into the secrets beneath her city. When the Vampires took over, she fled with the rest of the Igneous, leaving her research behind. Deeply committed to discovery and archaeology, she ventures into the city whenever she can, heedless of the danger.

Recently, she discovered strange repetitions in the stratification of the stone under the city. She's convinced it suggests manufacturing rather than natural formation but can't figure out what that means.

AI **Basalthea. Igneous. Level 39.**

You know what they say: curiosity killed the Caprid. Basalthea's a rarity among Igneous; quick on the uptake and good at connecting the dots. 'Course, she keeps getting attacked by Vampires, so maybe she's not as smart as she thinks. Serves her right for poking her nose where it doesn't belong.

GABRIELLA

Gabriella is an energetic and boisterous Australian who took the Setonix Race on Floor Three because it reminded her of Quokka back home. She took the Class Football Hooligan because she trained for it her whole life. Despite her newfound small stature, Gabriella is impulsive, runs headlong into every fight, and never backs down when she's sure she can win.

AI **Crawler #8,593,172. "Gabriella"**

Level 43.

Race: Setonix.

Class: Football Hooligan.

MARTINUS

Martinus was Kesla's closest confidant and lieutenant, acting as her advisor in their former territory. Over time, he watched her become indolent and needlessly cruel, overfeeding on the former citizens of the city she and her court conquered. He decided something needs to be done but knows he can't stand against her alone.

AI **Martinus. Vampire. Level 47.**

Craven weasel or king of the castle? I suppose it's all about who lives long enough to write history. I mean, you're all gonna die down here, obviously. Even Martinus when the floor collapses. Don't tell him though, okay? He's got such grand plans. It would be a shame to take that from him. Funny, sure. But, still, a shame.

SELUNA

Seluna is an intense, dry, and dedicated Night Elf. Armed to the teeth and handy with both blade and crossbow, she pioneered the use of UV-emitting fungus on weapons while hunting the undead who took her city. She lost her entire family to Vampires, watching from a closet as Ameron killed them one by one.

AI **Seluna. Night Elf. Level 41.**

I've been pretty into Vampire movies lately. I know, I know—I should be paying more attention to my work, keep the dungeon running, kill a couple thousand crawlers, but man, your planet made Vampires cool. Only thing better than a Vampire is a Vampire Hunter with a tragic backstory. Don't ask Seluna about hers. Or do—then I get to tick another crawler off my "to kill" list today.

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B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Overfed, Countess Kesla reclines upon her alabaster throne like a tick, full of blood, twirling a white umbrella in one hand. Her veins bulge like a two-pound sausage in a one-pound sack. As the crawlers enter, the dungeon doors slam shut, and torches flare to life. Chains along the walls hold collared Pet Ghasts, snapping at crawlers if they get close. Pools of slippery blood spread across the floor in streaks.

The Soul Crystal pendant at Kesla's throat pulses, and the Pet Ghasts twitch in unison with it. If she dies, every Ghast in the city, including those chained here, becomes Feral (*Feral Keyword*, p. 327). The pendant controls them only when worn by a Vampire.

As Kesla struggles to rise from her throne, an aristocratic voice sneers, announcing the Boss Battle. The crawlers' portraits rise in midair inside coffins. Opposite them, Kesla's portrait forms, blood dripping from the sides.

With a flick of her hand, Kesla releases a Weak group of Pet Ghasts from their restraints, initiating combat. She begins with blood sorcery; every Spell slims her as she uses her reserves, tightening her skin and sharpening her movements. As blood runs thin, she gets faster, abandoning magic for claws and fangs.

CLUES

- Kill Countess Kesla as quickly as possible.
- That pendant around her neck seems important for controlling her Pet Ghasts.
- Any crawler who grabs the pendant becomes her sole focus.

AI Countess Kesla. Bloated Lord of the Dead.

Level 60 Neighborhood Boss!

Countess Kesla. Before falling prey to the curse transforming her into the Vampire she is tonight, she had lands, titles, and sycophants. Now she's got a throne, self-control issues, and a city full of dead things on a leash.

Here's the fun part: that sparkly Soul Crystal around her throat? It's all that's keeping every Ghast in this charming metropolis from going completely feral. Kill her, and the whole city loses its housebroken setting. Cool opportunity if one of you ever wanted your own rotting army! 'Course, it only works when a Vampire wears it... Choices, choices.

Countess Kesla

Neighborhood Boss; Medium (4), Undead Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
6%	13%	20%	26%	33%	40%	46%	53%
5	5	5	5	5	5	5	
60%	66%	73%	80%	86%	93%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
60	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
50 (+6)	28 (+5)	42 (+5)	35 (+5)	50 (+6)

Pet Ghast Release Spell: A Ghast is released from the wall, joining the combat.

Blood Boil Spell: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Necrotic, 50ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Fatigued Debuff.

Feral Bite: 16+F to hit, 5d6+6 Piercing, 5ft range
For every 2 HB slots lost to this attack, Countess Kesla heals 1 HB slot.

Notes: *Blood Makes Noise*—At 60% and at 20% or less HB, Countess Kesla gains 1 Action, typically to release more Pet Ghasts to save her (if she has her pendant).

Pendant—A crawler may roll a melee attack with Disadvantage to cut or swipe the pendant off her neck. If she loses it, she can't release any Pet Ghasts.

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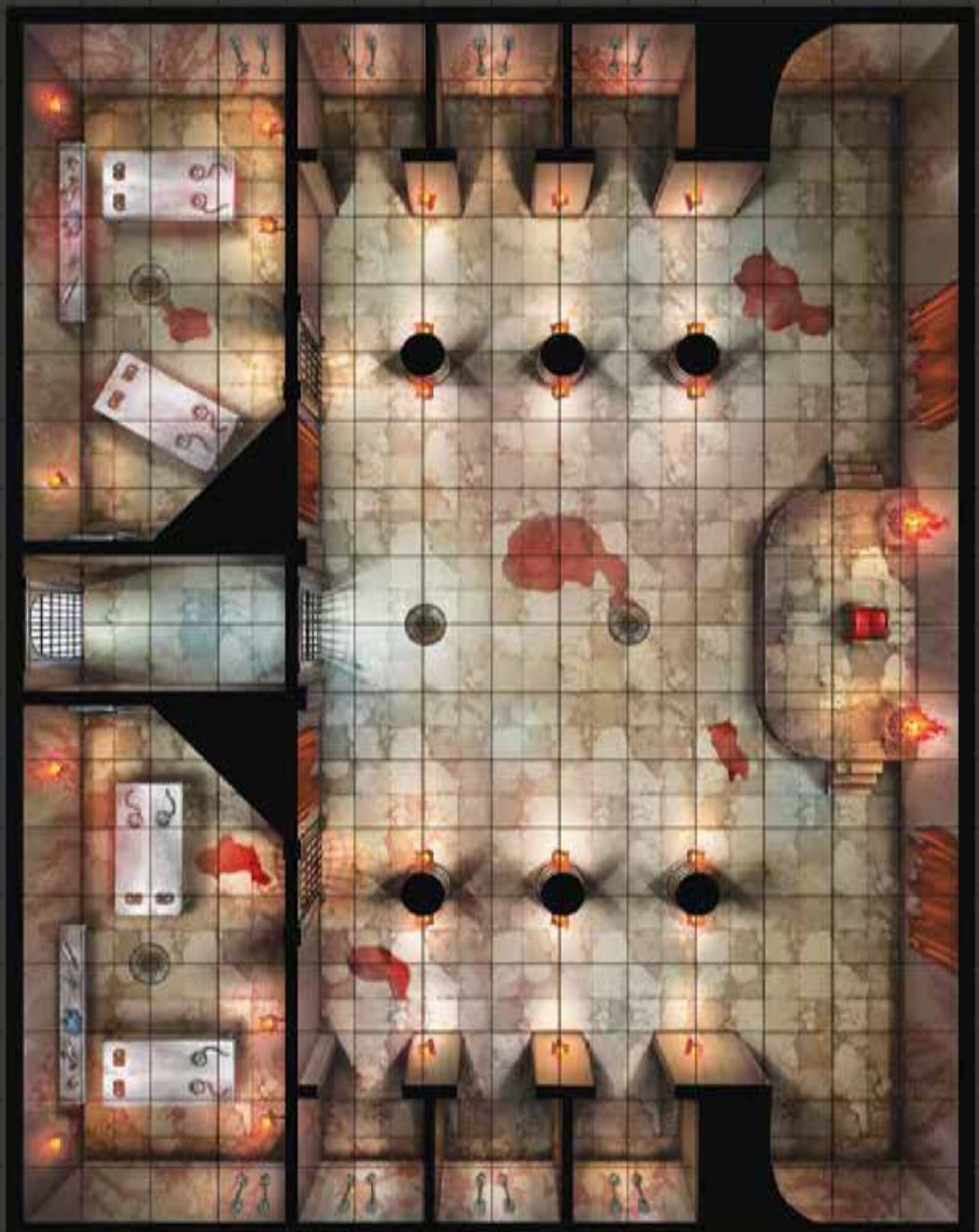

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NEIGHBORHOOD: OCEAN EXPLOSION (SEA QUADRANT)

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: HUNGRY, HUNGRY SHARKS!

This Neighborhood is the physical manifestation of a mudskipper's imagination after obsessing over far too many Hollywood movies. The result is a sprawling seascape studded with naval mines pulled from every era of Human history, arranged with the loose confidence of someone who has never seen an ordnance diagram.

The mines guard a graveyard of shipwrecks that range from wooden galleons to modern battleships and nuclear submarines. Kelp farms were added a little later, presumably so the place could pass for a functioning ecosystem instead of a weapons test conducted inside a fishbowl.

Predators lurk everywhere. Killer Whales, Octo-Sharks, and other creatures lifted straight from movies and mythology patrol the waters. To make matters worse, this Quadrant of ocean boasts one of the largest shark populations anywhere in the World Dungeon. Concierge Sharks appear particularly often; it's rare to look in any direction without spotting at least one circling nearby.

Good news: they rarely attack without provocation. Unfortunately, blood in the water counts as provocation.

Potential Castle: Unbound Will's Lightless Cavern

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- A small form moves in the distance with a single light floating beneath it as if extended from an arm. As it dives ever deeper, the crawlers catch a flash of light inside the shape, illuminating several humanoid forms inside a submarine that has absolutely no business being on this floor.
- A soft blue glow shimmers across the water some distance out, rising and falling with the waves like drifting lanterns. At first, it looks beautiful. Then the shapes beneath the surface shift, and the crawlers realize the light comes from a cluster of enormous Big Boy Blue jellyfish slowly pulsing through the dark water.
- One of the Crocodilians lounging in a nearby camp launches into a rambling story about Captain Bustabeard Trent, a legendary dwarven pirate who looted merchant ships by the dozen before scuttling his own vessel somewhere in these waters. According to the tale, Captain Trent's treasure went down with the ship, and no one ever recovered it. The Crocodilian swears the wreck lies somewhere beneath these very waves.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you'll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- A crew of thieves intends to rob the crawlers (and everyone else) blind. Thievery is still illegal, even on the high seas, so if they're caught, the thieves face severe, possibly fatal penalties. The thieves travel in a small submarine crawling along the ocean floor, eliminating anything that might expose them, including Mobs, NPCs, and crawlers. If the party stumbles across the sub or its operations, they must decide whether to shut the thieves down, profit from their scheme, or turn a blind eye.
- Soon after entering the region, the crawlers meet Earl, a Half-Giant who seems far too calm for someone living in a shark-filled minefield. Earl eventually reveals the truth: he's a crawler from a previous season and now a game guide with no crawlers under his charge. He offers to guide the party through parts of the Fifth Floor, though he refuses to risk his life for them. And if his advice happens to disagree with the wisdom of the crawlers' own game guide or manager... well, that could get interesting.
- The crawlers stumble across Mel, a lone scavenger hiding beneath a rocky outcropping on the sea floor. Mel has a treasure map that supposedly marks

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the resting place of Captain Bustabeard Trent's legendary hoard, which he'll happily sell for 10,000 gold. The map leads to a cavern where Bustabeard's ship finally came to rest, its hold packed with gold, jewels, and something far more valuable. Unfortunately, a massive Killer Whale has claimed the wreck as its home. When the creature notices intruders, the Neighborhood Boss Battle begins.

MOBS

Almost all the Mobs in and around the region are subaquatic, with the innate ability to breathe underwater. Those who can't breathe underwater have their own means of surviving outside the air pockets of the city and its surroundings.

BIG BOY BLUE

These enormous glowing blue jellyfish measure roughly 15 feet (4.5 m) across and trail long, lazily drifting tentacles behind them. They drift through the water with no obvious sense of direction, often bumping into one another like a cluster of underwater balloons. Unfortunately for crawlers, anything that brushes those trailing tentacles tends to get wrapped up in them and stung. And yes, their stingers hurt like a son-of-a-bitch.

AI **Big Boy Blue. Level 40.**

The good ol' Big Boy Blue is the largest of the jellyfish one might find floating around. They're a little like that guy you used to know in high school who was always wearing either overalls or a jersey of some sort. The dude was like six-foot-five and pushing 300 pounds when he was a freshman. He always had a crewcut. Dad's a trucker. Never talks. Never does his homework. He's just always, you know, kinda there.

He doesn't mean any harm. But he's so goddamned dumb, he does harm if you get in his way. Plus, he always has a super-hot girlfriend for some reason, but that has nothing to do with the jellyfish. Anyway, you get the point. Harmless as long as you don't touch them.

Big Boy Blue

Mob; Huge (6), Beast

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	13+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
43 (+5)	6 (+3)	35 (+5)	25 (+5)	16 (+4)

Sting: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Piercing, 30ft Line
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

CONCIERGE SHARK

The Janitor Mobs of the sea bubble look like tiger sharks, each about 15 feet (4.5 m) long, jet black from nose to tail, with glowing red eyes that cut through the water like warning lights. They usually patrol in loose groups, circling wrecks and minefields while cleaning up whatever the dungeon leaves floating. When blood hits the water, however, all sense of teamwork disappears. The Concierge Sharks erupt into a feeding frenzy, and suddenly it's every shark for itself (and very bad news for anything caught in the middle).

AI **Concierge Shark. Level 41.**

These psychos are of the bite-first, ask-questions-later school of underwater diplomacy.

Also known as the "Death's Welcoming Committee" Shark, the Concierge Shark is one of the fastest and most voracious of the ocean's predators. They'll eat anything. Anything. Even those circus peanut candy things. It's really kind of gross.

They're attracted to the scent of blood, making them the most common death dealers of any water-themed dungeon.

"Statistically speaking, the sharks can't eat all of us."

Crawler #1,197,506, Chrissie W.

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Concierge Shark

Mob; Large (5), Beast

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
41	13+F	15+F	35+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
47 (+5)	6 (+3)	42 (+5)	25 (+5)	8 (+3)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Feeding Frenzy*—If a shark-foe drops to 50% HB or less or gains the Blood Trail Debuff, Concierge Sharks may use their Move Action to attack.

JUVENILE OCTO-SHARK

These nightmarish hybrids combine the head and rows of razor-sharp teeth of a great white shark with the eight-armed body of an octopus. Juveniles measure roughly 16 feet from nose to the tips of their writhing arms. Adults are *much* larger.

AI **Juvenile Octo-Shark. Level 30.**

Ah, the babies. Here's the thing about Octo-Shark babies. The odds are stacked against them from the get-go. There's just too many of them. Their mom is really strict and won't let them leave her mouth. They don't know who their daddies are, which makes them kinda sad, especially around Christmas. They need constant nourishment. So when food does arrive, they have to fight for their morsels. Only the strongest survive.

Eventually, even their broodmother won't be able to keep up with the demand. That's right around the time the juveniles start to realize their brothers and sisters are also delicious. In each birthing of 2-3,000 pups, only one or two survive.

In other words, their odds of survival are better than yours!

Juvenile Octo-shark

Mob; Large (5), Beast

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
30	13+F	15+F	25+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
43 (+5)	6 (+3)	35 (+5)	25 (+5)	16 (+4)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Tentacle: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

CROCODILIAN ROID-SOLDIER

These Crocodilian soldiers dwarf the specimens crawlers faced on the Third Floor. Each one stands seven to eight feet tall and carries over 400 pounds of scale, muscle, and bad intentions. Their size and ferocity make them ideal shock troops for any army willing to point them at a problem and say, "go."

All Crocodilians possess a metabolism that triples the effects of Buffs gained from eating creatures. For that reason, many of these brutes carry "snacks" that grant them water-breathing or strength boosts. Apparently, even dungeon steroids work better on a full stomach.

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AI Crocodilian Roid-Soldier. Level 35.

Crocodilians are an intelligent, thick-skinned, semi-aquatic Race. They tend not to be the sharpest tools in the shed, but they're certainly more intelligent than their smaller cousins, the Troglodytes. They're inclined to work as muscle or enforcers for both legitimate and not-so-legitimate organizations throughout the universe. Here they serve as border guards for the region with orders to kick ass.

Who do they answer to, you ask? Wouldn't you like to know...

Crocodilian Roid-Soldier

Mob; Large (5), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	14+F	15+F	20+S	6
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
39 (+5)	12 (+4)	28 (+5)	21 (+5)	10 (+4)

Vicious Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

Harpoon Gun: 15+F to hit, 3d6 Piercing, 30 ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Pinned to a Surface Debuff: The crawler is Held against a surface like a wall, tree, or whatever is nearby (the ground as a last resort).

Notes: *Roid Rage*—Buffs have triple the effect on Roid-Soldiers.

GIANT DRAGONFISH

Normally, Dragonfish grow only 12 to 24 inches long, but the System AI decided that wasn't nearly entertaining enough. The specimens here stretch over four feet in length, and their black scaleless bodies end in enormous jaws packed with needle-like teeth and an appetite to match. A glowing lure dangles from their chin, and faint bioluminescent lines run along their bodies, softly illuminating their surroundings and ensuring curious meals are delivered right to their door.

AI Giant Dragonfish Level 35.

These things were weird lookin' before your world ended, but now they're just freaky! They usually eat shrimp and the like, but with you, no need to feed for the rest of the week.

Oh, see that glowing thing coming out of their chin? Whatever you do, don't head toward the light. Seriously, these glowing Satan-fish are incredibly fast, vicious, and always hungry. It's best to give them a wide berth... buuut you can't. So good luck!

Giant Dragonfish

Mob; Petite (3), Beast

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	14+F	15+F	40+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
39 (+5)	12 (+4)	28 (+5)	21 (+5)	10 (+4)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

Lure Spell: 14+F, No damage, 50ft range
Any hit crawler must spend actions moving until they are adjacent to the Dragonfish.

Notes: *Glowing Lure*—The first time each crawler would make a melee attack against the Dragonfish, if they don't say "I don't look at the light," they must make an Int Stat Check. On Fail, they lose that action.

ENVIRONMENT

The water here is clearer than anything that existed on Earth before the Collapse, allowing crawlers with the right equipment or magic to see surprisingly far beneath the surface. That might sound reassuring, but mostly it means you get to see what's about to kill you with absolute clarity. The ocean stretches endlessly in every direction, broken only by scattered coral reefs, dense kelp growths, and the occasional shipwreck slowly dissolving into the seabed. Plenty of creatures hide in those shadows, and most of them are hungry.

Much of the region's foot traffic (or fin traffic, if you prefer) travels through powerful undersea currents that flow like rivers between different parts of the Neighborhood. These currents act as subaquatic highways, carrying anything caught in them swiftly across long distances, speeding travel for experienced locals who know how to use them.

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Only a few locations, such as the kelp farms, contain air pockets where surface-dwellers can breathe normally. Everywhere else requires crawlers to breathe underwater by magic, equipment, or other creative solutions. But don't worry; if the lack of air doesn't kill you, the crushing pressure at the bottom of the sea probably will.

TRAPS

Most of the traps in the region are twists on naturally occurring terrain features. The showrunners set up both the mines and the more "natural" hazards before the floor opened, though some have been modified by the denizens of the dungeon to better serve their uses.

- **Crystal Pillars:** These pillars are typically reinforced with magic and are very difficult to break. If broken, however, the magic used to reinforce them explodes violently outward, sending shards at high speeds in every direction. They also have the added ability to reflect or refract light-based attacks if struck.
- **Heat Vents:** "Naturally" occurring vents shoot lava-heated water at seemingly random intervals. Some clever dungeon engineers even shaped a few of them to aim the blasts down specific corridors. These blasts not only inflict bone-searing burns but can blast crawlers and Mobs away, should they get in the line of fire. The silver lining is that the burns usually cauterize the wounds, which means Concierge Sharks show slightly less interest in the aftermath.
- **Light Crystals:** These glowing crystals illuminate the dark water like underwater lanterns. Unfortunately, they also store energy and release it in a concentrated beam when their trigger condition is met, usually when a living creature swims too close. Most crystals only fire a few times before needing to recharge. However, placing one near a heat vent solves that problem nicely. A single blast from the vent can recharge the crystal instantly, which means clever crawlers or particularly vindictive dungeon designers can keep the trap firing all day.
- **Nautical Mines:** Naval mines come in a variety of forms from a vast array of nations and eras. All of them are represented throughout the Quadrant, but particularly in the minefield quarter. They're designed to explode on contact, but a substantial enough force, such as an unrelated explosion, can also cause detonation. These spheres detonate in a five-to-twenty-foot radius, instantly vaporizing the water surrounding them and blasting anything nearby with heat and shrapnel.

ITEMS

Shark waters may look beautiful from a distance, but the seafloor tells a different story. Wrecked ships, shattered hulls, and the scattered leftovers of several civilizations carpet the bottom, making treasure hunting both fun and dangerous.

- **Coral Shards:** Broken fragments of razor-sharp and extremely colorful coral. May attract fish or be used as shrapnel.
- **Sunken Ships:** The shattered remains of vessels that failed to navigate the Quadrant's mines. Some hulls still contain salvageable gear, while others are little more than convenient piles of scrap material waiting to be harvested.
- **Nuclear Reactor:** Several of the ships and submarines dropped into the region still have active nuclear reactors on board. Most remain safely shut down... most. The others serve as a reminder that sometimes the most dangerous thing in the ocean isn't the sharks.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards.

- **I was in the pool!:** "You spent more than 60 seconds fully submerged underwater. It's about time. You were starting to smell.
  Reward: You've received a Bronze I'm Wet Box."
- **Rock-Bottom:** "You dove more than 1,000 meters below the surface of the sea! Nice work, Captain Nemo.
  Reward: You've received a Gold I'm Wet Box."
- **Let There Be Light:** "You managed to kill multiple Mobs by firing a light-based Spell through a crystal pillar. That's an oddly specific interaction, but I appreciate creative problem-solving.
  Reward: You've received a Platinum Tricky Bastard Box."
- **Calimari, Anyone?:** "You're underwater, but you still managed to fry ten Juvenile Octo-Sharks with a single fiery blast! Physics may have questions about this, but the viewers certainly don't. Those things had it coming, anyway.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Explosives Box."

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GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers have defeated a few Mobs, they might grind for experience by killing lots of the same Mobs again and again. Examples of this might include fishing with explosives or hunting the plethora of sharks to near extinction. Or pick one from Table 101.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: BORDERLANDS

The shoreline, shallows, and sea caves connect the sea region to the others in the bubble. Many Crocodilians congregate in these areas, particularly those steroid-driven wackadoos intent on showing everyone how big their muscles are. Crocodilian camps cluster along the beaches and in half-flooded caves along the shore. When Mobs from other regions wander in, the Crocodilians do their best to smash them flat.

When the crawlers arrive, they stumble into a full-blown blood sport. A circle of Crocodilians cheers while a Weak group of enormous Roid-Soldiers beat the scales off each other. As soon as the crawlers are noticed, the fight slows to a halt, and a voice calls out, "Change in plans! Kill the newcomers and claim the title for the day!"

More than a dozen Roid-Soldiers rush the crawlers to claim the highly coveted title of Supreme Overlord of Camp 3B and All Its Inhabitants (Except Earl).

Nearby, Earl the Half-Giant tries to fish from a battered dock. He hooks something big, wrestles with it for a moment, then drags a thrashing Juvenile Octo-Shark halfway out of the water before his pole snaps. The creature escapes, and Earl swears loudly, slamming his fist into the dock support. The pier splinters and slowly collapses into the shallows behind him as he stomps back to shore.

TABLE 101 GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A shiver of Concierge Sharks swarm in while the crawlers are in the midst of a battle with another Mob. They've been drawn by the blood and are now *really* hungry!
2	A crystal pillar nearby explodes, seemingly at random, blasting the whole area with shards of crystal, damaging Mobs and crawlers alike.
3	The crystals in the rock formations mesmerize the crawlers, who must randomly determine which of their Skills they are actually grinding.
4	Crawlers without Ranks in the Swimming Skill gain the Fatigued Debuff.
5	One of the submarines filled with pirate scavengers moves into the area, searching for gear and material to resell to local vendors.
6	A pod of whales swims through, calves in tow, paying the crawlers no heed unless harmed.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- Numerous Concierge Sharks devour the corpse of a Crocodilian unlucky enough to be caught too far from safety.
  Outcome: Sharks become more numerous in the area for 1d4 hours due to the blood in the water.
- An impromptu wrestling match breaks out between two Crocodilians!
  Outcome: The crawlers could help one of them win, upsetting the loser, or they could break up the fight, angering both participants.
- As the sun sets on the horizon, the blue glow of jellyfish lends an almost magical radiance to the water.
  Outcome: Sharks are scarcer in the area for 1d4 hours due to the presence of the jellyfish.
- A speedboat skips across the waves, its wake bisecting the water.
  Outcome: The crawlers may attempt to commandeer the speedboat for faster travel.

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If the crawlers defeat the Crocodilians, the camp elder grudgingly awards them the title of Supreme Overlord of Camp 3B. While a party member holds the title, the crawlers gain access to a hidden safe-room inside the camp. Lose the title, and the welcome disappears instantly.

QUARTER: MINEFIELD

Thousands of naval mines from every era of Earth's history drift through this Quadrant. Some remain tethered to anchors on the seafloor, others float freely at various depths, gently bobbing like the world's most explosive sea lanterns. Between them lies a graveyard of shipwrecks. Old galleons dominate the field, but the occasional submarine or modern warship rests among them, all slowly rusting into scrap.

For crawlers willing to risk it, the wrecks offer nearly unlimited miscellaneous junk and salvage. Of course, collecting it requires careful navigation through a floating field of explosives while avoiding the local shark population. The dungeon considers this an acceptable tradeoff.

Nearby, a shiver of Concierge Sharks tears apart the corpse of a freshly killed whale. The feeding frenzy keeps them occupied for the moment, but more sharks continue to arrive from across the region. If they encounter crawlers before reaching the whale, congratulations! You just became the appetizer.

Among the wreckage, the crawlers encounter the deep-sea salvager Mel, who fiercely guards whatever ship he currently claims, threatening anyone who gets too close. Respect his claim, and Mel happily sells salvage and odd treasures pulled from the wrecks. Among Mel's cherished goods is a weathered map titled Unbound Will's Trove, available for the very reasonable price of 10,000 gold.

Following the map through a narrow path between tightly packed mines barely big enough for the whale himself to swim through leads to Unbound Will's Cave, where a wrecked galleon filled with gold and magical loot awaits. Unfortunately, the treasure belongs to the Neighborhood Boss, a very large Killer Whale covered in prison tattoos from his time in the slammer.

And he's not going back.

QUARTER: THE FLOTILLA

The Flotilla is exactly what happens when a few hundred damaged ships, broken docks, and floating platforms get tied together with duct tape, rope, baling wire, and whatever else happens to be lying around. The result is a sprawling, unstable maze of decks, gangways, and half-sunken hulls bobbing in the water.

Most of the region's Crocodilians live here, except for the more aggressive camps out in the Borderlands. It's also the Neighborhood's only real trade hub. Shops, training guilds, and the Gator Tooth Pub all crowd together among the wreckage. The pub also houses the Flotilla's saferoom, which explains why it's always busy.

A gang of Crocodilian Roid-Soldiers lounges on the skeletal remains of an old galleon lashed to the rest of the Flotilla with long strips of duct tape twisted into rope. When the crawlers arrive, one of the guards throws a bottle at them and shouts an insult. Whether the crawlers respond or not, the gang keeps escalating the harassment until fists start flying.

After the friendly brawl concludes, a young Human-looking girl approaches the party and politely welcomes them to the Flotilla. She invites them to her family's shack for a bowl of homemade gumbo. Crawlers who eat the stew gain a 10% bonus to Strength and Constitution for 30 hours. Crawlers who are kind to her family may be rewarded with the family recipe and a few miscellaneous potions to help them on their journey.

Unfortunately, the Roid-Soldier gang leader happens to be the son of a powerful local merchant, Don Jackson DeVille. The Don knows his son is an idiot, but he still expects respect for the family name. Later, a nervous young Crocodilian tracks down the crawlers and tells them the Don "requests" their presence. The child strongly suggests they accept the invitation, insinuating that bad things tend to happen to people who don't.

The encounter at the Don's residence could end in a fight with the wealthy Crocodilian, but he can be convinced (magically or otherwise) that his son had it coming and got the whoopin' he deserved.

QUARTER: KELP FARMS

The Kelp Farms are a strangely unique aberration in the sea region. Much of the area exists within massive air bubbles resting on the ocean floor. Crocodilians live and work within these pockets, stepping into the surrounding underwater fields to tend their crops. The kelp grows in dense forests just beyond the bubble walls, providing food for the Flotilla far above and for countless sea creatures that would happily eat the farmers if given the chance.

Out in the kelp fields, a lone Crocodilian farmhand carefully rearranges the thick stalks so the plants grow more efficiently. Unfortunately, the work disturbs a hidden colony of shrimp, scattering them into the water. Almost immediately, a school of Giant

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Dragonfish that had been hunting nearby turns to investigate. The Dragonfish are far more interested in the shrimp than the farmer, but they aren't picky eaters.

Elsewhere in the fields, a small group of Crocodilians struggles to repair a damaged kelp harvester. Because they lack gills, the workers are forced to constantly return to the air bubble to breathe, making progress painfully slow. Crawlers passing through might spot one of the exhausted farmers heading back for air. Anyone with engineering Skills could help repair the machine, and even simple magic or equipment that allows longer underwater breathing would speed up the work considerably. The farmers repay helpful crawlers with gratitude and whatever supplies they can spare.

Meanwhile, a lone Crocodilian quietly slips down an alley between two farm outbuildings. The Croc glances around nervously but does a poor job of spotting anyone following. Inside a small barn, a hatch in the floor leads to a hidden shrine to Yemaya, goddess of the waters and bringer of life. The Crocodilian makes a small offering at the shrine and prays for a few moments before returning to their chores.

NPCS

Much of this region is dominated by Crocodilians, offering a vast pool of potential NPCs. A few former crawlers, pirates, and thieves add some spice to this NPC stew as well.

DON JACKSON DEVILLE

The Don is a businessman first and foremost, though the nature of his business seems to be a matter of much debate among his fellow Crocodilians. He holds a position of intimidating power on the Flotilla, where very few are brave enough to ignore his commands, even if they aren't on his payroll. This powerful Crocodilian is incredibly intelligent, a trait he neglected to pass on to his two sons.

AI **Don Jackson DeVille. Crocodilian Mob Boss. Level 50.**

I bet you've never seen a crocodile in a bowler hat before (even though I'm sure you've always wanted to). Well, here's your chance! Don Jackson Deville has a reputation for violence and intimidation against those who don't do what he says. Though he usually doesn't have to bloody his own knuckles and teeth (Yup! He's a biter). He's got people for that, and they're just as keen to hand out beatings as he is.

Crocodilian Mob Boss

Mob; Large (5), Humanoid

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	20+S	6
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
29 (+5)	27 (+5)	58 (+6)	21 (+5)	20 (+5)

Vicious Bite: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

Harpoon Gun: 15+F to hit, 3d10 Piercing, 30 ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Pinned to a Surface Debuff: The crawler is Held against a surface like a wall, tree, or whatever is nearby (the ground as a last resort).

Notes: *Boss's Orders*—At the beginning of each turn, the Mob Boss points out a target, and that target suffers Disadvantage on Evade Checks from the Boss's underlings.

EARL

Earl was a crawler more than a dozen seasons ago. He reached the 12th Floor and immediately took a deal to escape the dungeon. Now he's serving out his contract as an NPC shopkeeper, though he realized this season that no one is monitoring him: It doesn't matter if he actually sells anything or not, so he mostly just does as he pleases. Unlike most of the NPCs on this floor, Earl remembers the time before this season, though he doesn't talk about it much.

He'll generally do anything he can to aid the crawlers, so long as it doesn't endanger his own life. You can't enjoy freedom if you're dead, after all. That said, if a plan promises a particularly satisfying middle finger to the showrunners, Earl can be convinced to stretch those rules a little.

AI **Earl. Half-Giant Former Crawler. Level 46.**

This 10-foot-tall monster of a man makes for an intimidating sight, even when he's just sitting there, roasting marshmallows over the fire. He's a Half-Giant, but don't ask me how that Race came about.

Okay, one comment: it seems like that would be a case where size really does matter.

He's kinda boring for being such a big guy, but the last time the steroid-riddled Crocs tried to mess with him, he ended up eating crocodile stew, so they tend to leave him alone. Maybe you should, too.

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MEL

Mel is a scavenger who collects as much material as possible. It doesn't really matter what it is; if it's grabbable, he'll grab it and keep it until he can resell it for a profit. While he doesn't have the limitless inventory space of the crawlers, he manages to stuff an impossible amount of wood, steel, and other materials into his satchel.

AI **Mel. Lizardfolk. Level 51.**

Every system has its scavengers. Fish tanks have those little sucker fish, the dungeon has Janitor Mobs, and pre-Crawl societies usually called them "the wealthy." Well, Mel is none of those things! He just digs up broken shit and sells it to the highest bidder. I suppose that makes him an enterprising entrepreneur. Credit where credit is due: Mel knows his business and does it well.

AI "Today's entertainment features one extremely angry Killer whale, several hundred Sharks, and a cave with only one exit. Unfortunately, that exit is now blocked. Please enjoy the show."

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Deep inside a lightless cavern lies the wreck of a pirate galleon, once the vessel of Captain Broadbeard Trent, broken open and half-buried beneath piles of gold, bones, and whatever else sank with it. This is Unbound Will's lair. The enormous Killer Whale usually sleeps atop the treasure like a homicidal dragon, but he has an excellent sense of smell and a deep hatred of crawlers. Their scent wakes him quickly.

The cave itself sits far below the surface, making natural light nonexistent. Crawlers need magical or artificial light to see anything beyond shadows and wreckage. The walls of the cavern are riddled with holes two to three feet wide, each surrounded by veins of silver threading through the stone.

Shortly after combat begins, Unbound Will smashes the cavern wall with his massive tail, causing loose stone to crash down behind the crawlers, sealing the entrance. When Unbound Will rises from the wreckage, the full horror of the creature stretches nearly 80 feet long, with enormous jagged teeth and an impressive array of prison tattoos along his body.

Unbound Will prefers simple tactics. He charges, bites, slams crawlers with his massive tail, and attempts to tear his enemies in half with those impossibly powerful jaws. When facing multiple opponents, he unleashes a thunderous roar that summons nearby Sharks of all types through the holes in the cavern walls. The Sharks swirl around him in a frenzy, allowing Unbound Will to unleash his infamous Tsharknami! attack: a spinning storm of teeth and violence.

Unbound Will ruled this cavern for a long time. And he has no intention of giving it up.

CLUES

- If the crawlers can spoof their own smell, or that of other crawlers, they can distract Unbound Will.
- If enough blood is in the water, preferably non-crawler, the sharks go for it, leaving the party alone.
- The orca's attack that sealed the cavern also left unstable areas that, if hit, could fall on the Boss himself.

AI **Unbound Will. Orca With an Attitude. Level 60 Neighborhood Boss!**

This immense orca is covered with not-so-masterfully inked prison tattoos across its body. Wait, are Killer Whales black with white splotches or white with black splotches?

Anywaaaay, now that Unbound Will is finally free, he ain't never goin' back to prison! Ever hear of Moby Dick? Prison champ Unbound Will would chomp the shit outta that guy. And you're much tinier than Moby Dick, aren't you? Tough luck, buddy!

Unbound Will, Giant Orca

Neighborhood Boss; Colossal (7), Killer Whale

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
6%	13%	20%	26%	33%	40%	46%	53%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	
60%	66%	73%	80%	86%	93%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
60	14+F	14+F	35+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
75 (+6)	16 (+4)	80 (+6)	18 (+4)	16 (+4)

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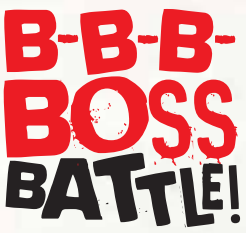
Tsharknami!: 14+F to hit, 7d12+6 Piercing, 30ft range

Bite: 16+F to hit, 6d6+6 Piercing, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Swallowed Debuff: The crawler is swallowed whole and cannot be attacked. When an attack against the Unbound Will results in an Amazing Success or better (or it dies), all crawlers remove the Swallowed Debuff. Swallowed crawlers take 1d10+F Acid at the end of each round. Swallowed crawlers attack with Disadvantage vs. 0 DR, and Slashing attacks deal ×2 damage.

Tail Whip: 16+F, 5d8+6 Bludgeoning, 20ft Cone
Any hit crawler is pushed 5ft for each HB slot lost.

Notes: *Blood In the Water*—Each time another creature in the area is killed, Unbound Will spends 1 Action moving toward the blood. If the number of dead creatures is equal to the crawler party size or more in the area, the sharks spend all of their Actions feeding, leaving the party alone, and the Tsharknami! attack cannot be used.

AI "Today's feature presentation includes one ancient sea horror, thousands of hungry offspring, and several crawlers who have made truly questionable life choices. Place your bets now. The house favors Lusca."



Lusca can be encountered anywhere in the deep water of the sea region, though she normally steers clear of Unbound Will's lair. Not because she fears him, but because navigating a minefield for a snack just isn't worth the effort.

When Lusca appears, the ocean freezes in place for a moment, and the crawlers receive an admin notice. *"This encounter has been flagged as a Special Event Boss Battle, now streaming live to premium subscribers across the galaxy."* A pair of overly enthusiastic commentators (Kevin and Magnificent Troy) appear above the battlefield and begin introducing the crawlers and Lusca as if they're prizefighters entering a boxing ring. They sound extremely confident about Lusca's chances.

Lusca most often attempts to swallow her prey whole, allowing the thousands of juveniles in her mouth to consume them, or digesting them slowly if they aren't already dead by the time she swallows. Her jaws are strong enough to chomp through all but the strongest materials after a few bites, and the currents she leaves in her wake as she swims throw crawlers into confusion, disorienting them until they can't determine which way is up.

But by far, the most dangerous aspect of the fight is the thousands of Juvenile Octo-Sharks that live within her mouth—and they're always hungry.

CLUES

- Stay close and hitch a ride. What a rush!
- Juvenile sharks are nurtured in Lusca's mouth, and are interested in soft and bloody tissue.

AI **Lusca, Octo-Shark Brood Mother Queen**

Level 82 City Boss!

I know, I know. Sharktopus is much cooler sounding than Octo-Shark. Hey, this is a real creature, not something I made up, so don't blame me. It's not—I repeat—it's not named in such a way because of Nadya Suleman, the so-called Octo-Mom and her eight babies who took the tabloids by storm all those years ago.

Though it would be appropriate for you to think so.

Being the biggest, baddest, and most voracious creature in the ocean requires a lot of sustenance, especially when you're a new mother carrying a boatload of hungry babies in your mouth. And since Lusca is a single mother, sometimes she requires a little help. She needs to keep them babies fed. And who's the daddy of these precious little babies?

Who knows? Lusca is a whore! Every Octo-Shark playa in the Neighborhood knows she offers that sweet tentacle booty of hers to any bad boy who'll drop something juicy onto her plate.

That, by the way, is exactly what you are. Food dropped onto Lusca's plate in exchange for some one-on-one time. The male Octo-Shark who brought you here already got his and is long gone. Just like your real daddy!

Lusca herself already ate. But that's okay!

Like I said, she needs to keep them babies fed.

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Lusca, Octo-Shark Brood Mother Queen

City Boss; Gargantuan (8), Octo-Shark

8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8
4%	8%	12%	16%	20%	24%	28%	32%	36%	40%	44%	48%	52%
8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	8	
56%	60%	64%	68%	72%	76%	80%	84%	88%	92%	96%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
82	15+F	16+F	50+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
177 (+8)	24 (+5)	158 (+8)	50 (+6)	25 (+5)

Rush: 18+F to hit, 6d8+8 Bludgeoning, 50ft Line
Crawlers adjacent to Lusca can spend an Action as an Interrupt to make a Str Stat Check when Lusca does a Rush attack. On Success, they move with Lusca and have Advantage on their next attack. On Fail, the crawler does not move with her (and may be in the Line path).

Bite: 18+F to hit, 5d10+8 Piercing, 15ft range
Any hit crawler ends up in Lusca's ginormous mouth, and gains the Fish Food Debuff: Take 1d12+F Piercing at the end of each round. Interior attacks are vs. 0 DR.

Flipper: 18+F to hit, 6d10+8 Bludgeoning, 30ft range
Any hit crawler slides 5ft for each HB slot lost.

Notes: *Mouth Sores*—If any crawler deals 3+ HB slots of damage to Lusca in one shot, the juvenile sharks cause Lusca to lose 1 HB slot at the end of each round, and the Fish Food Debuff is removed.

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NEIGHBORHOOD: SCREAMING SEA (SEA QUADRANT)

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: SLAUGHTER ON THE HIGH SEAS

The sea quadrant of this bubble is home to the Screaming Sea, a wide expanse of open ocean dotted with islands and crowded with Pirates.

The archipelagos of the Screaming Sea are paradise, inviting crawlers to settle down on sandy beaches with a coconut and wait for the floor to collapse. Those venturing farther inland may find buried treasure or dangers lying in wait. White sails and black flags move between these islands: ships hunting for easy prey and quick plunder. There's danger below the waves, with Bubble Belugas and blooms of Pain Amplifier Jellyfish ready to take advantage of anyone foolish enough to go for a swim.

A massive galleon under constant siege sits at the heart of the Screaming Sea. Ships converge there from every direction, firing on the vessel as well as each other the instant a target ventures within range.

This behemoth of a Pirate ship belongs to Admiral Stoma, self-proclaimed ruler of wind and wave. Her well-armed vessel sports hundreds of cannon ports and utilizes living artillery in the form of Cannonback Tortoises. Diminutive in size, the Mantis Shrimp Admiral has more blood on her limbs than any other Pirate on the sea. One way or another, all tides lead to her guns.

Potential Castle: Admiral Stoma's Galleon

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- The crawlers awaken on a sandy beach with waves lapping at their feet. Tropical music and the smell of roasting meat drifts in on the breeze. A group of Grulke, Crocodilian, and Monk Seal Pirates party at a makeshift cabana just up the shore. They invite the crawlers to join them, commiserating with the "newly marooned" about their island captivity and warning them against Bubble Belugas dwelling in the shallows.
- Crawlers entering the Screaming Sea from a different quadrant come across two sailors arguing on a deserted stretch of shoreline. Their ship ran aground while trying to escape a pod of Bubble Belugas, and the sailors wandered inland to find supplies, but now they can't remember where they left the vessel.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures, make one a Quest if you like:

- The crawlers discover an abandoned ship on Wreckwater Beach, retrofitting it and sailing it into the Screaming Seas Neighborhood. They break a Bubble Beluga blockade and brave Pirate-occupied, Pain Amplifier Jellyfish-infested seas. They soon learn the throne room is located on The Turn, a galleon commanded by Admiral Stoma. After navigating through a naval battle and boarding The Turn, the party meets fellow crawler Phinea, and recovers a medallion from the body of Harry the Goblin, providing access to Admiral Stoma's quarters.
- The party encounters a colossal sea turtle with an island on its back and a crew of Pirates trapped there. Assistance and careful negotiation can induce their captain to join the crawlers' crew. Shortly thereafter, the party visits the seedy Leviathan Tavern, where they get caught up in a brawl and meet Kristoph, a crawler who abandoned his party. He, too, can be convinced to rejoin the fight at the crawlers' side. Later, the party encounters an eternal battle of ghostly Pirates. Resolving their conflict leads to a spectral crew member coming aboard the crawlers' ship.
- The many islands and ships of the Screaming Sea present opportunities for wealth and adventure. The crawlers encounter Pirates with treasure maps for sale, Pirate hunters with grudges to pursue, and all kinds of gambling and lechery in which to indulge.

MOBS

The Screaming Sea is wild and free, and Mobs here reflect that liberty. The only common theme among the Pirates on these waters is fierce self-determination.

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The dangerous creatures of the Neighborhood likewise act with an almost chaotic drive to assert their dominance and autonomy.

BUBBLE BELUGA

Bubble Belugas traverse the Screaming Sea in pods, seeking out and destroying ships for entertainment. At a distance, they're easily mistaken for dolphins. But each can generate and fire dense spheres of pressurized air—elemental projectiles that can breach hulls and tear off limbs. The Bubble Belugas work together to bring down big targets, and they delight in slamming into vessels, knocking unfortunate crew into the water before using them as stress toys.

AI Bubble Beluga. Level 46.

One of the hallmarks of a truly evolved species is cruelty. We see that all over the galaxy. You might not like it, but trust me, I've got a much better view of things than you do.

By that measure, Bubble Belugas are one of the most evolved species you're likely to meet! They're not going to eat you; actually, I'm pretty sure these guys are pescatarian, and none of you look like fish. They're hunting you for sport! I hope that makes you feel better when they use you like a volleyball until you're reduced to a fine red paste.

Bubble Beluga

Mob; Medium (4), Whale

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
46	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
31 (+5)	38 (+5)	29 (+5)	35 (+5)	10 (+4)

Air Bubble: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Force, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Headbutt: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Piercing, 5ft range
The Bubble Beluga must be able to move 20ft in a straight line toward the target to make this attack. Any hit crawler is pushed 10 feet. If the target is a ship, all aboard must make an Unopposed Balance Skill Check or slide 5 feet toward the closest water space.

CANNONBACK TORTOISE

Over four feet long and weighing nearly nine hundred pounds when fully grown, Cannonback Tortoises are slow-moving but incredibly violent, their shells studded with fully functional cannon barrels pointing in all directions. Their eggs are indistinguishable from cannonballs, growing to full size in a matter of minutes. After maturation, their rampage begins. Many a ship was sunk after loading these false munitions into their hold and setting sail.

AI Cannonback Tortoise. Level 55.

You've jumped on a million of these dudes in that one plumber game, haven't you? Just hopped right up on their shells, broke their backs, and wandered away without a second thought about the families they left behind. I bet that lizard they work for ain't offering any kind of medical, either. Too bad you forgot your little red hat and blue overalls, eh? The age of the tortoise has come, and it's revenge time, baby! BOOM!

Cannonback Tortoise

Mob; Large (5), Reptilian

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
55	14+F	16+F	10+S	7
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
27 (+5)	12 (+4)	61 (+6)	65 (+6)	5 (+2)

Grapeshot: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Piercing, 30ft Cone

Cannonball: 16+F to hit, 5d8 Bludgeoning, 50ft range
Any hit crawler is pushed 5 feet for each HB slot lost.

Self-Destruct: 15+F to hit, 4d12 Bludgeoning, 10ft Burst radius
If the Cannonback Tortoise is reduced to 20% HB or less, it blows itself up and dies.

PAIN AMPLIFIER JELLYFISH

Pain Amplifier Jellyfish seek prey throughout the Screaming Sea, drifting on the tides in blooms until they find a suitable target. Once they make contact, the Jellyfish discharge a bioelectric shock and a cocktail of toxins to paralyze their mark and disrupt healing abilities and negate potions. The pain caused by this attack is severe, like pulling out one's eyeball with a pencil, overwhelming the victim's ability to fight back effectively.

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AI Pain Amplifier Jellyfish. Level 51.

There's always that one genius at the beach who's just waiting for someone to get stung by a jellyfish so he can run over and pee on them. Not that I'm judging—I've got my thing too, but... seriously, man... kids watch this program. Anyway, I'm just gonna get this out of the way now: get stung by one of these jellies, and yeah, you'll piss yourself, alright, but it definitely won't help you.

Pain Amplifier Jellyfish

Mob; Petite (3), Cnidaria

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
51	13+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
51 (+6)	6 (+3)	35 (+5)	58 (+6)	2 (+1)

Tentacles: 16+F to hit, 5d6+6 Piercing, 30ft Cone
Any hit crawler gains The Taint Debuff. On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Shocked Debuff.

PIRATE

Pirates of the Screaming Sea are battle-hardened sailors from virtually every sapient Race in the dungeon, drunk on an equal mix of lust for capers and cheap ale. Armed with the classic pistol and cutlass, they set out in search of treasure and glory, though a watery grave is often all they find.

Despite a rather grim life expectancy, Pirates are boisterous and energetic on the whole and tend to look on the bright side of life whenever possible. Some Pirates connect so strongly to the joys of seafaring that upon their deaths, they shed their mortal shells and become ghosts, haunting wrecks and islands just to continue their adventure.

AI Pirate. Level 52.

Some kids never grow up, I guess. Across most species in the galaxy, you'd be hard-pressed to find one who, at some age, didn't want to be a Pirate. The thing is, real-life responsibilities catch up. Or they don't, and you end up perma-drunk and crying as your leg gets torn off and eaten by a swarm of angry Jellyfish. Maybe that's why they call it the Screaming Sea?

Pirate

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
52	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
39 (+5)	26 (+5)	29 (+5)	38 (+5)	29 (+5)

Cutlass: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range
Pistol: 15+F to hit, 4d8 Piercing, 40ft range
Liquor Flamethrower: 15+F to hit 4d6+5 Fire, 15ft Cone
The Pirate takes a swig of grog, lights a match, and blows flame. Any hit crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Notes: *Ghostly*—If the Pirate is Ghost, it can only be harmed by enchanted weapons and Spells, and all its attacks are considered magical for the purposes of overcoming Resistances and Immunities.

SHIP

Ships transit island-to-island and along trade routes, bearing large complements of guns, cargo, and, of course, Pirates. Each ship is unique, bearing a flag and theme reflecting its crew, as well as battle scars that tell its story. While sailing, ships engage in combat as though they were a singular entity, with everyone aboard pulling together to fight as a unit with the vessel as their champion.

AI Ship. Level 55.

You spotted a ship on the ocean. Whoop-dee-doo. That's about as easy as spotting a dumbass in a dungeon, except people keep building more ships while crawler numbers dwindle every second. I'm sure you can trust their flag of truce, too. What kind of Pirate would run a false flag?

Ship

Vehicle; Colossal (7), Ship

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
55	11+F	16+F	20	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
50 (+6)	1 (+1)	70 (+6)	73 (+6)	1 (+1)

Roundshot: 16+F to hit, 4d12 Bludgeoning, 100ft range

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Boarding: 16+F to hit, No damage, 10ft range
On Success, Pirates use ropes and grapples to board the target vessel.

Ramming: 16+F to hit, 4d10+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
The ship strikes another target ship, which gains the Held Debuff until forcibly separated.

Notes: *Object Immunities*—Ships are objects. They are Immune to Psychic damage along with all Debuffs that have biological effects. Ships must spend 10ft Move to turn 30°.

ENVIRONMENT

The Screaming Sea is crystal-clear, stretching from one side of this bubble's sea quadrant to the other. This beautiful equatorial expanse is scattered with tropical islands and isolated coves, inviting crawlers to dig for buried treasure.

Pirates fill the space between these sandy beaches, plying their plundering trade whenever a suitable target approaches. The entire Neighborhood was designed with storybook swashbucklers in mind, leaving historical accuracy aside in favor of eye patches and peg legs. Anywhere there are Pirates in the Screaming Sea, there's drinking and partying. Grog flows freely amid the sound of gunfire and the smell of black powder, inescapable except on the open ocean.

Shallow waters reveal a graveyard of wrecked ships, and keen eyes might see ghostly buccaneers still roaming their decks. The sun above burns hot, but the water below is icy, and the same wind that barely makes the former bearable makes the latter bitterly cold. Beneath the surface, deadly predators lurk, waiting for a splash to signal prey in the water.

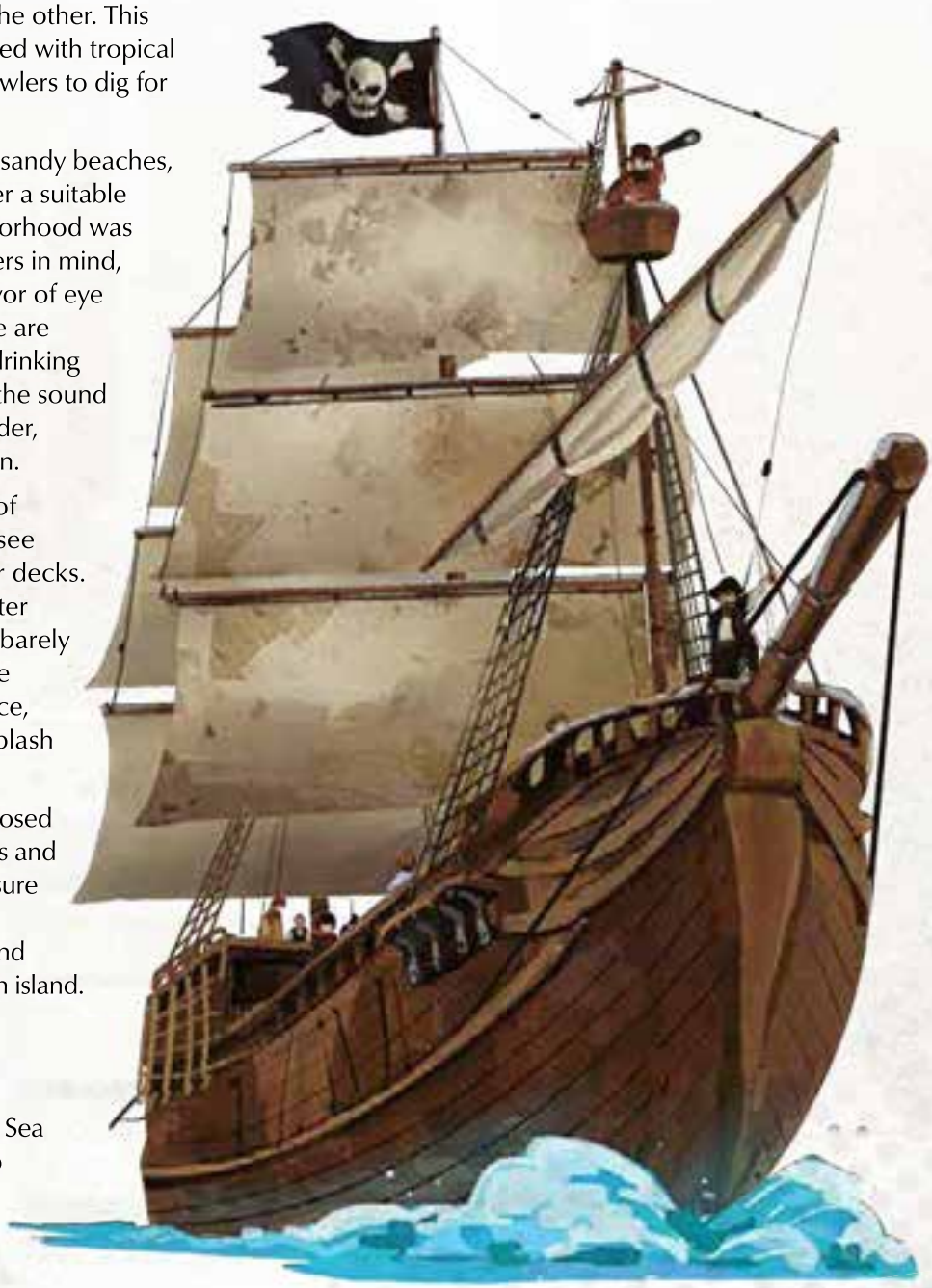
The saltwater itself corrodes any exposed metal, rusting it over in a matter of days and dulling sharp edges. Crawlers must ensure they have access to enough food and water while aboard, since saferooms and vendors can only be found when on an island.

SHIP BATTLES

Almost all travel through the Screaming Sea occurs by ship, exposing the crawlers to potential attacks by Pirates. A battle on water is handled similarly to any other combat, except that the crew works together to operate their vessel, all acting together on the ship's initiative.

The various duties aboard a sailing vessel are distributed among the party and any NPC crew members as the crawlers see fit. In any Ship Battle, the following positions can be filled, with the effect listed:

- **Captain:** The heart of the ship. The ship's Health Bar is equal to that of the Captain's permanent Health Bar, and the Captain rolls for the ship's initiative.
- **Helmsman:** Responsible for steering the ship. Ship movement speed is equal to the Helmsman's Speed.



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- **Master Gunner:** Responsible for operating and commanding the ship's cannons. Cannons have a range of 200ft, use the Master Gunner's Aiming Skill, and deal 4d12 damage unless modified. For each crew member assigned to the gun team, the Master Gunner may fire one cannon.
- **Master at Arms:** Responsible for maintaining shipboard weapons and training the crew to use them. The Master at Arms can give orders to any NPC crew member assigned to them during defensive boarding actions or when assaulting another ship.
- **Boatswain:** Responsible for ensuring the hull and rigging are shipshape. The Boatswain can bolster the efforts of other positions, providing a +1 bonus to each crewman's ship-running Skill Checks.
- **Carpenter:** Responsible for the daily upkeep and general repair of the vessel. The Carpenter can use their Repair Skill to patch damage to the ship during combat, making one roll for every crew member assigned to the repair team.

Only positions with an active crew member allow access to the listed effect. The Master Gunner, Master at Arms, and Carpenter positions accept members of the crew onto their teams, increasing the benefit of their position. A crew member can only be assigned to one position or team at a time.

If a ship is destroyed, every character on board must make an Unopposed Balance Skill Check to avoid getting tossed about, taking 2d6 damage for every level of failure (Near Miss 2d6; Standard 4d6; etc.). The vessel begins to sink, disappearing beneath the waves in 1d4 rounds.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in the Screaming Sea.

- **A Pirate's Life for Me:** "You set sail on your very own Pirate ship! Did you remember your vitamin C tablets?
  Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box."
  Contents: An enchanted eyepatch, an enchanted spyglass, and a single unenchanted lime.
- **Crewed Up:** "You recruited your first crew member. Hope you don't lead them to a gruesome death!
  Reward: You've received a Gold Minions Box."
  Contents: Pirate Articles—a mercenary coupon worth 25,000 gold.
- **Enemies to Lovers:** "You brought two old "friends" back together from beyond their watery graves, releasing their crews from eternal battle. The fanfic crowd is gonna eat this up.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Booty Box."
  Contents: A mysteriously moist book of poems written from one Pirate captain to another, and a treasure map leading to an island where a Crystal Heart pendant is buried (necklace accessory), which adds a +2 Con Mod to the 100% HB slot of the wearer.
- **Ker BLAM!:** "You survived a face-off with a Cannonback Tortoise. Thanks for not jumping on this one. It's a real pain to clean viscera off the deck.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Weapon Box."
  Contents: A Dragon's Breath Pistol. Same as a Handgun, except it deals d6s of damage, has a 40ft range, and any hit creature gains the Burned Debuff.
- **Drink and the Devil:** You outdrank a Pirate in a drinking contest. This is less of an achievement and more an intervention. You doing okay, bud?
  Reward: You've received a Gold Imbibers Box.
  Contents: A bucket and a jar of Cheat Code Capsules (3 pills; taking a pill removes a single Debuff.)

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers have bludgeoned some Belugas and punctured some Pirates, they might want to grind for experience. Table 102 contains some complications you might use while the PCs grind for experience.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: WRECKWATER BEACH

Wreckwater is a sandy beach littered with shipwreck debris. Former Pirates made themselves a home here after being marooned, lounging in coconut-husk hammocks under makeshift cabanas. A Weak pod of Bubble Belugas swims the waters of the cove, waiting to sink any ship coming in or out of the inlet. If this is the crawlers' first quadrant of the Fifth Floor, they awaken on the sandy beach. If they arrive from another quadrant, whatever environment they came from slowly blends into sandy shores and the smell of brine.

Music drifts through the air as a group of Grulke, Crocodilian, and Monk Seal Pirates party in a cabana

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TABLE 102: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A Scat Thug Pirate crew has tamed a pod of Bubble Belugas and now rides them into battle. They cut through the water, Pirates firing grappling hooks and leaping aboard, screaming "blub for the blub god" while the Belugas ram the ship from below.
2	The crawlers encounter a Pirate who claims to have a treasure map to an item of great power. He's too old to brave the Pain Amplifier Jellyfish that guard the approach and the Cannonback Tortoises patrolling the isle, but he's willing to sell the map for 3,000 gold.
3	A bloom of Pain Amplifier Jellyfish swarms the crawler's ship, tentacles sticking to the hull, and they begin to climb aboard.
4	The party comes across a whirlpool, around which a sea battle takes place. The crawlers' ship gets caught in the vortex along with the Pirate ships, who attack once they notice the newcomers.
5	A flamboyant Pirate hunter commodore leads a small fleet of ships in an attack against the crawlers, unwilling to believe they aren't buccaneers.
6	Cannonballs on the crawlers' ship begin to hatch. Soon the deck swarms with Cannonback Tortoises.

on the shore. These castaways invite the crawlers to join them, offering roasted meat and fruity tropical drinks. They only know of one way back to sea: a damaged but seaworthy ship, run aground on rocks further up the beach.

The former Pirates warn the crawlers against sailing out of the cove. A pod of Bubble Belugas sinks any vessel venturing into these waters, thus trapping everyone here. Crawlers can discover the ship, patch the hull with scavenged wreckage, restore the rigging, and relaunch the vessel.

Before the crawlers can exit the cove, the Bubble Beluga pod races toward them. They jet underneath the ship, rocking back and forth. These creatures are single-minded and relentless, working together to slam the vessel and send crawlers overboard, flood the deck with waves of sea spray, and shoot rapid bubbles of pressurized air, shattering the hull.

Once on open waters, the crawlers discover a jungle island. A Pirate ship sits impossibly in the treetops above gently upward-sloping ground. As they approach, the "island" slowly turns toward them, revealing itself as a colossal sea turtle.

The ancient creature complains to the crawlers about something beneath its shell itching for weeks and asks for help. A scaled section of the shell lifts to reveal a small colony of Pirates whose ship was caught and lifted out of the water when the turtle surfaced several weeks ago. They were attempting to escape from the Admiral and could provide directions to her galleon, The Turn.

If the crawlers convince the Pirates to leave, Bully the Pocket Kuma Captain offers to join the crawlers' crew. The party can also help repair the Pirates' ship and convince the turtle to resubmerge, thereby floating the Pirate vessel.

QUARTER: LEVIATHAN TAVERN

Built into the ribcage of a dead sea monster, Leviathan Tavern is one of the few neutral places on the Screaming Sea. Here, Pirates flying any flag are welcome, provided they adhere to a single rule: no killing. The interior is rowdy, shouting and laughter overpower a band in the corner who compensate for a lack of talent with wild enthusiasm.

An ale-stained wooden bar worn smooth by time snakes around the back of Leviathan Tavern. Inebriated Pirates fill most of the stools at the bar, but a Grulke crawler named Kristoph sits alone, surrounded by nothing but empty bottles and the tankard he's nursing. Formerly part of a crawler party with an Elf named Phinea, Harry the Goblin, and a Human named Charlie, he's now alone, his only company the player-killer skull hovering over his head.

In the Iron Tangle, Charlie was struck by a mind-control Spell and attacked the rest of his party. Kristoph was forced to kill him. He confesses that the rest of his party left to try to find the throne room, but he's given up on the Crawl. With a bit of encouraging conversation, he can be convinced to join the crawlers' crew.

A glass bottle shatters against a wall, followed by shouting and overturned tables. A pair of Crocodilian

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- Your course takes you directly toward a sinking ship. Survivors on the doomed vessel wave frantically from the mast.
  Outcome: Sail on and leave the survivors behind or bring them on board. One of them is a saboteur.
- A jungle island comes into view. Two tall palm trees on the beach cross at an odd angle, making an X impossible to miss.
  Outcome: Go treasure-hunting on the island or continue sailing.
- A Pirate bumps into you, spilling her drink. She draws her pistol, challenging you to a duel for the insult.
  Outcome: Accept her challenge and fight to the death, refuse and be branded a coward by every Pirate you meet on the Screaming Seas, or find a way to de-escalate.

Pirates smash their chairs into pieces, using the legs as clubs, while a table of Rat-Kin buccaneers pull brass knuckles and leap into a growing bar brawl.

Overhead, a lantern is knocked loose, smashing and sending flames across the liquor-strewn floor. In moments, every Pirate in the Leviathan is pulled into the melee. Any who aren't currently engaged attack the crawlers. Perceptive crawlers notice that none of the Pirates use immediately lethal weapons, and once someone is knocked out, they're left where they fell without further harm.

A rough group of Pirates waves the crawlers over once the brawl dies down, offering access to "the bilge," an invitation-only space beneath the Leviathan Tavern. Below, the room is packed with barrels of ale, tables, and corsairs gathered around raucous entertainments. Darts are thrown into a well-used board, tankards emptied one by one in drinking matches, arm-wrestlers vie at many of the tables, and a bare-knuckle fight ring marked out in the center awaits combatants. Crawlers are encouraged to join in with coins, drinks, and shouted bets flowing freely.

QUARTER: MARITIME MAUSOLEUM

The sea of this quarter is clear as glass, and patches of blue light beneath the surface illuminate a graveyard of broken hulls. A continental shelf only a hundred feet below sea level, the area is a debris field of sunken ships and spires of coral-encrusted rock rising from the water.

The ship halts as the keel catches on the entwined masts of two sunken vessels just below. The spars wedged the crawlers' ship and can't be removed from above. The party must dive beneath the surface, descend to the wrecks below, and find a way to cut down or remove the masts to free their craft. The current near the downed ships is strong, carrying away anything not firmly moored and making it difficult to stay in place without effort. If the crawlers cut one of the masts, they both topple, stirring sand and debris and restricting visibility to five feet.

As the crawlers attempt to return to the surface after a dive, the cause of the blue glow in the water is revealed. A bloom of Pain Amplifier Jellyfish spreads in a layer between the sea floor and the air above, blocking access back to the party's ship and safety. Jellyfish tendrils reach down through the brine seeking victims, and the bloom flows as one to maintain their blockade.

Two ships, both disabled in a ramming action, list toward each other. Their rigging is tangled together, and both have planks laid over their rails to bridge the gaps. Ghostly Pirates drift across both vessels, locked in never-ending combat. Once the ghosts notice the crawlers, a spectral boarding party floats over their ship and attacks. Each time a phantom Pirate is defeated, it turns into a mist flowing back to the embattled wrecks, reforms, and rejoins the assault on the crawler's vessel.

After a few ghosts are defeated, one arrives bearing no weapons, telling the crawlers she's tired of the fight and wants to rest. Particularly persuasive crawlers can convince her to join their crew. Ending the conflict and banishing the specters requires either defeating both Pirate captains or forcing the two bitter enemies into a truce.

QUARTER: THE TURN

Pirate ships fill this stretch of sea, engaged in combat both with each other and the Admiral's galleon at the center of the battle. Cannonballs fly, splintering hulls and sending vessels into the deep while buccaneers swing onto enemy decks. The Turn itself is a monstrosity, easily ten times the size of the largest ship here. The Admiral's throne room is found in her quarters at the back of the ship.

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The only way to reach the Admiral's ship is through the gathered armada of Pirate vessels. While the primary target of their attacks is the enormous galleon, any Pirate sloop in range of the party's vessel redirects their cannons and boarding parties to engage them in naval combat.

Meanwhile, the Admiral's vessel takes shots of its own; hundreds of cannons keep up a steady stream of fire against any ship within range. As the crawlers sail closer, a bank of cannons targets their vessel, firing Cannonback Tortoise eggs into their hull and onto their deck.

Boarding the Admiral's ship means scaling the slick hull and vaulting the railing. Once aboard, the crawlers discover Phinea, an Elf crawler, chained to the deck and scrubbing blood from the planks. When she spots the party, she calls out for help. She and her partner, a Goblin crawler named Harry, found the medallion that opens the Admiral's quarters but were caught before they could use it. Harry swallowed the medallion before he was hauled off to the brig while Phinea was put to work.

The brig below the main deck is narrow and filthy. Iron-barred doors lock cells built into the hull, and small portholes become occluded by sea spray as the ship rocks. Many of the cells contain bodies, some mere skeletons. Harry is in one such cell, dead and slumped against the wall. The medallion is inside his stomach and needs to be retrieved. Outside the cells, a Pirate jailer patrols. When he notices the crawlers, he asks which one of them is the prisoner and begins to unlock an unoccupied cell. Once the medallion is recovered, the crawlers make their way to the throne room in the Admiral's Quarters. (See the "B-B-B-Boss Battle" section later in this chapter).

NPCs

NPCs in the Screaming Sea are sailors and Pirates from every Race in the dungeon, all sharing a free spirit and love of the open water. Crawlers may encounter the following character or any other crawlers in the Neighborhood.

BULLY

Slow to trust but loyal to a fault, Bully took command of her vessel after the previous captain died at Admiral's hand. Bully is an excellent sailor, though she prefers working rigging to larceny and slaughter. She holds a grudge against the Admiral and would happily assist anyone she believes might take her down.

> **AI** **Bully. Pocket Kuma. Level 41.**
>
> Wow, cool find! There aren't many of these fuzzy little dudes left. They were originally pets for some snooty High Elves. When those pointy-eared bastards found out the Pocket Kumas were smarter than themselves, it went just about how you'd expect. One genocide later, and we've got Bully here, cutlass in hand, unwilling to see more friends killed by authority. Try not to die in front of her. We don't have great therapists down here, and her PTSD is already off the charts.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The Admiral's quarters occupy the stern deck of the galleon. A hardwood door bars entry, bearing an eight-pointed indentation for the medallion. As the crawlers open the door, a storm begins, plunging the ship into semi-darkness. Rain lashes the vessel, and wind threatens to yank crawlers from the deck and into the water below. Inside, the stately room is well-organized, with maps pinned to the walls and navigation equipment resting neatly on a desk set beside expansive windows at the back. A faint tapping of wood scuttles from port to starboard.

The instant a crawler sets foot in the cabin, a sea shanty begins to rise, over which a gruff and mocking voice announces the Boss Battle. The crawlers' portraits bob from the floor, rocking back and forth as if in liquid. Opposite them, the Admiral's portrait forms, appearing as nothing but an impressive tricorner hat before all the portraits turn into bubbles and drift through the ceiling.

Admiral Stoma leaps onto the desk and launches herself at the closest crawler, beginning combat. She lashes out with her smasher limb (dactyl), battering opponents and blowing them back. The Admiral tries to move the fight onto the deck where she can force the crawlers over the rails and into the sea. Any crawlers who fall into the water must clamber back aboard while under fire from nearby ships. Barrels of gunpowder litter the deck, igniting at the touch of any flame.

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CLUES

- Admiral Stoma isn't the only one who can knock enemies over the edge of the railing.
- Stoma's grappler could be anchored to the mast, denying her that attack until it's freed.
- The cannon firing at the ship could hit Stoma if the crawlers maneuver her toward the fusillade.

AI Admiral Stoma. Mantis Shrimp Commander.

Level 61 Neighborhood Boss!

The word "shrimp" is generally an insult, describing the small and the weak. That's because you look at shrimp the way I look at all of you: easy to crush and best when lightly poached in butter. That makes what's about to happen all the more delicious.

Admiral Stoma is a Mantis Shrimp. If you don't know what that is, you're about to get a first-class education in how evolution eventually equips the small to fight back.

The good admiral knows precisely how you treated her kind, and she's hellbent on revenge. Worse than that, she made herself into the most feared Pirate on the Screaming Sea by brutally murdering anyone stupid enough to be her enemy. The next dumdums on that list just broke into her quarters. It's you. You're the dumdums. I wonder what pasta she'll serve you with?

Admiral Stoma

Neighborhood Boss; Tiny (1), Insectoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
6%	13%	20%	26%	33%	40%	46%	53%
5	5	5	5	5	5	5	
60%	66%	73%	80%	86%	93%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
61	15+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
76 (+6)	41 (+5)	23 (+5)	53 (+6)	15 (+4)

Dactyl Smash: 16+F to hit, 6d8+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
If a crawler loses 4+ HB slots this way, they are thrown overboard (through a window if need be).

Grappling Gun: 15+F to hit, 7d4 Piercing, 50ft range
Any hit crawler is pulled 15 feet toward Stoma.

Boil the Air: 15+F to hit, 4d6 Fire, 20ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Scalded Debuff: Take 1d8+F at the end of each round for the next 2 rounds.

Notes: *Overboard*—Crawlers thrown overboard must make an Unopposed Swimming Skill Check or gain the Drowning Debuff. Make an Unopposed Climbing Skill Check to get back up. If a rope ladder is lowered, roll with Advantage.

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NEIGHBORHOOD: SHAFT OF DESPAIR (SUBTERRANEAN QUADRANT)

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: REALLY, REALLY DARK AND DEPRESSING

The Shaft of Despair is a huge empty cylinder of space surrounded by solid stone. The shaft has four levels: At the top lies the village of Nude Glabers and their corpse gardens. Crawlers wandering without a light source or the ability to see in the dark may tumble into one of the many waste holes in the area and plummet to the second level.

The Arachnids living in Spider City on the third level down got tired of having Nude Glaber waste falling on their intricately constructed web environment, so their Arcanists crafted the magical Warding Weave to block the ongoing rain of shit. The refuse collecting on the shield created the Pudding Pits of the second level and gave rise to the disgusting-but-oddly-tasty Pudding Pals.

Below the webs lies a place the Arachnids avoid: A supposedly bottomless well of pure darkness called Noxavel. Inhabited by Things Too Horrible to Name, it's the prison of a dreaded unknown cosmic godling whose cries of rage echo throughout the entire quadrant.

Getting from level to level in the Shaft of Despair usually involves falling or climbing. It's a long climb, but the outer walls of the Shaft are rough enough for purchase. A few small passages wend their way through the rock from the Nude Glaber level to the Pudding Pits and even down to Spider City. There, a magical gate allows passage through the Warding Weave if the crawlers discover the secret to using it. There are no passages, gateways, or other alternate means to and from Noxavel.

Potential Castle: The Donjon of Dolor

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- The crawlers arrive in the center of the Nude Glaber village during a festive amputation celebration. As the Nude Glabers stare at the interlopers, the guillotine blade falls, and a foot joins a large pile of fresh body parts.
- The crawlers find themselves drowning in a deep pool of pudding! After swimming to the surface, they're greeted by several enthusiastic Pudding Pals. This start has the advantage that the crawlers don't learn what the pudding is made of until after they've been in it for a while...
- If the AI is particularly annoyed with the crawlers, it has no compunction about putting them immediately into Noxavel.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- The crawlers enter the quadrant directly into a Nude Glaber village. While exploring the area around the village, they encounter Ceqob, an Arachnid Grappler NPC. Assuming the crawlers don't kill him, he invites them to visit Spider City and shows them the passage he uses to travel between the two places.
- After the locals notice the party in Spider City, a squad of Arachnid Grapplers and Arachnid Arcanists invite them (with the use of force, if necessary) to meet with Queen Joro. She tells them the story of how she recently became queen when her sister Szykalli vanished, along with her symbol of office, the Scepter of Domination. The Queen's Arcanists tracked the magical energies of the Scepter of Domination and believe it somewhere in Noxavel. Would the crawlers please go get it for her?
- On their way out, an Arachnid Arcanist pulls them aside and explains further: If the Scepter of Domination is not found, the Warding Weave fails, and the whole city perishes in pudding. They have not told the Queen yet.
- While exploring Noxavel, the crawlers do not find the Scepter, but they find Szykalli strung up in a webbed cocoon! She knows where the Scepter is, but it stays hidden as long as Joro is alive. If the crawlers free her and help her kill Joro, she lets them have the Scepter.

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- The Scepter of Dominion can instantly destroy the Warding Weave, and all the pudding falling on the Donjon of Dolor will surely kill Kensington, the Feral Boss that resides there. It also kills every Arachnid in Spider City and every Pudding Pal in the Pudding Pits, but maybe that's a price the crawlers are willing to pay.

MOBS

The Shaft of Despair is divided into four distinct levels. The Arachnids have been known to journey up to hunt Nude Glabers, and Nude Glabers and Flesh Farragoes sometimes fall to the Pudding Pits, but other than that, the Mobs stay in their respective areas.

NUDE GLABER

Nude Glabers are humanoids that resemble naked mole rats. Their bodies are short and frail and covered in wrinkled pink skin. Their eyes are white and bulbous, like onions, and their mouths contain rotting yellow teeth. They turn body parts into food, so they drive off any Glimmermotes in their area, and they act as their own Janitor Mobs.

AI **Nude Glaber. Level 36.**

If you detect a whiff of fecal scent in the air, hear snuffling, whining vocalizations around you, or spy short pale forms darting here and there in the darkness, you're about to confront a group of Nude Glabers... or the Ruling Council of the Null. It's hard to tell the difference, but if you can see their ugly genitals, it's the Nude Glabers.

Go ahead and stare if you want. Though they're surprisingly intelligent, they have no sense of modesty or basic hygiene. Speaking of their genitals, theirs regenerate in minutes if removed or destroyed. Not that you're sick enough to try that, right?

Nude Glaber

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
36	16+F	14+F	20+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
8 (+3)	57 (+6)	32 (+5)	15 (+4)	1 (+1)

Claw: 13+F to hit, 5d6+3 Slashing, 5ft range

Gagging Gaze: 16+F to hit, 4d6+6 Force, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the You Stanky! Debuff: Disadvantage on all Charisma Skill Checks until you take a long rest and wash up.

Notes: *Re-Mole-deling*—Heals 1 HB slot at the end of each round, and regrows a limb if it takes no damage during a round of combat.

FLESH FARRAGO

A huge, reanimated pile of random Nude Glaber body parts, it smells even worse than normal Nude Glabers. It's harder to "kill," too, since it's technically already dead.

AI **Flesh Farrago. Level 45.**

Even larger than the Shambling Berserkers from earlier floors, they're made from smaller and grosser body parts. They're slower than their cousins, but they're harder to put down. It turns out that Nude Glaber body parts still regenerate even when they're combined into undead monstrosities.

In this environment, Flesh Farragoes tend to stupidly shuffle into holes, dropping them into the Pudding Pits, so the Nude Glabers fence them into Farrago farms. Yes, farms. These things are a food source for Nude Glabers. And they're mostly made of Nude Glaber genitals. I'm gonna let you sit with that thought while you get mauled.

Flesh Farrago

Mob; Large (5), Undead

7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
45	12+F	14+F	20+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	3 (+2)	101 (+7)	10 (+4)	1 (+1)

Mushroom Stamp: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Spores: 12+F to hit, 3d8+2 Poison, 15ft Burst radius
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Woozy Debuff.

Notes: *Fast-Growing*—Heals 1 HB slot at the end of each round.

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GLIMMERMOTE SWARM

Glimmermote Swarms are the Janitor Mobs of this Quadrant, except for the top level where the Nude Glabers live. The Nude Glabers use corpse remains, so they chase off Glimmermote Swarms whenever they appear. If somehow captured before fading away, Glimmermotes are used in several rare and powerful crafting recipes involving life and cosmic light.

AI **Glimmermote Swarm. Level 34.**

Glimmermotes are minuscule creatures made of pure cosmic light. They appear in the Shaft of Despair whenever a creature dies, visible in the inky blackness as a faint cloud of sparkling gold. They delicately settle over the corpse and, after a few moments, both the Glimmermotes and the body fade into nothing.

It's a beautiful, bittersweet reminder in this place of pain and terror that we're all just faint sparks in a vast universe of darkness, and then suddenly there's nothing left to even show we were here.

Glimmermotes are the only things visible with unaided Human eyes in the depths of Noxavel, a metaphorical testament to the staggering power of ephemeral Life. Or maybe they're just the flaky cosmic smegma of the universe's foreskin. It's hard to say.

Glimmermote Swarm

Mob; Tiny (1), Celestial Janitor

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
34	15+F	14+F	20+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
1 (+1)	22 (+5)	10 (+4)	10 (+4)	64 (+6)

Fade Away: 15+F to hit, 4d6+6 Psychic, 5ft range
On an Evade Fail or worse, the crawler gains the rather-hard-to-remove Fading Debuff: A part of their body turns a little transparent, like it's slowly disappearing from existence. At the end of each day that the crawler has this Debuff, replace one of their External Buffs with a +1 Evade Buff (some attacks pass through). Once all three lines are filled, the crawler fades completely out of existence at the end of the following day. This Debuff can only be removed by a priest devoted to a deity of life... or the deity itself.

PUDDING PAL

Pudding Pals are semi-sentient humanoid globs of Nude Glaber trash and excrement.

AI **Pudding Pal. Level 41.**

When Nude Glaber filth falls to hit the arcane Warding Weave of the Arachnids, the magic of the barrier interacts with the Nude Glabers' regenerative properties in a weird way: It globs together in a humanoid form and becomes a semi-sentient homunculus: a Pudding Pal.

They come in a variety of delicious flavors, and each kind has its own particular effects on crawler bodies. Lemon Pudding Pals, for example, cause flesh to itch and burn. Banana Cream causes mild insanity, Chocolate violently irritates one's bowels, and Vanilla just makes you kind of uninteresting.

Pudding Pals are oddly endearing, and if they kill you, it's purely accidental due to their overexcitement at meeting a new friend.

(This description is sponsored by The Murglax Gloop & Slurry Co. "Eat Gloop! It's good for you!")

Pudding Pal

Mob; Medium (4), Ooze

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
41	14+F	15+F	20+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
33 (+5)	10 (+4)	33 (+5)	27 (+5)	25 (+5)

Pudding Punch: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains a Pudding Debuff (see below).

Pudding Blast: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Force, 25ft range, 5ft Blast radius
Any hit crawler gains a Pudding Debuff (see below).

Notes: *Pudding Debuff*—Each flavor of Pudding Pal gives a different Debuff. Feel free to make up more of your own.

Lemon Pudding—Take 1d10+5 Acid at the end of each round until the end of the combat.

Vanilla Pudding—Roll Charisma Skill Checks with Disadvantage for the rest of the day.

Chocolate Pudding—You poop yourself. Don't let any hit the ground!

Butterscotch Pudding—Cannot take Steps until the end of the combat.

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ARACHNID

Arachnids are Human from the waist up and spiders from the "waist" down. They tend to be sadistic, enjoying the suffering of other creatures. They come in two primary forms (or three, if you count the Queen): Arachnid Grapplers and Arachnid Arcanists.

Grapplers use sticky webs and venom to disable prey and enemies, and they're robust warriors. Arcanists are tough, too (by virtue of being giant fucking spider-people), but they sometimes leave an Arcane Gland as loot, an ingredient useful in many powerful potions. They might also drop a spell book.

AI Arachnid Grappler. Level 50.

These Arachnids are Human from the waist up, and spider from—oh, fuck it. They're goddamn spider-taurs. It's an easy descriptive shortcut, but way over-used: "-taur" is to monsters as "-gate" is to scandals and "-punk" is to science fiction subgenres.

It's so fashionably overused that it's completely lost its original meaning. It means "bull" in ancient Greek. What does "bull" have to do with a half-baked half-Human, half-spider monster concept? Goddamn nothing. That's what!

Anyway, rant over.

Arachnid Grapplers do what spiders do best: they immobilize prey. They make sticky webs and bear-hug you with their bulging Human arms. Hairy arms like your father's, and most of the damage you take is knowing you'll never be as manly as he was.

Arachnid Grappler

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	40+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
52 (+6)	25 (+5)	33 (+5)	30 (+5)	15 (+4)

Grappling: 16+F to hit, 4d8+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Web-Shooting: 15+F to hit, 5d6+6 Bludgeoning, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

AI Arachnid Arcanist. Level 50.

Arachnid Arcanists weave magic like other spiders weave webs. That's not metaphor; they literally spew raw magic from their butts and weave it into different Spells. Arcanists weaving together can create sorcery so powerful that no lone caster could ever hope to equal it. They created the Warding Weave, a shield that supports the weight of centuries of Nude Glaber excrement, and they did it while on the tail end of a week-long drug bender. That should tell you everything you need to know about their prowess.

Arachnid Arcanist

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	16+F	15+F	40+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	52 (+6)	33 (+5)	30 (+5)	20 (+5)

Butt Blast Spell: 16+F to hit, 5d6+6 Necrotic, 30ft range
Any hit crawler gains the But, Butt, Buu... Debuff: The crawler is marked until the end of combat. When hit by this Spell again, it becomes a different random attack Spell in every way (except range), dealing 5dX, and adding its Rank 10 Upgrade (if applicable).

"An endless abyss of pain and suffering? Ha. That's just another Saturday night at my house. Believe me, I'm doing you a favor by ending you now."

—Kensington, Feral Pear Tree

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THING TOO HORRIBLE TO NAME

A tortured demonic spirit with psychic powers and an appearance based on the creatures observing it. Reaching into all the minds around it, a Thing Too Horrible to Name grasps an image from the worst thing each mind ever experienced and combines them all into a single terrifying form.

AI **Thing Too Horrible to Name. Level 55.**

(Look, I get it. Capitalizing the words "Thing Too Horrible to Name" turns it into a name. You're just being a pedantic asshole by pointing it out.)

Psychic spirits from between dimensions, Things Too Horrible to Name do not have any physical form until they encounter the brains of other creatures, more specifically, the traumatized parts of brains. These spirits latch onto images and emotions from that tortured area and unconsciously craft their appearance around what they find. They randomly grab from every brain nearby and combine it all into a single wretched amalgamation of suffering and pain.

Throw together the crushed body of one crawler's childhood puppy who got hit by a car and the sneering face of another crawler's abusive uncle, for example. It reeks of the same mixture of perfume and formaldehyde pervading a third crawler's grandmother's funeral. It attacks with the same shotgun that killed a fourth crawler's father.

And every time it takes a step, you hear the exact same squelching sound that your friend's ribcage made on the Fourth Floor when that monster burst from her chest. Pretty cool, huh?

Thing Too Horrible to Name

Mob; Medium (4), Spirit

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
55	17+F	15+F	20+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
1 (+1)	110 (+7)	24 (+5)	30 (+5)	5 (+2)

Psychic Bolt Spell: 17+F to hit, 5d6+7, Psychic, 40ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Terrified Debuff, seeing the thing that most torments them.

ENVIRONMENT

It's dark—reeeally dark. The only light comes from the golden glow of the Warding Weave that covers the entire Shaft about halfway down. At the top, where the Nude Glabers live, the glow is faint, having to penetrate thick layers of pudding before reaching the top. It's noticeable, but not useful for seeing.

In the Pudding Pits, the light is much closer, but it still must push its way through the pudding before reaching any eyes. Unaided Human eyes can make out shadowy shapes lit from below, but not much more detail than that. Below, in Spider City, right under the Warding Weave, the light casts a gentle glow on the webs. The overall brightness is equivalent to dusk on Earth but with a distinctly golden hue.

Below the Spider City in Noxavel, all light is magically snuffed. It's pitch-black.

ITEMS

The crawlers might make use of random items they find in the Quadrant.

- **Glaber Guillotine:** In the center of the settlement sits a guillotine similar to the ones found on Earth. It's rusty and crusted in dried blood.
- **Giant Corpse:** Wrapped in webs is the corpse of a 50-foot-long giant, still with giant-sized gear.
- **Egg Cluster:** A massive bunch of Arachnid egg sacks webbed together and hanging from the ceiling.
- **Solid Pudding Chunk:** A boulder-sized hunk of solid chocolate floats in a big pond of liquid butterscotch.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood:

- **Pudenda Peeper:** "Hey, I saw that! Your gaze lingered just a bit too long on that Nude Glaber's crotch. I know it's been a long dungeon, but are you really that desperate?
  Reward: You've received a Silver Spicy Box."
  Contents: A Nude Glaber blowup doll and special lube from Dr. Numbwell's Intimate Emporium.
- **Gloop is Good for You:** "You ignored, failed, or otherwise fucked up an easy Quest involving Pudding Pals.
  Reward: You've received a Gold Food Box."

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Contents: A pudding upgrade for your personal space from Murglax Gloop & Slurry Co.

- **You Are Likely to be Eaten by a Grue:** "You have entered a pitch-black space without a torch or a match in your inventory. Wait, are you... Batman? *Reward:* You've received a Gold Adventurer Box." *Contents:* A lantern that holds a Glimmermote Swarm, casting golden light even in magical darkness.
- **Itsy-Bitsy Spiders:** "You destroyed the Warding Weave. The resulting pudding shower washed away the Arachnids of Spider City, and they won't be crawling up the spout again... or the Shaft... or anything. Because they're dead. *Reward:* You've received a Platinum Asshole's Box." *Contents:* An Extinction Sigil Tattoo (Arachnid Race).
- **Noxavel Rain of Pudding:** "You destroyed the Warding Weave, causing pudding (and dead Arachnids) to rain down on Noxavel. Not even a giant tree could survive that! And good thing there's not a portal to the Nothing in Noxavel somewhere. All that pudding leaking into the Nothing could get interesting (and sticky) down the road. *Reward:* You've received a Platinum Asshole's Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

This quadrant offers plenty of (if sometimes a bit gross) grinding options. Pudding Pals are the most plentiful choice, but Nude Glabers and Arachnids could be targets as well. Consult Table 103 for more options.

TABLE 103: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers encounter a group of Pudding Pals led by the ultra-rare Woodruff Pudding.
2	The village of Nude Glabers the crawlers are slaughtering decide they'd rather take their chances in the Pudding Pits, and they leap off an outcropping into the air. One of them does a beautiful swan dive.
3	A crawler who was grinding something other than a hand-held weapon has misplaced their weapon somewhere among the heaps of bodies. Only an Amazing Success with Tracking or Investigation finds it, each Check taking 1 hour.
4	An unknown crawler shows up and decides to help with the Mob-slaying. They're incredibly effective, killing most of the Mobs alone. The party doesn't get much from this grinding session, but they potentially have a strong new ally.
5	Queen Joro needs to speak with the crawlers about a matter they can help with, and she doesn't ask politely. A squad of highly skilled Arachnids shows up trying to web the party into submission and take them to Spider City.
6	While in Noxavel or the Pudding Pits, a random crawler is hit by a Mob that fell from the area above.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: NUDIST VILLAGES

On the top level of the Shaft of Despair, rocky platforms protrude from the walls, connected by narrow stone walkways. About half the total area of this slice of the cylinder is solid stone. The rest is empty air until you hit the Pudding Pits far below. Nudist villages consist of quaint huts made from dry-stacked stone arranged around a town center with a guillotine-like device. Outside the villages, fenced farms of Flesh Farragoes are common.

A Nude Glaber flies toward the crawlers with a terrified scream and smacks the ground among them with a crunch. An extra-huge, enraged Flesh Farrago tries to break free from its pen, throwing Nude Glabers through the air and using them as ranged weapons. If the crawlers defeat or recapture the Flesh Farrago, any Nude Glaber farmers remaining invite the crawlers to dine with them tonight on the very Flesh Farrago they just faced.

The crawlers enter a Nude Glaber village in search of something in particular: a shop, an NPC, a Quest item, or maybe simply just information. The chieftain, named Grodan, wants to know why the crawlers wear clothing. He insists that they honor Nude Glaber customs and fully disrobe before getting any assistance from the village.

Ceqob, an Arachnid hunter, springs from the underside of a ledge and webs up a Nude Glaber before the crawlers can react. If the crawlers are friendly toward

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- A howl of pure anguish reverberates throughout the entire Quadrant, sending a shiver down your spine. Even the NPCs and Mobs are unsettled by it. **Outcome:** Make a CHA Stat Check. On Fail, the crawler gains the Terrified Debuff.
- Walking along ground that seems solid, you suddenly plunge into a deep pool of unsolidified pudding. **Outcome:** One random crawler gets the Drowning Debuff until they are freed from the pudding.
- Your light flickers, making shadows jump all around you. Then it goes out. You're in darkness. **Outcome:** The crawlers must light another light or wander in the dark.

him, he tells them about some tunnels at the edge of the Shaft leading to other levels and invites them to Spider City. If the crawlers are hostile, they discover the tunnels only when Ceqob flees into them.

QUARTER: THE PUDDING PITS

A vast plain of gooey pudding formed atop the Arachnids' Warding Weave as the Nude Glabers dumped their waste—though this is not necessarily obvious to the crawlers. Some parts of the pudding surface are more solid than others, and it's difficult to tell the difference visually. But even the more solid parts are still quite spongy, which is good because the most common way to get here is to fall from above.

A dozen Pudding Pals of various flavors arise from the ground. Shrieking with excitement, the Pudding Pals try to hug the party to death. The crawlers are surrounded, so the only way out is through.

Crawler Gautier Rich is in his element. He filled up every container he could with pudding, but he still wants to collect more—at least one sample of every flavor. If the party can give him containers, he trades them for magical candies he created. The candy has the same effects as potions but comes in a more delicious form. Using the pudding as an ingredient for his special form of alchemy, he creates some exceptionally powerful potions back at his Alchemy Table.

In the distance, a bright golden building rises from the pudding. It is crafted from the same magical energy as the Warding Weave itself. Inside, the party finds nothing at first, but then they notice four consoles with buttons and dials attached to the *ceiling*.

The controls of all four consoles must be properly configured at the same time to reveal the nature of the building: a trivial matter for an eight-limbed creature that can walk on ceilings, but perhaps less so for crawlers. If successful, the crawlers are teleported to a similar chamber in Queen Joro's palace in Spider City.

QUARTER: UNDER THE WARDING WEAVE

Spider City is a vast network of chambers woven from Arachnid webs suspended in the Shaft far above the darkness of Noxavel. All web surfaces are sticky, and the Move distance of all non-Arachnids is halved while in the city unless they can fly or otherwise negate the material's adhesive properties. Everything is lit by the golden glow of the Warding Weave above the city.

A Weak group of Arachnid Arcanists ambushes the party and their contingent of Arachnid Grappler bodyguards. They do not intend to kill the crawlers. Instead, they want to capture them and bring them to Queen Joro for interrogation.

Queen Joro meets with the crawlers and gives them a Quest. She wants them to find the Scepter of Dominance, an important symbol of office that disappeared with her sister. The Arachnids never truly accept her as the queen unless she has the scepter. Joro is accustomed to obedience. She does not request help so much as demand it.

In a webbed tunnel far from the city center, the crawlers discover pudding drips through the webs from above. As a result, several Pudding Pals ambush them. But how is that possible? Is the Warding Weave failing? Some investigations indicate that it is...

QUARTER: NOXAVEL AND THE DONJON OF DOLOR

Noxavel is a realm of complete and utter darkness. Any lights, magical and non-magical alike, extinguish upon entering Noxavel. Any Class or Race abilities that allow sight while in darkness are ineffective here. The only illumination possible in Noxavel is that from celestial or cosmic sources, and even those are significantly dimmed. Crawlers' minimaps still function, so they know when other beings are nearby.

Aside from the Donjon, Noxavel is an endlessly flat floor. Outside NPCs have myths about this place but do not venture here. The anguished howling of the Despair Pair emanates from the Donjon of Dolor, resounding throughout the quadrant.

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When the crawlers enter Noxavel, Thing Too Horrible to Name set upon them.

A white dot appears on their minimaps. When they investigate, a cocooned Arachnid hangs by a thread leading to the Spider City far above. It's Szikalli, the estranged sister of Queen Joro. She was trapped here for a long time, but befriends the crawlers if they help her. She's not interested in reclaiming her throne, but you'd better believe she wants revenge on her sister.

The Donjon of Dolor is normally easy to find: it's the only tower on a flat floor. But with everything obscured in darkness, it's much more difficult. If crawlers manage to navigate their way there, they can confront Kensington and take control of the castle.

NPCS

The Nude Glaber villages and Spider City have no shortage of NPCs to meet and kill.

QUEEN JORO

She's the now-undisputed ruler of Spider City. Her spider portion is obviously a black widow, and her Human part has dark skin and long white hair.

AI **Queen Joro. Arachnid Monarch. Level 50 Elite.**

Arachnid society is matriarchal, so they're always ruled by a queen. Usually, it's the eldest daughter of the previous queen. Joro recently became queen when her elder sister, Szykalli, vanished without a trace.

Queen Joro observed all the proper mourning rituals and still wears the sacred Hair Net of Repression to this very day. So that proves there was no sororicide.

Riiiiiiiight.

CEQOB

An Arachnid Grappler who frequents the Nude Glaber farms, bringing Glabers back to Spider City for food.

AI **Ceqob, Arachnid Grappler. Level 50.**

He's remarkably friendly for a spider-person, unless you're something he wants to eat. You're about the right size and shape of his usual prey, so... hope you make friends easily or fight giant half-spider people with ease.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

As the party ascends the stairs of the Donjon of Dolor, a growing melancholy falls over them. By the time they reach the top, an almost unbearable weight of misery cloaks them. A 30-foot-tall tree-man stands on the top of the tower, his branches laden with white flowers and succulent pears. A top hat perches in his upper branches. The face on his trunk consists of a frowning mouth with a pouty lower lip and sad puppy-dog eyes, one of which sports a monocle.

As the opening drum and bass from the Cure's "The Figurehead" starts up, time freezes, and one of the *Dungeon Crawler World* announcers, Kevin or Magnificent Troy, introduces the combatants.

"These crawlers... You know them, you mostly love them... but they have finally met their match. It's depressing how short this battle is gonna be. Kensington the Pear Tree will make crawler chutney out of them. We might as well just stop watching now."

He heaves a heavy sigh, and the battle begins.

Kensington is tough as hell, but he's not much of a tactician. His main strategy is whacking crawlers with his powerful branches. On the top of a 100-foot marble tower, that can be effective, though. He hurls pears, and when they strike something, they instantly putrefy and explode into a cloud of noxious rot.

Overcoming Kensington's aura of despair is the most difficult part of the battle. All creatures within 100 feet of him gain the Despondent Debuff: At the beginning of each round, each crawler must make a CHA Stat Check at Difficulty 22, then see the effect below.

- **Amazing Success or better:** The creature finds strength enough to act normally this round. They also inspire one of their companions, resulting in a Standard Success for that companion.
- **Standard Success:** The creature shakes off the depression enough to act normally this round.
- **Near Miss:** −1 to all rolls this round.
- **Standard Fail:** All rolls are made with Disadvantage this round.
- **Major Fail or worse:** Gains the Resigned to Die Debuff: Takes 1 HB slot of damage at the end of each round until they roll a Standard Success or better. If they drop from 10% to 0% this way, instant death!

The crawlers dealing the killing blow gains a Silver

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Arborcide Boss Box. It contains a Pear of Despair. It's a delicious-looking fruit the size of a baby's head, but something looks decidedly off about it the more a crawler looks at it. If they take a single bite, the eater temporarily gains the Feral keyword (p. 327): They add +F (the floor number, in this case +5) to all their attacks and damage rolls for the next day. The fruit is big enough for six bites, but once bitten it rapidly decays over the next hour. The pear is an alchemical ingredient usable as a substitute in a wide variety of potions. Any potions crafted with it temporarily make the user Feral in addition to the potion's normal effects.

CLUES

- Kensington seems to appreciate goth clothing.
- That tower looks less sturdy than the tree trunk.
- Stand next to the tower and watch the fun.

AI **Kensington. Feral Pear Tree.**

Level 69 Borough Boss!

Originally, the Boss of this quadrant was a pustule-ridden demon-lord of darkness, yadda-yadda-yadda. Really fucking tough, but admittedly a little uninspired. Then this thing showed up out of the Nothing and killed that Boss without so much as rustling a twig. Such a more entertaining Boss fight. Let's get to it!

Even I don't know Kensington's full story, but it must be truly tragic, for he radiates such despair. He's like Eeyore to the nth degree, an infinite abyss of anguish making everyone around him miserable... kind of like your mother-in-law. (You can laugh at that joke, but just know she felt exactly the same way about you.)

Kensington

Borough Boss; Huge (6), Tree, Feral

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
5%	10%	15%	20%	25%	30%	35%	40%	45%	50%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
55%	60%	65%	70%	75%	80%	85%	90%	95%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
69	16+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
60 (+6)	51 (+6)	54 (+6)	24 (+5)	102 (+7)

Branch Manager: 16+F+F to hit, 6d10+6+F Bludgeoning, 100ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler falls into a deep depression and can do nothing but stare blankly into the abyss until the end of the current round.

Putrid Pear: 15+F+F to hit, 5d6+5+F Necrotic, 100ft range, 10ft Blast radius +10ft Splash
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Sepsis Debuff.

Notes: *So Tragic*—Crawlers wearing goth clothing have Resistance to the Branch Manager attack, because they're already depressed.

The Tower—Kensington's own Area Attack causes damage to the tower. Let the players know that the marble flakes with each hit. Dealing 100 total damage brings the tower down. Kensington falls in slow motion, singing an emo song during a lull in the combat. He then lands and takes 12d10 damage.

Feral—All to-hit and damage values include an extra +F (included above).

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NEIGHBORHOOD: TUNDRA RUMBLE (AIR QUADRANT)

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: SUFFERING SNOW SORROWS

This bubble is a land of ice, snow, and peace... at least until the ice tries to stab you, the snow tries to suffocate you, and bombs start dropping. It turns out snow looks much less pleasant when covered in blood and viscera.

Long ago, the Dirigible Gnomes, Skyfowl, and Frost Maidens lived in perfect Disharmony until the snow turned sentient and began attacking all of them. Now the three groups are in an uneasy truce (often broken by random 'accidental' attacks) and trying to get rid of the Snow Shifter so they can get back to killing the shit out of each other. It's much less fun when a common enemy kills your enemies.

There is a threadbare peace happening, but all three groups hate landwalkers more than anyone else, so crawlers are on thin ice in every sense of the word.

Potential Castle: The old ice-breaker ship in the Snowfields

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- A Frost Maiden huddles on the ground in a pool of blood. As you approach, her eyes sparkle in joy, despair becoming hope. She reaches out a hand to you. The moment her fingers touch yours, she grins in a wide, sinister smile, as ice flows from her hand along yours, beginning to freeze you solid. The corpse of a gnome lies mangled beneath her. She cackles, calling out, "Got another bleeding heart, ladies! Let's make it a little more literal!" as more Frost Maidens flutter to her aid.
- Ahead of the group, a gnomish plane lies smoking on the ground. The pilot scrambles to get out as the ground begins to shake beneath the crawlers' feet. A crack echoes from below, followed by a loud roaring as the plane, gnome and all, is caught in a massive surge of snow and disappears beneath it.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- The crawlers arrived at a time when something called the Snow Shifter began to hunt the different creatures of the region. While the three factions of Skyfowl, Dirigible Gnomes, and Frost Maidens each face some danger, they believe they're the only ones who can deal with the monster. Crawlers need each faction to be motivated to help hunt the beast, and they need the help of at least two factions to reach the Boss's lair.
- The Dirigible Gnomes have kidnapped a Skyfowl general and are holding him hostage unless the gnomes give up the information they have about the Snow Shifter. Initially, both Races are hostile toward the crawlers, believing they work for the other.
- Diana is a maverick Dirigible Gnome. She wants the crawlers to kill Braen for her safety. If they end up working with him, she may attack them, unless they can talk her down. Her attacking the crawlers may well mean they'll lose access to the Last Resort or even must fight Griselda herself.

MOBS

The Mobs of this Neighborhood all make their homes in ice and have a healthy respect for fire.

DIRIGIBLE GNOME

This type of Gnomes took its ingenuity to the skies in an attempt to make sure no one ever looked down on them again. Then, finding enemies in the skies above, they turned that ingenuity into weapons of war.

They tend to be paranoid, especially toward anything taller than them, so they likely aren't very receptive to any parley requests (even if they could hear them over the constant rush of wind).

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AI Dirigible Gnome. Level 30.

What's that up there? It's a bird! It's a plane! Actually, yes! It is a plane... or a type of aircraft flown by a couple of little guys. Little guys with dynamite.

These clever little gnomes got tired of seeing only kneecaps and assholes, so they took to the skies for a better view. They're paranoid fuckers, and they're more likely to nose-dive their planes into the ground than even try to hear any kind of parley.

There's a whole lot of rage in these small packages, and if you can read this, you're in the splash zone.

Dirigible Gnome

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
30	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	26 (+5)	9 (+3)	25 (+5)	10 (+4)

Gnomish Knock-Knocks: 15+F to hit, 4d8 Fire, 50ft range, 10ft Blast radius +10ft Splash
Any crawler who fails to Evade gains the Burned Debuff. On an Evade Amazing Success or better, this unstable fuel lands in the cockpit, detonating on the crew.

Nose-Dive: 15+F to hit, 5d10 Bludgeoning, 15ft Burst radius
This is a last resort attack that kills the Dirigible Gnomes.

Notes: *Flight*—Can move through the air as if it were on the ground. They stay aloft so melee attacks are difficult.

FROST MAIDENS

Frost Maidens are roughly 4'6", terrors with their ice magic, and have a yearning for the spotlight since their leaders are chosen via talent shows. The cold of this Neighborhood makes them even more dangerous than usual: Their ice magic is boosted from the weather. The cold never bothered these fairies anyway.

Charming when they want to be, most of these fairies are only satisfied when they're the center of attention, and they'll do anything to get that attention. While there is a tentative peace keeping these gals from going ape-shit, they're always up for a little violent fun. After all, their icy skin looks beautiful with a bit of blood splattered across it.

AI Frost Maidens. Level 33.

Frost Maidens may look like delicate icy beauties, but they're deadlier than running through a blizzard after losing in a wet T-shirt contest.

They're faster and meaner than you. And they have enough ice magic to freeze a desert, an ocean, and your blood right in your veins. You know, the thing you need to stay alive. Do you know how quickly blood can freeze in your veins? Shake hands with one of these fairies to find out!

Frost Maidens

Mob; Petite (3), Ice Fairy

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
33	15+F	15+F	30+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
9 (+3)	25 (+5)	10 (+4)	30 (+5)	30 (+5)

Ice Shard: 13+F to hit, 5d8+3 Ice, 5ft range

Ice Blast Spell: 15+F to hit, 3d10+5 Ice, 20ft Cone
Any hit crawler gets pushed 5ft for every 2 HB slots lost.

Notes: *Thermally Biased*—Frost Maidens are Immune to Ice damage and take ×2 damage from Fire damage.

SKYFOWL RAIDER

The Skyfowl are an incredibly proud people, so they take offense at the term "raider." After all, that implies they take what doesn't belong to them, which makes no sense because the Skyfowl are entitled to anything possessed by the flightless Races.

Those in this Neighborhood have an art form of swooping from high above to grab landwalkers and their items. They're not necessarily after anyone's life most of the time, but the screaming they elicit from their victims is almost as delightful as finding any other treasure.

AI Skyfowl Raider. Level 33.

These Skyfowl have a special fondness for Screamo. You know, the sound landwalkers make when you fly them up into the air and drop them. They love those dulcet tones from a scream fading as someone plummets to the ground.

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Skyfowl Raiders

Mob; Medium (4), Aerial Ambusher

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
33	14+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
30 (+5)	18 (+4)	15 (+4)	30 (+5)	11 (+4)

Crossbow: 15+F to hit, 5d8 Piercing, 50ft range

Talon: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

SNOWGRAVES

At first glance, these creatures could be mistaken for miscolored Goblins. They're small, slender, standing no more than four feet tall with alabaster skin and bright blood-red eyes. They always hold their arms curved, because otherwise they would drag along the ground. Those arms are nearly three times the length of their bodies and end in seven wickedly sharp talons.

Even worse, they have the ability to swim through ice or snow as if it weren't there. Their most dangerous attack involves waiting beneath the ice and snow, then reaching up to drag unwary Mobs or crawlers beneath and suffocate them with snow. They are known to stalk the Snow Fields.

AI Snowgrave. Level 35.

Have you ever wondered what would happen if a Goblin and a spider had a horrifying love-child raised by a ghost? You haven't?

Well, good news: the Snowgrave is the answer to that question.

These terrifying little creepers backstroke through the snow, using those disgustingly long arms to move twice as quickly as their little legs could carry them. Of course, most of the time they don't have to, as their unique bond with snow and ice allows them to swim through it like Michael Phelps at the Olympics. Most of the time, you won't notice them until you feel a seven-fingered hand wrap around your ankle.

Snowgrave

Mob; Small (2), Goblinoid Phantom

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	14+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
40 (+5)	15 (+4)	15 (+4)	35 (+5)	5 (+2)

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Talon: 15+F to hit, 5d10+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Grapple: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: *Snow Swimming*—Snowgraves can move through the snow as though on the ground.

Under Snow Tow—Any Held crawler is dragged under the snow the following round and gains the Suffocating Debuff: Take 1d6+F damage at the end of each round (until they make an Unopposed Swimming Skill Check).

GUARD DWARF

These squat creatures are the City Guards of the Last Resort. They're polite and friendly but only know about three words in Syndicate Standard. Usually just a greeting, a goodbye, and another phrase the individual memorized. They wander through the Last Resort. Some are nocturnal. Some are Diurnal. However, there are rarely more than nine wandering around at any one time.

Each of them wears massive plate armor covering them from head to toe, and each carries a long, slender dagger in addition to a small shield. In combat, they prefer to charge and grapple with their opponents, ripping them apart with their incredible strength or stabbing them repeatedly with their daggers.

AI **Guard Dwarf. Level 75.**

The guardians of the Last Resort, these stout little guys are good-natured when they're off duty. When on duty, they're consummate professionals. They understand Syndicate Standard, but they don't speak it. They've only memorized about three phrases, including a greeting, a goodbye, and a third line unique to each.

Don't try to hug these guys, either, especially if you've pissed them off first. They can literally rip you apart with their bare hands.

Guard Dwarf

Mob; Medium (4), City Guard

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
75	15+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
60 (+6)	30 (+5)	60 (+6)	50 (+6)	30 (+5)

Stiletto: 16+F to hit, 7d8+6 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing

Grapple: 16+F to hit, 6d6+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

ENVIRONMENT

This Neighborhood is shaped like a giant bowl set between incredibly tall mountains. Most of it is an abject desert of snow with a few occasional pine trees and other evergreens. Within this landscape, crawlers may find a single settlement of "friendly" Frost Maidens in The Last Resort situated at the base of one of the highest mountains.

High above it all, situated in the crystal clouds, sits Cloud Home and the Dirigible Gnome Academy. Absolutely everything not indoors in this Neighborhood is covered in a layer of snow and ice. The three groups have a peace as sturdy as the paper gown you wear during a pap smear. The gnomes have kidnapped a Skyfowl general and are holding him hostage. The Skyfowl are attacking the gnomes, and the Frost Maidens are sending blizzards at the Skyfowl.

They all like to blame others for anything that goes wrong and think only their plans are the best. Working together for the common good just seems like so much effort, and how can an individual group be the best if they have to work with others?

The outdoor area, incredibly dangerous for crawlers, occasionally erupts in snowstorms and avalanches. Some of these snowstorms have wings strong enough to yank a crawler straight into the sky or send waves of snow knocking crawlers into the bottom of an avalanche. Seeking shelter and allies will be key to getting to the stairs and staying alive.

TRAPS

In addition to environmental hazards, traps lie waiting throughout this Neighborhood. Most come from the Dirigible Gnomes' or the Frost Maidens' efforts to capture the Snow Shifter.

- **Snowcutter:** A single collapsible flagpole pokes from a mound of snow. When something ventures close to it, a loud whining sounds, and a net springs out, wrapping the target and pulling it tight against the pole, hard enough to slowly cut through flesh and sinew.
- **Flamethrower:** A line is buried in the snow. A small, white bubble of fuel sits nearby. When the line is tripped, the bubble roars, and fire spews forward to melt the snow and burn anyone nearby.

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- **Explosion Engine:** A pressure plate is buried beneath a loose layer of snow. Stepping on it causes a loud snap and an echoing explosion. These are sometimes set up near each other or near another trap to create an avalanche.
- **Snow Spirals:** Hidden under packs of snow, these traps drop anyone unfortunate enough to walk across them into a pit filled with sharpened icicles.

ITEMS

Thanks to the ongoing skirmishes between the various factions of this Neighborhood, crawlers may recover plenty of useful (and not-so-useful) items from the ice.

- **Leisure Vehicle Parts:** The Last Resort owned and operated several snowmobiles and ATVs before the world collapsed. The Dirigible Gnomes stole them, stripped them down for parts, and abandoned whatever they didn't keep. Sometimes, when the snow shifts, these metal carcasses reemerge, offering a few usable parts.
- **Sknives:** Ice skates have always been deadly, and now they can be equipped as forearm blades!
- **Gnomish Drop Bear:** This is one of the Dirigible Gnome's earliest fast-attack planes. There are only a handful of these still in service. While able to quickly reach most targets when drop-launched from home base, the twin engines of these early models were famously underpowered. Damaged Drop Bears oftentimes had difficulty obtaining enough altitude to reach home, even after ditching their payload. This is why most of these planes carry rapid-deploying, quick-escape balloons, making them sitting targets for enemy aircraft and flak.

  That information is not going to do you any good when you're sitting there on the ground watching this thing barrel at you like a robin descending upon a glistening, fat worm. Don't worry, these guys don't drop bombs. Their standard payload is something much more entertaining.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood, each with an associated reward.

- **Snownah and the Whale:** "You were swallowed and spat forth by a great beast. You might be incredibly lucky, but you're definitely in need of a shower. *Reward:* You've received a Gold Survivor's Box."
- **Into the Wild Blue Yonder:** "You took a ride on the wings of either a fae creature or a gnomish contraption. Either way, you're lucky you survived. *Reward:* You've received a Silver Riders Box."
- **Blue Balls:** "Surviving stage two of hypothermia sure gives you a new appreciation for warmth, huh? Hope you didn't lose any fingers or toes. Or anything else..." *Reward:* You've received a Gold Apparel Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers who try to grind for experience have much more to worry about than snowballs flying toward them, and Table 104 provides some options.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: THE LAST RESORT

The Last Resort belongs to the Frost Maidens, who run the gamut between "friendly" and barely constrained psychotic violence. The Last Resort itself is an elegant four-story building. The roof is red shingled, and the top level features large windows that look out over the landscape. Before the Collapse, it was a well-known ski resort that sat atop a mountain somewhere in the United States. Now it serves as one of the only places of refuge in this part of the bubble.

While violence is strictly prohibited within the hotel's boundaries, bored Frost Maidens often try to attack crawlers entering or exiting the building. (It won't happen every time, but that's what makes it fun, right?) Until the crawlers prove their worth, the Frost Maidens swoop from above while Snowgraves attack from below. Griselda, the current leader of the Frost Maidens, doesn't approve, but she figures if the crawlers are too weak to fight them off, they're better off dead and buried than taking up room in the hotel.

Inside, The Last Resort often has multiple shows going on as each Frost Maiden tries to upstage the other to become the most popular. Currently, Griselda is the star of the Last Resort for her raunchy Hot Chocolate dance routine, and thus de facto leader because everyone knows all a good leader needs is charisma.

Diana, an exceptionally tall gnome, took up residence in the Last Resort's garage after a falling out

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TABLE 104: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A Strong group of Skyfowl swoops down from above, trying to grasp the smallest crawler and carry them away. Their goal is to drop them from a great height, use them as bait, or carry them back to Cloud Home.
2	Crawlers find themselves staring at the elderly Skyfowl Ackler, who sits on a bench and stares out at the endless fields of snow and ice. He sighs deeply and asks them about the nature of futile struggles. How can someone continue when there's nothing good waiting for them at the end? After this, he is notably warmer any time they meet.
3	That last fight was a bit too loud. A sudden cracking sound rips through the air. Then a loud roaring rushes toward you as everything disappears into the snow and ice. AVALANCHE!
4	As the crawler party hunts through the Snow Fields, a loud *ping* sounds as a Snowcutter (p. 605) captures one of the group. Slowly, the engine ratchets back, starting to pull the net tight against the crawler. If the party does not act fast, the crawler is diced to pieces.
5	A Moderate group of Frost Maidens has a poker game, using the frozen corpse of a polar bear as a table. One swears as her friends cackle. They wave the party over, inviting two of them to join the game... but what are the stakes?
6	The crawlers happen upon a campsite. A journal details the journey of a crawler, and its last entry describes how they lost their entire party to some unknown force, and they intend to hunt it down. They discovered a weakness. The snow beast seems resistant to magic, but it's weak against piercing weapons.

with the Dirigible Gnome Commander, who claimed she was looking down on him and deemed her a traitor. She currently repairs an old Gnomish Drop Bear. Initially, she's hesitant to deal with the crawlers, but if they offer her food or indicate they want to kill the Dirigible Gnome Commander, she happily tells them what she needs to make the plane fly them to the Gnome Academy.

Griselda has a habit of acquiring rumors from those who pass through her establishment. She asks the crawlers if they've got anything juicy for her, especially anything good for blackmail. If they charm her, or if they bring her information about the Snow Shifter or the journal referenced in the *Grinding Complications* section, she happily shares that she once heard someone say the Snow Shifter was immune to magic. She also tells them the Snow Shifter is supposedly near the old icebreaker in the Snow Fields.

QUARTER: GNOME ACADEMY

Floating high above the clouds, the Dirigible Gnomes crafted a perfect home from multiple blimps (each bearing different brands and sports teams from Earth), creating a city in the sky. The walkways keeping this massive floating city together are perfectly safe... for creatures no taller than the Gnomes. If you aren't gnome-sized, a fall may lie ahead.

Crawlers who make it up here, whether by plane or alliance with another group, immediately face a group of "expert gnomish warriors." A Strong group of Dirigible Gnomes, highly trained warriors, tries to push the intruders over the side. They come in two waves. The first wave fires from a nearby blimp, while the second wave tries to bait crawlers into coming near the edge, where they can force them over the side.

An irate Skyfowl named Roscoe is their prisoner. The proud creature expects the crawlers to free him. Those who do so earn his grudging respect. If they haven't gone to Cloud Home yet, after they free him, he ensures they receive a much friendlier welcome from his people. If they already visited Cloud Home, he presents them with a Skyfowl Cloak of Slowfall, an item providing Resistance against cold and falling damage.

If the crawlers make their way to Commander Braen's office, he offers them a truce. He provides them with coordinates to the Snow Shifter. If the crawlers also bring him the head of the tall traitor Diana, he reluctantly instructs his people to stop bombing the crawlers. But only if asked. Politely.

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NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- A Moderate group of Frost Maidens dances in the sky above in a choreographed line dance, summoning a massive snowstorm to hit the Dirigible Gnome Academy.
  Outcome: If players are caught, the Frost Maidens attack. But if the Frost Maidens' dance routine isn't stopped, the Dirigible Gnomes lose a large number of their planes and cannot help fly the crawlers.
- As you walk through the fields of endless snow, a high-pitched whistling grows steadily louder overhead.
  Outcome: The crawlers see a bomb falling just in time to take damage. If they run instead, they might avoid it.
- Approaching the Dirigible Gnome Academy, the path is lined with bodies impaled on sticks sharpened to a point. The words 'Tall Examples' are written below all of the rotting bodies, though thankfully the biting cold has kept decay away for now... Instead, ice forms all over these unfortunate remains.
  Outcome: Crawlers can choose to work with the Dirigible Gnomes or seek revenge or loot.
- A Moderate group of Skyfowl stalks through trees high above, clearly looking for something, when a rush of snow explodes upwards and devours some of the Skyfowl.
  Outcome: Crawlers can try to help, risking an interaction with the Snow Shifter. Crawlers that leave avoid it.

QUARTER: CLOUD HOME

Cloud Home is the fancy name for a group of interconnected homes carved into the mountain above the Last Resort. It takes time for land-walkers to climb up the side of the mountain (where they face attacks from Skyfowl Raiders the entire time). However, it's quicker if they manage to fix the airplane with Diana.

If the crawlers decide to climb the mountain, they face repeated encounters with Weak to Moderate groups of Skyfowl Raiders attacking in unison. They're not strictly trying to kill the crawlers, but they attempt to ensure any safety lines are sheared so crawlers fall. If the crawlers arrive by plane, upon landing, they are attacked by a group of Skyfowl Raiders intent on stopping these invaders, but they can be reasoned with by a charismatic enough crawler. Looking for an easy meal.

The Skyfowl of Cloud Home are proud but not overly rude, that is, after crawlers reach them. They're desperate enough to seek allies, reasoning that any crawlers who make it up the mountain must have some "winged blood" in their veins. They openly trade with any such crawlers (though they won't necessarily deal fairly) and offer them access to safe-rooms and other amenities.

Ackler, leader of the Skyfowl, worries about his people's steadily shrinking population. He speaks with the crawlers if they've made it this far. He insists on proof of the usefulness before he helps them, and he demands the head of either Griselda or Braen as proof, or the return of the Skyfowl captured by the gnomes.

If crawlers are charming, offer him a very nice bribe, or if the crawlers found him on the bench as noted in the Grinding Complications section, he offers them a map of a cave system where he believes the Snow Shifter resides in the Snow Fields.

QUARTER: SNOW FIELDS

Being out in the snow is almost certainly a death sentence. If the weather doesn't get you, the traps or bomb dropping aerial units will, and if somehow you survive all that, the snow itself is alive and bloodthirsty.

Snow falls constantly throughout this area; sometimes lightly and sometimes heavily. It never stops. Evergreen trees cluster in small groups as far as the eye can see. Some of these lie toppled, ripped out by the roots.

What looks like half of an old ice-breaker ship lies buried in the snow. It's clear the Gnomes started breaking it down for parts but were scared off. Usable engine pieces and scrap metal remain inside, as well as an old sonar device that could be repurposed to detect movement under the snow. If the crawlers obtained the map from Ackler, or heard rumors from Griselda, or received the coordinate path from Braen, they can locate the lair of the Snow Shifter in the hold of the old ice-breaker ship. Crawlers cannot locate it without two of the above items.

The crawlers must progress through an incredibly narrow series of passages to reach the Boss Chamber, which is housed within half a large ship and pointed diagonally downward. Snow has settled on the floor of the hold, and icicles hang from above. Although this half of the ship is separated from the other, the light inside still glows. Once inside, it looks as if there's no way a monster can fit. However, a porthole swings open, and snow begins to pour in as the Boss arrives.

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NPCS

ACKLER

This elder Skyfowl is tired and grumpy, to say the least. He led his people here for more specialized hunting of gnomes and fairies. Now he's slowly losing his people, as the Snow Shifter has apparently grown fond of Skyfowl flesh.

Ackler splits his time between training his people in Cloud Home and hunting far away. He has no patience for land-dwellers, at least until they prove their worth. Or if they prove they understand his position.

AI **Skyfowl Huntmaster. Level 45.**

Master of the Skyfowl Raiders.

Ackler has been called many things, including the Demon of the Skies. He once considered himself top of the food chain and a master hunter... right up until he met a monster worse than he could ever dream of. Now, he watches that monster devour more and more of his people. Ackler is angry, but desperate. So desperate, he might even accept the help of land-walkers... if they prove their worth, that is.

GRISELDA

As Matron and proprietor of the Last Resort and leader of the Frost Maidens, she keeps the place tidy and welcoming for the most part. She retains a tight grip on the settlement, ruling with iron fairy wings and a dazzling dance routine that ends with her coating herself in chocolate. She insists there be absolutely no violence on the grounds of The Last Resort unless she approves. She's always happy to have more guests, especially if they bring her tasty snacks.

AI **Frost Maiden Matron. Level 50.**

This matronly Frost Maiden kept the Last Resort running in a neat and orderly manner ever since she dominated the cut-throat talent show of the Frost Maidens. Lately, far too many customers for her taste have returned. She much prefers the novelty of new guests and the roar of endless war with the gnomes and bird brains, but with the Snow Shifter slithering through the icy depths, no one is entirely safe outside the settlement. To her chagrin, that means people without wings tend to stick around, and that the war is on pause.

BRAEN

The illustrious Commandant of the Dirigible Gnome Academy has been in charge since it opened. The very picture of discipline, he stalks the halls of the academy, barking orders at his underlings. He is not one to cross. He is perhaps the only member of the academy willing to hear out the tall folk... if they bring him something that shows they're worth listening to and meeting him on his level.

AI **Dirigible Gnome Commander. Level 49.**

This tiny little general thinks he cuts quite the dashing figure. Considering he's an able fighter, a competent magician, and a master pilot, his arrogance could be worse. He's ready to be done with this Snow Shifter so he can get back to blasting Skyfowl and fairies out of the sky.

DIANA

A rogue Dirigible Gnome of unusual height, Diana still isn't particularly fond of tall-folk, and she almost instinctively points her weapon at anyone who comes too close to her or the plane she's repairing. However, she can be bribed, cajoled, or even threatened. If anyone tells her they're trying to kill Commander Braen, for instance, she is very willing to help them.

AI **Dirigible Gnome Commander. Level 44.**

Despite her surprising height, she is in fact a gnome, and a talented mechanic too. Get on her good side, and you might just get a chance to pilot one of those Gnomish Drop Bears without murdering a bunch of people first. But where's the fun in that?

The crawlers freeze (in the non-moving sense, though they are also quite chilly) as the AI shouts "B-B-B-Boss Battle!" through chattering teeth. Images of the crawlers appear in a lithographed style. The snow itself forms the words "Snow Shifter," then flows into the shape of a snake.

The Snow Shifter initially attacks the crawlers in serpentine form. It slaps the side of the ship with its body, denying a surprise attacks from those on the ship.

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When the Boss reaches 50% HB, it changes form, becoming a massive snowman with thick legs and arms, and gains DR. At 20%, it shifts into a living avalanche, a swirling mass of snow that pulls crawlers into itself to quickly freeze them.

It is utterly immune to magic (including fire magic!), but it is notably weak against Piercing weapons and Fire from nonmagical sources.

CLUES

- Snow Shifter has Immunity to all Spell damage!
- When shifting into a solid form, Snow Shifter is a little easier to hit.
- Piercing weapons and non-Spell Fire attacks deal extra damage.

AI Snow Shifter. Shape-Changing Terror of the Tundra.

Level 62 Neighborhood Boss!

Look over there! It's an avalanche that takes on shapes. Are you seeing a snake, or are you just happy to see me? It's been content to devour the occasional Skyfowl, Dirigible Gnome, or Frost Maiden until now, but most of them are too light on their feet to bother it. You bother it.

Congratulations, you've taught it a new emotion: anger. You must be a real dumbass to try to fight a literal force of nature.

Snow Shifter

Neighborhood Boss; Huge (6), Shapeshifter

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
6%	13%	20%	26%	33%	40%	46%	53%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	
60%	66%	73%	80%	86%	93%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
62	16+F	16+F	30+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
80 (+6)	60 (+6)	80 (+6)	85 (+6)	30 (+5)

Snake Bite: 16+F to hit, 7d10+6 Ice, 10ft range (only in snake form)

Snowman Crush: 16+F to hit, 6d8+6 Ice, 10ft range (only in snowman form)
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Snowburst: 16+F to hit, 5d6+6 Ice, 30ft Burst (only in avalanche form)
For every 2 HB slots lost to this attack, the crawler gains one stack of the Freezing to Death Debuff (stackable): Take 1d6+F Ice at the end of each round of combat.

Blizzard Spell: 15+F to hit, 5d6+6 Ice, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius
Any crawler who loses 3+ HB slots to this attack gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Notes: *Hot Poker Vulnerability*—Piercing and non-Spell Fire attacks deal ×2 damage.

Not So Shifty—When Snow Shifter changes form, he takes a −2 penalty to his Evade score that round.

Snowman Form—At 50% HB, it changes form into a snowman with a hard outer shell, gaining +5 DR.

Avalanche Form—At 20% HB, it changes form into a living avalanche, where it has Resistance to ALL damage types, but has 0 DR. (It still has Immunity to Spell damage.)

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QUEST: LUTIN PLUNDER

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: CHOSEN ONES ARE LAZY BULLSHIT

Everyone knows the Chosen One in fantasy novels, heralded in prophecies and with a destiny veiled in vaguely ominous poems. They stop the Dark Evil lurking in the world. This Quest begins as all classics of fantasy do, with the arrival of a Chosen One: You, aren't you a lucky crawler?

The village of Zhaton is cursed, and only a great Chosen One can enter the domed temple, find the lost Staff of Smacking, and stop the evil lurking within, restoring peace forever.

Zhaton is a village of cypress tree homes, swamps, and a large geodesic sphere that rises high above everything else and serves as the temple. The Crocodilians mostly live in the swamp itself, while the Lutins live in the trees above the water.

The leaders of the village, Priest Jaakob and King LaClaw, warned all the villagers that these Crawlers could never be their Chosen One and must be kept from the temple at all costs. What they haven't told the villagers is that both leaders believe there's no evil in the temple anymore.

Because wow, are scared, isolated villagers a whole lot easier to control. It'd be a shame if some crawlers ruined their plans.

Potential Castle: The Great Domed Temple

STRONG STARTS

- A loud splashing erupts in the swamp. Far ahead, a tall figure in a fancy hat bows toward the Crawlers and compliments the Chosen One. He warns them not everyone is going to be happy to see them in Zhaton.
- Children play together until they notice the crawlers and the golden glow of the Chosen One. They flee from the group, calling them liars.
- A crawler was wounded, potentially from a previous battle on the floor, or maybe from one of the traps described below. Regardless, from seemingly out of nowhere, a young but intense Lutin appears, examining the wound and asking the crawler if they need healing.

QUEST DESCRIPTION

When the first Crawler in a group steps into the village, they receive this Quest, the AI announces it with the following text in a dramatic fashion:

New Quest. The Chosen One of Shafted Destiny.

Congratulations! By stepping foot into Zhaton, you are now marked as a Chosen One of Staffed Destiny. Boy, standards for destined ones have really fallen low!

Hope you like attention because this golden glow is all yours until the quest is completed or you die.

At least you'll die glowing!

Buff: You glow! Neat! A warm golden glow radiates from you at all times.

Reward: You will receive a Silver Quest Box. That's right, just a Silver Quest Box.

ALTERATIONS

This Quest is written with the Lutins and the Crocodilians in mind. However, it also works with any magic-focused Race and any physical-focused Race. The important plot beats can all be hit as long as two very competent leaders are taking advantage of the situation.

MOBS

The Mobs in this Quest are primarily the minions of King LaClaw, the followers of the Lutin priest, Jaakop, and the minions of the Temple Guardian.

CROCODILIAN CLAWPAD

The more physically focused followers of LaClaw, Crocodilians have a slight predilection for ambush predation, and the Clawpads famously follow the saying, "Any fair fight is one I want no part of." But that's mostly because they prefer quick victories and easy meals rather than an inability to win a straight-up fight.

They dress in makeshift ghillie suits, allowing them stealthy movement. Each of them carries a heavy harpoon handgun, preferring to use it before moving

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in to finish the job with their razor-blade claws.

AI Crocodilian Clawpad. Level 43.

These are the lowest-ranking members of Bandit King LaClaw's Crocodilian Crew. Don't get too excited, though. Just because they lack a certain professional drive doesn't mean their prey drive is any lower.

They're not the most "book smart" creatures. Instead, their cunning is directed to removing threats and feeding themselves and their loved ones. Unfortunately for you, you're made of meat, and they've got knives for hands. And even if you're not, don't get too cocky, not only can their bites shear through rock and some types of metal, but they've also been known to do it just to prove they can.

Crocodilian Clawpad

Mob; Large (5), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
43	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
30 (+5)	24 (+5)	40 (+5)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)

Claws: 15+F to hit, 4d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Harpoon Gun: 15+F to hit, 3d10 Piercing, 50ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Stiff Legs Debuff.

Notes: *Ambush Predator*—Any Crocodilian Clawpad that is not surprised attacks with Advantage during the first round of combat.

CROCODILIAN DEATH-ROLLER

The Death-Rollers are much rarer than their physically focused teammates. The Death-Rollers are the thinkers, the assassins, and the magic-users among LaClaw's band. They firmly believe "Luck" is a being that can be manipulated, translated, and, perhaps most importantly, bribed.

Their particular brand of magic is all about taking control of odds, using cards or dice with most of their Spells. They dress in spiffy black three-piece suits and cast Spells every morning, making them impervious to dirt and water. They also have the same cutting smile as their brethren. Suffice it to say, there is more than one reason for their moniker.

AI Crocodilian Death-Roller. Level 52.

Whoa! That is one sharp suit! It's nearly as sharp as that thing's teeth. Of course, it would be difficult to get sharper than those, buuuut you're gonna find that out soon enough.

The Death-Rollers are the more magically inclined among LaClaw's little gang of cutthroat thieves. They heard the term "Card Sharp" once upon a time and completely misunderstood. Still, they found a way to use those fancy new skills for more than just a few card tricks.

Word to the wise, if they offer you a cut? Say No. They're not talking about their deck.

Crocodilian Deathroller

Mob; Large (5), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
52	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
30 (+5)	30 (+5)	40 (+5)	20 (+5)	41 (+5)

Bite: 15+5 to hit, 4d10+5 Piercing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Roll the Bones!: 15+F to hit, 5d10+5 (see below for damage type), 100ft range
Roll a 1d6 to determine the type of damage: 1—Electric, 2—Fire, 3—Force, 4—Ice, 5—Psychic, 6—Sonic.

Notes: *Death-Roll*—Any Held crawler is subjected to a violent, spinning motion the following round (as an Action) and gains the Shredded Debuff: Take 1d6+F Slashing at the end of each round until the Held Debuff is removed or the Crocodilian Deathroller is killed.

LUTIN BOUNTY HUNTER

The Lutins are said to prefer working together. There's a stereotype that they prefer to focus on helping rather than causing harm. These Lutins decided they like causing harm together.

They won't hesitate to cut, slice, stab, or disintegrate anyone who gets in their way. They make heavy use of teamwork, repeating crossbow bolts, and layered buffing Spells from members of their groups to overwhelm opponents with a rain of missiles.

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AI **Lutin Bounty Hunter. Level 44.**

What, never seen a Lutin before? These scrappy little guys are Hobgoblins from French folklore, but they look more like a cross between Gnomes and small Elves. Fun fact: the females are called Lutines, because why the hell not?

Despite their small stature, these guys sure pack a wallop.

Do you know how many bolts a repeating crossbow can fire a second?

Well, you're about to find out!

Lutin Bounty Hunter

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
44	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
27 (+5)	35 (+5)	20 (+5)	35 (+5)	20 (+5)

Knife: 15+F to hit, 5d4+5 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing

Repeating Crossbow: 15+F to hit, 5d8 Piercing, 60 ft range
A Lutin Bounty Hunter may use their Move Action to attack a second time in the same round, but may only do this every other round.

Notes: *Buff Dudes*—A Lutin Bounty Hunter can cast a Spell to give half of them a +1 Buff to one of the following values: Attack, Damage, or Evade.

LUTIN PRIEST

These members of the Lutin clergy are devoted worshipers of Diwata and are normally friendly. However, following the commands of Priest Jaakop, any crawlers glowing like a Chosen One must be dealt with. After all, only a Lutin could really be the true Chosen One.

They focus on buff Spells not just for their teammates but also for themselves. If they have time to prepare for an encounter, they buff themselves to near-invulnerability. In general, they prefer enchantment Spells or to talk their way around problems, but if that fails, they have no issue using their enhanced abilities to pound a heathen's face into the dirt. And if you're not already on your knees praying, you're a heathen.

AI **Lutin Priest. Level 50.**

This is a Lutin of the cloth. You may notice that the cloth is very red, that's because of the massive amount of heathen blood they're walking through most days. These guys tend to talk more than they hit, but they can throw some serious magic around.

Word of Advice: If they start making sense, run. They're adept at enchantment magic. Almost as adept as they are at enhancing their own bodies. Ever gotten your ass beat by a priest half your size? If you don't wanna find out, maybe try praying on your knees. It won't stop them, but at least you can look the little guys in the eye when they blow up your head.

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Lutin Priest

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	35 (+5)	20 (+5)	35 (+5)	40 (+5)

Unarmed Combat: 15+F to hit, 5d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Notes: *Even Buffer Dudes*—A Lutin Priest can cast a Spell to give themselves and a Weak group of their party a +1 Buff to any two of the following Checks: Attack, Damage, or Evade.

Spell Bound—Lutin Priests know the following Spells at Rank 10: Heal Others, Holy Aura, Smite, Shield, and Turn Undead.

TEMPLE GUARD

These temple spirits guard the geodesic sphere that serves as the Temple of Zhaton. Made of dark stone and sledgehammer arms, these creatures stop anyone trying to enter the temple. Lately, they've even started wandering into the city and attacking the citizens.

They're strong and durable as the stone they take on, and faster than they look. However, if their physical form is destroyed, their spirit vanishes with a goofy, oddly familiar laugh.

AI Temple Guard. Level 55.

Oh, no! It's a ghost! Worse—it's a self-righteous ghost burdened with glorious purpose.

The temple is their domain, and if you're stupid enough to walk into their domain, well, that seems more like a you problem. I hope you enjoy seeing just what getting a fistful of stone feels like. The good news is that, in their physical forms, they're vulnerable and can be killed. The bad news is it's incredibly hard to hurt living rock.

Temple Guard

Mob; Medium (4), Stony Phantasm

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
55	12+F	16+F	25+S	7
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
50 (+6)	5 (+2)	60 (+6)	50 (+6)	5 (+2)

Stone Fist: 16+F to hit, 5d8+6 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Stone Shot: 16+F to hit, 5d6+6 Bludgeoning, 60ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Woozy Debuff.

NPCS

Major NPCs of "Lutin Plunder" are the leaders of the Lutin and Crocodilian people of Zhaton. The two are working together to try to keep any Chosen One from entering the temple and realizing there is no great evil, but that the threat of that evil is a great cover for adding some extra 'protection' taxes and tithes. The two make a show of being against each other, even engaging in fights occasionally, but they split all their profits 50/50.

JAAKOP

The head priest of Diwata for the Lutin people, it is his job to interpret her words and spread them to the people of Zhaton. He has convinced most of his followers that the Chosen One would only be a Lutin and that they must hunt down non-Lutin claiming to be a Chosen One.

Originally a kind soul, Jaakop found the more respect he got, the more he got. And that people will pay anything to be saved.

AI Traveling Priest Jaakop. Lutin Healer. Level 70.

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Throughout his life, Jaakop saw too many of his loved ones pass before their time. Swearing to never let another person succumb to a preemptive fate, he became a traveling priest and learned the healing arts.

He brings hope to many Lutins within this world, and many know his name and his bravery. He walks alone, traveling with nothing more than his cane and the clothes on his back, bringing solace and relief to anyone who needs it... well, almost anyone.

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KING LACLAW

Lloyd LaClaw was born the son of a poor Crocodilian trout farmer in a small village and has risen to become the King of his people. He firmly espouses to his people that the Chosen One will be a Crocodilian, and anyone claiming otherwise needs to get killed. As a non-combatant, that's what servants are for.

After a childhood of nothing, King LaClaw lives in luxury befitting a king now.

AI **King LaClaw. Crocodilian Swashbuckler. Level 70.**

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Growing up, Lloyd LaClaw saw too many of his family and friends fall to starvation and has spent his life building a stable, safe home for his people.

This brave, flashy, and surprisingly friendly Crocodilian tries to solve problems with words before reaching for his sword (heh, loser.) However, those who earn his ire quickly find his sword is almost as sharp as his wit, and both are nearly as sharp as his teeth.

TRAPS

Both the Lutins and the Crocodilians make use of traps. The Lutins prefer more magical means and often use illusions and enchantments to weaken their prey. The Crocodilians, however, like to employ more mundane traps and ambushes.

- **Lutin Flashfryer:** A set of magic wards is etched into the side of two trees, facing one another. Anyone who steps between them, blocking their connection, detonates the runes, dousing the area with wood-shrapnel, flames, and concussive force.
- **Lutin Plothole:** The Lutins dig a pit and use illusion magic, making it appear like undisturbed ground. These traps are initially nonlethal and primarily used as tools for interrogation about the Chosen One. If their victim doesn't talk, the Lutins simply refill the pit, burying them alive.
- **Crocodile Nets:** This simple tripwire trap, typically buried just beneath the surface of mud near bodies of water, springs the net, pulling the victim up and holding them for later. However, one variation hauls the net and its contents underwater, trapping and potentially drowning those caught inside.
- **Balanced Plate:** Food, money, or other valuables are left on top of a plate. The plate is balanced such that removing any item causes a shift. A heavy counterweight then drops, shooting a spike into whoever took the bait.
- **Sauce-Tosser:** A simple Lutin teleport trap. A victim steps on it, only to be whisked away to an area within a half-mile radius, usually into a prebuilt cage. Victims are left disoriented for five minutes.

QUEST ITEMS

Items from this Quest may include some of the following:

- **Temple Keys:** To enter the temple, four keys must be collected: two from the Lutins and two from the Crocodlians. They are identical to one another and crafted of an impossibly heavy dark-gray metal.
- **The Scrolls of Solace:** These copies of the Lutin Gospel are dropped by Lutin Bounty-Hunters and Lutin Priests. They tell how an ancient hero, joined by his allies, defeated a demon and sealed it into a tomb beneath the Lutin Temple. It prophesies that one day the demon will escape, and a chosen Lutin must drive it back into the darkness.
- **The Book of Balance:** These copies of the Crocodilian Gospel are dropped by Clawpads and Death-Rollers. They tell how an ancient hero brought his people together and, with their allies, banished a demon into the depths. It tells how they were unable to slay the beast but instead bound it there. It prophesies that one day the demon will escape, and a chosen Crocodilian must step forward once more to take up arms with allies of their people against the beast, lest all die by its terrible wrath.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements on this Quest.

- **Croc Bait:** "You fell for a trap so obvious, a child would've seen it coming.
  Reward: Come on, dude. Don't make this more awkward by asking for a reward."
- **There Can Be More Than One?:** "You encountered another Chosen One. Hey, that's my title!
  Reward: You've received a Gold Not So Special Box."

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- **Vantage Point:** "You swore to help someone completely convinced that their cause was righteous. Hopefully, there's no information forthcoming that might change your mind.
  Reward: You've received a Silver Weapon box."
- **Chosen Dumb:** "You've seen that more than one 'chosen one' prophecy has absolutely no merit to it. Almost like 'chosen ones' and prophecies are total bullshit.
  Reward: You've received a Platinum Free Agent's Box!"

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers might try to grind for experience during this Quest, and Table 105 lays out a few complications that might arise.

STAGE 1: WARM WELCOME

The crawlers chance upon the Lutin priest, Jaakop, in his wanderings. He is a serious but friendly example of a Lutin and offers to heal any wounds the crawlers have accumulated thus far for a small fee of a few gold coins. He explains that they should leave this place as soon as possible, since one of them claims to be the Chosen One, and most of his kind will attack them on sight for that reason.

Jakoob tells the crawlers about the prophecy. How long ago, a great hero defeated a demon and sealed it into a tomb beneath the great domed temple. It prophesies that one day the demon will escape, and a chosen Lutin must take up the ancient hero's staff and drive it back into the darkness. For now, the temple is sealed by keys held by the Lutins and Crocodilians. If the crawlers are anything but supportive of the right hero being a Lutin, he suggests they study the Scrolls of Solace and leaves one behind for them to review. Should the crawlers read the scroll, they see the same prophecy and also find a Temple Key left behind by the priest.

Shortly after Jakoob walks away, a Strong group of Lutin Bounty Hunters attacks. They drop the Temple Key.

STAGE 2: THE HUNT

As the crawlers progress, more Crocodilian Clawpads and Lutin Bounty Hunters emerge. In the village, few people will speak to them or help them at all. They all seem to believe the marked Chosen One is evil, bringing danger to their village. It is easy to see the village is struggling: People are begging on the streets, and everything is in disrepair.

The longer the crawlers spend in the area, the more Death-Rollers attack, dropping a third Temple Key.

A Moderate group of Lutin Bounty Hunters, led by a Lutin Priest, ransacks a small hut in the swamps. The corpses of three Crocodilians lay nearby, one notably smaller than the others. The moment the Lutin Priest notices the crawlers, he howls and orders the Bounty Hunters to chase and eliminate the crawlers, declaring them "false prophets!"

If the crawlers check the Crocodilian bodies, they find that one of the larger (a parent) and the smaller one (their child) are still alive and can be healed. Should they do so, the parent and child mourn the loss of their loved one, but are grateful to the crawlers even though they also believe the Chosen One is a liar. The child will explain the absolutely, 100% true prophecy about a great hero who defeated a demon and sealed it into a tomb beneath the great domed temple. It prophesies that one day the demon will escape, and a chosen Crocodilian must take up the ancient hero's staff and drive it back into the darkness. The child hopes to grow up strong enough to be this Chosen One.

They show them where to find a supply of Scrolls of Water Breathing and offer to teach them how to swim, granting anyone who takes it a permanent +1 Swimming Skill.

They can also provide information about the King of the Crocodilians, who can explain more. If the crawlers cannot or do not heal the duo, then a map can be found providing the location of this castle, and a Book of Balance with the Crocodilian prophecy.

STAGE 3: CASTLE CONFRONTATION

The Crocodilian castle is a gaudy and gold thing against the swampy area. Despite sneers and attitude from the guards, the crawlers are allowed to speak to King LaClaw. He's gracious and a smooth talker, promising them that he understands they mean no harm by marking themselves as the Chosen One, but he really needs them to skedaddle before they cause any more unrest.

While the crawlers are there, King LaClaw calls in an advisor and tells her that he is raising taxes to make

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GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

TABLE 105: GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers come upon the High-Punchers (a group of stand-up comedians—see p. 620) engaged in a battle with Lutin Bounty Hunters. The Lutins attack the crawler party regardless of which side they attempt to join. The High-Punchers break bread with the crawler party afterward and are very surprised to see someone else is the Chosen One, since Mac is also a Chosen One.
2	A Lutin was caught in one of the Crocodilian nets. He reaches out, begging for the crawlers' help. The moment he's free, he steals an item from one of the crawlers and runs away cackling.
3	A Crocodilian floats backward in a pool of water, sunning himself. He waves to the crawlers and offers to play a game of dice with them. He happily wagers and even pays up if he loses.
4	Jaakop reads a copy of the Scrolls of Solace and tells the crawlers that a great Lutin Chosen One will rise soon. He suggests the players leave so the true Chosen One can reveal themselves.
5	A crawler becomes separated from the party by a Sauce-Tosser trap. They find themselves staring into the murderous face of a Lutin hunting party intent on carving them up for dinner.
6	A Weak group of Temple Guards attacks a Death-Roller. The Death-Roller calls for help. If the crawlers avoid the fight, the guards attack the party afterward. (This only triggers after *Stage 3*—see below.)

QUEST EVENTS

Here are things crawlers might experience to evoke the mood of this Quest:

- Jaakob comes upon the remnants of a battle, where three Lutins and a Crocodilian cling to life. He heals each of them in turn, based on the severity of their wounds, but does demand payment for his help.
- A Lutin child cries in the middle of the road. As you watch, LaClaw swaggers toward the child. A moment later, he lifts the child up onto his shoulders, singing and promising to find the child's parents and return the child for a reward.
- A Temple Guard's stony form stands over the slain corpse of a Crocodilian
- The bones of a giant beast lay glistening in the flickering torchlight, the scent of dust and decay heavy on the air as a massive grinding sounds from the stones around you. It's a trap!

sure their home is protected against the coming evil that only a Crocodilian Chosen One can stop. She hesitates and reminds him he's already raised taxes, and the Lutin temple is also demanding tithes, so the people are struggling.

He questions if she wants the prophesied ruin to overtake them or not, and she quickly agrees to draft the proclamation. King LaClaw again tells the crawlers to leave now before he is forced to take drastic measures.

As the crawlers leave, the harried advisor presses the fourth Temple Key into a crawler's hand. It has a note asking them to please find out what's really happening in the temple.

STAGE 4: TEMPLE RUN

With all the keys to the domed temple in hand now, the crawlers can enter the temple to face the truth.

As the crawlers enter the temple, they find a small entry room filled with holes and an old tapestry depicting a grand battle between a united group of Lutins and Crocodilians facing down a massive demonic beast. Beneath the tapestry, an old stone beam held together by ropes leans over four keyholes and a stick wrapped in shiny fabric. As soon as the keys are placed into the hole (that's what she said), LaClaw and Jaakop enter.

They admit that they should have known these crawlers would be too stubborn to leave well enough

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alone. Jaakop offers to pay them to leave, but King LaClaw tells him no way, that's his money. The two argue, coming to blows over it, both of them wanting more money from these scared villagers who will pay anything to feel safe and believe anything just to feel in control. They admit they've killed Crawlers before and they'll do it again to keep the truth from getting out: there is no Staff of Smacking, and an ancient demon died a long time ago and is never coming back.

While the pair are admitting there is no ancient evil to be slain, the stone beam over the keys twitches and smashes forward, crushing both men in a single blow. The ground rumbles, and the walls start to crack open.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The tapestry rips to pieces as eight stone pillars burst forward. Stone grinds against stone, and ropes creak as a giant stone spider emerges. The spider is made of stone, with eight pillar-legs bound together with rope and shadowy magic. Everything slows to a halt, and the crawlers' mugshots appear in the middle of their view. Below them, a cartoon torch slowly illuminates the word "versus" and *THE TEMPLE GUARDIAN* in all-caps. The Temple Guardian cackles madly in a voice exactly like the Temple Guards, whom it summons as fodder to distract and annoy the crawlers during the fight. It stomps the ground, sending earthquakes to knock the players down and raining chunks of rock from above. It tries to bowl them over in a stampede of stone, and executes a stone-shooting attack as well.

Every time it moves, the ropes that bind it together creak in protest. Cutting the ropes won't be easy, but if they manage to do it, it's an easy way to cause damage (see below). If the High-Punchers have been befriended, they can assist.

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CLUES

- Attacking the ropes should be easier than attacking the body.
- High-Punchers, if with the party, can distract the Boss while the crawlers focus on the ropes.

AI The Temple Guardian.

Level 63 Borough Boss!

You probably had an overachieving Boss. One that insists things be done to the highest level, regardless of who's watching.

Now imagine they have control over not just your life, but your eternity.

The Temple Guardian was created with a mix of Crocodilian and Lutin magic to bind the demon beneath the temple. Unfortunately, no one counted on one simple fact: Demons need to eat, too.

So, within two weeks, the demon, already massively weakened by a mortal wound, simply starved to death. The Temple Guardian was left with nothing to do—nothing but plot its escape. Over time, it managed to send pieces of itself into the world above in the form of Temple Guards.

The Temple Guardian claims it hasn't gone insane, but conveys that sentiment in a long, indecipherable string of words, so... you be the judge. Regardless, the task now falls to you to put this aggressive guardian down once and for all. Prophecy or no prophecy, it appears you're the only ones fit for the job, destiny be damned.

Temple Guardian

Borough Boss; Huge (6), Insane Guardian

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
5%	10%	15%	20%	25%	30%	35%	40%	45%	50%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
55%	60%	65%	70%	75%	80%	85%	90%	95%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
63	12+F	16+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
50 (+6)	5 (+2)	60 (+6)	50 (+6)	5 (+2)

Stone Shot: 16+F to hit, 5d12+6 Piercing, 50ft range

Stone Drop: 15+5 to hit, 7d8 Piercing, 30ft range

Earthquake Stomp: 15+F to hit, 5d6+6 Bludgeoning, 20ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Stone Stampede: 15+F to hit, 5d6+6 Bludgeoning, 20ft Line
This attack automatically hits any crawler with the Take Down Debuff.

Summon Temple Guard: One Temple Guard appears at the end of the Mob Action Resolution, maneuvers into position, but does not attack this turn.

Notes: *Fit to be Untied*—A crawler can attempt to cut one of the ropes holding the Temple Guardian together by making an Attack with Disadvantage vs. Difficulty 16. On Success, they sever the rope, and the Temple Guardian loses 2 HB slots.

WALK-ON CHARACTERS

The crawlers aren't the only ones mixed up in this misguided attempt to fulfill a prophecy that was never meant to be fulfilled.

THE HIGH-PUNCHERS

During one late-night practice improv session, this group of stand-up comedians had just stepped outside for a clove cigarette break, only for the world to end around them. While they never amounted to much in the world before, in the dungeon, they've formed a team of formidable martial artists. They've come to this Quest from the other side, believing "Brave Swordsman LaClaw" is the chosen one, and was besmirched by "Severe Priest Jaako."

AI Crawler #11,400,403 "Josh Camfo."

Level 53.

Race: Human.

Class: Brawler.

AI Crawler #11,400,407 "Mac Mac."

Level 53.

Race: Classic Dwarf.

Class: Pit Fighter.

Marked as a Chosen One.

AI Crawler #11,400,406 "Catie Sant"

Level 55.

Race: High Elf.

Class: Capoeistra.

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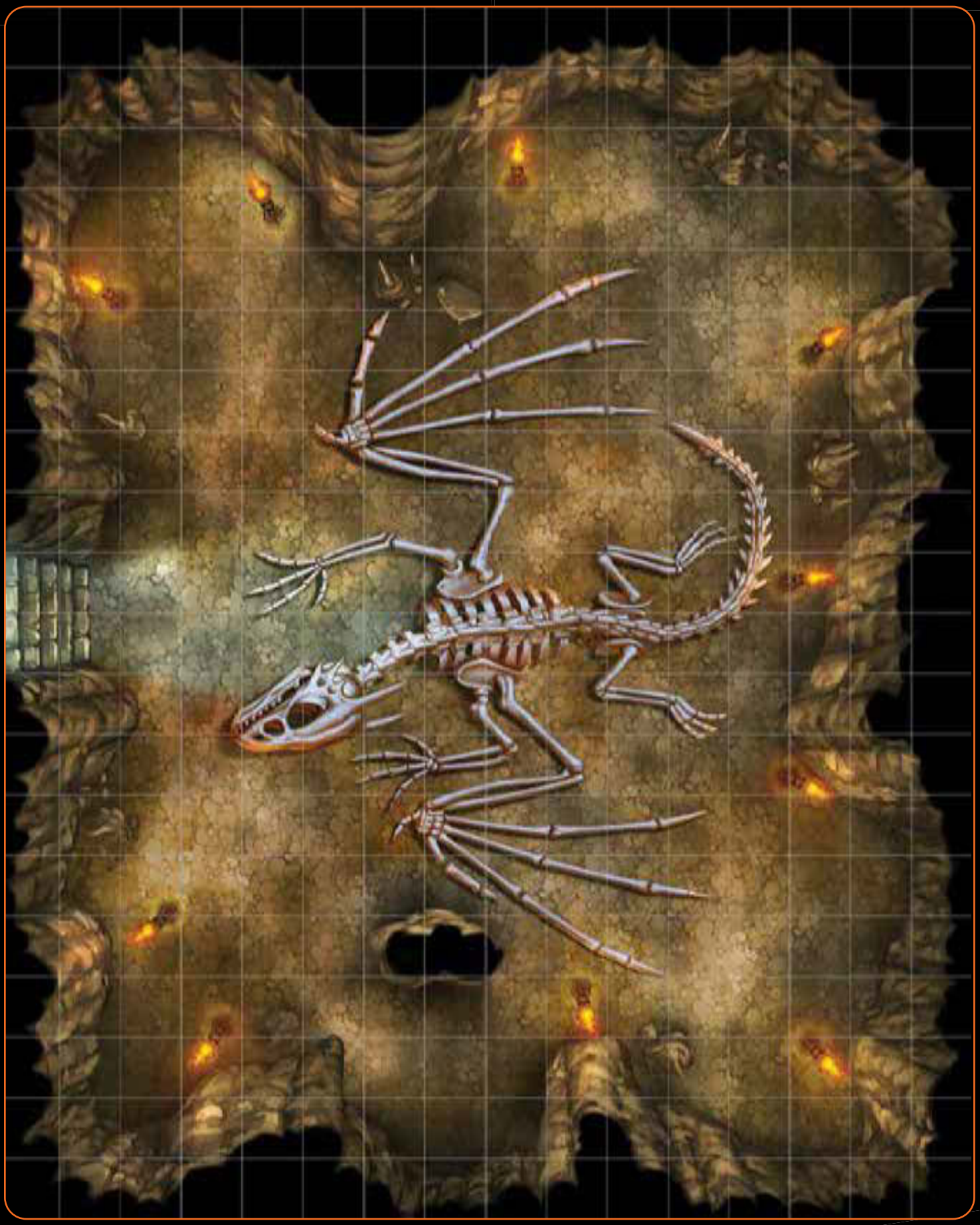

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QUEST: TOXIC POSITIVITY PROTOCOL

FLOOR: 5 — THEME: EVIL RAINBOWS VS. EMO BEARS

The battle between light and darkness is eternal—or at least that's what people say when they want to make something sound more important than it really is. The current conflict isn't a grand cosmic struggle so much as a war between weaponized cheerfulness and aggressively curated misery.

On one side is Whisper, a rainbow-obsessed Bune who rules from a castle in the clouds. She genuinely believes everyone would be better off if they'd just embrace the positivity of the light. On the other are the Ursine of The Bleak, led by Dominic Hawthorne, who would very much prefer to be left alone in their gloom, having grown tired of being forcibly "improved" by a swarm of glittering enforcers.

The Bleak didn't start this fight, but they're more than willing to end it. Unfortunately, the situation isn't nearly as straightforward as either side believes. Whisper isn't the true cause of the conflict, no matter how much she currently looks the part.

High above it all, nestled among storm clouds and Bolt Hawk nests, Aurion, the Quarrel Hawk, quietly stoked tensions, using his psionic abilities to push both sides closer and closer toward open war. The more everyone clashes, the more he feeds on the chaos, growing stronger with every escalation.

Potential Castle: Whisper's Castle

STRONG STARTS

- A group of Ursine musicians calling themselves The Bleak are midway through an emotionally devastating rendition of "Goodbye Sky Harbor" by Jimmy Eat World when the performance is swarmed by a group of Rainbow Sprites screaming, "Your depression has no place here! It's time to lighten up!" The creatures unleash a barrage of rainbow light and dust bombs across the stage. Within seconds, the band breaks, scattering in all directions while clutching their instruments and swatting desperately at the clinging clouds of color as the Sprites swarm.
- Rainbow Sprites swarm the crawlers, having taken immediate offense to their insufficiently vibrant appearance. Bursts of multicolored light and powder explode around them, coating armor, weapons, and clothing in thick flour-like layers of garish pigment. As the assault dies down, an Ursine with a perfectly maintained black comb-over appears calmly at their side, hands them a towel, and gestures vaguely at the lingering haze. "Yeah... that happens a lot. You'll want to keep moving."
- The crawlers spot a huge dragon hunting in their Air Quadrant. It's Cirrus (p. 630) who takes an opportunity for a friendly ear to learn about what's happening or to complain about his problems with Whisper. He can even suggest that Sprite Dust (p. 627) could help them with a problem they have.

QUEST DESCRIPTION

When the crawlers receive this Quest, the AI announces it with the following text in a dramatic fashion:

> New Quest: Toxic Positivity Protocol.
>
> There's a saying: "Let there be light." It sounds great, right up until someone shines that light directly into your eyes and insists you should be grateful for the experience. Some people, as it turns out, don't respond well to that level of enthusiasm and instead choose to lash out in increasingly dramatic and emotionally charged ways.
>
> The Rainbow Sprites and the Ursine of this region reached that exact stalemate. One side wants everything brighter. The other wants to be left alone in the dark. Neither is willing to compromise, and both are making it everyone else's problem. Go figure out what the hell is actually going on.
>
> *Reward:* You've received a Gold Quest Box.

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ALTERATIONS

This Quest can be adapted for a surface-dwelling faction attempting to bring light and color down into the depths, willing occupants or not. In this version, creatures such as wolverines might replace the Bolt Hawks, serving a similar territorial role with slightly less lightning and slightly more attitude.

The Cloud Dragon instead guards the passage between the subterranean world and the surface, preventing access to Whisper's domain unless specific conditions are met. Opening the path requires the right spectrum of light, because, of course, it does.

MOBS

The Mobs found in the Toxic Positivity Protocol Quest are either incredibly colorful in appearance or exceptionally dark, clad in torn skinny jeans, black band tees, and tightly fitted hoodies.

BOLT HAWK

At a glance, these large raptors bear a significant resemblance to other hawks found on the surface, apart from their blue and yellow plumage. A Bolt Hawk stands roughly four feet tall with a wingspan exceeding ten feet, putting it in the same size category as the largest condors but with far worse intentions.

When threatened, a Bolt Hawk can transform into a literal stroke of lightning, flashing up to 100 feet in an instant and carrying itself along the arc while blasting everything in its path. The effect is destructive, leaving little time to react and even less time to regret your life choices.

After unleashing this ability, the creature must recover briefly before it can do it again, so if you're planning to survive the encounter, that's your window. Use it wisely.

AI **Bolt Hawk. Level 30.**

It's a bird! It's a plane! Nope, it really is a bird—a big damn bird with razor-sharp talons, a bad attitude, and the tendency to spontaneously erupt into a bolt of lightning whenever the fancy strikes them. Don't piss these guys off, or you're likely to end up flash-fried, which I suppose isn't any worse than the other ways you're likely to die.

On second thought, go for it. Try not to have too much fun!

Bolt Hawk

Mob; Small (2), Beast

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
30	12+F	15+F	30+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	5 (+2)	22 (+5)	35 (+5)	12 (+4)

Ride the Lightning Spell: 12+F to hit, 4d8+2 Electric, 100ft Line
Bolt Hawks can Move 100ft along with this attack and can use this attack every other round.

Talons: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Slashing, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Can move through air as if on the ground.

BUNE LIEUTENANT

These small lizard-folk bear the semblance of a humanoid dragon from Earth's mythology. They're incredibly agile and have an innate understanding of magic that makes them versatile magic-casters. These Bunes in particular are reminiscent of the Syndicate Race that was once featured in a previous season of *Dungeon Crawler World*, but they have no direct ties to those of their Race outside the dungeon... or do they?

Wherever a large group of Rainbow Sprites can be found, one of these lieutenants is sure to be nearby, though they tend to let the little creatures run wild unless they're threatened or given some other reason to respond directly.

AI **Bune Lieutenant. Level 35.**

Bunes are a slight dragon-like people that are naturally peaceful, unless pressed into service by an overly colorful warlord disguising herself as a bright rainbow of light here to make everyone's lives better. They now wear garishly colorful robes and serve as Rainbow Sprite-herders while attempting to enforce the new, dizzyingly colorful agenda of their leader with as much force as necessary.

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Bune Lieutenant

NPC; Petite (3), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	41 (+5)	23 (+5)	37 (+5)	13 (+4)

Claw: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Notes: *Rainbow Magic*—Bune Lieutenants can cast the following Spells at Rank 10, each of which has rainbow-like visual effects: Dirt Clod, Heal Critter, Hole, Magic Missile, and Shield.

BUNE LIGHT GUARD

Though all Bune are considered small by most other Syndicate Races, these guards defy that assumption. Each wears chainmail armor constructed of golden rings that shine in the light, and they wield twin short swords with blades of harnessed rainbow hues that can cut through all but the most resilient materials. The guards are extremely loyal to Whisper and her lieutenants, but even some of them noticed the change in her mentality and methods as of late.

AI **Bune Light Guard. Level 38.**

The stereotypical Bune leans toward Rogue or Mage, but these light-wielding lizards clearly decided subtlety is overrated. They're fast, aggressive, and swinging blades made of solid light, which feels like it should break a few IP laws. (It probably does.)

Fortunately, those laws don't apply here. Good luck. You're gonna need it.

Bune Light Guard

NPC; Petite (3), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
38	14+F	15+F	20+S	6
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
26 (+5)	19 (+4)	31 (+5)	35 (+5)	9 (+3)

Lightsword: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Force, 5ft range, Armor-Piercing

Notes: *Golden Armor*—This armor grants Bune Light Guard the ability to use the Wisp Armor Spell at Rank 5, once per combat.

"He was a bune. They are a slight, dragon-like people. Naturally peaceful, but they can be some of the most clever fighters. That was his real race. I've seen a few crawlers this season who've picked it. Good rogues and magic casters, but they have low constitution. They grow wings and get a dexterity bonus when they hit level 50. If crocodilians are the barbarians of the lizard world, think of the bune as the elves."

—Mordecai

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RAINBOW SPRITE

Rainbow Sprites are hairy puffs of adorable, colorful fur roughly the size of a head of lettuce with arms, legs, and antennae. They dart around in wingless flight, leaving trails of fine dust and more than one resulting spasm of sneezing in their wake.

The color of a Rainbow Sprite's fur determines both the hue of its magic and the color of the glitter bomb it leaves behind, and they absolutely *love* linking hands to blanket entire areas in rainbow dust. Their antennae can sense invisible creatures in a general area, but if they want something more precise, they'll simply saturate the space with dust until the target is revealed.

They harbor an intense dislike for anything dark, drab, or insufficiently cheerful, and they're always willing to be "helpful" by sprucing them up with their "cheerful" dust.

AI Rainbow Sprite. Level 35.

These adorable tufts of colored fur zoom around, spraying everyone and everything with their multi-colored dander. Even killing them causes an explosion of colorful glitter. At this point, they're less a species and more an aggressively mobile bath bomb. Won't someone give these poor things a bath?

Rainbow Sprite

Mob; Tiny (1), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
35	14+F	15+F	20+S	7
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
18 (+4)	19 (+4)	29 (+5)	43 (+5)	9 (+3)

Light Lance Spell: 14+F to hit, 4d8+4 Force, 40ft range

Dust Blast Spell: 14+F to hit, 4d6+4 Force, 30ft range, 5ft Blast radius

Any crawler who loses 2+ HB slots gains the Dusted Debuff: Disadvantage on Attacks and Skill Checks requiring sight until an Action is spent to wipe their eyes clean. Invisible creatures are revealed until the end of combat.

Notes: *Flight*—Rainbow Sprites move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.

URSINE EDGE MEMBER

The Ursine are humanoid bears typically available as a crawler Race on the Third Floor. Unlike their Ursine cousins, they aren't bound by religious doctrine and tend toward more independent, worldly pursuits.

In this case, independence manifested as The Bleak, an emo collective that grew thoroughly tired of being surrounded by forced color and relentless cheer. What began as quiet protests and concerts escalated into a full-blown aesthetic rebellion of torn jeans, dyed black hair, and aggressively maintained angst.

AI Ursine Edge Member. Level 32.

This is an Ursine, a bear-like humanoid that decidedly does not care about the theocratic crap spewed by their distantly related Ursine Clerics. I like them better. They're much more fun to be around.

This particular Ursine is a member of The Bleak, an emo group dedicated to removing the poser Whisper from power. I'm rooting for these guys, but they aren't the most competent group when it comes to things like revolution... or personal hygiene.

Ursine Edge Member

NPC; Medium (4), Beastly

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
32	14+F	14+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
29 (+5)	14 (+4)	29 (+5)	15 (+4)	14 (+4)

Club: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Spreading Scent: 14+F to hit, 4d6+4 Acid, 20ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Tagged Debuff: A new Ursa Edge Member shows and seeks to mate with you.

NPCS

Key NPCs in Toxic Positivity Protocol Quest are at opposite ends of the social spectrum, with one end being toxically bubbly and the other quietly morose.

DOMINIC HAWTHORNE

In the before times, Hawthorne was a celebrated musician. His voice drew tens of thousands as he and his bandmates thrashed guitars, slammed drums,

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and unleashed smooth, gravel-tinged vocals on the world. A few years back, the Ursine fell out of the spotlight and retired to a small town alongside several of his former bandmates and the few fans who still remembered his name. Since then, he has been content to wallow in introspective misery, right up until Whisper descended on his home.

Since then, she and her Rainbow Sprites spread their unwelcome color across the town with abandon. Taking exception to this and recognizing an opportunity to rise to relevance once again, Dominic rallied his people and began protesting the intrusive chromaticism. Now he's had enough, and he's willing to do whatever it takes to make Whisper stop her bright antics and leave him to his carefully curated gloom.

AI Dominic Hawthorne. Ursine Bard. Level 50.

The self-righteous Ursine preach hypocrisy while this guy is out here living his best... well, most melancholy... life. No restrictions on his side-parted hair, The Bleak T-shirt he wears everywhere, or his frequent use of phrases like "all the world will turn to gray" and "your mother was a hamster."

Beneath the chronic gloom, Dominic is an exceptionally talented musician and a natural leader, whether he admits it or not.

Dominic Hawthorne

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
42 (+5)	23 (+5)	36 (+5)	24 (+5)	52 (+6)

Chain of Woe: 15+F to hit, 5d10+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Sorrowful Blast: 15+F to hit, 5d8+5 Sonic, 20ft Cone Any hit crawler is pushed 10 feet.

Notes: *Former Vocalist*—Dominic Hawthorne can cast the following Spells at Rank 5: Earworm, Hot Stuff Aura, and Panty Dropper.

WHISPER

While most Bune have scales of a single color, Whisper's are a myriad rainbow of shifting, metallic hues, constantly catching the light in ways a little too mesmerizing to be entirely comfortable. The scales atop her head gleam a bright, golden-yellow, flowing down the back of her neck and glinting in the sunlight. She favors a blue dress trimmed in softly spiraling rainbow tones, carefully arranged to project warmth, brightness, and just the right amount of authority.

Until recently, she was content to remain in her cloud-bound castle, looking down on the world below and quietly lamenting its distressing lack of color. However, as Aurion's influence grew, it convinced her that the world doesn't simply lack vibrancy but is actively suffering because of it. With the help of a summoned horde of Rainbow Sprites, she set out to correct the problem, spreading color, light, and enforced optimism across the land, whether it's wanted or not.

She rarely descends to the surface herself, preferring instead to observe from above as entire regions are transformed beneath her influence, each burst of color another step toward her vision of a better world. Whether anyone else agrees is, at this point, largely irrelevant.

AI Whisper. Bune Polychromatic Lightcaster. Level 50.

Holy Rainbow Brite, Batman! This polychromatic Bune is nothing if not colorful and cheery, so cheery it makes me want to vomit! (If I could vomit.)

Seriously, this lady's positivity is TOXIC! No one likes to hear "it could be worse" when they're lying there amid dead comrades and missing their left foot from an explosion that Merlin guy set off on the last floor. But that's just how she is. She sees a positive spin on everything. So gross!

Whisper

NPC; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
50	15+F	15+F	20+2	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
51 (+6)	40 (+5)	31 (+5)	32 (+5)	26 (+5)

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Light Lance: 16+F to hit, 5d8+5 Force, 50ft range

Polychrome Vortex Spell: 15+F to hit, 4d6+5 Force, 60ft range, 15ft Blast radius
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blinded Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Whisper can move through the air as though on the ground.

TRAPS

Crawlers likely face several traps in Whisper's castle, though less-harmful ones such as the Sparkly-Poof may trigger on the ground as well, to spread color and light, of course. Glooming traps are more likely encountered on the ground, set by The Bleak as a defense against the encroaching colorism.

- **Sparkly-Poof:** This delightful little nightmare combines rainbow magic with weaponized Sprite dander. When triggered, it detonates in a burst of blinding color and airborne glitter that blasts targets and aggressively invades their eyes, sinuses, and dignity. Temporary blindness is common. Regret is guaranteed.
- **Blinding Light Lance:** Think Sparkly-Poof, but with commitment. Instead of a polite explosion, this trap fires a concentrated beam of multicolored light straight through the offending individual, carving a glowing line of pain while attempting to blind anything still capable of seeing. Subtle, it is not.
- **Glooming:** Not everything here wants to be cheerful. This trap floods the area with oppressive shadow and existential dread, layering a psionic attack over a thick, vision-choking fog and triggering mental Debuffs. It doesn't just make it hard to see; it makes it hard to care.

QUEST ITEMS

The last portion of the Quest occurs on a cloud island adrift in the artificial sky. While crawlers may utilize several ways to reach the castle, the depressingly gray rainbow bridge (aka the Painbow) created by The Bleak is the most likely. Sprite dust harvested from the Rainbow Sprites is sprinkled on the Painbow to keep it solid and traversable, even if the band is silenced.

- **Sprite Dust:** Not to be confused with pixie dust, this colorful powder is gathered from Rainbow Sprites and used to extend the duration of any existing rainbow bridge.

TABLE 106 GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A lone drummer stumbles through a few drum patterns before launching into an incredible drum solo. Within moments, other musicians, a singer, and even dancers join in, flash-mob style, building to a full performance like this was planned... which it absolutely wasn't. I swear.
2	The crawlers come upon a building splattered with perfectly circular bursts of color, each radiating outward from a small untouched center about the size of a head of lettuce. The overlapping patterns suggest repeated targeted impacts. Whatever made them is either very precise or very enthusiastic.
3	A lone Bune Lieutenant sits crying and mumbling to themselves. Should the crawlers get close enough, they overhear phrases like "it didn't use to be like this..." and "She was such a kind soul once..." The moment they're noticed, the Bune snaps upright, wipes their face, and insists everything is fine.
4	The crawlers find a slain Ursine with every hair standing on end, bearing scorch marks and deep slashing wounds caused by talons. The Ursine got too close to one of the rare surface-bound Bolt Hawk nests, which the crawlers have now stumbled into as well. Then, half a dozen Bolt Hawks launch themselves into the air and attack.
5	A group of Ursine attempt to wash the colorful marks off of one of the town buildings and a nearby statue of Dominic Hawthorne built when he was still topping the charts. Their attempts are only moderately successful: colors smear, blend, and spread, turning the entire effort into a slow-motion disaster.
6	A trio of star-like lights shoots through the sky high above, trailing translucent rainbows in their wake before disappearing into the clouds above.

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QUEST EVENTS

- A drab, once-gray building was absolutely obliterated by color. Every surface is splattered in chaotic bursts like someone lost a fight with a crate of paint bombs and decided to take the building with them. It's vibrant, it's aggressive, and it's deeply upsetting.
- A Werak group of Ursine whispers in an alleyway. These bearfolk are obviously afraid of being seen by someone, but they don't react if they notice the crawlers watching them. Either the crawlers are not the problem, or they're so far down the list that it's not worth the energy.
- A swarm of Rainbow Sprites descends without warning, pelting buildings and NPCs alike with explosive bursts of color while shrieking with manic delight. The Ursine scatter for cover as laughter echoes through the streets, high-pitched and just a little too enthusiastic.
- After sunset, a tight group of clouds high in the sky glows with multicolored light. The clouds themselves radiate the rainbow of colors, even as rainbows themselves emanate from somewhere above them.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements on this Quest:

- **Blinded by the Light:** "You were blinded by a trap. I can't believe you didn't see that coming! Well, I guess you won't see much of anything coming anytime soon. Best of luck, Blinkin!
  Reward: Yeah... we don't reward people for being dumbasses. Feel free to try again. Maybe next time you'll earn something other than disappointment."
  Contents: A pair of old-timey swimming goggles that grant +2 to Swimming and Perception Checks.
- **Somewhere Over the Painbow:** "You reached the Sky Castle using the Painbow of sensation and internal pain created by The Bleak. Way to use their pain to your benefit!
  Reward: You've received a Gold Attaboy Box!"
  Contents: Character is it's own reward.
- **Cannonball!:** "You fell from a great height, and you survived! You know who else fell from a...? You know what, never mind. Fuck you.
  Reward: You've received a Bronce Skydiver's Box! Not that you deserve it, you little punk."
  Contents: A hang glider.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers defeat a few Mobs from Toxic Positivity Protocol, they might grind for experience by killing lots of the same Mobs over and over. Bolt Hawks are the most likely candidate for the slaughter, but other non-Quest-related Mobs are possibilities as well. Table 106 provides some complications.

STAGE 1: NIGHT AT THE IMPROV

The party stumbles into an open plaza just as a spontaneous emo concert erupts into existence like it was legally required to happen. A group of Ursine in matching black band shirts and aggressively dyed hair launch into a dueling guitar performance that swiftly escalates. Like a flash mob in a pre-Collapse mall, other Ursine musicians join in as the duel builds. Eventually, the concert crescendos to a huge climax of blazing guitar solos and ends with a chord that rings in the resounding silence.

As the concert draws to a close, a swarm of Rainbow Sprites descends on the plaza, shrieking about emotional wellness while unleashing blasts of multicolored light and dust across the crowd. Their enthusiasm is immediate, overwhelming, and deeply unwelcome. They don't just want to brighten the mood; they're here to enforce it.

The crowd responds the only way it knows how: with a mosh pit. It's less violent than most, more jumping and shoving than outright aggression, but it's still chaos. Somewhere, a giant blow-up goat appears and begins surfing the crowd. Crawlers who join in the tangled bodies of the mosh pit are quickly accepted as part of the scene as long as they aren't outright violent, which is great for morale and terrible for survival, as it makes them very obvious targets for Sprite "assistance."

A single Bune with a gray trenchcoat worn over rainbow robes stands in the back of the crowd, her head moving with the music in obvious elation. This is one of Whisper's lieutenants who doesn't understand why the drive to color everything became so extreme and so urgent. She runs from the congregation, if possible, but doesn't hesitate to stand her ground if caught, summoning the Rainbow Sprites under her command to defend her if necessary. If not attacked, the Bune expresses her misgivings but is not willing to outright betray Whisper's trust.

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STAGE 2: POLYCHROMATIC STORM

Whisper does not arrive quietly.

She descends from her cloud-top castle atop a hovering skateboard with the name "Starlight" scrawled across the underside in glittering graffiti as it leaves a blazing rainbow trail through the sky. A chorus of colorful Rainbow Sprites swarm around her, joined by several Bune Lieutenants, all descending in a display reminiscent of barfing up a family-sized pack of Skittles after a late-night tequila binge where you absolutely ate the worm.

When she speaks, it's with sickening warmth, addressing the town's "lack of color" like it's a problem that can and *will* be corrected. Her pedantic tone suggests she's not asking; she's *helping*. Whether anyone wants that help is, at best, a secondary consideration. When she's finished, the entire procession spirals upward in a literal tornado of color, vanishing back into the clouds like an overly enthusiastic natural disaster.

What follows is hours of chaos. Small skirmishes erupt across the town as The Bleak pushes back against waves of aggressively cheerful Sprites. None of it spills into the main streets, but alleyways become battlegrounds as Ursine defend homes, murals, and emotional boundaries with varying degrees of success. The crawlers inevitably stumble into the chaos and are liable to be drawn into skirmishes between the two sides.

In one street, a group of Ursine musicians steps out of a bar and begins to play. The sound attracts nearby Rainbow Sprites, their colors dimming as the music deepens into something raw and heavy. For a brief moment, the swarm of Sprites hangs suspended in a heavy gray silence before they snap from their stupor, shake the color back into themselves, and zip off to continue their forced pigmentation efforts.

Elsewhere, a Weak group of Bune argues in a narrow alley, their voices sharp enough to cut through the noise. One insists Whisper has changed, that something is influencing her. The other dismisses it entirely, convinced this is simply Whisper finally willing to do something about the boring and depressing state of the town.

STAGE 3: TO THE SKIES!

By now, the crawlers likely decided Whisper is the problem, or at the very least that someone needs to have a very urgent and direct conversation with her or her court. Unfortunately, that conversation requires getting to her, and the castle floats more than a mile above the ground.

If the crawlers earned the trust of The Bleak, they're offered a solution: the Painbow. Through sheer emotional commitment and an impressive amount of musical angst, the Ursine can generate a bridge of muted light in varying shades of gray that stretches into the sky. It holds as long as the music plays, which means it's on a timer the moment it starts. The crawlers may need to run or use vehicles and mounts to traverse the Painbow.

Rainbow Sprites won't tolerate that kind of vibe for long and are absolutely on their way to shut it down. Sprite dust can temporarily reinforce the bridge, but otherwise it's a race between ascent and interruption. Flight-based Skills or Spells like Air Buddy (p. 202) or flying machines are also options here, of course.

As the party climbs (or flies), Bolt Hawks descend in force, screaming through the air to defend their nests and cause general chaos. They harass the ascent relentlessly, diving and striking mercilessly as Aurion feeds on the escalating conflict. Below, Sprites converge on the band, eager to end the performance and collapse the bridge.

When the crawlers reach the island, they land near a cave mouth made of ominous dark clouds. Inside resides Cirrus, the antediluvian Cloud Dragon who comes out of his cave roaring, with puffs of cloud streaming from his nose and throat. Fortunately, his terrifying roar swiftly ends in a fit of coughing. A final forceful emission ejects a cloud puff that morphs into a tiny dragon and flutters off, only to die as a Bolt Hawk spears it with its talons. After a moment of stunned silence, the Cloud Dragon turns and addresses the crawlers politely as if nothing happened.

If befriended, Cirrus offers a hidden route into the castle that bypasses many of Whisper's defenses, along with a warning to watch out for traps and that something isn't right in the kingdom of color. Whisper hasn't been herself for months, and whatever influences her is only making things worse. Additionally, he believes the Ursine below will eventually come looking for answers, and the Dragon fears their retribution for something he wasn't particularly involved in.

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STAGE 4: THE SIEGE

Once the crawlers reach the castle, they must navigate a sprawling maze of hallways and chambers, each wing dedicated to a different color of the rainbow and filled with appropriately themed Sprites. Bune Lieutenants direct the swarms while Bune Light Guards patrol the halls, ensuring Whisper's version of "help" continues uninterrupted.

The entire place radiates positivity, bordering on mild psychological warfare. Whisper is convinced that the Ursine simply don't know what they need, so it's her duty to help them find their way to the rainbow. Some of the Bune embraced this philosophy wholeheartedly while others quietly question whether forcibly improving people is the best approach.

As the crawlers push deeper, they encounter a Moderate patrol of Bune Light Guards accompanied by a Moderate cluster of Rainbow Sprites making their rounds. If spotted, the patrol detains the group and demand an explanation. If that doesn't go well (and let's be honest, it won't), the situation escalates quickly.

As the crawlers wander through the complex, they discover a sitting room that appears recently occupied. A fire crackles in the hearth, and a cup of coffee still steams beside a plush deep-green chair. Resting in the seat is a book titled *The Invisible Influence*, detailing psionic manipulation and mind-affecting magic. A single dog-eared page describes the Quarrel Hawk who "inspires conflict where none exists so it feeds its vampire-like psyche."

Whether the crawlers figure it out from the book left behind by the Bune Lieutenant as a clue, or Whisper breaks down mid-conversation because she no longer understands why she's doing what she's doing, the party likely determines there is more to this mystery than there seems.

A hidden door somewhere in the castle leads to the top of the tallest tower where Aurion awaits, charged by the conflict he sowed between Whisper and The Bleak and unwilling to give up his schemes.

WALK-ON CHARACTERS

Cirrus is a Cloud Dragon NPC that can influence the course the Quest takes significantly but is not necessarily a required encounter. Shelly G, on the other hand, already has her goals in mind and is exceedingly difficult to sway once she sets her mind on something.

CIRRUS

This old fart of a Cloud Dragon knows a lot about a lot of things. He knows that Bolt Hawks taste great with the right seasoning. He knows he's in a game he doesn't care to participate in. And he knows that something is influencing Whisper, but he doesn't know what.

Whisper used to listen to his stories, but he hasn't seen her for weeks. Cirrus can offer this information, along with a secret entrance to the castle if befriended and if the crawlers promise not to harm his friend unless absolutely necessary.

Cirrus will, however, attack if he's insulted or threatened. He's a dangerous adversary, but doesn't intend to fight to the death and believes he'll move deeper in the dungeon after this floor collapses.

AI Cirrus. Antediluvian Cloud Dragon. Level 80.

This is Cirrus, a Cloud Dragon that is WAAAAY past his prime. Some say he never even had a prime. But he's still a badass Dragon who eats Bolt Hawks for breakfast, so ya gotta give the guy some credit. Then again, he might lose some of it when you realize his impressive form is covered in Rainbow Sprite graffiti, and don't even get me started on the windstorms he whips up when he's digesting those Bolt Hawks.

Ancient Cloud Dragon

NPC; Colossal (7), Dragon

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
80	16+F	15+F	30+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
55 (+6)	55 (+6)	55 (+6)	25 (+5)	55 (+6)

Bite: 16+F to hit, 6d8+6 Piercing, 15ft range
If a crawler does not successfully Evade, they gain the Swallowed Debuff: The crawler is swallowed whole and cannot be attacked. When an attack against the Ancient Cloud Dragon results in an Amazing Success or better (or it dies), all crawlers remove the Swallowed Debuff. Swallowed crawlers take 1d10+F Acid at the end of each round. Swallowed crawlers attack with Disadvantage vs 0 DR, and Slashing attacks deal ×2 damage.

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Flatulence Windstorm: 16+F to hit, 7d8+5 Sonic, 20ft Cone Any hit crawler is pushed back 10ft and gains the Queasy Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Ancient Cloud Dragons can move through the air as though on the ground.

SHELLY G.

Shelly previously pursued this Quest and refuses to let any other crawlers complete it before her. She likely blends in with the Ursine initially until she finds her own way up to the castle above. The information she collected convinced her that Whisper is terrorizing the Ursine. She identifies with The Bleak from her time before the Crawl and instantly sides with them, aiming to end Whisper's reign of polychromatic terror.

Even if the crawlers want to stop Whisper, Shelly G is likely to interfere so she can complete her solo quest and get her promised reward. She's obstinate and not particularly sympathetic to arguments of shared plight in the Bubble.

AI **Crawler #569,892. "Shelly G"**

Level 41.

Race: Doppelgänger.

Class: Pit Fighter.

Doppelgänger Saboteur

Crawler; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
41	15+F	15+F	20+S	F
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
51 (+6)	27 (+5)	21 (+5)	24 (+5)	20 (+5)

Fist Mass: 16+F to hit, 5d6+6 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

Notes: *Mass Shift*—This crawler can shift their mass into any shape so long as their mass remains the same. They lose 10% of their health each time they transform.

Slippery—Crawlers have Disadvantage when grappling or restraining this Doppelgänger.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Atop the tallest tower of Whisper's castle, hidden by an illusion that completely abandons all logic, is Aurion, the Quarrel Hawk Sovereign.

When the crawlers arrive, the rooftop is covered in a shallow, gently rippling sea of colorful rubber ducks. Bright balloons hang in the air above, tied to nothing yet somehow not torn away by the hurricane-force winds screaming just beyond the rooftop. At the center of this massive puddle stands a long party table with an untouched cake beneath a banner suspended midair that reads "CONGRATULATIONS!!!" in aggressively enthusiastic lettering.

As the crawlers step forward, the ducks slowly turn to face them and blink once before announcing in perfect cheerful unison: "We can fix you."

BOSS BATTLE DETECTED.

The illusion shatters, and reality slams back in. Surrounding the rooftop, Bolt Hawk nests crackle with energy as their inhabitants take to the air, and the wind threatens to send everyone plummeting toward the distant ground below. A deafening eagle's scream rips the sky apart.

Reality freezes mid-chaos, and feathers explode across the sky in a crackling storm of blue, yellow, and static as Aurion slams into view, wings spread wide.

Aurion is enormous, his blue-and-yellow plumage streaked with red as though the blood on his talons permanently seeped into his feathers. He moves with terrifying speed, diving in fly-by attacks that crackle the air and easily exceed 100mph.

His signature ability, Ride the Lightning, unleashes a devastating bolt of electricity that he rides across the battlefield for up to 200 feet, but the real danger isn't the lightning; it's the crawlers. Aurion feeds on conflict, twisting thoughts, amplifying aggression, and turning allies against each other. The more chaos he creates, the stronger he becomes.

CLUES

- Mobility and ranged weapons will serve you well against a flying Boss.
- If you find yourself attacking a friend, don't worry. It's for the best.
- If you can destroy enough of those little rubber duckies, that should help.

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AI **Aurion. Quarrel Hawk Sovereign.**

Level 75 Neighborhood Boss!

Instigator, manipulator, emotional parasite, and now he's your biggest problem.

You ever play that Angry Birds game that sapped the lives away from so many people on your planet? Yeah, those twitters ain't got nothin' on this guy. Conflict is literally his bread and butter. He eats it up, making him even more powerful. Good luck!

Aurion

Neighborhood Boss; Colossal (7), Beast

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
6%	13%	20%	26%	33%	40%	46%	53%
6	6	6	6	6	6	6	
60%	66%	73%	80%	86%	93%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
75	16+F	16+F	40+S	8
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
50 (+6)	50 (+6)	50 (+6)	50 (+6)	50 (+6)

Mind Dirge Spell: 16+F to hit, No damage, 20ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Angry Debuff: They must save at least one action to attack their nearest ally this round. After doing so, the attacker gains the Insight Buff: +2 to hit against Aurion (stackable).

Ride the Lightning Spell: 16+F to hit, 6d8+6 Electric, 200ft Line
Aurion can Move 200ft along with this attack. He never uses this more than once per round.

Talon: 16+F to hit, 7d10+6 Slashing, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Aurion can move through the air as though on the ground.

Ducky Destruction—Every point of damage an Area of Effect Spell deals to the sea of rubber ducks (vs. an Evade of 16 and 0 DR) destroys one of them. For every 25 damage dealt, Aurion loses 1 DR for the remainder of the fight, and targets those crawlers with at least 2 attacks the following round.

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APPENDIX 1: ICONIC GEAR

Whether or not Carl and Donut feature at your table, you may want to get your grubby little mitts on their gear. Here's a selection of gear from the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** series to use as-is, or modify.

ANKLET OF THE FALLEN OAK

Gear Slot: Accessory

Collected from the corpse of Grace Bautista 3, this accessory features three beads, possibly to signify the three benefits it grants.

- +1 Dexterity
- +1 Constitution
- +3 Double Tap Skill

CARL'S XISTERA

Gear Slot: Hand/Holding (when not retracted)

Carl's Xistera is a non-magical, wicker-like scoop used to play Cesta Punta. Carl's version is highly customized.

- Increase your Throwing Skill range by ×4 for things you throw this way
- The basket is retractable with a simple pull-ring, and when retracted it doesn't impede his gauntlets
- Items from your Inventory may be summoned (as an Action) straight into the basket. The basket automatically shrinks or widens to accommodate throwable items.

DRAKEA'S ENCHANTED KERCHIEF OF DISORDER

Gear Slot: Accessory or Head

This handy-dandy, versatile accessory can be worn around the neck, in the hair, or on your face if you want to cosplay as a cowboy robbing a bank. It can also be tied around your arms or legs, but only if you want to look like a moron. Don't tie it around your leg.

This simple, square piece of fabric is a reminder that looks can be deceiving. The wearer of this item receives the following benefits:

- +5 Detect Trap Skill
- Can cast a Rank 15 Tripper Spell once every 5 hours

EARTH UPGRADE PATCH

Gear Slot: Accessory

This patch depicts the planet Earth, which is currently under the regency of the Borant System. Ahh, the planet Earth. A whole lot of culture. A whole lot of spunk. So many dumbasses. If this upgrade patch is affixed to an eligible garment, it will imbue the following upgrades:

- +5% to Strength
- Immunity to Cone Area of Effect Attacks

Warning: *Upgrade patches are fleeting items. You may remove them, but they will be destroyed in the process.*

ENCHANTED ANARCHIST'S BATTLE RATTLE

Gear Slot: Torso

This sleeveless jacket offers only meager protection compared to some other items of this caliber. However, its ability to host as many upgrade patches as you can fit makes this one of the best, most upgradeable protection items in the game. The plain, unadorned version of this jacket imbues the following effects:

- +1 to all five Stats. Increases by +1 for each compatible patch added to this jacket. If an eligible Back Patch is added, this benefit is doubled.
- Access to the Desperado Club
- Access to the Naughty Boys Employment Agency
- +50% Throwing range and add DEX Mod a second time to hit for all thrown explosives
- You have +5 Accessory Gear Slots

ENCHANTED BIGBOI BOXERS

Gear Slot: Legs

Have you ever read an Incredible Hulk comic and wondered why everything rips off of his body except his pants? No way. Well, spoiler alert. You're not wrong. Size-altering and were-creatures, such as the BigBoi are required to wear enchanted, self-sizing items lest they wish to turn the dungeon into a nudist

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colony when they transform. That means everything they wear requires an enchantment. Everything, including their naughty little undies. The Enchanted BigBoi Boxers grant the following benefits:

- +2 Constitution
- Wearer may cast a Rank 15 Protective Shell Spell once every 30 hours
- Always fits

ENCHANTED CROWN OF THE SEPSIS WHORE

Gear Slot: Head

Equipping this glittering, purple crown permanently places the wearer into the line of succession for the Blood Sultanate.

For benefits and using the Crown in play, or a variant with a similar function in the story, see p. 238.

ENCHANTED FUR BRUSH OF THE ECCLESIASTIC

Must be used by someone other than the target. 10 minutes of brushing will impart the buff for 30 hours.

- +2 Constitution

ENCHANTED PEDICURE KIT OF THE SYLPH

Appears as a standard 12-item kit for essential foot care. Using the various tools for 15 minutes activates this item's benefits. All effects last for 30 hours and require the user to remain barefoot.

- Add your Str Mod a second time to damage from Foot Soldier Attacks
- +3 Smush Skill
- Unbreakable Feet Buff: Your feet and toes cannot be broken or severed
- Celestially Nimble and Tidy Feet Buff: Traps set off by your footfalls now set off an alarm and have a 5-second delay before the effect occurs

ENCHANTED NIGHTGAUNT CLOAK OF STOUTNESS

Gear Slot: Accessory or Torso

This black hooded cloak appears to be the leathery bat wing of a demon with finger-like bones running its length. With the hood up, the hood has ears on either side of the head, which makes you look like a dollar store Batman.

- +4 Constitution
- Resistance to Poison and Ice damage
- Adds Anti-Piercing to all worn armor

Warning: If a Nightgaunt spies you wearing this, they probably won't be too happy with you.

ENCHANTED NIGHT WYRM'S RING OF DIVINE SUFFERING

Gear Slot: Accessory

This band of green glass has an embedded red jewel that glows with enchantment. This accessory grants the Marked for Death Skill (p. 325).

For using the Ring in play, or a variant item, see pp. 325–327.

ENCHANTED REPEATING CROSSBOW OF THE SCAVENGER MOTHER OF MOTHERS

Gear Slot: Hand/Holding (requires two hands)

This golden ranged weapon will never run out of basic ammunition. It is said to have been made by Nekhebit and given to her last faithful warrior. It can be wielded only by a female.

- You may spend 1 AI Favor to make an additional Attack with this weapon each round
- Add your Str to the damage plus an extra +1 for every female in your party (to a max of +30)
- +15 Dexterity
- +10 Strength
- On Success, the target gains the Birth Defect Debuff: Their offspring will be "off" (GM's choice)

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ENCHANTED ROLL OF NEVER-ENDING DUCT TAPE

Appears identical to a regular, gray roll of duct tape. 50 meters in length. Regenerates at the rate of one meter per hour until restored to the original length.

ENCHANTED SHADE GNOLL RIOT FORCES CROWD CONTROL SHIELD

Gear Slot: Hand/Holding

This shield may only be equipped by those who have a physical Line Attack, like Monster Truck Driver (p. 151). With no DR, this shield is useless for most folks.

- +5% Constitution
- +5 Rooted in Place Skill (Passive): Reduce the number of feet you are pushed, pulled, slid, or thrown by your Rank in this Skill
- Crowd Blast: Add a +5ft Splash on each side of the physical Line Attack the user already has, though each victim in the Splash area has Advantage if they Evade

ENCHANTED SHADE GNOLL RIOT FORCES TELESCOPING CROWD CONTROL BATON

Gear Slot: Hand/Holding

A single-handed weapon (Club), its length adjusts from 10 inches to 3½ feet.

- When you make a Club Attack with this weapon, if there is a group of 10+ Mobs around you, make a free Rank 5 Cone of Knockback Spell Attack in a 20ft Cone. On Success, the group is pushed or slid 10 feet (your choice). Cooldown: 5 minutes

ENCHANTED SPIKED KNEEPADS OF THE SHADE GNOLL RIOT FORCES

Gear Slot: Legs

These kneepads are self-adjusting slip-on knee braces covered in retractable, thin, needle-like spikes that seem to magically pop out when needed. When equipped, the kneepads offer the following benefits.

- Damage Reflection 8:1 (if you lose 8+ HB slots in a single blow, the Attacker loses 1 HB slot)
- Immunity to momentum-based Attacks (Rush, Trample, or Ramming Attacks)

ENCHANTED TIARA OF MANA GENITA

Gear Slot: Head

A crystal tiara fit for royalty, it has a similar style to the Crown of the Sepsis Whore.

- +3 Intelligence
- +2 Acute Ears Skill
- Removes automatic hostility from worshipers of Mana Genita

ENCHANTED TROLLSKIN SHIRT OF PUMMELING

Gear Slot: Torso

This short-sleeve shirt is cool to the touch. Stylin'!

- +7 Regeneration Skill
- Immunity to melee damage Debuffs

ENCHANTED WAR GAUNTLET OF THE EXALTED GRULL

Gear Slot: Hands/Holding

This bracer transforms into a spiked war gauntlet when the wearer clenches a fist.

- +3 Strength
- +1 Dexterity
- +2 Iron Punch Skill
- +1 Powerful Strike Skill
- On an Amazing Success with any Hand-to-Hand Attack you make, the target gains the Stunned Debuff
- On a Critical Hit with any hand-to-hand Attack you make against a worshiper of the god Grull, the target transforms into the deity

ENCHANTED WRESTLING BELT OF THE GREAT GORGO

Gear Slot: Accessory

This gold wrestling belt is typically a bit sweaty.

- +5% Strength
- +5% Constitution

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- The Avalanche Benefit: Use a Move Action, immediately followed by an Unarmed Combat Attack. On Success, deal ×2 the total damage. The GM can add more if the attacker is unnaturally dense. A crawler with the Monster Truck Driver Class applies this multiplier to their Area Line Attack instead.

PRISM INDUSTRIES CAPACITATING AND FOCUSING GOGGLES. SPECIAL FASHION EDITION. "THE PRINCESS DONUT."

Gear Slot: Head

This unique item was signed and gifted by Princess D'Nadia to Princess Donut.

- Immunity to the Blindness Debuff
- Enhances vision effects and can be calibrated to view various visible-light spectra, including heat
- You may cast Magic Missile twice with one Action, paying the mana as usual, and rolling to hit twice
- You may cast Magic Missile using two Actions and double the Mana, dealing ×2 damage

SEIZE THE DAY TOOTHPASTE

Cherry-flavored, it comes with a toothbrush and has 5 applications. The Buff lasts for 30 hours.

- ×3 damage to all Bosses or ×4 damage if they are Province or higher

STUFFED KIMARIS FIGURE

Created by Jaxbrin Amusements, Ltd., the Stuffed Kimaris Figure is a unique plushie similar to Earth's hottest collectible toy of the 1990s—Beanie Babies™.

Jaxbrin's bean bag toys vary in rarity from unique, 1-of-1 items down to can't-enter-a-waystation-without-seeing-one common. They all function the same way. Pulling the tag (cheerfully decorated with a smiley-faced star) acts like a grenade. The bean bag will come to life by summoning the corresponding creature as a minion, and (usually) they will fight for you without needing to command them. Use the Mob vs. Mob rules (p. 83), with the figure matching your own level.

Their duration is directly tied to their rarity. Common versions of this toy will last for a quarter to half a minute (1d2+1 rounds in combat). Legendary rarity, such as the 1 of 5 Sage Sprite Lecturer, will last for several hours. Once timed out, if the toy is still alive, it will return to its collectible form, tag detached, and the summoning spell cannot be repeated.

The Kimaris toy depicts an armored man scowling while astride a black horse. Nothing more is known about the inspiration behind this plushie.

RING OF WATER BREATHING

Gear Slot: Accessory

Feel your lungs fill with water, but you don't die. You can still breathe on land, too. That makes you an amphibian. Did you know that all amphibians swallow their prey whole? That's such an interesting fact.

- −1 Charisma
- Wearer can breathe underwater

SCRATCH OFF TICKETS

These handy items are excellent ways to add chaos and calamity to any combat fight.

FIREBALL OR CUSTARD? SCRATCHER

A lottery-style ticket with 5 scratch-off spots. Each one has a 50/50 chance to cast a level 15 Fireball spell or launch a beach ball–sized sphere of delicious, healing custard onto the user's target. 30-minute cooldown.

DUNGEON GOLD RUSH SCRATCHER

This ticket has 6 scratch-off prize slots and two dozen possible outcomes, including Mob drops of 5,000 coins, damage against the Mob is doubled, the Mob splits in two, and the Mob is invulnerable for 30 seconds. One-hour cooldown.

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APPENDIX 2: THE ROYAL COURT OF PRINCESS DONUT AND OTHERS

Carl, Princess Donut, and some others have clearly defined Stats and Skills in the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** series. The following stats for Carl, Donut, Mongo, and Katia attempt to adhere closely to those, with minor adjustments and clarifications for gameplay.

For the friends (and rivals) of the Royal Court of Princess Donut, their Stats are much more speculative. Use them as inspiration or build these crawlers in different ways.

Either way, you can use the use these crawlers (and Mongo) as the basis of ready-to-play characters or as crawlers for the Game Master to portray.

CARL

Now that Carl has reached the Third Floor and chosen the Primal Race and the Compensated Anarchist Class, a wide breadth of options has opened to him. Hellbent on not only surviving but also breaking the system as much as possible, Carl is only held back by his tendency to get pulled into everyone else's problems (including Quests).

With a greater understanding of the World Dungeon, especially the Over City as the introduction to the Scolopendra storyline, Carl is determined to level up and fight off anything and everything that comes her way.

OVER CITY CARL

Carl. Primal. Compensated Anarchist.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
13	12+F	14+F	20+S	1
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
16 (+4)	5 (+2)	19 (+4)	11 (+4)	25 (+5)

Key Skills: Foot Soldier 6, Iron Punch 7, Powerful Strike 9, Pugilism 10, Smush 9

Key Items: Enchanted BigBoi Boxers, Enchanted Nightgaunt Cloak of Stoutness, Enchanted Spiked Kneepads of the Shade Gnoll Riot Forces, Enchanted Toe Ring of the Splatter Skunk, Enchanted Trollskin Shirt of Pummeling, Enchanted War Gauntlet of the Exalted Grull

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Fresh off the climactic (and abrupt) ending of the Third Floor, Carl and team have found themselves in a train-themed maze. With new powers, weapons, and significantly leveled up, Carl is better-equipped to face the travails, mysteries, and complexities of the Iron Tangle.

IRON TANGLE CARL

Carl. Primal. Compensated Anarchist.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
27	14+F	15+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
43 (+5)	15 (+4)	34 (+5)	23 (+5)	25 (+5)

Key Skills: Foot Soldier 6, Iron Punch 8, Powerful Strike 9, Pugilism 10, Smush 9

Key Items: Enchanted BigBoi Boxers, Enchanted Spiked Kneepads of the Shade Gnoll Riot Forces, Enchanted Nightgaunt Cloak of Stoutness, Enchanted Toe Ring of the Splatter Skunk, Enchanted Trollskin Shirt of Pummeling, Enchanted War Gauntlet of the Exalted Grull, Ring of Constitution

With the mess of the Iron Tangle behind him, Carl faces a new challenge: dealing with inept and lagging crawlers assigned to his Bubble. Tackling the four Quadrants to pop their Bubble will require new ingenuity and creativity, and Carl's leadership skills will be pushed to new extremes.

BUBBLES CARL

Carl. Primal. Compensated Anarchist.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
41	14+F	15+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
73 (+5)	17 (+4)	34 (+4)	32 (+4)	25 (+5)

Key Skills: Cesta Punta 3, Chopper Pilot 7, Explosives Handling 11, Foot Soldier 6, Incendiary Device Handling 9, Iron Punch 8, Powerful Strike 12, Pugilism 10, Regeneration 7, Smush 9

Key Items: Carl's Xistera, Earth Upgrade Patch, Enchanted Anarchist's Battle Rattle, Enchanted BigBoi Boxers, Enchanted Night Wyrm's Ring of Divine Suffering , Enchanted Spiked Kneepads of the Shade Gnoll Riot Forces, Enchanted Trollskin Shirt of Pummeling, Enchanted Toe Ring of the Splatter Skunk, Enchanted War Gauntlet of the Exalted Grull, Ring of Constitution

DONUT

Choosing the Race of Cat was Princess Donut's easiest decision since she entered the World Dungeon. Selecting her Class is a different task altogether, but despite a variety of good choices, she settles on the Former Child Actor Class, which lands Mordecai as her Manager. Despite Mordecai not being happy about it, the deal is sealed, and Donut is well on her way to topping the leaderboard charts.

With a host of new Skills, Spells, and tools, Donut is primed to show the galaxy why she truly deserves her title of "Best in Dungeon."

OVER CITY DONUT

Donut. Cat. Former Child Actor (Artist Alley Mogul).

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
13	15+F	15+F	20+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	29 (+5)	6 (+3)	21 (+5)	70 (+6)

Key Skills: Cockroach 2, Good First Impression 6, Light on Your Feet 8, Magic Missile 9, Slice Attack 7, Second Chance Spell 5

Key Items: Bracelet of Dexterity, Enchanted Anklet of the Fallen Oak , Enchanted Crown of the Sepsis Whore, Enchanted Fae Quadruped Crupper of the Fleet, Enchanted Fur Brush of the Ecclesiastic, Talisman of the Slate Butterfly

In the aftermath of their frantic escape from the Third Floor, Donut revels in the bounty of her loot boxes from their escapades in the Over City and a brand new Class selection thanks to her Former Child Actor Class. With her ever-rising Charisma (which she wields every chance she gets), Donut is more poised than ever to influence the trajectory of the Crawl.

IRON TANGLE DONUT

Donut. Cat. Former Child Actor (Football Hooligan).

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
26	15+F	14+F	20+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
33 (+5)	40 (+5)	17 (+4)	17 (+4)	94 (+6)

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Key Skills: Clockwork Triplicate Spell 1, Cockroach 5, Magic Missile Spell 10, Puddle Jumper Spell 5, Slice Attack 7, Second Chance Spell 5

Key Items: Bracelet of Dexterity, Enchanted Anklet of the Fallen Oak, Enchanted Fae Quadruped Crupper of the Fleet, Enchanted Fur Brush of the Ecclesiastic, Enchanted Tiara of Mana Genita, Talisman of the Slate Butterfly, *Prism Industries Capacitating and Focusing Goggles. Special High-Fashion Edition. "The Princess Donut"*

The Fifth Floor has pulled Donut even deeper into her role as the Crawl's most popular icon, cementing her place in the hearts and minds of viewers across the known universe. Facing her most difficult challenge yet, she takes on the mysteries of each of the four Quadrants in her Bubble with gusto, eager to make a lasting impact that will see her land at the top of the dungeon leaderboard.

BUBBLES DONUT

Donut. Cat. Former Child Actor (Glass Cannon).

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
40	15+F	14+F	20+S	0
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
47 (+5)	54 (+6)	9 (+3)	17 (+4)	108 (+7)

Key Skills: Astral Paw Spell 1, Clockwork Triplicate Spell 3, Cockroach 5, Magic Missile Spell 11, Puddle Jumper Spell 5, Slice Attack 7, Second Chance Spell 5

Key Items: Bracelet of Dexterity, Enchanted Anklet of the Fallen Oak, Enchanted Fae Quadruped Crupper of the Fleet, Enchanted Fur Brush of the Ecclesiastic, Enchanted Tiara of Mana Genita, Talisman of the Slate Butterfly, Prism *Industries Capacitating and Focusing Goggles. Special High-Fashion Edition. "The Princess Donut"*

MONGO

Mongo was found and claimed by Princess Donut in a pet reward room on the Second Floor. She fell in love with the chicken-like baby dinosaur's so-ugly-he's-cute appearance (like Labubus or a celebrity's crusty white dog). After training this food-motivated menace, he has grown into a fearsome apex predator and loyal Royal Steed.

OVER CITY MONGO

Mongo. Mongoliensis. Pet.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
1	11+F	11+F	20+S	1
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
2 (+1)	1 (+1)	2 (+1)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)

Key Skills: Back Claw F, Bite F

Key Items: None

BUBBLES MONGO

Mongo. Mongoliensis. Pet.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
26	11+F	15+F	25+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
25 (+5)	1 (+1)	36 (+5)	20 (+5)	11 (+3)

Key Skills: Back Claw F, Bite F

Key Benefits: Earthquake

Key Items: Enchanted Fang Caps of the Expectorating, Tizheruk Enchanted Mongoliensis Saddle

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KATIA

OVER CITY/IRON TANGLE KATIA

When Carl and Donut first meet Katia, she's been isolated from her party and behind in leveling. They plan on grinding to help her gain some levels, but don't have a chance as they're forced to go down to the Fourth Floor earlier than expected.

Katia. Doppelganger. Monster Truck Driver.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
9	13+F	15+F	20+S	6
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
11 (+4)	8(+3)	51 (+6)	30 (+5)	8 (+3)

Key Skills: Axe 10, Driving 10, Gear Head 3, Noggin Nocker 3, Pathfinder 3

Key Items: Enchanted Leather Jerkin, Enchanted Ring of Constitution +15

BUBBLES KATIA

Katia. Doppelganger. Monster Truck Driver.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
41	13+F	15+F	20+S	8
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
51 (+6)	8 (+3)	51 (+6)	34 (+5)	12 (+4)

Key Skills: Axe 12, Catcher 5, Gear Head 6, Noggin Nocker 6, Wrasslin' 8

Key Items: Enchanted Leather Jerkin, Enchanted Repeating Crossbow of the Scavenger Mother of Mothers, Enchanted Ring of Constitution +15, Enchanted Shade Gnoll Riot Forces Crowd Control Shield, Enchanted Wrestling Belt of the Great Gorgo, Left Fang of the Green Sultan

BRANDON

Brandon and the rest of team Meadow Lark don't meet up with Carl and Donut on the Third Floor, but they do keep in contact. Brandon made what he thought would be safe, reliable choices to protect his brother and the rest of the team.

OVER CITY BRANDON

Brandon. Human. Boring Ol' Fighter.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	14+F	13+F	20+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
39 (+5)	10(+4)	19 (+4)	8 (+3)	8 (+3)

Key Skills: Boomerang 6, Catcher 7, Engineering 6, Lightning Maul (Warhammer) 10, Repair 4

Key Items: Enchanted Cape of the Gnomex, Lightning Maul, Power Ring of Smashing, Utility Belt of the Cheerful Contractor

CHRIS

Quiet. Stoic. Kind. These are all words one could use to describe Chris before Race selection on the Third Floor, which left him aggressive and emotionally distant from the other members of the Meadow Lark crew... even from his own brother, Brandon.

OVER CITY CHRIS

Chris. Igneous. Zulu Warrior.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	13+F	14+F	20+S	5
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
21 (+5)	9 (+3)	30 (+5)	12 (+4)	1 (+1)

Key Skills: Attack of Opportunity 2, Dodge 2, Ambush 3, Spear 10, Shuriken 5, Geocaching[☸] 3

Key Items: Enchanted Shuriken of Bloodlust (12), Headcap of Smarting, Spear of Density, Belt of the Swole Troglodyte

IMANI

Before the collapse, Imani worked as a caregiver at the Meadow Lark Elder Facility, entering the dungeon with a group of patients and other staff members. Upon Race and Class selection, Imani transforms from a terrified 20-year-old human into a beautiful, if not a little scary, Obsidian Butterfly. Yay! Symbolism!

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OVER CITY IMANI

Imani. Obsidian Butterfly. Fire Spiritualist.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
11	14+F	14+F+1d4	20+S	1
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
6 (+3)	12 (+4)	6 (+3)	12 (+4)	12 (+4)

Key Skills: Dodge 3, First Aid 6, Heal Others Spell 2, Holy Aura Spell 5, Longsword 8

Key Items: Cloak of Some Hope, Golden Ring of Strength, Longsword of the Velvet Executioner

ELLE

Elle, along with many of the Meadow Lark residents, was unable to contribute on the first two Floors of the dungeon, but with Race and Class selection, she regained her mental and physical faculties. Almost every elderly Meadow Lark resident received a Platinum Pacifist's Box for taking no violent action on the Tutorial Floors. She's very weak at the start of the Third Floor but rapidly gains levels.

OVER CITY ELLE

Elle. Frost Maiden. Blizzardmancer.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	14+F	13+F	20+S	1
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
2 (+1)	12 (+4)	3 (+2)	9 (+3)	8 (+3)

Key Skills: Aiming 5, Dodge 3, Double Tap 2, Frost Scar Spell 10, Ice Blast Spell 7, Shield 5

Key Items: +1 DR Corset, Gold Standard Healing Potion

IRON TANGLE ELLE

Elle. Frost Maiden. Blizzardmancer.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
13	15+F	13+F	20+S	2
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
5 (+2)	22 (+5)	6 (+3)	13 (+4)	12 (+4)

Key Skills: Aiming 5, Dodge 5, Double Tap 2, Frost Scar Spell 10, Ice Blast Spell 10, Shield 8

Key Items: +1 DR Corset, +1 DR Ballet Slippers, Gold Standard Healing Potion

BAUTISTA

Muscular, shirtless, and covered in orange fur. What more could you want? Daniel Bautista chose the Tigran race upon reaching the Third Floor, which promptly transformed him into a cartoonish tiger-man that would fit in any number of '80s or '90s cartoons. His reliance on the Stuffed Figures has left him a little lackluster in the leveling department, but quite popular with his sponsor, Jaxbrin Amusements, Limited.

OVER CITY BAUTISTA

Bautista. Tigran. Swashbuckler.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	13+F	15+F	30+S	4
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
13 (+4)	6 (+3)	7 (+3)	27 (+5)	4 (+2)

Key Skills: Ambush 6, Cat-Like Reflexes 2, Dodge 4, Rapier 10, Unarmed Combat 7

Key Items: Potion Overload Rapier, Enchanted Bandana

FLORIN

At last! Someone who had the decency to enter the dungeon armed to the teeth! Florin's life before the collapse is a bit of a mystery, claiming to have been "private security," whatever that means. After selecting Crocodilian and Shotgun Messenger as his race and class on the third floor, and jumping onto the top ten list, it becomes clear that no one's gonna turn him into a pair of boots anytime soon.

OVER CITY FLORIN

Florin. Crocodilian. Shotgun Messenger.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	13+F	15+F	20+S	6
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
16 (+4)	6 (+3)	12 (+4)	26 (+5)	1 (+1)

Key Skills: Aiming 4, Handgun 10. Shotgun 10, Pugilism 2, Powerful Strike 2, Scrapbooking 3

Key Items: Skin-Slougher 5000 Shotgun, Enchanted Waistcoat

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IFECHI

Formerly a Red Cross medic, Ifechi entered the dungeon with Le Mouvement, a large paramilitary group that perished during a tragic City Boss fight, leaving Ifechi alone. Not for long, though! Ifechi and Florin teamed up, were thrust apart, then reunited shortly after race and class selection on the third floor, both choosing attributes that complemented one another in battle. What a great pair! It would be a shame if something...happened to them...

OVER CITY IFECHI

Ifechi. Human. Physicker.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	15+F	13+F	20+S	1
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
5 (+2)	27 (+5)	15 (+4)	8 (+3)	8 (+3)

Key Skills: First Aid 9, Heal Others Spell 5, Herding Staff 3, Nature's Breath Spell 3, Vine Porn Spell 10

Key Items: Enchanted Magic-User's Staff (+10 to Mana), Gold Standard Healing Potion

HEKLA

After abandoning her husband in the dungeon, Hekla forged ahead on her own, only to become the dazzlingly heroic leader of Brynhild's Daughters, gracing the top ten list and often appearing on recap episodes. Her choice to become an Amazonian Shieldmaiden on the Third Floor really enforced the whole sexy-Nordic-warrior-woman thing she had going on.

OVER CITY HEKLA

Hekla. Amazonian. Shield Maiden.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	12+F	14+F	20+S	6
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
20 (+5)	4 (+2)	13 (+4)	17 (+4)	9 (+3)

Key Skills: Crossbow 8, Dagger 5, Pugilism 2, Shield Block 6, Unarmed Combat 6, Yodeling[✺] 3

Key Items: Enchanted Repeating Crossbow of the Scavenger Mother of Mothers, Friendship Bracelet of Fairykind , Glittering Breastplate of Nordic Persona

MIRIAM DOM

Miriam Dom is a middle-aged, Italian crawler with a big heart. A heart so big, in fact, she thought it was a good idea to enter the dungeon with a whole herd of goats. What could go wrong? After taking the Shepherd class, she fed three of her goats enhanced pet biscuits. Prepotente became a Caprid, Bianca became a Hellspawn Familiar, and Angelo...well... let's just say Angelo's transformation didn't go so well, which resulted in the death of several of her goats.

OVER CITY MIRIAM DOM

Miriam Dom. Human. Shepherd.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	15+F	12+F	20+S	1
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
8 (+3)	26 (+5)	14 (+4)	5 (+2)	10 (+4)

Key Skills: Conlanging[✺] 3, Drain Life Spell 5, Herding Staff 6, Hole Spell 2, Nature's Breath Spell 5

Key Items: Enchanted Bonnet

PREPOTENTE

One minute you're a Boer goat being led into a dungeon by a sweet Italian lady, the next you're a walking, talking, goat-man menace! At least, that's how it was for Prepotente (or Pony if you're chill like that). After consuming an Enhanced Pet Biscuit on the third floor, Prepotente became a hyper-intelligent, hyper-sensitive Caprid and selected the Forsaken Aerialist class.

OVER CITY PREPOTENTE

Prepotente. Caprid. Forsaken Aerialist.

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	15+F	13+F	20+S	3
Str	**Int**	**Con**	**Dex**	**Cha**
4 (+2)	30 (+5)	10 (+4)	6 (+3)	4 (+2)

Key Skills: Dirt Clod Spell 10, Drain Life Spell 5, Soul Collector Spell 3, Shield Spell 6

Key Items: Enchanted Coat

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APPENDIX 3: ACHIEVEMENTS

Achievements are those cute little pop-ups given to crawlers who have completed some task the AI deems worthy of calling out. This ranges from entering the dungeon to, you know, killing a god. For most Game Masters, this is a great opportunity to call out fun gameplay moments and give out some sick loot. Some groups may prefer to share the job (the fun?) of making achievements. Each Neighborhood and Quest in Chapters 7, 8, and 9 has its own section with a few sample achievements. This section breaks down how to create your own achievements, provides examples, and offers guidance on when and how to use them.

MAKING YOUR OWN ACHIEVEMENTS

Achievements typically use a standard format. Stick with it most of the time. Break it for a specific purpose.

Name: Name the achievement. It usually related so something the crawler did in the dungeon.

Description: The first sentence explains what warrants the achievement. The last sentence is a quip or punchline related to the title. Short achievements don't have anything between those two, but you can sneak in a huge infodump as needed.

Reward: A crawler usually receives a loot box of a given rarity at the GM's discretion, typically based on how hard the achievement was to obtain. The type of box can be something generic like "Adventurer's Box" or "Crafter's Box" (see *Loot Boxes,* p. 21 for more). Or if you're feeling creative, it can be something fun and unique, like a Gold "I'm Wet" Box or the Silver "Here's-Some-Good-Shit-Because-You're-Gonna-Need-It" Box.

In the **Dungeon Crawler Carl** series, some achievements are given by the AI to troll the crawlers. These achievements have no rewards attached and should be used sparingly in gameplay unless the players love them. Keep in mind that it's good sportsmanship not to mock the player, only the character, and even that can get old quickly.

Contents: For the **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game**, we add a "contents" line to help GMs. The contents of the box often, but don't always, relate to the achievement or situation that triggered it. You may not need to write this line down explicitly; most players only need to know what type of box they've got till they open it. See *Loot* (p. 215) for information on creating loot and filling the boxes.

NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

MARTHA STEWART!

You used a workbench to craft for the first time. The next thing you know, you'll be fashioning bottle cap earrings, drinking oat milk, and selling your ugly crap on Etsy while you wax poetic on Instagram about your "journey."

REWARD?:

You've received a Bronze Crafter's Box!
Contents—A pair of pliers, a standard tape measure, and a bucket of pink glitter

NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

MILQUETOAST!

You somehow managed to win an important Boss Battle without actually killing the Boss. That's like paying money to a prostitute just so she'll cuddle with you.

REWARD?:

You received a Silver Pacifist's Box.
Contents—Two Potions of Bloodlust

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NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

YELLOW-BELLIED CHICKENSHIT!

You initiated a Boss Battle, and it somehow ended with neither of you dead. What a disappointment you are. What a goddamned smear.

REWARD?:

Pussies don't get prizes.
Contents—None.

NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

I WAS IN THE POOL!

You spent more than 60 seconds fully submerged underwater, and you didn't die! Parts of you may have experienced shrinkage, but otherwise you're okay. You're now an honorary mudskipper!

REWARD?:

You've received a Bronze I'm Wet Box!
Contents—Ten Scrolls of Water Breathing

If you're creating achievements as a player, the GM will probably either choose the reward and contents themselves or work with you to design them.

WHO GIVES ACHIEVEMENTS OUT?

It may make sense for only the GM to award achievements, but there's no reason the responsibility has to fall on the GM alone. Everyone could get in on the action, creating one achievement each time you play. Maybe just one industrious player takes on the role of achievement-crafter to help out the GM. This could be discussed during session zero (p. 246). Experiment a few different ways to see what everyone likes.

WHEN AND HOW TO AWARD ACHIEVEMENTS

There are many ways to hand out achievements at the table.

- **After Session:** When you break after a session or wrap for the day, have each player write an achievement down for one other player. It could be a free-for-all or ask everyone to do one for the player on their right (then swap seating orders or right vs left vs. across each session).
- **During Downtime**: Same as After Session, but it becomes "homework" during the days between sessions. This is great because it lets the GM prep Rewards and craft custom loot.
- **Start of Session**: Whether written down at the end of a session or during downtime, it may be fruitful to award achievements at the start of each session. It serves as a recap of what happened previously.
- **In the Thick of it:** Interrupt play to award a particularly good one.

HOW OFTEN?

While Carl is seemingly bombarded with achievements the moment he enters the dungeon, you may be more inclined to limit interruptions when in the thick of the action. Feel free to limit achievements to one per player every 2-hour session, once per gathering, or give them out next time your crawler hits a saferoom (yay, new toys!)

RECORDING ACHIEVEMENTS

As an individual or as a group, you may want to record your achievements. You can do this on basic note cards, in a shared online doc, or in a specifically prepared character journal. When it's all said and done, you may enjoy going back through all the achievements the crawlers have earned.

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